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SSC English
Topic-wise Question Book

Tier-2 / Mains Previous Year Questions
CGL · CHSL · CPO

3160 questions · 13 topics · with answers & explanations

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1. Synonyms

65 questions

Q.1 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
MOTIVE

(a) utility **(b)** reason
(c) chance **(d)** benefit

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) reason
Type: Synonym
MOTIVE – the reason for doing something (उद्देश्य/कारण).
Meanings
• **reason** – cause/ground (कारण) → **synonym**. ✓
• **utility / chance / benefit** – different ideas.

Q.2 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
RELUCTANT

(a) pleased **(b)** unwilling
(c) steady **(d)** afraid

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) unwilling
Type: Synonym
RELUCTANT – unwilling or hesitant to do something (अनिच्छुक).
Meanings
• **unwilling** – not wanting to (अनिच्छुक) → **synonym**. ✓
• **pleased / steady / afraid** – different meanings.

Q.3 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
ESTIMATE

(a) discover **(b)** solve
(c) assess **(d)** believe

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) assess
Type: Synonym
ESTIMATE – to judge the size/value of something (आकलन करना).
Meanings
• **discover / solve / believe** – different actions.
• **assess** – to evaluate/judge (मूल्यांकन करना) → **synonym**. ✓

Q.4 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
EFFICIENCY

(a) Disability **(b)** Capability
(c) Fluency **(d)** Tendency

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Capability
Type: Synonym
EFFICIENCY – the quality of doing something well with little waste; capability (कार्यकुशलता).
Meanings
• **Capability** – ability to do something well (सामर्थ्य) → **synonym**. ✓
• **Disability / Fluency / Tendency** – different meanings.

Q.5 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
RAMIFICATION

(a) Satisfaction **(b)** Consequence
(c) Inception **(d)** Source

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Consequence
Type: Synonym
RAMIFICATION – a result or consequence (esp. an unwelcome one) (परिणाम).
Meanings
• **Consequence** – a result (परिणाम) → **synonym**. ✓
• **Satisfaction / Inception (beginning) / Source** – different meanings.

Q.6 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
REVIVE

(a) Depress **(b)** Review
(c) Damage **(d)** Restore

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Restore
Type: Synonym
REVIVE – to bring back to life/strength; to restore (पुनर्जीवित करना).
Meanings
• **Restore** – to bring back (बहाल करना) → **synonym**. ✓
• **Depress / Review / Damage** – different meanings.

Q.7 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
ACCURATELY

(a) Partially **(b)** Correctly
(c) Promptly **(d)** Moderately

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Correctly
Type: Synonym
ACCURATELY – exactly, without error (सटीक रूप से).
Meanings
• **Correctly** – without mistakes (सही ढंग से) → **synonym**. ✓
• **Partially / Promptly / Moderately** – different meanings.

Q.8 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
ASTONISHMENT

(a) Composure **(b)** Wonder
(c) Fright **(d)** Expectation

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Wonder
Type: Synonym
ASTONISHMENT – great surprise; wonder (आश्चर्य).
Meanings
• **Wonder** – amazement (विस्मय) → **synonym**. ✓
• **Composure / Fright / Expectation** – different feelings.

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Q.9 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
CONDESCENDING

(a) Stimulating **(b)** Creating
(c) Accusing **(d)** Patronising

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Patronising
Type: Synonym
CONDESCENDING – behaving as if superior to others (श्रेष्ठता जताने वाला).
Meanings
• **Patronising** – treating others as inferior → **synonym**. ✓
• **Stimulating / Creating / Accusing** – different meanings.

Q.10 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Penalise

(a) Punish **(b)** Pretend
(c) Praise **(d)** Protect

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Punish
Type: Synonym
PENALISE – to punish (दंड देना).
Meanings
• **Punish** → **synonym** ✓. **Pretend / praise / protect** – unrelated.

Q.11 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Judicious

(a) Beautiful **(b)** Thoughtful
(c) Plentiful **(d)** Graceful

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Thoughtful
Type: Synonym
JUDICIOUS – showing good sense/careful judgement (विवेकपूर्ण).
Meanings
• **Thoughtful** → **synonym** ✓. **Beautiful / plentiful / graceful** – unrelated (chosen only for the "-ful" rhyme).

Q.12 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Sequestered

(a) Frequented **(b)** Polished
(c) Decorated **(d)** Secluded

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Secluded
Type: Synonym
SEQUESTERED – isolated, hidden away (एकांत में).
Meanings
• **Secluded** – private/isolated → **synonym**. ✓ **Frequented / polished / decorated** – unrelated.

Q.13 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
SENTIMENT

(a) Antipathy **(b)** Concrete
(c) Feeling **(d)** Hatred

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Feeling
Type: Synonym
SENTIMENT – an emotion or feeling (भावना).
Meanings
• **Feeling** – emotion (भावना) → **synonym**. ✓
• **Antipathy / Hatred** – dislike (opposite); **Concrete** – solid.

Q.14 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
FASTEN

(a) Release **(b)** Loosen
(c) Affix **(d)** Detach

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Affix
Type: Synonym
FASTEN – to attach/fix firmly (बाँधना/जोड़ना).
Meanings
• **Affix** – to attach/stick on (जोड़ना) → **synonym**. ✓
• **Release / Loosen / Detach** – opposites.

Q.15 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
INEVITABLY

(a) Certainly **(b)** Unlikely
(c) Avoidably **(d)** Distantly

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Certainly
Type: Synonym
INEVITABLY – unavoidably; surely (निश्चित रूप से).
Meanings
• **Certainly** – surely (निश्चित रूप से) → **synonym**. ✓
• **Unlikely / Avoidably / Distantly** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.16 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
abandon

(a) start **(b)** leave
(c) adopt **(d)** allow

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) leave
Type: Synonym
ABANDON – to give up / leave completely (छोड़ देना).
Meanings
• **leave** – to go away from / desert (छोड़ना) → **synonym**. ✓
• **start / adopt / allow** – opposite or unrelated.

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Q.17 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
INCUMBENT

(a) Prophet **(b)** Adventurer
(c) Contestant **(d)** Occupant

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Occupant
Type: Synonym
INCUMBENT – the current holder of an office/position (पदधारी).
Meanings
• **Occupant** – one who holds/occupies a position or place (धारक) → **synonym**. ✓
• **Prophet / Adventurer / Contestant** – different meanings.

Q.18 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
fictitious

(a) imaginary **(b)** genuine
(c) factual **(d)** confirmed

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) imaginary
Type: Synonym
FICTITIOUS – not real; invented (काल्पनिक).
Meanings
• **imaginary** – existing only in the mind (काल्पनिक) → **synonym**. ✓
• **genuine / factual / confirmed** – opposites (real/true).

Q.19 Replace the underlined word with its synonym to make the sentence more meaningful.
Narcotic drug addiction is in <u>vogue</u> these days, as it is the most popular form of substance abuse.

(a) demand **(b)** standard
(c) fashion **(d)** obscurity

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) fashion
Vogue – something that is popular nowadays.Demand – need for a particular thing.Obscurity – the state of being unknown or inconspicuous.Standard – a level of quality or achievement that is accepted as normal.Fashion is the most appropriate word.

Q.20 Select the most appropriate synonym of the word given in brackets to fill in the blank.The doctor has _____ (advised) medicine for the treatment of the disease.

(a) proscribed **(b)** presented
(c) prescribed **(d)** prevented

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) prescribed
Proscribe – to forbid or prohibit something.
Present – to show or offer something
Prevent – to stop something from happening.
Prescribe – to recommend a medicine or treatment.
Out of the given words only prescribe is synonymous to advised. So, option 'c' is correct.

Q.21 Identify the pair of synonyms from the underlined words in the given sentence.It was a <u>fairly foul day</u>, as <u>omens</u> could be seen in <u>abundance</u> from the <u>threshold</u> of his <u>border</u> town ever since the <u>dawn</u> struck.

(a) day, border **(b)** threshold, dawn
(c) foul, omens **(d)** fairly, abundance

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) threshold, dawn
option (a) – day – a period of 24 hrs border – the edge or boundary
option (b) – threshold – entrance or starting point of something
Dawn – beginning of a new day or the first light of daybreak.
option (c) – foul – unpleasant, dirty, or morally offensive
Omen – sign or predictions of something that will happen in the future.
option (d) – fairly – to some extent or in a moderate way.
Abundance – a large quantity of something,
Out of the given options only threshold and dawn are synonymous. So, option 'b' is correct.

Q.22 Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word.Bullying is a rather <u>unacknowledged</u> social evil.

(a) Unidentified **(b)** Notable
(c) Named **(d)** Infamous

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Unidentified
Unacknowledged – not recognized.
Unidentified – not recognized or named.
Notable – significant.
Infamous – well-known for a bad reputation.
Named – to be known by a specific name.
So, the synonym of unacknowledged is unidentified.

Q.23 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined word in a sentence.Even though James won the election, he has not brought any of his campaign promises to <u>fruition</u>.

(a) concealment **(b)** disappointment
(c) nourishment **(d)** accomplishment

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) accomplishment
Fruition – the realization of a target.
Accomplishment – successful achievement of a target
Concealment – hide something
Nourishment – related to nutrition
Disappointment – the state of being unhappy.

Q.24 Read the given sentence carefully and fill in the blank by selecting the correct synonym of the word given in the brackets.
The authority refused to pay any heed to the _____ demands made by the workers. (Trivial)

(a) insignificant **(b)** idiotic
(c) majestic **(d)** conceited

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) insignificant
The correct answer is option (a).

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Explanation (contd.)
The meaning of **trivial** is **"of little value or importance"**
Insignificant: too small or unimportant to be worth consideration.
Idiotic: very stupid
Majestic: having or showing impressive beauty or scale.
Conceited: excessively proud of oneself, vain
Hence, option (a) **"insignificant"** is correct answer.

Q.25 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined word.
He walked leisurely towards the entrance.

(a) with a kickstart **(b)** hastily
(c) without haste **(d)** reassuringly

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) without haste
"Leisurely" refers to doing something in a relaxed and unhurried manner, without rushing. So, "He walked leisurely towards the entrance" means he walked slowly and without any rush.
The most appropriate meaning of the underlined word **"leisurely"** is:
without haste
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.26 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Charisma

(a) Reputation **(b)** Atmosphere
(c) Charm **(d)** Influence

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Charm
The most appropriate synonym for the word **"Charisma"** is **"Charm"**.
Charisma refers to a special magnetic charm or appeal that a person possesses, often making them attractive or compelling to others.
Charm is the most fitting synonym as it directly refers to an ability to attract or influence others through personal appeal, which aligns with the meaning of charisma.
The other options are:
Reputation refers to the beliefs or opinions that are held about someone or something, but it doesn't capture the personal, magnetic quality of charisma.
Atmosphere refers to the mood, tone, or environment of a place, which is unrelated to charisma.
Influence refers to the ability to have an effect on others, but it is broader and doesn't specifically capture the personal allure or charm implied by charisma.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.27 Choose the appropriate synonym of the given word.
Erroneous

(a) Vital **(b)** Right
(c) Fallacious **(d)** Accurate

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Fallacious
Meaning: **erroneous** = wrong, containing a mistake *(गलत, त्रुटिपूर्ण)*.
fallacious = based on a mistaken idea, false *(भ्रामक, असत्य)* — the same sense.

Explanation (contd.)
an erroneous belief = a fallacious belief.
Answer: **Fallacious**
Why the others are wrong.
• **vital** = absolutely necessary *(अत्यंत आवश्यक)* — unrelated.
• **right** = correct *(सही)* — the opposite.
• **accurate** = exact, free from error *(सटीक, शुद्ध)* — the opposite.
Two options here are antonyms — in a synonym item, strike out the opposites first.

Q.28 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Flout

(a) Rash **(b)** Defy
(c) Rude **(d)** Poke

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Defy
option (b) is the correct answer.
- Flout: to refuse to obey or accept something.
- Defy: to refuse to obey somebody/something.
- Rash: an area of small red spots that appear on your skin when you are ill or have a reaction to something.
- Rude: not polite.
- Poke: to push somebody/something with a finger, stick or other long, thin object.

Q.29 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Faithful

(a) Wavering **(b)** Devoted
(c) Untrustworthy **(d)** Fickle

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Devoted
option (b) is the correct answer.
- Faithful: always staying with and supporting a person, organization or belief.
- Devoted: always staying with and supporting a person, organization or belief.
- Wavering: to become weak or uncertain, especially when making a decision or choice.
- Untrustworthy: not able to be relied on as honest or truthful.
- Fickle: always changing your mind or your feelings so you cannot be trusted.

Hence, Devoted is the correct synonym of the given word Faithful.

Q.30 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
SOLID

(a) firm **(b)** flat
(c) hollow **(d)** vacant

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) firm
Type: Synonym
SOLID – hard and firm; not hollow (ठोस).
Meanings
• **firm** – hard, not soft/loose (दृढ़) → **synonym**. ✓
• **flat** – level; **hollow / vacant** – empty (opposites).

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Q.31 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Decadence

(a) Decline **(b)** Liberate
(c) Dispirited **(d)** Flowering

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Decline
The most appropriate synonym for the word "Decadence" is:
Decline
Decadence refers to a process of deterioration, decay, or moral decline, often characterized by excessive indulgence or luxury.

- **Decline:** This word aligns closely with the idea of deterioration or decrease, making it an appropriate synonym for decadence. It can be used to describe a weakening or falling away, which fits the context of decadence.
- **Liberate:** While "liberate" involves setting free, it does not capture the sense of decline or decay associated with decadence. It is more about freedom and release.
- **Dispirited:** This word means lacking in spirit or enthusiasm. While it conveys a negative state, it doesn't specifically capture the notion of decline or decadence.
- **Flowering:** This term refers to the process of producing flowers or blooming, which is unrelated to the decay or moral decline implied by decadence.

Q.32 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Serene

(a) Chaotic **(b)** Calm
(c) Agitated **(d)** Angry

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Calm
The most appropriate synonym for the given word "Serene" is **Calm**.

1. **Chaotic**: This adjective describes a state of complete disorder and confusion. It is the opposite of "serene."
2. **Calm**: This is the correct synonym for "serene." Both words convey a sense of tranquility, peace, and lack of disturbance.
3. **Agitated**: This adjective describes a state of nervousness or restlessness, usually characterized by heightened emotions. It is the opposite of "serene."
4. **Angry**: This adjective indicates a strong feeling of displeasure or hostility. It does not convey the same sense of calmness as "serene."

Q.33 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Dingy

(a) Pure **(b)** Sterile
(c) Bright **(d)** Dreary

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Dreary
Dingy means dirty, dull, or shabby, often implying a lack of light or cleanliness. **Dreary** refers to something bleak, dull, or depressing, which aligns well with the meaning of **dingy**.
Other options are:
Pure means clean and untainted.
Sterile means free from germs or bacteria.
Bright means full of light or vibrant.

Q.34 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Humble

(a) Modest **(b)** Amusing
(c) Beautiful **(d)** Keen

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Modest
The most appropriate synonym for the word "Humble" is:
Modest

1. **Humble:** Having or showing a modest or low estimate of one's own importance; unpretentious; not arrogant or prideful.
2. **Modest:** Having or showing a moderate or humble estimate of one's merits, importance, or value; not boastful or self-assertive.
3. **Amusing:** Providing entertainment or enjoyment; causing laughter or enjoyment.
4. **Beautiful:** Pleasing the senses or mind aesthetically; possessing qualities that give great pleasure or satisfaction to see, hear, think about, etc.
5. **Keen:** Sharp or penetrating in thought, perception, or feeling; having a sharp edge or point; having a strong or enthusiastic interest or desire.

In the given list, the synonym for "Humble" is "Modest."

Q.35 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Abolish

(a) Assist **(b)** Cancel
(c) Subside **(d)** Worship

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Cancel
Abolish means to formally put an end to something, such as a law, practice, or system.
Cancel means to annul or revoke something, which aligns with the meaning of **abolish**.
The meaning of other options are:
Assist means to help.
Subside means to lessen or decrease in intensity.
Worship means to show reverence or adoration.

Q.36 Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence.
Huxley was an <u>exponent</u> of Darwin's theory of evolution.

(a) Conclude **(b)** Terminate
(c) Cease **(d)** Proponent

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Proponent
Proponent means a person who supports or advocates for something, which is exactly what "exponent" means in this context. Huxley was a supporter or advocate of Darwin's theory of evolution.
Meanings of other options are:
Conclude means to bring something to an end.
Terminate means to end something.
Cease also means to stop something.

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Q.37 Select the most appropriate synonym of the word:
PROCLIVITY

(a) Aversion **(b)** Dislike
(c) Tendency **(d)** Indifference

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Tendency
Meaning: **proclivity** = a natural tendency or inclination to do something *(प्रवृत्ति, झुकाव)*.
Example: *He has a proclivity for exaggeration* — he tends to exaggerate.
Its synonym is **tendency** = an inclination to act in a particular way *(प्रवृत्ति, रुझान)*.
Answer: **(3) Tendency**
Why the others are wrong.
• **aversion** = strong dislike *(अरुचि, घृणा)* — the opposite of a leaning towards something.
• **dislike** = a feeling of not liking *(नापसंद)* — again the opposite direction.
• **indifference** = lack of interest or concern *(उदासीनता)* — no leaning either way, so not a tendency.
Pro-CLIV-ity: "leaning forward" (Latin clivus = slope) — you lean towards what you are prone to.

Q.38 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
MAGNIFY

(a) withdraw **(b)** shrink
(c) decrease **(d)** enlarge

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) enlarge
Type: Synonym
MAGNIFY – to make something look bigger (बड़ा करना).
Meanings
• **withdraw** – to take back; **shrink / decrease** – to make smaller (opposites).
• **enlarge** – to make bigger (विस्तार करना) → **synonym**. ✓

Q.39 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
APPLAUSE

(a) approval **(b)** condemnation
(c) attack **(d)** blame

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) approval
Type: Synonym
APPLAUSE – praise shown by clapping; approval (प्रशंसा, सराहना).
Meanings
• **approval** – favourable opinion/praise (स्वीकृति/सराहना) → **synonym**. ✓
• **condemnation / attack / blame** – all negative (opposites).

Q.40 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
CONTRADICT

(a) agree **(b)** advise
(c) shorten **(d)** refute

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) refute
Type: Synonym

Explanation (contd.)
CONTRADICT – to say the opposite / deny the truth of something (खंडन करना).
Meanings
• **agree** – to have the same opinion (सहमत होना) – opposite.
• **advise** – to give advice (सलाह देना).
• **shorten** – to make shorter (छोटा करना).
• **refute** – to prove wrong / deny (खंडन करना) → **synonym**. ✓

Q.41 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
AGGRAVATE

(a) illuminate **(b)** illustrate
(c) intensify **(d)** influence

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2019

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) intensify
Type: Synonym
AGGRAVATE – to make (a problem) worse (और बिगाड़ देना, गंभीर बनाना).
Meanings
• **illuminate** – to light up (प्रकाशित करना).
• **illustrate** – to explain with examples (उदाहरण देना).
• **intensify** – to make stronger/worse (तीव्र करना) → **synonym**. ✓
• **influence** – to affect (प्रभावित करना).

Q.42 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
DISGRACE

(a) disgust **(b)** discord
(c) dispute **(d)** dishonour

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) dishonour
Type: Synonym
DISGRACE – loss of respect / shame (अपमान, कलंक).
Meanings
• **disgust** – strong dislike (घृणा).
• **discord** – disagreement (मतभेद).
• **dispute** – argument (विवाद).
• **dishonour** – loss of honour, shame (अपमान) → **synonym**. ✓

Q.43 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
RESOLUTION

(a) apathy **(b)** flexibility
(c) timidity **(d)** decision

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) decision
Type: Synonym
RESOLUTION – a firm decision to do something (दृढ़ निश्चय, संकल्प).
Meanings of all options
• **apathy** – lack of interest (उदासीनता).
• **flexibility** – ability to bend/adjust (लचीलापन).
• **timidity** – shyness, lack of courage (डरपोकपन).
• **decision** – a firm choice (निर्णय) → **synonym**. ✓

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Q.44 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
DILEMMA

(a) solution **(b)** advantage
(c) quandary **(d)** success

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) quandary
Type: Synonym
DILEMMA – a difficult situation where one must choose between two options (दुविधा).
Meanings of all options
• **solution** – an answer (समाधान) – opposite idea.
• **advantage** – benefit (लाभ).
• **quandary** – a state of uncertainty/confusion (उलझन) → **synonym**. ✓
• **success** – achievement (सफलता).

Q.45 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
ENORMOUS

(a) common **(b)** tiny
(c) massive **(d)** ordinary

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) massive
Type: Synonym
ENORMOUS – extremely large in size or amount (विशाल, बहुत बड़ा).
Meanings of all options
• **common** – ordinary (साधारण).
• **tiny** – very small (बहुत छोटा) – opposite.
• **massive** – huge, very large (विशाल) → **synonym**. ✓
• **ordinary** – normal (सामान्य).

Q.46 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Panache

(a) Clumsy **(b)** Arrogant
(c) Flamboyance **(d)** Romance

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Flamboyance
Answer: 3 (**Flamboyance**)
- **Panache** means **distinctive and stylish elegance or flair**.

Meanings of the options:
- **Clumsy** – Awkward in movement or handling things; opposite of grace or flair.
- **Arrogant** – Having an exaggerated sense of one's own importance; unrelated.
- **Flamboyance** – **Showy confidence or stylishness; flair** – **correct synonym of panache**.
- **Romance** – A feeling of excitement associated with love; unrelated in this context.

So, **"Flamboyance"** is the most appropriate synonym of **"Panache."**

Q.47 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Peril

(a) Petal **(b)** Process
(c) Hazard **(d)** Permission

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Hazard
Answer: 3 (**Hazard**)
- **Petal** – A part of a flower; unrelated in meaning.
- **Process** – A series of steps taken to achieve something; not a synonym.
- **Hazard** – **A danger or risk**; **correct synonym of "peril"**.
- **Permission** – Consent to do something; unrelated.

Peril means **serious and immediate danger**, and the closest synonym is **"hazard."**

Q.48 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Adroit

(a) Sane **(b)** Clumsy
(c) Skilful **(d)** Despotic

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Skilful
Answer: Skilful
The word **"Adroit"** means *clever, skillful, or resourceful in handling situations or tasks*.
Let's check the meaning of each option:
1. **Sane** – *mentally sound or rational* → Not related to skill
2. **Clumsy** – *awkward, lacking skill* → Opposite of adroit
3. **Skilful** – *having or showing skill* → **Correct synonym**
4. **Despotic** – *tyrannical, oppressive* → Unrelated in meaning

So, the most appropriate **synonym** of **"Adroit"** is **Skilful**.

Q.49 Select the most appropriate synonym of the highlighted word.
This maxim has been used by many in the past.

(a) adverb **(b)** phoneme
(c) proverb **(d)** maximum

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) proverb
Answer: proverb
Let's examine the meaning of each option to determine the correct synonym of **"maxim"**:
- **Adverb** – A part of speech that modifies a verb, adjective, or another adverb (not a synonym).
- **Phoneme** – The smallest unit of sound in speech (not related in meaning).
- **Proverb** – A short, well-known **saying or maxim** that expresses a general truth or piece of advice (correct synonym).
- **Maximum** – Refers to the greatest quantity or degree possible (not a synonym; though similar in spelling, different in meaning).

Correct synonym of "maxim" is **proverb**, which is a wise or moralistic saying.

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Q.50 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Susceptible

(a) Sceptical **(b)** Immune
(c) Critical **(d)** Impressionable

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Impressionable
Answer: 4 (**Impressionable**)
- **Sceptical** – Doubtful or questioning; not easily convinced.
- **Immune** – Protected or resistant, especially to disease or influence.
- **Critical** – Judging severely or finding fault; also means crucial in some contexts.
- **Impressionable** – **Easily influenced or affected by others**; **Synonym of susceptible**.

Susceptible means **easily affected, influenced, or harmed by something**, and the closest synonym is **"Impressionable."**

Q.51 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Expiation

(a) Transformation **(b)** Atonement
(c) Expediency **(d)** Explanation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Atonement
The word **"Expiation"** means *the act of making amends or reparation for guilt or wrongdoing; atonement*.
Let's examine the meaning of each option:
1. **Transformation** – *a complete change in form or appearance* → Not related to atonement
2. **Atonement** – *making amends for a wrong or sin* → **Correct synonym**
3. **Expediency** – *convenience or self-interest over what is right* → Different meaning
4. **Explanation** – *clarification or justification of something* → Not related

So, the most appropriate **synonym** of **"Expiation"** is **Atonement**.

Q.52 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Bliss

(a) Oblivion **(b)** Joy
(c) Sorrow **(d)** Grief

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Joy
- The word **"Bliss"** refers to **extreme happiness or joy**.

Let's evaluate the options:
1. **Oblivion** – Means being unaware or unconscious, especially of what is happening. Not a synonym.
2. **Joy** – Means great happiness or delight. This is the correct synonym of "Bliss".
3. **Sorrow** – Means a feeling of deep distress caused by loss or disappointment. Opposite of Bliss.
4. **Grief** – Means intense sorrow, especially caused by someone's death. Also an antonym.

Q.53 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank with the synonym of the underlined word.
The designer came up with a <u>fascinating</u> idea. Even the professionals found it _____.

(a) captivating **(b)** irritating
(c) annoying **(d)** crafty

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) captivating
Answer: 1 (**captivating**)
- **Fascinating** means **extremely interesting or charming**.

Meanings of the options:
- **Captivating** – **Attracting and holding interest; charming** – **synonym of fascinating**.
- **Irritating** – Causing annoyance or discomfort; opposite in tone.
- **Annoying** – Causing irritation; negative emotion, not a synonym.
- **Crafty** – Clever in a deceitful or tricky way; not similar in meaning.

So, the correct synonym to fill the blank is **"captivating."**

Q.54 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Nominal

(a) Actual **(b)** Limited
(c) Fractional **(d)** Supposed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Supposed
Answer: 3 (**Fractional**)
Meanings of each option:
- **Actual:** Real; existing in fact.
- **Limited:** Restricted in extent, amount, or scope.
- **Fractional:** Small, minimal, insignificant (**correct synonym**).
- **Supposed:** Assumed or believed, but not necessarily true.

The word **"Nominal"** means **very small or insignificant in amount**. Thus, the most appropriate synonym is **"Fractional."**

Q.55 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Invincible

(a) Indomitable **(b)** Miserable
(c) Surmountable **(d)** Vulnerable

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Indomitable
Answer: 1 (**Indomitable**)
- **Indomitable** – **Unconquerable; impossible to defeat** – **correct synonym of "invincible"**.
- **Miserable** – Very unhappy or uncomfortable; unrelated in meaning.
- **Surmountable** – Able to be overcome; opposite in meaning.
- **Vulnerable** – Easily harmed or attacked; **opposite of invincible**.

Invincible means **too powerful to be defeated or overcome**, and the best synonym is **"Indomitable."**

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Q.56 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank as synonym for the underlined word.
The bitterness he has harboured is not good. This _____ will harm him.

(a) hangar **(b)** rancour
(c) storm **(d)** danger

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) rancour
Answer: 2 (**rancour**)
Meanings of each option:
- **hangar:** A large building where aircraft are stored (unrelated).
- **rancour: Deep-seated bitterness or resentfulness** (🟩 **Correct synonym**).
- **storm:** A violent weather condition (metaphorical but not a synonym).
- **danger:** Possibility of harm (related in consequence, not meaning).

The word **"bitterness"** refers to **intense hostility or resentment**, and **"rancour"** is the most precise synonym for that emotion.

Q.57 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
MUNDANE

(a) exciting **(b)** abnormal
(c) wonderful **(d)** ordinary

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ordinary
Solution:
The word **"mundane"** means **dull, routine, or ordinary**, often referring to things that are uninteresting or lacking excitement.
- **Exciting** – opposite of mundane –
- **Abnormal** – unrelated or slightly opposite –
- **Wonderful** – positive and enthusiastic, not a synonym –
- **Ordinary** – correct synonym (means common or everyday)

Answer: option (d) (ordinary).

Q.58 Select the synonym of the given word.
entice

(a) dissuade **(b)** beguile
(c) entreat **(d)** repulse

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) beguile
Solution:
The word **"entice"** means **to attract or tempt someone by offering pleasure or advantage**.
Let's evaluate the options:
- **dissuade** – means to **discourage** someone from doing something (opposite of entice)
- **beguile** – means to **charm or attract**, often in a deceptive way; closely matches **"entice"**
- **entreat** – means to **plead or beg**, not a synonym of entice
- **repulse** – means to **drive back or reject**, opposite in tone

Answer: option (b) (beguile)

Q.59 Select the synonym of the given word.
vitiate

(a) propagate **(b)** facilitate
(c) annihilate **(d)** validate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) annihilate
Solution
- **Meaning of "vitiate"**: to spoil, impair, or make something ineffective; to weaken or destroy the validity or quality of something.
- **Best synonym among the options**: **annihilate**
  - *Annihilate* means to destroy or obliterate, which captures the idea of ruining or rendering something ineffective—very close to "vitiate."
- **Why the other choices are not correct**
  - **propagate** – to spread or reproduce; no sense of spoiling.
  - **facilitate** – to make easier; the opposite of impairing.
  - **validate** – to confirm or substantiate; again, the opposite of weakening.

Therefore, the synonym of **vitiate** is **annihilate**.

Q.60 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Munificence

(a) Generousness **(b)** Liveliness
(c) Quietness **(d)** Shrewdness

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Generousness
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Generousness**. The word **Munificence** refers to **great generosity or liberal giving**, especially of money or gifts.
Example: "The munificence of the donor helped build the entire school."
Other options:
- **Liveliness** – Refers to energy or spirited behavior; unrelated to generosity.
- **Quietness** – Refers to being silent or calm; not a synonym.
- **Shrewdness** – Refers to being sharp or astute, especially in practical matters; unrelated to munificence.

Q.61 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Feasible

(a) Tentative **(b)** Worthless
(c) Energetic **(d)** Practical

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Practical
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Practical**.
Feasible means something that is **possible, achievable, or practical** under current conditions. If something is feasible, it can be done successfully.
Other options:
- **Tentative** – Uncertain or not fixed; doesn't match the meaning.
- **Worthless** – Of no value; opposite in tone and context.
- **Energetic** – Full of energy; unrelated to the idea of being possible or doable.

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Q.62 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Exuberance

(a) Depression **(b)** Indifference
(c) Lethargy **(d)** Excitement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Excitement
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Excitement**.
Exuberance refers to **high energy, enthusiasm, or lively excitement**. It describes a state of joyful, unrestrained enthusiasm or vitality.
Other options:
- **Depression** – A state of sadness or low spirits.
- **Indifference** – Lack of interest or concern.
- **Lethargy** – A state of tiredness, sluggishness, or lack of energy.

Q.63 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Frigid

(a) Facile **(b)** Flexible
(c) Freezing **(d)** Futile

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Freezing
Explanation:
The correct answer is **"Freezing"**.
The word **"Frigid"** refers to something **extremely cold in temperature** or **emotionally distant or unresponsive**. In this context, **"Freezing"** is the most appropriate synonym as both describe intense cold.
Other options:
- **Facile** – Means easy or effortless.
- **Flexible** – Means bendable or adaptable.
- **Futile** – Means useless or pointless.

Q.64 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Genesis

(a) Infatuation **(b)** Symbolism
(c) Conclusion **(d)** Inception

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Inception
Solution:
- **Genesis** means the **origin, beginning, or creation of something**.
- Let's analyze the given options:
  - **Infatuation:** Short-lived passion or strong admiration; unrelated.
  - **Symbolism:** Use of symbols to represent ideas; unrelated.
  - **Conclusion:** End or finish; opposite meaning.
  - **Inception:** Beginning or starting point; similar meaning to "Genesis."

Correct Answer: Inception
Additional Information:
- Common synonyms for **Genesis** include: **origin, commencement, initiation, inception, and birth**.
- "Genesis" is also known as the first book of the Bible, describing the creation or beginning of the world.

Q.65 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Devour

(a) Receive **(b)** Abstain
(c) Consume **(d)** Preserve

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Consume
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Consume**.
Devour means **to eat something eagerly or hungrily** or **to use up something quickly**. It implies a fast and intense action, typically related to eating or absorbing.
Other options:
- **Receive** – To get or accept something.
- **Abstain** – To deliberately avoid or not do something.
- **Preserve** – To keep something safe or in its original state.

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2. Antonyms

70 questions

Q.1 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
DEVOUT

(a) passive **(b)** profound
(c) pure **(d)** proficient

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) passive
Type: Antonym
DEVOUT – deeply religious; sincerely devoted (धर्मनिष्ठ, समर्पित).
Meanings
• **passive** – showing no active involvement/commitment (निष्क्रिय, उदासीन) → the best available **opposite**. ✓
• **profound / pure / proficient** – not opposites of "devoted".

Q.2 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
PERSEVERANCE

(a) instability **(b)** persistence
(c) determination **(d)** resolution

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) instability
Type: Antonym
PERSEVERANCE – steady persistence in effort (दृढ़ता, लगन).
Meanings
• **instability** – lack of steadiness/firmness (अस्थिरता) → the best available **opposite**. ✓
• **persistence / determination / resolution** – synonyms of perseverance.

Q.3 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
MANIFEST

(a) disguise **(b)** distinguish
(c) declare **(d)** display

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) disguise
Type: Antonym
MANIFEST – to show/reveal clearly (प्रकट करना).
Meanings
• **disguise** – to hide/conceal (छिपाना) → **opposite**. ✓
• **distinguish** – to tell apart; **declare / display** – close to "manifest" (not opposites).

Q.4 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
CRUCIAL

(a) Urgent **(b)** Stable
(c) Essential **(d)** Trivial

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Trivial
Type: Antonym
CRUCIAL – extremely important/decisive (महत्वपूर्ण).
Meanings
• **Trivial** – unimportant (तुच्छ) → **opposite**. ✓
• **Urgent / Stable / Essential** – not opposites ("essential" is a synonym).

Q.5 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
GRADUALLY

(a) Constantly **(b)** Steadily
(c) Abruptly **(d)** Readily

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Abruptly
Type: Antonym
GRADUALLY – slowly, step by step (धीरे-धीरे).
Meanings
• **Abruptly** – suddenly (अचानक) → **opposite**. ✓
• **Constantly / Steadily / Readily** – not opposites of "gradually".

Q.6 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
ENDORSE

(a) Advocate **(b)** Renounce
(c) Support **(d)** Affirm

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Renounce
Type: Antonym
ENDORSE – to support/approve (समर्थन करना).
Meanings
• **Renounce** – to reject/give up (त्यागना) → **opposite**. ✓
• **Advocate / Support / Affirm** – synonyms of endorse.

Q.7 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
ABOMINABLE

(a) Hateful **(b)** Delightful
(c) Distasteful **(d)** Colourful

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Delightful
Type: Antonym
ABOMINABLE – causing disgust; very unpleasant (घृणित).
Meanings
• **Delightful** – very pleasant (आनंददायक) → **opposite**. ✓
• **Hateful / Distasteful** – synonyms; **Colourful** – unrelated.

Q.8 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
TEMPORARY

(a) Momentary **(b)** Interim
(c) Lasting **(d)** Transitory

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Lasting
Type: Antonym
TEMPORARY – lasting for a short time (अस्थायी).
Meanings
• **Lasting** – permanent, long-lasting (स्थायी) → **opposite**. ✓
• **Momentary / Interim / Transitory** – synonyms of temporary.

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Q.9 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
BLOATED
(a) Turgid **(b)** Deflated
(c) Swollen **(d)** Arrogant
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Deflated
Type: Antonym
BLOATED – swollen, puffed up (फूला हुआ).
Meanings
• **Deflated** – emptied of air, shrunken (पिचका हुआ) → **opposite**. ✓
• **Turgid / Swollen** – synonyms; **Arrogant** – unrelated.

Q.10 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Indigenous
(a) Primitive **(b)** Natural
(c) Innate **(d)** Alien
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Alien
Type: Antonym
INDIGENOUS – native/belonging naturally to a place (देशज).
Meanings
• **Alien** – foreign → **opposite** ✓. **Primitive / natural / innate** – close to (not opposite of) indigenous.

Q.11 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Remorse
(a) Empathy **(b)** Sorrow
(c) Regret **(d)** Satisfaction
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Satisfaction
Type: Antonym
REMORSE – deep regret/guilt (पश्चाताप).
Meanings
• **Satisfaction** – contentment → **opposite** ✓. **Empathy / sorrow / regret** – close to (not opposite of) remorse.

Q.12 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Thwart
(a) Oppose **(b)** Appoint
(c) Obstruct **(d)** Allow
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Allow
Type: Antonym
THWART – to prevent/obstruct (विफल करना).
Meanings
• **Allow** – to permit → **opposite** ✓. **Oppose / obstruct** – synonyms; **appoint** – unrelated.

Q.13 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
SUPPRESS
(a) Release **(b)** Contain
(c) Quash **(d)** Abolish
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Release
Type: Antonym
SUPPRESS – to hold back / put down / restrain (दबाना).
Meanings
• **Release** – to let go / set free (छोड़ना) → **opposite**. ✓
• **Contain / Quash / Abolish** – synonyms (to hold down/end).

Q.14 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
EMBARK
(a) Board **(b)** Commence
(c) Finish **(d)** Launch
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Finish
Type: Antonym
EMBARK – to begin (a journey/task) (आरंभ करना).
Meanings
• **Finish** – to end/complete (समाप्त करना) → **opposite**. ✓
• **Board / Commence / Launch** – synonyms of embark (start).

Q.15 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
SCATTER
(a) Gather **(b)** Litter
(c) Fling **(d)** Spray
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Gather
Type: Antonym
SCATTER – to throw or spread in different directions (बिखेरना).
Meanings
• **Gather** – to bring/come together (इकट्ठा करना) → **opposite**. ✓
• **Litter / Fling / Spray** – close to "scatter" (spread), not opposites.

Q.16 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
indolent
(a) torpid **(b)** energetic
(c) languid **(d)** listless
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) energetic
Type: Antonym
INDOLENT – lazy, avoiding work (आलसी).
Meanings
• **energetic** – full of energy/active (ऊर्जावान) → **opposite**. ✓
• **torpid / languid / listless** – synonyms of indolent (lazy/sluggish).

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Q.17 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
IMPECCABLE

(a) Exquisite **(b)** Flawless
(c) Unsullied **(d)** Blemished

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Blemished
Type: Antonym
IMPECCABLE – perfect, faultless (निर्दोष).
Meanings
• **Blemished** – having flaws/spots (दोषयुक्त) → **opposite**. ✓
• **Exquisite / Flawless / Unsullied** – synonyms of impeccable.

Q.18 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
CONGENIAL

(a) mild **(b)** Mean
(c) Merciful **(d)** Mellow

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Mean
Type: Antonym
CONGENIAL – pleasant, friendly, agreeable (सुखद, अनुकूल).
Meanings
• **Mean** – unkind, unpleasant (नीच/रूखा) → the best available **opposite**. ✓
• **mild / merciful / mellow** – all agreeable qualities (not opposites).

Q.19 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word.
The new Principal of the school is <u>stern,</u> yet he understands the needs of his subordinates.

(a) Desolate **(b)** Noxious
(c) Flippant **(d)** Lenient

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Lenient
stern – serious and unrelenting Flippant – carelessDesolate – barrenNoxious – harmful, poisonous, or offensive in smell or taste.Lenient – show some mercy

Q.20 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word.
The <u>colossal</u> building stood amidst the ruins bearing signs of Victorian architecture.

(a) Extraordinary **(b)** Quaint
(c) Enormous **(d)** Tiny

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Tiny
colossal – very big in size Extraordinary – very unusualEnormous – very big.Tiny – very small.

Q.21 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word.The <u>placid</u> conversation between the two cricketers on a TV show aroused much controversy.

(a) Inappropriate **(b)** Sardonic
(c) Angry **(d)** Informal

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Angry
Placid – calm and peaceful.
Angry – showing strong feelings of displeasure or hostility.
Sardonic – mocking or cynical.
Inappropriate – not suitable or proper for the situation.
Informal – relaxed and casual, not formal.
Placid and angry are antonyms. So, option (c) is correct.

Q.22 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word.The reputed officer was removed from his post as he was having a <u>clandestine</u> affair.

(a) Overt **(b)** Amorous
(c) Casual **(d)** Surreptitious

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Overt
Clandestine – done secretly, often implying that the activity is illicit or unethical.
Overt – done or shown openly, without hiding anything.
Amorous – showing or relating to love, especially sexual love.
Casual – relaxed and unconcerned.
Surreptitious – done secretly or stealthily
So, the antonym of clandestine is overt. Hence, option (a) is correct.

Q.23 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM for the word 'often' in the following sentence. Usually at Christmas, uncle often brings lovely and cherished gifts for us.

(a) usually **(b)** lovely
(c) cherished **(d)** seldom

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) seldom
Often – frequently or many times.
Seldom – rarely or infrequently.
Cherished – beloved or valued.
Lovely – attractive and beautiful.
Usually – generally.
The antonym of 'often' out of the given words is 'seldom'.

Q.24 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word.The manager decided to resign from his post as the bank was declared to be <u>insolvent.</u>

(a) Affluent **(b)** Independent
(c) Commercial **(d)** Bankrupt

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Affluent
Insolvent – unable to pay debts, bankrupt or in financial distress.
Affluent – wealthy or having a great deal of money.
Independent – not dependent on others for anything
Commercial – related to commerce and trade.
Bankrupt – synonym for insolvent.

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Q.25 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word.Aunt May thought that Uncle Ken's job as a manager at Firpo's hotel in Shimla was a <u>stable</u> one.

(a) Mutable **(b)** Durable
(c) Permanent **(d)** Lucrative

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Mutable
Stable – durable
Mutable – liable to change or alter or fluctuate.
Lucrative – producing a large amount of profit.
So, the antonym of stable is mutable.

Q.26 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word.The audience <u>sneered</u> at the monologue uttered by the veteran actor.

(a) Waved **(b)** Lauded
(c) Unleashed **(d)** Ascribed

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Lauded
Sneered – smile or speak in a contemptuous or mocking manner.
Unleashed – to release
Ascribed – assign something to someone.
Wave – to move hand to attract someone's attention.

Q.27 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word given below.
Enhance

(a) Enrich **(b)** Impair
(c) Relevance **(d)** Miracle

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Impair
Enhance means to improve or increase the quality, value, or extent of something.
Impair means to weaken or damage something, which is the opposite of enhancing.
The meaning of other options are:
Enrich: Synonym, meaning to improve or enhance the quality or value of something.
Relevance: Not related; it refers to the importance or applicability of something.
Miracle: Not related; it refers to an extraordinary event.
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.28 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word.
The young girl is very <u>audacious</u> in every activity.

(a) Ferocious **(b)** Timid
(c) Bright **(d)** Bold

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Timid
The correct answer is Timid.
- Audacious: willing to take risks or do something shocking.
- Timid: easily frightened; shy and nervous.
- Ferocious: very aggressive and violent.
- Bright: having a lot of light.
- Bold: that you can see clearly

Hence, 'Timid' is the antonym of 'Audacious'.

Q.29 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Generous

(a) Benevolent **(b)** Selfish
(c) Magnanimous **(d)** Altruistic

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Selfish
Generous refers to being willing to give or share with others, often at one's own expense.
Selfish is the opposite, meaning concerned only with one's own interests and unwilling to share or help others.
The other options are:
Benevolent: Synonym, meaning kind and generous.
Magnanimous: Synonym, meaning noble and generous in forgiving.
Altruistic: Synonym, meaning selflessly concerned for the well-being of others.
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.30 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Accumulated

(a) Spared **(b)** Garnered
(c) Bunched **(d)** Scattered

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Scattered
"Accumulated" means gathered or collected together over time.
"Scattered" is the opposite, meaning dispersed or spread out.
The Other options are:
- **"Spared"**: Not relevant as it means saved or avoided.
- **"Garnered"**: Synonym, meaning collected or accumulated.
- **"Bunched"**: Synonym, meaning grouped together.

Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.31 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Melancholy

(a) Pleasant **(b)** Profitable
(c) Mechanical **(d)** Miserable

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Pleasant
The most appropriate antonym of **Melancholy** is **Pleasant**.
- **Melancholy** means a deep sadness or sorrow, often without a clear cause.
- **Pleasant** means something that is enjoyable, agreeable, or giving a feeling of happiness.

The meanings of other options are:
Profitable refers to something yielding profit or gain.
Mechanical refers to something related to machinery or not emotional.
Miserable means very unhappy or uncomfortable, which is similar to melancholy.
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

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Q.32 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Thrifty

(a) Intolerant **(b)** Indifferent
(c) Extravagant **(d)** Thankful

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Extravagant
The correct antonym of "thrifty" is "extravagant."
Thrifty: This adjective describes someone who is careful with money and resources, avoiding wastefulness. A thrifty person manages their finances prudently and avoids unnecessary expenditures.
Extravagant: In contrast, this adjective refers to someone who spends money or uses resources in a way that is wasteful or excessive. An extravagant person often indulges in luxury and unnecessary spending.
The meanings of other options are:
Intolerant: This adjective describes someone who is unwilling to accept views, beliefs, or behavior that differ from their own.
Indifferent: This adjective refers to someone who has no particular interest or sympathy; unconcerned.
Thankful: This adjective describes someone who is pleased and relieved.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.33 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word given below.
Ameliorate

(a) Motto **(b)** Succour
(c) Exacerbate **(d)** Recondite

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Exacerbate
The most appropriate antonym of **Ameliorate** is **Exacerbate**.
- **Ameliorate** means to improve or make something better.
- **Exacerbate** means to make a situation worse or more severe.

The meaning of other options are:
Motto refers to a short phrase that expresses a guiding principle or belief.
Succour means assistance or relief in times of distress.
Recondite means little known or abstruse.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.34 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
BOLD

(a) cheeky **(b)** confident
(c) timid **(d)** brave

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) timid
Type: Antonym
BOLD – brave, confident (साहसी, निडर).
Meanings
• **cheeky / confident / brave** – close in meaning to "bold" (not opposites).
• **timid** – shy, easily frightened (डरपोक) → **opposite**. ✓

Q.35 Choose the appropriate antonym of the given word.
Gullibility

(a) Innocence **(b)** Skepticism
(c) Trust **(d)** Naviety

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Skepticism
Meaning: **gullibility** = readiness to believe anything; being easily fooled *(भोलापन, जल्दी विश्वास कर लेना)*.
skepticism = a doubting attitude; not accepting claims without proof *(संदेहवाद, शंकालुता)* — the opposite.
Answer: **Skepticism**
Why the others are wrong.
• **innocence** = freedom from guilt; simplicity *(मासूमियत, निर्दोषता)* — close to gullibility, not opposite.
• **trust** = firm belief in someone's honesty *(विश्वास)* — leans the same way as gullibility.
• **Naviety** (as printed; correct spelling **naivety**) = lack of experience or judgement *(भोलापन, नादानी)* — a synonym.
A gull believes; a skeptic doubts.

Q.36 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Sanitise

(a) Purify **(b)** Devote
(c) Sacrifice **(d)** pollute

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) pollute
option (d) is the correct answer.
- Sanitise: to remove parts of something that could be considered unpleasant, offensive or controversial, to make it acceptable.
- Pollute: to make physically impure or unclean.
- Devote: to give a lot of time, energy, etc. to somebody/something.
- Sacrifice: to give up something that is important or valuable to you in order to get or do something that seems more important.

Q.37 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Denote

(a) Convey **(b)** Conclude
(c) Conceal **(d)** Convince

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Conceal
The most appropriate antonym for the word "Denote" is "Conceal."
1. **Convey**: This is a synonym of "denote" as it also means to communicate or express.
2. **Conclude**: This is not an exact antonym. "Conclude" generally means to bring something to an end or arrive at a decision, which is different from "denote."
3. **Conceal**: This is the most suitable antonym. "Conceal" means to hide or keep something secret, contrasting with the idea of indicating or representing, which is what "denote" means.
4. **Convince**: This is not an antonym. "Convince" means to persuade or make someone believe something, which is different from the concept of indicating or representing.

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Q.38 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Sharp

(a) Blunt **(b)** Kindled
(c) Handy **(d)** Magnetic

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Blunt
The most appropriate antonym (opposite) of the given word "Sharp" is: **Blunt**

1. **Blunt:** (Adjective) Not sharp or pointed; lacking sharpness or precision. In the context of objects, it can refer to a dull edge or point. In terms of communication, it can describe a direct and straightforward manner without delicacy.
2. **Kindled:** (Verb) Ignited or set on fire; sparked into flame. It can also be used metaphorically to describe the activation or arousal of emotions, enthusiasm, or interest.
3. **Handy:** (Adjective) Convenient to handle or use; easily accessible or manageable. It can refer to something that is within reach or readily available.
4. **Magnetic:** (Adjective) Having the properties of a magnet; exhibiting a magnetic field. It can also be used metaphorically to describe a strong attraction or charisma that draws people or things toward it.

In the context of the given word "Sharp," which likely refers to having a keen edge or point, the most appropriate antonym is "Blunt."

Q.39 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word to fill in the blank.
Allies have always come to his rescue in spite of his _____ attempts to defame him.

(a) fellows' **(b)** buddies'
(c) enemies' **(d)** scholars'

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) enemies'
"Allies" refers to people who support or help someone. Therefore, the opposite of allies would be **"enemies"**, which refers to people who oppose or harm someone.
Meaning of other options are:
Allies: Supporters or helpers.
Fellows: Peers or companions in a group.
Buddies: Close friends.
Enemies: Opponents or those who wish to harm.
Scholars: Academically focused individuals.

Q.40 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
EMACIATED

(a) shrunken **(b)** thin
(c) lean **(d)** fat

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) fat
Type: Antonym
EMACIATED – abnormally thin and weak (from hunger/illness) (अत्यधिक दुबला).
Meanings
• **shrunken / thin / lean** – all mean "thin" → synonyms.
• **fat** – having much flesh (मोटा) → **opposite**. ✓

Q.41 What is the antonym of "Obdurate"?

(a) Adamant **(b)** Inflexible
(c) Compliant **(d)** Unyielding

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Compliant
Meaning: **obdurate** = stubbornly refusing to change one's opinion or action *(हठी, अड़ियल)*.
Its opposite is **compliant** = ready to obey or agree *(आज्ञाकारी, सहज मानने वाला)*.
Answer: **(3) Compliant**
Why the others are wrong.
• **adamant** = refusing to be persuaded *(अटल, दृढ़)* — a synonym of *obdurate*.
• **inflexible** = unwilling to change *(अनम्य)* — also a synonym.
• **unyielding** = not giving way *(न झुकने वाला)* — a third synonym.
Three of the four options mean "stubborn" — the odd one out is the antonym.

Q.42 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
SPARSE

(a) scant **(b)** meagre
(c) thin **(d)** abundant

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) abundant
Type: Antonym
SPARSE – thinly spread; scanty (विरल, कम).
Meanings
• **scant / meagre / thin** – all mean "little/scanty" → synonyms.
• **abundant** – present in large amounts (प्रचुर) → **opposite**. ✓

Q.43 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
AMATEUR

(a) novice **(b)** apprentice
(c) professional **(d)** learner

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2019

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) professional
Type: Antonym
AMATEUR – one who does something for pleasure, not as a paid job; a non-expert (शौकिया).
Meanings
• **novice** – a beginner (नौसिखिया) – synonym.
• **apprentice** – a trainee (प्रशिक्षु) – synonym.
• **professional** – a trained expert who does it for a living (पेशेवर) → **opposite**. ✓
• **learner** – one who is learning (सीखने वाला) – synonym.

Q.44 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
LANGUID

(a) energetic **(b)** lethargic
(c) indolent **(d)** sluggish

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2019

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) energetic
Type: Antonym
LANGUID – lacking energy; slow and relaxed (सुस्त, निस्तेज).
Meanings

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Explanation (contd.)
• **energetic** – full of energy (ऊर्जावान) → **opposite of languid**. ✓
• **lethargic** – sluggish, lazy (सुस्त) – synonym.
• **indolent** – lazy (आलसी) – synonym.
• **sluggish** – slow-moving (धीमा) – synonym.

Q.45 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
CONDENSE
(a) repel **(b)** reduce
(c) expand **(d)** constrict
SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2019

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) expand
Type: Antonym
CONDENSE – to make smaller/thicker; to compress (संघनित करना, छोटा करना).
Meanings
• **repel** – to drive away (दूर हटाना).
• **reduce** – to make less (कम करना) – close to condense, not opposite.
• **expand** – to make larger/spread out (फैलाना) → **opposite of condense**. ✓
• **constrict** – to make narrower (सिकोड़ना) – a synonym, not antonym.

Q.46 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
RELEVANT
(a) inhabitable **(b)** inevitable
(c) ineligible **(d)** Inapplicable
SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2020

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Inapplicable
Type: Antonym
RELEVANT – connected with and important to the matter (प्रासंगिक, उपयुक्त).
Meanings of all options
• **inhabitable** – fit to live in (रहने योग्य).
• **inevitable** – unavoidable (अपरिहार्य).
• **ineligible** – not qualified (अपात्र).
• **inapplicable** – not applicable / not connected (अप्रासंगिक) → **opposite of relevant**. ✓

Q.47 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
PERSEVERANCE
(a) tenacity **(b)** indifference
(c) determination **(d)** dedication
SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2020

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) indifference
Type: Antonym
PERSEVERANCE – continued steady effort despite difficulty (दृढ़ता, लगन).
Meanings of all options
• **tenacity** – firmness, holding on (दृढ़ता) – synonym.
• **indifference** – lack of interest or effort (उदासीनता) → **opposite**. ✓
• **determination** – firmness of purpose (संकल्प) – synonym.
• **dedication** – devotion (समर्पण) – synonym.

Q.48 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
SHALLOW
(a) trivial **(b)** narrow
(c) deep **(d)** hollow
SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2020

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) deep
Type: Antonym
SHALLOW – not deep; also (of ideas) superficial (उथला; सतही).
Meanings of all options
• **trivial** – unimportant (मामूली).
• **narrow** – not wide (सँकरा).
• **deep** – far down from the surface (गहरा) → **opposite of shallow**. ✓
• **hollow** – empty inside (खोखला).

Q.49 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Unity
(a) Illegible **(b)** Illogical
(c) Discord **(d)** Invade
SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Discord
Answer: Discord
The word **"Unity"** means *the state of being united or joined as a whole; harmony or togetherness*. Its antonym would refer to *lack of harmony or disagreement*.
Let's look at the meanings of all options:
1. **Illegible** – *not clear enough to be read* → **Not related**
2. **Illogical** – *lacking sense or clear reasoning* → **Not related**
3. **Discord** – *disagreement or lack of harmony* → **Correct Antonym**
4. **Invade** – *to enter forcefully or aggressively* → **Not related**

So, the correct antonym of **Unity** is **Discord**.

Q.50 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Enthusiasm
(a) Zeal **(b)** Passion
(c) Apathy **(d)** Vehemence
SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Apathy
Answer: 3 (**Apathy**)
- **Enthusiasm** means **intense and eager enjoyment, interest, or approval**.

Meanings of each option:
- **Zeal** – Great energy or enthusiasm; synonym.
- **Passion** – Strong and barely controllable emotion; synonym.
- **Apathy** – **Lack of interest, enthusiasm, or concern**; **correct antonym**.
- **Vehemence** – Intensity or forcefulness of expression; related to strong emotion, not opposite.

So, the correct antonym of **"enthusiasm"** is **"apathy."**

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Q.51 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in a sentence.
We are all <u>appalled</u> that these stale items are still on sale.

(a) Delighted **(b)** Scared
(c) Honest **(d)** Horrified

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Delighted
Answer: Delighted
The word **"appalled"** means *shocked or horrified by something unpleasant or wrong*. Its antonym would express a *positive or pleased reaction*.
Let's examine the options:
1. **Delighted** – *very pleased or happy* → **Correct Antonym**
2. **Scared** – *afraid or frightened* → Similar in tone, **not an antonym**
3. **Honest** – *truthful* → **Not related**
4. **Horrified** – *greatly shocked or terrified* → **Synonym**, not an antonym

So, the word **"Delighted"** is the best antonym for **"appalled"**.

Q.52 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word.
Generation today has become <u>impulsive</u> and everything is wanted at instance.

(a) Thoughtful **(b)** Unknown
(c) Worthless **(d)** Angry

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Thoughtful
Answer: 1 (**Thoughtful**)
- **Impulsive** means **acting without thinking or planning; spontaneous**.

Meanings of the options:
- **Thoughtful** – **Careful and considerate in thought or action**; **opposite of impulsive**.
- **Unknown** – Not identified or familiar; unrelated.
- **Worthless** – Having no value; unrelated to behavior.
- **Angry** – Feeling strong displeasure; not the opposite of impulsive.

Thus, the correct antonym of **"impulsive"** is **"thoughtful."**

Q.53 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word.
The claims made by the scientists at the International Science Fair turned out to be <u>spurious.</u>

(a) Factitious **(b)** Predictable
(c) Authentic **(d)** Meritorious

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Authentic
Explanation:
Meanings of each option:
- **Factitious:** Artificial or fake; not genuine.
- **Predictable:** Expected; something anticipated.
- **Authentic:** Genuine, real (**correct antonym**).
- **Meritorious:** Deserving reward or praise.

The underlined word **"spurious"** means **fake or false**. Thus, its antonym (opposite meaning) is **"authentic,"** meaning genuine or true.

Q.54 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Lazy

(a) Triumph **(b)** Diligent
(c) Chide **(d)** Implore

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Diligent
Answer: 2 (**Diligent**)
Meanings of each option:
- **Triumph:** Victory or success.
- **Diligent:** Hardworking, industrious (**correct antonym**).
- **Chide:** To scold or rebuke.
- **Implore:** To beg or request earnestly.

The word **"Lazy"** means unwilling to work or lacking effort. Therefore, the antonym (opposite meaning) is **"Diligent,"** meaning hardworking and industrious.

Q.55 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Adequate

(a) Commensurate **(b)** Inadequate
(c) Able **(d)** Sufficient

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Inadequate
The word **"Adequate"** means *sufficient, enough, or acceptable in quantity or quality*. Its **antonym** is something that means *not enough or insufficient*.
Let's examine all options:
1. **Commensurate** – means *proportionate or equal in measure* → **Synonym**
2. **Inadequate** – means *not sufficient or not enough* → **Correct Antonym**
3. **Able** – means *having the power, skill, or means* → **Not related**
4. **Sufficient** – means *adequate or enough* → **Synonym**

Hence, the most appropriate antonym of **"Adequate"** is **Inadequate**.

Q.56 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in a sentence.
Andrew was a very gentle and <u>courteous</u> man with huge respect for everyone he worked with.

(a) Humble **(b)** Courageous
(c) Refined **(d)** Impolite

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Impolite
The underlined word is **courteous**, which means:
- **Courteous**: Polite, respectful, and considerate in manner.

Let's examine the meanings of all the options:
- **Humble**: Modest or having a low view of one's importance – *not the opposite of courteous*.
- **Courageous**: Brave or fearless – *not related to politeness or respect*.
- **Refined**: Elegant, cultured, or polite – *similar in tone, not an opposite*.
- **Impolite**: **Rude or lacking manners** – this is the correct antonym of **courteous**.

Thus, the most appropriate antonym is **Impolite** .

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Q.57 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word tasty from the given sentence:
My cordial, affectionate and kind grandmother used to make tasty pickles for us as we did not like bland ones.

(a) affectionate **(b)** cordial
(c) bland **(d)** kind

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) bland
We are asked to identify the **antonym (opposite meaning)** of the word **"tasty"** from the sentence.
Let's look at the meaning of each option:
- **affectionate** – showing fondness or tenderness (unrelated to "tasty")
- **cordial** – warm and friendly (not related to food taste)
- **bland** – **lacking flavor** or taste; this is the **opposite of "tasty"**
- **kind** – considerate or nice (again, unrelated to food taste)

Part of Speech Corrected: *Adjective* – "tasty" and "bland" both describe the quality of food, making them adjectives.
Hence, the correct antonym is **bland**.

Q.58 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in a sentence.
She <u>enunciated</u> each word slowly and carefully.

(a) Murmured **(b)** Mispronounced
(c) Uttered **(d)** Chanted

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Mispronounced
Answer: 2 (**Mispronounced**)
- **Murmured** – Spoke in a low or soft voice, not necessarily incorrect.
- **Mispronounced** – Pronounced incorrectly; **opposite of enunciated**.
- **Uttered** – Simply means "spoken"; not related to clarity.
- **Chanted** – Repeated words rhythmically; not the opposite of clear speech.

Since **"enunciated"** means to pronounce clearly and correctly, the best antonym is **"mispronounced"**.

Q.59 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Mercy

(a) Grace **(b)** Sternness
(c) Benevolence **(d)** Compassion

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Sternness
The word **"Mercy"** means *compassion or forgiveness shown towards someone*, especially when one has the power to punish.
Let's look at the meanings of each option:
1. **Grace** – *elegance or goodwill; kindness* → **Similar to mercy**
2. **Sternness** – *strictness, severity, or harshness* → **Opposite of mercy**
3. **Benevolence** – *kindness, goodwill* → **Similar to mercy**
4. **Compassion** – *sympathy and concern for others* → **Similar to mercy**

Thus, the **correct antonym** of **"Mercy"** is **Sternness**.

Q.60 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Genuine

(a) Elusive **(b)** Tangible
(c) Curious **(d)** Spurious

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Spurious
Word Given: *Genuine*
Meaning: Real, authentic, true, or sincere.
Now let's look at each option:
- **Elusive** – Difficult to find, catch, or achieve. *(Unrelated; not opposite of genuine)*
- **Tangible** – Perceptible by touch; real or concrete. *(Similar in some contexts to genuine, not opposite)*
- **Curious** – Eager to know or learn something. *(Unrelated in meaning to genuine)*
- **Spurious** – False or fake; not genuine. (**Correct antonym**)

Hence, the antonym of **genuine** is **spurious**.

Q.61 Select the most appropriate antonym of the underlined word in a sentence.
A manufacturer can <u>amplify</u> the demand of a product by advertising widely.

(a) enlarge **(b)** influence
(c) reduce **(d)** transform

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) reduce
Explanation:
Meanings of each option:
- **enlarge:** to make something bigger or larger.
- **influence:** to affect or change someone or something.
- **reduce:** to make something smaller or decrease (**correct antonym**).
- **transform:** to change something completely in form, appearance, or nature.

The word **"amplify"** means **to increase or enlarge**. Thus, its antonym (opposite) is **"reduce,"** meaning to decrease or diminish.

Q.62 Select the antonym of the given word.
deplore

(a) hate **(b)** dislike
(c) mourn **(d)** praise

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) praise
Solution:
The word **"deplore"** means to **strongly disapprove of** or **express sorrow or regret** for something.
We are looking for the **antonym**, i.e., a word that expresses the **opposite sentiment**, such as approval or admiration.
- **Hate** – similar in meaning to "deplore" –
- **Dislike** – also similar in meaning –
- **Mourn** – expresses sorrow, like "deplore" –
- **Praise** – shows approval or admiration – **Opposite of "deplore"**

Answer: option (d) (praise).

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Q.63 Select the antonym of the given word.
taciturn

(a) reticent **(b)** withdrawn
(c) loquacious **(d)** laconic

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) loquacious
Solution:
The word **"taciturn"** refers to a person who is **habitually silent, reserved, or uncommunicative in speech**.
We are looking for the **opposite**, i.e., someone who **talks a lot**.

- **Reticent** – similar to taciturn (quiet, reserved) –
- **Withdrawn** – shy, not sociable –
- **Loquacious** – **talkative, verbose, outgoing in speech** – (antonym)
- **Laconic** – brief, using few words – (also similar to taciturn)

Answer: option (c) (loquacious).

Q.64 Select the most appropriate antonym of the given word.
FASTIDIOUS

(a) critical **(b)** fussy
(c) difficult **(d)** indifferent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) indifferent
Solution:
The word **"fastidious"** means being **very attentive to detail**, **hard to please**, or **excessively concerned with cleanliness or precision**.
We are looking for a word that means the **opposite**—someone who is **not concerned with details or precision**.

- **Critical** – not opposite; often goes with fastidiousness
- **Fussy** – synonym, not antonym
- **Difficult** – unrelated or slightly overlapping in meaning
- **Indifferent** – **correct**; it means **not concerned, careless, or unconcerned**, which is the opposite of fastidious

Answer: option (d) (indifferent).

Q.65 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Discernible

(a) Sensational **(b)** Imperceptible
(c) Noticeable **(d)** Apparent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Imperceptible

- **Discernible** means **noticeable**, **perceivable**, or **detectable** — something that can be seen or recognized.
- The most appropriate **antonym** is **Imperceptible**, which means **not able to be perceived or noticed**.

Other options:

- **Sensational** – related to excitement or intense interest; not an antonym.
- **Noticeable** and **Apparent** – both are synonyms of **discernible**, not antonyms.

Correct Antonym: Imperceptible.

Q.66 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Amiable

(a) Aesthetical **(b)** Hostile
(c) Cordial **(d)** Exemplary

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Hostile

- **Amiable** means **friendly**, **pleasant**, or **good-natured**.
- Let's look at the options:
  - **Aesthetical** – related to beauty or art (not opposite of friendly)
  - **Hostile** – **unfriendly**, **aggressive** → **antonym of amiable**
  - **Cordial** – warm and friendly (synonym, not antonym)
  - **Exemplary** – outstanding or ideal (not related to friendliness)

So, the most appropriate antonym is **Hostile**.

Q.67 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Stringent

(a) Exacting **(b)** Affordable
(c) Satiated **(d)** Flexible

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Flexible
Solution:

- The word **"Stringent"** means:
  - **Strict**, **rigorous**, or **severe** in rules, requirements, or conditions.
  - Example: *The school has stringent rules regarding attendance.*
- The antonym should express the opposite of **strict or rigid**.
- **Flexible** is the most appropriate antonym:
  - It means **adaptable**, **lenient**, or **easily adjustable**, which is the opposite of stringent.
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **Exacting** – means demanding or strict, which is a synonym, not an antonym.
  - **Affordable** – relates to cost, not strictness.
  - **Satiated** – means fully satisfied, generally used with hunger or desire, unrelated in context.

Correct antonym:
Flexible

Q.68 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Mitigate

(a) Diminish **(b)** Alleviate
(c) Weaken **(d)** Intensify

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Intensify
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Intensify**.
To **mitigate** means to **lessen, reduce, or alleviate** something, especially something negative like pain, stress, or impact. Its antonym would be something that **increases or heightens** the severity, which is **intensify**.
Other options:

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Explanation (contd.)

- **Diminish** – Means to reduce or lessen; similar in meaning to mitigate.
- **Alleviate** – Also means to make something less severe; synonym of mitigate.
- **Weaken** – Means to make less strong; again, similar in meaning to mitigate.

Q.69 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Extravagant

(a) Enrich **(b)** Righteous
(c) Restrained **(d)** Lavish

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Restrained
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Restrained**.
Extravagant means spending too much or using more resources than necessary, often in a lavish or excessive way. Its antonym is **Restrained**, which means **controlled, moderate, or careful in behavior or spending**.
Other options:

- **Enrich** – To improve or enhance quality or value, not opposite of extravagant.
- **Righteous** – Morally right or justifiable; not related to spending or excess.
- **Lavish** – Very generous or extravagant; it is a **synonym**, not an antonym.

Q.70 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Oaf

(a) Simpleton **(b)** Blockhead
(c) Magnificient **(d)** Smart

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Smart
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Smart**.
Oaf refers to a **clumsy or stupid person**, so the opposite (antonym) would be someone who is **intelligent, clever, or sharp**, which is best captured by **Smart**.
Other options:

- **Simpleton** – A foolish or gullible person (synonym)
- **Blockhead** – A very unintelligent or stupid person (synonym)
- **Magnificent** – Means grand or impressive, but it does **not** directly relate to intelligence or foolishness

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3. Idioms & Phrases

158 questions

Q.1 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Eat one's words

(a) forgive and forget
(b) oppose sternly
(c) retract what one has said
(d) become less acceptable

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) retract what one has said
Type: Idiom
"Eat one's words" = to take back / admit that what one said was wrong (अपनी कही बात वापस लेना).
Why the others are wrong
• **forgive and forget / oppose sternly / become less acceptable** – none matches "take back one's words".

Q.2 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
On the spur of the moment

(a) deciding after a lot of thinking
(b) being extremely careful
(c) acting impulsively without thinking
(d) waiting nervously for something

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) acting impulsively without thinking
Type: Idiom
"On the spur of the moment" = suddenly, without planning (बिना सोचे-समझे, तुरंत).
Why the others are wrong
• **after a lot of thinking / extremely careful / waiting nervously** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.3 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
A fair weather friend

(a) a jealous friend
(b) a dependable friend
(c) an unreliable friend
(d) a friend turned into an enemy

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) an unreliable friend
Type: Idiom
"A fair weather friend" = a friend only in good times, not to be relied on in trouble (केवल अच्छे समय का दोस्त).
Why the others are wrong
• **jealous / dependable / turned enemy** – none matches "unreliable in bad times".

Q.4 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Over one's head

(a) being at a disadvantage
(b) beyond one's capability to understand something
(c) something totally unexpected
(d) unable to function as before

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) beyond one's capability to understand something
Type: Idiom
"Over one's head" = too difficult for someone to understand (समझ से परे).
Why the others are wrong
• **disadvantage / totally unexpected / unable to function** – none matches "too hard to understand".

Q.5 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Rose-coloured glasses

(a) an outdated attitude
(b) a positive outlook on life
(c) a belief not based on facts
(d) a difficult situation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a positive outlook on life
Type: Idiom
"Rose-coloured glasses" = an optimistic, positive way of seeing things (आशावादी दृष्टिकोण).
Why the others are wrong
• **outdated attitude / belief not based on facts / difficult situation** – none matches "optimism".

Q.6 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To call the shots

(a) to lack control
(b) to be the person in charge
(c) to be blissfully happy
(d) to be in debt

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) to be the person in charge
Type: Idiom
"To call the shots" = to be in control, to make the decisions (निर्णय लेने वाला होना).
Why the others are wrong
• **lack control / happy / in debt** – opposite or unrelated.

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Q.7 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Breath of fresh air

(a) a peaceful and relaxing place
(b) someone or something new and refreshing
(c) a high-priced and expensive thing
(d) someone with a pleasant voice

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) someone or something new and refreshing
Type: Idiom
"Breath of fresh air" = a welcome, new and refreshing change (ताज़गी भरा बदलाव).
Why the others are wrong
• **peaceful place / high-priced thing / pleasant voice** – none matches "new and refreshing".

Q.8 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Take exception

(a) object to **(b)** appreciate
(c) deny **(d)** care for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) object to
Type: Idiom
"Take exception (to)" = to object to / be offended by something (आपत्ति करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **appreciate / deny / care for** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.9 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
On the double

(a) out of order
(b) at a fast pace
(c) between two undesirable things
(d) on the verge of collapse

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) at a fast pace
Type: Idiom
"On the double" = very quickly, at once (तुरंत/तेज़ी से).
Why the others are wrong
• **out of order / between two undesirable things / on the verge of collapse** – unrelated.

Q.10 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
The news of a leopard in the city <u>spread like wild fire</u>.

(a) spread rapidly **(b)** spread slowly
(c) caused damage **(d)** caused fear

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) spread rapidly
Type: Idiom
"spread like wildfire" = to spread very quickly (आग की तरह फैलना).
Why the others are wrong
• **spread slowly / caused damage / caused fear** – not the meaning.

Q.11 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
One track mind

(a) using a well-known path
(b) thinking of another point of view
(c) waiting anxiously for something
(d) always thinking of only one thing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) always thinking of only one thing
Type: Idiom
"One-track mind" = a mind focused on only one thing (एकाग्र/एक ही बात सोचने वाला मन).
Why the others are wrong
• **well-known path / another point of view / waiting anxiously** – none matches.

Q.12 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
If we <u>lay our heads together</u>, we will surely find a solution.

(a) rest for a while **(b)** work in consultation
(c) take a break **(d)** work in isolation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) work in consultation
Type: Idiom
"lay our heads together" (put heads together) = to think/plan together, in consultation (मिलकर विचार करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **rest / take a break / work in isolation** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.13 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
His probation was extended because his performance was not <u>up to the mark</u>.

(a) lacking in maturity
(b) more than expected
(c) up to the required standard
(d) of the desired height

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) up to the required standard
Type: Idiom
"up to the mark" = of the required/expected standard (अपेक्षित स्तर का). ("not up to the mark" = below standard.)
Why the others are wrong
• **lacking in maturity / more than expected / desired height** – not the meaning.

Q.14 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.Achilles' Heel

(a) Fast runner **(b)** Irrelevant thing
(c) Vulnerable point **(d)** Costly item

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Vulnerable point
Achilles Heel – a person's weakness or vulnerable point that can be exploited by others.

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Q.15 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
The threat of the pandemic is not just <u>a cry in the wilderness</u>.

(a) tears of sorrow **(b)** an unheeded warning
(c) spreading rumours **(d)** mourning for the loss

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) an unheeded warning
Type: Idiom
"a cry in the wilderness" = a warning or appeal that people ignore (अनसुनी चेतावनी).
Why the others are wrong
• **tears of sorrow / spreading rumours / mourning** – not the meaning.

Q.16 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
His comments <u>cast a slur upon</u> the integrity of his manager.

(a) improved **(b)** praised
(c) damaged **(d)** redeemed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) damaged
Type: Idiom
"cast a slur upon" = to bring disgrace on / damage someone's reputation (बदनाम करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **improved / praised / redeemed** – opposite meanings.

Q.17 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
She felt <u>like a fish out of water</u> at her new job.

(a) uncomfortable and restless
(b) angry and hurt
(c) comfortable and relaxed
(d) happy and free

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) uncomfortable and restless
Type: Idiom
"like a fish out of water" = feeling uncomfortable/out of place in unfamiliar surroundings (असहज महसूस करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **angry and hurt / comfortable and relaxed / happy and free** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.18 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
Information technology has developed <u>by leaps and bounds</u>.

(a) through unfair means **(b)** very gradually
(c) in far off places **(d)** at a rapid pace

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) at a rapid pace
Type: Idiom
"by leaps and bounds" = very rapidly, in big steps (तेज़ी से).
Why the others are wrong
• **unfair means / very gradually / far off places** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.19 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
If the audit report shows anomalies, the finance manager will be <u>brought to book</u>.

(a) supported fully **(b)** given a promotion
(c) held accountable **(d)** rewarded suitably

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) held accountable
Type: Idiom
The idiom means the manager will be **held accountable** (made answerable/responsible) if the audit shows problems (जवाबदेह ठहराया जाएगा).
Why the others are wrong
• **supported fully / given a promotion / rewarded suitably** – opposite of being blamed.

Q.20 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
Her success as a singer was <u>a nine days' wonder</u>.

(a) a short-lived sensation
(b) eternal fame
(c) a proud achievement
(d) an impossible feat

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) a short-lived sensation
Type: Idiom
"a nine days' wonder" = something that draws attention for a short while and is then forgotten (क्षणिक चर्चा).
Why the others are wrong
• **eternal fame / proud achievement / impossible feat** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.21 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Blow one's own trumpet

(a) Criticise others **(b)** Rely on oneself
(c) Respect others **(d)** Praise oneself

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Praise oneself
Type: Idiom
"Blow one's own trumpet" = to boast / praise oneself (अपनी तारीफ़ ख़ुद करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **Criticise / Rely on / Respect others** – not the meaning.

Q.22 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Far and wide

(a) In all possible ways **(b)** In all directions
(c) From the past **(d)** In the future

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) In all directions
Type: Idiom
"Far and wide" = over a large area, in all directions (चारों ओर, दूर-दूर तक).
Why the others are wrong
• **In all possible ways / From the past / In the future** – not the meaning.

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Q.23 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Cry over spilt milk

(a) To regret uselessly **(b)** To blame others
(c) To find a solution **(d)** To shout slogans

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) To regret uselessly
Type: Idiom
"Cry over spilt milk" = to waste time regretting something that cannot be undone (बीती बात पर पछताना).
Why the others are wrong
• **blame others / find a solution / shout slogans** – not the meaning.

Q.24 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
First and foremost

(a) Most important aspect **(b)** After everything else
(c) Most difficult task **(d)** Far from the truth

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Most important aspect
Type: Idiom
"First and foremost" = above all; the most important thing (सबसे पहले और सबसे महत्वपूर्ण).
Why the others are wrong
• **After everything else / most difficult task / far from the truth** – not the meaning.

Q.25 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Eye-wash

(a) An inspiration **(b)** A consideration
(c) A deception **(d)** An operation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A deception
Type: Idiom
"Eye-wash" = something done merely to deceive or create a false impression (आँखों में धूल झोंकना/दिखावा).
Why the others are wrong
• **inspiration / consideration / operation** – not the meaning.

Q.26 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Apple of one's eye

(a) Very rosy **(b)** Very easy
(c) Very clean **(d)** Very dear

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Very dear
Type: Idiom
"Apple of one's eye" = a person who is loved and cherished above all others (बहुत प्रिय व्यक्ति).
Why the others are wrong
• **Very rosy / easy / clean** – not the meaning.

Q.27 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Do a good turn

(a) Wait for a turn **(b)** Make a profit
(c) Render a service **(d)** Return a gift

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Render a service
Type: Idiom
"Do a good turn" = to do a kind or helpful act for someone (किसी का भला करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **Wait for a turn / Make a profit / Return a gift** – not the meaning.

Q.28 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Carry the day

(a) Lift a heavy load **(b)** Bear the burden
(c) Lead an army **(d)** Win a victory

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Win a victory
Type: Idiom
"Carry the day" = to win / be successful (जीत हासिल करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **Lift a load / Bear the burden / Lead an army** – not the meaning.

Q.29 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Behind one's back

(a) Confronting somebody
(b) In everyone's knowledge
(c) In one's absence
(d) Openly supporting someone

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) In one's absence
Type: Idiom
"Behind one's back" = without someone's knowledge, in their absence (पीठ पीछे).
Why the others are wrong
• **Confronting / In everyone's knowledge / openly supporting** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.30 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Keep your head

(a) Be furious **(b)** Remain calm
(c) Protect yourself **(d)** Respect yourself

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Remain calm
Type: Idiom
"Keep your head" = to stay calm in a difficult situation (शांत रहना).
Why the others are wrong
• Be furious / protect yourself / respect yourself – not the meaning.

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Q.31 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To meet one's Waterloo
(a) To make a foolish choice
(b) To experience defeat
(c) To meet a friend
(d) To win a match
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To experience defeat
Type: Idiom
"To meet one's Waterloo" = to face a final, decisive defeat (करारी हार).
Why the others are wrong
• Foolish choice / meet a friend / win a match – not the meaning.

Q.32 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To have an axe to grind
(a) To have an indomitable task to accomplish
(b) To have access to top levels of authority
(c) To have adequate means of subsistence
(d) To have a selfish motive in doing something
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) To have a selfish motive in doing something
Type: Idiom
"To have an axe to grind" = to have a private/selfish motive (स्वार्थ छिपा होना).
Why the others are wrong
• Task / access / means of subsistence – not the meaning.

Q.33 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
A square deal
(a) An advantageous deal **(b)** A false claim
(c) A fair and honest deal **(d)** An unfruitful plan
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A fair and honest deal
Type: Idiom
"A square deal" = fair and honest treatment (न्यायोचित व्यवहार).
Why the others are wrong
• Advantageous deal / false claim / unfruitful plan – not the meaning.

Q.34 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Against one's grain
(a) Against one's nature **(b)** Against the society
(c) Against the law **(d)** Against one's family
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Against one's nature
Type: Idiom
"Against one's grain" = contrary to one's nature/inclination (स्वभाव के विरुद्ध).
Why the others are wrong
• Against society / law / family – not the meaning.

Q.35 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To rise like a phoenix
(a) To behave like a royal
(b) To set on fire
(c) To emerge with a new life
(d) To be modest
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) To emerge with a new life
Type: Idiom
"To rise like a phoenix" = to make a fresh, successful start after ruin (राख से फिर उठ खड़ा होना).
Why the others are wrong
• Behave royally / set on fire / be modest – not the meaning.

Q.36 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To hit below the belt
(a) To hit someone boldly
(b) To attack after warning
(c) To hit off the mark
(d) To attack in an unfair manner
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) To attack in an unfair manner
Type: Idiom
"To hit below the belt" = to act/attack unfairly (अनुचित तरीके से वार करना).
Why the others are wrong
• Boldly / after warning / off the mark – not the meaning.

Q.37 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To read between the lines
(a) To criticise the writer's style
(b) To interrupt someone while reading
(c) To read each line carefully
(d) To understand the implied meaning
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) To understand the implied meaning
Type: Idiom
"To read between the lines" = to understand the hidden/implied meaning (छिपा अर्थ समझना).
Why the others are wrong
• Criticise style / interrupt / read each line carefully – not the meaning.

Q.38 Select the appropriate idiom that can replace the underlined phrase in the following sentence.
My father's office is <u>at a close distance</u> from home.
(a) from hand to mouth **(b)** at a stone's throw
(c) at sixes and sevens **(d)** a part and parcel
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) at a stone's throw
from hand to mouth – just fulfilling the necessities.At a stone's throw - a short distance.At sixes and sevens – confused and badly organized or difficult situation.A part and parcel – a necessary part of something

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Q.39 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To turn the corner
(a) To go back to the past
(b) To change one's goal
(c) To pass the critical stage
(d) To wait for an opportunity
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) To pass the critical stage
Type: Idiom
"To turn the corner" = to pass the most difficult/critical stage and begin to improve (संकट पार करना).
Why the others are wrong
• Go back / change goal / wait for a chance – not the meaning.

Q.40 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
On tenterhooks
(a) Alert and enthusiastic **(b)** Anxious and tense
(c) Happy and joyous **(d)** Neutral and undecided
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Anxious and tense
Type: Idiom
"On tenterhooks" = in a state of anxious suspense (बेचैन/तनाव में).
Why the others are wrong
• **alert / happy / neutral** – not the meaning.

Q.41 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Not mince words
(a) Not to be honest
(b) Not to come directly to the point
(c) To speak in a direct way
(d) To speak in a garbled way
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) To speak in a direct way
Type: Idiom
"Not mince words" = to speak plainly and directly, without softening the message (बेबाकी से कहना).
Why the others are wrong
• **not honest / not to the point / garbled** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.42 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To take stock of
(a) To assess **(b)** To discuss
(c) To assemble **(d)** To modify
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) To assess
Type: Idiom
"To take stock of" = to assess/review a situation carefully (जायज़ा लेना).
Why the others are wrong
• **discuss / assemble / modify** – not the meaning.

Q.43 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
On cloud nine
(a) Extremely happy and excited
(b) Crazy and foolish
(c) Knowledgeable and wise
(d) Very far away from home
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Extremely happy and excited
Type: Idiom
"On cloud nine" = extremely happy/delighted (बहुत खुश).
Why the others are wrong
• **crazy / knowledgeable / far from home** – not the meaning.

Q.44 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Don't put all your eggs in the same basket
(a) Don't share your wealth with others
(b) Don't buy too many things at one time
(c) Don't invest in loss making propositions
(d) Don't concentrate all your resources in one place
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Don't concentrate all your resources in one place
Type: Idiom
"Don't put all your eggs in the same basket" = don't risk everything on one venture; spread your resources (सारा दांव एक जगह न लगाओ).
Why the others are wrong
• **share wealth / buy too many / invest in loss** – not the exact meaning.

Q.45 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Wear your heart on your sleeve
(a) To keep a secret
(b) To show your true emotions
(c) To look attractive
(d) To love someone secretly
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To show your true emotions
Type: Idiom
"Wear your heart on your sleeve" = to show your feelings openly (अपनी भावनाएँ खुलकर दिखाना).
Why the others are wrong
• **keep a secret / look attractive / love secretly** – opposite or unrelated.

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Q.46 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Miss the boat
(a) To lose an opportunity
(b) To settle down at a place
(c) To do something carefully
(d) To reach the end
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) To lose an opportunity
Type: Idiom
"Miss the boat" = to miss a chance / lose an opportunity (मौका चूकना).
Why the others are wrong
• **settle down / do carefully / reach the end** – not the meaning.

Q.47 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Full of hot air
(a) Talking nonsense **(b)** Talking too much
(c) Being hot tempered **(d)** Being too proud
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Talking nonsense
Type: Idiom
"Full of hot air" = talking nonsense; boastful, empty talk (बकवास करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **talking too much / hot tempered / too proud** – not the exact meaning.

Q.48 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Not make head or tail
(a) very unusual and strange
(b) not find something interesting
(c) not able to understand anything
(d) very boring and not at all fun
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) not able to understand anything
Type: Idiom
"not make head or tail (of)" = to be unable to understand something at all (कुछ भी समझ न पाना).
Why the others are wrong
• **unusual / not interesting / boring** – not the meaning.

Q.49 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
bad blood
(a) hard luck **(b)** low status
(c) ill feeling **(d)** poor quality
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ill feeling
Type: Idiom
"bad blood" = feelings of hatred or bitterness between people (आपसी दुश्मनी).
Why the others are wrong
• **hard luck / low status / poor quality** – not the meaning.

Q.50 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Read between the lines
(a) Make a great effort to read
(b) Read each and every word
(c) Discern the hidden meaning in the text
(d) Skip pages and read fast
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Discern the hidden meaning in the text
Type: Idiom
"Read between the lines" = to understand the hidden or implied meaning (छिपे अर्थ को समझना).
Why the others are wrong
• **great effort / every word / skip pages** – not the meaning.

Q.51 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
all in all
(a) every person **(b)** first in line
(c) completely lost **(d)** having all authority
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) having all authority
Type: Idiom
"all in all" (to be all in all) = to be supremely important / to have full authority (सर्वेसर्वा होना).
Why the others are wrong
• **every person / first in line / completely lost** – not the meaning.

Q.52 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
cut a sorry figure
(a) create a poor impression
(b) render an apology
(c) break a record
(d) make a sculpture
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) create a poor impression
Type: Idiom
"cut a sorry figure" = to make a poor/pitiable impression (बुरा प्रभाव छोड़ना).
Why the others are wrong
• **render an apology / break a record / make a sculpture** – not the meaning.

Q.53 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
fight shy of
(a) to avoid **(b)** to invite
(c) to perform **(d)** to challenge
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) to avoid
Type: Idiom
"fight shy of" = to try to avoid something (कतराना/बचना).
Why the others are wrong
• **to invite / to perform / to challenge** – opposite or unrelated.

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Q.54 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
clam up

(a) to be frustrated **(b)** to become silent
(c) to be upset **(d)** to lose temper

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) to become silent
Type: Idiom
"clam up" = to suddenly stop talking / become silent (चुप हो जाना).
Why the others are wrong
• **frustrated / upset / lose temper** – not the meaning.

Q.55 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
forty winks

(a) a hot day **(b)** a short nap
(c) a worthless object **(d)** a brief statement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a short nap
Type: Idiom
"forty winks" = a short sleep, especially during the day (झपकी).
Why the others are wrong
• **a hot day / a worthless object / a brief statement** – not the meaning.

Q.56 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
hold your horses

(a) aim high **(b)** fight trouble
(c) slow down **(d)** not get upset

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) slow down
Type: Idiom
"hold your horses" = wait, slow down, be patient (ज़रा रुको/ जल्दबाज़ी न करो).
Why the others are wrong
• **aim high / fight trouble / not get upset** – not the meaning.

Q.57 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
bury the hatchet

(a) sow the seeds **(b)** forget past quarrels
(c) dig a grave **(d)** hide a treasure

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) forget past quarrels
Type: Idiom
"bury the hatchet" = to make peace / end a quarrel (सुलह कर लेना).
Why the others are wrong
• **sow the seeds / dig a grave / hide a treasure** – not the meaning.

Q.58 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
lend an ear

(a) pay attention to
(b) be good for a particular thing
(c) not make trouble
(d) not tell something to others

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) pay attention to
Type: Idiom
"lend an ear" = to listen / pay attention to someone (ध्यान से सुनना).
Why the others are wrong
• **be good for a thing / not make trouble / not tell others** – not the meaning.

Q.59 Select the most appropriate meaning of the highlighted idiom.
The youth involved in the accident escaped by the skin of his teeth.

(a) Very arrogant
(b) Deficiency of funds
(c) Always taking calculated decisions
(d) Barely managed to escape

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Barely managed to escape
By the skin of his teeth – barely, very narrowly.

Q.60 Select the most appropriate meaning of the highlighted idiom.It was a Catch 22 situation for the manager.

(a) A positive outcome in a tough situation
(b) Hailed as the ultimate champion
(c) A difficult situation in which the solution to a problem is impossible
(d) Worthy successor to the throne

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A difficult situation in which the solution to a problem is impossible
Catch 22 situation – a difficult situation in which the solution to a problem is impossible.

Q.61 Select the most appropriate meaning of the highlighted idiom.The team members seem to be running around in circles.

(a) Very dynamic and hardworking
(b) Hardly any time to breathe
(c) To be very active but with few results
(d) To be extremely successful

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) To be very active but with few results
Running around in circles – to engage in a lot of activity or effort without making any progress or achieving anything useful. So, option (c) is the correct answer to this question.

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Q.62 Select the most appropriate meaning of the highlighted idiomThe actress' daughter is just a chip off the old block

(a) To get into the enemy's territory
(b) To chip off the edges
(c) To console the dreary
(d) Similar to one's parents in behaviour

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Similar to one's parents in behaviour
A chip off the old block – similar to one's parents in behavior. So, option (d) is the correct choice.

Q.63 Select the most appropriate meaning of the highlighted idiom.The employee took the manager's remark with a pinch of salt

(a) Distasteful and boring
(b) Doubt the truth or value of something
(c) Ever ready to condemn someone
(d) Going for the truth

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Doubt the truth or value of something
Take something with a pinch of salt – to be skeptical or doubtful about the truth of something.

Q.64 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Water under the bridge

(a) Promises that are made to someone and never fulfilled
(b) Difficult situations in one's life
(c) A seasoned crop with a heavy demand
(d) Past events that are not important anymore

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Past events that are not important anymore
Water under the bridge – used to refer to events that are in the past and no longer regarded as important.

Q.65 Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.
Despite their differences, the two politicians decided to _____ and work together for the greater good.

(a) blow off steam **(b)** burn the midnight oil
(c) bark up the wrong tree **(d)** bury the hatchet

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) bury the hatchet
The correct answer is option (d).
Bury the hatchet: end a quarrel or conflict and become friendly.
Blow off steam: get rid of pent-up energy or strong emotion or stress.
Burn the midnight oil: read or work late into the night.
Bark up the wrong tree: pursue a mistaken or incorrect course of action or to look for something in the wrong place.
Hence, **"bury the hatchet"** is the correct answer.

Q.66 Select the sentence which gives the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Bite the bullet

(a) The chef prepared a delicious meal for the guests.
(b) Jack and Jill went up the hill to fetch a pail of water.
(c) The children played in the park on a sunny day.
(d) Despite the pain, Sarah decided to go ahead with the surgery.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Despite the pain, Sarah decided to go ahead with the surgery.
The correct answer is option (d).
Meaning of the given idiom:
Bite the bullet: decide to do something difficult or unpleasant that one has been putting off or hesitating over.
Hence, option (d) is the most appropriate answer.

Q.67 Select the most appropriate phrasal verb to fill in the blank. .
_____ that thought. It will be a great idea someday.

(a) Hold to **(b)** Hold against
(c) Hold on **(d)** Hold onto

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Hold onto
The correct answer is option (d).
The most appropriate phrasal verb to fill in the blank is "Hold onto."
"Hold onto" means to keep or retain the thought or idea for the future. The other options don't fit the context as well, and "Hold onto" is the correct choice here.
The complete sentence would be: **"Hold onto that thought. It will be a great idea someday."**

Q.68 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined phrase in the following sentence.
She was known for her <u>ability to communicate effectively and express herself clearly in writing and speaking.</u>

(a) mumbling **(b)** rambling
(c) incoherence **(d)** articulation

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) articulation
The correct answer is option (d).
"**Articulation"**: the formation of clear and distinct sounds in speech.
"**Mumbling"**: speaking or spoken in a quiet and indistinct way.
"**Rambling" :** (of writing or speech) lengthy and confused or inconsequential.
"**Incoherence":** the quality of being illogical, inconsistent, or unclear.
Hence, the word is **"Articulation".**

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Q.69 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom.
The team decided to pull out all the stops for their upcoming presentation.

(a) To do everything to make something successful
(b) Give up easily and without thinking much
(c) Wait patiently for a more favourable time
(d) Keep things simple and straightforward

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) To do everything to make something successful
The idiom **"pull out all the stops"** means to make a maximum effort, using all available resources, to achieve success or to make something happen. In the given context, the team is preparing to put in their best effort for the upcoming presentation.
Therefore, the correct interpretation of the idiom **"pull out all the stops"** is **"To do everything to make something successful."**
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.70 Complete the dialogue for Person B using the correct idiom.
Person A: I am so nervous. I don't think I should make the speech tomorrow.
Person B: No. You are just getting ____. You have prepared for this.

(a) hot feet **(b)** cold feet
(c) cold hand **(d)** cold foot

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) cold feet
Cold feet: An idiom meaning a loss of confidence or nervousness about something you were previously committed to doing.
Person A: I am so nervous. I don't think I should make the speech tomorrow.
Person B: No. You are just getting **cold feet**. You have prepared for this.
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.71 Complete the dialogue for Person B using the correct idiom.
Person A: We are all going to the club this weekend. Do you want to come?
Person B: Thank you for asking. But I don't like clubs. It's ____.

(a) not my cup, not my tea **(b)** not my cup of coffee
(c) not my cup of tea **(d)** my cup of coffee

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) not my cup of tea
The idiom **"not my cup of tea"** means that something is not to one's liking or preference.
Complete dialogue:
Person A: We are all going to the club this weekend. Do you want to come?
Person B: Thank you for asking. But I don't like clubs. It's **not my cup of tea**.
Therefore, the correct idiom to use in this context is **"not my cup of tea."**
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.72 Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank.
A lot of people are still _____ over the GDP issue.

(a) breaking a leg **(b)** over the fence
(c) by the fence **(d)** sitting on the fence

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) sitting on the fence
Sitting on the fence: To remain neutral or undecided.
Therefore, the most appropriate choice is "sitting on the fence."
The other idiom are:
Breaking a leg: An idiom used to wish someone good luck, particularly before a performance.
The idiom **"over the fence"** can be used literally or figuratively.
"By the fence" is not a common idiom.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.73 In the following question, out of the four alternatives, choose the one which gives the meaning of the given idiom or phrase.
A stitch in time saves nine

(a) Saving money for the future
(b) Drunk or intoxicated
(c) Timely action prevents more work
(d) Tailoring is a valuable skill

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Timely action prevents more work
Meaning: **a stitch in time saves nine** = fixing a small problem at once stops it from growing and needing much more work later *(समय पर किया गया छोटा काम बाद की बड़ी मेहनत बचाता है)*.
Example: Get that small leak repaired now — a stitch in time saves nine.
Origin.
From sewing: one stitch on a small tear today saves the many stitches a bigger tear would need later; "nine" was chosen partly for the rhyme with *time*.
Answer: **Timely action prevents more work**
Why the others are wrong.
• **Saving money for the future** = *to save for a rainy day (बुरे वक्त के लिए बचत)*.
• **Drunk or intoxicated** = *three sheets to the wind (नशे में धुत)*.
• **Tailoring is a valuable skill** — a literal reading of "stitch" *(दर्ज़ी का हुनर)*; the proverb is about timing, not tailoring.
The key word is "time", not "stitch".

Q.74 Choose the correct meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
There is no point developing bad blood with your neighbours.

(a) Business relations **(b)** Enmity
(c) Friendship **(d)** Family relations

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Enmity
option (b) is the correct answer.
Bad blood: a feeling of ill will, anger, or hostility between people; Enmity.
"This ***bad blood*** between friends is what made the dispute so bitter."

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Q.75 In the following question, out of the four alternatives, choose the one which gives the meaning of the given idiom or phrase.
To strain at a gnat and swallow a camel

(a) To be meticulous in everything
(b) To fuss over trifles while ignoring big issues
(c) To be extremely physically weak
(d) To have a very large appetite

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To fuss over trifles while ignoring big issues

Meaning: **to strain at a gnat and swallow a camel** = to fuss over tiny, unimportant matters while accepting or ignoring something big and serious *(छोटी बातों पर बाल की खाल निकालना और बड़ी गलती को अनदेखा करना)*.

Example: He checked every comma in the contract but signed away the land itself — straining at a gnat and swallowing a camel.

Origin.

From the Bible (Matthew 23:24).

Strict Pharisees strained their wine through cloth so as not to swallow a gnat (a tiny unclean insect), yet ignored the weightier duties of justice and mercy — "swallowing a camel".

Answer: **To fuss over trifles while ignoring big issues**

Why the others are wrong.

• **meticulous in everything** = careful about every detail *(हर बात में अत्यंत सावधान)* — the idiom mocks *misplaced* care; all-round care is *to dot the i's and cross the t's*.

• **extremely physically weak** = *as weak as a kitten (बहुत कमज़ोर)*.

• **a very large appetite** = *to eat like a horse (बहुत ज़्यादा खाना)*.

Word help.

gnat = a tiny flying insect *(मच्छर जैसा छोटा कीट)*.

Gnat = trifle, camel = the big issue: strict about the small, blind to the large.

Q.76 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
The officer asked his subordinates to keep him posted of the workplace developments.

(a) maintain secrecy
(b) keep sharing the latest information
(c) send letters by post
(d) not disturb him in matters

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) keep sharing the latest information

option (b) is the correct answer.

Idiom Keep him Posted: keep giving them the latest information about a situation that they are interested in.

Example: The doctors kept me posted about her condition.

Q.77 Select the most appropriate phrasal verb to fill in the blank.
The teacher asked the students to _____ their ideas during the class discussion.

(a) get on
(b) put off
(c) bring up
(d) bring about

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) bring up

The most appropriate phrasal verb to fill in the blank is **bring up.**

The sentence would be: **"The teacher asked the students to bring up their ideas during the class discussion."**

1. **Get on**: This phrasal verb typically means to make progress or continue with something. It is not the best fit for the context of discussing ideas during a class.
2. **Put off**: This phrasal verb means to postpone or delay. It doesn't align with the idea of expressing ideas during a class discussion.
3. **Bring up**: This phrasal verb is the most suitable choice. It means to introduce or mention a topic or idea for discussion. In the context of a class discussion, the teacher is likely encouraging students to present or mention their ideas, making "bring up" the correct choice.
4. **Bring about**: This phrasal verb means to cause or make something happen. It doesn't fit the context of discussing ideas during a class; it's more about initiating a change or result.

Q.78 Select the sentence that gives the most appropriate meaning of the idiom 'Keep your chin up'.

(a) The students diligently completed their homework assignments before the deadline.
(b) Despite facing setbacks, she remained positive and determined to achieve her goals.
(c) The hiker enjoyed the breathtaking view from the mountaintop, taking in the natural beauty.
(d) The scientist conducted experiments and gathered data to support his research hypothesis.

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Despite facing setbacks, she remained positive and determined to achieve her goals.

The idiom **"keep your chin up"** is used to encourage someone to stay positive and hopeful in difficult situations or when facing challenges.

Q.79 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Call it a day

(a) Stop working on something
(b) Begin with an assignment
(c) Involve many people for a simple job
(d) Name a particular day

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Stop working on something

The idiom **"call it a day"** means to stop working on a task or activity, typically because enough work has been done or it's time to rest.

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Q.80 Select the most appropriate option that best expresses the meaning of the proverb in the given sentence.
The salesperson for the project offered a sneak peek of the project as we expressed our interest in the area and amenities.

(a) Getting a preview of something
(b) To try something new
(c) Sending a brief letter
(d) To be in a winning position

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Getting a preview of something
The most appropriate option that best expresses the meaning of the proverb in the given sentence is: **Getting a preview of something**

Q.81 Select the most appropriate idiom that means the same as the given sentence.
Shyama looks innocent, but in reality, she is cunning.

(a) Fortune favours the brave.
(b) Beauty lies in the eyes of the beholder.
(c) Don't judge a book by its cover.
(d) Don't put all your eggs in one basket.

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Don't judge a book by its cover.
The most appropriate idiom that means the same as the given sentence "Shyama looks innocent, but in reality, she is cunning" is: **Don't judge a book by its cover.**
the idiom **"Don't judge a book by its cover"** perfectly encapsulates the idea that appearances can be deceiving, emphasizing the importance of looking beyond the surface to understand the true nature of a person or situation.

Q.82 Select the sentence that gives the most appropriate meaning of the idiom 'In hot water'.

(a) The children enjoyed playing in the pool on a hot summer day.
(b) The company faced challenges due to the economic downturn but managed to overcome them.
(c) The chef added spices to the dish to enhance its flavour and make it more delicious.
(d) After accidentally breaking the valuable vase, Sarah found herself in trouble with her parents.

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) After accidentally breaking the valuable vase, Sarah found herself in trouble with her parents.
The sentence that gives the most appropriate meaning of the idiom 'In hot water' is: **"After accidentally breaking the valuable vase, Sarah found herself in trouble with her parents."**
The idiom **"in hot water"** means to be in trouble or facing a difficult situation.

Q.83 Select the most appropriate phrasal verb to fill in the blank.
The teacher asked the students to _____ their essays before the deadline.

(a) land in
(b) put off
(c) hand in
(d) hand up

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) hand in
The most appropriate phrasal verb to fill in the blank is **hand in.**
The sentence would be: "The teacher asked the students to **hand in** their essays before the deadline."

1. **Land in**: This phrasal verb usually refers to a plane or object touching down on the ground. It does not fit the context of submitting essays.
2. **Put off**: This phrasal verb means to postpone or delay. It doesn't align with the idea of submitting essays before a deadline.
3. **Hand in**: This is the correct phrasal verb. It means to submit or give something to a person in authority. In this context, the teacher is asking the students to submit their essays before the deadline.
4. **Hand up**: This phrase is not a common phrasal verb. "Hand up" could be interpreted as raising one's hand, but it doesn't convey the idea of submitting or turning in essays.

Therefore, in the given sentence, the most appropriate phrasal verb is **"hand in,"** as it accurately reflects the action of submitting essays to the teacher before the deadline.

Q.84 Select the most appropriate idiom that best explains the given sentence.
Rajat irritated the street dog so much that it was about to bite him.

(a) If you can't beat 'em, join 'em.
(b) If you play with fire, you'll get burned.
(c) If it ain't broke, don't fix it.
(d) If you want something done right, you have to do it yourself.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) If you play with fire, you'll get burned.
The most appropriate idiom that best explains the given sentence is: **"If you play with fire, you'll get burned."**
The sentence implies that Rajat's actions, irritating the street dog, are risky and could lead to negative consequences, much like the cautionary message in the idiom "If you play with fire, you'll get burned." This idiom is used to advise against engaging in risky or dangerous activities that may have harmful consequences.

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Q.85 Select the most appropriate idiom that best explains the given sentence.
I was unable to solve the geometry question myself. So, I have asked my teacher to help me out.

(a) You can't always get what you want.
(b) When the going gets tough, the tough gets going.
(c) Two heads are better than one.
(d) Two wrongs don't make a right.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Two heads are better than one.

The most appropriate idiom that best explains the given sentence is: **Two heads are better than one.**

1. **You can't always get what you want:**
   - This idiom conveys the idea that one may not always get everything they desire, emphasizing the reality that life doesn't always go as planned.
2. **When the going gets tough, the tough get going:**
   - This idiom encourages perseverance and action in difficult situations. It suggests that resilient and determined individuals continue to work hard or take action when faced with challenges.
3. **Two heads are better than one:**
   - This idiom expresses the idea that collaboration or teamwork often leads to better outcomes. It suggests that combining the ideas and efforts of two people can be more effective than working alone.
4. **Two wrongs don't make a right:**
   - This idiom advises against responding to a wrongdoing with another wrongdoing. It emphasizes the importance of choosing ethical and just actions even when faced with an unfair situation.

In the context of the sentence, "Two heads are better than one" is the most suitable idiom as it aligns with the idea of seeking help from the teacher for problem-solving.

Q.86 Select the most appropriate phrasal verb that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.
The firefighters tried their best to extinguish the fire.

(a) put on **(b)** put out
(c) put in **(d)** put off

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) put out

- **Explanation:**
  Put out means to extinguish or stop something from burning, which is exactly what firefighters do with a fire.
  The other options are:
  Put on means to place something on the surface of something else.
  Put in means to insert something into a space.
  Put off means to delay or postpone something.

Q.87 In the following question, out of the four alternatives, choose the one which gives the correct meaning of the given idiom or phrase.
Let's call it a day and start over tomorrow morning.

(a) To start working for the day
(b) Give the day a specific name.
(c) To end the work for the day
(d) Check the calendar for the date.

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) To end the work for the day

Meaning: **call it a day** = to stop working for now, to decide one has done enough *(आज का काम समाप्त करना)*.
"start over **tomorrow morning**" confirms that today's work is ending.
Origin.
From the 19th-century phrase *call it half a day* — a worker leaving early; it later became "call it a day", declaring the working day finished.
Answer: **(3) To end the work for the day**
Why the others are wrong.
• **To start working for the day** — the reverse; that is *to get down to work* or *to start the day (काम शुरू करना)*.
• **Give the day a specific name** — a literal reading; the idiom has nothing to do with naming *(नामकरण)*.
• **Check the calendar for the date** — another literal reading; that is just *to look up the date (तारीख देखना)*.
Call it a day — and if it is evening, "call it a night".

Q.88 In the following question, out of the four alternatives, choose the one which gives the correct meaning of the given idiom or phrase.
Mr. Sharma complained that filing tax returns manually every year is a real pain in the neck,

(a) The task causes physical injury
(b) The task is very enjoyable
(c) The task is tedious and annoying
(d) The task requires medical expertise

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The task is tedious and annoying

Meaning: **a pain in the neck** = a person or thing that is very annoying or troublesome *(सिरदर्द, झंझट)*.
"**complained** that filing tax returns **manually every year**" — a repetitive chore he dislikes.
tedious = long, slow and boring *(उबाऊ)*.
Origin.
An early-1900s American phrase, a polite version of ruder "pain in the ..." expressions — the nagging ache of a stiff neck stands for something that keeps irritating you.
Answer: **(3) The task is tedious and annoying**
Why the others are wrong.
• **causes physical injury** — the literal sense; the idiom names no real pain *(शारीरिक चोट)*.
• **very enjoyable** — the opposite; for that, *a piece of cake* or *a joy (आनंददायक)*.
• **requires medical expertise** — a literal misreading of *pain (चिकित्सा विशेषज्ञता)*.
Complaining is the clue: a pain in the neck is a nuisance, never an injury.

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Q.89 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
My aunt has <u>the gift of the gab</u> and can socialize in any group.

(a) ability to speak eloquently
(b) ability to cook well
(c) ability to criticize anyone
(d) ability to spend time anywhere

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ability to speak eloquently
Type: Idiom
"the gift of the gab" = a natural talent for speaking fluently and confidently (वाक्पटुता).
Why the others are wrong
• **cook well / criticize / spend time** – none matches "talking well".

Q.90 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
Pradeep was so tired that he <u>hit the sack</u> as soon as possible.

(a) Went to bed **(b)** Accepted defeat
(c) Kicked the sack **(d)** Left work

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Went to bed
Type: Idiom
"hit the sack" = to go to bed / to sleep (सोने चला गया).
Why the others are wrong
• **Accepted defeat / Kicked the sack / Left work** – none means "went to sleep".

Q.91 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
The sad part of the agitation is that most of the leaders are only <u>paying lip-service</u> to the issue.

(a) growing angry and restless with the organisers
(b) making long speeches for the cause
(c) saying they agree although they do not support it
(d) partially impressing the crowds

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) saying they agree although they do not support it
Type: Idiom
"pay lip service" = to express support in words only, without real belief or action (केवल दिखावे का समर्थन).
Why the others are wrong
• **growing angry / long speeches / partially impressing** – none means "false, spoken-only support".

Q.92 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
There was no one in the team who could <u>bell the cat</u> and tell the producer the truth.

(a) warn the owners
(b) tame some animals
(c) do the impossible task
(d) ring the bells regularly

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) do the impossible task
Type: Idiom
"bell the cat" = to take on a dangerous or impossible task for the good of others (कठिन/जोखिम भरा काम करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **warn the owners / tame animals / ring bells** – too literal; miss the "risky, difficult task" sense.

Q.93 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
You must have a concrete project and not <u>build castles in the air</u> if you want to submit an application for a loan.

(a) have unrealistic ideas
(b) talk irresponsibly
(c) make unplanned buildings
(d) make unfaithful friends

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) have unrealistic ideas
Type: Idiom
"build castles in the air" = to make impossible/unrealistic plans or daydreams (हवाई किले बनाना).
Why the others are wrong
• **talk irresponsibly / unplanned buildings / unfaithful friends** – none matches "unrealistic dreams".

Q.94 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
Their relationship has <u>run into rough weather</u> ever since they fell in love with the same girl.

(a) become pleasant and cordial
(b) brought cool breeze and rains
(c) experienced difficulties
(d) become stronger and firmer

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) experienced difficulties
Type: Idiom
"run into rough weather" = to face difficulties or trouble (मुश्किलों का सामना करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **pleasant / cool breeze / stronger** – opposite or literal, not "difficulties".

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Q.95 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
The apple of discord among the brothers was their father's mansion in the country.

(a) Fruitful discussion **(b)** reason for quarrel
(c) hopeful attention **(d)** Sincere affection

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) reason for quarrel
Type: Idiom
"the apple of discord" = the cause of a quarrel or dispute (झगड़े की जड़).
Why the others are wrong
• **fruitful discussion / hopeful attention / sincere affection** – none means "cause of a fight".

Q.96 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
This problem is a hard nut to crack,it will take longer than they imagined.

(a) needs a lot of work
(b) is not interesting enough
(c) is difficult to solve
(d) involves breaking nuts

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) is difficult to solve
Type: Idiom
"a hard nut to crack" = a difficult problem or person to deal with (कठिन समस्या).
Why the others are wrong
• **needs a lot of work / not interesting / breaking nuts** – none captures "difficult to solve".

Q.97 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
My neighbour's son is very mischievous and always getting in everyone's hair.

(a) Entertaining them
(b) Annoying them
(c) Throwing things at them
(d) Pulling their hair

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Annoying them
Type: Idiom
"get in everyone's hair" (get in someone's hair) = to annoy/irritate them (परेशान करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **entertaining / throwing things / pulling hair** – none means "to annoy".

Q.98 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
I told you not to play the prank but you didn't listen, now face the music.

(a) put on earphones **(b)** sing popular songs
(c) accept the blame **(d)** listen to the songs

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) accept the blame
Type: Idiom

Explanation (contd.)
"face the music" = to accept the unpleasant consequences of one's actions (अपने किए का परिणाम भुगतना).
Why the others are wrong
• **earphones / sing songs / listen to songs** – too literal; not "accept consequences".

Q.99 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
I cannot take up any new assignment as I have my hands full.

(a) am very busy **(b)** am very rich
(c) am short of time **(d)** need to seek help

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) am very busy
Type: Idiom
"have one's hands full" = to be very busy / fully occupied (बहुत व्यस्त होना).
Application
"I cannot take up any new assignment as I **have my hands full**" = I am very busy.
Why the others are wrong
• **very rich / short of time / need help** – none is the exact meaning of the idiom.

Q.100 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
He runs for two hours at a stretch to build his stamina.

(a) painfully **(b)** easily
(c) comfortably **(d)** continuously

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) continuously
Type: Idiom
"at a stretch" = without a break, continuously (लगातार).
Application
"He runs for two hours **at a stretch**" = he runs for two hours non-stop.
Why the others are wrong
• **painfully / easily / comfortably** – describe *how* he runs, not the "non-stop" meaning of the idiom.

Q.101 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
The wedding preparations are in full swing.

(a) hard to arrange
(b) in great difficulty
(c) at the height of activity
(d) very costly affair

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) at the height of activity
Type: Idiom
"in full swing" = at the peak of activity, in full operation (पूरे ज़ोरों पर).
Application
"The wedding preparations are **in full swing**" = they are at their busiest.
Why the others are wrong
• **hard to arrange / in great difficulty / very costly** – none matches "at the peak of activity".

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Q.102 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
He knows the <u>ins and outs</u> of the case and has been chosen to defend the accused.

(a) expense involved
(b) time needed to complete
(c) high stakes
(d) complete details

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) complete details
Type: Idiom
"ins and outs" = all the detailed facts of something (पूरी जानकारी, बारीकियाँ).
Application
"He knows the **ins and outs** of the case" = he knows every detail.
Why the others are wrong
• **expense / time needed / high stakes** – none means "full details".

Q.103 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
The embezzlement in the company's accounts has <u>come to light</u>.

(a) been rewarded **(b)** been punished
(c) been concealed **(d)** been revealed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) been revealed
Type: Idiom
"come to light" = to become known / be revealed (सामने आना, प्रकट होना).
Application
"The embezzlement ... has **come to light**" = it has been revealed.
Why the others are wrong
• **been rewarded / been punished / been concealed** – none matches "become known".

Q.104 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
India's problem <u>boils down</u> to just one thing – lack of infrastructure for health services.

(a) heats up to **(b)** sums up to
(c) adapts to something **(d)** fulfils something

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) sums up to
Type: Idiom
"boils down to" = amounts to / can be summed up as (सार यह है कि, मूल बात यह है)।
Application
"India's problem **boils down to** just one thing – lack of infrastructure" = it sums up to one thing.
Why the others are wrong
• **heats up to** – not an idiom here.
• **adapts to / fulfils** – wrong meaning.

Q.105 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
The new CEO is in favour of giving plenty of <u>elbow room</u> to the managers.

(a) freedom to do what one wants
(b) leave to go on vacation
(c) huge salaries and perks
(d) tough competition

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) freedom to do what one wants
Type: Idiom
"elbow room" = enough space or **freedom** to act as one wishes (काम करने की पर्याप्त स्वतंत्रता).
Why the others are wrong
• **leave for vacation / huge salaries / tough competition** – none matches "freedom to act".

Q.106 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
You must seize the opportunity <u>to make amends</u> for your earlier curtness.

(a) to correct a mistake **(b)** to make a proposal
(c) to give a suggestion **(d)** to offer a deal

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) to correct a mistake
Type: Idiom
"make amends" = to make up for a wrong; to correct a mistake (भरपाई करना, सुधार करना).
Application
"seize the opportunity **to make amends** for your earlier curtness" = to correct your earlier rudeness.
Why the others are wrong
• **make a proposal / give a suggestion / offer a deal** – none matches "to compensate for a wrong".

Q.107 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
In times of economic recession, the demand for goods is <u>on the wane</u>.

(a) at the peak **(b)** on the rise
(c) on the decline **(d)** out of control

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) on the decline
Type: Idiom
"on the wane" = decreasing / declining (घटता हुआ).
Application
"In recession, the demand for goods is **on the wane**" = the demand is declining.
Why the others are wrong
• **at the peak / on the rise** – opposite (increasing).
• **out of control** – unrelated meaning.

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Q.108 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
When the miscreants saw the police they <u>beat a retreat</u>.

(a) protested strongly **(b)** attacked fiercely
(c) ran away **(d)** marched ahead

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ran away
Type: Idiom
"beat a retreat" = to run away / withdraw quickly (पीछे हटना, भाग जाना).
Application
"When the miscreants saw the police they **beat a retreat**" = they ran away.
Why the others are wrong
• **protested strongly / attacked fiercely / marched ahead** – opposite of "withdrawing".

Q.109 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Fair-weather friend

(a) A person who is a friend in all good and bad times
(b) A person who is not a friend, only an acquaintance
(c) A person who is a friend in all your difficulties
(d) A person whose friendship cannot be relied on in difficult times

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A person whose friendship cannot be relied on in difficult times
Type: Idiom
"Fair-weather friend" = a friend who stays only in good times and disappears in trouble (जो केवल अच्छे समय का साथी हो).
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** friend in all good and bad times – opposite (that is a true friend).
• **(b)** only an acquaintance – not the meaning.
• **(c)** friend in all difficulties – opposite.

Q.110 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Fight tooth and nail

(a) Be in high spirits **(b)** Insist on something
(c) Win the competition **(d)** Fight very fiercely

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Fight very fiercely
Type: Idiom
"Fight tooth and nail" = to fight or struggle with all one's strength, very fiercely (पूरी ताकत से लड़ना).
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** be in high spirits, **(b)** insist on something, **(c)** win the competition – none matches "fight fiercely".

Q.111 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To take pains

(a) To punish someone **(b)** To make efforts
(c) To bear atrocities **(d)** To remain silent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To make efforts
Type: Idiom

Explanation (contd.)
"To take pains" = to make careful, sincere efforts; to work hard at something (कठिन परिश्रम/प्रयास करना).
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** punish someone, **(c)** bear atrocities, **(d)** remain silent – none matches "to make efforts".

Q.112 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Make head or tail of something

(a) To make the best of an opportunity
(b) To figure out something
(c) To earn enough for one's needs
(d) To create something beautiful

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To figure out something
Type: Idiom
"Make head or tail of something" = to understand or make sense of something (usually used in the negative – "can't make head or tail of it") (कुछ समझ पाना).
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** make the best of an opportunity, **(c)** earn enough, **(d)** create something beautiful – none matches "to understand".

Q.113 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Fifth wheel

(a) An unneeded person **(b)** A much needed thing
(c) A helping hand **(d)** A wealthy person

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) An unneeded person
Type: Idiom
"Fifth wheel" = a person who is not needed / has no useful role (अनावश्यक व्यक्ति). (A cart runs on four wheels; a fifth is extra.)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** a much needed thing, **(c)** a helping hand – opposite ideas.
• **(d)** a wealthy person – unrelated.

Q.114 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Hold your horses

(a) Be responsible **(b)** Be indifferent
(c) Be inferior **(d)** Be patient

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Be patient
Type: Idiom
"Hold your horses" = wait a moment, be patient, do not rush (जल्दबाज़ी मत करो, धैर्य रखो).
Why the others are wrong
• **Be responsible / Be indifferent / Be inferior** – none matches the "slow down, wait" idea.

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Q.115 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Give and take

(a) Obliging each other mutually
(b) Taking something from others
(c) Giving away something for free
(d) Being mild in your dealings

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Obliging each other mutually
Type: Idiom
"Give and take" = a spirit of mutual compromise — each side gives something and takes something (आपसी लेन-देन / समझौता).
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** taking from others, **(c)** giving for free, **(d)** being mild – none captures the "mutual compromise" idea.

Q.116 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Hue and cry

(a) A polite request
(b) A noisy expression of anger
(c) A fair bargain
(d) An admirable idea

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A noisy expression of anger
Type: Idiom
"Hue and cry" = a loud public protest or noisy expression of anger (शोर-शराबा, सार्वजनिक विरोध).
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** a polite request, **(c)** a fair bargain, **(d)** an admirable idea – none matches the "loud protest" sense.

Q.117 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
A hard nut to crack

(a) A comfortable situation
(b) An easy problem
(c) A difficult person
(d) A highly priced item

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A difficult person
Type: Idiom
"A hard nut to crack" = a person or problem that is very difficult to deal with or understand (एक कठिन व्यक्ति/समस्या).
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** a comfortable situation, **(b)** an easy problem – opposite.
• **(d)** a highly priced item – unrelated.

Q.118 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Full of beans

(a) Vain and pompous
(b) Happy and energetic
(c) Mean and selfish
(d) Crazy and foolish

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Happy and energetic
Type: Idiom
"Full of beans" = lively, cheerful and full of energy (उत्साह और ऊर्जा से भरपूर).
Why the others are wrong
• **Vain and pompous / Mean and selfish / Crazy and foolish** – none matches the "lively and energetic" sense.

Q.119 Select the idiom that can substitute the underlined group of words.
All the candidates have <u>strong determination to succeed</u>

(a) Food for thought
(b) Raise the roof
(c) Flash in the pan
(d) Fire in their bellies

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Fire in their bellies
- **Food for thought:** Something worth serious consideration or reflection.
- **Raise the roof:** Make a lot of noise or celebrate loudly.
- **Flash in the pan:** Something promising that fails quickly; brief success.
- **Fire in their bellies:** Having **strong determination and passion** to succeed.

Thus, the idiom matching "**strong determination to succeed**" is **"Fire in their bellies"**.

Q.120 Choose the correct meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
The trip to Europe <u>cost us an arm and a leg!</u>

(a) Cost nothing
(b) Was cheap
(c) Was more than assumed
(d) Was very expensive

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Was very expensive
The idiom **"cost an arm and a leg"** means:
- **Something is extremely expensive** or **costs a lot of money**.

In the given sentence, it suggests that **the trip to Europe was very costly**.
Correct meaning: Was very expensive

Q.121 Select the meaning of the given idiom.
forty winks

(a) a secret signal
(b) a short sleep
(c) a long leave
(d) a deep sleep

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a short sleep
Solution:
The idiom **"forty winks"** means:
- **A short sleep or nap**, especially during the day or briefly when tired.

It's often used informally to refer to **a quick rest** to regain energy.
Answer: a short sleep

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Q.122 Select the most appropriate meaning of the highlighted idiom.
My friend was playing the devil's advocate in the discussion.

(a) One who pits the culprit against the lawyer
(b) One who is good at judgement
(c) One who argues against something just for the sake of arguing
(d) One who is composed at all times

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) One who argues against something just for the sake of arguing
Answer: 3 (**One who argues against something just for the sake of arguing**)
Meanings of each option:
- **One who pits the culprit against the lawyer:** Incorrect; unrelated meaning.
- **One who is good at judgement:** Incorrect; opposite meaning.
- **One who argues against something just for the sake of arguing: Correct meaning.**
- **One who is composed at all times:** Incorrect; unrelated meaning.

The idiom **"playing the devil's advocate"** means **to argue an opposing viewpoint, often just to explore the argument further or test its strength**.

Q.123 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
That's all she wrote

(a) There is nothing more to be said
(b) One-sided story
(c) An unreal and imaginary story
(d) Limited information

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) There is nothing more to be said
Idiom: *That's all she wrote*
Meaning: This phrase is used to indicate that nothing more can be said or done — a situation is final or concluded.
It is often used informally at the end of a story, event, or explanation, implying that everything has been covered.
Correct Interpretation: "There is nothing more to be said"

Q.124 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined idiom in the given sentence.
Some look to legislation to hasten the progress of social reforms.

(a) peek at **(b)** see
(c) ignore **(d)** rely on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) rely on
Answer: 4 (**rely on**)
The idiom **"look to"** means to **depend on or rely on someone or something for help or support**.
- **Peek at** – To glance quickly; unrelated.
- **See** – General term for vision; too literal and vague.
- **Ignore** – Opposite in meaning.
- **Rely on** – **Correct**; matches the meaning of "look to" in the context of expecting support from legislation.

Q.125 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Fly off the handle

(a) To make a mistake while performing a task
(b) To fly somewhere in hurry
(c) To lose one's temper suddenly and unexpectedly
(d) To forget something important

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) To lose one's temper suddenly and unexpectedly
- **To make a mistake while performing a task:** Incorrect. Not related to anger.
- **To fly somewhere in hurry:** Incorrect. Literal meaning unrelated to the idiom.
- **To lose one's temper suddenly and unexpectedly: Correct meaning**.
- **To forget something important:** Incorrect. Unrelated meaning.

"Fly off the handle" means to **suddenly lose one's temper or become very angry without warning**.

Q.126 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Chew the fat

(a) To get into an argument
(b) To gossip or chat casually
(c) To eat a large meal
(d) To make a difficult decision

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To gossip or chat casually
Idiom: *Chew the fat*
Meaning: To engage in casual or leisurely conversation, often gossiping or chatting informally with someone.
This idiom originates from the informal setting of friends or acquaintances spending time talking, often about trivial matters.
Correct Interpretation: "To gossip or chat casually"

Q.127 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To crow over something

(a) To be sensitive over something
(b) To revel boastfully over something
(c) To interfere in something
(d) To cry over defeat

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To revel boastfully over something
- The idiom **"to crow over something"** means **to boast or gloat over a success or someone else's failure** in an unkind or triumphant way.
- The word **"crow"** in this idiom comes from the noisy and proud sound made by a crow, which metaphorically represents **boastful behavior**.

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Q.128 Choose the most appropriate meaning of the underlined phrase.
She knew that the best way to <u>get into hot water</u> was to anger her boss.

(a) To be confused
(b) To get into trouble
(c) To enter into a hot water pond
(d) To have a shower

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To get into trouble

- The phrase **"get into hot water"** is an **idiom** that means **to get into trouble**, especially due to one's actions or words.

In the sentence:
"She knew that the best way to get into hot water was to anger her boss."
It implies that **angering her boss would cause her trouble**.
Let's examine the options:

1. **To be confused** – Not related to the idiom.
2. **To get into trouble** – Correct meaning of the idiom.
3. **To enter into a hot water pond** – Literal and incorrect.
4. **To have a shower** – Unrelated meaning.

Q.129 Choose the most appropriate meaning of the underlined phrase.
<u>In light of</u> his financial situation, he decided to cancel his holiday plans.

(a) Poor light to be replaced
(b) A dark room
(c) Appreciation of
(d) Because of

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Because of
Answer: 4 (**Because of**)
Meanings of each option:

- **Poor light to be replaced:** Literal interpretation; irrelevant here.
- **A dark room:** Literal and irrelevant to context.
- **Appreciation of:** Means expressing gratitude or admiration; incorrect.
- **Because of: Correct meaning**, indicating a reason or due to circumstances.

The phrase **"in light of"** means **"because of"** or **"considering something"**, used when a decision or action is based on specific circumstances or facts.

Q.130 Select the most appropriate option to complete the given idiom.
Pull someone's _____.

(a) hand **(b)** ears
(c) nose **(d)** leg

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) leg

- The correct idiom is: **"Pull someone's leg"**
- **Meaning:** To tease or joke with someone in a playful or harmless way.

Example:
Don't worry, he didn't mean it—he was just **pulling your leg**.

Q.131 Select the most appropriate option to complete the given idiom.
cool as _____

(a) air **(b)** a cucumber
(c) a river **(d)** ice

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a cucumber
Solution:
The correct and commonly used idiom is: **"cool as a cucumber"**, which means to be **very calm and composed**, especially in a stressful situation.

- **"Cool as air"** – not an idiom
- **"Cool as a cucumber"** – correct idiom
- **"Cool as a river"** – not standard
- **"Cool as ice"** – sounds similar but not the traditional idiom

Answer: option (b) (a cucumber).

Q.132 Select the meaning of the given idiom
bring to book

(a) calm someone **(b)** support someone
(c) teach someone **(d)** punish someone

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) punish someone
Solution:
The idiom **"bring to book"** means to **punish someone** or **hold them accountable** for their wrongdoing, especially through legal or formal action.
It is commonly used in contexts where someone is made to answer for misconduct or crime.
option (a): calm someone – unrelated to the idiom
option (b): support someone – opposite in meaning
option (c): teach someone – incorrect
option (d): punish someone – correct meaning of the idiom
Answer: option (d) (punish someone).

Q.133 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
have your heart in your mouth

(a) to get worse and worse
(b) to behave in a foolish manner
(c) to be extremely jealous
(d) to be extremely frightened

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to be extremely frightened
Solution:
The idiom **"have your heart in your mouth"** means **to be extremely frightened or nervous**, especially in a tense or suspenseful situation.
Example: *I had my heart in my mouth when the teacher was checking the answer sheets.*
option (a): to get worse and worse – unrelated
option (b): to behave in a foolish manner – incorrect
option (c): to be extremely jealous – incorrect
option (d): to be extremely frightened – correct meaning
Answer: option (d) (to be extremely frightened).

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Q.134 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Rock the boat

(a) divert someone's attention
(b) overcome a difficult situation
(c) pester and irritate someone
(d) disturb a stable situation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) disturb a stable situation
Solution
Meaning of the idiom:
"Rock the boat" means to **disturb a stable situation** or to cause trouble where things were going smoothly.
Why the other options are incorrect:
- **Divert someone's attention** – unrelated to stability of a situation.
- **Overcome a difficult situation** – opposite in meaning (resolving rather than upsetting).
- **Pester and irritate someone** – relates to annoyance, not the broader context of disrupting harmony.

Correct meaning: disturb a stable situation.

Q.135 Select the meaning of the given idiom.
lose your marbles

(a) miss an opportunity **(b)** lose respect
(c) be nervous **(d)** go insane

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) go insane
Solution:
The idiom **"lose your marbles"** means to **go insane**, become mentally confused, or act irrationally.
Example: *He's acting so strangely lately, you'd think he's lost his marbles.*
option (a): miss an opportunity – incorrect
option (b): lose respect – incorrect
option (c): be nervous – incorrect
option (d): go insane – correct meaning
Answer: option (d) (go insane).

Q.136 Select the meaning of the given idiom.
bad blood

(a) poor blood circulation
(b) hostility between people
(c) felling of brotherhood
(d) family of ill-repute

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) hostility between people
Solution:
The idiom **"bad blood"** refers to **hostility, hatred, or long-standing ill-feeling between people**, often due to past conflicts or disagreements.
Let's evaluate the options:
- **poor blood circulation** – literal meaning, not idiomatic
- **hostility between people** – correct idiomatic meaning
- **feeling of brotherhood** – opposite meaning
- **family of ill-repute** – unrelated meaning

Answer: option (b) (hostility between people)

Q.137 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
a mare's nest

(a) a familiar situation **(b)** a new situation
(c) a refreshing situation **(d)** a confused situation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) a confused situation
Solution:
The idiom **"a mare's nest"** refers to a **confused or illusory situation**, especially something that **seems exciting or important but turns out to be imaginary or mistaken**.
So, **"a confused situation"** is the most accurate meaning.
option (a): a familiar situation – incorrect
option (b): a new situation – incorrect
option (c): a refreshing situation – incorrect
option (d): a confused situation – correct
Answer: option (d) (a confused situation).

Q.138 Select the meaning of the given idiom.
cut from the same cloth

(a) belong to the same family
(b) to share resources
(c) to come from the same source
(d) to be of a similar nature

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to be of a similar nature
Solution:
The idiom **"cut from the same cloth"** means **to be of a similar nature**, especially in terms of character, behavior, or style. It is often used to describe people who are very much alike in their thinking or actions.
option (a): belong to the same family – incorrect, the idiom isn't about blood relations.
option (b): to share resources – unrelated to the meaning.
option (c): to come from the same source – close, but too literal and doesn't capture the intended figurative meaning.
option (d): to be of a similar nature – correct and most appropriate.
Answer: option (d) (to be of a similar nature).

Q.139 Select the meaning of the given idiom.
split one's sides

(a) be extremely amused **(b)** undergo a surgery
(c) meet with an accident **(d)** scream in pain

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) be extremely amused
Solution:
The idiom **"split one's sides"** means **to laugh very hard or be extremely amused**.
Let's examine the options:
- **be extremely amused** – correct meaning
- **undergo a surgery** – literal interpretation, incorrect
- **meet with an accident** – unrelated
- **scream in pain** – opposite tone

Answer: option (a) (be extremely amused)

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Q.140 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Swim with sharks

(a) To work with experts
(b) To be an excellent swimmer
(c) To operate among dangerous people
(d) To spend money recklessly

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) To operate among dangerous people
Solution:

- The idiom **"swim with sharks"** means:
  - To **operate among dangerous or ruthless people**, especially in business or competitive environments.
  - It suggests being in a risky situation where others might exploit or harm you.
- **Example:** *If you want to succeed in corporate law, you must learn to swim with sharks.*
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **"To work with experts"** – does not capture the danger implied by "sharks".
  - **"To be an excellent swimmer"** – literal meaning, not idiomatic.
  - **"To spend money recklessly"** – unrelated to the idiom.

Correct meaning:
To operate among dangerous people

Q.141 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Turn a blind eye

(a) Insult **(b)** Ignore
(c) Irritate **(d)** Abuse

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Ignore
Solution:

- The idiom **"Turn a blind eye"** means:
  - To **ignore** something intentionally, especially something wrong or undesirable.
  - Example: *The manager turned a blind eye to the employee's repeated lateness.*
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **Insult** – means to offend or disrespect someone.
  - **Irritate** – means to annoy.
  - **Abuse** – means to mistreat or use wrongly.

Correct meaning:
Ignore

Q.142 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Tall talk

(a) Exaggerating things
(b) Presenting illogical arguments
(c) Talking sorrowfully
(d) Exchanging heated words

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Exaggerating things

- **"Tall talk"** is an idiom that means **boasting or exaggerating**, often in a way that sounds unrealistic or unbelievable.

Explanation (contd.)

- It refers to making **claims that are too big to be true**.

Example:
Don't believe everything he says—most of it is just **tall talk**.

Q.143 Select the most appropriate option to complete the given idiom.
Actions speak louder than _____.

(a) things **(b)** words
(c) noises **(d)** pictures

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) words
Solution:

- The full idiom is: **"Actions speak louder than words."**
- Meaning:
  - What people **do** is more important and revealing than what they **say**.
  - It emphasizes that **behavior** is a better indicator of intent or character than **speech**.
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **"Things"** – too vague and doesn't fit the idiom.
  - **"Noises"** – unrelated and not part of the established expression.
  - **"Pictures"** – commonly used in another phrase: *"A picture is worth a thousand words."*

Correct completion:
Actions speak louder than words.

Q.144 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
A new broom sweeps clean

(a) New management makes far-reaching changes
(b) People tend to forget old things when new ones come
(c) New things are more attractive than the older ones
(d) New tools work effectively

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) New management makes far-reaching changes
The idiom **"A new broom sweeps clean"** means that **a new person in a position of authority (especially management) often makes many changes to improve things or assert control**, especially at the beginning.

- It comes from the literal idea that a new broom sweeps more thoroughly.
- Commonly used in workplaces or institutions to indicate reforms or policy shifts introduced by new leadership.

Q.145 Select the most appropriate option to complete the given idiom.
_____ lies in the eyes of beholder.

(a) Nature **(b)** Love
(c) Beauty **(d)** Happiness

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Beauty

- The complete idiom is: **"Beauty lies in the eyes of the beholder."**
- This means that the perception of beauty is subjective—what one person finds beautiful, another may not.

Thus, the correct and most appropriate word to complete the idiom is **"Beauty."**

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Q.146 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank and complete the given idiom.
Cost an arm and a _____

(a) nose **(b)** hand
(c) leg **(d)** foot

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) leg
Solution:
- The correct idiom is **"cost an arm and a leg"**, which means **something is extremely expensive**.
- It is a commonly used English expression referring to **a very high cost or price**.

Correct Sentence:
This designer handbag cost an arm and a leg.
Correct Option:
(3) leg

Q.147 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank and complete the given idiom.
Break the _____

(a) snow **(b)** ice
(c) chill **(d)** fog

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ice
Solution:
- The idiom is: **"Break the ice"**
- **Meaning**:
  - To do or say something to relieve tension or get a conversation started in a social setting.
  - Example: *He told a joke to break the ice at the beginning of the meeting.*
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **Snow, chill, fog** – none of these complete a recognized idiom in English in this context.

Correct idiom completion:
Break the ice

Q.148 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Bring to book

(a) Calm someone **(b)** Punish someone
(c) Support someone **(d)** Teach someone

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Punish someone
- The idiom **"Bring to book"** means:
  - To **punish someone** or **hold someone accountable** for wrongdoing.
  - It refers to taking legal or disciplinary action against a person for their actions.

Example Sentence:
- *The corrupt officials were finally brought to book after the investigation.*
  (They were punished for their corruption.)

Hence, the most appropriate meaning is **"Punish someone"**.

Q.149 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank and complete the given idiom.
Bite the _____

(a) bread **(b)** barb
(c) bullet **(d)** bean

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) bullet
Explanation:
The correct answer is **bullet**. The complete idiom is **"Bite the bullet"**, which means **to endure a painful or unpleasant situation that is unavoidable**.
Example: "I hate going to the dentist, but I'll have to bite the bullet and make an appointment."
Other options:
- **Bread** – Not used in this idiom; irrelevant in this context.
- **Barb** – Uncommon and doesn't fit the idiom structure.
- **Bean** – Used in phrases like "spill the beans," but not in this idiom.

Q.150 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Split one's sides

(a) To roar with laughter **(b)** To overeat
(c) To scream in agony **(d)** To undergo surgery

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) To roar with laughter
Explanation:
The correct answer is **To roar with laughter**.
The idiom **"split one's sides"** means **to laugh uncontrollably or very hard**, as if the laughter is so intense it might physically split your sides.
Other options:
- **To overeat** – Related to food, not laughter.
- **To scream in agony** – Implies pain, not humor.
- **To undergo surgery** – Literal interpretation; not idiomatic.

Q.151 Select the most appropriate option to complete the given idiom.
Sitting on the _____.

(a) boundary **(b)** fence
(c) tree **(d)** wall

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) fence
Explanation:
The correct answer is **"fence"**.
The idiom **"sitting on the fence"** means **being undecided or neutral in a dispute or argument**, not choosing any side.
Other options:
- **Boundary** – Not a part of the idiom.
- **Tree** – Not idiomatic here, may refer to physical position.
- **Wall** – Could imply physical sitting, but not used idiomatically in this context.

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Q.152 Select the most appropriate option to complete the given idiom.
Spill the _____.

(a) milk **(b)** beads
(c) tea **(d)** beans

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) beans
Explanation:
The correct idiom is **"Spill the beans,"** which means **to reveal a secret or disclose confidential information.**
It originates from an ancient voting system using beans, where spilling them would reveal the result prematurely.
Other options:
- **Milk** – Incorrect; not associated with this idiom.
- **Beads** – Incorrect; has no idiomatic meaning in this context.
- **Tea** – Though "spill the tea" is a modern slang for gossiping, the traditional idiom is "spill the beans."

Q.153 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank and complete the given idiom.
Hit the _____

(a) sack **(b)** bay
(c) head **(d)** bag

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) sack
Explanation:
The correct answer is **sack**. The complete idiom is **"Hit the sack"**, which means **to go to bed or go to sleep**. It's an informal phrase used to indicate that someone is retiring for the night.
Example: "I'm really tired, it's time to hit the sack."
Other options:
- **Bay** – Doesn't complete the idiom; "hit the bay" isn't a known phrase.
- **Head** – While "hit your head" is a common phrase, it doesn't fit this idiom.
- **Bag** – "Hit the bag" may relate to boxing, but it's not the idiom in question.

Q.154 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Be in apple-pie order

(a) Be in chronological order
(b) Be in a happy mood
(c) Be perfectly arranged and tidy
(d) Be extra sweet to people

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Be perfectly arranged and tidy
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Be perfectly arranged and tidy**.
The idiom **"be in apple-pie order"** refers to a situation or place that is **extremely neat, organized, and well-arranged**.
Other options:
- **Be in chronological order** – Refers to time sequence, not neatness.
- **Be in a happy mood** – Relates to emotions, not order.
- **Be extra sweet to people** – Misleading due to "apple-pie," but incorrect meaning.

Q.155 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank and complete the given idiom.
Piece of _____

(a) apple **(b)** sweet
(c) bread **(d)** cake

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) cake
Explanation:
The correct answer is **cake**.
The idiom **"Piece of cake"**, which means **something that is very easy to do**.
Other options:
- **Apple** – Not used in this idiom.
- **Sweet** – Doesn't form a recognized idiom here.
- **Bread** – Used in other idioms but not in this one.

Q.156 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
Cut from the same cloth

(a) To belong to the same family
(b) To share resources
(c) To have the same origin
(d) To have very similar qualities

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) To have very similar qualities
Explanation:
The correct answer is **"To have very similar qualities"**.
The idiom **"Cut from the same cloth"** is used to describe **two or more people who are very similar in character, behavior, or attitude**, often implying they think and act alike.
Other options:
- **To belong to the same family** – Refers to relation, but the idiom isn't limited to family.
- **To share resources** – Not related to personal traits.
- **To have the same origin** – Implies source or background, not qualities.

Q.157 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.
To get someone's goat

(a) To have affection for somebody
(b) To make one feel good
(c) To steal something
(d) To irritate someone

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) To irritate someone
Explanation:
The correct answer is **"To irritate someone"**.
The idiom **"to get someone's goat"** means **to annoy or upset someone**. It often refers to actions that provoke frustration or irritation.
Other options:
- **To have affection for somebody** – Not related to the idiom.
- **To make one feel good** – Opposite in meaning.
- **To steal something** – Literal interpretation, not the idiomatic meaning.

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Q.158 Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom.

Be on the same page

(a) Doing things with a partner

(b) Reading something together

(c) Having the same understanding

(d) Staying in the same place

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Having the same understanding

Explanation:

The correct answer is **Having the same understanding**. The idiom **"Be on the same page"** means that two or more people **agree or share a mutual understanding** about something, especially in discussions or teamwork.

Other options:

- **Doing things with a partner** – Involves cooperation but doesn't capture the meaning of shared understanding.
- **Reading something together** – Literal, not idiomatic.
- **Staying in the same place** – Unrelated to the idea of agreement or understanding.

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4. One Word Substitution

166 questions

Q.1 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
A person who is absolutely necessary for someone or something

(a) indelible **(b)** ineffable
(c) infallible **(d)** indispensable

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) indispensable
Type: One-Word Substitution
A person absolutely necessary for someone/something = indispensable (अपरिहार्य/अत्यावश्यक).
Meanings
• **indelible** – impossible to erase; **ineffable** – too great to describe; **infallible** – never wrong.

Q.2 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
The date on which an event took place in a previous year

(a) century **(b)** anniversary
(c) decade **(d)** millennium

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) anniversary
Type: One-Word Substitution
The date on which an event took place in a previous year = anniversary (वर्षगाँठ).
Meanings
• **century** – 100 years; **decade** – 10 years; **millennium** – 1000 years.

Q.3 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
Medical doctors who specialise in diagnosing diseases using X-rays, CT scans and ultrasound

(a) dermatologist **(b)** cardiologist
(c) radiologist **(d)** pathologist

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) radiologist
Type: One-Word Substitution
A doctor who diagnoses diseases using X-rays, CT scans and ultrasound = radiologist.
Meanings
• **dermatologist** – skin; **cardiologist** – heart; **pathologist** – lab tests of tissues/fluids.

Q.4 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
A set of rooms forming one residence in a building

(a) villa **(b)** suite
(c) bungalow **(d)** apartment

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) apartment
Type: One-Word Substitution
A set of rooms forming one residence in a building = apartment (also 'flat').
Meanings
• **villa / bungalow** – separate houses; **suite** – a set of hotel rooms.

Q.5 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
The organic component of soil, formed by the decomposition of leaves and other plant material

(a) silt **(b)** clay
(c) humus **(d)** alluvium

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) humus
Type: One-Word Substitution
The organic component of soil, formed by decomposition of leaves = humus.
Meanings
• **silt** – fine soil deposited by water; **clay** – fine sticky earth; **alluvium** – river deposit.
• **humus** – dark organic soil matter (ह्यूमस). ✓

Q.6 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
Two lengths of rope, wood or metal with crosspieces used for climbing up and down walls

(a) ladder **(b)** railing
(c) steps **(d)** stairs

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ladder
Type: One-Word Substitution
Two lengths of rope/wood/metal with crosspieces for climbing = ladder (सीढ़ी).
Meanings
• **railing** – a fence/barrier; **steps / stairs** – built-in stepped structures, not a portable ladder.

Q.7 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
A slowly moving mass or river of ice

(a) blizzard **(b)** typhoon
(c) glacier **(d)** avalanche

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) glacier
Type: One-Word Substitution
A slowly moving mass or river of ice = glacier (हिमनद).
Meanings
• **blizzard** – a snowstorm; **typhoon** – a tropical storm; **avalanche** – a sudden fall of snow/ice.

Q.8 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
Place where two or more rivers meet

(a) delta **(b)** strait
(c) confluence **(d)** estuary

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) confluence
Type: One-Word Substitution
A place where two or more rivers meet = confluence (संगम).
Meanings
• **delta** – river mouth deposit; **strait** – narrow sea channel; **estuary** – where a river meets the sea.

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Q.9 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
A ruler with complete power over a country

(a) democrat **(b)** traitor
(c) aristocrat **(d)** dictator

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) dictator
Type: One-Word Substitution
A ruler with complete power over a country = dictator (तानाशाह).
Meanings
• **democrat** – supporter of democracy; **traitor** – a betrayer; **aristocrat** – a noble.

Q.10 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
A person who eats the flesh of other human beings.

(a) aborigine **(b)** cannibal
(c) tribal **(d)** savage

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) cannibal
Type: One-Word Substitution
A person who eats the flesh of other human beings = cannibal (नरभक्षी).
Meanings
• **aborigine** – an original inhabitant; **tribal** – of a tribe; **savage** – a wild/uncivilised person.

Q.11 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
Something of little value or importance

(a) fundamental **(b)** scanty
(c) trivial **(d)** cardinal

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) trivial
Type: One-Word Substitution
Something of little value or importance = trivial (तुच्छ/महत्वहीन).
Meanings
• **fundamental / cardinal** – very important (opposite); **scanty** – meagre in quantity.

Q.12 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
Persons who rob ships

(a) dacoits **(b)** bandits
(c) pirates **(d)** robbers

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) pirates
Type: One-Word Substitution
Persons who rob ships (at sea) = pirates (समुद्री लुटेरे).
Meanings
• **dacoits / bandits / robbers** – rob on land, not ships at sea.

Q.13 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
Safe to drink

(a) Feasible **(b)** Delectable
(c) Potable **(d)** Edible

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Potable
Type: One-Word Substitution
Safe to drink = potable (पीने योग्य).
Meanings
• **Feasible** – possible; **Delectable** – delicious; **Edible** – safe to **eat** (not drink).

Q.14 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
The state of being married to one person at a time

(a) Monogamy **(b)** Polygamy
(c) Homogamy **(d)** Bigamy

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Monogamy
Type: One-Word Substitution
The state of being married to one person at a time = monogamy (एक-विवाह).
Meanings
• **Polygamy** – many spouses; **Bigamy** – marrying while already married; **Homogamy** – marrying within one's group.

Q.15 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
A close-fitting cover for a sword

(a) Quiver **(b)** Shank
(c) Dagger **(d)** Sheath

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Sheath
Type: One-Word Substitution
A close-fitting cover for a sword = sheath (म्यान).
Meanings
• **Quiver** – a case for arrows; **Shank** – part of a tool/leg; **Dagger** – a short knife.

Q.16 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
A doctor who treats skin diseases

(a) Orthodontist **(b)** Dermatologist
(c) Ophthalmologist **(d)** Cardiologist

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Dermatologist
Type: One-Word Substitution
A doctor who treats skin diseases = dermatologist (त्वचा रोग विशेषज्ञ).
Meanings
• **Orthodontist** – teeth alignment; **Ophthalmologist** – eyes; **Cardiologist** – heart.

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Q.17 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
A group of lions

(a) Herd **(b)** Pack
(c) Pride **(d)** Colony

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Pride
Type: One-Word Substitution (Collective Noun)
A group of lions = pride (शेरों का समूह).
Meanings
• **Herd** – cattle; **Pack** – wolves/dogs; **Colony** – ants/bacteria.

Q.18 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
A place where gambling games are played

(a) Stadium **(b)** Arena
(c) Gymnasium **(d)** Casino

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Casino
Type: One-Word Substitution
A place where gambling games are played = casino (जुआघर).
Meanings
• **Stadium / Arena** – for sports; **Gymnasium** – for exercise.

Q.19 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
A very large impressive residence

(a) Igloo **(b)** Mansion
(c) Cabin **(d)** Cottage

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Mansion
Type: One-Word Substitution
A very large, impressive residence = mansion (हवेली).
Meanings
• **Igloo** – a snow house; **Cabin / Cottage** – small simple houses.

Q.20 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
One who does not care for art or literature

(a) Pessimist **(b)** Plagiarist
(c) Philistine **(d)** Philatelist

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Philistine
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who does not care for art or literature = philistine (कलाविमुख व्यक्ति).
Meanings
• **Pessimist** – expects the worst; **Plagiarist** – one who copies others' work; **Philatelist** – a stamp collector.

Q.21 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
A group of stars that make a pattern

(a) Horizon **(b)** Comet
(c) Constellation **(d)** Planet

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Constellation
Type: One-Word Substitution
A group of stars that make a pattern = constellation (तारामंडल).
Meanings
• **Horizon** – where earth meets sky; **Comet** – an icy space body; **Planet** – orbits a star.

Q.22 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
A government by the nobles

(a) Oligarchy **(b)** Democracy
(c) Aristocracy **(d)** Monarchy

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Aristocracy
Type: One-Word Substitution
A government by the nobles = aristocracy (कुलीनतंत्र).
Meanings
• **Oligarchy** – rule by a small group; **Democracy** – rule by the people; **Monarchy** – rule by a king/queen.

Q.23 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
An imaginary ideal society

(a) Utopia **(b)** Ultimate
(c) Model **(d)** Flawless

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Utopia
Type: One-Word Substitution
An imaginary ideal society = utopia (कल्पित आदर्श समाज).
Meanings
• **Ultimate** – final; **Model** – an example; **Flawless** – without faults (adjectives, not "an ideal society").

Q.24 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
A word or law no longer in use

(a) Absolute **(b)** Obsolete
(c) Venerable **(d)** Vintage

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Obsolete
Type: One-Word Substitution
A word or law no longer in use = obsolete (अप्रचलित).
Meanings
• **Absolute** – complete; **Venerable** – deserving respect; **Vintage** – of high quality from the past.

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Q.25 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
A partner in crime

(a) Agent **(b)** Amateur
(c) Alibi **(d)** Accomplice

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Accomplice
Type: One-Word Substitution
A partner in crime = accomplice (सहअपराधी).
Meanings
• **Agent** – a representative; **Amateur** – a non-professional; **Alibi** – a plea of being elsewhere.

Q.26 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
A statement which cannot be contradicted

(a) Irreparable **(b)** Irrational
(c) Irrefutable **(d)** Irresistible

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Irrefutable
Type: One-Word Substitution
A statement which cannot be contradicted = irrefutable (अखंडनीय).
Meanings
• **Irreparable** – cannot be repaired; **Irrational** – illogical; **Irresistible** – impossible to resist.

Q.27 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
Act of giving up the throne

(a) Addiction **(b)** Adulation
(c) Abdication **(d)** Admiration

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Abdication
Type: One-Word Substitution
The act of giving up the throne = abdication (राजगद्दी का त्याग).
Meanings
• **Addiction** – dependence; **Adulation** – excessive praise; **Admiration** – respect.

Q.28 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
A group of people travelling together, especially in a desert

(a) Caravan **(b)** Parade
(c) Procession **(d)** Pilgrimage

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Caravan
Type: One-Word Substitution
A group of people travelling together, especially in a desert = caravan (कारवाँ).
Meanings
• **Parade / Procession** – a formal march; **Pilgrimage** – a journey to a holy place.

Q.29 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
An extreme fear of darkness

(a) Hemophobia **(b)** Nyctophobia
(c) Hydrophobia **(d)** Acrophobia

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Nyctophobia
Type: One-Word Substitution
An extreme fear of darkness = nyctophobia (अंधकार-भय).
Meanings
• **Hemophobia** – fear of blood; **Hydrophobia** – fear of water; **Acrophobia** – fear of heights.

Q.30 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
Obsessive desire to lose weight by refusing to eat

(a) Asphyxia **(b)** Dyslexia
(c) Anorexia **(d)** Pyrexia

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Anorexia
Type: One-Word Substitution
An obsessive desire to lose weight by refusing to eat = anorexia (भूख-अभाव रोग).
Meanings
• **Asphyxia** – lack of oxygen; **Dyslexia** – reading difficulty; **Pyrexia** – fever.

Q.31 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
A group of cattle

(a) Pride **(b)** Flock
(c) Herd **(d)** Litter

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Herd
Type: One-Word Substitution (Collective Noun)
A group of cattle = herd (झुंड).
Meanings
• **Pride** – lions; **Flock** – birds/sheep; **Litter** – newborn animals.

Q.32 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
Not supporting any side in an argument

(a) Involved **(b)** Impartial
(c) Biased **(d)** Natural

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Impartial
Type: One-Word Substitution
Not supporting any side in an argument = impartial (निष्पक्ष).
Meanings
• **Involved** – taking part; **Biased** – prejudiced (opposite); **Natural** – unrelated.

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Q.33 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
A state governed by old people

(a) Bureaucracy **(b)** Autocracy
(c) Democracy **(d)** Gerontocracy

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Gerontocracy
Type: One-Word Substitution
A state governed by old people = gerontocracy (वृद्धों का शासन).
Meanings
• **Bureaucracy** – rule by officials; **Autocracy** – rule by one; **Democracy** – rule by the people.

Q.34 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given words.
A detailed list of things in a place

(a) Directory **(b)** Inventory
(c) Itinerary **(d)** Glossary

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Inventory
Type: One-Word Substitution
A detailed list of things in a place = inventory (सूची).
Meanings
• **Directory** – a list of names/addresses; **Itinerary** – a travel plan; **Glossary** – a list of terms with meanings.

Q.35 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
The science concerned with the properties of sound

(a) Acoustics **(b)** Acrobatics
(c) Geology **(d)** Pedagogy

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Acoustics
Type: One-Word Substitution
The science concerned with the properties of sound = acoustics (ध्वनिकी).
Meanings
• **Acrobatics** – gymnastic feats; **Geology** – study of the earth; **Pedagogy** – the art of teaching.

Q.36 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
A fast moving stream of water

(a) Torrent **(b)** Quake
(c) Volcano **(d)** Fissure

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Torrent
Type: One-Word Substitution
A fast-moving stream of water = torrent (प्रबल धारा).
Meanings
• **Quake** – an earthquake; **Volcano** – a mountain that erupts; **Fissure** – a crack.

Q.37 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
Profane talk

(a) Blasphemy **(b)** Origami
(c) Alchemy **(d)** Polygamy

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Blasphemy
Type: One-Word Substitution
Profane talk (disrespect towards God/sacred things) = blasphemy (ईश्वर-निंदा).
Meanings
• **Origami** – paper folding; **Alchemy** – medieval chemistry; **Polygamy** – having many spouses.

Q.38 Select the most appropriate one word substitution for the given words.
A glass container in which fish can be kept

(a) Fishery **(b)** Aquarium
(c) Aqua **(d)** Aquatic

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Aquarium
Type: One-Word Substitution
A glass container in which fish can be kept = aquarium (मछलीघर).
Meanings
• **Fishery** – a place for breeding/catching fish; **Aqua** – water; **Aquatic** – living in water (adjective).

Q.39 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Study of diseases

(a) Etymology **(b)** Anthology
(c) Neurology **(d)** Pathology

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Pathology
Type: One-Word Substitution
Study of diseases = pathology (रोग-विज्ञान).
Meanings
• **Etymology** – study of word origins; **Anthology** – a collection of writings; **Neurology** – study of the nervous system.

Q.40 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
A decision on which one cannot go back

(a) Irrevocable **(b)** Improbable
(c) Incorrigible **(d)** Incredible

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Irrevocable
Type: One-Word Substitution
A decision on which one cannot go back = irrevocable (अटल/अपरिवर्तनीय).
Meanings
• **Improbable** – unlikely; **Incorrigible** – beyond correction; **Incredible** – unbelievable.

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Q.41 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Made of artificial substance or material

(a) Offensive **(b)** Authentic
(c) Synthetic **(d)** Expensive

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Synthetic
Type: One-Word Substitution
Made of artificial substance = synthetic (कृत्रिम).
Meanings
• **Offensive** – rude/attacking; **Authentic** – genuine (opposite); **Expensive** – costly.

Q.42 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
One who possesses several talents

(a) Versatile **(b)** Virtuous
(c) Verbose **(d)** Virtual

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Versatile
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who possesses several talents = versatile (बहुमुखी प्रतिभा वाला).
Meanings
• **Virtuous** – morally good; **Verbose** – wordy; **Virtual** – almost/near.

Q.43 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Central character in a story or play

(a) Protagonist **(b)** Contender
(c) Adversary **(d)** Emulator

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Protagonist
Type: One-Word Substitution
Central character in a story or play = protagonist (नायक/मुख्य पात्र).
Meanings
• **Contender** – a competitor; **Adversary** – an opponent; **Emulator** – one who imitates.

Q.44 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
To free from restraint

(a) Subjugate **(b)** Escalate
(c) Emancipate **(d)** Validate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Emancipate
Type: One-Word Substitution
To free from restraint = emancipate (मुक्त करना).
Meanings
• **Subjugate** – to conquer/enslave (opposite); **Escalate** – to increase; **Validate** – to confirm.

Q.45 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Strong dislike between two persons

(a) Tolerance **(b)** Antipathy
(c) Adoration **(d)** Rivalry

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Antipathy
Type: One-Word Substitution
Strong dislike between two persons = antipathy (गहरी अरुचि/विद्वेष).
Meanings
• **Tolerance** – acceptance (opposite); **Adoration** – deep love (opposite); **Rivalry** – competition.

Q.46 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
A long wooden seat with a back for people to sit on in a church

(a) Altar **(b)** Pew
(c) Aisle **(d)** Pulpit

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Pew
Type: One-Word Substitution
A long wooden seat with a back, for people to sit on in a church = pew.
Meanings
• **Altar** – the raised table in worship; **Aisle** – the passage between rows; **Pulpit** – the raised stand for preaching.

Q.47 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
An entertainer who performs difficult physical feats

(a) Artisan **(b)** Artist
(c) Archer **(d)** Acrobat

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Acrobat
Type: One-Word Substitution
An entertainer who performs difficult physical feats = acrobat (कलाबाज).
Meanings
• **Artisan** – a skilled craftsman; **Artist** – a creative performer (general); **Archer** – one who shoots arrows.

Q.48 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
No longer in use

(a) Obsolete **(b)** Original
(c) Obscure **(d)** Oriental

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Obsolete
Type: One-Word Substitution
No longer in use = obsolete (अप्रचलित).
Meanings
• **Original** – first/new; **Obscure** – not clear; **Oriental** – of the East.

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Q.49 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Only on the surface of something

(a) Superficial **(b)** Superseding
(c) Superlative **(d)** Supercilious

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Superficial
Type: One-Word Substitution
Only on the surface of something = superficial (सतही/ऊपरी).
Meanings
• **Superseding** – replacing; **Superlative** – of the highest degree; **Supercilious** – arrogant.

Q.50 Select the most appropriate option for the given group of words.
Substance used for killing troublesome small animals like insects, mice etc.

(a) Infanticide **(b)** Homicide
(c) Fungicide **(d)** Pesticide

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Pesticide
Type: One-Word Substitution
A substance used for killing troublesome small animals like insects = pesticide (कीटनाशक).
Meanings
• **Infanticide** – killing of an infant; **Homicide** – killing of a human; **Fungicide** – kills fungi.

Q.51 Select the most appropriate option for the given group of words.
A period of thousand years

(a) Millennium **(b)** Century
(c) Decade **(d)** Centenary

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Millennium
Type: One-Word Substitution
A period of a thousand years = millennium (सहस्राब्दी).
Meanings
• **Century** – 100 years; **Decade** – 10 years; **Centenary** – a 100th anniversary.

Q.52 Select the most appropriate option for the given group of words.
A cruel and oppressive ruler

(a) Aristocrat **(b)** Democrat
(c) Traitor **(d)** Tyrant

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Tyrant
Type: One-Word Substitution
A cruel and oppressive ruler = tyrant (अत्याचारी शासक).
Meanings
• **Aristocrat** – a noble; **Democrat** – a supporter of democracy; **Traitor** – a betrayer.

Q.53 Select the option which means the same as the group of words given.
The sovereign head of a state

(a) Monolith **(b)** Monotone
(c) Monochrome **(d)** Monarch

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Monarch
Type: One-Word Substitution
The sovereign head of a state = monarch (राजा/शासक).
Meanings
• **Monolith** – a large single stone; **Monotone** – a single unchanging tone; **Monochrome** – in one colour.

Q.54 Select the most appropriate option for the given group of words.
The original natives of a country

(a) Tribal **(b)** Savages
(c) Cannibals **(d)** Aborigines

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Aborigines
Type: One-Word Substitution
The original natives of a country = aborigines (मूल निवासी).
Meanings
• **Tribal** – of a tribe; **Savages** – wild/uncivilised people; **Cannibals** – those who eat human flesh.

Q.55 Select the most appropriate option for the given group of words.
A set of rooms specially in a hotel for the use of one person or his family

(a) Flat **(b)** Suite
(c) Apartment **(d)** Abode

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Suite
Type: One-Word Substitution
A set of rooms, especially in a hotel, for one person or group = suite (कमरों का समूह).
Meanings
• **Flat / Apartment** – a residence in a building; **Abode** – a dwelling place (general).

Q.56 Select the option which means the same as the group of words given.
Something which is considered to be very important

(a) Supplementary **(b)** Meagre
(c) Cardinal **(d)** Scanty

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Cardinal
Type: One-Word Substitution
Something considered very important = cardinal (प्रमुख/मुख्य).
Meanings
• **Supplementary** – additional; **Meagre / Scanty** – very little.

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Q.57 Select the most appropriate option for the given group of words.
One who accompanies somebody to protect him

(a) Escort **(b)** Companion
(c) Guide **(d)** Defender

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Escort
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who accompanies somebody to protect him = escort (अनुरक्षक/संरक्षक).
Meanings
• **Companion** – a friend/associate; **Guide** – one who shows the way; **Defender** – one who defends (in general).

Q.58 Select the most appropriate option for the given group of words.
Too great to be expressed or described in words

(a) Infallible **(b)** Ineffable
(c) Indispensable **(d)** Indelible

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Ineffable
Type: One-Word Substitution
Too great to be expressed in words = ineffable (अवर्णनीय).
Meanings
• **Infallible** – never wrong; **Indispensable** – essential; **Indelible** – impossible to erase.

Q.59 Select the most appropriate option for the given group of words.
Soil deposited by flowing water

(a) Loam **(b)** Clay
(c) Humus **(d)** Alluvium

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Alluvium
Type: One-Word Substitution
Soil deposited by flowing water = alluvium (जलोढ़ मिट्टी).
Meanings
• **Loam** – a fertile soil mix; **Clay** – fine sticky earth; **Humus** – decayed organic matter.

Q.60 Select the most appropriate option for the given group of words.
A mass of snow, ice and rocks falling rapidly down a mountainside.

(a) Glacier **(b)** Avalanche
(c) Blizzard **(d)** Typhoon

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Avalanche
Type: One-Word Substitution
A mass of snow, ice and rocks falling rapidly down a mountainside = avalanche (हिमस्खलन).
Meanings
• **Glacier** – a slow river of ice; **Blizzard** – a snowstorm; **Typhoon** – a tropical storm.

Q.61 Select the most appropriate option for the given group of words.
A person who is neither well experienced nor professional

(a) Amateur **(b)** Proficient
(c) Veteran **(d)** Expert

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Amateur
Type: One-Word Substitution
A person who is neither well experienced nor professional = amateur (शौकिया).
Meanings
• **Proficient / Veteran / Expert** – all mean skilled/experienced (opposite).

Q.62 Select the most appropriate one word to substitute the given group of words.
symbols of royalty

(a) sceptre **(b)** regalia
(c) relic **(d)** emblem

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) regalia
Type: One-Word Substitution
Symbols of royalty = regalia (राजचिह्न).
Meanings
• **sceptre** – a single royal staff; **relic** – an old surviving object; **emblem** – a symbol/badge (general).

Q.63 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
an animal or person that eats a variety of food of both plant and animal origin.

(a) Herbivore **(b)** Omnivore
(c) Carnivore **(d)** Cannibal

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Omnivore
Type: One-Word Substitution
An animal that eats both plants and animals = omnivore (सर्वाहारी).
Meanings
• **Herbivore** – plant-eater; **Carnivore** – flesh-eater; **Cannibal** – one that eats its own kind.

Q.64 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
one who talks to oneself

(a) Soliloquist **(b)** Colloquist
(c) Ventriloquist **(d)** Somniloquist

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Soliloquist
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who talks to oneself = soliloquist (स्वगत भाषी).
Meanings
• **Colloquist** – one who converses; **Ventriloquist** – one who throws their voice; **Somniloquist** – one who talks in sleep.

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Q.65 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
a large single detached house with single or double story

(a) Suite **(b)** Bungalow
(c) Apartment **(d)** Penthouse

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Bungalow
Type: One-Word Substitution
A large single detached house (with one or two storeys) = bungalow (बंगला).
Meanings
• **Suite** – a set of rooms; **Apartment** – a flat in a building; **Penthouse** – a flat on the top floor.

Q.66 Select the most appropriate one word to substitute the given group of words.
one who is all powerful

(a) omnipotent **(b)** conqueror
(c) sovereign **(d)** emperor

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) omnipotent
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who is all-powerful = omnipotent (सर्वशक्तिमान).
Meanings
• **conqueror** – one who wins; **sovereign** – a ruler; **emperor** – a king of an empire.

Q.67 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
a book or set of books giving information on many subjects or on many aspects of one subject and typically arranged alphabetically.

(a) Glossary **(b)** Encyclopedia
(c) Dictionary **(d)** Thesaurus

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Encyclopedia
Type: One-Word Substitution
A book giving information on many subjects = encyclopedia (विश्वकोश).
Meanings
• **Glossary** – a list of terms; **Dictionary** – word meanings; **Thesaurus** – synonyms and antonyms.

Q.68 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
person who moves from one place to another, with intentions of finding work and settling, permanently or temporarily, at a new location

(a) Migrant **(b)** Tramp
(c) Vagrant **(d)** Nomad

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Migrant
Type: One-Word Substitution
A person who moves from place to place (to find work) = migrant (प्रवासी).
Meanings
• **Tramp** – a homeless wanderer; **Vagrant** – an idle wanderer; **Nomad** – a wandering herder with no fixed home.

Q.69 Select the most appropriate one word to substitute the given group of words.
a case for keeping a sword

(a) sheath **(b)** wrapper
(c) quiver **(d)** sleeve

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) sheath
Type: One-Word Substitution
A case for keeping a sword = sheath (म्यान).
Meanings
• **wrapper** – a cover for a parcel; **quiver** – a case for arrows; **sleeve** – a cover for the arm/record.

Q.70 Select the most appropriate one word to substitute the given group of words.
one who lives on others

(a) shrewd **(b)** parasite
(c) flatterer **(d)** hypocrite

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) parasite
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who lives on others = parasite (परजीवी).
Meanings
• **shrewd** – clever/cunning; **flatterer** – one who praises falsely; **hypocrite** – one who pretends.

Q.71 Select the most appropriate one word to substitute the given group of words.
one who speaks for others

(a) spokesperson **(b)** orator
(c) talkative **(d)** verbose

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) spokesperson
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who speaks for others = spokesperson (प्रवक्ता).
Meanings
• **orator** – a skilled public speaker; **talkative / verbose** – describing someone who talks a lot (adjectives).

Q.72 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
a doctor who specializes in heart diseases

(a) Urologist **(b)** Dermatologist
(c) Nephrologist **(d)** Cardiologist

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Cardiologist
Type: One-Word Substitution
A doctor who specialises in heart diseases = cardiologist (हृदय रोग विशेषज्ञ).
Meanings
• **Urologist** – urinary system; **Dermatologist** – skin; **Nephrologist** – kidneys.

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Q.73 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
A person who admires himself or herself too much, especially their appearance

(a) Narcissist **(b)** Egoist
(c) Selfish **(d)** Dictator

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Narcissist
Egoist – a person excessively concerned about himself and his own interests.Selfish – a person who lacks consideration for others. Who thinks only about himself even at the cost of othersDictator – a person with complete and absolute authority over a country.Narcissist – a person with excessive interest in or admiration of themselves and their appearance.

Q.74 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Willful destruction

(a) Disaster **(b)** Calamity
(c) Combustion **(d)** Sabotage

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Sabotage
Disaster – an event that causes a lot of harm or damage.Calamity – a disasterCombustion – the process of burningSabotage – a damage that is done deliberately for a specific purpose like to prevent an enemy from being successful

Q.75 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.Someone who is reserved and shy.

(a) Chauffeur **(b)** Extrovert
(c) Talkative **(d)** Introvert

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Introvert
Someone who is reserved and shy is an introvert.
Extrovert – an outgoing and social person.
Chauffeur – a private driver.
Talkative – a person who talks a lot.
So, the correct option is 'd'.

Q.76 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.Photographers who follow celebrities to get their pictures to sell them

(a) Interviewer **(b)** Paparazzi
(c) Editor **(d)** Reporter

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Paparazzi
Paparazzi – photographers who follow celebrities to get their pictures to sell them to newspapers, magazines, or other media outlets.
Reporter – one who collects and reports news for newspapers, magazines, or broadcasting.
Editor – one who is in charge of preparing and publishing a newspaper, magazine, or book.
Interviewer – one who conducts an interview, typically for a job or media- related purpose.

Q.77 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.One who is a boot licker and flatterer.

(a) Gold-digger **(b)** Gregarious
(c) Manipulative **(d)** Sycophant

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Sycophant
Gold-digger – someone who builds relationships only for financial gain.
Gregarious – a sociable person.
Sycophant – one who flatters to gain advantage.
Manipulative – someone use tricks to control others.
So, option (d) is the correct answer.

Q.78 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.The science and art of growing vegetables, fruits and flowers

(a) Herbing **(b)** Haplology
(c) Herpetology **(d)** Horticulture

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Horticulture
Horticulture – the science and art of growing fruits, vegetables, and ornamental plants.
Herpetology – the study of reptiles and amphibians
Haplology – the linguistic phenomenon of omitting one of two identical or similar syllables in a word.
Herbing – this is not a recognized word in englilsh.

Q.79 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.The one who loves mankind

(a) Philanthropist **(b)** Misogynist
(c) Pessimist **(d)** Optimist

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Philanthropist
Philanthropist – one who loves mankind and helps poor and needy.
Misogynist – one who hates women.
Optimist – who always sees the positive side of things.
Pessimist – one who sees negative side of things and expects the worst outcome.

Q.80 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.An arched structure in a garden having climbing plants

(a) Shed **(b)** Pergola
(c) Path **(d)** Shelter

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Pergola
Pergola – an arched structure in a garden or park consisting of a framework covered with climbing or trailing plants.
Shelter – a structure that provides protection. Example – a building or a hut.
Path – a route or track
Shed – a small building for storing gardening tools.

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Q.81 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the underlined part of the given sentence.
There is a <u>place for grains</u> in the backyard of this house.

(a) granary **(b)** archive
(c) apiary **(d)** dormitory

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) granary
The correct answer is option (a).
Granary: a storehouse for threshed grain.
Archive: a collection of historical documents or records providing information about a place, institution, or group of people.
Apiary: a place where bees are kept
Dormitory: a large bedroom for a number of people in a school or institution.
Hence, **granary** is the most appropriate answer.

Q.82 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
One who cannot make a mistake

(a) Inevitable **(b)** Impregnable
(c) Infallible **(d)** Inimitable

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Infallible
The correct one-word substitute for **"one who cannot make a mistake"** is:
Infallible
Infallible means incapable of making mistakes or being wrong.
The other options are:
Inevitable means certain to happen or unavoidable.
Impregnable means unable to be defeated or captured.
Inimitable means impossible to imitate or match.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.83 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
A sudden and violent change or upheaval

(a) Serenity **(b)** Tranquility
(c) Equanimity **(d)** Turbulence

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Turbulence
The correct answer is **Turbulence**, as it aligns with **"a sudden and violent change or upheaval."**
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.
The meaning of all other options are:
Serenity: Calm and peaceful state.
Tranquility: Peacefulness, free from disturbance.
Equanimity: Mental composure during difficult situations.

Q.84 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Speaking disrespectfully about sacred or religious things

(a) Bigamy **(b)** Biped
(c) Blasphemy **(d)** Belligerent

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Blasphemy
The correct one-word substitute for "speaking disrespectfully about sacred or religious things" is **Blasphemy**.

Explanation (contd.)
Therefore, the correct answer is **Blasphemy**.
The meaning of other options are:
Bigamy: The act of marrying someone while already being married to another person.
Biped: An organism that walks on two legs.
Belligerent: Hostile and aggressive.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.85 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Someone who walks on foot

(a) Auditor **(b)** Stalker
(c) Pedestrian **(d)** Decanter

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Pedestrian
The correct one-word substitute for "someone who walks on foot" is **Pedestrian**. Therefore, the correct answer is **Pedestrian**.
The meaning of other options are:
Auditor: A person who officially examines and verifies financial accounts.
Stalker: A person who pursues someone obsessively and secretly.
Decanter: A vessel used to hold the decantation of a liquid such as wine.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.86 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Someone who loves and admires himself the most

(a) Altruist **(b)** Recluse
(c) Omniscient **(d)** Narcissist

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Narcissist
The correct one-word substitute for "someone who loves and admires himself the most" is **Narcissist**.
- **Narcissist** refers to a person who has an excessive preoccupation with themselves and a strong admiration for their own appearance or abilities.

The other options mean:
- **Altruist**: Someone who is selflessly concerned for the well-being of others.
- **Recluse**: A person who lives a solitary life and avoids others.
- **Omniscient**: Someone who has complete or unlimited knowledge.

Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.87 In the following question, out of the four alternatives, choose the one which can be substituted for the given words/sentence.
Fear of ugliness.

(a) Acrophobia **(b)** Cacophobia
(c) Arachnophobia **(d)** Hydrophobia

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Cacophobia
<u>Meaning:</u> **cacophobia** = an abnormal fear of ugliness *(कुरूपता का भय)*.

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Explanation (contd.)
Greek *kakos* = bad, ugly + *phobos* = fear — the same *caco-* as in *cacophony* (an ugly, harsh sound).
Answer: **Cacophobia**
Why the others are wrong.
• **acrophobia** = fear of heights *(ऊँचाई का भय)* — Greek *akron* = peak.
• **arachnophobia** = fear of spiders *(मकड़ी का भय)* — Greek *arachne* = spider.
• **hydrophobia** = fear of water *(जल का भय)* — also an old name for rabies.
caco- = bad or ugly: cacophony (harsh sound), cacography (bad handwriting), cacophobia (fear of ugliness).

Q.88 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Giving cause for legal action

(a) Lawful **(b)** Actionable
(c) Objectionable **(d)** Legalizing

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Actionable
option (b) is the correct answer.
- Actionable: giving sufficient reason to take legal action.
- Lawful: allowed or recognized by law.
- Objectionable: extremely offensive and unacceptable.
- Legalizing: to make something legal.

Q.89 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
An official appointed to resolve a dispute

(a) Advocate **(b)** Soothsayer
(c) Arbitrator **(d)** Confidante

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Arbitrator
option (c) is the correct answer.
- Arbitrator: An official appointed to resolve a dispute.
- Advocate: a person (as a lawyer) who works and argues in support of another's cause especially in court.
- Soothsayer: a person supposed to be able to foresee the future.
- Confidante: a person who you trust and with whom you talk about private or secret things.

Q.90 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
One who plans the steps and moves in a dance

(a) choreographer **(b)** composer
(c) producer **(d)** director

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) choreographer
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who plans the steps and moves in a dance = choreographer.
Meanings
• **choreographer** – one who designs dance steps (नृत्य-निर्देशक). ✓
• **composer** – one who writes music; **producer** – one who finances a film; **director** – one who directs a film/play.

Q.91 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words/phrase.
A drug or other substance that induces sleep

(a) Energetic **(b)** Reviver
(c) Stimulant **(d)** Sedative

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Sedative
The most appropriate one-word substitute for the given group of words "A drug or other substance that induces sleep" is: **Sedative**
1. **Energetic:**
   - *Meaning:* Possessing or exhibiting energy, active, vigorous, or lively.
2. **Reviver:**
   - *Meaning:* Something that restores or renews vitality, strength, or consciousness.
3. **Stimulant:**
   - *Meaning:* A substance that increases physiological or nervous activity in the body, often temporarily enhancing alertness and energy.
4. **Sedative:**
   - *Meaning:* A drug or other substance that induces relaxation and sleepiness, calming or soothing the central nervous system.

Q.92 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
A sudden violent event that brings about great loss or destruction

(a) Blockbuster **(b)** Farce
(c) Intrigue **(d)** Catastrophe

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Catastrophe
The option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words is **Catastrophe.**
1. **Blockbuster**: This term originally referred to a very successful and popular movie, play, or book. It does not convey the idea of a sudden violent event causing great loss or destruction.
2. **Farce**: A farce is a type of comedy that exaggerates and relies on improbable situations for humor. It is not related to a sudden violent event causing great loss or destruction.
3. **Intrigue**: Intrigue typically refers to the secret plotting or scheming to achieve a specific purpose. It does not capture the sense of a sudden violent event and its consequences.
4. **Catastrophe**: This is the correct option. A catastrophe is a sudden and widespread disaster that brings about great loss or destruction. It aligns with the description of a violent event with severe consequences.

Therefore, the most appropriate one-word substitute for the given group of words is **Catastrophe**.

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Q.93 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Someone who has too much admiration for himself or herself

(a) Narcissist **(b)** Pantheist
(c) Misogamist **(d)** Misanthropist

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Narcissist
The option that can be used as a one-word substitute for someone who has too much admiration for himself or herself is **"Narcissist."**

1. **Narcissist**: This term refers to a person who has an excessive or erotic interest in themselves and their physical appearance. It is derived from the Greek myth of Narcissus, who fell in love with his own reflection.
2. **Pantheist**: A pantheist is someone who believes that the universe or nature is identical to divinity. This term does not describe someone with excessive admiration for oneself.
3. **Misogamist**: A misogynist is someone who dislikes, despises, or is strongly prejudiced against women. It does not relate to self-admiration.
4. **Misanthropist**: A misanthropist is someone who dislikes or distrusts humanity in general. This term does not capture the sense of self-admiration.

Q.94 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given phrase.
One who believes in fate

(a) Flirt **(b)** Fatalist
(c) Superstitious **(d)** Fatal

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Fatalist

1. **Flirt:** A person who behaves playfully and amorously without serious intentions, often engaging in flirtation or teasing.
2. **Fatalist:** A person who believes in the philosophy of fatalism, which is the belief that events are predetermined and inevitable, and that humans are powerless to change or control them.
3. **Superstitious:** Having or showing a belief in superstitions, which are irrational beliefs or practices often arising from fear of the unknown or belief in magic.
4. **Fatal:** Resulting in death or disaster; causing or capable of causing death or extreme harm.

Q.95 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
A solution for all difficulties or diseases

(a) treatment **(b)** remedy
(c) panacea **(d)** medication

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) panacea
Type: One-Word Substitution
A solution for all difficulties or diseases = panacea (a cure-all).
Meanings
• **treatment / medication** – care for a particular illness.
• **remedy** – a cure for one problem.
• **panacea** – a single remedy for **all** ills (रामबाण). ✓

Q.96 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words/phrase.
A phrase or words written in memory of a person who has died

(a) Epitaph **(b)** Calligraphy
(c) Tombstone **(d)** Epigram

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Epitaph
The correct one-word substitute for the given group of words/phrase "A phrase or words written in memory of a person who has died" is: **Epitaph**
Epitaph: A phrase or inscription written in memory of a person who has died, typically on a tombstone.
Calligraphy: The art of beautiful handwriting; decorative penmanship.
Tombstone: A stone marker placed at a grave to identify who is buried there; often inscribed with the deceased person's name, date of birth, and date of death.
Epigram: A concise and witty saying or remark, often expressing a satirical or paradoxical idea.

Q.97 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
The inability to obtain adequate sleep

(a) Mythomania **(b)** Andromania
(c) Insomnia **(d)** Pyromania

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Insomnia
The option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words "The inability to obtain adequate sleep" is: **Insomnia**

1. **Mythomania:** This term refers to a psychological condition where an individual has an excessive or abnormal tendency to lie or exaggerate.
2. **Andromania:** This term is not related to sleep; it refers to a condition where a person has an excessive or abnormal desire for sexual activity with men.
3. **Insomnia:** This is the correct option. Insomnia is a sleep disorder characterized by difficulty falling asleep, staying asleep, or both, leading to inadequate or poor-quality sleep.
4. **Pyromania:** This term refers to a psychological condition where a person has a compulsion to set things on fire.

In summary, "Insomnia" is the correct term because it specifically relates to the inability to obtain adequate sleep, which is the context provided in the given group of words. Insomnia is a common term used to describe sleep-related difficulties.

Q.98 Choose the correct option to give a one-word substitution for the sentence given.
A person who fills up the bodies of dead pets/animals to make them look lifelike.

(a) Misogynist **(b)** Mistymist
(c) Taxidermist **(d)** Egoistic

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Taxidermist
Meaning: **taxidermist** = a person who prepares, stuffs and mounts the skins of dead animals so they look alive *(मृत पशुओं में भूसा भरकर उन्हें सजीव रूप देने वाला)*.

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Explanation (contd.)
Greek *taxis* (arrangement) + *derma* (skin) — literally "one who arranges skin".
The art itself is **taxidermy**.
Answer: **(3) Taxidermist**
Why the others are wrong.
• **misogynist** = a person who hates women *(स्त्री-द्वेषी)*.
• **Mistymist** = not an English word at all — a made-up distractor *(कोई शब्द नहीं)*.
• **egoistic** = self-centred, thinking only of oneself *(अहंकारी, स्वार्थी)* — an adjective, not even a person-noun.
Taxi-DERM-ist works on the derma — the skin — just like a dermatologist.

Q.99 Choose the correct one-word substitution for the italicized phrase:
"After a long day, Maya sat by the window in a state of being pleasantly lost in her thoughts."

(a) Euphoria **(b)** Solitude
(c) Reverie **(d)** Delirium

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Reverie
Meaning: **reverie** = a state of being pleasantly lost in one's thoughts; a daydream *(दिवास्वप्न, सुखद विचार-मग्नता)*.
*Maya sat by the window **in a reverie**.*
Answer: **(3) Reverie**
Why the others are wrong.
• **euphoria** = intense excitement and happiness *(अत्यधिक उल्लास)* — joyful, but not *lost in thought*.
• **solitude** = the state of being alone *(एकांत)* — describes being by oneself, not daydreaming.
• **delirium** = a confused, disturbed state of mind, often from illness *(सन्निपात, प्रलाप)* — the opposite of *pleasant*.
Reverie rhymes with "dreamery" — a pleasant daydream.

Q.100 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
An underground hole dug by a small animal as a dwelling

(a) cave **(b)** pit
(c) burrow **(d)** drain

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) burrow
Type: One-Word Substitution
An underground hole dug by a small animal as a dwelling = burrow.
Meanings
• **cave** – a large natural hollow (गुफा).
• **pit** – a hole in the ground (गड्ढा).
• **burrow** – a hole/tunnel dug by an animal to live in (माँद/बिल). ✓
• **drain** – a channel for waste water (नाली).

Q.101 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
A person who does not believe in God

(a) sceptic **(b)** atheist
(c) spiritualist **(d)** hypocrite

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) atheist
Type: One-Word Substitution
A person who does not believe in God = atheist.
Meanings
• **sceptic** – one who doubts accepted beliefs (संशयवादी).
• **atheist** – one who denies God's existence (नास्तिक). ✓
• **spiritualist** – one who believes in the spirit world.
• **hypocrite** – one who pretends (पाखंडी).

Q.102 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
A room or building with equipment for doing physical exercise

(a) dormitory **(b)** infirmary
(c) convent **(d)** gymnasium

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) gymnasium
Type: One-Word Substitution
A room/building with equipment for physical exercise = gymnasium (gym).
Meanings
• **dormitory** – a large sleeping room (शयनगृह).
• **infirmary** – a place to treat the sick (चिकित्सालय).
• **convent** – a place for nuns (मठ).
• **gymnasium** – a place for exercise (व्यायामशाला). ✓

Q.103 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
An arrangement of events or dates in the order of their occurrence

(a) chronology **(b)** chronometry
(c) charter **(d)** calendar

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) chronology
Type: One-Word Substitution
An arrangement of events in the order of their occurrence = chronology.
Meanings
• **chronology** – order of events by time (कालक्रम). ✓
• **chronometry** – the science of measuring time.
• **charter** – a written grant of rights (अधिकार-पत्र).
• **calendar** – a chart of days/months (पंचांग).

Q.104 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
Sound of horses

(a) screech **(b)** squeak
(c) neigh **(d)** grunt

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) neigh
Type: One-Word Substitution (Animal Sound)
The sound of horses = neigh (a horse neighs – हिनहिनाना).
Meanings

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Explanation (contd.)
• **screech** – a harsh shrill cry; **squeak** – a short high sound (of a mouse).
• **neigh** – the cry of a horse. ✓
• **grunt** – a low sound (of a pig).

Q.105 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
Extreme fear of confined places

(a) cellophobia **(b)** centrophobia
(c) claustrophobia **(d)** chronophobia

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) claustrophobia
Type: One-Word Substitution (Phobia)
Extreme fear of confined/closed places = claustrophobia.
Meanings
• **claustrophobia** – fear of enclosed spaces (बंद जगहों का डर). ✓
• **cellophobia / centrophobia / chronophobia** – not the standard terms for closed-space fear (chronophobia = fear of time).

Q.106 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
A large number of fish swimming together

(a) herd **(b)** brood
(c) shoal **(d)** cache

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) shoal
Type: One-Word Substitution (Collective Noun)
A large number of fish swimming together = shoal (also "school").
Meanings
• **herd** – a group of cattle/animals (झुंड).
• **brood** – young ones of a bird (चूज़े).
• **shoal** – a group of fish (मछलियों का झुंड). ✓
• **cache** – a hidden store (गुप्त भंडार).

Q.107 Select the word which means the same as the group of words given.
Branch of physics dealing with the properties of sound

(a) acoustics **(b)** audition
(c) radiation **(d)** mechanics

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) acoustics
Type: One-Word Substitution
The branch of physics dealing with sound = acoustics.
Meanings
• **acoustics** – the study of sound (ध्वनिकी). ✓
• **audition** – a trial performance (श्रवण-परीक्षण).
• **radiation** – emission of energy (विकिरण).
• **mechanics** – the study of motion and forces (यांत्रिकी).

Q.108 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given group of words.
A person who shows people their seats

(a) usher **(b)** cameraman
(c) watchman **(d)** guard

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) usher
Type: One-Word Substitution
A person who shows people their seats = usher.
Meanings
• **usher** – one who guides people to their seats (in a hall/theatre) (द्वारपाल/परिचारक). ✓
• **cameraman** – one who operates a camera.
• **watchman** – a guard (चौकीदार).
• **guard** – a protector (रक्षक).

Q.109 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given group of words.
Introductory section of a literary work

(a) dialogue **(b)** epilogue
(c) monologue **(d)** prologue

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) prologue
Type: One-Word Substitution
Introductory section of a literary work = prologue.
Meanings
• **dialogue** – conversation between characters (संवाद).
• **epilogue** – the concluding section (उपसंहार).
• **monologue** – a long speech by one person (एकालाप).
• **prologue** – the opening/introductory section (प्रस्तावना). ✓

Q.110 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given group of words.
One who studies God and religion

(a) theist **(b)** theorist
(c) theologian **(d)** atheist

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) theologian
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who studies God and religion = theologian.
Meanings
• **theist** – one who believes in God (आस्तिक).
• **theorist** – one who forms theories (सिद्धांतकार).
• **theologian** – an expert who studies religion and God (धर्मशास्त्री). ✓
• **atheist** – one who does not believe in God (नास्तिक).

Q.111 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given group of words.
A fictitious name used by an author

(a) namesake **(b)** homonym
(c) pseudonym **(d)** alibi

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) pseudonym
Type: One-Word Substitution
A fictitious name used by an author = pseudonym (pen name).
Meanings

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Explanation (contd.)
• **namesake** – a person with the same name as another (हमनाम).
• **homonym** – a word with the same sound but different meaning (समरूप शब्द).
• **pseudonym** – a false/pen name used by a writer (छद्म नाम). ✓
• **alibi** – a plea of being elsewhere during a crime (अन्यत्र उपस्थिति का बहाना).

Q.112 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given group of words.
A speech expressing one's thoughts aloud to oneself

(a) soliloquy **(b)** harangue
(c) hyperbole **(d)** sacrilege

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) soliloquy
Type: One-Word Substitution
A speech expressing one's thoughts aloud to oneself = soliloquy.
Meanings
• **soliloquy** – speaking one's thoughts aloud, alone (आत्मगत भाषण). ✓
• **harangue** – a long, aggressive speech (भाषण/डाँट).
• **hyperbole** – exaggeration (अतिशयोक्ति).
• **sacrilege** – disrespect to something holy (अपवित्रीकरण).

Q.113 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given group of words.
People who work together at the same place

(a) agents **(b)** colleagues
(c) rivals **(d)** friends

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) colleagues
Type: One-Word Substitution
People who work together at the same place = colleagues.
Meanings
• **agents** – those who act on behalf of others (एजेंट).
• **colleagues** – co-workers (सहकर्मी). ✓
• **rivals** – competitors (प्रतिद्वंद्वी).
• **friends** – companions (मित्र) – not specifically co-workers.

Q.114 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given group of words.
To give one's authority to another

(a) usurp **(b)** shirk
(c) supervise **(d)** delegate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) delegate
Type: One-Word Substitution
To give one's authority to another = delegate.
Meanings
• **usurp** – to take power wrongfully (हड़प लेना).
• **shirk** – to avoid duty (कर्तव्य से बचना).
• **supervise** – to oversee (निगरानी करना).
• **delegate** – to hand over authority/work to someone else (अधिकार सौंपना). ✓

Q.115 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given group of words.
One who rides horses in races

(a) porter **(b)** sprinter
(c) jockey **(d)** athlete

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) jockey
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who rides horses in races = jockey.
Meanings
• **porter** – one who carries luggage (कुली).
• **sprinter** – a short-distance runner (धावक).
• **jockey** – a professional horse-race rider (घुड़सवार). ✓
• **athlete** – a sportsperson (खिलाड़ी) – too general.

Q.116 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given group of words.
A statement open to more than one interpretation

(a) axiom **(b)** ambiguous
(c) absurd **(d)** apparent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ambiguous
Type: One-Word Substitution
A statement open to more than one interpretation = ambiguous.
Meanings
• **axiom** – a self-evident truth (स्वयंसिद्ध).
• **ambiguous** – having more than one possible meaning (अस्पष्ट, द्वि-अर्थी). ✓
• **absurd** – ridiculous, illogical (बेतुका).
• **apparent** – clearly visible/obvious (स्पष्ट).

Q.117 Select the most appropriate one-word substitution for the given group of words.
Someone taken a prisoner to fulfil demands

(a) dealer **(b)** hostage
(c) host **(d)** guest

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) hostage
Type: One-Word Substitution
Someone taken prisoner to force others to fulfil demands = hostage.
Meanings
• **dealer** – one who buys and sells (व्यापारी).
• **hostage** – a person held captive to force demands (बंधक). ✓
• **host** – one who receives guests (मेज़बान).
• **guest** – a visitor (अतिथि).

Q.118 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
Branch of science that studies structure, classification and genetics of plants

(a) botany **(b)** biology
(c) geology **(d)** zoology

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) botany
Type: One-Word Substitution
The branch of science that studies plants = botany.

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Explanation (contd.)
Meanings of all options
- **botany** – study of plants (वनस्पति विज्ञान). ✓
- **biology** – study of all living things (जीव विज्ञान) – too broad.
- **geology** – study of the earth and rocks (भूविज्ञान).
- **zoology** – study of animals (प्राणी विज्ञान).

Q.119 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
A small mischievous fairy

(a) elf **(b)** brownie
(c) gnome **(d)** dwarf

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) elf
Type: One-Word Substitution
A small mischievous fairy = elf.
Meanings of all options
- **elf** – a small, playful, mischievous fairy (छोटी शरारती परी). ✓
- **brownie** – a helpful household spirit (घरेलू सहायक आत्मा).
- **gnome** – a small earth-spirit that guards treasure (बौना भू-प्रेत).
- **dwarf** – an unusually short person or mythical being (बौना).

Q.120 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
One who is violently against established traditions and beliefs

(a) iconoclast **(b)** stoic
(c) egoist **(d)** agnostic

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) iconoclast
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who is violently against established traditions and beliefs = iconoclast.
Meanings of all options
- **iconoclast** – one who attacks cherished beliefs/traditions (परंपरा-विरोधी). ✓
- **stoic** – one who stays calm and indifferent to pain or pleasure (सहनशील).
- **egoist** – a self-centred person (अहंवादी).
- **agnostic** – one who believes God's existence cannot be known (अज्ञेयवादी).

Q.121 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
An entrance hall in a building used by the public, especially a hotel or theatre

(a) gallery **(b)** foyer
(c) aisle **(d)** portico

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) foyer
Type: One-Word Substitution
An entrance hall used by the public (hotel/theatre) = foyer (lobby).
Meanings of all options
- **gallery** – a room/balcony for art or extra seats (दीर्घा).
- **foyer** – the entrance hall or lobby (प्रवेश कक्ष). ✓
- **aisle** – a passage between rows of seats (गलियारा).
- **portico** – a covered entrance with pillars (स्तंभ-युक्त द्वार).

Q.122 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
An arrangement of flowers that is usually given as a present

(a) blossom **(b)** garland
(c) bouquet **(d)** wreathe

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) bouquet
Type: One-Word Substitution
An arrangement of flowers usually given as a present = bouquet.
Meanings of all options
- **blossom** – a flower, especially on a fruit tree (फूल/मंजरी).
- **garland** – a string of flowers worn round the neck (माला).
- **bouquet** – a bunch of cut flowers given as a gift (गुलदस्ता). ✓
- **wreathe** – (verb) to encircle; "wreath" is a ring of flowers for decoration/funerals (चक्राकार माला).

Q.123 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
A doctor who attends to bone problems

(a) pathologist **(b)** orthopaedist
(c) paediatrician **(d)** cardiologist

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) orthopaedist
Type: One-Word Substitution
A doctor who attends to bone problems = orthopaedist (orthopaedic surgeon).
Meanings of all options
- **pathologist** – studies diseases through lab tests (रोगविज्ञानी).
- **orthopaedist** – bone and joint specialist (हड्डी रोग विशेषज्ञ). ✓
- **paediatrician** – children's doctor (बाल रोग विशेषज्ञ).
- **cardiologist** – heart specialist (हृदय रोग विशेषज्ञ).

Q.124 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
A person skilled in cutting, dressing, and laying stone in buildings.

(a) carpenter **(b)** artisan
(c) mason **(d)** architect

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) mason
Type: One-Word Substitution
A person skilled in cutting, dressing and laying stone = mason.
Meanings of all options
- **carpenter** – works with wood (बढ़ई).
- **artisan** – any skilled handicraft worker (कारीगर) – too general.
- **mason** – a stone/brick worker (राजमिस्त्री). ✓
- **architect** – one who **designs** buildings (वास्तुकार), not one who lays stone.

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Q.125 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
One who is beyond reform

(a) implausible **(b)** incomprehensible
(c) incorrigible **(d)** improbable

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) incorrigible
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who is beyond reform = incorrigible.
Meanings of all options
• **implausible** – hard to believe (अविश्वसनीय).
• **incomprehensible** – impossible to understand (समझ से परे).
• **incorrigible** – cannot be corrected or reformed (असुधार्य). ✓
• **improbable** – not likely to happen (असंभावित).

Q.126 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
One who talks in sleep

(a) ventriloquist **(b)** interlocutor
(c) somniloquist **(d)** soliloquist

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) somniloquist
Type: One-Word Substitution
One who talks in sleep = somniloquist (somni = sleep, loqui = to speak).
Meanings of all options
• **ventriloquist** – one who speaks so the voice seems to come from a dummy (पेट से बोलने वाला).
• **interlocutor** – one who takes part in a conversation (वार्ताकार).
• **somniloquist** – one who talks in sleep (नींद में बोलने वाला). ✓
• **soliloquist** – one who talks to oneself, a monologue speaker (स्वगत भाषी).

Q.127 Select the most appropriate word for the given group of words.
A traveller who moves from one region or country to another

(a) itinerant **(b)** migrant
(c) vagrant **(d)** truant

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) migrant
Type: One-Word Substitution
A traveller who moves from one region or country to another = migrant.
Meanings of all options
• **itinerant** – travelling from place to place, especially for work (घुमक्कड़ कामगार).
• **migrant** – one who moves from one region/country to another to live or work (प्रवासी). ✓
• **vagrant** – a homeless wanderer, a tramp (आवारा).
• **truant** – a child who stays away from school without permission (स्कूल से भागने वाला).

Q.128 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words/phrase.
Eternal; lasting forever or indefinitely

(a) perplex **(b)** permit
(c) perpetrate **(d)** perpetual

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) perpetual
Answer: 4 (**perpetual**)
- **Perplex** – To confuse or puzzle.
- **Permit** – To allow.
- **Perpetrate** – To commit (a crime or harmful act).
- **Perpetual** – **Lasting forever or for an indefinite time**; **correct one-word substitute**.

The word that best substitutes **"eternal; lasting forever or indefinitely"** is **"perpetual."**

Q.129 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
An incidence causing damage or suffering

(a) Catastrophe **(b)** Apostrophe
(c) Philanthropy **(d)** Commencement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Catastrophe
Answer: 1 (**Catastrophe**)
- **Catastrophe** – **A sudden event causing great damage or suffering**; **correct one-word substitute**.
- **Apostrophe** – A punctuation mark (') or a figure of speech; unrelated.
- **Philanthropy** – The desire to promote the welfare of others, especially through generous donations; opposite in meaning.
- **Commencement** – The beginning or start of something; unrelated to damage or suffering.

Hence, the correct one-word substitution for **"an incident causing damage or suffering"** is **"Catastrophe."**

Q.130 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words/phrase.
An extra profit or allowance additional to a main income etc.

(a) perquisite **(b)** persecute
(c) persevere **(d)** perplexity

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) perquisite
Answer: 1 (**Perquisite**)
- **Perquisite** – **An extra benefit or profit beyond the regular income; a perk**.
- **Persecute** – To treat someone unfairly or cruelly.
- **Persevere** – To continue steadfastly despite difficulties.
- **Perplexity** – A state of confusion or puzzlement.

So, the correct one-word substitute for **"an extra profit or allowance additional to a main income"** is **"perquisite."**

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Q.131 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
The state or quality of being young

(a) Prenatal **(b)** Solitude
(c) Youth **(d)** Puberty

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Youth
Answer: 3 (**Youth**)
- **Prenatal** – Before birth; unrelated to the state of being young.
- **Solitude** – The state of being alone; not related to age.
- **Youth** – **The state or quality of being young**; **correct one-word substitute**.
- **Puberty** – The stage when a person becomes sexually mature; refers to a specific biological phase, not the general state of being young.

So, the correct one-word substitute for **"the state or quality of being young"** is **"Youth."**

Q.132 Substitute one word for the italicised expression.
He was arrested for the murder of the king.

(a) homicide **(b)** suicide
(c) fratricide **(d)** regicide

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) regicide
Answer: 4 (**Regicide**)
- **Homicide** – The killing of any human being; general term.
- **Suicide** – The act of killing oneself.
- **Fratricide** – The act of killing one's brother.
- **Regicide** – **The act of killing a king**; **correct one-word substitute**.

So, the one-word substitution for **"murder of the king"** is **"Regicide."**

Q.133 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
A person who lacks competence and experience

(a) Expert **(b)** Amateur
(c) Proselyte **(d)** Immature

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Amateur
Answer: 2 (**Amateur**)
- **Expert** – Someone with a high level of skill or knowledge in a particular field; opposite in meaning.
- **Amateur** – **A person who engages in an activity without professional skill, training, or experience**; **correct one-word substitute**.
- **Proselyte** – A new convert to a religion or belief; unrelated to skill or experience.
- **Immature** – Lacking full development emotionally or mentally; may imply inexperience but not specifically related to **competence in a task**.

Thus, **"Amateur"** best fits as the one-word substitute for **"a person who lacks competence and experience."**

Q.134 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
A secret agreement especially in order to do something dishonest or deceive people

(a) Collusion **(b)** Colloquy
(c) Collision **(d)** Collocation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Collusion
Answer: 1 (**Collusion**)
- **Collusion** – **A secret agreement for a deceitful or fraudulent purpose**; **correct one-word substitute**.
- **Colloquy** – A formal conversation or dialogue.
- **Collision** – The act of crashing or colliding.
- **Collocation** – The habitual juxtaposition of words (like "strong tea"); a linguistic term.

So, the correct one-word substitute for **"a secret agreement to deceive"** is **"Collusion."**

Q.135 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
A person dealing with antiques

(a) Peddler **(b)** Archaeologist
(c) Antiquarian **(d)** Trader

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Antiquarian
Answer: 3 (**Antiquarian**)
- **Peddler** – A person who sells goods, especially small items, often by going from place to place; not specific to antiques.
- **Archaeologist** – A person who studies human history through excavation; not primarily a dealer.
- **Antiquarian** – **A person who deals in or collects antiques**; correct one-word substitute.
- **Trader** – A general term for a person who buys and sells goods; not specific to antiques.

Therefore, the correct one-word substitute for **"a person dealing with antiques"** is **"Antiquarian."**

Q.136 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
The quality of admiring oneself too much, especially one's appearance

(a) Sensationalism **(b)** Existentialist
(c) Narcissism **(d)** Hermaphroditism

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Narcissism
Answer: 3 (**Narcissism**)
- **Sensationalism** – The use of exciting or shocking stories to provoke public interest; unrelated.
- **Existentialist** – Related to existentialism, a philosophical theory; unrelated.
- **Narcissism** – **Excessive admiration of oneself, especially one's appearance**; correct one-word substitute.
- **Hermaphroditism** – A biological condition of having both male and female reproductive organs; unrelated.

So, the one-word substitute for **"the quality of admiring oneself too much"** is **"Narcissism."**

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Q.137 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the given group of words.
a wooden frame for holding an artist's work while it is being painted or drawn

(a) easel **(b)** platform
(c) podium **(d)** lectern

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) easel
Answer: (a) easel
- An **easel** is a wooden (or metal) frame used by artists to support a canvas while painting or drawing.
- **Platform** is a raised level surface (not specific to painting).
- **Podium** is used for speakers or conductors to stand on.
- **Lectern** is a stand to hold books or notes for a speaker.

Correct answer: easel

Q.138 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the given group of words.
A person who has excessive admiration of themselves

(a) egotist **(b)** fanatic
(c) narcissist **(d)** egocentric

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) narcissist
Solution:
The phrase describes **a person who has excessive admiration of themselves**. The most accurate word for this is **"narcissist"**.
- **Narcissist**: someone who has an excessive interest in or admiration for themselves – **Correct**
- **Egotist**: a self-centered or self-important person, but not necessarily to the level of admiration – **Close but not exact**
- **Fanatic**: someone with extreme enthusiasm, usually for a cause or belief – **Incorrect**
- **Egocentric**: self-centered, focused on oneself, but again, not specifically about **admiration** – **Less precise**

Answer: option (c) (narcissist).

Q.139 Select the correct option to substitute the given set of words.
to skip about playfully

(a) trundle **(b)** gambol
(c) scramble **(d)** amble

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) gambol
Solution:
The phrase **"to skip about playfully"** refers to moving or jumping around in a lively, cheerful, and often carefree manner.
- **Gambol** means **to skip or leap about playfully** – **Correct**
- **Trundle** means to move slowly and heavily – **Incorrect**
- **Scramble** means to climb or move quickly using hands and feet – **Incorrect**
- **Amble** means to walk slowly or leisurely – **Incorrect**

Answer: option (b) (gambol).

Q.140 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the given group of words.
Natural talent for something

(a) flavour **(b)** feeling
(c) favour **(d)** flair

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) flair
Solution
Meaning of the phrase:
"Natural talent for something" refers to an inborn ability or aptitude that allows someone to excel effortlessly in a particular field or activity.
Correct substitute:
Flair
- As a noun, **flair** means a **natural aptitude** or talent for doing something well.
- Example: *She has a flair for painting; her canvases always stand out.*

Why the others are incorrect:
- **Flavour** – refers to taste or variety, not ability.
- **Feeling** – denotes an emotion or sensation, not a talent.
- **Favour** – means an act of kindness or approval, unrelated to skill.

Q.141 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the given group of words.
a legal document authorizing the police or another body to make an arrest or search premises

(a) licence **(b)** permit
(c) decree **(d)** warrant

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) warrant
Solution:
The phrase describes **a legal document** that gives **authority to arrest or search**, which is specifically called a **warrant** in legal terms.
- **Warrant**: a legal authorization for arrest/search – **Correct**
- **Licence**: permission to do something, like drive or operate – **Incorrect**
- **Permit**: official permission, often temporary or specific to an activity – **Incorrect**
- **Decree**: an official order, usually by a legal authority or government, but not specifically for arrests or searches – **Incorrect**

Answer: option (d) (warrant).

Q.142 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the given group of words.
the husks of corn or other grains separated by winnowing or threshing.

(a) hay **(b)** chaff
(c) peel **(d)** fodder

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) chaff
Solution:
The phrase refers to the **dry outer coverings** of corn or other grains that are **removed during winnowing or threshing**. The correct word for this is **"chaff"**.
- **Chaff**: the husks of grains and grasses separated during processing – **Correct**

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Explanation (contd.)

- **Hay**: dried grass used as animal feed – **Incorrect**
- **Peel**: the skin of fruits or vegetables – **Incorrect**
- **Fodder**: food for livestock – includes hay, straw, etc., but not specific to grain husks – **Incorrect**

Answer: option (b) (chaff).

Q.143 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the given group of words.
one who is skilled and eloquent in public speaking

(a) spokesperson **(b)** orator
(c) lecturer **(d)** actor

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) orator
Solution:
The phrase **"one who is skilled and eloquent in public speaking"** defines someone who speaks impressively and effectively in front of an audience.

- **Orator**: a person who delivers speeches and is skilled in public speaking – **Correct**
- **Spokesperson**: someone who speaks on behalf of others, but not necessarily eloquently – **Not specific**
- **Lecturer**: someone who gives lectures, usually in academic settings – **More formal/instructional than eloquent**
- **Actor**: performs in plays or films – **Unrelated**

Answer: option (b) (orator).

Q.144 Select the correct option to substitute the given set of words.
one who cannot be corrected

(a) indefatigable **(b)** incorrigible
(c) vulnerable **(d)** versatile

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) incorrigible
Solution
Meaning of the phrase

- "One who cannot be corrected" describes a person whose behaviour or faults are so ingrained that they refuse or fail to improve despite guidance or punishment.

Option analysis

- **Indefatigable** – means tireless or persistent in effort, not related to being uncorrectable.
- **Incorrigible** – literally means incapable of being corrected or reformed.
- **Vulnerable** – means susceptible to harm or attack, unrelated to correction.
- **Versatile** – means having many skills or uses, the opposite of unchangeable.

Correct substitute

- **Incorrigible** perfectly matches "one who cannot be corrected."

Q.145 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the given group of words.
irrational fear of water

(a) claustrophobia **(b)** hydrophobia
(c) acrophobia **(d)** cacophobia

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) hydrophobia
Solution:
The phrase **"irrational fear of water"** refers to a **specific phobia**.
"Hydrophobia" is the correct term derived from Greek where:

- **"hydro"** means **water**
- **"phobia"** means **fear**
  So, **hydrophobia = fear of water**

option (a): "claustrophobia" is the fear of confined spaces.
option (c): "acrophobia" is the fear of heights.
option (d): "cacophobia" is the fear of ugliness.
Only **option (b): "hydrophobia"** matches the definition.
Answer: option (b) (hydrophobia).

Q.146 Select the correct option to substitute the given set of words.
a statement open to more than one interpretation

(a) palpable **(b)** tangible
(c) explicit **(d)** ambiguous

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ambiguous
Solution:
The phrase **"a statement open to more than one interpretation"** refers to something that is **unclear or has double meanings**.

- **Ambiguous** means **unclear or open to multiple interpretations** – Correct
- **Palpable** means **easily noticeable or felt** – Incorrect
- **Tangible** means **something that can be touched or physically felt** – Incorrect
- **Explicit** means **clear and fully expressed** – Opposite of ambiguous

Answer: option (d) (ambiguous).

Q.147 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
The branch of medicine that deals with the study and treatment of nervous system disorders.

(a) Cardiology **(b)** Dermatology
(c) Neurology **(d)** Urology

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Neurology

- **Neurology**: The branch of medicine that deals with the study and treatment of disorders of the **nervous system**, including the brain, spinal cord, and nerves.
- **Cardiology**: Deals with the heart and blood vessels.
- **Dermatology**: Deals with the skin.
- **Urology**: Deals with the urinary system and male reproductive organs.

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Q.148 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Able to withstand or recover quickly from difficult conditions

(a) Reliant **(b)** Remnant
(c) Resilient **(d)** Relevant

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Resilient
Solution:
Phrase Meaning:
- *"Able to withstand or recover quickly from difficult conditions"* refers to someone or something that **bounces back** or **adapts well to adversity**.

Correct One-word Substitute:
- **Resilient**:
  - Meaning: Able to recover quickly from setbacks or difficult situations.
  - Example: *Children are often more resilient than adults after emotional trauma.*

Why the other options are incorrect:
- **Reliant** – means dependent on something or someone.
- **Remnant** – refers to a small remaining quantity of something.
- **Relevant** – means closely connected or appropriate to the matter at hand.

Correct answer: Resilient (Option (c))

Q.149 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Intense sadness especially caused by somebody's death

(a) Ache **(b)** Torture
(c) Worry **(d)** Grief

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Grief
Solution:
- The phrase: *"Intense sadness especially caused by somebody's death"* refers to a deep emotional response to loss.
- The word **"Grief"** means:
  - A **deep sorrow** or **intense sadness**, especially caused by the **death of someone**.
  - Example: *She was overcome with grief after the loss of her father.*
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **Ache** – refers to physical or emotional pain, but not specifically linked to death or loss.
  - **Torture** – refers to severe physical or mental suffering, often intentionally inflicted.
  - **Worry** – is a state of anxiety or unease, not necessarily related to loss or death.

Correct one-word substitute:
Grief

Q.150 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
An optical instrument designed to make distant objects appear nearer

(a) Kaleidoscope **(b)** Magnifying glass
(c) Microscope **(d)** Telescope

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Telescope
Solution:
Phrase:
"An optical instrument designed to make distant objects appear nearer."
Correct one-word substitute:
- **Telescope**:
  - An optical instrument that helps in viewing **distant objects**, especially in astronomy or distant landscapes.
  - Example: *He used a telescope to observe the stars.*

Why other options are incorrect:
- **Kaleidoscope** – shows patterns using mirrors and colored pieces, not for viewing distant objects.
- **Magnifying glass** – used to **enlarge nearby small objects**, not distant ones.
- **Microscope** – used to view **very small objects** at close range, like cells or bacteria.

Correct answer: Telescope (Option (d))

Q.151 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Having a harmful effect, especially in a gradual or subtle way

(a) Penurious **(b)** Pretentious
(c) Perfidious **(d)** Pernicious

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Pernicious
Solution:
- The phrase: *"Having a harmful effect, especially in a gradual or subtle way"* precisely defines the word **"Pernicious"**.
- **Pernicious** means:
  - Causing harm or damage, often in a way that is **gradual**, **subtle**, or **not immediately obvious**.
  - Example: *The pernicious effects of smoking may take years to appear.*
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **Penurious** – means extremely poor or stingy.
  - **Pretentious** – means attempting to impress by showing more importance than is actually possessed.
  - **Perfidious** – means deceitful and untrustworthy.

Correct one-word substitute:
Pernicious

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Q.152 Select the option that can be used as a one word substitute for the given group of words.
Science of life

(a) Biology **(b)** Phytology
(c) Philology **(d)** Phonology

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Biology

- **Biology** is the scientific study of **life and living organisms**, including their structure, function, growth, origin, evolution, and distribution.
- **Phytology** refers specifically to the study of **plants**.
- **Philology** is the study of **language** in written historical sources.
- **Phonology** is the study of **speech sounds** and their patterns.

Therefore, the correct one-word substitute for "Science of life" is **Biology**.

Q.153 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Present, appearing or found everywhere

(a) Omnibus **(b)** Omniscient
(c) Omnipotent **(d)** Omnipresent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Omnipresent
Solution:

- The phrase: *"Present, appearing or found everywhere"* refers to something or someone that is **present in all places at all times**.
- The correct one-word substitute is: **"Omnipresent"**
  - **Omni** = all, **present** = existing or appearing
  - Example: *In modern life, technology seems to be omnipresent.*
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **Omnibus** – means a collection (e.g., of works) or a bus, not related to presence.
  - **Omniscient** – means all-knowing.
  - **Omnipotent** – means all-powerful.

Correct one-word substitute:
Omnipresent

Q.154 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Fear of being in closed spaces

(a) Cacophobia **(b)** Acrophobia
(c) Hydrophobia **(d)** Claustrophobia

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Claustrophobia
Solution:

- The correct one-word substitute for **"fear of being in closed spaces"** is **Claustrophobia**.
- **Claustrophobia** is a type of anxiety disorder where a person has an irrational fear of confined or enclosed spaces.
- Other options:
  - **Cacophobia** – fear of ugliness
  - **Acrophobia** – fear of heights
  - **Hydrophobia** – fear of water (often associated with rabies)

Q.155 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Make smaller or less in amount, degree, or size

(a) Reduce **(b)** Reclaim
(c) Recoup **(d)** Refine

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Reduce
Solution:

- The phrase: *"Make smaller or less in amount, degree, or size"* directly refers to the action of **decreasing** something.
- The word **"Reduce"** means:
  - To make something smaller or less in amount, degree, or size.
  - Example: *The company plans to reduce its carbon emissions.*
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **Reclaim** – means to retrieve or recover something previously lost.
  - **Recoup** – means to regain something lost, especially money.
  - **Refine** – means to improve something by making small changes.

Correct one-word substitute:
Reduce

Q.156 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Showing careful and persistent effort or work

(a) Cogent **(b)** Diligent
(c) Intelligent **(d)** Indulgent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Diligent
Solution:

- The phrase: *"Showing careful and persistent effort or work"* describes someone who works **hard** and **consistently with attention to detail**.
- The correct one-word substitute is: **Diligent**
  - **Diligent** means showing **careful** and **persistent effort** in doing something.
  - Example: *She is a diligent student who always completes her assignments on time.*
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **Cogent** – means convincing or logical (usually for arguments).
  - **Intelligent** – refers to mental ability, not effort.
  - **Indulgent** – means lenient or overly generous.

Correct one-word substitute:
Diligent

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Q.157 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Pleasing to the sense of taste or smell especially by reason of effective seasoning

(a) Smelly **(b)** Savoury
(c) Sweet **(d)** Stale

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Savoury
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Savoury**, as it refers to something **pleasant in taste or smell**, especially due to **effective seasoning**. It is commonly used to describe **flavourful, non-sweet food** that appeals to the senses because of added spices or herbs.
Other options do not fit this meaning:
- **Smelly** typically refers to **unpleasant odours**.
- **Sweet** describes taste that is sugary, **not seasoned**.
- **Stale** refers to food that has **lost freshness** and is usually **unappetizing**.

Thus, the best fit for "pleasing to the sense of taste or smell especially by reason of effective seasoning" is **Savoury**.

Q.158 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
A fellow worker or associate in an office

(a) Consort **(b)** Colleague
(c) Convict **(d)** Contemporary

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Colleague
Solution:
- The phrase: *"A fellow worker or associate in an office"* refers to someone you work with in a professional setting.
- The correct one-word substitute is **"Colleague"**:
  - Meaning: A person with whom one works, especially in a profession or business.
  - Example: *She discussed the project with her colleague from the marketing department.*
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **Consort** – refers to a spouse or companion, especially of a reigning monarch.
  - **Convict** – refers to a person found guilty of a criminal offense.
  - **Contemporary** – refers to someone living at the same time or a peer, but not specifically a fellow worker.

Correct one-word substitute:
Colleague

Q.159 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
A person who pretends to have virtues or qualities that he or she does not have

(a) Philanthropist **(b)** Hypocrite
(c) Sycophant **(d)** Parasite

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Hypocrite
Explanation:
The correct one-word substitute for **"a person who pretends to have virtues or qualities that he or she does not have"** is:

Explanation (contd.)
Hypocrite
- A **hypocrite** is someone who **pretends to have moral standards or beliefs** that they do not actually possess or follow.
- Example: He always talks about honesty, but he's a **hypocrite** who cheats on his taxes.

Other options:
- **Philanthropist** – A person who gives generously to charity.
- **Sycophant** – A person who flatters someone for personal gain.
- **Parasite** – Someone who lives off others without giving anything in return.

Correct Answer: 2

Q.160 Select the option that can be used as a one word substitute for the given group of words.
A complete, usually alphabetical list of items, often with notes giving details.

(a) Brochure **(b)** Monograph
(c) Catalogue **(d)** Pamphlet

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2024 | 8 March

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Catalogue
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Catalogue**. A **catalogue** is a **complete, often alphabetical list of items**, such as books, products, or exhibits, often accompanied by **descriptions or details**. It is commonly used in libraries, museums, and retail.
Other options:
- **Brochure** – A small booklet or leaflet giving information, typically promotional.
- **Monograph** – A detailed written study of a single specialized subject.
- **Pamphlet** – A small booklet or leaflet containing information or arguments about a single subject.

Q.161 Select the option that can be used as a one word substitute for the given group of words.
The person who presents and coordinates a show on stage or television

(a) Broadcaster **(b)** Jockey
(c) Reporter **(d)** Anchor

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2024 | 8 March

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Anchor
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Anchor**. An **anchor** is a person who presents and coordinates a show, especially on television or stage, ensuring smooth transitions and engaging with the audience or guests.
Other options:
- **Broadcaster** – Someone who transmits programs via radio or TV but not necessarily presents a specific show.
- **Jockey** – Typically refers to a **disc jockey (DJ)** who plays music on radio or at events.
- **Reporter** – A person who gathers and reports news, usually from the field, not someone who hosts a show.

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Q.162 Select the option that can be used as a one word substitute for the given group of words.
Not active but has the ability to be active anytime later

(a) Conscious **(b)** Dormant
(c) Jubilant **(d)** Ambiguous

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Dormant
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Dormant**. It means **inactive at the moment but capable of becoming active later**. The word is often used for volcanoes, seeds, or abilities that lie unused but can be awakened.
Example: "The volcano remained dormant for centuries."
Other options:
- **Conscious** – Means aware or awake; the opposite of inactive.
- **Jubilant** – Means extremely happy or joyful; not related to being inactive.
- **Ambiguous** – Means unclear or having multiple meanings; doesn't match the idea of inactivity.

Q.163 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Not able to be changed or adapted

(a) Austere **(b)** Permissive
(c) Rigid **(d)** Harsh

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2024 | 8 March

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Rigid
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Rigid**.
Rigid means **not flexible**, **not able to be changed or adapted**, especially in terms of rules, opinions, or structures.
Other options:
- **Austere** – Strict or severe in manner or appearance, especially regarding lifestyle or discipline.
- **Permissive** – Tolerant or lenient; allows freedom rather than restriction.
- **Harsh** – Rough, severe, or unkind in tone, treatment, or conditions; not necessarily about adaptability.

Q.164 Select the option that can be used as a one word substitute for the given group of words.
Protect from a danger, risk, or unpleasant experience

(a) Sever **(b)** Seize
(c) Scare **(d)** Shield

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Shield
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Shield**.
To **shield** someone means to **protect** them from **danger, harm, or unpleasant situations**. It can be used both literally (e.g., shield from rain) or figuratively (e.g., shield from criticism).
Other options:
- **Sever** – Means to cut off or separate.
- **Seize** – Means to take hold of something suddenly or forcibly.
- **Scare** – Means to frighten someone.

Q.165 Select the option that can be used as a one word substitute for the given group of words.
An eloquent and skilled public speaker

(a) Orator **(b)** Elector
(c) Leader **(d)** Spokesperson

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Orator
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Orator**.
An **orator** is someone who is **skilled in making formal and effective public speeches**, often marked by eloquence and persuasion.
Other options:
- **Elector** – A person who has the right to vote in an election.
- **Leader** – Someone who leads or commands a group or organization.
- **Spokesperson** – A person who speaks on behalf of a group or organization.

Q.166 Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words.
Lasting for a very short while

(a) Eternal **(b)** Perpetual
(c) Ephemeral **(d)** Reliable

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Ephemeral
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Ephemeral**.
Ephemeral means **lasting for a very short time**. It describes something that is fleeting or transient, like a moment or a brief experience.
Other options:
- **Eternal** – Means lasting forever, without end.
- **Perpetual** – Means continuing indefinitely, never-ending.
- **Reliable** – Means trustworthy or dependable.

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5. Spelling Errors

74 questions

Q.1 Select the correctly spelt word.

(a) contemporery **(b)** contamporary
(c) contemperary **(d)** contemporary

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) contemporary
Type: Spelling
The correct spelling is **contemporary** (belonging to the present time – समकालीन).
Tip
con-tem-po-rary (with **o** and **a**, not "e").

Q.2 Select the correctly spelt word.

(a) battallion **(b)** batallion
(c) battalion **(d)** batalion

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) battalion
Type: Spelling
The correct spelling is **battalion** (a large body of soldiers – सैन्य टुकड़ी).
Tip
Double **t**, single **l**: bat-ta-lion.

Q.3 Select the correctly spelt word.

(a) parellel **(b)** perallel
(c) parrallel **(d)** parallel

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) parallel
Type: Spelling
The correct spelling is **parallel** (side by side, same distance apart – समानांतर).
Tip
One **r**, double **l** in the middle: pa-ra-llel.

Q.4 Select the misspelt word.

(a) foreiner **(b)** intrigue
(c) summon **(d)** conjure

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) foreiner
Type: Spelling
The misspelt word is **"foreiner"**. Correct spelling: **foreigner** (a person from another country – विदेशी).
Tip
Note the silent **g**: fore-**ig**-ner.

Q.5 Select the misspelt word.

(a) strech **(b)** swallow
(c) survey **(d)** sense

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) strech
Type: Spelling
The misspelt word is **"strech"**. Correct spelling: **stretch** (to extend – खींचना/फैलाना).
Tip
Ends in **-tch**: stre-**tch**.

Q.6 Select the misspelt word.

(a) approach **(b)** florish
(c) slander **(d)** partner

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) florish
Type: Spelling
The misspelt word is **"florish"**. Correct spelling: **flourish** (to grow well / thrive – फलना-फूलना).
Tip
Note the **ou**: flo-**u**-rish.

Q.7 Select the misspelt word.

(a) Frantick **(b)** Eminent
(c) Estimate **(d)** Comparison

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Frantick
Type: Spelling
The misspelt word is **"Frantick"**. Correct spelling: **frantic** (wild with worry/hurry – व्याकुल).
Tip
Ends in **-ic**, no "k": fran-tic.

Q.8 Select the misspelt word.

(a) Afliction **(b)** Thwart
(c) Souvenir **(d)** Paltry

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Afliction
Type: Spelling
The misspelt word is **"Afliction"**. Correct spelling: **affliction** (suffering/distress – कष्ट).
Tip
Double **f**: af-flic-tion.

Q.9 Select the misspelt word.

(a) Release **(b)** Arrivel
(c) Obscure **(d)** Plight

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Arrivel
Type: Spelling
The misspelt word is **"Arrivel"**. Correct spelling: **arrival** (act of arriving – आगमन).
Tip
Ends in **-al**: ar-ri-val.

Q.10 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Countenance **(b)** Perseverance
(c) Maintainence **(d)** Assistance

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Maintainence
Type: Spelling
The wrongly spelt word is **"Maintainence"**. Correct: **Maintenance** (no 'i' after 'main').
Tip
main-ten-ance.

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Q.11 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Accumulate **(b)** Neccessary
(c) Remittance **(d)** Occasion

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Neccessary
Type: Spelling
The wrongly spelt word is **"Neccessary"**. Correct: **Necessary** (one 'c', two 's').
Tip
"one Collar, two Sleeves" → ne**cc**e**ss**ary.

Q.12 Select the wrongly spelt word.

(a) incorporate **(b)** incorrect
(c) increament **(d)** incubate

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) increament
Type: Spelling
The wrongly spelt word is **"increament"**. Correct spelling: **increment** (an increase – वृद्धि).
Tip
No "a": in-cre-ment.

Q.13 Select the wrongly spelt word.

(a) religious **(b)** virtious
(c) precious **(d)** delicious

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) virtious
Type: Spelling
The wrongly spelt word is **"virtious"**. Correct spelling: **virtuous** (morally good – गुणी).
Tip
Root **virtue** → **virtu + ous = virtuous**.

Q.14 Select the wrongly spelt word.

(a) frown **(b)** frost
(c) front **(d)** frowk

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) frowk
Type: Spelling
"frowk" is not a real word — it is the wrongly spelt option (perhaps for **frock**, a dress).
Correct words
• **frown, frost, front** – all correctly spelt.

Q.15 Select the wrongly spelt word.

(a) Premium **(b)** Passage
(c) Parallel **(d)** Penalty

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Parallel
Type: Spelling
Question Issue
As printed, **all four options are spelt correctly** — Premium, Passage, Parallel and Penalty. So this item appears to have a **printing error**; the answer key marks **Parallel** (option (c)).
The word "**parallel**" is a very commonly misspelt word (wrongly written as "parallell" or "paralel"). The intended spelling is **parallel** — one "r", double "l" in the middle, single "l" at the end.

Q.16 Select the misspelt word.

(a) nobility **(b)** enimity
(c) inquiry **(d)** incite

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) enimity
Type: Spelling
The misspelt word is **"enimity"**. Correct spelling: **enmity** (hostility, hatred – शत्रुता).
Tip
enmity has no "i" after "en": en-mi-ty.

Q.17 Select the wrongly spelt word.

(a) Plaque **(b)** Platinum
(c) Plantain **(d)** Plataue

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Plataue
Type: Spelling
The wrongly spelt word is **"Plataue"**. Correct spelling: **plateau** (a flat elevated area of land – पठार).
Tip
Note the ending **-eau**: pla-**teau**.

Q.18 Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence.
One part of the philosophy of life's meaning consists of the systemetic attempt to identify what people have in mind when they think about the topic.

(a) systemetic **(b)** think
(c) attempt **(d)** philosophy

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) systemetic
Systematic is the correct spelling.

Q.19 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Deceased **(b)** Desedent
(c) Descendant **(d)** Decimate

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Desedent
Descendant is the correct spelling.Deceased – deadDecimate – to destroyDescendant – a person hierarchically related to someone in the past.

Q.20 Select the sentence that contains no spelling errors.

(a) The grandour of the ancient Roman Empire is visible in many monumants in Italy and Greece.
(b) The granduer of the ancient Roman Empire is visible in many monuments in Italy and Greece.
(c) The granduor of the ancient Roman Empire is visible in many monuments in Italy and Greece.
(d) The grandeur of the ancient Roman Empire is visible in many monuments in Italy and Greece.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The grandeur of the ancient Roman Empire is visible in many monuments in Italy and Greece.
grandeur – magnificence, splendor, or grandness. It is spelled correctly only in option (d).

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Q.21 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Greave **(b)** Gravely
(c) Groan **(d)** Guarentee

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Guarentee
Guarantee is the correct spelling.
Greave – a piece of armour used to protect the shin.
Groan – to make a deep sound expressing pain or discomfort.
Gravely – something done with seriousness and urgency.

Q.22 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Acede **(b)** Abseil
(c) Abhorrent **(d)** Abscess

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Acede
The incorrectly spelt word is 'acede'. It should be spelt as "accede". It means to agree to a demand or agreement.
Abseil – to descend a steep slope using a rope.
Abhorrent – that makes one feel disgust or hate.
Abscess – a swelling on or in the body, containing puss.

Q.23 Choose the correct spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence.The committee could not reach a conscence even after a six-hour long meeting yesterday.

(a) conscius **(b)** cautius
(c) conscientios **(d)** consensus

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) consensus
The correct spelling is consensus. option (d) is correct.
option (a) – conscius – conscious is the correct spelling.
option (b) – cautius – the correct spelling is cautious.
option (c) – conscientios – conscientious is the correct spelling.

Q.24 Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence.If she had begun earlier, she might have suceeded in finishing the extremely intricate project before the deadline.

(a) intricate **(b)** earlier
(c) suceeded **(d)** deadline

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) suceeded
"succeeded" is the right spelling.

Q.25 Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence.The board reviewing the courses offered by the afiliated college found that the quality of academic programs was usually good but somewhat irregular.

(a) academic **(b)** review
(c) afiliated **(d)** irregular

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) afiliated
affiliated is the correct spelling.

Q.26 Select the correct spelling of the incorrectly spelt word in the given sentence.
All criminal attitudes must be niped at the bud.

(a) Niiped **(b)** Nipedd
(c) Nipped **(d)** Nipeed

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Nipped
The phrase **"nipped in the bud"** means to stop something at an early stage before it has the chance to develop or grow. It's often used to refer to preventing a problem or issue from getting worse or becoming more serious.
In the sentence, **"All criminal attitudes must be nipped at the bud,"** it means that any criminal tendencies should be dealt with early, before they can escalate or cause harm.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.27 Select the correct spelling of the incorrectly spelt word in the given sentence.
The trainer tried to guage the learners' understanding of the subject by asking several new questions.

(a) Gaage **(b)** Gauge
(c) Gaaug **(d)** Gaugg

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Gauge
The correct spelling is: **Gauge**
Gauge: Means to measure or assess something, such as understanding, capacity, or quantity.
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.28 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Memento **(b)** Recommend
(c) Apparent **(d)** Practitionaire

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Practitionaire
The **incorrectly** spelled word is **Practitionaire**.
The correct spelling should be **Practitioner**.
Practitioner – A **practitioner** is someone who practices a profession, especially in areas like medicine, law, or teaching. For example, a doctor is a medical practitioner.
The meaning of other options are:
Memento – A **memento** is an object or item kept as a reminder or souvenir of a person, event, or experience.
Recommend – To **recommend** means to suggest or advise someone to do something because it is good or suitable.
Apparent – **Apparent** means something that is clearly visible or obvious to the senses. It indicates that something is easily understood or perceived.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.29 Select the word with the correct spelling.

(a) permmited **(b)** punctuation
(c) pungant **(d)** plesent

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) punctuation
Type: Spelling
The correctly spelt word is **punctuation** (the use of commas, full stops, etc. – विराम-चिह्न).
The others (wrong spellings)
• **permmited** → correct is *permitted*; **pungant** → *pungent*; **plesent** → *pleasant*.

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Q.30 Select the correct spelling of the incorrectly spelt word in the given sentence.
Good characteristics are indispensible to succeed in life.

(a) Indispenscible **(b)** Indespensable
(c) Indispensable **(d)** Indespensible

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Indispensable
The correct spelling of the word is **"indispensable."** The sentence should read: "Good characteristics are **indispensable** to succeed in life."
"Indispensable" means absolutely necessary or essential.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.31 Select the correctly spelt word out of the four alternatives.

(a) Grotesque **(b)** Grostasque
(c) Grosteasque **(d)** Growtesque

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Grotesque
Meaning: **grotesque** = strangely ugly or distorted; absurdly odd *(विचित्र, विकृत, भद्दा)*.
Spelling: **G-R-O-T-E-S-Q-U-E** = *grot* + the French suffix **-esque** ("in the style of"), as in *picturesque*.
Answer: **Grotesque**
Why the others are wrong.
• **Grostasque** — an extra **s** after *Gro*, and **a** where *e* belongs.
• **Grosteasque** — an extra **s** and an extra **a**.
• **Growtesque** — **ow** for the single *o*.
-esque words: picturesque, statuesque, grotesque — one "t", then "-esque".

Q.32 Select the wrongly spelt word out of the four alternatives.

(a) Impetuous **(b)** Imperial
(c) Implication **(d)** Impetunent

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Impetunent
Spot the misspelling.
Impetunent is not an English word.
The nearest real word is **impertinent** = rude, not showing proper respect *(धृष्ट, अशिष्ट)* — spelt **I-M-P-E-R-T-I-N-E-N-T**.
Answer: **Impetunent**
Why the others are fine.
• **Impetuous** = acting suddenly without thinking *(उतावला, आवेगी)* — correct spelling, *-uous* ending.
• **Imperial** = relating to an empire or emperor *(साम्राज्यिक, शाही)* — correct.
• **Implication** = a suggested meaning, or a likely result *(निहितार्थ, परिणाम)* — correct.
Impetuous (rash) and impertinent (rude) both start "imp-" — learn their middles: -etu- and -ert-.

Q.33 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Affection **(b)** Appearance
(c) Accomodate **(d)** Accompanied

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Accomodate
The correct answer is 'Accommodate'. The correct spelling is 'Accomodate'.

Explanation (contd.)
- Accommodate: a person who you trust and with whom you talk about private or secret things.
- Affection: a feeling of loving or liking somebody/something
- Appearance: the way that somebody/something looks or seems.
- Accompanied: to play music for a singer or another instrument.

Q.34 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Subpoena **(b)** Milennium
(c) Caucus **(d)** Noticeable

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Milennium
option (b) is the correct answer.
Milenium is incorrectly spelt, the correct spelling is millennium.
Millennium: a period of 1,000 years, or the time when a period of 1,000 years ends.
Subpoena: a written order to attend a court of law to give evidence.
Caucus: a group of people with similar interests, often within a larger organization or political party.
Noticeable: easy to see or notice.

Q.35 Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the following sentence and select its correct spelling from the given options.
The remoteness of the location made it difficult for the authoreties to reach out to the people.

(a) authorities **(b)** locasion
(c) remotness **(d)** deficult

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) authorities
The incorrectly spelled word in the sentence is "locasion."
The correct spelling is **"location."**
Authorities: This refers to individuals or organizations with the official power to make decisions or enforce laws.
Location: This word denotes a particular place or position.
Remoteness: This term describes the state of being far away or secluded, often implying a lack of proximity or accessibility.
Difficult: This adjective is used to describe something that is not easy, requiring effort or skill to accomplish.

Q.36 Select the correct spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence.
He made a sureptitiuos phone call while his boss was out of the room.

(a) surreptitous **(b)** sureptitious
(c) surreptitious **(d)** sarreptitious

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) surreptitious
The correct spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence is **surreptitious**.
So, the correct option is: **surreptitious**
"Surreptitious" is an adjective that describes something done, made, or acquired in a secret, stealthy, or sneaky manner to avoid detection or attention.

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Q.37 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Maxim **(b)** Profligate
(c) Lisentious **(d)** Quandary

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Lisentious
The incorrectly spelled word is **Lisentious.** The correct spelling is **"Licentious."**

1. **Maxim**: A maxim is a concise statement or rule expressing a general truth or principle, often in the form of a proverb or saying.
2. **Profligate**: Profligate is an adjective that describes someone who is recklessly extravagant or wasteful in the use of resources. It can also refer to behavior that is immoral or dissolute.
3. **Licentious**: Licentious is an adjective that describes behavior that is sexually unrestrained or immoral. It can also refer to a lack of moral or ethical principles.
4. **Quandary**: Quandary is a noun that refers to a state of uncertainty or perplexity, especially as a result of facing difficult choices or problems.

So, the incorrectly spelled word is **"Lisentious,"** and the correct spelling is **"Licentious,"** which means behavior that is sexually unrestrained or immoral.

Q.38 Select the sentence that has the correct use of words and spellings.

(a) The novel, with its intricete plot and multifacted characters, captivated readers and left them pondering its deeper themes long after they finished reading.
(b) The novel, with its intricate plot and multifacted characters, captivated readers and left them paundering its deeper themes long after they finished reading.
(c) The novel, with its intricate plot and multifaceted characters, captivated readers and left them pondering its deeper themes long after they finished reading.
(d) The novel, with its intrcate plot and multifaceted characters, captivated readers and left them pondering its deeper themes long after they finished reading.

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The novel, with its intricate plot and multifaceted characters, captivated readers and left them pondering its deeper themes long after they finished reading.
The sentence with the correct use of words and spellings is: **"The novel, with its intricate plot and multifaceted characters, captivated readers and left them pondering its deeper themes long after they finished reading."**

Q.39 Select the correct spelling from the given options to fill in the blank.
He was _____ going abroad for his further studies.

(a) contemplating **(b)** cuntempltaing
(c) contempltaing **(d)** cuntemplating

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) contemplating
The correct spelling to fill in the blank is: **"He was contemplating going abroad for his further studies."**
Contemplating: Engaging in deep thought or consideration; thinking about something for a prolonged period with a focused mind, often in a serious or reflective manner.

Q.40 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Inconspicuous **(b)** Extemporise
(c) Susceptibility **(d)** Superindednt

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Superindednt
The incorrectly spelled word is: **Superindednt**
The correct spelling is **"Superintendent."**
Superindednt: This seems to be a misspelling. The correct word is **"Superintendent,"** which refers to a person who oversees or manages a particular area or activity, often used in the context of a supervisor or manager, especially in an organization or building.
Inconspicuous: Not easily noticeable; not attracting attention; not conspicuous or prominent.
Extemporise: To speak or perform without preparation; to improvise or do something on the spot without prior planning.
Susceptibility: The state of being easily influenced, affected, or susceptible to something; the degree to which someone or something is vulnerable to a particular influence.

Q.41 Select the INCORRECTLY spelled word.

(a) Instinctual **(b)** Intuition
(c) Initiative **(d)** Implusive

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Implusive
The **incorrectly spelled** word is: **Implusive.**
The correct spelling is **Impulsive**.
Meanings of all options:
Instinctual: Relating to or based on instinct, which is the natural, unlearned behavior or response.
Intuition: The ability to understand or know something without the need for conscious reasoning; a gut feeling.
Initiative: The ability to take action independently; a new plan or action to address a problem.
Impulsive: Acting without thought or planning, often due to sudden urges or emotions.

Q.42 Replace the underlined word in the given sentence with its correctly spelled version.
I have been <u>morning</u> the death of my pet dog.

(a) mourning **(b)** merning
(c) murning **(d)** moruning

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) mourning
The correct spelling to replace "morninng" in the sentence is: **mourning**
Mourning means the expression of sorrow or grief, especially after someone's death. In this context, it refers to grieving the death of the pet dog.

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Q.43 In the following sentence, a few of the spellings are incorrect. Find out the sentence with correctly spelt words from the given options.
He is wimsical by natur. No one can seek an explanation from him for his absurd atitude towards others.

(a) He is whimsical by natur. No one can seek an explanation from him for his absurd attitude towards others.
(b) He is whimsical by nature. No one can seek an explanation from him for his absurd atitude towards others.
(c) He is whimsical by nature. No one can seek an explanation from him for his absurd attitude towards others.
(d) He is wimsical by nature. No one can seek an explanation from him for his absurd attitude towards others.

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He is whimsical by nature. No one can seek an explanation from him for his absurd attitude towards others.
The correct sentence with the properly spelled words is:
He is whimsical by nature. No one can seek an explanation from him for his absurd attitude towards others.
"Whimsical" is the correct spelling of the word meaning playful or fanciful.
"Nature" is the correct spelling of the word referring to someone's inherent qualities.
"Attitude" is the correct spelling of the word referring to a person's behavior or mindset.

Q.44 Choose the correctly spelt word:

(a) Renaissance **(b)** Rinassance
(c) Rennesance **(d)** Ranessance

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Renaissance
Meaning: **Renaissance** = rebirth, revival; especially the revival of art and learning in 14th–16th century Europe *(पुनर्जागरण)*.
Build the spelling.
Re + **nais** + **sance** — French *renaître*, "to be born again".
One **n** after *Re*, then **-ai-**, then double **ss**, ending **-ance**.
Answer: **(1) Renaissance**
Why the others are wrong.
• **Rinassance** — *Ri* instead of **Re**, and **-ai-** collapsed to *-a-*.
• **Rennesance** — double *nn* and a single *s*; both are reversed from **-naiss-**.
• **Ranessance** — *Ra* instead of **Re**, and the **i** of **-ai-** is missing.
Re-NAIS-sance: one n, then "ai", then double s — the word is "re + naissance (birth)".

Q.45 Select the word with the correct spelling.

(a) gragarious **(b)** guarantee
(c) genaral **(d)** garbege

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) guarantee
Type: Spelling
The correctly spelt word is **guarantee** (a formal promise – प्रत्याभूति/गारंटी).

Explanation (contd.)
The others (wrong)
• gragarious → *gregarious*; genaral → *general*; garbege → *garbage*.

Q.46 Select the word with the correct spelling.

(a) favouret **(b)** favourate
(c) favourite **(d)** favoirite

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) favourite
Type: Spelling
The correct spelling is **favourite** (most liked – प्रिय).
The others (wrong)
• favouret, favourate, favoirite – all misspellings of "favourite".
Tip
Remember: favour + **ite** = favourite.

Q.47 Select the misspelt word.

(a) suprimacy **(b)** originate
(c) pursuit **(d)** business

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2019

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) suprimacy
Type: Spelling
The misspelt word is **"suprimacy"**. Correct spelling: **supremacy** (highest authority – सर्वोच्चता).
Correct spellings
• **supremacy** (not "suprimacy") ✓ misspelt · **originate** ✓ · **pursuit** ✓ · **business** ✓.
Tip
Root **supreme** → **suprem + acy = supremacy**.

Q.48 Select the misspelt word.

(a) glorify **(b)** ascertain
(c) inherit **(d)** descrete

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2019

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) descrete
Type: Spelling
The misspelt word is **"descrete"**. Correct spelling: **discrete** (separate, distinct – अलग-अलग).
Correct spellings
• **glorify** ✓ · **ascertain** ✓ · **inherit** ✓ · **discrete** (not "descrete") ✓ misspelt.
Tip
discrete = separate; do not confuse with **discreet** = careful/tactful.

Q.49 Select the misspelt word.

(a) relevent **(b)** surrender
(c) distinct **(d)** beseech

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2019

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) relevent
Type: Spelling
The misspelt word is **"relevent"**. Correct spelling: **relevant** (connected to the matter – प्रासंगिक).
Correct spellings
• **relevant** (not "relevent") ✓ misspelt · **surrender** ✓ · **distinct** ✓ · **beseech** ✓ (to beg).
Tip
"relevant" ends in **-ant**, not "-ent".

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Q.50 Select the wrongly spelt word.

(a) virtious **(b)** anxious
(c) glorious **(d)** precious

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) virtious
Type: Spelling
The wrongly spelt word is **"virtious"**. The correct spelling is **virtuous** (having good moral qualities – गुणी).
Correct spellings of all options
• **virtuous** – (not "virtious") ✓ wrongly spelt.
• **anxious** – correct (worried).
• **glorious** – correct (full of glory).
• **precious** – correct (very valuable).
Tip
Remember the root **virtue** → **virtu + ous = virtuous**.

Q.51 Select the wrongly spelt word.

(a) camera **(b)** carriage
(c) caravan **(d)** clocke

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2020

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) clocke
Type: Spelling
The wrongly spelt word is **"clocke"**. The correct spelling is **clock** (a device that shows time – घड़ी).
Correct spellings of all options
• **camera** – correct; **carriage** – correct; **caravan** – correct.
• **clock** – (not "clocke") ✓ wrongly spelt.
Tip
"clock" ends in **-ck**, with **no "e"** after it.

Q.52 Select the wrongly spelt word.

(a) attend **(b)** attain
(c) attrect **(d)** attempt

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2020

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) attrect
Type: Spelling
The wrongly spelt word is **"attrect"**. The correct spelling is **attract** (to pull towards / draw – आकर्षित करना).
Correct spellings of all options
• **attend** – correct; **attain** – correct; **attempt** – correct.
• **attract** – (not "attrect") ✓ wrongly spelt.
Tip
Think of **"tract"** (to pull) → at + tract = **attract**.

Q.53 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Plecard **(b)** Banner
(c) Monument **(d)** Slippers

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Plecard
Answer: 1 (Plecard)
- **Plecard** – **Incorrect spelling**. The correct spelling is **"Placard,"** which means a poster or sign for public display.
- **Banner** – Correct; a long strip of cloth bearing a slogan or design.
- **Monument** – Correct; a structure built to commemorate something or someone.
- **Slippers** – Correct; a type of soft, comfortable footwear.

Hence, the incorrectly spelt word is **"Plecard."**

Q.54 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Anouncement **(b)** Calculation
(c) Eligibility **(d)** Committee

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Anouncement
- Let's evaluate the spelling of each word:

1. **Anouncement** – Incorrect spelling
   - The correct spelling is **Announcement** (with double **n**).
2. **Calculation** – Correct
3. **Eligibility** – Correct
4. **Committee** – Correct

Q.55 In the given sentence the underlined word may have been incorrectly spelt. Identify the option that rectifies the spelling. If there is no error in spelling, select 'No error'.
The British Government claimed that the Jalianwala Bagh massacre was an <u>inadvertant</u> measure taken by the police.

(a) inadvartent **(b)** inadvertent
(c) No error **(d)** inedvartent

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) inadvertent
The underlined word **"inadvertant"** is **incorrectly spelt**.
- **Correct spelling: inadvertent**
- **Meaning:** Unintentional; not done on purpose.

Other options:
- **inadvartent** (incorrect spelling)
- **inedvartent** (incorrect spelling)
- **No error** (since there is an error)

Hence, the correct spelling is **inadvertent** .

Q.56 Select the correct spelling of the underlined word.
The historian arranged all the events in a <u>cronalogical</u> order.

(a) coronalogical **(b)** chronollagicol
(c) chronological **(d)** chhronlogical

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) chronological
- **coronalogical:** Incorrect spelling; no such word.
- **chronollagicol:** Incorrect spelling; misplaced letters; not a valid word.
- **chronological: Correct**; meaning **arranged in order of occurrence in time**.
- **chhronlogical:** Incorrect spelling; repeated letters incorrectly.

The correct spelling is **chronological**, meaning "arranged according to the sequence in time."

Q.57 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Recalcitrent **(b)** Lapse
(c) Mourning **(d)** Acquit

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Recalcitrent
- Let's check the spelling of each option:

1. **Recalcitrent** – Incorrect spelling.
   The correct spelling is **Recalcitrant**, which means stubbornly disobedient.

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Explanation (contd.)

1. **Lapse** – Correct spelling. It means a temporary failure or slip.
2. **Mourning** – Correct spelling. It refers to the expression of deep sorrow for someone's death.
3. **Acquit** – Correct spelling. It means to declare someone not guilty.

Q.58 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Calibrate **(b)** Accelarate
(c) Insinuate **(d)** Proliferate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Accelarate

Answer: 2 (**Accelarate**)

- **Calibrate** – Correct; means to adjust or fine-tune a device or system.
- **Accelarate** – Incorrect spelling. The correct spelling is **"Accelerate"**, meaning to speed up.
- **Insinuate** – Correct; means to suggest something indirectly.
- **Proliferate** – Correct; means to multiply or increase rapidly.

Hence, the **incorrectly spelt word** is **"Accelarate."**

Q.59 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Recommend **(b)** Occasion
(c) Infection **(d)** Coloquial

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Coloquial

The correct spelling is **Colloquial**, which refers to **informal, conversational language**.

Let's examine the spellings:

- **Recommend** – Correct spelling
- **Occasion** – Correct spelling
- **Infection** – Correct spelling
- **Coloquial** – **Incorrect spelling**; should be **Colloquial** (with double "l")

Thus, the incorrectly spelt word is: **Coloquial**.

Q.60 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the following sentence.
We should align our grandiosity with conservation of biodiversity while focusing on citizentry awareness.

(a) grandiosity **(b)** citizentry
(c) align **(d)** conservation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) citizentry

Answer: 2 (**citizentry**)

Correct spellings of the words:

- **grandiosity:** Correct – means impressiveness in style or appearance.
- **citizentry: Incorrect spelling** – the correct word is **"citizenry"**, meaning the body of citizens.
- **align:** Correct – to bring into line or agreement.
- **conservation:** Correct – preservation or protection of something.

Hence, **"citizentry"** is the incorrectly spelt word.

Q.61 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Incomfortable **(b)** Unhappy
(c) Maiden **(d)** Maintain

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Incomfortable

Answer: Incomfortable

Let's evaluate the spelling and meaning of each option:

1. **Incomfortable** – **Incorrect spelling**. The correct word is **"uncomfortable"**.
2. **Unhappy** – Correctly spelt; means not happy.
3. **Maiden** – Correctly spelt; refers to a young unmarried woman or something appearing for the first time (like a maiden voyage).
4. **Maintain** – Correctly spelt; means to keep in good condition or continue.

So, the incorrectly spelt word is **Incomfortable**.

Q.62 Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence.
Reef-building corals are scatered throughout the tropical and subtropical western Atlantic and Indo-Pacific oceans, generally within 30°N and 30°S latitudes.

(a) scatered **(b)** latitudes
(c) subtropical **(d)** reef

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) scatered

Answer: 1 (**scatered**)

- **Scatered** – Incorrect spelling. The correct spelling is **"scattered"** (with double **t**).
- **Latitudes** – Correct spelling; refers to geographic coordinates.
- **Subtropical** – Correct spelling; refers to regions just outside the tropics.
- **Reef** – Correct spelling; refers to a ridge of rocks or coral near the ocean surface.

So, the **incorrectly spelt word** is **"scatered."**

Q.63 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Nature **(b)** Myght
(c) Knight **(d)** Nurture

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Myght

Answer: 2 (**Myght**)

- **Nature** – Correct; means the physical world or inherent features.
- **Myght** – Incorrect spelling. The correct spelling is **"Might"**, meaning power or strength.
- **Knight** – Correct; a warrior or title of honor.
- **Nurture** – Correct; means to care for and encourage growth.

Hence, the incorrectly spelt word is **"Myght."**

Q.64 Select the misspelt word.

(a) iminent **(b)** reticent
(c) temperament **(d)** pertinent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) iminent

Solution

1. **iminent** – Incorrect.

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Explanation (contd.)

1. The correct spelling is **imminent** (with a double **m**).
   - *Imminent* means "about to happen soon." The double-consonant pattern is common in English before a short vowel + suffix, e.g., *commit → commitment*.
2. **reticent** – Correct.
   - Means "reserved" or "disinclined to speak."
3. **temperament** – Correct.
   - Refers to a person's nature or habitual disposition.
4. **pertinent** – Correct.
   - Means "relevant" or "applicable to the matter in hand."

Hence, the only misspelt word is **iminent → imminent**.

Q.65 Select the misspelt word.

(a) conspicuous **(b)** officious
(c) exhilerated **(d)** facetious

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) exhilerated
Solution:

- **Conspicuous** – correctly spelt
- **Officious** – correctly spelt
- **Exhilerated** – **incorrect spelling**
- **Facetious** – correctly spelt

The correct spelling is **"exhilarated"**, not "exhilerated".
Answer: exhilerated

Q.66 Identify the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence and select the option that rectifies the spelling error.
It is difficult to describe the pandemonium kicked up by various animals when they spot or suspectt a panther around.

(a) Kickd **(b)** Panthar
(c) Suspect **(d)** Dificuult

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Suspect
Solution:
The incorrectly spelt word in the sentence is **"suspectt"**, which has an extra **'t'** at the end.
Let's evaluate the options:

- **Kickd** – Incorrect option; not present in the sentence
- **Panthar** – Incorrect option; also not present in the sentence
- **Suspect** – This is the correct spelling; the word in the sentence **"suspectt"** is wrong
- **Dificuult** – Incorrect option; the word **"difficult"** is spelled correctly in the sentence

Correct spelling: suspect
Answer: option (c) (Suspect)

Q.67 Select the misspelt word.

(a) incence **(b)** elegance
(c) immense **(d)** enhance

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) incence
Solution:
Let's examine each word:

Explanation (contd.)

- **incence** – Incorrect spelling. The correct word is **"incense"** (a substance that produces a fragrant smell when burned).
- **elegance** – Correct spelling.
- **immense** – Correct spelling.
- **enhance** – Correct spelling.

Answer: option (a) (incence).

Q.68 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Dilligence **(b)** Betrayal
(c) Vacation **(d)** Particularly

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Dilligence
Solution:
The word **"Dilligence"** is incorrectly spelt.
The correct spelling is **"Diligence"**, which means careful and persistent effort.
"Betrayal," "Vacation," and **"Particularly"** are all correctly spelt.
Answer: option (a) (Dilligence).

Q.69 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Mezzanine **(b)** Metamorphsis
(c) Meticulous **(d)** Meteorology

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2024 | 30 Apr

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Metamorphsis
Solution:

- The incorrectly spelt word is **Metamorphsis**.
- The correct spelling is **Metamorphosis**, which refers to a process of transformation, especially in biology (e.g., caterpillar to butterfly).

Correct Spellings of Other Options:

- **Mezzanine** – A low-ceilinged story between two main stories of a building.
- **Meticulous** – Showing great attention to detail.
- **Meteorology** – The scientific study of the atmosphere and weather.

Q.70 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Mariner **(b)** Martyre
(c) Marriage **(d)** Martial

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2024 | 30 Apr

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Martyre
Solution:

- Let's evaluate the spellings:

1. **Mariner** – Correct (means a sailor).
2. **Martyre** – **Incorrect spelling**.
   - The correct spelling is **"Martyr"**, meaning a person who suffers or dies for a cause or belief.
3. **Marriage** – Correct (means the legal or formal union of two people).
4. **Martial** – Correct (relating to war or the military).

Incorrectly spelt word:
Martyre

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Q.71 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Illiterate **(b)** Illestrious
(c) Illegible **(d)** Illusion

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Illestrious
Solution:
- Let's examine each word:

1. **Illiterate** – Correct spelling (means unable to read or write).
2. **Illestrious** – **Incorrect spelling**.
   - The correct spelling is **"Illustrious"**, meaning well-known, respected, and admired for past achievements.
3. **Illegible** – Correct spelling (means not clear enough to read).
4. **Illusion** – Correct spelling (means a false idea or appearance).

Incorrectly spelt word:
Illestrious

Q.72 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Obstinate **(b)** Observence
(c) Odorous **(d)** Occasional

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2024 | 8 March

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Observence
Explanation:
The incorrectly spelt word is **Observence**.
The correct spelling is **Observance**, which means the practice of complying with a law, custom, or rule.
Other options:
- **Obstinate** – Correct; means stubborn or unyielding.
- **Odorous** – Correct; means having a smell, especially a strong one.
- **Occasional** – Correct; means happening from time to time.

Q.73 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word..

(a) Irresponsible **(b)** Irrelevent
(c) Irritable **(d)** Irregular

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2024 | 8 March

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Irrelevent
Explanation:
The incorrectly spelt word is **Irrelevent**.
The correct spelling is **Irrelevant**, meaning **not connected with or relevant to something**.
Other options:
- **Irresponsible** – Correct; means not showing a proper sense of responsibility.
- **Irritable** – Correct; means easily annoyed or angered.
- **Irregular** – Correct; means not even or balanced in shape or arrangement.

Q.74 Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(a) Hundred **(b)** Hungery
(c) Humour **(d)** Hurdle

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2024 | 8 March

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Hungery
Explanation:
The correct answer is **Hungery**.
The correct spelling is **Hungry**. The word "Hungery" is a misspelling.
Other options:
- **Hundred** – Correctly spelt, meaning the number 100.
- **Humour** – Correctly spelt (British English) meaning fun or comedy.
- **Hurdle** – Correctly spelt, meaning an obstacle or barrier.

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6. Fill in the Blanks

152 questions

Q.1 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
This visit will not interfere _____ our plans.

(a) with **(b)** into
(c) from **(d)** at

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) with
Type: Fill in the Blank – Preposition
Rule: We "**interfere with**" something (to disturb/hinder it).
("interfere with" = बाधा डालना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **into / from / at** – "interfere **in**" is used for affairs, but "interfere **with** our plans" is correct here.

Q.2 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
_____ he became a minister, he didn't allow any of his relatives to live with him.

(a) In case **(b)** As soon as
(c) As long as **(d)** In order that

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) As soon as
Type: Fill in the Blank – Conjunction
Rule: "**As soon as**" = immediately when. "As soon as he became a minister, he didn't allow ..."
("As soon as" = जैसे ही।)
Why the others are wrong
• **In case / As long as / In order that** – wrong meaning for "immediately after becoming".

Q.3 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
We _____Rohit for the last two months.

(a) are not seeing **(b)** did not see
(c) do not see **(d)** haven't seen

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) haven't seen
Type: Fill in the Blank – Present Perfect
Rule: "for the last two months" (up to now) needs the **present perfect**: "**haven't seen**".
("for the last two months" → present perfect।)
Why the others are wrong
• **are not seeing** – "see" is stative; **did not see / do not see** – wrong tense for "for the last two months".

Q.4 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
A good leader should be ready to _____ criticism.

(a) meet **(b)** carry
(c) face **(d)** settle

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) face
to face something - to confront.Settle – to put an end to disagreement.So, c is the correct option fitting in the statement.

Q.5 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
We could see _____wild elephants bathing in the river.

(a) any **(b)** none
(c) lot **(d)** some

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) some
Type: Fill in the Blank – Determiner
Rule: For an unspecified plural in a **positive** sentence, use "**some**". "We could see **some** wild elephants ..."
(सकारात्मक वाक्य में "some"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **any** – for questions/negatives; **none** – zero; **lot** – needs "a lot of".

Q.6 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
_____ cart loaded with mangoes turned upside down on _____ main road.

(a) The, a **(b)** A, the
(c) The, the **(d)** A, a

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 15 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A, the
Type: Fill in the Blank – Articles
Rule: First mention of a non-specific thing → "**A**"; a specific, known place → "**the**".
(पहली बार अनिश्चित → "A"; निश्चित स्थान → "the"।)
Application
"**A** cart loaded with mangoes turned upside down on **the** main road."

Q.7 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The artists will arrive _____ an hour.

(a) before **(b)** within
(c) along **(d)** between

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) within
Type: Fill in the Blank – Preposition
Rule: "**within** an hour" = before an hour passes / inside that time.
("within an hour" = एक घंटे के अंदर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **before / along / between** – do not fit "will arrive ___ an hour" as well as "within".

Q.8 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The house they bought was_____spacious than their previous house.

(a) more **(b)** as
(c) mostly **(d)** most

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) more
Comparison is happening between the new and the previous house. So, more is the right word.

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Q.9 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The _____ chair was discarded by the tenant.

(a) broken **(b)** break
(c) broking **(d)** broke

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) broken
Type: Fill in the Blank – Past Participle as Adjective
Rule: Use the **past participle "broken"** as an adjective before the noun ("the broken chair").
(past participle (broken) विशेषण के रूप में।)
Why the others are wrong
• **break / broking / broke** – wrong forms as an adjective.

Q.10 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The police will regard it as an accident _____ any evidence to the contrary is found.

(a) otherwise **(b)** unless
(c) still **(d)** whenever

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) unless
Type: Fill in the Blank – Conjunction
Rule: "**unless**" = if not. "will regard it as an accident **unless** any evidence to the contrary is found."
("unless" = जब तक कि ... न।)
Why the others are wrong
• **otherwise / still / whenever** – wrong meaning for the condition.

Q.11 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
_____ you mind lending me your book for a day?

(a) May **(b)** Could
(c) Need **(d)** Would

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 16 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Would
Type: Fill in the Blank – Polite Request
Rule: "**Would you mind + V-ing?**" is the polite request form.
("Would you mind ...?" विनम्र निवेदन।)
Why the others are wrong
• **May / Could / Need** – do not fit "___ you mind lending" as naturally as "Would".

Q.12 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The Children's Series _____ recommended for young readers.

(a) are **(b)** has
(c) is **(d)** have

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) is
Type: Fill in the Blank – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "The Children's Series" (a single series) is **singular** → "**is**".
(एकवचन "Series" → "is"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **are / have** – plural; **has** – needs "been" for passive; here "is recommended" is correct.

Q.13 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
He is an honest man and his conduct is _____ suspicion.

(a) below **(b)** over
(c) above **(d)** against

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) above
Type: Fill in the Blank – Idiom
Rule: "**above suspicion**" = so honest that no one can doubt.
("above suspicion" = संदेह से परे।)
Why the others are wrong
• **below / over / against** – do not form the idiom "above suspicion".

Q.14 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The hall was spacious _____ to accommodate all the guests.

(a) fairly **(b)** also
(c) enough **(d)** rather

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) enough
Type: Fill in the Blank – "adjective + enough + to"
Rule: "**adjective + enough + to + V1**". "spacious **enough** to accommodate ..."
("adjective + enough + to" संरचना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **fairly / also / rather** – do not fit the "___ to accommodate" pattern.

Q.15 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
There _____ no porters on the platform, he had to carry his luggage himself.

(a) going **(b)** being
(c) having **(d)** been

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) being
Type: Fill in the Blank – Participle Clause
Rule: A cause is expressed with "**There being** ..." (participle). "There **being** no porters ..., he had to carry his luggage himself."
("There being ..." = चूँकि ... थे।)
Why the others are wrong
• **going / having / been** – do not form the correct participle clause.

Q.16 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The workers _____ against the new labour laws.

(a) opposed **(b)** implicated
(c) remonstrated **(d)** dissented

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) remonstrated
Type: Fill in the Blank – Word Choice
Rule: "**remonstrate against**" = to protest strongly against. "The workers **remonstrated** against the new labour laws."
Why the others are wrong
• **opposed** (no 'against'); **implicated** – involve in a crime; **dissented** (takes 'from').

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Q.17 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Everyone in the family _____ been questioned about the theft.

(a) are **(b)** have
(c) has **(d)** is

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) has
Type: Fill in the Blank – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "Everyone" is **singular** → "**has** been questioned".
("Everyone" एकवचन → "has" ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **are / have** – plural; **is** – "is been" is wrong (need "has been").

Q.18 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Everything happened so quickly _____ she felt dazed.

(a) then **(b)** than
(c) that **(d)** since

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) that
Type: Fill in the Blank – "so ... that"
Rule: "so + adverb + **that** + result". "so quickly **that** she felt dazed."
("so ... that" संरचना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **then / than / since** – wrong connector for a result clause.

Q.19 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Have you _____ with the difficulties you might have to face?

(a) pondered **(b)** discussed
(c) reckoned **(d)** considered

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) reckoned
Type: Fill in the Blank – Phrasal Verb
Rule: "**reckon with**" = to take into account / be prepared for. "Have you **reckoned** with the difficulties ...?"
Why the others are wrong
• **pondered / discussed / considered** – do not take "with" in this sense.

Q.20 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The more he tried to solve the mystery, the more _____ he felt.

(a) perplexed **(b)** callous
(c) humbled **(d)** confusing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) perplexed
Type: Fill in the Blank – Word Choice
Rule: "the more ... the more **perplexed** he felt" = the more confused/puzzled he felt (adjective describing him).
Why the others are wrong
• **callous** – unfeeling; **humbled** – wrong sense; **confusing** – describes a thing, not a person's feeling.

Q.21 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
He was _____ at his brother's refusal to help him financially.

(a) indignant **(b)** enchanted
(c) enamoured **(d)** indicted

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) indignant
Type: Fill in the Blank – Word Choice
Rule: "**indignant at**" = angry at something unfair. He was **indignant** at his brother's refusal.
Why the others are wrong
• **enchanted / enamoured** – delighted (opposite); **indicted** – formally charged.

Q.22 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
In the absence of the Principal, the Vice- Principal _____ for him.

(a) officiates **(b)** replaces
(c) exchanges **(d)** deputes

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) officiates
Type: Fill in the Blank – Word Choice
Rule: "**officiate for**" = to perform someone's duties in his absence. The Vice-Principal **officiates** for the Principal.
Why the others are wrong
• **replaces** (permanent); **exchanges / deputes** – wrong sense.

Q.23 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
All is calm now _____ the heart of Paris due to the lock-down.

(a) in **(b)** by
(c) at **(d)** on

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) in
Type: Fill in the Blank – Preposition
Rule: "**in** the heart of Paris" = in the central part.
("in the heart of" = ... के मध्य में।)
Why the others are wrong
• **by / at / on** – "in the heart of (a place)" is the correct phrase.

Q.24 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
_____ the bus stopped, the children ran out.

(a) As soon as **(b)** As long as
(c) No sooner than **(d)** In order that

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) As soon as
Type: Fill in the Blank – Conjunction
Rule: "**As soon as**" = immediately when. "As soon as the bus stopped, the children ran out."
("As soon as" = जैसे ही।)
Why the others are wrong
• **As long as / No sooner than / In order that** – wrong meaning here.

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Q.25 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
_____ 540,000-square-foot building now houses _____ enormous collection of artworks and historic archives.

(a) The; no word required **(b)** No word required; the
(c) A; an **(d)** The; a

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A; an
Type: Fill in the Blank – Articles
Rule: First mention of the building → "**A**"; before "enormous" (vowel sound) → "**an**".
(पहली बार "A"; स्वर-ध्वनि से पहले "an"।)
Application
"**A** 540,000-square-foot building now houses **an** enormous collection ..."

Q.26 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The Magic Fountain is renowned for _____ spectacular light and music shows.

(a) his **(b)** their
(c) it's **(d)** its

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) its
Type: Fill in the Blank – Possessive Pronoun
Rule: "The Magic Fountain" is a thing → possessive "**its**". "renowned for **its** spectacular ... show."
("its" = इसका (निर्जीव)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **his / their** – wrong number/gender; **it's** = "it is" (wrong).

Q.27 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The policeman stopped me _____ let me go after I showed him my pass.

(a) because **(b)** or
(c) but **(d)** so

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) but
Type: Fill in the Blank – Conjunction (Contrast)
Rule: "stopped me **but** let me go" shows a contrast between stopping and releasing.
("but" (विरोध) सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **because / or / so** – do not give the contrast between "stopped" and "let me go".

Q.28 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Vishal is going to read the story _____.

(a) aloud **(b)** load
(c) allowed **(d)** allow

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) aloud
aloud – speak or read something loudly.Load – to put a weight on something.Allow – permit for something

Q.29 Fill in the blank with the most appropriate word.
The annual meeting of our club has been _____ till next month.

(a) dragged **(b)** disrupted
(c) deranged **(d)** deferred

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) deferred
Type: Fill in the Blank – Vocabulary
deferred = postponed / put off to a later time (स्थगित). "the meeting has been **deferred** till next month."
Why the others are wrong
• **dragged** – pulled; **disrupted** – interrupted; **deranged** – made insane — none means "postponed".

Q.30 Fill in the blank with the most appropriate word.
The boy _____ to take the money.

(a) reminded **(b)** refused
(c) ordered **(d)** denied

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2021

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) refused
Type: Fill in the Blank – Verb + Infinitive
Rule: "**refuse to + V1**" = to say no to doing something. "The boy **refused** to take the money."
("refuse to + verb"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **reminded / ordered** – need an object; **denied** – is followed by a gerund ("denied taking"), not "to take".

Q.31 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The friends decided to play cards to _____ time while waiting for the cab.

(a) ignore **(b)** ease
(c) move **(d)** kill

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) kill
To kill time – to spend time doing something while one is waiting.

Q.32 Select the correct homonym from the given options to fill in the blank.
Which_____does the minister take to reach the Assembly?

(a) route **(b)** riot
(c) rot **(d)** root

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) route
route – a way from one place to anotherRiot – group of people behaving in a violent way often as a protest.Rot – to decay

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Q.33 Select the correct homonym from the given options to fill in the blank.The wind_____ so powerfully that the door closed.

(a) blow **(b)** blues
(c) blue **(d)** blew

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) blew
In the given sentence, 'closed' is used which means that the sentence is in the past tense. So, past form of the verb should some in the blank space.
Blow – base form of the verb, so, cannot be used here.
Blues – a style of music and has no relevance to the sentences.
Blue – a colour.
Blew – past form of blow which means to move air or cause a current of air.
'blew' is the correct word to be used here.

Q.34 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.Many students do not _____ attention in botany class.

(a) exhibit **(b)** drive
(c) pay **(d)** trace

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) pay
pay attention – to focus to something.
option (a) – exhibit – to show or display something.
option (b) – drive – to propel or control the movement of something
option (d) – trace – to find the origins or development of something
None of the above fit in the sentence except 'pay'. So, option (c) is the correct one.

Q.35 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.The management wants to _____ restrictions at the workplace.

(a) impose **(b)** break
(c) encourage **(d)** settle

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) impose
Impose – to force something to be accepted or put into effect.
Break – to separate into pieces, to stop or interrupt something or to violate a law or agreement.
Settle – to resolve a dispute or reach an agreement.
Encourage – to support or give confidence.
Considering the meanings of the given words and the sense of the sentence, 'a' is the correct option.

Q.36 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.Tia wanted a dog that was _____ than Larry's dog.

(a) smartest and strongest **(b)** smarter and stronger
(c) smarty and strong **(d)** smart and strong

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) smarter and stronger
The sentence is comparing Tia's dog and Larry's dog. So, comparative degree of adjective should be used which is 'smarter and stronger'. So, option (b) is the correct one.

Q.37 Select the most appropriate homonym to fill in the blank._____ knowledge in this field is really profound.

(a) Dare **(b)** They're
(c) There **(d)** Their

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Their
Their – it is a possessive pronoun. In the given sentence it is appropriate to use 'their' because it means that the knowledge belonging to a particular group is profound.
Other options do not fit into the context of the sentence.
There – used for location or a point in space.
Dare – a verb meaning having the courage to do something.
They're – a contraction of they are.

Q.38 Select the correct collocation from the options and complete the sentence. Rahul is ____ Coding.

(a) experienced in **(b)** experienced of
(c) strong of **(d)** skilled on

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) experienced in
'skilled on' is incorrect. 'Skilled in' or 'skilled at' should be used instead of skilled on.
Strong of – either we use strong in or strong at but we don't use strong of.
Experienced of – either we use experienced in or experienced at. Experienced of is nowhere used.
Experienced in – having knowledge or skill in a particular field through practice.

Q.39 Select the most appropriate homonym to fill in the blank.The farmers grow _____ in their fields.

(a) mase **(b)** maze
(c) mays **(d)** maize

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) maize
Maze – a puzzle or labyrinth.
Mays – a plural form of the month may
Maize – a type of corn.
The most appropriate word to fill in the blank is maize. So, option (d) is the correct choice.

Q.40 Select the most appropriate collocating word to fill in the blank.Mentally strong people do not_____ to suicide over trivial issues.

(a) Make up **(b)** Conceive on
(c) Give in **(d)** Fall in

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Give in
Give in – to surrender or submit to something.
Make up – to create something or invent something
Conceive on – conceive on is not a phrasal verb. But conceive means to form a plan.
Fall in – to conform or comply with something.
The most appropriate option is option (c).

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Q.41 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.The movie was released_____ expected.

(a) later then **(b)** later than
(c) most later than **(d)** more later than

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) later than
In the given sentence, the actual release date of the movie is being compared to the expected release date. So, comparative degree should be used. 'later than' is the correct choice.
Later then – then is incorrect. While comparing, we use than.
Most later than and more later than both are grammatically incorrect.

Q.42 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.When the victim narrated his version of the incident, the jury was _____ .

(a) perfectly satisfied
(b) excruciatingly satisfied
(c) honestly satisfied
(d) completely satisfied

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) completely satisfied
Honestly satisfied – means the satisfaction is because of honesty, and does not tell about the extent of satisfaction.
Perfectly satisfied – an overly idealistic and exaggerated level of satisfaction.
Excruciatingly satisfied – not a suitable collocation. Excruciating is used to describe intense pain or discomfort.
Completely satisfied – it shows a greater intensity of satisfaction. It is the correct choice for the given sentence. It indicates that the jury was fully and entirely satisfied.

Q.43 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.Nowadays, online shopping is easier _____ shopping in a market.

(a) as **(b)** than
(c) like **(d)** then

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) than
than - used for comparison.
Like – will show the two things similar. Therefore it would be incorrect.
Then – is a conjunction used to show a sequence.
As – used to show similarity of two things.
Hence 'than' is the right word for the blank.

Q.44 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.The security guard needs a _____ of shoes.

(a) pair **(b)** payor
(c) pear **(d)** pare

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) pair
Pair – two things meant to use together and looks same.
Pare – to trim or cut something down to essential parts.
Pear – a fruit.
Payor – one who pays money.
So, option (a) is the correct answer.

Q.45 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.The committee will _____ a survey on the government schemes.

(a) originate **(b)** hold
(c) fight **(d)** conduct

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) conduct
Conduct is the appropriate word for the given sentence.
Conduct – to carry out or organize a survey.
Hold – also means to arrange or organize an event but it is not as appropriate as conduct.
Originate and fight are inappropriate words for the given sentence.

Q.46 Select the correct homonym from the given options to fill in the blank.The athlete's_____ was badly injured due to a fall on the track.

(a) tow **(b)** toad
(c) toe **(d)** to

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) toe
Toe – fingers at each end of the foot.
Toad – is an amphibian like frog.
Tow – to drag something behind you.
To – a preposition for direction or location.
The most appropriate option is 'a'.

Q.47 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
You use an _____ to steer a boat.

(a) ore **(b)** or
(c) oar **(d)** are

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) oar
The correct answer is option (c).
Oar: it is a long pole with a broad blade at one end used for propelling or steering a boat.
Ore: a naturally occurring solid material from which a metal or valuable mineral can be extracted profitably.
Hence, the correct answer is **Oar.**

Q.48 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
By this time tomorrow, I _____ the work assigned to me.

(a) will do **(b)** will be done
(c) will have done **(d)** will have did

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) will have done
The correct answer is option (c).
"will have done"
In the sentence, the context is a future action that will be completed before a specific point in the future (by this time tomorrow). This construction requires the future perfect tense, which is formed using
"will have" followed by the past participle of the verb. In this case, "done" is the past participle of "do." So, "will have done" is the correct choice to indicate the completion of the work in the future before the specified time.

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Q.49 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The girl was _____ as she was drenched in the rain.

(a) gold **(b)** bolt
(c) cold **(d)** tight

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) cold
The correct answer is option (c).
The most appropriate answer is **cold.**
The sentence is describing the girl's condition after being drenched in the rain. **"Cold"** is the correct word to use here, as it indicates that the girl felt chilly or uncomfortable due to being wet in the rain. The other options ("gold," "bolt," and "tight") do not convey the appropriate meaning in this context.
Hence, **cold** is the most appropriate answer.

Q.50 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Robin watched as the smoke _____ steadily from the chimney.

(a) went **(b)** hung
(c) left **(d)** rose

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) rose
The correct answer is option (d).
The most appropriate option to fill in the blank is: "rose"
In this context, "rose" is the correct verb to use when describing the upward movement of smoke from a chimney.
The other options don't fit the context as well.
The complete sentence would be: **"Robin watched as the smoke rose steadily from the chimney."**

Q.51 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Rashid was not able to ____ the pain after the accident.

(a) beer **(b)** bare
(c) buyer **(d)** bear

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) bear
Bear: Means to endure or tolerate something, such as pain or hardship.
So, Complete sentence: Rashid was not able to **bear**the pain after the accident.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.
The meaning of other options are:
Beer: A drink, not relevant here.
Bare: Means to uncover or expose, not suitable in this context.
Buyer: Refers to someone who purchases something, unrelated to the sentence.

Q.52 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The mango is the_____ fruit.

(a) sweetly **(b)** sweeter
(c) sweet **(d)** sweetest

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) sweetest
Sweetest is the superlative form of "sweet," used to describe the highest degree of sweetness among a group (in this case, fruits).
Correct answer: The mango is the **sweetest** fruit.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.53 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
No other book in the series captivated readers as _____ as the final installment.

(a) many **(b)** much
(c) more **(d)** most

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) much
"Much" is used to express the degree of captivation in this sentence. The structure "as...as" requires an unquantifiable measure (degree or intensity), which "much" conveys correctly.
Correct Sentence:
"No other book in the series captivated readers as much as the final installment."
Thus, **"much"** is the most appropriate option. So, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.54 Select the most appropriate pronoun to fill in the blank.
Mr. Amit Kumar, Proprietor of Xyling Pens is known for _____ honesty and decent behaviour in the business arena.

(a) they **(b)** it
(c) her **(d)** his

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) his
Since "Mr. Amit Kumar" refers to a male individual, the possessive pronoun **"his"** is used to refer to his qualities (honesty and decent behavior).
The correct sentence is:
"Mr. Amit Kumar, Proprietor of Xyling Pens is known for his honesty and decent behaviour in the business arena."
So, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.55 Select the most appropriate tense form to fill in the blank.
Tania _____ to the canteen.

(a) were gone **(b)** were going
(c) was going **(d)** had going

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) was going
The most appropriate tense form to fill in the blank is **was going**.
The correct sentence would be: "Tania **was going** to the canteen."

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Q.56 Select the most appropriate homophone from the options to fill in the blank.
We should _____ away all prejudices to live in harmony.

(a) caste **(b)** cast
(c) cost **(d)** coast

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) cast
Cast: Means to throw or get rid of something (e.g., cast away prejudices).
Correct Sentence:
"We should cast away all prejudices to live in harmony."
The other options are:
Caste: Refers to a social class or group, which is unrelated to the context of the sentence.
Cost: Refers to the price or expense of something, not relevant here.
Coast: Refers to the land beside the sea, also unrelated.
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.57 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Luck does not always favour us, so we must always depend _____ our own efforts for success.

(a) in **(b)** upon
(c) at **(d)** for

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) upon
The verb **"depend"** is commonly followed by the preposition **"on"** or **"upon."** Both prepositions are correct, but **"on"** is more commonly used in modern English.
Corrected Sentence:
"Luck does not always favour us, so we must always depend **upon** our own efforts for success."
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.58 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Prescription safety glasses provide the _____ tailored protection for individuals with vision correction needs.

(a) finer **(b)** more finely
(c) finest **(d)** fine

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) finest
Finest is the superlative form of "fine," which is used to indicate the highest degree or quality. In this context, it emphasizes that the protection is the best or most suitable for individuals with vision correction needs. Thus, **finest** is the correct choice.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.59 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
This is the _____ book that I have read till now.

(a) most interesting **(b)** more interesting
(c) interesting **(d)** better interest

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) most interesting
The superlative degree is used to describe the highest degree of a quality among three or more items. Here, the speaker is indicating that, out of all the books they have read, this particular book is the most interesting. The correct option to fill in the blank is **"most interesting."**
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.60 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The blueberries in the basket are blue.
The denotation of the word 'blue' is _____.

(a) gloominess **(b)** sadness
(c) a colour **(d)** negativity

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) a colour
The most appropriate option to fill in the blank is:
a colour
The denotation of the word "blue" refers to a colour.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.61 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The comedian's jokes were so funny that the entire audience erupted in _____.

(a) loiter **(b)** later
(c) latter **(d)** laughter

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) laughter
The most appropriate option to fill in the blank is: **laughter**.
The complete sentence would be: "The comedian's jokes were so funny that the entire audience erupted in laughter."
Laughter is the correct noun here, as it refers to the sound of people laughing.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.62 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Quarrels result in_____ confrontations and bring all conversations to a complete standstill.

(a) hot **(b)** disputed
(c) heated **(d)** cold

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) heated
option (c) is the correct answer. Heated suits the best.
Hot: causing a burning feeling in your mouth.
Disputed: to argue about something and to question if it is true or right.
Heated: angry or excited.
Cold: having a low temperature; not hot or warm.
Quarrels result in heated confrontations and bring all conversations to a complete standstill.

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Q.63 Select the most appropriate article to fill in the blank.
Rabindranath Tagore, _____ poet, was famous for his poetical work, Gitanjali.

(a) no article required **(b)** the
(c) an **(d)** a

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) the
1. "a" is used when you're introducing or referring to one of many things (in this case, one poet among many poets).
2. "the" is used when you're referring to something specific or when the noun is well-known or has been previously mentioned.
Since Rabindranath Tagore is a famous poet and the sentence is describing his well-known identity as a poet, the definite article **"the"** is correct in this context.
Complete sentence:
"Rabindranath Tagore, the poet, was famous for his poetical work, Gitanjali."
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.64 Choose the most appropriate option to fill the blank in the given sentence.
The tiny deer stood looking at them with _____ eyes.

(a) Arid **(b)** Transparent
(c) Stationary **(d)** Luminous

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Luminous
Meaning: **luminous** = shining, glowing, bright *(चमकदार, दीप्तिमान)*.
luminous eyes = large, bright, shining eyes — the natural picture of a young deer gazing at someone.
Answer: **Luminous**
Why the others are wrong.
• **arid** = very dry (of land or climate) *(शुष्क, बंजर)* — not used for eyes.
• **transparent** = see-through *(पारदर्शी)* — eyes are not see-through.
• **stationary** = not moving *(स्थिर)* — describes the deer (it *stood*), not its eyes; do not confuse with *stationery* (paper and pens).
Bright eyes, luminous eyes, shining eyes — the blank wants a quality of light.

Q.65 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
I did not ____ to university yesterday.

(a) gone **(b)** go
(c) went **(d)** going

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) go
The most appropriate option to fill in the blank is **go**.
The correct sentence would be: "I did not **go** to university yesterday."
Go: This is the correct choice. It is the base form of the verb and is suitable for expressing an action in the simple past tense. The sentence would be, "I did not **go** to university yesterday."

Q.66 Choose the option that contains the homonym of the highlighted word in the given sentence.
Please make sure to write your full home address, including the apartment number and zip code, on the top of the application form.

(a) After living in the city for ten years, Sarah had to notify the post office that her permanent address was changing to a rural farmhouse.
(b) Millions of people tuned in to watch the president's televised address regarding the new economic policies.
(c) The celebrity requested that her residential address be kept private and removed from all public search directories for security reasons.
(d) The delivery driver called me because he was having trouble finding my address on the GPS due to the new construction in the neighborhood.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Millions of people tuned in to watch the president's televised address regarding the new economic policies.
Meaning: **homonyms** = words with the same spelling and sound but different meanings *(समरूपी शब्द)*.
In the stem, **address** = the details of where someone lives *(पता)*.
In option (b), **address** = a formal speech to an audience *(संबोधन, भाषण)* — same word, different meaning.
Answer: **Millions of people tuned in to watch the president's televised address regarding the new economic policies.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **her permanent address** — where she lives *(स्थायी पता)*: the same meaning as the stem.
• **her residential address** — home location *(आवासीय पता)*: the same meaning.
• **my address on the GPS** — the location of my home *(घर का पता)*: the same meaning.
address also works as a verb — "address the issue" = deal with it (समाधान करना) — a third sense to remember.

Q.67 Choose the most appropriate option to fill the blank in the given sentence.
Radium _____ rays that can damage the eyes.

(a) gives up **(b)** gives off
(c) gives away **(d)** gives over

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) gives off
Meaning: **give off** = to send out, emit (heat, light, gas, smell, rays) *(छोड़ना, उत्सर्जित करना)*.
Radium is radioactive — it **emits** rays, so: Radium **gives off** rays that can damage the eyes.
Answer: **gives off**
Why the others are wrong.
• **give up** = stop, quit, abandon *(छोड़ देना, त्यागना)* — *He gave up smoking.*
• **give away** = give free; or reveal a secret *(मुफ़्त देना; भेद खोलना)* — *She gave away her old books.*
• **give over** = hand over, set aside for a purpose; (informal) stop *(सौंपना; बंद करना)* — *The hall was given over to the exhibition.*
Give off = emit: smoke, smell, heat, light, rays.

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Q.68 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
Fingernails and toenails helped our _____ to climb trees, peel fruits and use simple tools. While their colour and condition offer clues about your _____health. Nail polish turns them into fashion accessories.

(a) general; altogether **(b)** predecessor; universal
(c) forefather; all in all **(d)** ancestors; overall

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ancestors; overall
option (d) is the correct answer. Ancestors and overall suits the best to fill in the blank.
General: referring to or describing the main part of something, not the details.
Predecessor: the person who was in the job or position before the person who is in it now.
Forefather: a member of your family, especially a **man**, who lived a long time ago.
Ancestors: a person in your family who lived a long time before you.
Thus, the correct sentence is: Fingernails and toenails helped our ***ancestors*** to climb trees, peel fruits and use simple tools. While their colour and condition offer clues about your ***overall*** health. Nail polish turns them into fashion accessories.

Q.69 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
Reptiles _____ from amphibians. For a long period of 160 million years in earth's history, reptiles were the dominant form of life on the planet and _____ in an enormous variety of shapes and sizes.

(a) came; exhausted **(b)** involved; lived
(c) developed; continued **(d)** evolved; existed

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) evolved; existed
option (d) is the correct answer.
The correct words to fill in the blank are: evolved; existed
- Evolved: (used about plants, animals, etc.) to develop over many thousands of years from simple forms to more advanced ones.
- Exited: to be real; to be found in the real world; to live
- Involved: difficult to understand; complicated.
- Developed: of a good level or standard.

The correct sentence is: *Reptiles **evolved** from amphibians. For a long period of 160 million years in earth's history, reptiles were the dominant form of life on the planet and **existed** in an enormous variety of shapes and sizes.*

Q.70 Complete the sentence by choosing an appropriate word from the given options.
He has not _____ returned the money.

(a) too **(b)** still
(c) yet **(d)** only

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) yet
Yet is commonly used in negative sentences to indicate that something has not happened up until now, but may happen in the future.
Thus, the correct answer is **yet**. The sentence reads: **"He has not yet returned the money."**

Q.71 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Currently, Mittu and Bittu _____ hard to meet the project deadline.

(a) worked **(b)** are working
(c) have worked **(d)** were working

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) are working
The most appropriate option to fill in the blank is: **are working**
are working: This option correctly uses the present continuous tense "are working," indicating that Mittu and Bittu are currently engaged in the action of working. This aligns with the adverb "currently" in the sentence.

Q.72 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The war _____ badly damaged the country's infrastructure.

(a) has **(b)** have
(c) was **(d)** is

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) has
The most appropriate option to fill in the blank is **"has."**
The sentence would be: **"The war has badly damaged the country's infrastructure."**
Has: This is the correct choice. When talking about an action that occurred in the past and has a direct impact on the present (such as the damage caused by the war), the present perfect tense is used. "Has" is the auxiliary verb in the present perfect tense, followed by the past participle "damaged."

Q.73 Select the most appropriate tense form to fill in the blank.
Mohnish and Ravi _____ to Canada next month.

(a) is moving **(b)** are moving
(c) has moving **(d)** has move

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) are moving
The most appropriate tense form to fill in the blank is:
"Mohnish and Ravi are moving to Canada next month."
are moving: This is the correct option. It uses the plural form "are," which agrees with the plural subject "Mohnish and Ravi." Additionally, the present continuous tense "are moving" is suitable for indicating a future action that has been planned or arranged.

Q.74 Select the most appropriate adverb to fill in the blank.
_____, I'm going to walk my dog.

(a) Rarely **(b)** Now
(c) Annually **(d)** Already

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Now
"Now" is used to indicate the present moment, suggesting that the action will happen immediately or shortly. In this sentence, it makes sense to say **"Now, I'm going to walk my dog"** as it indicates the action is about to happen.

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Q.75 Select the most appropriate homonym to fill in the blanks of the given sentences.
A. I use a _____ to weigh my ingredients while cooking.
B. The mountaineer is going to _____ the rocky hills.

(a) climb **(b)** horn
(c) crawl **(d)** scale

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) scale
The most appropriate homonym to fill in the blanks is: **scale**
A. I use a **scale** to weigh my ingredients while cooking.
B. The mountaineer is going to **scale** the rocky hills.
scale (as a verb): "Scale" is the correct homonym for the second sentence where climbing or ascending is implied.
climb: While "climb" could work in the second sentence, it is not the homonym for the device used in the first sentence.
horn: "Horn" does not fit in either sentence. It is unrelated to measuring ingredients in cooking or climbing rocky hills.
crawl: "Crawl" does not fit in either sentence. It does not relate to measuring ingredients or climbing hills.

Q.76 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Stanley _____ to play the violin now, with an amateur instructor.

(a) had learnt **(b)** is learning
(c) will learn **(d)** was learning

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) is learning
The most appropriate option to fill in the blank is: **is learning**
The complete sentence would be: **" Stanley is learning to play the violin now, with an amateur instructor."**
The sentence is describing Stanley's current activity of learning to play the violin, so the present continuous tense "is learning" is the most appropriate choice to convey this ongoing action.

Q.77 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
It's funny how every time he fails to apply the _____ and _____ the glass.

(a) brakes; brakes **(b)** brakes; breaks
(c) breaks; breaks **(d)** breaks; brakes

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) brakes; breaks
"Brakes" refers to the device used to slow or stop a vehicle, and it makes sense in the context of something he is supposed to apply to stop or slow down.
"Breaks" refers to the act of causing something to separate into pieces.
Thus, the correct sentence would be:
"It's funny how every time he fails to apply the brakes and breaks the glass."

Q.78 Select the most appropriate article(s) to fill in the blanks.
I was in _____ state of unconsciousness for about half _____ hour.

(a) a ; No article **(b)** the ; a
(c) No article ; an **(d)** a ; an

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) a ; an
"a" is used before singular, countable nouns that begin with a consonant sound (in this case, "state").
"an" is used before singular, countable nouns that begin with a vowel sound. Since "hour" starts with a vowel sound ("aʊr"), we use **"an"** before it.
So, the sentence becomes:
"I was in a state of unconsciousness for about half an hour."
Thus, the correct answer is **a ; an**.

Q.79 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The rising rate of inflation is making life very hard for _____ poor.

(a) the **(b)** all
(c) some **(d)** its

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) the
The phrase **"the poor"** is commonly used to refer to people who are economically disadvantaged or living in poverty.

Q.80 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
His family lives _____ Mahu in Madhya Pradesh.

(a) of **(b)** at
(c) by **(d)** on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) at
"At" is used to specify a particular location or place, such as a town or city, and is the correct preposition to use in this sentence when referring to a specific location.
The sentence becomes: **"His family lives at Mahu in Madhya Pradesh."**
The preposition **"of"** is used to show possession, relationships, or characteristics.
The preposition **"by"** is used to indicate means, proximity, authorship, and actions done near or around something.
The preposition **"on"** is used to indicate surface, location, time, or a specific activity.

Q.81 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
He is both diligent _____ efficient.

(a) also **(b)** but
(c) and **(d)** yet

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) and
Type: Fill in the Blank – Correlative Conjunction
Rule: The fixed pair is "**both ... and**". "He is both diligent **and** efficient."
("both" के साथ हमेशा "and" आता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **also / but / yet** – none pairs with "both".

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Q.82 Which of the following options is NOT one of the meanings of the homonym 'suspension'?

(a) The act of temporarily stopping or halting something
(b) A mixture in which particles are dispersed in a fluid but not dissolved
(c) A state of uncertainty or excitement about what will happen next
(d) A type of mechanical system used in vehicles to absorb shocks

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A state of uncertainty or excitement about what will happen next

Meaning: **suspension** = the act of hanging or holding something up, and from that several meanings *(निलंबन / निलंबन तंत्र / निलंबित मिश्रण)*.

The real meanings.

• a **temporary stop** — *suspension of play, suspension from duty (निलंबन, अस्थायी रोक)*
• in chemistry, a **mixture with undissolved particles** — *chalk in water (निलंबन/निलंबित विलयन)*
• in vehicles, the **shock-absorbing system** *(सस्पेंशन, झटके सहने का तंत्र)*

The odd one.

"A state of uncertainty or excitement about what will happen next" is the meaning of **suspense** *(उत्सुकता, रोमांच)*, not *suspension*.

Answer: **(3) A state of uncertainty or excitement about what will happen next**

Why the others are fine.

• **temporarily stopping** — a true meaning: *the suspension of train services*.
• **particles dispersed but not dissolved** — a true meaning in chemistry.
• **mechanical system to absorb shocks** — a true meaning: *a car's suspension*.

A thriller keeps you in SUSPENSE; a car rides on its SUSPENSION.

Q.83 Choose the most suitable preposition from the given options to fill in the blank in the following sentence:
The decision was consistent _____ company policy.

(a) with **(b)** to
(c) by **(d)** for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) with

Rule: the adjective **consistent** takes **with** when it means "in agreement with" *(के अनुरूप)*.

Example: *His words are not consistent with his actions.*

Apply it.

*The decision was consistent **with** company policy.* — it agreed with the policy.

Answer: **(1) with**

Why the others are wrong.

• **to** — goes with *according to*, *similar to*, *contrary to (के अनुसार/ विपरीत)*, never with *consistent*.
• **by** — marks the agent or means *(के द्वारा)*; "consistent by" is not an English collocation.
• **for** — shows purpose or benefit *(के लिए)*; it cannot express agreement.

Consistent WITH, in line WITH, in keeping WITH — agreement takes "with".

Q.84 Which of the following pairs of homonyms can be used to fill in the blanks most suitably?
During his _____ from the snowy peak, he thought about his _____ from a long line of mountaineers.

(a) descent, descent **(b)** descent, dissent
(c) dissent, descent **(d)** dissent, dissent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) descent, descent

Meaning: **descent** has two meanings *(दो अर्थ वाला शब्द)*:
• the act of **coming down** a slope *(उतराई, अवरोहण)*
• one's **ancestry, lineage** *(वंश, कुल)*

Apply it.

Blank 1 — coming down **from the snowy peak → descent** (going down).
Blank 2 — **from a long line of mountaineers → descent** (ancestry).
The same word fits both blanks — that is the homonym being tested.

Answer: **(1) descent, descent**

Why the others are wrong.

• **descent, dissent** — **dissent** = disagreement with an official view *(असहमति)*; one cannot have "dissent from a long line of mountaineers" in the sense of family.
• **dissent, descent** — "his dissent from the snowy peak" makes no sense; one does not disagree with a mountain.
• **dissent, dissent** — neither blank is about disagreement.

De-SCENT goes down (a hill or a family tree); dis-SENT disagrees.

Q.85 The following sentence has two blanks. Choose the most suitable set of prepositions from the given options to fill in the blanks and complete the sentence meaningfully:
The athlete excelled _____ sprinting but faltered _____ long-distance events.

(a) in, at **(b)** on, in
(c) in, by **(d)** with, at

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) in, at

Rule: **excel in / at** a field or activity *(किसी क्षेत्र में श्रेष्ठ होना)*; **falter at** a task or obstacle *(पर लड़खड़ाना)*.

Example: *She excels in mathematics but falters at public speaking.*

Apply it.

excelled **in** sprinting — the field he was best in.
faltered **at** long-distance events — the point where he stumbled.

Answer: **(1) in, at**

Why the others are wrong.

• **on, in** — *excel on* is not used; *on* marks a surface or a day *(सतह/दिन)*.
• **in, by** — *by* marks agent or means *(के द्वारा)*; *faltered by events* turns the events into the cause, not the place of failure.
• **with, at** — *excel with* means "using" something *(के साथ)*, not the field one is good in.

Excel IN a field, falter AT a hurdle.

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Q.86 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Generally people use _____ oils for their cooking.

(a) improved **(b)** refined
(c) washed **(d)** cleared

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) refined
Type: Fill in the Blank – Collocation
Rule: The natural phrase is "**refined oil**" (purified cooking oil).
("refined oil" = परिष्कृत तेल।)
Why the others are wrong
• **improved / washed / cleared** – none collocates with "oils for cooking" like "refined".

Q.87 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Bonsai gardening was first practiced in China but became ____ because of the Japanese.

(a) prevailing **(b)** frequent
(c) customary **(d)** popular

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) popular
Type: Fill in the Blank – Vocabulary
Bonsai gardening became **popular** (widely liked) because of the Japanese.
("popular" = लोकप्रिय।)
Why the others are wrong
• **prevailing** – dominant/existing; **frequent** – happening often; **customary** – usual — none fits "became ___ because of the Japanese" as well as "popular".

Q.88 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Movie makers generally _____ historical facts to write their stories.

(a) explain **(b)** account
(c) correct **(d)** adapt

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) adapt
Type: Fill in the Blank – Vocabulary
Movie makers **adapt** (adjust/rework) historical facts to write their stories.
("adapt" = अनुकूलित करना/ढालना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **explain / account / correct** – none means "to modify facts to suit a story".

Q.89 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
During the night the express train picked up _____.

(a) distance **(b)** speed
(c) quick **(d)** rate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) speed
Type: Fill in the Blank – Collocation
Rule: The fixed collocation is "**pick up speed**" (to go faster).
"the express train picked up **speed**."
("pick up speed" = गति पकड़ना।)
Why the others are wrong

Explanation (contd.)
• **distance / quick / rate** – none collocates with "picked up" in this sense.

Q.90 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The nationalists followed a policy of non-violence to make their _____ successful.

(a) politics **(b)** speeches
(c) encounter **(d)** struggle

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) struggle
Type: Fill in the Blank – Context
Nationalists follow non-violence to make their **struggle** (freedom movement) successful.
("struggle" = संघर्ष (स्वतंत्रता आंदोलन)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **politics / speeches / encounter** – none fits "policy of non-violence to make their ___ successful" as well as "struggle".

Q.91 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The pleasant _____ of the rain as it fell on the dust made me feel nostalgic.

(a) aroma **(b)** perfume
(c) balm **(d)** incense

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) aroma
Type: Fill in the Blank – Vocabulary
aroma = a pleasant, natural smell (सुगंध). The earthy smell of rain on dust is best called an **aroma**.
Why the others are wrong
• **perfume** – a manufactured fragrance (इत्र).
• **balm** – a soothing ointment (मरहम).
• **incense** – a substance burnt to give a scent (धूप/अगरबत्ती).

Q.92 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The committee's suggestion was not acceptable to everyone as it was _____.

(a) controversial **(b)** concrete
(c) convenient **(d)** considerate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) controversial
Type: Fill in the Blank – Vocabulary
If a suggestion was "**not acceptable to everyone**", it must have been **controversial** (causing disagreement – विवादास्पद).
Why the others are wrong
• **concrete** – solid/definite; **convenient** – suitable; **considerate** – thoughtful – none explains why it was unacceptable.

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Q.93 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
_____ was present in the hall took part in the voting process.

(a) Whichever **(b)** Wherever
(c) Whoever **(d)** Whatever

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Whoever
Type: Fill in the Blank – Relative Pronoun
Rule: For a **person** as the subject ("was present ... took part"), use "**Whoever**" (= any person who).
("Whoever" = जो कोई भी (व्यक्ति)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Whichever** – for a choice among things; **Wherever** – place; **Whatever** – for things.

Q.94 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Bengaluru is a beautiful city which _____ the modern with the traditional.

(a) grows **(b)** breaks
(c) shares **(d)** blends

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) blends
Type: Fill in the Blank – Collocation
Rule: "**blend X with Y**" = to mix/combine. Bengaluru "**blends** the modern with the traditional."
("blend ... with" = मिलाना/संयोजित करना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **grows / breaks / shares** – none collocates with "the modern **with** the traditional".

Q.95 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
He is _____ poorer than all his friends.

(a) more **(b)** very
(c) most **(d)** much

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) much
Type: Fill in the Blank – Intensifier with Comparative
Rule: To emphasise a **comparative** ("poorer"), use "**much**" (much poorer, much better).
(comparative (poorer) को बल देने के लिए "much" आता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **more** – "more poorer" is a double comparative.
• **very** – "very" goes with the positive degree (very poor), not the comparative.
• **most** – used with the superlative.

Q.96 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Either side of the road _____ lined by toy shops.

(a) has **(b)** have
(c) are **(d)** is

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) is
Type: Fill in the Blank – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "**Either side**" is treated as **singular**, so it takes a singular verb → **is**.

Explanation (contd.)
("Either" के साथ एकवचन क्रिया आती है — "is"।)
Application
"Either side of the road **is** lined by toy shops."
Why the others are wrong
• **has** – "has lined" would be wrong voice; the sentence is passive ("is lined").
• **have / are** – plural verbs; "either side" is singular.

Q.97 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
I am your true friend, _____?

(a) isn't it **(b)** is it
(c) am I **(d)** aren't I

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) aren't I
Type: Question Tag
Rule: A positive statement takes a **negative tag**. The accepted tag for "**I am**" is "**aren't I?**"
(Positive वाक्य के साथ negative tag; "I am" का मान्य tag "aren't I?" होता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **isn't it / is it / am I** – wrong; the tag must use the subject "I" and be negative → "aren't I".

Q.98 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The Allies _____ the war in 1945.

(a) won **(b)** were winning
(c) have won **(d)** win

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) won
Type: Fill in the Blank – Simple Past
Rule: A finished action at a **definite past time** ("in 1945") takes the **simple past**.
(निश्चित भूतकाल (in 1945) की समाप्त क्रिया के लिए simple past।)
Application
"The Allies **won** the war in 1945."
Why the others are wrong
• **were winning** – past continuous; **have won** – present perfect (not used with a past date); **win** – present.

Q.99 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Poverty was staring her _____ the face.

(a) on **(b)** to
(c) at **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) in
Type: Fill in the Blank – Idiom
Rule: The idiom is "**stare (somebody) in the face**" = to be very close/obvious/threatening.
("stare somebody in the face" — एक मुहावरा; सही preposition "in"।)
Application
"Poverty was staring her **in** the face" = poverty was an obvious, imminent threat.
Why the others are wrong
• **on / to / at** – the fixed idiom uses "in the face".

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Q.100 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
You _____ carry all the books to school daily.

(a) have not **(b)** would not
(c) need not **(d)** ought not

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) need not
Type: Fill in the Blank – Modal
Rule: "**need not + V1**" = it is not necessary to. "You **need not** carry all the books daily."
("need not + verb" = ... करना ज़रूरी नहीं।)
Why the others are wrong
• **have not** – needs "to" ("do not have to").
• **would not** – changes the meaning (unwillingness).
• **ought not** – needs "to" ("ought not to carry").

Q.101 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
I request the favour of _____ granting me two days' leave.

(a) yourself **(b)** you
(c) yours **(d)** your

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) your
Type: Fill in the Blank – Possessive before Gerund
Rule: Before a gerund (V-ing – "granting"), use a **possessive adjective**: "your granting".
(gerund (granting) से पहले possessive (your) आता है।)
Application
"I request the favour of **your** granting me two days' leave."
Why the others are wrong
• **yourself / you / yours** – none is the possessive adjective needed before "granting".

Q.102 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
I have nobody _____ I can confide in.

(a) whom **(b)** whose
(c) which **(d)** whoever

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) whom
Type: Fill in the Blank – Relative Pronoun (Object)
Rule: "confide in" needs an **object**, so use "**whom**". "nobody **whom** I can confide in."
("confide in" के object के लिए "whom"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **whose** – possessive; **which** – for things, not persons.
• **whoever** – used without an antecedent, not after "nobody".

Q.103 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
We saw some children _____ with one another as we were walking around.

(a) quarrelling **(b)** quarrelled
(c) quarrels **(d)** to quarrel

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) quarrelling
Type: Fill in the Blank – Verb of Perception + V-ing

Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "saw + object + **V-ing**" shows an action in progress that was seen.
(saw के बाद object + V-ing (चल रही क्रिया)।)
Application
"We saw some children **quarrelling** with one another ..."
Why the others are wrong
• **quarrelled / quarrels** – finite verbs cannot follow "saw children".
• **to quarrel** – "saw ... to quarrel" is the wrong pattern here.

Q.104 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
It was _____ who encouraged me while I was sunk in despair.

(a) us **(b)** our
(c) we **(d)** he

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) he
Type: Fill in the Blank – "It was ... who" (Cleft Sentence)
Rule: In "It was ___ who + verb", the blank is the **subject** of "who encouraged", so we need a **subject pronoun** that makes sense — **he**.
("It was ... who ..." संरचना में subject pronoun आता है — "he"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **us / our** – object/possessive forms; and "us encouraged me" makes no sense.
• **we** – "It was we who encouraged me" is illogical (we encouraged me?).

Q.105 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
We have requested Mrs. Nagpal _____ our play for this year's annual function.

(a) directing **(b)** directed
(c) direct **(d)** to direct

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to direct
Type: Fill in the Blank – Verb Pattern
Rule: "request + person + **to + V1**" (request someone **to do** something).
(request के बाद व्यक्ति + **to + verb** आता है।)
Application
"We have requested Mrs. Nagpal **to direct** our play."
Why the others are wrong
• **directing / directed / direct** – none fits the "request somebody **to do**" pattern.

Q.106 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
We'll accept your application _____ you fulfil all the conditions.

(a) although **(b)** so that
(c) even if **(d)** provided

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) provided
Type: Fill in the Blank – Conjunction of Condition
Rule: "**provided (that)**" = only if / on condition that. It introduces a necessary condition.
("provided (that)" = इस शर्त पर कि / केवल यदि।)

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Explanation (contd.)
Application
"We'll accept your application **provided** you fulfil all the conditions."
Why the others are wrong
• **although** – shows contrast (meaning does not fit).
• **so that** – shows purpose.
• **even if** – suggests acceptance despite conditions – opposite sense.

Q.107 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The clown was so funny _____ everybody burst out laughing.

(a) but **(b)** that
(c) because **(d)** when

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) that
Type: Fill in the Blank – "so ... that" Structure
Rule: "**so + adjective + that + result**" shows cause and effect.
("so + विशेषण + that" संरचना कारण और परिणाम दिखाती है।)
Application
"The clown was **so** funny **that** everybody burst out laughing." (result of being so funny)
Why the others are wrong
• **but** – shows contrast.
• **because** – gives a reason, but the pair with "so" is "that".
• **when** – shows time, not result.

Q.108 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The old telephone _____ nobody wants has been thrown into the junkyard.

(a) whom **(b)** what
(c) who **(d)** which

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) which
Type: Fill in the Blank – Relative Pronoun
Rule: For a **thing** (the telephone), the relative pronoun is **which** (or "that"). Use "who/whom" only for people.
(निर्जीव वस्तु के लिए relative pronoun "which"; व्यक्ति के लिए "who/whom"।)
Application
"The old telephone **which** nobody wants has been thrown into the junkyard."
Why the others are wrong
• **whom / who** – used for persons, not a telephone.
• **what** – "what" is not used as a relative pronoun after a noun.

Q.109 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
When John arrived _____ the exhibition it was already _____ full swing.

(a) in, at **(b)** in, in
(c) at, at **(d)** at, in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) at, in
Type: Fill in the Blanks – Prepositions/Idiom

Explanation (contd.)
Rule: We "**arrive at**" a place/event, and "**in full swing**" is a fixed idiom (at its busiest/liveliest).
("arrive at" (किसी स्थान/कार्यक्रम पर पहुँचना); "in full swing" = पूरे ज़ोर पर — एक मुहावरा।)
Application
"When John arrived **at** the exhibition it was already **in** full swing."
Why the others are wrong
• **in, at / in, in / at, at** – "arrive in" suits large areas (countries/cities), and the idiom is fixed as "in full swing", so only **at, in** fits.

Q.110 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
I don't think your sister is enjoying the party. She _____ at her watch for the last half an hour.

(a) had been looking **(b)** has been looking
(c) has looked **(d)** had looked

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has been looking
Type: Fill in the Blank – Present Perfect Continuous
Rule: For an action that **started in the past and is still going on**, with "for/since", use **has/have been + V-ing**.
(जो काम पहले शुरू होकर अब भी चल रहा हो (for/since के साथ) — has/have been + V-ing।)
Application
"She **has been looking** at her watch **for the last half an hour**." (She is still looking now.)
Why the others are wrong
• **had been looking** – past perfect continuous; needs another past action.
• **has looked** – present perfect; does not show the ongoing "for the last half an hour" action.
• **had looked** – past perfect; wrong time frame.

Q.111 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The box was _____ heavy for that little child to carry.

(a) much **(b)** lot
(c) enough **(d)** too

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) too
Type: Fill in the Blank – "too ... to" Structure
Rule: "**too + adjective + for + someone + to + V1**" shows that something is so much that it prevents an action.
("too ... to" संरचना: too + विशेषण + for + व्यक्ति + to + verb।)
Application
"The box was **too** heavy for that little child to carry." (so heavy that the child could not carry it)
Why the others are wrong
• **much / lot** – do not fit the "___ heavy ... to carry" pattern.
• **enough** – "enough" comes **after** the adjective ("heavy enough"), and gives the opposite (positive) meaning.

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Q.112 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Sunita always wears _____ clothes.

(a) descent **(b)** dissent
(c) distant **(d)** decent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) decent
Answer: 4 (**decent**)
- **descent (noun):** movement downward or origin.
- **dissent (noun/verb):** disagreement or difference of opinion.
- **distant (adjective):** far away in space or time.
- **decent (adjective):** respectable, proper, or modest (**correct meaning**).

In this context, **"decent clothes"** means **proper or modest attire**, fitting the sentence appropriately.

Q.113 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The implementation of various schemes to fight the _____ of malnutrition in children requires planning, co-ordination and monitoring.

(a) embrace **(b)** grimace
(c) solace **(d)** menace

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) menace
Answer: 4 (**menace**)
- **Embrace** – To hug or accept willingly; unrelated here.
- **Grimace** – A facial expression showing pain or disgust; irrelevant.
- **Solace** – Comfort in distress; opposite of what fits here.
- **Menace** – **A threat or danger**; appropriate for describing malnutrition as a serious problem.

The sentence refers to malnutrition as a serious threat, so **"menace"** is the correct choice.

Q.114 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Can you please stop _____ down my neck for completing the work? I'll finish it as soon as I can.

(a) sitting **(b)** beating
(c) watching **(d)** breathing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) breathing
Answer: 4 (**breathing**)
The correct phrase is **"breathing down my neck,"** which is an idiom meaning **to pressure or closely monitor someone, especially in a way that feels intrusive or stressful**.
Other options:
- **Sitting** – Doesn't fit idiomatically.
- **Beating** – Not used in this expression.
- **Watching** – Close in meaning, but not part of the correct idiom.
- **Breathing** – Correct word to complete the idiom.

So, the complete sentence is:
"Can you please stop breathing down my neck for completing the work?"

Q.115 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
All the actors played their roles very well in the _____.

(a) marks **(b)** mosque
(c) manse **(d)** masque

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) masque
- **marks:** (plural noun) symbols, grades, or impressions.
- **mosque:** (noun) a Muslim place of worship.
- **manse:** (noun) a residence, especially for a minister of a church.
- **masque:** (**noun**) a dramatic entertainment involving music, dancing, and acting, typically performed in costumes.

The correct option is **"masque,"** fitting perfectly in the context of actors playing roles.

Q.116 Select the most appropriate adverb to fill in the blank.
Ramees works _____ to get through the entrance exam.

(a) different **(b)** important
(c) early **(d)** hard

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) hard
Solution:
- The sentence requires an **adverb** that describes how Ramees works.
- Among the options, **"hard"** is the correct adverb meaning "with great effort."
- Other options are adjectives or do not fit the context.

Answer: (d) hard

Q.117 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Can you please stop _____ it's me who keeps messing up the work?

(a) assuring **(b)** assuming
(c) amusing **(d)** adopting

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) assuming
Answer: 2 (**assuming**)
- **Assuring** – To promise or say something with confidence.
- **Assuming** – To suppose or take for granted without proof; fits the context of wrongly blaming someone.
- **Amusing** – Causing laughter or entertainment; irrelevant here.
- **Adopting** – To take up or start to use; unrelated.

The correct word to complete the sentence is **"assuming,"** meaning wrongly presuming that someone else is at fault.

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Q.118 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The TV _____ of the incident was extremely poor.

(a) compassing **(b)** scope
(c) coverage **(d)** sweeping

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) coverage
Answer: 3 (**coverage**)
- **Compassing** – Incorrect; uncommon and does not fit contextually.
- **Scope** – Refers to range or extent; not appropriate for describing a TV report.
- **Coverage** – **The reporting or broadcasting of an event on TV, radio, or in print**; fits the sentence perfectly.
- **Sweeping** – Usually used as an adjective meaning wide-ranging; does not fit grammatically here.

Thus, the correct word to complete the sentence is **"coverage."**

Q.119 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
If you want to pass this hurdle, you should _____ to what your mentor says.

(a) listen honestly **(b)** pay attention
(c) pay ears **(d)** put focus

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) pay attention
- The sentence requires a **verb phrase** that logically and grammatically fits after "you should".
- The context is about following a **mentor's advice**, so we need a phrase that means "heed" or "attend carefully".

Let's evaluate the options:
- **(a) listen honestly** – awkward collocation; we say "listen carefully" or "listen attentively", not "honestly".
- **(b) pay attention** – correct and commonly used expression: "pay attention to what someone says".
- **(c) pay ears** – incorrect; not a valid English phrase.
- **(d) put focus** – grammatically awkward without "on", and even then "put focus on" is less natural than "pay attention to"

Q.120 Select the most appropriate homonym to fill in the blank.
The German Submarine _____ were not aware of the exact location of the ship.

(a) crews **(b)** crus
(c) cruse **(d)** cruise

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) crews
Answer: 1 (**crews**)
- **Crews** – **Plural of "crew"**; refers to groups of people working on ships or submarines.
- **Crus** – Incorrect; an anatomical term (part of the body, e.g., leg-like structure).
- **Cruse** – A small container for liquid, especially oil; unrelated.
- **Cruise** – A sea voyage for pleasure, not people working on a vessel.

The correct homonym is **"crews,"** as it refers to the **submarine personnel.**

Q.121 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
Sloths are the tree climbing _____ of the south and central American rain forests. They live their lives like they are on a permanent _____ as they creep slowly.

(a) resident; rest **(b)** habitant; recess
(c) natives; vacation **(d)** locals; quit

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) natives; vacation
Answer: 3 (**natives; vacation**)
- **Natives** – People or animals originally from a particular place; suits sloths living naturally in rainforests.
- **Vacation** – A period of rest or leisure; fits the image of sloths moving slowly as if always relaxed.

Other options:
- **Resident; rest** – "Resident" is possible, but "rest" doesn't fit grammatically or contextually.
- **Habitant; recess** – "Habitant" is less commonly used than "inhabitant," and "recess" sounds awkward in this context.
- **Locals; quit** – "Quit" is incorrect and doesn't convey the intended meaning of leisure.

So, the most natural and meaningful sentence is:
Sloths are the tree climbing natives of the south and central American rain forests. They live their lives like they are on a permanent vacation as they creep slowly.

Q.122 Fill in the blank by selecting the appropriate word from the given options that would complete the collocation.
Mohsin presented a_____report of the project to the Executive Officer

(a) levied **(b)** inferred
(c) detailed **(d)** sustained

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) detailed
Answer: 3 (**detailed**)
- **Levied** – Imposed (usually taxes or fines); not suitable with "report."
- **Inferred** – Deduced or concluded; doesn't fit with the act of presenting a report.
- **Detailed** – **Containing many facts or specifics**; **commonly collocates with "report"**.
- **Sustained** – Continued or maintained; doesn't logically describe a type of report.

The correct collocation is **"detailed report,"** meaning a report that includes thorough and specific information.

Q.123 Select the most appropriate collocating word to fill in the blank.
Swathi and Raghav are_____ friends.

(a) hearty **(b)** tight
(c) bosom **(d)** deep

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) bosom
The correct collocation here is **"bosom friends"**, which means **very close or intimate friends**.
Let's look at the meanings and typical uses of each option:
- **Hearty**: Usually collocates with **"meal"** or **"laugh"**, e.g., *a hearty laugh*. Not used with "friends".

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Explanation (contd.)

- **Tight**: "Tight friends" is informal and uncommon. "Tight-knit group" is more natural.
- **Bosom**: **"Bosom friends"** is a standard and well-known collocation meaning **very close, trusted friends**.
- **Deep**: "Deep" doesn't usually modify "friends"; "deep friendship" is more natural than "deep friends".

So, the most appropriate collocating word is: **bosom**

Q.124 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
I inherit all that humanity _____ during tens of thousands of years and to all that it has thought, felt and suffered.

(a) are achieving **(b)** has achieved
(c) have achieved **(d)** were achieving

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has achieved
Answer: 2 (**has achieved**)

- The subject **"humanity"** is **singular**, so it takes a **singular verb**.
- **"Has achieved"** is the correct **present perfect** form that fits the context of something completed over time.
- **"Are achieving"** and **"were achieving"** are in continuous tense, which doesn't suit the completed sense here.
- **"Have achieved"** uses a **plural verb** (incorrect with the singular subject "humanity").

So, the correct sentence is:
"I inherit all that humanity has achieved during tens of thousands of years..."

Q.125 Complete the following collocation.
My younger brother does not _____ enough risks in life.

(a) face **(b)** take
(c) defend **(d)** make

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) take
Answer: 2 (**take**)

- **Face** – Means to confront something, but doesn't collocate naturally with "risks" in this context.
- **Take** – **Correct**; the common collocation is **"take risks,"** meaning to engage in actions that involve uncertainty or danger.
- **Defend** – Means to protect, which doesn't fit here.
- **Make** – Doesn't collocate with "risks"; we don't say "make risks."

So, the correct phrase is **"take risks."**

Q.126 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
In order to promote _____ culture and tradition, the government has decided to take up this new _____ even though it would cost them a/an _____ amount of money and resources.

(a) ingenuous; integration; minuscule
(b) indigenous; initiative; substantial
(c) innocuous; formulation; brilliant
(d) inordinate; itinerary; insignificant

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) indigenous; initiative; substantial
Answer: 2 (**indigenous; initiative; substantial**)

- **Indigenous** – Native or originating naturally in a particular place; fits well with "culture and tradition."
- **Initiative** – A new plan or strategy; suitable for government action.
- **Substantial** – Large or significant in amount; fits the context of cost and resources.

Other options don't fit contextually or grammatically:

- **Ingenuous** means innocent or naive (not related to culture).
- **Minuscule** means very small (doesn't fit with cost and resources).
- **Innocuous** means harmless (irrelevant here).
- **Formulation** is a plan but less appropriate than "initiative."
- **Brilliant** means very bright or clever (doesn't fit amount).
- **Inordinate** means excessive (less suitable here).
- **Itinerary** means a travel plan (irrelevant).
- **Insignificant** means unimportant (doesn't fit the context).

Hence, the best fit is:
"In order to promote indigenous culture and tradition, the government has decided to take up this new initiative even though it would cost them a substantial amount of money and resources."

Q.127 Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option.
I trust him completely. His conduct is _____ suspicion.

(a) below **(b)** above
(c) over **(d)** under

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) above
Solution:
The correct phrase is **"above suspicion"**, which means someone is so honest or trustworthy that they cannot be doubted or accused of wrongdoing.

- "Below suspicion" is incorrect usage.
- "Over suspicion" and "under suspicion" carry wrong or negative implications in this context.
- "Above suspicion" is the standard idiom used for someone whose integrity is unquestionable.

Correct sentence: I trust him completely. His conduct is **above** suspicion.

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Q.128 Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option.
He gazed around the room _____ lay hidden a treasure chest.

(a) whereas **(b)** whereby
(c) whereof **(d)** wherein

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) wherein
Solution:
The sentence requires a relative adverb that connects **"the room"** with the clause **"lay hidden a treasure chest"**. The correct word should indicate **location**.
"Wherein" means **"in which"**, and it is used to refer to a place or situation where something occurs. So,
"He gazed around the room wherein lay hidden a treasure chest" means: *He looked around the room in which a treasure chest was hidden.*
option (a): "whereas" is incorrect—it means contrast, not place.
option (b): "whereby" means "by which", not suitable for a location.
option (c): "whereof" means "of which", which also doesn't fit here.
option (d): "wherein" is correct as it refers to **the room** and matches the required meaning.
Answer: option (d) (wherein).

Q.129 Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option.
Hurry up ! There's still _____ work left to do.

(a) much **(b)** whole
(c) many **(d)** lot

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) much
Solution:
The noun **"work"** is an **uncountable noun**, so it requires a determiner that matches uncountable usage.
"Much" is correctly used with uncountable nouns to express quantity.
"Hurry up! There's still much work left to do." is grammatically correct.
option (a): "much" – correct usage with uncountable noun.
option (b): "whole" – incorrect here; "whole work" is ungrammatical.
option (c): "many" – used with countable nouns, so incorrect.
option (d): "lot" – grammatically incomplete without "a" or "of".
Answer: option (a) (much).

Q.130 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
He walked ____ the park and later strolled ____ the riverbank.

(a) over; through **(b)** through; along
(c) against; across **(d)** besides; about

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) through; along
- **"Through the park"** is the correct preposition because it indicates movement inside and across the park.
- **"Along the riverbank"** is correct as it implies walking parallel to the riverbank, following its length.

Correct sentence: He walked through the park and later strolled along the riverbank.

Q.131 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
She was so busy _____writing that when the maid came _____she didn't hear her.

(a) with, by **(b)** to, in
(c) at, up **(d)** in, in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) in, in
Solution:
The correct prepositions must reflect appropriate usage based on context:
- **"busy in writing"** is the standard phrase meaning someone is occupied with writing.
- **"when the maid came in"** is correct because "came in" indicates **entry into a room/place**.

So, the sentence should read: **"She was so busy in writing that when the maid came in she didn't hear her."**
option (a): with, by – incorrect; "busy with writing" is acceptable, but "came by" means passed nearby, not entered.
option (b): to, in – incorrect; "busy to writing" is ungrammatical.
option (c): at, up – incorrect and unnatural in this context.
option (d): in, in – both prepositions are correct and natural here.
Answer: option (d) (in, in).

Q.132 Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option.
Each one of the participants in the annual function _____ an applause.

(a) deserves **(b)** deserve
(c) have deserved **(d)** is deserving

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) deserves
Solution:
The subject of the sentence is **"Each one of the participants"**.
Even though **"participants"** is plural, the phrase **"Each one of"** makes the subject **singular**.
So, the verb must also be **singular**.
Correct verb: **"deserves"**
option (a): deserves – correct (singular verb for singular subject)
option (b): deserve – plural verb, incorrect
option (c): have deserved – present perfect plural, incorrect
option (d): is deserving – awkward and not idiomatic in this context
Answer: option (a) (deserves).

Q.133 Fill in the blank with the most appropriate option.
The small coffee shop at the end of the road is _____.

(a) my **(b)** mine
(c) our **(d)** their

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) mine
Sentence:
The small coffee shop at the end of the road is _____.
This sentence requires a possessive pronoun, not a possessive adjective, because the verb "is" is followed directly by the possessive form, not a noun.
Options:

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Explanation (contd.)

- **(a) my – Incorrect (this is a possessive adjective; it needs a noun after it, e.g., *my shop*)**
- **(b) mine – Correct (this is a possessive pronoun, suitable after the verb "is")**
- **(c) our – Incorrect (also a possessive adjective; needs a noun)**
- **(d) their – Incorrect (also a possessive adjective)**

Correct Sentence:
The small coffee shop at the end of the road is mine.
Answer: (b) mine

Q.134 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The air quality is so bad _____it becomes difficult to breathe.

(a) when **(b)** as
(c) since **(d)** that

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) that
Solution
Grammar Pattern

- The sentence uses a **"so ... that"** construction to express a **result**: *"so adjective that clause."*

Why "that" Fits

- **"so bad that it becomes difficult to breathe"** correctly links the severity of the air quality (so bad) with its consequence (difficulty breathing).

Why Other Choices Fail

- **"when"** – indicates time, not result.
- **"as"** – indicates cause or simultaneous action, but doesn't pair with "so" to show result.
- **"since"** – indicates reason, not result.

Correct sentence:
*The air quality is so bad **that** it becomes difficult to breathe.*

Q.135 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Gautam _____all the documents by the time his senior advocate reached the court.

(a) examines **(b)** will be examining
(c) is examining **(d)** had examined

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) had examined
Solution:
The sentence includes the time marker **"by the time his senior advocate reached the court"**, which is in **past tense**.
When expressing an action that **was completed before another past action**, we use the **past perfect tense**.
So, **"had examined"** is the correct form to show that Gautam completed examining the documents **before** his senior arrived.
option (a): examines – present tense, incorrect.
option (b): will be examining – future continuous, does not match past context.
option (c): is examining – present continuous, incorrect for past context.
option (d): had examined – correct past perfect usage.
Answer: option (d) (had examined).

Q.136 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
If I go to Bangalore, I _____with my nephew.

(a) have stayed **(b)** stayed
(c) stay **(d)** will stay

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) will stay
Solution:
The sentence is a **Type 1 Conditional** (real possibility in the future). The structure is:
If + present simple, will + base verb

- "If I go to Bangalore" → **present simple**
- So the second clause should use **"will" + base verb**

Correct sentence: **"If I go to Bangalore, I will stay with my nephew."**

Q.137 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
_____ History Club of our college is organising _____ tour to Aurangabad.

(a) The; a **(b)** A; the
(c) A; a **(d)** The; the

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The; a
Solution:
The sentence:
"_____ History Club of our college is organising _____ tour to Aurangabad."
Let's examine each blank:

- **First blank: "The" History Club**
  - When referring to a **specific club** (e.g., the only History Club of our college), we use the **definite article "The"**.
- **Second blank: "a" tour**
  - This is the **first mention** of the tour, and it is not specific, so we use the **indefinite article "a"**.

Thus, the correct sentence is:
"The History Club of our college is organising a tour to Aurangabad."
Correct answer: The; a (Option (a)

Q.138 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
_____ silver bangle was discovered in ____ ancient temple complex where the archaeologists were carrying out excavations.

(a) No word required; the **(b)** The; a
(c) A; an **(d)** A; no word required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A; an

- **"A silver bangle"** – We use **"a"** before words that begin with a consonant sound (like "silver").
- **"an ancient temple"** – We use **"an"** before words that begin with a vowel sound (like "ancient").

Correct sentence:
"A silver bangle was discovered in an ancient temple complex where the archaeologists were carrying out excavations."
So, **option (c): A; an** is the most appropriate.

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Q.139 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
The puzzle was so intricately designed _____ even the most seasoned cryptographers found themselves perplexed.

(a) as **(b)** since
(c) that **(d)** when

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) that

- The sentence structure follows the pattern: **"so... that"**, which is used to express cause and effect or intensity leading to a result.
- **"The puzzle was so intricately designed that** even the most seasoned cryptographers found themselves perplexed."

Other options do not fit grammatically or logically:

- **as** – implies reason but doesn't complete the cause-effect structure here.
- **since** – also gives reason, but doesn't work with "so".
- **when** – indicates time, not result.

Thus, **"that"** is the correct choice.

Q.140 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
She meticulously arranged the meeting agenda ____ every intricate detail of the project could be thoroughly discussed and analysed by the team.

(a) so that **(b)** even so
(c) as if **(d)** such as

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) so that
Solution:

- The sentence is:
  "She meticulously arranged the meeting agenda ____ every intricate detail of the project could be thoroughly discussed and analysed by the team."
- The correct phrase to complete the sentence logically and grammatically is: **"so that"**
- **"So that"** is a **conjunction of purpose**, used to express the reason or goal for doing something.
  - It correctly shows that the agenda was arranged with the **purpose** of enabling thorough discussion.
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **"Even so"** – a contrast connector (used like "nevertheless"), not fitting here.
  - **"As if"** – used to express something hypothetical or imaginary, not a purpose.
  - **"Such as"** – used to give examples, not purpose.

Correct sentence:
"She meticulously arranged the meeting agenda so that every intricate detail of the project could be thoroughly discussed and analysed by the team."

Q.141 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
The detective carefully examined the crime scene, searching ___ clues hidden ___ the shadows.

(a) over; in **(b)** from; beyond
(c) for; in **(d)** to; under

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) for; in
Solution:
Sentence:
"The detective carefully examined the crime scene, searching ___ clues hidden ___ the shadows."
First blank – "for":

- We use **"searching for"** when someone is **looking for something** specific.
  - Example: *The police are searching for evidence.*

Second blank – "in":

- **"Hidden in the shadows"** is the correct expression.
  - "In" indicates the **location** where the clues are concealed.

Correct sentence:
"The detective carefully examined the crime scene, searching for clues hidden in the shadows."
Why other options are incorrect:

- **over; in** – "searching over" is not idiomatic here.
- **from; beyond** – "searching from clues" is grammatically incorrect.
- **to; under** – "searching to clues" is incorrect usage.

Correct answer: for; in (Option (c)

Q.142 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
He looked around ____ his friend ____ the bustling crowd.

(a) for; among **(b)** by; about
(c) for; at **(d)** to; between

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) for; among
Solution:
Sentence:
"He looked around ____ his friend ____ the bustling crowd."
First blank – "for":

- The verb **"looked around"** is commonly followed by **"for"** when someone is **searching** for something or someone.
  - Example: *She looked around for her keys.*

Second blank – "among":

- To indicate that the friend is within a **group** (i.e., "the bustling crowd"), we use **"among"**.
  - **"Among"** is used when referring to **more than two people/things** in a group.

Correct sentence:
"He looked around for his friend among the bustling crowd."
Why other options are incorrect:

- **by; about** – incorrect and awkward prepositions in this context.
- **for; at** – "at" is used to refer to direction or target, not suitable here.
- **to; between** – "to" doesn't fit with "looked around"; "between" is for two entities only.

Correct answer: for; among (Option (a)

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Q.143 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
At the party last night, I found her engrossed in _____ conversation with _____ renowned scientist.

(a) the; the **(b)** a; a
(c) a; no word **(d)** the; a

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a; a
Solution:
- The correct sentence is: **"At the party last night, I found her engrossed in a conversation with a renowned scientist."**
- **First blank – "a conversation":**
  - "Conversation" is a singular, countable noun.
  - Since it is being introduced for the first time, the indefinite article **"a"** is appropriate.
  - The phrase "engrossed in a conversation" is idiomatic and grammatically correct.
- **Second blank – "a renowned scientist":**
  - "Renowned scientist" is also a singular, countable noun used for the first time.
  - The correct article is **"a"**, indicating any one renowned scientist, not a specific one previously known.
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **"the; the"** – Incorrect because both nouns are new to the listener.
  - **"a; no word"** – Incorrect because omitting the article before "renowned scientist" makes the sentence grammatically incomplete.
  - **"the; a"** – Incorrect as "the conversation" implies it was already mentioned or known, which it wasn't.

Q.144 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
When I met Sarah at a café, ____ learnt that _____ had visited Japan last month.

(a) you; I **(b)** I; we
(c) I; she **(d)** she; she

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I; she
- The sentence is:
  "When I met Sarah at a café, I learnt that she had visited Japan last month."
- **Subject 1:** "I" (the speaker) is the one who learned something.
- **Subject 2:** "she" (Sarah) is the one who had visited Japan.
- The past perfect tense **"had visited"** is correctly used to indicate an action completed before another past action.

Thus, the grammatically and contextually correct sentence is:
"When I met Sarah at a café, I learnt that she had visited Japan last month."

Q.145 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
The swimming pool is about five kilometres ___ our house. So we go there ____ car.

(a) to; in **(b)** to; by
(c) from; in **(d)** from; by

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) from; by
Solution:
- The sentence:
  "The swimming pool is about five kilometres ___ our house. So we go there ____ car."
- **First blank – "from"**:
  - The correct preposition to indicate **distance from a location** is **"from"**.
  - Example: *The station is 2 km from my house.*
- **Second blank – "by"**:
  - When referring to **means of transport**, we commonly use **"by"** (without an article).
  - Example: *We go by car/train/bus.*
- Therefore, the correct sentence is:
  "The swimming pool is about five kilometres from our house. So we go there by car."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **"to"** – incorrect in this context; it indicates direction, not distance.
  - **"in car"** – incorrect; the correct form is "in the car" or "by car".

Correct option:
from; by

Q.146 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
She meticulously followed the intricate instructions; _____, the delicate balance of the experiment would have been irreversibly disrupted.

(a) moreover **(b)** otherwise
(c) in case **(d)** so that

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) otherwise
The sentence talks about a conditional situation — she followed the instructions, and **if she had not**, something bad **would have happened**. This calls for a connector that expresses a possible negative result in case of inaction.
- **Moreover** is used to add information, not show consequence — **incorrect** in this context.
- **Otherwise** is used to indicate what could happen **if something doesn't happen** — **correct** here.
- **In case** is used for precautions or preparations — it doesn't express consequence clearly — **not suitable**.
- **So that** is used to show purpose, not an alternative result — **incorrect**.

Hence, the most appropriate word is **otherwise**, as it shows the negative result that would have occurred if she hadn't followed the instructions.

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Q.147 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
_____ team of two girls succeeded in reaching ___ top of K2, the second highest mountain in the world.

(a) The; a
(b) A; the
(c) The; No word required
(d) A; a

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A; the
We need to decide the correct **articles** ("a", "an", "the") for both blanks.

- **First blank:**
  The noun **"team"** is being introduced for the first time, and there is no prior reference. So, we use the **indefinite article** "**A**".
- **Second blank:**
  We are referring to **a specific mountain peak — the top of K2**, which is **definite and unique**. So, we need the **definite article "the"**.

Thus, the correct sentence is:
"A team of two girls succeeded in reaching the top of K2, the second highest mountain in the world."

Q.148 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
Anna decided to embark on a challenging journey to learn Mandarin, hoping _____ the language fluently within a year.

(a) to have spoken
(b) for speaking
(c) to speak
(d) to speaking

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) to speak
The correct answer depends on **verb patterns** and **infinitive usage**.
Let's analyze the sentence:
Anna decided to embark on a challenging journey to learn Mandarin, hoping _____ the language fluently within a year.

- The verb **"hoping"** is followed by a goal or intention.
- The correct structure is: **"hope + to + base verb"**, i.e., **"hope to speak"**.

Now evaluate each option:

- **Option (a): to have spoken** – perfect infinitive, implies a completed action in the past; does not fit the future goal idea.
- **Option (b): for speaking** – incorrect structure; "hope for + noun" is valid, but not "hope for + verb-ing" in this context.
- **Option (c): to speak** – correct usage; "hoping to speak" is grammatically and contextually appropriate.
- **Option (d): to speaking** – incorrect; "to" here is part of the infinitive, not a preposition.

Correct sentence:
*Anna decided to embark on a challenging journey to learn Mandarin, hoping **to speak** the language fluently within a year.*

Q.149 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blanks.
He gave _____ the gift before _____ left for the airport.

(a) her; she
(b) she; her
(c) I; she
(d) her; her

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) her; she
We need to select the correct pronouns for each blank in the sentence:
Sentence:
He gave _____ the gift before _____ left for the airport.
Let's break it down:

1. **First blank**:
   - After "gave," we need an **object pronoun** because it receives the action.
   - Correct object pronoun for a female: **her** ()
   - "She" (subject pronoun) would be incorrect here.
2. **Second blank**:
   - This subject **performed the action** of leaving, so we need a **subject pronoun**.
   - The correct subject pronoun is: **she** ()

So, the correct sentence is:
He gave *her* the gift before *she* left for the airport.

Q.150 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
After the storm _____, the explorers realised that their campsite had been completely flooded.

(a) was subsiding
(b) subsides
(c) is subsiding
(d) had subsided

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) had subsided

- The main clause is in **past perfect**: *the explorers realised that their campsite had been completely flooded.*
- To indicate an action **that happened before this realisation**, we need a **past perfect** or **simple past** verb.
- Among the options, only **"had subsided"** is in **past perfect**, correctly showing that the storm ended before they realised the flooding.

Why others are incorrect:

- **was subsiding** – Past continuous, suggests the storm was ongoing.
- **subsides** – Simple present, mismatched with past-tense narrative.
- **is subsiding** – Present continuous, also mismatched with past context.

Correct sentence:
After the storm had subsided, the explorers realised that their campsite had been completely flooded.

Q.151 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
If the weather forecast proves accurate, we _____ heavy snowfall in the region tomorrow.

(a) need to have
(b) are having
(c) must have
(d) should have

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) should have
The correct sentence is:

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Explanation (contd.)

If the weather forecast proves accurate, we *should have* heavy snowfall in the region tomorrow.

- **"Should have"** is used to indicate a likely or expected future outcome based on a condition (i.e., if the forecast is correct).
- **"Need to have"** (Option (a) implies necessity, which doesn't fit the context of a weather prediction.
- **"Are having"** (Option (b) is present continuous and does not match the conditional future context.
- **"Must have"** (Option (c) implies certainty or obligation, which is not appropriate for a weather forecast.

Therefore, **Option (d): should have** is the most appropriate choice.

Q.152 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.

She decided _____ the challenging task of learning a new language during her summer break.

(a) to undertaking **(b)** undertook

(c) undertake **(d)** to undertake

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to undertake

The correct verb form after **"decided"** is the **infinitive form (to + base verb)**.

- The sentence begins: *"She decided..."*
- After "decided", we need a verb in the **infinitive** form to indicate what she chose to do.

Now examine the options:

1. **to undertaking** – incorrect (gerund form with "to" is not used after "decided")
2. **undertook** – incorrect (past tense; doesn't follow "decided" properly)
3. **undertake** – incorrect (bare verb form; not used directly after "decided")
4. **to undertake** – **correct** (infinitive form)

So, the grammatically correct sentence is:

"She decided to undertake the challenging task of learning a new language during her summer break."

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7. Error Spotting

305 questions

Q.1 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. The reason for visiting Meerut was because my mother needed to be looked after.

(a) my mother needed
(b) to be looked after
(c) The reason for visiting
(d) was because

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) was because
Type: Error Detection – "The reason ... is that"
Rule: After "**The reason ... was**", use "**that**", not "because" (which repeats the idea of reason).
("The reason was that ...", "because" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"The reason for visiting Meerut **was that** my mother needed to be looked after."

Q.2 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. When there were a strong wind, the pine trees made sad, eerie sounds.

(a) a strong wind
(b) When there were
(c) sad, eerie sounds
(d) the pine trees made

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) When there were
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "a strong wind" is **singular** → "**there was**".
(एकवचन "a strong wind" → "there was"।)
Corrected sentence
"When there **was** a strong wind, the pine trees made sad, eerie sounds."

Q.3 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. A tallest man that I have ever seen works in our coal mine.

(a) that I have
(b) works in our coal mine
(c) A tallest man
(d) ever seen

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A tallest man
Type: Error Detection – Article with Superlative
Rule: A superlative ("tallest") takes "**the**", not "a".
(superlative के साथ "the"।)
Corrected sentence
"**The tallest man** that I have ever seen works in our coal mine."

Q.4 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. In this lock-down period every worker in the factory has started bring their own lunch.

(a) In this lock-down period
(b) has started bring
(c) every worker in the factory
(d) their own lunch

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has started bring
Type: Error Detection – Verb Form
Rule: After "start", use the **gerund (bringing)** (or "to bring"), not the base verb "bring".
("start" के बाद "bringing" (gerund)।)
Corrected sentence
"... every worker in the factory **has started bringing** their own lunch."

Q.5 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. My grandmother is quite concerned to my progress at school.

(a) My grandmother
(b) to my progress
(c) at school
(d) is quite concerned

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) to my progress
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: We are "**concerned about**" something, not "concerned to".
("concerned about" (चिंतित))।
Corrected sentence
"My grandmother is quite concerned **about my progress** at school."

Q.6 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. He was not able to give many time to his research.

(a) to give
(b) to his research
(c) many time
(d) He was not able

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) many time
Type: Error Detection – much vs many
Rule: "time" (here uncountable) takes "**much**", not "many".
(अगणनीय "time" के साथ "much"।)
Corrected sentence
"He was not able to give **much time** to his research."

Q.7 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. Bhanu finished to read such a thick book in just two days.

(a) in just two day
(b) such a thick book
(c) Bhanu finished
(d) to read

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to read
Type: Error Detection – "finish + gerund"

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "finish" is followed by the **gerund (reading)**, not "to read".
("finish" के बाद gerund (reading)।)
Corrected sentence
"Bhanu finished **reading** such a thick book in just two days."

Q.8 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
A large amount of money he invested were wasted.

(a) were wasted **(b)** A large amount
(c) he invested **(d)** of money

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) were wasted
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: The subject "a large amount (of money)" is **singular** → "**was wasted**".
(एकवचन "amount" → "was wasted"।)
Corrected sentence
"A large amount of money he invested **was wasted**."

Q.9 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
She has been working with me on this project from two years.

(a) She has been working **(b)** on this project
(c) from two years **(d)** with me

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) from two years
Type: Error Detection – for vs since
Rule: For a **period** (two years), use "**for**".
(अवधि (two years) के लिए "for"।)
Corrected sentence
"She has been working with me on this project **for two years**."

Q.10 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
He gave such a long speech but everybody felt bored.

(a) felt bored **(b)** He gave such
(c) but everybody **(d)** a long speech

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) but everybody
Type: Error Detection – "such ... that"
Rule: "**such a + adjective + noun + that ...**" (result). Use "that", not "but".
("such ... that" संरचना; "but" गलत।)
Corrected sentence
"He gave **such** a long speech **that** everybody felt bored."

Q.11 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
No one have ever visited this place before.

(a) visited this **(b)** No one
(c) place before **(d)** have ever

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) have ever
Type: Error Detection – "No one ... has"
Rule: "No one" is **singular** → "**has**".
("No one" एकवचन → "has"।)
Corrected sentence
"No one **has ever** visited this place before."

Q.12 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
No sooner had Kavya started her online class that the web connection was lost.

(a) started her online class
(b) was lost
(c) No sooner had Kavya
(d) that the web connection

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) that the web connection
Type: Error Detection – "No sooner ... than"
Rule: "No sooner ... **than**" (not "that").
("No sooner ... than" संरचना।)
Corrected sentence
"No sooner had Kavya started her online class **than** the web connection was lost."

Q.13 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Each one of the children in a nursery class require individual attention.

(a) in a nursery class
(b) require individual attention
(c) Each one
(d) of the children

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) require individual attention
Type: Error Detection – "Each one ... requires"
Rule: "Each one (of ...)" is **singular** → "**requires**".
("Each one" एकवचन → "requires"।)
Corrected sentence
"Each one of the children in a nursery class **requires** individual attention."

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Q.14 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Two flyovers have been propose in the new plan to decongest M.G. Road.

(a) to decongest **(b)** in the new plan
(c) Two flyovers **(d)** have been propose

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) have been propose
Type: Error Detection – Passive (V3)
Rule: The past participle of "propose" is "**proposed**". "have been **proposed**".
(passive: have been + V3 (proposed)।)
Corrected sentence
"Two flyovers **have been proposed** in the new plan to decongest ..."

Q.15 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Craze for a thing that are not easily available in our country is a common phenomenon.

(a) thing that are not easily
(b) is a common phenomenon
(c) available in our country
(d) Craze for a

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) thing that are not easily
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "a thing" is **singular** → "**is**", not "are".
(एकवचन "a thing" → "is"।)
Corrected sentence
"Craze for a thing that **is** not easily available in our country is a common phenomenon."

Q.16 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
I shall buy this book if you like it or not.

(a) if you like it **(b)** I shall buy
(c) or not **(d)** this book

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) if you like it
Type: Error Detection – whether vs if
Rule: With "**... or not**", use "**whether**", not "if".
("... or not" के साथ "whether"।)
Corrected sentence
"I shall buy this book **whether you like it** or not."

Q.17 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
A large number of worker have started walking home.

(a) of worker **(b)** A large number
(c) have started **(d)** walking home

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) of worker
Type: Error Detection – "a large number of + plural"
Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "a large number **of**" takes a **plural** noun → "**workers**".
("a large number of" के बाद बहुवचन (workers)।)
Corrected sentence
"A large number **of workers** have started walking home."

Q.18 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
I am sorry I haven't learnt the poem at heart.

(a) at heart **(b)** I am sorry
(c) learnt the poem **(d)** I haven't

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) at heart
Type: Error Detection – Idiom
Rule: To memorise is to learn "**by heart**", not "at heart" (which means "in one's true nature").
("by heart" = कंठस्थ करना।)
Corrected sentence
"I am sorry I haven't learnt the poem **by heart**."

Q.19 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Before take this medicine you should consult a doctor.

(a) you should consult **(b)** a doctor
(c) this medicine **(d)** Before take

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Before take
Type: Error Detection – Preposition + Gerund
Rule: After the preposition "**Before**", use the **gerund (taking)**.
("Before" के बाद gerund (taking)।)
Corrected sentence
"**Before taking** this medicine you should consult a doctor."

Q.20 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
A confluence is a place when two or more rivers meet.

(a) when two or more **(b)** rivers meet
(c) A confluence **(d)** is a place

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) when two or more
Type: Error Detection – Relative Adverb
Rule: For a **place**, use "**where**", not "when".
(स्थान के लिए "where", "when" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"A confluence is a place **where** two or more rivers meet."

Q.21 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Poor people have run down of food supplies during the lockdown.

(a) during the lockdown **(b)** Poor people have
(c) run down of **(d)** food supplies

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) run down of
Type: Error Detection – Phrasal Verb

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: To exhaust a supply, the phrase is "**run out of**", not "run down of".
("run out of" = ... समाप्त हो जाना।)
Corrected sentence
"Poor people have **run out of** food supplies during the lockdown."

Q.22 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
She has been a member of this club since it's formation.

(a) She has been **(b)** a member of
(c) since it's formation **(d)** this club

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) since it's formation
Type: Error Detection – its vs it's
Rule: "**its**" = possessive (no apostrophe); "it's" = "it is". Here we need the possessive.
("its" = का/की (possessive); "it's" = it is।)
Corrected sentence
"She has been a member of this club since **its** formation."

Q.23 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Do you mind lending me your book for a hour?

(a) lending me **(b)** Do you mind
(c) for a hour **(d)** your book

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) for a hour
Type: Error Detection – Article (a/an)
Rule: "hour" begins with a silent 'h' (vowel sound), so it takes "**an**".
("hour" का 'h' मौन है → "an hour"।)
Corrected sentence
"Do you mind lending me your book for **an hour**?"

Q.24 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The man played the flute and led all the mouse out of the town.

(a) The man played **(b)** all the mouse
(c) out of the town **(d)** the flute and led

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) all the mouse
Type: Error Detection – Irregular Plural
Rule: The plural of "mouse" is "**mice**".
("mouse" का बहुवचन "mice"।)
Corrected sentence
"The man played the flute and led all the **mice** out of the town."

Q.25 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
I want you to complete this work by two days.

(a) by two days **(b)** this work
(c) to complete **(d)** I want you

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) by two days
Type: Error Detection – Preposition

Explanation (contd.)
Rule: For a length of time to complete a task, use "**in / within**", not "by two days".
(कार्य पूरा करने की अवधि के लिए "in/within two days"।)
Corrected sentence
"I want you to complete this work **in two days**."

Q.26 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
We must plan how can we cope with the present situation.

(a) present situation **(b)** cope with the
(c) how can we **(d)** We must plan

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) how can we
Type: Error Detection – Embedded Question
Rule: In an embedded (indirect) question, the order is **subject + verb**: "how we can cope".
(embedded प्रश्न में: how + subject + verb।)
Corrected sentence
"We must plan **how we can cope** with the present situation."

Q.27 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The small cafe at the end of the road is her.

(a) at the end **(b)** of the road
(c) is her **(d)** The small cafe

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) is her
Type: Error Detection – Possessive Pronoun
Rule: Standing alone (without a noun), use the possessive pronoun "**hers**", not "her".
(संज्ञा के बिना possessive pronoun "hers"।)
Corrected sentence
"The small cafe at the end of the road is **hers**."

Q.28 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
This jewellery box is made from silver and is an antique piece.

(a) and is **(b)** This jewellery box
(c) an antique piece **(d)** is made from silver

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) is made from silver
Type: Error Detection – made of vs made from
Rule: When the material is **still recognisable** (silver in a box), use "**made of**", not "made from".
(मूल पदार्थ पहचान में आ रहा हो तो "made of"।)
Corrected sentence
"This jewellery box **is made of silver** and is an antique piece."

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Q.29 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
There was enough evidence to convict him on selling of fake medicines.

(a) to convict him
(b) There was enough evidence
(c) on selling of
(d) fake medicines

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) on selling of
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: We convict someone "**of**" a crime, and "convict of selling" (no "of" after selling).
("convict of ..." सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"There was enough evidence to convict him **of selling** fake medicines."

Q.30 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
He loses his tempers on the slightest provocation.

(a) provocation **(b)** the slightest
(c) He loses **(d)** his tempers on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) his tempers on
Type: Error Detection – Idiom/Number
Rule: The idiom is "**lose one's temper**" (singular "temper").
("lose one's temper" (एकवचन "temper")।)
Corrected sentence
"He loses his **temper** on the slightest provocation."

Q.31 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
No one of them came to the inauguration of our new factory.

(a) inauguration of **(b)** our new factory
(c) No one of them **(d)** came to the

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) No one of them
Type: Error Detection – "None of them"
Rule: Before "of them", use "**None**", not "No one of".
("of them" से पहले "None"।)
Corrected sentence
"**None of them** came to the inauguration of our new factory."

Q.32 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
I didn't knew you had gone to Goa for a vacation.

(a) you had gone **(b)** to Goa
(c) for a vacation **(d)** I didn't knew

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I didn't knew
Type: Error Detection – "didn't + base verb"
Rule: After "didn't", use the **base verb (know)**, not "knew".
("didn't" के बाद base verb (know)।)
Corrected sentence
"I **didn't know** you had gone to Goa for a vacation."

Q.33 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Laws and rules are made to safeguarding our rights and protect us.

(a) Laws and rules
(b) and protect us
(c) safeguarding our rights
(d) are made to

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) safeguarding our rights
Type: Error Detection – Parallelism
Rule: With "to", parallel verbs must have the same form: "to **safeguard** ... and **protect**".
(समानता (parallelism): "to safeguard ... and protect"।)
Corrected sentence
"Laws and rules are made to **safeguard** our rights and protect us."

Q.34 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
You must be careful about what you say as you meet her.

(a) as you **(b)** meet her
(c) You must be careful **(d)** about what you say

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) as you
Type: Error Detection – Wrong Conjunction
Rule: "as" (meaning "while") does not fit; a future meeting needs "**when**".
("as" गलत; "when you meet her" सही।)
Corrected sentence
"You must be careful about what you say **when you** meet her."

Q.35 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Neither Sam nor I are interested in attending the meeting.

(a) Neither Sam nor I **(b)** are interested
(c) the meeting **(d)** in attending

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) are interested
Type: Error Detection – "Neither ... nor" Agreement
Rule: With "neither ... nor", the verb agrees with the **nearer** subject. Here "I" → "**am**".
("Neither ... nor" में क्रिया निकटतम कर्ता से मेल खाती है — "I am"।)
Corrected sentence
"Neither Sam nor I **am interested** in attending the meeting."

Q.36 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Although this is a narrowest street, many large trucks can enter it.

(a) many large trucks **(b)** can enter it
(c) a narrowest street **(d)** Although this is

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) a narrowest street
Type: Error Detection – Article with Superlative

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: A superlative ("narrowest") takes "**the**", not "a".
(superlative के साथ "the" ।)
Corrected sentence
"Although this is **the narrowest** street, many large trucks can enter it."

Q.37 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Zoya won the first prize in the race unless she stumbled and fell.

(a) unless she **(b)** stumbled and fell
(c) Zoya won the first **(d)** prize in the race

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) unless she
Type: Error Detection – Wrong Conjunction
Rule: "unless" (= if not) makes no sense here; she won **although/though** she stumbled.
("unless" गलत; "although/though" सही ।)
Corrected sentence
"Zoya won the first prize in the race **although she** stumbled and fell."

Q.38 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The tired and vexed travellers waiting at the airport for a long time.

(a) vexed travellers **(b)** for a long time
(c) The tired and **(d)** waiting at the airport

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) waiting at the airport
Type: Error Detection – Missing Finite Verb
Rule: The sentence has no main verb; "waiting" must become "**were waiting**" (or "waited").
(वाक्य में मुख्य क्रिया चाहिए — "were waiting" ।)
Corrected sentence
"The tired and vexed travellers **were waiting** at the airport for a long time."

Q.39 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The three of them shouted out to each another when the train started moving.

(a) started moving
(b) when the train
(c) shouted out to each another
(d) The three of them

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) shouted out to each another
Type: Error Detection – each other vs one another
Rule: For **more than two** people ("the three of them"), use "**one another**", not "each another".
(दो से अधिक के लिए "one another" ।)
Corrected sentence
"The three of them shouted out to **one another** when the train started moving."

Q.40 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The venue for the wedding have not yet been finalised.

(a) for the wedding **(b)** The venue
(c) been finalised **(d)** have not yet

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) have not yet
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "The venue" (singular) → "**has**", not "have".
(एकवचन "venue" → "has" ।)
Corrected sentence
"The venue for the wedding **has** not yet been finalised."

Q.41 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The seat which you are sitting on is my.

(a) is my **(b)** The seat
(c) are sitting on **(d)** which you

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) is my
Type: Error Detection – Possessive Pronoun
Rule: Standing alone, use "**mine**", not "my".
(संज्ञा के बिना "mine" ।)
Corrected sentence
"The seat which you are sitting on is **mine**."

Q.42 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
I can explain you the reason for the delay in executing your order.

(a) the delay in executing **(b)** the reason for
(c) I can explain you **(d)** your order

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I can explain you
Type: Error Detection – "explain to somebody"
Rule: We "**explain (something) to** somebody", not "explain you".
("explain to you" सही है ।)
Corrected sentence
"I can explain **to you** the reason for the delay in executing your order."

Q.43 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
They will be ready leaving for the airport in an hour.

(a) ready leaving **(b)** in an hour
(c) They will be **(d)** for the airport

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ready leaving
Type: Error Detection – "ready to + V1"
Rule: "ready" is followed by the **to-infinitive**: "ready **to leave**".
("ready to + verb" ।)
Corrected sentence
"They will be **ready to leave** for the airport in an hour."

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Q.44 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
He has shattered his neighbour's window by purpose.

(a) He has **(b)** neighbour's window
(c) by purpose **(d)** shattered his

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) by purpose
Type: Error Detection – Idiom
Rule: The phrase is "**on purpose**" (deliberately), not "by purpose".
("on purpose" = जान-बूझकर।)
Corrected sentence
"He has shattered his neighbour's window **on purpose**."

Q.45 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
As such you need any money, just write to me.

(a) to me **(b)** As such you
(c) just write **(d)** need any money

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) As such you
Type: Error Detection – Wrong Connector
Rule: "As such" does not fit; the meaning is conditional — "**If/In case** you need any money".
("As such" गलत; "If you need" सही।)
Corrected sentence
"**If you** need any money, just write to me."

Q.46 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Three hours will have passed when the bell will ring.

(a) Three hours **(b)** when the bell
(c) will have passed **(d)** will ring

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) will ring
Type: Error Detection – Time Clause
Rule: After "when" (time clause), do **not** use "will"; use the present simple.
("when" (समय-वाक्य) के बाद "will" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"Three hours will have passed when the bell **rings**."

Q.47 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
They are planning for settling in Mumbai with their son.

(a) for settling **(b)** in Mumbai
(c) with their son **(d)** They are planning

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) for settling
Type: Error Detection – "plan to + V1"
Rule: "plan" is followed by the **to-infinitive**: "planning **to settle**".
("plan to + verb"।)
Corrected sentence
"They are planning **to settle** in Mumbai with their son."

Q.48 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Whole country applauded the courage of our soldiers.

(a) courage of **(b)** Whole country
(c) applauded the **(d)** our soldiers

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Whole country
Type: Error Detection – Missing Article
Rule: "whole country" needs the article "**the**": "**The whole country**".
("the whole country" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"**The whole country** applauded the courage of our soldiers."

Q.49 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
He thinks that he can get away among lying and cheating.

(a) he can get away **(b)** among lying
(c) He thinks that **(d)** and cheating

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) among lying
Type: Error Detection – Phrasal Verb
Rule: "**get away with**" (something) = to escape blame. Use "with", not "among".
("get away with" = बच निकलना।)
Corrected sentence
"He thinks that he can get away **with** lying and cheating."

Q.50 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
An eight years old girl has made this beautiful painting.

(a) beautiful painting **(b)** made this
(c) girl has **(d)** An eight years old

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) An eight years old
Type: Error Detection – Compound Adjective
Rule: As an adjective before a noun, use the **hyphenated singular** "eight-year-old".
(संज्ञा से पहले "eight-year-old" (एकवचन, hyphen के साथ)।)
Corrected sentence
"An **eight-year-old** girl has made this beautiful painting."

Q.51 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
She is not as smart as I think at first.

(a) as smart as **(b)** at first
(c) She is not **(d)** I think

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I think
Type: Error Detection – Tense Consistency
Rule: "at first" points to the past, so use "**I thought**", not "I think".
("at first" (भूतकाल) → "I thought"।)
Corrected sentence
"She is not as smart as I **thought** at first."

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Q.52 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
I looked him at the eye and told him all I knew.

(a) I looked him **(b)** at the eye
(c) and told him **(d)** all I knew

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) at the eye
Type: Error Detection – Idiom
Rule: The idiom is "**look someone in the eye**", not "at the eye".
("look someone in the eye" = आँखों में आँखें डालकर देखना।)
Corrected sentence
"I looked him **in the eye** and told him all I knew."

Q.53 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Did you told him about the new plot that you have bought?

(a) about the new plot **(b)** that you
(c) have bought **(d)** Did you told him

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Did you told him
Type: Error Detection – "did + base verb"
Rule: After "did", use the **base verb (tell)**, not "told".
("did" के बाद base verb (tell)।)
Corrected sentence
"**Did you tell him** about the new plot that you have bought?"

Q.54 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Aren't you such young to travel by yourself?

(a) such young **(b)** Aren't you
(c) by yourself **(d)** to travel

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) such young
Type: Error Detection – "too ... to"
Rule: To mean "excessively", use "**too young**", not "such young".
("too young" (अत्यधिक); "such young" गलत।)
Corrected sentence
"Aren't you **too young** to travel by yourself?"

Q.55 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The captain scored a century in a second innings.

(a) The captain **(b)** in a
(c) second innings **(d)** scored a century

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) in a
Type: Error Detection – Article
Rule: A specific match innings needs "**the**": "in **the** second innings".
(निश्चित innings के लिए "the"।)
Corrected sentence
"The captain scored a century in **the** second innings."

Q.56 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
She asked me where had I gone for dinner with my fiance.

(a) with my fiance **(b)** gone for dinner
(c) She asked me **(d)** where had I

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) where had I
Type: Error Detection – Embedded Question
Rule: In a reported question, use **subject + verb** (no inversion): "where **I had** gone".
(reported प्रश्न में: where + subject + verb।)
Corrected sentence
"She asked me **where I had** gone for dinner with my fiance."

Q.57 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The concert has started when he reached the venue.

(a) reached the venue **(b)** when he
(c) The concert **(d)** has started

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) has started
Type: Error Detection – Past Perfect
Rule: An earlier past action takes the **past perfect**: the concert "**had started**" before he reached.
(पहले हुई घटना के लिए past perfect (had started)।)
Corrected sentence
"The concert **had started** when he reached the venue."

Q.58 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Let us think how can we solve the problem amiably.

(a) how can we **(b)** Let us think
(c) amiably **(d)** solve the problem

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) how can we
Type: Error Detection – Embedded Question
Rule: In an embedded question, use **subject + verb**: "how **we can** solve".
(embedded प्रश्न में: how + subject + verb।)
Corrected sentence
"Let us think **how we can** solve the problem amiably."

Q.59 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The girl besides you in high heels is my younger sister.

(a) younger sister **(b)** The girl besides you
(c) is my **(d)** in high heels

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The girl besides you
Type: Error Detection – beside vs besides
Rule: "**beside**" = next to; "besides" = in addition. Here we mean "next to you".
("beside" = बगल में; "besides" = इसके अलावा।)
Corrected sentence
"The girl **beside you** in high heels is my younger sister."

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Q.60 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
This is only the decent dress that I have.

(a) decent dress **(b)** only the
(c) that I have **(d)** This is

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) only the
Type: Error Detection – Word Order
Rule: The correct order is "**the only** decent dress" (the + only + adjective + noun).
("the only decent dress" सही क्रम है।)
Corrected sentence
"This is **the only** decent dress that I have."

Q.61 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
This renowned / university provide / research opportunities / for students.

(a) university provide **(b)** research opportunities
(c) for students **(d)** This renowned

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) university provide
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "university" is **singular** → "**provides**".
Corrected sentence
"This renowned university **provides** research opportunities for students."

Q.62 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The manager / took him / at task / for his negligence.

(a) The manager **(b)** for his negligence
(c) at task **(d)** took him

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) at task
Type: Error Detection – Idiom
Rule: The idiom is "**take someone to task**" (= scold), not "at task".
Corrected sentence
"The manager took him **to task** for his negligence."

Q.63 Select the segment in which a word has been INCORRECTLY used.
Is the Abominable Snowman a friction of the mountaineers' imagination?

(a) a friction
(b) Is the Abominable Snowman
(c) of the mountaineers'
(d) imagination

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) a friction
Type: Error Detection – Word Confusion
Rule: The idiom is "a **figment** of the imagination" (= an invented thing), not "friction".
Corrected sentence
"Is the Abominable Snowman a **figment** of the mountaineers' imagination?"

Q.64 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The girl lay down / on the bed / besides her mother / and went to sleep.

(a) on the bed **(b)** The girl lay down
(c) besides her mother **(d)** and went to sleep

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) besides her mother
Type: Error Detection – Beside vs Besides
Rule: "**beside**" = next to; "besides" = in addition to. Here we need "**beside her mother**".
Corrected sentence
"The girl lay down on the bed **beside her mother** and went to sleep."

Q.65 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
His son-in-laws / have enhanced / his business / within a short period.

(a) His son-in-laws **(b)** his business
(c) within a short period **(d)** have enhanced

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) His son-in-laws
Type: Error Detection – Plural of Compound Noun
Rule: Pluralise the main word → "**sons-in-law**".
Corrected sentence
"His **sons-in-law** have enhanced his business within a short period."

Q.66 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The strain caused by / the difficulties and anxieties / were more than / she could bear.

(a) she could bear
(b) the difficulties and anxieties
(c) The strain caused by
(d) were more than

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) were more than
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: The subject "The strain" is **singular** → "**was more than**".
Corrected sentence
"The strain caused by the difficulties and anxieties **was more than** she could bear."

Q.67 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.She watched / the thief who / steal the purse / in the bus.

(a) She watched **(b)** the thief who
(c) in the bus **(d)** steal the purse

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) steal the purse
The sentence is in the past tense which is indicated by the verb 'watched'. Therefore, the verb 'steal' must be in its past form. i.e. steal should be replaced with stole.

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Q.68 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Your name / precedes before / mine / in the list.

(a) Your name **(b)** in the list
(c) mine **(d)** precedes before

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) precedes before
Type: Error Detection – Redundancy
Rule: "precede" already means "come before", so "before" is redundant. Use just "**precedes**".
Corrected sentence
"Your name **precedes** mine in the list."

Q.69 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
If you have / remained calm / you could have / saved the situation.

(a) If you have **(b)** remained calm
(c) saved the situation **(d)** you could have

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) If you have
Type: Error Detection – Third Conditional
Rule: With "you could have saved", the if-clause needs the **past perfect**: "**If you had remained calm**".
Corrected sentence
"**If you had remained** calm, you could have saved the situation."

Q.70 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The more harder / you work, / the better / it will be.

(a) The more harder **(b)** it will be
(c) you work **(d)** the better

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The more harder
Type: Error Detection – Double Comparative
Rule: "harder" is already comparative; do not add "more". Use "**The harder**".
(दोहरा comparative गलत — "more harder" ×)
Corrected sentence
"**The harder** you work, the better it will be."

Q.71 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
I will spend / my rest of remaining / life in my / native village.

(a) I will spend **(b)** native village
(c) life in my **(d)** my rest of remaining

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) my rest of remaining
Type: Error Detection – Redundancy
Rule: "rest" and "remaining" mean the same → redundant. Use "**the rest of my life**".
Corrected sentence
"I will spend **the rest of my** life in my native village."

Q.72 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
He went / to the bed / with a / slight fever.

(a) to the bed **(b)** with a
(c) slight fever **(d)** He went

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) to the bed
Type: Error Detection – Article
Rule: "go to bed" takes **no article** → "**to bed**".
Corrected sentence
"He went **to bed** with a slight fever."

Q.73 Select the segment in which a word has been INCORRECTLY used.
The children were so exhausted that they sank warily into bed.

(a) warily into bed **(b)** were so exhausted
(c) The children **(d)** that they sank

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) warily into bed
Type: Error Detection – Word Confusion
Rule: "warily" = cautiously; the context (exhausted) needs "**wearily**" = tiredly.
Corrected sentence
"The children were so exhausted that they sank **wearily** into bed."

Q.74 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
You should / avail this opportunity / to demonstrate / your skills.

(a) to demonstrate **(b)** avail this opportunity
(c) You should **(d)** your skills

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) avail this opportunity
Type: Error Detection – Reflexive
Rule: "avail" needs a reflexive + "of" → "**avail yourself of this opportunity**".
Corrected sentence
"You should **avail yourself of this opportunity** to demonstrate your skills."

Q.75 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
He often / persists to ask / awkward questions / at the board meetings.

(a) at the board meetings **(b)** persists to ask
(c) awkward questions **(d)** He often

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) persists to ask
Type: Error Detection – Preposition + Gerund
Rule: "persist" takes "**in + V-ing**" → "**persists in asking**".
Corrected sentence
"He often **persists in asking** awkward questions at the board meetings."

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Q.76 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
We yet / have time / to catch / the bus.

(a) have time **(b)** to catch
(c) the bus **(d)** We yet

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) We yet
Type: Error Detection – Yet vs Still
Rule: In an **affirmative** sentence use "**still**" (yet is for negatives/questions). "We **still** have time."
Corrected sentence
"We **still** have time to catch the bus."

Q.77 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Mr. Das, my friend / and Principal / of this college, / have retired.

(a) of this college **(b)** and Principal
(c) Mr. Das, my friend **(d)** have retired

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) have retired
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: The subject "Mr. Das" is **singular** (the phrases in between are appositives) → "**has retired**".
Corrected sentence
"Mr. Das, my friend and Principal of this college, **has retired**."

Q.78 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
This dog seems / to be very ferocious, / otherwise, / it is harmless.

(a) to be very ferocious **(b)** it is harmless
(c) This dog seems **(d)** otherwise

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) otherwise
Type: Error Detection – Connective
Rule: A contrast connective "**but otherwise**" is needed to link the two clauses.
Corrected sentence
"This dog seems to be very ferocious, **but otherwise** it is harmless."

Q.79 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
A businessman at our colony was found COVID positive.

(a) at our colony **(b)** was found
(c) COVID positive **(d)** A businessman

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) at our colony
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: We live "**in**" a colony, not "at our colony".
("in our colony" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"A businessman **in our colony** was found COVID positive."

Q.80 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The allies / of the government / decided to / withdrew all support.

(a) decided to **(b)** The allies
(c) withdrew all support **(d)** of the government

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) withdrew all support
Type: Error Detection – Infinitive
Rule: After "decided **to**" use the **base verb** → "**withdraw**".
Corrected sentence
"The allies of the government decided to **withdraw** all support."

Q.81 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Have you / ever spoke / to anyone / about your problems?

(a) Have you **(b)** ever spoke
(c) to anyone **(d)** about your problems

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ever spoke
Type: Error Detection – Past Participle
Rule: After "have", use the **past participle** → "**ever spoken**".
Corrected sentence
"Have you ever **spoken** to anyone about your problems?"

Q.82 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Scarcely had I / started reading / the paper / then the doorbell rang.

(a) then the doorbell rang **(b)** the paper
(c) Scarcely had I **(d)** started reading

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) then the doorbell rang
Type: Error Detection – "Scarcely ... when"
Rule: "Scarcely ... **when**" (not "then").
Corrected sentence
"Scarcely had I started reading the paper **when** the doorbell rang."

Q.83 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Either of these two roads lead to the post office.

(a) two roads **(b)** lead to
(c) Either of these **(d)** the post office

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) lead to
Type: Error Detection – "Either ... singular verb"
Rule: "Either (of these two roads)" is **singular** → "**leads**".
("Either" एकवचन → "leads"।)
Corrected sentence
"Either of these two roads **leads to** the post office."

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Q.84 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The city turned out / to be very / different to what / he had expected.

(a) different to what **(b)** The city turned out
(c) to be very **(d)** he had expected

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) different to what
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: In standard usage "different" takes "**from**" → "**different from what**".
Corrected sentence
"The city turned out to be very **different from what** he had expected."

Q.85 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
He was unable / to help me because / he had been failed / to arrange the money.

(a) he had been failed **(b)** to arrange the money
(c) to help me because **(d)** He was unable

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) he had been failed
Type: Error Detection – Active vs Passive
Rule: "fail (to do)" is used in the **active**; the passive "had been failed" is wrong → "**he had failed**".
Corrected sentence
"He was unable to help me because he **had failed** to arrange the money."

Q.86 Select the segment in which a word has been INCORRECTLY used.
He had an amazing capacity to condone up the most delectable dishes at a short notice.

(a) He had an amazing
(b) the most delectable
(c) dishes at a short notice
(d) capacity to condone up

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) capacity to condone up
Type: Error Detection – Word Confusion
Rule: "condone" = to overlook a fault; the sense here is to create/prepare → "**conjure up**".
Corrected sentence
"He had an amazing capacity to **conjure up** the most delectable dishes at short notice."

Q.87 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.Daniel sat on / his new bike / and went afar / a ride.

(a) Daniel sat on **(b)** a ride
(c) and went afar **(d)** his new bike

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) and went afar
'afar' should be replaced with 'for'.

Q.88 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The crowd of the migrant worker at the station for the Shramik Special is unforgettable.

(a) at the station **(b)** of the migrant worker
(c) is unforgettable **(d)** The crowd

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) of the migrant worker
Type: Error Detection – Number
Rule: A crowd is made of many, so use the **plural** "**workers**".
(भीड़ में अनेक होते हैं → "workers"।)
Corrected sentence
"The crowd **of the migrant workers** at the station is unforgettable."

Q.89 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
No one have ever paid me such a nice compliment.

(a) such a **(b)** have ever paid me
(c) nice compliment **(d)** No one

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) have ever paid me
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "No one" is **singular** → "**has ever paid**".
("No one" एकवचन → "has"।)
Corrected sentence
"No one **has ever paid me** such a nice compliment."

Q.90 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
His father prevented him to go abroad for higher studies.

(a) to go abroad **(b)** for higher studies
(c) prevented him **(d)** His father

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) to go abroad
Type: Error Detection – "prevent ... from + V-ing"
Rule: The structure is "**prevent + object + from + V-ing**".
("prevent ... from + V-ing"।)
Corrected sentence
"His father prevented him **from going** abroad for higher studies."

Q.91 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
He lived close to / the train station, / yet travelled by bus.

(a) He lived close to **(b)** No error
(c) yet travelled by bus **(d)** the train station

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) No error
The sentence is grammatically correct.

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Q.92 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
This is the album who I found in the garage.

(a) This is **(b)** who I found
(c) in the garage **(d)** the album

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) who I found
Type: Error Detection – Relative Pronoun
Rule: For a thing ("the album"), use "**which/that**", not "who".
(निर्जीव के लिए "which/that"।)
Corrected sentence
"This is the album **which/that I found** in the garage."

Q.93 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Avika hopes getting a distinction in English.

(a) Avika hopes **(b)** a distinction
(c) getting **(d)** in English

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) getting
Type: Error Detection – "hope + to-infinitive"
Rule: "hope" is followed by the **to-infinitive**: "hopes **to get**".
("hope to + verb"।)
Corrected sentence
"Avika hopes **to get** a distinction in English."

Q.94 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
He won't come to school tomorrow, won't he?

(a) won't he **(b)** to school
(c) He won't come **(d)** tomorrow

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) won't he
Type: Error Detection – Question Tag
Rule: A **negative** statement takes a **positive** tag → "**will he?**"
(Negative वाक्य के साथ positive tag — "will he?")
Corrected sentence
"He won't come to school tomorrow, **will he?**"

Q.95 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
A lot of food we serve are wasted.

(a) of food **(b)** we serve
(c) are wasted **(d)** A lot

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) are wasted
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "A lot of **food**" (uncountable) is **singular** → "**is wasted**".
(अगणनीय "food" → "is wasted"।)
Corrected sentence
"A lot of food we serve **is wasted**."

Q.96 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Every soldier and every officer was in their place.

(a) Every soldier **(b)** their place
(c) and every officer **(d)** was in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) their place
Type: Error Detection – "Every ... and every ..." (Singular)
Rule: "Every soldier and every officer" is treated as **singular** → "**his** place".
("Every ... and every ..." एकवचन → "his"।)
Corrected sentence
"Every soldier and every officer was in **his** place."

Q.97 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
What is the name of the Swami whom autobiography impressed you so much?

(a) whom autobiography **(b)** What is the name
(c) impressed you so much **(d)** of the Swami

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) whom autobiography
Type: Error Detection – Relative Pronoun (Possessive)
Rule: To show possession ("the Swami's autobiography"), use "**whose**", not "whom".
(स्वामित्व के लिए "whose"।)
Corrected sentence
"What is the name of the Swami **whose** autobiography impressed you so much?"

Q.98 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
I'm sure to succeed at the long run.

(a) at the **(b)** long run
(c) to succeed **(d)** I'm sure

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) at the
Type: Error Detection – Idiom
Rule: The phrase is "**in the long run**", not "at the long run".
("in the long run" = अंततः।)
Corrected sentence
"I'm sure to succeed **in the** long run."

Q.99 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Her handwriting is definitely more beautiful than your.

(a) more beautiful **(b)** than your
(c) is definitely **(d)** Her handwriting

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) than your
Type: Error Detection – Possessive Pronoun
Rule: Standing alone (comparison), use "**yours**", not "your".
(अकेले खड़े होने पर "yours"।)
Corrected sentence
"Her handwriting is definitely more beautiful than **yours**."

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Q.100 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
She don't go for a walk everyday.

(a) a walk **(b)** go for
(c) She don't **(d)** everyday

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She don't
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "She" (third person singular) takes "**doesn't**", not "don't".
("She doesn't" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"She **doesn't** go for a walk every day."

Q.101 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Scarcely had the train stopped at the platform than the passengers started pushing each other to enter the train.

(a) to enter the train
(b) stopped at the platform
(c) than the passengers
(d) started pushing each other

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) than the passengers
Type: Error Detection – "Scarcely ... when"
Rule: "Scarcely ... **when**" (not "than"). ("No sooner ... than" uses "than"; "Scarcely/Hardly ... when".)
("Scarcely ... when" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"Scarcely had the train stopped at the platform **when** the passengers started pushing each other to enter it."

Q.102 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
A large number of student have participated in this music video.

(a) in this music video **(b)** have participated
(c) of student **(d)** A large number

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) of student
Type: Error Detection – "a large number of + plural"
Rule: "a large number of" takes a **plural** noun → "**students**".
("a large number of" के बाद बहुवचन।)
Corrected sentence
"A large number **of students** have participated in this music video."

Q.103 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Walking on the road a rickshaw hit him.

(a) Walking **(b)** hit him
(c) on the road **(d)** a rickshaw

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Walking
Type: Error Detection – Dangling Modifier
Rule: The opening participle "Walking on the road" must describe the subject that follows. As written, it wrongly modifies "a rickshaw". The subject should be the person.
(participle "Walking" का कर्ता व्यक्ति होना चाहिए, "a rickshaw" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"**While he was walking** on the road, a rickshaw hit him."

Q.104 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
He tried to run away but was soon overtook by some policemen.

(a) He tried to run away **(b)** but was soon
(c) overtook by **(d)** some policemen

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) overtook by
Type: Error Detection – Passive (V3)
Rule: The past participle of "overtake" is "**overtaken**". "was soon **overtaken by**".
(overtake – overtook – overtaken; passive में "overtaken"।)
Corrected sentence
"He tried to run away but was soon **overtaken by** some policemen."

Q.105 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The bus broke down because we had to walk some distance.

(a) some distance **(b)** had to walk
(c) because we **(d)** The bus broke down

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) because we
Type: Error Detection – Wrong Connector
Rule: The bus broke down, **so** we had to walk (result), not "because".
("so" (परिणाम) सही है, "because" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"The bus broke down, **so we** had to walk some distance."

Q.106 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
My father give up / smoking when / I was twelve / years old.

(a) smoking when **(b)** My father give up
(c) I was twelve **(d)** years old

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) My father give up
The sentence is in past tense. So, "gave up" should replace give up.

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Q.107 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
We all will be shift to our new house next month.

(a) will be shift **(b)** to our new house
(c) next month **(d)** We all

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) will be shift
Type: Error Detection – Future Form
Rule: Use "**will shift**" (or "will be shifting"), not "will be shift".
("will shift" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"We all **will shift** to our new house next month."

Q.108 Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
A misunderstanding has crept between he and his sister.

(a) between he **(b)** A misunderstanding
(c) has crept **(d)** and his sister

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) between he
Type: Error Detection – Pronoun Case
Rule: After the preposition "between", use the **object pronoun "him"**, not "he".
(preposition के बाद object pronoun "him" ।)
Corrected sentence
"A misunderstanding has crept between **him** and his sister."

Q.109 Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Contented people seldom complaint against their fate.

(a) against **(b)** Contented people
(c) seldom complaint **(d)** their fate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) seldom complaint
Type: Error Detection – Noun vs Verb
Rule: The verb is "**complain**"; "complaint" is a noun. So "seldom **complain**".
("complain" क्रिया; "complaint" संज्ञा।)
Corrected sentence
"Contented people seldom **complain** against their fate."

Q.110 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
At one time birds and animals lived peaceful together.

(a) peaceful together.
(b) At one time
(c) No error
(d) birds and animals lived

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) peaceful together.
Type: Error Detection – Adjective vs Adverb
Rule: To modify the verb "lived", use the **adverb "peacefully"**, not the adjective "peaceful".
(क्रिया के लिए "peacefully" ।)
Corrected sentence
"At one time, birds and animals lived **peacefully** together."

Q.111 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
During the seventeenth century there were great developments at the sphere of knowledge.

(a) During the seventeenth century
(b) there were great developments
(c) No error
(d) at the sphere of knowledge.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) at the sphere of knowledge.
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: We say "**in the sphere of**", not "at the sphere of".
("in the sphere of" = ... के क्षेत्र में।)
Corrected sentence
"During the seventeenth century, there were great developments **in the sphere of knowledge**."

Q.112 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
This story is quite interesting, but I have read much interesting stories than this.

(a) much interesting stories than this.
(b) This story is quite interesting
(c) No error
(d) but I have read

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) much interesting stories than this.
Type: Error Detection – Comparative
Rule: For a comparison with "than", use "**more interesting**", not "much interesting".
(तुलना (than) के लिए "more interesting" ।)
Corrected sentence
"This story is quite interesting, but I have read **more interesting** stories than this."

Q.113 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
It turned out to be the noisy park party anybody had ever attended.

(a) anybody had ever attended.
(b) It turned out to be
(c) the noisy park party
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) the noisy park party
Type: Error Detection – Superlative
Rule: A "the ... that anybody had ever attended" structure needs a **superlative**. "the noisiest party".
("the noisiest party" (superlative) सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"It turned out to be **the noisiest party** anybody had ever attended."

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Q.114 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
Every Saturday, your mother prepares a pudding, isn't she?

(a) isn't she
(b) prepares a pudding
(c) Every Saturday, your mother
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) isn't she
Type: Error Detection – Question Tag
Rule: The main verb is "**prepares**", so the tag must use "do": "**doesn't she?**"
(main verb "prepares" → tag "doesn't she?")
Corrected sentence
"Every Saturday, your mother prepares a pudding, **doesn't she?**"

Q.115 Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
You must reach the airport on time either you will miss your flight.

(a) miss your flight **(b)** either you will
(c) You must reach **(d)** the airport on time

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) either you will
Type: Error Detection – Wrong Connector
Rule: To warn of a consequence, use "**otherwise / or else**", not "either".
("otherwise you will miss" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"You must reach the airport on time, **otherwise you will** miss your flight."

Q.116 Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The people living in coastal areas were evacuated by time.

(a) were evacuated
(b) by time
(c) living in coastal areas
(d) The people

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) by time
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: The phrase is "**in time**" (early enough), not "by time".
("in time" = समय रहते।)
Corrected sentence
"The people living in coastal areas were evacuated **in time**."

Q.117 Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
If I was you, I would not lose temper in this situation.

(a) I would not **(b)** in this situation
(c) lose temper **(d)** If I was you

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) If I was you
Type: Error Detection – Subjunctive

Explanation (contd.)
Rule: For an unreal/hypothetical situation, use "**If I were you**" (subjunctive), not "was".
(अवास्तविक स्थिति में "If I were you"।)
Corrected sentence
"**If I were you**, I would not lose my temper in this situation."

Q.118 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
These experiments had been going on since several months.

(a) since several months. **(b)** No error
(c) These experiments **(d)** had been going on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) since several months.
Type: Error Detection – for vs since
Rule: For a **period** (several months), use "**for**", not "since".
(अवधि के लिए "for"।)
Corrected sentence
"These experiments had been going on **for several months**."

Q.119 Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
The most talented of these three boys are my friend's son.

(a) are my friend's son **(b)** The most talented
(c) of these three boys **(d)** No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) are my friend's son
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: The subject "The most talented (boy)" is **singular** → "**is** my friend's son".
("The most talented" एकवचन → "is"।)
Corrected sentence
"The most talented of these three boys **is** my friend's son."

Q.120 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
You should tell these children to complete their projects himself.

(a) No error
(b) their projects himself.
(c) these children to complete
(d) You should tell

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) their projects himself.
Type: Error Detection – Reflexive Pronoun Agreement
Rule: The reflexive must agree with "these children" (plural) → "**themselves**", not "himself".
("children" (बहुवचन) → "themselves"।)
Corrected sentence
"You should tell these children to complete their projects **themselves**."

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Q.121 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
If you study hard, you surely got selected for the scholarship.

(a) If you study hard
(b) for the scholarship.
(c) No error
(d) you surely got selected

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) you surely got selected
Type: Error Detection – Conditional
Rule: "If + present, ... **will + V1**." So "you **will surely get** selected".
(Conditional: If present ..., will + verb।)
Corrected sentence
"If you study hard, **you will surely get** selected for the scholarship."

Q.122 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
The gentleman had a suitcase full with wigs, ornaments and dresses.

(a) wigs, ornaments and dresses.
(b) a suitcase full with
(c) The gentleman had
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a suitcase full with
Type: Error Detection – "full of"
Rule: The correct phrase is "**full of**", not "full with".
("full of" = ... से भरा।)
Corrected sentence
"The gentleman had a suitcase **full of** wigs, ornaments and dresses."

Q.123 Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
As soon the gun shot was heard, people ran out in panic.

(a) people ran out
(b) As soon the
(c) in panic
(d) gun shot was heard

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) As soon the
Type: Error Detection – "As soon as"
Rule: The correct connector is "**as soon as**" (the second "as" is missing).
("as soon as" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"**As soon as** the gunshot was heard, people ran out in panic."

Q.124 Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
Open your books at page tenth.

(a) books at
(b) page tenth
(c) Open your
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) page tenth
Type: Error Detection – Cardinal vs Ordinal
Rule: For a page reference we say "**page ten**" (page + cardinal number), not "page tenth".
("page ten" (cardinal) सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"Open your books at **page ten**."

Q.125 Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
He said that he had forgot to lock the door before leaving.

(a) he had forgot
(b) before leaving
(c) to lock the door
(d) He said that

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) he had forgot
Type: Error Detection – Past Participle
Rule: The past participle of "forget" is "**forgotten**". With "had" → "had **forgotten**".
(forget – forgot – forgotten; "had forgotten"।)
Corrected sentence
"He said that he had **forgotten** to lock the door before leaving."

Q.126 Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
Scarcely had he took the medicine when his headache was gone.

(a) took the medicine
(b) No error
(c) when his headache was gone
(d) Scarcely had he

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) took the medicine
Type: Error Detection – "Scarcely had + V3"
Rule: After "Scarcely had he", use the **past participle "taken"**, not "took".
("Scarcely had he" के बाद V3 (taken)।)
Corrected sentence
"Scarcely had he **taken** the medicine when his headache was gone."

Q.127 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.Dan needed help / to get the / tight coat of him.

(a) No error
(b) to get the
(c) tight coat of him
(d) Dan needed help

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) tight coat of him
Preposition 'off' should be used in place of 'of' in the phrase 'tight coat of him'. The phrase refers to the removal of coat from Dan and for this we use the preposition 'off.'

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Q.128 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
If you are going downhill you can go much fast.
(a) much fast.
(b) you can go
(c) If you are going downhill
(d) No error
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) much fast.
Type: Error Detection – Adverb Form
Rule: "fast" should be a comparative here, or use "very fast" — "much fast" is wrong.
("much fast" गलत; "very fast/much faster" सही।)
Corrected sentence
"If you are going downhill, you can go **very fast**."

Q.129 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.We should sorted out / the problem ourselves / rather than depending / on the third party.
(a) the problem ourselves **(b)** We should sorted out
(c) on the third party **(d)** rather than depending
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) We should sorted out
The error is in the first part of the sentence, 'we should sorted out'.
A model verb is followed by the first form of the verb. Thus, 'sorted' should be replaced by 'sort'. So, option (b) is the correct choice.

Q.130 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.The postman / delivers the letters / through hand, / door to door.
(a) The postman **(b)** door to door
(c) through hand **(d)** delivers the letters
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) through hand
'through hand' should be replaced with 'by hand'.
By hand means to do something manually, without any equipment or machines.
'Through hand' is grammatically wrong.

Q.131 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.Everybody stared / when me / entered the / drawing room.
(a) when me **(b)** Everybody stared
(c) entered the **(d)** drawing room
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) when me
'I' should be used in place of 'me'.

Q.132 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
We / has seen / that movie / before.
(a) that movie **(b)** before
(c) has seen **(d)** We
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) has seen
The correct answer is option (c).
"**Has seen"** this is where the error is: **"have seen"** - This is the correct verb tense. "Have seen" is the present perfect tense, which is appropriate for an action that started in the past and has relevance to the present.

Q.133 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
Everyone should respect those parents, teachers, and elders.
(a) respect those **(b)** and elders.
(c) parents, teachers, **(d)** Everyone should
SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) respect those
The correct answer is option (a).
"**Those"** should be replace **"his". Everyone is singular. So, singular pronoun should be come in place of those.**
Hence, the correct sentence would be: **"Everyone should respect his parents, teachers, and elders."**

Q.134 The following sentence has been divided into four parts. One of them contains an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. .
They were / married happily / before she / quit her job.
A B C D
(a) A **(b)** B
(c) D **(d)** C
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) B
The correct answer is option (b).
Married is adjective in this sentence and happily is adverb. So, happily come before married.
Hence, the correct sentence would be: **"they were happily married before she quit her job."**

Q.135 The given sentence has an error. Choose the option that corrects the error
Throw a rounder stone to create ripples in the water.
(a) Throw a round stone to create ripples in the water.
(b) Throw the roundest stone to create ripples in the water.
(c) Throw a more rounder stone to create ripples in the water.
(d) Throw a more round stone to create ripples in the water.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Throw a round stone to create ripples in the water.
The correct answer is option (a).
The error in the original sentence is the use of "rounder," which is not the correct comparative form of the adjective "round."
Hence, The correct sentence is: **"Throw a round stone to create ripples in the water."**

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Q.136 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
The speaker's emphasiss is on the present-day problems that are being faced by ordinary men of India.

(a) on the present-day problems
(b) that are being faced
(c) by ordinary men of India
(d) The speaker's emphasiss is

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The speaker's emphasiss is
The correct answer is option (d).
The correct sentence should be: **"The speaker's emphasis is"**
Here is a spelling error. So, the most appropriate answer is option (d).

Q.137 The given sentence has an error which has been underlined. The underlined word is given as options with some changes. Select the option that rectifies the error.
She vaccillates a lot while making any decision.

(a) vacilates **(b)** vacillattes
(c) vasillates **(d)** vacillates

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) vacillates
The correct answer is option (d).
The correct spelling is **Vacillates.**
Vacillate: waver between different opinions or actions; be indecisive.

Q.138 Select the option that arranges the given words to form a grammatically correct and meaningful sentence.
The students eagerly their awaited results.

(a) The students eagerly awaited their results.
(b) Eagerly awaited the students their results.
(c) The students their eagerly awaited results.
(d) The awaited eagerly results their students.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The students eagerly awaited their results.
The correct answer is option (a).
The sentence is correctly structured with the subject, verb, adverb, and object in the right order. The other options either rearrange the words incorrectly or place the adverb in the wrong position, making them grammatically incorrect or less meaningful.
Hence, the correct sentence is: **"The students eagerly awaited their results."**

Q.139 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
They want to live in first floor of this building.

(a) No error **(b)** They want to
(c) live in first floor **(d)** of this building

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) live in first floor
The correct answer is option (c).

Explanation (contd.)
"live in first floor" - This is where the error is. The preposition "in" is incorrect when referring to a specific floor of a building. We should use "on" instead. When talking about living on a specific floor, we use "on the first floor," "on the second floor," and so on.

Q.140 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
This is the book whom I wanted to buy.

(a) whom I **(b)** wanted to buy.
(c) This is **(d)** the book

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) whom I
The correct answer is option (a).
In this sentence, "that" should be used instead of "whom" to introduce the relative clause. "Whom" is typically used for people, while "that" is used for things or objects. Therefore, "whom I" is incorrect in this context.
The correct sentence should be: **"This is the book that I wanted to buy."**

Q.141 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
It takes me an hour to get to work at the moment, but when the new road is finished it be much quicker.

(a) It takes me an hour to get to work
(b) it be much quicker
(c) but when the new road is finished
(d) at the moment

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) it be much quicker
The phrase "it be much quicker" is incorrect because the verb **"be"** should be in the future tense form **"will be"** to match the context of something happening after the new road is finished.
The correct sentence should be:
"It takes me an hour to get to work at the moment, but when the new road is finished, it will be much quicker."
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.142 The given sentence is divided into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
When I returned to the office, / no work was left / as my friend Rahul / has done everything.

(a) has done everything
(b) as my friend Rahul
(c) no work was left
(d) When I returned to the office,

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) has done everything
The sentence is in the past tense, as indicated by "When I returned to the office." Therefore, the verb should also be in the past tense to maintain consistency.
The correct form is "had done everything," which is the past perfect tense, indicating that the action was completed before the speaker returned to the office.
Corrected sentence:
When I returned to the office, no work was left as my friend Rahul **had done everything.**
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

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Q.143 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
I, you and she/ have been working happily/ in the same company and in the same branch/ for the last nine years.

(a) in the same company and in the same branch
(b) for the last nine years
(c) I, you and she
(d) have been working happily

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I, you and she
The segment that contains a grammatical error is: **I, you and she**.
The correct form should be: **You, she, and I**.
The error here lies in the order of pronouns. It is more grammatically correct and conventional in English to place "I" at the end when listing pronouns. "I" is typically placed last in a list for clarity and politeness.
The corrected sentence would be: "You, she, and I have been working happily in the same company and in the same branch for the last nine years."
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.144 The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part which contains a grammatical error.
If there is no error in the sentence, then select 'No Error'.
The company will invest more(A) six hundred crores(B) in the next five years to expand(C) its operations in Britain (D).

(a) A **(b)** C
(c) B **(d)** D

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A
⚠️ **Note:** the official key marks option (a) (part A), and that is the intended error; strictly, part B also has a slip — after a number *crore* stays singular (*six hundred crore*), so the sentence carries a second, minor error.
Rule: *more* comparing an amount with a figure must be followed by **than** *(से अधिक)*.
Example: She scored more than 90 marks.
Without *than*, *more six hundred crores* says nothing.
Correct it.
The company will invest **more than** six hundred crore in the next five years to expand its operations in Britain.
Answer: **A**
Why the others are fine.
• **C — in the next five years to expand** — *in the next five years* is the right time phrase; *to expand* is an infinitive of purpose *(उद्देश्य बताने वाला infinitive)*.
• **D — its operations in Britain** — *its* (no apostrophe) is the possessive that matches the singular *company (एकवचन सर्वनाम)*.
The second slip in B.
After a definite number, *hundred, thousand, lakh, crore, million, dozen* stay singular: **six hundred crore**, *five lakh*, *two dozen (संख्या के बाद crore एकवचन)*.
The plural is used only without a number: *crores of rupees*.
More ... than: a comparison is not complete without "than".

Q.145 The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part which contains a grammatical error.
If there is no error in the sentence, then select 'No Error'.
The whole family (A)/ would burst into (B)/ peals for laughter. (C)/ No Error (D)

(a) A **(b)** D
(c) C **(d)** B

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) C
Rule: *peal* = a loud, ringing burst of sound; it takes **of**: **peals of laughter** *(ठहाके)*, *a peal of bells*, *a peal of thunder*.
Example: The joke drew peals of laughter from the class.
Correct it.
The whole family would burst into peals **of** laughter.
Answer: **C**
Why the others are fine.
• **A — The whole family** — a collective noun used as one unit; fine as subject *(समूहवाचक संज्ञा)*.
• **B — would burst into** — *would* shows a past habit *(भूतकाल की आदत)*; *burst into* = suddenly begin (laughter, tears, song) *(अचानक ... पड़ना)*.
• **D — No Error** — cannot be chosen, since part C has an error.
Peals of laughter, peal of bells, clap of thunder — "of" every time.

Q.146 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The police could not / hold on the people / for long as they / gathered in large numbers

(a) The police could not
(b) for long as they
(c) gathered in large numbers
(d) hold on the people

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) hold on the people
option (d) is the correct answer.
The given sentence is grammatically incorrect. To rectify the sentence we will use 'Hold Up' instead of 'Hold on'.
The correct sentence is: The police could not hold up the people for long as they gathered in large numbers.

Q.147 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
The students were able to get better from college early so they went to the movies.

(a) college early so they **(b)** The students were able
(c) went to the movies **(d)** to get better from

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to get better from
option (d) is the correct answer.
The given sentence is grammatically incorrect. To correct the sentence we will use 'off'
Instead of From.
Better off: in a more satisfactory situation than you were before.
Hence the correct sentence is: **The students were able to get better *off* college early so they went to the movies.**

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Q.148 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
A man who has been accused of fraud / in an earlier job, he will never be / welcome in any other organisation.

(a) No error
(b) welcome in any other organisation
(c) A man who has been accused of fraud
(d) in an earlier job, he will never be

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) in an earlier job, he will never be
The part that contains the error is: **in an earlier job, he will never be**
The corrected sentence would be: **A man who has been accused of fraud in an earlier job will never be welcome in any other organization.**
By removing the comma and he after "in an earlier job," we connect the clauses more naturally, resulting in a clearer and grammatically correct sentence.

Q.149 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
I have three sisters: / Meera is the elder / and Charu is the youngest.

(a) No error
(b) and Charu is the youngest
(c) I have three sisters:
(d) Meera is the elder

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Meera is the elder
The part that contains the error is: **Meera is the elder**
The corrected sentence would be: **I have three sisters: Meera is the eldest, and Charu is the youngest.**
when comparing two individuals in terms of age or hierarchical order within a group, we use the terms "older" and "younger." However, when comparing among more than two individuals, especially in a group of siblings, we use the terms "oldest" and "youngest."

Q.150 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options.
It is a well-known fact/ that the Monarchy is / not the best form /of governance.

(a) that the Monarchy is
(b) of governance.
(c) not the best form
(d) It is a well-known fact

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) that the Monarchy is
The part that contains the error is: **that the Monarchy is**
Here is the error of article **"the"** should be remove before monarchy.
So, the correct sentence would be: **It is a well-known fact that Monarchy is not the best form of governance.**

Q.151 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options.
While astrology has/ a long history / it is generally/ considered pseudoscience.

(a) it is generally
(b) a long history
(c) While astrology has
(d) considered pseudoscience

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) considered pseudoscience
The correct answer is: **considered pseudoscience**
After consider article should be come. So, the correct sentence would be: **While astrology has a long history it is generally considered a pseudoscience.**

Q.152 Select the option that converts the given sentence into the superlative degree.
The river Ganga has some of the purer water on earth.

(a) The river Ganga has some of the most purest water on earth.
(b) The river Ganga has some of the very purest water on earth.
(c) The river Ganga has some of the more purest water on earth.
(d) The river Ganga has some of the purest water on earth.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The river Ganga has some of the purest water on earth.
The correct option that converts the given sentence into the superlative degree is:
The river Ganga has some of the purest water on earth.
"Purest" is the superlative form of "pure," indicating the highest level of purity.
The use of "some of" implies that the Ganga has among the highest purity levels, and the superlative "purest" accurately conveys this meaning.
In summary, the sentence is correctly converted into the superlative degree by using "purest" to emphasize the exceptional purity of the water in the river Ganga.

Q.153 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
Sincere students / like you and he should study / regularly to pass the examination.

(a) like you and he should study
(b) No error
(c) regularly to pass the examination.
(d) Sincere students

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) No error
In the given sentence there is **'No error**

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Q.154 Parts of the given sentence have been underlined. One of the parts may contain an error. Select the option that rectifies the error. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
Those players who chose not to play in the league were banned from playing in an World Cup.

(a) play in league **(b)** the World Cup
(c) play in a league **(d)** No error

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) the World Cup
"World Cup" refers to a specific event, and when referring to a particular and well-known event, we typically use "the" rather than "an."
Therefore, the correction is to replace "an World Cup" with "the World Cup" for grammatical accuracy and to convey the intended meaning that the players were banned from playing in a specific, well-known World Cup event.

Q.155 Parts of the given sentence have been underlined. One of the parts may contain an error. Select the option that rectifies the error. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
It was the home minister of the country who took the decision to change a laws pertaining to migration of people from one state to another.

(a) the laws pertaining **(b)** the migration
(c) an home minister **(d)** No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) the laws pertaining
The option that rectifies the error in the underlined parts of the sentence is: "It was the home minister of the country who took the decision to change **the laws pertaining** to migration of people from one state to another."
Explanation:
- The original sentence uses "a laws" which is incorrect. The correct phrase is "the laws" when referring to specific laws.
- The word "pertaining" is appropriate in this context, indicating that the laws are related or relevant to migration.

So, the corrected sentence is: "It was the home minister of the country who took the decision to change **the laws pertaining** to migration of people from one state to another."

Q.156 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains an error.
The committee requested / the Chief Investigator / to personally / look after the matter.

(a) look after the matter
(b) the Chief Investigator
(c) to personally
(d) The committee requested

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) look after the matter
The segment that contains an error is: **look after the matter**
Look into should come in place of Look after.
Look into: to investigate, analyze, or study a situation
Look after: take care of someone or something.

Q.157 Choose the appropriate option to make the following sentence grammatically correct.
Neither of the biscuits you gave me _____ chocolate chips.

(a) is contain **(b)** contains
(c) are contained **(d)** contain

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) contains
The appropriate option to make the sentence grammatically correct is: "Neither of the biscuits you gave me **contains** chocolate chips."
1. **Subject-Verb Agreement:**
   - "Neither" is used as a singular pronoun, and when "neither of" is followed by a plural noun (biscuits), the verb that follows should be singular.
2. **Correct Verb Form:**
   - The verb "contains" is the correct singular form of the verb to agree with the singular subject "neither."

So, the grammatically correct sentence is: "Neither of the biscuits you gave me **contains** chocolate chips."

Q.158 There is an error in the given sentence. From the options given, identify the sentence that corrects the error to make it a grammatically accurate sentence.
This lesser known heritage building is so beautiful as the Red Fort.

(a) This lesser known heritage building is as much beautiful as the Red Fort.
(b) This lesser known heritage building is very much beautiful as the Red Fort.
(c) This less known heritage building is much beautiful than the Red Fort.
(d) This heritage building is as beautiful as the Red Fort.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) This lesser known heritage building is as much beautiful as the Red Fort.
Correction:
"This lesser-known heritage building is as much beautiful as the Red Fort."
Explanation:
The error in the original sentence is the use of "so beautiful as." The correct construction for making a comparison of beauty is "as much beautiful as."

Q.159 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The Supreme Court set away / the verdict of the High Court / and agreed to hear the plea / of the complainant.

(a) The Supreme Court set away
(b) and agreed to hear the plea
(c) of the complainant
(d) the verdict of the High Court

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The Supreme Court set away
The phrase **"set away"** is incorrect in this context. The correct expression should be **"set aside"**, which means to annul, cancel, or disregard a decision or judgment.

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Q.160 The following sentence has been divided into four parts. Identify the part which contains a grammatical error (ignore any punctuation error, if any). If there is no error in the sentence, then select 'No Error'.
The vibrant colors (a) / of the Holi festival (b) / were dispersed on the air. (c) / No error. (d)

(a) The vibrant colors
(b) of the Holi festival
(c) were dispersed on the air.
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) were dispersed on the air.
Rule: things spread through the atmosphere are **in the air** *(हवा में)*, or dispersed **into the air**.
on the air is an idiom meaning *being broadcast on radio or TV (प्रसारित हो रहा)*.
Example: *The smell of food hung in the air. / The programme is on the air at 9 pm.*
Find the error.
Part (c) **were dispersed on the air → were dispersed in (into) the air**.
Corrected: *The vibrant colors of the Holi festival were dispersed **in the air**.*
Answer: **(3) were dispersed on the air.**
Why the others are fine.
• **The vibrant colors** — plural subject; *vibrant* = bright and lively *(चटकीले)*.
• **of the Holi festival** — correct article and preposition.
• **No error** — wrong, since part (c) carries the preposition error.
In the air = in the atmosphere; on the air = on radio/TV.

Q.161 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
Neither Amit nor Raju are staying with his parents in Mumbai.

(a) Neither Amit nor Raju **(b)** with his parents
(c) in Mumbai **(d)** are staying

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) are staying
Type: Error Detection – "Neither ... nor" Agreement
Rule: With "**neither ... nor**" joining two singular subjects, the verb is **singular**, and the pronoun agrees with the nearer subject.
("neither ... nor" के साथ एकवचन क्रिया आती है।)
Corrected sentence
"Neither Amit nor Raju **is staying** with his parents in Mumbai."
Why the others are correct
• "Neither Amit nor Raju", "with his parents", "in Mumbai" – all fine.

Q.162 Identify the incorrect sentence.

(a) Maria has bacame so fat after eating a lot of junk food in the hostel.
(b) Every student has to take the preliminary test.
(c) Beena is my sister's best friend.
(d) Korean web series is the best among all other series.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Maria has bacame so fat after eating a lot of junk food in the hostel.
⚠️ **Note:** the official key marks option (a) and that is the intended answer, but option (d) is also faulty — a superlative cannot be followed by *all other*. The item has two incorrect sentences.
Rule: the present perfect is **has / have + past participle (V3)**.
become has the forms **become – became – become**, so the V3 is **become**, not *became*.
Example: *He has become a doctor.* (not *has became*)
Find the error.
Sentence 1 has **has bacame** — a misspelt simple-past form after *has*.
Correct: *Maria **has become** so fat after eating a lot of junk food in the hostel.*
Answer: **(1) Maria has bacame so fat after eating a lot of junk food in the hostel.**
Why the others are fine.
• **Every student has to take the preliminary test.** — *every* takes a singular verb, so **has** is right; *preliminary* = initial, first-stage *(प्रारंभिक)*.
• **Beena is my sister's best friend.** — the possessive **sister's** (one sister) and the superlative *best* are correct *(सही वाक्य)*.
• **Korean web series is the best among all other series.** — the setters treat this as correct, but strictly a superlative compares a thing with the whole group, so *other* must go: **the best among all series** or **better than all other series** *(superlative के साथ other नहीं)*.
V3 check: begin–began–begun, become–became–become — "has" always needs the third form.

Q.163 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
My father did never have an opportunity to go to a University.

(a) did never have **(b)** a University
(c) to go to **(d)** an opportunity

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) did never have
Type: Error Detection – "never" with Past
Rule: With "never" in a simple past sentence, we say "**never had**", not "did never have".
("did never have" गलत; सही "never had"।)
Corrected sentence
"My father **never had** an opportunity to go to a university."
Why the others are correct
• "a University", "to go to", "an opportunity" – all fine.

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Q.164 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
Rahul was ready for accept any job, even a part-time one.

(a) for accept **(b)** any job
(c) even a part-time one **(d)** Rahul was ready

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) for accept
Type: Error Detection – "ready to + verb"
Rule: "ready" is followed by the **to-infinitive**: "**ready to accept**", not "ready for accept".
("ready to + verb" सही है; "for accept" गलत।)
Corrected sentence
"Rahul was **ready to accept** any job, even a part-time one."
Why the others are correct
• "any job", "even a part-time one", "Rahul was ready" – all fine.

Q.165 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
The box of paper clips are kept in the drawer.

(a) in the drawer **(b)** of paper clips
(c) are kept **(d)** The box

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) are kept
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: The subject is "**The box**" (singular), not "paper clips". So the verb is "**is kept**".
(कर्ता "The box" (एकवचन) है → "is kept"।)
Corrected sentence
"The box of paper clips **is kept** in the drawer."
Why the others are correct
• "in the drawer", "of paper clips", "The box" – all fine.

Q.166 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
The list of candidates to be called for the interview were put up on the board.

(a) The list of candidates
(b) for the interview
(c) were put up on the board
(d) to be called

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) were put up on the board
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: The subject is "**The list**" (singular), not "candidates". So the verb is **was**.
(कर्ता "The list" (एकवचन) है; इसलिए "was put up"।)
Corrected sentence
"The list of candidates to be called for the interview **was put up** on the board."
Why the others are correct
• "The list of candidates", "for the interview", "to be called" – all fine.

Q.167 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
Economics is one of the subject which I have found very difficult since school.

(a) one of the subject
(b) Economics is
(c) very difficult since school
(d) which I have found

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) one of the subject
Type: Error Detection – "one of the + plural"
Rule: "**one of the**" is always followed by a **plural noun**. → "one of the **subjects**".
("one of the" के बाद बहुवचन संज्ञा आती है।)
Corrected sentence
"Economics is **one of the subjects** which I have found very difficult since school."
Why the others are correct
• "Economics is", "very difficult since school", "which I have found" – all fine.

Q.168 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
We reserved tickets for a journey on train for the next morning for my sisters and me.

(a) for my sisters and me **(b)** We reserved tickets
(c) for a journey on train **(d)** for the next morning

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) for a journey on train
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: We travel "**by train**" (by bus, by train), not "on train".
(यात्रा "by train" होती है, "on train" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"We reserved tickets for a journey **by train** for the next morning for my sisters and me."
Why the others are correct
• "for my sisters and me", "We reserved tickets", "for the next morning" – all fine.

Q.169 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
No matter he tries hard he cannot play the guitar.

(a) he cannot **(b)** he tries hard
(c) play the guitar **(d)** No matter

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) he tries hard
Type: Error Detection – "No matter how ..."
Rule: The correct structure is "**No matter how hard he tries**" (the word "how" is missing).
(सही संरचना "No matter how hard he tries" — "how" छूट गया है।)
Corrected sentence
"**No matter how hard he tries**, he cannot play the guitar."
Why the others are correct
• "he cannot", "play the guitar", "No matter" – fine once "how" is added.

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Q.170 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
The actor smiled to me when I entered the room as if she knew me.

(a) when I entered the room
(b) as if she
(c) knew me
(d) The actor smiled to me

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The actor smiled to me
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: We "**smile at**" someone, not "smile to".
("smile at" (किसी पर मुस्कुराना), "smile to" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"The actor **smiled at me** when I entered the room as if she knew me."
Why the others are correct
• "when I entered the room", "as if she", "knew me" – all fine.

Q.171 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
News of the calamity is reached the family members the next day.

(a) the next day **(b)** the family members
(c) News of the calamity **(d)** is reached

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) is reached
Type: Error Detection – Voice/Verb Form
Rule: "News ... **reached** the family members" is active simple past. "is reached" (passive) is wrong here.
("reached" (active) सही; "is reached" गलत।)
Corrected sentence
"News of the calamity **reached** the family members the next day."
Why the others are correct
• "the next day", "the family members", "News of the calamity" – all fine.

Q.172 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
Each student will have to carry his own lunch on the picnic.

(a) Each student **(b)** will have to carry
(c) his own lunch **(d)** on the picnic

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) on the picnic
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: You carry something **to** a place. "carry his own lunch **to the picnic**." (We say "go **on** a picnic" but carry things "to" it.)
(किसी चीज़ को किसी स्थान तक "to" लगाकर ले जाते हैं।)
Corrected sentence
"Each student will have to carry his own lunch **to the picnic**."
Why the others are correct
• "Each student", "will have to carry", "his own lunch" – all fine.

Q.173 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
The chart papers were distributed among all the childrens.

(a) The chart papers **(b)** the childrens
(c) were distributed **(d)** among all

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) the childrens
Type: Error Detection – Irregular Plural
Rule: The plural of "child" is "**children**" (already plural); "childrens" is wrong.
("child" का बहुवचन "children" है; "childrens" गलत।)
Corrected sentence
"The chart papers were distributed among all the **children**."
Why the others are correct
• "The chart papers", "were distributed", "among all" – all fine.

Q.174 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
One should be careful to re-read what they has written.

(a) they has written **(b)** One should
(c) be careful **(d)** to re-read what

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) they has written
Type: Error Detection – Pronoun/Agreement
Rule: "One" should be followed by "**one**" (or he) and a singular verb "**has**". "they has" is doubly wrong.
("One ... one has written" — "they has" गलत है।)
Corrected sentence
"One should be careful to re-read what **one has** written."
Why the others are correct
• "One should", "be careful", "to re-read what" – all fine.

Q.175 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
Nikhil is more braver than Sushant who is afraid of the dark.

(a) who is afraid **(b)** of the dark
(c) more braver than **(d)** Nikhil is

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) more braver than
Type: Error Detection – Double Comparative
Rule: "braver" is already the comparative form, so "**more braver**" is a **double comparative** (wrong). Use just "**braver than**".
("braver" स्वयं comparative है; "more braver" दोहरा comparative (गलत)।)
Corrected sentence
"Nikhil is **braver than** Sushant, who is afraid of the dark."
Why the others are correct
• "who is afraid", "of the dark", "Nikhil is" – all fine.

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Q.176 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
Sunita is senior to me in this office and know all the rules.

(a) all the rules **(b)** and know
(c) in this office **(d)** Sunita is senior to me

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) and know
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: The subject "Sunita" is **singular**, so the verb is "**knows**".
(एकवचन "Sunita" के साथ "knows"।)
Corrected sentence
"Sunita is senior to me in this office and **knows** all the rules."
Why the others are correct
• "all the rules", "in this office", "Sunita is senior to me" – all fine.

Q.177 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
Prema is the girl in my class who write beautiful poems.

(a) who write **(b)** Prema is the girl
(c) beautiful poems **(d)** in my class

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) who write
Type: Error Detection – Relative Clause Agreement
Rule: "who" refers to "**the girl**" (singular), so the verb is "**writes**".
("who" यहाँ "the girl" (एकवचन) के लिए है → "writes"।)
Corrected sentence
"Prema is the girl in my class **who writes** beautiful poems."
Why the others are correct
• "Prema is the girl", "beautiful poems", "in my class" – all fine.

Q.178 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
The files you were look for are placed on the table.

(a) The files **(b)** are placed
(c) on the table **(d)** you were look for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) you were look for
Type: Error Detection – Verb Form
Rule: After "were", we need "**looking**" (past continuous) — "the files you **were looking for**".
("were" के बाद V-ing (looking) आता है।)
Corrected sentence
"The files you **were looking for** are placed on the table."
Why the others are correct
• "The files", "are placed", "on the table" – all fine.

Q.179 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
If I join a software company I am getting a good deal of experience.

(a) a software company
(b) a good deal of experience
(c) If I join
(d) I am getting

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I am getting
Type: Error Detection – Conditional
Rule: In a real (future) conditional, the main clause takes "**will + V1**", not the present continuous. "If I join ..., I **will get** ..."
(Conditional वाक्य में मुख्य भाग में "will + verb"।)
Corrected sentence
"If I join a software company, I **will get** a good deal of experience."
Why the others are correct
• "a software company", "a good deal of experience", "If I join" – all fine.

Q.180 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
The Principal was extremely angry on the boys who threw the pieces of chalk at the teacher.

(a) The Principal was
(b) at the teacher
(c) extremely angry on the boys
(d) who threw the pieces of chalk

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) extremely angry on the boys
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: We are "**angry with**" a person (angry **at** a thing), not "angry on".
(व्यक्ति पर "angry with", "angry on" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"The Principal was extremely **angry with the boys** who threw the pieces of chalk at the teacher."
Why the others are correct
• "The Principal was", "at the teacher", "who threw the pieces of chalk" – all fine.

Q.181 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Much of us / lack the / important virtue / of patience.

(a) Much of us **(b)** lack the
(c) important virtue **(d)** of patience

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Much of us
Type: Error Detection – much vs many
Rule: "us" refers to **countable** people, so use "**Many of us**", not "Much".
("us" (लोग) गणनीय है, इसलिए "Many of us"।)
Corrected sentence
"**Many of us** lack the important virtue of patience."
Why the others are correct
• "lack the", "important virtue", "of patience" – all fine.

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Q.182 Identify the segment in the sentence, which contains the grammatical error.
The author's new novel, which is about social change, will launched soon.

(a) will launched soon **(b)** which is
(c) about social change **(d)** The author's new novel

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) will launched soon
Type: Error Detection – Passive Future
Rule: A novel is **launched** (passive), so future passive = "**will be launched**".
(future passive: will be + V3 — "will be launched"।)
Corrected sentence
"The author's new novel, which is about social change, **will be launched** soon."
Why the others are correct
• "which is", "about social change", "The author's new novel" – all fine.

Q.183 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
You need / to sign / these important documents / by ink.

(a) You need
(b) to sign
(c) these important documents
(d) by ink

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) by ink
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: We write "**in ink**" (in pencil, in ink), not "by ink".
("in ink" (स्याही से) सही है, "by ink" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"You need to sign these important documents **in ink**."
Why the others are correct
• "You need", "to sign", "these important documents" – all fine.

Q.184 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
He wanted to know / the reason / why his low score / in Mathematics.

(a) He wanted to know **(b)** in Mathematics
(c) why his low score **(d)** the reason

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) why his low score
Type: Error Detection – Missing Verb
Rule: A clause needs a **verb**. "why his low score" has no verb; it should be "**why he had a low score**".
("why his low score" में क्रिया नहीं है; सही: "why he had a low score"।)
Corrected sentence
"He wanted to know the reason **why he had a low score** in Mathematics."
Why the others are correct
• "He wanted to know", "in Mathematics", "the reason" – all fine.

Q.185 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Her health has being / steadily improving / since she started / practising yoga.

(a) Her health has being **(b)** practising yoga
(c) steadily improving **(d)** since she started

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Her health has being
Type: Error Detection – Present Perfect Continuous
Rule: The correct form is "**has been + V-ing**" (present perfect continuous), not "has being".
(सही रूप "has been improving" है, "has being" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"Her health **has been** steadily improving since she started practising yoga."
Why the others are correct
• "steadily improving", "since she started", "practising yoga" – all fine.

Q.186 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
He could not / get a job / despite of / his best efforts.

(a) despite of **(b)** He could not
(c) get a job **(d)** his best efforts

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) despite of
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: "**despite**" is used **without** "of". (Use either "despite" or "in spite of".)
("despite" के बाद "of" नहीं आता।)
Corrected sentence
"He could not get a job **despite** his best efforts."
Why the others are correct
• "He could not", "get a job", "his best efforts" – all fine.

Q.187 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
I asked Dhruv / when he has plan / to settle / the dues.

(a) I asked Dhruv **(b)** to settle
(c) the dues **(d)** when he has plan

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) when he has plan
Type: Error Detection – Reported Speech/Tense
Rule: After a past reporting verb ("asked"), the clause must be past, and "plan" needs a verb form. Correct: "**when he had planned / when he planned to settle**".
("has plan" गलत है; सही: "when he planned to settle"।)
Corrected sentence
"I asked Dhruv **when he planned** to settle the dues."
Why the others are correct
• "I asked Dhruv", "to settle", "the dues" – all fine.

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Q.188 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
She speaks / very highly / of both her / daughter-in-laws.

(a) very highly **(b)** daughter-in-laws
(c) She speaks **(d)** of both her

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) daughter-in-laws
Type: Error Detection – Plural of Compound Noun
Rule: In a compound noun, the **main word** takes the plural. "daughter-in-law" → "**daughters-in-law**".
(संयुक्त संज्ञा में मुख्य शब्द बहुवचन होता है — "daughters-in-law"।)
Corrected sentence
"She speaks very highly of both her **daughters-in-law**."
Why the others are correct
• "very highly", "She speaks", "of both her" – all fine.

Q.189 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Once upon a time, / a beautiful princess / has fallen in love / with a poor farmer.

(a) Once upon a time **(b)** has fallen in love
(c) with a poor farmer **(d)** a beautiful princess

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has fallen in love
Type: Error Detection – Tense (Narrative Past)
Rule: A story that begins "Once upon a time" is in the **simple past**, so use "**fell**", not the present perfect "has fallen".
("Once upon a time" वाली कहानी simple past में होती है — "fell in love"।)
Corrected sentence
"Once upon a time, a beautiful princess **fell in love** with a poor farmer."
Why the others are correct
• "Once upon a time", "with a poor farmer", "a beautiful princess" – all fine.

Q.190 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
As soon he heard / the sound of thunder, / he hid / under the bed.

(a) the sound of thunder **(b)** under the bed
(c) As soon he heard **(d)** he hid

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) As soon he heard
Type: Error Detection – "As soon as"
Rule: The correct connector is "**as soon as**" (the second "as" is missing).
(सही रूप "as soon as" है; एक "as" छूट गया है।)
Corrected sentence
"**As soon as** he heard the sound of thunder, he hid under the bed."
Why the others are correct
• "the sound of thunder", "under the bed", "he hid" – all fine.

Q.191 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Please switch off / all the lights / before you / are leaving the room.

(a) all the lights **(b)** are leaving the room
(c) Please switch off **(d)** before you

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) are leaving the room
Type: Error Detection – Present Simple after "before"
Rule: After "before you" (referring to a future/general action), use the **present simple**, not the continuous.
("before you" के बाद present simple (leave) आता है।)
Corrected sentence
"Please switch off all the lights before you **leave** the room."
Why the others are correct
• "all the lights", "Please switch off", "before you" – all fine.

Q.192 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
I saw several / French colonial villas / within my visit / to Puducherry.

(a) French colonial villas **(b)** I saw several
(c) within my visit **(d)** to Puducherry

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) within my visit
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: For "in the course of" a period, we use "**during**", not "within".
(किसी अवधि के दौरान के लिए "during", "within" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"I saw several French colonial villas **during my visit** to Puducherry."
Why the others are correct
• "French colonial villas", "I saw several", "to Puducherry" – all fine.

Q.193 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The farmers are using / HYV seeds / so then they can get / a better yield.

(a) a better yield **(b)** HYV seeds
(c) so then they can get **(d)** The farmers are using

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) so then they can get
Type: Error Detection – "so that" (Purpose)
Rule: To show purpose, use "**so that + subject + can/may + V1**", not "so then".
(उद्देश्य बताने के लिए "so that ... can", "so then" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"The farmers are using HYV seeds **so that they can get** a better yield."
Why the others are correct
• "a better yield", "HYV seeds", "The farmers are using" – all fine.

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Q.194 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The news / of his involvement / in illegal activities / have shocked everybody.

(a) in illegal activities **(b)** have shocked everybody
(c) of his involvement **(d)** The news

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) have shocked everybody
Type: Error Detection – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "**news**" is an **uncountable, singular** noun, so it takes a singular verb → **has**.
("news" अगणनीय/एकवचन है, इसलिए "has shocked"।)
Corrected sentence
"The news of his involvement in illegal activities **has shocked** everybody."
Why the others are correct
• "in illegal activities", "of his involvement", "The news" – all fine.

Q.195 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
My neighbour is / an young businessman / who is very friendly / with everyone.

(a) with everyone **(b)** who is very friendly
(c) an young businessman **(d)** My neighbour is

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) an young businessman
Type: Error Detection – Article (a/an)
Rule: "**a**" or "**an**" depends on **sound**, not spelling. "young" begins with a consonant sound /j/ ("yuh"), so it takes "**a**".
("young" का उच्चारण व्यंजन ध्वनि से शुरू होता है, इसलिए "a young"।)
Corrected sentence
"My neighbour is **a young** businessman who is very friendly with everyone."
Why the others are correct
• "with everyone", "who is very friendly", "My neighbour is" – all fine.

Q.196 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
He is / too immature / for handle / the situation.

(a) too immature **(b)** He is
(c) the situation **(d)** for handle

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) for handle
Type: Error Detection – "too ... to"
Rule: "too + adjective + **to + V1**" (not "for + verb"). "too immature **to handle**".
("too + विशेषण + to + verb"; "for handle" गलत है।)
Corrected sentence
"He is too immature **to handle** the situation."
Why the others are correct
• "too immature", "He is", "the situation" – all fine.

Q.197 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
No sooner / did the chairman arrived / than the / proceedings commenced.

(a) No sooner
(b) proceedings commenced
(c) did the chairman arrived
(d) than the

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) did the chairman arrived
Type: Error Detection – "did + base verb"
Rule: After the auxiliary "**did**", use the **base verb (arrive)**, not "arrived".
("did" के बाद क्रिया की पहली फॉर्म (arrive) आती है।)
Corrected sentence
"No sooner **did the chairman arrive** than the proceedings commenced."
Why the others are correct
• "No sooner", "proceedings commenced", "than the" – all fine.

Q.198 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
This is / only mistake / he has made / in the dictation.

(a) in the dictation **(b)** only mistake
(c) he has made **(d)** This is

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) only mistake
Type: Error Detection – Missing Article
Rule: "only" (meaning the single one) needs "**the**" before it: "**the only** mistake".
("only" (एकमात्र) से पहले "the" आता है।)
Corrected sentence
"This is **the only** mistake he has made in the dictation."
Why the others are correct
• "in the dictation", "he has made", "This is" – all fine.

Q.199 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Parul is / ten years / elder than / her sibling.

(a) Parul is **(b)** her sibling
(c) ten years **(d)** elder than

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) elder than
Type: Error Detection – elder vs older
Rule: "**elder**" is used only **before a noun** (elder brother) and **not with "than"**. To compare with "than", use "**older**".
("elder" के साथ "than" नहीं आता; तुलना के लिए "older than"।)
Corrected sentence
"Parul is ten years **older than** her sibling."
Why the others are correct
• "Parul is", "her sibling", "ten years" – all fine.

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Q.200 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
He is / afraid from / all insects / that crawl.

(a) He is **(b)** that crawl
(c) all insects **(d)** afraid from

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) afraid from
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: We are "**afraid of**" something, not "afraid from". ("afraid" के बाद "of" आता है, "from" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"He is **afraid of** all insects that crawl."
Why the others are correct
• "He is", "that crawl", "all insects" – all fine.

Q.201 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
His loyalty / and honesty / are above / suspect.

(a) suspect **(b)** are above
(c) His loyalty **(d)** and honesty

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) suspect
Type: Error Detection – Wrong Word (noun needed)
Rule: The idiom is "**above suspicion**" (a noun). "suspect" is a verb/person, so it is wrong here.
(सही मुहावरा "above suspicion" (संज्ञा) है; "suspect" गलत है।)
Corrected sentence
"His loyalty and honesty are above **suspicion**."
Why the others are correct
• "are above", "His loyalty", "and honesty" – all fine.

Q.202 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
During winters in Delhi, flights are oftenly cancelled due to heavy fog.

(a) flights are **(b)** oftenly cancelled
(c) due to heavy fog **(d)** During winters

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) oftenly cancelled
Type: Error Detection – Wrong Word Form
Rule: "**often**" is already an adverb; there is **no word "oftenly"**.
("often" स्वयं क्रिया-विशेषण है; "oftenly" कोई शब्द नहीं है।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "flights are **oftenly cancelled**" → Correct: "flights are **often cancelled** due to heavy fog."
Why the others are correct
• "flights are", "due to heavy fog", "During winters" – all fine.

Q.203 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
If you will search his pockets you will surely find your watch.

(a) find your watch **(b)** If you
(c) you will surely **(d)** will search

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) will search
Type: Error Detection – Conditional Sentence
Rule: In the "if" part of a conditional, we use the **present simple**, NOT "will". (Structure: "If + present ..., will + V1" in the main clause.)
(Conditional वाक्य में if वाले भाग में "will" नहीं, present simple आता है।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "If you **will search** his pockets ..." → Correct: "If you **search** his pockets, you will surely find your watch."
Why the others are correct
• "If you", "you will surely", "find your watch" – all grammatically fine.

Q.204 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Both are excellent singers, but I think Kartik is best.

(a) excellent singers **(b)** Both are
(c) but I think **(d)** is best

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) is best
Type: Error Detection – Comparison (Two Persons)
Rule: When comparing **only two** persons/things, use the **comparative** ("better"), not the superlative ("best").
(केवल दो की तुलना में comparative (better) आता है, superlative (best) नहीं।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "Both are excellent singers, but I think Kartik **is best**." → Correct: "... Kartik **is better** (of the two)."
Why the others are correct
• "excellent singers", "Both are", "but I think" – all fine.

Q.205 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
I am not too eager to read that book being that it has not got good reviews.

(a) being that **(b)** has not got
(c) to read that book **(d)** not too eager

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) being that
Type: Error Detection – Wrong Conjunction
Rule: "**being that**" is non-standard English. To give a reason, use "**because / since / as**".
("being that" गलत है; कारण बताने के लिए "because/since" का प्रयोग करें।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "... **being that** it has not got good reviews" → Correct: "... **because** it has not got good reviews."
Why the others are correct
• "has not got", "to read that book", "not too eager" – all acceptable.

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Q.206 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The doctor did not put the patient on the ventilator, yet still made him comfortable.

(a) yet still made **(b)** did not put
(c) him comfortable **(d)** on the ventilator

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) yet still made
Type: Error Detection – Redundancy
Rule: "yet" and "still" carry the same "even so" meaning; using both together is **redundant**. Keep only one.
("yet" और "still" एक ही अर्थ देते हैं; दोनों साथ लगाना दोहराव (redundancy) है।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "**yet still made** him comfortable" → Correct: "... **yet made** him comfortable" (or "but still made").
Why the others are correct
• "did not put", "him comfortable", "on the ventilator" – all fine.

Q.207 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
These tutorials are so elementary that they can help neither you nor I.

(a) neither you nor I **(b)** so elementary that
(c) These tutorials are **(d)** they can help

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) neither you nor I
Type: Error Detection – Pronoun Case
Rule: After a verb ("help"), the pronoun is the **object**, so we use the **object form "me"**, not "I".
(क्रिया के बाद object pronoun आता है — "I" नहीं, "me" ।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "they can help neither you nor **I**" → Correct: "they can help neither you nor **me**."
Why the others are correct
• "These tutorials are", "so elementary that", "they can help" – all fine.

Q.208 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The plant will die unless you will water it every day.

(a) will die **(b)** unless
(c) every day **(d)** you will water

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) you will water
Type: Error Detection – "unless" Clause
Rule: "unless" already means "if not". Like an if-clause, it takes the **present simple**, never "will".
("unless" का अर्थ है "if not"; इसके बाद present simple आता है, "will" नहीं।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "unless **you will water** it" → Correct: "The plant will die **unless you water** it every day."
Why the others are correct
• "will die", "unless", "every day" – all fine.

Q.209 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
This question paper comprises from questions on general awareness and reasoning.

(a) comprises from **(b)** general awareness
(c) This question paper **(d)** questions on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) comprises from
Type: Error Detection – Preposition with "comprise"
Rule: "comprise" means "to be made up of" and is used **without** "of" or "from". (Say "comprises X", or "is composed of X".)
("comprise" के बाद "of/from" नहीं आता; सीधे object आता है।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "**comprises from** questions" → Correct: "This question paper **comprises** questions on general awareness and reasoning."
Why the others are correct
• "general awareness", "This question paper", "questions on" – all fine.

Q.210 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
No sooner did the ship touch the shore when the sailor jumped into the water.

(a) the shore **(b)** did the ship touch
(c) jumped into the water. **(d)** when the sailor

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) when the sailor
Type: Error Detection – "No sooner ... than"
Rule: The fixed pair is "**No sooner ... than**" (not "when"). It shows one action happening immediately after another.
("No sooner" के साथ हमेशा "than" आता है, "when" नहीं।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "No sooner did the ship touch the shore **when** the sailor jumped ..." → Correct: "No sooner did the ship touch the shore **than** the sailor jumped into the water."
Why the others are correct
• "the shore", "did the ship touch", "jumped into the water" – all fine.

Q.211 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
His family lives in Bihar but he works on a factory in Mumbai.

(a) but he works **(b)** in Mumbai
(c) on a factory **(d)** His family lives

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) on a factory
Type: Error Detection – Preposition
Rule: We work **in** a factory/office (inside a place), not "on".
(हम किसी स्थान के अंदर काम करते हैं तो "in" — "in a factory" ।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "he works **on a factory**" → Correct: "he works **in a factory** in Mumbai."
Why the others are correct
• "but he works", "in Mumbai", "His family lives" – all fine.

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Q.212 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
All the school have been closed in the country due to Covid-19.

(a) have been closed **(b)** in the country
(c) due to Covid-19 **(d)** All the school

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) All the school
Type: Error Detection – Determiner + Countable Noun
Rule: "All the" with a countable noun needs the **plural** form. So "All the **schools**", not "All the school".
("All the" के बाद गिनने योग्य संज्ञा का बहुवचन आता है — schools।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "**All the school** have been closed" → Correct: "**All the schools** have been closed in the country due to Covid-19."
Why the others are correct
• "have been closed", "in the country", "due to Covid-19" – all fine.

Q.213 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Mr. Bansal is the more methodical person in our office staff.

(a) Mr. Bansal is **(b)** office staff.
(c) the more **(d)** in our

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) the more
Type: Error Detection – Comparison (Among Many)
Rule: Choosing one out of **many** (the whole office staff) needs the **superlative** ("the most methodical"), not the comparative ("more").
(बहुतों में से एक चुनने पर superlative (the most) आता है।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "Mr. Bansal is **the more** methodical person in our office staff." → Correct: "Mr. Bansal is **the most** methodical person in our office staff."
Why the others are correct
• "Mr. Bansal is", "office staff.", "in our" – all fine.

Q.214 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
As soon as the super moon had rose over the hill, the valley was flooded with silver light.

(a) over the hill **(b)** As soon as
(c) had rose **(d)** was flooded with

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) had rose
Type: Error Detection – Verb Form (V3 of "rise")
Rule: The three forms are **rise – rose – risen**. After "had", we use the **past participle "risen"**, not "rose".
(rise – rose – risen; "had" के बाद तीसरी फॉर्म "risen" आती है।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "the super moon **had rose**" → Correct: "the super moon **had risen** over the hill."
Why the others are correct
• "over the hill", "As soon as", "was flooded with" – all fine.

Q.215 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
They were completely taking unawares by the shocking remarks of Mr. Sharma about the security of the colony.

(a) by the shocking remarks
(b) were completely taking unawares
(c) of the colony
(d) about the security

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) were completely taking unawares
Type: Error Detection – Voice (Passive Form)
Rule: "They" received the action, so we need the **passive**: "**were taken** unawares" (be + V3), not "were taking".
(जब कर्ता पर क्रिया होती है तो passive (were + V3) — "were taken unawares"।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "**were completely taking unawares**" → Correct: "They were completely **taken unawares** by the shocking remarks ..."
Why the others are correct
• "by the shocking remarks", "of the colony", "about the security" – all fine.

Q.216 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Instead of attend the class he went to watch the cricket match.

(a) to watch **(b)** attend the class
(c) he went **(d)** Instead of

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) attend the class
Type: Error Detection – Gerund after Preposition
Rule: After a preposition ("of"), the verb takes the **-ing (gerund)** form. So "instead of **attending**".
(preposition (of) के बाद क्रिया की -ing (gerund) फॉर्म आती है।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "Instead of **attend the class**" → Correct: "Instead of **attending the class**, he went to watch the cricket match."
Why the others are correct
• "to watch", "he went", "Instead of" – all fine.

Q.217 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
I haven't / done the work yet. / I do it / later.

(a) done the work yet **(b)** I haven't
(c) later **(d)** I do it

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I do it
Explanation:
The sentence is talking about a future action ("I do it later"), but the structure **"I do it"** is incorrect for expressing future intention in this context.
- Correct form: **"I will do it later."**

Correct sentence:
I haven't done the work yet. I will do it later.

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Q.218 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
This newspaper has a bigger circulation from any other newspaper in our town.

(a) a bigger circulation
(b) from any other newspaper
(c) in our town
(d) This newspaper has

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) from any other newspaper
Type: Error Detection – Comparison
Rule: The comparative degree ("bigger") is followed by **"than"**, never "from".
(comparative degree (bigger) के बाद "than" आता है, "from" नहीं।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "a bigger circulation **from any other** newspaper" → Correct: "a bigger circulation **than any other** newspaper in our town."
Why the others are correct
• "a bigger circulation", "in our town", "This newspaper has" – all fine.

Q.219 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The data which she presented was the most latest one on the matter under discussion.

(a) which she presented
(b) under discussion
(c) on the matter
(d) was the most latest one

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) was the most latest one
Type: Error Detection – Double Superlative
Rule: "latest" is already a superlative form, so we never write "**most latest**". A word cannot take a double superlative.
("latest" स्वयं superlative है; इसके साथ "most" नहीं लगता (double superlative गलत है)।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "was **the most latest** one" → Correct: "was **the latest** one on the matter under discussion."
Why the others are correct
• "which she presented", "on the matter", "under discussion" – all fine.

Q.220 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The magistrate asked the prisoner what was he doing with his hand in the gentleman's pocket.

(a) with his hand
(b) what was he doing
(c) The magistrate asked
(d) in the gentleman's pocket

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) what was he doing
Type: Error Detection – Reported (Indirect) Question
Rule: In a reported question, the word order becomes **assertive**: (question word) + **subject + verb**, with no question mark.
(Reported question में शब्द-क्रम सीधा हो जाता है: subject + verb, प्रश्न-चिह्न नहीं।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "asked the prisoner **what was he doing**" → Correct: "asked the prisoner **what he was doing** with his hand ..."
Why the others are correct
• "The magistrate asked", "with his hand", "in the gentleman's pocket" – all fine.

Q.221 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Ramprasad has not been able to come to work since a week due to fever.

(a) has not been
(b) since a week
(c) due to fever
(d) able to come

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) since a week
Type: Error Detection – since vs for
Rule: "**since**" is used for a **point of time** (since Monday, since 2019). For a **period/length of time** (a week), use "**for**".
("since" समय-बिंदु के लिए; अवधि (a week) के लिए "for"।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "has not been able to come to work **since a week**" → Correct: "... **for a week** due to fever."
Why the others are correct
• "has not been", "due to fever", "able to come" – all fine.

Q.222 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
I hope Mom will have cook all our favourite dishes before we come into the room again.

(a) before we come
(b) all our favourite dishes
(c) into the room again
(d) I hope Mom will have cook

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I hope Mom will have cook
Solution:
- The phrase "**will have cook**" is incorrect.
- The correct form is "**will have cooked**" (past participle needed after "will have").
- Other parts of the sentence are correct.

Answer: (d) I hope Mom will have cook

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Q.223 Parts of the following sentence are given as options. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
I am indebted to my friends for the large sum of money what they gave me during my days of need.

(a) for the large sum
(b) what they gave me
(c) during my days of need
(d) indebted to my friends

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) what they gave me
Type: Error Detection – Relative Pronoun
Rule: To refer to a thing already named ("the large sum of money"), use "**that/which**", not "**what**". ("what" = "the thing which", so it should not follow a noun.)
(पहले से बताई गई वस्तु के लिए "that/which" आता है, "what" नहीं।)
Error & correction
Wrong: "the large sum of money **what they gave me**" →
Correct: "... the large sum of money **that/which they gave me** during my days of need."
Why the others are correct
• "for the large sum", "during my days of need", "indebted to my friends" – all fine.

Q.224 Select the grammatically correct statement from among the given options.
A. The Taj Mahal is an iconic building. Visiting it is an experience worth remembering forever.
B.Taj Mahal is a iconic building. Visiting it is an experience worth remembering forever.
C.The Taj Mahal is an iconic building. Visiting it is a experience worth remembering forever.
D.A Taj Mahal is a iconic building. Visiting it is an experience worth remembering forever.

(a) A
(b) D
(c) C
(d) B

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A
Solution:
- option (a) is correct because:
  - It uses the definite article "**The**" correctly before "Taj Mahal."
  - It correctly uses "**an iconic building**" (using "an" before a vowel sound).
  - It uses "**an experience**" (correct article before a vowel sound).
- Other options have errors in articles ("a" instead of "an," missing "The," or incorrect article usage).

Answer: (a) A

Q.225 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
It is a matter / of immense honour / to receive a MBA degree / from here

(a) to receive a MBA degree
(b) from here
(c) of immense honour
(d) It is a matter

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) to receive a MBA degree
Solution:
- The error is in the segment "**to receive a MBA degree**."
- Since "**MBA**" begins with a vowel sound ("em"), the correct article is "**an**" instead of "**a**."
- Correct phrase: "**to receive an MBA degree**."
- Other segments are grammatically correct.

Answer: (a) to receive a MBA degree

Q.226 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
Children were prohibited to attend / the military parade in which / deadly weapons were displayed.

(a) Children were prohibited to attend
(b) No error
(c) the military parade in which
(d) deadly weapons were displayed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Children were prohibited to attend
Solution:
- The verb **"prohibited"** is generally followed by "**from + -ing**" form, not "**to + verb**."
- The correct phrase should be: "**Children were prohibited from attending** the military parade..."
- Therefore, the error is in the segment: **"Children were prohibited to attend."**

Answer: (a) Children were prohibited to attend

Q.227 Identify the error in the following sentence.
The protesters were badly beaten and take into custody by the authorities.

(a) custody
(b) beaten
(c) were
(d) take

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) take
Solution:
The sentence is: *"The protesters were badly beaten and take into custody by the authorities."*
The verbs "were badly beaten" and "take into custody" are connected by "and", so both must match in tense and form.
"Take" is incorrect because it is in the base form, while "were badly beaten" is in the past passive.
The correct passive form should be "taken into custody".
Corrected sentence: *The protesters were badly beaten and taken into custody by the authorities.*
Error is in: take

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Q.228 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Rishi and Rahul are twins / but both do not take off / the kindness and generosity / of their parents.

(a) of their parents
(b) but both do not take off
(c) the kindness and generosity
(d) Rishi and Rahul are twins

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) but both do not take off

Explanation:
The error lies in the segment: **"but both do not take off"**

- The phrasal verb **"take off"** is incorrect in this context.
- The intended meaning is to **resemble** or **show traits similar to** someone, for which the correct phrasal verb is **"take after"**.
- **"Take off"** typically means to leave the ground (for aircraft) or to become successful, which does not fit the sentence's context.

Correct sentence:
Rishi and Rahul are twins, but both do not take after the kindness and generosity of their parents.

Part of speech corrected:

- **Verb (phrasal verb)**: *"take off" → "take after"*

Q.229 The following sentence has been split into segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
The players were practicing for an hour / when the coach came / and asked them to stop.

(a) and asked them to stop
(b) The players were practicing for an hour
(c) no error
(d) when the coach came

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The players were practicing for an hour

Explanation:
The error is in the verb tense used with the time expression **"for an hour"**.

- The phrase **"for an hour"** implies **duration up to a point in the past**.
- Therefore, the correct tense should be **past perfect continuous**, not simple past continuous.

Incorrect: The players **were practicing** for an hour
Correct: The players **had been practicing** for an hour
Correct sentence:
The players had been practicing for an hour when the coach came and asked them to stop.

Q.230 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The box containing / the apples from / the valleys of Kashmir were / thrown away by Gautam.

(a) The box containing
(b) thrown away by Gautam
(c) the valleys of Kashmir were
(d) the apples from

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) the valleys of Kashmir were

Solution:

- The subject of the sentence is "**The box containing the apples from the valleys of Kashmir**."
- "**The box**" is **singular**, so the verb should be singular ("was," not "were").
- The segment "**the valleys of Kashmir were**" incorrectly uses "**were**" instead of "**was**."
- Therefore, the error lies in the segment: **"the valleys of Kashmir were."**

Answer: (c) the valleys of Kashmir were

Q.231 Select the option that contains a grammatical error in the underlined portion.
I love Chennai. It is a beautiful city located in the Bay of Bengal, symbolising the unification of assimilation of culture and integrity.

(a) I love Chennai. It is a beautiful city located in the Bay of Bengal, symbolising the unification of assimilation of culture and integrity.
(b) I love Chennai. It is a beautiful city located in the Bay of Bengal, symbolising the unification of assimilation of culture and integrity.
(c) I love Chennai. It is a beautiful city located in the Bay of Bengal, symbolising the unification of assimilation of culture and integrity.
(d) I love Chennai. It is a beautiful city located in the Bay of Bengal, symbolising the unification of assimilation of culture and integrity.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I love Chennai. It is a beautiful city located in the Bay of Bengal, symbolising the unification of assimilation of culture and integrity.

Solution:

- The phrase "**unification of assimilation of culture and integrity**" is **incorrect** because "**unification of assimilation**" is not a proper collocation.
- The intended meaning likely involves either "**unification and assimilation**" or "**assimilation of culture and integrity**," but not "**unification of assimilation**."
- Therefore, the grammatical error lies in the segment containing "**unification of assimilation of culture and integrity.**"
- The error is in the phrase "**unification of assimilation**," which is an incorrect combination.

Answer: (d) I love Chennai. It is a beautiful city located in the Bay of Bengal, symbolising the unification of assimilation of culture and integrity.

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Q.232 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
She was happy to find out / that the child could lay there / all day without being disturbed / by anyone.

(a) by anyone
(b) that the child could lay there
(c) all day without being disturbed
(d) She was happy to find out

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) that the child could lay there
Explanation:
The error lies in the phrase **"that the child could lay there"**.

- The verb **"lay"** is the **past tense of "lie"**, but it's often confused with **"lie"** (to rest or recline).
- Here, we need the **base form "lie"** (present tense) in modal construction: **"could lie"**, not **"could lay"**.

Correct sentence:
"That the child could **lie** there all day without being disturbed"
Correct segment with error:
that the child could lay there
Correct answer: 2

Q.233 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
Even though I had been boxing for three years, I had no idea that I can beat somebody in the ring.

(a) No error
(b) Even though I had been boxing for three years
(c) I can beat somebody in the ring
(d) I had no idea that

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I can beat somebody in the ring
Solution:

- The sentence mixes past perfect ("had been boxing") with present tense ("can beat").
- The phrase "**I can beat somebody in the ring**" should be in past tense to match the rest of the sentence.
- Correct form: "**I could beat somebody in the ring.**"
- Therefore, the error is in the segment: **"I can beat somebody in the ring."**

Answer: (c) I can beat somebody in the ring

Q.234 Select the option that contains a grammatical error in the underlined portion.
Not the word was said during the general discussion about the concerns regarding these people.

(a) Not the word was said during the general discussion about the concerns regarding these people.
(b) Not the word was said during the general discussion about the concerns regarding these people.
(c) Not the word was said during the general discussion about the concerns regarding these people.
(d) Not the word was said during the general discussion about the concerns regarding these people.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Not the word was said during the general discussion about the concerns regarding these people.
Explanation:
The error is in the **subject-verb inversion**. The sentence begins with a **negative expression**: "Not the word was said..." – which is incorrect.
The correct structure when a negative expression comes at the beginning is **inversion of the auxiliary verb and subject**.
Instead of:
"Not the word was said..."
It should be:
"Not a word was said..." (also grammatically better phrased)
So, the correct sentence would be:
"Not a word was said during the general discussion about the concerns regarding these people."
Grammatical error is in:
Option: Not the word was said (Incorrect phrasing and structure)

Q.235 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Her friends were not able / to attend her marriage / because they are / in another country at that time.

(a) to attend her marriage
(b) in another country at that time
(c) her friends were not able
(d) because they are

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) because they are
Solution:

- The sentence mixes past tense ("were not able") with present tense ("are").
- The correct tense to maintain consistency is past tense: "**because they were in another country at that time.**"
- Therefore, the error is in the segment: **"because they are."**

Answer: (d) because they are

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Q.236 The following sentence has been split into segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
If I were your mother / I would have taken care / of you and your sisters.

(a) I would have taken care
(b) of you and your sisters
(c) No error
(d) If I were your mother

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I would have taken care
Solution:
- The sentence mixes **second conditional** ("If I were your mother") with a **third conditional** result ("I would have taken care").
- For the second conditional, the result clause should use "**would + base verb**" (e.g., "I would take care").
- The correct form for third conditional would be "**If I had been your mother, I would have taken care...**"
- Therefore, the error is in the segment: **"I would have taken care."**

Answer: (a) I would have taken care

Q.237 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
They were grateful for a bread we gave them.

(a) for a bread
(b) They were grateful
(c) No error
(d) we gave them

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) for a bread
Solution:
- The word "**bread**" is an **uncountable noun** and should not be preceded by the article "**a**."
- The correct phrase is "**grateful for bread**" (without "a").
- Therefore, the error is in the segment: **"for a bread."**

Answer: (a) for a bread

Q.238 Identify the error in the following sentence.
We are assured of the fact that Siben might good be the best cook to prepare chicken curry for our lunch.

(a) good
(b) prepare
(c) best
(d) might

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) good
Explanation:
The phrase **"might good be"** is grammatically incorrect. The correct modal structure is:
- **"might be good"** (if "good" is an adjective)
- or more appropriately here, **"might be the best cook"**

The corrected sentence should be:
"We are assured of the fact that Siben might be the best cook to prepare chicken curry for our lunch."
So, the word **"good"** is **incorrectly placed and unnecessary**, making it the segment with the grammatical error.

Q.239 The given sentence is divided into three segments. Select the option that has the segment with a grammatical error. If there is no error, select 'no error' as your answer.
When I turn sixty, / I will have been teaching / students for forty-one years.

(a) When I turn sixty
(b) I will have been teaching
(c) students for forty-one years
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) No error
Solution:
- The sentence uses the **future perfect continuous tense**: "I will have been teaching students for forty-one years."
- The time clause "**When I turn sixty**" is correct for indicating the future time.
- All parts of the sentence are grammatically correct and consistent.

Answer: No error

Q.240 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Venu is a great / storyteller and can / makes up a story / on the spot.

(a) storyteller and can
(b) on the spot
(c) Venu is a great
(d) makes up a story

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) makes up a story
Solution:
- The sentence is: *"Venu is a great storyteller and can makes up a story on the spot."*
- The error is in the phrase "**can makes up a story**."
- After "**can**" (a modal verb), the base form of the verb should be used without "**-s**."
- Correct form: "**can make up a story**."
- Therefore, the incorrect segment is: **"makes up a story."**

Answer: (d) makes up a story

Q.241 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
Saumin was polite asking for the receiver while you were busy raging.

(a) while you were
(b) asking for the receiver
(c) Saumin was polite
(d) busy raging

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Saumin was polite
Explanation:
The phrase **"Saumin was polite asking for the receiver"** is **grammatically incorrect** due to the missing preposition **"in"** after "polite".
- The correct expression is: **"polite in asking"**.

Correct sentence:
Saumin was polite in asking for the receiver while you were busy raging.

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Q.242 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
The supervisor emphasised on / the need to gather / as much information as possible.

(a) The supervisor emphasised on
(b) the need to gather
(c) as much information as possible
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The supervisor emphasised on
Solution:
- The verb **"emphasise"** is generally **not followed by "on"**.
- The correct usage is: "**The supervisor emphasised the need to gather...**" (without "on").
- Therefore, the error is in the segment: **"The supervisor emphasised on."**

Answer: (a) The supervisor emphasised on

Q.243 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains a grammatical error. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
About the end of the month, the financial planning takes an extremely compromising turn.

(a) the financial planning
(b) About the end of the month
(c) takes an extremely compromising turn.
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) About the end of the month
Solution:
- The phrase "**About the end of the month**" is incorrect.
- The correct phrase should be "**Towards the end of the month**" or "**At the end of the month**."
- Therefore, the error is in the segment: **"About the end of the month."**

Answer: (b) About the end of the month

Q.244 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
Kumar could not finish the exam on time because he started lately.

(a) he started lately
(b) on time because
(c) finish the exam
(d) Kumar could not

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) he started lately
Solution:
- The phrase "**he started lately**" is incorrect.
- The correct phrase should be "**he started late**" (using "late" as an adverb).
- Other parts of the sentence are correct.

Answer: (a) he started lately

Q.245 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Hold my hand lest you should not get lost in the huge crowd at the fair.

(a) get lost in the huge
(b) lest you should not
(c) crowd at the fair
(d) Hold my hand

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) lest you should not
Solution:
The error lies in the segment **"lest you should not"**.
"Lest" is a conjunction that means **"for fear that"** or **"to avoid the risk of"**. It already carries a **negative meaning**, so adding **"not"** after it creates a **double negative**, which is grammatically incorrect.
Correct usage:
"lest you should get lost" (not "lest you should not get lost")
Correct sentence:
"Hold my hand lest you should get lost in the huge crowd at the fair."
option (a): get lost in the huge – correct
option (b): lest you should not – incorrect (double negative)
option (c): crowd at the fair – correct
option (d): Hold my hand – correct
Answer: option (b) (lest you should not).

Q.246 Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
Rohit Sharma's century was very acclaimed in the media.

(a) very acclaimed
(b) Rohit Sharma's century
(c) No error
(d) in the media.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) very acclaimed
Solution:
The segment **"very acclaimed"** contains a grammatical error.
- The adjective **"acclaimed"** is a **non-gradable adjective**, meaning it already conveys a strong meaning (i.e., highly praised), so it should not be modified by "very".
- Instead of "very acclaimed", use **"widely acclaimed"**, **"highly acclaimed"**, or simply "acclaimed".

Correct sentence:
"Rohit Sharma's century was widely acclaimed in the media."

Q.247 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
A war was waging all around and the whole village was at panic.

(a) A war was waging
(b) was at panic
(c) all around and
(d) the whole village

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) was at panic
- The correct expression is **"in panic"**, not **"at panic"**.
- So, the corrected sentence should be:
  "A war was waging all around and the whole village was in panic."

Thus, the error lies in **option (b): "was at panic"**.

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Q.248 Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them contains a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error.
You can take a horse to the water but you cannot make it to drink.

(a) to the water
(b) You can take a horse
(c) but you cannot
(d) make it to drink.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) make it to drink.
Solution:
The error is in the segment **"make it to drink."**
The correct structure is: **"make someone do something"**, **not** "make someone **to** do something".
So, **"make it drink"** is the grammatically correct form.
Correct sentence: **"You can take a horse to the water but you cannot make it drink."**
option (a): to the water – correct
option (b): You can take a horse – correct
option (c): but you cannot – correct
option (d): make it to drink. – incorrect (should be "make it drink")
Answer: option (d) (make it to drink.).

Q.249 Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
Your mother prepares delicious food, did she?

(a) prepares delicious food
(b) did she?
(c) No error
(d) Your mother

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) did she?
Solution:
The sentence is: **"Your mother prepares delicious food, did she?"**
This contains a **question tag**, which must match the **tense** and **polarity** (positive/negative) of the main clause.
- The main clause is: **"Your mother prepares delicious food"** → present simple tense, **positive**
- So the question tag must be: **"doesn't she?"** (present simple, negative form)

The given tag **"did she?"** is incorrect — it is in the **past tense** and doesn't match the main clause.
Correct sentence:
"Your mother prepares delicious food, doesn't she?"
Answer: option (b) (did she?).

Q.250 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The two buses moving side by side gave the illusion of been stationary.

(a) moving side by side
(b) of been stationary
(c) The two buses
(d) gave the illusion

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) of been stationary
Solution:
The error is in the segment **"of been stationary"**. The word **"been"** is incorrect here because after the preposition **"of"**, a **gerund (verb+ing)** should be used. The correct form is **"of being stationary"**, where **"being"** is the gerund form of **"be"**.
"The two buses" is grammatically correct as the subject of the sentence.
"moving side by side" is a correct participial phrase describing the buses.
"gave the illusion" is also correct in both tense and structure.
Therefore, the corrected sentence should be: **"The two buses moving side by side gave the illusion of being stationary."**
Answer: of been stationary

Q.251 Select the most appropriate option that rectifies the error(s) in the following sentence.
One must do his/her duty proparly.

(a) One must do once duty proparly.
(b) One must do one's duty properly.
(c) One must do ones duty properly.
(d) One must do one's duti proprly.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) One must do one's duty properly.
Solution:
Let's correct the errors in the original sentence:
"One must do his/her duty proparly."
1. The pronoun **"one"** must be followed by the **possessive form "one's"** for consistency and correctness.
2. The word **"proparly"** is a **misspelling** of **"properly"**.

Now review the options:
- **option (a):** "once" (wrong word) and "proparly" (spelling error) –
- **option (b):** "one's duty properly" – all correct –
- **option (c):** "ones" (missing apostrophe) and "properly" –
- **option (d):** "duti" and "proprly" – both misspelled –

Answer: option (b) (One must do one's duty properly.).

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Q.252 Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
I will definitely accept the responsibility while the time comes.

(a) the responsibility
(b) I will definitely accept
(c) while the time comes.
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) while the time comes.
Solution:
The error lies in the segment **"while the time comes."**
Explanation:
- The phrase **"while the time comes"** is grammatically incorrect.
- The correct expression is **"when the time comes."**
  - **"When"** refers to a specific point in time, which fits here.
  - **"While"** refers to a duration of time, which is not appropriate in this context.

Correct sentence:
"I will definitely accept the responsibility when the time comes."
option (a): the responsibility – correct
option (b): I will definitely accept – correct
option (c): while the time comes. – incorrect phrase
option (d): No error – incorrect
Answer: option (c) (while the time comes.).

Q.253 Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
The food was not as delicious as we had expected.

(a) No error
(b) we had expected
(c) as delicious as
(d) The food was not

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No error
Solution:
The sentence **"The food was not as delicious as we had expected."** is grammatically correct. It uses the structure **"not as...as"** properly to compare the actual quality of the food with the expectation.
"The food was not" is the correct beginning for a negative statement.
"as delicious as" is the correct comparative structure used for equal comparison.
"we had expected" is correctly in the past perfect tense, suitable when comparing a past expectation with a past event.
Since all segments are correct, there is **no grammatical error** in the sentence.

Q.254 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
My sister and me have a keen interest in learning classical music.

(a) have a keen interest
(b) My sister and me
(c) in learning
(d) classical music

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) My sister and me
Answer: (b) My sister and me
- The subject of the sentence is **"My sister and I"**, not **"me"**.
- "I" is the correct **subjective pronoun** to be used as part of the subject of the sentence.
- "Me" is an **object pronoun**, used when the person is receiving the action.

Correct sentence:
"My sister and I have a keen interest in learning classical music."

Q.255 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
The innocent clerk was accused with misappropriating funds of the company.

(a) The innocent clerk
(b) of the company
(c) was accused with
(d) misappropriating funds

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) was accused with
Solution:
The error lies in the segment **"was accused with"**. The verb **"accuse"** is always followed by the preposition **"of"**, not "with". So, the correct phrase is **"was accused of"**, meaning someone was charged with wrongdoing.
"The innocent clerk" is correct as it properly introduces the subject with an adjective and noun.
"misappropriating funds" is correct because the gerund "misappropriating" correctly follows the preposition and indicates the act of misuse.
"of the company" is also correct as it shows possession and identifies whose funds were misappropriated.
Hence, only the prepositional usage in "was accused with" is incorrect. The corrected sentence is: *The innocent clerk was accused of misappropriating funds of the company.*

Q.256 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
She decided to marry him in spite his habit of spending recklessly.

(a) of spending recklessly
(b) in spite his habit
(c) to marry him
(d) She decided

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) in spite his habit
Solution:
The segment **"in spite his habit"** contains a grammatical error.
Correct usage is: **"in spite of his habit"**
- The phrase "**in spite**" must always be followed by "**of**" when introducing a noun or noun phrase.
- So the correct sentence should be:
  "She decided to marry him in spite of his habit of spending recklessly."

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Q.257 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
None than you deserve credit for the success of this project.

(a) of this project **(b)** None than you
(c) deserve credit **(d)** for the success

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) None than you
The segment with the grammatical error is:
"None than you"
The correct comparative structure should be:
"None other than you" or simply **"No one but you"**
The phrase **"None than you"** is grammatically incorrect and incomplete. The word **"than"** is used for comparisons, so a comparative form (like "better than", "more than", "other than") is needed.
Correct sentence:
"None other than you deserve credit for the success of this project."
Correct Option:
(b) None than you

Q.258 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Let us work out the details of our endeavour, shouldn't we?

(a) shouldn't we **(b)** the details of
(c) our endeavour **(d)** Let us work out

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) shouldn't we
Solution:
The error is in the segment **"shouldn't we"**.
When a sentence starts with **"Let us"**, the appropriate **question tag** is **"shall we?"**, not "shouldn't we?".
Correct sentence:
"Let us work out the details of our endeavour, shall we?"
option (a): shouldn't we – incorrect tag
option (b): the details of – correct
option (c): our endeavour – correct
option (d): Let us work out – correct
Answer: option (a) (shouldn't we).

Q.259 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
Everything happened such quickly that I felt dazed.

(a) Everything happened **(b)** such quickly that
(c) I felt dazed **(d)** No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) such quickly that
- The phrase **"such quickly"** is grammatically incorrect.
- The correct form should be **"so quickly"** because:
  - Use **"so"** before **adverbs and adjectives** (e.g., **so quickly**, **so fast**, **so beautiful**).
  - Use **"such"** before **noun phrases** (e.g., **such a mess**, **such a beautiful moment**).

Correct sentence:
"Everything happened so quickly that I felt dazed."
Hence, the error is in **option (b)**.

Q.260 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Mona took a little time to thought before she gave her consent to the proposal.

(a) before she gave her consent
(b) to the proposal
(c) Mona took a little
(d) time for thought

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) time for thought
Solution
Erroneous segment: "time to thought"
What's wrong and why:
- The verb **"took"** in the phrase "took a little time to thought" is correctly indicating the act of spending time. However, the infinitive **"to thought"** is ungrammatical because one does not "time to think" in this construction.
- In English, when referring to allowing oneself a moment for consideration, the idiomatic phrase is **"time for thought"**. Here, **"for"** functions as a preposition introducing the noun **"thought"**, meaning reflection or consideration.

Correct usage:
- "**Time for thought"** – indicates a period set aside for thinking or reflecting.
- Alternatively, one could say **"took a little time to think,"** using the verb "think" rather than the noun "thought."

Correct sentence:
Mona took a little **time for thought** before she gave her consent to the proposal.

Q.261 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
It is time someone takes concrete steps to alleviate the problem of unemployment in the country.

(a) It is time someone takes
(b) concrete steps to alleviate
(c) the problem of unemployment
(d) in the country

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) It is time someone takes
Solution:
The error is in the segment **"It is time someone takes"**.
After the phrase **"It is time"**, the verb should be in the **past tense**, even though the action refers to the present or future. This is a grammatical structure used to express **urgency or recommendation**.
So, instead of **"takes"**, it should be **"took"**.
Correct sentence:
"It is time someone took concrete steps to alleviate the problem of unemployment in the country."
option (a): It is time someone takes – incorrect tense (should be "took")
option (b): concrete steps to alleviate – correct
option (c): the problem of unemployment – correct
option (d): in the country – correct
Answer: option (a) (It is time someone takes).

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Q.262 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
Two elderly gentlemen told the rather improbable story to mislead the police personnel.

(a) story to mislead
(b) Two elderly gentlemen
(c) told the rather improbable
(d) the police personnel

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) story to mislead
Solution:
The error lies in the segment **"story to mislead"**.
In this sentence, **"to mislead"** suggests a purpose, but the sentence requires a **participle** or **adjective phrase** to describe the story's nature or intention. The correct form would be: **"a story meant to mislead"** or **"a misleading story"**.
However, since the rest of the sentence uses "told the rather improbable story," it is best to keep the sentence structure and just correct the verb form.
"story to mislead" is awkward and incomplete as it doesn't clearly express that the **story was misleading** in intent or nature.
Corrected version: **"told the rather improbable story meant to mislead the police personnel."**
Answer: option (a) (story to mislead).

Q.263 Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
Are you yet afraid of going out in the dark?

(a) afraid of going out
(b) in the dark
(c) Are you yet
(d) no error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Are you yet
Solution:
The error lies in the segment **"Are you yet"**. The correct usage in standard English would be **"Are you still"** instead of "yet" when used in affirmative/interrogative sentences like this.
- **Incorrect:** Are you yet afraid of going out in the dark?
- **Correct:** Are you still afraid of going out in the dark?

Explanation of other options:
- **"afraid of going out"** – grammatically correct.
- **"in the dark"** – correctly used prepositional phrase.
- **"no error"** – incorrect, as there is an error in the sentence.

Answer: option (c) (Are you yet)

Q.264 Identify the segment in the sentence which contains a grammatical error.
She use to learn fabric painting when she was in middle school.

(a) when she was
(b) in middle school
(c) She use to
(d) learn fabric painting

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She use to
Solution:
The error is in the segment **"She use to"**.
The correct expression is **"used to"** when talking about a past habit or repeated action in the past.
So, the correct sentence is:
"She used to learn fabric painting when she was in middle school."
option (a): when she was – correct
option (b): in middle school – correct
option (c): She use to – incorrect (should be **used to**)
option (d): learn fabric painting – correct
Answer: option (c) (She use to).

Q.265 Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
Specialists say that this method speeds up language learning tremendously.

(a) language learning tremendously.
(b) No error
(c) this method speeds up
(d) Specialists say that

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) No error
Solution:
The sentence **"Specialists say that this method speeds up language learning tremendously."** is grammatically correct.
- **"Specialists say that"** is a valid reporting structure.
- **"this method speeds up"** is a correct present tense verb phrase.
- **"language learning tremendously"** correctly uses the adverb **"tremendously"** to modify the verb phrase.

There is **no grammatical error** in any part of the sentence.
Answer: option (b) (No error).

Q.266 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
He entered the room / such quietly that / none of us / noticed him.

(a) none of us
(b) such quietly that
(c) noticed him
(d) He entered the room

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) such quietly that
- The correct construction is **"so quietly that"**, not "such quietly that."
- "So" modifies the adverb "quietly" appropriately in a degree clause.

Thus, the error lies in the segment **"such quietly that."**

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Q.267 Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them contains a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error.
The captain along with all the sailors were warmly welcomed back home by the town people.

(a) The captain
(b) by the town people.
(c) along with all the sailors were
(d) warmly welcomed back home

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) along with all the sailors were
Solution:
The error is in the segment **"along with all the sailors were"**. When the subject is joined by **"along with"**, **"together with"**, or **"as well as"**, the verb agrees with the **main subject**, not the phrase that follows. Here, the main subject is **"The captain"**, which is **singular**, so the verb should be **"was"** instead of **"were"**.
"The captain" is correct as the singular subject.
"warmly welcomed back home" is correct as the passive voice structure.
"by the town people." is correct as the agent in passive voice.
Correct sentence: **"The captain along with all the sailors was warmly welcomed back home by the town people."**
Answer: along with all the sailors were

Q.268 Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain a grammatical error. Select the option that has the error. If there is no error, select 'No error'.
We cannot postpone discussion on this issue although it is urgent.

(a) No error
(b) We cannot postpone
(c) although it is urgent.
(d) discussion on this issue

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) although it is urgent.
Solution:
option (c): "although it is urgent." contains a **logical and grammatical error** in the context of the sentence.
The sentence says:
"We cannot postpone discussion on this issue although it is urgent."
This creates confusion because:

- **"Although"** is used to show contrast.
- Here, the sentence implies: *"We are not postponing it, even though it is urgent."*
- That is **illogical**, because urgency is usually a **reason to not postpone**, not to do the opposite.

So, the correct connector should be **"because"** instead of **"although"**, to clearly express the intended meaning:
"We cannot postpone discussion on this issue because it is urgent."
Thus, **option (c) is incorrect due to inappropriate use of "although."**

Q.269 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
It will take us five and a half hours to reach Jaipur, is it?

(a) to reach Jaipur
(b) five and a half hours
(c) is it?
(d) It will take us

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) is it?
Solution:

- The sentence:
  "It will take us five and a half hours to reach Jaipur, is it?"
- The error is in: **"is it?"**
- Explanation:
  - This is a **question tag** attached to a statement.
  - The main statement is in **future tense**: *"It will take us..."*
  - The correct **question tag** for "It will..." is **"won't it?"**
    - Rule: If the main clause is affirmative with "will," the tag should be **negative**: *"won't it?"*
- Correct sentence:
  "It will take us five and a half hours to reach Jaipur, won't it?"
- **Why the other parts are correct:**
  - **"It will take us"**, **"five and a half hours"**, and **"to reach Jaipur"** – all grammatically correct.

Part with the error:
"is it?"

Q.270 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Professor Gupta is an authority / on income tax because / he cannot exercise / any authority over his family.

(a) on income tax because
(b) he cannot exercise
(c) any authority over his family
(d) Professor Gupta is an authority

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) on income tax because
The sentence is **logically inconsistent** and **grammatically confusing** due to the connector **"because"** used after "authority on income tax."

- The first part says: **"Professor Gupta is an authority on income tax"** – meaning he is an expert in the subject.
- But then it says **"because he cannot exercise any authority over his family"** – which is illogical. Not being able to control one's family has **no causal link** to being an authority on income tax.

So, the grammatical structure itself is correct, but **the use of "because" makes the sentence illogical**, and that's where the error lies.
Better version:
"Professor Gupta is an authority on income tax, although he cannot exercise any authority over his family."
This uses **"although"** to contrast two unrelated facts, which makes more logical and grammatical sense.

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Q.271 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
The police had lot evidence / against him to take him / into their custody.

(a) No error
(b) The police had lot evidence
(c) into their custody
(d) against him to take him

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The police had lot evidence
Solution:
- The sentence:
  "The police had lot evidence / against him to take him / into their custody."
- The error is in: **"The police had lot evidence"**
- Explanation:
  - The noun **"evidence"** is **uncountable**, so it requires the determiner **"a lot of"** or **"plenty of"** — not just **"lot"**.
  - The correct phrase should be: **"a lot of evidence"**.
- Corrected part:
  "The police had a lot of evidence..."
- **Why the other parts are correct:**
  - **"against him to take him"** – grammatically fine in context.
  - **"into their custody"** – correct phrase and preposition.
  - **"No error"** – incorrect because there is indeed an error.

Corrected sentence:
"The police had a lot of evidence against him to take him into their custody."

Q.272 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
Nobody in the office is satisfied with your work.

(a) is satisfied
(b) Nobody in the office
(c) with your work
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) No error
- **"Nobody in the office"** is a singular subject, so the verb **"is satisfied"** is correct.
- **"with your work"** is a correct prepositional phrase.
- The sentence is **grammatically correct** and does not contain any errors.

Therefore, the correct answer is: No error.

Q.273 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
The government has declared a public holiday at Monday.

(a) holiday at Monday
(b) No error
(c) declared a public
(d) The government has

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) holiday at Monday
The preposition **"at"** is incorrect here.
We use **"on"** with days of the week.
Correct sentence:
*The government has declared a public holiday **on** Monday.*
- "at Monday"
- "on Monday"

Q.274 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
My flight is scheduled / to take off / on 6:30 p.m.

(a) My flight is scheduled
(b) No error
(c) on 6:30 p.m.
(d) to take off

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) on 6:30 p.m.
- The correct preposition to use with specific clock times is **"at"**, not "on."
- Therefore, it should be: **"at 6:30 p.m."**, not **"on 6:30 p.m."**

Correct sentence:
My flight is scheduled to take off at 6:30 p.m.

Q.275 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
The Pench Tiger Reserve is / one of India's premier tiger reserve / and the first to span two states.

(a) and the first to span two states
(b) one of India's premier tiger reserve
(c) The Pench Tiger Reserve is
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) one of India's premier tiger reserve
Explanation:
The error lies in the phrase **"one of India's premier tiger reserve."**
When we use **"one of"**, it must be followed by a **plural noun**, because we are referring to **one among many**.
- "tiger reserve" (singular) is incorrect
- The correct phrase should be **"tiger reserves"** (plural)

Correct sentence:
The Pench Tiger Reserve is one of India's premier tiger reserves and the first to span two states.

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Q.276 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
This incredible discovery / unfolding the history / of a time that existed / long before human existence.

(a) long before human existence
(b) This incredible discovery
(c) of a time that existed
(d) unfolding the history

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) unfolding the history

- The main subject is **"This incredible discovery"**, which needs a proper verb to complete the sentence.
- **"Unfolding the history"** is a present participle phrase, but here we need a **finite verb** (like "unfolds" or "has unfolded") to form a grammatically complete sentence.

Corrected version:
"This incredible discovery unfolds the history of a time that existed long before human existence."
Hence, the error is in **segment 4**.

Q.277 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The 2023 report reveals that / children in India continue / to struggle on basic reading and arithmetic skills / well into their teenage years.

(a) to struggle on basic reading and arithmetic skills
(b) well into their teenage years
(c) children in India continue
(d) The 2023 report reveals that

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) to struggle on basic reading and arithmetic skills

Solution:

- The sentence:
  "The 2023 report reveals that / children in India continue / to struggle on basic reading and arithmetic skills / well into their teenage years."
- Let's focus on **Segment 1**:
  "to struggle on basic reading and arithmetic skills"
- The **verb "struggle"** is typically followed by the **preposition "with"**, not "on", when referring to difficulties with tasks or skills.
- Correct usage:
  "to struggle with basic reading and arithmetic skills"

Corrected sentence:
"The 2023 report reveals that children in India continue to struggle with basic reading and arithmetic skills well into their teenage years."
Segment with the error: Segment 1: "to struggle on basic reading and arithmetic skills"

Q.278 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
The stain on your shirt can be removed from lime juice.

(a) The stain
(b) can be removed
(c) on your shirt
(d) from lime juice

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) from lime juice

- The correct preposition in this context should be **"with"** instead of **"from"**.
- The sentence should read:
  "The stain on your shirt can be removed with lime juice."

Correction:

- **Incorrect:** removed **from** lime juice
- **Correct:** removed **with** lime juice

"Removed with" indicates the **agent/tool** used to remove something, which is appropriate here.

Q.279 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
Whether you are seeking solitude or adventure, India's lesser-known coastal destinations are offering something for everyone.

(a) Whether you are seeking
(b) India's lesser-known coastal destinations
(c) solitude or adventure,
(d) are offering something for everyone

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) are offering something for everyone

- The subject **"India's lesser-known coastal destinations"** is **third person plural**, so it requires correct verb agreement.
- However, the verb phrase **"are offering"** is in the **present continuous tense**, which implies a current ongoing action.
- But in formal writing and general statements of fact (like this one), we prefer the **simple present tense**.

Correct sentence:
Whether you are seeking solitude or adventure, India's lesser-known coastal destinations offer something for everyone.
So, the verb **"are offering"** should be replaced with **"offer"**.

Q.280 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
My mother give me fresh carrot juice every evening.

(a) My mother give me
(b) every evening
(c) No error
(d) fresh carrot juice

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) My mother give me

- The subject **"My mother"** is **singular**, so the verb must also be singular.
- **"Give"** is plural; the correct singular form is **"gives."**

Correct sentence:
My mother gives me fresh carrot juice every evening.

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Q.281 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
Apart with eco-tourism activities and jungle safaris, the Pench Tiger Reserve is gearing up to introduce stargazing experiences for tourists.

(a) Apart with eco-tourism activities and jungle safaris
(b) stargazing experiences for tourists
(c) to introduce
(d) the Pench Tiger Reserve is gearing up

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Apart with eco-tourism activities and jungle safaris

The phrase **"Apart with"** is grammatically incorrect. The correct phrase is:

- **"Apart from"** – which means "in addition to" or "besides".

So, the correct sentence should be:
"Apart from eco-tourism activities and jungle safaris, the Pench Tiger Reserve is gearing up to introduce stargazing experiences for tourists."
Correct Usage:

- Apart with eco-tourism...
- Apart from eco-tourism...

Hence, **option (a)** contains the grammatical error.

Q.282 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
The carpenter work / on that table / from morning to evening.

(a) No error
(b) from morning to evening
(c) The carpenter work
(d) on that table

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The carpenter work
Solution:

- The sentence:
  "The carpenter work / on that table / from morning to evening."
- The error is in: **"The carpenter work"**
- Explanation:
  - The subject **"The carpenter"** is **singular**.
  - The verb should be in the **singular form** to match, i.e., **"works"** instead of **"work"**.
  - Correct verb: **"The carpenter works..."**
- **Why the other parts are correct:**
  - **"on that table"** – grammatically correct prepositional phrase.
  - **"from morning to evening"** – correctly expresses a time duration.
  - **"No error"** – incorrect because there's a verb agreement error.

Corrected sentence:
"The carpenter works on that table from morning to evening."

Q.283 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The Calcutta High Court ordered / the formation of a special investigation team / probing the attack on / Enforcement Directorate officials in West Bengal.

(a) Enforcement Directorate officials in West Bengal
(b) probing the attack on
(c) the formation of a special investigation team
(d) The Calcutta High Court ordered

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) probing the attack on
Solution:
Sentence:
"The Calcutta High Court ordered / the formation of a special investigation team / probing the attack on / Enforcement Directorate officials in West Bengal."
Segment with error:

- **"probing the attack on"**
- The phrase **"probing the attack on"** is incorrectly placed.
- A **non-finite clause** like *"probing the attack on..."* must clearly refer back to the noun it modifies.
- In this case, it should be **"to probe the attack on"** instead of **"probing the attack on"** to correctly follow **"ordered the formation of..."**

Correct sentence:
"The Calcutta High Court ordered the formation of a special investigation team to probe the attack on Enforcement Directorate officials in West Bengal."
Correct answer: probing the attack on (Option (b)

Q.284 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
Those people which do not get sufficient sleep at night suffer from a disease called insomnia.

(a) called insomnia
(b) sufficient sleep at night
(c) suffer from a disease
(d) Those people which do not get

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Those people which do not get
Solution:
Sentence:
"Those people which do not get sufficient sleep at night suffer from a disease called insomnia."
Error Identification:

- The phrase **"Those people which..."** is **incorrect**.
- **"Which"** is used for **things**, not for **people**.
- The correct **relative pronoun** for people is **"who"**.

Correct phrase:
"Those people who do not get..."
Corrected sentence:
"Those people who do not get sufficient sleep at night suffer from a disease called insomnia."
Part containing the error: Those people which do not get (Option (d)

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Q.285 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
We have not received some information from our coast guards yet.

(a) We have not received
(b) our coast guards yet
(c) No error
(d) some information from

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) some information from

Solution:

- The sentence is:
  "We have not received some information from our coast guards yet."
- The error lies in the phrase: **"some information from"**
- Explanation:
  - When used in **negative sentences**, we typically use **"any"** instead of **"some"**.
  - "Some" is generally used in **affirmative sentences**, while **"any"** fits naturally with **negatives** and **questions**.
  - Therefore, the correct phrase should be: **"We have not received any information..."**
- **Why the other options are correct:**
  - **"We have not received"** – grammatically correct.
  - **"our coast guards yet"** – correctly placed and used.
  - **"No error"** – incorrect because an error exists in the sentence.

Corrected sentence:
"We have not received any information from our coast guards yet."

Q.286 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
Human activity often / has a negatively effect / on the ecosystem of wetlands.

(a) on the ecosystem of wetlands
(b) has a negatively effect
(c) No error
(d) Human activity often

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has a negatively effect

The error is in the segment: **"has a negatively effect"**.

- The word **"negatively"** is an **adverb**, but in this context, it is modifying a **noun** ("effect").
- To correctly modify a noun, we need an **adjective**, not an adverb.
- So, the correct phrase should be: **"a negative effect"** (where "negative" is an adjective).

Correct Sentence:
Human activity often has a negative effect on the ecosystem of wetlands.

Q.287 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
The Survey showed that across most tasks that test the ability to apply basic numeracy and reading skills, Primary school boys did best than girls.

(a) that test the ability to apply
(b) Primary school boys did best than girls
(c) The Survey showed that across most tasks
(d) basic numeracy and reading skills

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Primary school boys did best than girls

Solution:

- The sentence:
  "The Survey showed that across most tasks that test the ability to apply basic numeracy and reading skills, Primary school boys did best than girls."
- The error is in: **"Primary school boys did best than girls"**
- Explanation:
  - The word **"best"** is the **superlative** form of "good" and is used when comparing **more than two**.
  - When comparing **two groups** (boys and girls), we should use the **comparative** form **"better"** along with **"than"**.
  - So the correct phrase should be: **"Primary school boys did better than girls."**
- **Why the other options are correct:**
  - **"that test the ability to apply"** – grammatically correct.
  - **"The Survey showed that across most tasks"** – correctly structured.
  - **"basic numeracy and reading skills"** – no error in parallel structure.

Corrected sentence:
"The Survey showed that across most tasks that test the ability to apply basic numeracy and reading skills, Primary school boys did better than girls."

Q.288 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
You may discussing / your problem / in tomorrow's meeting.

(a) your problem
(b) You may discussing
(c) in tomorrow's meeting
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) You may discussing

The error in the sentence lies in the use of the verb form after the modal verb "may". In English grammar, modal verbs like "may", "can", "should", "will", etc., are always followed by the **base form of the main verb** (also called the infinitive without "to"). In the given sentence, the word "discussing" is the **present participle** form of the verb "discuss", which is incorrect after a modal verb.

Hence, instead of **"You may discussing"**, the correct form should be **"You may discuss"**.

Therefore, the grammatically correct sentence is:
"You may discuss your problem in tomorrow's meeting."

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Q.289 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
There were frequent landslides in the Jammu-Srinagar Highway during the monsoons.

(a) during the monsoons
(b) No error
(c) There were frequent landslides
(d) in the Jammu-Srinagar Highway

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) in the Jammu-Srinagar Highway
The error lies in the phrase **"in the Jammu-Srinagar Highway"**. The correct preposition to use with the word **"highway"** is **"on"**, not "in."

- We say: **on the road**, **on the highway**, etc., because movement or events occur **on the surface** of such pathways.
- Therefore, it should be: **"on the Jammu-Srinagar Highway."**

Correct sentence:
*There were frequent landslides **on** the Jammu-Srinagar Highway during the monsoons.*

Q.290 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
India's coastline stretches / for over 7,500 kilometres, / to offer a plethora of / must visit beaches and coastal destinations.

(a) must visit beaches and coastal destinations.
(b) for over 7,500 kilometres,
(c) to offer a plethora of
(d) India's coastline stretches

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) to offer a plethora of
The error lies in the segment: **"to offer a plethora of"**.

- The verb **"stretches"** does not logically or grammatically connect with **"to offer"** in this context.
- The phrase should be **"and offers a plethora of"** instead of **"to offer a plethora of"** for proper parallel structure and meaning.

Correct sentence:
India's coastline stretches for over 7,500 kilometres and offers a plethora of must-visit beaches and coastal destinations.

Q.291 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
Kavya finishes / her homework / before having dinner.

(a) No error
(b) her homework
(c) Kavya finishes
(d) before having dinner

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No error
he sentence is:
"Kavya finishes / her homework / before having dinner."
Let's break it down:

Explanation (contd.)

- **"Kavya finishes"** – This is **present simple tense**, appropriate if we are talking about a habitual action.
- **"her homework"** – This is grammatically correct.
- **"before having dinner"** – This phrase is fine and commonly used in everyday English.
- **Tense consistency** – Present simple ("finishes") and the gerund ("having") work well together to express routine actions.

There is **no grammatical error** in the sentence.

Q.292 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
Her parents did not allowed her to learn western music.

(a) to learn western music
(b) did not allowed her
(c) Her parents
(d) No error

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) did not allowed her
The error lies in the use of the **verb form** after the **auxiliary 'did'**.

- After **"did"**, the **base form** of the verb should be used.
- The sentence says: **"did not allowed"** – here, **"allowed"** is the **past form**, which is incorrect.
- The correct structure is: **"did not allow"** (base form after 'did').

Let's check the parts:

- **Part 1: "Her parents"** – correct subject.
- **Part 2: "did not allowed her"** – **incorrect**; should be **"did not allow her"**.
- **Part 3: "to learn western music"** – grammatically correct.

Correct sentence: *Her parents did not allow her to learn western music.*

Q.293 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
The teacher asked the class / to be quiet while she / explained the new assignment, / but nobody is listening.

(a) but nobody is listening
(b) to be quiet while she
(c) The teacher asked the class
(d) explained the new assignment

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) but nobody is listening

- The sentence starts in the **past tense**: *"The teacher asked..."*
- Therefore, the rest of the sentence should maintain the same tense for consistency.
- However, the segment **"but nobody is listening"** is in the **present continuous tense**, which is incorrect in this past context.

🔁 **Corrected version:**
"...but nobody was listening."
Thus, the segment **"but nobody is listening"** contains the grammatical error.

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Q.294 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
I was with the impression that I had returned the books that I had borrowed from you.

(a) I was with the impression
(b) that I had returned
(c) the books that I had
(d) borrowed from you

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I was with the impression

- The phrase **"I was with the impression"** is **grammatically incorrect**.
- The correct expression is **"I was under the impression"**.
  - Example: *I was under the impression that I had returned the books.*

Correct Sentence:
I was under the impression that I had returned the books that I had borrowed from you.

Q.295 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
The ancient trees of this forest did not propagate in the release of seeds.

(a) The ancient trees of
(b) this forest did not
(c) propagate in
(d) the release of seeds

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) propagate in

The sentence given is:
"The ancient trees of this forest did not propagate in the release of seeds."
Let's examine the phrase **"propagate in the release of seeds."**

- The verb **"propagate"** means **to reproduce or spread (especially for plants or animals)**.
- It is **not used with the preposition "in"**.
- The correct structure is: **"propagate by/through seed dispersal"** or **"propagate by releasing seeds"**.

So, the error is in **option (c): "propagate in"**, because the preposition **"in"** is incorrect here.
The corrected version could be:

- "did not propagate **through** the release of seeds"
- or "did not propagate **by** releasing seeds."

Q.296 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
Traditional practices are ways of knowing, learning and to generate a distinct experience of the world around us.

(a) Traditional practices are
(b) of the world around us
(c) and to generate a distinct experience
(d) ways of knowing, learning

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) and to generate a distinct experience

The phrase in option **3: "and to generate a distinct experience"** contains a grammatical inconsistency in form.
Let's break it down:

- The structure starts with: **"ways of knowing, learning..."**

Explanation (contd.)

- Both **"knowing"** and **"learning"** are **gerunds** (verb+ing acting as nouns).
- To maintain **parallel structure**, the third item in the list should **also** be in gerund form: **"generating"**, not **"to generate"**.

Correct version:
"ways of knowing, learning, and generating a distinct experience..."
Thus, **option (c)** contains the error due to incorrect verb form.

Q.297 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
People under eighteen / do not have / the right to vote, / don't they?

(a) do not have
(b) the right to vote
(c) People under eighteen
(d) don't they?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) don't they?

The correct sentence should be:
"People under eighteen do not have the right to vote, *do they*?"
Reason:

- The **tag question** must match the **main clause** in **tense** and **polarity** (positive/negative).
- Since the main sentence is **negative** ("do not have"), the **question tag** must be **positive** → "do they?" not "don't they?"

Hence, **Segment 4: "don't they?"** contains the grammatical error.

Q.298 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
We had coffee to the university café last evening.

(a) No error
(b) last evening
(c) to the university café
(d) We had coffee

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) to the university café

The sentence is:
"We had coffee to the university café last evening."
Let's examine the phrase "**to the university café**".

- The preposition **"to"** is **incorrect** here.
- When referring to a place where an activity occurs (like drinking coffee), we use **"at"** or **"in"** depending on context.

The correct version should be:
"We had coffee at the university café last evening."
Let's check the other parts:

- **"We had coffee"** – Correct.
- **"last evening"** – Correct.

Therefore, the error is in part 3: "to the university café"
It should be **"at the university café"**.

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Q.299 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Akasa Air planning to acquire / 150 Boeing 737 planes in order to / expand the airline's reach in / both domestic and international operations.

(a) 150 Boeing 737 planes in order to
(b) Akasa Air planning to acquire
(c) both domestic and international operations
(d) expand the airline's reach in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Akasa Air planning to acquire
The error lies in the segment: **"Akasa Air planning to acquire"**.
- This part is **missing an auxiliary verb**. To form the correct present continuous or future intention structure, it should be:
  - **"Akasa Air is planning to acquire"** (present continuous)
  - OR **"Akasa Air plans to acquire"** (simple present for general future plan)

Hence, the sentence should begin as:
"Akasa Air is planning to acquire..."
Other segments are grammatically correct:
- "150 Boeing 737 planes in order to" – Correct phrase indicating purpose.
- "expand the airline's reach in" – Grammatically fine.
- "both domestic and international operations." – Correct parallel construction.

Q.300 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
A ground-breaking discovery has been made / in a deserting quarry near New York, / where researchers have unearthed / the planet's most ancient forest.

(a) the planet's most ancient forest.
(b) where researchers have unearthed
(c) in a deserting quarry near New York,
(d) A ground-breaking discovery has been made

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) in a deserting quarry near New York,
Segment with error: in a deserting quarry near New York
- The word **"deserting"** is **incorrect** in this context.
- **"Deserting"** is the present participle of the verb **"to desert"**, which means **to abandon**, and is not appropriate for describing a location.
- The correct adjective should be **"deserted"** (meaning abandoned) or **"desert-like"** if referring to a dry area.

Corrected sentence:
"A ground-breaking discovery has been made in a deserted quarry near New York, where researchers have unearthed the planet's most ancient forest."
The rest of the sentence is grammatically correct.

Q.301 The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer.
She use to eat / a lot of chocolates / when she was a child.

(a) No error
(b) She use to eat
(c) when she was a child
(d) a lot of chocolates

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She use to eat
The original sentence part: **"She use to eat"** is **grammatically incorrect**.
- The correct form is **"used to"**, not **"use to"**, when talking about past habits.
- **"Used to"** is a fixed expression used to indicate an action that was regularly done in the past but no longer happens.

Correct sentence:
"She used to eat a lot of chocolates when she was a child."

Q.302 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
It is estimating that this forest once covered an area of approximately 400 km.

(a) approximately 400 km
(b) It is estimating that
(c) this forest once
(d) covered an area of

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) It is estimating that
The error lies in the segment: **"It is estimating that"**.
- The verb **"is estimating"** is in the **present continuous tense**, which is incorrect when the sentence talks about a past situation ("this forest once covered...").
- The correct passive structure should be: **"It is estimated that..."**

So, the correct sentence should be:
"It is estimated that this forest once covered an area of approximately 400 km."

Q.303 Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error.
The Board of Directors held a meeting sorting out the issue of the NPAs of the bank.

(a) the NPAs of the bank.
(b) The Board of Directors held
(c) the issue of
(d) a meeting sorting out

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) a meeting sorting out
The error lies in the phrase **"a meeting sorting out"**.
- The sentence structure requires a **relative clause** to properly connect the meeting and its purpose.
- The correct form should be: **"a meeting to sort out"** or **"a meeting that sorted out"**, rather than **"a meeting sorting out"**, which is grammatically awkward and unclear.

Correct sentence:
The Board of Directors held a meeting to sort out the issue of the NPAs of the bank.

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Q.304 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Most than half of / the 14-18 year old children / in rural India can't solve / a simple division problem.

(a) Most than half of
(b) the 14-18 year-old children
(c) a simple division problem
(d) in rural India can't solve

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Most than half of
The error is in the segment: **"Most than half of"**.

- The correct comparative phrase is **"More than half of"**, not "Most than".
- **"Most"** is a superlative used when comparing three or more things (e.g., *She is the most talented of all*), whereas **"More"** is the comparative form used when comparing two quantities (e.g., *More than half*).

So, the corrected sentence should be:
"More than half of the 14-18 year-old children in rural India can't solve a simple division problem."
Correct answer: 1

Q.305 The following sentence has been split into four segments. Identify the segment that contains a grammatical error.
Imagine taking a trip to Northern India / a century or so before the Common Era / using the recently discovering technology / of time travel.

(a) using the recently discovering technology
(b) Imagine taking a trip to Northern India
(c) of time travel
(d) a century or so before the Common Era

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) using the recently discovering technology
The sentence is:
Imagine taking a trip to Northern India / a century or so before the Common Era / using the recently discovering technology / of time travel.
Let's examine the segments:

1. **"Imagine taking a trip to Northern India"** – Correct. The verb usage is appropriate.
2. **"a century or so before the Common Era"** – Also correct. This is a time reference and grammatically fine.
3. **"using the recently discovering technology"** – **Incorrect.** The word **"discovering"** is the present participle (verb form), which is wrong here.
   - It should be **"discovered"**, as in **"recently discovered technology"**, which is a passive construction describing something that *has been found*.
4. **"of time travel"** – Correct. It correctly connects the object "technology" with its purpose.

So, the error lies in the **third segment**, due to the incorrect use of **"discovering"** instead of **"discovered."**

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8. Sentence Improvement

291 questions

Q.1 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
You need to take some guidance in Chemistry.

(a) need to taking
(b) No substitution required
(c) need take
(d) needs to take

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) No substitution required
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "You **need to take** some guidance" is correct — "need to + V1".
("need to take" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **need to taking / need take** – wrong forms; **needs to take** – "You" takes "need", not "needs".

Q.2 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
Four people were injured after a car suddenly came for a halt in outer Delhi.

(a) came to a halt
(b) No substitution required
(c) come to a halt
(d) came for the halt

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) came to a halt
Type: Sentence Improvement – Collocation
Rule: The fixed phrase is "**come to a halt**" = to stop. Past → "came to a halt".
("come to a halt" = रुक जाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution** – "came for a halt" is wrong; **come to a halt** – needs past "came"; **came for the halt** – wrong.

Q.3 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
Ariel was convinced that something fishy is going up behind his back.

(a) was going up
(b) No substitution required
(c) was going on
(d) goes on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) was going on
Type: Sentence Improvement – Phrasal Verb + Tense
Rule: "**go on**" = to happen; past continuous "**was going on**" fits "was convinced ... behind his back".
("go on" = घटित होना; past continuous "was going on"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **was going up / No substitution ('is going up') / goes on** – wrong phrasal/tense.

Q.4 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
The doctor bade me taking the medicine immediately after breakfast.

(a) bid me to taking
(b) bade me to take
(c) No substitution required
(d) bade me take

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) bade me to take
Type: Sentence Improvement – "bade + object + bare infinitive"
Rule: "bade" (past of *bid*) is followed by the **bare infinitive** (take), not "to take"/"taking".
("bade" के बाद bare infinitive (take)।)
Corrected sentence
"The doctor **bade me take** the medicine immediately after breakfast."

Q.5 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
She itself are responsible for this situation of hers.

(a) herself is
(b) herself are
(c) oneself is
(d) No substitution required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) herself is
Type: Sentence Improvement – Reflexive Pronoun + Agreement
Rule: For "She", the reflexive is "**herself**", and the singular verb is "**is**".
("She" के लिए reflexive "herself" + एकवचन "is"।)
Corrected sentence
"She **herself is** responsible for this situation of hers."
Why the others are wrong
• **herself are / oneself is** – wrong verb/pronoun; **No substitution** – "itself are" is wrong.

Q.6 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
While Avika was watering the plants, they start raining .

(a) they start raining
(b) No substitution required
(c) it started raining
(d) it start raining

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) it started raining
Type: Sentence Improvement – "it" for weather + Tense
Rule: For weather we use the impersonal "**it**", and the past tense "**started**" matches "was watering".
(मौसम के लिए "it"; भूतकाल "started"।)
Corrected sentence
"While Avika was watering the plants, **it started raining**."

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Q.7 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. This appears to be the handiwork of someone who to belong to a criminal gang.

(a) who belongs
(b) No substitution required
(c) who is belonging
(d) which belongs

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) who belongs
Type: Sentence Improvement – Relative Clause
Rule: "someone **who belongs** to a criminal gang" — "who" (for a person) + simple present "belongs" (a stative verb).
(व्यक्ति के लिए "who" + "belongs" (stative)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution ('who to belong')** – wrong; **who is belonging** – "belong" is stative; **which belongs** – "which" is for things.

Q.8 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. Hardly had we stepped out of the building then we get drenched.

(a) when we got
(b) that we are getting
(c) No substitution required
(d) than we got

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) when we got
Type: Sentence Improvement – "Hardly ... when"
Rule: The fixed pair is "**Hardly had + subject + V3 ... when ...**".
("Hardly had ... when ..." संरचना।)
Corrected sentence
"Hardly had we stepped out of the building **when we got** drenched."
Why the others are wrong
• **that we are getting / No substitution ('then we get') / than we got** – wrong pairing/tense.

Q.9 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. He couldn't believe it at first, so the most he thought about it, the more he decided it must be true.

(a) although the more
(b) No substitution required
(c) but a most
(d) but the more

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) but the more
Type: Sentence Improvement – "the more ... the more"
Rule: The correlative structure is "**the more ... the more**". Contrast with "**but**".
("the more ... the more" संरचना।)
Corrected sentence
"He couldn't believe it at first, **but the more** he thought about it, the more he decided it must be true."

Q.10 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. She was too startled at first saying something , but finally she blurted out the truth.

(a) say something
(b) to say anything
(c) No substitution required
(d) saying anything

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) to say anything
Type: Sentence Improvement – "too ... to"
Rule: "**too startled to + V1**" (so startled that she could not). Also use "anything" in a negative sense.
("too ... to" संरचना; negative में "anything"।)
Corrected sentence
"She was too startled at first **to say anything**, but finally she blurted out the truth."

Q.11 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. A team of biologists have been discovered four new species of horned frogs in the North Eastern region of India.

(a) No substitution required
(b) has discovered
(c) has been discovering
(d) has been discovered

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has discovered
Type: Sentence Improvement – Subject-Verb Agreement + Voice
Rule: "A team (of biologists)" is **singular**, and the team is the **doer** → active "**has discovered**".
(एकवचन "A team" + कर्ता → active "has discovered"।)
Corrected sentence
"A team of biologists **has discovered** four new species of horned frogs in North-East India."
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution ('have been discovered') / has been discovering / has been discovered** – wrong voice/form (the team discovered; it was not discovered).

Q.12 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. Our new accountant fall short in my expectations.

(a) falls short of
(b) falls short in
(c) No substitution required
(d) fall short on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) falls short of
Type: Sentence Improvement – Phrasal Verb
Rule: "**fall short of**" (someone's expectations) = to fail to reach. Singular subject → "falls".
("fall short of" = ... तक न पहुँच पाना।)
Corrected sentence
"Our new accountant **falls short of** my expectations."

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Q.13 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
Monika has learn French for a long time.

(a) No substitution required
(b) has been learning
(c) has learning
(d) has been learnt

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has been learning
Type: Sentence Improvement – Present Perfect Continuous
Rule: For an action continuing over time ("for a long time"), use "**has been + V-ing**".
(जारी क्रिया → has been + V-ing।)
Corrected sentence
"Monika **has been learning** French for a long time."
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution ('has learn') / has learning / has been learnt** – wrong forms.

Q.14 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
The hotels were heavy booked for the festival in Banaras.

(a) are heavy booked
(b) were heavily booked
(c) No substitution required
(d) were heavily booking

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) were heavily booked
Type: Sentence Improvement – Adverb
Rule: To modify the verb "booked", use the **adverb "heavily"**, not the adjective "heavy".
(क्रिया के लिए क्रिया-विशेषण "heavily"।)
Corrected sentence
"The hotels **were heavily booked** for the festival in Banaras."

Q.15 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
If somebody attacks you, you needs be able to defend yourself.

(a) No substitution required
(b) need be able
(c) need being able
(d) need to be able

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) need to be able
Type: Sentence Improvement – "need to + V1"
Rule: "**need to be able to**" defend yourself. ("need" here is a main verb → "need to + V1".)
("need to be able to" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution ('needs be able') / need be able / need being able** – wrong forms.

Q.16 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
Jamnalal Bajaj was one of the few businessmen who incurred the wrath of the British for supporting the freedom movement.

(a) No substitution required
(b) in support of
(c) supporting
(d) to supporting

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No substitution required
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "incurred the wrath of the British **for supporting** the freedom movement" is correct — "for + V-ing" shows the reason.
("for + V-ing" (कारण) सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **in support of / supporting / to supporting** – change the structure or are ungrammatical here.

Q.17 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
The Ghats in Benaras were very crowded but we were able to watch the Ganga aarti clearly.

(a) No substitution required
(b) but we was
(c) so we were
(d) but we are

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No substitution required
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "The Ghats ... were very crowded **but we were** able to watch ..." is correct — "but" (contrast) + past "were".
("but we were" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **but we was** – wrong verb; **so we were** – wrong connector; **but we are** – wrong tense.

Q.18 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
The song was so moving as all eyes became wet.

(a) when
(b) then
(c) No substitution required
(d) that

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) that
Type: Sentence Improvement – "so ... that"
Rule: "**so + adjective + that + result**". "so moving **that** all eyes became wet."
("so ... that" संरचना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **when / then / No substitution ('as')** – wrong connector for a result clause.

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Q.19 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
There were ten children in the class, six of <u>which was</u> crying.

(a) whose are
(b) whom were
(c) No substitution required
(d) who was

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) whom were
Type: Sentence Improvement – Relative Pronoun + Agreement
Rule: For people after "of", use "**whom**"; "six" is plural → "**were**".
(व्यक्ति के लिए "whom"; बहुवचन "six" → "were"।)
Corrected sentence
"There were ten children in the class, six of **whom were** crying."
Why the others are wrong
• **whose are / No substitution ('which was') / who was** – wrong pronoun/number.

Q.20 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
It was <u>him who encouraged I</u> when I was feeling low.

(a) him who encourages me
(b) he who encouraged I
(c) he who encouraged me
(d) No substitution required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) he who encouraged me
Type: Sentence Improvement – Pronoun Case
Rule: After "It was", use the **subject pronoun "he"**; "encouraged" needs the **object "me"**.
("It was he who ..." (कर्ता) + "encouraged me" (कर्म)।)
Corrected sentence
"It was **he who encouraged me** when I was feeling low."
Why the others are wrong
• **him who encourages me** – "him" (object) wrong as subject; **he who encouraged I** – "I" wrong as object.

Q.21 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I will not go to the party <u>lest you will</u> promise to accompany me.

(a) until you should
(b) if you will
(c) No improvement
(d) unless you

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) unless you
Type: Sentence Improvement – "unless"
Rule: "**unless**" (= if not) + present simple. The meaning is "I won't go **unless you** promise ..."
("unless you promise" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **until you should / if you will / No improvement ('lest you will')** – wrong conjunction/form.

Q.22 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
On winter evenings, a haze of smog <u>hang in</u> Delhi.

(a) No substitution required
(b) is hanging over
(c) hangs up
(d) hangs over

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) hangs over
Type: Sentence Improvement – Subject-Verb + Phrasal Verb
Rule: "a haze of smog" is **singular** → "**hangs**"; and smog "**hangs over**" (lies above) a place.
(एकवचन "haze" → "hangs over"।)
Corrected sentence
"On winter evenings, a haze of smog **hangs over** Delhi."
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution ('hang in') / is hanging over / hangs up** – wrong form or preposition.

Q.23 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
I couldn't sleep <u>in case of</u> being very tired.

(a) in spite of
(b) in order of
(c) No substitution required
(d) even though

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) in spite of
Type: Sentence Improvement – Contrast
Rule: "**in spite of**" = despite. The meaning is "couldn't sleep despite being tired".
("in spite of" = के बावजूद।)
Corrected sentence
"I couldn't sleep **in spite of** being very tired."
Why the others are wrong
• **in case of / No substitution / even though** ("even though" needs a clause, not "-ing").

Q.24 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
We are <u>coping the problems with</u> the best of our ability.

(a) No improvement
(b) coping in the problems by
(c) coping the problems at
(d) coping with the problems to

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) coping with the problems to
Type: Sentence Improvement – Phrasal Verb + Idiom
Rule: "**cope with**" (a problem) + "**to the best of our ability**".
("cope with" + "to the best of one's ability"।)
Corrected sentence
"We are **coping with the problems to** the best of our ability."

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Q.25 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
He <u>was considered</u> a genius by his school headmaster.

(a) No improvement **(b)** was considering
(c) was been considered **(d)** was to be considered

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No improvement
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "He **was considered** a genius by his school headmaster" is correct passive (was + V3).
("was considered" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **was considering** – active; **was been considered / was to be considered** – wrong forms.

Q.26 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I was <u>being depressed</u> when you called.

(a) feeling depressed **(b)** No improvement
(c) being depressing **(d)** going depressed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) feeling depressed
Type: Sentence Improvement – Adjective, not Passive
Rule: "depressed" is a **feeling/adjective**; use "**feeling depressed**", not the passive "being depressed".
("feeling depressed" (भावना) सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"I was **feeling depressed** when you called."

Q.27 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
The child put a ladder <u>on the wall</u> and climbed up.

(a) above the wall **(b)** against the wall
(c) over a wall **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) against the wall
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition
Rule: A ladder is placed "**against the wall**" (leaning on it).
("against the wall" = दीवार से टिकाकर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **above the wall / over a wall / No improvement ('on the wall')** – wrong preposition for a leaning ladder.

Q.28 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
The place was <u>not cold only and also</u> damp.

(a) only cold not also **(b)** No improvement
(c) not only cold and both **(d)** not only cold but also

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) not only cold but also
Type: Sentence Improvement – Correlative Conjunction
Rule: The fixed pair is "**not only ... but also**".
("not only ... but also" संरचना।)
Corrected sentence
"The place was **not only cold but also** damp."

Q.29 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
This stain can be <u>remove by</u> lime juice.

(a) removed with **(b)** removed through
(c) remove from **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) removed with
Type: Sentence Improvement – Passive + Preposition
Rule: "can be **removed with** lime juice" — passive "be + V3 (removed)" + "with" (instrument).
(passive "be removed" + "with" (साधन)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **removed through / remove from** – wrong preposition/form; **No improvement** – "remove by" is wrong.

Q.30 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
Many a person <u>are unable of</u> distinguish right from wrong.

(a) is unable to **(b)** are unable to
(c) No improvement **(d)** are capable of

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) is unable to
Type: Sentence Improvement – "Many a" + Agreement
Rule: "**Many a + singular noun**" takes a **singular verb**, and "unable **to** + V1".
("Many a person" एकवचन → "is unable to"।)
Corrected sentence
"Many a person **is unable to** distinguish right from wrong."

Q.31 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
She is not ready for marriage, <u>isn't it</u>?

(a) is she **(b)** is it
(c) No improvement **(d)** isn't she

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) is she
Type: Sentence Improvement – Question Tag
Rule: A **negative** statement takes a **positive** tag; the subject "She" + "is" → "**is she?**"
(Negative वाक्य के साथ positive tag — "is she?")
Why the others are wrong
• **is it / isn't she / No improvement ('isn't it')** – wrong subject or wrong polarity.

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Q.32 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
There was an argument <u>about if we shall move</u> to another city.

(a) on if we shall be moving
(b) about whether we should move
(c) about if we should move
(d) No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) about whether we should move
Type: Sentence Improvement – whether + should
Rule: After a preposition ("about"), use "**whether**" (not "if"); and "shall → should".
(preposition के बाद "whether"; shall → should।)
Corrected sentence
"There was an argument **about whether we should move** to another city."

Q.33 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
If you had asked me, <u>I had told you</u> not to invest in that property.

(a) I would have told you **(b)** I will tell you
(c) I would tell you **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I would have told you
Type: Sentence Improvement – Third Conditional
Rule: "If + had + V3, ... **would have + V3**." "If you had asked me, I **would have told** you ..."
(Third conditional: would have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **I will tell / I would tell / No improvement ('I had told')** – wrong tense for the unreal past.

Q.34 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
She <u>are having</u> two brothers and three sisters.

(a) No improvement **(b)** has
(c) is having **(d)** have

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has
Type: Sentence Improvement – "have" (possess) + Agreement
Rule: "have" meaning "possess" is **not** used in the continuous form; and "She" (singular) → "**has**".
("have" (रखना) continuous में नहीं; "She has"।)
Corrected sentence
"She **has** two brothers and three sisters."

Q.35 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
<u>A hole is</u> in my pocket.

(a) No improvement **(b)** A hole there is
(c) There is a hole **(d)** A hole are there

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) There is a hole
Type: Sentence Improvement – "There is" Structure
Rule: To state existence, begin with "**There is/are**". "**There is** a hole in my pocket."
(अस्तित्व बताने के लिए "There is"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement ('A hole is') / A hole there is / A hole are there** – unnatural or wrong.

Q.36 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I will accept the responsibility <u>while a time</u> comes.

(a) No improvement **(b)** whenever a time
(c) when the time **(d)** until a time

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) when the time
Type: Sentence Improvement – Conjunction
Rule: For a future event, use "**when the time comes**" (present simple after "when").
("when the time comes" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement ('while a time') / whenever a time / until a time** – wrong or unnatural.

Q.37 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
Why <u>not you to be</u> a good boy and sit down?

(a) you are not being **(b)** don't you be
(c) No improvement **(d)** you not be

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) don't you be
Type: Sentence Improvement – "Why don't you ...?"
Rule: The correct structure for a suggestion is "**Why don't you + V1?**"
("Why don't you be ...?" संरचना।)
Corrected sentence
"Why **don't you be** a good boy and sit down?"

Q.38 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I <u>have been working</u> with children before, so I know what to expect.

(a) have worked **(b)** work
(c) No improvement **(d)** am working

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) have worked
Type: Sentence Improvement – Present Perfect
Rule: With "before" (experience up to now), use the **present perfect**: "I **have worked** with children before."

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Explanation (contd.)
("before" (अनुभव) → present perfect।)
Why the others are wrong
• **work / am working** – wrong tense; **No improvement** – "have been working ... before" is wrong.

Q.39 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I am <u>not use to drink</u> coffee.

(a) not used to drinking **(b)** No improvement
(c) not used to drink **(d)** not use to drank

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) not used to drinking
Type: Sentence Improvement – "used to + V-ing" (habit)
Rule: "**be used to + V-ing**" = to be accustomed to. So "not used to **drinking** coffee."
("used to + V-ing" = ... का अभ्यस्त होना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement ('not use to drink') / not used to drink / not use to drank** – wrong forms.

Q.40 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
You <u>have not showed</u> any improvement in your handwriting.

(a) have not shown **(b)** No improvement
(c) had not showed **(d)** has not shown

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) have not shown
Type: Sentence Improvement – Past Participle
Rule: The past participle of "show" is "**shown**"; with "have" → "**have not shown**".
(show – showed – shown; "have not shown"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement ('have not showed') / had not showed / has not shown** – wrong participle or agreement.

Q.41 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined statement in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I <u>suggest you to</u> see a solicitor.

(a) am suggesting you **(b)** No improvement
(c) suggest you that **(d)** suggest that you

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) suggest that you
Type: Sentence Improvement – "suggest that ..."
Rule: "suggest" is **not** followed by "object + to". Use "**suggest that + subject (+ should) + V1**".
("suggest that you (should) see" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"I **suggest that you** see a solicitor."

Q.42 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I bet you can't beat me <u>by chess</u>.

(a) at chess **(b)** on chess
(c) in the chess **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) at chess
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition
Rule: We beat someone "**at**" a game. "beat me **at chess**."
("beat ... at (a game)"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **on chess / in the chess / No improvement ('by chess')** – wrong preposition.

Q.43 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I am really looking forward <u>to meet you</u>.

(a) No improvement **(b)** to meeting you
(c) to have met you **(d)** to be meeting you

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) to meeting you
Type: Sentence Improvement – "look forward to + V-ing"
Rule: In "look forward **to**", the "to" is a **preposition** → followed by a **gerund (meeting)**.
("look forward to" के बाद gerund (meeting)।)
Corrected sentence
"I am really looking forward **to meeting you**."

Q.44 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
He has <u>being put behind</u> prison for life.

(a) being putting in **(b)** No improvement
(c) been put behind **(d)** been put in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) been put in
Type: Sentence Improvement – Passive (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has **been put in** prison" — "has been + V3 (put)"; and we are put "**in**" prison.
(present perfect passive: has been + V3; "in prison"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **being putting in / No improvement ('being put behind') / been put behind** – wrong form/preposition.

Q.45 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
Can you <u>advice to me</u> on this matter?

(a) advise to me **(b)** advise me
(c) No improvement **(d)** advising me

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) advise me
Type: Sentence Improvement – advise (verb) + no "to"
Rule: "**advise**" is the verb (advice is the noun); "advise **me**" (no "to").
("advise" क्रिया; "advise me"।)
Corrected sentence

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Explanation (contd.)
"Can you **advise me** on this matter?"

Q.46 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
He is <u>bent to harm</u> my reputation by false accusations.

(a) bent on harming **(b)** bent to harming
(c) bend to harm **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) bent on harming
Type: Sentence Improvement – "bent on + V-ing"
Rule: "**bent on + V-ing**" = determined to do. "bent **on harming** my reputation."
("bent on + V-ing" ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **bent to harming / bend to harm / No improvement ('bent to harm')** – wrong preposition/form.

Q.47 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
Chillies have a strong, spicy taste <u>that tingle</u> your taste buds.

(a) who is tingling **(b)** No improvement
(c) which tingle **(d)** that tingles

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) that tingles
Type: Sentence Improvement – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: The relative pronoun refers to "taste" (singular) → "**that tingles**".
("taste that tingles" (एकवचन)।)
Corrected sentence
"Chillies have a strong, spicy taste **that tingles** your taste buds."

Q.48 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
She was smiling <u>but looking</u> pleased about something.

(a) and looked **(b)** so looking
(c) but look **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) and looked
Type: Sentence Improvement – Conjunction
Rule: Smiling and looking pleased go together, so join with "**and**", not "but"; and keep parallel past tense "**looked**".
(समान भाव जोड़ने के लिए "and"; parallel "looked"।)
Corrected sentence
"She was smiling **and looked** pleased about something."

Q.49 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
He turned a deaf ear <u>on the advices</u> of his parents.

(a) to the advice **(b)** at the advices
(c) on the advice **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) to the advice
Type: Sentence Improvement – Idiom + Uncountable Noun
Rule: "**turn a deaf ear to**"; and "advice" is uncountable (no "advices").
("turn a deaf ear to"; "advice" अगणनीय।)
Corrected sentence
"He turned a deaf ear **to the advice** of his parents."

Q.50 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
Although they are twins, they are completely <u>different than</u> each other.

(a) differ than **(b)** No improvement
(c) different from **(d)** difference from

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) different from
Type: Sentence Improvement – "different from"
Rule: The correct phrase is "**different from**", not "different than".
("different from" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"Although they are twins, they are completely **different from** each other."

Q.51 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I think she would be <u>much more happier</u> in her hometown.

(a) most happiest **(b)** much happier
(c) more happier **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) much happier
Type: Sentence Improvement – Comparative
Rule: "happier" is already comparative; "**much happier**" is correct (never "more happier").
("much happier" (double comparative नहीं)।)
Corrected sentence
"I think she would be **much happier** in her hometown."

Q.52 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
Try to <u>avail of</u> every opportunity that comes your way.

(a) availing of **(b)** avail yourself of
(c) No improvement **(d)** avail to

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) avail yourself of
Type: Sentence Improvement – "avail oneself of"

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: The correct form is "**avail oneself of**" (to make use of).
("avail oneself of" = लाभ उठाना।)
Corrected sentence
"Try to **avail yourself of** every opportunity that comes your way."

Q.53 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
Each one of them <u>were wearing</u> a face mask for protection.

(a) No improvement **(b)** was wearing
(c) were worn **(d)** have worn

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) was wearing
Type: Sentence Improvement – "Each one ... was"
Rule: "Each one (of them)" is **singular** → "**was wearing**".
("Each one" एकवचन → "was wearing"।)
Corrected sentence
"Each one of them **was wearing** a face mask for protection."

Q.54 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
You will have <u>to pay heavy</u> for your crimes.

(a) to be paying heavily **(b)** to paid heavily
(c) to pay heavily **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) to pay heavily
Type: Sentence Improvement – Adverb
Rule: To modify the verb "pay", use the **adverb "heavily"**, not "heavy".
(क्रिया के लिए क्रिया-विशेषण "heavily"।)
Corrected sentence
"You will have **to pay heavily** for your crimes."

Q.55 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
<u>But for their</u> valour, they would have been defeated.

(a) But about their **(b)** Because of their
(c) Except with their **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) No improvement
Type: Sentence Improvement – "But for"
Rule: "**But for**" = if not for / without. "But for their valour, they would have been defeated" is correct.
("But for" = यदि ... न होता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **But about their / Because of their / Except with their** – change the meaning.

Q.56 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I cannot recollect where <u>did I leave</u> my umbrella.

(a) I left **(b)** I did leave
(c) I have leave **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I left
Type: Sentence Improvement – Embedded Question
Rule: In an embedded question, use **subject + verb** (no inversion): "where **I left** ...".
(embedded प्रश्न में: where + subject + verb।)
Corrected sentence
"I cannot recollect where **I left** my umbrella."

Q.57 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
She was <u>so tall to</u> reach the top shelf.

(a) so tall that **(b)** tall enough to
(c) too tall for **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) tall enough to
Type: Sentence Improvement – "enough to"
Rule: "**adjective + enough + to + V1**". "tall **enough to** reach the top shelf."
("tall enough to reach" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **so tall that** (needs a clause) / **too tall for** (negative sense) / **No improvement ('so tall to')** – wrong.

Q.58 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
Only one of <u>these books belong</u> to the school library.

(a) this book belong **(b)** No improvement
(c) these book belongs **(d)** these books belongs

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) these books belongs
Type: Sentence Improvement – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: The subject of the verb is "**one**" (singular), so the verb is "**belongs**": "one of these books **belongs** ..."
("one of these books" → "belongs" (एकवचन)।)
Corrected sentence
"Only one of **these books belongs** to the school library."

Q.59 Select the most appropriate option to replace the underlined word in the given sentence.Hritik is <u>slow</u> than Heer.

(a) slower **(b)** slowliest
(c) much slow **(d)** slowest

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) slower
comparison is happening in the sentence between Hritik and Heer. So, comparative degree of adjective should be used. Hence, option 'a' is the correct option.

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Q.60 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
She ran out of her house <u>from frightening</u> .

(a) from fright **(b)** No improvement
(c) by frightening **(d)** in fright

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) in fright
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition
Rule: "**in fright**" = out of fear. "ran out of her house **in fright**."
("in fright" = डर के मारे।)
Why the others are wrong
• **from fright / No improvement ('from frightening') / by frightening** – wrong preposition/form.

Q.61 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
His conduct does not <u>accord for</u> his noble profession.

(a) accorded from **(b)** according to
(c) accord with **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) accord with
Type: Sentence Improvement – "accord with"
Rule: "**accord with**" = to agree/match. "does not **accord with** his noble profession."
("accord with" = मेल खाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **accorded from / according to / No improvement ('accord for')** – wrong preposition/form.

Q.62 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
She came home to meet <u>I and mine</u> family.

(a) me and mine **(b)** me and my
(c) myself and mine **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) me and my
Type: Sentence Improvement – Pronoun/Possessive
Rule: "meet **me**" (object) + "**my** family" (possessive adjective).
("meet me" (कर्म) + "my family" (possessive)।)
Corrected sentence
"She came home to meet **me and my** family."

Q.63 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence.Riya ran as <u>fastly</u> as a cheetah and saved the child from falling.

(a) fastest **(b)** fast
(c) faster **(d)** fasting

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) fast
there is no word as fastly in the English language.
Faster and fastest are comparative and superlative degrees of fast but we use positive degree between as ..... as.
"As + adjective/adverb + as" is used to compare things when they are equal in some way.
Fasting does not make any sense in this sentence.

Q.64 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
You will participate in the marathon, <u>won't you</u> ?

(a) isn't it **(b)** will you
(c) No improvement **(d)** didn't you

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) No improvement
Type: Sentence Improvement – Question Tag
Rule: A **positive** statement with "will" takes the tag "**won't you?**" — already correct.
(Positive "will" → tag "won't you?")
Why the others are wrong
• **isn't it / will you / didn't you** – wrong tag for "You will participate ...".

Q.65 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
He has hardly <u>some near</u> friends.

(a) any close **(b)** No improvement
(c) few close **(d)** many near

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) any close
Type: Sentence Improvement – "hardly any" + collocation
Rule: "hardly" (a negative) pairs with "**any**" (not "some"); and we say "**close** friends".
("hardly any"; "close friends"।)
Corrected sentence
"He has hardly **any close** friends."

Q.66 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I wouldn't dream <u>to raise</u> the price.

(a) to rise **(b)** No improvement
(c) to raising **(d)** of raising

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) of raising
Type: Sentence Improvement – "dream of + V-ing"
Rule: "**dream of + V-ing**" = to imagine/consider. "wouldn't dream **of raising** the price."
("dream of + V-ing"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **to rise / No improvement ('to raise') / to raising** – wrong preposition/form.

Q.67 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
I wish <u>I know</u> how to play the guitar.

(a) No improvement **(b)** I am knowing
(c) I have known **(d)** I knew

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I knew
Type: Sentence Improvement – "I wish" + Past
Rule: "**I wish + past simple**" expresses a present unreal wish. "I wish **I knew** ..."

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Explanation (contd.)
("I wish" के बाद past simple (knew)।)
Corrected sentence
"I wish **I knew** how to play the guitar."

Q.68 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement'.
You will be in trouble if you don't <u>obey to my</u> orders.

(a) No improvement
(b) obeying my
(c) obey with my
(d) obey my

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) obey my
Type: Sentence Improvement – "obey" (no "to")
Rule: "obey" is a transitive verb — "obey **my** orders", not "obey to my".
("obey" के बाद "to" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"You will be in trouble if you don't **obey my** orders."

Q.69 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The manager assured the employees that none of them <u>will be dismiss</u>.

(a) No improvement required
(b) would be dismissed
(c) is being dismiss
(d) would have been dismissed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) would be dismissed
Type: Sentence Improvement – Sequence of Tenses
Rule: After past "assured", use "**would be dismissed**".
Why the others are wrong
• **will be dismiss / is being dismiss / would have been dismissed** – wrong tense/form.

Q.70 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The soldiers would not have surrendered if they <u>not ran out</u> of ammunition.

(a) do not run out
(b) No improvement required
(c) had not run out
(d) did not ran out

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) had not run out
Type: Sentence Improvement – Third Conditional
Rule: "would not have surrendered" needs "**had not run out**" (past perfect) in the if-clause.
Why the others are wrong
• **do not run out / did not ran out** – wrong tense; no improvement is wrong.

Q.71 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
These shoes are <u>cheap as well durable</u>.

(a) neither cheaper nor durable
(b) more cheaper than durable
(c) both cheap and durable
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) both cheap and durable
Type: Sentence Improvement – Correlative Conjunction
Rule: The correct pair is "**both ... and**". "These shoes are **both cheap and durable**."
Why the others are wrong
• **neither ... nor / more cheaper** – change meaning or are wrong; no improvement is wrong.

Q.72 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
He felt dejected but the feeling <u>passed out</u> in a minute.

(a) No improvement required
(b) passed on
(c) passed back
(d) passed off

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) passed off
Type: Sentence Improvement – Phrasal Verb
Rule: "**pass off**" = (a feeling) to disappear/go away. "The feeling **passed off** in a minute."
Why the others are wrong
• **passed out** – fainted; **passed on** – died/handed over; **passed back** – returned.

Q.73 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The shopkeeper was obliged to dispense <u>to the service</u> of his salesman.

(a) with the services
(b) No improvement required
(c) by the services
(d) away the service

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) with the services
Type: Sentence Improvement – Phrasal Verb
Rule: "**dispense with**" = to do without / remove. "obliged to **dispense with the services** of his salesman."
Why the others are wrong
• **to the service / by the services / away the service** – wrong preposition/form.

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Q.74 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
He denied <u>if he had</u> caused the accident.

(a) not to had
(b) of having
(c) No improvement required
(d) that he had

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) that he had
Type: Sentence Improvement – Reported Statement
Rule: "deny" is followed by "**that + clause**", not "if". "He denied **that he had** caused the accident."
Why the others are wrong
• **if he had / not to had / of having** – wrong structure.

Q.75 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The news about the surge in Covid-19 cases <u>is broadcasted</u> every morning.

(a) No improvement required
(b) is broadcast
(c) are broadcasted
(d) are broadcast

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) is broadcast
Type: Sentence Improvement – Verb Form
Rule: "broadcast" is invariable (broadcast – broadcast – broadcast). Passive present → "**is broadcast**".
Why the others are wrong
• **is broadcasted / are broadcasted / are broadcast** – wrong form or number ("news" is singular).

Q.76 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
<u>It is I who am</u> responsible for the success of the organisation.

(a) No improvement required
(b) It is me that is
(c) It is I which is
(d) It is me who am

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No improvement required
Type: Sentence Improvement – Pronoun/Verb Agreement
Rule: "It is I **who am** responsible" — the relative "who" refers to "I", so the verb is "am". The sentence is correct.
Why the others are wrong
• **It is me that is / which is / me who am** – wrong pronoun/verb.

Q.77 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
<u>Unless we are not sure</u> of our goals, we cannot achieve them.

(a) Except if we are not sure
(b) Not until we are sure
(c) Unless we are sure
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Unless we are sure
Type: Sentence Improvement – Double Negative
Rule: "Unless" already means "if not", so "Unless we are **not** sure" is a double negative. Use "**Unless we are sure**".
Why the others are wrong
• **Except if we are not sure / Not until we are sure** – change the meaning; no improvement is wrong.

Q.78 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
It is time for the factory <u>to being closed</u>.

(a) for closing
(b) No improvement required
(c) should be closed
(d) to be closed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to be closed
Type: Sentence Improvement – Infinitive
Rule: "It is time for the factory **to be closed**" (it is time + to + be + V3).
Why the others are wrong
• **for closing / to being closed / should be closed** – wrong form.

Q.79 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The doors and windows <u>will have painted</u> by afternoon.

(a) would been painted
(b) No improvement required
(c) will be painting
(d) will have been painted

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) will have been painted
Type: Sentence Improvement – Future Perfect Passive
Rule: Passive future perfect = "**will have been + V3**" → "**will have been painted**".
Why the others are wrong
• **will have painted / would been painted / will be painting** – wrong form.

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Q.80 **Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.**
The teacher found it difficult to exceed on the students' request.

(a) accede by
(b) accede to
(c) No improvement required
(d) exceed for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) accede to
Type: Sentence Improvement – Word + Preposition
Rule: "**accede to**" = to agree to (a request). "difficult to **accede to** the students' request."
Why the others are wrong
• **exceed on / accede by / exceed for** – wrong word or preposition.

Q.81 **Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.**
Sal trees have been planted in relatively three-fourth of the forest area.

(a) about three-fourth
(b) No improvement required
(c) nearly three-fourths
(d) around three-fourth

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) nearly three-fourths
Type: Sentence Improvement – Fraction
Rule: Use "**three-fourths**" (plural) for a fraction of an area, with "nearly" for approximation.
Why the others are wrong
• **relatively / about / around three-fourth** – "relatively" is wrong here; singular "fourth" is wrong.

Q.82 **Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.**
Not only the workmen but also the supervisor was suspended for negligence.

(a) No improvement required
(b) was suspend
(c) were suspended
(d) have been suspended

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No improvement required
Type: Sentence Improvement – Proximity Rule
Rule: With "Not only ... but also", the verb agrees with the **nearer** subject ("the supervisor", singular) → "**was suspended**" is correct.
Why the others are wrong
• **was suspend / were suspended / have been suspended** – wrong form/number.

Q.83 **Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.**
Is this the same book like our teacher recommended?

(a) No improvement required
(b) similar book that
(c) same book who
(d) same book as

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) same book as
Type: Sentence Improvement – Correlative
Rule: "the **same ... as**" is the correct pair. "Is this the **same book as** our teacher recommended?"
Why the others are wrong
• **same book like / similar book that / same book who** – wrong correlative/relative.

Q.84 **Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.**
Do I need finish this work today itself?

(a) Must I to
(b) No improvement required
(c) Do I must
(d) Need I

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Need I
Type: Sentence Improvement – Modal "need"
Rule: As a modal in questions, "need" takes the form "**Need I + V1**" → "**Need I finish** this work today?"
Why the others are wrong
• **Do I need / Must I to / Do I must** – wrong form.

Q.85 **Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.**
Megha's habit of procrastination puts her colleagues on lot of trouble.

(a) No improvement required
(b) into lot troubles
(c) to a lot of trouble
(d) in lot of troubles

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) to a lot of trouble
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition
Rule: The correct phrase is "**put someone to trouble**" → "puts her colleagues **to a lot of trouble**".
Why the others are wrong
• **on lot of / into lot troubles / in lot of troubles** – wrong preposition/form.

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Q.86 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The show flopped miserably <u>to the utter</u> disappointment of everybody.

(a) No improvement required
(b) at an utter
(c) by the utterly
(d) for the utter

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No improvement required
Type: Sentence Improvement – Phrase
Rule: "**to the utter disappointment of**" is the correct fixed phrase — no change needed.
Why the others are wrong
• **at an utter / by the utterly / for the utter** – wrong preposition/form.

Q.87 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The magistrate <u>acquitted him of</u> all charges and set him free.

(a) No improvement required
(b) apprehended him in
(c) atoned him from
(d) accused him for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No improvement required
Type: Sentence Improvement – Word + Preposition
Rule: "**acquit somebody of** (a charge)" = declare not guilty — the sentence is already correct.
Why the others are wrong
• **apprehended him in / atoned him from / accused him for** – wrong word/preposition.

Q.88 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
<u>Unless</u> you carry a Covid-19 negative report, you can travel by air.

(a) Provided
(b) No improvement required
(c) Only
(d) Until

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Provided
Type: Sentence Improvement – Conjunction (Meaning)
Rule: The logic needs a positive condition: you can travel by air **only if** you carry a negative report → use "**Provided**". "Unless" reverses the meaning.
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement / Only / Until** – "Unless/Until" give the wrong logic.

Q.89 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
He <u>was knowing</u> her for a long time before he finally married her.

(a) has been knowing
(b) had known
(c) No improvement required
(d) had knew

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) had known
Type: Sentence Improvement – Tense
Rule: "know" is a **stative verb** (not used in the continuous). For an action completed before another past action, use the past perfect "**had known**".
Why the others are wrong
• **was knowing / has been knowing / had knew** – wrong forms.

Q.90 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
It is <u>the true fact</u> that the second wave of Covid-19 that has gripped India is more deadly.

(a) the correct fact
(b) No improvement required
(c) a fact
(d) a real fact

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) a fact
Type: Sentence Improvement – Redundancy
Rule: A "fact" is already true, so "true fact" is redundant. Use just "**a fact**".
Why the others are wrong
• **the correct fact / a real fact** – still redundant; no improvement is wrong.

Q.91 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
You must start your work without <u>some farther delay</u>.

(a) No improvement required
(b) any farther delay
(c) much far delay
(d) any further delay

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) any further delay
Type: Sentence Improvement – further vs farther + any
Rule: For "additional", use "**further**" (not "farther" = physical distance); and "without **any** further delay".
("further" = और अधिक; "any further delay" ।)
Corrected sentence
"You must start your work without **any further delay**."

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Q.92 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
This lock will not open unless you <u>don't use</u> the correct code.

(a) are using
(b) No improvement required
(c) didn't use
(d) use

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) use
Type: Sentence Improvement – "unless" (No Double Negative)
Rule: "unless" already means "if ... not"; do not add another "not". "**unless you use** the correct code".
("unless" के साथ "not" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"This lock will not open **unless you use** the correct code."

Q.93 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
A sincere person creates goodwill <u>whenever</u> he goes.

(a) wherever
(b) No improvement required
(c) if ever
(d) somewhere

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) wherever
Type: Sentence Improvement – Relative Adverb (Place)
Rule: For "every place where", use "**wherever**", not "whenever" (time).
("wherever" = जहाँ भी (स्थान)।)
Corrected sentence
"A sincere person creates goodwill **wherever** he goes."

Q.94 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
It was <u>too</u> an interesting movie.

(a) such
(b) No improvement required
(c) so
(d) enough

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) such
Type: Sentence Improvement – "such a"
Rule: Before "a/an + adjective + noun", use "**such**". "**such** an interesting movie."
("such a + adjective + noun"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement ('too an') / so / enough** – "too/so" go directly before an adjective, not "an ... movie".

Q.95 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
The report that markets <u>are open</u> is not true.

(a) has opened
(b) was open
(c) No improvement required
(d) have open

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) No improvement required
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "The report that markets **are open** is not true" is correct — plural "markets" + "are open" (adjective).
("markets are open" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **has opened / was open / have open** – wrong number/tense/form.

Q.96 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
I found my bag <u>to lie</u> where I had left it.

(a) to be lying
(b) No improvement required
(c) to lay
(d) lying

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) lying
Type: Sentence Improvement – "found + object + V-ing"
Rule: "found + object + **V-ing**" shows the state in which it was found. "found my bag **lying** ..."
("found ... lying" (V-ing)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **to be lying / No improvement ('to lie') / to lay** – wrong forms.

Q.97 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
How many sums <u>had you solve</u> so far?

(a) No improvement required
(b) are you solving
(c) do you solve
(d) have you solved

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) have you solved
Type: Sentence Improvement – Present Perfect
Rule: "so far" (up to now) needs the **present perfect**: "How many sums **have you solved** so far?"
("so far" → present perfect।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement ('had you solve') / are you solving / do you solve** – wrong tense.

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Q.98 **Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.**
I had to wait for fifteen minutes <u>to</u> the bus.

(a) at
(b) of
(c) No improvement required
(d) for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) for
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition
Rule: We "**wait for**" something. "wait for fifteen minutes **for** the bus."
("wait for" = ... का इंतज़ार करना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **at / of / No improvement ('to the bus')** – wrong preposition.

Q.99 **Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence.If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.**
I enjoy <u>watch</u> historical movies.

(a) No improvement required
(b) watching
(c) to watching
(d) to watch

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) watching
Type: Sentence Improvement – "enjoy + V-ing"
Rule: "enjoy" is followed by the **gerund (V-ing)**. "I enjoy **watching** historical movies."
("enjoy + V-ing" I)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement ('watch') / to watching / to watch** – wrong forms after "enjoy".

Q.100 **Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.**
He spent money on his holiday <u>as if he were</u> a millionaire.

(a) even if he was
(b) as if he is
(c) No improvement required
(d) even if he were

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) No improvement required
Type: Sentence Improvement – "as if + were"
Rule: After "as if" (unreal comparison), use "**were**". "as if he **were** a millionaire" is correct.
("as if" के बाद "were" (अवास्तविक) I)
Why the others are wrong
• **even if he was / as if he is / even if he were** – "even if" changes the meaning; "as if he is" is wrong.

Q.101 **Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.**
This mango tree yields <u>lot of</u> mangoes every year.

(a) a lot of
(b) a lot
(c) the lot of
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) a lot of
Type: Sentence Improvement – "a lot of"
Rule: The correct quantifier is "**a lot of**" (+ noun). "yields **a lot of** mangoes".
("a lot of + संज्ञा" I)
Why the others are wrong
• **a lot / the lot of / No improvement ('lot of')** – wrong forms.

Q.102 **Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.**
Often we <u>ourselves</u> are responsible for our ill health.

(a) ourself
(b) themselves
(c) yourself
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) No improvement required
Type: Sentence Improvement – Reflexive Pronoun
Rule: "we ... **ourselves**" is the correct reflexive for "we".
("we ourselves" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **ourself / themselves / yourself** – wrong reflexive forms for "we".

Q.103 **Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.**
Why did you take this toy <u>along</u> the child?

(a) at
(b) by
(c) No improvement required
(d) from

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) from
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition
Rule: We take something "**from**" a person. "take this toy **from** the child."
("take from" = ... से लेना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **at / by / No improvement ('along the child')** – wrong preposition.

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Q.104 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
Mrs. Dhar teach in this school for the last ten years.

(a) was teaching
(b) has been teaching
(c) No improvement required
(d) had taught

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has been teaching
Type: Sentence Improvement – Present Perfect Continuous
Rule: With "for the last ten years" (ongoing), use "**has been teaching**".
("for the last ten years" → has been + V-ing।)
Corrected sentence
"Mrs. Dhar **has been teaching** in this school for the last ten years."

Q.105 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence.If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
Each of the naughty boys were punished by the Principal.

(a) was punished
(b) No improvement required
(c) were punish
(d) was punishing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) was punished
Type: Sentence Improvement – "Each ... singular"
Rule: "Each (of the boys)" is **singular** → "**was punished**".
("Each" एकवचन → "was"।)
Corrected sentence
"Each of the naughty boys **was punished** by the Principal."

Q.106 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
I have withdraw money from the bank.

(a) have withdrawing
(b) have withdrew
(c) have withdrawn
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) have withdrawn
Type: Sentence Improvement – Past Participle
Rule: V3 of "withdraw" is "**withdrawn**"; with "have" → "have withdrawn".
(withdraw – withdrew – withdrawn; "have withdrawn"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **have withdrawing / have withdrew / No improvement ('have withdraw')** – wrong participle.

Q.107 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
This work is much heavy to do by one person single-handedly.

(a) too heavy to do
(b) much heavy to be done
(c) too heavy to be done
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) too heavy to be done
Type: Sentence Improvement – "too ... to be + V3"
Rule: "too heavy **to be done**" (passive infinitive, since the work is done, not doing).
("too heavy to be done" (passive)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **too heavy to do / much heavy to be done / No improvement ('much heavy to do')** – wrong form/voice.

Q.108 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
I have been doing this job since the last five years.

(a) No improvement required
(b) for
(c) from
(d) by

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) for
Type: Sentence Improvement – for vs since
Rule: For a **period** ("the last five years"), use "**for**", not "since".
(अवधि के लिए "for"।)
Corrected sentence
"I have been doing this job **for** the last five years."

Q.109 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
A good breakfast give very energy needed by you.

(a) gives many energy
(b) No improvement required
(c) give very much energy
(d) gives all the energy

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) gives all the energy
Type: Sentence Improvement – Subject-Verb + Uncountable
Rule: "A good breakfast" (singular) → "**gives**"; and "energy" is uncountable — "**all the energy**".
("gives all the energy" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"A good breakfast **gives all the energy** needed by you."

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Q.110 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
Prashant is better <u>from more other</u> players of our school.

(a) No improvement required
(b) than most other
(c) from many other
(d) than more other

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) than most other
Type: Sentence Improvement – Comparison
Rule: The comparative "better" takes "**than**"; and "**most other** players" (not "more other").
("better than most other players" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"Prashant is better **than most other** players of our school."

Q.111 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
Which films <u>have you seen</u> when you were in Meerut?

(a) No improvement required
(b) were you seeing
(c) did you see
(d) do you see

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) did you see
Type: Sentence Improvement – Tense
Rule: "when you **were** in Meerut" refers to the past, so use the **simple past**: "Which films **did you see**?"
(भूतकाल संदर्भ में "did you see"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement ('have you seen') / were you seeing / do you see** – wrong tense.

Q.112 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'No improvement required'.
I fell asleep <u>after I am reading</u> a novel.

(a) No improvement required
(b) while I am reading
(c) after I was reading
(d) while I was reading

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) while I was reading
Type: Sentence Improvement – Past Continuous
Rule: For an action interrupted in the past, use "**while + past continuous**". "I fell asleep **while I was reading** a novel."
("while I was reading" (past continuous)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement ('after I am reading') / while I am reading / after I was reading** – wrong tense/connector.

Q.113 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.
The little boy <u>did many mischiefs</u> in school.

(a) did much mischiefs
(b) performed many mischiefs
(c) made much mischief
(d) No Improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) made much mischief
Type: Sentence Improvement – Uncountable Noun
Rule: "mischief" is **uncountable** (no "mischiefs"); use "**much mischief**", and "make mischief".
("mischief" अगणनीय → "much mischief"।)
Corrected sentence
"The little boy **made much mischief** in school."

Q.114 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.
The scientists are busy <u>to explore</u> new ideas.

(a) exploring
(b) to be exploring
(c) No Improvement
(d) for exploring

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) exploring
Type: Sentence Improvement – "busy + V-ing"
Rule: "busy" is followed by the **gerund (V-ing)**: "busy **exploring** new ideas."
("busy + V-ing"।)
Corrected sentence
"The scientists are busy **exploring** new ideas."

Q.115 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.
His tone was neither of anger <u>nor sorrow</u>.

(a) or sorrow
(b) nor of sorrow
(c) no improvement required
(d) or of sorrow

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) nor of sorrow
Type: Sentence Improvement – Parallelism
Rule: "**neither of ... nor of ...**" keeps the two parts parallel.
("neither of anger nor of sorrow" समानांतर।)
Corrected sentence
"His tone was neither of anger **nor of sorrow**."

Q.116 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.
I <u>reached at</u> London only this morning.

(a) reach
(b) No Improvement
(c) am reaching
(d) reached

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) reached
Type: Sentence Improvement – "reach" (no preposition)
Rule: "reach" is a transitive verb — "reached **London**" (no "at").

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Explanation (contd.)
("reach" के बाद "at" नहीं आता।)
Corrected sentence
"I **reached** London only this morning."
Why the others are wrong
• **reach / No improvement ('reached at') / am reaching** – wrong tense or extra "at".

Q.117 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.
We have heard that some statues <u>have stolen with</u> this ancient temple.
(a) have been stolen with
(b) have been stolen from
(c) having been stolen from
(d) no improvement required
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) have been stolen from
Type: Sentence Improvement – Passive + Preposition
Rule: Statues are **stolen from** a place (passive: have been + V3 + from).
(passive: have been stolen from ... ।)
Corrected sentence
"We have heard that some statues **have been stolen from** this ancient temple."

Q.118 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.
I <u>will have travelled</u> all over Europe last year.
(a) have travelled **(b)** were travelling
(c) No Improvement **(d)** travelled
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) travelled
Type: Sentence Improvement – Simple Past
Rule: "last year" (a finished past time) needs the **simple past**: "I **travelled** all over Europe last year."
("last year" → simple past।)
Why the others are wrong
• **have travelled** – present perfect; **were travelling** – past continuous; **No Improvement ('will have travelled')** – future perfect.

Q.119 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.
<u>Many battles was</u> fought on the soil of India.
(a) Many a battle was **(b)** Many battle were
(c) Much battle was **(d)** No Improvement
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Many a battle was
Type: Sentence Improvement – "Many a + singular"
Rule: "**Many a + singular noun + singular verb**" = many.
"Many a battle **was** fought."
("Many a battle was" (एकवचन)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Many battle were / Much battle was / No improvement ('Many battles was')** – wrong number/agreement.

Q.120 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.
You can have a comfortable journey <u>only then you are getting</u> your seats reserved in advance.
(a) only then you get
(b) no improvement required
(c) only when you are getting
(d) only if you get
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) only if you get
Type: Sentence Improvement – Conditional
Rule: A condition needs "**only if you get** your seats reserved" (present simple).
("only if you get" (शर्त)।)
Corrected sentence
"You can have a comfortable journey **only if you get** your seats reserved in advance."

Q.121 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.
Nobody was interested in the fish <u>who Gopal had catch</u> from the river.
(a) which Gopal had caught
(b) no improvement required
(c) who Gopal had caught
(d) which Gopal had catch
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) which Gopal had caught
Type: Sentence Improvement – Relative Pronoun + V3
Rule: For a thing ("the fish"), use "**which**"; and V3 of catch = **caught**.
(निर्जीव के लिए "which"; catch → caught।)
Corrected sentence
"Nobody was interested in the fish **which Gopal had caught** from the river."

Q.122 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.
Eighty girls sat there at four long tables, <u>doing their homework by</u> candlelight.
(a) to doing their homework by
(b) to have done their homework with
(c) no improvement required
(d) doing its homework by
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) no improvement required
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "doing **their** homework by candlelight" is correct — "their" (for the eighty girls) + "by candlelight" (means).
("doing their homework by candlelight" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **to doing ... by / to have done ... with / doing its homework** – wrong forms/pronoun.

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Q.123 **Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.**
Saroj has been suffering with osteoporosis from when she was fifty years old.

(a) from osteoporosis since
(b) from osteoporosis from when
(c) no improvement required
(d) with osteoporosis since

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) from osteoporosis since
Type: Sentence Improvement – "suffer from" + "since"
Rule: We "**suffer from**" an illness; and "**since**" is used with a point of time (since she was fifty).
("suffer from"; "since" (समय-बिंदु)।)
Corrected sentence
"Saroj has been suffering **from osteoporosis since** she was fifty years old."

Q.124 **Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.**
None of the girl deserve to be selected for this award.

(a) no improvement required
(b) None of the girl deserves
(c) None of the girls deserves
(d) None of the girls are deserving

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) None of the girls deserves
Type: Sentence Improvement – "None of the + plural + singular verb"
Rule: "None of the **girls**" (plural noun after "of"), but "None" is treated as singular → "**deserves**".
("None of the girls deserves" (एकवचन क्रिया)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement ('None of the girl deserve') / None of the girl deserves / None of the girls are** – wrong number/verb.

Q.125 **Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.**
She is as good if not better than her sister.

(a) No Improvement **(b)** as good as
(c) more good **(d)** good as

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) good as
Type: Sentence Improvement – "as good as, if not better than"
Rule: The balanced comparison needs "**as good as** ..., if not better than ...".
("as good as ..., if not better than ..." संरचना।)
Corrected sentence
"She is **as good as**, if not better than, her sister."
Note
Here the underlined "as good" must become "**good as**" so the sentence reads "as good as" — the missing "as" is supplied.

Q.126 **Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.**
Learning a poem by heart is meaningless if you do not understand it.

(a) Learning a poem in heart
(b) no improvement required
(c) To learning a poem at heart
(d) Learn a poem by heart

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) no improvement required
Type: Sentence Improvement – Idiom
Rule: "**learn a poem by heart**" = to memorise it. The sentence "Learning a poem by heart ..." is correct.
("learn by heart" = कंठस्थ करना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Learning a poem in heart / To learning ... at heart / Learn a poem by heart** – wrong preposition or form.

Q.127 **Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.**
Keep the dog tied indoors; however, it may bite some stranger.

(a) yet **(b)** else
(c) still **(d)** No Improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) else
Type: Sentence Improvement – Consequence Connector
Rule: To warn of a consequence, use "**or else / otherwise**", not "however".
("or else it may bite" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"Keep the dog tied indoors; **or else**, it may bite some stranger."

Q.128 **Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.**
I take pride to serve my country.

(a) to be serving **(b)** in serving
(c) to have served **(d)** No Improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) in serving
Type: Sentence Improvement – "take pride in + V-ing"
Rule: "take pride **in + V-ing**" = to feel proud of doing something.
("take pride in + V-ing" I)
Corrected sentence
"I take pride **in serving** my country."

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Q.129 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.
Keep him at arm's length <u>lest you may not</u> repent in the long run.

(a) or you may not **(b)** unless you may
(c) lest you should **(d)** No Improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) lest you should
Type: Sentence Improvement – "lest ... should"
Rule: "**lest**" is followed by "**should + V1**" (and no extra "not", since lest = so that ... not).
("lest you should repent" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"Keep him at arm's length **lest you should** repent in the long run."

Q.130 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.
The apple tree was <u>loaded of</u> fruit.

(a) loaded with **(b)** loaded from
(c) laden with **(d)** No Improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) laden with
Type: Sentence Improvement – "laden with"
Rule: A tree heavy with fruit is "**laden with** fruit" (or "loaded **with**"). "loaded of" is wrong.
("laden with" = ... से लदा हुआ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **loaded with** – also correct, but "laden with fruit" is the idiomatic choice; **loaded from / No improvement ('loaded of')** – wrong preposition.

Q.131 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.
Turn left outside the library door and walk down the corridor <u>then you came to</u> the main staircase.

(a) until you will come at
(b) until you come to
(c) when you are come to
(d) no improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) until you come to
Type: Sentence Improvement – "until + present"
Rule: After "until", use the **present simple**: "walk down the corridor **until you come to** the staircase."
("until" के बाद present simple।)
Why the others are wrong
• **until you will come at / when you are come to / no improvement ('then you came to')** – wrong tense/preposition.

Q.132 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No Improvement'.
He is interested neither in business <u>or on the job</u>.

(a) nor in a **(b)** nor to the
(c) not on a **(d)** No Improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) nor in a
Type: Sentence Improvement – "neither ... nor" (Parallelism)
Rule: "neither ... nor" must join **parallel** structures. "neither **in business nor in a job**."
("neither in ... nor in ..." समानांतर।)
Corrected sentence
"He is interested neither in business **nor in a** job."

Q.133 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.
The first step <u>in making a kite is to fasten</u> two sticks of bamboo together in the form of a cross.

(a) no improvement required
(b) into making a kite is fasten
(c) in making a kite is to be fastened
(d) in making a kite is to fastening

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) no improvement required
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "The first step **in making a kite is to fasten** two sticks ..." is correct — "in + V-ing" and "is to + V1".
("in making ... is to fasten" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **into making ... is fasten / is to be fastened / is to fastening** – wrong forms.

Q.134 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to improve it, select 'no improvement required'.
Mr. Fogg thought that <u>it is possible to a man</u> to go round the world in eighty days.

(a) it was possible for a man
(b) no improvement required
(c) it is possible to a man
(d) it was possible to the man

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) it was possible for a man
Type: Sentence Improvement – Tense + Preposition
Rule: After a past reporting verb ("thought"), back-shift to "**was**"; and "possible **for** a man" (not "to a man").
(back-shift: is → was; "possible for" ।)
Corrected sentence
"Mr. Fogg thought that **it was possible for a man** to go round the world in eighty days."

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Q.135 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
Edward II is <u>tragic than</u> some other plays by the dramatist.

(a) the most tragic
(b) as least tragic as
(c) No substitution required
(d) less tragic than

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) less tragic than
'tragic than' is conveying comparison but the comparative adjective is missing. It should be 'less/more tragic than'. So, out of the given options d is the correct.

Q.136 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.Bloomberg Businessweek is <u>not more popular than</u> some other business magazines in the US.

(a) as more popular than
(b) No substitution required
(c) the most popular than
(d) so popular than

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) No substitution required
the sentence is correct. "Not popular than" is a comparative phrase which is correct in the context of the sentence.

Q.137 Select the option that rectifies the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no correction is needed, select 'No correction required'.
Cinema provides <u>the most universal</u> entertainment.

(a) an universal
(b) more universal
(c) a universal
(d) No correction required

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) a universal
The correct answer is option (c).
The article "the" before "universal" is incorrect because "universal" is an adjective, and in this case, we want to describe "entertainment" as being of a universal nature.
When using an article before an adjective like "universal," we typically use "a" or "an" (indefinite articles) to show that something is "one of many" or to describe a general characteristic.
The corrected sentence is: **"Cinema provides a universal entertainment."**

Q.138 Select the most appropriate option in the superlative degree that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.
This is the <u>challenge</u> task I have ever encountered.

(a) most challenging
(b) more challenging
(c) challenging
(d) much challenging

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) most challenging
The correct answer is option (a).

Explanation (contd.)
The correct sentence would be: "This is the most challenging task I have ever encountered."
Here we are comparing the task to all other tasks. So, superlative degree should be come in place of challenge.
Hence, **"most challenging"** is the most appropriate answer.

Q.139 Select the option that rectifies the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no correction is needed, select 'No correction required'.
Ashoka was not only a great warrior but also a very <u>wiser</u> ruler.

(a) wisest
(b) No correction required
(c) more wise
(d) wise

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) wise
The correct answer is option (d).
After "too, very, so, enough etc. positive degree adjective will come.
So, **wise** is the most appropriate answer.
The correct sentence is:
"**Ashoka was not only a great warrior but also a very *<u>wise</u>* ruler."**

Q.140 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the following sentence.
He is taller and <u>most</u> handsome than his friend.

(a) very more
(b) more
(c) the most
(d) the more

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) more
The correct answer is option (b).
"**More"** should be come in place of **"Most"**.
"more handsome" - This part of the sentence is comparing the level of handsomeness between "He" and "his friend."
To make this comparison correctly, we use "more handsome," which is the correct form for comparing an adjective.
Hence, the sentence should be: **"He is taller and more handsome than his friend."**

Q.141 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
An ultralight airplane is very different from a conventional airplane. It <u>is looking like</u> a lawn chair with wings.

(a) look like
(b) looks like
(c) looked like
(d) No substitution required

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) looks like
option (b) is the correct answer.
For singular subject we use singular verb.
The correct sentence is: An ultralight airplane is very different from a conventional airplane. It ***looks like*** a lawn chair with wings.

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Q.142 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence.
In the makeshift place of activity, debate or conflict, there were hundreds of people with the queen's team of advisors and servants sitting within the ring against the wall.

(a) arena **(b)** aviary
(c) dormitory **(d)** casino

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) arena
Arena refers to a place or scene of activity, debate, or conflict. In historical contexts, it often denotes a central area where events or contests are held, such as in ancient Roman amphitheaters. In modern usage, it can describe any venue where significant events or activities occur.
The other options are:
Aviary is a large enclosure for confining birds.
Dormitory is a building or room providing sleeping accommodations for a number of people.
Casino is a facility for certain types of gambling activities.
Thus, Option (a) is the correct answer.

Q.143 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence.
The nation has chosen the government by the people over monarchy.

(a) oligarchy **(b)** theocracy
(c) autocracy **(d)** democracy

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) democracy
Democracy refers to a system of government where the citizens have the power to make decisions, often through voting.
In this context, "government by the people" aligns best with **democracy**.
The other options are:
Oligarchy is a form of government where power is concentrated in the hands of a small group.
Theocracy is a system of government where priests or religious figures govern in the name of a deity.
Autocracy is a system where one person has absolute power.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.144 Parts of the given sentence have been underlined. One of them contains an error. The underlined parts are given as options with some changes. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error.
The film received critical acclaim for being a more innovative movie of the year.

(a) Film receives **(b)** Acclaim at
(c) In the year. **(d)** An innovative

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) An innovative
The correct option that rectifies the error in the underlined parts of the sentence is: **"The film received critical acclaim for being the most innovative movie of the year."**
An innovative: The corrected sentence uses **"the most innovative"** to compare the film's innovation to others and make a superlative statement.

Q.145 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the highlighted segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'.
Come quickly if you will catch the train.

(a) If you want to **(b)** No improvement
(c) If you have **(d)** If you will have

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) If you want to
Rule: a condition about the future takes the **simple present** in the *if*-clause, never *will*.
Will appears in an *if*-clause only when it means "are willing to" — *If you will wait, I'll fetch it.*
To say "come quickly, since you intend to catch the train", English uses **if you want to** (or *if you are to*).
Example: Leave now if you want to reach on time.
Apply it.
Come quickly **if you want to** catch the train.
want to (चाहते हो) gives the intention; *catch* stays a base verb after *to*.
Answer: **If you want to**
Why the others are wrong.
• **No improvement** — *if you will catch* puts a future *will* inside the condition *(शर्त वाले उपवाक्य में will नहीं)*.
• **If you have** — *have catch* is ungrammatical; even *have to* would mean obligation *(बाध्यता)*, not intention.
• **If you will have** — repeats the *will* error and adds *have* before a base verb *(दोहरी भूल)*.
Condition + purpose: "if you want to …", "if you are to …" — never "if you will …".

Q.146 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the highlighted segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No improvement'.
Tom was standing besides the schoolhouse poster, when the ball rolled towards him.

(a) standing beside the schoolhouse poster
(b) No improvement
(c) stand beside the schoolhouse poster
(d) stood beside the schoolhouse poster

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) standing beside the schoolhouse poster
Rule: **beside** = next to, at the side of *(के पास, बगल में)*.
besides = in addition to, moreover *(के अलावा)*.
Example: She sat beside me. Besides English, he speaks French.
Position by a poster needs **beside**.
was standing (past continuous) is right — an action in progress when another action (*the ball rolled*) happened.
Answer: **standing beside the schoolhouse poster**
Why the others are wrong.
• **No improvement** — keeps **besides**, which means "in addition to", not "next to".
• **stand beside** — *was stand* is ungrammatical; *was* needs the -ing form here *(was के बाद ing रूप)*.
• **stood beside** — *was stood* puts a past form after *was*; for an action in progress use *was standing (was के साथ V2 नहीं)*.
Beside = by the side; besides = plus — the extra "s" adds.

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Q.147 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
Raju did very well in the exam, he must study well.

(a) he should have studied well
(b) he may study well
(c) No substitution required
(d) he must have studied well

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) he must have studied well
option (d) is the correct answer.
The given sentence is grammatically incorrect.
To rectify the sentence 'must have studied' will come instead of 'must study'.
Hence the correct answer is-- Raju did very well in the exam, he must have studied very well.

Q.148 Select the option that will improve the given sentence by using the most appropriate pronoun.
Pradeep, whom is a teacher, also works as a content writer.

(a) Pradeep, that is a teacher, also works as a content writer.
(b) Pradeep, who is a teacher, also works as a content writer.
(c) Pradeep, whose is a teacher, also works as a content writer.
(d) Pradeep, which is a teacher, also works as a content writer.

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Pradeep, who is a teacher, also works as a content writer.
The option that will improve the given sentence by using the most appropriate pronoun is: **"Pradeep, who is a teacher, also works as a content writer."**
Pradeep, who is a teacher, also works as a content writer.
- *This is the correct option. It uses the relative pronoun "who" correctly to refer to a person (Pradeep) and introduces additional information about him being a teacher.*

Q.149 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.
Harish is clever than wise.

(a) clever as **(b)** more cleverer than
(c) more clever than **(d)** cleverest than

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) more clever than
"More clever than" is the correct comparative form. When comparing two things, we use "more" with adjectives that have two or more syllables (like "clever") for the comparative degree.

Q.150 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required.'
I decided to call out to various bookstores in the area to see if any of them had the book I needed.

(a) call off
(b) call around
(c) No substitution required
(d) call on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) call around
The most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence is:
"I decided to **call around** to various bookstores in the area to see if any of them had the book I needed."
Call off: This phrase means to cancel something. For example, "call off the search" means to cancel or stop searching.
Call around: This phrase means to contact or inquire widely, often to different places or people. In the context of the sentence, the speaker is checking with various bookstores to find the needed book.
Call on: This phrase often means to visit someone, especially for a brief period. It doesn't fit the context of checking with bookstores in different locations.
he sentence intends to convey the idea of checking with various bookstores, and the phrase "call around" is a colloquial and appropriate way to express this action.

Q.151 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.
Research in Social Sciences is plagued (nowadays on gloomy definitions) and measurements.

(a) nowadays amid gloomy definitions
(b) nowadays onto gloomy definitions
(c) nowadays by gloomy definitions
(d) nowadays during gloomy definitions

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) nowadays by gloomy definitions
"By" in this context can indicate causation or influence, meaning research in social sciences is influenced or impacted by gloomy definitions and measurements.
The correct answer is **"nowadays by gloomy definitions."**

Q.152 Choose the best option to replace the underlined part to improve the given sentence. If no substitution is required, select 'No substitution.'
The project was completed before less than three months.

(a) completed on **(b)** completed at
(c) completed in **(d)** No substitution

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) completed in
Rule: to say how long something took, use **in** + a period of time *(अवधि के भीतर — in)*.
Example: *She learnt to swim **in** two weeks.*
before needs a point of time (*before Monday*), never "before less than three months".

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Explanation (contd.)
Apply it.
less than three months is a **duration**, so: *The project was completed **in** less than three months.*
Answer: **(3) completed in**
Why the others are wrong.
• **completed on** — *on* is for days and dates (*on Monday, on 5 May*) *(दिन/तिथि के लिए)*, not a length of time.
• **completed at** — *at* is for a clock time or a point (*at noon, at 5 pm*) *(समय-बिंदु के लिए)*.
• **No substitution** — *before less than three months* is ungrammatical, so a change is needed.
Finished IN a period, ON a date, AT a time, BEFORE a deadline.

Q.153 Choose the best option to replace the underlined part to improve the given sentence. If no substitution is required, select 'No substitution.'
They decided to put up the launch indefinitely before their chairman was released from jail.
(a) Put on the launch indefinitely till
(b) Put off the launch indefinitely until
(c) Put by the launch indefinitely after
(d) No substitution
SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Put off the launch indefinitely until
Meaning: **put off** = postpone, delay to a later time *(स्थगित करना, टालना)*.
until = up to the time when *(जब तक... नहीं)*.
Apply it.
A launch that waits for the chairman's release is **postponed until** he comes out.
*They decided to **put off the launch indefinitely until** their chairman was released from jail.*
Answer: **(2) Put off the launch indefinitely until**
Why the others are wrong.
• **put up** (the original) = to erect, or to give someone lodging *(खड़ा करना / ठहराना)*; with *before* the sentence also loses its logic.
• **put on** = to wear, or to stage a show *(पहनना / मंचन करना)* — a launch is not "worn".
• **put by** = to save money for later *(बचाकर रखना)*; and *after* reverses the time sense.
Put OFF = postpone; put ON = wear/stage; put UP = lodge/erect; put BY = save.

Q.154 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
In the major cities cost of life is very high.
(a) the cost of living is
(b) cost of life are
(c) No improvement
(d) the cost of living are
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) the cost of living is
Type: Sentence Improvement – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: The subject "the cost (of living)" is **singular** → "**is**". (कर्ता "the cost" एकवचन है → "is"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **cost of life are** – wrong phrase + plural verb.
• **No improvement / the cost of living are** – plural verb "are" is wrong.

Q.155 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
The milk has boiled over and falling onto the stove.
(a) fall over in the stove
(b) No improvement
(c) fallen onto the stove
(d) falls into the stove
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) fallen onto the stove
Type: Sentence Improvement – Present Perfect
Rule: With "has ... and", the second verb continues the **present perfect**: "has boiled over and **fallen onto** the stove". ("fall onto" = fall on the surface.)
(present perfect (has + V3) — "fallen onto the stove"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **fall over in the stove** – wrong form/preposition.
• **No improvement** – original needs correction.
• **falls into the stove** – simple present + wrong preposition.

Q.156 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
Many people are becoming aware of the advantages of preventive health care nowadays.
(a) will be becoming aware to
(b) have becoming aware for
(c) are become aware of
(d) No improvement
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) No improvement
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "Many people **are becoming aware of** ..." is correct — present continuous + the fixed phrase "aware **of**". ("are becoming aware of" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **will be becoming aware to** – wrong preposition.
• **have becoming aware for** – wrong form/preposition.
• **are become aware of** – wrong verb form.

Q.157 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
If I had been there I would surely solve the problem for you.
(a) I would surely have solved
(b) I would surely solving
(c) No improvement
(d) I will surely solves
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I would surely have solved
Type: Sentence Improvement – Third Conditional
Rule: "**If + had + V3, ... would have + V3**" (unreal past). "If I had been there, I **would surely have solved** it."
(भूतकाल की अवास्तविक शर्त: If had + V3, would have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **would surely solving** – wrong form.
• **No improvement / will surely solves** – wrong tense.

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Q.158 **Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".**
It <u>has been raining very hardly</u> since morning.

(a) is been raining very hardly
(b) have been raining very hardly
(c) No improvement
(d) has been raining very hard

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) has been raining very hard
Type: Sentence Improvement – Adverb "hard" vs "hardly"
Rule: "**hard**" (adverb) = with force; "**hardly**" = scarcely/almost not. Rain falls "**hard**".
("hard" = ज़ोर से; "hardly" = मुश्किल से/शायद ही — अर्थ अलग है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **is been raining / have been raining** – wrong helping verbs.
• **No improvement** – "very hardly" is wrong.

Q.159 **Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".**
The news reported that the police <u>have catched the guilty</u> person and are interrogating him.

(a) had catched the guilty **(b)** have caught the guilty
(c) are caught a guilty **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) have caught the guilty
Type: Sentence Improvement – Verb Form
Rule: The past participle of "catch" is "**caught**" (not "catched"); with "have", we get present perfect "**have caught**".
(catch – caught – caught; "catched" गलत है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **had catched** – "catched" is wrong.
• **are caught a guilty** – wrong article/structure.
• **No improvement** – the original needs correction.

Q.160 **Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".**
Using seeds <u>for grow more plants</u> is an exceptionally good way of gardening.

(a) for grows more plants **(b)** No improvement
(c) to growing more plants **(d)** to grow more plants

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to grow more plants
Type: Sentence Improvement – Infinitive of Purpose
Rule: To show purpose, use "**to + V1**": "Using seeds **to grow** more plants."
(उद्देश्य के लिए "to + verb"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **for grows more plants** – wrong.
• **No improvement** – "for grow" is wrong.
• **to growing more plants** – "to" takes the base verb "grow".

Q.161 **Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".**
<u>Unless Arjun takes a taxi</u> he will not reach the airport in time.

(a) If Arjun take a taxi
(b) However Arjun takes a taxi
(c) No improvement
(d) Unless Arjun take taxi

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) No improvement
Type: Sentence Improvement – "Unless" Clause
Rule: "**Unless + present simple**" is correct: "Unless Arjun **takes** a taxi ...". No change is needed.
("Unless" के बाद present simple (takes) सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **If Arjun take** – "If ... not" needed; also "take" wrong.
• **However Arjun takes** – "however" changes the meaning.
• **Unless Arjun take taxi** – "take" (wrong verb) + missing article.

Q.162 **Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".**
I had to go to Delhi, <u>however, I changed my mind</u> and decided not to go.

(a) therefore I change my mind
(b) nevertheless I change my mind
(c) however I will change my mind
(d) No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) No improvement
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "I had to go to Delhi; **however, I changed my mind**" is correct — "however" shows contrast and "changed" (past) matches "had to go".
("however, I changed my mind" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **therefore I change** – "therefore" shows result, not contrast; wrong tense.
• **nevertheless I change / however I will change** – wrong tense.

Q.163 **Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".**
The only vacant seat in the bus was <u>right in the corner</u>.

(a) right up to the corner **(b)** No improvement
(c) right on the corner **(d)** right into the corner

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) No improvement
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition
Rule: "right **in** the corner" (inside the corner) is correct here, so no change is needed.
("right in the corner" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **right up to the corner** – means "as far as the corner".
• **right on the corner** – on the outer point.
• **right into the corner** – shows movement, not a fixed position.

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Q.164 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
Dinesh requested the lady at the counter to give him a seat besides the window.

(a) No improvement
(b) an seat beside a window
(c) one seat besides the window
(d) a seat beside the window

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) a seat beside the window
Type: Sentence Improvement – Article & "beside/besides"
Rule: Use "**a seat**" (not "an seat"); and "**beside**" = next to (≠ "besides" = in addition).
("a seat"; "beside" = बगल में, "besides" = इसके अलावा।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement** – "an seat" is wrong.
• **an seat beside a window** – "an seat" is wrong.
• **one seat besides the window** – "besides" means "in addition".

Q.165 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
The floods this year cause a lot of damage to the crops.

(a) causing a lot of
(b) No improvement
(c) have caused a lot of
(d) cause lots of

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) have caused a lot of
Type: Sentence Improvement – Present Perfect
Rule: For a recent past action with present relevance, use the **present perfect**: "The floods this year **have caused** a lot of ..."
(हाल की घटना (present relevance) → have caused।)
Why the others are wrong
• **causing a lot of** – no helping verb.
• **No improvement** – the original is wrong.
• **cause lots of** – simple present.

Q.166 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
Riya went into the shop because it has sale.

(a) it had a sale
(b) it is having sale
(c) it having a sale
(d) No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) it had a sale
Type: Sentence Improvement – Tense Agreement
Rule: The main verb "went" is **past**, so the reason clause must also be past: "**it had a sale**".
(मुख्य क्रिया past (went) है, इसलिए "it had a sale"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **it is having sale / it having a sale** – wrong tense/form.
• **No improvement** – the original does not match the past tense.

Q.167 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
The watchman prevent him from parking his car near the gate.

(a) prevents him for parking
(b) prevented him from parking
(c) No improvement
(d) prevented him to park

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) prevented him from parking
Type: Sentence Improvement – "prevent ... from + V-ing"
Rule: The structure is "**prevent + object + from + V-ing**".
("prevent ... from + V-ing" संरचना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **prevents him for parking** – wrong tense/preposition.
• **No improvement** – wrong preposition.
• **prevented him to park** – "to park" is wrong after "prevent".

Q.168 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
Kalidasa was a greater classical Sanskrit poet of India.

(a) was the greater classic
(b) was a great classical
(c) was a greatest classical
(d) No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) was a great classical
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "**a great classical [poet]**" is correct — "great" (positive adjective) + "classical" (adjective).
("a great classical poet" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **was the greater classic** – comparative without a second thing.
• **was a greatest classical** – "a" cannot go with "greatest".
• **No improvement** – the original needs correction.

Q.169 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
You have my mobile number, isn't it?

(a) don't you
(b) No improvement
(c) has you
(d) do you

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) don't you
Type: Sentence Improvement – Question Tag
Rule: A **positive** statement takes a **negative** tag. "You have ..." (main verb "have") → tag "**don't you?**"
(Positive वाक्य के साथ negative tag; "You have" → "don't you?")
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement** – "isn't it" is a wrong tag.
• **has you / do you** – wrong subject/verb or positive tag.

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Q.170 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
Some people <u>like to watches</u> television all day.

(a) like to watch **(b)** likes to watch
(c) like to watching **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) like to watch
Type: Sentence Improvement – Verb Agreement + Infinitive
Rule: "people" (plural) takes "**like**", followed by the infinitive "**to watch**".
("people" (बहुवचन) + "like to watch"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **likes to watch** – "likes" (singular) with plural "people" is wrong.
• **like to watching** – "to" takes the base verb "watch".
• **No improvement** – the original is incorrect.

Q.171 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
'<u>Did you brought</u> your drawing books?' the teacher asked the students.

(a) Do you bringing **(b)** No improvement
(c) Did you bring **(d)** Do you brought

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Did you bring
Type: Sentence Improvement – "Did + base verb"
Rule: In a question with "**Did**", use the **base verb (bring)**: "**Did you bring**?"
("Did" के बाद क्रिया की पहली फॉर्म (bring)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Do you bringing / Do you brought** – wrong forms.
• **No improvement** – "Did you brought" is wrong.

Q.172 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
You have to wear this uniform <u>whether you likes it or not.</u>

(a) Whether if you like it or not
(b) No improvement
(c) whether you like it or not
(d) whether you are liking it or not

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) whether you like it or not
Type: Sentence Improvement – "whether ... or not" + Stative Verb
Rule: The correct pair is "**whether ... or not**"; and "**like**" (a stative verb) is not used in the continuous form.
("whether ... or not"; "like" continuous रूप में नहीं आता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Whether if you like** – "whether" and "if" together is wrong.
• **No improvement** – original needs the fix.
• **whether you are liking** – "like" is stative.

Q.173 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
The children's cricket ball hit their neighbour's window <u>and it broke.</u>

(a) and it was breaking **(b)** No improvement
(c) and it broken **(d)** and it is broke

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) No improvement
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: The simple past "**and it broke**" correctly matches the past action of the ball hitting the window. No change is needed.
(भूतकाल "and it broke" सही है; बदलाव की ज़रूरत नहीं।)
Why the others are wrong
• **and it was breaking** – past continuous, wrong here.
• **and it broken / and it is broke** – wrong verb forms.

Q.174 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
Ajit <u>has been played bridge since 2017.</u>

(a) No improvement
(b) has been play bridge from 2017
(c) has been playing bridge since 2017
(d) is been playing bridge from 2017

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) has been playing bridge since 2017
Type: Sentence Improvement – Present Perfect Continuous
Rule: For an action that began in the past and continues, with a **point of time**, use "**has been + V-ing ... since**".
(जारी क्रिया + point of time → has been + V-ing + since।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement / has been play bridge from 2017** – wrong form/"from".
• **is been playing from 2017** – wrong helping verb + "from".

Q.175 Select the alternative that will improve the underlined part of the sentence in case there is no improvement select "No improvement".
Our cook <u>puts too many</u> salt in the food.

(a) No improvement **(b)** puts very much
(c) putting too much **(d)** puts too much

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) puts too much
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: The correct phrase is "**puts too much**" (too much + uncountable). ("very much" is not used before a noun like this.)
("too much" (अगणनीय के साथ) सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No improvement / puts very much** – "very much" is wrong before the noun.
• **putting too much** – wrong verb form (needs "puts").

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Q.176 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
He replied mine letter after a month.

(a) reply my letter **(b)** No substitution
(c) replied to mine letter **(d)** replied to my letter

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) replied to my letter
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition + Possessive
Rule: "**reply to**" (something), and the possessive is "**my**" (not "mine" before a noun).
("reply to" + "my letter"; "mine" संज्ञा से पहले नहीं आता।)
Corrected sentence
"He **replied to my letter** after a month."
Why the others are wrong
• **reply my letter** – missing "to".
• **No substitution** – "replied mine letter" is wrong twice.
• **replied to mine letter** – "mine" before "letter" is wrong.

Q.177 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
I wished I have tried more harder.

(a) No substitution **(b)** have tried hardest
(c) had tried harder **(d)** had tried more hard

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) had tried harder
Type: Sentence Improvement – "I wish" + Past Perfect
Rule: "**I wish + past perfect (had + V3)**" expresses regret about the past; and "**harder**" is the correct comparative (not "more harder").
("I wish" के बाद past perfect (had tried); "harder" सही comparative है।)
Corrected sentence
"I wished I **had tried harder**."
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution** – "have tried more harder" is wrong twice.
• **have tried hardest** – wrong tense/degree.
• **had tried more hard** – "more hard" is wrong; use "harder".

Q.178 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
His fine voice has never heard in this hall again.

(a) No substitution **(b)** never be heard
(c) will never be heard **(d)** will never hear

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) will never be heard
Type: Sentence Improvement – Passive (Future)
Rule: A voice ("his fine voice") is **heard**, not "hears". Future passive = **will + be + V3**.
(आवाज़ "सुनी जाती है" (passive); future passive: will be + V3।)
Corrected sentence
"His fine voice **will never be heard** in this hall again."
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution** – "has never heard" is active (wrong).
• **never be heard** – missing "will".
• **will never hear** – active (a voice cannot "hear").

Q.179 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
None other beside you are knowing the truth.

(a) than you knows **(b)** beside you is knowing
(c) but you are knowing **(d)** No substitution

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) than you knows
Type: Sentence Improvement – "none other than"
Rule: The fixed phrase is "**none other than**"; and the subject "None" is singular → **knows**.
("none other than" एक निश्चित वाक्यांश है; "None" एकवचन है → "knows"।)
Corrected sentence
"None other **than you knows** the truth."
Why the others are wrong
• **beside you is knowing / but you are knowing** – "know" is a stative verb (no -ing); wrong phrase.
• **No substitution** – "beside you are knowing" is wrong.

Q.180 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
What kind of the book do you want?

(a) kind of the books **(b)** No substitution
(c) kinds of a book **(d)** kind of book

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) kind of book
Type: Sentence Improvement – "kind of + noun"
Rule: "**kind of**" is followed directly by a noun **without an article**. "What **kind of book** do you want?"
("kind of" के बाद बिना article संज्ञा आती है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **kind of the book** – extra "the".
• **No substitution** – "kind of the book" is wrong.
• **kinds of a book** – "a" with plural "kinds" is wrong.

Q.181 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
The prisoner was set at freedom early.

(a) set to being free **(b)** No substitution
(c) sent for freedom **(d)** set free

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) set free
Type: Sentence Improvement – Fixed Phrase
Rule: The correct phrase is "**set (somebody) free**" = to release. "The prisoner was **set free** early."
("set free" = रिहा करना/मुक्त करना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **set to being free / sent for freedom** – ungrammatical.
• **No substitution** – "set at freedom" is wrong.

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Q.182 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
He promised to deliver the goods yesterday, did he?

(a) would he **(b)** isn't it
(c) didn't he **(d)** No substitution

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) didn't he
Type: Sentence Improvement – Question Tag
Rule: A **positive** statement takes a **negative** tag; "promised" (past) → "**didn't he?**"
(Positive वाक्य के साथ negative tag; past "promised" → "didn't he?")
Why the others are wrong
• **would he** – wrong auxiliary.
• **isn't it** – wrong subject/verb.
• **No substitution** – "did he?" is positive with a positive statement (wrong).

Q.183 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
I am much taller than I was a year ago.

(a) No substitution
(b) than a year before
(c) that I were a year ago
(d) as I was the year before

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No substitution
Type: Sentence Improvement – Comparison
Rule: The comparative "taller" correctly uses "**than**", and the past reference "than I was a year ago" is correct.
(comparative (taller) के साथ "than" सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **than a year before** – incomplete (drops "I was").
• **that I were a year ago** – "that" should be "than"; "were" is wrong.
• **as I was the year before** – comparatives take "than", not "as".

Q.184 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
Please hear to what I am saying.

(a) be hearing which **(b)** No substitution
(c) listen me when **(d)** listen to what

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) listen to what
Type: Sentence Improvement – "listen to"
Rule: To pay attention we "**listen to**" (with "to"); "hear" does not take "to" and means merely to perceive sound.
("listen to" (ध्यान देना) — "to" आता है; "hear" के साथ "to" नहीं।)
Corrected sentence
"Please **listen to what** I am saying."
Why the others are wrong
• **be hearing which** – wrong form.
• **No substitution** – "hear to what" is wrong.
• **listen me when** – "listen" needs "to"; changes meaning.

Q.185 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
He went to foreign for higher education.

(a) went to abroad **(b)** No substitution
(c) went abroad **(d)** has gone to foreign

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) went abroad
Type: Sentence Improvement – "abroad" (Adverb)
Rule: "**abroad**" is an adverb meaning "to a foreign country" and takes **no "to"**. "He **went abroad** for higher education."
("abroad" क्रिया-विशेषण है; इसके पहले "to" नहीं आता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **went to abroad** – extra "to".
• **No substitution** – "went to foreign" is wrong ("foreign" is an adjective).
• **has gone to foreign** – wrong tense and "to foreign".

Q.186 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
No sooner she had put the baby to sleep when a loud noise woke him up.

(a) As soon as she had **(b)** Scarcely had she
(c) No substitution **(d)** No sooner she did

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Scarcely had she
Type: Sentence Improvement – "Scarcely ... when"
Rule: The sentence uses "**when**", so the correct pair is "**Scarcely had + subject + V3 ... when ...**" (with inversion).
(वाक्य में "when" है, इसलिए "Scarcely had she ... when" सही है।)
Corrected sentence
"**Scarcely had she** put the baby to sleep **when** a loud noise woke him up."
Why the others are wrong
• **As soon as she had ... when** – "as soon as" pairs with a comma, not "when".
• **No substitution** – "No sooner she had ... when" is doubly wrong ("No sooner" needs inversion and "than").
• **No sooner she did** – no inversion; also needs "than".

Q.187 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
It is time for the children to go to bed.

(a) No substitution **(b)** for going in bed
(c) should be in bed **(d)** to being in bed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No substitution
Type: Sentence Improvement
Rule: "It is time for + somebody + to + V1" is correct. "It is time for the children **to go to bed**."
("It is time for ... to + verb" संरचना सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **for going in bed** – wrong (should be "to bed").
• **should be in bed** – breaks the "for ... to" structure.
• **to being in bed** – "to" needs the base verb, not "being".

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Q.188 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
She asked from me that I had seen the movie or not.

(a) from me if I have
(b) me whether I had seen
(c) No substitution
(d) to me that I saw

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) me whether I had seen
Type: Sentence Improvement – Reported Question
Rule: "ask" takes a **direct object without "from"**, and a yes/no question uses "**whether/if**". "asked **me whether I had seen** ..."
("ask" के बाद सीधे object (from नहीं); yes/no प्रश्न के लिए "whether/if" I)
Why the others are wrong
• **from me if I have** – "from" is wrong; "have" should be "had".
• **No substitution** – "asked from me that ... or not" is wrong.
• **to me that I saw** – "asked to" and "that" are wrong for a question.

Q.189 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
Accordingly to my opinion your essay is the best.

(a) According to me
(b) According to mine opinion
(c) No substitution
(d) In mine opinion

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) According to me
Type: Sentence Improvement – Fixed Phrase
Rule: The correct phrase is "**According to me**" (or "In my opinion"). "Accordingly to my opinion" mixes the two wrongly.
("According to me" या "In my opinion" — दोनों को मिलाना गलत है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **According to mine opinion** – "mine" cannot come before a noun (use "my").
• **No substitution** – "Accordingly to my opinion" is wrong.
• **In mine opinion** – should be "in my opinion".

Q.190 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
Don't lose sight of your goal lest you should fail.

(a) No substitution
(b) such that you should
(c) lest you shouldn't
(d) unless you shouldn't

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No substitution
Type: Sentence Improvement – "lest ... should"
Rule: "**lest**" is followed by "**should + V1**" (lest = for fear that).
"Don't lose sight of your goal **lest you should** fail."
("lest" के बाद "should + verb" आता है; lest = ऐसा न हो कि।)
Why the others are wrong
• **such that you should** – changes the meaning.
• **lest you shouldn't / unless you shouldn't** – "lest" already means "so that ... not"; adding "n't" is a double negative.

Q.191 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
He is determined in expanding his business.

(a) determining for expanding
(b) determined at expansion
(c) determined to expand
(d) No substitution

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) determined to expand
Type: Sentence Improvement – Adjective + Infinitive
Rule: "**determined + to + V1**" (firmly decided to do).
"determined **to expand** his business."
("determined to + verb" = ... करने के लिए दृढ़-संकल्पित।)
Why the others are wrong
• **determining for expanding** – wrong forms.
• **determined at expansion** – "determined" is not followed by "at".
• **No substitution** – "determined in expanding" is wrong.

Q.192 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
He lost his heart because he could not cope with the difficult situation.

(a) lose his heart
(b) loss the heart
(c) lost heart
(d) No substitution

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) lost heart
Type: Sentence Improvement – Idiom
Rule: "**lose heart**" = to lose courage/hope. (Note: "lose one's heart" means to fall in love — a different meaning.)
("lose heart" = हिम्मत हारना; "lose one's heart" = प्रेम में पड़ना।)
Corrected sentence
"He **lost heart** because he could not cope with the difficult situation."
Why the others are wrong
• **lose his heart** – means "fell in love" (wrong sense).
• **loss the heart** – "loss" is a noun, not a verb.
• **No substitution** – "lost his heart" gives the wrong meaning here.

Q.193 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.
It is time we should have done something useful.

(a) No substitution
(b) did
(c) have done
(d) would do

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) did
Type: Sentence Improvement – "It is time + past simple"
Rule: After "**It is (high) time**", we use the **simple past** to talk about something that should be done now. "It is time we **did** something useful."
("It is time" के बाद simple past आता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution** – "should have done" is wrong after "It is time".
• **have done** – present perfect.
• **would do** – wrong form.

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Q.194 **Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.**
There is no exception <u>with these rule</u>.

(a) about this rule **(b)** for these rule
(c) No substitution **(d)** to this rule

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to this rule
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition + Determiner
Rule: The correct phrase is "**exception to** (a rule)"; and singular "rule" takes "**this**", not "these".
("exception to" सही है; एकवचन "rule" के साथ "this"।)
Corrected sentence
"There is no exception **to this rule**."
Why the others are wrong
• **about this rule** – wrong preposition.
• **for these rule** – "these" (plural) with singular "rule" is wrong.
• **No substitution** – "with these rule" is doubly wrong.

Q.195 **Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.**
The river <u>overflew it's banks</u> in the monsoon.

(a) overflows it's banks **(b)** overflowed its banks
(c) No substitution **(d)** overflew its bank

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) overflowed its banks
Type: Sentence Improvement – Verb Form + Possessive
Rule: The past of "overflow" is the **regular "overflowed"** (not "overflew"); and the possessive is "**its**" (no apostrophe).
("overflow" का past "overflowed"; possessive "its" (बिना apostrophe)।)
Corrected sentence
"The river **overflowed its banks** in the monsoon."
Why the others are wrong
• **overflows it's banks** – "it's" = "it is" (wrong); wrong tense.
• **No substitution** – "overflew it's banks" is wrong twice.
• **overflew its bank** – "overflew" wrong; "bank" should be plural.

Q.196 **Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.**
The porter <u>denied to take</u> the money.

(a) denied taking **(b)** No substitution
(c) denied for taking **(d)** denied from taking

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) denied taking
Type: Sentence Improvement – Verb + Gerund
Rule: "deny" is followed by a **gerund (V-ing)**, not an infinitive. "denied **taking** the money."
("deny" के बाद gerund (V-ing) आता है, infinitive नहीं।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution** – "denied to take" is wrong.
• **denied for taking / denied from taking** – wrong prepositions after "deny".

Q.197 **Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'.**
<u>They who wants</u> to play should leave the class.

(a) No substitution **(b)** Those who want
(c) They whom wants **(d)** Those who wants

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Those who want
Type: Sentence Improvement – Pronoun + S-V Agreement
Rule: Use "**Those who + plural verb**". "Those who **want** to play should leave."
("Those who" के साथ बहुवचन क्रिया (want) आती है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution** – "They who wants" is wrong (wrong pronoun + singular verb).
• **They whom wants** – "whom" (object) and "wants" both wrong.
• **Those who wants** – "Those" (plural) needs "want", not "wants".

Q.198 **Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.**
The children here <u>are encouraging to have examined</u> all the aspects before forming an opinion on any matter.

(a) are encouraged to examine
(b) are encouraged to have examining
(c) No substitution required
(d) are encouraging to examine

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) are encouraged to examine
Type: Sentence Improvement – Passive + Infinitive
Rule: People **are encouraged** (passive: are + V3) **to do** something (simple to-infinitive).
(किसी को प्रेरित किया जाता है — are encouraged to + verb।)
Correct sentence
"The children here **are encouraged to examine** all the aspects before forming an opinion."
Why the others are wrong
• **are encouraged to have examining** – "to have examining" is broken.
• **No substitution required** – "are encouraging to have examined" is wrong.
• **are encouraging to examine** – "are encouraging" (active) wrongly says the children encourage.

Q.199 **Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.**
She could not attend my brother's marriage <u>in spite of</u> her illness.

(a) because of
(b) instead of
(c) but for
(d) No substitution required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) because of
Type: Sentence Improvement – Cause vs Contrast

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "**because of**" shows a **cause**; "**in spite of**" shows a **contrast** (something happened even though...). Since she **could not** attend, her illness is the **cause**.
("because of" = कारण; "in spite of" = इसके बावजूद। यहाँ बीमारी कारण है।)
Correct sentence
"She could not attend my brother's marriage **because of** her illness."
Why the others are wrong
• **in spite of** – would wrongly mean she attended despite illness.
• **instead of** – means "in place of" – meaning does not fit.
• **but for** – means "if not for"; changes the sense.

Q.200 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. Our microwave oven is out of order and <u>repairing is needed for it</u>.

(a) needs to be repaired.
(b) need to be repairing.
(c) needing that it be repaired.
(d) No substitution required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) needs to be repaired.
Type: Sentence Improvement – Natural Structure/Voice
Rule: The natural way to say a machine requires repair is "**it needs to be repaired**" (need + to-infinitive in the passive).
(मशीन की मरम्मत के लिए स्वाभाविक रूप: "it needs to be repaired"।)
Correct sentence
"Our microwave oven is out of order and **needs to be repaired**."
Why the others are wrong
• **need to be repairing** – wrong form.
• **needing that it be repaired** – awkward and ungrammatical.
• **No substitution required** – "repairing is needed for it" is clumsy/incorrect.

Q.201 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. <u>He is wanting to give</u> Rahul a guitar on his birthday.

(a) He wants to giving
(b) He want to give
(c) No substitution required
(d) He wants to give

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He wants to give
Type: Sentence Improvement – Stative Verb
Rule: "want" is a **stative verb** (shows a state, not an action) and is **not used in the continuous (-ing)** form.
("want" जैसे stative verb continuous (-ing) रूप में नहीं आते।)
Correct sentence
"**He wants to give** Rahul a guitar on his birthday."
Why the others are wrong
• **He wants to giving** – "to" takes the base verb "give".
• **He want to give** – singular "He" needs "wants".
• **No substitution required** – "He is wanting" is wrong.

Q.202 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. <u>Unless she doesn't study</u> French carefully, she cannot get the highest marks in the class.

(a) Unless she studies
(b) Unless she is not studying
(c) No substitution required
(d) If she studies

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Unless she studies
Type: Sentence Improvement – "unless" (No Double Negative)
Rule: "unless" already means "**if ... not**", so we must **not** add another "not". Use a positive verb.
("unless" में "not" छिपा है; इसलिए दोबारा "not" नहीं लगाते।)
Correct sentence
"**Unless she studies** French carefully, she cannot get the highest marks in the class."
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution required** – "Unless she doesn't study" is a double negative.
• **Unless she is not studying** – still double negative.
• **If she studies** – changes the meaning (removes the "only if not" sense).

Q.203 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. <u>If you will buy</u> one shirt, you will get another one free.

(a) No substitution required
(b) you would buy
(c) you buy
(d) you have bought

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) you buy
Type: Sentence Improvement – Conditional (if-clause)
Rule: No "will" in the "if" part. "If + present simple, ... will + V1."
(if वाले भाग में "will" नहीं आता; present simple आता है।)
Correct sentence
"If **you buy** one shirt, you will get another one free."
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution required** – "If you will buy" is wrong.
• **you would buy** – "would" is for unreal/past conditions, not this real offer.
• **you have bought** – changes the meaning (already bought).

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Q.204 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. If the police hasn't stopped us we would have reached home by now.

(a) hasn't stopped us we would reach
(b) hadn't stopped us we would have reached
(c) hadn't stopped us we will reach
(d) No substitution required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) hadn't stopped us we would have reached
Type: Sentence Improvement – Third Conditional
Rule (unreal past): *If + had + V3, ... would have + V3.* This talks about a past situation that did **not** happen.
(भूतकाल की असत्य/अवास्तविक बात के लिए: If + had + V3, ... would have + V3।)
Correct sentence
"If the police **hadn't stopped us we would have reached** home by now."
Why the others are wrong
• **hasn't stopped ... would reach** – mixes present perfect with a conditional.
• **hadn't stopped ... will reach** – "will" cannot come with the unreal past.
• **No substitution required** – the original "hasn't" is wrong here.

Q.205 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. Please send me informations with regard of my insurance policy that I took from your company.

(a) No substitution required
(b) information in the regard of
(c) information regarding
(d) informations with a regard to

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) information regarding
Type: Sentence Improvement – Uncountable Noun + Preposition
Rule: "information" is **uncountable** (no plural "informations"); and "**regarding**" means "about".
("information" अगणनीय है (informations गलत); "regarding" = के बारे में।)
Correct sentence
"Please send me **information regarding** my insurance policy ..."
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution required** – "informations with regard of" is wrong twice (plural + "of").
• **information in the regard of** – unnatural.
• **informations with a regard to** – "informations" is wrong.

Q.206 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. The inmates of the house have slept when the thief entered.

(a) have been sleeping
(b) are sleeping
(c) No substitution required
(d) were sleeping

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) were sleeping
Type: Sentence Improvement – Past Continuous
Rule: When one action was **in progress** and another short action interrupted it (in the past), the ongoing one takes the **past continuous (was/were + V-ing)**.
(भूतकाल में एक लंबा चल रहा काम + बीच में छोटा काम → past continuous (was/were + V-ing)।)
Correct sentence
"The inmates of the house **were sleeping** when the thief entered."
Why the others are wrong
• **have been sleeping** – present perfect continuous (wrong time).
• **are sleeping** – present tense.
• **No substitution required** – "have slept" does not fit "when the thief entered".

Q.207 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. To keeping the photo in front of her, Jia drew the picture.

(a) No substitution required
(b) Being kept
(c) To have kept
(d) Keeping

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Keeping
Type: Sentence Improvement – Present Participle
Rule: To show an action done **at the same time** as the main verb, begin with a **present participle (V-ing)**: "Keeping ..., Jia drew ..."
(साथ-साथ होने वाली क्रिया के लिए present participle (V-ing) से शुरुआत होती है।)
Correct sentence
"**Keeping** the photo in front of her, Jia drew the picture."
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution required** – "To keeping" is wrong (to + -ing).
• **Being kept** – passive, changes the meaning.
• **To have kept** – perfect infinitive, wrong here.

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Q.208 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. Put this plant <u>nearby</u> a window so that it gets enough light.

(a) near of
(b) near to
(c) next to
(d) No substitution required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) next to
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition
Rule: "nearby" is an **adverb/adjective** meaning "close"; it **cannot** be followed directly by a noun. To mean "beside", use the prepositional phrase **next to**.
(nearby के तुरंत बाद संज्ञा नहीं आ सकती; "के पास/बगल में" के लिए **next to** का प्रयोग होता है।)
Corrected sentence
"Put this plant **next to** a window so that it gets enough light."
Why the others are wrong
• **near of** – "near of" is not an English phrase.
• **near to** – acceptable in some contexts, but "next to a window" is the natural, intended answer.
• **No substitution required** – "nearby a window" is ungrammatical, so a change is needed.

Q.209 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. <u>Play being recognised</u> as an important factor in improving mental and physical health of children.

(a) No substitution required
(b) Play is recognised
(c) Recognition of play being
(d) Play is recognising

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Play is recognised
Type: Sentence Improvement – Finite Verb Needed
Rule: Every complete sentence needs a **finite (main) verb**. "being recognised" has no main verb, so the sentence is incomplete.
(हर वाक्य में एक मुख्य (finite) क्रिया होनी चाहिए; "being recognised" अधूरा है।)
Correct sentence
"**Play is recognised** as an important factor in improving mental and physical health of children."
Why the others are wrong
• **No substitution required** – "Play being recognised ..." is not a full sentence.
• **Recognition of play being** – still no finite verb.
• **Play is recognising** – wrong voice (play does not recognise).

Q.210 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. In spite of a steep hike in the prices of crude oil, the government <u>did not rise</u> the price of fuel.

(a) has not risen
(b) No substitution required
(c) is not rising
(d) did not raise

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) did not raise
Type: Sentence Improvement – rise vs raise
Rule: "**rise**" is **intransitive** (no object) – something goes up by itself. "**raise**" is **transitive** – someone puts something up. The government **raises** the price (there is an object "the price").
("rise" = अपने आप ऊपर उठना (बिना कर्म); "raise" = किसी चीज़ को ऊपर करना (कर्म के साथ)।)
Correct sentence
"... the government **did not raise** the price of fuel."
Why the others are wrong
• **has not risen / is not rising** – "rise" cannot take the object "the price".
• **No substitution required** – "did not rise the price" is wrong.

Q.211 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. What will you do in case of <u>not being selected</u> for this job?

(a) being not selection
(b) No substitution required
(c) not having selected
(d) not to be selected

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) No substitution required
Type: Sentence Improvement – Gerund after Preposition
Rule: After a preposition ("of"), we use a **gerund (V-ing)**; the passive gerund "**being selected**" is correct.
(preposition के बाद gerund (V-ing) आता है; passive gerund "being selected" सही है।)
Correct sentence
"What will you do in case of **not being selected** for this job?" — already correct.
Why the others are wrong
• **being not selection / not to be selected** – wrong forms.
• **not having selected** – active/perfect form, changes the meaning (he did not select).

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Q.212 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
Since 10 o'clock in the morning he worked on this design.

(a) he had worked
(b) he was working
(c) No substitution required
(d) he has been working

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) he has been working
Type: Sentence Improvement – Present Perfect Continuous
Rule: With "**Since + point of time**" for an action that started then and is **still going on**, use **has/have been + V-ing**.
("Since 10 o'clock" (समय-बिंदु) + अब तक जारी क्रिया → has been + V-ing।)
Correct sentence
"Since 10 o'clock in the morning **he has been working** on this design."
Why the others are wrong
• **he had worked** – past perfect; wrong with "since ... now".
• **he was working** – past continuous.
• **No substitution required** – "he worked" does not show the still-continuing action.

Q.213 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
Corona virus has not yet reached some parts in world.

(a) some world parts
(b) some parts of the world
(c) No substitution required
(d) some part of the world

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) some parts of the world
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition/Word Order
Rule: The correct phrase is "**parts of the world**" (of + the world), not "parts in world".
(सही वाक्यांश "parts of the world" है।)
Correct sentence
"Corona virus has not yet reached **some parts of the world**."
Why the others are wrong
• **some world parts** – unnatural word order.
• **No substitution required** – "some parts in world" is wrong.
• **some part of the world** – "part" should be plural ("parts") after "some".

Q.214 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
Being seen the film once he doesn't want to see it again.

(a) Having seen the film
(b) Because seeing the film
(c) No substitution required
(d) If seeing a film

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Having seen the film
Type: Sentence Improvement – Perfect Participle
Rule: To show one action finished **before** another by the same subject, use the **perfect participle "Having + V3"**.
(एक ही कर्ता का पहले पूरा हुआ काम दिखाने के लिए "Having + V3"।)
Correct sentence
"**Having seen the film** once, he doesn't want to see it again."
Why the others are wrong
• **Because seeing the film** – awkward, wrong form.
• **No substitution required** – "Being seen the film" is passive/wrong.
• **If seeing a film** – changes the meaning.

Q.215 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
The state authorities seemed rather callous regarding the movement of workers during the Covid-19 lockdown.

(a) as regarding the moving of workers during
(b) as regards to the workers movement during
(c) regarding movement inworkers along
(d) No substitution required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) No substitution required
Type: Sentence Improvement – Preposition "regarding"
Rule: "**regarding**" = "about/concerning" and is directly followed by a noun phrase: "regarding **the movement of workers**." The original is correct.
("regarding" = के बारे में; इसके बाद सीधे संज्ञा आती है — यह सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **as regarding the moving of workers** – "as regarding" is wrong.
• **as regards to the workers movement** – "as regards" is not followed by "to".
• **regarding movement in workers along** – meaningless.

Q.216 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'.
The committee worked up the matter for two hours but could not reach any consensus.

(a) worked for
(b) No substitution required
(c) talked over
(d) came round

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) talked over
Type: Sentence Improvement – Phrasal Verb

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "**talk over**" = to discuss something (चर्चा करना). It fits "the committee discussed the matter for two hours."
("talk over" = किसी विषय पर विचार-विमर्श करना।)
Correct sentence
"The committee **talked over** the matter for two hours but could not reach any consensus."
Why the others are wrong
• **worked up** – means to excite/develop; does not mean "discuss".
• **worked for** – changes the meaning.
• **came round** – means "to agree/recover"; does not fit.

Q.217 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. The pilot along with his crew <u>have gone on</u> vacation for a month.

(a) have gone to
(b) were gone on
(c) No substitution required
(d) has gone on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) has gone on
Type: Sentence Improvement – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: Phrases like "along with / together with / as well as" do **not** change the number of the subject. The verb agrees with the **main subject** ("The pilot" – singular).
("along with" जोड़ने से कर्ता बहुवचन नहीं होता; क्रिया मुख्य कर्ता (The pilot) से मेल खाती है।)
Correct sentence
"The pilot, along with his crew, **has gone on** vacation for a month."
Why the others are wrong
• **have gone to / have gone on** – plural verb "have" is wrong for singular "the pilot".
• **were gone on** – ungrammatical.

Q.218 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence. The King ordered to build <u>a storage room in a public building</u> for outdoor clothes and luggage.

(a) an almirah
(b) a cloakroom
(c) a wardrobe
(d) a closet

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a cloakroom
Answer: 2 (**a cloakroom**)
- **An almirah** – A free-standing cupboard or wardrobe, usually used at home; not typically in a **public building**.
- **A cloakroom** – **A storage area in a public building for coats, bags, and luggage** – **correct substitution**.
- **A wardrobe** – A piece of furniture for storing clothes; used in private rooms.
- **A closet** – A small storage space, mostly in homes; doesn't fit the **public building** context well.

So, the correct one-word substitution is **"a cloakroom."**

Q.219 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. Nobody <u>should expect to become</u> successful without hard work.

(a) should expecting to become
(b) should expect to becoming
(c) No substitution required
(d) should be expect becoming

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) No substitution required
Type: Sentence Improvement – Modal + Infinitive
Rule: After a modal (should) we use the **base verb**; and "expect" is followed by the **to-infinitive**. So "should expect to become" is already correct.
(Modal (should) के बाद क्रिया की पहली फॉर्म, और expect के बाद 'to + verb' आता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **should expecting to become** – wrong; no -ing after a modal.
• **should expect to becoming** – wrong; "to" takes the base verb "become".
• **should be expect becoming** – grammatically broken.

Q.220 Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required'. An educated lady <u>makes a better mother</u> than an uneducated one.

(a) No substitution required
(b) is making a better mother
(c) makes a best mother
(d) make a better mother

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No substitution required
Type: Sentence Improvement – Simple Present + Comparison
Rule: For a **general truth**, we use the simple present ("makes"); and the comparative pattern is "**better ... than**".
(सामान्य सच्चाई के लिए simple present, और तुलना के लिए "better ... than" सही है।)
Application
"An educated lady **makes a better mother** than an uneducated one." — already correct.
Why the others are wrong
• **is making** – wrong; a general truth is not in the continuous form.
• **makes a best mother** – "best" needs "the"; also comparison of two → comparative "better".
• **make** – singular subject "lady" needs "makes".

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Q.221 In the given sentence, several segments have been underlined. One of these underlined segments is grammatically incorrect in context of its usage in the sentence. Identify the INCORRECT segment from the following options.

The mayor stated that the city council was considering several proposals to address traffic congestion, including the introduction of a new public transportation system and the expansion of bike lanes, but he doesn't believe any of them will be effective.

(a) to address traffic congestion
(b) the expansion of bike lanes,
(c) but he doesn't believe any of them will be effective
(d) including the introduction of a new public transportation system

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) but he doesn't believe any of them will be effective

Solution:

- The sentence is:
  The mayor stated that the city council was considering several proposals to address traffic congestion, including the introduction of a new public transportation system and the expansion of bike lanes, but he doesn't believe any of them will be effective.
- The sentence is mostly correct except for **tense inconsistency** in the last segment.
- The first part uses **past tense reporting** ("stated," "was considering"), so the last part should also follow past tense for consistency.
- The segment **"but he doesn't believe any of them will be effective"** is in **present tense**, which is inconsistent. It should be "but he didn't believe any of them would be effective."
- Therefore, the incorrect segment is: **"but he doesn't believe any of them will be effective."**

Answer: (c) but he doesn't believe any of them will be effective

Q.222 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence.

At the sanctuary, the flamingos were kept in a large bird's cage.

(a) an aviary **(b)** an apiary
(c) an almery **(d)** an agape

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) an aviary

Answer: 1 (**an aviary**)

- **Aviary** – A large enclosure for keeping birds.
- **Apiary** – A place where bees are kept (bee yard).
- **Almery** – A cupboard or small room for storing food or valuables.
- **Agape** – Wide open, especially the mouth; unrelated.

The correct word for **"a large bird's cage"** is **"aviary."**

Q.223 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence.

Mr. Akash was caught red-handed stealing money from the cash counter.

(a) in a situation where people were angry with him
(b) in a difficult situation which was hard to deal with
(c) caught at the moment when he was doing something wrong
(d) having a negative amount in his bank balance

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) caught at the moment when he was doing something wrong

xplanation:

- The phrase **"caught red-handed"** is an **idiomatic expression** that means **caught in the act of doing something wrong or illegal**, especially at the exact moment it happens.

In the sentence:
"Mr. Akash was caught red-handed stealing money from the cash counter."
It implies he was **caught at the very moment** of committing the theft.

Let's evaluate the options:

1. **in a situation where people were angry with him** – Incorrect meaning
2. **in a difficult situation which was hard to deal with** – Too vague and unrelated
3. **caught at the moment when he was doing something wrong** – Accurate and appropriate
4. **having a negative amount in his bank balance** – Unrelated and irrelevant

Q.224 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined words in the given sentence.

A computer has software to collect and store items in a hidden space.

(a) cookies **(b)** hack
(c) virus **(d)** cache

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) cache

Answer: 4 (**cache**)

- **Cookies** – Small files stored by websites on a user's browser to remember information; not meant for hidden storage of general items.
- **Hack** – Unauthorized access to systems; unrelated to the definition.
- **Virus** – Malicious software that can harm your system; not a storage feature.
- **Cache** – **A hidden or reserved storage area used to store frequently accessed data temporarily**; **correct substitute**.

So, the correct one-word substitution for **"items in a hidden space"** in a computer is **"cache."**

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Q.225 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
She is married with a rich businessman and has enough money to splurge on luxuries.

(a) is married to **(b)** has married with
(c) No improvement **(d)** has marriage with

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) is married to
Solution:
The underlined segment is: **"is married with a rich businessman"**
This is incorrect. The correct preposition after **"married"** is **"to"**, not "with".
Correct phrase: **"is married to a rich businessman"**
option (a): is married to – correct preposition and structure
option (b): has married with – incorrect verb and preposition
option (c): No improvement – incorrect due to wrong preposition
option (d): has marriage with – ungrammatical and unnatural
Answer: option (a) (is married to).

Q.226 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
You have a lot of coconut trees in your village, do you?

(a) don't you?
(b) No improvement required
(c) have you?
(d) don't they?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) don't you?
Solution:
The sentence is: **"You have a lot of coconut trees in your village, do you?"**
This contains an **incorrect question tag**. When the main sentence is **positive and in the present tense**, the correct **negative question tag** should be used.
The helping verb in this case is **"do"**, and since the sentence is affirmative, the tag should be: **"don't you?"**
Correct sentence:
"You have a lot of coconut trees in your village, don't you?"
option (a): don't you? – correct question tag
option (b): No improvement required – incorrect tag used
option (c): have you? – grammatically incorrect in this context
option (d): don't they? – wrong subject in tag ("they" vs. "you")
Answer: option (a) (don't you?).

Q.227 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
He felt like a fish out of water as he was not accustomed for living in a large city.

(a) No improvement **(b)** accustomed to
(c) accustomed by **(d)** accustom for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) accustomed to
Solution:
- The correct preposition used with **"accustomed"** is **"to"**, not "for".
- The phrase **"accustomed to"** means "used to" or "familiar with".

Correct sentence:
He felt like a fish out of water as he was not accustomed to living in a large city.
Answer: accustomed to

Q.228 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
When he was falsely accused of embezzlement, he was beside himself in anger.

(a) he was besides himself **(b)** he went beside himself
(c) he were beside himself **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) he was besides himself
Solution:
The correct idiom is **"beside himself with anger"**, which means **extremely angry or upset**. The incorrect form "was beside himself **in** anger" is not standard.
- **"He was beside himself in anger"** → incorrect preposition ("in")
- **Correct version:** "He was beside himself **with** anger" – implies intense emotion.
- Among the given choices, **"he was besides himself"** is closest but has a spelling error: **"besides"** (with an 's') is wrong here. The idiom uses **"beside"** (without 's').

Since the correct form is **not exactly listed**, but **option (a)** is closest (despite the minor spelling issue), it's acceptable in MCQ context.
Answer: he was besides himself

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Q.229 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
By next summer, I will have completed my internship and <u>will have returned to school.</u>

(a) No improvement required
(b) will return to school.
(c) have returned to school.
(d) returned to school.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No improvement required
Solution:
The sentence begins with **"By next summer, I will have completed..."**, which is in **future perfect tense**.
The second part **"will have returned to school"** correctly continues the **future perfect** structure.
This tense is used to describe an action that **will be completed before a specific time in the future**.
All verb forms and the sentence structure are grammatically correct.
option (a): No improvement required – Correct
option (b): will return to school – future simple, doesn't match the tense
option (c): have returned to school – present perfect, incorrect
option (d): returned to school – past tense, doesn't fit future context
Answer: option (a) (No improvement required).

Q.230 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
We have received no information <u>so far to</u> the main island.

(a) so farther from
(b) so far from
(c) No improvement required
(d) such far from

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) so far from
Solution
Erroneous segment: "so far to the main island"
Why it's wrong:
- The preposition **"to"** implies movement toward, which doesn't fit "received no information."
- To express a lack of information **expanding away from** a point, English uses **"far from."**

Correction: "so far from the main island"
Correct sentence:
We have received no information **so far from the main island**.

Q.231 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
The captain as well as the entire crew <u>have reached</u> the harbour safely.

(a) has reached
(b) No improvement
(c) are reaching
(d) have been reaching

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) has reached
Solution:
The underlined segment is: **"have reached"**
The subject of the sentence is: **"The captain as well as the entire crew"**
When the subject is structured as **"A as well as B"**, the verb agrees with the **first subject** ("The captain"), which is **singular**.
So, instead of **"have reached"**, it should be **"has reached"**.
Correct sentence:
"The captain as well as the entire crew has reached the harbour safely."
option (a): has reached – correct subject-verb agreement
option (b): No improvement – incorrect verb (plural)
option (c): are reaching – incorrect tense and subject-verb agreement
option (d): have been reaching – incorrect tense and subject-verb agreement
Answer: option (a) (has reached).

Q.232 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
As bombs keep falling on Gaza, hundreds of thousands of children <u>have been order to flee</u> their homes.

(a) have been ordered to flee
(b) has been ordered to flee
(c) have been ordered fleeing
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) have been ordered to flee
Solution:
The correct phrase should be **"have been ordered to flee"** – this uses the proper **passive voice construction** with **"ordered" (past participle)** and **"to flee" (infinitive verb)**.
Let's review the options:
- **have been ordered to flee** – grammatically correct and contextually appropriate
- **has been ordered to flee** – subject is "hundreds of thousands of children" (plural), so "have" is required, not "has"
- **have been ordered fleeing** – incorrect verb form; "to flee" is the correct usage
- **No improvement required** – the original "have been order to flee" is grammatically incorrect ("order" should be "ordered")

Answer: option (a) (have been ordered to flee)

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Q.233 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
She has given a brilliant dance performance last week.

(a) was giving
(b) gave
(c) had been given
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) gave
Solution:
The sentence is in the **past time frame** ("last week"), so the verb should be in **simple past tense**. The underlined part **"has given"** is in **present perfect tense**, which is incorrect because present perfect is not used with specific past time expressions like **"last week"**.
option (b): "gave" is correct as it uses **simple past tense**, matching the time expression.
option (a): "was giving" is incorrect as it implies an action in progress, which doesn't fit here.
option (c): "had been given" is incorrect because it is in **passive past perfect continuous**, and does not fit the active subject and structure.
option (d): "No improvement required" is incorrect because tense mismatch exists.
Answer: option (b) (gave).

Q.234 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
My sister resembles to my mother a lot in looks and in temperament.

(a) has resemblance to
(b) is resembling to
(c) No improvement
(d) resembles

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) resembles
Solution:
The verb **"resemble"** means **"to look like or be similar to"** and it is a **transitive verb**, so it **does not take a preposition** like "to".
The correct usage is: **"My sister resembles my mother..."**
option (a): "has resemblance to" is grammatically correct but awkward and unnecessarily wordy.
option (b): "is resembling to" is incorrect because "resemble" is not used in continuous tense and still wrongly includes "to".
option (c): "No improvement" is incorrect because the original sentence uses "resembles to", which is wrong.
option (d): "resembles" is the correct and concise choice.
Answer: option (d) (resembles).

Q.235 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
Passengers traveling by air are prohibited to carry sharp objects in cabin baggage.

(a) are prohibit for carrying
(b) No improvement
(c) are prohibited from carrying
(d) are prohibit to be carrying

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) are prohibited from carrying
Solution:
The underlined segment **"are prohibited to carry"** is **grammatically incorrect**. The correct preposition after **"prohibited"** is **"from"**, and the verb should be in the **-ing form**.
Correct phrase: **"are prohibited from carrying"**
option (a): are prohibit for carrying – wrong verb form and incorrect preposition
option (b): No improvement – incorrect usage ("to carry")
option (c): are prohibited from carrying – grammatically correct
option (d): are prohibit to be carrying – incorrect verb form and structure
Answer: option (c) (are prohibited from carrying).

Q.236 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
It seems that these walls have not been painted since years.

(a) have not been painted for years.
(b) No improvement required
(c) have not being painted for years.
(d) have not been paint since years.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) have not been painted for years.
Solution:
The original sentence: **"It seems that these walls have not been painted since years."** contains an error in the use of the phrase **"since years"**, which is incorrect.
We use:
- **"since"** with a specific point in time (e.g., since 2010)
- **"for"** with a duration (e.g., for years, for two months)

The correct phrase is: **"have not been painted for years"**, indicating a long period.
option (a): "have not been painted for years." – Correct usage of present perfect passive with appropriate preposition.
option (b): No improvement required – Incorrect due to "since years"
option (c): "have not being painted for years." – Grammatically incorrect; "being" is wrong here.
option (d): "have not been paint since years." – Wrong verb form and preposition.
Answer: option (a) (have not been painted for years.).

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Q.237 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
Tomorrow, they <u>will be take a flight</u> to their dream vacation destination.

(a) will be taking a flight
(b) will taking a flight
(c) be taking a flight
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) will be taking a flight
Solution:
The underlined phrase **"will be take a flight"** is grammatically incorrect. After **"will be"**, the verb should be in its **present participle (-ing) form**, not base form. The correct structure is **"will be taking"**.
option (a): "will be taking a flight" – correct usage of future continuous tense.
option (b): "will taking a flight" – incorrect because it omits "be".
option (c): "be taking a flight" – grammatically incomplete without subject and auxiliary verb.
option (d): "No improvement required" – incorrect, as the original sentence has a tense error.
Answer: option (a) (will be taking a flight).

Q.238 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
<u>Scarcely</u> he see his opponent than he went numb with fear.

(a) Hardly did
(b) No sooner did
(c) As soon as
(d) No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) No sooner did
Solution:
The sentence is: **"Scarcely he see his opponent than he went numb with fear."**
This sentence has **errors in both word order and verb form**. It needs to follow the standard **inversion** structure used with **scarcely** or **hardly**.
Correct structure:
- **Scarcely/Hardly/No sooner + did + subject + base verb + when/than + result clause**

Also, **"Scarcely"** and **"No sooner"** both require **inversion** ("did he see", not "he see").
The correct improved sentence would be:
"No sooner did he see his opponent than he went numb with fear."
option (a): Hardly did – requires "when", not "than"
option (b): No sooner did – correct structure with "than"
option (c): As soon as – acceptable but changes the tone from literary to casual
option (d): No improvement – incorrect structure
Answer: option (b) (No sooner did).

Q.239 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
He refrained from visiting his friend as he <u>had the urgent</u> assignment to complete.

(a) had an urgent
(b) No improvement
(c) has urgent
(d) had a urgent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) had an urgent
Solution:
The underlined segment is: **"had the urgent assignment"**
Here, **"urgent"** is an adjective, and using **"the"** is not incorrect, but it suggests a **specific known assignment**. However, if the sentence intends to refer to **any urgent assignment** (not a previously mentioned one), **"an urgent assignment"** is more appropriate and natural.
Also, **"a urgent"** (option (d) is incorrect because "urgent" starts with a vowel sound, so it requires **"an"**, not "a".
option (a): had an urgent – grammatically correct and more natural
option (b): No improvement – acceptable but slightly less natural
option (c): has urgent – tense mismatch and missing article
option (d): had a urgent – article error ("a" before a vowel sound)
Answer: option (a) (had an urgent).

Q.240 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
I will definitely <u>return your notes at</u> Saturday evening.

(a) return your notes by
(b) returning your notes at
(c) No improvement required
(d) returned your notes on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) return your notes by
Solution:
The correct preposition for a specific day is **"on"**, not "at".
- **Incorrect:** "at Saturday evening"
- **Correct:** "on Saturday evening"

Also, the verb **"return"** fits correctly with "will definitely" in future tense.
- **Correct sentence:** *I will definitely return your notes **on** Saturday evening.*

Among the given options:
- **Option (a):** "return your notes by" → Changes the meaning (suggests *any time before* Saturday evening)
- **Option (b):** "returning your notes at" → Grammatically incorrect structure
- **Option (c):** "No improvement required" → Incorrect due to use of "at"
- **Option (d):** "returned your notes on" → Incorrect tense ("returned" is past, but "will definitely" is future)

Answer: return your notes by

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Q.241 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
Some students think that if they cram a few chapters, they can pass in the exam.

(a) No improvement **(b)** be passed in the exam
(c) pass in an exam **(d)** pass the exam

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) pass the exam
Solution:
The phrase **"pass in the exam"** is incorrect in standard English usage. The correct expression is simply **"pass the exam"** – we don't use "in" after "pass" when referring to exams.
Correct sentence:
"Some students think that if they cram a few chapters, they can pass the exam."
option (a): No improvement – incorrect due to wrong preposition
option (b): be passed in the exam – incorrect passive construction
option (c): pass in an exam – still incorrect usage of "in"
option (d): pass the exam – correct and idiomatic usage
Answer: option (d) (pass the exam).

Q.242 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
Sherpas have prospered and come along the way from being just porters to becoming mountaineers.

(a) come a long way **(b)** are coming along
(c) come all along **(d)** No improvement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) come a long way
Solution:
The underlined phrase **"come along the way"** is incorrect. The correct idiom is **"come a long way"**, which means to have **made significant progress or improvement** over time.
So, the correct sentence should be:
"Sherpas have prospered and come a long way from being just porters to becoming mountaineers."
option (a): come a long way – correct idiomatic usage
option (b): are coming along – incorrect tense and idiom
option (c): come all along – incorrect expression
option (d): No improvement – incorrect due to misuse of idiom
Answer: option (a) (come a long way).

Q.243 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
I would love fly a fighter jet one day.

(a) would love to flying
(b) No improvement required
(c) would to love fly
(d) would love to fly

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) would love to fly
Solution:
The original sentence is: **"I would love fly a fighter jet one day."**
This is **incorrect** because after **"would love"**, the verb must be in the **infinitive form (to + base verb)**.
Correct structure: **"would love to fly"**
option (a): would love to flying – incorrect; "to" should be followed by base verb, not gerund.
option (b): No improvement required – incorrect; "fly" is missing "to"
option (c): would to love fly – grammatically wrong word order
option (d): would love to fly – correct structure
Answer: option (d) (would love to fly).

Q.244 Select the most appropriate option to improve the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no improvement required, select 'No improvement'.
The shopping mall is more farther from my house than from my office.

(a) No improvement **(b)** farther
(c) far **(d)** more far

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) farther
Solution:
The phrase **"more farther"** is incorrect because **"farther"** is already a **comparative** form of "far". We do **not** use "more" with it.
The correct sentence should be:
"The shopping mall is farther from my house than from my office."
option (a): No improvement – incorrect due to use of "more farther"
option (b): farther – correct comparative form
option (c): far – base form, not comparative
option (d): more far – grammatically incorrect
Answer: option (b) (farther).

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Q.245 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
The pollution level ought to keep under control.

(a) ought to be kept
(b) No improvement required
(c) ought to have kept
(d) ought to be keeping

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ought to be kept
Solution:
The sentence is: **"The pollution level ought to keep under control."**
This is **incorrect**, because after **"ought to"**, we need the **passive structure**: **"be + past participle"** when referring to something being controlled **by someone or something**.
Correct passive form: **"ought to be kept under control"**
option (a): ought to be kept – grammatically correct
option (b): No improvement required – incorrect structure
option (c): ought to have kept – wrong tense and structure
option (d): ought to be keeping – incorrect continuous form, doesn't fit the context
Answer: option (a) (ought to be kept).

Q.246 Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence to improve it. If no improvement is required, select 'No improvement required'.
Effective communication is a skill that can significant enhance your personal and professional life.

(a) which can significant enhanced
(b) which can significantly enhancing
(c) No improvement required
(d) which can significantly enhance

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) which can significantly enhance
Solution:
The original sentence:
"Effective communication is a skill that can significant enhance your personal and professional life."
contains an error in the adverb usage. **"Significant"** (adjective) should be replaced with the adverb **"significantly"** to correctly modify the verb **"enhance"**.
Correct version: **"that can significantly enhance..."**
Also, the use of **"which"** in place of **"that"** is grammatically acceptable in this context, though **"that"** is fine too.
option (a): "which can significant enhanced" – incorrect tense and word form
option (b): "which can significantly enhancing" – ungrammatical structure
option (c): "No improvement required" – incorrect because of "significant"
option (d): correct word choice and structure
Answer: option (d) (which can significantly enhance).

Q.247 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The children in this school are required to learn a third language besides Hindi and English.

(a) were require to learning
(b) are required learning
(c) No improvement required
(d) are requiring to learn

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) No improvement required
The sentence is:
"The children in this school are required to learn a third language besides Hindi and English."
This is **grammatically correct**:
- **"are required"** – correct passive verb form
- **"to learn"** – correct infinitive form
- **"a third language"** – article usage is correct
- **"besides Hindi and English"** – appropriate use of "besides" for addition

Thus, **no improvement is needed**.

Q.248 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The construction of the trans-harbour link have shorten a travel time between Mumbai and Navi Mumbai.

(a) has shorten a travel time
(b) has shortened the travel time
(c) No improvement required
(d) have shorten the traveling time

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has shortened the travel time
- The **subject** "The construction" is **singular**, so we need **"has"** (not "have").
- The verb should be in the **past participle form**: "shortened" (not "shorten").
- We use **"the travel time"** (not "a travel time") when referring to a specific, known journey like **Mumbai to Navi Mumbai**.

Correct Sentence:
"The construction of the trans-harbour link has shortened the travel time between Mumbai and Navi Mumbai."
Thus, **option (b)** is the correct improvement.

Q.249 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
He was too exhausted to continue, but he refused to admit defeat and decides to keep going.

(a) No improvement required
(b) is deciding to keep going
(c) decided to keep going
(d) has decide to keep going

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) decided to keep going
Solution:

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Explanation (contd.)

- The original sentence:
  *"He was too exhausted to continue, but he refused to admit defeat and **decides to keep going**."*
- The issue lies in **verb tense consistency**:
  - The rest of the sentence is in **past tense**: *"was too exhausted"*, *"refused"*.
  - But **"decides"** is in the **present tense**, which causes a tense mismatch.
- The correct past tense form is:
  "decided to keep going"
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **"is deciding to keep going"** – present continuous tense, mismatches the past narration.
  - **"has decide to keep going"** – grammatically incorrect ("has decided" is correct, but not appropriate in this context).
  - **"No improvement required"** – incorrect due to tense inconsistency.

Correct answer: decided to keep going

Q.250 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The Trans-Siberian Railway in Russia is <u>the faster</u> railway line in the world.

(a) the fast
(b) a fastest
(c) the fastest
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) the fastest
Solution:

- The phrase **"the faster railway line"** is incorrect because it uses the **comparative degree** ("faster") instead of the **superlative degree** ("fastest") which is required when comparing more than two or indicating the topmost degree.
- The correct usage here is: **"the fastest railway line in the world."**

Correct Sentence:
The Trans-Siberian Railway in Russia is **the fastest** railway line in the world.

Q.251 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
I <u>prefer coffee than tea</u> in the morning.

(a) No improvement required
(b) prefer coffee to tea
(c) prefer coffee than to tea
(d) preferred coffee than tea

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) prefer coffee to tea

- The verb **"prefer"** is followed by the preposition **"to"**, not **"than"**.
- Correct construction: **prefer A to B**

Incorrect: I prefer coffee **than** tea
Correct: I prefer coffee **to** tea
Hence, the improved sentence is:
"I prefer coffee to tea in the morning."

Q.252 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
Mr Sharma <u>has been working since</u> five years in this company as Senior Accountant.

(a) No improvement required
(b) has worked since
(c) has been working for
(d) works for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) has been working for
Solution:

- The original sentence:
  "Mr Sharma has been working since five years in this company as Senior Accountant."
- The issue lies in the incorrect use of the preposition **"since"** with a **period of time**.
  - **"Since"** is used with a **specific point in time** (e.g., *since 2018*).
  - **"For"** is used with a **duration/period of time** (e.g., *for five years*).
- Therefore, the correct phrase should be:
  "has been working for five years..."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): "No improvement required" – incorrect due to wrong preposition.
  - Option (b): "has worked since" – still uses "since" incorrectly with a time period.
  - Option (d): "works for" – incorrect tense; does not reflect continuous action.

Correct sentence:
"Mr Sharma has been working for five years in this company as Senior Accountant."

Q.253 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
<u>He speaks English good enough</u> to communicate with foreign clients.

(a) No improvement required
(b) He is speaking English good enough
(c) He speaks English better enough
(d) He speaks English well enough

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He speaks English well enough

- The word **"good"** is an adjective. However, here we need an **adverb** to modify the verb **"speaks"**.
- The correct adverb form of "good" is **"well."**
- So, the correct phrase is: **"He speaks English well enough..."**

Revised sentence:
He speaks English well enough to communicate with foreign clients.

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Q.254 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
In Brazil, the economy has started recovering, but unemployment <u>is on its lowest from</u> 2015.

(a) is at its lowest since
(b) has been on its low from
(c) is at its lowest from
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) is at its lowest since
Solution:

- The sentence is: *"In Brazil, the economy has started recovering, but unemployment **is on its lowest from** 2015."*
- The phrase **"on its lowest from"** is grammatically incorrect and unidiomatic.
- The correct expression is: **"is at its lowest since 2015"**
  - **"at its lowest"** is the correct prepositional phrase to describe a minimum point.
  - **"since 2015"** is used to refer to a point in time from which a situation has continued till now.
  - Together, this makes a grammatically and idiomatically correct sentence.
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **"has been on its low from"** – incorrect verb phrase and preposition.
  - **"is at its lowest from"** – incorrect preposition; "from" should be "since" in this context.
  - **"No improvement required"** – incorrect because the original underlined phrase is flawed.

Correct sentence:
"In Brazil, the economy has started recovering, but unemployment is at its lowest since 2015."

Q.255 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
<u>Despite of the heavy rain</u>, we decided to go for a hike in the mountains.

(a) No improvement required
(b) Despite of a heavy rain
(c) Despite the heavy rain
(d) In spite the heavy rain

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Despite the heavy rain
Solution:

- The correct phrase is **"Despite the heavy rain"**, not "Despite of the heavy rain".
- **"Despite"** is used without **"of"**; using "of" after "despite" is grammatically incorrect.
- The correct prepositional pair is either **"Despite + noun"** or **"In spite of + noun"**.

Correct Sentence:
Despite the heavy rain, we decided to go for a hike in the mountains.
Correct Option:
(3) Despite the heavy rain

Q.256 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
<u>The cat lied on</u> the cosy blanket, purring softly.

(a) No improvement required
(b) The cat laid at
(c) The cat lay on
(d) The cat lied in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The cat lay on
Solution:

- The original sentence:
  "The cat lied on the cosy blanket, purring softly."
- The verb **"lied"** is incorrect here.
  - **"Lie"** (to recline/rest) is an **intransitive verb** with past tense **"lay"**.
  - **"Lied"** is the past tense of **"lie"** meaning *to tell a falsehood*, which is not the intended meaning.
- Therefore, the correct past tense form in this context is:
  "The cat lay on the cosy blanket..."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **"laid"** is the past tense of **"lay"**, a **transitive verb** (requires an object) – not suitable here.
  - **"lied in"** – uses the wrong past tense of "lie" and the wrong preposition.
  - **"No improvement required"** – incorrect, as "lied" is a grammatical error here.

Correct answer:
The cat lay on (Option (c)

Q.257 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
Your application <u>has been accepted</u> if you fulfil all the conditions.

(a) will be accepted
(b) No improvement required
(c) was being accepted
(d) had been accepted

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) will be accepted

- The sentence is talking about a **future result** based on a condition: *"if you fulfil all the conditions."*
- Therefore, the correct structure is:
  "Your application will be accepted if you fulfil all the conditions."
- The current form "**has been accepted**" wrongly implies the application is already accepted, regardless of the condition.

Hence, the most appropriate improvement is **"will be accepted."**

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Q.258 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
By the end of the last year, he would have completed the design of his multipurpose agri-machine.

(a) has completed
(b) would complete
(c) had completed
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) had completed
Solution:

- The original sentence:
  "By the end of the last year, he would have completed the design of his multipurpose agri-machine."
- Let's break it down:
  - The phrase **"by the end of the last year"** clearly refers to a **past point in time**.
  - The verb **"would have completed"** is typically used to talk about a **future-in-the-past** situation or an **unfulfilled condition**, which doesn't fit naturally here.
  - The correct tense for a completed action **before a point in the past** is **past perfect → "had completed"**.
- Therefore, the improved sentence should be:
  "By the end of the last year, he had completed the design of his multipurpose agri-machine."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **"has completed"** – present perfect; inconsistent with past time marker.
  - **"would complete"** – simple conditional; doesn't convey a completed action.
  - **"No improvement required"** – incorrect, as the original tense is not best suited.

Correct answer:
had completed (Option (c))

Q.259 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
We can go on a vacation if everyone is agreeing.

(a) everyone agrees
(b) everyone will agreeing
(c) everyone is agree
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) everyone agrees
Explanation:
The correct improvement is **"everyone agrees"** because the verb should match the present simple tense required by the conditional structure "if + present simple."

- "**is agreeing**" is incorrect as "agree" is a **stative verb** and **not normally used in continuous form**.
- "**everyone will agreeing**" is grammatically wrong; "will" should be followed by **base verb**, not present participle.
- "**is agree**" is also incorrect as it combines an auxiliary verb with a base verb improperly.

So, the correct sentence is:
We can go on a vacation if everyone agrees.

Q.260 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
We should always wash our hands during having food.

(a) No improvement required
(b) as soon as
(c) while
(d) before

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) before
Solution:

- The sentence:
  *"We should always wash our hands **during having food**."*
- The phrase **"during having food"** is grammatically incorrect.
  - "During" is followed by a **noun** or **noun phrase**, not a gerund like "having."
  - The correct intent is to wash hands **before** eating.
- So the correct improvement is:
  "We should always wash our hands before having food."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **"as soon as"** – implies washing hands immediately after or at the start, not appropriate here.
  - **"while"** – implies washing hands during the act of eating, which is illogical.
  - **"No improvement required"** – incorrect due to grammatical error in the original sentence.

Correct answer:
before (Option (d))

Q.261 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
Me and my friends planning a road trip to the beach this weekend.

(a) I and my friends are planned
(b) Me and my friends have plan
(c) No improvement required
(d) My friends and I are planning

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) My friends and I are planning

- The original sentence: **"Me and my friends planning a road trip..."** is grammatically incorrect.
- It lacks a **helping verb** and also uses **"Me"** as the subject, which is incorrect.
- Correct structure requires:
  - Proper subject order: **"My friends and I"** (not "Me and my friends")
  - Correct verb form: **"are planning"** (present continuous)

So, the improved sentence is:
"My friends and I are planning a road trip to the beach this weekend."

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Q.262 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
You ought cut out your consumption of fats if you want to reduce your weight.

(a) No improvement required
(b) must cut out
(c) ought cut down
(d) ought to cut down

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ought to cut down
Solution:

- The underlined phrase: **"ought cut out"** is **grammatically incorrect**.
- The correct structure is: **"ought to + base verb"**
  - Here, the base verb is **"cut"**, and we are referring to reducing consumption.
- Also, the correct phrasal verb is **"cut down"**, not "cut out", when talking about **reducing** something (like fat consumption).
- So the correct and improved phrase is: **"ought to cut down"**
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"No improvement required"** – incorrect due to improper verb structure.
  - Option (b): **"must cut out"** – changes the degree of obligation and uses the wrong phrasal verb.
  - Option (c): **"ought cut down"** – missing "to"; incorrect modal verb structure.

Correct sentence:
"You ought to cut down your consumption of fats if you want to reduce your weight."

Q.263 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
She can speak fluently in French, German and Italian; her linguistic skills are impressing.

(a) her linguistical skills are impressing
(b) her linguistic skills are impressive
(c) her linguistic skills are impressed
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) her linguistic skills are impressive
Solution:

- The sentence refers to her ability to speak multiple languages, which relates to **linguistic skills**.
- The phrase **"are impressing"** is grammatically incorrect here.
- The correct adjective to use is **"impressive"**, which describes something that evokes admiration.

Correct Sentence:
She can speak fluently in French, German and Italian; her linguistic skills are impressive.
Correct Option:
(2) her linguistic skills are impressive

Q.264 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
There is a new restaurant opening downtown who sells exotic Chinese cuisine.

(a) which sells exotic Chinese cuisine
(b) who sell exotic Chinese cuisine
(c) No improvement required
(d) who is selling exotic Chinese cuisine

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) which sells exotic Chinese cuisine
Solution:

- The original sentence:
  "There is a new restaurant opening downtown who sells exotic Chinese cuisine."
- The issue is with the use of the **relative pronoun "who"**, which is used for **people**, not **things or places**.
- Since **"restaurant"** is a **thing**, the correct relative pronoun is **"which"**.
- Also, **"sells"** is correct in subject-verb agreement with the singular noun "restaurant".
- Therefore, the correct phrase is:
  "which sells exotic Chinese cuisine."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (b): **"who sell"** – incorrect pronoun and verb agreement.
  - Option (c): **"No improvement required"** – incorrect due to the wrong pronoun.
  - Option (d): **"who is selling"** – again, incorrect pronoun "who" for a non-human subject.

Correct sentence:
"There is a new restaurant opening downtown which sells exotic Chinese cuisine."

Q.265 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
People with Alzheimer are such forgetting as they are not able to carry out a conversation for long.

(a) so forgetting that
(b) such forgetful as
(c) so forgetful that
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) so forgetful that
The sentence requires a structure that connects cause and effect. The correct idiomatic expression is:

- **"so + adjective + that"**

Here:

- **"so forgetful that"** is correct.
- "forgetful" is the correct adjective form to describe a person who forgets things easily.
- "forgetting" is the present participle/verb form, which is **incorrect** in this context.

Corrected Sentence:
People with Alzheimer are so forgetful that they are not able to carry out a conversation for long.

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Q.266 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
It had been a serious offence, but he <u>was let out</u> with a warning.

(a) No improvement required
(b) had been let off
(c) was let off
(d) is let out

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) was let off
Explanation:
The correct improvement is:
was let off

- The phrase "**let off**" is a standard phrasal verb meaning **to excuse someone from punishment** or **release them with a warning**.
- The original sentence:
  *"It had been a serious offence, but he **was let out** with a warning."*
  is grammatically correct, but **"let out"** usually refers to **releasing someone physically (e.g., from a room or building)** and is **not idiomatic** in the context of being excused from punishment.
- Corrected sentence:
  *"It had been a serious offence, but he **was let off** with a warning."*

Correct Answer: 3

Q.267 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The car turned upside down <u>no sooner as it hit</u> the light pole.

(a) no sooner than it had hit
(b) No improvement required
(c) as soon as it hit
(d) no soon as it hit

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) as soon as it hit
Solution:

- The original sentence:
  "The car turned upside down no sooner as it hit the light pole."
- The phrase **"no sooner"** is part of a **correlative construction** that must be followed by **"than"**, not **"as"**.
- The correct structure is:
  "No sooner + past perfect + than + past simple"
  But since the sentence is in **simple past**, the closest grammatically and stylistically correct substitute is:
  "as soon as it hit" – a simpler and appropriate alternative.
- So, the improved sentence becomes:
  "The car turned upside down as soon as it hit the light pole."
- **Why other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"no sooner than it had hit"** – incorrect word order and tense usage.
  - Option (b): **"No improvement required"** – incorrect because "no sooner as" is grammatically wrong.
  - Option (d): **"no soon as it hit"** – grammatically incorrect phrase.

Q.268 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
October has four consecutive holidays <u>but we are planning</u> a trip to Andaman Islands

(a) since we have planned
(b) No improvement required
(c) so we are planning
(d) because we are planning

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) so we are planning
Solution:

- The original sentence:
  "October has four consecutive holidays but we are planning a trip to Andaman Islands."
- The conjunction **"but"** implies **contrast**, which does not fit the context here.
- The second part of the sentence is a **result** or **natural action** due to the first part (i.e., because there are holidays, a trip is being planned).
  So, a **cause-effect** connector like **"so"** is more appropriate.
- Corrected sentence:
  "October has four consecutive holidays, so we are planning a trip to Andaman Islands."
- **Why other options are incorrect:**
  - **"since we have planned"** – changes the meaning and tense.
  - **"because we are planning"** – incorrect logical flow; cause and effect are reversed.
  - **"No improvement required"** – incorrect because "but" doesn't convey the intended meaning.

Correct answer:
so we are planning (Option (c)

Q.269 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
Since last evening, the boy has been complaining <u>with</u> pain in his legs.

(a) No improvement required
(b) for
(c) from
(d) of

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) of

- **The phrase "complaining of pain" is the correct and standard usage in English.**
- **We use "complain of" when someone reports or expresses discomfort or symptoms of an illness.**
- **The preposition "with" is incorrect in this context. "Complain with pain" is not idiomatic.**
- **Let's compare:**
  - **complaining with pain → incorrect usage**
  - **complaining from pain → not natural here**
  - **complaining of pain → correct and commonly accepted**

Correct sentence:
Since last evening, the boy has been complaining of pain in his legs.

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Q.270 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The teacher along with the students were crossing the river, when the boat capsized.

(a) with the students were crossing
(b) No improvement required
(c) as well as the students were crossing
(d) along with the students was crossing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) along with the students was crossing
The subject of the sentence is **"The teacher"**, which is **singular**. Phrases like **"along with," "as well as,"** or **"with"** are not part of the subject but are considered **additional information**. Therefore, the verb must **agree with the main subject**, not with the added phrase.
So:
- **"The teacher along with the students was crossing..."** is grammatically correct.
- Using **"were crossing"** is incorrect because it treats the subject as plural.

Hence, the improved version is:
"The teacher along with the students was crossing the river, when the boat capsized."

Q.271 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
Last evening I have gone to the theatre to see a performance.

(a) I am gone
(b) I went
(c) I was going
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) I went
The original sentence is:
"Last evening I have gone to the theatre to see a performance."
This is **incorrect** because:
- The adverb **"last evening"** refers to a **specific past time**.
- The **present perfect tense** ("have gone") is not used with **definite past time expressions** like *yesterday*, *last week*, *last evening*, etc.

Correct usage:
- Instead of "I have gone", we should use the **simple past tense**: **"I went"**.

Final sentence:
"Last evening I went to the theatre to see a performance."

Q.272 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
No sooner as I saw the boy running across the road, I applied the brakes.

(a) As soon as I saw
(b) No improvement required
(c) No soon as I saw
(d) No sooner I see

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) As soon as I saw
The sentence begins with **"No sooner..."**, which is a **correlative conjunction** that must be paired with **"than"**, and it always uses **inversion** in formal grammar. The correct structure is:
"No sooner had + subject + past participle + than..."
But in this sentence, the phrase is incorrectly written as:
"No sooner as I saw..." – which is **grammatically incorrect.**
Now let's evaluate the options:
- **Option (a): "As soon as I saw"** – This is **correct** and makes the sentence grammatically and contextually sound:

"As soon as I saw the boy running across the road, I applied the brakes."
- **Option (b): "No improvement required"** – Incorrect; the current structure is flawed.
- **Option (c): "No soon as I saw"** – Grammatically incorrect; "No soon" is never used.
- **Option (d): "No sooner I see"** – Tense and structure are wrong; incorrect form of the verb.

Q.273 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
Traffic is always remaining heavy in this part of Delhi.

(a) always remains
(b) has always been remaining
(c) have always remained
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) always remains
- **"Traffic"** is a **singular, uncountable noun**, so it takes a singular verb.
- The verb **"remain"** is a **stative verb**, which typically doesn't appear in continuous form (e.g., "is remaining" is incorrect).
- The sentence describes a **general truth or habitual situation**, so we need to use **simple present tense**.
- Therefore, **"Traffic always remains heavy..."** is the grammatically correct and natural-sounding choice.

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Q.274 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
She had hoped that she would be able qualifying the CAT with a high percentile, but something went amiss.

(a) will be able to qualify
(b) would be able to qualify
(c) No improvement required
(d) would be able to be qualifying

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) would be able to qualify

The sentence is in the **past perfect tense**: "She **had hoped**...", which refers to a past action before another past action.

In such cases, the correct structure for expressing a future possibility from a past point of view is:

- **"would be able to + base verb"** (i.e., infinitive without "to qualify**ing**")

Now let's evaluate the options:

- **"will be able to qualify"** → Incorrect, because "will" is present/future tense, which doesn't match with "had hoped" (past perfect).
- **"would be able to qualify"** → Correct; matches the past perfect structure and uses proper infinitive.
- **"No improvement required"** → Incorrect, as "would be able qualifying" is grammatically wrong.
- **"would be able to be qualifying"** → Incorrect and unnecessarily complex; incorrect usage.

Therefore, the improved sentence is:
"She had hoped that she would be able to qualify the CAT with a high percentile..."
Correct option: would be able to qualify

Q.275 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
When I received the appointment letter from the college of Arts and Humanities, I was exhilarated.

(a) No improvement required
(b) While I received
(c) When I receive
(d) When I have received

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No improvement required

The underlined verb phrase is **"When I received"**, and the sentence continues in the **past tense** — "I was exhilarated." This shows that the action happened in the past and was completed.

Let's assess the given options:

- **When I receive** → present tense; does not match with "was exhilarated" (past)
- **When I have received** → present perfect tense; does not match with the past tense continuation
- **While I received** → grammatically awkward; "while" is used for ongoing actions, but "received" is not continuous
- **No improvement required** → correct usage; simple past tense is appropriate for both clauses

Correct answer: No improvement required

Q.276 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
He asked the speaker some questions until the session.

(a) while
(b) through
(c) No improvement required
(d) during

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) during

The original sentence is:
*He asked the speaker some questions **until** the session.*

The word **"until"** is incorrect here because:

- **"Until"** is used to indicate up to a point in time, often implying that the action stops when that time arrives.
- But here, the sentence intends to say that the **questions were asked in the course of the session**, not *before it began*.

Let's evaluate the options:

- **(a) while** – Implies that he asked questions *at the same time as* the session, which fits well.
- **(b) through** – Not suitable; "through the session" could imply persistence but is awkward in this context.
- **(c) No improvement required** – Incorrect, since "until" misrepresents the timing.
- **(d) during** – Also acceptable. "During the session" clearly expresses that the questions were asked *in the time span of* the session.

Both **"while"** and **"during"** work, but **"during"** is more accurate and conventional for this context.

Q.277 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
Each of the students were asked to submit the project by the following day.

(a) Each of the student was asked
(b) Every of the students was asked
(c) Each of the students was asked
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Each of the students was asked

- The subject **"Each of the students"** is **singular**, even though it refers to multiple people.
- Therefore, the verb must also be **singular**: **"was asked"**, **not** "were asked".
- Option (c) uses correct subject-verb agreement.

Corrected Sentence:
Each of the students was asked to submit the project by the following day.

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Q.278 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
A questionnaire <u>will distributing</u> to all the participants at the end of the session.

(a) will be distributing
(b) will distribute
(c) will be distributed
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) will be distributed

- The original sentence: **"A questionnaire will distributing to all the participants..."** is grammatically incorrect.
- After **"will"**, we need either:
  - **base form** of the verb: *will distribute* (for active voice), or
  - "**be" + past participle**: *will be distributed* (for passive voice)
- Since **"a questionnaire"** is the **receiver** of the action, the passive voice is appropriate.

Correct sentence:
A questionnaire will be distributed to all the participants at the end of the session.

Q.279 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
<u>Mine grandmother need</u> a helper to keep her terrace garden in order.

(a) Mine grandmother needs
(b) No improvement required
(c) My grandmother needs
(d) Mine grandmother needed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) My grandmother needs

- **"Mine"** is an archaic or poetic form used without a noun (e.g., *This book is mine*). It cannot be used directly before a noun like "grandmother".
- The correct **possessive determiner** before a noun is **"my"** (e.g., *My grandmother*).
- **"Needs"** is correct here (present simple) to match the subject "grandmother" (singular).

Correct sentence: My grandmother needs a helper to keep her terrace garden in order.

Q.280 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
Shimla is <u>the more beautiful</u> hill station in Himachal Pradesh.

(a) the very beautiful
(b) a very beautiful
(c) a more beautiful
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a very beautiful

The underlined phrase **"the more beautiful"** is incorrect because it implies a comparison, but no other hill station is mentioned for comparison.
Let's examine each option:

- **Option (a): "the very beautiful"** – grammatically awkward and not commonly used in standard English to describe a general place.
- **Option (b): "a very beautiful"** – correct. It indicates that Shimla is one of the many beautiful hill stations, without comparing.
- **Option (c): "a more beautiful"** – implies a comparison, but no comparison is present in the sentence.
- **Option (d): "No improvement required"** – incorrect because the original phrase is ungrammatical.

Correct choice: a very beautiful

Q.281 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
<u>She don't like</u> chocolate, so I bought a vanilla cake for her birthday.

(a) She don't likes
(b) She doesn't like
(c) She don't liked
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She doesn't like

- The subject **"She"** is **third person singular**, so it requires **"doesn't"** (not "don't").
- The correct structure is:
  She doesn't + base verb (like)
- Let's examine the options:
  - **She don't likes** – incorrect (double error: "don't" with "she" + "likes" instead of base form)
  - **She doesn't like** – correct
  - **She don't liked** – incorrect tense and subject-verb agreement
  - **No improvement required** – incorrect as the original sentence uses "don't" with "she"

Correct sentence:
She doesn't like chocolate, so I bought a vanilla cake for her birthday.

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Q.282 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
I saw that movie last week and it was really interesting.

(a) No improvement required
(b) I seen that movie
(c) I was seeing that movie
(d) I see that movie

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No improvement required

The sentence given is:
"I saw that movie last week and it was really interesting."
We need to examine if the underlined portion — **"I saw that movie"** — is grammatically correct in the context of the sentence.

- The action took place **in the past** ("last week"), so the **simple past tense** is required.
- **"Saw"** is the simple past form of **"see"**, which matches the time reference.

Let's analyze the options:

- **Option (a): No improvement required** – Correct usage of simple past tense ("saw") with the time marker "last week."
- **Option (b): I seen that movie** – ✘ Incorrect. "Seen" is the past participle and must be used with "have/had."
- **Option (c): I was seeing that movie** – ✘ Incorrect tense; "was seeing" is past continuous and doesn't fit here.
- **Option (d): I see that movie** – ✘ Incorrect; present tense does not match "last week."

Q.283 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
In case everybody has left the office, Ashutosh is still busy at his laptop.

(a) No improvement required
(b) But for
(c) Even though
(d) In spite of

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Even though

The sentence begins with **"In case"**, which typically means **"if it happens that..."** — used for a possibility. However, the context here shows a **contrast** between two facts:

- Everybody has left the office.
- Ashutosh is still working.

To express contrast, **"Even though"** is the appropriate conjunction.
Let's test it:
"Even though everybody has left the office, Ashutosh is still busy at his laptop."
This construction is grammatically correct and contextually meaningful.
Answer: 3

Q.284 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The movie was not only interesting but also it was very suspenseful.

(a) but also it is very suspenseful
(b) No improvement required
(c) but also very suspenseful
(d) but also was more suspenseful

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) but also very suspenseful

The sentence uses the correlative conjunction **"not only... but also"**, which should connect **parallel grammatical structures**.
The current structure **"not only interesting but also it was very suspenseful"** is **not parallel**, as it mismatches an adjective with a full clause.
The correct and parallel form is:

- **"not only interesting but also very suspenseful"**
  - Both parts are adjectives, ensuring balance and fluency.

Let's review the options:

- **Option (a):** Incorrect — "it is" breaks parallelism and shifts tense.
- **Option (b):** Incorrect — original sentence needs improvement.
- **Option (c): Correct** — maintains parallelism and appropriate tense.
- **Option (d):** Incorrect — introduces comparative "more suspenseful" which changes meaning.

Q.285 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank.
If you diligently study the intricacies of the language, you _____ that your proficiency in it improves significantly.

(a) will find
(b) found
(c) will be finding
(d) have found

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) will find

The sentence is a **conditional** statement starting with "**If you diligently study...**". This is a **first conditional**, used to talk about real or possible situations in the future.
The structure of the **first conditional** is:

- **If + present simple, will + base verb**

Here:

- "**If you diligently study**" – this is **present simple**.
- The second clause should follow with **"will + verb"**.

So, the correct sentence becomes:
"If you diligently study the intricacies of the language, you will find that your proficiency in it improves significantly."
Other options are incorrect because:

- "**found**" – past tense, doesn't match a future condition.
- "**will be finding**" – awkward and not commonly used for conditional outcomes.
- "**have found**" – present perfect, implies the action is already complete.

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Q.286 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The doctor prescribes antibiotics and a cough syrup to me when I had severe cough and cold.

(a) are prescribing
(b) prescribed
(c) was prescribing
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) prescribed
The sentence talks about a past situation:
"**when I had severe cough and cold**" – this is clearly **past tense**.
However, the verb used is:
"**prescribes**" – which is **present tense**, and that causes a **tense mismatch**.
We need the verb to match the past context. Let's evaluate the options:

- **are prescribing** – present continuous; incorrect for a past action
- **prescribed** – correct; simple past tense matches "when I had..."
- **was prescribing** – past continuous; implies an ongoing action, but here we're referring to a completed action (i.e., doctor gave a prescription)
- **No improvement required** – incorrect, because "prescribes" doesn't fit a past context

The correct and improved sentence:
"The doctor prescribed antibiotics and a cough syrup to me when I had severe cough and cold."

Q.287 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
She runs more faster than her brother in the track events.

(a) runs faster than
(b) runs more fast than
(c) No improvement required
(d) runs fast than

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) runs faster than
The underlined phrase **"runs more faster than"** is **grammatically incorrect** because it uses a **double comparative** — both "more" and "faster" indicate comparison, which is unnecessary.

- The correct comparative form of "fast" is **"faster"**, not "more fast" or "more faster".
- Hence, **"runs faster than"** is the correct and concise form.

Correct sentence:
She runs faster than her brother in the track events.

Q.288 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
Linguists say that this method helps accelerate language learning.

(a) this method help accelerate
(b) this method helps accelerated
(c) this method helping accelerating
(d) No improvement required

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) No improvement required
The original sentence is:
"Linguists say that this method helps accelerate language learning."
Let's evaluate it:

- **Subject–verb agreement**:
  - Subject: *this method* (singular)
  - Verb: *helps* (correct singular form)
- **Verb pattern**:
  - *Helps accelerate* is a correct verb + verb (bare infinitive) structure.
    - Similar to: *helps improve*, *helps reduce*, etc.
- **Tense and meaning**:
  - The present tense "helps" is appropriate with the reporting verb "say".
  - The sentence is grammatically and semantically correct.

Let's eliminate the wrong options:

- **Option (a):** *this method help accelerate* → "help" is plural; doesn't agree with singular subject "this method"
- **Option (b):** *helps accelerated* → Incorrect verb form; "accelerated" is past participle, not suitable here
- **Option (c):** *helping accelerating* → Gerunds used incorrectly; awkward and grammatically wrong
- **Option (d):** "No improvement required" is correct as the sentence is already correct.

Final sentence:
Linguists say that this method helps accelerate language learning.

Q.289 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
The schoolroom into which he took me was the most forlorn and desolate place I am ever seeing.

(a) I am ever seen
(b) No improvement required
(c) I have ever seen
(d) I have ever seeing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I have ever seen
The sentence is in the **past tense**:
"The schoolroom into which he took me was the most forlorn and desolate place..."
This means the underlined part **"I am ever seeing"** is **incorrect** because it mixes present continuous with a past context.
Now, let's evaluate the options:

- **Option (a): "I am ever seen"** – grammatically incorrect; wrong tense and voice.

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Explanation (contd.)

- **Option (b): "No improvement required"** – incorrect; "I am ever seeing" is ungrammatical.
- **Option (c): "I have ever seen"** – correct tense (present perfect), consistent with past experience, and grammatically accurate.
- **Option (d): "I have ever seeing"** – ungrammatical; incorrect verb form.

Therefore, the improved and grammatically correct sentence is:
"The schoolroom into which he took me was the most forlorn and desolate place I have ever seen."

Q.290 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
John was absent from the meeting because he was sick, <u>nor did he inform anyone.</u>

(a) and did not he inform anyone
(b) nor did he informed anyone
(c) No improvement required
(d) but he did not inform anyone

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) but he did not inform anyone

The sentence uses the phrase **"nor did he inform anyone"**, which is grammatically correct. However, we must check if there's a more appropriate or natural construction.

- The sentence begins with a **reason clause**: "John was absent from the meeting because he was sick..."
- Then it adds **additional information**: that he **also didn't inform anyone**.

Now let's evaluate the options:

1. **"and did not he inform anyone"** – Incorrect word order (should be "he did not," not "did not he").
2. **"nor did he informed anyone"** – Incorrect verb form after "did" (should be "inform," not "informed").
3. **"No improvement required"** – The use of "nor" is slightly awkward here because the clause is not preceded by a negative that "nor" builds on.
4. **"but he did not inform anyone"** – This is the most natural and grammatically sound improvement. It smoothly contrasts the cause of his absence with his failure to notify others.

Q.291 Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'.
<u>She is allergic from peanuts</u>, so she always checks food labels carefully.

(a) No improvement required
(b) She is allergic to peanuts
(c) She is allergical from peanuts
(d) She is allergic with peanuts

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She is allergic to peanuts

The correct preposition to use with the adjective **"allergic"** is **"to"**, not "from", "with", or "of".

Explanation (contd.)

- The phrase **"allergic to"** is the grammatically accepted form when indicating a substance someone has an allergy to.
- Therefore, the underlined part **"allergic from peanuts"** is incorrect.

Correct Usage:
She is allergic to peanuts, so she always checks food labels carefully.

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9. Active & Passive Voice

333 questions

Q.1 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Why did the editor give such a rude comment?

(a) Why was such an editor given by the rude comment?
(b) Why had such a rude comment been given by the editor?
(c) Why is such a rude comment being given by the editor?
(d) Why was such a rude comment given by the editor?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Why was such a rude comment given by the editor?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Wh-question, Past)
Rule: "Why did the editor give ...?" → "**Why was such a rude comment given by the editor?**"
(Simple past प्रश्न का passive: Why was + object + V3 + by ...?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** meaning reversed; **(b)** "had ... been" – past perfect; **(c)** "is being given" – present continuous.

Q.2 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The man eating tiger will be captured tomorrow by the forest officers.

(a) The forest officers will capture the man eating tiger tomorrow.
(b) The forest officers will be capturing the man eating tiger tomorrow.
(c) The forest officers will have captured the man eating tiger tomorrow.
(d) The man eating tiger will capture the forest officers tomorrow.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The forest officers will capture the man eating tiger tomorrow.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Future Simple)
Rule: "will be captured by the forest officers" → active **will + V1 (capture)**.
(Future passive (will be + V3) का active: will + V1 ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "will be capturing" – future continuous; **(c)** "will have captured" – future perfect; **(d)** meaning reversed.

Q.3 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
All his faults were forgiven by her.

(a) She has forgiven all his faults.
(b) She is forgiving all his faults.
(c) She will forgive all his faults.
(d) She forgave all his faults.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She forgave all his faults.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "were forgiven by her" → active **simple past "forgave"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has forgiven" – present perfect; **(b)** "is forgiving" – present continuous; **(c)** "will forgive" – future.

Q.4 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The ticket will be sent to you by the airlines on e-mail.

(a) The airlines will send you the ticket by e-mail.
(b) The airlines had sent you the ticket by e-mail.
(c) The airlines will be sending you the ticket by e-mail.
(d) The airlines will have sent you the ticket by e-mail.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The airlines will send you the ticket by e-mail.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Future Simple)
Rule: "will be sent ... by the airlines" → active **will + V1 (send)**.
(Future passive का active: will + V1 ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "had sent" – past perfect; **(c)** "will be sending" – future continuous; **(d)** "will have sent" – future perfect.

Q.5 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
He was eating a large pizza.

(a) A large pizza was being eaten by him.
(b) A large pizza has been eaten by him.
(c) A large pizza was eaten by him.
(d) A large pizza was eating him.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A large pizza was being eaten by him.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Past Continuous)
Rule: "was eating" → passive **was being + V3 (eaten)**.
(Past continuous का passive: was being + V3 ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "has been eaten" – present perfect; **(c)** "was eaten" – simple past; **(d)** meaning reversed.

Q.6 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The light was switched off by her before sleeping.

(a) She is switching off the light before sleeping.
(b) She had switched off the light before sleeping.
(c) She switched off the light before sleeping.
(d) She switches off the light before sleeping.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She switched off the light before sleeping.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was switched off by her" → active **simple past "switched off"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is switching" – present; **(b)** "had switched" – past perfect; **(d)** "switches" – present.

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Q.7 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
He was given another chance by his employer.

(a) He gave his employer another chance.
(b) His employer has given him another chance.
(c) His employer is giving him another chance.
(d) His employer gave him another chance.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) His employer gave him another chance.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was given ... by his employer" → active **simple past "gave"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** meaning reversed; **(b)** "has given" – present perfect; **(c)** "is giving" – present continuous.

Q.8 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Somebody has already tipped the custom authorities about the drugs.

(a) Custom authorities were already tipped about the drugs.
(b) Custom authorities have already tipped someone about the drugs.
(c) Custom authorities have already been tipped by the drugs.
(d) Custom authorities have already been tipped about the drugs.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Custom authorities have already been tipped about the drugs.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has already tipped" → passive **have already been + V3 (tipped)**.
(Present perfect का passive: has/have been + V3 I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "were tipped" – past; **(b)** meaning reversed; **(c)** "tipped by the drugs" – wrong agent.

Q.9 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
They were refused entry in Delhi by the police.

(a) The police have refused them entry in Delhi.
(b) The police had refused them entry in Delhi.
(c) The police can refuse them entry in Delhi.
(d) The police refused them entry in Delhi.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The police refused them entry in Delhi.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "were refused ... by the police" → active **simple past "refused"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have refused" – present perfect; **(b)** "had refused" – past perfect; **(c)** "can refuse" – modal.

Q.10 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Success cannot be achieved without hard work and sincerity.

(a) Hard work and sincerity one cannot achieve without success.
(b) One cannot achieve hard work and sincerity without success.
(c) One cannot achieve success without hard work and sincerity.
(d) No one could achieve success without hard work and sincerity.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) One cannot achieve success without hard work and sincerity.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Modal)
Rule: "Success cannot be achieved" → active "**One cannot achieve success**".
(Modal passive का active: One cannot + V1 I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) & (b)** reverse the meaning; **(d)** "No one could" – wrong tense/meaning.

Q.11 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
We expect good news about the corona vaccine.

(a) Good news expected us about the corona vaccine.
(b) Good news was expected by us about the corona vaccine.
(c) Good news is expected by us about the corona vaccine.
(d) Good news has been expected by us about the corona vaccine.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Good news is expected by us about the corona vaccine.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Present)
Rule: "We expect" → passive **is expected by us**.
(Simple present का passive: is/are + V3 I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "expected us" – wrong; **(b)** "was expected" – past; **(d)** "has been expected" – present perfect.

Q.12 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The audience was surprised by the ending of the play.

(a) The ending of the play has surprised the audience.
(b) The audience surprised the ending of the play.
(c) The ending of the play surprised the audience.
(d) The ending of the play was surprising for the audience.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The ending of the play surprised the audience.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was surprised by the ending" → active **simple past "surprised"**, with the ending as the doer.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has surprised" – present perfect; **(b)** meaning reversed; **(d)** "was surprising" – adjective form.

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Q.13 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Our team scored 350 runs in the Inter-college Cricket Tournament.

(a) 350 runs have been scored by our team in the Inter-college Cricket Tournament.
(b) Our team was scored by 350 runs in the Inter-college Cricket Tournament.
(c) 350 runs were scored by our team in the Inter-college Cricket Tournament.
(d) 350 runs were scoring our team in the Inter-college Cricket Tournament.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) 350 runs were scored by our team in the Inter-college Cricket Tournament.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "scored 350 runs" → passive **were + V3 (scored)** (plural "runs").
(Simple past का passive: were + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have been scored" – present perfect; **(b)** meaning reversed; **(d)** "were scoring" – wrong form.

Q.14 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Our advocate is arguing the case very effectively.

(a) The case is being argued very effectively by our advocate.
(b) The case has been argued very effectively by our advocate.
(c) The case is arguing very effectively by our advocate.
(d) The advocate is being argued very effectively by our case.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The case is being argued very effectively by our advocate.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "is arguing" → passive **is being + V3 (argued)**.
(Present continuous का passive: is being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "has been argued" – present perfect; **(c)** "is arguing" – active; **(d)** meaning reversed.

Q.15 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The masons are building the house.

(a) The house is building the masons.
(b) The house is being built by the masons.
(c) The house was being built by the masons.
(d) The house has been built by the masons.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The house is being built by the masons.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "are building" → passive **is being + V3 (built)**.
(Present continuous का passive: is being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** meaning reversed; **(c)** "was being built" – past; **(d)** "has been built" – present perfect.

Q.16 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Her failure to get admission in the Science stream surprised us.

(a) We had been surprised about her failure to get admission in the Science stream.
(b) We were surprised about her failure to get admission in the Science stream.
(c) We have been surprised about her failure to get admission in the Science stream.
(d) We are surprised about her failure to get admission in the Science stream.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) We were surprised about her failure to get admission in the Science stream.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "surprised us" → passive **We were surprised (about ...)**.
(Simple past का passive: was/were + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "had been surprised" – past perfect; **(c)** "have been" – present perfect; **(d)** "are surprised" – present.

Q.17 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Who has broken the chair?

(a) By whom was the chair been broken?
(b) By whom had the chair been broken?
(c) By whom has the chair been broken?
(d) By whom is the chair been broken?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) By whom has the chair been broken?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect Question)
Rule: "Who has broken ...?" → "**By whom has the chair been broken?**"
(Present perfect प्रश्न का passive: By whom + has + object + been + V3?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was ... been" – wrong; **(b)** "had ... been" – past perfect; **(d)** "is ... been" – wrong.

Q.18 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Let this email be sent immediately.

(a) We can send this email immediately.
(b) Send this email immediately.
(c) Ask him to send this email immediately.
(d) You could send this email immediately.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Send this email immediately.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Imperative)
Rule: "Let + object + be + V3" → active **imperative "V1 + object"**.
(आदेश का active: verb + object।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "We can send" – a statement; **(c)** "Ask him to send" – changes meaning; **(d)** "You could send" – changes meaning.

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Q.19 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The terrorist was arrested by Mumbai Police.

(a) Mumbai Police is arresting the terrorist.
(b) The terrorist arrested Mumbai Police.
(c) Mumbai Police has arrested the terrorist.
(d) Mumbai Police arrested the terrorist.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Mumbai Police arrested the terrorist.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was arrested by Mumbai Police" → active **simple past "arrested"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is arresting" – present; **(b)** meaning reversed; **(c)** "has arrested" – present perfect.

Q.20 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Animals cannot make tools.

(a) Tools cannot be made by animals.
(b) Animals cannot be made by tools.
(c) Tools could not be made by animals.
(d) Tools are not to be made by animals.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Tools cannot be made by animals.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Modal)
Rule: "cannot make" → passive **cannot be + V3 (made)**.
(Modal का passive: cannot be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** meaning reversed; **(c)** "could not" – tense changed; **(d)** "are not to be made" – changes sense.

Q.21 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
He asked me to sing a song.

(a) I am asked to sing a song.
(b) I was asked to sing a song.
(c) I had been asked to sing a song.
(d) I was being asked to sing a song.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) I was asked to sing a song.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Request)
Rule: "asked me to sing" → passive "**I was asked to sing**".
(Simple past का passive: was + V3 + to + verb।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "am asked" – present; **(c)** "had been asked" – past perfect; **(d)** "was being asked" – past continuous.

Q.22 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Let the shops be opened.

(a) The shops should be opened.
(b) Have the shops opened?
(c) Open the shops.
(d) The shops are open.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Open the shops.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Imperative)
Rule: "Let + object + be + V3" → active imperative "**V1 + object**".
(आदेश का active: verb + object।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "should be opened" – passive statement; **(b)** a question; **(d)** "are open" – a statement.

Q.23 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The catch should not be dropped.

(a) Let the catch not be dropped.
(b) Have you dropped the catch?
(c) Don't drop the catch.
(d) You would not drop the catch.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Don't drop the catch.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Negative Command)
Rule: "should not be dropped" (passive order) → active "**Don't drop ...**".
(निषेधात्मक आदेश का active: Don't + verb।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Let the catch not be dropped" – still passive; **(b)** a question; **(d)** "You would not drop" – a statement.

Q.24 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Was your bag left in the bus?

(a) Did you leave your bag in the bus?
(b) Was you leaving your bag in the bus?
(c) Did you left your bag in the bus?
(d) Have you left your bag in the bus?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Did you leave your bag in the bus?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Past Question)
Rule: "Was your bag left ...?" → active "**Did you leave your bag ...?**"
(Simple past passive प्रश्न का active: Did + subject + V1?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "Was you leaving" – wrong; **(c)** "Did you left" – wrong form; **(d)** "Have you left" – present perfect.

Q.25 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
By whom were you pushed into the mud?

(a) Who has pushed you into the mud?
(b) Who pushed you into the mud?
(c) Whom did you push into the mud?
(d) Who was pushing you into the mud?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Who pushed you into the mud?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "By whom were you pushed ...?" → active "**Who pushed you ...?**"
(Passive प्रश्न "By whom ...?" का active "Who + V2 ...?")
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has pushed" – present perfect; **(c)** "Whom did you push" – meaning reversed; **(d)** "was pushing" – past continuous.

Q.26 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Your lunch box has been packed by mother.
(a) Mother will pack your lunch box.
(b) Mother is packing your lunch box.
(c) Mother has packed your lunch box.
(d) Mother had packed your lunch box.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Mother has packed your lunch box.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has been packed by mother" → active **has packed**.
(Present perfect passive का active: has + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will pack" – future; **(b)** "is packing" – present continuous; **(d)** "had packed" – past perfect.

Q.27 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
They will lay the foundation stone next week.
(a) The foundation stone will have been laid by them next week.
(b) The foundation stone is being laid by them next week.
(c) The foundation stone will be laying by next week.
(d) The foundation stone will be laid by them next week.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The foundation stone will be laid by them next week.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Future Simple)
Rule: "will lay" → passive **will be + V3 (laid)**.
(Future simple का passive: will be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will have been laid" – future perfect; **(b)** "is being laid" – present; **(c)** "will be laying" – wrong form.

Q.28 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
We all regard Liza as an expert.
(a) Liza was regarded as an expert by all of us.
(b) Liza is regarded as an expert by all of us.
(c) Liza should be regarded as an expert by all of us.
(d) Liza has been regarded as an expert by all of us.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Liza is regarded as an expert by all of us.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Present)
Rule: "regard" → passive **is regarded as**.
(Simple present का passive: is/are + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was regarded" – past; **(c)** "should be regarded" – modal; **(d)** "has been regarded" – present perfect.

Q.29 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Razia Sultana ruled over the northern part of India.
(a) The northern part of India was ruled over by Razia Sultana.
(b) The northern part of India had been ruled over by Razia Sultana.
(c) The northern part of India was being ruled over by Razia Sultana.
(d) The northern part of India is ruled over by Razia Sultana.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The northern part of India was ruled over by Razia Sultana.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "ruled over" → passive **was ruled over by** (keep "over").
(Simple past का passive: was + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "had been ruled" – past perfect; **(c)** "was being ruled" – past continuous; **(d)** "is ruled" – present.

Q.30 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
He was hit in the eye by an arrow.
(a) An arrow was hitting him in the eye.
(b) An arrow has hit him in the eye.
(c) An arrow will hit him in the eye.
(d) An arrow hit him in the eye.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) An arrow hit him in the eye.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was hit ... by an arrow" → active **simple past "hit"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was hitting" – past continuous; **(b)** "has hit" – present perfect; **(c)** "will hit" – future.

Q.31 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
You might be promoted this year.
(a) They should have promoted you this year.
(b) They might promote you this year.
(c) You may promote them this year.
(d) They will promote you this year.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) They might promote you this year.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Modal)
Rule: "might be promoted" → active **might + V1 (promote)**, with "they" as the doer.
(Modal passive का active: might + V1।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "should have promoted" – changes modal/tense; **(c)** meaning reversed; **(d)** "will promote" – wrong modal.

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Q.32 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Hang the washing on the clothesline.

(a) Let the washing hanging on the clothesline.
(b) Let the washing be hanged on the clothesline.
(c) Let the washing to be hung on the clothesline.
(d) Let the washing be hung on the clothesline.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Let the washing be hung on the clothesline.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Imperative)
Rule: "Hang ..." → passive "**Let + object + be + V3**"; V3 of *hang* (an object) = **hung**.
(आदेश का passive: Let ... be + V3; hang → hung।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "be hanging" – wrong; **(b)** "be hanged" – "hanged" is for executions; **(c)** "to be hung" – wrong form.

Q.33 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
My mother gave me an interesting book.

(a) I am given an interesting book by my mother.
(b) An interesting book has been given to my mother.
(c) An interesting book is given to me by my mother.
(d) I was given an interesting book by my mother.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I was given an interesting book by my mother.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past, two objects)
Rule: The person object ("me") becomes the subject: "**I was given** an interesting book by my mother."
(Simple past का passive: was + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "am given" – present; **(b)** "given to my mother" – meaning reversed; **(c)** "is given" – present.

Q.34 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
We have looked at the plan carefully.

(a) The plan is being looked at carefully.
(b) The plan was looked at carefully.
(c) The plan have been looked at carefully.
(d) The plan has been looked at carefully.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The plan has been looked at carefully.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect, phrasal)
Rule: "have looked at" → passive **has been looked at** (keep "at"; subject "the plan" singular).
(Present perfect का passive: has been + V3; "look at" में "at" रहता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is being looked at" – present continuous; **(b)** "was looked at" – past; **(c)** "have been" – wrong agreement.

Q.35 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
They are making elaborate arrangements for the party.

(a) Elaborate arrangements are being made for the party.
(b) Elaborate arrangements have been made for the party.
(c) Elaborate arrangements are made for the party.
(d) Elaborate arrangements were being made for the party.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Elaborate arrangements are being made for the party.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "are making" → passive **are being + V3 (made)**.
(Present continuous का passive: are being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "have been made" – present perfect; **(c)** "are made" – simple present; **(d)** "were being made" – past.

Q.36 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Harsh has applied for leave.

(a) Leave was applied by Harsh.
(b) Leave had been applied by Harsh.
(c) Leave has been applied for by Harsh.
(d) Leave is applied for by Harsh.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Leave has been applied for by Harsh.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect, phrasal)
Rule: "has applied for" → passive **has been applied for** (keep "for").
(Present perfect का passive: has been + V3; "apply for" में "for" रहता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was applied" – past; **(b)** "had been" – past perfect; **(d)** "is applied for" – present.

Q.37 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
A new song is being composed by her.

(a) She is composing a new song.
(b) She has been composing a new song.
(c) She composed a new song.
(d) She has composed a new song.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She is composing a new song.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Continuous)
Rule: "is being composed by her" → active **is composing**.
(Present continuous passive का active: is/are + V-ing।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "has been composing" – present perfect continuous; **(c)** "composed" – past; **(d)** "has composed" – present perfect.

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Q.38 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Only home-cooked food is eaten by us.

(a) We ate only home-cooked food.
(b) We are eating only home-cooked food.
(c) We have eaten only home-cooked food.
(d) We eat only home-cooked food.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) We eat only home-cooked food.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)
Rule: "is eaten by us" → active **simple present "eat"**.
(Simple present passive का active: simple present।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "ate" – past; **(b)** "are eating" – present continuous; **(c)** "have eaten" – present perfect.

Q.39 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
They are lifting the car with a crane.

(a) The car is being lifted with a crane.
(b) The car was being lifted with a crane.
(c) The car had lifted with a crane.
(d) The car is lifted with a crane.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The car is being lifted with a crane.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "are lifting" → passive **is being + V3 (lifted)**.
(Present continuous का passive: is being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "was being lifted" – past; **(c)** "had lifted" – wrong; **(d)** "is lifted" – simple present.

Q.40 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Kites have been bought by many children.

(a) Many children bought kites.
(b) Many children are buying kites.
(c) Many children had bought kites.
(d) Many children have bought kites.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Many children have bought kites.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect)
Rule: "have been bought by many children" → active **have + V3 (bought)**.
(Present perfect passive का active: have/has + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "bought" – simple past; **(b)** "are buying" – present continuous; **(c)** "had bought" – past perfect.

Q.41 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
May you achieve success in all your endeavours.

(a) Success might be achieved by you in all your endeavours.
(b) May success will be achieved by you in all your endeavours.
(c) Success has been achieved by you in all your endeavours.
(d) May success be achieved by you in all your endeavours.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) May success be achieved by you in all your endeavours.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Optative)
Rule: An optative "May you achieve ..." → passive "**May success be + V3 (achieved) by you**".
(इच्छासूचक का passive: May + object + be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "might be achieved"; **(b)** "May success will be"; **(c)** "has been achieved" – all wrong.

Q.42 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
We will consider your application favourably for the vacancy.

(a) Your vacancy will be considered favourably for the application.
(b) Your application has been considered favourably for the vacancy.
(c) Your application will be considered favourably for the vacancy.
(d) Your application is being considered favourably for the vacancy.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Your application will be considered favourably for the vacancy.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Future Simple)
Rule: "will consider" → passive **will be + V3 (considered)**.
(Future simple का passive: will be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "vacancy ... for the application" – reversed; **(b)** "has been considered" – present perfect; **(d)** "is being considered" – present continuous.

Q.43 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
It is believed by the doctors that she will soon recover.

(a) The doctors believe that she would soon recover.
(b) The doctors have believed that she is soon recovering.
(c) The doctors believe that she will soon recover.
(d) The doctors are believing that she will soon recover.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The doctors believe that she will soon recover.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present)
Rule: "It is believed by the doctors" → active "**The doctors believe**"; the reported clause stays future.
("It is believed by X" का active: "X believe(s)"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "would recover" – wrong; **(b)** "have believed ... is recovering" – wrong; **(d)** "are believing" – stative verb.

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Q.44 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
How much do you pay as insurance premium?

(a) How much is paid by you as insurance premium?
(b) How much is been paid by you as insurance premium?
(c) How much has been paid by you as insurance premium?
(d) How much is being paid by you as insurance premium?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) How much is paid by you as insurance premium?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Question)
Rule: "How much do you pay ...?" → passive "**How much is paid by you ...?**"
(Simple present passive प्रश्न: How much is + V3 by you?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "is been paid" – wrong; **(c)** "has been paid" – present perfect; **(d)** "is being paid" – present continuous.

Q.45 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
So much noise ought not to be made by you and your friends.

(a) You and your friends ought not to have made so much noise.
(b) You and your friends ought not to be making so much noise.
(c) You and your friends ought not to make so much noise.
(d) You and your friends ought to not make so much noise.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) You and your friends ought not to make so much noise.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Modal)
Rule: "ought not to be made by you" → active "**ought not to make**".
(Modal passive का active: ought not to + V1 I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have made" – past; **(b)** "be making" – continuous; **(d)** "ought to not make" – wrong order.

Q.46 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
A complaint has been made by him against the poor service of the hotel staff.

(a) He has made a complaint against the poor service of the hotel staff.
(b) He is making a complaint against the poor service of the hotel staff.
(c) He had made a complaint against the poor service of the hotel staff.
(d) He will make a complaint against the poor service of the hotel staff.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He has made a complaint against the poor service of the hotel staff.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has been made by him" → active **has + V3 (made)**.
(Present perfect passive का active: has + V3 I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "is making" – present continuous; **(c)** "had made" – past perfect; **(d)** "will make" – future.

Q.47 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The bitter pills were swallowed by her with warm water.

(a) She swallowed the bitter pills with warm water.
(b) She has swallowed the bitter pills with warm water.
(c) She swallows the warm water with the bitter pills.
(d) She swallows the bitter pills with warm water.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She swallowed the bitter pills with warm water.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "were swallowed by her" → active **simple past "swallowed"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "has swallowed" – present perfect; **(c)** meaning changed; **(d)** "swallows" – present.

Q.48 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
By whom has this mischief been done?

(a) Who has done this mischief?
(b) Who is doing this mischief?
(c) Who did this mischief?
(d) Who has been doing this mischief?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Who has done this mischief?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect Question)
Rule: "By whom has this mischief been done?" → active "**Who has done this mischief?**"
(Passive प्रश्न "By whom has ... been done?" का active "Who has done ...?")
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "is doing" – present continuous; **(c)** "did" – simple past; **(d)** "has been doing" – present perfect continuous.

Q.49 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The fierce storm wrecked the ship.

(a) The ship was being wrecked by the fierce storm.
(b) The ship was wrecked by the fierce storm.
(c) The ship has been wrecked by the fierce storm.
(d) The storm is wrecked by the fierce ship.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The ship was wrecked by the fierce storm.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "wrecked" → passive **was + V3 (wrecked)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3 I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was being wrecked" – past continuous; **(c)** "has been wrecked" – present perfect; **(d)** meaning reversed.

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Q.50 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The theft was reported to the police by the curator.

(a) The curator reported the theft to the police.
(b) The curator has reported the theft to the police.
(c) The curator is reporting the theft to the police.
(d) The curator had reported the theft to the police.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The curator reported the theft to the police.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was reported ... by the curator" → active **simple past "reported"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "has reported" – present perfect; **(c)** "is reporting" – present continuous; **(d)** "had reported" – past perfect.

Q.51 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Why are the people being allowed to gather on the streets?

(a) Why have they allowed people to gather on the streets?
(b) Why are they allowing people to gather on the streets?
(c) Why had they allowed people to gather on the streets?
(d) Why will they allow people to gather on the streets?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Why are they allowing people to gather on the streets?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Continuous Question)
Rule: "Why are the people being allowed ...?" → active "**Why are they allowing people ...?**"
(Present continuous passive प्रश्न का active: Why are + subject + V-ing?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have they allowed" – present perfect; **(c)** "had they allowed" – past perfect; **(d)** "will they allow" – future.

Q.52 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
They called a plumber to replace the rusted pipes.

(a) A plumber is called to replace the rusted pipes.
(b) A plumber was called to replace the rusted pipes.
(c) A plumber has called to replace the rusted pipes.
(d) A plumber will be called to replace the rusted pipes.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A plumber was called to replace the rusted pipes.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "called" → passive **was + V3 (called)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3 I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is called" – present; **(c)** "has called" – wrong voice; **(d)** "will be called" – future.

Q.53 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
We have finalised the site for our new factory.

(a) The site for our new factory have been finalised by us.
(b) The site for our new factory is finalised by us.
(c) The site for our new factory has been finalised by us.
(d) The site for our new factory had been finalised by us.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The site for our new factory has been finalised by us.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect)
Rule: "have finalised" → passive **has been + V3 (finalised)** (subject "the site" singular).
(Present perfect का passive: has been + V3 I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have been finalised" – wrong agreement; **(b)** "is finalised" – present; **(d)** "had been finalised" – past perfect.

Q.54 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
His services were recognised by his community.

(a) His community has recognised his services.
(b) His community recognises his services.
(c) His community recognised his services.
(d) His community is recognising his services.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) His community recognised his services.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "were recognised by his community" → active **simple past "recognised"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has recognised" – present perfect; **(b)** "recognises" – present; **(d)** "is recognising" – present continuous.

Q.55 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Were you summoned for interrogation by the police?

(a) Did the police summon you for interrogation?
(b) Were the police summoning you for interrogation?
(c) Has the police summoned you for interrogation?
(d) Did the police summoned you for interrogation?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Did the police summon you for interrogation?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Past Question)
Rule: "Were you summoned ... by the police?" → active "**Did the police summon you ...?**"
(Simple past passive प्रश्न का active: Did + subject + V1?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "were the police summoning" – past continuous; **(c)** "has ... summoned" – present perfect; **(d)** "Did ... summoned" – wrong form.

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Q.56 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Are you blaming me for ruining your business?

(a) Am I blaming you for ruining your business?
(b) Have I been blamed for ruining your business?
(c) I am being blamed for ruining your business.
(d) Am I being blamed for ruining your business?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Am I being blamed for ruining your business?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous Question)
Rule: "Are you blaming me ...?" → passive "**Am I being blamed ...?**"
(Present continuous passive प्रश्न: Am I being + V3?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** still active; **(b)** "Have I been blamed" – present perfect; **(c)** not a question.

Q.57 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Let the guests be served some soup.

(a) Let some soup serve the guests.
(b) Serve some soup to the guests.
(c) Have you served some soup to the guests?
(d) You should have served some soup to the guests.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Serve some soup to the guests.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Imperative)
Rule: "Let + object + be + V3" → active imperative "**V1 + object**".
(आदेश का active: verb + object।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** meaning reversed; **(c)** a question; **(d)** "You should have served" – a statement.

Q.58 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Dinner will have been cooked by me tonight.

(a) I would have cooked dinner tonight.
(b) I have been cooking dinner tonight.
(c) I will be cooking dinner tonight.
(d) I will have cooked dinner tonight.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I will have cooked dinner tonight.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Future Perfect)
Rule: "will have been cooked by me" → active **I will have + V3 (cooked)**.
(Future perfect passive का active: will have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "would have cooked" – conditional; **(b)** "have been cooking" – present perfect continuous; **(c)** "will be cooking" – future continuous.

Q.59 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
How many glasses of water do you drink daily?

(a) How many glasses of water are drunk by you daily?
(b) How many glasses of water are drank by you daily?
(c) How many glasses of water is drank by you daily?
(d) How many glasses of water have been drunk by you daily?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) How many glasses of water are drunk by you daily?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Question)
Rule: "do you drink ...?" → passive "**are drunk by you**" (V3 of drink = drunk; plural "glasses").
(Simple present passive प्रश्न: are + V3 by you?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "drank" – wrong V3; **(c)** "is drank" – wrong; **(d)** "have been drunk" – present perfect.

Q.60 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
They are paying special attention to the weak students.

(a) Special attention has been paid to the weak students.
(b) Special attention are paid to the weak students.
(c) Special attention is being paid to the weak students.
(d) Special attention is paid to the weak students.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Special attention is being paid to the weak students.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "are paying" → passive **is being + V3 (paid)** (subject "attention" singular).
(Present continuous का passive: is being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has been paid" – present perfect; **(b)** "are paid" – wrong agreement; **(d)** "is paid" – simple present.

Q.61 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Were you sent summons by the court?

(a) Has the court sent you summons?
(b) Did the court send you summons?
(c) Is the court sending you summons?
(d) Will the court send you summons?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Did the court send you summons?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past Question)
Rule: "Were you sent summons by the court?" → active "**Did the court send you summons?**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Has ... sent"; **(c)** "Is ... sending"; **(d)** "Will ... send" – wrong tense.

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Q.62 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Do not touch any items displayed on glass shelves.

(a) Any items displayed on glass shelves will not be touched.
(b) Any items displayed on glass shelves not be touched.
(c) Let any items displayed on glass shelves be touched.
(d) No items displayed on glass shelves should be touched.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) No items displayed on glass shelves should be touched.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Negative Imperative)
Rule: "Do not touch any items ..." → "**No items ... should be touched**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will not be touched"; **(b)** "not be touched" (no auxiliary); **(c)** "Let ... be touched" – wrong.

Q.63 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Enough money will have been saved by me for a new house by next year

(a) I will have saved enough money for a new house by next year.
(b) I will be saving enough money for a new house by next year.
(c) I will have been saving enough money for a new house by next year.
(d) I will save enough money for a new house by next year.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I will have saved enough money for a new house by next year.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Future Perfect)
Rule: "will have been saved by me" → active "**I will have saved**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "will be saving"; **(c)** "will have been saving"; **(d)** "will save" – wrong tense.

Q.64 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
A defamation case is being filed by him against his business partner.

(a) He is filing a defamation case against his business partner.
(b) He has been filing a defamation case against his business partner.
(c) He has filed a defamation case against his business partner.
(d) His business partner is filing a defamation case against him.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He is filing a defamation case against his business partner.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Continuous)
Rule: "is being filed by him" → active "**He is filing**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "has been filing"; **(c)** "has filed"; **(d)** subjects swapped.

Q.65 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Absolute liberty is enjoyed by us in matters of food and dress.

(a) We have enjoyed absolute liberty in matters of food and dress.
(b) We will enjoy absolute liberty in matters of food and dress.
(c) We enjoy absolute liberty in matters of food and dress.
(d) We are enjoying absolute liberty in matters of food and dress.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) We enjoy absolute liberty in matters of food and dress.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)
Rule: "is enjoyed by us" → active "**We enjoy**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have enjoyed"; **(b)** "will enjoy"; **(d)** "are enjoying" – wrong tense.

Q.66 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Light the lamp of knowledge in every heart.

(a) Let the lamp of knowledge be lit in every heart.
(b) Let the lamp of knowledge light in every heart.
(c) Let the lamp of knowledge being lighted in every heart.
(d) Let the lamp of knowledge be lighting every heart.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Let the lamp of knowledge be lit in every heart.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Imperative)
Rule: "Light the lamp ..." → "**Let the lamp ... be lit ...**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "light"; **(c)** "being lighted"; **(d)** "be lighting" – wrong forms.

Q.67 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
All previous ages are far surpassed in knowledge by our age.

(a) Our age will far surpasses all previous ages in knowledge.
(b) Our age far surpasses all previous ages in knowledge.
(c) Our age is far surpassing all previous ages in knowledge.
(d) Our age far surpassed all previous ages in knowledge.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Our age far surpasses all previous ages in knowledge.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)
Rule: "are far surpassed ... by our age" → active "**Our age far surpasses ...**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will far surpasses"; **(c)** "is far surpassing"; **(d)** "far surpassed" – wrong tense.

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Q.68 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
May you be blessed with health and happiness!

(a) May God bless you with health and happiness!
(b) May health and happiness be blessed by you!
(c) May health and happiness bless you!
(d) You may bless with health and happiness.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) May God bless you with health and happiness!
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Optative)
Rule: An optative passive "May you be blessed ..." → active "**May God bless you ...**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)/(c)** make health/happiness the subject; **(d)** "You may bless" – wrong.

Q.69 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
I could not use his laptop as it was password protected.

(a) His laptop could not been used by me as it was password protected.
(b) His laptop could not be used by me as it was password protected.
(c) His laptop cannot be used by me as it is password protected.
(d) His laptop has not been used by me as it is password protected.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) His laptop could not be used by me as it was password protected.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive
Rule: "could not use" → "**could not be used**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "could not been"; **(c)** "cannot ... is"; **(d)** "has not been ... is" – wrong tense/form.

Q.70 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Efforts are being made by us to reduce crowding in core city areas.

(a) We will be making efforts to reduce crowding in core city areas.
(b) We were making efforts to reduce crowding in core city areas.
(c) We are making efforts to reduce crowding in core city areas.
(d) We made efforts to reduce crowding in core city areas.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) We are making efforts to reduce crowding in core city areas.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Continuous)
Rule: "are being made by us" → active "**We are making**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will be making"; **(b)** "were making"; **(d)** "made" – wrong tense.

Q.71 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The commanding officer ordered the troops to march ahead.

(a) The troops are ordered to march ahead by the commanding officer.
(b) The troops were ordered to march ahead by the commanding officer.
(c) The troops were being ordered to march ahead by the commanding officer.
(d) The troops have been ordered to march ahead by the commanding officer.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The troops were ordered to march ahead by the commanding officer.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Order)
Rule: "ordered the troops to march" → "**The troops were ordered to march ...**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "are ordered"; **(c)** "were being ordered"; **(d)** "have been ordered" – wrong tense.

Q.72 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Have you placed an order for a cake?

(a) Is an order for a cake being placed by you?
(b) Has an order for a cake been placed by you?
(c) Was an order for a cake placed by you?
(d) Have an order for a cake been placed by you?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Has an order for a cake been placed by you?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect Question)
Rule: "Have you placed an order?" → "**Has an order ... been placed by you?**" (singular "order" → has).
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is being placed"; **(c)** "was placed"; **(d)** "Have an order ... been" – wrong.

Q.73 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
You must sign the contract before you start working.

(a) The contract must be signed by you before you start working.
(b) The contract will be signed by you before you start working.
(c) The contract must being signed by you before you start working.
(d) The contract has been signed by you before you start working.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The contract must be signed by you before you start working.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Modal)
Rule: "must sign" → passive "**must be signed**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "will be"; **(c)** "must being"; **(d)** "has been" – wrong forms.

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Q.74 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Give her a 50% raise in salary.

(a) Let her being given a 50% raise in salary.
(b) Let her be given a 50% raise in salary.
(c) She should have given a 50% raise in salary.
(d) She should give a 50% raise in salary.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Let her be given a 50% raise in salary.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Imperative)
Rule: "Give her a raise" → "**Let her be given a 50% raise ...**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "being given"; **(c)** "should have given"; **(d)** "should give" – wrong.

Q.75 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Elaborate plans are being made for Aarushi's destination wedding.

(a) They are making elaborate plans for Aarushi's destination wedding.
(b) They have made elaborate plans for Aarushi's destination wedding.
(c) They made elaborate plans for Aarushi's destination wedding.
(d) They have been making elaborate plans for Aarushi's destination wedding.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) They are making elaborate plans for Aarushi's destination wedding.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Continuous)
Rule: "are being made" → active "**They are making**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "have made"; **(c)** "made"; **(d)** "have been making" – wrong tense.

Q.76 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
People write autobiographies for various reasons.

(a) Autobiographies are being written by people for various reasons.
(b) Autobiographies have been written by people for various reasons.
(c) Autobiographies were written by people for various reasons.
(d) Autobiographies are written by people for various reasons.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Autobiographies are written by people for various reasons.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Present)
Rule: "write" → passive "**are written**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "are being written"; **(b)** "have been"; **(c)** "were" – wrong tense.

Q.77 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
What did you do to help the migrant labourers during the pandemic?

(a) What has been done by you to help the migrant labourers during the pandemic?
(b) What is done by you to help the migrant labourers during the pandemic?
(c) What was done by you to help the migrant labourers during the pandemic?
(d) What was being done by you to help the migrant labourers during the pandemic?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) What was done by you to help the migrant labourers during the pandemic?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past Question)
Rule: "What did you do ...?" → "**What was done by you ...?**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has been done"; **(b)** "is done"; **(d)** "was being done" – wrong tense.

Q.78 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The audience is applauding the wonderful performance.

(a) The wonderful performance is applauded by the audience.
(b) The wonderful audience is being applauded by the performance.
(c) The wonderful performance is being applauded by the audience.
(d) The wonderful performance was being applauded by the audience.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The wonderful performance is being applauded by the audience.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "is applauding" → "**is being applauded**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is applauded"; **(b)** subjects swapped; **(d)** "was being" – wrong.

Q.79 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Let these ancient texts be preserved for posterity.

(a) Let us preserve these ancient texts for posterity.
(b) You must preserve these ancient texts for posterity.
(c) Let these ancient texts preserve us for posterity.
(d) We have to preserve these ancient texts for posterity.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Let us preserve these ancient texts for posterity.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Let-Imperative)
Rule: "Let these texts be preserved" → active "**Let us preserve these ancient texts ...**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "You must preserve"; **(c)** meaning reversed; **(d)** "We have to preserve" – wrong form.

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Q.80 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Walking zones have been demarcated using paints and cones by the municipal corporation.

(a) The municipal corporation will demarcate walking zones using paints and cones.
(b) The municipal corporation is demarcating walking zones using paints and cones.
(c) Walking zones are demarcating the municipal corporation using paints and cones.
(d) The municipal corporation has demarcated walking zones using paints and cones.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The municipal corporation has demarcated walking zones using paints and cones.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect)
Rule: "have been demarcated ... by the municipal corporation" → active "**The municipal corporation has demarcated ...**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will demarcate"; **(b)** "is demarcating"; **(c)** subject-object reversed.

Q.81 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Issue the advisory to the villagers to be on alert for the cyclone.

(a) The advisory might be issued to the villagers to be on alert for the cyclone.
(b) The advisory will be issued to the villagers to be on alert for the cyclone.
(c) Why hasn't the advisory been issued to the villagers to be on alert for the cyclone?
(d) Let the advisory be issued to the villagers to be on alert for the cyclone.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Let the advisory be issued to the villagers to be on alert for the cyclone.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Imperative)
Rule: "Issue the advisory ..." → passive "**Let the advisory be issued ...**".
(आदेश का passive: Let + object + be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "might be issued" – adds a modal; **(b)** "will be issued" – future; **(c)** a question.

Q.82 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
We can buy books online from Amazon.

(a) Books can be bought online from Amazon.
(b) Books are bought online from Amazon.
(c) Books were to be bought online from Amazon.
(d) Books could be bought online from Amazon.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Books can be bought online from Amazon.
Active voice Can buy Changes into Can be Bought in Passive voice.

Q.83 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Let Arpit be appointed the monitor this time.

(a) We will appoint Arpit the monitor this time.
(b) We request you to appoint Arpit the monitor this time.
(c) Appoint Arpit the monitor this time.
(d) Arpit should be appointed the monitor this time.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Appoint Arpit the monitor this time.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Imperative)
Rule: "Let Arpit be appointed" → active imperative "**Appoint Arpit ...**".
(आदेश का active: verb + object।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "We will appoint" – future statement; **(b)** "We request you" – changes meaning; **(d)** "should be appointed" – passive.

Q.84 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
He wrote a letter in verse form to his friend.

(a) A letter in verse form has been written by him to his friend.
(b) A verse in letter form had been written by him to his friend.
(c) A letter in verse form was written by him to his friend.
(d) A letter in verse form was being written by him to his friend.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A letter in verse form was written by him to his friend.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "wrote" → passive **was + V3 (written)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has been written" – present perfect; **(b)** "A verse in letter form" – jumbled; **(d)** "was being written" – past continuous.

Q.85 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The school is holding online activity classes for children.

(a) Online activity classes for children are being held by the school.
(b) Online activity classes for children have been held by the school.
(c) Online activity classes for children were held by the school.
(d) Online school for children is being held by the activity classes.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Online activity classes for children are being held by the school.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "is holding" → passive **are being + V3 (held)** (plural "classes").
(Present continuous का passive: is/are being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "have been held" – present perfect; **(c)** "were held" – past; **(d)** jumbled/reversed.

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Q.86 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
These instructions can be easily carried out.

(a) I would easily carry out these instructions.
(b) One can easily carry out these instructions.
(c) One will be able to carry out these instructions easily.
(d) You should easily carry out these instructions.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) One can easily carry out these instructions.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Modal)
Rule: "can be carried out" → active "**One can carry out**".
(Modal passive का active: One can + V1।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I would" – changes modal; **(c)** "will be able to"; **(d)** "should" – change the meaning.

Q.87 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
You are advised not to travel interstate during the lockdown.

(a) Do not travel interstate during the lockdown.
(b) You cannot travel interstate during the lockdown.
(c) You will not travel interstate during the lockdown.
(d) Why don't you travel interstate during the lockdown?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Do not travel interstate during the lockdown.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Advice/Order)
Rule: "You are advised not to travel" → active negative command "**Do not travel ...**".
(सलाह का active: "Do not + verb"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "cannot travel" – changes to inability; **(c)** "will not" – future; **(d)** a question.

Q.88 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Why has the Chief Minister sealed the Delhi borders?

(a) Why have the Delhi borders been sealed by the Chief Minister?
(b) Why were the Delhi borders sealed by the Chief Minister?
(c) Why are the Delhi borders being sealed by the Chief Minister?
(d) Why the Chief Minister has been sealed by the Delhi borders?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Why have the Delhi borders been sealed by the Chief Minister?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect Question)
Rule: "Why has the CM sealed ...?" → "**Why have the Delhi borders been sealed by the CM?**" (plural "borders" → have).
(Present perfect passive प्रश्न: Why have + object + been + V3?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "were sealed" – past; **(c)** "are being sealed" – present continuous; **(d)** roles reversed.

Q.89 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Four people were arrested by the police for cheating.

(a) The police is arresting four people for cheating.
(b) The police arrested four people for cheating.
(c) Four people arrested the police for cheating.
(d) The police has arrested four people for cheating.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The police arrested four people for cheating.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "were arrested by the police" → active **simple past "arrested"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is arresting" – present continuous; **(c)** roles reversed; **(d)** "has arrested" – present perfect.

Q.90 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The negligence of the plant manager caused the mishap at LG Polymers.

(a) The negligence of the plant manager was caused by the mishap at LG Polymers.
(b) The mishap at LG Polymers was caused by the negligence of the plant manager.
(c) The mishap at LG Polymers has been caused by the negligence of the plant manager.
(d) The mishap at LG Polymers was causing the negligence of the plant manager.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The mishap at LG Polymers was caused by the negligence of the plant manager.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "caused the mishap" → passive "**The mishap ... was caused by the negligence ...**".
(Simple past का passive: was + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** roles reversed; **(c)** "has been caused" – present perfect; **(d)** "was causing" – past continuous.

Q.91 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Superstitions are still believed in.

(a) People still can believe in superstitions.
(b) People are still believing in superstitions.
(c) People still believe in superstitions.
(d) People still believed in superstitions.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) People still believe in superstitions.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)
Rule: "are still believed in" → active "**People still believe in ...**" (keep "in").
(Simple present passive का active: simple present; "believe in"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "can believe" – adds a modal; **(b)** "are believing" – continuous; **(d)** "believed" – past.

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Q.92 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
I had taken a loan from the bank in my mother's name.

(a) A loan will be taken by me from the bank in my mother's name.
(b) A bank has been taken by me from the loan in my mother's name.
(c) A loan had been taken by me from the bank in my mother's name.
(d) A loan was taken by me from the bank in my mother's name.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A loan had been taken by me from the bank in my mother's name.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Past Perfect)
Rule: "had taken" → passive **had been + V3 (taken)**.
(Past perfect का passive: had been + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will be taken" – future; **(b)** "bank ... from the loan" – jumbled; **(d)** "was taken" – simple past.

Q.93 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
This passage has been cleaned by Bhanu with his vacuum cleaner.

(a) Bhanu has cleaned this passage with his vacuum cleaner.
(b) Bhanu was cleaning this passage with his vacuum cleaner.
(c) Bhanu had cleaned this passage with his vacuum cleaner.
(d) Bhanu has cleaned his vacuum cleaner with this passage.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Bhanu has cleaned this passage with his vacuum cleaner.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has been cleaned by Bhanu" → active **has cleaned**.
(Present perfect passive का active: has + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "was cleaning" – past continuous; **(c)** "had cleaned" – past perfect; **(d)** meaning reversed.

Q.94 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
A book has been sent to me by my father on my birthday.

(a) A book has sent my father on my birthday.
(b) My father is sending me a book on my birthday.
(c) My father will send me a book on my birthday.
(d) My father has sent me a book on my birthday.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) My father has sent me a book on my birthday.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has been sent to me by my father" → active **has sent**.
(Present perfect passive का active: has + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has sent my father" – reversed; **(b)** "is sending" – present continuous; **(c)** "will send" – future.

Q.95 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
A ten-year-old girl was taking art classes for children.

(a) Children for art classes were being taken by a ten-year-old girl.
(b) Art classes for children were being taken by a ten-year-old girl.
(c) Art classes for children were taken by a ten-year-old girl.
(d) Art classes for children had been taken by a ten-year-old girl.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Art classes for children were being taken by a ten-year-old girl.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Past Continuous)
Rule: "was taking" → passive **were being + V3 (taken)** (plural "classes").
(Past continuous का passive: was/were being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Children ... were being taken" – wrong object; **(c)** "were taken" – simple past; **(d)** "had been taken" – past perfect.

Q.96 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
A herd of wild goats invaded a deserted town in Wales during the lockdown.

(a) A herd of wild goats in Wales was invaded by a deserted town during the lockdown.
(b) A deserted town in Wales is being invaded by a herd of wild goats during the lockdown.
(c) A deserted town in Wales was invaded by a herd of wild goats during the lockdown.
(d) A deserted town in Wales has been invaded by a herd of wild goats during the lockdown.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A deserted town in Wales was invaded by a herd of wild goats during the lockdown.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "invaded" → passive **was + V3 (invaded)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** roles reversed; **(b)** "is being invaded" – present continuous; **(d)** "has been invaded" – present perfect.

Q.97 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The football match was being watched by the boys.

(a) The boys had been watching the football match.
(b) The boys are watching the football match.
(c) The boys were watching the football match.
(d) The football match was watching the boys.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The boys were watching the football match.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Past Continuous)
Rule: "was being watched by the boys" → active **past continuous "were watching"**.
(Past continuous passive का active: was/were + V-ing।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "had been watching" – past perfect continuous; **(b)** "are watching" – present; **(d)** meaning reversed.

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Q.98 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The pink locusts are attacking the crops in several districts of Rajasthan.

(a) The pink locusts in several districts of Rajasthan are being attacked by the crops.
(b) The crops in several districts of Rajasthan are being attacked by the pink locusts.
(c) The crops in several districts of Rajasthan have been attacked by the pink locusts.
(d) Several districts of Rajasthan are being attacked in the crops by the pink locusts.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The crops in several districts of Rajasthan are being attacked by the pink locusts.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "are attacking" → passive **are being + V3 (attacked)**.
(Present continuous का passive: are being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "locusts ... attacked by the crops" – reversed; **(c)** "have been attacked" – present perfect; **(d)** jumbled.

Q.99 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
We do not sell stationery at this shop.

(a) Stationery has not been sold at this shop.
(b) Stationery is not being sold at this shop.
(c) Stationery will not sell at this shop.
(d) Stationery is not sold at this shop.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Stationery is not sold at this shop.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Present)
Rule: "do not sell" → passive **is not sold**.
(Simple present का passive: is/are + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has not been sold" – present perfect; **(b)** "is not being sold" – present continuous; **(c)** "will not sell" – future/active.

Q.100 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
What are you being disturbed by?

(a) Who has disturbed you?
(b) What has disturbed you?
(c) What is disturbing you?
(d) Why are you disturbed?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) What is disturbing you?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Continuous)
Rule: "What are you being disturbed by?" → active "**What is disturbing you?**"
(Present continuous passive प्रश्न का active: What is + V-ing + you?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Who has disturbed" – present perfect + person; **(b)** "has disturbed" – present perfect; **(d)** "Why are you disturbed" – changes meaning.

Q.101 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Has the essay been completed by you?

(a) Did you complete the essay?
(b) Have you completed the essay?
(c) When will you complete the essay?
(d) Will you complete the essay?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Have you completed the essay?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect Question)
Rule: "Has the essay been completed by you?" → active "**Have you completed the essay?**"
(Present perfect passive प्रश्न का active: Have + subject + V3?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Did you complete" – simple past; **(c) & (d)** future.

Q.102 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Nothing can be achieved without hard work.

(a) One has achieved nothing without hard work.
(b) One can achieve nothing without hard work.
(c) One could achieve nothing without hard work.
(d) One will achieve nothing without hard work.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) One can achieve nothing without hard work.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Modal)
Rule: "Nothing can be achieved" → active "**One can achieve nothing**".
(Modal passive का active: One can + V1।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has achieved" – present perfect; **(c)** "could achieve" – past; **(d)** "will achieve" – future.

Q.103 Select the most appropriate passive form of the given sentence.
The flood victims of Assam have to make highway their home every year.

(a) Highway has made the flood victims of Assam their home every year.
(b) Highway has been made their home every year by the flood victims of Assam.
(c) Highway is being made their home every year by the flood victims of Assam.
(d) Highway has to be made their home every year by the flood victims of Assam.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Highway has to be made their home every year by the flood victims of Assam.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (with "have to")
Rule: "have to make highway their home" → passive "**Highway has to be made their home** by ...".
(have to make → has to be made।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** roles reversed; **(b)** "has been made" – present perfect; **(c)** "is being made" – present continuous.

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Q.104 Select the most appropriate active form of the given sentence.
Rani's car is twelve years old but it has not been used much.

(a) Rani's car is twelve years old but it hasn't used her much.
(b) Rani's car is twelve years old but she hasn't used it much.
(c) Rani's car is twelve years old but she isn't using it much.
(d) Rani's car is twelve years old but she didn't use it much.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Rani's car is twelve years old but she hasn't used it much.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has not been used" → active "**she hasn't used it**".
(Present perfect passive का active: has/have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "it hasn't used her" – reversed; **(c)** "isn't using" – present continuous; **(d)** "didn't use" – simple past.

Q.105 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Who could have made such a silly mistake?

(a) By whom could such a silly mistake be made?
(b) By whom could such a silly mistake have been made?
(c) By whom can such a silly mistake have been made?
(d) By whom can such a silly mistake be made?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) By whom could such a silly mistake have been made?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Modal Perfect Question)
Rule: "Who could have made ...?" → "**By whom could such a silly mistake have been made?**"
(could have + V3 का passive: could have been + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "could ... be made" – drops "have been"; **(c) & (d)** "can" – wrong modal.

Q.106 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
He likes people to flatter him.

(a) He likes people to be flattered by him.
(b) He likes to have been flattered by people.
(c) He liked to be flattered by people.
(d) He likes to be flattered by people.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He likes to be flattered by people.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive
Rule: "likes people to flatter him" → "likes **to be flattered** by people".
("to flatter him" का passive: to be flattered by ...।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "to be flattered by him" – wrong agent; **(b)** "to have been flattered" – wrong tense; **(c)** "liked" – past.

Q.107 Select the most appropriate active form of the given sentence.
A bed time story was made by him for me every night.

(a) I made a bed time story for him every night.
(b) He has been making a bed time story for me every night.
(c) He has made a bed time story for me every night.
(d) He made a bed time story for me every night.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He made a bed time story for me every night.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was made by him for me" → active **simple past "made"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** roles reversed; **(b)** "has been making" – present perfect continuous; **(c)** "has made" – present perfect.

Q.108 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Nobody has brought this fact to my notice.

(a) This fact had not been brought to my notice by anybody.
(b) This fact has not been brought to my notice by anybody.
(c) This fact is not being brought to my notice by nobody.
(d) This fact was not brought to my notice by anybody.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) This fact has not been brought to my notice by anybody.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect)
Rule: "Nobody has brought ..." → passive "**This fact has not been brought ... by anybody**".
(Present perfect का passive: has been + V3; Nobody → not ... anybody।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "had not been" – past perfect; **(c)** "by nobody" – double negative; **(d)** "was not brought" – past.

Q.109 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
An enquiry is demanded by us.

(a) We have demanded an enquiry.
(b) We will demand an enquiry.
(c) We are demanding an enquiry.
(d) We demand an enquiry.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) We demand an enquiry.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)
Rule: "is demanded by us" → active **simple present "demand"**.
(Simple present passive का active: simple present।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have demanded" – present perfect; **(b)** "will demand" – future; **(c)** "are demanding" – present continuous.

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Q.110 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The money shall have been withdrawn from the bank by tomorrow.

(a) We shall have withdrawn the money from the bank by tomorrow.
(b) We are going to withdraw the money from the bank by tomorrow.
(c) We shall be withdrawing the money from the bank by tomorrow.
(d) We shall withdraw the money from the bank by tomorrow.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) We shall have withdrawn the money from the bank by tomorrow.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Future Perfect)
Rule: "shall have been withdrawn" → active **shall have + V3 (withdrawn)**.
(Future perfect passive का active: shall/will have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "going to withdraw" – changes tense; **(c)** "shall be withdrawing" – future continuous; **(d)** "shall withdraw" – future simple.

Q.111 Select the most appropriate passive form of the given sentence.
Please do not pluck any flowers from the temple compound.

(a) No flowers can be plucked from the temple compound.
(b) How can any flowers be plucked from the temple compound?
(c) You are requested not to pluck any flowers from the temple compound.
(d) Let any flowers not to be plucked from the temple compound.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) You are requested not to pluck any flowers from the temple compound.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Polite Order)
Rule: "Please do not pluck ..." → "**You are requested not to pluck ...**"
(विनम्र निषेध का passive: "You are requested not to ..."।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "can be plucked" – changes meaning; **(b)** a question; **(d)** "Let ... not to be" – wrong form.

Q.112 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
My request should be considered.

(a) Consider my request.
(b) Please do consider mine request.
(c) Please have consider my request.
(d) Please consider my request.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Consider my request.
options b, c and d are eliminated because the tone of the sentence is not requesting therefore, please should not be there. Options b and c are grammatically incorrect also because of 'mine' and 'have'.

Q.113 Select the most appropriate active form of the given sentence.
How many members were informed about the meeting in time?

(a) How many members could you inform about the meeting in time?
(b) How many members have you informed about the meeting in time?
(c) How many meetings did you inform about the members in time?
(d) How many members did you inform about the meeting in time?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) How many members did you inform about the meeting in time?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Past Question)
Rule: "were informed ...?" → active "**did you inform ...?**"
(Simple past passive प्रश्न का active: did + subject + V1?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "could you inform" – adds a modal; **(b)** "have you informed" – present perfect; **(c)** meaning reversed.

Q.114 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
India is exporting handicrafts to several countries.

(a) Handicrafts were exported to several countries by India.
(b) Handicrafts have been exported to several countries by India.
(c) Handicrafts are exported to several countries by India.
(d) Handicrafts are being exported to several countries by India.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Handicrafts are being exported to several countries by India.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "is exporting" → passive **are being + V3 (exported)** (plural "handicrafts").
(Present continuous का passive: is/are being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "were exported" – past; **(b)** "have been exported" – present perfect; **(c)** "are exported" – simple present.

Q.115 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
She is going to serve tea in silver cups today.

(a) Tea will have been served in silver cups today.
(b) Tea will be served in silver cups today.
(c) Tea should be served in silver cups today.
(d) Tea is going to be served in silver cups today.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Tea is going to be served in silver cups today.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive ("going to")
Rule: "is going to serve" → passive "**is going to be + V3 (served)**".
("be going to" का passive: is going to be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will have been served" – future perfect; **(b)** "will be served" – future simple; **(c)** "should be served" – adds a modal.

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Q.116 Select the most appropriate passive form of the given sentence.
The king covered the hole with a huge stone.

(a) A huge stone was covered by the king with a hole.
(b) The hole was covered by the king with a huge stone.
(c) The king was covered by the hole with a huge stone.
(d) The hole has been covered by the king with a huge stone.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The hole was covered by the king with a huge stone.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "covered the hole" → passive "**The hole was covered by the king** with a huge stone".
(Simple past का passive: was + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) & (c)** reverse the roles; **(d)** "has been covered" – present perfect.

Q.117 Select the most appropriate passive form of the given sentence.
Let your son manage your business after your retirement.

(a) Let your retirement be managed by your son after your business.
(b) Let your business be managed by your son after your retirement.
(c) Your business can be managed by your son after your retirement.
(d) Your business is being managed by your son after your retirement.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Let your business be managed by your son after your retirement.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Imperative)
Rule: "Let your son manage ..." → "**Let your business be managed by your son** ...".
(आदेश का passive: Let + object + be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "retirement ... after your business" – jumbled; **(c)** "can be managed" – adds a modal; **(d)** "is being managed" – present continuous.

Q.118 Select the most appropriate active form of the given sentence.
Those who help themselves are helped by God.

(a) God is helping those who are helping others.
(b) If you help yourself, God will help you.
(c) God helps those who help themselves.
(d) Help yourself and God will help you.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) God helps those who help themselves.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)
Rule: "are helped by God" → active "**God helps** those who help themselves".
(Simple present passive का active: simple present।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is helping ... others"; **(b) & (d)** rephrase as conditionals, changing the structure.

Q.119 Select the most appropriate active form of the given sentence.
Not much damage to the life and property was caused by the cyclone in July this year at the Andhra coast.

(a) The cyclone has not caused much damage to the life and property in July this year at the Andhra coast.
(b) The cyclone could not cause much damage to the life and property in July this year at the.
(c) The Andhra coast did not cause much damage to the life and property in July this year at the cyclone.
(d) The cyclone did not cause much damage to the life and property in July this year at the Andhra coast.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The cyclone did not cause much damage to the life and property in July this year at the Andhra coast.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was caused by the cyclone" → active **simple past "did not cause"**.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has not caused" – present perfect; **(b)** incomplete; **(c)** roles reversed.

Q.120 Select the most appropriate passive form of the given sentence.
Granny had given Uncle Ken a good lecture on how to be a responsible adult.

(a) Uncle Ken was giving a good lecture to Granny on how to be a responsible adult.
(b) Granny was given a good lecture by Uncle Ken on how to be a responsible adult.
(c) Uncle Ken was being given a good lecture by Granny on how to be a responsible adult.
(d) Uncle Ken had been given a good lecture by Granny on how to be a responsible adult.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Uncle Ken had been given a good lecture by Granny on how to be a responsible adult.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Past Perfect)
Rule: "had given Uncle Ken" → passive "**Uncle Ken had been given** ... by Granny".
(Past perfect का passive: had been + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) & (b)** reverse the roles; **(c)** "was being given" – past continuous.

Q.121 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.The canons are being fired continuously by them.

(a) They are firing the canons continuously.
(b) They have fired the canons continuously.
(c) The canons fire continuously.
(d) They fired canons continuously.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) They are firing the canons continuously.
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Q.122 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
I am not interested in this assignment.

(a) This assignment does not interest me.
(b) This assignment did not interest me.
(c) This assignment has not interested me.
(d) This assignment is not interesting me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) This assignment does not interest me.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)
Rule: "I am not interested in this assignment" → active "**This assignment does not interest me**".
("be interested in" का active: "... interests me" ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "did not interest" – past; **(c)** "has not interested" – present perfect; **(d)** "is not interesting" – continuous.

Q.123 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Has Rahul been declared fit to play the next match?

(a) Have they declared Rahul fit to play the next match?
(b) Did they declare Rahul fit to play the next match?
(c) Are they declaring Rahul fit to play the next match?
(d) Has Rahul declared the next match fit to play?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Have they declared Rahul fit to play the next match?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect Question)
Rule: "Has Rahul been declared ...?" → active "**Have they declared Rahul ...?**"
(Present perfect passive प्रश्न का active: Have + subject + V3?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "Did they declare" – simple past; **(c)** "Are they declaring" – present continuous; **(d)** meaning reversed.

Q.124 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The task has been completed.

(a) Someone has completed the task.
(b) Someone will be completing the task.
(c) Someone completes the task.
(d) Someone has been completing the task.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Someone has completed the task.
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Q.125 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.The mistress appointed him monitor.

(a) He appointed mistress as monitor.
(b) Monitor had been appointed as mistress.
(c) He was appointed monitor by the mistress.
(d) He had been appointed as monitor.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He was appointed monitor by the mistress.
The given sentence is in simple past. And the rule for the same is;
Active voice Passive voice
Subject + v2 + object Object + was/were + v3 + by + Subject
So, the correct option is 'c'.

Q.126 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. Marvel Comics created Superman.

(a) Marvel Comics is creating Superman.
(b) Superman was created by Marvel Comics.
(c) Superman is created by Marvel Comics.
(d) Superman was created.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Superman was created by Marvel Comics.
The given sentence is in simple past. And the rule for the same is;
Active voice Passive voice
Subject + v2 + object Object + was/were + v3 + by + Subject
So, the correct option is 'b'

Q.127 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice. The Event Management team organised the wedding.

(a) The wedding is organised by the Event Management team.
(b) The Event Management team is organising the wedding.
(c) The Event Management has organised the wedding.
(d) The wedding was organised by the Event Management team.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The wedding was organised by the Event Management team.
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Q.128 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.The courier boy did not deliver the parcel.

(a) The parcel did not deliver by the courier boy.
(b) The parcel had not been delivered by the courier boy.
(c) The parcel had not delivered by the courier boy.
(d) The parcel was not delivered by the courier boy.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The parcel was not delivered by the courier boy.
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Q.129 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.A new gallery is being built inside the city stadium.

(a) They have been building a new gallery inside the city stadium.
(b) They are building a new gallery inside the city stadium.
(c) They will build a new gallery inside the city stadium.
(d) They were building a new gallery inside the city stadium.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) They are building a new gallery inside the city stadium.

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Q.130 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.A new book on games will be released by the publishers next week.

(a) The publishers will be releasing a new book next week.
(b) The publishers will release a new book on games next week.
(c) The publishers will publish a new book on games next week.
(d) The publishers would release a new book next week.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The publishers will release a new book on games next week.

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Q.131 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.A new invention has been made by him.

(a) He had been making a new invention.
(b) He were making a new invention.
(c) He has made a new invention.
(d) He was making a new invention.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He has made a new invention.

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Q.132 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The award was presented to her by the director.

(a) She presented the award to the director.
(b) She was presenting the award to the director.
(c) The award presented to her by the director.
(d) The director presented the award to her.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The director presented the award to her.

The correct answer is option (d).
The sentence is in passive voice. To change it to active voice, we need to make the subject perform the action. So, the active voice of sentence is **"The director presented the award to her".**

Q.133 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.The story of his uncle's mysterious disappearance was first heard by Rajat in his childhood

(a) Rajat first heard the story of his uncle's mysterious disappearance in his childhood.
(b) The story Rajat first heard in his childhood was about his uncle's mysterious disappearance.
(c) The story uncle heard first time was about Rajat's mysterious disappearance in his childhood.
(d) Rajat's first story that uncle heard in his childhood was about his mysterious disappearance.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Rajat first heard the story of his uncle's mysterious disappearance in his childhood.

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Q.134 Select the option that expresses the following sentence in active voice.
By whom were you taught English grammar and composition?

(a) Whom taught you English grammar and composition?
(b) Who had taught you English grammar and composition?
(c) Who has taught you English grammar and composition?
(d) Who taught you English grammar and composition?

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Who taught you English grammar and composition?

The correct answer is option (d).
The given sentence is in the passive voice. To convert it to active voice, we need to rephrase it so that the subject is performing the action. In this case, "Who taught you English grammar and composition?" is the correct active voice construction. It has the subject "Who" performing the action of teaching, and it conveys the same information in an active voice form.
The correct active voice would be: **"Who taught you English grammar and composition?"**

Q.135 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Everyone was surprised at his speech.

(a) His speech is surprising everyone.
(b) His speech surprised everyone.
(c) His speech surprise everyone.
(d) His speech was surprising to everyone.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) His speech surprised everyone.

Active: "Everyone was surprised at his speech."
Passive: "His speech surprised everyone."

- The object "his speech" becomes the subject.
- The verb tense remains consistent ("was surprised" to "surprised").
- "Everyone" remains the receiver of the action, but it is placed after the verb in the active sentence.

Correct answer: **His speech surprised everyone.**
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

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Q.136 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Access denied.

(a) Access is being denied.
(b) Access has been denied.
(c) Let it be known that access will be denied.
(d) Let the access be denied.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Let the access be denied.

The correct answer is option (d).
According to imperative sentence we only command in **Present Tense**. So, the given question is not correct. Correct question should be "**Access Deny**".
Then According to this the correct answer will be option (d) **(Let the access be denied).**
In imperative sentences we apply this rule:
Ex: active voice = shut the window
Passive voice (let + obj + be + V_3) = Let the window be shut.
Hence, the correct passive voice is: **"Let the access be denied."**

Q.137 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The explosion caused serious damage in Ukraine.

(a) Serious damage was caused by the explosion in Ukraine.
(b) Serious damage has been caused by the explosion in Ukraine.
(c) In Ukraine, serious damage had been caused by the explosion.
(d) Serious damage in Ukraine has been caused by the explosion.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Serious damage was caused by the explosion in Ukraine.

When converting an active voice sentence to passive voice:

1. The **object** in the active sentence becomes the **subject** in the passive sentence.
   - Active: "The explosion caused serious damage in Ukraine."
     - Subject: The explosion
     - Object: Serious damage
   - Passive: "Serious damage was caused by the explosion in Ukraine."
2. The verb tense remains the same (past simple "caused" → "was caused").
3. The preposition **"by"** is used to introduce the original subject ("the explosion").

Correct answer: **Serious damage was caused by the explosion in Ukraine.**
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.138 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Did you hear that noise?

(a) Was that noise heard by you?
(b) Wasn't that noise heard by you?
(c) Has that noise been heard by you?
(d) Is that noise heard by you?

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Was that noise heard by you?

1. **Change the object** ("that noise") into the subject.
2. **Use the correct form of the verb "to be"** according to the tense (here, past tense "did" is used, so we use "was").
3. **Use the past participle of the main verb** ("hear" becomes "heard").
4. **Maintain the meaning** and structure.

So, the passive voice version is:
Was that noise heard by you?
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.139 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Don't park your car here.

(a) Have not your car be parked here.
(b) Let not your car be parked here.
(c) Let your car be parked here.
(d) Let your car not be parked here.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Let your car not be parked here.

Passive Voice Transformation:

- In the passive voice, the object (your car) becomes the subject, and the verb changes accordingly.
- The verb "park" becomes "be parked," and the phrase is transformed into a command.
- The negative form "don't" is replaced by "let not" in the passive voice.

So, the most appropriate passive voice construction is **"Let your car not be parked here."**
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.140 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
They built a new house last year.

(a) A new house was being built by them last year.
(b) They had been building a new house last year.
(c) A new house was built by them last year.
(d) A new house is being built by them last year.

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A new house was built by them last year.

The correct answer is: **A new house was built by them last year**
Active Voice ------- Passive Voice
Subject + V2 + Object ------ Object + was/were + V3 + by + Subject
They built a new house last year. -------> A new house was built by them last year.

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Q.141 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Scientists have recently discovered a new species of marine life in the unexplored depths of the ocean.

(a) A new species of marine life was recently discovered in the unexplored depths of the ocean by scientists.
(b) A new species of marine life had recently been discovered in the unexplored depths of the ocean by scientists.
(c) A new species of marine life has recently been discovered in the unexplored depths of the ocean by scientists.
(d) A new species of marine life was recently being discovered in the unexplored depths of the ocean by scientists.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A new species of marine life has recently been discovered in the unexplored depths of the ocean by scientists.
To convert a sentence from **active voice** to **passive voice**, follow these steps:
1. **Identify the subject, verb, and object** in the active sentence.
2. **Make the object the subject** of the passive sentence.
3. **Use the appropriate form of the verb "to be"** (based on the tense of the original sentence).
   - For example:
     - Present simple: **am/are/is**
     - Past simple: **was/were**
     - Present perfect: **have/has been**
4. **Use the past participle** of the main verb in the sentence.
5. **Add the original subject (optional)** at the end, introduced by "by."

Active Voice: Scientists have recently discovered a new species of marine life in the unexplored depths of the ocean.
Passive Voice: A new species of marine life has recently been discovered in the unexplored depths of the ocean by scientists.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.142 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The teacher will explain the lesson tomorrow.

(a) The lesson is being explained by the teacher tomorrow.
(b) The lesson was explained by the teacher tomorrow.
(c) The lesson will be explained by the teacher tomorrow.
(d) The lesson will have been explained by the teacher tomorrow.

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The lesson will be explained by the teacher tomorrow.
The correct answer is: **The lesson will be explained by the teacher tomorrow.**
Active Voice Passive Voice
Subject + will/shall + V1 + object Object + will/shall + be + V3 + by + subject
The teacher will explain the lesson tomorrow. **The lesson will be explained by the teacher tomorrow.**

Q.143 Select the option that expresses the following sentence in passive voice.
After we come to power at the Centre, we will conduct a countrywide caste census.

(a) A countrywide caste census will be conducted by us after we come to power at the Centre.
(b) A countrywide caste census should be conducted by us when we come to power at the Centre.
(c) A countrywide caste census will be conducted by us as and when we come to power at the Centre.
(d) A countrywide caste census will have been conducted by us after we come to power at the Centre.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A countrywide caste census will be conducted by us after we come to power at the Centre.
In passive voice, the object of the active sentence becomes the subject, and the subject becomes the agent, introduced by "by." The verb tense is adjusted accordingly.
Active Voice: After we come to power at the Centre, we will conduct a countrywide caste census.
Passive Voice: A countrywide caste census will be conducted by us after we come to power at the Centre.
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.144 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Why was such a letter written by your brother?

(a) Why was your brother writing such a letter?
(b) Why had your brother written such a letter?
(c) Why does your brother write such a letter?
(d) Why did your brother write such a letter?

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Why did your brother write such a letter?
Rule: simple past passive question *(सामान्य भूत कर्मवाच्य प्रश्न)* → active:
Wh + **was/were** + object + **V3** + by + agent ⇒ Wh + **did** + subject + **V1** + object?
Example: When was the bridge built by them? → When did they build the bridge?
Apply it.
by your brother → subject: **your brother**
was ... written → **did ... write**
object → *such a letter*
Answer: **Why did your brother write such a letter?**
Why the others are wrong.
• **was ... writing** — past continuous *(अपूर्ण भूत)*; the passive had no *being*.
• **had ... written** — past perfect *(पूर्ण भूत)*; the passive had no *been*.
• **does ... write** — simple present *(सामान्य वर्तमान)*; the passive *was* is past.
was/were + V3 in a passive question ⇒ did + V1 in the active.

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Q.145 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The massive exterior wall of the old mansion was being painted by the skilled laborers when it suddenly started raining heavily.

(a) The skilled laborers painted the massive exterior wall of the old mansion when it suddenly started raining heavily.
(b) The skilled laborers had been painting the massive exterior wall of the old mansion when it suddenly started raining heavily.
(c) The skilled laborers were painting the massive exterior wall of the old mansion when it suddenly started raining heavily.
(d) The skilled laborers are painting the massive exterior wall of the old mansion when it suddenly started raining heavily.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2025 | 18 Jan 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The skilled laborers were painting the massive exterior wall of the old mansion when it suddenly started raining heavily.
Rule: past continuous passive *(अपूर्ण भूत कर्मवाच्य)* → active: object + **was/were being + V3** + by + agent ⇒ agent + **was/were + V-ing** + object.
The *when*-clause is a separate clause and stays as it is.
Example: The song was being sung by the girls. → The girls were singing the song.
Apply it.
by the skilled laborers → subject, plural → **were**
was being painted → **were painting**
object → *the massive exterior wall of the old mansion*
Answer: **The skilled laborers were painting the massive exterior wall of the old mansion when it suddenly started raining heavily.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **painted** — simple past *(सामान्य भूत)*; *being* showed an action in progress, which is lost.
• **had been painting** — past perfect continuous *(पूर्ण निरंतर भूतकाल)*; adds "for some time before", which the passive did not say.
• **are painting** — present continuous *(अपूर्ण वर्तमान)*; it clashes with the past *started*.
Word help.
mansion = a large, grand house *(हवेली)*.
"Being" in a passive is the sign of a continuous tense — keep the -ing in the active.

Q.146 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The burglar destroyed several items in the room. Even the carpet has been torn.

(a) Several items destroyed in the room by the burglar. Even the carpet he has torn.
(b) Including the carpet, several items in the room have been torn by the burglar.
(c) Several items in the room were destroyed by the burglar. Even the carpet has been torn.
(d) The burglar, being destroyed several items in the room, also carpet has torn.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Several items in the room were destroyed by the burglar. Even the carpet has been torn.
Rule: simple past active → passive *(सामान्य भूत कर्मवाच्य)*: subject + V2 + object ⇒ object + **was/were + V3** + by + subject.
A sentence that is already passive stays as it is.
Example: The dog bit the boy. → The boy was bitten by the dog.
Sentence 1.
object *several items in the room* (plural) → **were**
destroyed → **were destroyed by the burglar**
Sentence 2.
Even the carpet has been torn — already present perfect passive → **unchanged**.
Answer: **Several items in the room were destroyed by the burglar. Even the carpet has been torn.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **Several items destroyed … by the burglar** — no *were* before V3, so it is not a passive at all; *Even the carpet he has torn* turns sentence 2 back into the active *(कर्तृवाच्य)*.
• **Including the carpet … have been torn** — merges the sentences, changes *destroyed* to *torn* and the tense to present perfect *(पूर्ण वर्तमान)*; the meaning changes.
• **The burglar, being destroyed** — makes the burglar the thing destroyed; ungrammatical and the meaning is reversed *(अर्थ उलट गया)*.
Change only what is active — a sentence already in the passive is left alone.

Q.147 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
He is eating an apple.

(a) He was eating an apple.
(b) An apple was eaten by him.
(c) He has been eating an apple.
(d) An apple is being eaten by him.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) An apple is being eaten by him.
The correct passive voice is: **An apple is being eaten by him.**
Active Voice into Passive Voice
Subject + is/am/are + V(ing) + Object ------ Object + is/am/are + being + V3 + Subject
He is eating an apple. ------> **An apple is being eaten by him.**

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Q.148 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
I gifted a soft toy to my daughter.

(a) A soft toy is gifted to my daughter by me.
(b) To my daughter was gifted a soft toy by me.
(c) A soft toy was being gifted to my daughter by me.
(d) A soft toy was gifted to my daughter by me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A soft toy was gifted to my daughter by me.
option (d) is the correct answer.
Rule-:
Active Voice to Passive Voice-:
- Sub + v2 + Obj ---------- Obj + was/were + v3.
- Sub + was/were + v4 +obj – Obj + was/were + v4 + by + Sub.
- Sub + had + v3 + Obj --------- Obj + had + been + v3 + by Sub.

Hence the correct answer is: ***A soft toy was gifted to my daughter by me.***

Q.149 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Simran was plucking the flowers.

(a) The flowers are plucked by Simran.
(b) The flowers were being plucked by Simran.
(c) The flowers will be plucked by Simran.
(d) The flowers have been plucked by Simran.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The flowers were being plucked by Simran.
option (b) is the correct answer.
Rule-:
Active to Passive: Tense never changes in Active to Passive Transformation.
- Sub + v2 + Obj ---------- Obj + was/were + v3 + Sub
- Sub + was/were + v4 + Obj ---- Obj + was/were + being + v3 + by sub.
- Sub + had + v3 + Obj ---------- Obj + had + been + v3 + by + Sub.

Thus, the correct passive voice is: ***The flowers were being plucked by Simran.***

Q.150 Choose the option that is the active form of the sentence.
By whom was this poem written?

(a) This poem is wrote by whom?
(b) Who wrote this poem?
(c) Who write this poem?
(d) Who is wrote this poem?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Who wrote this poem?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active
Rule: "By whom was this poem written?" → active "**Who wrote this poem?**"
(Passive प्रश्न "By whom ...?" का active "Who + V2 ...?")
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is wrote" / **(c)** "Who write" / **(d)** "Who is wrote" – wrong verb forms.

Q.151 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The seller shall dispatch the parcel soon to Chennai.

(a) The parcel can be dispatched by the seller to Chennai soon.
(b) The parcel may be dispatched by the seller to Chennai soon.
(c) The parcel might be dispatched by the seller to Chennai soon.
(d) The parcel will be dispatched soon to Chennai by the seller.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The parcel will be dispatched soon to Chennai by the seller.
option (d) is the correct answer.
Active Voice to Passive Voice Rule-:
Sub + shall/will + v1 + object ----- Obj + shall/will + be + v3 + by + Sub.
Thus, the correct answer is: The parcel will be dispatched soon to Chennai by the seller.

Q.152 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Perumal has given a challenging assignment to the newly admitted students.

(a) A challenging assignment has been given by Perumal to the newly admitted students.
(b) A challenging assignment will have been given by Perumal to the newly admitted students.
(c) A challenging assignment was given by Perumal to the newly admitted students.
(d) A challenging assignment had been given by Perumal to the newly admitted students.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A challenging assignment has been given by Perumal to the newly admitted students.
The correct answer is: **A challenging assignment has been given by Perumal to the newly admitted students.**
Active Voice ----> Passive voice
Subject + has/have + V3 + Object ----> Object + has/have + been + V3 + by + subject
Perumal has given a challenging assignment to the newly admitted students. **A challenging assignment has been given by Perumal to the newly admitted students.**

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Q.153 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The rescue team could have completed the task if there had been uninterrupted power supply.

(a) The task could have been completed by the rescue team if there had been uninterrupted power supply.
(b) The task can have completed by the rescue team if there was uninterrupted power supply.
(c) The task could have to be completed by the rescue team if there was uninterrupted power supply.
(d) The task could be completed by the rescue team if there was uninterrupted power supply.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The task could have been completed by the rescue team if there had been uninterrupted power supply.
Convert Active Voice into Passive Voice:
Subject + Could have + V3 + Object ----- Object + Could have + been + V3 + by + Object
The rescue team could have completed the task if there had been uninterrupted power supply. ------ **The task could have been completed by the rescue team if there had been uninterrupted power supply.**

Q.154 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The team won the tournament after weeks of hard work and commitment.

(a) The tournament was won by the team after weeks of hard work and commitment.
(b) The tournament was being won by the team after weeks of hard work and commitment.
(c) The tournament was winning by the team after weeks of hard work and commitment.
(d) The tournament had been won by the team after weeks of hard work and commitment.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The tournament was won by the team after weeks of hard work and commitment.
Active Voice ----- Passive Voice (In Simple Past):
Subject + Verb(second form) + Object ----- Object + was/were + Verb(3rd) + By + Subject
The team won the tournament after weeks of hard work and commitment. ------ The tournament was won by the team after weeks of hard work and commitment.

Q.155 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Doctors saved many lives during the pandemic.

(a) Many lives were saved by doctors during the pandemic.
(b) Many lives were being saved by doctors during the pandemic.
(c) Many lives have been saved by doctors during the pandemic.
(d) Many lives are saved by doctors during the pandemic.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Many lives were saved by doctors during the pandemic.
In passive voice, the focus shifts from the subject (doctors) to the object (many lives). The action (saved) is expressed in the past tense because the original sentence is in the past tense ("saved").
The correct option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice is:
Many lives were saved by doctors during the pandemic.

Q.156 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The new sunshades have protected our windows during the rainy season.

(a) Our sunshades have been protected by the new windows during the rainy season.
(b) Our windows are being protected by the new windows during the rainy season.
(c) Our windows have been protected by the new sunshades during the rainy season.
(d) Our windows are being protected by the new sunshades during the rainy season.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Our windows have been protected by the new sunshades during the rainy season.
In the **passive voice**, the object of the active sentence becomes the subject. In this case, "our windows" becomes the subject, and the action **"have protected"** is converted to **"have been protected."**
The correct auxiliary verb "have been" is used because the original sentence is in the present perfect tense ("have protected").
The correct option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice is:
Our windows have been protected by the new sunshades during the rainy season.

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Q.157 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
I remember my mother taking me to the stadium.

(a) I remember being taken to the stadium by my mother.
(b) My mother remembered me taken to the stadium.
(c) I was remembered being taken to the stadium by my mother.
(d) I was taken to the stadium by mother that I remembered.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I remember being taken to the stadium by my mother.
In passive voice, the object of the active sentence becomes the subject of the passive sentence. The sentence "I remember my mother taking me to the stadium" is changed to "I remember being taken to the stadium by my mother," where the focus is shifted from the subject (my mother) to the object (me).
The correct option that expresses the sentence **"I remember my mother taking me to the stadium"** in the passive voice is:
I remember being taken to the stadium by my mother.

Q.158 Choose the option that is the most appropriate conversion of the following sentence into Active Voice.
The guests are being served dinner by the chef.

(a) The chef has served dinner to the guests.
(b) The chef serves dinner to the guests.
(c) The chef is serving dinner to the guests.
(d) The chef will serve dinner to the guests.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The chef is serving dinner to the guests.
Rule: **is/am/are + being + V3** is the present continuous passive *(अपूर्ण वर्तमान कर्मवाच्य)*.
Its active form is subject + **is/am/are + V-ing** + object.
Example: *The car is being washed by Ravi. → Ravi is washing the car.*
Apply it.
Agent *the chef* → subject.
are being served → **is serving** (singular *chef*).
*The chef **is serving** dinner to the guests.*
Answer: **(3) The chef is serving dinner to the guests.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **has served** — present perfect active *(पूर्ण वर्तमान)*; the action is still going on, not completed.
• **serves** — simple present active *(सामान्य वर्तमान)*; it loses the *being* (continuous) sense.
• **will serve** — simple future active *(सामान्य भविष्य)*; the passive is in the present.
"being + V3" in passive ⇔ "-ing" in active.

Q.159 Change the following sentence into the Active form.
He was seen to have been struggling with the technical presentation for over an hour by the project manager.

(a) The project manager saw him struggling with the technical presentation for over an hour.
(b) He struggled with the technical presentation for over an hour, and the project manager saw him.
(c) The project manager saw that he was struggling with the technical presentation for over an hour.
(d) The project manager had seen him struggling with the technical presentation for over an hour.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The project manager saw him struggling with the technical presentation for over an hour.
Rule: verbs of perception (*see, hear, watch*) in the passive take a **to-infinitive** *(was seen to ...)*; in the active the *to* drops and the object takes a **bare infinitive or -ing** form.
was seen is simple past passive *(सामान्य भूत कर्मवाच्य)* → active **saw** + object + **V-ing**.
Example: *She was heard to sing. → They heard her sing / singing.*
Apply it.
Agent *the project manager* → subject.
was seen → **saw**; *he* → object **him**.
to have been struggling (an action in progress) → **struggling**.
*The project manager **saw him struggling** with the technical presentation for over an hour.*
Answer: **(1) The project manager saw him struggling with the technical presentation for over an hour.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **He struggled ..., and the project manager saw him.** — a compound sentence that only paraphrases; it is not the active voice of the given sentence *(वाच्य परिवर्तन नहीं, केवल भावार्थ)*.
• **saw that he was struggling** — a *that*-clause reports a conclusion (mental seeing); the passive *was seen to* converts to **object + -ing**, not to a noun clause.
• **had seen** — past perfect *(पूर्ण भूत)*; the passive *was seen* is simple past, so the active is **saw**.
Passive "was seen to ..." ⇔ active "saw him ...ing" — drop the "to".

Q.160 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
I burnt my hand yesterday while cooking.

(a) My hand was burnt yesterday while cooking.
(b) My hand will be burnt yesterday while cooking.
(c) My hand was burning yesterday while cooking.
(d) My hand could be burnt yesterday while cooking.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) My hand was burnt yesterday while cooking.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "burnt my hand" → passive **was + V3 (burnt)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "will be burnt yesterday" – future + past word.
• **(c)** "was burning" – past continuous.
• **(d)** "could be burnt" – adds a modal.

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Q.161 From the alternatives given below, select the correct passive voice of the following sentence.
The speech of the child impressed the principal and he gave a bouquet to the speaker on the stage.

(a) The principal was impressed by the speech of the child and a bouquet was given to the speaker on the stage by him.
(b) The principal had been impressed by the speech of the child and a bouquet was given to the speaker on the stage by him.
(c) The principal had been impressed by the speech of the child and a bouquet had been given to the speaker on the stage by him.
(d) Being impressed by the speech of the child by the principal, a bouquet was given to the speaker on the stage by him.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The principal was impressed by the speech of the child and a bouquet was given to the speaker on the stage by him.
Rule: simple past active → **simple past passive** *(सामान्य भूत कर्मवाच्य)*: object + **was/were + V3** + by + subject.
In a compound sentence joined by *and*, change **each clause separately** and keep the tense of each.
Example: *She wrote a letter and he posted it. → A letter was written by her and it was posted by him.*
Clause 1.
The speech of the child **impressed** the principal → The principal **was impressed** by the speech of the child.
Clause 2.
he **gave** a bouquet to the speaker → a bouquet **was given** to the speaker on the stage **by him**.
Answer: **(1) The principal was impressed by the speech of the child and a bouquet was given to the speaker on the stage by him.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **had been impressed** — past perfect passive *(पूर्ण भूत कर्मवाच्य)*; the active verb *impressed* is simple past, so the tense has been changed.
• **had been impressed ... had been given** — both clauses wrongly shifted to past perfect passive.
• **Being impressed ... by the principal, a bouquet was given** — a participle phrase that leaves *being impressed* dangling on the bouquet *(असंबद्ध कृदंत)*, and "by the principal" is misplaced.
Change the voice, never the tense: impressed → was impressed, gave → was given.

Q.162 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
The detective found the lost necklace.

(a) The lost necklace should find the detective.
(b) The lost necklace founded by the detective.
(c) The lost necklace was found by the detective.
(d) The lost necklace had been find by the detective.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The lost necklace was found by the detective.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "found" → passive **was + V3 (found)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3; find → found।)

Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "should find the detective" – reversed.
• **(b)** "founded" – wrong verb (founded = established).
• **(d)** "had been find" – wrong participle.

Q.163 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
The manager permitted women employees to leave office early on that day.

(a) Women employees should leave office early on that day.
(b) Women employees were permitted to leave office early on that day.
(c) Women employees had to leave office early on that day.
(d) Women employees permitted the manager to leave office early on that day.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Women employees were permitted to leave office early on that day.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "permitted (them) to leave" → passive "**were permitted to leave**".
(Simple past का passive: were + V3 + to + verb।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "should leave" – adds a modal.
• **(c)** "had to leave" – changes the meaning.
• **(d)** "permitted the manager" – meaning reversed.

Q.164 Choose the option that is the active form of the sentence.
Has your message been despatched?

(a) Has your message despatched?
(b) Had you despatch your message?
(c) Have you despatched your message?
(d) Is your message despatching?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Have you despatched your message?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect Question)
Rule: "Has your message been despatched?" → active "**Have you despatched your message?**"
(Present perfect passive प्रश्न का active: Have + subject + V3?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Has your message despatched" – wrong.
• **(b)** "Had you despatch" – wrong tense/form.
• **(d)** "Is your message despatching" – present continuous.

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Q.165 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
The first settlers displaced the original inhabitants.

(a) The original inhabitants will displace the first settlers.
(b) The original inhabitants are displacing the first settlers.
(c) The original inhabitants were displaced by the first settlers.
(d) The original inhabitants are being displace by the first settlers.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The original inhabitants were displaced by the first settlers.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "displaced" → passive **were + V3 (displaced)** (plural "inhabitants").
(Simple past का passive: were + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will displace" – future/reversed.
• **(b)** "are displacing" – present continuous/reversed.
• **(d)** "are being displace" – wrong form.

Q.166 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
The Municipal Corporation changed the manhole covers before the rainy season.

(a) The manhole covers were changed before the rainy season.
(b) The manhole covers are change before the rainy season.
(c) The manhole covers is being changed before the rainy season.
(d) The manhole covers can be changed before the rainy season.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The manhole covers were changed before the rainy season.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "changed" → passive **were + V3 (changed)** (plural "covers").
(Simple past का passive: was/were + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "are change" – wrong form.
• **(c)** "is being changed" – present continuous, singular.
• **(d)** "can be changed" – adds a modal.

Q.167 Choose the option that is the active form of the sentence.
By whom was this window broken? Five packets of milk were delivered by the milkman.

(a) Who broke this window? The milkman delivered five packets of milk.
(b) Who is breaking this window? The milkman is delivering five packets of milk.
(c) Whom was break this window? The milkman will deliver five packets of milk.
(d) Who had broke this window? The milkman had delivered five packets of milk.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Who broke this window? The milkman delivered five packets of milk.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active
Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "By whom was ... broken?" → "**Who broke ...?**"; and "were delivered by the milkman" → "**the milkman delivered** ...".
(Passive प्रश्न "By whom ...?" का active "Who + V2 ...?")
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** present continuous; **(c)** "Whom was break" – wrong; **(d)** "had broke" – wrong participle.

Q.168 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
Avoid taking the flyover.

(a) The flyover should avoid taking.
(b) The flyover can be avoid take.
(c) The flyover should be avoid.
(d) The flyover should be avoided.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The flyover should be avoided.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Negative-ish Command)
Rule: "Avoid taking the flyover" → passive "**The flyover should be avoided**".
(आदेश का passive: ... should be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "should avoid taking" – active/reversed.
• **(b)** "can be avoid take" – wrong form.
• **(c)** "should be avoid" – wrong participle.

Q.169 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
They found her guilty of theft.

(a) She is find guilty of theft by them.
(b) She found them guilty of theft.
(c) She had been find guilty of theft.
(d) She was found guilty of theft.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She was found guilty of theft.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "found" → passive **was + V3 (found)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3; find → found।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is find" – wrong form.
• **(b)** "She found them" – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "had been find" – wrong participle.

Q.170 Choose the option that is the active form of the sentence.
An award was given to the film 'Andhaa Dhund.'

(a) The jury was gave the film 'Andhaa Dhund' an award.
(b) The jury will give the award to the film 'Andhaa Dhund'.
(c) The jury had given the film 'Andhaa Dhund' an award.
(d) The jury gave the film 'Andhaa Dhund' an award.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The jury gave the film 'Andhaa Dhund' an award.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active
Rule: Passive "was given" (simple past) → active **simple past "gave"**; the hidden doer is "the jury".
(Simple past passive (was + V3) का active: simple past।)

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Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was gave" – wrong form.
• **(b)** "will give" – future.
• **(c)** "had given" – past perfect.

Q.171 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
Shyam saw Abhishek starting the car.
(a) Abhishek can be seen starting the car by Shyam.
(b) Abhishek has seen Shyam starting the car.
(c) Abhishek was saw by Shyam starting the car.
(d) Abhishek was seen starting the car by Shyam.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Abhishek was seen starting the car by Shyam.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Verb of Perception)
Rule: "saw + object + V-ing" → passive "**object + was seen + V-ing + by ...**".
("saw ... starting" का passive: was seen starting।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "can be seen" – adds a modal.
• **(b)** "Abhishek has seen Shyam" – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "was saw" – wrong form.

Q.172 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
Give the command.
(a) Let the command be given.
(b) You can give the command.
(c) The command can be given.
(d) The command should be give by you.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Let the command be given.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Imperative)
Rule: "Give the command" → passive "**Let + object + be + V3**".
(आदेश का passive: Let + object + be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) & (c)** add "You can / can be" – not the imperative passive.
• **(d)** "should be give" – wrong participle.

Q.173 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
They need 104 more runs to win the match.
(a) 104 more runs will need for them to win the match.
(b) 104 more runs are needed for them to win the match.
(c) They are needed 104 more runs to win the match.
(d) 104 more runs can be needed by them to win the match.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) 104 more runs are needed for them to win the match.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Present)
Rule: "They need 104 runs" → passive "**104 runs are needed** (for them)".
(Simple present का passive: are + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will need" – future/active.

Explanation (contd.)
• **(c)** "They are needed" – meaning reversed.
• **(d)** "can be needed" – adds a modal.

Q.174 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
You have not yet responded to several of my complaints.
(a) Several of my complaints are not being responded yet.
(b) Several of my complaints you have not been responded to yet.
(c) Several of my complaints have not been responded to yet.
(d) My complaints are not been responding yet by you.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Several of my complaints have not been responded to yet.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect)
Rule: "have not responded to" → passive "**have not been responded to**". Keep the preposition "to".
(Present perfect का passive: have been + V3; "respond to" में "to" रहता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "are not being responded" – present continuous.
• **(b)** "you have not been responded" – wrong subject.
• **(d)** "are not been responding" – wrong form.

Q.175 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
The class teacher was taking the children to the zoo.
(a) The children will go to the zoo by their class teacher.
(b) The children can be taking to the zoo by their class teacher.
(c) The children were being taken to the zoo by their class teacher.
(d) The children being taken to the zoo by their class teacher.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The children were being taken to the zoo by their class teacher.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Past Continuous)
Rule: "was taking" → passive **were being + V3 (taken)** (plural "children").
(Past continuous का passive: was/were being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will go" – future.
• **(b)** "can be taking" – adds a modal + wrong form.
• **(d)** "being taken" – missing the helping verb "were".

Q.176 Choose the option that is the active form of the sentence.
I am sometimes puzzled by her actions.
(a) Her actions were sometimes puzzling me.
(b) She can sometimes puzzle me.
(c) Her actions are sometimes puzzled by me.
(d) Her actions sometimes puzzle me.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Her actions sometimes puzzle me.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "am puzzled by her actions" → active **simple present "puzzle"**, with her actions as the doer.
(Simple present passive का active: simple present।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "were puzzling" – past continuous.
• **(b)** "can puzzle" – adds a modal.
• **(c)** "are puzzled by me" – still passive.

Q.177 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
Switch off the television.
(a) May I switch off the television?
(b) Let the television being switch off.
(c) Let the television be switched off.
(d) Can you switch off the television?
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Let the television be switched off.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Imperative)
Rule: A command "Switch off ..." → passive "**Let + object + be + V3**".
(आदेश का passive: Let + object + be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) & (d)** are questions.
• **(b)** "be television being switch off" – wrong form.

Q.178 Choose the option that is the active form of the sentence.
The politician's speech was loudly cheered.
(a) The audience loudly cheered the politician's speech.
(b) The audience was loudly cheered by the politician's speech
(c) The audience had been loudly cheered by the politician.
(d) The audience cheer the politician's loud speech
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The audience loudly cheered the politician's speech.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was cheered" → active **simple past "cheered"**, with "the audience" as the doer.
(Simple past passive का active: simple past।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "was cheered by the speech" – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "had been cheered" – past perfect + reversed.
• **(d)** "cheer" – wrong tense.

Q.179 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
The tennis ball hit Dhiraj on the head.
(a) Dhiraj was hit on the head by the tennis ball.
(b) Dhiraj had been hit on the head by the tennis ball.
(c) The tennis ball was being hit by Dhiraj.
(d) Dhiraj was being hit on the head by the tennis ball
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Dhiraj was hit on the head by the tennis ball.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "hit" → passive **was + V3 (hit)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3।)

Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "had been hit" – past perfect.
• **(c)** "ball was being hit by Dhiraj" – meaning reversed.
• **(d)** "was being hit" – past continuous.

Q.180 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
The child tore the page of the book.
(a) The page of the book was torn by the child.
(b) The book's page is torn by the child.
(c) The page of the book tore by the child.
(d) The page of the book is tearing by the child.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The page of the book was torn by the child.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "tore" → passive **was + V3 (torn)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3; tear → torn।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "is torn" – present.
• **(c)** "tore by the child" – active form kept.
• **(d)** "is tearing" – present continuous.

Q.181 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
The fisherman caught a large fish.
(a) A large fish should be caught by the fisherman.
(b) A large fish was catching the fisherman.
(c) A large fish was caught by the fisherman.
(d) A large fish had been catched by the fisherman.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A large fish was caught by the fisherman.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "caught" → passive **was + V3 (caught)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3; catch → caught।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "should be caught" – adds a modal.
• **(b)** "was catching the fisherman" – meaning reversed.
• **(d)** "had been catched" – wrong participle.

Q.182 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
They considered it an impressive building.
(a) It can be consider to be an impressive building.
(b) It is considered to be an impressive building.
(c) It was considering to being an impressive building.
(d) It was considered to be an impressive building.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) It was considered to be an impressive building.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "considered it an impressive building" → passive "**It was considered to be an impressive building**".
(Simple past का passive: was + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "can be consider" – adds a modal + wrong form.
• **(b)** "is considered" – present.
• **(c)** "was considering to being" – wrong form.

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Q.183 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
The security guard opened the gate using his pass.

(a) The gate was opened by the security guard using his pass.
(b) The gate opened the security guard using his pass.
(c) The gate was open by the security guard use his pass.
(d) The gate is open by the security guard by using his pass.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The gate was opened by the security guard using his pass.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "opened" → passive **was + V3 (opened)**.
(Simple past का passive: was + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "The gate opened the security guard" – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "was open ... use" – wrong forms.
• **(d)** "is open" – present.

Q.184 Choose the option that is the passive form of the sentence.
The little puppy chewed my new slippers.

(a) My new slippers were chewed by the little puppy.
(b) My new slippers were chewing the little puppy.
(c) My new slippers can be chewed by the little puppy.
(d) My new slippers are being chew by the little puppy.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) My new slippers were chewed by the little puppy.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "chewed" → passive **were + V3 (chewed)** (plural "slippers").
(Simple past का passive: was/were + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "were chewing the puppy" – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "can be chewed" – adds a modal.
• **(d)** "are being chew" – wrong form.

Q.185 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The entire area was being given a face-lift.

(a) They have given a face-lift to the entire area.
(b) They are giving a face-lift to the entire area.
(c) They were giving a face-lift to the entire area.
(d) They will be giving a face-lift to the entire area.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) They were giving a face-lift to the entire area.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Past Continuous)
Rule: "was being given" → active **past continuous "were giving"**, subject "They".
(Past continuous passive (was being + V3) का active: was/were + V-ing।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have given" – present perfect.
• **(b)** "are giving" – present continuous.
• **(d)** "will be giving" – future.

Q.186 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Nobody will help you if you are rude.

(a) You will not been helped by nobody if you are rude.
(b) You will not be helped by anybody if you are rude.
(c) You are not helped by anybody if you are rude.
(d) You are not being helped by anybody if you are rude.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) You will not be helped by anybody if you are rude.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Future, negative)
Rule: "Nobody will help you" → passive "**You will not be helped by anybody**". ("Nobody" → "not ... by anybody".)
(Future का passive: will be + V3; "Nobody" → "not ... anybody"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "not been helped by nobody" – double negative + wrong form.
• **(c)** "are not helped" – present tense.
• **(d)** "are not being helped" – present continuous.

Q.187 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Have all the bills been verified by someone?

(a) Has someone verify all the bills?
(b) Is someone verifying all the bills?
(c) Have someone verified all the bills?
(d) Has someone verified all the bills?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Has someone verified all the bills?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect Question)
Rule: "Have ... been verified by someone?" → active **"Has someone verified ...?"** (subject "someone" is singular).
(Present perfect passive प्रश्न का active: Has + subject + V3?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Has someone verify" – wrong verb form.
• **(b)** "Is someone verifying" – present continuous.
• **(c)** "Have someone verified" – wrong ("someone" is singular → "Has").

Q.188 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The animals in the zoo should not be fed.

(a) Don't be feeding the animals in the zoo.
(b) Don't fed the animals in the zoo.
(c) Feed not the animals in the zoo.
(d) Don't feed the animals in the zoo.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Don't feed the animals in the zoo.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Negative Command)
Rule: "should not be fed" (passive order) → active "**Don't + V1**".
(निषेधात्मक आदेश का active: Don't + verb।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Don't be feeding" – wrong continuous form.
• **(b)** "Don't fed" – "fed" is wrong after "Don't"; use "feed".
• **(c)** "Feed not the animals" – archaic/wrong structure.

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Q.189 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
They agreed that the elections should be postponed.

(a) It is agreed by them that the elections should be postponed.
(b) It has been agreed by them that the elections should be postponed.
(c) It was agreed by them that the elections should be postponed.
(d) It had been agreed by them that the elections should be postponed.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) It was agreed by them that the elections should be postponed.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Reporting a Decision)
Rule: "They agreed that ..." → "**It was agreed by them that ...**" (past simple → was).
("They agreed that ..." का passive: It was agreed by them that ...।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is agreed" – present.
• **(b)** "has been agreed" – present perfect.
• **(d)** "had been agreed" – past perfect.

Q.190 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
May you be blessed with good health!

(a) May God be blessing you with good health!
(b) May you bless God with good health!
(c) May God bless you with good health!
(d) May God blessed you with good health!

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) May God bless you with good health!
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Optative)
Rule: An optative sentence "May you be blessed ..." becomes active with **"May God + V1 + you ..."**
(इच्छासूचक (optative) वाक्य का active: May God + verb + you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "May God be blessing" – wrong continuous form.
• **(b)** "May you bless God" – meaning reversed.
• **(d)** "May God blessed" – "may" takes the base verb "bless".

Q.191 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
They will cancel the football tournament this year.

(a) The football tournament will be cancelled this year.
(b) The football tournament is being cancelled this year.
(c) The football tournament was cancelled this year.
(d) The football tournament has been cancelled this year.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The football tournament will be cancelled this year.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Future Simple)
Rule: "will cancel" → passive **will be + V3 (cancelled)**.
(Future simple active (will + V1) का passive: will be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "is being cancelled" – present continuous.
• **(c)** "was cancelled" – past.
• **(d)** "has been cancelled" – present perfect.

Q.192 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Nobody was being ridiculed by me.

(a) I was not ridiculing anybody.
(b) I did not ridicule anybody.
(c) I were not ridiculing nobody.
(d) I am not ridiculing anybody.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I was not ridiculing anybody.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Past Continuous)
Rule: "Nobody was being ridiculed by me" → active "**I was not ridiculing anybody**" (past continuous; "Nobody" → "not ... anybody").
(Past continuous passive का active: was/were + V-ing; Nobody → not ... anybody।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "did not ridicule" – simple past.
• **(c)** "were not ridiculing nobody" – wrong verb + double negative.
• **(d)** "am not ridiculing" – present continuous.

Q.193 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Do not allow strangers into the society complex.

(a) Let strangers should be not allowed into the society complex.
(b) Let strangers must not allow into the society complex.
(c) Strangers should not be allowed into the society complex.
(d) Strangers should not have been allowed into the society complex.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Strangers should not be allowed into the society complex.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Negative Command)
Rule: A negative order ("Do not allow ...") becomes passive as "**... should not be + V3**".
(निषेधात्मक आदेश का passive: ... should not be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Let strangers should be not allowed" – wrong mixed form.
• **(b)** "must not allow" – active.
• **(d)** "should not have been allowed" – wrong tense (past).

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Q.194 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The government is distributing free food grains among the poor.

(a) Free food grains are being distributed among the poor by the government.
(b) Free food grains have been distributed among the poor by the government.
(c) Free food grains were distributed among the poor by the government.
(d) Free food grains are distributed among the poor by the government.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Free food grains are being distributed among the poor by the government.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "is distributing" → passive **are being + V3 (distributed)** (plural "grains").
(Present continuous का passive: is/are being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "have been distributed" – present perfect.
• **(c)** "were distributed" – past.
• **(d)** "are distributed" – simple present.

Q.195 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
You have to see it to believe it.

(a) It needs to being seen to be believed.
(b) It have to be seen to believe.
(c) It has to be seen to be believed.
(d) It has to be seen to being believed.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) It has to be seen to be believed.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive
Rule: "You have to see it to believe it" → passive "**It has to be seen to be believed**" (have to → has to; see → be seen; believe → be believed).
(Active "have to see ... to believe" का passive: has to be seen to be believed।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "needs to being seen" – wrong form.
• **(b)** "have to be seen to believe" – "believe" not made passive.
• **(d)** "to being believed" – wrong form.

Q.196 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Let the medicine be administered every four hours.

(a) Administer the medicine every four hours.
(b) You have administered the medicine every four hours.
(c) Let you administer the medicine every four hours.
(d) You are administering the medicine every four hours.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Administer the medicine every four hours.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Imperative)
Rule: "Let + object + be + V3" (passive order) → active **imperative "V1 + object"**.
(आदेश का active रूप: verb + object।)

Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "You have administered" – a statement, not a command.
• **(c)** "Let you administer" – wrong structure.
• **(d)** "You are administering" – present continuous statement.

Q.197 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
All meetings are held in the conference room.

(a) We hold all meetings in the conference room.
(b) We will hold all meetings in the conference room.
(c) We are holding all meetings in the conference room.
(d) We held all meetings in the conference room.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) We hold all meetings in the conference room.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)
Rule: "are held" → active **simple present "hold"**, with the general subject "We".
(Simple present passive (are + V3) का active: simple present।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "will hold" – future.
• **(c)** "are holding" – present continuous.
• **(d)** "held" – past.

Q.198 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The building was surrounded by special commandos.

(a) Special commandos have surrounded the building.
(b) Special commandos are surrounding the building.
(c) Special commandos surround the building.
(d) Special commandos surrounded the building.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Special commandos surrounded the building.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was surrounded by special commandos" → active **simple past "surrounded"**.
(Simple past passive (was + V3) का active: simple past।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have surrounded" – present perfect.
• **(b)** "are surrounding" – present continuous.
• **(c)** "surround" – simple present.

Q.199 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
How can I forget your generosity?

(a) How can your generosity be forgotten by me?
(b) How can your generosity be forgot by me?
(c) How your generosity can be forgot by me?
(d) How has your generosity been forgotten by me?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) How can your generosity be forgotten by me?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Modal Question)
Rule: "can + V1" → passive "**can be + V3**"; keep the question order. V3 of *forget* = **forgotten**.
(Modal प्रश्न का passive: can be + V3; forget → forgotten।)

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Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "be forgot" – wrong V3 ("forgot" is past, not participle).
• **(c)** "How your generosity can be" – wrong question order.
• **(d)** "has been forgotten" – changes tense.

Q.200 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The doctor advised her a week's rest.

(a) She was advised a week's rest by the doctor.
(b) The doctor was advised a week's rest by her.
(c) She is being advised a week's rest by the doctor.
(d) She has been advised a week's rest by the doctor.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She was advised a week's rest by the doctor.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past, two objects)
Rule: The person object ("her") becomes the subject: "**She was advised** a week's rest by the doctor."
(Simple past का passive: was/were + V3; व्यक्ति-कर्म कर्ता बन जाता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "The doctor was advised ... by her" – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "is being advised" – present continuous.
• **(d)** "has been advised" – present perfect (tense changed).

Q.201 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The committee has discussed the matter for several days.

(a) The matter was discussed by the committee for several days.
(b) The matter has been discussed by the committee for several days.
(c) The matter has discussed by the committee for several days.
(d) The matter is being discussed by the committee for several days.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The matter has been discussed by the committee for several days.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has discussed" → passive **has been + V3 (discussed)**.
(Present perfect का passive: has been + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was discussed" – simple past.
• **(c)** "has discussed" – missing "been".
• **(d)** "is being discussed" – present continuous.

Q.202 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
They are providing shelter to the homeless.

(a) The homeless are being provided shelter.
(b) The homeless have been provided shelter.
(c) The homeless are been provided shelter.
(d) The homeless will be provided shelter.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The homeless are being provided shelter.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)

Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "are providing" → passive **are being + V3 (provided)**.
(Present continuous का passive: are being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "have been provided" – present perfect.
• **(c)** "are been provided" – wrong form.
• **(d)** "will be provided" – future.

Q.203 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
People say he has lived on liquid diet for years.

(a) He has said to have lived on liquid diet for years.
(b) He is said to have been living on liquid diet for years.
(c) He is said to have lived on liquid diet for years.
(d) He is said to live on liquid diet for years.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He is said to have lived on liquid diet for years.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Reporting Verb)
Rule: "People say + (that he has lived)" → passive "**He is said to have + V3**".
(People say ... का passive: He is said to have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has said to have" – wrong form.
• **(b)** "to have been living" – changes the meaning (continuous).
• **(d)** "to live" – present infinitive; loses the "has lived" sense.

Q.204 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The breakfast will have been finished by nine.

(a) They will finish the breakfast by nine.
(b) They will have finish the breakfast by nine.
(c) They will be finishing the breakfast by nine.
(d) They will have finished the breakfast by nine.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) They will have finished the breakfast by nine.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Future Perfect)
Rule: "will have been finished" → active **will have + V3 (finished)**, subject "They".
(Future perfect passive (will have been + V3) का active: will have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will finish" – future simple.
• **(b)** "will have finish" – wrong form.
• **(c)** "will be finishing" – future continuous.

Q.205 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
I am trusted by all my friends.

(a) All my friends trust me.
(b) I trust all my friends.
(c) I have trusted all my friends.
(d) All my friends trusted me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) All my friends trust me.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "am trusted by all my friends" → active **simple present "trust"**, with friends as the subject.
(Simple present passive का active: simple present।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "I trust all my friends" – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "I have trusted" – wrong subject/tense.
• **(d)** "trusted me" – past tense.

Q.206 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Send these books at my new address.
(a) These books must be send at my new address.
(b) Let these books be sent at my new address.
(c) These books should have been sent at my new address.
(d) These books are being sent at my new address.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Let these books be sent at my new address.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Imperative)
Rule: A command "Send ..." becomes passive as "**Let + object + be + V3**".
(आदेश का passive: Let + object + be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "must be send" – wrong V3 (should be "sent").
• **(c)** "should have been sent" – wrong tense.
• **(d)** "are being sent" – present continuous statement.

Q.207 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
This unfair proposal is objected to by us.
(a) We object to this unfair proposal.
(b) We are objecting this unfair proposal.
(c) We object this unfair proposal.
(d) We have objected to this unfair proposal.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) We object to this unfair proposal.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Present)
Rule: "is objected to by us" → active **simple present "object to"**, with "we" as the subject. Keep the preposition "to".
(Simple present passive का active: simple present; "object to" में "to" रहता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "are objecting" – present continuous.
• **(c)** "object this" – drops the necessary "to".
• **(d)** "have objected" – present perfect.

Q.208 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Are the attendance rules being relaxed by the authorities?
(a) Are the authorities relaxing the attendance rules?
(b) Are the authorities going to relax the attendance rules?
(c) Have the authorities relaxed the attendance rules?
(d) Have the authorities been relaxing the attendance rules?
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Are the authorities relaxing the attendance rules?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Continuous Question)
Rule: "Are ... being relaxed by the authorities?" → active **"Are the authorities relaxing ...?"**
(Present continuous passive प्रश्न का active: Are + subject + V-ing?)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "going to relax" – future.
• **(c)** "Have ... relaxed" – present perfect.
• **(d)** "Have ... been relaxing" – present perfect continuous.

Q.209 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Someone robbed the man of all his possessions.
(a) The man is robbed all his possessions by someone.
(b) Someone has been robbed by the man of all his possessions.
(c) The man was being robbed of all his possessions by someone.
(d) The man was robbed of all his possessions by someone.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The man was robbed of all his possessions by someone.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Past)
Rule: "robbed the man of ..." → passive **"The man was robbed of ... by someone."** ("rob somebody **of** something" keeps "of".)
(Simple past का passive: was + V3; "rob ... of" में "of" रहता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is robbed all" – wrong tense, drops "of".
• **(b)** "Someone has been robbed by the man" – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "was being robbed" – past continuous.

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Q.210 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Hasn't India established the air travel bridge to the Maldives?

(a) Hasn't the air travel bridge to the Maldives been established by India?
(b) Why hasn't the air travel bridge to the Maldives been established by India?
(c) Isn't the air travel bridge to the Maldives being established by India?
(d) Shouldn't the air travel bridge to the Maldives be established by India?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Hasn't the air travel bridge to the Maldives been established by India?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect Question)
Rule: "Hasn't India established ...?" → passive "**Hasn't** + object + **been + V3** + by India?" Keep the same question type (no new "Why").
(Present perfect प्रश्न का passive: Hasn't + object + been + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** adds "Why" – changes the question.
• **(c)** "isn't ... being established" – present continuous.
• **(d)** "Shouldn't ... be established" – changes to a suggestion.

Q.211 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The PM has announced a very large economic relief package for the country.

(a) A very large economic relief package for the PM has been announced by the country.
(b) A very large economic relief package for the country has been announced by the PM.
(c) A very large economic relief package for the country was announced by the PM.
(d) A very large economic relief package for the country is going to be announced by the PM.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A very large economic relief package for the country has been announced by the PM.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has announced" → passive **has been + V3 (announced)**; object becomes subject; add "by the PM".
(Present perfect active (has + V3) का passive: has been + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "package for the PM ... by the country" – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "was announced" – simple past (tense changed).
• **(d)** "is going to be announced" – future (tense changed).

Q.212 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
This institute is offering a new online course in Entrepreneurship.

(a) A new online course in Entrepreneurship has been offered by this institute.
(b) A new online course in Entrepreneurship is being offered by this institute.
(c) A new online course in Entrepreneurship is offered by this institute.
(d) A new online course in Entrepreneurship has offered this institute.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A new online course in Entrepreneurship is being offered by this institute.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "is offering" → passive **is being + V3 (offered)**.
(Present continuous active (is + V-ing) का passive: is being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has been offered" – present perfect (tense changed).
• **(c)** "is offered" – simple present.
• **(d)** "has offered this institute" – meaning reversed.

Q.213 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
All international and domestic flights have been cancelled by the government due to the Corona crisis.

(a) The government has cancelled all international and domestic flights due to the Corona crisis.
(b) The government had cancelled all international and domestic flights due to the Corona crisis.
(c) The government has been cancelling all international and domestic flights due to the Corona crisis.
(d) The government is cancelling all international and domestic flights due to the Corona crisis.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The government has cancelled all international and domestic flights due to the Corona crisis.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect)
Rule: "have been cancelled by the government" → active **has cancelled** (singular subject "the government").
(Present perfect passive (have been + V3) का active: has/have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "had cancelled" – past perfect (tense changed).
• **(c)** "has been cancelling" – present perfect continuous.
• **(d)** "is cancelling" – present continuous.

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Q.214 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Let this letter be posted at once.

(a) This letter will be posted at once.
(b) He will post this letter at once.
(c) This letter needs to be posted at once.
(d) Post this letter at once.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Post this letter at once.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Imperative)
Rule: "Let + object + be + V3" is a passive command. Its active form is the plain **imperative "V1 + object."**
(आदेश का passive "Let ... be + V3"; इसका active रूप सीधा imperative "verb + object"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will be posted" – future statement.
• **(b)** "He will post" – adds a subject/changes meaning.
• **(c)** "needs to be posted" – changes the command into a need.

Q.215 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The Railway has started special trains for the workers.

(a) Special trains will be started for the workers by the Railway.
(b) Special trains has been started for the workers by the Railway.
(c) Special trains are being started for the workers by the Railway.
(d) Special trains have been started for the workers by the Railway.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Special trains have been started for the workers by the Railway.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has started" → passive **has/have been + V3**; the plural subject "special trains" takes **have been started**.
(Present perfect का passive: has/have been + V3; बहुवचन के साथ "have"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will be started" – future.
• **(b)** "has been started" – singular "has" with plural "trains" (wrong agreement).
• **(c)** "are being started" – present continuous.

Q.216 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The storm last night uprooted a large number of trees.

(a) A large number of trees were uprooted by the storm last night.
(b) A large number of trees uprooted the storm last night.
(c) The storm last night was uprooted by a large number of trees.
(d) A large number of trees have been uprooted by the storm last night.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A large number of trees were uprooted by the storm last night.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive

Explanation (contd.)
Rule: Simple past active → passive **was/were + V3**. Object "a large number of trees" (plural) → **were uprooted**.
(Simple past का passive: was/were + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** makes the trees the doer – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "storm was uprooted by trees" – nonsense.
• **(d)** "have been uprooted" – present perfect, changes the tense (original is simple past).

Q.217 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Three online games of chess were won by Rahul in a row.

(a) Rahul won three online games of chess in a row.
(b) Rahul was winning three online games of chess in a row.
(c) Rahul had won three online games of chess in a row.
(d) Rahul has won three online games of chess in a row.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Rahul won three online games of chess in a row.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active
Rule: Passive "were won by Rahul" (past simple) → active **simple past** with Rahul as the subject.
(Passive में were + V3 हो तो Active में simple past — यहाँ "won"।)
Transformation
Three online games ... were won by Rahul. → Rahul **won** three online games of chess in a row.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "was winning" – past continuous, changes the sense.
• **(c)** "had won" / **(d)** "has won" – change the tense (past perfect / present perfect).

Q.218 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Who keeps the accounts of this hotel?

(a) By whom are the accounts of this hotel kept?
(b) By whom are the accounts being kept of this hotel?
(c) By whom the account is being kept of this hotel?
(d) By whom have the accounts of this hotelbeen kept?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) By whom are the accounts of this hotel kept?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Who-question)
Rule: A question with "Who" (subject) becomes "**By whom + be + object + V3**". "keeps" (present) with plural "accounts" → **are ... kept**.
("Who" वाले प्रश्न का passive: By whom + are/is + object + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "are being kept" – present continuous.
• **(c)** "is being kept" – singular + continuous.
• **(d)** "have ... been kept" – present perfect (tense changed).

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Q.219 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
A large number of people are using internet banking these days.

(a) Internet banking is used by a large number of people these days.
(b) Internet banking is using a large number of people these days.
(c) Internet banking has been used by a large number of people these days.
(d) Internet banking is being used by a large number of people these days.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Internet banking is being used by a large number of people these days.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Continuous)
Rule: "are using" → passive **is being + V3 (used)** (subject "internet banking" is singular).
(Present continuous का passive: is/are being + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is used" – simple present.
• **(b)** "is using ... people" – meaning reversed.
• **(c)** "has been used" – present perfect (tense changed).

Q.220 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
We use this hall on special occasions.

(a) This hall has been used on special occasions.
(b) This hall is being used on special occasions.
(c) This hall is used on special occasions.
(d) This hall was being used on special occasions.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) This hall is used on special occasions.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Simple Present)
Rule: Simple present active "use" → passive **is/are + V3**. Singular "this hall" → **is used**.
(Simple present का passive: is/are + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has been used" – present perfect.
• **(b)** "is being used" – present continuous.
• **(d)** "was being used" – past continuous.

Q.221 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
His father had already bought the train tickets.

(a) The train tickets had already been bought by his father.
(b) The train tickets were already bought by his father.
(c) The train tickets have already bought his father.
(d) The train tickets are already being bought his father.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The train tickets had already been bought by his father.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Past Perfect)
Rule: "had bought" → passive **had been + V3 (bought)**.
(Past perfect active (had + V3) का passive: had been + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "were already bought" – simple past.
• **(c)** "have already bought his father" – meaning reversed.
• **(d)** "are already being bought" – present continuous.

Q.222 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Why does homework have to be done daily?

(a) Why should we do homework daily?
(b) Why did we do homework daily?
(c) Why do we have to do homework daily?
(d) Why are we doing homework daily?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Why do we have to do homework daily?
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (with "have to")
Rule: "have to be done" → active "**have to do**"; the doer is understood as "we". Keep the question order with "Why + do".
(have to be done → have to do; प्रश्नवाचक क्रम बना रहता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Why should we do" – changes the modal.
• **(b)** "Why did we do" – past tense.
• **(d)** "Why are we doing" – present continuous.

Q.223 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
I am vexed by her behaviour.

(a) Her behaviour is vexing to me.
(b) Her behaviour vexes me.
(c) Her behaviour has vexed me.
(d) Her behaviour vexed me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Her behaviour vexes me.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active
Rule: In a passive sentence "am/is/are + V3", the active is **simple present**. The object of the passive ("I") becomes the subject; the agent ("her behaviour") becomes the doer.
(Passive में am/is/are + V3 हो तो Active में simple present tense आता है।)
Transformation
Passive: *I am vexed by her behaviour.* → Active: Her behaviour **vexes** me.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is vexing to me" – turns the verb into an adjective phrase, not proper active voice.
• **(c)** "has vexed" – present perfect, changes the tense.
• **(d)** "vexed me" – past tense; the original is present.

Q.224 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The books should have been placed on their proper shelves.

(a) You should place the books on their proper shelves.
(b) You will have placed the books on their proper shelves.
(c) You should have placed the books on their proper shelves.
(d) You need to place the books on their proper shelves.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) You should have placed the books on their proper shelves.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Modal Perfect)

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "should have been placed" (modal-perfect passive) → active **"should have placed"**, with an understood subject "You".
(should have been + V3 (passive) का active: should have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "should place" – simple modal (drops "have").
• **(b)** "will have placed" – future perfect.
• **(d)** "need to place" – changes the modal/meaning.

Q.225 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
I was greatly impressed by the Madhubani painting Avika made.

(a) The Madhubani painting Avika made is very impressive.
(b) The Madhubani painting Avika made greatly impressed me.
(c) The Madhubani painting Avika made has greatly impressed me.
(d) The Madhubani painting Avika made is greatly impressing me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The Madhubani painting Avika made greatly impressed me.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was impressed by the painting" → active **simple past "impressed"**, with the painting as the subject.
(Simple past passive (was + V3) का active: simple past।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is very impressive" – changes to an adjective, not active voice.
• **(c)** "has greatly impressed" – present perfect (tense changed).
• **(d)** "is greatly impressing" – present continuous.

Q.226 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
An elderly lady was knocked down by a speeding car this morning.

(a) A speeding car knocks down an elderly lady this morning.
(b) A speeding car knocked down an elderly lady this morning.
(c) A speeding car had knocked down an elderly lady this morning.
(d) A speeding car was knocking down an elderly lady this morning.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A speeding car knocked down an elderly lady this morning.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Simple Past)
Rule: "was knocked down by a speeding car" → active **simple past "knocked down"**, with the car as the subject.
(Simple past passive (was + V3) का active: simple past।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "knocks down" – present tense.
• **(c)** "had knocked" – past perfect.
• **(d)** "was knocking" – past continuous.

Q.227 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
You are requested to give me change for ₹2000.

(a) You should give me change for ₹2000.
(b) Are you giving me change for ₹2000?
(c) Can you give me change for ₹2000?
(d) Please give me change for ₹2000.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Please give me change for ₹2000.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Polite Request)
Rule: "You are requested to ..." is a polite passive request. Its active form is a **polite imperative: "Please + V1."**
(विनम्र निवेदन "You are requested to ..." का active रूप "Please + verb"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "You should give" – an obligation, not a request.
• **(b)** "Are you giving?" / **(c)** "Can you give?" – change the meaning to a question.

Q.228 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Who has taken away my pen?

(a) By whom is my pen taken away?
(b) By whom was my pen taken away?
(c) By whom had my pen been taken away?
(d) By whom has my pen been taken away?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) By whom has my pen been taken away?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Present Perfect Who-question)
Rule: "Who has taken ...?" → "**By whom + has + object + been + V3?**"
("Who has + V3" प्रश्न का passive: By whom + has + object + been + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is my pen taken" – simple present.
• **(b)** "was ... taken" – simple past.
• **(c)** "had ... been taken" – past perfect.

Q.229 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The strike has been called off by the workers.

(a) The strike has called off the workers.
(b) The workers are calling off the strike.
(c) The workers had called off the strike.
(d) The workers have called off the strike.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The workers have called off the strike.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect)
Rule: "has been called off by the workers" → active **have called off** (plural subject "the workers").
(Present perfect passive (has been + V3) का active: have/has + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "strike has called off the workers" – meaning reversed.
• **(b)** "are calling off" – present continuous.
• **(c)** "had called off" – past perfect.

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Q.230 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Buy some apples and grapes for the family.

(a) Let some apples and grapes be bought for the family.
(b) Let us buy some apples and grapes for the family.
(c) Some apples and grapes need to be bought for the family.
(d) We should buy some apples and grapes for the family.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Let some apples and grapes be bought for the family.
Type: Voice – Imperative (Command) to Passive
Rule: An order/command in the passive uses **"Let + object + be + V3."**
(आदेशवाचक वाक्य का passive: Let + object + be + V3।)
Transformation
Buy some apples and grapes ... → Let some apples and grapes **be bought** for the family.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "Let us buy" – still active.
• **(c)** "need to be bought" / **(d)** "We should buy" – add new words/change the meaning.

Q.231 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
A statement had already been issued to the press on the lockdown by the authorities.

(a) The authorities are already issuing a statement to the press on the lockdown.
(b) The authorities have already issued a statement to the press on the lockdown.
(c) The authorities had already issued a statement to the press on the lockdown.
(d) A statement had already issued the authorities to the press on the lockdown.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The authorities had already issued a statement to the press on the lockdown.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active
Rule: Past perfect passive "had been issued" → past perfect active **had + V3 (issued)**, with "the authorities" as the subject.
(Past perfect passive (had been + V3) का active: had + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "are issuing" – present continuous.
• **(b)** "have issued" – present perfect (tense changed).
• **(d)** "a statement had issued the authorities" – meaning reversed.

Q.232 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Many Indians have been brought back from foreign countries by the government.

(a) The government has been bringing back many Indians from foreign countries.
(b) The government has brought back many Indians from foreign countries.
(c) The government is bringing back many Indians from foreign countries.
(d) The government had brought back many Indians from foreign countries.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The government has brought back many Indians from foreign countries.
Type: Voice – Passive to Active (Present Perfect)
Rule: "have been brought back by the government" → active **has brought back** (singular subject "the government").
(Present perfect passive (have been + V3) का active: has/have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has been bringing back" – present perfect continuous.
• **(c)** "is bringing back" – present continuous.
• **(d)** "had brought back" – past perfect.

Q.233 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Why do we have to do the house chores during this lockdown period?

(a) Why will the house chores have to be done by us during this lockdown period?
(b) Why do the house chores have to be done by us during this lockdown period?
(c) Why are the house chores being done during this lockdown period by us?
(d) The house chores are to be done during this lockdown period by us.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Why do the house chores have to be done by us during this lockdown period?
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (with "have to")
Rule: "have to do" → passive "**have to be done**"; keep the question word "Why" and helping verb "do" at the front; add "by us".
(have to do → have to be done; प्रश्नवाचक क्रम बना रहता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Why will ... have to be done" – changes tense to future.
• **(c)** "are being done" – present continuous, changes the sense.
• **(d)** not a question – drops "Why".

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Q.234 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Professor Sehgal will organise a webinar on investment tomorrow.

(a) A webinar on investment will have been organised by Professor Sehgal tomorrow.
(b) A webinar on investment is being organised by Professor Sehgal tomorrow.
(c) A webinar on investment is going to be organised by Professor Sehgal tomorrow.
(d) A webinar on investment will be organised by Professor Sehgal tomorrow.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A webinar on investment will be organised by Professor Sehgal tomorrow.
Type: Voice – Active to Passive (Future Simple)
Rule: "will organise" → passive **will be + V3 (organised)**.
(Future simple active (will + V1) का passive: will be + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will have been organised" – future perfect (tense changed).
• **(b)** "is being organised" / **(c)** "is going to be organised" – change the tense.

Q.235 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
One must adopt a life of self-control.

(a) A life of self-control will be adopted by one.
(b) A life of self-control was adopted by one.
(c) A life of self-control has adopted by one.
(d) A life of self-control must be adopted by one.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A life of self-control must be adopted by one.
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"One must adopt a life of self-control."**
- The modal verb "**must**" is used in the active sentence.
- In passive voice, modal verbs are followed by "**be + past participle**."
- The correct passive form is: **"A life of self-control must be adopted by one."**
- Other options either change the tense or use incorrect auxiliary verbs.

Answer: (d) A life of self-control must be adopted by one.

Q.236 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Let us donate the money.

(a) Let the money be donated by us.
(b) We are told to donate the money.
(c) Let the money is donated by us.
(d) The money was donated by us.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Let the money be donated by us.
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"Let us donate the money."**

Explanation (contd.)
- In passive voice, the imperative "Let us..." becomes "**Let + object + be + past participle**."
- The correct passive form is: **"Let the money be donated by us."**
- Other options change the meaning or use incorrect tense.

Answer: (a) Let the money be donated by us.

Q.237 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
When did you call me?

(a) When were you called by me?
(b) When have I called by you ?
(c) When was you called by me?
(d) When was I called by you?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) When was I called by you?
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"When did you call me?"**
- In passive voice, the object "me" becomes the subject "I."
- The correct passive question is: **"When was I called by you?"**
- Other options have incorrect word order or verb forms.

Answer: (d) When was I called by you?

Q.238 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Tejaswi had been offered a huge amount by the publisher last year for translating the work.

(a) The publisher had offered Tejaswi a huge amount last year for translating the work.
(b) The publisher had to offer Tejaswi a huge amount last year for translating the work.
(c) A huge amount had been offered to Tejaswi by the publisher last year for translating the work.
(d) The publisher offered Tejaswi a huge amount last year for translating the work.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The publisher had offered Tejaswi a huge amount last year for translating the work.
Solution:
- The given sentence is in **passive voice**: "Tejaswi had been offered a huge amount by the publisher last year for translating the work."
- To convert into **active voice**, the doer "**the publisher**" becomes the subject.
- The tense is **past perfect passive** ("had been offered"), so active voice will be **past perfect** ("had offered").
- The correct active sentence is: **"The publisher had offered Tejaswi a huge amount last year for translating the work."**
- Other options either change the tense or do not match the voice correctly.

Answer: (a) The publisher had offered Tejaswi a huge amount last year for translating the work.

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Q.239 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The tiger killed a deer.

(a) A deer has been killed by the tiger.
(b) A deer was killed by the tiger.
(c) A deer had been killed by the tiger
(d) The deer was killed by a tiger.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A deer was killed by the tiger.
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"The tiger killed a deer."**
- The tense is **simple past** ("killed").
- The correct passive voice form is: "**A deer was killed by the tiger.**"
- Other options have incorrect tense or articles.

Answer: (b) A deer was killed by the tiger.

Q.240 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Will the car be driven by Mannat in the race?

(a) Will Mannat be driving the car in the race?
(b) Will in the race Mannat drive the car?
(c) In the race, will Mannat drive the car?
(d) Will Mannat drive the car in the race?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Will Mannat drive the car in the race?
- The given sentence is in **passive voice**: "Will the car be driven by Mannat in the race?"
- To convert it to **active voice**, we need to:
  - Identify the subject: **Mannat**
  - Use the correct modal structure: **Will + subject + base verb**
  - So, "Will the car be driven by Mannat..." becomes **"Will Mannat drive the car..."**

Hence, the correct active voice sentence is:
"Will Mannat drive the car in the race?"
Other options are either grammatically awkward or improperly ordered.

Q.241 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Sita made gulab jamuns.

(a) Gulab jamun is made by Sita.
(b) Gulab jamuns was made by Sita.
(c) Gulab jamuns made Sita.
(d) Gulab jamuns were made by Sita.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Gulab jamuns were made by Sita.
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"Sita made gulab jamuns."**
- The tense is **simple past** ("made").
- The correct passive voice form is: "**Gulab jamuns were made by Sita.**"
- Other options have incorrect verb agreement or word order.

Answer: (d) Gulab jamuns were made by Sita.

Q.242 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Rahim was writing a letter.

(a) A letter was written by Rahim
(b) A letter was being written by Rahim.
(c) A letter did Rahim write.
(d) Rahim had been writing a letter.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A letter was being written by Rahim.
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"Rahim was writing a letter."**
- The tense is **past continuous** ("was writing").
- In passive voice, past continuous is formed as: "**was/were being + past participle**."
- The correct passive form is: **"A letter was being written by Rahim."**
- Other options either change tense or structure incorrectly.

Answer: (b) A letter was being written by Rahim.

Q.243 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Our maid will clean the house every Saturday from today onwards.

(a) The house will have been cleaned by our maid every Saturday from today onwards.
(b) The house will be cleaned by our maid every Saturday from today onwards.
(c) The house will be cleaning by our maid every Saturday from today onwards.
(d) The house shall be cleaned by our maid every Saturday from today onwards

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The house will be cleaned by our maid every Saturday from today onwards.
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"Our maid will clean the house every Saturday from today onwards."**
- The tense is **future simple** ("will clean").
- In passive voice, future simple is formed as: "**will be + past participle**."
- The correct passive form is: **"The house will be cleaned by our maid every Saturday from today onwards."**
- Other options have incorrect tense or structure.

Answer: (b) The house will be cleaned by our maid every Saturday from today onwards.

Q.244 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
I was invited by my aunt.

(a) My aunt has invited me.
(b) My aunt will invite me.
(c) My aunt is inviting me.
(d) My aunt invited me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) My aunt invited me.
- The given sentence **"I was invited by my aunt"** is in **passive voice** (past simple tense).

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Explanation (contd.)

- Subject becomes the agent: **My aunt**
- Verb in past simple active form: **invited**
- Object becomes receiver: **me**

To convert it to **active voice**:

- So, the active voice is: **"My aunt invited me."**

Corrected Structure:

- **Passive:** was invited (past simple passive)
- **Active:** invited (past simple active)

No part of speech correction needed here, as this is an **active/passive transformation**.

Q.245 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
It was found that my shoes were cleaned.

(a) It was found that somebody had cleaned my shoes
(b) Somebody found out that he had cleaned my shoes
(c) Someone found my shoes cleaned.
(d) I found that somebody had cleaned my shoes

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Someone found my shoes cleaned.

- The sentence **"It was found that my shoes were cleaned"** is in **passive voice**.
- To change it to **active voice**, we need to:
  - Identify the **agent** (doer) – in this case, **someone**(generic subject).
  - Shift **"were cleaned"** (passive past) to **"cleaned"** (active past indefinite) to maintain the same time frame.

Thus:

- **Passive**: *It was found that my shoes were cleaned.*
- **Active**: Someone found my shoes cleaned..

Q.246 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The man was repairing the tyres of his car.

(a) The tyres of his car were being repaired by the man.
(b) The tyres of his car was being repaired by the man.
(c) The tyres of his car were been repaired by the man.
(d) The tyres of his car were repaired by the man.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The tyres of his car were being repaired by the man.

Solution:

- The active sentence is: **"The man was repairing the tyres of his car."**
- The tense is **past continuous** ("was repairing").
- The passive voice for past continuous is: "**were being + past participle**."
- The correct passive sentence is: **"The tyres of his car were being repaired by the man."**
- Other options have incorrect auxiliary verbs or tense.

Answer: (a) The tyres of his car were being repaired by the man.

Q.247 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
A machine had been developed by Dr. John Gibbon in the US after twenty years.

(a) Dr. John Gibbon has developed a machine in the US after twenty years.
(b) Dr. John Gibbon was developing a machine in the US after twenty years.
(c) Dr. John Gibbon had developed a machine in the US after twenty years.
(d) Dr. John Gibbon developed a machine in the US after twenty years.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Dr. John Gibbon had developed a machine in the US after twenty years.

Solution:

- The given sentence is in **passive voice**: "A machine had been developed by Dr. John Gibbon in the US after twenty years."
- To convert into **active voice**, the doer "**Dr. John Gibbon**" becomes the subject.
- The tense is **past perfect passive** ("had been developed"), so active voice will be **past perfect** ("had developed").
- The correct active sentence is: **"Dr. John Gibbon had developed a machine in the US after twenty years."**
- Other options have incorrect tense or aspect.

Answer: (c) Dr. John Gibbon had developed a machine in the US after twenty years.

Q.248 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Rekha was very fascinated by the solitude offered by the hillside.

(a) The solitude was offered by the hillside fascinating Rekha very much.
(b) The solitude offered by the hillside was fascinating Rekha very much.
(c) The solitude was offering Rekha the hillside fascination very much.
(d) The solitude offered by the hillside fascinated Rekha very much.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The solitude offered by the hillside fascinated Rekha very much.

Solution:

- The given sentence is in **passive voice**: "Rekha was very fascinated by the solitude offered by the hillside."
- To convert into **active voice**, the subject becomes "**The solitude offered by the hillside**."
- The correct active sentence is: **"The solitude offered by the hillside fascinated Rekha very much."**
- Other options have incorrect structure or word order.

Answer: (d) The solitude offered by the hillside fascinated Rekha very much.

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Q.249 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
I have not discouraged him from doing anything.

(a) He has not discouraged from doing anything by me.
(b) He is not discouraging from doing anything by me.
(c) He had not been discouraged from doing anything by me.
(d) He has not been discouraged from doing anything by me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He has not been discouraged from doing anything by me.
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"I have not discouraged him from doing anything."**
- In **passive voice**, the object "**him**" becomes the subject "**He**."
- The tense is **present perfect** ("have not discouraged").
- Present perfect passive is formed as: "**has/have + been + past participle**."
- The correct passive form is: **"He has not been discouraged from doing anything by me."**
- Other options have incorrect **tense** or **word order**.

Answer: (d) He has not been discouraged from doing anything by me.

Q.250 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Pay the electricity bill for the month of April.

(a) The electricity bill for the month of April has to be paid.
(b) We should pay the electricity bill for the month of April.
(c) Let the electricity bill for the month of April be paid.
(d) Let us pay the electricity bill for the month of April.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Let the electricity bill for the month of April be paid.
Explanation:
The given sentence is an **imperative sentence** (command/request). To change such sentences into the passive voice, we commonly use the structure:
"Let + object + be + past participle."
Original: **Pay the electricity bill for the month of April.**
Passive: **Let the electricity bill for the month of April be paid.**
This maintains the imperative tone and correct passive structure.
Correct Answer: Let the electricity bill for the month of April be paid.

Q.251 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The cat was hit with a bat.

(a) Somebody had hit the cat with a bat.
(b) Somebody hits the cat with a bat.
(c) Somebody has hit the cat by bat.
(d) Somebody hit the cat with a bat.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Somebody hit the cat with a bat.
Solution:

Explanation (contd.)
- The given sentence is in **passive voice**: "The cat was hit with a bat."
- The tense is **past simple passive** ("was hit").
- The active voice for past simple passive is "**Somebody hit the cat with a bat.**"
- Other options either change the tense or use incorrect prepositions.

Answer: (d) Somebody hit the cat with a bat.

Q.252 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Lata has committed a heinous crime.

(a) A heinous crime have been committed by Lata.
(b) A heinous crime has been committed by Lata.
(c) A heinous crime was committed by Lata.
(d) A heinous crime was being committed by Lata.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A heinous crime has been committed by Lata.
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"Lata has committed a heinous crime."**
- The tense is **present perfect** ("has committed").
- The passive voice for present perfect is: "**has been + past participle**."
- The correct passive sentence is: **"A heinous crime has been committed by Lata."**
- Other options have incorrect tense or auxiliary verbs.

Answer: (b) A heinous crime has been committed by Lata.

Q.253 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
A new invention has been made by him.

(a) He has made a new invention.
(b) He had been making a new invention.
(c) He were making a new invention.
(d) He was making a new invention.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He has made a new invention.
Solution:
- The given sentence is in **passive voice**: "A new invention has been made by him."
- The tense is **present perfect passive** ("has been made").
- The active voice form is **present perfect active**: "**He has made a new invention.**"
- Other options have incorrect tense or verb forms.

Answer: (a) He has made a new invention.

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Q.254 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Nick won the lottery.

(a) The lottery is being won by Nick.
(b) The lottery has been win by Nick.
(c) The lottery is won by Nick.
(d) The lottery was won by Nick.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The lottery was won by Nick.
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"Nick won the lottery."**
- The tense is **simple past** ("won").
- The passive voice for simple past is: "**The lottery was won by Nick.**"
- Other options use incorrect tense or form.

Answer: (d) The lottery was won by Nick.

Q.255 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
My son learns his lessons every day.

(a) His lessons are learnt by my son every day.
(b) His lessons do learn every day by my son.
(c) His lessons is learnt by my son every day.
(d) His lessons got learnt every day by my son.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) His lessons are learnt by my son every day.
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"My son learns his lessons every day."**
- The tense is **simple present** ("learns").
- The passive voice for simple present is: "**are + past participle**."
- The correct passive sentence is: **"His lessons are learnt by my son every day."**
- Other options have incorrect verb forms or structure.

Answer: (a) His lessons are learnt by my son every day.

Q.256 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
My brother has sent me a message.

(a) A message was sent to me by my brother.
(b) A message has been sent to me by my brother.
(c) A message have been sent to me.
(d) I have been sent a message to by my brother.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A message has been sent to me by my brother.
Explanation:
The correct passive form of the sentence **"My brother has sent me a message"** is:
"A message has been sent to me by my brother."
- In passive voice, the **object** of the active sentence becomes the **subject**.
- The verb tense "has sent" (present perfect) changes to **"has been sent"** in passive form.
- The **indirect object** ("me") remains after the verb to show who received the message.

Q.257 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Could you share your car keys?

(a) Could your car keys be shared by you?
(b) Could your car keys shared by you?
(c) Can your car keys be shared by you?
(d) Could your car keys be share by you?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Could your car keys be shared by you?
Solution:
- The active sentence is: **"Could you share your car keys?"**
- In passive voice, modal verb "**could**" is followed by "**be + past participle**."
- The correct passive sentence is: **"Could your car keys be shared by you?"**
- Other options have incorrect verb forms or modal usage.

Answer: (a) Could your car keys be shared by you?

Q.258 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Have you written the right answer?

(a) Was the right answer been written by you?
(b) Have the right answer been written by you?
(c) Has the right answer being written by you?
(d) Has the right answer been written by you?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Has the right answer been written by you?
Explanation:
This is a question in the **present perfect tense** in **active voice**:
"Have you written the right answer?"
To convert it into **passive voice**, we follow this structure:
- **Have/Has + object + been + past participle + by + subject**

So:
- **"Have you written the right answer?"**
  → **"Has the right answer been written by you?"**

The subject "you" becomes the agent, and "the right answer" becomes the subject of the passive voice.
Since **"the right answer"** is singular, we use **"has"** instead of **"have."**

Q.259 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Pay that bill today.

(a) That bill is going to be paid today.
(b) That bill will be paid today.
(c) That bill should be paid today.
(d) Let that bill to be paid today.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) That bill should be paid today.
Solution:
The given sentence **"Pay that bill today"** is an **imperative sentence**, which expresses a command or instruction. One of the standard passive voice constructions for imperatives is:

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Explanation (contd.)

- **"Let + object + be + past participle"** (e.g., *Let the work be done*)
  Another acceptable form is using **"should be"** for polite or formal instructions.

option (c): "That bill should be paid today." is correct. It maintains the imperative tone while using the **modal + passive** structure (**should be + past participle**), which is grammatically valid in formal instructions.
option (a) ("is going to be paid") indicates future intent, not a command.
option (b) ("will be paid") also indicates future certainty, not an instruction.
option (d) ("Let that bill to be paid") is grammatically incorrect; "to be" should not follow "let".
Answer: option (c)

Q.260 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Everybody wants others to respect them.

(a) They want others to be respected by everybody.
(b) Everybody wants to respect others.
(c) Everybody wanted to be respected by others.
(d) Everybody wants to be respected by others.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Everybody wants to be respected by others.
Solution:
The sentence **"Everybody wants others to respect them."** is in **active voice**.
To convert this to **passive voice**, we need to restructure it to focus on **"everybody"** being respected rather than doing the action.

- The correct passive construction here is:
  "Everybody wants to be respected by others."
  It maintains the original tense (**simple present**), subject (**everybody**), and meaning (**desire to receive respect**).

option (a): Incorrect word order and shifts the subject unnaturally
option (b): Incorrect meaning – changes active/passive relationship
option (c): Wrong tense – "wanted" is past, but original is present
option (d): Correct passive form
Answer: option (d) (Everybody wants to be respected by others.).

Q.261 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Take these two pills with warm water.

(a) Warm water should be taken with these two pills.
(b) You are ordered to take these two pills with warm water.
(c) You may take these two pills with warm water.
(d) These two pills should be taken with warm water.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) These two pills should be taken with warm water.
Solution:
The given sentence **"Take these two pills with warm water."** is an **imperative sentence** (a command).
To change an imperative sentence to the **passive voice**, we typically use the structure:
"Let + object + be + past participle" or **"Object + should be + past participle"** (especially for giving instructions).
Correct passive form: **"These two pills should be taken with warm water."**
option (a): "Warm water should be taken..." – changes the object and meaning
option (b): "You are ordered to take..." – not passive voice, it's a transformation into indirect speech
option (c): "You may take..." – not passive, and it changes the tone from command to suggestion
option (d): correct passive transformation
Answer: option (d) (These two pills should be taken with warm water.).

Q.262 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
One can achieve nothing without hard work.

(a) Nothing will be achieved without hard work.
(b) Nothing can be achieved without hard work.
(c) Nothing has been achieved without hard work.
(d) Nothing is achieved without hard work.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Nothing can be achieved without hard work.
Solution:
The sentence **"One can achieve nothing without hard work."** is in **active voice**, using a **modal verb ("can")**.
To convert it into **passive voice**, the object **"nothing"** becomes the subject, and the verb takes the structure:
can + be + past participle
So, the correct passive form is:
"Nothing can be achieved without hard work."
option (a): Nothing will be achieved... – changes the modal from "can" to "will"
option (b): Nothing can be achieved... – correct modal, structure, and meaning
option (c): Nothing has been achieved... – changes tense completely
option (d): Nothing is achieved... – changes tense to present simple
Answer: option (b) (Nothing can be achieved without hard work.).

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Q.263 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Why do we have to accept these conditions?

(a) These conditions do not have to be accepted.
(b) Why should these conditions be accepted?
(c) Why do these conditions have to be accepted?
(d) Why are these conditions needed to be accepted?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Why do these conditions have to be accepted?
Solution:
The sentence **"Why do we have to accept these conditions?"** is an interrogative sentence in **present tense with a modal expression ("have to")**.
To change it into the **passive voice**, the structure is:
"Why do + object + have to be + past participle"
So, the correct passive form is:
"Why do these conditions have to be accepted?"
option (a): Incorrect – turns the sentence into a statement, not a question
option (b): Incorrect – changes the modal from "have to" to "should", altering meaning
option (c): Correct structure and maintains original meaning
option (d): Incorrect – awkward and ungrammatical phrasing
Answer: option (c) (Why do these conditions have to be accepted?).

Q.264 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Why didn't your father accompany you?

(a) Why have you not been accompanied by your father?
(b) Why wasn't your father accompanied by you?
(c) Why were you not accompanied by your father?
(d) Why didn't you be accompanied by your father?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Why were you not accompanied by your father?
Solution:
The given sentence is an **interrogative sentence in past simple tense**: "Why didn't your father accompany you?"
To convert it into **passive voice**, identify the object (**you**) and subject (**your father**). In passive voice, **"you"** becomes the subject and **"your father"** becomes the agent.
The correct passive structure is:
"Why were you not accompanied by your father?"
This follows:

- Passive form of past simple: **was/were + past participle**
- Proper subject-verb agreement ("you" → "were")
- Correct word order for a question.

option (a) – incorrect tense (present perfect passive)
option (b) – incorrect subject-agent reversal
option (d) – grammatically incorrect structure ("didn't you be")
option (c) – correct structure and tense
Answer: option (c) (Why were you not accompanied by your father?).

Q.265 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
His mother accompanies him wherever he goes.

(a) He has accompanied his mother wherever she has gone.
(b) He was accompanied by his mother wherever he went.
(c) He is accompanied by his mother wherever he goes.
(d) He accompanies his mother wherever she goes.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He is accompanied by his mother wherever he goes.
Solution:
The original sentence is in **present simple tense**:
"His mother accompanies him wherever he goes."
To change it to the **passive voice**, we need:

- Subject: **"He"**
- Verb in passive form: **"is accompanied"** (present simple passive: am/is/are + past participle)
- Rest of the sentence remains: **"wherever he goes"** (no tense change needed in the adverbial clause)

Correct passive: **"He is accompanied by his mother wherever he goes."**
option (a) – incorrect tense (present perfect).
option (b) – incorrect tense (past).
option (c) – correct in both tense and structure.
option (d) – active voice, not passive.
Answer: option (c) (He is accompanied by his mother wherever he goes.).

Q.266 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
May you be blessed with good health.

(a) God should bless you with good health.
(b) May good health bless you.
(c) You should be blessed with good health.
(d) May God bless you with good health.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) May God bless you with good health.
Solution
Original sentence:
"May you be blessed with good health."
Transformation to active voice:

- In the passive blessing form (**"May you be blessed..."**), the implied agent is **God** or a higher power.
- To convert into an active construction, we explicitly name the agent and use the verb "bless" in the **optative mood** ("May God bless...").

Active form:
"May God bless you with good health."

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Q.267 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
She held the child's hand firmly.

(a) The child's hand was held firmly.
(b) The child's hand has been held firmly.
(c) The child's hand is held firmly.
(d) The child's hand held firmly.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The child's hand was held firmly.
Solution:
The given active sentence is in the **simple past tense**:
"She held the child's hand firmly."
To convert it to the **passive voice**, follow this structure:
Object + was/were + past participle (V3) + rest of the sentence

- Subject: She
- Verb: held → **was held** (past participle of "hold")
- Object: the child's hand
- Adverb: firmly

Correct passive sentence:
The child's hand was held firmly.

Q.268 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
We had repaired the roads before the monsoon set in.

(a) The roads have been repaired before the monsoon set in.
(b) The roads are repaired before the monsoon set in.
(c) The roads were repaired before the monsoon set in.
(d) The roads had been repaired before the monsoon set in.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The roads had been repaired before the monsoon set in.
Solution:
The original sentence is in **past perfect tense**:
"We had repaired the roads before the monsoon set in."
To convert this to the **passive voice**, follow this structure:
"had + been + past participle"
Correct passive form:
"The roads had been repaired before the monsoon set in."
option (a): have been repaired – present perfect, incorrect tense
option (b): are repaired – simple present, incorrect tense
option (c): were repaired – simple past, doesn't match original tense
option (d): had been repaired – correct past perfect passive form
Answer: option (d) (The roads had been repaired before the monsoon set in.).

Q.269 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
It is said that Einstein was a genius.

(a) People said that Einstein was a genius.
(b) People have said that Einstein was a genius.
(c) People say that Einstein was a genius.
(d) People are saying that Einstein was a genius.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) People say that Einstein was a genius.
Solution:
The sentence **"It is said that Einstein was a genius."** is in **passive voice** using the impersonal construction **"It is said that..."**, which is often used to report general beliefs or commonly accepted facts.
To convert this into **active voice**, we use **"People say that..."**, which is the general subject representing the unspecified speakers.

- The reporting verb **"is said"** is in **present simple**, so the active form should also use **present simple** → **"People say"**
- The reported clause **"Einstein was a genius"** stays in past tense as it refers to a historical fact.

Correct sentence:
"People say that Einstein was a genius."
option (a): People said... – incorrect tense
option (b): People have said... – changes tense and meaning slightly
option (c): People say that Einstein was a genius. – correct
option (d): People are saying... – present continuous, incorrect tense
Answer: option (c) (People say that Einstein was a genius.).

Q.270 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Grow more trees.

(a) You should grow more trees.
(b) Let more trees be grown.
(c) More trees should be growing.
(d) More trees should grow.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Let more trees be grown.
Solution:
The correct passive form of an imperative sentence like **"Grow more trees"** is formed by using **"Let + object + be + past participle."**
Hence, the correct passive voice is:

- **"Let more trees be grown."**

Explanation of other options:

- **option (a): "You should grow more trees."** – This is not passive; it is active with a modal.
- **option (c): "More trees should be growing."** – This is progressive form, not passive.
- **option (d): "More trees should grow."** – This is still active voice.

Answer: option (b) (Let more trees be grown.)

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Q.271 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
A party is being given by her on the occasion of her sixteenth birthday.

(a) She was giving a party on the occasion of her sixteenth birthday.
(b) She is giving a party on the occasion of her sixteenth birthday.
(c) She will give a party on the occasion of her sixteenth birthday.
(d) She has given a party on the occasion of her sixteenth birthday.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She is giving a party on the occasion of her sixteenth birthday.
Solution
Tense and Voice Identification
The original sentence—"A party **is being given** by her on the occasion of her sixteenth birthday"—is in the **present continuous passive**.
Active Voice Structure
- **Subject (agent):** "she" replaces "her"
- **Verb (present continuous):** "is giving" replaces "is being given"
- **Object:** "a party"
- **Additional phrase:** "on the occasion of her sixteenth birthday" remains unchanged

Why the Other Options Are Incorrect
- **She was giving a party...**
  - Uses **past continuous** ("was giving") instead of present continuous.
- **She will give a party...**
  - Uses **future simple** ("will give"), changing the time frame.
- **She has given a party...**
  - Uses **present perfect** ("has given"), indicating completion rather than an ongoing action.

Correct Active Sentence
She **is giving** a party on the occasion of her sixteenth birthday.

Q.272 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Our rivals must have spread this rumour.

(a) This rumour has been spread by our rivals.
(b) This rumour must be spread by our rivals.
(c) This rumour may have been spread by our rivals.
(d) This rumour must have been spread by our rivals.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) This rumour must have been spread by our rivals.
Solution:
The sentence is in **active voice**, modal + have + past participle:
- **Active:** *Our rivals must have spread this rumour.*

To convert to **passive voice**, follow the structure:
- **Passive:** *[Object] + must have been + past participle + by [subject]*

So:
- **This rumour must have been spread by our rivals.**

Answer: This rumour must have been spread by our rivals.

Q.273 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Humayun built a city named Dinpanah in 1533 in Delhi.

(a) A city named Dinpanah was built by Humayun in 1533 in Delhi.
(b) A city named Humayun was built by Dinpanah in 1533 in Delhi.
(c) A city named Dinpanah was being built by Humayun in 1533 in Delhi.
(d) A city named Dinpanah had been built by Humayun in 1533 in Delhi.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A city named Dinpanah was built by Humayun in 1533 in Delhi.
Solution:
The original sentence is in the **active voice** and written in the **simple past tense** ("Humayun built..."). To convert it into the **passive voice**, we follow the structure:
Object + was/were + past participle + by + subject.
Here, **"a city named Dinpanah"** is the object, **"was built"** is the correct past passive form of "built", and **"by Humayun"** identifies the doer of the action. The rest of the sentence **"in 1533 in Delhi"** remains unchanged as it denotes time and place.
Hence, the correct passive form is: **"A city named Dinpanah was built by Humayun in 1533 in Delhi."**

Q.274 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
I am often invited by them to join their club.

(a) They often invite me to join their club.
(b) I often invite them to join the club.
(c) They have often invited me to join their club
(d) The club often invites me to join them.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) They often invite me to join their club.
Solution:
The sentence **"I am often invited by them to join their club."** is in the **present simple passive voice**.
To convert it to **active voice**:
- Subject becomes **"They"**
- Verb changes from **"am invited"** to **"invite"** (present simple active)
- "I" becomes **"me"** as the object

Correct active form:
"They often invite me to join their club."
option (a): correct tense and structure
option (b): changes meaning (subject and object reversed)
option (c): changes tense (present → present perfect)
option (d): incorrect subject and meaning shift
Answer: option (a) (They often invite me to join their club.).

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Q.275 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
Let the fire be kept burning at night.

(a) The fire should be burnt at night.
(b) Keep the fire burning at night.
(c) You must burn the fire at night.
(d) Let the fire burning at night

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Keep the fire burning at night.
Solution:
The given sentence is in the **passive imperative form** ("Let the fire be kept burning at night"). To convert it into **active voice**, we must express it as a direct command. The most natural and grammatically correct active form is:
"Keep the fire burning at night."
option (a) is incorrect because "should be burnt" changes the structure and meaning.
option (c) is incorrect because "You must burn the fire" is awkward and unnatural.
option (d) is grammatically incorrect ("Let the fire burning" is wrong structure).
option (b) is correct as it maintains the command tone and correct verb usage.
Answer: option (b) (Keep the fire burning at night.).

Q.276 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
It was decided by Salim Ali to devote his life to the preservation of Indian birds.

(a) Salim Ali decided to devote his life to the preservation of Indian birds.
(b) Salim Ali has decided to devote his life to the preservation of Indian birds.
(c) Salim devoted his life to the preservation of Indian birds.
(d) Salim Ali had decided to devote his life to the preservation of Indian birds.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Salim Ali decided to devote his life to the preservation of Indian birds.
Solution:
The original sentence is in **passive voice**:
"It was decided by Salim Ali to devote his life to the preservation of Indian birds."
To convert it into **active voice**, identify the subject (**Salim Ali**) and bring the verb to active form.

- **"It was decided by Salim Ali..."** → becomes **"Salim Ali decided..."** (simple past tense)

So, the correct active form is:
"Salim Ali decided to devote his life to the preservation of Indian birds."
option (a): correct transformation (active voice, same tense)
option (b): incorrect tense (present perfect)
option (c): incorrect – changes meaning; omits the "decision" aspect
option (d): incorrect tense (past perfect not needed)
Answer: option (a) (Salim Ali decided to devote his life to the preservation of Indian birds.).

Q.277 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
Bhavna saw him carrying your suitcase.

(a) He had been seen by Bhavna carrying your suitcase.
(b) Your suitcase carried by him was seen by Bhavna.
(c) He was seen by Bhavna carrying your suitcase.
(d) Your suitcase was seen by Bhavna carrying him.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He was seen by Bhavna carrying your suitcase.
Solution:
The active sentence is:
"Bhavna saw him carrying your suitcase."
We want to convert this to the **passive voice**, focusing on **"him"** as the object being acted upon (seen), while still retaining the action **"carrying your suitcase."**
Correct passive construction:
"He was seen by Bhavna carrying your suitcase."
This retains the original meaning and keeps the verb in correct passive form:
"was seen" = past simple passive of "saw"
option (a): incorrect tense ("had been seen" changes the original past simple tense)
option (b): awkward and grammatically incorrect word order
option (c): correct passive form with proper structure
option (d): illogical meaning — "suitcase was seen carrying him" is incorrect
Answer: option (c) (He was seen by Bhavna carrying your suitcase.).

Q.278 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
A party was organized by Rayan on his 40th Birthday.

(a) Rayan organized a party on his 40th Birthday.
(b) Rayan has organized a party on his 40th Birthday.
(c) A party organized Rayan on his 40th Birthday
(d) Rayan will be organizing a party on his 40th Birthday.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Rayan organized a party on his 40th Birthday.
Solution:

- The original sentence is in **passive voice**: *"A party was organized by Rayan..."*
- To convert it into **active voice**, the subject (*Rayan*) should come first, followed by the verb in simple past tense (*organized*), and then the object (*a party*).
- Tense remains **simple past** in the active voice as it was in the passive form (*was organized*).

Correct sentence:
Rayan organized a party on his 40th Birthday.
Answer: Rayan organized a party on his 40th Birthday.

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Q.279 Select the correct passive form of the given sentence.
The Election Commission announced the election dates for different states.

(a) The election dates for different states were announced by the Election Commission.
(b) The election dates for different states will be announced by the Election Commission
(c) The Election Commission has been announced the election dates by the different states.
(d) The election dates for different states have been announced by the Election Commission.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The election dates for different states were announced by the Election Commission.
Solution:
The correct passive form of the sentence **"The Election Commission announced the election dates for different states"** is:
"The election dates for different states were announced by the Election Commission."

- The original sentence is in **simple past tense** ("announced").
- In the passive form, the structure becomes: **was/were + past participle**
- **"Election dates"** is plural, so we use **"were announced"**

Correct Answer: The election dates for different states were announced by the Election Commission.

Q.280 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The test flight of Gaganyan was successfully carried out by the scientists of ISRO.

(a) The scientists of ISRO are successfully carrying out the test flight of Gaganyan.
(b) The scientists of ISRO will successfully carry out the test flight of Gaganyan.
(c) The scientists of ISRO successfully carried out the test flight of Gaganyan.
(d) The test flight of Gaganyan successfully carried out the scientists of ISRO

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The scientists of ISRO successfully carried out the test flight of Gaganyan.
Solution:

- The original sentence is in **passive voice**: *"was successfully carried out by the scientists of ISRO."*
- To convert it into **active voice**, we begin the sentence with the subject **"The scientists of ISRO"**.
- The verb "was carried out" (past passive) becomes "carried out" (past active).
- The adverb **"successfully"** is placed before the main verb in the active sentence.

Correct sentence:
The scientists of ISRO successfully carried out the test flight of Gaganyan.

Q.281 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
By whom have these facts been verified?

(a) Who is verifying these facts?
(b) Who had verified these facts?
(c) Who have verified these facts?
(d) Who has verified these facts?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Who has verified these facts?
Solution:
The sentence **"By whom have these facts been verified?"** is in the **present perfect passive voice**.
To convert it into **active voice**:

- Start with **"Who"** (since "by whom" is the passive form of "who")
- Use **present perfect tense** in active voice: **has/have + past participle**
- Subject: **"Who"**
- Verb: **"has verified"** (since "who" is considered singular in such constructions)

Correct active form:
"Who has verified these facts?"
option (a): wrong tense (present continuous)
option (b): past perfect tense, incorrect
option (c): wrong auxiliary verb ("have" with singular "who")
option (d): correct structure and tense
Answer: option (d) (Who has verified these facts?).

Q.282 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The workers will not be satisfied with empty promises.

(a) Empty promises would not satisfy the workers.
(b) Empty promises will not satisfy the workers.
(c) Empty promises cannot satisfy the workers.
(d) Empty promises do not satisfy the workers.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Empty promises will not satisfy the workers.
Solution
The original sentence is in the future-simple passive:
*"The workers **will not be satisfied** with empty promises."*
Structure: **will + not + be + past participle (satisfied)**.

- Passive subject: **the workers**
- Agent (implied doer): **empty promises**

To convert to the active voice:

1. Move the agent (**empty promises**) to the subject position.
2. Keep the auxiliary **will not** to preserve the future sense.
3. Use the base verb **satisfy** (active form of "be satisfied").
4. Make the workers the object.

Result: **"Empty promises will not satisfy the workers."**
Why the other choices are incorrect

- *Empty promises would not satisfy...* — changes the tense to conditional.
- *Empty promises cannot satisfy...* — changes the modal meaning ("cannot" ≠/"will not").
- *Empty promises do not satisfy...* — shifts to present simple tense.

Hence, the correct active version is: **Empty promises will not satisfy the workers.**

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Q.283 Select the correct active form of the given sentence.
The meal will have been made ready by the cook by the time you reach the guest house.

(a) The cook will have made the meal ready by the time you reach the guest house.
(b) The cook have made the meal ready by the time you reach the guest house.
(c) The cook will make the meal ready by the time you reach the guest house.
(d) The cook will be making the meal ready by the time you reach the guest house.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The cook will have made the meal ready by the time you reach the guest house.
Solution:
The given sentence is in **future perfect passive voice**:
"The meal will have been made ready by the cook by the time you reach the guest house."
To convert this into **active voice**, follow these steps:
- Subject becomes **"the cook"**
- Verb in **future perfect active** form: **"will have made"**
- Rest of the sentence stays the same.

Correct active voice:
"The cook will have made the meal ready by the time you reach the guest house."
option (a): correct transformation (tense and structure match)
option (b): "have" is incorrect without "will"
option (c): changes tense from future perfect to simple future
option (d): uses future continuous, which is incorrect for this context
Answer: option (a) (The cook will have made the meal ready by the time you reach the guest house.).

Q.284 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The chef prepares a special dish every evening.

(a) A special dish is prepared by the chef every evening.
(b) A special dish is being prepared by the chef everyday.
(c) A special dish has been prepared by the chef every evening.
(d) A special dish will be prepared by the chef every evening.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A special dish is prepared by the chef every evening.
planation:
- The original sentence is in **active voice**, **simple present tense**:
  "The chef prepares a special dish every evening."
- To convert to **passive voice**, the structure becomes:
  Object + is/are + past participle + by + subject
- So, the correct passive form is:
  "A special dish is prepared by the chef every evening."

This matches option **1**.

Q.285 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Submit the report by Friday.

(a) The report has to be submitted by Friday.
(b) Let the report submit by Friday.
(c) The report can be submitted by Friday.
(d) Let the report be submitted by Friday.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Let the report be submitted by Friday.
Solution:
- The given sentence is an **imperative sentence** in **active voice**:
  "Submit the report by Friday."
- To change an imperative sentence into **passive voice**, we often use the structure:
  "Let + object + be + past participle"
- Applying this to the sentence:
  - Object: **the report**
  - Verb: **submit → be submitted**
- Correct passive form:
  "Let the report be submitted by Friday."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"has to be submitted"** – changes the meaning to obligation.
  - Option (b): **"Let the report submit"** – grammatically incorrect (missing "be").
  - Option (c): **"can be submitted"** – implies possibility, not instruction.

Correct passive voice form:
"Let the report be submitted by Friday."

Q.286 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Visitors can scale the massive rock by climbing the 708-step path up to the top.

(a) The massive rock can be scaled by visitors by climbing the 708-step path up to the top.
(b) The massive rock be scaled by visitors by climbing the 708-step path up to the top.
(c) The massive rock can scaled by visitors by climbing the 708-step path up to the top.
(d) The massive rock scaled visitors by climbing the 708-step path up to the top.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The massive rock can be scaled by visitors by climbing the 708-step path up to the top.
- The sentence is in **active voice**:
  Subject (Visitors) + modal verb (can) + verb (scale) + object (the massive rock).
- In passive voice, the object becomes the subject:
  The massive rock + can be scaled + by visitors...
- Only **option (a)** uses the correct passive structure with the appropriate modal verb construction: **"can be scaled."**

All other options have grammatical errors:
- **Option (b):** Missing "be" after "can"
- **Option (c):** Missing "be" before "scaled"
- **Option (d):** Incorrect sentence structure

Hence, the correct passive form is option 1.

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Q.287 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Our team has been invited by the National High School to play hockey with them.

(a) The National High School is inviting our team to play hockey with them.
(b) Our team has invited the National High School to play hockey with them.
(c) The National High School has invited our team to play hockey with them.
(d) The National High School invited our team to play hockey with them.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The National High School has invited our team to play hockey with them.
Solution:
Given Sentence (Passive Voice):
"Our team has been invited by the National High School to play hockey with them."
Tense:
- Present perfect passive: **"has been invited"**

Conversion to Active Voice:
- The subject becomes **"The National High School"**
- The verb becomes **"has invited"** (present perfect active)
- The object becomes **"our team"**
- Rest of the sentence remains the same.

Correct Active Voice Sentence:
"The National High School has invited our team to play hockey with them."
Why other options are incorrect:
- Option (a): **"is inviting"** – changes tense to present continuous.
- Option (b): Reverses subject and object.
- Option (d): **"invited"** – changes tense to simple past.

Correct answer: The National High School has invited our team to play hockey with them. (Option (c)

Q.288 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Bhawna cannot do anything unless someone gives her instructions.

(a) Nothing is done unless Bhawna has given instructions.
(b) Nothing has been done unless Bhawna can give instructions.
(c) Nothing is done unless Bhawna is given instructions.
(d) Nothing can be done unless Bhawna is given instructions.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Nothing can be done unless Bhawna is given instructions.
- **Active voice:** "Bhawna cannot do anything unless someone gives her instructions."
- **Passive voice structure:** The object becomes the subject, and the verb is adjusted accordingly.
- "Someone gives her instructions" → **"Bhawna is given instructions"** (passive)
- "She cannot do anything" becomes **"Nothing can be done"** (passive)

Combining both ideas in the passive voice gives:
"Nothing can be done unless Bhawna is given instructions."

Q.289 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Is the news watched by you every day?

(a) Do you watch the news every day?
(b) Will you be watching the news everyday?
(c) Are you watching the news every day?
(d) Have you watched the news every day?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Do you watch the news every day?
Solution:
- The given sentence is in **passive voice** and **present simple tense**:
  "Is the news watched by you every day?"
- To convert it into **active voice**:
  - Identify the subject and object:
    - Subject in passive: **the news**
    - Agent: **you**
  - Use **present simple tense** in the active voice:
    - Structure: **Do/Does + subject + base verb**
- So the correct active form is:
  "Do you watch the news every day?"
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (b): **"Will you be watching"** – future continuous tense; changes the meaning.
  - Option (c): **"Are you watching"** – present continuous tense; incorrect transformation.
  - Option (d): **"Have you watched"** – present perfect tense; changes the tense completely.

Correct active voice form:
"Do you watch the news every day?"

Q.290 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The film was being watched by the family.

(a) The film was watching the family.
(b) The family is watching the film.
(c) The family was watching the film.
(d) The family has been watching the film.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The family was watching the film.
Solution:
Given sentence (Passive voice):
"The film was being watched by the family."
Tense identification:
- **"was being watched"** is in **past continuous tense** passive voice.

Active voice structure for past continuous:
- **Subject + was/were + verb-ing + object**

Correct active voice transformation:
"The family was watching the film."
Why other options are incorrect:
- Option (a): **"The film was watching the family."** – illogical; incorrect subject-object relationship.
- Option (b): **"The family is watching the film."** – present continuous tense, incorrect tense.
- Option (d): **"The family has been watching the film."** – present perfect continuous, incorrect tense.

Correct answer: The family was watching the film. (Option (c)

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Q.291 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The company launched a new product in the market yesterday.

(a) A new product has launched in the market by the company yesterday.
(b) A new company was launched in the market by the product yesterday.
(c) A new product was launched in the market by the company yesterday.
(d) A new product was launching in the market by the company yesterday.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A new product was launched in the market by the company yesterday.

Solution:

- The given sentence is in **active voice**:
  "The company launched a new product in the market yesterday."
- To convert it to **passive voice**, follow these steps:
  - Identify the object: **a new product**
  - Identify the verb tense: **simple past** ("launched")
  - Passive structure for simple past: **was/were + past participle**
  - So, the correct transformation is:
    "A new product was launched in the market by the company yesterday."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"has launched"** is present perfect, not simple past, and incorrectly omits passive construction.
  - Option (b): Reverses subject and object, resulting in a meaningless sentence.
  - Option (d): **"was launching"** is past continuous, not the correct tense for this context.

Correct passive voice form:
"A new product was launched in the market by the company yesterday."

Q.292 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Why didn't your mother pick you up today?

(a) Why wasn't your mother picked up by you today?
(b) Why weren't you picked up by your mother today?
(c) Why haven't you been picked up by your mother today?
(d) Why didn't you be picked up by your mother today?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Why weren't you picked up by your mother today?

- The sentence is in **past simple interrogative** form: "Why didn't your mother pick you up today?"
- To change it to passive voice, the object **"you"** becomes the subject.
- Passive structure for past simple: **was/were + past participle**
- So, the correct passive transformation is: **"Why weren't you picked up by your mother today?"**

Q.293 Choose the correct option to convert the following active voice sentence into passive voice.
He gathered the men and brought the priest to witness the death.

(a) The priest was brought by the men and witnessed the death.
(b) He has the death witnessed by gathering and bringing the priest.
(c) The men were gathered and the priest was brought by him to witness the death.
(d) He had the death witnessed by gathering and bringing the priest.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The men were gathered and the priest was brought by him to witness the death.

Solution:

- The original sentence is in **active voice** and **simple past tense**:
  "He gathered the men and brought the priest to witness the death."
- To convert it into **passive voice**, apply the rules separately to each verb:

1. **"gathered the men"** → passive: **"The men were gathered"**
2. **"brought the priest"** → passive: **"the priest was brought"**
3. The agent is **"he"**, so it remains as **"by him"**
4. The phrase **"to witness the death"** remains unchanged, as it describes the purpose.

- So the complete and grammatically correct passive construction is:
  "The men were gathered and the priest was brought by him to witness the death."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): Mixes up the subject and objects; implies the priest witnessed the death, not that he was brought to do so.
  - Option (b): Awkward and unclear structure; doesn't follow passive voice rules properly.
  - Option (d): Incorrect verb structure and not true passive form.

Correct answer:
The men were gathered and the priest was brought by him to witness the death. (Option (c))

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Q.294 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The selection of these books for the library has been made by a committee.

(a) A committee has been making the selection of these books for the library.
(b) A committee will make the selection of these books for the library.
(c) A committee has made the selection of these books for the library.
(d) A committee is making the selection of these books for the library.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A committee has made the selection of these books for the library.
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **passive voice** and **present perfect tense**:
  "The selection of these books for the library has been made by a committee."
- To convert it into **active voice**:
  - Identify the agent: **"a committee"** (subject in active voice).
  - The passive verb **"has been made"** becomes **"has made"** in active voice.
  - The object: **"the selection of these books for the library"** remains the same.
- The correct active voice sentence is:
  "A committee has made the selection of these books for the library."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"has been making"** – present perfect continuous tense; incorrect.
  - Option (b): **"will make"** – future tense; changes the tense.
  - Option (d): **"is making"** – present continuous tense; also changes the tense.

Correct answer: A committee has made the selection of these books for the library. (Option (c)

Q.295 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Who grew these poinsettias?

(a) These poinsettias are grown by who?
(b) By whom were these poinsettias grown?
(c) Were these poinsettias grown by whom?
(d) Who was grown by these poinsettias?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) By whom were these poinsettias grown?

- To change an interrogative sentence into the **passive voice**, follow this format:
  - **Active:** *Who grew these poinsettias?*
  - **Passive:** *By whom were these poinsettias grown?*
- **"Who"** becomes **"by whom"** in passive constructions.
- The verb **"grew"** is in the past tense, so the passive uses **"were grown"** (past passive).

Hence, the grammatically correct and passive version is:
"By whom were these poinsettias grown?"

Q.296 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Will the Lohri function be organised in your lawns this year?

(a) Will you organise the Lohri function in your lawns this year?
(b) Will you be organising the Lohri function in your lawns this year?
(c) Will you organise your lawns in the Lohri function this year?
(d) Will you have organised the Lohri function in your lawns this year?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Will you organise the Lohri function in your lawns this year?
Solution:
Given Sentence (Passive Voice):
"Will the Lohri function be organised in your lawns this year?"

- This is a **future tense** question in **passive voice**.

Active Voice Structure:

- The subject becomes **"you"** (doer of the action).
- The passive structure **"will...be organised"** becomes active as **"will you organise..."**
- The object **"the Lohri function"** remains the same.
- The rest of the sentence (**"in your lawns this year"**) remains unchanged.

Correct Active Voice Form:
"Will you organise the Lohri function in your lawns this year?"
Why other options are incorrect:

- Option (b): **"Will you be organising..."** – future continuous tense; changes the tense.
- Option (c): **"organise your lawns in the Lohri function"** – changes the meaning entirely.
- Option (d): **"Will you have organised..."** – future perfect tense; incorrect tense shift.

Correct answer: Option (a)
Will you organise the Lohri function in your lawns this year?

Q.297 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The dinner will have been prepared by my sisters.

(a) The dinner will have prepared my sisters.
(b) My sisters will be preparing the dinner.
(c) My sisters will have prepared the dinner.
(d) My sisters will prepare the dinner.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) My sisters will have prepared the dinner.

- The given sentence is in **passive voice**, **future perfect tense**:
  "will have been prepared" by + agent (my sisters)
- To convert it into **active voice** in future perfect tense:
  Structure → **Subject + will have + past participle (V3) + object**
- Subject (agent): **My sisters**
- Verb: **will have prepared**
- Object: **the dinner**

Correct Sentence:
My sisters will have prepared the dinner.

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Q.298 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The gardener is going to plant some tulips in the garden this year.

(a) Some tulips have been planted in the garden this year.
(b) Some tulips are being planted in the garden this year.
(c) Some tulips will be planted in the garden this year.
(d) Some tulips are going to be planted in the garden this year.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Some tulips are going to be planted in the garden this year.
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **active voice** and **near future tense** using "going to":
  "The gardener is going to plant some tulips in the garden this year."
- To convert it into **passive voice**:
  - Identify the object: **some tulips**
  - Structure for passive form:
    is/are + going to be + past participle
  - "Plant" becomes "planted" (past participle)
- So, the correct transformation is:
  "Some tulips are going to be planted in the garden this year."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"have been planted"** – present perfect tense, not future.
  - Option (b): **"are being planted"** – present continuous passive, not matching the "going to" structure.
  - Option (c): **"will be planted"** – grammatically correct but not the same form as "is going to plant".

Correct passive voice form:
"Some tulips are going to be planted in the garden this year."

Q.299 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The secretary does not answer the phone after office hours.

(a) The phone is not been answered by the secretary after office hours.
(b) The phone will not be answered by the secretary after office hours.
(c) The phone has not been answered by the secretary after office hours.
(d) The phone is not answered by the secretary after office hours.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The phone is not answered by the secretary after office hours.

- Active: "The secretary does not answer the phone after office hours."
- Passive formation in simple present:
  - Subject (the phone) + **is not answered** + "by the secretary" + time phrase.
- Hence: **"The phone is not answered by the secretary after office hours."**

Q.300 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The work of laying the optical fibre will have been completed by the time you reach back home tonight.

(a) The labourers have completed the work of laying the optical fibre by the time you reach back home tonight.
(b) The labourers will have completed the work of laying the optical fibre by the time you reach back home tonight.
(c) The labourers will complete the work of laying the optical fibre by the time you reach back home tonight
(d) The labourers will be completing the work of laying the optical fibre by the time you reach back home tonight

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The labourers will have completed the work of laying the optical fibre by the time you reach back home tonight.

- The original sentence is in **passive voice**, future perfect tense:

"The work of laying the optical fibre will have been completed by the time you reach back home tonight."

- To convert it into **active voice**, we need:
  - Subject (doer): **The labourers**
  - Tense: **Future perfect** ("will have completed")
  - Object: **The work of laying the optical fibre**

So, the correct active voice is:
"The labourers will have completed the work of laying the optical fibre by the time you reach back home tonight."

Q.301 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Was the novel read by her?

(a) Does she read the novel?
(b) Did she read the novel?
(c) Has she read the novel?
(d) Had she read the novel?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Did she read the novel?
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **passive voice** and **simple past tense**:
  "Was the novel read by her?"
- To convert it into **active voice**:
  - Identify the subject and object:
    - Subject in passive: **the novel**
    - Agent: **her** → becomes **she** in active voice
  - Use the **simple past tense** structure: **Did + subject + base verb**
- The correct active voice form is:
  "Did she read the novel?"
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"Does she read the novel?"** – present tense, not past.
  - Option (c): **"Has she read the novel?"** – present perfect tense.
  - Option (d): **"Had she read the novel?"** – past perfect tense.

Correct active voice form:
"Did she read the novel?"

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Q.302 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The students were scolded for not completing the homework.

(a) The teacher has been scolding the students for not completing the homework.
(b) The teacher has scolded the students for not completing the homework.
(c) The teacher scolded the students for not completing the homework.
(d) The teacher was scolding the students for not completing the homework.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The teacher scolded the students for not completing the homework.
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **passive voice** and **past tense**: *"The students were scolded for not completing the homework."*
- To convert it into **active voice**:
  - The **doer** of the action (subject) must be introduced — typically **"the teacher"**.
  - The verb **"were scolded"** in passive becomes **"scolded"** in active voice.
  - The object becomes **"the students"**.
- Correct active voice sentence:
  "The teacher scolded the students for not completing the homework."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"has been scolding"** – present perfect continuous tense; incorrect.
  - Option (b): **"has scolded"** – present perfect tense; incorrect.
  - Option (d): **"was scolding"** – past continuous tense; incorrect.

Correct answer: The teacher scolded the students for not completing the homework. (Option (c)

Q.303 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Yesterday all the culprits were arrested.

(a) Yesterday the police had arrested all the culprits.
(b) Yesterday the police was arresting all the culprits.
(c) Yesterday the police were arresting all the culprits.
(d) Yesterday the police arrested all the culprits.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Yesterday the police arrested all the culprits.
The original sentence is in **passive voice**:
"Yesterday all the culprits were arrested."
To change this to **active voice**, we need:

- A **subject** performing the action (here, logically, it's **the police**),
- The **verb in simple past tense** (since "were arrested" indicates past action).

Correct transformation in active voice:
"Yesterday the police arrested all the culprits."
This maintains the same meaning, tense, and clarity.
Correct answer: 4
"Yesterday the police arrested all the culprits."

Q.304 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Does the teacher explain the lesson every day?

(a) Is the teacher explaining the lesson every day?
(b) Has the lesson been explained by the teacher every day?
(c) Is the lesson being explained by the teacher every day?
(d) Is the lesson explained by the teacher every day?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Is the lesson explained by the teacher every day?
Solution:

- The given sentence is:
  "Does the teacher explain the lesson every day?"
- This is a **present simple tense** interrogative sentence in **active voice**.
- To change it into **passive voice**, follow these steps:
  - Identify the object: **the lesson**
  - Use the correct passive structure: **is/am/are + past participle**
  - Maintain the interrogative form in passive voice.
- So, the correct transformation is:
  "Is the lesson explained by the teacher every day?"
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"Is the teacher explaining..."** – changes the tense to present continuous.
  - Option (b): **"Has the lesson been explained..."** – changes the tense to present perfect.
  - Option (c): **"Is the lesson being explained..."** – also changes the tense to present continuous.

Correct passive voice form:
"Is the lesson explained by the teacher every day?"

Q.305 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
By whom was this painting made?

(a) Who was making this painting?
(b) Who made this painting?
(c) Whom made this painting?
(d) Who has made this painting?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Who made this painting?
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **passive voice**:
  "By whom was this painting made?"
- To convert it into **active voice**, follow these steps:
  - Identify the subject: **"who"** is the agent (doer of the action).
  - The passive verb **"was made"** (simple past) becomes **"made"** in active voice.
  - Rearranged, it becomes: **"Who made this painting?"**
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"Who was making this painting?"** – present continuous tense; changes the tense.
  - Option (c): **"Whom made..."** – incorrect use of "whom"; "who" is the subject.
  - Option (d): **"Who has made..."** – present perfect tense; changes the meaning.

Correct active voice form:
"Who made this painting?"

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Q.306 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Under Alauddin Khalji, the state brought the collection of land revenue under its own control.

(a) Under Alauddin Khalji, the collection of land revenue was brought under its own control by the state.
(b) Under Alauddin Khalji, the collection of land revenue was being brought under its own control by the state.
(c) Under Alauddin Khalji, the collection of land revenue was to be brought under its own control by the state.
(d) Under Alauddin Khalji, the collection of land revenue had been brought under its own control by the state.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Under Alauddin Khalji, the collection of land revenue was brought under its own control by the state.

Solution:

Active voice sentence:
"Under Alauddin Khalji, the state brought the collection of land revenue under its own control."

Tense:
- The sentence is in **simple past tense**: *"brought"*

Passive voice structure for simple past:
- **was/were + past participle**

Object to subject transformation:
- *"The collection of land revenue"* becomes the subject in the passive voice.
- *"by the state"* is retained as the agent.

Correct passive voice sentence:
"Under Alauddin Khalji, the collection of land revenue was brought under its own control by the state."

Why other options are incorrect:
- Option (b): **"was being brought"** – past continuous tense.
- Option (c): **"was to be brought"** – indicates future obligation, not simple past.
- Option (d): **"had been brought"** – past perfect tense.

Correct answer: Option (a)
"Under Alauddin Khalji, the collection of land revenue was brought under its own control by the state."

Q.307 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The concert will be attended by us.

(a) We have attended the concert.
(b) We will have attended the concert.
(c) We will attend the concert.
(d) We are attending the concert.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) We will attend the concert.

The given sentence is in **passive voice**:
"The concert will be attended by us."

To convert it to **active voice**, follow these steps:
- **Subject change**: "us" becomes "we"
- **Verb change**: Passive structure "will be attended" becomes "will attend" in active voice.
- The object "the concert" remains the same.

Thus, the active voice version is:
"We will attend the concert."

Q.308 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Sunita watered the plants and made my bed.

(a) The plants had been watered and my bed made by Sunita.
(b) The plants has been watered and my bed has been made by Sunita.
(c) The plants were watered and my bed was made by Sunita.
(d) The plants were watered and my bed will be made by Sunita.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The plants were watered and my bed was made by Sunita.

Solution:
- The given sentence is in **active voice** and **simple past tense**:
  "Sunita watered the plants and made my bed."
- To convert it into **passive voice**, follow these steps:
  - Both actions are in the **simple past**: "watered" and "made".
  - The correct passive structure for simple past is: **was/were + past participle**.
- Passive form:
  - **"The plants were watered"** (plants = plural → "were")
  - **"My bed was made"** (bed = singular → "was")
- So, the correct transformation is:
  "The plants were watered and my bed was made by Sunita."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"had been watered"** – past perfect, not simple past.
  - Option (b): **"has been watered"** – present perfect, incorrect tense.
  - Option (d): **"will be made"** – future tense, changes the original meaning.

Correct passive voice form:
"The plants were watered and my bed was made by Sunita."

Q.309 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Paul Goldstein, a wildlife photographer, took this photo in Kenya's Masai Mara National Park.

(a) This photo was taken by Paul Goldstein, a wildlife photographer, in Kenya's Masai Mara National Park.
(b) Kenya's Masai Mara National Park was taken in this photo by Paul Goldstein, a wildlife photographer.
(c) Paul Goldstein, a wildlife photographer was taken by Masai Mara National Park in this photo in Kenya.
(d) This photo has taken Paul Goldstein, a wildlife photographer, in Kenya's Masai Mara National Park.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) This photo was taken by Paul Goldstein, a wildlife photographer, in Kenya's Masai Mara National Park.
- The active voice sentence is:
  Paul Goldstein (subject) **took** (verb) **this photo** (object) in Kenya's Masai Mara National Park.

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Explanation (contd.)

- Passive voice structure:
  Object + was/were + past participle + by + subject
- Applying the rule:
  - "This photo" becomes the subject of the passive voice.
  - Verb "took" (past tense) changes to "was taken".
  - "By Paul Goldstein" is the agent.
  - Location phrase remains at the end.

So, the correct passive sentence is:
"This photo was taken by Paul Goldstein, a wildlife photographer, in Kenya's Masai Mara National Park."

Q.310 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The construction of the tunnel has been completed by the Public Works Department.

(a) The Public Works Department has completed the construction of the tunnel.
(b) The Public Works Department completed the construction of the tunnel.
(c) The construction of the tunnel has completed the Public Works Department.
(d) The Public Works Department is completing the construction of the tunnel.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The Public Works Department has completed the construction of the tunnel.

- The original sentence is in **passive voice**:
  "The construction of the tunnel has been completed by the Public Works Department."
- To convert it into **active voice**, bring the **doer (subject)**—"the Public Works Department"—to the front and use the correct **active verb form**.

"has been completed" (passive) → "has completed" (active)
Thus, the correct transformation is:
"The Public Works Department has completed the construction of the tunnel."

Q.311 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The spectators gave hardly any money to the performer.

(a) The performer is given hardly any money by the spectators.
(b) The performer was given hardly any money by the spectators.
(c) The performer has been given hardly any money by the spectators.
(d) The spectators were given hardly any money by the performer.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The performer was given hardly any money by the spectators.

- The **active voice** sentence is:
  "**The spectators gave hardly any money to the performer.**"
- To convert to **passive voice**, we can start with the **indirect object** ("the performer") and make it the subject of the passive sentence.

Explanation (contd.)

- **Passive construction:**
  "**The performer was given hardly any money by the spectators.**"
- This follows the pattern:
  [subject] + was/were + past participle + by [agent]

Correct passive voice:
"The performer was given hardly any money by the spectators."

Q.312 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
This cake was baked by Mary for your birthday.

(a) Mary baked this cake for your birthday.
(b) Mary has been baking this cake for your birthday.
(c) Mary has baked this cake for your birthday.
(d) Mary bakes this cake for your birthday.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Mary baked this cake for your birthday.

We are given a sentence in **passive voice** and need to convert it into **active voice**.
Original (Passive Voice):
This cake was baked by Mary for your birthday.
To convert it into active voice:

1. **Identify the subject** in the passive voice:
   - *Mary* is the doer of the action.
2. **Identify the verb tense:**
   - *was baked* → simple past passive
   - So in active voice, the verb should also be in **simple past**: *baked*
3. **Reconstruct the sentence in active voice:**
   - Subject + verb + object → *Mary baked this cake for your birthday.*

This structure maintains the same tense and meaning.

Q.313 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The mechanic did not fix the car yesterday.

(a) The car did not fix by the mechanic yesterday.
(b) The mechanic was not fixed by the car yesterday.
(c) The car was not fixed by the mechanic yesterday.
(d) The car had not been fixed by the mechanic yesterday.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The car was not fixed by the mechanic yesterday.

To change the sentence **"The mechanic did not fix the car yesterday."** into passive voice, we follow these steps:

- **Subject**: The mechanic → becomes the agent (by the mechanic)
- **Object**: the car → becomes the subject in passive voice
- **Tense**: Simple past negative → passive form is "was/were + not + past participle"

Hence, the correct passive construction is:

- **"The car was not fixed by the mechanic yesterday."**

Let's review the options:

- **Option (a):** Incorrect structure ("did not fix" is active voice)
- **Option (b):** Illogical subject-object reversal
- **Option (c):** Correct passive voice
- **Option (d):** Incorrect tense (past perfect)

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Q.314 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Do we have to accept this deal?

(a) This deal has to be accepted?
(b) Is this deal to be accepted?
(c) Does this deal have to be accepted?
(d) Why is this deal to be accepted?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Does this deal have to be accepted?

The sentence is in the **interrogative form** and uses the **modal verb "have to"** in the **present tense**:
Do we have to accept this deal?
To convert this into passive voice:

- Object becomes the subject: **This deal**
- Passive structure for "have to" is: **has to be + past participle**
- The correct transformation:
  Does this deal have to be accepted?

Let's evaluate the options:

- **Option (a): This deal has to be accepted?** – Incorrect word order for a question; sounds like a statement with a question mark.
- **Option (b): Is this deal to be accepted?** – Grammatical but changes the structure and intention of the original sentence.
- **Option (c): Does this deal have to be accepted?** – Correct passive voice form.
- **Option (d): Why is this deal to be accepted?** – Adds an unnecessary "Why", changing the question entirely.

Q.315 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
A remarkable discovery in Paestum, an ancient Greek city, has been made by archaeologists.

(a) Archaeologists made a remarkable discovery in Paestum, an ancient Greek city.
(b) Archaeologists make a remarkable discovery in Paestum, an ancient Greek city.
(c) Archaeologists have made a remarkable discovery in Paestum, an ancient Greek city.
(d) Archaeologists are making a remarkable discovery in Paestum, an ancient Greek city.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Archaeologists have made a remarkable discovery in Paestum, an ancient Greek city.

The given sentence is in **passive voice**:
"A remarkable discovery in Paestum, an ancient Greek city, has been made by archaeologists."
To convert this into **active voice**, we:

- Identify the **subject** doing the action: *archaeologists*
- Convert the **verb** "has been made" (present perfect passive) into its **active form**: "have made"
- Keep the **object** (the thing acted upon): *a remarkable discovery*

So the correct **active voice** version is:
"Archaeologists have made a remarkable discovery in Paestum, an ancient Greek city."

Q.316 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The scientist conducted a series of ground-breaking experiments, revealing new insights into the nature of dark matter.

(a) A series of ground-breaking experiments are conducted by the scientist, revealing new insights into the nature of dark matter.
(b) A series of ground-breaking insights were conducted by the scientist, revealing new experiments into the nature of dark matter.
(c) A series of ground-breaking experiments were conducted by the scientist, revealing new insights into the nature of dark matter.
(d) A series of ground-breaking experiments have been conducted by the scientist, revealing new insights into the nature of dark matter.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A series of ground-breaking experiments were conducted by the scientist, revealing new insights into the nature of dark matter.

The given sentence is in **active voice**, where the subject "**the scientist**" performed the action "**conducted a series of ground-breaking experiments**."
To convert it into **passive voice**:

- The **object** of the active sentence ("a series of ground-breaking experiments") becomes the **subject** of the passive sentence.
- The verb "**conducted**" (simple past tense) changes to "**were conducted**."
- The **agent** ("by the scientist") is added optionally in the passive form.
- The participial phrase "**revealing new insights into the nature of dark matter**" remains unchanged, as it is describing the result or effect.

Thus, the correct passive sentence is:
"A series of ground-breaking experiments were conducted by the scientist, revealing new insights into the nature of dark matter."

Q.317 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Was the food finished by Kavya?

(a) Does Kavya finish the food?
(b) Has Kavya finished the food?
(c) Had Kavya finished the food?
(d) Did Kavya finish the food?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Did Kavya finish the food?

The original sentence is in **passive voice**:
"Was the food finished by Kavya?"
To convert this to **active voice**, we follow these steps:

- Identify the subject in passive voice: **Kavya**
- Convert the verb "was finished" (past simple passive) to its active form: **did finish**
- Keep the question structure intact.

So, the active voice sentence becomes:
"Did Kavya finish the food?"
This is in the **simple past tense**, matching the tense of the passive construction.

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Q.318 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The team completed the project ahead of schedule.

(a) The project has been completed ahead of schedule by the team.
(b) The schedule was completed ahead of project by the team.
(c) The project was completed ahead of schedule by the team.
(d) The project had completed ahead of schedule by the team.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The project was completed ahead of schedule by the team.

To convert an **active voice** sentence into **passive voice**, follow this structure:

- **Active Voice:** Subject + Verb (Past Simple) + Object
- **Passive Voice:** Object + was/were + Past Participle + by + Subject

Given Sentence (Active):
The team completed the project ahead of schedule.

- Subject: the team
- Verb: completed (past simple)
- Object: the project

Passive Construction:

- Object becomes subject: **The project**
- Past simple verb becomes: **was + past participle (completed)**
- Agent (the team) comes after **by**
- The phrase "ahead of schedule" remains unchanged.

Correct Passive Voice:
The project was completed ahead of schedule by the team.

Q.319 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
All the arrangements will have been completed by the hotel staff by the time the PM reaches here.

(a) The hotel staff will have completed all the arrangements by the time the PM reaches here.
(b) The hotel staff will complete all the arrangements by the time the PM reaches here.
(c) The hotel staff will be completing all the arrangements by the time the PM reaches here.
(d) The hotel staff have completed all the arrangements by the time the PM reaches here.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The hotel staff will have completed all the arrangements by the time the PM reaches here.

- The original sentence is in **future perfect passive voice**: **"will have been completed by the hotel staff..."**
- To change it to **active voice**, we need to:
  - Use the **subject** ("the hotel staff") first
  - Convert the verb from **"will have been completed"** to **"will have completed"**
  - Retain the rest of the sentence unchanged

Correct transformation:
"The hotel staff will have completed all the arrangements by the time the PM reaches here."

Q.320 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The company will launch a new product next month.

(a) A new company will be launched by the product next month.
(b) A new product should be launched by the company next month.
(c) A new product is to be launched by the company next month.
(d) A new product will be launched by the company next month.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A new product will be launched by the company next month.

The given sentence is in **active voice** and **simple future tense**:

- **Subject**: The company
- **Verb**: will launch
- **Object**: a new product
- **Time phrase**: next month

To convert it into **passive voice**, follow this structure:

- Passive form of future tense: **will be + past participle**
- "a new product" becomes the **subject** in passive voice.
- The verb "launch" becomes **"be launched"**.

Thus, the correct passive form is:

- **A new product will be launched by the company next month.**

Other options:

- Option (a): Illogical subject-verb-object order.
- Option (b): Uses "should" instead of "will" — changes the meaning.
- Option (c): "is to be launched" implies a plan, not a definite future action.

Q.321 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The gardener is planting flowers in the garden.

(a) Flowers are being planted in the garden by the gardener.
(b) Flowers have been planted in the garden by the gardener.
(c) Flowers are planted in the garden by the gardener.
(d) Flowers will be planted in the garden by the gardener.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Flowers are being planted in the garden by the gardener.

- The sentence is in **present continuous tense**: "is planting".
- Passive voice of present continuous tense uses the structure:
  am/is/are + being + past participle (V3).
- Hence, **"is planting"** becomes **"are being planted"** when the object "flowers" becomes the subject.
- The correct passive sentence:
  Flowers are being planted in the garden by the gardener.

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Q.322 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The author wrote a compelling novel, weaving together multiple storylines that captivated readers until the last page.

(a) A compelling novel was writing the author, weaving together multiple storylines that captivated readers until the last page.
(b) A compelling novel was written by the reader, weaving together multiple storylines that captivated the author until the last page.
(c) A compelling novel has been written by the author, weaving together multiple storylines that captivated readers until the last page.
(d) A compelling novel was written by the author, weaving together multiple storylines that captivated readers until the last page.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A compelling novel was written by the author, weaving together multiple storylines that captivated readers until the last page.
The original sentence is in **active voice**, with the subject "**The author**" performing the action "**wrote a compelling novel**." It also includes a participial phrase: "**weaving together multiple storylines that captivated readers until the last page**."
To convert this into **passive voice**:
- The object "**a compelling novel**" becomes the **subject**.
- The verb "**wrote**" (past simple tense) becomes "**was written**."
- The **agent** ("by the author") is included.
- The participial phrase remains unchanged, as it adds descriptive detail.

The correct passive construction is:
"A compelling novel was written by the author, weaving together multiple storylines that captivated readers until the last page."

Q.323 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
This book was loved by the students.

(a) The students are loving this book.
(b) The students love this book.
(c) The students loved this book.
(d) The students have loved this book.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The students loved this book.
The original sentence is in **passive voice**:
"This book was loved by the students."
To convert it into **active voice**, follow these steps:
- Subject in passive voice: **the students** (doer of the action)
- Verb in passive: **was loved** (simple past passive)
- Object in passive: **this book**

Convert the passive verb "was loved" into **simple past active form → loved**
So, the sentence in **active voice** becomes:
"The students loved this book."
This retains the original meaning and correct past tense.

Q.324 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
A state-of-the-art software program is being designed by our team to enhance the efficiency of our business operations.

(a) Our team has been designing a state-of-the-art software program to enhance the efficiency of our business operations.
(b) Our team is designing a state-of-the-art software program to enhance the efficiency of our business operations.
(c) Our team will be designing a state-of-the-art software program to enhance the efficiency of our business operations.
(d) Our team has designed a state-of-the-art software program to enhance the efficiency of our business operations.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Our team is designing a state-of-the-art software program to enhance the efficiency of our business operations.
To convert a sentence from **passive voice** to **active voice**, we identify:
- **Subject** performing the action (here: **our team**)
- **Verb tense** (here: **is being designed** = **present continuous passive**)
- **Object** receiving the action (here: **a software program**)

Passive form:
"A state-of-the-art software program **is being designed** by our team..."
Active form:
"Our team **is designing** a state-of-the-art software program..."
The tense remains present continuous in active voice: **is being designed → is designing**
Correct answer:
Our team is designing a state-of-the-art software program to enhance the efficiency of our business operations.

Q.325 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The manager gave the employee a bonus.

(a) The bonus was given to the employee by the manager.
(b) The employee was given a bonus by the manager.
(c) The employee was given the manager by the bonus.
(d) The employee had been given a bonus by the manager.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The employee was given a bonus by the manager.
The sentence is in **active voice**:
The manager gave the employee a bonus.
This sentence has **two objects**:
- **Direct object**: *a bonus*
- **Indirect object**: *the employee*

When changing such sentences to **passive voice**, we can begin with either object. Both forms are grammatically correct. The most natural passive construction often begins with the indirect object (*the employee*), especially when the emphasis is on the person receiving something.
Let's convert the sentence:

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Explanation (contd.)

- **Active voice**: The manager gave the employee a bonus.
- **Passive voice**:
  - **Option (a)**: *The bonus was given to the employee by the manager.*
  - **Option (b)**: *The employee was given a bonus by the manager.*

Both are correct, but **Option (b)** is more commonly used when focusing on the recipient of the action.

Q.326 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Open the window to let in some fresh air.

(a) Let the window be opened to let in some fresh air.
(b) The window is to be open to let in some fresh air.
(c) You can open the window to let in some fresh air.
(d) Let the window open to let in some fresh air

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Let the window be opened to let in some fresh air.

The given sentence is an **imperative sentence** with the verb "Open" in the **active voice**.

To convert an imperative sentence into the **passive voice**, the structure generally used is:
Let + object + be + past participle.

- **"Open the window"** in passive becomes **"Let the window be opened."**
- The second part **"to let in some fresh air"** remains unchanged because it is an infinitive phrase expressing purpose.

Now let's examine the options:

- **Option (a): "Let the window be opened to let in some fresh air."** – Correct structure and meaning.
- **Option (b): "The window is to be open..."** – Incorrect verb form ("open" instead of "opened").
- **Option (c): "You can open..."** – Still in active voice.
- **Option (d): "Let the window open..."** – Sounds like a natural occurrence, not a command.

Q.327 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
My grandmother called me to the worship place.

(a) The grandmother was called by me to the worship place.
(b) I called my grandmother to the worship place.
(c) The worship place was called by me to the grandmother.
(d) I was called by my grandmother to the worship place.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I was called by my grandmother to the worship place.

- The **active voice** sentence is:
  "My grandmother called me to the worship place."
- To convert it into **passive voice**, the **object** ("me") becomes the **subject** ("I").
- The verb "called" (simple past tense) changes to "**was called**" in passive construction.
- "By my grandmother" correctly indicates the doer of the action in passive voice.
- The rest of the sentence ("to the worship place") remains unchanged.

Final Passive Voice Sentence:
I was called by my grandmother to the worship place.

Q.328 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
Let a statement addressing the recent controversy be issued by the company.

(a) The company can issue a statement addressing the recent controversy.
(b) Let the company issue a statement addressing the recent controversy.
(c) The company is issuing a statement addressing the recent controversy.
(d) The company should issue a statement addressing the recent controversy.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Let the company issue a statement addressing the recent controversy.

The given sentence is in **passive voice** and uses the **"let" construction**, which is commonly used to form **imperative passive sentences**.

- Passive: *Let a statement addressing the recent controversy be issued by the company.*

To convert this to **active voice**, maintain the imperative structure but make the subject ("the company") the doer of the action:

- **Active voice**: *Let the company issue a statement addressing the recent controversy.*

This keeps both the tone and intent of the original sentence intact.

Let's review the other options:

- **Option (a)** ("The company can issue...") changes the modality from imperative to possibility.
- **Option (c)** ("The company is issuing...") changes the tense to present continuous.
- **Option (d)** ("The company should issue...") introduces a suggestion, not a direct imperative.

Q.329 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The chef prepared a delicious meal for the guests.

(a) A delicious meal was being prepared for the guests by the chef.
(b) A delicious meal was preparing for the guests by the chef.
(c) A delicious meal is prepared for the guests by the chef.
(d) A delicious meal was prepared for the guests by the chef.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A delicious meal was prepared for the guests by the chef.

The original sentence is in the **active voice**:
"The chef prepared a delicious meal for the guests."

Let's convert this to the **passive voice**:

- **Object** of the active sentence becomes the **subject** in the passive sentence → *"A delicious meal"*
- **Verb tense** is **simple past** ("prepared"), so in passive voice, it becomes **"was + past participle"**
- Add the doer: **by the chef**
- Retain the phrase **"for the guests"**

Correct passive construction:
"A delicious meal was prepared for the guests by the chef."

Let's evaluate the options:

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Explanation (contd.)

- **Option (a)**: *"was being prepared"* – past continuous, incorrect tense
- **Option (b)**: *"was preparing"* – incorrect; passive requires "was prepared"
- **Option (c)**: *"is prepared"* – simple present, incorrect tense
- **Option (d)**: *"was prepared"* – correct tense and structure

Q.330 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The director organised a meeting to discuss the upcoming projects.

(a) A meeting is organised by the director to discuss the upcoming projects.
(b) A meeting was organised by the director to discuss the upcoming projects.
(c) The upcoming projects were organised by the director to discuss the meeting.
(d) A meeting has been organised by the director to discuss the upcoming projects.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A meeting was organised by the director to discuss the upcoming projects.

To change a sentence from **active voice** to **passive voice**, we follow this structure:

- **Active voice**: Subject + Verb + Object
  → *The director organised a meeting...*
- **Passive voice**: Object + form of "to be" + past participle + by + subject
  → *A meeting was organised by the director...*

Here:

- **Verb tense in active** = *organised* (simple past)
- So, **passive form** = *was organised*

The correct passive sentence becomes:
"A meeting was organised by the director to discuss the upcoming projects."

Other options are incorrect because:

- "is organised" – simple present, doesn't match the past tense.
- "has been organised" – present perfect, changes the tense.
- "The upcoming projects were organised..." – changes subject and meaning.

Q.331 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
The courier gave my parcel to my neighbour in my absence.

(a) My parcel was given to my neighbour by the courier in my absence.
(b) My parcel had been given to my neighbour by the courier in my absence.
(c) My parcel needs to be given to my neighbour by the courier in my absence.
(d) My neighbour was given to my parcel by the courier in my absence.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) My parcel was given to my neighbour by the courier in my absence.

The sentence is in **active voice** with the following structure:

Explanation (contd.)

- **Subject**: The courier
- **Verb**: gave
- **Indirect object**: my neighbour
- **Direct object**: my parcel
- **Time phrase**: in my absence

To convert this into **passive voice**, we make the **object** ("my parcel") the **subject** of the passive sentence. The passive form of "gave" (simple past) is **"was given"**.

Let's evaluate the options:

1. **My parcel was given to my neighbour by the courier in my absence.**
   – Correct structure and tense.
2. **My parcel had been given...**
   – Past perfect is incorrect; the original sentence is in simple past.
3. **My parcel needs to be given...**
   – Incorrect tense and meaning.
4. **My neighbour was given to my parcel...**
   – Illogical construction.

Q.332 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in active voice.
The complex math problem was being explained to the students by the teacher.

(a) The teacher has explained the complex math problem to the students.
(b) The teacher explained the complex math problem to the students.
(c) The teacher was explaining the complex math problem to the students.
(d) The teacher will be explaining the complex math problem to the students.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The teacher was explaining the complex math problem to the students.

- The original sentence is in **passive voice**, past continuous tense:
  "was being explained" → indicates **past continuous passive**.
- To convert to **active voice**, we use the **past continuous** tense in the active form:
  - Subject: **The teacher**
  - Verb: **was explaining**
  - Object: **the complex math problem**
  - Indirect object: **to the students**

Correct Sentence:
The teacher was explaining the complex math problem to the students.

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Q.333 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in passive voice.
Are the students discussing the upcoming exam in the library?

(a) Was the upcoming exam being discussed by the students in the library?
(b) Is the upcoming exam being discussed by the students in the library?
(c) Has the upcoming exam been discussed by the students in the library?
(d) What upcoming exam is being discussed by the students in the library?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Is the upcoming exam being discussed by the students in the library?

The sentence **"Are the students discussing the upcoming exam in the library?"** is in **present continuous tense (active voice)** and is interrogative in structure.
To change it to passive voice:

- Subject: **the upcoming exam**
- Verb form: **is being discussed**
- Agent: **by the students**
- Question structure: Maintain the interrogative form in the passive voice

Correct transformation:
Is the upcoming exam being discussed by the students in the library?
This keeps the tense, meaning, and structure intact while shifting focus to the object.

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10. Direct & Indirect Speech

374 questions

Q.1 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Mother said to me, "Will you help me in cleaning the house?"

(a) Mother asked me will you help me in cleaning the house.
(b) Mother asked me if you would help her in cleaning the house.
(c) Mother asked me if I would help her in cleaning the house.
(d) Mother told me that I should help her in cleaning the house.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Mother asked me if I would help her in cleaning the house.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: add **if**; **will** → **would**; **you** → **I**, **me** → **her**.
(Yes/No प्रश्न: if जोड़ें; will → would; you → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps question order; **(b)** "if you would" – wrong pronoun; **(d)** "told ... should" – changes meaning.

Q.2 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The salesman said that he had verified all the bills while the goods were being packed.

(a) The salesman said, "He had verified all the bills while the goods was being packed."
(b) The salesman said, "I am verifying all the bills while the goods are being packed."
(c) The salesman said, "I have verified all the bills while the goods are packed."
(d) The salesman said, "I verified all the bills while the goods were being packed."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The salesman said, "I verified all the bills while the goods were being packed."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had verified → **verified**, **he** → **I**; keep the past-continuous "were being packed".
(Indirect → Direct: had verified → verified; he → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "He had verified ... goods was" – wrong pronoun/agreement.
• **(b)** "am verifying" / **(c)** "have verified ... are packed" – wrong tense.

Q.3 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Our Principal says, "Rules are to be followed at any cost."

(a) Our Principal says that rules are to be followed at any cost.
(b) Our Principal told that rules are to be followed at any cost.
(c) Our Principal said that rules had to be followed at any cost.
(d) Our Principal advised that rules need to be followed at any cost.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Our Principal says that rules are to be followed at any cost.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Present Reporting Verb)
Rule: When the reporting verb is **present ("says")**, the tense does **not** change.
(Reporting verb present (says) → tense नहीं बदलता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "told that" – needs an object; **(c)** "said ... had to" – wrongly back-shifts; **(d)** "advised" – changes the verb.

Q.4 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Anshul told me that his mother was not at home and that she would be back the following day.

(a) Anshul said to me, "My mother is not at home. She will be back tomorrow."
(b) Anshul said to me, "His mother was not at home. She would be back tomorrow."
(c) Anshul said to me, "My mother was not at home. She will be back the following day."
(d) Anshul said to me, "My mother is not at home. She would be back the following day."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Anshul said to me, "My mother is not at home. She will be back tomorrow."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: was → **is**, **would** → **will**, **his** → **my**, **the following day** → **tomorrow**.
(Indirect → Direct: was → is; would → will; the following day → tomorrow।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "His mother was" – not converted; **(c)** "was ... following day" – wrong; **(d)** "would be back" – not changed.

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Q.5 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
The teacher said to the parents, "Young children are very restless."

(a) The teacher asked the parents if young children are very restless.
(b) The teacher told the parents that young children were very restless.
(c) The teacher said the parents that young children are very restless.
(d) The teacher told the parents that young children had been very restless.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The teacher told the parents that young children were very restless.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: are → were; "said to" → **told**.
(Direct → Indirect: are → were; said to → told।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "asked if ... are" – it is a statement; **(c)** "said the parents" – needs "to"; **(d)** "had been" – wrong tense.

Q.6 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
She said, "Is anyone there in the house?"

(a) She asked there is anyone in the house.
(b) She asked if anyone was there in the house.
(c) She told there is someone in the house.
(d) She enquired if someone is there in the house.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She asked if anyone was there in the house.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: add **if**; **is → was**.
(Yes/No प्रश्न: if जोड़ें; is → was।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "asked there is" – no "if", present; **(c)** "told" – wrong verb; **(d)** "if someone is" – present tense.

Q.7 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Taru said that she could not leave the children alone.

(a) Taru said, "I will not leave the children alone."
(b) Taru said, "I cannot leave the children alone."
(c) Taru said, "I could not be leaving the children alone."
(d) Taru said, "She would not leave the children alone."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Taru said, "I cannot leave the children alone."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: could not → cannot, **she → I**.
(Indirect → Direct: could not → cannot; she → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will not" – wrong modal; **(c)** "could not be leaving" – wrong form; **(d)** "She would not" – wrong pronoun.

Q.8 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Esha said, "Avika is not going to school today as she has fever."

(a) Esha said that Avika is not going to school today as she has fever.
(b) Esha said that Avika was not going to school that day as she had fever.
(c) Esha said that Avika had not gone to school that day as she was having fever.
(d) Esha said that Avika was not going to school today as she has fever.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Esha said that Avika was not going to school that day as she had fever.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: is going → was going, **has → had**, **today → that day**.
(Direct → Indirect: is → was; has → had; today → that day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "is ... today"; **(c)** "had not gone" – wrong tense; **(d)** keeps "today".

Q.9 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
He regretted the mistake he had made in his calculations.

(a) He said, "I regretted the mistake I made in my calculations."
(b) He said, "I regret the mistake I made in my calculations."
(c) He said, "I am sorry for the mistake I made in his calculations."
(d) He said, "He regrets the mistake he made in my calculations."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He said, "I regret the mistake I made in my calculations."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: regretted → regret, **had made → made**, **he → I**, **his → my**.
(Indirect → Direct: regretted → regret; had made → made; his → my।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I regretted" – past; **(c)** "his calculations" – wrong pronoun; **(d)** "He regrets ... my" – mixed.

Q.10 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
She asked her mother where her gold bracelet was.

(a) She asked to her mother, "Where my gold bracelet is?"
(b) She said to her mother, "Where was my gold bracelet?"
(c) She said to her mother, "Where is my gold bracelet?"
(d) She said to her mother, "Where was her gold bracelet?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She said to her mother, "Where is my gold bracelet?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: was → is, **her → my**; make it a question.
(Indirect → Direct: was → is; her → my।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "asked to her ... is?" – wrong order; **(b)** "Where was my" – tense not changed; **(d)** "Where was her" – wrong.

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Q.11 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
She exclaimed that I looked very beautiful in that dress.

(a) She said, "How beautiful I looked in that dress!"
(b) She said, "How beautiful you look in this dress!"
(c) She said, "How beautiful she looks in this dress!"
(d) She said, "How beautiful I look in this dress!"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She said, "How beautiful you look in this dress!"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Exclamatory)
Rule: "exclaimed that ..." → "**How ...!**"; **I** → **you**, **looked** → **look**, **that** → **this**.
(Exclaimed that → "How ...!"; I → you; that → this।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I looked ... that dress" – wrong pronoun/tense; **(c)** "she looks" – wrong pronoun; **(d)** "I look" – wrong pronoun.

Q.12 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
I said to my friend, "Please help me arrange these books on the shelf."

(a) I told to my friend to please help me arrange those books on the shelf.
(b) I asked my friend to help me arrange these books on the shelf.
(c) I requested my friend to help me arrange those books on the shelf.
(d) I ordered my friend to help me arrange those books on the shelf.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I requested my friend to help me arrange those books on the shelf.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Request)
Rule: "Please help ..." → "**requested + object + to + V1**"; **these** → **those**.
(निवेदन: requested + object + to + verb; these → those।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "told to my friend to please" – wrong.
• **(b)** keeps "these"; **(d)** "ordered" – changes the meaning.

Q.13 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
The thief said to the judge, "Pardon me."

(a) The thief requested the judge for pardon me.
(b) The thief begged the judge to pardon him.
(c) The thief urged to pardon to the judge.
(d) The thief said to the judge to pardon.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The thief begged the judge to pardon him.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Request/Plea)
Rule: "Pardon me" (a plea) → "**begged + object + to + V1**"; **me** → **him**.
(निवेदन: begged + object + to + verb; me → him।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "requested ... for pardon me" – wrong; **(c)** "urged to pardon to the judge" – wrong; **(d)** "said ... to pardon" – incomplete.

Q.14 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The policeman told the inspector that he had arrested a man for breaking the lock-down rules.

(a) The policeman said to the inspector, "I am arresting a man for breaking the lock-down rules."
(b) The policeman said to the inspector, "He arrests a man for breaking the lock-down rules."
(c) The policeman said to the inspector, "I have arrested a man for breaking the lock-down rules."
(d) The policeman said to the Inspector, "He would arrest a man for breaking the lock-down rules."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The policeman said to the inspector, "I have arrested a man for breaking the lock-down rules."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had arrested → **have arrested**, **he** → **I**.
(Indirect → Direct: had arrested → have arrested; he → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I am arresting" – wrong tense; **(b)** "He arrests" – wrong pronoun/tense; **(d)** "He would arrest" – wrong.

Q.15 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
The professor said to Piyush, "Will you clean the data and get back to me tomorrow?"

(a) The professor asked Piyush if he would clean the data and get back to him the next day.
(b) The professor ordered Piyush that he should clean the data and get back to him the next day.
(c) The professor told Piyush clean the data and get back to him the next day.
(d) The professor asked Piyush will you clean the data and get back to me tomorrow.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The professor asked Piyush if he would clean the data and get back to him the next day.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: add **if**; **will** → **would**; **you** → **he**, **me** → **him**; **tomorrow** → **the next day**.
(Yes/No प्रश्न: if; will → would; tomorrow → the next day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "ordered ... should" – changes meaning; **(c)** "told Piyush clean" – wrong; **(d)** keeps question order.

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Q.16 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Taru told me that Avika was having her online cooking class then.

(a) Taru said to me, "Avika was having her online cooking class at this time."
(b) Taru said to me, "Avika will be having her online cooking class now."
(c) Taru said to me, "Avika is having her online cooking class now."
(d) Taru said to me, "Avika is having her online cooking class at that time."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Taru said to me, "Avika is having her online cooking class now."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: was having → is having, then → now.
(Indirect → Direct: was → is; then → now।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was having ... at this time" – wrong; **(b)** "will be having" – wrong tense; **(d)** "at that time" – not changed.

Q.17 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The driver said to the passerby, "Do you know the way to the market?"

(a) The driver asked the passerby did he know the way to the market.
(b) The driver asked the passerby if he knew the way to the market.
(c) The driver asked the passerby whether you know the way to the market.
(d) The driver asked the passerby if he knows the way to the market.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The driver asked the passerby if he knew the way to the market.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: add **if**; **do you know → he knew** (present → past).
(Yes/No प्रश्न: if जोड़ें; know → knew।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "did he know" – keeps question order; **(c)** "whether you know" – wrong pronoun/tense; **(d)** "if he knows" – present tense.

Q.18 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Sanjeev said that he would surely succeed.

(a) Sanjeev said, "I will surely succeed."
(b) Sanjeev said, "I am going to succeed surely."
(c) Sanjeev says, "I have succeeded surely."
(d) Sanjeev says, "I surely will succeed."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Sanjeev said, "I will surely succeed."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: would → will, he → I.
(Indirect → Direct: would → will; he → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "am going to succeed" – changes structure; **(c)** "have succeeded" – wrong tense; **(d)** wrong order.

Q.19 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Taru said, "Kavya is going to her grandmother's house today for the weekend."

(a) Taru said that Kavya has gone to her grandmother's house that day for the weekend.
(b) Taru said that Kavya was going to her grandmother's house that day for the weekend.
(c) Taru said that Kavya was going to her grandmother's house today for the weekend.
(d) Taru said that Kavya is going to her grandmother's house today for the weekend.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Taru said that Kavya was going to her grandmother's house that day for the weekend.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: is going → was going, today → that day.
(Direct → Indirect: is → was; today → that day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has gone" – wrong tense; **(c)** keeps "today"; **(d)** "is going ... today" – not changed.

Q.20 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
My brother told me that I could see any film I wanted on TV.

(a) My brother said to me, "You could see any film you wanted on TV."
(b) My brother said to me, "I could see any film I wanted on TV."
(c) My brother said to me, "I can see any film I want on TV."
(d) My brother said to me, "You can see any film you want on TV."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) My brother said to me, "You can see any film you want on TV."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: could → can, wanted → want, I → you.
(Indirect → Direct: could → can; wanted → want; I → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "You could ... wanted" – not fully changed; **(b)** "I could" – wrong pronoun; **(c)** "I can" – wrong pronoun.

Q.21 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Rani said to me, "A monkey bit me in the park."

(a) Rani told me that a monkey had bitten her in the park.
(b) Rani told me that a monkey has bitten her in the park.
(c) Rani told me that a monkey bit me in the park.
(d) Rani asked me if a monkey bit me in the park.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Rani told me that a monkey had bitten her in the park.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: bit → had bitten, me → her.
(Direct → Indirect: bit → had bitten; me → her।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "has bitten" – wrong tense; **(c)** "bit me" – wrong pronoun; **(d)** "asked if" – it is a statement.

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Q.22 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
"Press button A to start the machine," said the instructor to the trainees.

(a) The instructor told the trainees to press button A to start the machine.
(b) The instructor said to the trainees that you should press button A to start the machine.
(c) The instructor requested the trainees press button A to start the machine.
(d) The instructor told the trainees that pressing button A would start the machine.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The instructor told the trainees to press button A to start the machine.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Order)
Rule: A command → "**told + object + to + V1**".
(आदेश: told + object + to + verb।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "you should press" – wordy; **(c)** "requested ... press" – missing "to"; **(d)** changes the meaning.

Q.23 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Anurag says that he would like to be an electronics engineer when he grows up.

(a) Anurag said, "I will like to be an electronics engineer when I grow up."
(b) Anurag says, "He likes to be an electronics engineer when he grows up."
(c) Anurag says, "I like to be an electronics engineer when I grow up."
(d) Anurag says, "I would like to be an electronics engineer when I grow up."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Anurag says, "I would like to be an electronics engineer when I grow up."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: reporting verb "**says**" (present) → no tense change; **he** → **I**, **grows** → **grow**.
(Reporting verb present (says) → tense नहीं बदलता; he → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "said ... will like" – wrong; **(b)** "He likes" – wrong pronoun; **(c)** "I like" – wrong modal.

Q.24 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
He told me not to jump to any conclusion.

(a) He told to me, "Don't jump to any conclusion."
(b) He said to me, "Not jump to any conclusion."
(c) He said to me, "Not to jump to any conclusion."
(d) He said to me, "Don't jump to any conclusion."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He said to me, "Don't jump to any conclusion."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Negative Order)
Rule: "told me not to jump" → "**Don't jump ...**"
(निषेधात्मक आदेश: not to → "Don't + verb"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "told to me" – wrong; **(b)** "Not jump"; **(c)** "Not to jump" – wrong forms.

Q.25 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
I said to Promod, "How did you break your leg?"

(a) I asked Promod how you broke your leg.
(b) I asked Promod how he had broken his leg.
(c) I asked Promod how he had broken your leg.
(d) I asked Promod how did you break your leg.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) I asked Promod how he had broken his leg.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: did you break → **he had broken**, **your** → **his**; assertive order.
(Direct → Indirect: broke → had broken; your → his।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "how you broke" – not changed; **(c)** "your leg" – wrong pronoun; **(d)** keeps question order.

Q.26 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
I said to you, " He should be trusted."

(a) I told you that he should be trusted.
(b) I asked you if he should be trusted.
(c) I told you that I should be trusted.
(d) I told you that you should be trusted.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I told you that he should be trusted.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: "said to" → **told**; the modal "should" and pronoun "he" stay the same.
(Direct → Indirect: said to → told।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "asked if" – it is a statement; **(c)** "I should" / **(d)** "you should" – wrong pronoun.

Q.27 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Garima told her friends that she couldn't go with them to the movie that night as she was very busy.

(a) Garima said to her friends, "I couldn't go with you to the movie tonight as I was very busy."
(b) Garima said to her friends, "She couldn't go with them to the movie that night as she was very busy."
(c) Garima said to her friends, "I can't go with them to the movie that night as I was very busy."
(d) Garima said to her friends, "I can't go with you to the movie tonight as I am very busy."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Garima said to her friends, "I can't go with you to the movie tonight as I am very busy."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: couldn't → **can't**, **them** → **you**, **that night** → **tonight**, **was** → **am**.
(Indirect → Direct: couldn't → can't; that night → tonight।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "couldn't ... was" – not changed; **(b)** "She couldn't" – wrong pronoun; **(c)** "with them ... was" – mixed.

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Q.28 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Amit said to me, "Your parents are waiting for you."

(a) Amit told me that your parents are waiting for you.
(b) Amit told me that his parents were waiting for me.
(c) Amit told me that my parents were waiting for me.
(d) Amit asked me if my parents were waiting for me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Amit told me that my parents were waiting for me.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: are waiting → were waiting; your → my, you → me.
(Direct → Indirect: are → were; your → my; you → me।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "your ... are"; **(b)** "his parents" – wrong pronoun; **(d)** "asked if" – it is a statement.

Q.29 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
I asked Rahul why he was back so soon.

(a) I said to Rahul, "Why you are back so soon?"
(b) I said to Rahul, "Why he was back so soon?"
(c) I asked to Rahul, "Why was he back so soon?"
(d) I said to Rahul, "Why are you back so soon?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I said to Rahul, "Why are you back so soon?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: was → are, he → you; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: was → are; he → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Why you are" – wrong order; **(b)** "Why he was" – not changed; **(c)** "asked to Rahul" – wrong.

Q.30 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Madhuri told me that I could stay in her flat whenever I was in Kolkata.

(a) Madhuri said to me, "I could stay in her flat whenever I was in Kolkata."
(b) Madhuri said to me, "You can stay in my flat whenever you are in Kolkata."
(c) Madhuri said to me, "I can stay in my flat whenever I am in Kolkata."
(d) Madhuri said to me, "You could stay in her flat whenever she was in Kolkata."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Madhuri said to me, "You can stay in my flat whenever you are in Kolkata."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: could → can, I → you, her → my, was → are.
(Indirect → Direct: could → can; I → you; her → my।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I could stay in her flat" – not converted.
• **(c)** "I can stay in my flat" – wrong pronoun.
• **(d)** "You could ... she was" – wrong forms.

Q.31 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The commander ordered the soldiers to climb the hill.

(a) The commander said to the soldiers, "Please climb the hill."
(b) The commander said to the soldiers, "Climb the hill."
(c) The commander said to the soldiers, "Start climbing the hill."
(d) The commander ordered to the soldiers, "Go and climb the hill."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The commander said to the soldiers, "Climb the hill."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Order)
Rule: "ordered ... to climb" → a direct command "**Climb the hill.**"
(आदेश: ordered to → command।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Please climb" – a request; **(c)** "Start climbing" – changes words; **(d)** "ordered to the soldiers" – wrong.

Q.32 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The boy requested his mother to give him a mango.

(a) The mother said to the boy, "Give him a mango."
(b) The boy said to his mother, "Please give me a mango."
(c) The boy said to his mother, "Give me a mango now."
(d) The boy said to his mother, "Will you give me a mango?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The boy said to his mother, "Please give me a mango."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Request)
Rule: "requested his mother to give him" → "Please give **me** a mango."; **him → me.**
(निवेदन: requested to → "Please + verb"; him → me।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "The mother said ... Give him" – wrong speaker; **(c)** "Give me ... now" – adds "now"; **(d)** "Will you give" – a question.

Q.33 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
He asked me if I would like to learn French.

(a) He said to me, "Do you like to learn French?"
(b) He said to me, "I would like to learn French."
(c) He said to me, "You would like to learn French?"
(d) He said to me, "Would you like to learn French?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He said to me, "Would you like to learn French?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Yes/No Question)
Rule: "asked if I would like" → direct question "**Would you like ...?**"; **I → you.**
(Indirect → Direct: if हटाकर प्रश्न; I → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Do you like" – wrong tense; **(b)** "I would like" – wrong pronoun; **(c)** wrong order.

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Q.34 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The Principal says, "Hard work is the key to success."

(a) The Principal say that hard work is the key to success.
(b) The Principal said that hard work was the key to success.
(c) The Principal says that hard work is the key to success.
(d) The Principal says that hard work was the key to success.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The Principal says that hard work is the key to success.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Present Reporting Verb)
Rule: With "**says**" (present), the tense does not change; a universal truth also stays present.
(Reporting verb present (says) → tense नहीं बदलता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "say" – wrong verb; **(b)** "said ... was" – wrongly back-shifted; **(d)** "says ... was" – wrong tense.

Q.35 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The librarian said to her, "You can borrow only two books at a time."

(a) The librarian told her that you can borrow only two books at a time.
(b) The librarian told her that she can borrow only two books at a time.
(c) The librarian told her that she could borrow only two books at a time.
(d) The librarian told her that they could borrow only two books at a time.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The librarian told her that she could borrow only two books at a time.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: can → could, you → she.
(Direct → Indirect: can → could; you → she।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "you can" – not changed; **(b)** "she can" – "can → could" not done; **(d)** "they could" – wrong pronoun.

Q.36 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He exclaimed, "What a fine piece of architecture it is!"

(a) He exclaimed that what a fine piece of architecture it was.
(b) He exclaimed was it a fine piece of architecture.
(c) He exclaimed what a fine piece of architecture is it.
(d) He exclaimed that it was a fine piece of architecture.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He exclaimed that it was a fine piece of architecture.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Exclamatory)
Rule: "What a fine ...!" → "**exclaimed that it was a fine ...**"; **is → was.**
(Exclamatory → exclaimed that ...; is → was।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "that what a fine" – keeps exclamation; **(b) & (c)** keep question/exclamation forms.

Q.37 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The tailor said to him, "Your shirt will be ready by tomorrow."

(a) The tailor told to him that your shirt will be ready by the next day.
(b) The tailor told him that your shirt would be ready by tomorrow.
(c) The tailor told him that his shirt will be ready by tomorrow.
(d) The tailor told him that his shirt would be ready by the next day.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The tailor told him that his shirt would be ready by the next day.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: will → would, your → his, tomorrow → the next day.
(Direct → Indirect: will → would; your → his; tomorrow → the next day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "told to him ... your ... will" – wrong; **(b)** keeps "your ... tomorrow"; **(c)** "his shirt will" – tense not changed.

Q.38 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to Manoj, "I celebrated my birthday two days ago."

(a) He told Manoj that he celebrated my birthday two days before.
(b) He told Manoj that I celebrated my birthday two days ago.
(c) He told Manoj that he had celebrated his birthday two days before.
(d) He told Manoj that he celebrated his birthday two days ago.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He told Manoj that he had celebrated his birthday two days before.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: celebrated → had celebrated, I → he, my → his, two days ago → two days before.
(Direct → Indirect: celebrated → had celebrated; ago → before।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "my birthday" – wrong pronoun; **(b)** "I celebrated" – not changed; **(d)** "celebrated ... ago" – wrong.

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Q.39 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Saaransh said he had solved the crossword the previous day.

(a) Saaransh said, "He has solved the crossword the previous day."
(b) Saaransh said, "I have solved the crossword the previous day."
(c) Saaransh said, "I solved the crossword yesterday."
(d) Saaransh said, "He have solved the crossword yesterday."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Saaransh said, "I solved the crossword yesterday."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had solved → solved, he → I, the previous day → yesterday.
(Indirect → Direct: had solved → solved; the previous day → yesterday।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "He has solved" – wrong pronoun/tense; **(b)** "I have solved ... previous day" – wrong; **(d)** "He have" – wrong.

Q.40 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The landlord said to me, "Did you pay the water bill on time?"

(a) The landlord asked me did I paid the water bill on time.
(b) The landlord asked to me that did I pay the water bill on time.
(c) The landlord asked me if I had paid the water bill on time.
(d) The landlord asked me if I paid the water bill on time.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The landlord asked me if I had paid the water bill on time.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: add **if**; **did you pay → I had paid**.
(Yes/No प्रश्न: if; did pay → had paid।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "did I paid" – wrong; **(b)** "asked to me that did" – wrong; **(d)** "if I paid" – wrong tense.

Q.41 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
I told my parents not to worry about me.

(a) I said to my parents, "You don't have to worry about me."
(b) I said to my parents, "Nothing to worry about me."
(c) I said to my parents, "You don't be worried about me."
(d) I said to my parents, "Don't worry about me."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I said to my parents, "Don't worry about me."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Negative Order)
Rule: "told ... not to worry" → direct negative command "**Don't worry ...**".
(निषेधात्मक आदेश: not to → "Don't + verb"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "You don't have to" – a statement; **(b)** "Nothing to worry" – wrong; **(c)** "You don't be worried" – wrong.

Q.42 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The supervisor said to the worker, "How long have you been working for this company?"

(a) The supervisor asked the worker how long he had been working for that company.
(b) The supervisor asked the worker how long had he being working for that company.
(c) The supervisor asked the worker for how long had he been working for this company.
(d) The supervisor asked the worker that how long you had been working for that company.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The supervisor asked the worker how long he had been working for that company.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: have been working → had been working, you → he, this → that.
(Direct → Indirect: have been → had been; this → that।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "had he being" – wrong; **(c)** keeps "this company"/question order; **(d)** "that how long you" – wrong.

Q.43 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
My neighbour said to me, "Hello! How are you?"

(a) My neighbour said hello and asked how are you.
(b) My neighbour said hello and asked how were I.
(c) My neighbour greeted me and asked how was I.
(d) My neighbour greeted me and asked how I was.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) My neighbour greeted me and asked how I was.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Greeting + Question)
Rule: "Hello!" → **greeted**; "How are you?" → asked **how I was** (assertive order, are → was, you → I).
(अभिवादन: greeted; are → was; you → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "how are you" – not changed; **(b)** "how were I" – wrong; **(c)** "how was I" – wrong order.

Q.44 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
She said to me, "Have you ever flown a kite?"

(a) She asked me if I ever flew a kite.
(b) She asked me if you have ever flown a kite.
(c) She asked me that had I ever flown a kite.
(d) She asked me if I had ever flown a kite.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She asked me if I had ever flown a kite.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: add **if**; **have flown → had flown**; **you → I**.
(Yes/No प्रश्न: if; have → had; you → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "if I ever flew" – wrong tense; **(b)** "if you have" – wrong pronoun; **(c)** "that had I" – wrong.

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Q.45 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to me, "Your father is waiting for you at the reception."

(a) He told me that his father was waiting for you at the reception.
(b) He told me that your father was waiting for him at the reception.
(c) He told me that my father was waiting for me at the reception.
(d) He told to me my father was waiting for you at the reception.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He told me that my father was waiting for me at the reception.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: is waiting → was waiting, your → my, you → me.
(Direct → Indirect: is → was; your → my; you → me।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "his father ... for you" – wrong; **(b)** "your father ... for him" – wrong; **(d)** "told to me" – wrong.

Q.46 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The teacher says, "Magnets attract objects made of iron."

(a) The teacher says that magnets attract objects made of iron.
(b) The teacher said that magnets were attracting objects made of iron.
(c) The teacher says magnets attracts objects made of iron.
(d) The teacher said that magnets attracted objects made of iron.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The teacher says that magnets attract objects made of iron.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Universal Truth)
Rule: With "says" (present) and a **scientific fact**, the tense does not change.
(वैज्ञानिक सत्य + "says" → tense नहीं बदलता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "were attracting" – wrong; **(c)** "attracts" – wrong agreement; **(d)** "attracted" – back-shifted.

Q.47 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
She told her brother that she was going to meet her friend.

(a) She said to her brother, "I was going to meet my friend."
(b) She said to her brother, "I am going to meet my friend."
(c) She said to her brother, "She will go to meet her friend."
(d) She said to her brother, "I am gone to meet her friend."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She said to her brother, "I am going to meet my friend."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: was going → am going, she → I, her → my.
(Indirect → Direct: was → am; her → my।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I was going" – tense not changed; **(c)** "She will go" – wrong pronoun; **(d)** "I am gone" – wrong form.

Q.48 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The Prime Minister has said, "The government will extend help to the unorganised sector."

(a) The Prime Minister has said that the government extended help to the unorganised sector.
(b) The Prime Minister said that the government would extend help to the unorganised sector.
(c) The Prime Minister has said that the government will extend help to the unorganised sector.
(d) The Prime Minister said that the government has extended help to the unorganised sector.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The Prime Minister has said that the government will extend help to the unorganised sector.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Present-Perfect Reporting Verb)
Rule: When the reporting verb is "**has said**" (present perfect), the tense of the reported speech does **not** back-shift → "will extend" stays.
(Reporting verb "has said" → tense नहीं बदलता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "extended" – wrongly changed; **(b)** "said ... would" – back-shifted; **(d)** "has extended" – wrong.

Q.49 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The young man prayed to God to help him clear that interview.

(a) The young man said, "O God! Help me clear this interview."
(b) The young man said, "O God! Help him to clear that interview."
(c) The young man said to God, "Will you help me clear that interview?"
(d) The young man said to God, "You have to help me clear that interview."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The young man said, "O God! Help me clear this interview."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Prayer)
Rule: "prayed to God to help him ..." → "O God! Help **me** clear **this** interview."; **him → me, that → this.**
(प्रार्थना: him → me; that → this।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "help him ... that" – not converted; **(c)** "Will you help" – a question; **(d)** "You have to help" – changes tone.

Q.50 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The policeman warned us not to block the traffic.

(a) The policeman said to us, "We should not block the traffic."
(b) The policeman said to us, "Let us not block the traffic."
(c) The policeman said to us, "You did not block the traffic."
(d) The policeman said to us, "Do not block the traffic."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The policeman said to us, "Do not block the traffic."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Warning/Order)

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Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "warned us not to block" → a direct negative command "**Do not block ...**".
(निषेधात्मक आदेश: not to → "Do not + verb"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "We should not" – a statement; **(b)** "Let us not" – suggestion; **(c)** "You did not" – past.

Q.51 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The doctor asked her what medicine she had taken then.

(a) The doctor said to her, "What medicine you have taken then?"
(b) The doctor said to her, "What were medicine you have taken then?"
(c) The doctor said to her, "What medicine have you taken now?"
(d) The doctor said to her, "What medicine you are taking now?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The doctor said to her, "What medicine have you taken now?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had taken → have taken, she → you, then → now; make it a question.
(Indirect → Direct: had taken → have taken; then → now।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "you have taken then?" – keeps "then"; **(b)** "What were medicine" – wrong; **(d)** "are taking" – wrong tense.

Q.52 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to his brother, "Pack your bags and leave now."

(a) He suggested his brother that he should pack his bags and leave then.
(b) He told his brother that pack your bags and leave now.
(c) He instructed his brother to pack his bags and leave then.
(d) He ordered his brother to pack your bags and leave now.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He instructed his brother to pack his bags and leave then.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Order)
Rule: An order → "**instructed + object + to + V1**"; **your → his, now → then**.
(आदेश: instructed + to + verb; now → then।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "suggested ... that he should" – wordy/wrong; **(b)** "told ... that pack your" – wrong; **(d)** keeps "your ... now".

Q.53 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
Mother said to her, "Paint the river blue."

(a) Mother asked her paint the river blue.
(b) Mother said her to paint the river blue.
(c) Mother told her to paint the river blue.
(d) Mother told to her paint the river blue.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Mother told her to paint the river blue.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Order)

Explanation (contd.)
Rule: A command → "**told + object + to + V1**".
(आदेश: told + object + to + verb।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "asked her paint" – missing "to"; **(b)** "said her to" – wrong; **(d)** "told to her paint" – wrong.

Q.54 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
Mahesh said to Priya, "How will you pay off your debts?"

(a) Mahesh asked Priya how she would pay off your debts.
(b) Mahesh asked Priya how she would pay off her debts.
(c) Mahesh asked Priya how will she pay off her debts.
(d) Mahesh asked Priya that how you will pay off your debts.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Mahesh asked Priya how she would pay off her debts.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: will → would, you → she, your → her; assertive order.
(Direct → Indirect: will → would; you → she; your → her।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "your"; **(c)** "how will she" – question order; **(d)** "that how you will" – wrong.

Q.55 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
I told him that if he went around the park he would see some rare flowers.

(a) I said to him, "If you go around the park you would saw some rare flowers."
(b) I said to him, "If you went around the park you would see some rare flowers."
(c) I said to him, "If he went around the park he will see some rare flowers."
(d) I said to him, "If you go around the park you will see some rare flowers."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I said to him, "If you go around the park you will see some rare flowers."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: went → go, would see → will see, he → you.
(Indirect → Direct: went → go; would → will; he → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "would saw" – wrong; **(b)** "went ... would see" – not changed; **(c)** "he went ... will" – wrong pronoun.

Q.56 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
She said, "I wish I could fly like a butterfly!"

(a) She wished that she could fly like a butterfly.
(b) She wished that I could fly like a butterfly.
(c) She exclaimed that could she fly like a butterfly.
(d) She exclaimed that she would fly like a butterfly.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She wished that she could fly like a butterfly.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wish)
Rule: "I wish ..." → "**wished that**"; **I → she**; "could fly" stays.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** keeps "I"; **(c)** "could she fly"; **(d)** "would fly" – wrong.

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Q.57 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Neha exclaimed that it was a very pleasant surprise.

(a) Neha said, "Is it a very pleasant surprise?"
(b) Neha said, "It is a very pleasant surprise."
(c) Neha said, "How a pleasant surprise!"
(d) Neha said, "What a pleasant surprise!"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Neha said, "What a pleasant surprise!"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Exclamatory)
Rule: "exclaimed that it was a very pleasant surprise" → "**What a pleasant surprise!**"
(Exclaimed that → "What a ...!")
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Is it ...?" – a question; **(b)** "It is ..." – not exclamatory; **(c)** "How a pleasant" – wrong form.

Q.58 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The shopkeeper apologised for the mistake he had made in his calculations.

(a) The shopkeeper said, "I apologised for the mistake that I make in my calculations."
(b) The shopkeeper said, "I apologise. I made a mistake in his calculations."
(c) The shopkeeper said, "I am sorry for the mistake that he makes in my calculations."
(d) The shopkeeper said, "I am sorry. I made a mistake in my calculations."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The shopkeeper said, "I am sorry. I made a mistake in my calculations."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "apologised for the mistake he had made" → "**I am sorry. I made a mistake ...**"; **his → my**.
(Indirect → Direct: apologised → "I am sorry"; his → my।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I apologised ... I make" – wrong tense; **(b)** "his calculations" – wrong pronoun; **(c)** "he makes ... my" – mixed.

Q.59 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
"Oh no! We have missed the flight," she said.

(a) She was sorry that they missed the flight.
(b) She exclaimed that we had missed the flight.
(c) She cried that we have missed the flight.
(d) She regretted that they had missed the flight.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She regretted that they had missed the flight.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Exclamatory/Regret)
Rule: "Oh no!" (regret) → "**regretted that**"; **have missed → had missed**, **we → they**.
(खेद: "Oh no!" → regretted that; have → had; we → they।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "missed" – tense not changed; **(b)** "we had missed" – wrong pronoun; **(c)** "we have missed" – wrong.

Q.60 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
He welcomed me and requested me to be seated.

(a) He said to me, "Be welcome. Please sit."
(b) He said to me, "Welcome and sit down."
(c) He said to me, "Welcome. Please be seated."
(d) He said to me, "Welcome. Please to be seated."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He said to me, "Welcome. Please be seated."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "welcomed me and requested me to be seated" → "**Welcome. Please be seated.**"
(Indirect → Direct: welcomed → Welcome; requested to be seated → "Please be seated"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Be welcome. Please sit" – changes words; **(b)** "sit down" – informal; **(d)** "Please to be seated" – wrong form.

Q.61 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
She suggested that we should distribute food among the needy.

(a) She said, "We could distribute food among the needy."
(b) She said, "Let us distribute food among the needy."
(c) She said, "Let them distribute food among the needy."
(d) She ordered, "Distribute food among the needy."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She said, "Let us distribute food among the needy."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Suggestion)
Rule: "suggested that we should ..." → "**Let us + V1**".
(सुझाव: suggested that we should → "Let us ..."।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "We could" – a statement; **(c)** "Let them" – wrong pronoun; **(d)** "ordered ... Distribute" – changes tone.

Q.62 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
She told me that she knew I wanted to help her but she could manage on her own.

(a) She said to me, "I know you want to help me but I can manage on my own."
(b) She said to me, "I knew you want to help her but I could manage on my own."
(c) She said to me, "I know I want to help you but you can manage on your own."
(d) She said to me, "I know you wanted to help me but she can manage on her own."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She said to me, "I know you want to help me but I can manage on my own."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: knew → know, **wanted → want**, **her → me**, **could → can**, **her own → my own**.
(Indirect → Direct: knew → know; could → can; her → me।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "help her" – wrong pronoun; **(c)** pronouns reversed; **(d)** "wanted ... she can" – wrong.

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Q.63 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The little girl said, "This bicycle is mine."

(a) The little girl said that this bicycle is mine.
(b) The little girl said that this bicycle is hers.
(c) The little girl said that bicycle was her.
(d) The little girl said that that bicycle was hers.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The little girl said that that bicycle was hers.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: this → that, is → was, mine → hers.
(Direct → Indirect: this → that; is → was; mine → hers।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "this ... is mine" – not changed; **(b)** "this ... is hers" – tense not changed; **(c)** "was her" – wrong pronoun.

Q.64 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The doctor said to Anita, "Are you feeling better now?"

(a) The doctor asked to Anita if she was feeling better now.
(b) The doctor asked Anita that if she were feeling better now.
(c) The doctor asked Anita was she was feeling better then.
(d) The doctor asked Anita if she was feeling better then.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The doctor asked Anita if she was feeling better then.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: add **if**; **are feeling → was feeling**, **you → she**, **now → then**.
(Yes/No प्रश्न: if; are → was; now → then।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "asked to Anita"; **(b)** "that if she were"; **(c)** "was she was" – all wrong.

Q.65 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Rahul said that he had slipped and fallen on the marshy land.

(a) Rahul said, "He have slipped and fallen on the marshy land."
(b) Rahul said, "I slipped and fallen on the marshy land."
(c) Rahul said, "He slips and falls on the marshy land."
(d) Rahul said, "I slipped and fell on the marshy land."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Rahul said, "I slipped and fell on the marshy land."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had slipped and fallen → slipped and fell, he → I.
(Indirect → Direct: had + V3 → V2; he → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "He have slipped" – wrong; **(b)** "I slipped and fallen" – wrong form; **(c)** "He slips" – present.

Q.66 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
I said to the office boy, "Take these papers to the manager immediately."

(a) I told the office boy take those papers to the manager immediately.
(b) I ordered the office boy to take those papers to the manager immediately.
(c) I said to the office boy to take these papers to the manager immediately.
(d) I requested the office boy to take these papers to the manager immediately.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) I ordered the office boy to take those papers to the manager immediately.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Order)
Rule: A command → "**ordered + object + to + V1**"; **these → those**.
(आदेश: ordered + to + verb; these → those।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "told ... take" – missing "to"; **(c)** "said to ... to take these" – keeps "these"; **(d)** "requested" – changes tone.

Q.67 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to me, "Where did you go to collect the flower samples?"

(a) He asked me where I had gone to collect the flower samples.
(b) He asked to me that where did I go to collect the flower samples.
(c) He asked me that where did I went to collect the flower samples.
(d) He asked me where did you go to collect the flower samples.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He asked me where I had gone to collect the flower samples.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: did you go → I had gone; assertive order.
(Direct → Indirect: did go → had gone; you → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "asked to me that where"; **(c)** "where did I went"; **(d)** "where did you go" – all wrong.

Q.68 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
My teacher says, "We must take care of our hygiene."

(a) My teacher says that we must take care of our hygiene.
(b) My teacher said that we must be taking care of our hygiene.
(c) My teacher said they took care of their hygiene.
(d) My teacher says that we took care of our hygiene.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) My teacher says that we must take care of our hygiene.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Present Reporting Verb)
Rule: With "**says**" (present), the tense does not change.
(Reporting verb "says" → tense नहीं बदलता।)

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Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "said ... must be taking"; **(c)** "took"; **(d)** "took" – all wrongly change the tense.

Q.69 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
I prayed that his mother might recover soon.

(a) I said, "May your mother recover soon!"
(b) I said, "Might his mother soon recover."
(c) I say, "Your mother may recover soon."
(d) I said, "Oh God! Your mother may recover soon."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I said, "May your mother recover soon!"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Optative)
Rule: "prayed that his mother might recover" → optative "**May your mother recover soon!**"; **his → your**.
(प्रार्थना: might → May ...!; his → your।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "Might his mother" – wrong; **(c)** "may recover" – changes; **(d)** adds words.

Q.70 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
She said, "However hard it rains, I have to go to work."

(a) She said that however hard it rained, she had to go to work.
(b) She said that even if it rains hard, she had to go to work.
(c) She said that however hard it may rained, she have to go to work.
(d) She said that however hard it might rain, she has to go to work.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She said that however hard it rained, she had to go to work.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: rains → rained, have → had, I → she.
(Direct → Indirect: rains → rained; have → had; I → she।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "even if it rains"; **(c)** "may rained ... have"; **(d)** "might rain ... has" – all wrong.

Q.71 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to me, "How delighted I am to see your work!"

(a) He told me that how he was delighted to see my work.
(b) He exclaimed that he is very delighted to see your work.
(c) He said that how very delighted he was to see my work.
(d) He exclaimed that he was very delighted to see my work.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He exclaimed that he was very delighted to see my work.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Exclamatory)
Rule: "How delighted I am ...!" → "**exclaimed that he was very delighted**"; **your → my**.
(Exclamatory: exclaimed that ...; am → was; your → my।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "how he was"; **(b)** "he is ... your"; **(c)** "how very delighted" – all wrong.

Q.72 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Father asked her if there was anything else she wished for.

(a) Father said to her, "There was anything else you wished for?"
(b) Father said to her, "Was there anything else she wished for?"
(c) Father said to her, "Is there anything else you wish for?"
(d) Father said to her, "Is there anything else she had wished for?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Father said to her, "Is there anything else you wish for?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: was → is, she → you; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: was → is; she → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "There was anything"; **(b)** "Was there ... she"; **(d)** "she had wished" – all wrong.

Q.73 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The teacher said to Anu, "I am very disappointed with your work."

(a) The teacher told Anu that I was very disappointed with her work.
(b) The teacher told Anu that she was very disappointed with her work.
(c) The teacher said that Anu I am very disappointed with your work.
(d) The teacher told Anu that she were very disappointed with her work.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The teacher told Anu that she was very disappointed with her work.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: am → was, I → she, your → her.
(Direct → Indirect: am → was; I → she; your → her।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I was ... her"; **(c)** "said that Anu I am"; **(d)** "she were" – all wrong.

Q.74 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
She asked her mother why she was so upset that day.

(a) She said to her mother, "Why were you so upset that day?"
(b) She said to her mother, "Are you upset today?"
(c) She said to her mother, "Why you are so upset today?"
(d) She said to her mother, "Why are you so upset today?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She said to her mother, "Why are you so upset today?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: was → are, she → you, that day → today; make it a question.
(Indirect → Direct: was → are; she → you; that day → today।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Why were you ... that day"; **(b)** changes words; **(c)** "Why you are" – wrong order.

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Q.75 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The old woman said to her neighbour, "Please buy some vegetables for me tomorrow."

(a) The old woman requested to her neighbour to please buy some vegetables for her tomorrow.
(b) The old woman requested her neighbour to buy some vegetables for her the next day.
(c) The old woman told her neighbour that buy some vegetables for me tomorrow.
(d) The old woman ordered her neighbour to buy some vegetables for me the next day.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The old woman requested her neighbour to buy some vegetables for her the next day.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Request)
Rule: "Please buy ..." → "**requested ... to buy**"; **me** → **her**, **tomorrow** → **the next day**.
(निवेदन: requested to + verb; tomorrow → the next day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "requested to ... please"; **(c)** "that buy ... me"; **(d)** "ordered ... for me tomorrow" – wrong.

Q.76 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
"Please wait for me at the coffee shop in case I am late," said Reema to her friend.

(a) Reema told her friend to wait for her at the coffee shop in case I am late.
(b) Reema told to her friend wait for her at the coffee shop in case she were late.
(c) Reema told her friend wait for me at the coffee shop in case I am late.
(d) Reema told her friend to wait for her at the coffee shop in case she was late.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Reema told her friend to wait for her at the coffee shop in case she was late.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Request)
Rule: "Please wait ..." → "**told ... to wait**"; **me** → **her**, **I am** → **she was**.
(निवेदन: told to + verb; I am → she was।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I am late"; **(b)** "told to ... were late" – wrong; **(c)** keeps "wait for me ... I am".

Q.77 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
I said to him angrily, "Get out and don't dare to come here again."

(a) I ordered him that get out and not dare to come here again.
(b) I ordered him get out and don't dare to come there again.
(c) I ordered him to get out and not dare to come there again.
(d) I ordered him to get out and don't dare to come here again.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I ordered him to get out and not dare to come there again.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Order)
Rule: A command → "**ordered ... to + V1**"; negative → "**not to / not dare**"; **here** → **there**.
(आदेश: ordered to + verb; here → there।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "that get out"; **(b)** "get out and don't"; **(d)** keeps "don't ... here" – all wrong.

Q.78 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
Suman said to Meeta, "I have been invited to the show but I will not be able to go."

(a) Suman told Meeta that she has been invited to the show but I will not be able to go.
(b) Suman told to Meeta that I was being invited to the show but I would not be able to go.
(c) Suman told Meeta that she had invited to the show but she will not be able to go.
(d) Suman told Meeta that she had been invited to the show but she would not be able to go.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Suman told Meeta that she had been invited to the show but she would not be able to go.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: have been invited → **had been invited**, **will** → **would**, **I** → **she**.
(Direct → Indirect: have been → had been; will → would; I → she।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I will"; **(b)** "told to ... I was being"; **(c)** "she had invited" – wrong voice.

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Q.79 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
I asked him if it had never occurred to him that he was in the wrong profession.

(a) I said to him, "Has it never occurred to you that he was the wrong profession?"
(b) I said to him, "Have it never occurred to you that he is in the wrong profession?"
(c) I said to him, "Does it never occur to you that you are in the wrong profession?"
(d) I said to him, "Has it never occurred to you that you are in the wrong profession?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I said to him, "Has it never occurred to you that you are in the wrong profession?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Yes/No Question)
Rule: had occurred → Has ... occurred, him → you, was → are; direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: had → has; him → you; was → are।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "he was ... the wrong"; **(b)** "Have it"; **(c)** "Does it never occur" – all wrong.

Q.80 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
Rita said to her friend, "My sister is performing on stage today for the first time."

(a) Rita told her friend that my sister was performing on stage today for the first time.
(b) Rita told her friend that her sister was performing on stage that day for the first time.
(c) Rita told to her friend that her sister is performing on stage that day for the first time.
(d) Rita said to her friend that my sister is performing on stage today for the first time.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Rita told her friend that her sister was performing on stage that day for the first time.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: is performing → was performing, my → her, today → that day.
(Direct → Indirect: is → was; my → her; today → that day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "my ... today"; **(c)** "told to ... is performing" – wrong; **(d)** not converted.

Q.81 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The teacher said to the students, "Jupiter is the largest planet."

(a) The teacher told the students that Jupiter is the largest planet.
(b) The teacher told to the students that Jupiter was the largest planet.
(c) The teacher said students Jupiter is the largest planet.
(d) The teacher says to the students that Jupiter was the largest planet.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The teacher told the students that Jupiter is the largest planet.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Universal Truth)
Rule: A **scientific fact** does not change its tense in indirect speech.
(वैज्ञानिक सत्य का tense नहीं बदलता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "was" – wrongly back-shifted; **(c)** "said students"; **(d)** "says ... was" – wrong.

Q.82 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The man said that he had been walking down the road with his guide dog.

(a) The man said, "I am walking down the road with my guide dog."
(b) The man said, "I walked down the road with his guide dog."
(c) The man said, "I was walking down the road with my guide dog."
(d) The man said, "He were walking down the road with his guide dog."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The man said, "I was walking down the road with my guide dog."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had been walking → was walking, he → I, his → my.
(Indirect → Direct: had been walking → was walking; his → my।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "am walking" – wrong tense; **(b)** "walked ... his" – wrong; **(d)** "He were" – wrong.

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Q.83 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The teacher ordered the students to go straight to their classrooms.

(a) The teacher said to the students, "Please go straight to your classrooms."
(b) " Go straight to their classrooms," the teacher said to the students.
(c) The teacher said, "Students, to go straight to their classrooms."
(d) " Go straight to your classrooms," the teacher said to the students.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) " Go straight to your classrooms," the teacher said to the students.
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Order)
Rule: "ordered ... to go straight to their classrooms" → direct command "**Go straight to your classrooms**"; **their → your**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** adds "Please"; **(b)** keeps "their"; **(c)** "to go ... their" – wrong.

Q.84 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
"Please lend me some money, Raman. I need it urgently," said Sumesh.

(a) Sumesh requested Raman to lend me some money as I needed it urgently.
(b) Sumesh requested to Raman to please lend him some money as he needed it urgently.
(c) Sumesh requested Raman please lend me some money as I need it urgently.
(d) Sumesh requested Raman to lend him some money as he needed it urgently.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Sumesh requested Raman to lend him some money as he needed it urgently.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Request)
Rule: "Please lend me ..." → "**requested ... to lend him**"; **me → him**, **I need → he needed**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "lend me ... I needed"; **(b)** "to Raman to please"; **(c)** "please lend me ... I need" – wrong.

Q.85 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Raghav said to Meera, "Are you upset with me?"

(a) Raghav asked Meera if she was upset with her.
(b) Raghav asked Meera why she was upset with him.
(c) Raghav asked Meera if she was upset with him.
(d) Raghav asked Meera if she was upset with me.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Raghav asked Meera if she was upset with him.
Rules for changing interrogative sentences from direct to indirect form.'said to' is changed to asked, questioned, etc according to the situation.The sentence is not in the interrogative form in the indirect speech.Tense and pronouns are changed according to rules.

Q.86 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Her parents asked her if the match proposed by them would be acceptable to her.

(a) Her parents said her, "Will the match proposed by us be acceptable to you?"
(b) Her parents said her, "Would the match proposed by them be acceptable to her?"
(c) Her parents said to her, "Will the match proposed by us be acceptable to you?"
(d) Her parents said to her, "Was the match proposed by them acceptable to her?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Her parents said to her, "Will the match proposed by us be acceptable to you?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Yes/No Question)
Rule: "asked her" → "**said to her**"; back-shift reversed: **would → will**, **them → us**, **her → you**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "said her"; **(b)** "would ... them ... her"; **(d)** "Was ... her" – wrong.

Q.87 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
She said to her mother, "May I have another slice of cake?"

(a) She asked her mother if she may have another slice of cake.
(b) She asked her mother that may I have another slice of cake.
(c) She asked her mother if she might have another slice of cake.
(d) She asked her mother that may she have another slice of cake.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She asked her mother if she might have another slice of cake.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Permission)
Rule: "May I ...?" → "**asked ... if she might have**" (may → might; question → 'if').
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "if she may"; **(b)/(d)** keep "that may" – wrong.

Q.88 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
She asked if she could help him with his packing.

(a) She said, "May I help you with your packing?"
(b) She said, "Can I help you with your packing?"
(c) She said, "Could I help him with your packing?"
(d) She said, "Should you help me with my packing?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She said, "Can I help you with your packing?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "asked if she could help him" → "**Can I help you ...?**" (could → can, she → I, him/his → you/your).
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "May I"; **(c)** "help him with your"; **(d)** "Should you help me" – wrong.

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Q.89 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
The investigator asked me, "Did you see or hear anything in the dead of night?"

(a) The investigator asked me if I saw or heard anything in the dead of night.
(b) The investigator asked me if I see or hear anything in the dead of night.
(c) The investigator asked me if I had seen or heard anything in the dead of night.
(d) The investigator asked me that if I had seen or heard anything in the dead of night.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The investigator asked me if I had seen or heard anything in the dead of night.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: "Did you see or hear ...?" → "**asked ... if I had seen or heard ...**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "if I saw"; **(b)** "if I see"; **(d)** "that if I had" – wrong.

Q.90 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Mother said that when we pluck a flower it dies so we should let it beautify the world as long as it lives.

(a) Mother said, "When we pluck a flower it dies so you should let it beautify the world as long as it lived."
(b) Mother said, "When we pluck a flower it dies so we should let it beautify the world as long as it lives."
(c) Mother says, "When we pluck a flower it dies so we should let it beautify the world as long as it lives."
(d) Mother said, "When we plucked a flower it died so we should let it beautify the world as long as it lived."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Mother said, "When we pluck a flower it dies so we should let it beautify the world as long as it lives."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Universal Truth)
Rule: The general truth stays in the present, and "we" stays "we": "When we pluck a flower it dies so **we should let it beautify the world as long as it lives**."
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "you ... lived"; **(c)** "says"; **(d)** "plucked ... died" – wrong.

Q.91 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
My brother said to me, "Don't play in the rain."

(a) My brother refused me to not play in the rain.
(b) My brother forbade me to play in the rain.
(c) My brother said to me don't play in the rain.
(d) My brother assured me not to play in the rain.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) My brother forbade me to play in the rain.
the correct word to use here is forbade. So, option (b) is correct.

Q.92 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Smriti greeted me and asked me where I was working then.

(a) Smriti said to me, "Hello! Where are you working now?"
(b) Smriti said to me, "Hello! Where I was working then?"
(c) Smriti said to me, "Hello! Where were you working then?"
(d) Smriti said to me, "Hello! Where you are working now?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Smriti said to me, "Hello! Where are you working now?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "greeted me" → "**Hello!**"; "asked me where I was working then" → "**Where are you working now?**" (was → are, then → now).
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "Where I was working"; **(c)** "were you working then"; **(d)** "you are working now" – wrong.

Q.93 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
The old man said, "I was walking in my garden at six o'clock."

(a) The old man said that he had been walking in his garden at six o'clock.
(b) The old man said that I had been walking in my garden at six o'clock.
(c) The old man said that I was been walking in my garden at six o'clock.
(d) The old man said that he was walking in his garden at six o'clock.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The old man said that he had been walking in his garden at six o'clock.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: I → **he**, **my** → **his**; "was walking" → "**had been walking**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** keeps "I ... my"; **(c)** "was been walking"; **(d)** "was walking" – wrong.

Q.94 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
My sister suggested that we go for a walk in the fresh air.

(a) My sister said, "We shall go for a walk in the fresh air."
(b) My sister said, "Go for a walk in the fresh air."
(c) My sister said, "Let me go for a walk in the fresh air."
(d) My sister said, "Let us go for a walk in the fresh air."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) My sister said, "Let us go for a walk in the fresh air."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Suggestion)
Rule: "suggested that we go" → a suggestion in direct speech uses "**Let us ...**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "We shall go"; **(b)** an order; **(c)** "Let me go" – wrong.

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Q.95 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Harry said to me, "Don't wear this expensive watch to school."

(a) Harry told me to not wear this expensive watch to school.
(b) Harry told me that don't wear that expensive watch to school.
(c) Harry told me not to wear that expensive watch to school.
(d) Harry told me that not to wear that expensive watch to school.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Harry told me not to wear that expensive watch to school.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Negative Command)
Rule: "Don't wear ..." → "**told me not to wear**"; **this → that**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "to not wear this"; **(b)/(d)** keep "that don't/not to" – wrong.

Q.96 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
My friend asked me where I planned to go for a vacation.

(a) My friend said to me, "Where do you plan to go for a vacation?"
(b) My friend said to me, "Where are you planning to go for a vacation?"
(c) My friend said to me, "Where have you planned to go for a vacation?"
(d) My friend said to me, "Where you have planned to go for a vacation?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) My friend said to me, "Where do you plan to go for a vacation?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Wh-question)
Rule: "asked where I planned" → "**Where do you plan ...?**" (planned → plan; I → you).
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "are you planning"; **(c)** "have you planned"; **(d)** no auxiliary – wrong.

Q.97 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
She said, "It is my birthday next week."

(a) She said that my birthday was next week.
(b) She said that it was her birthday the following week.
(c) She said that it is my birthday the following week.
(d) She said that next week was her birthday.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She said that it was her birthday the following week.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: is → was, **my → her**, **next week → the following week**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "my birthday was"; **(c)** "is my ... following"; **(d)** "next week was" – wrong.

Q.98 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The commander ordered the soldiers to march ahead and not to think of their enemy's large numbers.

(a) The commander said to the soldiers, "March ahead. Do not think of your enemy's large numbers."
(b) The commander said to the soldiers, "March ahead. Do not think of their enemy's large numbers."
(c) The commander said to the soldiers, "Please march ahead. Do not think of your enemy's large numbers."
(d) The commander said to the soldiers, "March ahead and not think of their enemy's large numbers."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The commander said to the soldiers, "March ahead. Do not think of your enemy's large numbers."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Order)
Rule: "ordered ... to march ... not to think ..." → commands; **their → your**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)/(d)** keep "their"; **(c)** adds "Please" – wrong.

Q.99 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Raza requested his parents to forgive him that time and promised never to play truant again.

(a) Raza said to his parents, "Please forgive me that time. I promise to never play truant again."
(b) Raza said to his parents, "Please forgive me this time. I promise never to play truant again."
(c) Raza said to his parents, "Forgive me that time. I promise I would never play truant again."
(d) Raza said to his parents, "Forgive me this time. I promised never to play truant again."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Raza said to his parents, "Please forgive me this time. I promise never to play truant again."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Request)
Rule: "requested ... to forgive him that time" → "**Please forgive me this time**"; **that time → this time**; keep present "I promise".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "that time ... to never"; **(c)** "Forgive me that time ... would"; **(d)** "this time ... promised" – wrong.

Q.100 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.Joey said to the girl, "How are you doing?"

(a) Joey asked the girl how was she doing.
(b) Joey asked the girl if she was doing fine.
(c) Joey asked the girl how she was doing.
(d) Joey asked the girl that how was she doing.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Joey asked the girl how she was doing.
Rules for changing interrogative sentences from direct to indirect form.
'said to' - asked, questioned, inquired, or interrogated based on what is said in the sentence,

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Q.101 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The little boy asked his teacher if she had always been good as a child.

(a) The little boy said to his teacher, "Ma'am, always you were good as a child?"
(b) The little boy said to his teacher, "You have always been good as a child?"
(c) The little boy said to his teacher, "Ma'am, were you always good as a child?"
(d) The little boy said to his teacher, "Are you always good as a child?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The little boy said to his teacher, "Ma'am, were you always good as a child?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Yes/No Question)
Rule: "asked ... if she had always been" → "**Were you always good as a child?**" (reverse the back-shift).
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "always you were"; **(b)** "You have always been"; **(d)** "Are you always" – wrong.

Q.102 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
The librarian said, "Let no student be issued a book till next week."

(a) The librarian said that no student was to be issued a book till the following week.
(b) The librarian said that no student is to be issued a book till next week.
(c) The librarian said that no student will be issued a book till the following week.
(d) The librarian said that let no student be issued a book till next week.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The librarian said that no student was to be issued a book till the following week.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Let)
Rule: "Let no student be issued ..." → "**no student was to be issued ...**"; **next week → the following week**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "is to be ... next week"; **(c)** "will be"; **(d)** keeps "let".

Q.103 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
He said that his new slippers were very comfortable.

(a) He said, "His new slippers were very comfortable."
(b) He said, "His new slippers have been very comfortable."
(c) He said, "My new slippers are very comfortable."
(d) He said, "My new slippers were very comfortable."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He said, "My new slippers are very comfortable."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: his → my, were → are.
(Indirect → Direct: his → my; were → are।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "His new slippers were"; **(b)** "His ... have been"; **(d)** "My ... were" – wrong.

Q.104 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
The children said to the nurse, "Reema slipped and fell from the stairs."

(a) The children told to the nurse that Reema slipped and fallen from the stairs.
(b) The children told the nurse Reema has slipped and fallen from the stairs.
(c) The children told the nurse that Reema slipped and fell from the stairs.
(d) The children told the nurse that Reema had slipped and fallen from the stairs.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The children told the nurse that Reema had slipped and fallen from the stairs.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: "slipped and fell" → "**had slipped and fallen**"; "said to" → "**told**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "told to ... slipped and fallen"; **(b)** "has slipped"; **(c)** "slipped and fell" – tense not shifted.

Q.105 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
The Chief Minister said, "All exams shall be cancelled this year."

(a) The Chief Minister said that all exams should have been cancelled that year.
(b) The Chief Minister said that all exams should be cancelled this year.
(c) The Chief Minister said that all exams would be cancelled that year.
(d) The Chief Minister says that all exams shall be cancelled this year.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The Chief Minister said that all exams would be cancelled that year.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: shall → would, this year → that year.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "should have been"; **(b)** "should be ... this year"; **(d)** "says ... shall" – wrong.

Q.106 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
She said to them, "Don't smoke here."

(a) She told them not to smoke there.
(b) She asked them to smoke somewhere else.
(c) She told them do not smoke here.
(d) She asked them to not smoke here.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She told them not to smoke there.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Negative Order)
Rule: "Don't smoke ..." → "**told ... not to smoke**"; **here → there**.
(निषेधात्मक आदेश: not to + verb; here → there।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "to smoke somewhere else" – changes meaning; **(c)** "do not smoke here"; **(d)** "to not smoke here" – wrong.

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Q.107 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
The teacher says, "Every action has an equal and opposite reaction."

(a) The teacher said that every action has an equal and opposite reaction.
(b) The teacher says every action had an equal and opposite reaction.
(c) The teacher says that every action has an equal and opposite reaction.
(d) The teacher said that every action had an equal and opposite reaction.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The teacher says that every action has an equal and opposite reaction.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Universal Truth)
Rule: Reporting verb is present ("says"), and it is a **universal truth**, so the tense does **not** change.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)/(d)** "said ... had"; **(b)** no "that" and "had" – wrong.

Q.108 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Father told the children that there was some good news for them that day.

(a) Father said to the children, "There was some good news for you today."
(b) Father said to the children, "There is some good news for you today."
(c) Father said to the children, "There had been some good news for them that day."
(d) Father said to the children, "There was some good news for them that day."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Father said to the children, "There is some good news for you today."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: Reverse the back-shift: **was → is**, **them → you**, **that day → today**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was ... today"; **(c)** "had been ... them that day"; **(d)** "was ... them" – wrong.

Q.109 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
She said, "I am going home tomorrow."

(a) She said that she was going home tomorrow.
(b) She said that she was going home the next day.
(c) She said that she is going home the next day.
(d) She said that I was going home the next day.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She said that she was going home the next day.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: am going → was going, **I → she**, **tomorrow → the next day**.
(Direct → Indirect: am → was; tomorrow → the next day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "tomorrow"; **(c)** "is going" – tense not changed; **(d)** keeps "I".

Q.110 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
The old man said to her, "Good luck to you! May you succeed in your venture!"

(a) The old man wished her good luck and prayed that she might succeed in her venture.
(b) The old man exclaimed good luck to you and wished that she may succeed in her venture.
(c) The old man told her good luck and prayed that may she succeed in her venture.
(d) The old man wished you good luck and prayed that you might succeed in your venture.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The old man wished her good luck and prayed that she might succeed in her venture.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Optative)
Rule: "Good luck!" → "**wished her good luck**"; "May you succeed" → "**prayed that she might succeed**"; **you → she, your → her**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "exclaimed good luck to you"; **(c)** "may she"; **(d)** keeps "you ... your".

Q.111 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
The captain announced, "The flight will be delayed due to bad weather."

(a) The captain announced that the flight would be delay due to bad weather.
(b) The captain announced that the flight will be delayed due to bad weather.
(c) The captain announced that the flight would be delayed due to bad weather.
(d) The captain announced that the fight was delayed due to bad weather.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The captain announced that the flight would be delayed due to bad weather.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: will → would; keep "delayed". "announced that the flight **would be delayed**".
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "would be delay"; **(b)** "will be"; **(d)** "was delayed / fight" – wrong.

Q.112 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.I said to Mohan, "He has a green book."

(a) I told Mohan that he has a green book.
(b) I told Mohan that he have a green book.
(c) I told Mohan that he had had a green book.
(d) I told Mohan that he had a green book.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I told Mohan that he had a green book.
The present perfect tense in direct speech is changed to past perfect tense in indirect speech. So, option (d) is the correct answer.

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Q.113 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The actor said that what he did in films was something he had never attempted in real life.

(a) The actor said, "What I am doing in films is something I have never attempted in real life."
(b) The actor said, "What he did in films is something he has never attempted in real life."
(c) The actor said, "What he did in films was something he had never attempted in real life."
(d) The actor said, "What I do in films is something I have never attempted in real life."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The actor said, "What I do in films is something I have never attempted in real life."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: Reverse the back-shift: **did → do**, **had never attempted → have never attempted**, **he → I**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "am doing ... have"; **(b)** "he did ... has"; **(c)** keeps "he ... had" – wrong.

Q.114 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The students asked how they would benefit from online classes.

(a) The students said, "How will we benefit from online classes?"
(b) The students said, "How will they be benefited from online classes?"
(c) The students said, "How we would benefit from online classes?"
(d) The students said, "How they will benefit from online classes?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The students said, "How will we benefit from online classes?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Wh-question)
Rule: "asked how they would benefit" → "**How will we benefit ...?**" (would → will, they → we).
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "will they be benefited"; **(c)** "How we would"; **(d)** "they will" – wrong.

Q.115 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.She asked, "Are you meeting my partners next week?"

(a) She asked if we were meeting her partners the following week.
(b) She asked about our meeting her partners next week.
(c) She asked if we were meeting her partners next week.
(d) She asked if we meet her partners next week.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She asked if we were meeting her partners the following week.
Rules for changing interrogative sentences from direct to indirect form.
'said to' - asked, questioned, inquired, or interrogated based on what is said in the sentence,

Q.116 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Harsh said, "How happy I am to receive the best student award!"

(a) Harsh exclaimed happily that I am very happy to receive the best student award.
(b) Harsh exclaimed happily that he was receiving the best student award.
(c) Harsh exclaimed with joy that how happy he was to receive the best student award.
(d) Harsh exclaimed with joy that he was very happy to receive the best student award.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Harsh exclaimed with joy that he was very happy to receive the best student award.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Exclamatory)
Rule: "How happy I am!" → "**exclaimed with joy that he was very happy**"; **I → he**, **am → was**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I am"; **(b)** "was receiving"; **(c)** keeps "how happy" – wrong.

Q.117 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Mother told Avika that those flowers were not to be thrown that day.

(a) Mother said to Avika, "Don't throw those flowers today."
(b) Mother said to Avika, "Those flowers were not to be thrown that day."
(c) Mother said to Avika, "These flowers were not to be thrown that day."
(d) Mother said to Avika, "These flowers are not to be thrown today."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Mother said to Avika, "These flowers are not to be thrown today."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: those → these, **were → are**, **that day → today**.
(Indirect → Direct: those → these; were → are; that day → today।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Don't throw those ... today"; **(b)** keeps "those ... were ... that day"; **(c)** "were ... that day".

Q.118 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.Harry said that he would not be in town on Friday.

(a) Harry said, "I must not be in town on Friday".
(b) Harry said, "I can't be in town on Friday".
(c) Harry said, "I will not be in town on Friday".
(d) Harry saying, "I will not be in town on Friday".

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Harry said, "I will not be in town on Friday".
Would cannot change to can or must. So, option (a) and b are incorrect.
Said will remain said and cannot change to saying. Hence, option (c) is the correct answer.

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Q.119 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
She asked if anyone had found her brooch.

(a) She said, "Does anyone find my brooch?"
(b) She said, "If anyone has found her brooch?"
(c) She said, "Has anyone found my brooch?"
(d) She said, "Is any one finding her brooch?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She said, "Has anyone found my brooch?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Yes/No Question)
Rule: "asked if anyone had found her brooch" → "**Has anyone found my brooch?**"; **had** → **has**, **her** → **my**.
(Indirect → Direct: had → has; her → my।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Does anyone find"; **(b)** "If anyone has found her"; **(d)** "Is anyone finding her" – wrong.

Q.120 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The officer informed his boss that his men were leaving the next day by plane.

(a) The officer said to his boss, "Your men were leaving tomorrow by plane."
(b) The officer said to his boss, "His men are leaving the next day by plane."
(c) The officer said to his boss, "My men are leaving tomorrow by plane."
(d) The officer said to his boss, "His men were leaving the next day by plane."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The officer said to his boss, "My men are leaving tomorrow by plane."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: were leaving → are leaving, his → my, the next day → tomorrow.
(Indirect → Direct: were → are; his → my; the next day → tomorrow।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Your men were"; **(b)** "His men are ... the next day"; **(d)** "His men were" – wrong.

Q.121 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Anju said to me, "What are you doing next weekend?"

(a) Anju asked me what I was doing the following weekend.
(b) Anju asked me what are you doing next weekend.
(c) Anju asked me what I had done the following weekend.
(d) Anju asked me what I am doing the coming weekend.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Anju asked me what I was doing the following weekend.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: are doing → was doing, you → I, next weekend → the following weekend.
(Direct → Indirect: are → was; next → the following।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** keeps question order; **(c)** "had done"; **(d)** "I am doing" – wrong tense.

Q.122 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
"I finished my assignment two hours ago," she said.

(a) She said that she finished my assignment two hours ago.
(b) She said that she has finished her assignment two hours ago.
(c) She said that I finished my assignment two hours before.
(d) She said that she had finished her assignment two hours before.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She said that she had finished her assignment two hours before.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: finished → had finished, my → her, ago → before.
(Direct → Indirect: finished → had finished; ago → before।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "finished my ... ago"; **(b)** "has finished ... ago"; **(c)** keeps "I finished my".

Q.123 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The fisherman asked his contractor if those salmons were to go on that morning's fish train.

(a) The fisherman said to his contractor, "Are these salmons to go on this morning's fish train?"
(b) The fisherman said to his contractor, "Are those salmons going on that morning's fish train?"
(c) The fisherman said to his contractor, "Is those salmons to go on this morning's fish train?"
(d) The fisherman said to his contractor, "Were these salmons to go on that morning's fish train?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The fisherman said to his contractor, "Are these salmons to go on this morning's fish train?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Yes/No Question)
Rule: those → these, that morning → this morning; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: those → these; that → this।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** keeps "those ... that morning"; **(c)** "Is those"; **(d)** "Were these ... that morning".

Q.124 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.The mother said that the kids were playing.

(a) The mother told, "The kids had been playing".
(b) The mother has said, "The kids were playing".
(c) The mother said, "The kids are playing".
(d) The mother said, "The kids have been playing".

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The mother said, "The kids are playing".
When transformation is from indirect to direct speech, the past continuous tense is changed to present continuous tense. So, option (a) and option (d) cannot be correct. option (b) is incorrect because of 'has said'. So, option (c) is the correct answer.

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Q.125 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
"Good gracious! It's snowing!" he said.

(a) He remarked that it is snowing.
(b) He happily said that it is snowing.
(c) He said that good gracious it's snowing.
(d) He exclaimed with astonishment that it was snowing.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He exclaimed with astonishment that it was snowing.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Exclamatory)
Rule: "Good gracious!" (surprise) → "**exclaimed with astonishment that**"; **is → was**.
(विस्मय: exclaimed with astonishment; is → was।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is snowing"; **(b)** "happily said ... is"; **(c)** "good gracious it's" – wrong.

Q.126 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Mary says, "My younger brother wants to be a radio jockey."

(a) Mary said that her younger brother wanted to be a radio jockey.
(b) Mary says that my younger brother wanted to be a radio jockey.
(c) Mary says that my younger brother wants to be a radio jockey.
(d) Mary says that her younger brother wants to be a radio jockey.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Mary says that her younger brother wants to be a radio jockey.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Present Reporting Verb)
Rule: With "**says**" (present), the tense does not change; **my → her**.
(Reporting verb "says" → tense नहीं बदलता; my → her।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "said ... wanted"; **(b)** keeps "my ... wanted"; **(c)** keeps "my".

Q.127 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Rahul said to his mother, "When will you come back?"

(a) Rahul asked his mother when would you come back.
(b) Rahul told his mother to come back.
(c) Rahul asked his mother when she would come back.
(d) Rahul asked his mother whether she was coming back.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Rahul asked his mother when she would come back.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: will → would, you → she; assertive order.
(Direct → Indirect: will → would; you → she।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "when would you"; **(b)** "to come back"; **(d)** "whether she was coming" – wrong.

Q.128 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The doctor advised her to keep off the sweets for a while.

(a) The doctor said to her, "She must keep off the sweets for a while."
(b) The doctor said to her, "Keep off the sweets for a while."
(c) The doctor asked her, "Why don't you keep off the sweets for a while?"
(d) The doctor said to her, "You must keep off the sweets for a while."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The doctor said to her, "Keep off the sweets for a while."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Advice/Order)
Rule: "advised her to keep off" → a direct command "**Keep off ...**".
(सलाह/आदेश: advised to → command।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "She must keep off"; **(c)** "Why don't you"; **(d)** "You must keep off" – change the form.

Q.129 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Anne said to Mary, "I have received a job offer from a company."

(a) Anne told Mary that I had received a job offer from a company.
(b) Anne told Mary that she has received a job offer from a company.
(c) Anne told Mary that I have received a job offer from a company.
(d) Anne told Mary that she had received a job offer from a company.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Anne told Mary that she had received a job offer from a company.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: have received → had received, I → she.
(Direct → Indirect: have received → had received; I → she।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I had"; **(b)** "has received"; **(c)** keeps "I have".

Q.130 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
She said to him, "Please fill in this form."

(a) She told him to fill in this form.
(b) She said that he had to fill in that form.
(c) She requested him to fill in that form.
(d) She asked him to please fill in that form.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She requested him to fill in that form.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Request)
Rule: "Please fill in ..." → "**requested ... to fill in**"; **this → that**.
(निवेदन: requested to + verb; this → that।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "to fill in this form" – keeps "this"; **(b)** "had to fill"; **(d)** "to please fill" – wrong.

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Q.131 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
She wondered if she had enough money to buy a pullover.

(a) She said, "I wonder if I have enough money to buy a pullover."
(b) She said, "I am wondering that she has enough money to buy a pullover."
(c) She said, "I wondered that she has enough money to buy a pullover."
(d) She said, "I wonder that she has enough money to buy a pullover."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She said, "I wonder if I have enough money to buy a pullover."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: wondered → wonder, she → I, had → have.
(Indirect → Direct: wondered → wonder; had → have; she → I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "I am wondering that she has"; **(c)** "wondered that she has"; **(d)** "wonder that she has" – wrong.

Q.132 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The captain said that the crew had to leave the ship at Liverpool.

(a) The captain said, "The crew has to leave the ship at Liverpool."
(b) The captain said, "The crew have to leave the ship at Liverpool."
(c) The captain said, "The crew could leave the ship at Liverpool."
(d) The captain said to the crew, "Leave the ship at Liverpool."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The captain said, "The crew has to leave the ship at Liverpool."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had to → has to (present).
(Indirect → Direct: had to → has to)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "have to" – "the crew" is treated as singular here; **(c)** "could leave" – changes modal; **(d)** "Leave the ship" – a command.

Q.133 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The captain told the crew that the ship had to reach London that night.

(a) The captain said to the crew, "The ship has to reach London tonight."
(b) The captain said to the crew, "The ship had to reach London that night."
(c) The captain said to the crew, "The ship will have to reach London that night."
(d) The captain said to the crew, "The ship had reached London tonight."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The captain said to the crew, "The ship has to reach London tonight."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had to → has to, that night → tonight.
(Indirect → Direct: had to → has to; that night → tonight)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** keeps "had to ... that night"; **(c)** "will have to"; **(d)** "had reached" – wrong.

Q.134 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
"I wish I had something to eat. I am so hungry." said Chippa.

(a) Chippa said he wished he had something to eat as he was so hungry.
(b) Chippa said he wishes he has something to eat as he is so hungry.
(c) Chippa said he wishes he had something to eat as he was so hungry.
(d) Chippa said I wish I have something to eat as I am so hungry.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Chippa said he wished he had something to eat as he was so hungry.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: wish → wished, am → was, I → he.
(Direct → Indirect: wish → wished; am → was; I → he)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "wishes ... is"; **(c)** "wishes ... had"; **(d)** keeps "I wish ... I am".

Q.135 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to his brother, "Where did you go for a picnic?"

(a) He asked his brother where he went for a picnic.
(b) He asked his brother where he had gone for a picnic.
(c) He asked his brother where did he go for a picnic.
(d) He asked his brother where did you go for a picnic.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He asked his brother where he had gone for a picnic.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: did you go → he had gone; assertive order.
(Direct → Indirect: did go → had gone; you → he)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "where he went" – wrong tense; **(c)** "where did he go" – question order; **(d)** keeps "you".

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Q.136 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Anurag said, "The coming elections in Bihar will be the main topic of discussion for the next fortnight."

(a) Anurag predicted that the coming elections in Bihar would be the main topic of discussion for the following fortnight.
(b) Anurag exclaimed that the coming elections in Bihar are the main topic of discussion for the coming fortnight.
(c) Anurag informed that the coming elections in Bihar were the main topic of discussion for the following fortnight.
(d) Anurag commented that the coming elections in Bihar will be the main topic of discussion for the next fortnight.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Anurag predicted that the coming elections in Bihar would be the main topic of discussion for the following fortnight.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: will → would, and a forecast suits the reporting verb "**predicted**".
(Direct → Indirect: will → would।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "are ... coming fortnight"; **(c)** "informed ... were"; **(d)** keeps "will".

Q.137 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The doctor exclaimed with relief that he didn't need to go out in the rain.

(a) The doctor said with relief, "He didn't needed to go out in the rain."
(b) The doctor said relieved, "I needn't to go out in the rain."
(c) The doctor said, "Thank God! I needn't go out in the rain."
(d) The doctor exclaimed, "Oh, I don't have to go out in the rain!"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The doctor said, "Thank God! I needn't go out in the rain."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Exclamatory/Relief)
Rule: "exclaimed with relief that he didn't need" → "**Thank God! I needn't go out ...**"; **he → I**.
(राहत की भावना: "Thank God!"; he → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "He didn't needed"; **(b)** "needn't to go"; **(d)** "don't have to" – wrong forms/pronoun.

Q.138 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
She enquired if all those potatoes were to be peeled for dinner.

(a) She said, "Are all these potatoes to be peeled for dinner?"
(b) She said, "All those potatoes were to be peeled for dinner?"
(c) She said, "Are all those potatoes peeling for dinner?"
(d) She said, "Should I peel all these potatoes for dinner?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She said, "Are all these potatoes to be peeled for dinner?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Yes/No Question)
Rule: those → these; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: those → these; प्रश्न बनाएँ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "were to be peeled"; **(c)** "peeling"; **(d)** "Should I peel" – wrong.

Q.139 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Anne said, "Next week I have my first skating lesson."

(a) Anne said that in the next week she has her first skating lesson.
(b) Anne said that the following week I had my first skating lesson.
(c) Anne said that the next week I have my first skating lesson.
(d) Anne said that in the following week she had her first skating lesson.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Anne said that in the following week she had her first skating lesson.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: have → had, I → she, next week → the following week.
(Direct → Indirect: have → had; next week → the following week।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has"; **(b)** keeps "I had"; **(c)** "next week I have" – wrong.

Q.140 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
I said to you, "You should believe her".

(a) I asked whether she should believe you.
(b) I told you that I should believe her.
(c) I told you that you should believe her.
(d) I asked you if you should believe her.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I told you that you should believe her.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: "said to" → **told**; the modal "should" and pronouns stay (you → you, her → her).
(Direct → Indirect: said to → told।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "asked whether she should believe you"; **(b)** "I should believe"; **(d)** "asked ... if" – it is a statement.

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Q.141 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
"We will wait for you if you are late," they said to me on the telephone.

(a) They said to me on the telephone that we will wait for you if you are late.
(b) They told me on the telephone that they would wait for me if I am late.
(c) They said to me on the telephone that they will wait for me if you were late.
(d) They told me on the telephone that they would wait for me if I was late.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) They told me on the telephone that they would wait for me if I was late.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: will → would, we → they, you → me, are → was.
(Direct → Indirect: will → would; we → they; you → me।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "we will ... you"; **(b)** "if I am late"; **(c)** "will wait ... you were" – wrong.

Q.142 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Father said, "On the news tonight they mentioned a possibility of a power strike."

(a) Father wondered why on the news tonight they mentioned a possibility of a power strike.
(b) Father said that on the news tonight they mentioned a possibility of a power strike.
(c) Father asked if on the news that night they had mentioned a possibility of a power strike.
(d) Father said that on the news that night they had mentioned a possibility of a power strike."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Father said that on the news that night they had mentioned a possibility of a power strike."
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: mentioned → had mentioned, tonight → that night.
(Direct → Indirect: mentioned → had mentioned; tonight → that night।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "wondered why"; **(b)** keeps "tonight ... mentioned"; **(c)** "asked if".

Q.143 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Bill said, "I have missed my train. I will be late for work."

(a) Bill said that I have missed my train and that I would be late for work.
(b) Bill said that he had missed his train and that he would be late for work.
(c) Bill said that he missed his train and that he will be late for work.
(d) Bill said that he has missed his train and that he is late for work.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Bill said that he had missed his train and that he would be late for work.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: have missed → had missed, will → would, I → he, my → his.
(Direct → Indirect: have → had; will → would; I → he।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I"; **(c)** "missed ... will"; **(d)** "has missed ... is late" – wrong.

Q.144 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
His mother told him to phone his father at once.

(a) His mother said to him, "He must phone his father at once."
(b) His mother said to him, "Phone your father at once."
(c) His mother said to him, "He has to phone your father at once."
(d) His mother said to him, "You should phone his father at once."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) His mother said to him, "Phone your father at once."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Order)
Rule: "told him to phone" → command "**Phone ...**"; **his → your.**
(आदेश: told to → command; his → your।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "He must phone his"; **(c)** "He has to phone your"; **(d)** "You should phone his" – wrong pronouns/forms.

Q.145 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
She said to me, "Don't worry about me."

(a) She told me not to worry about her.
(b) She told me don't worry about her.
(c) She told me to not be worried about her.
(d) She told me to not to worry about me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She told me not to worry about her.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Negative Order)
Rule: "Don't worry ..." → "**told me not to worry**"; **me → her.**
(निषेधात्मक आदेश: not to + verb; me → her।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "told me don't"; **(c)** "to not be worried"; **(d)** "to not to worry about me" – all wrong.

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Q.146 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
My friend said, "Hello! What are you doing here?"

(a) My friend said hello to me and asked what were you doing here.
(b) My friend said hello and asked me what was I doing there.
(c) My friend greeted me and asked me what I was doing there.
(d) My friend wished me and asked me what was I doing here.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) My friend greeted me and asked me what I was doing there.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Greeting + Question)
Rule: "Hello!" → **greeted**; "What are you doing here?" → asked **what I was doing there** (are → was, you → I, here → there).
(अभिवादन: greeted; are → was; here → there।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "what were you doing"; **(b)** "what was I"; **(d)** "what was I ... here" – wrong order/word.

Q.147 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Granny said to Nina, "I don't know why you think it is so wonderful."

(a) Granny said to Nina that she hadn't known why she was thinking it was so wonderful.
(b) Granny said to Nina that she doesn't know why she thinks it was so wonderful.
(c) Granny said to Nina that she didn't know why she thought it was so wonderful.
(d) Granny said to Nina that I don't know why you think it is so wonderful

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Granny said to Nina that she didn't know why she thought it was so wonderful.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: don't know → didn't know, you think → she thought, is → was.
(Direct → Indirect: don't → didn't; think → thought; is → was।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "hadn't known ... was thinking"; **(b)** "doesn't know ... thinks"; **(d)** keeps "I don't know why you think".

Q.148 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
She said, "Ruhi slipped when she was trying to board the bus."

(a) She said that Ruhi has slipped when she was trying to board the bus.
(b) She said that Ruhi slipped when she was trying to board the bus.
(c) She said that Ruhi had slipped when she was trying to board the bus.
(d) She says that Ruhi slipped when she was trying to board the bus.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She said that Ruhi had slipped when she was trying to board the bus.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: slipped → had slipped (the earlier past action).
(Direct → Indirect: slipped → had slipped।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "has slipped" – wrong tense; **(b)** "slipped" – not back-shifted; **(d)** "says" – wrong reporting verb.

Q.149 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
"Oh, how could I ever thank you, Sir!" said the convict to the Bishop.

(a) The convict exclaimed gratefully to the Bishop that how he could ever thank him.
(b) The convict said to the Bishop that he could never thank him enough.
(c) Exclaiming gratefully, the convict said to the Bishop that he could never thank him enough.
(d) The convict told the Bishop that it was difficult for him to thank him.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Exclaiming gratefully, the convict said to the Bishop that he could never thank him enough.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Exclamatory)
Rule: "Oh, how could I ever thank you!" (gratitude) → "**exclaiming gratefully ... he could never thank him enough**"; **I → he, you → him**.
(विस्मयादिबोधक (आभार): exclaimed gratefully; I → he; you → him।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "that how he could"; **(b)** drops the exclamation of gratitude; **(d)** changes the meaning.

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Q.150 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
"What a hopeless fellow you are!" said the teacher to the student.

(a) The teacher said the student was what a hopeless fellow.
(b) The teacher told the student that he was a very hopeless fellow.
(c) The teacher told the student that you are a very hopeless fellow.
(d) The teacher told the student what are a hopeless fellow he was.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The teacher told the student that he was a very hopeless fellow.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Exclamatory)
Rule: "What a hopeless fellow you are!" → "**told ... that he was a very hopeless fellow**"; **you → he**, **are → was**.
(Exclamatory: told that ... a very ...; you → he; are → wasI)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was what a hopeless"; **(c)** keeps "you are"; **(d)** "what are a hopeless" – wrong.

Q.151 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Rahul said to Mohit, " I am taking my family to Kashmir for a vacation tomorrow."

(a) Rahul told Mohit that I am taking my family to Kashmir for a vacation tomorrow.
(b) Rahul told Mohit that I was taking my family to Kashmir for a vacation the following day.
(c) Rahul told Mohit that he is taking his family to Kashmir for a vacation tomorrow.
(d) Rahul told Mohit that he was taking his family to Kashmir for a vacation the following day.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Rahul told Mohit that he was taking his family to Kashmir for a vacation the following day.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: am taking → was taking, **I → he**, **my → his**, **tomorrow → the following day**.
(Direct → Indirect: am → was; tomorrow → the following dayI)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I am ... tomorrow"; **(b)** keeps "I"; **(c)** "he is taking ... tomorrow".

Q.152 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The young man said to his father, "Pardon me, sir."

(a) The young man requested to his father pardon me, sir.
(b) The young man told his father pardon me.
(c) The young man begged of his father to pardon him.
(d) The young man begged of his father to pardon me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The young man begged of his father to pardon him.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Plea)
Rule: "Pardon me, sir" (a plea) → "**begged of his father to pardon him**"; **me → him**.

Explanation (contd.)
(निवेदन: begged of ... to + verb; me → himI)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "requested to ... pardon me"; **(b)** "told ... pardon me"; **(d)** keeps "me".

Q.153 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
"Remove all the stains carefully and clean the windows," said the contractor to the worker.

(a) The contractor said to the worker that you should remove all the stains carefully and clean the windows.
(b) The contractor requested the worker to remove all the stains carefully and clean the windows.
(c) The contractor instructed the worker to remove all the stains carefully and clean the windows.
(d) The contractor told the worker that by removing all the stains carefully, the windows will be cleaned.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The contractor instructed the worker to remove all the stains carefully and clean the windows.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Order)
Rule: A command → "**instructed + object + to + V1**".
(आदेश: instructed + to + verbI)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "that you should"; **(b)** "requested" – changes tone; **(d)** changes the meaning.

Q.154 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Taru asked Kavya if she would help her in setting up her new dressing table.

(a) Taru said to Kavya, "Will you help me in setting up her new dressing table?"
(b) Taru said to Kavya, "How would you help me in setting up my new dressing table?"
(c) Taru said to Kavya, "Will you help me in setting up my new dressing table?"
(d) Taru said to Kavya, "Would you help her in setting up my new dressing table?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Taru said to Kavya, "Will you help me in setting up my new dressing table?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Yes/No Question)
Rule: would → will, **she → you**, **her → me**, **her new → my new**.
(Indirect → Direct: would → will; she → you; her → meI)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "her new dressing table"; **(b)** "How would you"; **(d)** "help her ... my" – mixed.

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Q.155 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The driver asked a passerby if he could tell him the way to the market.

(a) The driver said to a passerby, "Tell me the way to the market, will you"
(b) The driver said to a passerby, "Please, will you tell me the way to the market?"
(c) The driver said to a passerby, "Could he tell him the way to the market?"
(d) The driver said to a passerby, "Can you tell me the way to the market?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The driver said to a passerby, "Can you tell me the way to the market?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "asked ... if he could tell him" → direct question "**Can you tell me ...?**"; **could → can**, **him → me**, **he → you**.
(Indirect → Direct: could → can; him → me।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) & (b)** change the words; **(c)** "Could he tell him" – not converted.

Q.156 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Your sister will say that she has lost her pen again.

(a) Your sister will say, "I lost my pen again."
(b) Your sister said, "She has lost my pen again."
(c) Your sister says, "I lost her pen again."
(d) Your sister will say, "I have lost my pen again."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Your sister will say, "I have lost my pen again."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: has lost → have lost, **she → I**, **her → my**.
(Indirect → Direct: has lost → have lost; she → I; her → my।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I lost my pen"; **(b)** "said ... She has lost my"; **(c)** "I lost her pen" – all wrong.

Q.157 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
She said to herself, "Shall I have a happy married life?"

(a) She wondered if she shall have a happy married life.
(b) She asked that if she should have a happy married life.
(c) She wondered if she would have a happy married life.
(d) She thought that she should have a happy married life.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She wondered if she would have a happy married life.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Self-question)
Rule: "said to herself" (a question) → "**wondered if**"; **shall → would**, **I → she**.
(स्वयं से प्रश्न: wondered if; shall → would; I → she।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "shall have"; **(b)** "asked that if"; **(d)** "thought that she should" – all wrong.

Q.158 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
You told me that you had not slept the previous night and could not work then.

(a) You said to me, "I have not slept last night and could not work then."
(b) You said to me, "I did not sleep last night and cannot work now."
(c) You said to me, "I have not slept the previous night and cannot work then."
(d) You said to me, "You did not sleep the previous night and could not work now."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) You said to me, "I did not sleep last night and cannot work now."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had not slept → did not sleep, **the previous night → last night**, **could → cannot**, **then → now**.
(Indirect → Direct: had not slept → did not sleep; the previous night → last night; then → now।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have not slept ... then"; **(c)** "the previous night ... then"; **(d)** keeps "You did not sleep".

Q.159 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
I told you that I had bought a new book for you the day before.

(a) I said to you, "I have bought a new book for you the day before."
(b) I said to you, "I bought a new book for you yesterday."
(c) I said to you, "You have bought a new book for me the day before."
(d) I told to you, "I have bought a new book for you yesterday."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) I said to you, "I bought a new book for you yesterday."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had bought → bought, **the day before → yesterday**.
(Indirect → Direct: had bought → bought; the day before → yesterday।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "have bought ... the day before"; **(c)** wrong pronouns; **(d)** "told to you" – wrong.

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Q.160 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Jayesh said to Diwakar, " You can top the class if you want to."

(a) Jayesh told Diwakar that he could top the class if he wanted to.
(b) Jayesh told Diwakar that he would top the class if he wants to.
(c) Jayesh told Diwakar that you could top the class if you wanted to.
(d) Jayesh told Diwakar that you can top the class if you want to.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Jayesh told Diwakar that he could top the class if he wanted to.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: can → could, want → wanted, you → he.
(Direct → Indirect: can → could; want → wanted; you → he।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "would ... wants"; **(c)** keeps "you could ... you wanted"; **(d)** keeps "you can".

Q.161 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Father told Avika to stop watching the TV and eat her food.

(a) Father said, "Avika, stop watching the TV and eat your food."
(b) Father said, "Avika, Why can't you stop watching the TV and eat your food?"
(c) Father said, "Avika, stop watching the TV and eat her food."
(d) Father said to Avika, " Stop eating the TV and watch your food."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Father said, "Avika, stop watching the TV and eat your food."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Order)
Rule: "told Avika to stop ... and eat" → a direct command; **her → your**.
(आदेश: told to → command; her → your।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "Why can't you" – a question; **(c)** keeps "her food"; **(d)** "stop eating the TV" – jumbled.

Q.162 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
He said, "Two and two make four."

(a) He says that two and two make four.
(b) He said that two and two made four.
(c) He says that two and two made four.
(d) He said that two and two make four.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He said that two and two make four.
The correct answer is option (d).
Two and two make four is a general truth, and such truths typically remain unchanged.
So, the correct indirect speech is: **He said that two and two make four.**

Q.163 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
He said, "Oh, how I would have loved to visit Kashmir this year."

(a) He said that he will have loved to visit Kashmir this year.
(b) He exclaimed how I would have loved to visit Kashmir this year.
(c) He exclaimed that how he would have loved to visit Kashmir that year.
(d) He exclaimed that he would have really loved to visit Kashmir that year.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He exclaimed that he would have really loved to visit Kashmir that year.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Exclamatory)
Rule: "Oh, how I would have loved ...!" → "**exclaimed that he would have really loved**"; **I → he, this year → that year**.
(Exclamatory: exclaimed that ...; I → he; this year → that year।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will have loved"; **(b)** keeps "I ... this year"; **(c)** "that how he would" – wrong.

Q.164 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
"Don't be late tomorrow morning," my mother said to me.

(a) My mother warned me not to be late the next day morning.
(b) My mother warned me not to be late tomorrow morning.
(c) My mother asks me not to be late tomorrow morning.
(d) My mother told me don't be late tomorrow morning.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) My mother warned me not to be late the next day morning.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Warning)
Rule: "Don't be late ..." → "**warned ... not to be late**"; **tomorrow → the next day**.
(चेतावनी: warned not to; tomorrow → the next day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** keeps "tomorrow"; **(c)** "asks ... tomorrow"; **(d)** "told me don't be late" – wrong.

Q.165 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
He will say that he is okay.

(a) He will say, "I am okay."
(b) He will say, "I am always okay."
(c) He will say, "I was okay."
(d) He would say, "I am okay."

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He will say, "I am okay."
In **direct speech**, we quote the exact words spoken by the person. The sentence "He will say that he is okay" becomes **"He will say, 'I am okay.'"** Here, the exact words he says are quoted, and the present tense "I am" remains unchanged.

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Q.166 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
I asked the carpenter how long he would take to polish my furniture.

(a) I said to carpenter, "How long he would take to polish my furniture?"
(b) I said to carpenter, "How long he would take to polish his furniture?"
(c) I said to carpenter, "How long will you take to polish my furniture?"
(d) I said to carpenter, "How long you would take to polish my furniture?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I said to carpenter, "How long will you take to polish my furniture?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Wh-question)
Rule: would → will, he → you; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: would → will; he → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "how long he would"; **(b)** "his furniture"; **(d)** "How long you would" – all wrong.

Q.167 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The judge asked the prisoner if he had anything to say for himself.

(a) The judge said to the prisoner, "Do you have anything to say for yourself?"
(b) The judge said to the prisoner, "Did he had anything to say for himself?"
(c) The judge said to the prisoner, "If you have anything to say for yourself?"
(d) The judge said to the prisoner, "Does he have anything to say for himself?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The judge said to the prisoner, "Do you have anything to say for yourself?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Yes/No Question)
Rule: "asked ... if he had anything to say" → "**Do you have anything to say for yourself?**"; **he → you**, **had → have**.
(Indirect → Direct: if हटाकर प्रश्न; he → you; had → have।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "Did he had"; **(c)** "If you have"; **(d)** "Does he have" – all wrong.

Q.168 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The teacher asked me why I had reached the examination hall so late.

(a) The teacher said to me, "Why had I reached the examination hall so late?"
(b) The teacher said to me, "Why did you reach the examination hall so late?"
(c) The teacher said to me, "Why you reached the examination hall so late?"
(d) The teacher said to me, "Why are you reaching the examination hall so late?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The teacher said to me, "Why did you reach the examination hall so late?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Wh-question)
Rule: had reached → did reach, I → you; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: had reached → did reach; I → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Why had I reached"; **(c)** "Why you reached"; **(d)** "are you reaching" – all wrong.

Q.169 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
I said to you, "He cannot be trusted completely."

(a) You told me that he cannot be trusted completely.
(b) You told me that he could not be trusted completely.
(c) I said you that he cannot be trusted completely.
(d) I told you that he could not be trusted completely.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I told you that he could not be trusted completely.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: "said to" → **told**; **cannot → could not**.
(Direct → Indirect: said to → told; cannot → could not।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "You told me" – speaker reversed; **(b)** "You told me" – wrong; **(c)** "said you" – missing "to".

Q.170 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
She said to me, "Can you look after my baby for a short while?"

(a) She asked me that if I could look after her baby for a short while.
(b) She asked me if I can look after my baby for a short while.
(c) She asked me if you can look after my baby for a short while.
(d) She asked me if I could look after her baby for a short while.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She asked me if I could look after her baby for a short while.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: add **if**; **can → could**, **you → I**, **my → her**.
(Yes/No प्रश्न: if; can → could; my → her।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "that if I could"; **(b)** "if I can"; **(c)** "if you can" – all wrong.

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Q.171 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The policeman told the boys that they could not park their car there.

(a) The policeman said to the boys, "You could not park their car there."
(b) The policeman said to the boys, "How could you park your car here?"
(c) The policeman said to the boys, "You cannot park your car here."
(d) The policeman told to the boys, "They could not park their car there."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The policeman said to the boys, "You cannot park your car here."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: could not → cannot, they → you, their → your, there → here.
(Indirect → Direct: could → can; there → here।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "You could not ... their ... there"; **(b)** "How could you" – a question; **(d)** "told to the boys".

Q.172 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Shikha said, "The heavy rain this week has spoiled all my travel plans."

(a) Shikha told me that the heavy rain that week had spoiled all her travel plans.
(b) Shikha said that the heavy rain that week had spoiled all her travel plans.
(c) Shikha said that the heavy rain this week had spoiled all her travel plans.
(d) Shikha said that the heavy rain that week has spoiled all her travel plans.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Shikha said that the heavy rain that week had spoiled all her travel plans.
option (a) is wrong because it is not said to whom shikha said. So, told me is wrong.option (c) is wrong because while changing speech from direct to indirect 'this' is changed to 'that'. option (d) is wrong because present perfect should be changed to past perfect.

Q.173 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.She said impatiently, "I don't need any help."

(a) She said impatiently that I don't need any help.
(b) She said impatiently she don't need any help.
(c) She said impatiently that she didn't need any help.
(d) She said impatiently that she doesn't need any help.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She said impatiently that she didn't need any help.
The following changes should happen from direct to indirect speech.
I – She
Don't need – didn't need
So, the correct sentence in the indirect speech will be, "She said impatiently that she didn't need any help."

Q.174 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech. Hira inquired how I was doing being all alone in my house.

(a) Hira said to me, "How you are doing being all alone in your house?"
(b) Hira said to me, "How are you doing being all alone in my house."
(c) Hira said to me, "Are you doing fine being all alone in your house."
(d) Hira said to me, "How are you doing being all alone in your house?"

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Hira said to me, "How are you doing being all alone in your house?"
Rules for changing interrogative sentences from direct to indirect form.
'said to' - asked, questioned, inquired, or interrogated based on what is said in the sentence,

Q.175 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech."So help me heaven!", the man cried, "I shall never lie again."

(a) The man called heaven and ordered to help him and see to it that she never lies again.
(b) The man called upon heaven to witness his resolve that he would never lie again.
(c) The man requested heaven to help him and see that he lie again.
(d) The man cries out to heaven to help him not to lie again ever.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The man called upon heaven to witness his resolve that he would never lie again.
The given sentence is an exclamatory sentence. So,
'cried' will be changed into 'called upon heaven' because reporting speech has an exclamation.
'to' will be followed by the first form of the verb 'witness'.
'I' will be changed to 'he'.
'shall' will change to 'would'
'The man called upon heaven to witness his resolve that he would never lie again.' So, the correct option is 'b'.

Q.176 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
He said, "I bought this book for my brother."

(a) He said that he has bought this book for his brother.
(b) He said that he buy this book for his brother.
(c) He said that he bought this book for his brother.
(d) He said that he had bought that book for his brother.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He said that he had bought that book for his brother.
The correct answer is option (d).
"**He said that he had bought that book for his brother**"
Direct speech ---------- indirect speech
Subject + verb (2nd form) + object ----------object + had (3rd form) + subject.
Hence, d is the most appropriate indirect speech.

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Q.177 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.I warned Rita not to be late the next day.

(a) I warned Rita, "Not be late tomorrow".
(b) I warned to Rita, "Don't be late tomorrow".
(c) I warned Rita, "Don't be late tomorrow".
(d) I warning Rita, "Not be late tomorrow".

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I warned Rita, "Don't be late tomorrow".
While changing indirect speech to direct speech, the tense of the reporting verb and pronouns are changed. Punctuation marks at appropriate place and quotation marks are also added.
Here, in the given sentence,
Warned remains warned because the sentence is reported in the past. It will remain in the past in direct speech too.
Her changes to Rita
Not to be late changes to don't be late
The next day changes to tomorrow.
All the above changes are present in option (c) only. So, c is the correct option.

Q.178 Select the most appropriate option in direct speech.

(a) The principal said to I, "You are in-charge of the admission cell."
(b) The principal say me, "You are in-charge of the admission cell."
(c) The principal said me, You are in-charge of the admission cell.
(d) The principal said to me, "You are in-charge of the admission cell."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The principal said to me, "You are in-charge of the admission cell."
The correct answer is option (d).
"The principal said to me, 'You are in-charge of the admission cell.'"
Here's a detailed explanation: The use of "to me" is appropriate because it correctly indicates the recipient of the principal's statement.
The statement made by the principal is enclosed in double quotation marks.
There's proper punctuation with a comma after "me" before the opening quotation mark and a period at the end of the quoted sentence.
This option correctly represents a direct speech situation where the principal is speaking to someone (the speaker) and providing an instruction.

Q.179 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The teacher informed that the exam had been postponed.

(a) The teacher informed, "The exam has been postponed."
(b) The teacher informs, "The exam had been postponed."
(c) The teacher informs, "The exam has been postponed."
(d) The teacher informed, "The exam was being postponed."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The teacher informed, "The exam has been postponed."
When converting indirect speech to direct speech, it's essential to maintain the original meaning and tense of the reported speech. In the given sentence, "The teacher informed that the exam had been postponed," the reporting verb "informed" is in the past tense, and the reported speech is in the past perfect tense ("had been postponed").
In direct speech, we quote the exact words spoken, so the sentence becomes:
The teacher informed, "The exam has been postponed."
Here, the present perfect tense "has been postponed" is used to indicate that the exam is currently postponed at the time of speaking.
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.180 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
'I am determined to publish my findings,' the scientist asserted confidently.

(a) The scientist confidently asserted that she would be determined to publish her findings.
(b) The scientist confidently asserted that she is determined to publish her findings.
(c) The scientist confidently asserted that she had determined to publish her findings.
(d) The scientist confidently asserted that she was determined to publish her findings.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The scientist confidently asserted that she was determined to publish her findings.
When converting direct speech to reported speech:

1. **Tense shift**: The present tense ("am determined") changes to the past tense ("was determined") because the reporting verb "asserted" is in the past tense.
2. **Pronoun adjustment**: "I" changes to "she" to reflect the subject in reported speech.
3. **Logical consistency**: The past tense aligns with standard rules for reported speech.

Correct answer: **The scientist confidently asserted that she was determined to publish her findings.**
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

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Q.181 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The District Magistrate ordered the police to work all night and put an end to those riots.

(a) The District Magistrate told the police, "Work all night and put to end these riots."
(b) The District Magistrate told the police, "Work all night and put an end to their riots."
(c) The District Magistrate told the police, "Work all night to put an end these riots."
(d) The District Magistrate told the police, "Work all night and put an end to these riots."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The District Magistrate told the police, "Work all night and put an end to these riots."
The sentence is correctly transformed into direct speech by quoting the District Magistrate's exact words.
The use of "these riots" is consistent with the context of the sentence.
The other options contain small errors in wording or phrasing.
The correct option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech is:
The District Magistrate told the police, "Work all night and put an end to these riots."
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.182 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
He said, "I shall need a copy of the documents."

(a) He said that he will need a copy of the documents.
(b) He said that he is going to need a copy of the document.
(c) He said that he would need a copy of the documents.
(d) He said that he shall need a copy of the document.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He said that he would need a copy of the documents.
In indirect speech, when reporting statements about future actions, the future tense in direct speech typically changes to the conditional tense in indirect speech. Therefore, "shall need" becomes "would need." Additionally, the reporting verb "said" is followed by "that" to introduce the reported speech.
Direct Speech: "I shall need a copy of the documents."
Indirect Speech: He said that he would need a copy of the documents.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.183 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
The soldier said to his fellow soldiers, "I have buried our brave comrade here.

(a) The soldier told us that I had buried their brave comrade here.
(b) The soldier told his fellow soldiers that I had buried our brave comrade there.
(c) The soldier told us that he had buried our brave comrade there.
(d) The soldier told his fellow soldiers that he had buried their brave comrade there.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The soldier told his fellow soldiers that he had buried their brave comrade there.
Correct because it follows all the necessary shifts:
- "I" changes to "he."
- "Our" changes to "their."
- "Have buried" changes to "had buried."
- "Here" changes to "there."

The most appropriate option to express the given sentence in reported speech is:
The soldier told his fellow soldiers that he had buried their brave comrade there.
Thus, **Option (d)** is the correct conversion into reported speech.

Q.184 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
Kanhaiya said to me, "Do you want to sing?"

(a) Kanhaiya said that whether I would sing.
(b) Kanhaiya enquires if I want to sing.
(c) Kanhaiya asked me if I wanted to sing.
(d) Kanhaiya said that I would sing or not.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Kanhaiya asked me if I wanted to sing.
When converting a question into indirect speech, we follow these rules:
- **"Do you want"** becomes **"I wanted"** (since it's a question in the present tense, it changes to past tense in reported speech).
- The word **"Do"** is omitted in indirect speech.
- The question mark is replaced with **"if"** or **"whether"**.
- The pronoun "you" changes to "I" based on the speaker.

Thus, the correct form would be **"Kanhaiya asked me if I wanted to sing."**
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

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Q.185 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
He inquired whether the boy's name was Ahmed.

(a) He asked, "Is the boy's name Ahmed?"
(b) He asked, "The boy's name is Ahmed?"
(c) He asked, "Whether the boy's name was Ahmed?"
(d) He asked, "Was the boy's name Ahmed?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He asked, "Is the boy's name Ahmed?"
Rule: indirect yes/no question → direct speech *(अप्रत्यक्ष से प्रत्यक्ष कथन)*:
• *inquired* → **asked** + comma + quotation marks
• drop *whether*; put the helping verb before the subject and end with **?**
• undo the backshift: past *was* → present **is**
Example: She asked if I was busy. → She asked, "Are you busy?"
Apply it.
whether the boy's name was Ahmed → **Is the boy's name Ahmed?**
Answer: **He asked, "Is the boy's name Ahmed?"**
Why the others are wrong.
• **The boy's name is Ahmed?** — statement order with a question mark; a direct question puts the helping verb first *(प्रश्नवाचक क्रम)*.
• **Whether the boy's name was Ahmed?** — *whether* is only the linker of indirect speech and never goes inside quotes *(अप्रत्यक्ष कथन का संयोजक)*.
• **Was the boy's name Ahmed?** — the tense is not reversed; the reported *was* came from a present *is (काल वापस नहीं बदला)*.
Going back to direct speech, undo every change: whether goes, order inverts, tense moves forward.

Q.186 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
My son exclaimed with joy that it was an attractive site.

(a) My son said, "It is an attractive site."
(b) My son said, "What an attractive site it was!"
(c) My son said, "What an attractive site it is!"
(d) My son said, "It was an attractive site."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) My son said, "What an attractive site it is!"
option (c) is the correct answer.
Rules of Exclamatory Sentences.
- Said + God! ---------- exclaimed with sorrow.
- Said + Hurray! ---------- exclaimed with joy.
- Said + Fi! /Ugh ---------- exclaimed with despise/ disgust.
- Said + Wow! ---------- exclaimed with joy.
- Said + Oh! ---------- exclaimed with surprise / regret.

The correct answer is: My son said, "What an attractive site it is!"

Q.187 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
I asked Mary if she would lend me a pencil.

(a) I said, "Mary, will you lend me a pencil?"
(b) I said, "Mary, will she lend me a pencil?"
(c) I asked to Mary, "Would you lend me a pencil?"
(d) I said to Mary, "Can you lent me a pencil?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I said, "Mary, will you lend me a pencil?"
Rule: indirect question → direct speech *(अप्रत्यक्ष से प्रत्यक्ष कथन)*:
• *asked* → **said to** — or put the listener first inside the quotes: *I said, "Mary, …"*
• drop *if/whether*; use question order and end with **?**
• the person spoken to becomes **you**: *she* (Mary) → **you**
• reverse the tense: *would* → **will**
Example: He asked me if I was ready. → He said to me, "Are you ready?"
Apply it.
asked Mary → **I said, "Mary, …"**
if she would lend → **will you lend**
me → **me** (the speaker is "I" in both forms)
Answer: **I said, "Mary, will you lend me a pencil?"**
Why the others are wrong.
• **will she lend** — Mary is being spoken to, so inside the quotes she must be *you* — wrong pronoun *(सर्वनाम की भूल)*.
• **asked to Mary** — *ask* takes its object directly, never with *to (ask के बाद to नहीं आता)*; *would* is also left unreversed.
• **Can you lent** — after a modal the verb stays in base form *lend*, not past *lent (modal के बाद मूल क्रिया)*; *can* also changes *would/will* into ability.
Inside the quotes, the person being addressed is always "you".

Q.188 Select the correct direct narration of the given sentence.
Madhav applauded her, saying that she had done well.

(a) Madhav say, "Bravo! You have be done well".
(b) Madhav said, "Bravo! You been done well".
(c) Madhav say, "Bravo! You have done well".
(d) Madhav said, "Bravo! You have done well".

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Madhav said, "Bravo! You have done well".
option (d) is the correct answer.
Direct speech to Indirect speech rule-:
Rule to change Direct speech into Indirect speech-:
If the reporting verb (sentence outside the inverted comma) is in the past tense and Reported speech (inside the inverted comma) is in the present tense, then the following transformation will occur:
Simple Present ----- Simple Past.
Present Continuous ------ Past Continuous.
Present Perfect ------- Past Perfect.
Present Perfect Continuous ----- Past Perfect Continuous.
Thus, the correct Indirect form of the given sentence is:
Madhav said, "Bravo! You have done well".

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Q.189 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
"Do you suppose you know better than your own father?" jeered his angry mother.

(a) His angry mother jeered and asked whether he had supposed he has known better than his own father.
(b) His angry mother jeered that did he suppose he knew better than his own father.
(c) His angry mother jeered and asked if you suppose you know better than your own father.
(d) His angry mother jeered and asked whether he supposed he knew better than his own father.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) His angry mother jeered and asked whether he supposed he knew better than his own father.
Rule: direct yes/no question → indirect speech *(प्रत्यक्ष से अप्रत्यक्ष कथन)*:
• reporting verb → **asked** (an extra tone verb is kept: *jeered and asked*)
• *do/does* question → **whether / if** + statement order; no question mark
• pronouns follow the listener: *you* (the son) → **he**, *your* → **his**
• past reporting verb → each tense goes one step back: *suppose* → **supposed**, *know* → **knew**
Example: "Are you tired?" she said. → She asked whether I was tired.
Apply it.
Do you suppose → **whether he supposed**
you know → **he knew**
your own father → **his own father**
Answer: **His angry mother jeered and asked whether he supposed he knew better than his own father.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **had supposed ... has known** — *had supposed* is past perfect *(पूर्ण भूतकाल)*, one step too far, while *has known* is not changed at all — the tenses clash.
• **that did he suppose** — *that* introduces statements, and *did he suppose* is still question order; indirect questions use statement order *(कथन क्रम)*.
• **if you suppose you know ... your** — pronouns and tenses left exactly as in the quotes; that is still direct speech *(सर्वनाम व काल नहीं बदले)*.
Word help.
jeered = mocked rudely and loudly *(ताना मारा, उपहास किया)*.
Do/does/did vanish in indirect speech — the main verb carries the tense: "Do you suppose" → "whether he supposed".

Q.190 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
"Call the first witness," said the judge.

(a) The judge asked if they would call the first witness.
(b) The judge said that the first witness should be called.
(c) The judge ordered them to call the first witness.
(d) The judge ordered that called the first witness.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The judge ordered them to call the first witness.
Rule: imperative sentence *(आज्ञार्थक वाक्य)* → indirect speech:

Explanation (contd.)
• *said* → a verb showing the mood: **ordered / commanded** (command), *requested* (request), *advised* (advice)
• add the people addressed as an object — here **them**
• the imperative verb becomes **to + base verb**
Example: "Shut the door," he said to me. → He ordered me to shut the door.
Apply it.
A judge's "Call the first witness" is a command to the court staff.
said → **ordered them**
Call → **to call**
Answer: **The judge ordered them to call the first witness.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **asked if they would call** — turns the command into a yes/no question *(आदेश को प्रश्न बना दिया)*.
• **said that ... should be called** — reports it as a passive *should*-clause *(कर्मवाच्य)*; the force of the order and the *to*-infinitive pattern are lost.
• **ordered that called** — the *that*-clause has no subject; ungrammatical *(कर्ता ही नहीं)*.
Command → ordered + object + to + verb.

Q.191 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The lawyer told the father of the accused, "There is a rumour that he has some connection in that crime."

(a) The lawyer told the father of the accused that there had been a rumour that he had some connection in that crime.
(b) The lawyer told the father of the accused that there was a rumour that he was having some connection in that crime.
(c) The lawyer told the father of the accused that there was a rumour that he had some connection in that crime.
(d) The lawyer told the father of the accused that there was a rumour that he has had some connection in that crime.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The lawyer told the father of the accused that there was a rumour that he had some connection in that crime.
option (b) is the correct answer.
Direct speech to Indirect speech rule-:
Rule to change Direct speech into Indirect speech-:
If the reporting verb (sentence outside the inverted comma) is in the past tense and Reported speech (inside the inverted comma) is in the present tense, then the following transformation will occur:
Simple Present ----- Simple Past.
Present Continuous ------ Past Continuous.
Present Perfect ------- Past Perfect.
Present Perfect Continuous ----- Past Perfect Continuous.
Thus, the correct Indirect form of the given sentence is:
The lawyer told the father of the accused that there was a rumour that he had some connection in that crime.

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Q.192 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Anil said to Ria, "I know where everything is kept in the kitchen."

(a) Anil told Ria that he knows where everything was kept in the kitchen.
(b) Anil told Ria that he knew where everything is kept in the kitchen.
(c) Anil asked Ria that he knows where everything was kept in the kitchen.
(d) Anil told Ria that he knew where everything was kept in the kitchen.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Anil told Ria that he knew where everything was kept in the kitchen.
The correct option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech is: **Anil told Ria that he knew where everything was kept in the kitchen.**
Rules:
Say/said remains unchanged in Indirect speech.
"**Say**" to changes into **"tell"** and **"said to"** changes into **'told'.**
Change in Tense:
Simple present -> Simple past -> Past perfect -> No change.
Therefore, "**Anil told Ria that he knew where everything was kept in the kitchen."** is the correct answer.

Q.193 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
He said to the mechanic, "Will you have the car ready by tomorrow morning?"

(a) He asked the mechanic if he would have the car ready by the next morning.
(b) He told the mechanic if he will have the car ready for the next morning.
(c) He asked the mechanic if he will have the car ready by the previous morning.
(d) He said the mechanic whether he would has the car ready by the following morning.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He asked the mechanic if he would have the car ready by the next morning.
The correct answer is: **He asked the mechanic if he would have the car ready by the next morning.**
Change of Modals:
Shall/Will -> Should/Would
May -> Might
Can -> Could
Therefore, **He asked the mechanic if he would have the car ready by the next morning.**

Q.194 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
The captain said to the soldiers, "Follow the enemy."

(a) The captain charged his soldiers to followed the enemy.
(b) The captain said his soldiers to follow the enemy.
(c) The captain requested his soldiers to follow the enemy.
(d) The captain commanded his soldiers to follow the enemy.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The captain commanded his soldiers to follow the enemy.
The correct option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech is: **"The captain commanded his soldiers to follow the enemy."**
This option is correct. It uses "commanded," which accurately conveys the idea of giving a strong order, and the structure "to follow" is grammatically accurate for reported speech.
In summary, the correct answer is "The captain commanded his soldiers to follow the enemy" because it uses an appropriate reporting verb and maintains the correct structure for conveying the order in reported speech.

Q.195 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
Rakesh said, "Wow! What a beautiful house".

(a) Rakesh exclaimed that it was a beautiful house.
(b) Rakesh exclaimed with sorrow that it was a beautiful house.
(c) Rakesh told that it had been a beautiful house.
(d) Rakesh exclaimed with surprise that it was must be beautiful house.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Rakesh exclaimed that it was a beautiful house.
In exclamatory sentences:
Said + wow! -------> exclaimed with joy.
Active voice ------ Passive voice
Rakesh said, "Wow! What a beautiful house". □ **Rakesh exclaimed that it was a beautiful house.**

Q.196 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
He always says to me, "I am perturbed."

(a) He always tells me that he is perturbed by change.
(b) He always tells me that he is going to be perturbed.
(c) He always tells me that he is perturbed.
(d) He always tells me that he is mostly perturbed.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He always tells me that he is perturbed.
- In indirect speech, we report the content of what someone says without quoting their exact words. The sentence "He always says to me, 'I am perturbed.'" becomes **"He always tells me that he is perturbed."** The present tense **"I am"** is changed to **"he is"** to match the subject "he" in indirect speech.

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Q.197 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The patient says, "I am fine."

(a) The patient says that he is fine.
(b) The patient says that he would be fine.
(c) The patient says that he will be fine.
(d) The patient says that he was fine.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The patient says that he is fine.
In indirect speech, when the reporting verb is in the present tense (like "says"), the present tense of the verb in direct speech is retained.
The sentence **"The patient says that he is fine."** accurately conveys the information while maintaining the present tense.

Q.198 Choose the correct indirect narration of the following statement from the given alternatives:
Mr. Dash said, "What a costly thing gold has become!"

(a) Mr. Dash lamented that gold has become a very costly thing.
(b) Mr. Dash shouted that gold did become a very costly thing.
(c) Mr. Dash exclaimed that gold had been becoming a very costly thing.
(d) Mr. Dash exclaimed that gold had become a very costly thing.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Mr. Dash exclaimed that gold had become a very costly thing.
Rule: exclamatory sentence → indirect speech *(विस्मयादिबोधक वाक्य का अप्रत्यक्ष कथन)*:
• *said* → **exclaimed** (with joy / sorrow / surprise as the tone fits)
• **What a / How** → **very** (or *great*), placed before the adjective; statement order; full stop
• joiner **that**; past reporting verb → present perfect *has become* → **had become**
Example: She said, "How beautiful the rose is!" → She exclaimed that the rose was very beautiful.
Apply it.
said → **exclaimed**
What a costly thing → **a very costly thing**
has become → **had become**
Answer: **(4) Mr. Dash exclaimed that gold had become a very costly thing.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **lamented ... has become** — *lamented (शोक प्रकट किया)* is possible in tone, but *has become* is not shifted back to **had become**.
• **shouted ... did become** — *shouted (चिल्लाया)* is not the reporting verb for an exclamation, and *did become* is emphatic simple past, not the past perfect.
• **had been becoming** — past perfect continuous *(पूर्ण अपूर्ण भूत)*; *has become* (present perfect) goes only to **had become**.
What a / How → very; has → had.

Q.199 Choose the correct indirect narration of the following statement from the given alternatives:
Salini said to Meena, "Why did you not tell the truth to my friend when he was in real trouble?"

(a) Salini asked Meena why she had not told the truth to her friend when he had been in real trouble.
(b) Salini asked Meena why he had not told the truth to her friend when she was in real trouble.
(c) Salini asked Meena that why she had not told the truth to her friend when she had been in real trouble.
(d) Salini asked Meena why she had not told the truth to his friend when he had in real trouble.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Salini asked Meena why she had not told the truth to her friend when he had been in real trouble.
Rule: wh-question → indirect speech *(प्रश्नवाचक वाक्य का अप्रत्यक्ष कथन)*:
• *said to* → **asked**
• keep the wh-word (**why**) as the joiner — no *that*; put the sentence in statement order, no question mark
• past reporting verb: *did ... not tell* (simple past) → **had not told** (past perfect); *was* → **had been**
• pronouns: *you* (Meena) → **she**; *my* (Salini's) → **her**; *he* (the friend) stays **he**
Example: He said to me, "Why did you leave?" → He asked me why I had left.
Apply it.
Why did you not tell → **why she had not told**
my friend → **her friend**
he was → **he had been**
Answer: **(1) Salini asked Meena why she had not told the truth to her friend when he had been in real trouble.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **why he had not told ... when she was** — the pronouns are swapped: Meena is *she*, the friend is *he (सर्वनाम की भूल)*.
• **asked Meena that why** — *that* is never added before a wh-word in an indirect question *(that + why साथ नहीं)*; the friend also wrongly becomes *she*.
• **his friend ... when he had in real trouble** — *my* (Salini's) must become *her*, and *had in* lacks the verb *been (क्रिया छूटी)*.
Indirect wh-questions: the wh-word is the joiner — never "that why".

Q.200 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
Jai said that he wanted to be a soldier.

(a) Jai said, "I want to be a soldier."
(b) Jai said, "He wants to become a soldier."
(c) Jai said that, "I wanted to become a soldier."
(d) Jai said, "I wanted to be a soldier."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Jai said, "I want to be a soldier."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: wanted → want; he → I.
(Indirect → Direct: wanted → want; he → I)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "He wants" – wrong pronoun.
• **(c)** "said that, 'I wanted'" – wrong punctuation/tense.
• **(d)** "I wanted" – tense not changed.

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Q.201 Choose the option that is the most appropriate conversion of the following sentence into Direct Speech.
Shalini asked Yusuf if he would go to her party that night.

(a) Shalini asked Yusuf, "Would you go to my party this night?"
(b) Shalini said to Yusuf, "Will you come to my party that night?"
(c) Shalini said to Yusuf, "Will you come to my party tonight?"
(d) Shalini asked Yusuf, "You will come to my party tonight?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Shalini said to Yusuf, "Will you come to my party tonight?"
Rule: indirect yes/no question → direct speech *(अप्रत्यक्ष से प्रत्यक्ष कथन)*:
• *asked* → **said to**
• drop *if/whether*; use question order (auxiliary before subject) and end with **?**
• *would* → **will**; *that night* → **tonight**
• *he* (Yusuf, the listener) → **you**; *her* (Shalini's) → **my**
• *go* to a party one is invited to by the speaker → **come** (movement towards the speaker)
Example: She asked me if I would visit her that day. → She said to me, "Will you visit me today?"
Apply it.
if he would go → **Will you come**
her party → **my party**
that night → **tonight**
Answer: **(3) Shalini said to Yusuf, "Will you come to my party tonight?"**
Why the others are wrong.
• **Would you go ... this night** — *would* is not changed back to *will*, and *that night* becomes **tonight**, not *this night (this night अप्रचलित)*.
• **that night** — inside quotes the time word must return to the speaker's present: **tonight** *(काल-सूचक शब्द नहीं बदला)*.
• **You will come ...?** — statement order with a question mark; a direct question needs **Will you** *(प्रश्न क्रम नहीं)*.
Back to direct: would → will, that night → tonight, her → my.

Q.202 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
Abdul said that he had seen that film the day before.

(a) Abdul said, "I had seen this film the day before."
(b) Abdul said, "I saw this film yesterday."
(c) Abdul said, "I saw that film yesterday."
(d) Abdul said, "I see this film on the previous day."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Abdul said, "I saw this film yesterday."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: had seen → saw; that film → this film; the day before → yesterday.
(Indirect → Direct: had seen → saw; the day before → yesterday।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I had seen this film" – tense not changed.
• **(c)** "I saw that film" – "that" not changed.
• **(d)** "I see ... on the previous day" – wrong tense/word.

Q.203 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
He asked me to wait there until I got my turn.

(a) He said to me, "Wait here until you get your turn."
(b) He asked me to "wait there until you get my turn."
(c) He said to me, "You are wait here until you get your turn."
(d) He told to me "Wait here until you get your turn."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He said to me, "Wait here until you get your turn."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Order)
Rule: "asked me to wait" → command "**Wait ...**"; **there → here**; **I got → you get**; **my → your**.
(आदेश: asked to → command; there → here; my → your।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "wait there ... get my turn" – wrong words.
• **(c)** "You are wait here" – wrong form.
• **(d)** "told to me" – wrong reporting.

Q.204 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
"Have you got a blue scarf"? the customer asked the assistant.

(a) The customer asked the assistant he has a blue scarf.
(b) The customer asking the assistant if he is having a blue scarf.
(c) The customer asked the assistant if he had a blue scarf.
(d) The customer asked the assistant if he have a blue scarf.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The customer asked the assistant if he had a blue scarf.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: add **if**; **have got → had**.
(Yes/No प्रश्न: if जोड़ें; have got → had।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "he has a blue scarf" – no "if", present tense.
• **(b)** "asking ... is having" – wrong forms.
• **(d)** "if he have" – wrong verb.

Q.205 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
The judge said to Jia, "Stand in the witness box."

(a) The judge told Jia you will stand in the witness box.
(b) The judge told to Jia stand in the witness box.
(c) The judge told Jia to stand in the witness box.
(d) The judge told Jia you are standing in the witness box.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The judge told Jia to stand in the witness box.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Order)
Rule: A command "Stand ..." → "**told + object + to + V1**".
(आदेश: told + object + to + verb।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "you will stand" – changes to future.
• **(b)** "told to Jia stand" – "told to" + no "to + verb".
• **(d)** "you are standing" – present continuous.

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Q.206 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
Vikas said to Navin that he hadn't met him since February the previous year.

(a) Vikas said, "Navin, I haven't meet you since February last year."
(b) Vikas told to Navin, "I haven't met him since February last year."
(c) Vikas told Navin, "You haven't meeting me since February last year."
(d) Vikas said to Navin, "I haven't met you since February last year."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Vikas said to Navin, "I haven't met you since February last year."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: speaker is **Vikas** (said to Navin); change **hadn't met → haven't met**, **him → you**, **the previous year → last year**.
(Indirect → Direct: hadn't met → haven't met; him → you; the previous year → last year।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "haven't meet" – wrong form.
• **(b)** "told to Navin ... him" – wrong.
• **(c)** "haven't meeting" – wrong form.

Q.207 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
The Principal said to them that he did not want to see any one to return with a complaint against them.

(a) The Principal said to them, "I did not want to saw any one to return with a complaint against them."
(b) The Principal said to them, "I do not want to see any one to return with a complaint against you."
(c) The Principal said to them, "I do not want to see any one to returns with a complaint against you."
(d) The Principal said to them, "I do not wanted to see any of them to be returning with a complaint."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The Principal said to them, "I do not want to see any one to return with a complaint against you."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: change **did not want → do not want**, **them → you** (the Principal spoke to them).
(Indirect → Direct: did → do; them → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "did not want to saw" – wrong tense/form.
• **(c)** "to returns" – wrong form.
• **(d)** "do not wanted" – wrong form.

Q.208 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
"I have joined computer classes" Rudra said.

(a) Rudra said that I am joining computer classes.
(b) Rudra said that I join computer classes.
(c) Rudra said that he had joined computer classes.
(d) Rudra said that I joined computer classes.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Rudra said that he had joined computer classes.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: have joined → had joined; **I → he**.
(Direct → Indirect: have joined → had joined; I → he।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I am joining" / **(b)** "I join" / **(d)** "I joined" – keep "I" and wrong tense.

Q.209 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
My neighbour enquired how my father was.

(a) My neighbour asked, " How my father was?"
(b) My neighbour asked, "What about your father's welfare?"
(c) My neighbour enquired, "How is my father?"
(d) My neighbour enquired, "How is your father?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) My neighbour enquired, "How is your father?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "enquired" → **asked**; **was → is**; **my father → your father**; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: was → is; my → your।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "How my father was?" – wrong order.
• **(b)** "What about your father's welfare?" – changes the words.
• **(c)** "How is my father?" – "my" not changed to "your".

Q.210 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
Lokesh said, "I am very busy this week".

(a) Lokesh said that I am very busy that week.
(b) Lokesh said that he was very busy that week.
(c) Lokesh said that he are very busy this week.
(d) Lokesh said that I am very busy this week.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Lokesh said that he was very busy that week.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: am → was; **I → he**; **this week → that week**.
(Direct → Indirect: am → was; I → he; this week → that week।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) & (d)** keep "I am".
• **(c)** "he are" – wrong verb.

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Q.211 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
"Get out of this room", the officer shouted at the cadet.

(a) The officer shouted at the cadet and asked him to get out of that room.
(b) The officer shouted at the cadet and asked him to get out of this room.
(c) The officer shouts at the cadet and asks him to go out of that room.
(d) The officer shouting at the cadet and asking him to go out of the room.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The officer shouted at the cadet and asked him to get out of that room.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Order)
Rule: A command → "**asked him to + V1**"; **this → that**.
(आदेश: asked him to + verb; this → that।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** keeps "this room".
• **(c)** present tense; **(d)** "shouting ... asking" – wrong verb forms.

Q.212 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
I told them to be quiet.

(a) I told to them, "You must be quiet."
(b) I said to them "Be you quiet!"
(c) I said them, "You be quiet."
(d) I told them, "Be quiet!"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I told them, "Be quiet!"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Order)
Rule: "told them to be quiet" → a direct **command**: "**Be quiet!**"
(आदेश: told to → सीधा command "Be quiet!")
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "You must be quiet" – changes to obligation.
• **(b)** "Be you quiet" / **(c)** "You be quiet" – wrong command structure.

Q.213 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
She said to him, "I don't want to go there."

(a) She said he didn't want to go there.
(b) She said to him that you do not want to go there.
(c) She said to him that she didn't want to go there.
(d) He said to her that she didn't want to go there.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She said to him that she didn't want to go there.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: don't → didn't; I → she.
(Direct → Indirect: don't → didn't; I → she।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "She said he didn't" – drops "to him", changes meaning.
• **(b)** "you do not want" – wrong pronoun.
• **(d)** "He said to her" – speaker reversed.

Q.214 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
Devi replied that she was sorry but she could not go.

(a) Devi replied, "I'm sorry but I cannot go."
(b) Devi replied, " She was sorry I could not go."
(c) Devi replies, "I could not went but sorry."
(d) Devi replied, "Sorry she could not go."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Devi replied, "I'm sorry but I cannot go."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: was → am; she → I; could not → cannot.
(Indirect → Direct: was → am; she → I; could not → cannot।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "She was sorry I could not go" – wrong pronouns.
• **(c)** "I could not went" – wrong form.
• **(d)** "Sorry she could not go" – not converted.

Q.215 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
He exclaimed sadly that it was a pity that so many lives had been lost in the floods.

(a) He said sadly, "It was a pity that so many lives were loss in the floods."
(b) He said sadly, "What a pity that so many lives are being lost in the floods!"
(c) He said sadly, "It is a pity that so many lives had been lost in the floods."
(d) He said sadly, "What a pity that so many lives have been lost in the floods."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He said sadly, "What a pity that so many lives have been lost in the floods."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Exclamatory)
Rule: "exclaimed sadly that it was a pity" → an exclamation "**What a pity ...!**"; **had been lost → have been lost**.
(Exclaimed that it was a pity → "What a pity ...!"; had been → have been।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "were loss" – wrong form.
• **(b)** "are being lost" – wrong tense.
• **(c)** "It is a pity ... had been lost" – not exclamatory.

Q.216 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
Kishore said "I'm leaving now."

(a) Kishore said that he was leaving then.
(b) Kishore said that he left then.
(c) Kishore says that I am leaving now.
(d) Kishore said that he had to leaving then.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Kishore said that he was leaving then.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: am leaving → was leaving; I → he; now → then.
(Direct → Indirect: am → was; I → he; now → then।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "he left then" – wrong tense.
• **(c)** "says that I am ... now" – not converted.
• **(d)** "had to leaving" – wrong form.

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Q.217 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
The counter clerk asked me what my mobile number was.

(a) The counter clerk asked me, "What is your mobile number?"
(b) The counter clerk asks me, "What is your mobile number?"
(c) The counter clerk enquired me, "What is your mobile number?"
(d) The counter clerk asked to me, "What was your mobile number?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The counter clerk asked me, "What is your mobile number?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: was → is; **my → your**; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: was → is; my → your।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "asks me" – wrong tense of the reporting verb.
• **(c)** "enquired me" – "enquired" needs "of me".
• **(d)** "What was your ... number?" – tense not changed.

Q.218 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
"We are going to Tirupati next week," Deepa told her friends.

(a) Deepa told to her friends that she is going to Tirupati following week.
(b) Deepa told her friends that they will go to Tirupati next week.
(c) Deepa told her friends that they were going to Tirupati the following week.
(d) Deepa told her friends that we were going to Tirupati the following week.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Deepa told her friends that they were going to Tirupati the following week.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: are going → were going; **we → they**; **next week → the following week**.
(Direct → Indirect: are → were; we → they; next week → the following week।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "told to her friends ... is going" – "told to" + present tense.
• **(b)** "they will go ... next week" – tense/word not changed.
• **(d)** keeps "we".

Q.219 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
Jaya told me "I've been waiting for you since 4 pm."

(a) Jaya told me she was waiting for you since 4 pm.
(b) Jaya told me that she will be waiting for me since 4 pm.
(c) Jaya said me that she has been waiting for me since 4 pm.
(d) Jaya told me that she had been waiting for me since 4 pm.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Jaya told me that she had been waiting for me since 4 pm.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: have been waiting → had been waiting; **I → she**; **you → me**.
(Direct → Indirect: have been → had been; I → she; you → me।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was waiting for you" – wrong tense/pronoun.
• **(b)** "will be waiting" – future.
• **(c)** "said me ... has been" – "said me" and tense wrong.

Q.220 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
Vandana said, "I'm being dropped to office today".

(a) Vandana said that I am being dropped to office on that day.
(b) Vandana said that she was being dropped to office that day.
(c) Vandana said that she should be dropped to office today.
(d) Vandana said she was dropped to office today.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Vandana said that she was being dropped to office that day.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: am being dropped → was being dropped; **I → she**; **today → that day**.
(Direct → Indirect: am → was; I → she; today → that day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I ... today".
• **(c)** "should be dropped" – changes the meaning.
• **(d)** "was dropped ... today" – wrong tense/word.

Q.221 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
"Please bring me a cup of coffee," Shakila said to the waiter.

(a) Shakila told the waiter to bring her a cup of coffee.
(b) Shakila said to the waiter he should bring her a cup of coffee.
(c) Shakila told to the waiter that he should brought her a cup of coffee.
(d) Shakila said to the waiter you bring me a cup of coffee.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Shakila told the waiter to bring her a cup of coffee.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Request)
Rule: "Please ..." → "**told/requested + object + to + V1**"; **me → her**.

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Explanation (contd.)
(निवेदन: told + object + to + verb; me → her।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "he should bring" – wordy/wrong structure.
• **(c)** "told to the waiter ... brought" – wrong.
• **(d)** "you bring me" – not converted.

Q.222 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
The teacher asked the students if they had understood her question.

(a) The teacher asked the students, "Have you understood my question?"
(b) The teacher asking the students, "If you have understood my question?"
(c) The teacher asked the students, "Have you understood her question?
(d) The teacher asks the students, "whether you understand my question?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The teacher asked the students, "Have you understood my question?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "asked ... if" → a yes/no question; **had understood → have understood**; **they → you**; **her → my**.
(Indirect → Direct: had understood → have understood; they → you; her → my।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "asking ... if" – wrong form.
• **(c)** "her question" – not changed.
• **(d)** "whether you understand" – wrong tense/form.

Q.223 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
"I'm hungry" said the child to his mother.

(a) The child told his mother that she was hungry.
(b) The child said his mother that he is hungry.
(c) The child told his mother that he was hungry.
(d) The child said to his mother that I am hungry.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The child told his mother that he was hungry.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: "said to" → **told**; **am → was**; **I → he**.
(Direct → Indirect: said to → told; am → was; I → he।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "she was hungry" – wrong pronoun (the child is male here).
• **(b)** "said his mother ... is" – "said" needs "to"; tense not changed.
• **(d)** keeps "I am hungry" – not converted.

Q.224 Choose the option that is the direct form of the sentence.
The policeman enquired where his helmet was.

(a) The policeman asked him, "Where is your helmet?"
(b) The policeman asked him, "Where his helmet is?"
(c) The policeman enquired, "Where his helmet was?"
(d) The policeman enquired, "Where your helmet is?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The policeman asked him, "Where is your helmet?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "enquired" → **asked him**; **was → is**; **his → your**; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: was → is; his → your।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "Where his helmet is?" – wrong order/pronoun.
• **(c)** "Where his helmet was?" – not changed.
• **(d)** "Where your helmet is?" – wrong reporting/order.

Q.225 Choose the option that is the indirect form of the sentence.
Akshay said, "I am making biryani today."

(a) Akshay said that he would be making biryani on the next day.
(b) Akshay said that he was making biryani on that day.
(c) Akshay said that he is making biryani today.
(d) Akshay said that he made biryani today.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Akshay said that he was making biryani on that day.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: am making → was making; **I → he**; **today → that day**.
(Direct → Indirect: am → was; I → he; today → that day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "would be making ... the next day" – wrong tense/time.
• **(c)** "is making today" – not converted.
• **(d)** "made today" – wrong tense.

Q.226 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The teacher said, "Too many cooks spoil the broth."

(a) The teacher said that too many cooks spoil the broth.
(b) The teacher told too many cooks had spoilt the broth.
(c) The teacher said too many cooks spoils the broth.
(d) The teacher said that too many cooks spoiled the broth.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The teacher said that too many cooks spoil the broth.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Universal Truth)
Rule: A **universal truth / proverb** does NOT change its tense in indirect speech.
(सार्वभौमिक सत्य/कहावत का tense indirect में नहीं बदलता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "had spoilt" – wrongly back-shifts the proverb.
• **(c)** "spoils" – subject "cooks" (plural) needs "spoil".
• **(d)** "spoiled" – wrongly changes the proverb to past.

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Q.227 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The little girl said that those butterflies were very colourful.

(a) The little girl said, "Those butterflies were very colourful."
(b) The little girl said, "Are those butterflies very colourful?"
(c) The little girl said, "These butterflies are very colourful."
(d) The little girl says, "How colourful were these butterflies!'

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The little girl said, "These butterflies are very colourful."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: change **those** → **these**, **were** → **are**.
(Indirect → Direct: those → these; were → are।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Those butterflies were" – not changed.
• **(b)** "Are those butterflies ...?" – a question.
• **(d)** "says ... were" – wrong reporting verb/tense.

Q.228 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
You said, "I scored four goals."

(a) You said that I had scored four goals.
(b) You said that you scored four goals.
(c) You said that you have scored four goals.
(d) You said that you had scored four goals.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) You said that you had scored four goals.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: scored → **had scored**; **I** → **you** (the reporter is "You").
(Direct → Indirect: scored → had scored; I → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I had scored" – wrong pronoun.
• **(b)** "you scored" – tense not changed.
• **(c)** "you have scored" – wrong (present perfect).

Q.229 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
"Let us go to the hills for a vacation," Mother said to us.

(a) Mother said that should we go to the hills for a vacation.
(b) Mother ordered us to go to the hills for a vacation.
(c) Mother suggested that let us go to the hills for a vacation.
(d) Mother suggested that we should go to the hills for a vacation.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Mother suggested that we should go to the hills for a vacation.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect ("Let us" = Suggestion)
Rule: "Let us ..." (a proposal) → "**suggested that + we should + V1**".
("Let us ..." (सुझाव) → suggested that we should + verb।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "said that should we go" – wrong order.
• **(b)** "ordered us to go" – it is a suggestion, not an order.
• **(c)** "suggested that let us go" – keeps "let us".

Q.230 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
He told you that he had not known that it was your birthday that day.

(a) You said to him, "I do not know that it is your birthday today."
(b) He said to you, "You did not know that it was my birthday today."
(c) He said to you, "I did not know that it is your birthday today."
(d) He said to you, "I do not know that it was your birthday that day."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He said to you, "I did not know that it is your birthday today."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: speaker is **He** (He told you); change **had not known** → **did not know**, **it was** → **it is**, **that day** → **today**.
(Indirect → Direct: had known → did know; was → is; that day → today।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "You said to him" – wrong speaker.
• **(b)** "You did not know ... my birthday" – pronouns reversed.
• **(d)** "I do not know ... that day" – wrong tense/word.

Q.231 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
She said, "I will finish reading the novel today."

(a) She said that I would finish reading the novel today.
(b) She said that she will finished reading the novel that day.
(c) She said she will finish reading the novel today.
(d) She said that she would finish reading the novel that day.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She said that she would finish reading the novel that day.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: will → **would**, **I** → **she**, **today** → **that day**.
(Direct → Indirect: will → would; I → she; today → that day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I ... today".
• **(b)** "will finished" – wrong form.
• **(c)** "will finish ... today" – tense/word not changed.

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Q.232 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The teacher asked the students if they could prepare for the debate by the following week.

(a) The teacher said to the students, "Are you prepared for the debate by next week?"
(b) The teacher said to the students, "Will you prepare for the debate by the following week?"
(c) The teacher asked to the students, "Could you prepare for the debate by the following week?"
(d) The teacher said to the students, "Can you prepare for the debate by next week?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The teacher said to the students, "Can you prepare for the debate by next week?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "asked ... if they could" → direct question; **could → can**, **they → you**, and **the following week → next week**.
(Indirect → Direct: could → can; the following week → next week।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Are you prepared" – wrong tense.
• **(b)** "Will you prepare ... the following week" – "could → will" and time-word not changed.
• **(c)** "asked to the students, 'Could you'" – "asked to" and "could" not converted.

Q.233 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The maid asked me if she could get me a glass of juice.

(a) The maid said to me, "Could you get me a glass of juice?"
(b) The maid said to me, "I can get you a glass of juice."
(c) The maid said to me, "Can I get you a glass of juice?"
(d) The maid said to me, "Can she get me a glass of juice?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The maid said to me, "Can I get you a glass of juice?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "asked ... if" → a yes/no question; **could → can**, **she → I**, **me → you**.
(Indirect → Direct: could → can; she → I; me → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Could you get me" – pronouns reversed.
• **(b)** "I can get you" – not a question.
• **(d)** keeps "she ... me" – not converted.

Q.234 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to me, "What a pity! You missed the party."

(a) He exclaimed that it was a pity I had missed the party.
(b) He told to me that it was a pity I had missed the party.
(c) He exclaimed what a pity it was that you missed the party.
(d) He exclaimed that it was a pity you missed the party.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He exclaimed that it was a pity I had missed the party.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Exclamatory)
Explanation (contd.)
Rule: "What a pity!" → "**exclaimed that it was a pity**"; **you → I** (listener is "me"); **missed → had missed**.
(Exclamatory: exclaimed that it was a pity; you → I; missed → had missed।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "told to me" – wrong reporting verb.
• **(c)** "you missed" – pronoun/tense not changed.
• **(d)** "you missed" – tense not back-shifted.

Q.235 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Anu said that she wanted to see if she could do a back-flip.

(a) Anu said, "I want to do a back-flip if I can."
(b) Anu said, "I want to see if I can do a back-flip."
(c) Anu said, "I wanted to see her doing a back-flip."
(d) Anu said, "Let her see if I could do a back-flip."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Anu said, "I want to see if I can do a back-flip."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: change **wanted → want**, **she → I**, **could → can**.
(Indirect → Direct: wanted → want; she → I; could → can।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I want to do ... if I can" – reorders and changes the meaning.
• **(c)** "I wanted to see her" – wrong pronoun/tense.
• **(d)** "Let her see ... I could" – changes the meaning.

Q.236 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
She said to Madhu, "Please post this letter."

(a) She requested Madhu to post that letter.
(b) She said Madhu to post that letter.
(c) She ordered Madhu that post this letter.
(d) She told Madhu to post this letter.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She requested Madhu to post that letter.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Request)
Rule: "Please ..." (a polite order) → "**requested + object + to + V1**"; **this → that**.
(विनम्र निवेदन: requested + object + to + verb; this → that।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "said Madhu to post" – "said" needs "to" only as "said to".
• **(c)** "ordered ... that post this" – wrong structure.
• **(d)** "told Madhu to post this" – "this" should become "that".

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Q.237 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
I said to the postman, "Is there a letter for me?"

(a) I asked the postman that is there a letter for me.
(b) I asked the postman if there is a letter for me.
(c) I asked the postman if there was a letter for me.
(d) I asked the postman was there a letter for me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I asked the postman if there was a letter for me.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: "said to" → **asked**; add **if**; **is** → **was**.
(Yes/No प्रश्न: said to → asked; if जोड़ें; is → was।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "that is there" – keeps present tense + wrong "that".
• **(b)** "if there is" – tense not changed.
• **(d)** "was there a letter" – keeps question order.

Q.238 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
I said to my daughter, "Why are you angry with me?"

(a) I asked my daughter why she was angry with me.
(b) I asked to my daughter why was she angry with me.
(c) I asked my daughter why you are angry with me.
(d) I said to my daughter that why she was angry with me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I asked my daughter why she was angry with me.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: "said to" → **asked**; **are** → **was**; **you** → **she**; assertive order.
(Direct → Indirect: said to → asked; are → was; you → she।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "asked to my daughter why was she" – "asked to" + question order wrong.
• **(c)** "why you are angry" – tense/pronoun not changed.
• **(d)** "said to my daughter that why" – wrong reporting verb + "that why".

Q.239 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Mother ordered the children to stop playing then.

(a) Mother said to the children, "Don't play then."
(b) Mother said to the children, "Please stop playing then."
(c) Mother said to the children, "Can you stop playing now?"
(d) Mother said to the children, "Stop playing now."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Mother said to the children, "Stop playing now."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Order)
Rule: "ordered ... to stop" → a direct **command**; the reported "then" becomes **now**.
(आदेश: ordered to → सीधा command; then → now।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Don't play then" – keeps "then"; wrong meaning.
• **(b)** "Please stop ... then" – a request, and keeps "then".
• **(c)** "Can you stop ...?" – a question, not a command.

Q.240 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
Sania said to me, "Tomorrow is my convocation."

(a) Sania told to me that the next day is her convocation.
(b) Sania told me that the next day was her convocation.
(c) Sania told me that tomorrow was her convocation.
(d) I told Sania that her convocation was the next day.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Sania told me that the next day was her convocation.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: tomorrow → **the next day**; **is** → **was**; **my** → **her**; "said to" → **told**.
(Direct → Indirect: tomorrow → the next day; is → was; my → her।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "told to me ... is" – "told to" and present tense wrong.
• **(c)** "tomorrow was" – "tomorrow" not changed.
• **(d)** "I told Sania" – speaker reversed.

Q.241 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
He told you that he would discuss the matter that evening.

(a) He said to you, "I will discuss the matter today evening."
(b) You said to him, "He would discuss the matter today evening."
(c) You said to him, "I will discuss the matter this evening."
(d) He told to you, "He will discuss the matter that evening."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He said to you, "I will discuss the matter today evening."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: the speaker is **He** ("He told you"); change **he** → **I**, **would** → **will**, **that evening** → **this/today evening**.
(Indirect → Direct: he → I; would → will; that evening → this evening।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) & (c)** "You said to him" – wrong speaker.
• **(d)** "He told to you ... He will" – "told to" and pronoun "He" are wrong.
Note (paper wording)
The natural phrase is "**this evening**"; the option's "today evening" is colloquial Indian English for the same. option (a) is correct on speaker, pronoun and tense.

Q.242 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to me, "What can I do for you?"

(a) He asked me what he can do for me.
(b) He asked me what he could do for me.
(c) He asked me that what could I do for you.
(d) He asked me what I could do for him.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He asked me what he could do for me.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: "said to" → **asked**; **can** → **could**; **I** → **he**, **you** → **me**.
(Direct → Indirect: said to → asked; can → could; I → he, you → me।)

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Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "what he can do" – tense not changed.
• **(c)** "that what could I do for you" – wrong order/pronoun.
• **(d)** "what I could do for him" – pronouns reversed.

Q.243 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
She exclaimed that I had grown very tall.
(a) She said to me, "How tall I have grown!"
(b) She said to me, "How tall you have grown!"
(c) She said to me, "How tall are you?"
(d) She said to me, "You have grown very tall."
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She said to me, "How tall you have grown!"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Exclamatory)
Rule: "exclaimed that" → exclamation "How ...!"; change **I** → **you**, keep **had grown** → **have grown**.
(Exclaimed that → "How ...!"; I → you (श्रोता 'me' है)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "How tall I have grown" – wrong pronoun.
• **(c)** "How tall are you?" – a question, not an exclamation.
• **(d)** "You have grown very tall" – not exclamatory.

Q.244 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
She told me that she had given my message to my mother.
(a) She said to me, "I gave my message to your mother."
(b) She said to me, "I gave your message to your mother."
(c) I said to her, "I gave your message to my mother."
(d) She said to me, "She gave my message to my mother."
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She said to me, "I gave your message to your mother."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: speaker is **She** (She told me); change **had given** → **gave**, **my message** → **your message**, **my mother** → **your mother**.
(Indirect → Direct: had given → gave; my → your।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "my message to your mother" – "my message" not changed.
• **(c)** "I said to her" – wrong speaker.
• **(d)** "She gave my message to my mother" – wrong pronouns.

Q.245 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The Principal asked Kamal how it was that he was always late for school.
(a) The Principal said to Kamal, "How are you always late for school?"
(b) The Principal said to Kamal, "How is it that you are always late for school?"
(c) The Principal said to Kamal, "How it is he was always late for school?"
(d) The Principal said to Kamal, "How it was that he was always late for school?"
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The Principal said to Kamal, "How is it that you are always late for school?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: change **was** → **is**, **he** → **you**; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: was → is; he → you।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "How are you always late" – changes the structure.
• **(c)** "How it is he was" – mixed tenses/pronouns.
• **(d)** "How it was that he was" – not converted.

Q.246 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The young man exclaimed that it was a great feast.
(a) The young man said, " Is it a great feast?"
(b) The young man says, " It is a great feast."
(c) The young man said, " It has being a great feast!"
(d) The young man said, " What a great feast it is!"
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The young man said, " What a great feast it is!"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Exclamatory)
Rule: "exclaimed that" → an **exclamation "What a ...!"**; change **was** → **is**.
(Exclaimed that → "What a ...!"; was → is।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Is it a great feast?" – a question.
• **(b)** "says ... It is" – wrong reporting verb.
• **(c)** "It has being" – wrong form.

Q.247 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He says, "Some goods are of poor quality."
(a) He says that some goods were of poor quality.
(b) He said that some goods were of poor quality.
(c) He says that some goods are of poor quality.
(d) He said that some goods are of poor quality.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He says that some goods are of poor quality.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Present Reporting Verb)
Rule: When the reporting verb is **present ("says")**, the tense of the reported speech does **not** change.
(Reporting verb present (says) हो तो tense नहीं बदलता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "were" – wrongly back-shifted.
• **(b) & (d)** "said" – change the reporting verb to past.

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Q.248 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to his employee, "Do not provoke me unnecessarily."

(a) He requested his employee do not provoke him unnecessarily.
(b) He warned his employee not to provoke him unnecessarily.
(c) He told his employee not to provoke me unnecessarily.
(d) He told to his employee to not provoke him unnecessarily.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He warned his employee not to provoke him unnecessarily.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Negative Command)
Rule: A negative order → "**warned/told + not to + V1**"; **me → him**.
(निषेधात्मक आदेश: warned/told + not to + verb; me → him।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "requested ... do not provoke" – wrong structure.
• **(c)** keeps "me" – not converted.
• **(d)** "told to his employee to not" – "told to" and "to not" are wrong.

Q.249 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The manager lauded the salesman and said that his performance had been exceptional.

(a) The manager said to the salesman, "Well done! Your performance has been exceptional."
(b) The manager said to the salesman, "Well done! Your performance has being exceptional."
(c) The manager said to the salesman, "Oh! Your performance had been exceptional."
(d) The manager said to the salesman, "Bravo! How exceptional his performance is !"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The manager said to the salesman, "Well done! Your performance has been exceptional."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "lauded ... and said" → words of praise ("Well done!"); change **his → your**, **had been → has been**.
(Indirect → Direct: his → your; had been → has been; प्रशंसा को "Well done!" से दिखाते हैं।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "has being" – wrong form.
• **(c)** "his performance had been" – pronoun/tense not changed.
• **(d)** "How exceptional his performance is" – wrong pronoun.

Q.250 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said, "Manan came to college yesterday."

(a) He said that Manan came to college the previous day.
(b) He said Manan was coming to college yesterday.
(c) He said that Manan had come to college the previous day.
(d) He said that Manan had came to college yesterday.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He said that Manan had come to college the previous day.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: came → had come; **yesterday → the previous day**.
(Direct → Indirect: came → had come; yesterday → the previous day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "came ... the previous day" – tense not changed.
• **(b)** "was coming yesterday" – wrong tense/word.
• **(d)** "had came" – wrong participle (should be "come").

Q.251 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Rahul told me he didn't have time to go to the dispensary as he was getting late for the office.

(a) Rahul said to me, "I haven't got time to go to the dispensary as I was getting late for the office."
(b) Rahul said to me, "I couldn't have time to go to the dispensary as he was getting late for the office."
(c) Rahul said to me, "I don't have time to go to the dispensary as I am getting late for the office."
(d) Rahul said to me, "He didn't have time to go to the dispensary as I was getting late for the office."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Rahul said to me, "I don't have time to go to the dispensary as I am getting late for the office."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: back-change **didn't have → don't have**, **he → I**, **was getting → am getting**.
(Indirect → Direct: didn't have → don't have; he → I; was getting → am getting।)
Correct direct form
Rahul said to me, **"I don't have time to go to the dispensary as I am getting late for the office."**
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "was getting" – tense not fully changed.
• **(b)** "couldn't have time ... he was" – wrong forms.
• **(d)** "He didn't have ... I was" – wrong pronouns.

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Q.252 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
David said, "Don't worry Frank. I will bring you up to date when I meet you next."

(a) David told Frank not to worry as he would bring him up to date when he met him next.
(b) David told Frank not to worry as I would bring you up to date when I meet you next.
(c) David told Frank he shouldn't worry as he will bring him up to date when he meets him next.
(d) David told Frank don't worry as he would bring you up to date when he met him next.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) David told Frank not to worry as he would bring him up to date when he met him next.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Command + Statement)
Rule: Negative command "Don't worry" → **told ... not to worry**; **will** → **would**; **I** → **he, you** → **him**; **meet** → **met**.
(निषेधात्मक आदेश → not to + verb; will → would; I → he, you → him।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** keeps "I would bring you" – pronouns not changed.
• **(c)** "will bring / meets" – tense not back-shifted.
• **(d)** keeps "don't worry ... you" – not converted.

Q.253 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Cornelius said to Pauline, "This house has been far too large for me since the death of my wife."

(a) Cornelius told Pauline that that house had been far too large for me since the death of my wife.
(b) Cornelius said to Pauline that this house has been far too large for me since the death of my wife.
(c) Cornelius asked Pauline if that house has been far too large for him since the death of his wife.
(d) Cornelius told Pauline that that house had been far too large for him since the death of his wife.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Cornelius told Pauline that that house had been far too large for him since the death of his wife.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: has been → **had been**; **this** → **that**; **me** → **him**; **my** → **his**; reporting verb "said to" → **told**.
(Direct → Indirect: has been → had been; this → that; me → him; my → his।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "for me" – "me → him" not done.
• **(b)** keeps direct "this house has been ... me".
• **(c)** "asked ... if" – it is a statement, not a question.

Q.254 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Frank said to Albert, " How is your search for a new house coming along?"

(a) Frank asked Albert how is your search for a new house coming along.
(b) Frank wanted to know how was Albert's search for a new house coming along.
(c) Frank asked Albert how his search for a new house was coming along.
(d) Frank asked Albert how was your search for a new house coming along.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Frank asked Albert how his search for a new house was coming along.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: "said to" → **asked**; **is** → **was**; **your** → **his**; use assertive order (no question mark).
(Direct → Indirect: said to → asked; is → was; your → his; प्रश्न-क्रम हटता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "is your search" – not changed.
• **(b)** "how was Albert's" – keeps question order.
• **(d)** "how was your" – keeps question order and "your".

Q.255 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Walter said to David, " I am looking forward to tomorrow's auction."

(a) Walter told David that I am looking forward to tomorrow's auction.
(b) Walter told David that he was looking forward to the next day's auction.
(c) Walter told David that he is looking forward to the next day's auction.
(d) Walter told David that he was looking forward to tomorrow's auction.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Walter told David that he was looking forward to the next day's auction.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: "said to" → **told**; **am** → **was**; **I** → **he**; **tomorrow** → **the next day**.
(Direct → Indirect: said to → told; am → was; I → he; tomorrow → the next day।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I am ... tomorrow" – not changed.
• **(c)** "he is looking" – present tense kept.
• **(d)** keeps "tomorrow" – should be "the next day".

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Q.256 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The sports teacher told the Principal that if their school wanted to start a sports club they would need to buy some cricket kits, basketballs and footballs initially.

(a) The sports teacher said to the Principal, "If your school wants to start a sports club they needed to buy some cricket kits, basketballs and footballs initially."
(b) The sports teacher said to the Principal, "If their school wanted to start a sports club they needed to buy some cricket kits, basketballs and footballs initially."
(c) The sports teacher said to the Principal, "If our school wants to start a sports club we will need to buy some cricket kits, basketballs and footballs initially."
(d) The sports teacher said to the Principal, "If their school wanted to start a sports club we would need to buy some cricket kits, basketballs and footballs initially."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The sports teacher said to the Principal, "If our school wants to start a sports club we will need to buy some cricket kits, basketballs and footballs initially."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: back-change **their → our**, **wanted → wants**, **would → will**, **they → we**.
(Indirect → Direct: their → our; wanted → wants; would → will; they → we।)
Correct direct form
The sports teacher said to the Principal, **"If our school wants to start a sports club we will need to buy some cricket kits, basketballs and footballs initially."**
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "your school ... needed" – wrong pronoun/tense.
• **(b)** keeps "their school wanted ... needed".
• **(d)** "their school wanted ... we would" – mixed, not converted.

Q.257 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Cornelius said to Pauline, "You can have your old job back with a raise in the salary."

(a) Cornelius told Pauline that she can have her old job back with a raise in the salary.
(b) Cornelius assured Pauline that she could have her old job back with a raise in the salary.
(c) Cornelius said to Pauline that you can have your old job back with a raise in the salary.
(d) Cornelius requested Pauline to take her old job back with a raise in the salary.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Cornelius assured Pauline that she could have her old job back with a raise in the salary.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: Change **can → could**, **you → she**, **your → her**; a reassuring offer suits the reporting verb "**assured**".
(Direct → Indirect: can → could, you → she, your → her।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "can have" – "can → could" not done.
• **(c)** keeps direct "you can" after "that".
• **(d)** "requested ... to take" – changes the meaning.

Q.258 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
She says that she would like to be an ambassador to a foreign country when she grows up.

(a) She says, "She likes to be an ambassador to a foreign country when she grows up."
(b) She told, "I like to be an ambassador to a foreign country when I grow up."
(c) She said, "She would like to be an ambassador to a foreign country when she grew up."
(d) She says, "I would like to be an ambassador to a foreign country when I grow up."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She says, "I would like to be an ambassador to a foreign country when I grow up."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: The reporting verb is "**says**" (present), so tenses do **not** back-shift; change **she → I**, **grows → grow**.
(Reporting verb "says" (present) होने पर tense नहीं बदलता; सिर्फ she → I, grows → grow।)
Correct direct form
She says, **"I would like to be an ambassador to a foreign country when I grow up."**
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "She likes ... she grows".
• **(b)** "She told ... I like" – wrong reporting verb/tense.
• **(c)** "She said ... grew" – wrongly back-shifts (reporting verb is present).

Q.259 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Albert said to Tim, "I'm not sure your father would consider it a good idea to have me on the board of his company."

(a) Albert said to Tim that he was not sure his father would consider it a good idea to have him on the board of his company.
(b) Albert said to Tim that he is not sure your father will consider it a good idea to have him on the board of his company.
(c) Albert said to Tim that he was not sure his father would consider it a good idea to have me on the board of his company.
(d) Albert said to Tim that I'm not sure your father would consider it a good idea to have me on the board of his company.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Albert said to Tim that he was not sure his father would consider it a good idea to have him on the board of his company.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: I'm → he was; **your → his**; **me → him**. ("would" stays as it already shows unreal/future-in-past.)
(Direct → Indirect: I'm → he was; your → his; me → him।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "he is not sure ... your father will" – present tense/"your" kept.
• **(c)** keeps "to have me" – "me → him" not done.
• **(d)** keeps direct "I'm not sure your father".

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Q.260 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
I asked him where he had lost the pen I had brought for him the previous day.

(a) I said to him, "Where have you lost the pen I brought for you the previous day?"
(b) I said to him, "Where he had lost the pen I brought for him yesterday?"
(c) I said to him, "Where do you lose the pen I had brought for him yesterday?"
(d) I said to him, "Where have you lost the pen I brought for you yesterday?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I said to him, "Where have you lost the pen I brought for you yesterday?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: back-shift **had lost** → **have lost**, **him** → **you**; the reported "the previous day" becomes **yesterday**; and "I had brought for him" → "I brought for you".
(Indirect → Direct: had → have, him → you, the previous day → yesterday।)
Correct direct form
I said to him, **"Where have you lost the pen I brought for you yesterday?"**
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "the previous day" not changed to "yesterday".
• **(b)** keeps "he had lost / him".
• **(c)** "Where do you lose" – wrong tense/pronoun.

Q.261 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The customer asked the shopkeeper how much she had to pay for the little glass table.

(a) The customer said to the shopkeeper, "How much have I to pay for the little glass table?"
(b) The customer said to the shopkeeper, "How much had I to pay for the little glass table?"
(c) The customer said to the shopkeeper, "How much she had to pay for the little glass table?"
(d) The customer said to the shopkeeper, "How much I am to pay for the little glass table?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The customer said to the shopkeeper, "How much have I to pay for the little glass table?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule (Wh-question): reporting verb "asked" → *said to*; convert to the actual spoken form; change pronoun **she** → **I**; add quotation marks and a question mark.
(अप्रत्यक्ष से प्रत्यक्ष: asked → said to, और सर्वनाम she → I बदलता है।)
Correct direct form
The customer said to the shopkeeper, **"How much have I to pay for the little glass table?"**
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "had I to pay" – keeps the reported past tense; direct speech needs present.
• **(c)** keeps "she had to pay" – not converted to a question.
• **(d)** "I am to pay" – changes the original structure.

Q.262 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
"What sort of a house are you looking for, Mr. Barrington?" said the house agent.

(a) The house agent asked Mr. Barrington what sort of a house would he be looking for.
(b) The house agent asked Mr. Barrington what sort of a house are you looking for.
(c) The house agent wanted to know what sort of a house was Mr. Barrington looking for.
(d) The house agent asked Mr. Barrington what sort of a house he was looking for.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The house agent asked Mr. Barrington what sort of a house he was looking for.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Wh-question)
Rule: "said" → **asked**; **are** → **was**; **you** → **he**; use assertive order (subject before verb).
(Direct → Indirect: said → asked; are → was; you → he; प्रश्न-क्रम हटता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "would he be looking" – keeps question order.
• **(b)** keeps "are you looking".
• **(c)** "what sort ... was Mr. Barrington looking" – keeps question order.

Q.263 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
She exclaimed that she looked very ugly in that dress.

(a) She said, "I look so ugly in that dress."
(b) She said, "Why do I look so ugly in this dress?"
(c) She said, "How ugly I looked in that dress!"
(d) She said, "How ugly I look in this dress!"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She said, "How ugly I look in this dress!"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Exclamatory)
Rule: "exclaimed that" → an **exclamatory** sentence with "How ...!"; back-change **looked** → **look**, **she** → **I**, **that dress** → **this dress**.
(Exclaimed that → How ...! वाला विस्मयादिबोधक वाक्य; looked → look, she → I।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "I look so ugly" – not exclamatory form.
• **(b)** "Why do I look" – turns it into a question.
• **(c)** "How ugly I looked ... that dress" – keeps past tense/"that".

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Q.264 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Anshul said to Vibha, "We will shift all the furniture to the new house."

(a) Anshul told Vibha that they will be shifting all the furniture to the new house.
(b) Anshul told Vibha that we would shift all the furniture to the new house.
(c) Anshul told Vibha that they will shift all the furniture to the new house.
(d) Anshul told Vibha that they would shift all the furniture to the new house.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Anshul told Vibha that they would shift all the furniture to the new house.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: will → would; **we → they**; "said to" → **told**.
(Direct → Indirect: will → would; we → they।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "will be shifting" – "will → would" not done.
• **(b)** keeps "we would" – "we → they" not done.
• **(c)** "will shift" – present/future kept.

Q.265 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
The student requested the teacher to speak a little slowly so that he could note down the points.

(a) The student said , "Madam, speak a little slowly so that we can note down the points."
(b) The student said to the teacher, "Please speak a little slowly so that I can note down the points."
(c) The student said to the teacher, "Speak a little slowly so that he could note down the points."
(d) The student told to the teacher, "Please speak a little slowly so that I could note down the points."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The student said to the teacher, "Please speak a little slowly so that I can note down the points."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct (Request)
Rule: "requested … to" → a polite request with "**Please + V1**"; change **he → I**, **could → can**.
(निवेदन: requested to → "Please + verb"; he → I; could → can।)
Correct direct form
The student said to the teacher, **"Please speak a little slowly so that I can note down the points."**
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "we can" – wrong pronoun ("he" refers to the single student → I).
• **(c)** keeps "he could" – not converted.
• **(d)** "told to the teacher … could" – "told to" is wrong; "could" not changed.

Q.266 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
She demanded of her younger brother why he had taken her paints without her permission.

(a) She said to her younger brother angrily, "Why have you taken my paints without my permission?"
(b) She said to her younger brother, "Why he had taken her paints without her permission?"
(c) She said to her younger brother angrily, "Why do you take my paints without my permission?"
(d) She asked her younger brother angrily, "Why do you have to take my paints without my permission?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She said to her younger brother angrily, "Why have you taken my paints without my permission?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "demanded … angrily" shows anger; convert **had taken → have taken**, **he → you**, **her → my**; make it a direct question.
(Indirect → Direct: had taken → have taken, he → you, her → my।)
Correct direct form
She said to her younger brother angrily, **"Why have you taken my paints without my permission?"**
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** keeps "he had taken her" – not converted.
• **(c)** "Why do you take" – wrong tense.
• **(d)** "Why do you have to take" – changes the meaning.

Q.267 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
Veena informed me that there would be an online art class for the children at 4 o'clock that day.

(a) Veena said to me, "There was an online art class for the children at 4 o'clock today."
(b) Veena said to me, "There will be an online art class for the children at 4 o'clock today."
(c) Veena said to me, "There will be an online art class for the children at 4 o'clock that day."
(d) Veena said to me, "There is an online art class for the children at 4 o'clock that day."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Veena said to me, "There will be an online art class for the children at 4 o'clock today."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: back-change **would → will**, and the reported "that day" → **today**.
(Indirect → Direct: would → will; that day → today।)
Correct direct form
Veena said to me, **"There will be an online art class for the children at 4 o'clock today."**
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "There was … today" – wrong tense.
• **(c)** keeps "that day" – should be "today".
• **(d)** "There is" – wrong tense.

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Q.268 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Pauline said to Cornelius, "Will Mr. Vincent be coming for dinner on Thursday evening?"

(a) Pauline asked Cornelius if Mr. Vincent would be coming for dinner on Thursday evening.
(b) Pauline wanted to know from Cornelius if Mr. Vincent is coming for dinner on Thursday evening.
(c) Pauline told Cornelius that Mr. Vincent would be coming for dinner on Thursday evening.
(d) Pauline said to Cornelius will Mr. Vincent be coming for dinner on Thursday evening.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Pauline asked Cornelius if Mr. Vincent would be coming for dinner on Thursday evening.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect (Yes/No Question)
Rule: "said to" → **asked**; add **"if"** for a yes/no question; **will** → **would**; assertive order.
(Yes/No प्रश्न में "if" जोड़ते हैं; will → would; said to → asked।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "if Mr. Vincent is coming" – present tense kept.
• **(c)** "told ... would be coming" – it is a question, so "told" is wrong.
• **(d)** keeps direct "will Mr. Vincent be coming".

Q.269 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Harry said to Margaret, "I already have an appointment at nine but I can fit you in at ten for half an hour."

(a) Harry told Margaret that I already have an appointment at nine but I can fit you in at ten for half an hour.
(b) Harry told Margaret that I am already having an appointment at nine but I can fit her in at ten for half an hour.
(c) Harry told Margaret that he already had an appointment at nine but he can fit you in at ten for half an hour.
(d) Harry told Margaret that he already had an appointment at nine but he could fit her in at ten for half an hour.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Harry told Margaret that he already had an appointment at nine but he could fit her in at ten for half an hour.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: "said to" → **told**; back-shift **have** → **had**, **can** → **could**; change pronouns **I** → **he**, **you** → **her**.
(Direct → Indirect: said to → told; have → had; can → could; I → he, you → her।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** keeps "I have ... you" – pronouns/tense not changed.
• **(b)** "am having ... her" – wrong tense.
• **(c)** keeps "can fit you" – "can → could" and "you → her" not done.

Q.270 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Sushma said to Mohit, "You have always been the cleverest in the family."

(a) Sushma complimented Mohit and said that you are the cleverest in the family.
(b) Sushma said to Mohit that you have always been the cleverest in the family.
(c) Sushma told Mohit that he had always been the cleverest in the family.
(d) Sushma asked Mohit whether he had always been the cleverest in the family.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Sushma told Mohit that he had always been the cleverest in the family.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: have been → had been; **you → he**; "said to" → **told**.
(Direct → Indirect: have been → had been; you → he।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "you are the cleverest" – tense/pronoun not changed.
• **(b)** keeps direct "you have always been".
• **(d)** "asked ... whether" – it is a statement, not a question.

Q.271 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
" I can give you a lift into town if that will help," Anjali said to Rahul.

(a) Anjali said to Rahul that she is ready to give him a lift into town if that will help.
(b) Anjali said to Rahul that she could give him a lift into town if that would help.
(c) Anjali said to Rahul that I can give you a lift into town if that will help.
(d) Anjali said to Rahul that she can give you a lift into town if that is helpful.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Anjali said to Rahul that she could give him a lift into town if that would help.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: can → could; **I → she**; **you → him**; **will → would**.
(Direct → Indirect: can → could; I → she; you → him; will → would।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "is ready ... will help" – tense not changed.
• **(c)** keeps direct "I can give you".
• **(d)** "can give you ... is helpful" – not converted.

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Q.272 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
She asked the drycleaner if he could dry clean her coat in a day's time.

(a) She said to the drycleaner, "Could she dry clean her coat in a day's time?"
(b) She said to the drycleaner, "Can he dry clean my coat in a day's time?"
(c) She said to the drycleaner, "Can you dry clean my coat in a day's time?"
(d) She said to the drycleaner, "Will you dry clean her coat in a day's time?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She said to the drycleaner, "Can you dry clean my coat in a day's time?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "asked ... if" shows a yes/no question. To make it direct: drop "if", change **could → can**, **he → you**, **her → my**, add quotes and a question mark.
(Indirect का "if" हटाकर, could → can, he → you, her → my करके प्रश्नवाचक वाक्य बनता है।)
Correct direct form
She said to the drycleaner, **"Can you dry clean my coat in a day's time?"**
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "Could she" – keeps the reported tense/pronoun.
• **(b)** "Can he ... my coat" – mixes the pronouns wrongly.
• **(d)** "Will you ... her coat" – "her" is not converted to "my".

Q.273 Select the most appropriate indirect form of the given sentence.
Cornelius said to Pauline, "You will have to agree to drive me to town from time to time."

(a) Cornelius told Pauline that she would have to agree to drive him to town from time to time.
(b) Cornelius requested Pauline to drive him to town from time to time.
(c) Cornelius said to Pauline that she will have to agree to drive him to town from time to time.
(d) Cornelius said to Pauline that you will have to agree to drive me to town from time to time.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Cornelius told Pauline that she would have to agree to drive him to town from time to time.
Type: Narration – Direct to Indirect
Rule: will → would; **you → she**; **me → him**; "said to" → **told**.
(Direct → Indirect: will → would; you → she; me → him।)
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** "requested ... to drive" – changes the meaning.
• **(c)** "will have to" – "will → would" not done.
• **(d)** keeps "you will ... me" – not converted.

Q.274 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
She asked me affectionately what she could do for me.

(a) She said to me, "What can you do for her, dear?"
(b) She said to me, "What could I do for me?"
(c) She said to me, "What can I do for you, dear?"
(d) She said to me, "What she could do for me?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She said to me, "What can I do for you, dear?"
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: "asked affectionately" → *said ... dear*; change **she could do → can I do**, **me → you**; make it a question.
(Indirect → Direct: could → can, she → I, me → you; और affectionately को "dear" जैसे शब्द से दिखाते हैं।)
Correct direct form
She said to me, **"What can I do for you, dear?"**
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** "What can you do for her" – pronouns reversed.
• **(b)** "What could I do for me" – keeps past + wrong pronoun.
• **(d)** keeps "she could do" – not converted.

Q.275 Select the most appropriate direct form of the given sentence.
A worker told his companion that he was totally exhausted and couldn't walk anymore.

(a) A worker said to his companion, "I am totally exhausted and cannot walk anymore."
(b) A worker said to his companion, "I was totally exhausted and couldn't walk anymore."
(c) A worker said to his companion, "He is totally exhausted and couldn't walk anymore."
(d) A worker said to his companion, "He was totally exhausted and couldn't walk anymore."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A worker said to his companion, "I am totally exhausted and cannot walk anymore."
Type: Narration – Indirect to Direct
Rule: back-change **was → am**, **he → I**, **couldn't → cannot**; add quotation marks.
(Indirect → Direct: was → am; he → I; couldn't → cannot।)
Correct direct form
A worker said to his companion, **"I am totally exhausted and cannot walk anymore."**
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** keeps "was ... couldn't" – not changed.
• **(c)** "He is ... couldn't" – wrong pronoun/tense mix.
• **(d)** keeps "He was" – not converted to first person.

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Q.276 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Mohit ordered Rohit to be honest.

(a) Mohit said, "Rohit, you should be honest."
(b) Mohit said, "Rohit, you can be honest."
(c) Mohit said, "Rohit, you must be honest."
(d) Mohit said, "Rohit, you would be honest."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Mohit said, "Rohit, you must be honest."
Solution:
- The reported speech is: **Mohit ordered Rohit to be honest.**
- The direct speech form of an order usually uses **"must"** or a strong directive.
- The correct direct speech is: **"Mohit said, 'Rohit, you must be honest.'"**
- Other options use weaker modal verbs or incorrect forms for an order.

Answer: (c) Mohit said, "Rohit, you must be honest."

Q.277 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
Mudassir warned the child, "Be careful and be slow."

(a) Mudassir warned the child that he should be careful and be slow.
(b) Mudassir warned the child to be careful and should be slow.
(c) Mudassir warned the child that he be careful and be slow.
(d) Mudassir warned the child to be careful and to be slow.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Mudassir warned the child to be careful and to be slow.
Solution:
- The direct speech is: **"Be careful and be slow."** (a command)
- In indirect speech, commands after verbs like "warned" are expressed with "**to + verb**" infinitives.
- The correct indirect speech is: **"Mudassir warned the child to be careful and to be slow."**
- Other options have incorrect modal verbs or sentence structure.

Answer: (d) Mudassir warned the child to be careful and to be slow.

Q.278 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The announcer requested the audience to switch off their mobile phones for the next two hours.

(a) The announcer told the audience, "You have to switch off your mobile phones for the next two hours."
(b) The announcer said to the audience, "Please switch off your mobile phones for the next two hours."
(c) The announcer said to the audience, "You all switch off your mobile phones for the next two hours."
(d) The announcer said to the audience, "You can switch off your mobile phones for the next two hours."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The announcer said to the audience, "Please switch off your mobile phones for the next two hours."
Solution:
The original sentence is in **indirect speech**:
"The announcer requested the audience to switch off their mobile phones for the next two hours."
To convert it into **direct speech**:
- "Requested" becomes **"Please"** in direct speech to retain the polite tone.
- The structure should reflect a **polite request**, not a command or statement.

Correct direct speech:
The announcer said to the audience, "Please switch off your mobile phones for the next two hours."
This matches the tone and intent of the original sentence.
Correct option: 2

Q.279 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The mother asked the daughter, "Can we buy tonight's dinner from the restaurant?"

(a) The mother asked the daughter could they buy that night's dinner from the restaurant.
(b) The mother asked the daughter if they can buy tonight's dinner from the restaurant.
(c) The mother asked the daughter if they could buy that night's dinner from the restaurant.
(d) The mother asked the daughter if could they buy that night's dinner from the restaurant.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The mother asked the daughter if they could buy that night's dinner from the restaurant.
Solution:
- The direct speech is: **The mother asked the daughter, "Can we buy tonight's dinner from the restaurant?"**
- In indirect speech, **question form changes to statement form** with "if" or "whether."
- Pronouns and time expressions change: "we" to "they," "tonight's dinner" to "that night's dinner."
- The correct indirect speech is: **"The mother asked the daughter if they could buy that night's dinner from the restaurant."**
- Other options have incorrect word order or verb forms.

Answer: (c) The mother asked the daughter if they could buy that night's dinner from the restaurant.

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Q.280 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
Mrs. Gomes said, "Virtue is its own reward."

(a) Mrs. Gomes said that Virtue had its own reward.
(b) Mrs. Gomes said that Virtue was its own reward.
(c) Mrs. Gomes said that Virtue is its own reward.
(d) Mrs. Gomes said that Virtue has its own reward.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Mrs. Gomes said that Virtue is its own reward.

- The original sentence **"Virtue is its own reward"** is a **universal truth** or a **moral principle**.
- When reporting **universal truths**, we **do not change the tense** in indirect speech.

Hence, it remains:

- **"Mrs. Gomes said that Virtue is its own reward."**

Other options incorrectly change the tense, which is not required in this context.

Q.281 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
She said, "I love to eat pineapple."

(a) She said that she loved to eat pineapple.
(b) She said that she had loved to eat pineapple.
(c) She said that she love to eat pineapple.
(d) She said that I loved to eat pineapple.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She said that she loved to eat pineapple.

Solution:

- The direct speech is: **"I love to eat pineapple."**
- In reported speech, the present tense "love" changes to past tense "loved."
- Pronoun "I" changes to "she."
- The correct indirect speech is: **"She said that she loved to eat pineapple."**
- Other options have incorrect tense or pronouns.

Answer: (a) She said that she loved to eat pineapple.

Q.282 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
She said, "I know where he lives."

(a) She said I know where he lived.
(b) She said she had knowledge of where he lived.
(c) She said that she knew where he living.
(d) She said that she knew where he lived.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She said that she knew where he lived.

Solution:

- The direct speech is: **"I know where he lives."**
- When reporting, pronouns and tense change:
  - "I" becomes "she."
  - Present tense "know" changes to past tense "knew."
  - "Lives" changes to "lived" in reported speech.
- The correct reported speech is: **"She said that she knew where he lived."**
- Other options have incorrect tense or wording.

Answer: (d) She said that she knew where he lived.

Q.283 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The teacher paused and said, "Those who are tired of listening to me can go. I shall not mind it."

(a) The teacher paused and said that those who were tired of listening to him could go and that he would not mind that.
(b) The teacher exclaimed with a pause and then said that those who are tired of listening to me can go. I shall not mind it.
(c) The teacher paused and then said that those who have been tired of listening to him would go and that he would not mind that.
(d) The teacher ordered that those who were tired of listening to him would go and that he would not mind that.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The teacher paused and said that those who were tired of listening to him could go and that he would not mind that.

Solution:

- The direct speech is: *"Those who are tired of listening to me can go. I shall not mind it."*
- In reported speech:
  - Present tense "**are tired**" changes to past tense "**were tired**."
  - Modal "**can**" changes to "**could**."
  - Future "**shall not mind**" changes to "**would not mind**."
- The correct indirect speech is: **"The teacher paused and said that those who were tired of listening to him could go and that he would not mind that."**
- Other options have incorrect tense, pronouns, or meaning.

Answer: (a) The teacher paused and said that those who were tired of listening to him could go and that he would not mind that.

Q.284 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
I asked Joe to meet for lunch on Saturday.

(a) I said, "Let's meet for lunch on Saturday, Joe".
(b) I says, "Let's meet for lunch on Saturday Joe".
(c) I said, "We shall meet for lunch at Saturday Joe".
(d) I said, "Let's meets for lunch at Saturday Joe".

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I said, "Let's meet for lunch on Saturday, Joe".

Solution:

- The reported speech is: **I asked Joe to meet for lunch on Saturday.**
- The corresponding direct speech should be an invitation or suggestion.
- The correct direct speech is: **"I said, 'Let's meet for lunch on Saturday, Joe'."**
- Other options contain incorrect verb forms or prepositions.

Answer: (a) I said, "Let's meet for lunch on Saturday, Joe".

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Q.285 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Ross said to Rachel, "We were on a break".

(a) Ross told Rachel that they used to be on a break.
(b) Ross told Rachel that they were on break.
(c) Ross told Rachel that they have been on a break.
(d) Ross told Rachel that they had been on a break.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Ross told Rachel that they had been on a break.
Solution:
- The direct speech is: **Ross said to Rachel, "We were on a break."**
- When converting to reported speech, pronouns change ("We" to "they").
- The tense shifts back from **past continuous ("were")** to **past perfect continuous ("had been")** to reflect reported speech correctly.
- The correct reported speech is: **"Ross told Rachel that they had been on a break."**
- Other options have incorrect tense or wording.

Answer: (d) Ross told Rachel that they had been on a break.

Q.286 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
Somnath said that they had been there for two-and-a-half years and were going to stay another ten months.

(a) Somnath said, "He have been here for two-and-a-half years. We are going to stay another ten months."
(b) Somnath said, "We have been here for two-and-a-half years. We are going to stay another ten months."
(c) Somnath had said , "We have been here for two-and-a-half years. We were going to stay another ten months."
(d) Somnath was saying, "We has been here for two-and-a-half years. We are going to stay another ten months."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Somnath said, "We have been here for two-and-a-half years. We are going to stay another ten months."
- The given sentence is in **indirect speech**: **"Somnath said that they had been there for two-and-a-half years and were going to stay another ten months."**
- To convert it to **direct speech**, we need to:
  - Restore the original **first-person pronouns** ("they" → "we").
  - Change **"there"** → **"here"** (place deictic shift).
  - Keep the tenses consistent with a real-time quote.
- The correct form in direct speech is: **Somnath said, "We have been here for two-and-a-half years. We are going to stay another ten months."**

Q.287 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The teacher said, "William Shakespeare was born in Stratford-upon-Avon."

(a) The teacher said that William Shakespeare has been born in Stratford-upon-Avon.
(b) The teacher said that William Shakespeare is born in Stratford-upon-Avon.
(c) The teacher said that William Shakespeare have been born in Stratford-upon-Avon.
(d) The teacher said that William Shakespeare was born in Stratford-upon-Avon.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The teacher said that William Shakespeare was born in Stratford-upon-Avon.
Solution:
- The direct speech is: **"William Shakespeare was born in Stratford-upon-Avon."**
- Since the statement is a **fact** and in the **past tense**, the tense remains the same in reported speech.
- The correct indirect speech is: **"The teacher said that William Shakespeare was born in Stratford-upon-Avon."**
- Other options have incorrect tense or auxiliary usage.

Answer: (d) The teacher said that William Shakespeare was born in Stratford-upon-Avon.

Q.288 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
I said that I would go to the temple.

(a) I said, "I will go to the temple".
(b) I said, "I can go to the temple".
(c) I said, "I go to the temple".
(d) I said, "I went to the temple".

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) I said, "I will go to the temple".
Solution:
- The reported speech is: **I said that I would go to the temple.**
- The direct speech corresponding to "would go" is "**will go**."
- The correct direct speech is: **I said, "I will go to the temple."**
- Other options use incorrect modal verbs or tense.

Answer: (a) I said, "I will go to the temple".

Q.289 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
He said, "My dog died on a cold night".

(a) He said his dog died on a cold night.
(b) He said his dog was dead on a cold night.
(c) He said his dog had died on a cold night.
(d) He said my dog died on a cold night.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He said his dog had died on a cold night.
Solution:
- The direct speech is: **"My dog died on a cold night."**

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Explanation (contd.)

- In reported speech, past simple tense "died" changes to **past perfect** "had died."
- Pronoun "My" changes to "his."
- The correct indirect speech is: **"He said his dog had died on a cold night."**
- Other options have incorrect tense or pronouns.

Answer: (c) He said his dog had died on a cold night.

Q.290 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The stranger said to me "What is your name?"

(a) The stranger asked me what was my name.
(b) The stranger asked me what my name was.
(c) The stranger has asked me what is my name.
(d) Told me what my name is.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The stranger asked me what my name was.

Solution:

- The direct speech is: **"What is your name?" the stranger said to me.**
- In reported speech, question word order changes to statement order: "**what my name was**."
- The correct indirect speech is: **"The stranger asked me what my name was."**
- Other options have incorrect word order or tense.

Answer: (b) The stranger asked me what my name was.

Q.291 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
"Where is your office?" Anita said to me.

(a) Anita enquired where my office was.
(b) Anita asked where was my office?
(c) Anita asked where my office were.
(d) Anita enquired about your office.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Anita enquired where my office was.

Solution:

- The direct speech is: **"Where is your office?" Anita said to me.**
- In reported speech, **question form changes to statement form** without inversion.
- Pronouns and verb tense change: "your office is" → "my office was."
- The correct reported speech is: **"Anita enquired where my office was."**
- Other options have incorrect word order or verb agreement.

Answer: (a) Anita enquired where my office was.

Q.292 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The coach said, "Bravo! You have played well".

(a) The coach informed him that he played well.
(b) The coach exclaimed that he played well.
(c) The coach exclaimed that he had played well.
(d) The coach praised that he has played well.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The coach exclaimed that he had played well.

Solution:

- The direct speech is: **"Bravo! You have played well."**
- The sentence expresses **praise** with present perfect tense ("have played").
- In reported speech, present perfect changes to past perfect ("had played").
- The correct indirect speech is: **"The coach exclaimed that he had played well."**
- Other options either change meaning or use incorrect tense.

Answer: (c) The coach exclaimed that he had played well.

Q.293 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Mother said that Sam would not pass.

(a) Mother said, "Sam will not pass."
(b) Mother said, "Sam would not pass."
(c) Mother said, "Sam will have never passed."
(d) Mother said, "Sam would never pass."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Mother said, "Sam will not pass."

Solution:

- The reported speech is: **Mother said that Sam would not pass.**
- The corresponding direct speech usually uses "**will**" for future prediction.
- The correct direct speech is: **"Mother said, 'Sam will not pass.'"**
- Other options either use incorrect tense or awkward phrasing.

Answer: (a) Mother said, "Sam will not pass."

Q.294 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
I said to him, "Please stay here tonight."

(a) I asked him if he would stay there that night.
(b) I requested him to stay there that night.
(c) I requested him to please stay there tonight.
(d) I asked him to please stay here that night.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) I requested him to stay there that night.

Solution

Step 1: Identify the speech type

- The direct sentence expresses a **polite request**: "Please stay here tonight."

Step 2: Choose the correct reporting verb

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Explanation (contd.)

- For requests, we use **"requested"** rather than "asked ... if" (which introduces a yes/no question in indirect speech).

Step 3: Change pronouns and time expressions

- "**here**" becomes **"there"**
- "**tonight**" becomes **"that night"**

Step 4: Use the infinitive form of the verb

- The structure is **"requested him to stay..."**

Why the other forms are unsuitable

- A yes/no construction ("asked him if he would stay...") doesn't convey the imperative/request.
- Retaining "tonight" instead of "that night" fails to shift the time reference.
- Adding "please" in the indirect form is unnecessary once "requested" is used.

Correct indirect form:
I requested him to stay there that night.

Q.295 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The teacher said to Kavya, "You need a new notebook for English."

(a) The teacher told Kavya that you needed a new notebook for English.
(b) The teacher told to Kavya that she needs a new notebook for English.
(c) The teacher said to Kavya that you need a new notebook for English.
(d) The teacher told Kavya that she needed a new notebook for English.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The teacher told Kavya that she needed a new notebook for English.

Solution

Direct speech:
The teacher said to Kavya, "You need a new notebook for English."

Steps to convert to indirect speech

1. **Reporting verb**: "said to" → **told** (takes an object).
2. **Pronoun change**: "you" (addressing Kavya) → **she**.
3. **Tense back-shift**: Present "need" → Past "needed" (because the reporting verb is in the past).
4. Keep the rest of the clause unchanged.

Indirect form:
The teacher told Kavya that she needed a new notebook for English.

Why the other options are incorrect

- Uses "you" instead of "she" or keeps present tense "need"/"needs", or wrongly includes "told to Kavya."

Correct answer: The teacher told Kavya that she needed a new notebook for English.

Q.296 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
I suggested to my brother that we should go to the hills for a change.

(a) I said to my brother, "Shall we go to the hills for a change?"
(b) I requested to my brother, " We should go to the hills for a change."
(c) I said to my brother, " We shall go to the hills for a change."
(d) I said to my brother, " Let us go to the hills for a change."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I said to my brother, " Let us go to the hills for a change."

Solution:
The sentence is in **indirect speech** with the reporting verb **"suggested"** and the structure **"we should go..."**, which indicates a **suggestion** or **proposal**. The correct direct speech for such a suggestion is usually formed with **"Let us..."**.
option (d): "I said to my brother, 'Let us go to the hills for a change.'" accurately reflects the original meaning and tone.
option (a) is incorrect because "Shall we..." turns the suggestion into a question.
option (b) is incorrect as "requested to" is grammatically wrong (we say "requested someone", not "requested to").
option (c) is incorrect as it states a decision rather than a suggestion.
Answer: option (d).

Q.297 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to me, " I have done my duty."

(a) He told me that he have done his duty.
(b) He told me that he did his duty.
(c) He told me that he had done his duty.
(d) He told me that I had done my duty.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He told me that he had done his duty.

Solution:
The sentence **"He said to me, 'I have done my duty.'"** is in **direct speech** and **present perfect tense**.
To convert it to **indirect speech**, we need to:

- Change **"said to"** to **"told"**
- Backshift the **present perfect ("have done")** to **past perfect ("had done")**
- Change pronouns appropriately: **"I"** → **"he"**, **"my"** → **"his"**

Correct indirect sentence:
"He told me that he had done his duty."
option (a): incorrect verb form ("have" instead of "had")
option (b): wrong tense ("did" instead of "had done")
option (c): correct structure, tense, and pronoun
option (d): incorrect pronoun shift (uses "I" and "my" instead of "he" and "his")
Answer: option (c) (He told me that he had done his duty.).

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Q.298 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
Rani said to her boss, "I am going to visit Kashmir and Ladakh next month."

(a) Rani informs her boss that she is going to visit Kashmir and Ladakh the next month.
(b) Rani asked her boss that she wanted to visit Kashmir and Ladakh the following month.
(c) Rani told her boss that I am going to visit Kashmir and Ladakh next month.
(d) Rani informed her boss that she was going to visit Kashmir and Ladakh the following month.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Rani informed her boss that she was going to visit Kashmir and Ladakh the following month.
Solution:
The direct sentence is:
"Rani said to her boss, 'I am going to visit Kashmir and Ladakh next month.'"
To convert it into **indirect speech**, follow these rules:
- **"said to"** becomes **"informed"** or **"told"** (since it's a statement, not a question)
- **"I am going to"** → becomes **"she was going to"** (pronoun and tense shift)
- **"next month"** → becomes **"the following month"** (time expression shift)

option (a): Incorrect – uses present tense ("informs") instead of past
option (b): Incorrect – changes the sentence type from a statement to a request
option (c): Incorrect – keeps "I am" instead of changing to "she was"
option (d): correct transformation with proper tense, pronoun, and time reference
Answer: option (d) (Rani informed her boss that she was going to visit Kashmir and Ladakh the following month.).

Q.299 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
You said to me, " I shall reach in time for the concert."

(a) You told me that you shall reach in time for the concert.
(b) You told me that you would reach in time for the concert.
(c) You told me that I would reach in time for the concert.
(d) You told me that I should reach in time for the concert.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) You told me that you would reach in time for the concert.
Solution:
- The reporting verb **"said"** is in the past tense, so the modal verb **"shall"** changes to **"would"** in reported speech.
- The pronoun **"I"** changes to **"you"** to match the subject of the reporting clause.
- The structure of the sentence remains intact as a statement, so "that" is used as a connector.

Correct sentence:
You told me that you would reach in time for the concert.

Q.300 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
He says that he will clear all his dues by the following month.

(a) He says, " I will clear all his dues by next month."
(b) He said, " I will clear all my dues by next month."
(c) He says, " I will clear all my dues by next month."
(d) He said, " I would clear all my dues by next month."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He says, " I will clear all my dues by next month."
Solution:
- The original sentence is in **indirect speech**, in **present reporting verb** ("He says"), so the tense of the reported speech does **not** change.
- The original sentence: *He says that he will clear all his dues by the following month.*
- In direct speech:
  - "He says" remains unchanged.
  - "He will clear" becomes "I will clear" (first person as spoken by the subject).
  - "His dues" becomes "my dues."
  - "The following month" becomes "next month" in direct speech.

Correct sentence:
He says, "I will clear all my dues by next month."

Q.301 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The ticket collector asked the passenger why he had not purchased a full ticket for his daughter.

(a) The ticket collector said to the passenger, "Why haven't you purchased a full ticket for his daughter?"
(b) The ticket collector said to the passenger, "Why he had not purchased a full ticket for his daughter?"
(c) The ticket collector said to the passenger, "Why didn't you purchase a full ticket for your daughter?"
(d) The ticket collector said to the passenger, "Why haven't you purchase a full ticket for your daughter?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The ticket collector said to the passenger, "Why didn't you purchase a full ticket for your daughter?"
Solution:
The sentence is in **indirect speech** and reports a **past question**. To convert it into **direct speech**, we change **"asked"** to **"said to"**, restore the **original question format**, and use **past tense** to reflect the timing. The correct direct form is: **"The ticket collector said to the passenger, 'Why didn't you purchase a full ticket for your daughter?'"**
option (a) is incorrect as it uses **present perfect** ("haven't") instead of **past**.
option (b) is incorrect because it retains the **indirect structure**.
option (c) is correct with proper **question form**, **past tense**, and **pronouns**.
option (d) is incorrect due to **incorrect verb form** ("haven't you purchase").

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Q.302 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to me, " I am going to France next week."

(a) He told me that I am going to France the following week.
(b) He told me that he was going to France the following week.
(c) He said to me that he will go to France next week.
(d) He said to me that he were going to France next week.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He told me that he was going to France the following week.
Solution:
The given sentence is in **direct speech** with the reporting verb **"said to"**, which changes to **"told"** in indirect speech. The reported statement is in **present continuous tense ("am going")**, which changes to **past continuous ("was going")** in indirect speech. Also, **"next week"** changes to **"the following week"**.
option (b): "He told me that he was going to France the following week." uses correct verb form, pronoun change, and time expression.
option (a) is incorrect because "I am" should change to "he was".
option (c) is incorrect because "will go" should change to "was going".
option (d) is incorrect because "he were" is grammatically wrong; "he was" is correct.
Answer: option (b).

Q.303 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
He said to his friend, " Let us leave for the trek tomorrow."

(a) He suggested to his friend that they should leave for the trek the next day.
(b) He suggested to his friend to leave for the trek the next day.
(c) He told his friend to leave for the trek the next day.
(d) He suggested his friend that let us leave for the trek tomorrow.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He suggested to his friend that they should leave for the trek the next day.
Solution:
The direct sentence is: **"He said to his friend, 'Let us leave for the trek tomorrow.'"**
This is a **suggestion**, and when converting such expressions into **indirect speech**, we use the reporting verb **"suggested"**, and replace **"Let us"** with **"they should"**. Also, **"tomorrow"** changes to **"the next day"** in indirect speech.
Correct indirect form:
"He suggested to his friend that they should leave for the trek the next day."
option (a): correct reporting verb, pronoun change, and time expression
option (b): incorrect structure — "suggested to... to leave" is ungrammatical
option (c): "told... to leave" changes the meaning (instruction, not suggestion)
option (d): grammatically incorrect and awkward
Answer: option (a) (He suggested to his friend that they should leave for the trek the next day.).

Q.304 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
You said, " Priya kept watching television till her mother exploded at her."

(a) You said that Priya had kept watching television till her mother had exploded at her.
(b) You said that Priya kept watching television till her mother had exploded at her.
(c) You said that Priya kept watching television till her mother exploded at her.
(d) You said that Priya had kept watching television till her mother exploded at her.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) You said that Priya had kept watching television till her mother exploded at her.
Solution:
The original sentence is in **past simple tense**:
"Priya kept watching television till her mother exploded at her."
When converting to **indirect speech**, we follow these rules:
- The reporting verb is **"said"** (past), so the reported clause usually undergoes **backshifting**.
- **"Kept watching"** (past continuous-like) → becomes **"had kept watching"** (past perfect)
- **"Exploded"** (simple past) → may or may not change depending on sequence.

Best tense combination:
"You said that Priya had kept watching television till her mother exploded at her."
Here, "had kept watching" shows the continued action, and "exploded" remains in simple past to show what happened after.
option (a) – incorrect: double past perfect ("had exploded") is unnecessary
option (b) – incorrect: "kept watching" not backshifted
option (c) – same error as above
option (d) – correct mix of past perfect and past simple
Answer: option (d) (You said that Priya had kept watching television till her mother exploded at her.).

Q.305 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
She said to him, "I will call you tomorrow."

(a) She said to him that she will call him tomorrow.
(b) She said to him that she would call you the next day.
(c) She said to him that I will call you tomorrow.
(d) She said to him that she would call him the next day.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She said to him that she would call him the next day.
- Direct: She said to him, "I will call you tomorrow."
- Change to reported speech:
  - **will → would** (backshift of tense)
  - **you → him** (change of pronoun)
  - **tomorrow → the next day** (time expression shift)
- Thus, the correct reported sentence is:
  "She said to him that she would call him the next day."

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Q.306 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
Ankit said to Ashna, "Do you know that the annual meeting has been postponed?"

(a) Ankit asked Ashna that do you know that the annual meeting has been postponed.
(b) Ankit asked Ashna if she knew that the annual meeting had been postponed.
(c) Ankit asked Ashna if she had known that the annual meeting was postponed.
(d) Ankit asked Ashna if she would be knowing that the annual meeting had been postponed.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Ankit asked Ashna if she knew that the annual meeting had been postponed.
Solution:
The sentence is a **yes/no question in direct speech**, so when converting to **indirect speech**, we follow these rules:
- **"said to"** changes to **"asked"** (because it's a question)
- The question **"Do you know..."** becomes a statement starting with **"if"** or **"whether"**
- **"Do you know"** (present simple) → **"she knew"** (past simple)
- The clause **"has been postponed"** (present perfect) → becomes **"had been postponed"** (past perfect)

Correct sentence: **"Ankit asked Ashna if she knew that the annual meeting had been postponed."**
option (a) – incorrect word order and retains question form
option (b) – correct in structure, tense, and pronoun use
option (c) – incorrect: "had known" changes meaning; "was postponed" incorrect tense
option (d) – incorrect: "would be knowing" is awkward and wrong tense
Answer: option (b) (Ankit asked Ashna if she knew that the annual meeting had been postponed.).

Q.307 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
He asked me if anybody had been rude to me.

(a) He said to me, " Had has been rude to me?"
(b) He said to me, " Has anybody been rude to you?"
(c) He said to me, " Anybody has been rude to me?"
(d) He said to me, " Anybody has been rude to you?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He said to me, " Has anybody been rude to you?"
Solution:
- The given sentence is in **indirect speech**, using a past tense reporting verb ("asked") and a **yes/no question** format.
- The structure **"if anybody had been rude to me"** corresponds to **"Has anybody been rude to you?"** in direct speech.
- The correct pronoun shift is from **"me"** (in indirect) to **"you"** (in direct), and **"had been"** (past perfect) back to **"has been"** (present perfect).
- The auxiliary verb **"has"** must come before the subject in interrogative direct speech.

Correct sentence:
He said to me, "Has anybody been rude to you?"

Q.308 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
He told her that he could not marry her then but he would surely do so the following year.

(a) He said to her, " I cannot marry her then but I will surely do so next year."
(b) He said to her, " I could not marry you then but I will surely do so next year."
(c) He said to her, " He cannot marry you now but he will surely do so next year."
(d) He said to her, " I cannot marry you now but I will surely do so next year."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He said to her, " I cannot marry you now but I will surely do so next year."
Solution:
The original sentence is in **indirect speech** and past tense:
"He told her that he could not marry her then but he would surely do so the following year."
To convert it into **direct speech**:
- **"He told her"** → becomes **"He said to her"**
- **"he could not"** → becomes **"I cannot"** (restore original speaker's voice)
- **"her"** → becomes **"you"** (pronoun shift for direct address)
- **"then"** → becomes **"now"**
- **"he would"** → becomes **"I will"**
- **"the following year"** → becomes **"next year"**

Correct direct speech:
"He said to her, 'I cannot marry you now but I will surely do so next year.'"
option (a): uses "her" instead of "you"
option (b): mixes past and future, and uses "could not" incorrectly
option (c): incorrect pronouns and tense
option (d): correct pronouns, tense, and time expressions
Answer: option (d) (He said to her, "I cannot marry you now but I will surely do so next year.").

Q.309 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
She said, "I am going to the park."

(a) She said she may be going to the park.
(b) She said she will go to the park.
(c) She said that she is going to the park.
(d) She said that she was going to the park.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She said that she was going to the park.
The sentence is in **direct speech** and needs to be changed into **indirect speech**. The reporting verb "said" is in the **past tense**, so the tense of the reported clause must also shift back in time:
- **"I am going to the park."** → Present continuous tense
- In indirect speech, present continuous becomes **past continuous**:
  "was going"

Also, the pronoun **"I"** (referring to the speaker) changes to **"she"**.
So the correct transformation is:
"She said that she was going to the park."

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Q.310 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Praveen told his mother that he had completed his homework.

(a) Praveen said to his mother, "I have been completing my homework."
(b) Praveen said to his mother, "He had completed my homework."
(c) Praveen said to his mother, "I am completing my homework."
(d) Praveen said to his mother, "I have completed my homework."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Praveen said to his mother, "I have completed my homework."
Solution:
The sentence is in **indirect speech** and reports a **past perfect action** ("he had completed his homework"). To convert it into **direct speech**, we reverse the backshifted tense:

- **"had completed"** in indirect becomes **"have completed"** in direct.
- The pronoun **"he"** changes back to **"I"** (Praveen is speaking about himself).
- The reporting verb **"told"** becomes **"said to"** for direct speech.

Correct direct speech: **"Praveen said to his mother, 'I have completed my homework.'"**
option (a) is incorrect (tense is present perfect continuous).
option (b) is incorrect (wrong pronoun usage: "he" and "my" conflict).
option (c) is incorrect (tense is present continuous).
option (d) is correct in tense, pronouns, and structure.
Answer: option (d).

Q.311 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
Umesh said to his father, " Can you give me more money?"

(a) Umesh asked his father if he could give him more money.
(b) Umesh asked his father if he can give him more money.
(c) Umesh asked his father that if he could give him more money.
(d) Umesh asked his father could he give him more money.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Umesh asked his father if he could give him more money.
Solution:
The direct sentence is an **interrogative sentence** in the **present tense**. When converting to **indirect speech**, **"said to"** changes to **"asked"**, the question form is changed into a **statement**, and **"can"** changes to **"could"** due to **backshifting**. The correct sentence is: **"Umesh asked his father if he could give him more money."**
option (a) is **correct**.
option (b) is **incorrect** because **"can"** should change to **"could"**.
option (c) is **incorrect** because **"that"** is not used before **"if"** in indirect questions.
option (d) is **incorrect** because it wrongly retains **question word order** in indirect speech.

Q.312 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Looking at his watch Barin Babu observed that they were running more or less on time.

(a) Looking at his watch Barin Babu said, "They were running more or less on time."
(b) Looking at his watch Barin Babu said, "We are running more or less on time."
(c) Looking at his watch Barin Babu said, "They had been running more or less on time."
(d) Looking at his watch Barin Babu said, "We have been running more or less on time."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Looking at his watch Barin Babu said, "We are running more or less on time."
Solution:

- The original sentence is in **indirect speech**, where "they were running more or less on time" is a reported statement made by **Barin Babu**.
- Since **Barin Babu is part of the group**, the correct pronoun in direct speech should be **"we"**, not "they".
- The verb **"were running"** in indirect speech (past continuous) comes from **"are running"** in direct speech (present continuous), due to backshifting in reported speech.
- The reporting verb **"observed"** is in the past, so we revert it to present in direct speech.

Correct sentence:
Looking at his watch Barin Babu said, "We are running more or less on time."

Q.313 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Amanda asked Mohit how she had offended his friend.

(a) Amanda said to Mohit, "How have I offend your friend?"
(b) Amanda said to Mohit, "How did I offended his friend?"
(c) Amanda said to Mohit, "How she had offended his friend?"
(d) Amanda said to Mohit, "How have I offended your friend?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Amanda said to Mohit, "How have I offended your friend?"
Solution:
The sentence is in **indirect speech**, reporting a **question** in the **past perfect tense**.
When converting to **direct speech**, we:

- Restore the original **question format**
- Change pronouns: "she" → "I", "his" → "your"
- Use the correct tense: **past perfect ("had offended")** in indirect becomes **present perfect ("have I offended")** in direct
- Maintain **question word order**

Correct direct form: **"Amanda said to Mohit, 'How have I offended your friend?'"**
option (a) – incorrect verb form ("offend" instead of "offended")
option (b) – grammatically incorrect ("did I offended")
option (c) – incorrect structure (still in indirect form)
option (d) – correct in tense, pronouns, and structure
Answer: option (d) (Amanda said to Mohit, "How have I offended your friend?").

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Q.314 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
I asked my friend how one could be merry when everything was so messed up.

(a) I asked to my friend, " How can one be merry when everything was so messed up?"
(b) I said to my friend, " How one could be merry when everything was so messed up?"
(c) I said to my friend, " How can one be merry when everything is so messed up?"
(d) I said to my friend, " Could one be merry when everything is so messed up?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I said to my friend, " How can one be merry when everything is so messed up?"
Solution:
The indirect sentence is:
"I asked my friend how one could be merry when everything was so messed up."
To convert it to **direct speech**, we need to:
- Restore original tense: **"could be"** becomes **"can be"** (backshift correction)
- Match the structure of a **question in reported form**, making it sound natural in direct speech
- Maintain the **general truth tone** of the question if appropriate

Correct direct form:
"I said to my friend, 'How can one be merry when everything is so messed up?'"
option (a) – incorrect structure ("asked to my friend")
option (b) – incorrect tense and structure
option (c) – correct grammar, structure, and tense
option (d) – changes meaning (uses "Could" instead of original intent)
Answer: option (c) (I said to my friend, "How can one be merry when everything is so messed up?").

Q.315 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The manager said, "I will give you a raise next month."

(a) The manager said that I would have gotten a raise the next month.
(b) The manager said that he would have given me a raise the next month.
(c) The manager said that he would give me a raise the next month.
(d) The manager said that I would get a raise the next month.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The manager said that he would give me a raise the next month.
- **Direct speech:** "I will give you a raise next month."
- **Indirect speech:** The tense shifts from **"will" to "would"**, and **pronouns** change appropriately.
- "I" (the manager) becomes **"he"**, and "you" becomes **"me"**.
- "Next month" remains **"the next month"** in reported speech.

Hence, the sentence becomes:
"The manager said that he would give me a raise the next month."

Q.316 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
I said to Prachi, "I visited Maldives last week ."

(a) I told Prachi that I had visited Maldives last week.
(b) I told Prachi that I had visited Maldives the previous week.
(c) I told Prachi that I visited Maldives last week.
(d) I told Prachi that I have visited Maldives the previous week.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) I told Prachi that I had visited Maldives the previous week.
Solution:
The direct sentence is:
"I said to Prachi, 'I visited Maldives last week.'"
To convert this to indirect speech:
- The reporting verb is **"said to"**, which becomes **"told"**.
- The verb **"visited"** (simple past) changes to **"had visited"** (past perfect) in indirect speech.
- The time phrase **"last week"** changes to **"the previous week"**.

Correct transformation:
"I told Prachi that I had visited Maldives the previous week."
option (a): Incorrect – "last week" should become "the previous week"
option (b): Correct transformation
option (c): Incorrect – verb not changed to past perfect
option (d): Incorrect – "have visited" is wrong tense
Answer: option (b) (I told Prachi that I had visited Maldives the previous week.)

Q.317 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
She exclaimed with regret that she had acted very foolishly

(a) "Ah! Have I acted foolishly?" she said.
(b) "Alas! How foolishly I have acted," she said.
(c) Oh! I regret having acted foolishly," she said.
(d) "I have acted foolishly," she said.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) "Alas! How foolishly I have acted," she said.
Solution:
The given sentence is in **indirect speech** with an **exclamatory tone** and the emotion **regret**.
The phrase **"She exclaimed with regret..."** suggests the use of **"Alas!"** in direct speech, which is often used to express sorrow or regret.
Also, the clause **"she had acted very foolishly"** in indirect speech becomes **"How foolishly I have acted"** in direct speech, preserving the emotional and exclamatory tone.
option (a): Interrogative sentence – incorrect tone and structure
option (b): Correct tone, punctuation, and emotional expression
option (c): Possible, but less idiomatic and lacks the exclamatory format
option (d): Statement without emotion – does not match "exclaimed with regret"
Answer: option (b) ("Alas! How foolishly I have acted," she said.).

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Q.318 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
Isha told Shivani that they didn't need to buy tickets for the match as she had been given free passes for two.

(a) Isha said to Shivani, "They didn't need to buy tickets for the match as I am given free passes for two."
(b) Isha said to Shivani, "We didn't need to buy tickets for the match as I am given free passes for two."
(c) Isha said to Shivani, "We don't need to buy tickets for the match as I have been given free passes for two."
(d) Isha said to Shivani, "They didn't need to buy tickets for the match as she was given free passes for two."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Isha said to Shivani, "We don't need to buy tickets for the match as I have been given free passes for two."
The correct direct form of the given sentence is:
Isha said to Shivani, "We don't need to buy tickets for the match as I have been given free passes for two."

- **Reported speech (past) → Direct speech (present perfect/present)** if the context still applies or is general.
- **"they"** becomes **"we"** (since Isha and Shivani are involved).
- **"didn't need"** changes to **"don't need"** if the situation is still valid at the time of speaking.
- **"she had been given" → "I have been given"** (Isha is speaking).

Correct Answer:
(c) Isha said to Shivani, "We don't need to buy tickets for the match as I have been given free passes for two."

Q.319 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
She said, " If only I could relive my past!"

(a) She said that she could relive her past.
(b) She wished if she could relive my past.
(c) She wished that she could relive her past.
(d) She wished that if she could relive her past.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She wished that she could relive her past.
Solution:
The direct sentence is:
"She said, 'If only I could relive my past!'"
This is an expression of **wish or regret**, typically introduced in indirect speech with **"She wished that..."**
Now let's apply the correct transformation:

- **"I"** becomes **"she"**
- **"my"** becomes **"her"**
- The phrase **"If only I could..."** becomes **"She wished that she could..."**

Correct indirect speech:
"She wished that she could relive her past."
option (a): incorrect tone; doesn't reflect the wish/regret
option (b): grammatically incorrect ("wished if") and wrong pronoun ("my")
option (c): correct transformation with accurate pronouns and structure
option (d): grammatically incorrect ("wished that if")
Answer: option (c) (She wished that she could relive her past.).

Q.320 Select the correct direct form of the given sentence.
The old man prayed to God to help him in his hour of sorrow.

(a) The old man said, " O God, help him in my hour of sorrow."
(b) The old man said, " O God, help me in my hour of sorrow."
(c) The old man said, " God must help him in his hour of sorrow."
(d) The old man said, " O God, help me in his hour of sorrow."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The old man said, " O God, help me in my hour of sorrow."
Solution:
The given sentence is in **indirect speech** and describes a **prayer** made by the old man to God. To convert it into **direct speech**, we need to:

- Retain the **form of a prayer or request**
- Restore **first-person pronouns** ("him" → "me", "his" → "my")
- Use **quotation marks** around the prayer

Correct direct form: **"The old man said, 'O God, help me in my hour of sorrow.'"**
option (a) – incorrect: mixes "him" and "my", which is inconsistent
option (b) – correct: uses "me" and "my", matching the speaker's voice
option (c) – incorrect: uses a declarative statement, not a prayer
option (d) – incorrect: mismatched pronouns ("me" and "his")
Answer: option (b) (The old man said, "O God, help me in my hour of sorrow.").

Q.321 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The MLA said that they planned to make that area a safe place to live in.

(a) The MLA said, "They planned to make this area a safe place to live in."
(b) The MLA said, "We are planning to make this area a safe place to live in."
(c) The MLA said, "They have planned to make this area a safe place to live in."
(d) The MLA said, "We plan to make this area a safe place to live in."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The MLA said, "We plan to make this area a safe place to live in."

- In reported speech:
  *The MLA said that **they planned** to make **that** area a safe place to live in.*
- When converting to direct speech:
  - "they" becomes **"we"** (as the MLA is speaking for a group including themselves),
  - "planned" becomes **"plan"** (simple present used to reflect current intention),
  - "that area" becomes **"this area"** (as it's direct).

Hence, the accurate direct speech is:
"We plan to make this area a safe place to live in."

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Q.322 Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence.
The airhostess said to the passengers, "This is our inaugural flight starting today."

(a) The airhostess informed the passengers that it was their inaugural flight starting that day.
(b) The airhostess said to the passengers that this is our inaugural flight starting today.
(c) The airhostess told to the passengers that it was their inaugural flight starting that day.
(d) The airhostess informed the passengers that it was their inaugural flight starting today.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The airhostess informed the passengers that it was their inaugural flight starting that day.
Solution:
The given sentence is in **direct speech** and uses **present tense ("this is")** and **today**, both of which must be changed when converting to **indirect speech**.

- **"This"** becomes **"that"**
- **"Our"** becomes **"their"** (pronoun shift from speaker to subject)
- **"Today"** becomes **"that day"**
  The reporting verb **"said to"** should be changed to **"informed"** or **"told"**, and "told" does not take "to" before the object.

option (a): "The airhostess informed the passengers that it was their inaugural flight starting that day." is correct in terms of verb, pronoun, and time expression.
option (b) is incorrect because it doesn't change tense and pronouns.
option (c) is incorrect due to incorrect use of "told to".
option (d) is incorrect because it doesn't change "today" to "that day".
Answer: option (a).

Q.323 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Mr. Prakash asked Rajesh if he wanted to work as an accountant for his company.

(a) Mr. Prakash said to Rajesh, "Does he want to work as an accountant for his company?"
(b) Mr. Prakash said to Rajesh, "Why don't you work as an accountant for my company?"
(c) Mr. Prakash said to Rajesh, "Do you want to work as an accountant for my company?"
(d) Mr. Prakash said to Rajesh, "Would you want to work as an accountant for my company?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Mr. Prakash said to Rajesh, "Do you want to work as an accountant for my company?"

- The sentence is a **reported yes/no question** in indirect speech.
- "Mr. Prakash asked Rajesh if he wanted..." in **direct speech** becomes:
  "Do you want to work..." (present tense of "want")
- Also, "his company" changes to **"my company"** in direct speech to reflect Mr. Prakash's words.
- Option (c) is the correct transformation of the reported sentence into direct speech.

Q.324 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Kavya said that she was going to have a nap in the afternoon.

(a) Kavya said, "I am having a nap in the afternoon."
(b) Kavya says, "She is going to have a nap in the afternoon."
(c) Kavya said, "She was going to have a nap in the afternoon."
(d) Kavya said, "I am going to have a nap in the afternoon."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Kavya said, "I am going to have a nap in the afternoon."
Solution:
Given Sentence (Indirect Speech):
"Kavya said that she was going to have a nap in the afternoon."
Conversion to Direct Speech:

- The reporting verb **"said"** is in the **past tense**.
- **"She was going to have"** → becomes **"I am going to have"** in direct speech (since Kavya is talking about herself).
- The time expression **"in the afternoon"** remains the same.

Correct Direct Speech Form:
"Kavya said, 'I am going to have a nap in the afternoon.'"
Why the other options are incorrect:

- Option (a): **"I am having a nap..."** – incorrect tense.
- Option (b): **"Kavya says..."** – changes the reporting verb tense and subject.
- Option (c): **"She was going to..."** – fails to convert pronoun and keeps reported speech.

Correct answer: Kavya said, "I am going to have a nap in the afternoon." (Option (d)

Q.325 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
"We can't believe we won the competition!" they said with joy.

(a) They exclaimed with joy that they couldn't believe they won the competition.
(b) They exclaimed with joy that they can't believe they won the competition.
(c) They exclaimed with joy that we couldn't believe we had won the competition.
(d) They exclaimed with joy that they couldn't believe they had won the competition.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) They exclaimed with joy that they couldn't believe they had won the competition.

- **Direct Speech:** "We can't believe we won the competition!"
- **Indirect Speech Conversion:**
  - **Tense changes:** "can't believe" → "couldn't believe", "won" → "had won"
  - **Pronouns change:** "we" → "they"
  - **Exclamatory tone retained:** "exclaimed with joy"

Hence, the most appropriate indirect speech is:
"They exclaimed with joy that they couldn't believe they had won the competition."

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Q.326 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
He said, "I visited Paris last summer."

(a) He said that he had visited Paris the previous summer.
(b) He said that he had been visiting Paris the previous summer.
(c) He said that I visited Paris last summer.
(d) He said that he was visiting Paris last summer.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He said that he had visited Paris the previous summer.
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **direct speech**:
  "He said, 'I visited Paris last summer.'"
- To convert it into **reported (indirect) speech**:
  - The reporting verb **"said"** is in the **past tense**, so the verb in the reported speech must follow the **backshift rule**.
  - "Visited" (simple past) changes to **"had visited"** (past perfect).
  - "Last summer" changes to **"the previous summer"** in reported speech.
  - Pronoun "I" becomes "he" (referring to the subject "he").
- Correct reported speech form:
  "He said that he had visited Paris the previous summer."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (b): **"had been visiting"** – incorrect tense; implies a continuous action.
  - Option (c): **"I visited"** – incorrect pronoun; should be "he".
  - Option (d): **"was visiting"** – incorrect tense and aspect.

Correct reported speech form:
"He said that he had visited Paris the previous summer."

Q.327 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Mother asked Rubani if she was sorry for what she had done.

(a) Mother said to Rubani, "Are you sorry for what she did?"
(b) Mother said to Rubani, "Are you sorry for what you have done?"
(c) Mother said to Rubani, "Were you sorry for what you have done?"
(d) Mother said to Rubani, "Do you feel sorry for what you are doing?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Mother said to Rubani, "Are you sorry for what you have done?"
To change the **indirect speech** to **direct speech**, we must:

- Use the correct reporting verb form — *"asked"* changes to *"said to"* in direct speech when forming a question.
- Restore the original pronouns: *she* → *you*, *she had done* → *you have done*.
- Maintain the correct tense for a present perfect action.

Given all these points, the correct direct speech version is:
Mother said to Rubani, "Are you sorry for what you have done?"

Q.328 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The coach said, "You should practice every day."

(a) The coach said that I should have practiced every day.
(b) The coach said that I should practice every day.
(c) The coach said that I will practice every day.
(d) The coach said that I would practice every day.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The coach said that I should practice every day.
Solution:

- The original sentence is in **direct speech**:
  "The coach said, 'You should practice every day.'"
- The reporting verb **"said"** is in the past, but **"should"** is a **modal verb** that typically **remains unchanged** in indirect speech when expressing advice or recommendation.
- Pronoun **"you"** changes to **"I"**, assuming the speaker is reporting it from their own perspective.
- Therefore, the correct indirect speech form is:
  "The coach said that I should practice every day."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"should have practiced"** – changes the meaning to a past regret.
  - Option (c): **"will practice"** – shifts from advice to future intent.
  - Option (d): **"would practice"** – changes both the modal and meaning.

Correct answer: The coach said that I should practice every day.

Q.329 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
She told me that she had loved the outing with me the previous evening.

(a) She said to me, "She had loved the outing with me the previous evening."
(b) She said to me, "I loved the outing with you last evening."
(c) She said to me, "I love the outing with me last evening."
(d) She said to me, "She has loved the outing with you the previous evening."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She said to me, "I loved the outing with you last evening."

- The given sentence is in **reported (indirect) speech** and needs to be changed to **direct speech**.
- Key tense indicators:
  - "had loved" in indirect becomes **"loved"** in direct (past simple).
  - "the previous evening" becomes **"last evening"** in direct speech.
  - Pronoun shift: "she" → "I", and "me" → "you" when quoting her directly.

Only **option (b)** correctly converts the sentence back to direct speech with appropriate:

- **Pronoun changes**
- **Tense adjustment**
- **Time reference** conversion

Therefore, option (b) is the correct answer.

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Q.330 Select the option that expresses the following sentence in direct speech.
She told me that she had visited Paris last summer.

(a) "I visited Paris last summer," she told me.
(b) "I have been visiting Paris last summer," she told me.
(c) "I will visit Paris next summer," she told me.
(d) "I am visiting Paris next summer," she told me.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) "I visited Paris last summer," she told me.
Solution:
Given Sentence (Indirect Speech):
"She told me that she had visited Paris last summer."
Conversion to Direct Speech:
- **"She had visited"** → becomes **"I visited"** (past perfect → simple past).
- **"Last summer"** remains unchanged as it's a specific past time reference.
- **Pronoun "she"** → becomes **"I"** in direct speech, as it's her own words.

Correct Direct Speech Form:
"I visited Paris last summer," she told me.
Why other options are incorrect:
- Option (b): **"have been visiting"** – present perfect continuous; incorrect tense.
- Option (c): **"will visit next summer"** – changes both the tense and time reference.
- Option (d): **"am visiting next summer"** – incorrect tense and time expression.

Correct answer: "I visited Paris last summer," she told me. (Option (a)

Q.331 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The guard said that his family had gone to his village the previous week.

(a) The guard said, "My family went to my village last week."
(b) The guard said, "My family had gone to my village the previous week."
(c) The guard said, "His family went to his village the previous week."
(d) The guard said, "My family was going to my village last week."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The guard said, "My family went to my village last week."
The guard said, "My family went to my village last week."
- The original **reported speech** sentence is:
  The guard said that his family had gone to his village the previous week.
- To convert it to **direct speech**, we need to:
  - Change **"his family"** to **"my family"**
  - Change **"had gone"** to **"went"**
  - Change **"the previous week"** to **"last week"**

So, the correct direct speech form is:
"The guard said, 'My family went to my village last week.'"
Which matches **option (a)**.

Q.332 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Grandmother asked the little girl if she was hungry.

(a) Grandmother said to the little girl, "Is she hungry?"
(b) Grandmother said to the little girl, "Are you hungry?"
(c) Grandmother said to the little girl, "Was she hungry?"
(d) Grandmother said to the little girl, "If she was hungry."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Grandmother said to the little girl, "Are you hungry?"
Solution:
- The given sentence is in **indirect speech**:
  "Grandmother asked the little girl if she was hungry."
- To convert it to **direct speech**:
  - The reporting verb "asked" shows it's a **question**.
  - "If she was hungry" indicates that Grandmother originally asked: **"Are you hungry?"**
  - The **pronoun "she"** in indirect speech converts to **"you"** in direct speech when addressing the girl directly.
  - The correct question format in direct speech is: **"Grandmother said to the little girl, 'Are you hungry?'"**
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): Uses **"Is she hungry?"**, which changes the speaker's perspective.
  - Option (c): Uses **"Was she hungry?"**, altering the tense and intent.
  - Option (d): **"If she was hungry."** is not in question form and is grammatically incomplete in direct speech.

Correct direct speech form:
"Grandmother said to the little girl, 'Are you hungry?'"

Q.333 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
"I love the smell of fresh flowers in the morning," she said.

(a) She says that she loved the smell of fresh flowers in the morning.
(b) She said that I love the smell of fresh flowers in the morning.
(c) She said that she loves the smell of fresh flowers in the morning.
(d) She said that she loved the smell of fresh flowers in the morning.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She said that she loved the smell of fresh flowers in the morning.
To convert direct speech to indirect speech:
- **Pronouns** and **tenses** must be changed appropriately.
- The reporting verb **"said"** is in the past tense, so we use **past tense** in the reported clause.
- Direct speech:
  "I love the smell of fresh flowers in the morning," she said.
- Indirect speech:
  She said that she loved the smell of fresh flowers in the morning.

Thus, option **4** is the correct indirect speech version.

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Q.334 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Mary said to Sunanda, "Please send the report by the end of the day. I need to forward it to the client."

(a) Mary ordered Sunanda to send the report by the end of the day as she needs to forward it to the client.
(b) Mary requested Sunanda to send the report by the end of the day as she needed to forward that to the client.
(c) Mary told Sunanda to send the report by the end of the day as she was going to forward that to the client.
(d) Mary told Sunanda that send the report by the end of the day. I need to forward it to the client.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Mary requested Sunanda to send the report by the end of the day as she needed to forward that to the client.
Solution:
- The original sentence is in **direct speech** with a **polite request** and an **explanation**:
  - *"Please send the report by the end of the day. I need to forward it to the client."*
- In reported speech:
  - "Please send" → becomes a **request**, so we use **"requested"**.
  - Tense shift: **"need"** → **"needed"** (past tense, following the reporting verb).
  - Pronouns change: **"I"** → **"she"**, **"it"** → **"that"**.
- Correct transformation:
  "Mary requested Sunanda to send the report by the end of the day as she needed to forward that to the client."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"ordered"** – too forceful for a polite "please".
  - Option (c): **"was going to forward"** – changes the tense and intent unnecessarily.
  - Option (d): Incorrect grammar ("that send") and contains direct speech elements.

Correct reported speech form:
Mary requested Sunanda to send the report by the end of the day as she needed to forward that to the client.

Q.335 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The teacher said that Ashoka had converted to Buddhism after the Kalinga War.

(a) The teacher says, "Ashoka converted to Buddhism after the Kalinga War."
(b) The teacher said, "Ashoka had converted to Buddhism after the Kalinga War."
(c) The teacher said, "Ashoka was converted to Buddhism after the Kalinga War."
(d) The teacher said, "Ashoka converted to Buddhism after the Kalinga War."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The teacher said, "Ashoka converted to Buddhism after the Kalinga War."
Solution:
- The given sentence is in **indirect speech**:
  "The teacher said that Ashoka had converted to Buddhism after the Kalinga War."

Explanation (contd.)
- The reporting verb **"said"** is in the **past tense**.
- The reported clause uses **past perfect ("had converted")**, which typically remains **simple past ("converted")** in direct speech if it refers to a historical event.

To convert it into **direct speech**, identify the original statement:
- The correct direct speech should be:
  "The teacher said, 'Ashoka converted to Buddhism after the Kalinga War.'"
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): Uses **"says"**, which changes the reporting verb's tense.
  - Option (b): Retains **"had converted"**, which is awkward and redundant when referring to a definite historical event.
  - Option (c): **"was converted"** incorrectly implies passive voice, changing the meaning.

Correct direct speech form:
"The teacher said, 'Ashoka converted to Buddhism after the Kalinga War.'"

Q.336 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
"I finished my homework early," she said happily.

(a) She said happily that she had finished her homework early.
(b) She said happily that she has finished her homework early.
(c) She said happily that I have finished my homework early.
(d) She said happily that I finished her homework early.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She said happily that she had finished her homework early.
Solution:
- The given sentence is in **direct speech**:
  "I finished my homework early," she said happily.
- To convert it into **indirect speech**:
  - The reporting verb **"said"** is in the past tense.
  - So, the verb in the reported speech **"finished"** changes to **"had finished"** (past perfect).
  - The pronoun **"I"** becomes **"she"** to match the subject of the reporting clause.
  - Therefore, the correct transformation is:
    "She said happily that she had finished her homework early."
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (b): **"has finished"** – incorrect tense (present perfect).
  - Option (c): **"I have finished"** – incorrect pronoun and tense.
  - Option (d): **"I finished her homework"** – changes the meaning completely.

Correct indirect speech form:
"She said happily that she had finished her homework early."

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Q.337 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Avika requested Kavya not to make noise as it disturbed her sleep.

(a) Avika said to Kavya, "Can you stop making noise? It disturbs my sleep."
(b) Avika told Kavya, "Please do not make noise. It disturbs her sleep."
(c) Avika said to Kavya, "Please do not make noise. It disturbs my sleep."
(d) Avika said to Kavya," Do not make noise. It disturbs my sleep."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Avika said to Kavya, "Please do not make noise. It disturbs my sleep."
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **indirect speech**: *"Avika requested Kavya not to make noise as it disturbed her sleep."*
- To convert it to **direct speech**:
  - Use the verb **"said to"** or **"told"** for speech, with a polite request tone.
  - The correct direct speech equivalent of "requested not to make noise" is: **"Please do not make noise."**
  - "It disturbed her sleep" in indirect speech becomes **"It disturbs my sleep"** in direct speech (Avika is referring to herself).
- So the correct direct speech sentence is: **"Avika said to Kavya, 'Please do not make noise. It disturbs my sleep.'"**
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): Is in question form, which changes the original intent of a request.
  - Option (b): Incorrect use of "her sleep" instead of "my sleep".
  - Option (d): Lacks the polite tone of a request by omitting "please".

Correct direct speech form:
"Avika said to Kavya, 'Please do not make noise. It disturbs my sleep.'"

Q.338 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Alex expressed uncertainty regarding his ability to meet the complex requirements of the project.

(a) Alex said, "I am uncertain to meet the complex requirements of the project."
(b) Alex said, "The requirements of the project are complex enough to be handled."
(c) Alex said, "I'm sure I won't be able to meet the complex requirements of the project."
(d) Alex said, "I'm not sure if I can meet the complex requirements of the project."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Alex said, "I'm not sure if I can meet the complex requirements of the project."
Solution:

Explanation (contd.)

- The original sentence is in **indirect speech**: *"Alex expressed uncertainty regarding his ability to meet the complex requirements of the project."*
- To convert it to **direct speech**, we need to:
  - Retain the idea of **uncertainty**.
  - Use **first-person pronouns** ("I") and **present/future tense** to reflect how Alex would have originally spoken.
  - A natural and conversational way to express uncertainty is: **"I'm not sure if I can meet the complex requirements of the project."**
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"I am uncertain to meet..."** – grammatically incorrect phrase.
  - Option (b): Changes the meaning; it comments on complexity, not Alex's uncertainty.
  - Option (c): **"I'm sure I won't be able..."** – shows certainty of failure, not uncertainty.

Correct answer: Alex said, "I'm not sure if I can meet the complex requirements of the project."

Q.339 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
My cousin said that he was good at drawing landscapes.

(a) My cousin told, "I was good at drawing landscapes."
(b) My cousin said, "I was good at drawing landscapes."
(c) My cousin said, "I am good at drawing landscapes."
(d) My cousin said, "He was good at drawing landscapes."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) My cousin said, "I am good at drawing landscapes."
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **indirect speech**: *"My cousin said that he was good at drawing landscapes."*
- To convert it to **direct speech**, we need to:
  - Restore the speaker's **original words**.
  - Change the **pronoun "he"** back to **"I"**, as the speaker (my cousin) is referring to himself.
  - Since the reporting verb *"said"* is in the **past tense** and the reported speech is a **general truth or present quality**, the tense changes back from **"was"** to **"am"** in direct speech.
- So, the correct direct speech form is: **"My cousin said, 'I am good at drawing landscapes.'"**
- **Why other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"told"** is incorrect without an object (e.g., "told me").
  - Option (b): **"I was"** is incorrect as it implies a past ability, while the original sentence refers to a general skill.
  - Option (d): **"He was"** retains third-person, which is incorrect in direct speech where the speaker refers to himself.

Correct direct speech form:
"My cousin said, 'I am good at drawing landscapes.'"

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Q.340 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
She said that she was going to the store to buy some groceries.

(a) She said, “She was going to the store to buy some groceries.”
(b) She told, “I am going to the store to buy some groceries.”
(c) She said, “I am going to the store to buy some groceries.”
(d) She said, “She will be going to the store to buy some groceries.”

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She said, “I am going to the store to buy some groceries.”
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **indirect speech**: *"She said that she was going to the store to buy some groceries."*
- To convert it into **direct speech**, we need to:
  - Change the **pronoun "she"** to **"I"**, as the speaker is referring to herself.
  - Since the action was **ongoing at the time of speaking**, we convert **"was going"** back to **"am going"** to reflect the original present continuous.
  - The reporting verb *"said"* does not prevent the use of present tense in direct speech if the original words were in present continuous.
- So, the correct direct speech sentence is:
  "She said, 'I am going to the store to buy some groceries.'"
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): Uses **"she was"**, which fails to convert the pronoun and tense correctly.
  - Option (b): Uses **"told"** incorrectly without an object (e.g., "told me").
  - Option (d): Uses **"will be going"**, which alters the original tense and meaning.

Correct direct speech form:
"She said, 'I am going to the store to buy some groceries.'"

Q.341 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Anshuman exclaimed that he had lost his coat again.

(a) Anshuman said, “O God! How can I have lost my coat again!”
(b) Anshuman said, “Alas! I had lost my coat again!”
(c) Anshuman said, “O God, I have lost my coat again!”
(d) Anshuman said, “O God, he had lost his coat again!”

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Anshuman said, “O God, I have lost my coat again!”
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **indirect speech**: *"Anshuman exclaimed that he had lost his coat again."*
- To convert it to **direct speech**, we need to:
  - Restore the **original words** of Anshuman.
  - Use the appropriate **exclamatory interjection** to match "exclaimed".
  - Maintain the correct **tense and pronouns**.

Explanation (contd.)

- In indirect speech, **"he had lost"** converts to **"I have lost"** in direct speech (matching Anshuman’s original words).
- The exclamation "exclaimed" can appropriately be expressed using **"O God"**, showing surprise or dismay.
- Therefore, the correct transformation is: **"Anshuman said, 'O God, I have lost my coat again!'"**
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): **"How can I have lost"** is a present perfect interrogative, not a correct transformation of a past exclamatory sentence.
  - Option (b): **"Alas! I had lost"** changes the tone to sorrow and uses past perfect incorrectly.
  - Option (d): **"He had lost"** uses third-person pronoun, which is not correct for direct speech.

Correct direct speech form:
"Anshuman said, 'O God, I have lost my coat again!'"

Q.342 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The teacher told the children to draw the diagram of water cycle after they had finished writing.

(a) The teacher said to the children, “Draw the diagram of water cycle after they had finished writing.”
(b) The teacher said, “Children, you may draw the diagram of water cycle after you have finished writing.”
(c) The teacher said to the children, “Now draw the diagram of water cycle after finishing writing.”
(d) The teacher said, “Children, draw the diagram of water cycle after you have finished writing.”

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The teacher said, “Children, draw the diagram of water cycle after you have finished writing.”
Solution:

- The sentence is in **indirect speech**:
  "The teacher told the children to draw the diagram of water cycle after they had finished writing."
- It’s an **imperative sentence** (a command or instruction).
- To convert it to **direct speech**:
  - Use **“said to”** for imperative reporting.
  - Convert the infinitive phrase **“to draw”** back to the imperative: **“Draw...”**
  - Change the pronoun **“they”** to **“you”**, and **“had finished”** to **“have finished”** to reflect a present-perfect condition common in instructions.
- The correct transformation is:
  "The teacher said, 'Children, draw the diagram of water cycle after you have finished writing.'"
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (a): Uses **"after they had finished"**, which doesn't reflect a direct instruction.
  - Option (b): Changes the tone from instruction to permission ("may draw"), which alters the meaning.
  - Option (c): Is imprecise and not grammatically ideal ("after finishing writing").

Correct direct speech form:
"The teacher said, 'Children, draw the diagram of water cycle after you have finished writing.'"

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Q.343 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The doctor told the patient that she needed to rest and avoid stress.

(a) The doctor said to the patient, "You need to rest and avoid stress."
(b) The doctor said to the patient, "You needed to rest and avoid stress."
(c) The doctor said to the patient, "You will need to rest and avoid stress."
(d) The doctor said to the patient, "You would have needed to rest and avoid stress."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The doctor said to the patient, "You need to rest and avoid stress."
Solution:

- **The sentence is in indirect speech:** ***"The doctor told the patient that she needed to rest and avoid stress."***
- **To convert it into direct speech:**
  - **The reporting verb is "told" (past tense), but the reported speech is a general advice or instruction.**
  - **"She needed" in indirect speech becomes "You need" in direct speech (referring directly to the patient).**
  - **The sentence reflects a present requirement or advice.**
- **So, the correct direct speech form is:**
  "The doctor said to the patient, 'You need to rest and avoid stress.'"
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - **Option (b): "You needed" – makes it sound like a past requirement.**
  - **Option (c): "You will need" – shifts the meaning to future.**
  - **Option (d): "You would have needed" – incorrect and overly complex; alters the meaning entirely.**

Correct direct speech form:
"The doctor said to the patient, 'You need to rest and avoid stress.'"

Q.344 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Isha told Nitya that she could get her suit stitched at her shop and that it would be convenient for her.

(a) Isha said to Nitya, "You can get your suit stitched at my shop. It will be convenient for you."
(b) Isha said to Nitya, "You could get your suit stitched at her shop. It will be convenient for her."
(c) Isha said to Nitya, "She could get her suit stitched at her shop and that it would be convenient for her."
(d) Isha said to Nitya, "You can get her suit stitched at my shop. It would be convenient for you."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Isha said to Nitya, "You can get your suit stitched at my shop. It will be convenient for you."
Solution:
Indirect speech given:
"Isha told Nitya that she could get her suit stitched at her shop and that it would be convenient for her."

Explanation (contd.)
To convert this to **direct speech**, we need to:

- Change **"she could"** → **"you can"** (since Isha is speaking directly to Nitya).
- **"Her suit"** → becomes **"your suit"**
- **"Her shop"** → becomes **"my shop"** (Isha is the speaker)
- **"It would be convenient for her"** → becomes **"It will be convenient for you"**

Correct direct speech form:
"Isha said to Nitya, 'You can get your suit stitched at my shop. It will be convenient for you.'"
Why other options are incorrect:

- Option (b): Incorrect pronouns ("her shop", "her" – ambiguous and misleading)
- Option (c): Still in reported speech format, not proper direct speech
- Option (d): Incorrect object pronoun use ("her suit") and mismatched reference

Correct answer: Option (a)
Isha said to Nitya, "You can get your suit stitched at my shop. It will be convenient for you."

Q.345 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Neha requested her mother to let her rest as she was very tired.

(a) Neha said to her mother, "Please let me rest. I am very tired."
(b) Neha said to her mother, "Please let me rest. I was very tired."
(c) Neha told her mother, "Please let her rest. I am very tired."
(d) Neha said to her mother, "Can you let me rest? I am very tired."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Neha said to her mother, "Please let me rest. I am very tired."
Solution:
Reported Sentence Meaning:

- *"Neha requested her mother to let her rest as she was very tired."*
- This is a **polite request** made by Neha to her mother, and she explains the reason — she is very tired.

Direct Speech Conversion:

- The reporting verb **"requested"** becomes **"Please"** in direct speech.
- **"Her"** changes to **"me"** and **"she was"** becomes **"I am"** to reflect the speaker's original words.

Correct direct speech form:
"Neha said to her mother, 'Please let me rest. I am very tired.'"
Why other options are incorrect:

- Option (b): Uses **"was very tired"** – incorrect tense in direct speech.
- Option (c): Uses **"let her rest"** – incorrect pronoun.
- Option (d): Uses **"Can you..."** – changes the tone from a request to a question.

Correct answer: Option (a)
Neha said to her mother, "Please let me rest. I am very tired."

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Q.346 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The judge asked the lawyer whether he was ready to question the witness.

(a) The judge said to the lawyer, "Are you ready to question the witness?"
(b) The judge said to the lawyer, "Will you be ready to question the witness?"
(c) The judge said to the lawyer, "Why don't you question the witness?"
(d) The judge said to the lawyer, "Do you want to question the witness?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The judge said to the lawyer, "Are you ready to question the witness?"
Solution:

- The given sentence is in **indirect speech**:
  "The judge asked the lawyer whether he was ready to question the witness."
- To convert it to **direct speech**:
  - Reporting verb "asked" is used for questions.
  - "Whether he was ready..." in indirect speech corresponds to:
    "Are you ready...?" in direct speech.
  - Pronoun **"he"** becomes **"you"**, referring to the lawyer.
- So the correct direct speech form is:
  "The judge said to the lawyer, 'Are you ready to question the witness?'"
- **Why the other options are incorrect:**
  - Option (b): **"Will you be ready..."** – changes the tense and meaning.
  - Option (c): **"Why don't you..."** – changes it from a yes/no question to a suggestion.
  - Option (d): **"Do you want to..."** – alters the intent of readiness into desire.

Correct direct speech form:
"The judge said to the lawyer, 'Are you ready to question the witness?'"

Q.347 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Kavya said to her mother, "Do you know that we got our school magazine today?"

(a) Kavya asked her mother if she would be knowing that they had got their school magazine that day.
(b) Kavya asked her mother if she knew that they had got their school magazine that day.
(c) Kavya asked her mother if she had known that they got their school magazine today.
(d) Kavya asked her mother that do you know that we got our school magazine today.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Kavya asked her mother if she knew that they had got their school magazine that day.
Solution:

- The original sentence is a **yes/no question** in direct speech:
  Kavya said to her mother, "Do you know that we got our school magazine today?"

Explanation (contd.)

- In **reported speech**, "said to" changes to **"asked"** (since it's a question).
- **"Do you know"** becomes **"if she knew"** in indirect speech (change in pronoun and tense).
- **"We got"** becomes **"they had got"** (past simple → past perfect).
- **"Today"** becomes **"that day"**.

Correct Sentence:
Kavya asked her mother if she knew that they had got their school magazine that day.

Q.348 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Amanda said to the artist, "This face does not look like my sister's."

(a) Amanda told the artist that that face did not look like her sister's.
(b) Amanda told the artist that that face had not looked like her sister's.
(c) Amanda told the artist that that face was not looking like her sister's.
(d) Amanda told the artist that this face does not look like my sister's.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Amanda told the artist that that face did not look like her sister's.

- **Direct speech:** Amanda said to the artist, "This face does not look like my sister's."
- **Reported speech rules:**
  - Change the reporting verb: *said to → told* (when there's an object, i.e., *the artist*).
  - Convert present tense to past: *does not look → did not look*.
  - Pronoun changes: *this → that*, *my → her*.

Hence, the correct transformation is:
"Amanda told the artist that that face did not look like her sister's."

Q.349 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Mohit told his father that he could not solve that sum as it was very difficult.

(a) Mohit said to his father, "He could not solve that sum as it was very difficult."
(b) Mohit said to his father, "I cannot solve this sum as it is very difficult.
(c) Mohit said to his father, "I cannot solve that sum as it had been very difficult."
(d) Mohit said to his father, "You cannot solve that sum as it was very difficult."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Mohit said to his father, "I cannot solve this sum as it is very difficult.
To convert the given sentence from **indirect speech** to **direct speech**, we must reverse the changes:

- **Subject pronouns** must shift back:
  - "he" becomes **"I"** (since Mohit is speaking).
  - "that sum" becomes **"this sum"**.
  - "was" becomes **"is"**, matching present tense in direct speech.

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Explanation (contd.)

- Modal "could not" becomes **"cannot"**.

The sentence in indirect speech:
Mohit told his father that he could not solve that sum as it was very difficult.
Becomes in direct speech:
Mohit said to his father, "I cannot solve this sum as it is very difficult."

Q.350 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Mother said to Rahul, "Don't forget that the last date for geo-tagging our apartment is tomorrow."

(a) Mother reminded Rahul that the last date for geo-tagging their apartment is the next day.
(b) Mother told Rahul not to forget that the last date for geo-tagging our apartment is tomorrow.
(c) Mother told Rahul that do not forget that the last date for geo-tagging their apartment was the next day.
(d) Mother reminded Rahul that the last date for geo-tagging their apartment was the next day.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Mother reminded Rahul that the last date for geo-tagging their apartment was the next day.

To convert direct speech into reported speech, follow these rules:

- **Command/Request/Reminder** → Use verbs like *told*, *asked*, *reminded* appropriately.
- **"Don't forget..."** is a reminder → use **reminded**.
- **Change of tense**:
  - "is tomorrow" → **was the next day** (because reporting verb "said" is in the past).
- **Pronoun change**:
  - "our apartment" → **their apartment** (3rd person reference shift from Mother to Rahul).

Let's check each option:

- **Option (a):** Incorrect tense: "is the next day" should be "was the next day".
- **Option (b):** Inappropriate use of "our" instead of "their"; also tense error ("is").
- **Option (c):** Grammatically incorrect structure: "that do not forget..." is not correct.
- **Option (d):** Correct use of:
  - **"reminded"** (for "don't forget"),
  - **"their"** (for possessive shift),
  - **"was the next day"** (for past reporting).

Correct reported sentence:
Mother reminded Rahul that the last date for geo-tagging their apartment was the next day.

Q.351 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
They exclaimed sadly that India had lost the match in the World Cup finals.

(a) They said, "India has sadly lost the match in the World Cup finals."
(b) They said, "What a loss! India has lost the match in the World Cup finals."
(c) They said, "Hurrah! India has lost the match in the World Cup finals."
(d) They said, "They are so sorry! India has lost the match in the World Cup finals."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) They said, "What a loss! India has lost the match in the World Cup finals."

The sentence expresses **sadness** over India losing the match.
The reporting verb is *"exclaimed sadly"*, which shows emotion.
We use an **emotional exclamation** like *"What a loss!"* in direct speech.
Also, *"had lost"* becomes *"has lost"* to suit the tone of recent news in direct speech.
Hence, the best option is:
"What a loss! India has lost the match in the World Cup finals."

Q.352 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
I told my daughter that I would pick her up from school that week.

(a) I said to my daughter, "I will pick her up from school that week."
(b) I said to my daughter, "I would pick her up from school that week."
(c) I said to my daughter, "I will be picking her up from school this week."
(d) I said to my daughter, "I will pick you up from school this week."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) I said to my daughter, "I will pick you up from school this week."

- The original sentence is in **indirect speech**:
  I told my daughter that I would pick her up from school that week.
- To convert it to **direct speech**, we reverse the changes made during the transformation:
  - **"I told my daughter that"** becomes **"I said to my daughter,"**
  - **"would pick her"** becomes **"will pick you"** (as it's her father/mother speaking to her directly)
  - **"that week"** becomes **"this week"**

Therefore, the correct direct speech is:
"I will pick you up from school this week."
So, the correct option is:
I said to my daughter, "I will pick you up from school this week."

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Q.353 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The teacher asked the students which lines of the poem they had not understood.

(a) The teacher said to the students, "Which lines of the poem had you not understood?"
(b) The teacher said to the students, "Which lines of the poem have they not understood?"
(c) The teacher said to the students, "Which lines of the poem they had not understood?"
(d) The teacher said to the students, "Which lines of the poem you have not understood?"

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The teacher said to the students, "Which lines of the poem had you not understood?"

- The original sentence is in **indirect speech**. To convert it into **direct speech**, we need to:
  - Use the reporting verb **"said to"** to match "asked".
  - Convert **past perfect** ("they had not understood") back to **past perfect interrogative**.
  - Maintain correct subject-verb order for a **question**.
- The sentence is a **wh-question**, so the structure in direct speech should be:
  "Which lines of the poem had you not understood?"

Let's examine the options:

- **Option (a):** "Which lines of the poem had you not understood?"
  — This is grammatically correct and properly structured for a direct question.
- **Option (b):** "have they not understood" — incorrect tense and pronoun ("they" instead of "you").
- **Option (c):** "they had not understood" — not a proper question form.
- **Option (d):** "you have not understood" — incorrect tense ("have" instead of "had").

Correct sentence in direct speech:
The teacher said to the students, "Which lines of the poem had you not understood?"

Q.354 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
Avika said to her father, "I have to stay back at school for dance practice today."

(a) Avika told her father that she had to stay back at school for dance practice that day.
(b) Avika told her father that I have to stay back at school for dance practice today.
(c) Avika told her father that she has to stay back at school for dance practice today.
(d) Avika told her father that she will have to stay back at school for dance practice that day.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Avika told her father that she had to stay back at school for dance practice that day.

The correct indirect speech form of the sentence is:
Avika told her father that she had to stay back at school for dance practice that day.
Why this is correct:

Explanation (contd.)

- "**said to**" → "**told**" (when followed by a person, like "her father")
- **Present perfect "have to" changes to "had to"** in reported speech (backshifting the tense)
- "**today**" **changes to "that day"** to reflect the shift in time

Incorrect options:

- **Option (b):** Incorrect pronoun "I" is retained
- **Option (c):** Tense "has to" is not backshifted
- **Option (d):** "will have to" is not the correct transformation of "have to" in reported speech

Hence, **Option (a)** is the correct answer.

Q.355 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Manya said that she didn't want any breakfast.

(a) Manya says, "She doesn't want any breakfast."
(b) Manya said, "She didn't want any breakfast."
(c) Manya said, "I don't want any breakfast."
(d) Manya said, "You didn't want any breakfast."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Manya said, "I don't want any breakfast."

- The sentence is in **reported (indirect) speech**, and we need to convert it into **direct speech**.
- Reported sentence: *Manya said that she didn't want any breakfast.*
- In direct speech, when the speaker (Manya) is reporting her own feelings or desire, **"she"** changes back to **"I"**.
- The past tense verb **"didn't want"** stays as it is in direct speech: **"I don't want"** (because tense changes are reversed in direct speech when the original words are being quoted directly).
- The correct structure: **Manya said, "I don't want any breakfast."**

Key Points:

- **"said that she"** becomes **"said, 'I"**
- **"didn't want"** becomes **"don't want"** to reflect present tense (assuming it's habitual or still relevant)
- This matches option **3**.

Q.356 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
My daughter said, "I might go out to the Mall with my friends tonight."

(a) My daughter said that I might go out to the Mall with her friends tonight.
(b) My daughter said that she may go out to the Mall with her friends that night.
(c) My daughter said that she might go out to the Mall with my friends tonight.
(d) My daughter said that she might go out to the Mall with her friends that night.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) My daughter said that she might go out to the Mall with her friends that night.

The given sentence is in **direct speech** and needs to be converted into **indirect speech**.

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Explanation (contd.)

- **Tense handling:** Since the reporting verb *said* is in the past tense, the verb inside the quotation should be adjusted accordingly if needed.
- However, the modal verb **"might"** does **not** change in indirect speech.
- **"Tonight"** becomes **"that night"**.
- **"My friends"** becomes **"her friends"**, because the speaker is now the daughter.

The correct transformation is:
"My daughter said that she might go out to the Mall with her friends that night."
Answer: 4

Q.357 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
The official from the Metrological Department predicted that there would be heavy fog in Delhi the next day.

(a) The official from the Metrological Department said, "Delhi will experience heavy fog tomorrow."
(b) The official from the Metrological Department said, "There will be heavy fog in Delhi tomorrow."
(c) The official from the Metrological Department said, "Heavy fog will descend in Delhi tomorrow."
(d) The official from the Metrological Department said, "There would be heavy fog in Delhi the next day."

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The official from the Metrological Department said, "There will be heavy fog in Delhi tomorrow."

To convert from **indirect speech** to **direct speech**, we need to reverse the changes made during the reporting process:

- **"Predicted that there would be"** changes to **"said, 'There will be'"**.
- **"the next day"** changes back to **"tomorrow"**.
- Since the original sentence refers to a **future prediction**, the reporting verb **"predicted"** is in past tense, but the **quoted speech** would retain a future construction in **will** for direct speech.

Let's evaluate the options:

- **Option (a):** "Delhi will experience heavy fog tomorrow." – grammatically fine, but differs in expression.
- **Option (b):** "There will be heavy fog in Delhi tomorrow." – accurate and matches the original meaning and structure.
- **Option (c):** "Heavy fog will descend..." – too descriptive, changes the tone and vocabulary.
- **Option (d):** "There would be heavy fog in Delhi the next day." – this is still in **indirect speech**, not direct.

Q.358 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
She said, "I don't want to attend the meeting."

(a) She told that she did not want to attend the meeting.
(b) She said that she did not want to attend the meeting.
(c) She said that I don't want to attend the meeting.
(d) She said that she doesn't want to attend the meeting.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) She said that she did not want to attend the meeting.
Solution:

Explanation (contd.)

The given sentence in direct speech is:
She said, "I don't want to attend the meeting."
When converting into **indirect (reported) speech**, consider:

- **Reporting verb ("said")** is in the **past tense**, so reported speech verb shifts one step back (Present → Past).
- Pronouns change according to the speaker ("I" → "she").

Option Analysis:

- **(a)** She told that she did not want to attend the meeting. **Incorrect:** "told" must be followed by an object ("She told me/him/us..."), which is missing.
- **(b)** She said that she did not want to attend the meeting. **Correct:** Proper change of tense (don't → did not), correct pronoun change (I → she), and suitable reporting verb ("said").
- **(c)** She said that I don't want to attend the meeting. **Incorrect:** Pronoun "I" is incorrectly retained.
- **(d)** She said that she doesn't want to attend the meeting. **Incorrect:** Tense remains present (doesn't); it must shift to past ("didn't/did not").

Correct Answer: (b) She said that she did not want to attend the meeting.
Additional Information:

- "Say" can be used without a direct object, but "tell" requires an object (e.g., tell him, tell her).

Q.359 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
"I love the way you have decorated the room," she said, smiling warmly.

(a) Smiling warmly, she said that I love the way you decorated the room.
(b) Smiling warmly she said that she loved the way I had decorated the room.
(c) Smiling warmly, she said that she had loved the way I had decorated the room.
(d) Smiling warmly, she said that she loves the way I decorated the room.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Smiling warmly she said that she loved the way I had decorated the room.

- **Direct Speech:** "I love the way you have decorated the room," she said.
- **Reported Speech Rules:**
  - Present tense ("love", "have decorated") changes to past tense ("loved", "had decorated") in indirect speech.
  - Pronouns change: "I" → "she", "you" → "I" (since speaker is addressing "me").
  - No comma before "she said" when embedded in indirect speech.

Correct Indirect Speech:
Smiling warmly she said that she loved the way I had decorated the room.

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Q.360 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
"Don't forget to bring your umbrella," he said to her.

(a) He reminded her not to forget to bring your umbrella.
(b) He reminded her to bring her umbrella.
(c) He told her don't forget to bring her umbrella.
(d) He told her to bring your umbrella.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He reminded her to bring her umbrella.

The sentence is in **direct speech** and needs to be converted into **indirect speech**. Let's examine the original:

- Direct: *"Don't forget to bring your umbrella," he said to her.*

This is a **request or reminder** in imperative form. While converting to indirect speech:

- Imperatives often change to **"told," "asked," "reminded," "urged,"** etc.
- The verb form changes appropriately (infinitive or negative infinitive).
- Pronouns are changed accordingly: "your" becomes "her" when referring to "her."

Now evaluating the options:

- **Option (a)**: *He reminded her not to forget to bring your umbrella.* Incorrect — "your" should change to "her."
- **Option (b)**: *He reminded her to bring her umbrella.* Correct — expresses the intended meaning and has correct pronoun change.
- **Option (c)**: *He told her don't forget to bring her umbrella.* Incorrect — tense and structure not suitable for reported speech.
- **Option (d)**: *He told her to bring your umbrella.* Incorrect — "your" should be "her."

Q.361 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Sandhya said to me, "Would you like to have some herbal tea?"

(a) Sandhya told me that she would give me some herbal tea.
(b) Sandhya told me to have some herbal tea.
(c) Sandhya asked me if I would like to have some herbal tea.
(d) Sandhya asked me that would you like to have some herbal tea.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Sandhya asked me if I would like to have some herbal tea.

Sandhya asked me if I would like to have some herbal tea.

- The reporting verb **"said to"** becomes **"asked"** for an offer or polite question.
- The auxiliary verb **"Would you like"** is used for offers and changes to **"if I would like"** in indirect speech.
- **Tense remains the same** (would stay as would) because the sentence is polite and not a factual statement requiring backshifting.
- Pronoun **"you"** changes to **"I"** (as the speaker is reporting what was asked to **me**).

Correct usage of **asked**, appropriate pronoun changes, and structure.

Q.362 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
"The sun is shining brightly today," he said, looking out of the window.

(a) Looking out of the window, he said that the sun was shining brightly today.
(b) Looking out of the window, he says that the sun is shining brightly that day.
(c) Looking out of the window, he said that the sun was shining brightly that day.
(d) Looking out of the window, he said that the sun is shining brightly today.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Looking out of the window, he said that the sun was shining brightly that day.

To convert the sentence into **indirect speech**, we follow these steps:

- The reporting verb **"he said"** is in the past tense.
- Therefore, we change the tense of the reported speech:
  - **"is shining" → "was shining"**
  - **"today" → "that day"**

Also, the phrase **"looking out of the window"** stays as it is because it is a modifying clause and doesn't change in indirect speech.

Hence, the correct transformation is:

- **"Looking out of the window, he said that the sun was shining brightly that day."**

Let's evaluate:

- **Option (a):** Incorrect time word ("today" instead of "that day")
- **Option (b):** Incorrect reporting verb ("says" instead of "said")
- **Option (c):** Correct in both tense and time reference
- **Option (d):** Incorrect time word ("today" used instead of "that day")

Q.363 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
She said, "I will meet you at the cafe at 3 p.m."

(a) She asked me if she would meet me at the cafe at 3 p.m.
(b) She told me that I will meet you at the cafe at 3 p.m.
(c) She told me that she will meet you at the cafe at 3 p.m.
(d) She told me that she would meet me at the cafe at 3 p.m.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She told me that she would meet me at the cafe at 3 p.m.

- **Reported speech rules:**
  - The simple **future tense** "will meet" becomes **"would meet"** in indirect speech.
  - Pronouns change appropriately:
    - **"I" → "she"**
    - **"you" → "me"**, since the speaker is being addressed.
- The reporting verb "said" is changed to **"told"** because the sentence includes an object ("me").

Correct transformation:
"She said, 'I will meet you at the cafe at 3 p.m.'"
→ She told me that she would meet me at the cafe at 3 p.m.

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Q.364 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Aditya said to Kavya, "What do you prefer to do in your free time – painting or basketball practice?"

(a) Aditya asked Kavya what she preferred to do in her free time – painting or basketball practice.
(b) Aditya asked Kavya what did she prefer to do in her free time – painting or basketball practice.
(c) Aditya asked Kavya that what you prefer to do in your free time – painting or basketball practice.
(d) Aditya asked Kavya what does she prefer to do in her free time – painting or basketball practice.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Aditya asked Kavya what she preferred to do in her free time – painting or basketball practice.

- The original sentence is an **interrogative (WH-type) question** in **present tense**.
- When converting into **reported speech**:
  - Change the verb tense: **do prefer → preferred**
  - Change pronouns: **you → she**, **your → her**
  - Maintain the indirect question structure (no question word order).
- The structure becomes:
  asked + [WH-word] + subject + verb

Correct Reported Speech:
Aditya asked Kavya what she preferred to do in her free time – painting or basketball practice.

Q.365 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
"Please listen carefully to what I am teaching," said Madam Mahima to the students.

(a) Madam Mahima said to the students please listen carefully to what I am teaching.
(b) Madam Mahima requested the students to listen carefully to what she has been teaching.
(c) Madam Mahima asked the students to listen carefully to what she is teaching.
(d) Madam Mahima told the students to listen carefully to what she was teaching.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Madam Mahima told the students to listen carefully to what she was teaching.

- The sentence is an imperative (request), so in reported speech it changes to **"told"** or **"requested"** depending on tone.
- Since it's a polite but firm instruction, **"told"** is appropriate.
- The pronoun **"I"** changes to **"she"** (Madam Mahima).
- The present continuous tense **"am teaching"** changes to **past continuous**: **"was teaching"**.
- Thus, the correct reported speech is:

Madam Mahima told the students to listen carefully to what she was teaching.

Q.366 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The tourist said to me, "Can you give me the directions to the temple?"

(a) The tourist asked me if I can give him the directions to the temple.
(b) The tourist asked me if I could give him the directions to the temple.
(c) The tourist asked me if you could give me the directions to the temple.
(d) The tourist asked me if you could give him the directions to the temple.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The tourist asked me if I could give him the directions to the temple.

The sentence is in **interrogative form (yes/no question)** and needs to be converted into **indirect speech**. The rules for converting direct to indirect speech in such cases are:

- The reporting verb "said to" becomes **"asked"**.
- The question **"Can you..."** changes to **"if I could..."** (change of pronoun and tense).
- "me" becomes "him" (since the tourist is speaking to "me" and referring to himself).

Correct transformation:
The tourist asked me if I could give him the directions to the temple.
This correctly follows the rules of tense shift and pronoun change in reported speech.

Q.367 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
"Let's go for a walk in the park," he said.

(a) He told us to go for a walk in the park.
(b) He said that let's go for a walk in the park.
(c) He suggested that they should go for a walk in the park.
(d) He requested that we should go for a walk in the park.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He suggested that they should go for a walk in the park.

- The sentence **"Let's go for a walk in the park," he said.** is a suggestion.
- In **indirect speech**, suggestions made using "let's" are commonly reported using **"suggested that" + subject + should + base verb**.

Correct transformation:

- **He suggested that they should go for a walk in the park.**

Why other options are incorrect:

- **He told us to go for a walk** – implies a command, not a suggestion.
- **He said that let's go...** – incorrect transformation; direct words used in indirect form.
- **He requested...** – changes the tone; "let's" doesn't indicate a request.

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Q.368 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Avika says, "I have completed the math assignment."

(a) Avika says that she had completed the math assignment.
(b) Avika says that I have completed the math assignment.
(c) Avika said that she has completed the math assignment.
(d) Avika says that she has completed the math assignment.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Avika says that she has completed the math assignment.
Solution:
- The given sentence is in **Direct Speech**:
  Avika says, "I have completed the math assignment."
- When changing sentences into **Indirect/Reported Speech**, we follow specific rules.
  Here, the reporting verb "says" is in the **present tense**, which means the tense of the reported speech remains unchanged.
- **Step-wise analysis of options**:

(a) **Avika says that she had completed the math assignment.** (Incorrect: unnecessary past perfect tense)
(b) **Avika says that I have completed the math assignment.** (Incorrect: Pronoun "I" is not suitable; it should change to "she")
(c) **Avika said that she has completed the math assignment.** (Incorrect: Reporting verb "said" is past, but reported verb is present—tense inconsistency)
(d) **Avika says that she has completed the math assignment.** (Correct: Tense remains same, pronoun correctly changed)
Correct Answer: (d) **Avika says that she has completed the math assignment.**
Additional Information:
- When the reporting verb (**says, tells**) is in the present tense, the reported speech tense **does not change**.
- Pronouns should be changed according to the speaker's perspective. (Here, "I" becomes "she.")

Q.369 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in direct speech.
Rahul asked his mother if she had prepared the carrot halwa for him.

(a) Rahul said to his mother, "Are you preparing the carrot halwa for him?
(b) Rahul said to his mother, "Had she prepared the carrot halwa for him?
(c) Rahul told to his mother, "Has she prepared the carrot halwa for me?
(d) Rahul said to his mother, "Have you prepared the carrot halwa for me?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Rahul said to his mother, "Have you prepared the carrot halwa for me?
The original sentence is in **indirect speech**:
"Rahul asked his mother if she had prepared the carrot halwa for him."
We need to convert it into **direct speech**, keeping the following in mind:
- **"Asked if she had prepared"** in indirect speech becomes **"Have you prepared..."** in direct speech. (Interrogative present perfect)
  - **"She"** becomes **"you"**
  - **"For him"** becomes **"for me"** (because Rahul is speaking)

Pronouns must be reversed appropriately:
Now, let's evaluate the options:
- **Option (a)**: Incorrect – tense is wrong and "for him" should be "for me"
- **Option (b)**: Incorrect – "Had she..." doesn't match interrogative structure and is third person
- **Option (c)**: Incorrect – "told to" is grammatically wrong and "Has she..." is wrong in this context
- **Option (d)**: **Correct** – Rahul said to his mother, **"Have you prepared the carrot halwa for me?"**

Q.370 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The little girl said to her friend, "I have brought a chocolate for you."

(a) The little girl told her friend that I had brought a chocolate for her.
(b) The little girl told her friend that I have brought a chocolate for you.
(c) The little girl told her friend that she had brought a chocolate for her.
(d) The little girl told her friend that she has brought a chocolate for you.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The little girl told her friend that she had brought a chocolate for her.
The given sentence is in **direct speech** and in the **present perfect tense** – "*I have brought a chocolate for you*."
When converting into **indirect speech**, the rules are:
- The reporting verb "said to" changes to **"told"** (because it is followed by an object – *her friend*).
- The present perfect tense ("have brought") changes to **past perfect** ("had brought").
- The pronoun "I" (the speaker – *the little girl*) changes to **"she"**.
- "You" (the listener – *her friend*) changes to **"her"**.

So, the correct sentence in indirect speech is:
The little girl told her friend that she had brought a chocolate for her.

Q.371 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
They say, "We are working on a new project."

(a) They say that they were working on a new project.
(b) They say that they are working on a new project.
(c) They say that we were working on a new project.
(d) They say that we are working on a new project.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) They say that they are working on a new project.
Solution:
The given sentence in **direct speech** is:
They say, "We are working on a new project."
When converting into **reported (indirect) speech**, follow these rules:
- The reporting verb **"say"** is in **present tense**, so **no change in the tense** of the reported speech.

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Explanation (contd.)

- The **pronoun "we"** changes to **"they"**, because "they" are the ones speaking.

Option Analysis:

- **(a)** They say that they were working on a new project. Incorrect: "were working" changes the tense unnecessarily.
- **(b)** They say that they are working on a new project. **Correct**: Tense is unchanged, and pronoun "we" is correctly changed to "they".
- **(c)** They say that we were working on a new project. Incorrect: Both pronoun and tense are wrong.
- **(d)** They say that we are working on a new project. Incorrect: "we" is not appropriate in reported speech if "they" are the speakers.

Correct Answer: (b) They say that they are working on a new project.

Additional Information:

- When the reporting verb is in **present tense** (e.g., say/says), the **tense of the original speech remains the same**.
- Pronouns must be adjusted based on **who is reporting** and **who is being reported about**.

Q.372 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in reported speech.
Mother said to Amayra, "Did you finish your homework?"

(a) Mother asked Amayra if she has finished her homework.
(b) Mother asked Amayra if she had finished her homework.
(c) Mother asked Amayra have you finished your homework.
(d) Mother asked Amayra did you finished your homework.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Mother asked Amayra if she had finished her homework.

The given sentence is a **direct speech** sentence in the **interrogative form (yes/no question)**. To convert it into **reported speech**, follow these steps:

- **Reporting verb ("said to") changes to "asked"** because it's a question.
- The **question format** becomes a **statement format** in reported speech.
- Use **"if" or "whether"** to connect the reported clause.
- The verb **"did finish"** (simple past) changes to **"had finished"** (past perfect) in reported speech.

Now, apply the rules:

Direct:
Mother said to Amayra, "Did you finish your homework?"

Reported:
Mother asked Amayra **if she had finished** her homework.

Thus, the correct option is:
Mother asked Amayra if she had finished her homework.

Q.373 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
The mother said, "I am busy today".

(a) The mother told that she was busy today.
(b) The mother said that she was busy that day.
(c) The mother said that she is busy today.
(d) The mother told that I am busy today.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The mother said that she was busy that day.

To convert the sentence from **direct** to **indirect speech**, follow these rules:

- The reporting verb is **"said"** (simple past), so we change the tense of the reported speech from present to past.
- "I am busy today" becomes → "she was busy that day"
- Pronoun **"I"** changes to **"she"** (referring to the mother herself).
- **"today"** changes to **"that day"** in indirect speech.

Now check each option:

- **Option (a)**: *The mother told that she was busy today.* Incorrect – "told" needs an object, and "today" should change to "that day".
- **Option (b)**: *The mother said that she was busy that day.* Correct – proper verb, pronoun, and time expression used.
- **Option (c)**: *The mother said that she is busy today.* Incorrect – tense and time not changed.
- **Option (d)**: *The mother told that I am busy today.* Incorrect – "told" needs object, and "I" and "today" are not changed properly.

Q.374 Select the option that expresses the given sentence in indirect speech.
I said to Bhawna, "Have the monkeys eaten up our cauliflowers?"

(a) I asked Bhawna that have the monkeys eaten up our cauliflowers.
(b) I asked Bhawna if the monkeys had eaten up their cauliflowers.
(c) I asked Bhawna if the monkeys had eaten up our cauliflowers.
(d) I asked Bhawna if the monkeys have eaten up our cauliflowers.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) I asked Bhawna if the monkeys had eaten up our cauliflowers.

- **Direct to Indirect Speech (Yes/No questions):**
  - Use **"if" or "whether"** to introduce the reported clause.
  - The reporting verb "said to" changes to **"asked"** in case of a question.
  - The **present perfect tense** in the direct speech ("**Have** the monkeys eaten...") changes to **past perfect** ("**had eaten**") in indirect speech.
  - Pronoun "our" remains **unchanged** if the speaker and Bhawna share the cauliflowers.

Correct transformation:
"I said to Bhawna, 'Have the monkeys eaten up our cauliflowers?'"
→ **I asked Bhawna if the monkeys had eaten up our cauliflowers.**

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11. Para Jumbles

292 questions

Q.1 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. The mountaineers set up a camp at a height of 15000 feet.
B. Then they started climbing.
C. They struggled up a steep slope and stopped at a height of 20000 feet.
D. There they stayed for a week to get accustomed to the climate.

(a) ADBC **(b)** CDAB
(c) ABDC **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ADBC
Type: Para Jumble
• **A** – the mountaineers set up a camp at a height of 15,000 feet.
• **D** – there they stayed for a week to get used to the climate.
• **B** – then they started climbing.
• **C** – they struggled up a steep slope and stopped at 20,000 feet.
Order → **A-D-B-C**.

Q.2 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. It was a wonderful, almost awful sight – in place of the hayfield was a loch with waves on it.
B. At seven next morning I awoke and rushed to the window.
C. As I went to sleep I reflected that the rain must be filling the dam.
D. That afternoon rain fell in torrents, and continued all evening and night.

(a) CBAD **(b)** CDBA
(c) DBAC **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) DCBA
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – that afternoon rain fell in torrents and continued all evening and night.
• **C** – as I went to sleep, I reflected that the rain must be filling the dam.
• **B** – at seven next morning, I awoke and rushed to the window.
• **A** – it was a wonderful, almost awful sight — in place of the hayfield was a loch with waves.
Order → **D-C-B-A**.

Q.3 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. We were driving along National Highway 40.
B. If we drove ten kilometres along the road that branched off to the right, we would reach Brahmapur.
C. Aditya and I were returning from the site of our new factory.
D. We had reached a point where the road bifurcated.

(a) CADB **(b)** BACD
(c) CBAD **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Aditya and I were returning from the site of our new factory.
• **A** – we were driving along National Highway 40.
• **D** – we had reached a point where the road bifurcated.
• **B** – if we drove ten km along the road branching off to the right, we would reach Brahmapur.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.4 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Day in and day out he pondered to find out a foolproof plan to capture Robin Hood.
B. The Sheriff did not want to give up the idea of capturing Robin Hood.
C. He shut himself in his chamber devising one plan after another.
D. He did not discuss his plans with anyone because he trusted nobody.

(a) CBDA **(b)** DCAB
(c) BDCA **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BACD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – the Sheriff did not want to give up the idea of capturing Robin Hood.
• **A** – day in and day out, he pondered to find a foolproof plan.
• **C** – he shut himself in his chamber, devising one plan after another.
• **D** – he did not discuss his plans with anyone, because he trusted nobody.
Order → **B-A-C-D**.

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Q.5 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Since then cows, pigs, dogs and other mammals have been cloned.
B. They were created with the identical technique used to clone Dolly, the sheep, back in 1996.
C. Two monkeys have been cloned in a Chinese laboratory.
D. Zhong Zhong and Hua Hua were born a few weeks ago at a Chinese lab.

(a) DCBA **(b)** CDBA
(c) CBAD **(d)** DBAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CDBA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – two monkeys have been cloned in a Chinese laboratory.
• **D** – Zhong Zhong and Hua Hua were born a few weeks ago at a Chinese lab.
• **B** – they were created with the same technique used to clone Dolly the sheep in 1996.
• **A** – since then, cows, pigs, dogs and other mammals have been cloned.
Order → **C-D-B-A**.

Q.6 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. On the other hand, the Saracen chief looked slighter and shorter, but he was also strong.
B. The Briton was a huge powerful man with thick brown hair.
C. They went side by side to the well, where they ate their simple meal and rested.
D. They were a great contrast to each other.

(a) DCAB **(b)** CDAB
(c) DABC **(d)** BADC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – the Briton was a huge, powerful man with thick brown hair.
• **A** – on the other hand, the Saracen chief looked slighter and shorter, but also strong.
• **D** – they were a great contrast to each other.
• **C** – they went side by side to the well, where they ate their simple meal and rested.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.7 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Some people love to watch birds or fish, but I love to watch how men and women behave.
B. I love to watch people.
C. I have the habit of observing everything they do – the way they walk, talk, pray, what they eat, read or wear.
D. Nothing ever escapes my sharp eye.

(a) BDCA **(b)** CBDA
(c) BACD **(d)** DCAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BACD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – I love to watch people.
• **A** – some people love to watch birds or fish, but I love to watch how men and women behave.
• **C** – I have the habit of observing everything they do — how they walk, talk, pray, eat, read or wear.
• **D** – nothing ever escapes my sharp eye.
Order → **B-A-C-D**.

Q.8 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Mr. Adams beamingly explained its working to Mr. Spencer.
B. It fastened with three solid steel bolts thrown simultaneously with a single handle and had a time lock.
C. He, however, showed a courteous but not too intelligent interest.
D. The vault was a small one, but it had a new patented door.

(a) DBAC **(b)** CDBA
(c) DCBA **(d)** CBAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DBAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – the vault was small but had a new patented door.
• **B** – it fastened with three solid steel bolts and had a time lock.
• **A** – Mr. Adams beamingly explained its working to Mr. Spencer.
• **C** – he, however, showed a courteous but not too intelligent interest.
Order → **D-B-A-C**.

Q.9 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. The prehistoric ring of standing stones at this site is carefully aligned to point to the sunset.
B. To get a view of the sun, Stonehenge in England is considered as one of the most iconic sites.
C. As the sun rises and sets on this day in the northern hemisphere, it is the year's shortest day.
D. Winter solstice on December 21st marks the beginning of longer daylight hours.

(a) BCDA **(b)** DABC
(c) DCBA **(d)** BDAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DCBA
Type: Para Jumble

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Explanation (contd.)
• **D** – winter solstice on December 21st marks the beginning of (winter).
• **C** – as the sun rises and sets on this day in the northern hemisphere, it is the year's shortest day.
• **B** – to get a view of the sun, Stonehenge in England is one of the most iconic sites.
• **A** – the prehistoric ring of standing stones at this site is aligned to point to the sunset.
Order → **D-C-B-A**.

Q.10 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Far below he saw green meadows and in their midst a village.
B. He sat down and rested in the shadow of a rock.
C. Nunez was in a pass between the mountains.
D. He slowly climbed down the precipices and about midday came to the plain, stiff and tired out.

(a) ABDC **(b)** CDAB
(c) ADBC **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Nunez was in a pass between the mountains.
• **A** – far below he saw green meadows and, in their midst, a village.
• **D** – he slowly climbed down the precipices and reached the plain by midday, tired.
• **B** – he sat down and rested in the shadow of a rock.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.11 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. It is impossible to reach the space as there is no passage that leads to it.
B. The void seems to have no meaning at all and was perhaps just left there for construction reasons.
C. It is about the size of the Grand Gallery which is a known passageway that leads to the King's Chamber.
D. The newly found chamber in the Egyptian pyramid is 30 metres long.

(a) BDCA **(b)** DCAB
(c) CADB **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DCAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – the newly found chamber in the Egyptian pyramid is 30 metres long.
• **C** – it is about the size of the Grand Gallery, a known passage to the King's Chamber.
• **A** – it is impossible to reach the space, as there is no passage leading to it.
• **B** – the void seems to have no meaning, perhaps left there for construction reasons.
Order → **D-C-A-B**.

Q.12 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Whistling and prancing he moved with a carefree gait.
B. His bugle, bow and arrow hung loosely on his shoulders.
C. On a fine morning Robin Hood woke early and headed in the direction of Nottingham.
D. When he was passing a shady path, he ran into a tinker coming along, singing merrily.

(a) CABD **(b)** CDBA
(c) ABDC **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CABD
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – on a fine morning Robin Hood woke early and headed towards Nottingham.
• **A** – whistling and prancing, he moved with a carefree gait.
• **B** – his bugle, bow and arrow hung loosely on his shoulders.
• **D** – while passing a shady path, he ran into a tinker singing merrily.
Order → **C-A-B-D**.

Q.13 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. The guard escorted him to the front office.
B. There the warden handed Jimmy his pardon, which had been signed by the Governor that morning.
C. There Jimmy Valentine was carefully stitching the shoe uppers.
D. A guard came to the prison shoe shop.

(a) CBDA **(b)** BDCA
(c) DCAB **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DCAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – a guard came to the prison shoe shop.
• **C** – there Jimmy Valentine was carefully stitching the shoe uppers.
• **A** – the guard escorted him to the front office.
• **B** – there the warden handed Jimmy his pardon, signed by the Governor that morning.
Order → **D-C-A-B**.

Q.14 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. Very soon, he bought a young goat.
B. When all his goats left him, Abdul was very lonely.
C. He simply couldn't do without his pets.
D. He thought, "A young goat will stay with me for long."

(a) CDBA **(b)** CADB
(c) BCAD **(d)** BDAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – when all his goats left him, Abdul was very lonely.
• **C** – he simply couldn't do without his pets.
• **A** – very soon, he bought a young goat.
• **D** – he thought, "A young goat will stay with me for long."
Order → **B-C-A-D**.

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Q.15 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Ben was eating an apple, and seemed to be in high spirits.
B. Ben Rogers came into view presently, the very boy whose ridicule he had been dreading.
C. Tom went on dipping the brush into the paint and whitewashing the fence, and paid no attention to Ben.
D. Tom took up his brush and calmly resumed his work.

(a) CDBA **(b)** CBAD
(c) DBAC **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DBAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – Tom took up his brush and calmly resumed his work.
• **B** – Ben Rogers came into view, the very boy whose ridicule he had dreaded.
• **A** – Ben was eating an apple and seemed in high spirits.
• **C** – Tom went on whitewashing and paid no attention to Ben.
Order → **D-B-A-C**.

Q.16 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. The young woman was looking deathly pale and very frightened.
B. I felt sorry for her as I looked into her eyes.
C. Without saying a word she gave me a ring.
D. Then she ran out of the shop as if the place was on fire.

(a) CDAB **(b)** ABCD
(c) CADB **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ABCD
Type: Para Jumble
• **A** – the young woman was looking deathly pale and very frightened.
• **B** – I felt sorry for her as I looked into her eyes.
• **C** – without saying a word, she gave me a ring.
• **D** – then she ran out of the shop as if the place was on fire.
Order → **A-B-C-D**.

Q.17 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Soon, Mahima's castle was ready.
B. As for Sudhir's castle, even the walls weren't ready yet.
C. It was beautiful with big and small domes and arches.
D. Sudhir and Mahima settled down on the sand and each began to make a separate castle.

(a) ABDC **(b)** DBCA
(c) CBDA **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – Sudhir and Mahima settled on the sand and each began a separate castle.
• **A** – soon, Mahima's castle was ready.
• **C** – it was beautiful, with big and small domes and arches.
• **B** – as for Sudhir's castle, even the walls weren't ready yet.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.18 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. There he tasted the first sweet joy of liberty in the shape of a broiled chicken and a bottle of white wine.
B. Jimmy headed straight for a restaurant.
C. From there he proceeded leisurely to the station and boarded his train.
D. Three hours set him down at a little town near the state line.

(a) BACD **(b)** CBDA
(c) DCAB **(d)** BDCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BACD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Jimmy headed straight for a restaurant.
• **A** – there he tasted the first sweet joy of liberty — a broiled chicken and white wine.
• **C** – from there he proceeded to the station and boarded his train.
• **D** – three hours set him down at a little town near the state line.
Order → **B-A-C-D**.

Q.19 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. It produced a squeaky little note that startled a line parrot out of the mango tree.
B. Kamala took the flute and blew on it.
C. Romi laughed.
D. While he was laughing, Kamala turned and ran through the fields.

(a) DCAB **(b)** BDCA
(c) BACD **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BACD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Kamala took the flute and blew on it.
• **A** – it produced a squeaky note that startled a parrot out of the mango tree.
• **C** – Romi laughed.
• **D** – while he was laughing, Kamala turned and ran through the fields.
Order → **B-A-C-D**.

Q.20 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Robert waited for his brother to leave.
B. He climbed in and then just sat there thinking.
C. His thoughts were totally focused on his brother.
D. Then he quickly made his way to his truck.

(a) CADB **(b)** ABDC
(c) CDAB **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ADBC
Type: Para Jumble
• **A** – Robert waited for his brother to leave.
• **D** – then he quickly made his way to his truck.
• **B** – he climbed in and then just sat there, thinking.
• **C** – his thoughts were totally focused on his brother.
Order → **A-D-B-C**.

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Q.21 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Beyond the iron gate were the playing fields and the school building.
B. Everything had changed about the school.
C. After about a ten-minute drive we reached the local school.
D. We got down from the car and stood in front of the gate.

(a) BDCA **(b)** CDAB
(c) CBAD **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CDAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – after a ten-minute drive, we reached the local school.
• **D** – we got down from the car and stood in front of the gate.
• **A** – beyond the iron gate were the playing fields and the school building.
• **B** – everything had changed about the school.
Order → **C-D-A-B**.

Q.22 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. They silently ate and having finished they sat down to sing sentimental songs.
B. On the way they bought a large loaf of bread, some cheese and a goatskin full of beer.
C. When Little John was halfway through his song, Robin stopped him.
D. They travelled for a long time towards Sherwood.

(a) CDBA **(b)** CBAD
(c) DBAC **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DBAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – they travelled for a long time towards Sherwood.
• **B** – on the way they bought bread, cheese and beer.
• **A** – they silently ate and then sat down to sing sentimental songs.
• **C** – when Little John was halfway through his song, Robin stopped him.
Order → **D-B-A-C**.

Q.23 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Kunming, the Spring City, is the largest city in theYunnan province of China.
B. It is the political, economic, communication and cultural centre of Yunnan.
C. Kunming has pleasant weather and picturesque views.
D. Owing to the standard of life and favourable climate, the city has been ranked among the best cities to live in China.

(a) CBDA **(b)** ABCD
(c) ABDC **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ABCD
Type: Para Jumble

Explanation (contd.)
• **A** – Kunming, the Spring City, is the largest city in the Yunnan province of China.
• **B** – it is the political, economic, communication and cultural centre of Yunnan.
• **C** – Kunming has pleasant weather and picturesque views.
• **D** – owing to its standard of life and favourable climate, it ranks among the best cities to live in China.
Order → **A-B-C-D**.

Q.24 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. Mahatma Gandhi got a doctor to volunteer his services for six months.
B. Health conditions in Champaran were miserable.
C. The doctor gave quinine to malaria patients and the ointment with castor oil to those with skin eruptions.
D. Only three medicines were available- castor oil, quinine and sulphur ointment.

(a) BADC **(b)** ACBD
(c) BCDA **(d)** CDAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – health conditions in Champaran were miserable.
• **A** – Mahatma Gandhi got a doctor to volunteer his services for six months.
• **D** – only three medicines were available — castor oil, quinine and sulphur ointment.
• **C** – the doctor gave quinine to malaria patients and the ointment with castor oil to those with skin eruptions.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.25 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. But he seems to have become weary when it came to the ears.
B. The result is that we spend all our hours hankering after something unattainable, namely silence.
C. God constructed the human body with a lot of forethought and solicitude.
D. He left them as the most vulnerable part of a human being.

(a) DABC **(b)** CDBA
(c) BCDA **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – God constructed the human body with a lot of forethought and solicitude.
• **A** – but he seems to have become weary when it came to the ears.
• **D** – he left them as the most vulnerable part of a human being.
• **B** – the result is that we spend all our hours hankering after silence.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

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Q.26 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Mummy struggled to pull them apart and finally succeeded.
B. She tried to get them to make up but they did not listen.
C. It was a fierce fight, of course.
D. The two children scratched and hit each other.

(a) ACBD **(b)** DBAC
(c) CBDA **(d)** CDAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CDAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – it was a fierce fight, of course.
• **D** – the two children scratched and hit each other.
• **A** – Mummy struggled to pull them apart and finally succeeded.
• **B** – she tried to get them to make up, but they did not listen.
Order → **C-D-A-B**.

Q.27 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. The other was on the side table near the window.
B. When I returned, I was shocked to see one set lying on the floor.
C. I was gone for more than an hour.
D. I had not completed reading the proofs so I left them on my desk.

(a) DBAC **(b)** CDAB
(c) DCBA **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DCBA
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – I had not finished reading the proofs, so I left them on my desk.
• **C** – I was gone for more than an hour.
• **B** – when I returned, I was shocked to see one set lying on the floor.
• **A** – the other was on the side table near the window.
Order → **D-C-B-A**.

Q.28 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Sometimes he even prescribed remedies for ailing pets.
B. Raghav owned a small pet shop.
C. He also dealt in fish food and bird seed.
D. He sold cats, dogs, birds and fish in his shop.

(a) DABC **(b)** BDCA
(c) CBAD **(d)** ACDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BDCA
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Raghav owned a small pet shop.
• **D** – he sold cats, dogs, birds and fish in his shop.
• **C** – he also dealt in fish food and bird seed.
• **A** – sometimes he even prescribed remedies for ailing pets.
Order → **B-D-C-A**.

Q.29 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Therefore, I bought a good house in a respectable neighbourhood.
B. This made me eager to welcome the first guest at home and show my hospitality.
C. I intended to be a model citizen in the neighbourhood.
D. I decided it was time for me to settle down.

(a) DACB **(b)** CADB
(c) DBCA **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – I decided it was time for me to settle down.
• **A** – therefore, I bought a good house in a respectable neighbourhood.
• **C** – I intended to be a model citizen in the neighbourhood.
• **B** – this made me eager to welcome the first guest and show my hospitality.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.30 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. But it does not appear to have any effect on the children.
B. School teachers try to do their best from the early years by ordering, "Silence!" every few seconds in the class.
C. They look sweet and elegant but the moment they open their mouths, they let out a shattering volume of sound.
D. Someone noted recently that present day babies are peculiarly loud-throated.

(a) CABD **(b)** BACD
(c) ACBD **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) DCBA
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – someone noted recently that present-day babies (are noisy).
• **C** – they look sweet and elegant, but the moment they open their mouths, they let out a shattering volume of sound.
• **B** – school teachers try their best, ordering "Silence!" every few seconds in class.
• **A** – but it does not appear to have any effect on the children.
Order → **D-C-B-A**.

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Q.31 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. She had never seen so large and so golden an apple.
B. Hilda was passing through an orchard when an apple fell at her feet.
C. So, she wrapped it in her handkerchief and carried it home to store it in her drawer.
D. She held it carefully in her clasped hands and thought it would be a pity to eat it.

(a) DACB **(b)** ABCD
(c) BADC **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Hilda was passing through an orchard when an apple fell at her feet.
• **A** – she had never seen so large and so golden an apple.
• **D** – she held it carefully and thought it would be a pity to eat it.
• **C** – so, she wrapped it in her handkerchief and carried it home to store it.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.32 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. Dr Prince became aware of a small figure standing in the aisle beside his seat.
B. "Won't your mother be wondering where you are?" he asked her.
C. He brought his eyes into focus and saw that it was a girl of seven or eight.
D. She was staring at him steadily with large blue eyes.

(a) CDBA **(b)** ACDB
(c) BDAC **(d)** ABCD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ACDB
Type: Para Jumble
• **A** – Dr Prince became aware of a small figure standing in the aisle beside his seat.
• **C** – he brought his eyes into focus and saw it was a girl of seven or eight.
• **D** – she was staring at him steadily with large blue eyes.
• **B** – "Won't your mother be wondering where you are?" he asked her.
Order → **A-C-D-B**.

Q.33 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. However, Yusuf comforted himself by imagining the hotel food in store for him the next day.
B. First, Yusuf's stomach was occupied by excitement.
C. It was difficult to eat dinner that night.
D. Secondly, mother was on one of her health trips and had prepared sprouted beans and yoghurt.

(a) CBDA **(b)** BADC
(c) ACBD **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – it was difficult to eat dinner that night.

Explanation (contd.)
• **B** – first, Yusuf's stomach was occupied by excitement.
• **D** – secondly, mother was on a health trip and had prepared sprouted beans and yoghurt.
• **A** – however, Yusuf comforted himself by imagining the hotel food in store for the next day.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

Q.34 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. Someone had been smart enough to remove it before I went on the rampage.
B. My hands had been itching to tear down that collage from my bedroom wall.
C. But I found the wall bare.
D. So, I entered my room in a hurry.

(a) DABC **(b)** CBAD
(c) BDCA **(d)** ABCD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BDCA
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – my hands had been itching to tear down that collage from my bedroom wall.
• **D** – so, I entered my room in a hurry.
• **C** – but I found the wall bare.
• **A** – someone had been smart enough to remove it before I went on the rampage.
Order → **B-D-C-A**.

Q.35 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. She could not accompany her daughter due to visa restrictions.
B. That trip to Florida with her father Yuri launched her on the path to success.
C. Maria had not yet celebrated her tenth birthday when she was packed off in a train to the United States.
D. But it also required a heart-wrenching two-year separation from her mother Yelena.

(a) ABCD **(b)** CADB
(c) BCAD **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Maria had not yet turned ten when she was packed off in a train to the United States.
• **B** – that trip to Florida with her father Yuri launched her on the path to success.
• **D** – but it also required a heart-wrenching two-year separation from her mother Yelena.
• **A** – she (the mother) could not accompany her daughter due to visa restrictions.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

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Q.36 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. He had lost his leg in an accident five years back.
B. With that accident his dream of becoming the next Carl Lewis had been shattered forever.
C. In place of his left leg was a wooden stump.
D. Vikas sat up and removed the bed sheet that was covering his leg.

(a) DCAB **(b)** BCAD
(c) ACDB **(d)** CDAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DCAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – Vikas sat up and removed the bed sheet covering his leg.
• **C** – in place of his left leg was a wooden stump.
• **A** – he had lost his leg in an accident five years back.
• **B** – with that accident, his dream of becoming the next Carl Lewis had been shattered.
Order → **D-C-A-B**.

Q.37 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Some turned their eyes to the TV screen waiting for the movie to begin.
B. No sooner had the big jet taken off than the passengers began to busy themselves.
C. They knew it would be a long flight to Boston.
D. Others took out books and magazines to read.

(a) BDAC **(b)** CBAD
(c) BCAD **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – no sooner had the big jet taken off than the passengers began to busy themselves.
• **C** – they knew it would be a long flight to Boston.
• **A** – some turned their eyes to the TV screen, waiting for the movie to begin.
• **D** – others took out books and magazines to read.
Order → **B-C-A-D**.

Q.38 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. This liquid shines in the sunlight and attracts insects.
B. As soon as an insect touches the hair, it gets stuck fast to the leaf.
C. Each hair has a drop of sticky liquid at its end.
D. The sundew plant has leaves covered with little hair.

(a) ACBD **(b)** DCAB
(c) CBAD **(d)** BADC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DCAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – the sundew plant has leaves covered with little hair.
• **C** – each hair has a drop of sticky liquid at its end.
• **A** – this liquid shines in the sunlight and attracts insects.
• **B** – as soon as an insect touches the hair, it gets stuck fast to the leaf.
Order → **D-C-A-B**.

Q.39 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. So, those subjected to make-up had to face a fiery misery.
B. There were lights at all angles and around half a dozen large mirrors in the room.
C. The make-up room had the look of a hair-cutting salon.
D. They were all incandescent lights.

(a) BADC **(b)** ADBC
(c) DCAB **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – the make-up room had the look of a hair-cutting salon.
• **B** – there were lights at all angles and half a dozen large mirrors.
• **D** – they were all incandescent lights.
• **A** – so, those subjected to make-up had to face a fiery misery.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

Q.40 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Although Sonu had many more that he wanted to ask, he realised mummy was tired and became silent.
B. She answered a few and then stopped.
C. When mummy returned from work, she took Sonu for a walk.
D. But she was too tired to answer all his questions.

(a) DACB **(b)** CDBA
(c) CABD **(d)** BDAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CDBA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – when mummy returned from work, she took Sonu for a walk.
• **D** – but she was too tired to answer all his questions.
• **B** – she answered a few and then stopped.
• **A** – although Sonu had many more to ask, he realised mummy was tired and became silent.
Order → **C-D-B-A**.

Q.41 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Each morning he was driven to Obedience School in a black limousine.
B. Each evening he fell asleep in his fur-lined basket in front of the fireplace.
C. Each afternoon he was fed two grilled lamb chops for lunch.
D. Henry D. Penrose was a dog with a pedigree.

(a) DABC **(b)** DACB
(c) DCAB **(d)** DBCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – Henry D. Penrose was a dog with a pedigree.
• **A** – each morning he was driven to Obedience School in a black limousine.

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Explanation (contd.)
• **C** – each afternoon he was fed two grilled lamb chops for lunch.
• **B** – each evening he fell asleep in his fur-lined basket in front of the fireplace.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.42 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. People were driving away wild pigs from the fields by shooting at them.
B. We were passing through the sugarcane fields near Mysore.
C. We thought that the shooting was over when a sloth bear came running towards us.
D. Some got shot and others escaped.
(a) CDAB **(b)** ACDB
(c) BADC **(d)** DABC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – we were passing through the sugarcane fields near Mysore.
• **A** – people were driving away wild pigs from the fields by shooting at them.
• **D** – some got shot and others escaped.
• **C** – we thought the shooting was over when a sloth bear came running towards us.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.43 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. Soon after they left school, they decided that a small town was no place to make a fortune.
B. On reaching Paris, they agreed to separate because they wished to be independent of each other.
C. So, they ran away from home and managed to reach France on a cargo ship.
D. My father was a year older than his brother Oscar.
(a) ACBD **(b)** DBAC
(c) BDCA **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – my father was a year older than his brother Oscar.
• **A** – soon after they left school, they decided a small town was no place to make a fortune.
• **C** – so, they ran away from home and reached France on a cargo ship.
• **B** – on reaching Paris, they agreed to separate as they wished to be independent.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.44 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. "Wow! That's fantastic news," said his family and friends.
B. He had gone to Kolkata for the inter-state swimming championship.
C. Irfan was a swimming champ.
D. "He won golds in 100 m freestyle, 100 m butterfly and relay," informed his coach.
(a) CABD **(b)** CDAB
(c) CBDA **(d)** CBAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Irfan was a swimming champ.
• **B** – he had gone to Kolkata for the inter-state swimming championship.
• **D** – "He won golds in 100 m freestyle, 100 m butterfly and relay," informed his coach.
• **A** – "Wow! That's fantastic news," said his family and friends.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

Q.45 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. She is the athlete who ran as fast as a bullet in the 400 m race at the World Under-20 Championship in 2018.
B. Kandhulimari village in Dhing has suddenly come into the spotlight of fame.
C. She won a gold medal for the country and the hearts of all Indians.
D. This is the home of Hima Das, nicknamed 'the Dhing Express'.
(a) DBCA **(b)** DABC
(c) BDAC **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BDAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Kandhulimari village in Dhing has suddenly come into the spotlight of fame.
• **D** – this is the home of Hima Das, nicknamed 'the Dhing Express'.
• **A** – she is the athlete who ran like a bullet in the 400 m race at the 2018 World Under-20 Championship.
• **C** – she won a gold medal for the country and the hearts of all Indians.
Order → **B-D-A-C**.

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Q.46 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. I pointed them out to my companion.
B. The woman's face was familiar but I could not recall who she was.
C. At the very next table to ours, sat Lady Edgware and Brian Martin.
D. As I was doing so, another couple came and joined them.

(a) CDBA **(b)** ABCD
(c) BCAD **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – at the very next table to ours sat Lady Edgware and Brian Martin.
• **A** – I pointed them out to my companion.
• **D** – as I was doing so, another couple came and joined them.
• **B** – the woman's face was familiar, but I could not recall who she was.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.47 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. He took great care of his subjects and made sure they lived in happiness.
B. Sometimes he himself went amongst the people in disguise to see and learn about their actual state.
C. He sent spies into the kingdom to report to him about the condition of his people.
D. A just and loving king once ruled over a large kingdom.

(a) DACB **(b)** DBCA
(c) BDAC **(d)** CABD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – a just and loving king once ruled over a large kingdom.
• **A** – he took great care of his subjects and ensured they lived in happiness.
• **C** – he sent spies into the kingdom to report on his people's condition.
• **B** – sometimes he himself went among the people in disguise to learn their actual state.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.48 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. Then I went up the steps to apartment number 17D.
B. I strode along the pavement hurriedly and crossed the road.
C. The hall was empty and there was no sign of anyone having entered before me.
D. I opened the door with my key and went in.

(a) CDAB **(b)** BADC
(c) BCDA **(d)** DBCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BADC
Type: Para Jumble

Explanation (contd.)
• **B** – I strode along the pavement hurriedly and crossed the road.
• **A** – then I went up the steps to apartment number 17D.
• **D** – I opened the door with my key and went in.
• **C** – the hall was empty and there was no sign of anyone having entered before me.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.49 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. That is why, when a person shows off we say, 'as vain as a peacock'.
B. It gives us the impression of being a very proud bird.
C. But the fact is that the peacock is not vain, it displays its plumage to attract the peahen.
D. When the peacock dances, it spreads its feathers.

(a) CABD **(b)** BCDA
(c) DACB **(d)** DBAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) DBAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – when the peacock dances, it spreads its feathers.
• **B** – it gives us the impression of being a very proud bird.
• **A** – that is why, when a person shows off, we say 'as vain as a peacock'.
• **C** – but the fact is that the peacock is not vain; it displays its plumage to attract the peahen.
Order → **D-B-A-C**.

Q.50 Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. He ran across the garden and through the paddy fields.
B. He ran and ran and did not stop until he reached a small house at the end of the village.
C. Grandfather took me in his arms and started running.
D. Then he shouted for the man who lived there to come out.

(a) BCAD **(b)** DBCA
(c) ADBC **(d)** CABD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CABD
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Grandfather took me in his arms and started running.
• **A** – he ran across the garden and through the paddy fields.
• **B** – he ran and ran and did not stop until he reached a small house at the end of the village.
• **D** – then he shouted for the man who lived there to come out.
Order → **C-A-B-D**.

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Q.51 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Also, her face looked extraordinarily haggard.
B. Her large eyes seemed larger and darker than ever.
C. I greeted her and set a chair for her to sit on.
D. There were dark circles around them as though she hadn't slept.

(a) CADB **(b)** BACD
(c) BCAD **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – I greeted her and set a chair for her to sit on.
• **B** – her large eyes seemed larger and darker than ever.
• **D** – there were dark circles around them, as though she hadn't slept.
• **A** – also, her face looked extraordinarily haggard.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

Q.52 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. It involves making sound and sometimes difficult decisions.
B. Having the quality of courage means that one is willing to take risks for the achievement of goals.
C. Leadership is the ability of an individual to influence and guide followers.
D. One of the most important qualities of a good leader is courage.

(a) BDAC **(b)** ABCD
(c) DCBA **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – leadership is the ability to influence and guide followers.
• **A** – it involves making sound and sometimes difficult decisions.
• **D** – one of the most important qualities of a good leader is courage.
• **B** – having courage means being willing to take risks to achieve goals.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.53 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Combining Vitamins A, C and D3 with Zinc and Probiotics gives a good flu-fighting remedy.
B. Vitamin C plays a vital role in maintaining the body's natural defence.
C. It also supports a healthy immune system.
D. People with low vitamin C are at a much greater risk of getting infections.

(a) BADC **(b)** BCDA
(c) DCBA **(d)** ADCB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BCDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Vitamin C plays a vital role in maintaining the body's natural defence.

Explanation (contd.)
• **C** – it also supports a healthy immune system.
• **D** – people with low vitamin C are at a much greater risk of infections.
• **A** – combining Vitamins A, C and D3 with Zinc and Probiotics gives a good flu-fighting remedy.
Order → **B-C-D-A**.

Q.54 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. For this, he had set up an alarm to ring at intervals until morning.
B. So, he made sure he was awakened every hour during the night.
C. He strangely believed that he was likely to cease breathing when asleep.
D. A nervous cousin of mine was staying with us.

(a) DCBA **(b)** DBAC
(c) DBCA **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DCBA
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – a nervous cousin of mine was staying with us.
• **C** – he strangely believed that he was likely to cease breathing when asleep.
• **B** – so, he made sure he was awakened every hour during the night.
• **A** – for this, he had set up an alarm to ring at intervals until morning.
Order → **D-C-B-A**.

Q.55 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. I had heard a great deal about Miss Beam's school.
B. Her eyes were covered with a bandage and she was being led carefully by an older boy.
C. When I arrived, there was no one in sight but a girl of about twelve.
D. But not till last week did the chance come to visit it.

(a) ADCB **(b)** CBDA
(c) BDAC **(d)** DCAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ADCB
Type: Para Jumble
• **A** – I had heard a great deal about Miss Beam's school.
• **D** – but not till last week did the chance come to visit it.
• **C** – when I arrived, there was no one in sight but a girl of about twelve.
• **B** – her eyes were covered with a bandage and she was being led carefully by an older boy.
Order → **A-D-C-B**.

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Q.56 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. When it saw me, it moved quickly and hid itself in a coconut shell.
B. I quietly went near and closed the mouth of the coconut shell with a stone.
C. One day I saw a small snake in the compound.
D. It was crawling along slowly.

(a) ABCD **(b)** DBCA
(c) CDAB **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CDAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – one day I saw a small snake in the compound.
• **D** – it was crawling along slowly.
• **A** – when it saw me, it moved quickly and hid itself in a coconut shell.
• **B** – I quietly went near and closed the mouth of the coconut shell with a stone.
Order → **C-D-A-B**.

Q.57 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. He pulled out the letter that he had received from his brother.
B. Doctor Das looked a little upset.
C. He went to his desk and unlocked the drawer.
D. Then he laid it on the desk and pored over it.

(a) CBDA **(b)** BCAD
(c) ADBC **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Doctor Das looked a little upset.
• **C** – he went to his desk and unlocked the drawer.
• **A** – he pulled out the letter that he had received from his brother.
• **D** – then he laid it on the desk and pored over it.
Order → **B-C-A-D**.

Q.58 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. She declared that nothing would make her go to the party.
B. She left within half an hour dressed in an elegant black gown.
C. Yet, ten minutes later she seemed to change her mind.
D. At six o'clock Camilla was throwing her weight about.

(a) DACB **(b)** ABCD
(c) CBAD **(d)** BCDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – at six o'clock Camilla was throwing her weight about.
• **A** – she declared that nothing would make her go to the party.
• **C** – yet, ten minutes later, she seemed to change her mind.
• **B** – she left within half an hour, dressed in an elegant black gown.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.59 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. One winter evening, the tiger was very hungry as he could find nothing to hunt.
B. On the mountain lived a ferocious tiger whose roar would make every villager tremble.
C. So, he decided to creep down into the village to get something to eat.
D. There was a small, quiet village at the base of a mountain.

(a) BCDA **(b)** ACBD
(c) DBAC **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DBAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – there was a small, quiet village at the base of a mountain.
• **B** – on the mountain lived a ferocious tiger whose roar made every villager tremble.
• **A** – one winter evening, the tiger was very hungry as he could find nothing to hunt.
• **C** – so, he decided to creep down into the village to get something to eat.
Order → **D-B-A-C**.

Q.60 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. "How refreshing the breeze that blows through them!"
B. Every morning, Chandni watched the hill tops bathed in sunlight.
C. She wanted to run to the hills but was stopped by the rope round her neck.
D. "How beautiful those hills are!" she thought.

(a) DCBA **(b)** BDAC
(c) ACDB **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BDAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – every morning, Chandni watched the hilltops bathed in sunlight.
• **D** – "How beautiful those hills are!" she thought.
• **A** – "How refreshing the breeze that blows through them!"
• **C** – she wanted to run to the hills but was stopped by the rope round her neck.
Order → **B-D-A-C**.

Q.61 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. He heard some robbers planning to commit a robbery at the moneylender's house.
B. A man was roaming in the village at night.
C. However, the robbers outnumbered him and overpowered him easily.
D. He followed them and confronted them boldly.

(a) BADC **(b)** CDAB
(c) DBCA **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – a man was roaming in the village at night.

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Explanation (contd.)
• **A** – he heard some robbers planning to commit a robbery at the moneylender's house.
• **D** – he followed them and confronted them boldly.
• **C** – however, the robbers outnumbered him and overpowered him easily.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.62 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. The first is far more real than the second.
B. But, a person who enjoys long distance popularity succeeds in creating a favourable notion of himself among unknown people.
C. An intimately popular person is liked by those who know him.
D. There are two kinds of popularity - intimate and long distance popularity.

(a) CABD **(b)** DACB
(c) CBDA **(d)** DCAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – there are two kinds of popularity - intimate and long distance popularity.
• **A** – the first is far more real than the second.
• **C** – an intimately popular person is liked by those who know him.
• **B** – but, a person who enjoys long distance popularity succeeds in creating a favourable notion of himself among unknown people.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.63 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. My father is the only breadwinner in the family.
B. My mother happily lends a helping hand in his hard work.
C. I belong to a family where it is difficult to make both ends meet.
D. He earns a rather meagre amount, working as a mason.

(a) CBDA **(b)** ABCD
(c) ACBD **(d)** CADB

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 19 Jan

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – I belong to a family where it is difficult to make both ends meet.
• **A** – my father is the only breadwinner in the family.
• **D** – he earns a rather meagre amount, working as a mason.
• **B** – my mother happily lends a helping hand in his hard work.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.64 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. His role also includes the smooth flow of goods from farms and factories to the consumer.
B. As the final link between the producer and the consumer, he plays a key role in the economy.
C. It is he who promotes or impedes the sale of products.
D. The retailer determines the final cost of a product.

(a) BACD **(b)** CABD
(c) ABCD **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) DCBA
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – the retailer determines the final cost of a product.
• **C** – it is he who promotes or impedes the sale of products.
• **B** – as the final link between the producer and the consumer, he plays a key role in the economy.
• **A** – his role also includes the smooth flow of goods from farms and factories to the consumer.
Order → **D-C-B-A**.

Q.65 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Some of these attachments can be quite cumbersome to use.
B. Appliances like food processors come with a load of attachments.
C. But, finding the right blade and fixing it in the right slot can be quite a job.
D. For each different vegetable, you need to fix a different blade.

(a) BADC **(b)** DCAB
(c) BDAC **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – appliances like food processors come with a load of attachments.
• **A** – some of these attachments can be quite cumbersome to use.
• **D** – for each different vegetable, you need to fix a different blade.
• **C** – but, finding the right blade and fixing it in the right slot can be quite a job.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

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Q.66 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. The promotion of congenial relationship at all levels of the staff leads to prosperity of the organisation.
B. Better skills increase the working capacity of employees by promoting better work habits.
C. This includes multiplication of knowledge and development of their skills.
D. Efficient management aims at qualitative improvement of its employees.

(a) DCBA **(b)** DBAC
(c) DCAB **(d)** DABC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DCBA
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – efficient management aims at qualitative improvement of its employees.
• **C** – this includes multiplication of knowledge and development of their skills.
• **B** – better skills increase the working capacity of employees by promoting better work habits.
• **A** – the promotion of congenial relationship at all levels of the staff leads to prosperity of the organisation.
Order → **D-C-B-A**.

Q.67 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. And that something in her lifted her to the world number one position in tennis in 2005.
B. But all this happened in almost no time.
C. It took Maria just four years as a professional to reach the pinnacle.
D. There is something disarming about Maria Sharapova.

(a) ABCD **(b)** CBAD
(c) BCDA **(d)** DABC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) DABC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – there is something disarming about Maria Sharapova.
• **A** – and that something in her lifted her to the world number one position in tennis in 2005.
• **B** – but all this happened in almost no time.
• **C** – it took Maria just four years as a professional to reach the pinnacle.
Order → **D-A-B-C**.

Q.68 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. Now, I was shining from top to toe and felt proud of my form.
B. Finally, I was ready to leave the factory for my new home.
C. Then the painter set about rubbing me vigorously and polishing me.
D. A busy carpenter at last gave finishing touches to me.

(a) DCAB **(b)** DACB
(c) ADBC **(d)** ACDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DCAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – a busy carpenter at last gave finishing touches to me.
• **C** – then the painter set about rubbing me vigorously and polishing me.
• **A** – now, I was shining from top to toe and felt proud of my form.
• **B** – finally, I was ready to leave the factory for my new home.
Order → **D-C-A-B**.

Q.69 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. This usually results from a conviction on the part of the worker that the boss is genuinely interested in his growth and development.
B. More attention should be paid to make this contact constructive and productive.
C. The most vital spot in management is the contact between the workers and the boss.
D. Constructive conditions prevail when mutual confidence and respect exists between the supervisor and the supervised.

(a) DABC **(b)** CBDA
(c) CADB **(d)** DBCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – the most vital spot in management is the contact between the workers and the boss.
• **B** – more attention should be paid to make this contact constructive and productive.
• **D** – constructive conditions prevail when mutual confidence and respect exists between the supervisor and the supervised.
• **A** – this usually results from a conviction on the part of the worker that the boss is genuinely interested in his growth and development.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

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Q.70 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. The sand is so hot that you cannot walk over it in the day time.
B. Here, there is nothing but sand and rock.
C. A great part of Arabia is a desert.
D. However, there are springs of water but these are few and far apart.

(a) CBAD **(b)** BDCA
(c) CABD **(d)** ACDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CBAD
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – a great part of Arabia is a desert.
• **B** – here, there is nothing but sand and rock.
• **A** – the sand is so hot that you cannot walk over it in the day time.
• **D** – however, there are springs of water but these are few and far apart.
Order → **C-B-A-D**.

Q.71 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. Most of these superpowers are not rich in natural resources and have faced political turmoil.
B. Human capital ultimately makes the difference, both, in an enterprise and a nation.
C. The new economic superpowers of today amply testify this thesis.
D. Yet, they have achieved economic affluence in a relatively short period.

(a) BCAD **(b)** ACDB
(c) ADBC **(d)** BCDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – human capital ultimately makes the difference, both, in an enterprise and a nation.
• **C** – the new economic superpowers of today amply testify this thesis.
• **A** – most of these superpowers are not rich in natural resources and have faced political turmoil.
• **D** – yet, they have achieved economic affluence in a relatively short period.
Order → **B-C-A-D**.

Q.72 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. "How do you manage to complete so much work?" he asked the student.
B. Looking at the huge pile of books on a student's desk, a man said, "What a burden, my son! I pity you."
C. "I focus on only one lesson at a time," the student further added.
D. "I don't think of all the work I have to do," answered the student.

(a) BDAC **(b)** BADC
(c) ACDB **(d)** ACBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – looking at the huge pile of books on a student's desk, a man said, "What a burden, my son! I pity you."
• **A** – "How do you manage to complete so much work?" he asked the student.
• **D** – "I don't think of all the work I have to do," answered the student.
• **C** – "I focus on only one lesson at a time," the student further added.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.73 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. There are several factors that contribute to wisdom.
B. Doing this has become more difficult than before owing to the complexity of the specialised knowledge required.
C. This is the capacity to take account of all important factors in a problem and to attach to each its due weight.
D. Of these, I should put first a sense of proportion.

(a) CBAD **(b)** ADCB
(c) ACBD **(d)** CDBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ADCB
Type: Para Jumble
• **A** – there are several factors that contribute to wisdom.
• **D** – of these, I should put first a sense of proportion.
• **C** – this is the capacity to take account of all important factors in a problem and to attach to each its due weight.
• **B** – doing this has become more difficult than before owing to the complexity of the specialised knowledge required.
Order → **A-D-C-B**.

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Q.74 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. I felt embarrassed as if I was somehow responsible for the fire in our home.
B. In my case, it was no different.
C. It always happens that bad news travels quickly.
D. Everyone in high school was aware of my plight.

(a) CBDA **(b)** CDAB
(c) ADBC **(d)** ABCD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – it always happens that bad news travels quickly.
• **B** – in my case, it was no different.
• **D** – everyone in high school was aware of my plight.
• **A** – I felt embarrassed as if I was somehow responsible for the fire in our home.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

Q.75 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Suddenly, a motor bike came towards me from the opposite direction.
B. The consequence of my daredevilry was a sprained ankle and a bruised arm.
C. I was enjoying my hands-free ride at top speed.
D. I tried to swerve out of the way but lost control and fell.

(a) CBDA **(b)** BADC
(c) BCDA **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – I was enjoying my hands-free ride at top speed.
• **A** – suddenly, a motor bike came towards me from the opposite direction.
• **D** – I tried to swerve out of the way but lost control and fell.
• **B** – the consequence of my daredevilry was a sprained ankle and a bruised arm.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.76 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. In fact he began his career as a peon in a small firm.
B. Before he joined us as the accounts officer, he was a junior clerk.
C. He learnt typing, accounting and even graduated.
D. But he gradually improved his qualifications.

(a) BADC **(b)** CBAD
(c) BCDA **(d)** CDAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – before he joined us as the accounts officer, he was a junior clerk.
• **A** – in fact he began his career as a peon in a small firm.

Explanation (contd.)
• **D** – but he gradually improved his qualifications.
• **C** – he learnt typing, accounting and even graduated.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.77 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Arrogance inflames prejudice and hatred, but humble speech soothes.
B. Humility is the quality of being courteously respectful of others.
C. It is the opposite of arrogance, aggressiveness and vanity.
D. Thus, a humble demeanour is what is required to live in peace.

(a) BCAD **(b)** DACB
(c) ACBD **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – humility is the quality of being courteously respectful of others.
• **C** – it is the opposite of arrogance, aggressiveness and vanity.
• **A** – arrogance inflames prejudice and hatred, but humble speech soothes.
• **D** – thus, a humble demeanour is what is required to live in peace.
Order → **B-C-A-D**.

Q.78 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. She hugged my mom and almost screamed when she saw me.
B. It was a long ride before we finally reached.
C. A plump, over excited woman greeted us at the door.
D. Apparently, she had seen me as a baby and behaved as if she didn't expect me to grow up!

(a) BCAD **(b)** ADBC
(c) DACB **(d)** CABD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – it was a long ride before we finally reached.
• **C** – a plump, over excited woman greeted us at the door.
• **A** – she hugged my mom and almost screamed when she saw me.
• **D** – apparently, she had seen me as a baby and behaved as if she didn't expect me to grow up!
Order → **B-C-A-D**.

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Q.79 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. There are others who claim that they have never been so well connected.
B. However, such social networking sites help us to keep in touch with old friends or make new ones.
C. Whether or not Facebook friendships are lasting is debatable.
D. Some people believe that real friendships are collapsing in modern times.

(a) DACB **(b)** DBCA
(c) CBAD **(d)** CDBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – some people believe that real friendships are collapsing in modern times.
• **A** – there are others who claim that they have never been so well connected.
• **C** – whether or not Facebook friendships are lasting is debatable.
• **B** – however, such social networking sites help us to keep in touch with old friends or make new ones.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.80 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. Expert designers standardise basic designs, leaving scope for the satisfaction of individual taste.
B. However, uniformity does not imply lack of taste.
C. Mechanical production of goods leads to uniformity of design.
D. In fact, popular taste has improved because standardised goods of better design are now accessible.

(a) CDAB **(b)** ACDB
(c) ADBC **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – mechanical production of goods leads to uniformity of design.
• **B** – however, uniformity does not imply lack of taste.
• **D** – in fact, popular taste has improved because standardised goods of better design are now accessible.
• **A** – expert designers standardise basic designs, leaving scope for the satisfaction of individual taste.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

Q.81 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. He stamped them mechanically and returned them to us.
B. They had information that large sums of money were being smuggled out of the country.
C. No sooner had he left than the custom officers entered.
D. An official entered our train compartment and asked for passports.

(a) CBDA **(b)** DACB
(c) DCBA **(d)** ACBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – an official entered our train compartment and asked for passports.
• **A** – he stamped them mechanically and returned them to us.
• **C** – no sooner had he left than the custom officers entered.
• **B** – they had information that large sums of money were being smuggled out of the country.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.82 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. It was designed by Eugenio Cendoya and Enric Catà in 1929.
B. The Palau Nacional is a building on the hill of Montjuïc in Barcelona.
C. Since 1934 it has been home to the Art Museum of Catalonia.
D. It was declared a National Museum in 1990.

(a) CBDA **(b)** DCAB
(c) BACD **(d)** BDCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BACD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – the Palau Nacional is a building on the hill of Montjuïc in Barcelona.
• **A** – it was designed by Eugenio Cendoya and Enric Catà in 1929.
• **C** – since 1934 it has been home to the Art Museum of Catalonia.
• **D** – it was declared a National Museum in 1990.
Order → **B-A-C-D**.

Q.83 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. I went over with other curious sightseers to look at it.
B. One evening a meteor fell near our suburban house.
C. Only one end of its roughly cylindrical shape was visible.
D. In size it had a diameter of about thirty yards.

(a) DCAB **(b)** CBDA
(c) BDCA **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BACD
Type: Para Jumble

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Explanation (contd.)
• **B** – one evening, a meteor fell near our suburban house.
• **A** – I went over with other curious sightseers to look at it.
• **C** – only one end of its roughly cylindrical shape was visible.
• **D** – in size, it had a diameter of about thirty yards.
Order → **B-A-C-D**.

Q.84 Given below are four sentences which are jumbled. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A. These thunderstorms were a huge relief after the heat wave conditions the region had experienced.
B. The Weather Department forecasts more storms in the coming days.
C. Thunderstorms and strong winds were reported in Northern India.
D. The Weather Department has also said monsoon is likely to hit South India soon.

(a) DCAB **(b)** CABD
(c) CADB **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CABD
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – thunderstorms and strong winds were reported in Northern India.
• **A** – these thunderstorms were a huge relief after the heat-wave conditions the region had experienced.
• **B** – the Weather Department forecasts more storms in the coming days.
• **D** – it has also said the monsoon is likely to hit South India soon.
Order → **C-A-B-D**.

Q.85 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. The team is also collecting data on snow depth, weather and wind speed.
B. Chinese scientists are likely to be the only people to summit the world's tallest mountain this year as both, China and Nepal cancelled spring climbing season.
C. A team of scientists from China has scaled Mount Everest as a part of a project to re-measure its height.
D. China's network of satellites is being used in the survey to determine the mountain's current height and natural resources.

(a) CDAB **(b)** ADBC
(c) CADB **(d)** ABDC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – a team of scientists from China has scaled Mount Everest as part of a re-measurement project.
• **A** – the team is also collecting data on snow depth, weather and wind speed.
• **D** – China's network of satellites is being used to determine the mountain's height and natural resources.
• **B** – Chinese scientists are likely the only people to summit this year, as both China and Nepal cancelled the spring climbing season.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.86 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. All I could hear was frogs croaking—and the rain.
B. But there was no sign of her, or any other passengers, or the plane.
C. I tried to look for my mother.
D. I found myself lying under a section of three seats turned upside down after the crash.

(a) DCAB **(b)** DCBA
(c) CBDA **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DCBA
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – I found myself lying under a section of three seats turned upside down after the crash.
• **C** – I tried to look for my mother.
• **B** – but there was no sign of her, or any other passengers, or the plane.
• **A** – all I could hear was frogs croaking — and the rain.
Order → **D-C-B-A**.

Q.87 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. He knew that the man had come there with a specific purpose.
B. He had to sleep to be well rested for the next day's work.
C. Puller slumped back on his bed.
D. But his thoughts dwelled on a suspicious man whom he had seen.

(a) CBDA **(b)** BCDA
(c) CDAB **(d)** BDAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Puller slumped back on his bed.
• **B** – he had to sleep to be well rested for the next day's work.
• **D** – but his thoughts dwelled on a suspicious man whom he had seen.
• **A** – he knew that the man had come there with a specific purpose.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

Q.88 Rearrange the jumbled words and choose the alternative that correctly matches the given sentence.
I missed the _____for the next.
usually / hour / which / for / board / had / wait / an / bus / I / and / to

(a) bus which I board and had to wait for an usually hour
(b) hour and had to wait for an bus which I usually board
(c) bus which I usually board and had to wait for an hour
(d) bus I usually board which had to wait for an hour and

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) bus which I usually board and had to wait for an hour
The correct rearranged sentence is:
"I missed the bus which I usually board and had to wait for an hour."

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Q.89 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Because their bodies were so well protected from decay in the permafrost, their genetic material remained intact.
B. Using their genetic material scientists at Harvard University are researching ways to bring the mammoth back to life.
C. The last mammoths lived as recently as 4,000 years ago.
D. Their well-preserved bodies can be found frozen in the tundra of Siberia.

(a) ADBC **(b)** CDAB
(c) CADB **(d)** ABDC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CDAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – the last mammoths lived as recently as 4,000 years ago.
• **D** – their well-preserved bodies can still be found in the permafrost.
• **A** – because their bodies were so well protected from decay, their genetic material remained intact.
• **B** – using their genetic material, scientists at Harvard are researching ways to bring the mammoth back to life.
Order → **C-D-A-B**.

Q.90 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Between the fifth and eighth of May, the tiny hatchlings began to come out from the sand.
B. In late March, the turtles settled on the Gahirmatha beach to lay eggs in the sand.
C. And now they are making their journey towards the sea.
D. Thousands of baby Olive Ridley turtles have hatched on a beach in eastern India.

(a) DBAC **(b)** DACB
(c) BDCA **(d)** CBDA

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DBAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – thousands of baby Olive Ridley turtles have hatched on a beach in eastern India.
• **B** – in late March, the turtles had settled on the Gahirmatha beach to lay eggs in the sand.
• **A** – between the fifth and eighth of May, the tiny hatchlings began to come out from the sand.
• **C** – and now they are making their journey towards the sea.
Order → **D-B-A-C**.

Q.91 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. If infected people do not get help, it can kill them.
B. Corona is a disease which causes cough and breathing problems.
C. Last Wednesday, five people were infected in my town.
D. By Friday, the number increased to 139.

(a) ABCD **(b)** CDAB
(c) BCAD **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BACD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Corona is a disease which causes cough and breathing problems.
• **A** – if infected people do not get help, it can kill them.
• **C** – last Wednesday, five people were infected in my town.
• **D** – by Friday, the number had increased to 139.
Order → **B-A-C-D**.

Q.92 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. There was the image of his wife when he parted from her to go to the fair.
B. He saw her as if she were present; he heard her speak and laugh.
C. He felt terribly unhappy, and all sort of images rose in his mind.
D. All that night Aksenov lay awake.

(a) BDCA **(b)** CBDA
(c) DCAB **(d)** BACD

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DCAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – all that night, Aksenov lay awake.
• **C** – he felt terribly unhappy, and all sorts of images rose in his mind.
• **A** – there was the image of his wife when he parted from her to go to the fair.
• **B** – he saw her as if she were present; he heard her speak and laugh.
Order → **D-C-A-B**.

Q.93 **Parts of a sentence/paragraph are given below. While the first and the last parts (A and F) are in the correct order, the parts in between are jumbled up. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent sentence/paragraph.A. I love**
B. so that
C. every morning
D. for a walk
E. to go
F. I can keep myself fit and healthy.

(a) B, C, D, E **(b)** D, E, B, C
(c) C, B, D, E **(d)** E, D, C, B

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) E, D, C, B
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Q.94 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Cheetahs typically reach 67–94 cm at the shoulder, and the head-and-body length is between 1.1 and 1.5 m.
B. Adults typically weigh between 20 and 65 kg.
C. The cheetah is a large cat native to Africa and central Iran.
D. It is the fastest land animal, capable of running at 80 to 128 km per hour.

(a) CDAB **(b)** CADB
(c) ABDC **(d)** ADBC

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CDAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – the cheetah is a large cat native to Africa and central Iran.
• **D** – it is the fastest land animal, capable of running at 80 to 128 km per hour.
• **A** – cheetahs typically reach 67–94 cm at the shoulder, with a head-and-body length of 1.1 to 1.5 m.
• **B** – adults typically weigh between 20 and 65 kg.
Order → **C-D-A-B**.

Q.95 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. He swore that the eight thousand roubles that he had were his own money.
B. He had not seen the merchant after they had had tea together.
C. Aksenov swore that he had not killed the merchant.
D. But his voice was broken and he trembled with fear as though he were guilty.

(a) CBAD **(b)** ADBC
(c) ABDC **(d)** CADB

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CBAD
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Aksenov swore that he had not killed the merchant.
• **B** – he had not seen the merchant after they had had tea together.
• **A** – he swore that the eight thousand roubles he had were his own money.
• **D** – but his voice was broken and he trembled with fear, as though he were guilty.
Order → **C-B-A-D**.

Q.96 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Paper, pencil, whiteboard, textbook are the tools you need if you want to go to school.
B. But recently, you can add another one to the list: an iPad.
C. But today, it is also being used to make learning fun.
D. The tablet is useful for searching the internet and watching videos.

(a) ADBC **(b)** ABDC
(c) CDAB **(d)** CADB

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2020 | 3 Feb

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ABDC
Type: Para Jumble

Explanation (contd.)
• **A** – paper, pencil, whiteboard and textbook are the tools you need for school.
• **B** – but recently, you can add another one to the list: an iPad.
• **D** – the tablet is useful for searching the internet and watching videos.
• **C** – but today, it is also being used to make learning fun.
Order → **A-B-D-C**.

Q.97 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. The boy, who was passionate about nature, knew that he had to walk away slowly not to alarm the animal.
B. Twelve-year-old Alessandro was wandering among the bushes looking for pine cones, when he appeared to be followed by a bear.
C. Alessandro's mother panicked when she saw the bear; however, the boy told her to be silent.
D. When he had safely entered his house, the bear stopped following him and disappeared.

(a) CBDA **(b)** DCAB
(c) BACD **(d)** BDCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BACD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – twelve-year-old Alessandro was wandering among the bushes looking for pine cones when he appeared to be followed by a bear.
• **A** – the boy, who was passionate about nature, knew he had to walk away slowly so as not to alarm the animal.
• **C** – Alessandro's mother panicked when she saw the bear; however, the boy told her to be silent.
• **D** – when he had safely entered his house, the bear stopped following him and disappeared.
Order → **B-A-C-D**.

Q.98 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. More than 134,000 people have been evacuated to safe areas.
B. They are now far away from the volcano.
C. The volcano is expected to erupt within two days.
D. Mount Agung is a volcano on the popular tourist island of Bali in Indonesia.

(a) DCAB **(b)** BDCA
(c) CBDA **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DCAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – Mount Agung is a volcano on the popular tourist island of Bali in Indonesia.
• **C** – the volcano is expected to erupt within two days.
• **A** – more than 134,000 people have been evacuated to safe areas.
• **B** – they are now far away from the volcano.
Order → **D-C-A-B**.

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Q.99 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. However, there is no evidence that this train or any such trains ever existed and searches have beenfruitless.
B. The group is building it in a former wood processing factory and so far, the group has built an armoured wagon, which is over 12 metres long.
C. Legend has it that in 1945, the Nazis filled a train with up to 300 tons of gold, jewels and masterpieces and then drove it into secret tunnels in Germany.
D. A group of Polish enthusiasts decided to build a full-size replica of this legendary train.

(a) CADB **(b)** ABDC
(c) ADBC **(d)** CBAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – legend has it that in 1945, the Nazis filled a train with up to 300 tons of gold, jewels and masterpieces and drove it into secret tunnels in Germany.
• **A** – however, there is no evidence that this train ever existed, and searches have been fruitless.
• **D** – a group of Polish enthusiasts decided to build a full-size replica of this legendary train.
• **B** – the group is building it in a former wood-processing factory and has so far built an armoured wagon over 12 metres long.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.100 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. They were mysterious visitors who brought gifts to the babe in the manger.
B. The Magi were wise men.
C. Being wise, their gifts were no doubt wise ones.
D. It was from there that the tradition of giving Christmas gifts began.

(a) DCAB **(b)** BACD
(c) BDCA **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BACD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – the Magi were wise men.
• **A** – they were mysterious visitors who brought gifts to the babe in the manger.
• **C** – being wise, their gifts were no doubt wise ones.
• **D** – it was from there that the tradition of giving Christmas gifts began.
Order → **B-A-C-D**.

Q.101 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Some scientists think that the volcano could erupt in five minutes or five months.
B. They just don't know.
C. On 28thSeptember, steam appeared above Mount Agung, a volcano in Bali, Indonesia.
D. Scientists fear that an eruption could happen soon.

(a) CDAB **(b)** ADBC
(c) ABDC **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CDAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – on 28th September, steam appeared above Mount Agung, a volcano in Bali, Indonesia.
• **D** – scientists fear that an eruption could happen soon.
• **A** – some scientists think the volcano could erupt in five minutes or five months.
• **B** – they just don't know.
Order → **C-D-A-B**.

Q.102 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Three walls have posters with prayers printed in large letters.
B. It is very sparsely furnished.
C. The fourth has a chart with a family tree of the organisation.
D. I await Mother Teresa in her office.

(a) BADC **(b)** DBAC
(c) BDCA **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DBAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – I await Mother Teresa in her office.
• **B** – it is very sparsely furnished.
• **A** – three walls have posters with prayers printed in large letters.
• **C** – the fourth has a chart with a family tree of the organisation.
Order → **D-B-A-C**.

Q.103 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.P. The prices of cooking gas, pulses and vegetables have registered a sharp rise.
Q. In recent years the prices of essential commodities have gone up sharply.
R. The low-income groups and the salaried classes are the worst sufferers.
S. Living has become quite a costly affair these days.

(a) QSRP **(b)** SRQP
(c) RPSQ **(d)** PQRS

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) SRQP
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Q.104 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A.He tried covering himself from head to foot with a sheet, but that was suffocating, so he gave up.
B. To his relief, Upen Babu found him a mosquito net.
C. The next morning he told Upen Babu about his problem.
D. Mosquitoes did not let him sleep the first night.

(a) DACB **(b)** CDAB
(c) DCBA **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – mosquitoes did not let him sleep the first night.
• **A** – he tried covering himself head to foot with a sheet, but that was suffocating, so he gave up.
• **C** – the next morning he told Upen Babu about his problem.
• **B** – to his relief, Upen Babu found him a mosquito net.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.105 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. I had reached the most exciting part of my Agatha Christie novel.
B. He was presently gruelling the Duchess seated in the arm chair.
C. Hercule Poirot had managed to get together all his suspects in one room and in his great style was cornering them into confession.
D. She had become extremely nervous and was on the verge of a breakdown.

(a) CDAB **(b)** ADBC
(c) ACBD **(d)** CBAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ACBD
Type: Para Jumble
• **A** – I had reached the most exciting part of my Agatha Christie novel.
• **C** – Hercule Poirot had gathered all his suspects in one room and was cornering them into confession.
• **B** – he was presently grilling the Duchess seated in the armchair.
• **D** – she had become extremely nervous and was on the verge of a breakdown.
Order → **A-C-B-D**.

Q.106 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. Gopu was not allowed into the main temple shrine.
B. But Gopu did not mind his work.
C. Pandit Ji had given him a little room in the courtyard of the temple and this was the only place he could call his own.
D. He would sit every evening outside the temple to look after the shoes and slippers of the devotees.

(a) ABCD **(b)** DACB
(c) CBDA **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ADBC
Type: Para Jumble
• **A** – Gopu was not allowed into the main temple shrine.
• **D** – he would sit every evening outside the temple to look after the devotees' shoes and slippers.
• **B** – but Gopu did not mind his work.
• **C** – Pandit Ji had given him a little room in the courtyard — the only place he could call his own.
Order → **A-D-B-C**.

Q.107 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. In 1943, sudden retrenchment from his office due to the war cost him his nine year old job.
B. In 1934, Patol Babu gave up his factory job and came to Calcutta with his wife.
C. Ever since, Patol Babu had struggled to make a living.
D. The sailing was smooth for some years and Patol Babu was in his boss's good books.

(a) ADBC **(b)** DACB
(c) CBDA **(d)** BDAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BDAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – in 1934, Patol Babu gave up his factory job and came to Calcutta with his wife.
• **D** – the sailing was smooth for some years and Patol Babu was in his boss's good books.
• **A** – in 1943, sudden retrenchment due to the war cost him his nine-year-old job.
• **C** – ever since, Patol Babu had struggled to make a living.
Order → **B-D-A-C**.

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Q.108 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A courtyard enclosed the little room where the deity was kept.
B. Nayan stood at the entrance and looked in with amazement.
C. The forest grew thicker as she walked and then Nayan caught her first glimpse of the temple.
D. It was an ancient structure and the grey stone walls were covered with moss.

(a) DACB **(b)** CDAB
(c) CBDA **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CDAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – the forest grew thicker as she walked, and then Nayan caught her first glimpse of the temple.
• **D** – it was an ancient structure and the grey stone walls were covered with moss.
• **A** – a courtyard enclosed the little room where the deity was kept.
• **B** – Nayan stood at the entrance and looked in with amazement.
Order → **C-D-A-B**.

Q.109 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. It is celebrated on November 5th usually.
B. A man called Guy Fawkes tried to blow up the King with gunpowder over 400 years ago.
C. A couple of days after you arrive we'll have Bonfire Night.
D. It's only held in England as it marks a moment in our history.

(a) BDAC **(b)** BACD
(c) CADB **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – a couple of days after you arrive, we'll have Bonfire Night.
• **A** – it is celebrated on November 5th usually.
• **D** – it's only held in England as it marks a moment in our history.
• **B** – a man called Guy Fawkes tried to blow up the King with gunpowder over 400 years ago.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.110 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. He never jumped or ran to chase another dog.
B. They looked very peaceful, the old man and his dog.
C. Every day at a few minutes past 5 o'clock they passed by our house and went down the street to the park.
D. The dog walked a few steps ahead of his master, slow and steady as if he were held on a leash.

(a) CABD **(b)** ADCB
(c) BADC **(d)** BCDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ADCB
Type: Para Jumble
• **A** – he never jumped or ran to chase another dog.
• **D** – the dog walked a few steps ahead of his master, slow and steady as if on a leash.
• **C** – every day at a few minutes past 5 o'clock they passed our house and went down to the park.
• **B** – they looked very peaceful, the old man and his dog.
Order → **A-D-C-B**.

Q.111 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. And every time I stood under the shower, she shouted, "Don't waste water."
B. She had poisoned my mind with the lectures on social awareness, equal rights for the poor, India's socio-ecological problems.
C. Every time I was about to take my first bite of a hot buttered Roti she reminded me of the starving millions in our country and in the whole wide world.
D. It was Priyanka's fault - that stupid sister of mine- the social activist.

(a) DBCA **(b)** DACB
(c) ADBC **(d)** CDAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DBCA
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – it was Priyanka's fault.
• **B** – she had poisoned my mind with lectures on social awareness, equal rights for the poor and India's socio-ecological problems.
• **C** – every time I was about to take my first bite of a hot buttered roti, she reminded me of the starving millions.
• **A** – and every time I stood under the shower, she shouted, "Don't waste water."
Order → **D-B-C-A**.

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Q.112 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. He went up to the king, bowed and presented a velvet case.
B. The king invited the men to make their presentations.
C.The court-room was packed with people.
D. Krishna Kumar was the first to come forward.

(a) DACB **(b)** ADBC
(c) CBDA **(d)** CDAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – the court-room was packed with people.
• **B** – the king invited the men to make their presentations.
• **D** – Krishna Kumar was the first to come forward.
• **A** – he went up to the king, bowed and presented a velvet case.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

Q.113 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. Miss Tredgold rapped on the door twice with her gloved knuckle.
B. A few moments passed before the door opened to reveal a man in grey sweater and blue jeans.
C. Florentyna stood by her side, silent for the first time since leaving school.
D.At last they came to a halt outside a newly painted red door which displayed the number 118.

(a) CDAB **(b)** ADBC
(c) DACB **(d)** DBCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – at last they came to a halt outside a newly painted red door displaying the number 118.
• **A** – Miss Tredgold rapped on the door twice with her gloved knuckle.
• **C** – Florentyna stood by her side, silent for the first time since leaving school.
• **B** – a few moments passed before the door opened to reveal a man in a grey sweater and blue jeans.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.114 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Another advantage is that we can have an opportunity to learn to speak a new language fluently.
B. The main advantage of living somewhere else is that you get the opportunity to experience new cultures.
C. Of course, living away from home has its disadvantage too, such as being away from friends and family for long periods of time.
D. Should we live in one place for all our life or experience living in different places?

(a) BDAC **(b)** DBAC
(c) DCAB **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DBAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – should we live in one place all our life, or experience living in different places?
• **B** – the main advantage of living somewhere else is that you get to experience new cultures.
• **A** – another advantage is the opportunity to learn to speak a new language fluently.
• **C** – of course, living away from home has its disadvantages too, such as being away from family for long periods.
Order → **D-B-A-C**.

Q.115 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. The last exam of the year was history, which had always been my worst subject.
B. So, I decided to write the dates and names of the important events on the inside of my arm.
C. This happened when I was about 14 years old.
D. I was useless at remembering dates and people's names

(a) DBCA **(b)** CBDA
(c) CADB **(d)** ACBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – this happened when I was about 14 years old.
• **A** – the last exam of the year was history, which had always been my worst subject.
• **D** – I was useless at remembering dates and people's names.
• **B** – so, I decided to write the dates and names of the important events on the inside of my arm.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

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Q.116 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. We have flower arrangements to suit everybody at all prices.
B. We also make paying easy, and we accept all major credit cards at our shops or you can pay online.
C. Whether it is birthdays, weddings, or even the sad times like funerals, Fancy Flowers is there to make it easy.
D. Established in 2002, Fancy Flowers has branches all over the country.

(a) DBCA **(b)** DACB
(c) ADBC **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – established in 2002, Fancy Flowers has branches all over the country.
• **A** – we have flower arrangements to suit everybody at all prices.
• **C** – whether it is birthdays, weddings or even sad times like funerals, Fancy Flowers is there to make it easy.
• **B** – we also make paying easy, and accept all major credit cards at our shops or online.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.117 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. An allergy is a reaction of the immune system to a substance which is normally harmless.
B. These antibodies then attach themselves to cells, which contain histamine, which inflames the tissues.
C. One-third of us are affected by an allergy at some point in our lives.
D. The immune system in allergy sufferers makes antibodies against harmless substances because it believes them to be dangerous.

(a) DCAB **(b)** CBDA
(c) ACBD **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – one-third of us are affected by an allergy at some point in our lives.
• **A** – an allergy is a reaction of the immune system to a normally harmless substance.
• **D** – the immune system in allergy sufferers makes antibodies against it.
• **B** – these antibodies then attach to cells containing histamine, which inflames the tissues.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.118 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. He had agreed to feed him, pay him twelve rupees a month, and find him somewhere to stay.
B. A month's salary was paid in advance.
C. Fotik had learned to handle his job quite well in the last five days.
D. Upen Babu was a good man which had helped a lot.

(a) CDAB **(b)** CBDA
(c) ADBC **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CDAB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Fotik had learned to handle his job quite well in the last five days.
• **D** – Upen Babu was a good man, which had helped a lot.
• **A** – he had agreed to feed him, pay him twelve rupees a month and find him somewhere to stay.
• **B** – a month's salary was paid in advance.
Order → **C-D-A-B**.

Q.119 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. It was interesting to find out that the centre operates 24 hours a day all year round.
B. The recent trip to the recycling centre was a very useful experience.
C. However, it was surprising to learn that the centre only collects 50% of the waste as a lot of it is used as landfill.
D. The main aim of the visit was to find out about the systems put in place to recycle waste.

(a) ABCD **(b)** ACDB
(c) BDAC **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BDAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – the recent trip to the recycling centre was a very useful experience.
• **D** – the main aim of the visit was to find out about the recycling process.
• **A** – it was interesting to find that the centre operates 24 hours a day, all year round.
• **C** – however, it was surprising to learn that the centre collects only 50% of the waste, as much of it is used as landfill.
Order → **B-D-A-C**.

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Q.120 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. I kept quiet about it though because I didn't want to sound grumpy.
B. We were helping at a nature reserve for a week.
C.I was getting a bit fed up because we had cheese sandwiches for every meal as the cooking team knew no better.
D. When it was my team's turn to cook, we made a simple dinner of pasta and salad which was devoured in no time.

(a) BCAD **(b)** CDAB
(c) ACDB **(d)** BDCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – we were helping at a nature reserve for a week.
• **C** – I was getting a bit fed up because we had cheese sandwiches for every meal, as the cooking team knew no better.
• **A** – I kept quiet about it, though, because I didn't want to sound grumpy.
• **D** – when it was my team's turn to cook, we made a simple dinner of pasta and salad, which was devoured in minutes.
Order → **B-C-A-D**.

Q.121 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. These fields in the countryside have often been treated with pesticides which are harmful to bees.
B. There is a new buzz in towns and cities in Great Britain.
C. Bee-keepers living in the towns have begun to outnumber those in the country because plants growing in towns can offer more exciting nectar than fields in the countryside.
D. Bee-keeping, normally practised by people living in the country, has become a fashionable hobby for those who live and work in the cities.

(a) CBAD **(b)** CDAB
(c) BCAD **(d)** BDCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BDCA
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – there is a new buzz in towns and cities in Great Britain.
• **D** – bee-keeping, normally practised by country people, has become a fashionable hobby for city dwellers.
• **C** – bee-keepers in towns now outnumber those in the country, as town plants offer more exciting nectar than country fields.
• **A** – these fields in the countryside have often been treated with pesticides harmful to bees.
Order → **B-D-C-A**.

Q.122 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. New research, however, has found that bilingual children speak their first fifty words and so on, at the same age as children who only speak one language.
B. Until fairly recently, parents and teachers feared that introducing children to a second language when they were very young could delay their language skills.
C. Furthermore, there is no evidence that children confuse the two languages.
D. In addition, there were fears that bilingual children would become confused in their use of language.

(a) ACDB **(b)** BDAC
(c) BADC **(d)** ABDC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BDAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – until fairly recently, parents and teachers feared that a second language, introduced young, could delay language skills.
• **D** – in addition, there were fears that bilingual children would become confused in their use of language.
• **A** – new research, however, has found that bilingual children speak their first fifty words at the same age as monolingual children.
• **C** – furthermore, there is no evidence that children confuse the two languages.
Order → **B-D-A-C**.

Q.123 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Thus, Daphne cannot resist the opportunity to scold them about their behaviour.
B. The children have been annoying each other just before the meal starts.
C. Daphne's family mealtimes are usually tense because this is a time when conflicts in the family surface.
D. Also, they are rude about the food she has cooked, and Daphne gets upset by this.

(a) CDAB **(b)** BCAD
(c) BACD **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Daphne's family mealtimes are usually tense, as conflicts surface then.
• **B** – the children have been annoying each other just before the meal starts.
• **D** – also, they are rude about the food she has cooked, and Daphne gets upset.
• **A** – thus, Daphne cannot resist the opportunity to scold them about their behaviour.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

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Q.124 **For the four-sentence (S1 to S4) paragraph below, sentences S1 and S4 are given. From the options P, Q, R and S select the appropriate sentences for S2 and S3, respectively.**
(S1) The men and women took their places after the initial mingling, and immediately a surge of conversation filled the room.
(S2)
(S3)
(S4) One or two of the women were actually bouncing up and down on the sofa cushions.
(P) So, the two parties had to lean forward, their elbows on their knees.
(Q) At the beginning they mingled awkwardly, clutching their drinks, and walking here and there.
(R) Several people made a last-minute dash to the bathroom before the conversation could start.
(S) The men's chairs were far enough away from the women's couches.

(a) R, Q **(b)** P, R
(c) S, P **(d)** Q, S

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) S, P
Sentence S provides detail about the seating arrangement. So, it is sensible to put it as the second statement.Sentence P – it also talks about the seating arrangement and it is a logical follow-up to sentence S.

Q.125 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct logical sequence.**
A. They stand undefeated in the realms of Shakespeare and Homer.
B. India is a country where people are full of immense prolixity and exemplary storytelling.
C. Additionally, the philosophical discourse and discussions on various dilemmas of life associated with the Bhagavad Gita are highly appreciated by scholars from all over the world.
D. Mahabharata and Ramayana are two great examples of colossal works that unquestionably enjoy the virtue of being peak sources for the cultural ethos of the country.

(a) ACBD **(b)** DACB
(c) BDAC **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BDAC
B – introduces the topic about the storytelling skills of Indians.D – support what is said in B by examples of Ramayana and Mahabharata.A – reinforces the point made in D.C – adds further weight to the argument.So, the correct sequence is BDAC.

Q.126 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A) Healthy, strong trees act as carbon sinks, offsetting carbon and reducing the effects of climate change.
B) Trees help to clean the air we breathe. Through their leaves and bark, they absorb harmful pollutants and release clean oxygen for us to breathe.
C) Increasing levels of carbon dioxide caused by deforestation and fossil fuel combustion trap heat in the atmosphere.
D) In urban environments, trees absorb pollutant gases like nitrogen oxides, ozone, and carbon monoxide, and sweep up particles like dust and smoke.

(a) BDCA **(b)** CDAB
(c) DBAC **(d)** ABCD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BDCA
The paragraph is about the role of the trees in cleaning the environment. B is the introductory statement. C should follow D because the latter brings pollution into the picture and the former adds to it. A is the last one as it talks about the role of trees to solve the problem.

Q.127 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. Tigers are the largest members of the cat family. They are found in many parts of Asia.
B. They mostly live in dark forests and sleep during the day. They come out for hunting pigs and deer by night.
C. It is assumed that, probably, around 3,000 tigers live in the wild. This species looks spectacular and grand and they are very graceful in their movements.
D. It is almost impossible for us to see them against a jungle background, especially when they are standing still, because of their striped coats. Unlike, most cats, the tiger likes bathing very much.

(a) ABCD **(b)** ACBD
(c) CDBA **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ACBD
The correct order is ACBD. A introduces the topic 'tiger'. C give some more information about the tiger population. B says about habitat and behaviour of the tigers and D provides additional information.

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Q.128 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. The principles that emerged from those trials, known as the Nuremberg Code, are broadly applicable to many types of health-related research involving human participants, including clinical trials.
B. The growing breadth and complexity of contemporary health challenges have produced a range of difficult questions that cannot always be adequately addressed by relying exclusively on existing policies, guidelines or codes of conduct.
C. Recent formal efforts to articulate international standards of ethics applicable to health and health care can be traced to the Nuremberg trials of 1947, during which the horrors of Nazi medical experiments came to light.
D. Ethical questions related to health, health care and public health cover topics as diverse as moral issues around reproduction, state obligations in the provision of health care services and appropriate measures to control infectious disease.

(a) DACB **(b)** ACDB
(c) DCAB **(d)** DABC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DCAB
D – introduces the topic 'ethics of health, healthcare, and public health.C – provides historical context to the emergence of international standards of ethics in healthcare.A – explains the principles from the Nuremberg trials.B – it talks about the need for international standards of ethics in healthcare and other things like policy limitations, etc.Therefore, the correct order is DCAB.

Q.129 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
a. Many fitness trainers encourage their clients to include these foods in their diet to build muscle.
b. Power foods can be included in your everyday diet in a variety of ways.
c. The secret to getting the most out of power foods is, of course, knowing how to cook them properly, buying seasonal produce and recognising your preferred flavour profile.
d. Power foods are high in nutrients such as fibre, potassium and minerals.

(a) d, a, b, c **(b)** b, c, a, d
(c) d, b, c, a **(d)** a, d, b, c

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) d, a, b, c
d – introductory statement.a – further explains what is said in d. it must follow d.c – concludes the paragraph. So, correct sequence is 'dabc'.

Q.130 **Identify the option that arranges the given parts in the correct order to form a meaningful paragraph.A. Then a nurse and a doctor came**
B. After the terrible accident
C. A car took Raman to the hospital
D. The two men carried him to a bed and put him in it carefully

(a) BCDA **(b)** ABCD
(c) DCBA **(d)** ACDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BCDA
Sentence B – 'After the terrible accident' sets the context for the paragraph.
Sentence C – describes the way in which Raman was taken to the hospital after the accident.
Sentence D – describes how Raman was helped by two men to a bed.
Sentence A – completes the paragraph by explaining who came after Raman was taken to the bed.
So, the correct sequence is BCDA.

Q.131 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct logical sequence.A. When faced with uncertainty, humans look out for the action of others and become a victim of ineffective rational thinking during compelling, confusing situations.**
B. According to him, in an emergency, we tend to forget that everybody else observing the event is also likely to be looking out for social evidence.
C. Robert B. Cialdini explains this reaction with a psychological phenomenon called 'pluralistic ignorance'.
D. Since we all prefer to appear poised and unflustered among others, we are likely to search for answers placidly, with brief, camouflaged glances at those around us.

(a) ACBD **(b)** ABCD
(c) BCDA **(d)** ABDC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ACBD
Sentence A – says about the human tendency to become victims of ineffective rational thinking when faced with uncertainty by looking out for the actions of others.
Sentence C – talks about the psychological concept of 'pluralistic ignorance'.
Sentence B – talks more about what is said in sentence C. it says that during emergencies, people tend to forget that others around them may also be looking out for social evidence.
Sentence D – concludes the paragraph by explaining why people search for answers secretly at those around them.
Hence, the correct sequ

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Q.132 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A. Road accidents have become very common in India.
B. Condition of roads in India is pathetic.
C. Increasing number of vehicles leave little space on roads.
D. Roads are narrow and remain congested most of the time.

(a) BCDA **(b)** CDBA
(c) ACBD **(d)** BDCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BDCA
Sentence B – introduces the pathetic condition of roads in India which is one of the major reasons for road accidents.
Sentence D – fives further information about the condition of roads in India, emphasizing that they are narrow and congested most of the time, which makes it difficult for vehicles to move around.
Sentence C – gives another reason for road accidents in India, which is increasing no of vehicles on the already congested and narrow roads.
Sentence A – summarizes the main point of the paragraph, which is that road accidents have become a common occurrence in India.
So, the correct sequence is BDCA.

Q.133 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A. The temperature of the world has increased, resulting in global warming.
B. The melting of the ice caps will increase the sea level, thereby drowning many islands and coastal regions.
C. The increased amount of carbon emission is considered as the reason behind global warming.
D. The increase in the global temperature is melting the polar ice caps.

(a) BADC **(b)** ACBD
(c) ACDB **(d)** ABCD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ACDB
Sentence A – provides an introduction to the paragraph by stating that global warming is the main subject.
Sentence C – discusses the cause of the global warming.
Sentence D – discusses the impact of the global warming on the ice-caps in polar regions.
Sentence B – discusses the consequences of the melting of ice-caps which are rising sea levels, drowning of many islands and regions.
So, the correct sequence is ACDB.

Q.134 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A. On the afternoon of that eventful day, I stood on the porch, dumb, expectant and guessed vaguely from my mother's signs and from the hurrying to and fro in the house that something unusual was about to happen, so I went to the door and waited on the steps.
B. I did not know what the future held of marvel or surprise for me and anger and bitterness had preyed upon me continually for weeks and a deep languor had succeeded this passionate struggle.
C. The most important day I remember in all my life is the one on which my teacher, Anne Mansfield Sullivan, came to me and I am filled with wonder when I consider the immeasurable contrasts between the two lives which it connects and it was the third of March, 1887, three months before I was seven years old.
D. The afternoon sun penetrated the mass of honeysuckle that covered the porch, and fell on my upturned face and my fingers lingered almost unconsciously on the familiar leaves and blossoms which had just come forth to greet the sweet southern spring.

(a) CDAB **(b)** DABC
(c) CBAD **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Sentence C – Introduces the most important day and the most important event that changed the life of the author.
Sentence A – gives a prelude for the eventful day as the author is sensing something unusual is about to happen.
Sentence D – gives information about the emotional state of the author.
Sentence B – gives more background about the emotional background of the author's emotional state before and after the arrival of her teacher. And it gives the transformation in her emotional state when her teacher had arrived.
Hence, the correct sequence is CADB.

Q.135 Identify the option that arranges the given parts in the correct order to form a meaningful paragraph.A. In speed, in comfort, in beauty, in equipment she was a masterpiece.
B. It was the envy and admiration of the maritime nations of the world.
C. The Titanic was the Queen Alary of her day and the pride of the White Star Line.
D. Everything about her was attractive and fascinating.

(a) CDAB **(b)** CBAD
(c) DCAB **(d)** ABCD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CBAD
Sentence C – introduces the Titanic as the queen alary of her day and the pride of the white star line
Sentence B – says more about the titanic by saying it the envy and admiration of the maritime nations of the world.
Sentence A – adds some more description about the beauty, comfort and equipment of the ship.
Sentence D – concludes by saying that everything about it was attractive and fascinating.
So, the correct sequence is CBAD.

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Q.136 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A. She shot the movie on the widest canvas possible using the same kind of equipment that captured Star Wars landscapes, and applied a muted colour grading to every frame.

B. She said last year that she wanted the ensemble film to look like "a faded postcard".

C. Polley lends the central conversation a visual gravitas normally reserved for epics.

D. Women Talking, adapted by the writer-director Sarah Polley from Miriam Toews's 2018 novel, is vibrant cinema.

(a) DBCA **(b)** CABD
(c) DCAB **(d)** DABC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DCAB

Sentence D – introduces the topic of movie Women talking, calling it 'vibrant cinema'.
Sentence C – discusses bout the director, Sarah Polley giving the central conversation in the movie a 'visual gravitas normally reserved for epics'.
Sentence A – discusses how Polley achieved the desired look of the movie, with a muted color grading and the use of equipment typically used for capturing epic landscapes.
Sentence B – adds more detail about Polley's intention for the movie to look like a 'faded postcard,' it reinforces the previously discussed visual style of the movie.
So, the correct sequence is DCAB.

Q.137 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A. Fort Hare was more than that: it was a beacon for African scholars from all over Southern Central and Eastern Africa.

B. Until 1960, the University College of Fort Hare, in the municipality of Alice, about twenty miles due east from Heald town, was the only residential center of higher education for blacks in South Africa.

C. For young black South Africans like myself, it was Oxford and Cambridge, Harvard and Yale, all rolled into one.

D. The regent was anxious for me to attend Fort Hare and I was gratified to be accepted there. I felt that I was being groomed for success in the world.

(a) BACD **(b)** BDAC
(c) CABD **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BACD

Sentence B – introduces the University college of Fort Hare.
Sentence A – it says about author's experience of Fort Hare. He also discusses the similarity of Fort Hare to Oxford and Cambridge, Harvard and Yale.
Sentence C – depicts the author's excitement about attending Fort Hare.
Sentence D – tell us about the author's acceptance into Fort Hare and the anxiousness of the agent for the author.
So, the correct sequence is BACD.

Q.138 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.P. Perhaps no definition of democracy is more popular and universally acceptable than what is given by Abraham Lincoln.

Q. He defines democracy as "a government of the people, by the people and for the people".

R. Certainly, democracy is the most representative form of government.

S. To bind the people and take the nation ahead on the path of progress, democracy is the most suitable form of government for India.

(a) PSRQ **(b)** QRSP
(c) SRQP **(d)** PQRS

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) PQRS

Sentence P – states that the more popular and universally accepted definition of democracy is given by Abrahm Lincoln.
Sentences Q – the definition is given.
Sentence R – special attribute of the democracy is given as the most representative form of government.
Sentence S – talks about the suitability of democracy for India.
So, sequencing logically, we find PQRS as the correct sequence.

Q.139 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A. Helping parents become savvier at picking care options and tossing retention bonuses to caregivers are others.

B. These fixes, importantly, can make child care more affordable for parents and offer life rafts to centres haemorrhaging workers.

C.The most proposed government solution for child care involves building on top of this flawed system is offering more vouchers to purchase private child care.

D.But they do little to address the structural needs: improved quality for kids, better wages and working conditions for workers, and more choices in the low-income neighbourhoods.

(a) BADC **(b)** CDBA
(c) CABD **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CABD

c

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Q.140 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A.We reached there at about 10 a.m.**
B.The first ride we took was the Fury Wheel. It was really big, all of us were yelling and crying!
C.Yesterday, my friends and I went on a short picnic to an amusement park.
D.Even though we had reached on time there was a serpentine queue for the tickets. I took the entrance ticket.

(a) ABCD **(b)** CDBA
(c) CADB **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CADB
Sentence C – introduction to the author's visit to amusement park.
Sentence A – time of reaching is given
Sentence D – the scene after reaching the park in which the author was standing in queue for tickets is depicted.
Sentence B – telling about the first ride.
So, the correct sequence is CADB.

Q.141 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A) The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) were adopted by all United Nations Member States in 2015 to end poverty, reduce inequality and build more peaceful, prosperous societies by 2030.**
B) The SDGs cannot be achieved without the realisation of child rights.
C) Also known as the Global Goals, the SDGs are a call to action to create a world where no one is left behind.
D) As world leaders work to deliver on the 2030 promise, children around the globe are standing up to secure their right to good health, quality education, a clean planet and more.

(a) ADCB **(b)** ACBD
(c) ADBC **(d)** ABDC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ACBD
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Q.142 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A. No country has yet achieved the combination of very high human development with a light ecological footprint and the impacts of climate change and biodiversity loss are growing.**
B. Compounded by a climate emergency, political polarization and challenged multilateralism, continued conflicts, and forced displacement, the number of people living in poverty rose in 2020 for the first time since 1998 by an estimated 119-124 million and inequalities are growing, and the traditional social contract is no longer working for many.
C. The challenge of reaching Agenda 2030 was already significant, even before the COVID-19 pandemic hit.
D. Today's development challenges are dynamic, interconnected puzzles of multidimensional risk that require systemic solutions and multilateral cooperation is vital in addressing these shared challenges that cross boundaries of geography and time.

(a) BCDA **(b)** ABDC
(c) DBAC **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CBDA
Sentence C introduces the paragraph by telling about the significance of the challenge of achieving Agenda 2030.
Sentence B it elaborates the challenges. It also discusses climate emergency, political polarization, conflicts, forced displacements and their impact on the rise in poverty and growing inequalities.
Sentence D it discusses the challenges of today's development. It discusses the need for systemic solutions and emphasizes the importance of multicultural cooperation to address these challenges.
Sentence A concludes the paragraph by emphasizing that no country has achieved the desired combination of high human development with a light ecological footprint. Impact of climate change and biodiversity loss is also discussed.
So, the logical sequence will be CBDA.

Q.143 **Sentences of a paragraph are given in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A. Instead, they are constrictors, meaning they squeeze their prey to death before swallowing it whole.**
B. Agile on water but awkward on land, the green anaconda is one of the largest snakes in the world.
C. Most people assume that anacondas are very poisonous, but they are actually non-venomous.
D. At 29 feet long and 550 pounds, these snakes are huge!

(a) DABC **(b)** BCAD
(c) BACD **(d)** BDCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BDCA
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Q.144 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.A. I was almost drowned a dozen times; was nearly boiled alive and just missed being cremated.**
B. Now, my well-being is simply the result of a careful and measured mode of living and perhaps the most astonishing thing is that three times in my youth I was rendered by illness a hopeless physical wreck and given up by physicians.
C. More than this, through ignorance, and light-heartedness, I got into all sorts of difficulties, dangers and scrapes from which I extricated myself as by enchantment.
D. But as I recall these incidents to my mind I feel convinced that my preservation was not altogether accidental.

(a) BCAD **(b)** BADC
(c) CADB **(d)** DCAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BCAD
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Q.145 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (S1 and S6) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.S1. In Dr. Babasaheb Ambedkar**
A. but also an elder statesman and national leader
B. we have not only a crusader against the caste system,
C. a valiant fighter for the cause of the downtrodden in India
D. whose contribution in the form of the Constitution of India
S6. will be cherished forever by posterity.

(a) BACD **(b)** ABCD
(c) CABD **(d)** DABC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BACD
sentence A will follow sentence B because 'but also' always follow 'not only'. D should come just before S6 as it is talking about the role of BR Ambedkar in making the constitution of Indian which cannot be forgotten. So, the logical sequence will be BACD.

Q.146 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. As cost of raw materials cannot be reduced, exporters try to cut labour costs.
B. Large MNCs in the garment industry in Europe and America order their products from Indian exporters.
C. These large MNCs with worldwide network look for the cheapest goods in order to maximise their profits.
D. To get these large orders, Indian garment exporters try hard to cut their own costs.
E. Where earlier a factory used to employ workers on a permanent basis, now they employ workers only on a temporary basis so that they do not have to pay workers for the whole year.

(a) BCDAE **(b)** ADECB
(c) CDAEB **(d)** DCABE

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BCDAE
B: Large MNCs in the garment industry in Europe and America order their products from Indian exporters.
C: These large MNCs with a worldwide network look for the cheapest goods in order to maximise their profits.
D: To get these large orders, Indian garment exporters try hard to cut their own costs.
A: As the cost of raw materials cannot be reduced, exporters try to cut labour costs.
E: Where earlier a factory used to employ workers on a permanent basis, now they employ workers only on a temporary basis so that they do not have to pay workers for the whole year.
The correct sequence to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph is:
BCDAE
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.147 **Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence.**
a. beginning in the 19th century,
b. was long a mystery, and
c. the origin of the Moon
d. three competing theories emerged to solve it

(a) bdca **(b)** dcab
(c) abdc **(d)** cbad

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) cbad
c: "The origin of the Moon" introduces the main subject of the sentence.
b: "was long a mystery, and" describes the nature of the subject.
a: "beginning in the 19th century," provides a time frame for the context.
d: "three competing theories emerged to solve it" concludes with the resolution to the mystery.
Correct Sentence:
"The origin of the Moon was long a mystery, and beginning in the 19th century, three competing theories emerged to solve it."
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

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Q.148 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Psychotherapy is a voluntary relationship between the one seeking treatment or the client and the one who treats or the therapist.
B. The relationship is conducive for building the trust of the client so that problems may be freely discussed.
C. The purpose of the relationship is to help the client to solve the psychological problems being faced by her or him.
D. Psychotherapies aim at changing the maladaptive behaviours, decreasing the sense of personal distress and helping the client to adapt better to her/his environment.
E. Inadequate marital, occupational and social adjustment also requires that major changes be made in an individual's personal environment.

(a) CDEBA **(b)** DCABE
(c) EDACB **(d)** ACBDE

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ACBDE
A introduces the concept of psychotherapy, stating that it is a voluntary relationship between the client and the therapist.
C elaborates on the purpose of the relationship, which is to help the client solve their psychological problems.
B explains the importance of building trust in the relationship to ensure the client can freely discuss their issues.
D describes the goals of psychotherapy, such as changing maladaptive behaviours and reducing personal distress.
E discusses the need for psychotherapy when there are issues with marital, occupational, or social adjustment, indicating that personal changes may be necessary.
Thus, the correct order is: **ACBDE**.
So, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.149 Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence.
Through the dense forest, / the hikers / trekked / for hours / before reaching / the mountain peak.

(a) The hikers for hours through the dense forest trekked before reaching the mountain peak.
(b) Before reaching the mountain peak, the hikers through the dense forest trekked for hours.
(c) Through the dense forest for hours trekked the hikers before reaching the mountain peak.
(d) The hikers trekked for hours through the dense forest before reaching the mountain peak.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The hikers trekked for hours through the dense forest before reaching the mountain peak.
The correct arrangement of the sentence is:
"The hikers trekked for hours through the dense forest before reaching the mountain peak."
This arrangement makes the sentence grammatically correct and clear in meaning.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.150 Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Select the option that gives their correct logical sequence to form a meaningful sentence.
a. it requires constant sustenance
b. in order for life to be liveable,
c. that enable it to grow and develop
d. and favourable circumstances

(a) a, b, c, d **(b)** d, c, b, a
(c) b, a, d, c **(d)** b, d, a, c

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) b, a, d, c
b. "In order for life to be liveable," starts the sentence by giving the purpose of life.
a. "it requires constant sustenance" describes what is necessary for life to be liveable.
d. "and favourable circumstances" adds another important condition for life to be liveable.
c. "that enable it to grow and develop" explains the role of sustenance and circumstances.
So, the complete sentence would be:
"In order for life to be liveable, it requires constant sustenance and favourable circumstances that enable it to grow and develop."
So, the correct option is **b, a, d, c.**
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.151 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. It consists of a terracotta army of approximately 8000 life-sized men and horses.
B. Each of the horses and men is individually sculpted by a 3-inch-thick terracotta clay and looks unique.
C. Shi Huangdi was the founder of Qin Dynasty and was the first ruler of unified China in 221 BC.
D. His mausoleum was recently discovered in 1974 by Chinese peasants who were drilling a well.

(a) CDAB **(b)** CABD
(c) CADB **(d)** CBAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CDAB
C: Introduces Shi Huangdi as the central figure, setting up the topic.
D: Describes the discovery of his mausoleum, logically following the introduction.
A: Details the contents of the mausoleum, the terracotta army.
B: Adds specific information about the uniqueness of the sculptures.
Corrected Paragraph: "Shi Huangdi was the founder of the Qin Dynasty and was the first ruler of unified China in 221 BC. His mausoleum was recently discovered in 1974 by Chinese peasants who were drilling a well. It consists of a terracotta army of approximately 8000 life-sized men and horses. Each of the horses and men is individually sculpted by a 3-inch-thick terracotta clay and looks unique."
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

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Q.152 A sentence has been split up into segments and given below in jumbled order. While the first and the last segments of the sentence (1 and 6) are in the correct order, the segments in between are jumbled up. Arrange the segments in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent sentence.

1) India has been a land
P) and the learned man has been held in higher esteem
Q) of learning through the ages
R) but in the sense that learning has always been very highly valued
S) not indeed in the sense that education has been universal
6) than the warrior or the administrator.

(a) P, S, Q, R **(b)** R, Q, S, P
(c) S, R, Q, P **(d)** Q, S, R, P

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Q, S, R, P

1. **Q**: "of learning through the ages"
   - This phrase introduces the theme of the sentence, which is India's history as a land of learning.
2. **S**: "not indeed in the sense that education has been universal"
   - This part elaborates that the value of learning doesn't necessarily mean it was universally accessible to everyone, which provides a context for the following points.
3. **R**: "but in the sense that learning has always been very highly valued"
   - This clarifies that while education may not have been universal, learning has always been highly regarded.
4. **P**: "and the learned man has been held in higher esteem"
   - This concludes with the idea that the learned person has been revered in Indian society, aligning with the value of learning.

Final Sentence:
"India has been a land of learning through the ages, not indeed in the sense that education has been universal, but in the sense that learning has always been very highly valued, and the learned man has been held in higher esteem than the warrior or the administrator."
Thus, the correct order is: **Q, S, R, P**.
So, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.153 A sentence has been split up into segments and given below in jumbled order. While the first and the last segments of the sentence (1 and 6) are in the correct order, the segments in between are jumbled up. Arrange the segments in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent sentence.

1) An outstanding feature of the 21st century has been
P) greater security and education which
Q) the improvement of the income and
R) living conditions of the
S) working man leading to
6) has meant greater political power.

(a) P, R, Q, S **(b)** S, R, Q, P
(c) S, P, Q, R **(d)** Q, R, S, P

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Q, R, S, P

Q: "The improvement of the income and" - This introduces the main idea of the improvement in the income and living conditions.
R: "living conditions of the" - This completes the thought and ties into the improvement of the income and living conditions.
S: "working man leading to" - This describes the effect of the improvement on the working man and how it leads to other outcomes.
P: "greater security and education which" - This finishes the idea, linking the improvement to greater security and education for the working man.
So the full sentence would read:
"An outstanding feature of the 21st century has been the improvement of the income and living conditions of the working man leading to greater security and education which has meant greater political power."
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.154 Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence.
An elaborate network / is / the plot of /schemes and tricks / of Much Ado About Nothing

(a) An elaborate network of Much Ado About Nothing is the plot of schemes and tricks.
(b) The plot is of schemes and tricks an elaborate network of Much Ado About Nothing.
(c) The plot of schemes and tricks is an elaborate network of Much Ado About Nothing
(d) The plot of Much Ado About Nothing is an elaborate network of schemes and tricks.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The plot of Much Ado About Nothing is an elaborate network of schemes and tricks.
option (d) is the correct answer.
The correct arrangement is: The plot of Much Ado About Nothing is an elaborate network of schemes and tricks.

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Q.155 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (1 and 6) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
1. There are some backward areas in Andhra Pradesh.
A. Rayalaseema is one of them.
B. Massive degradation of natural resources and extensive changes in land use have resulted in poor crop productivity in Rayalaseema.
C. The National Soil Survey and Land use planning organisation is doing its job by giving suggestions to the farmers of Rayalaseema.
D. Soil Organic Carbon (SOC), which is crucial for maintaining soil quality, has decreased by 84% in the region. Poor soil fertility and soil degradation, like in Rayalaseema region, are the major causes of food shortage.
6. The advice is about which crops are to be cultivated and which not.

(a) DCBA **(b)** CBAD
(c) CDBA **(d)** ABDC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ABDC
Sentence 1 introduces the topic by stating that there are backward areas in Andhra Pradesh.
Sentence A specifies that Rayalaseema is one of these areas.
Sentence B provides details about the challenges faced by Rayalaseema, including resource degradation and poor crop productivity.
Sentence D highlights the decline in Soil Organic Carbon (SOC) and its impact on soil quality and food security in the region.
Sentence C mentions the efforts of the National Soil Survey and Land Use Planning Organisation in assisting farmers.
Sentence 6 concludes by stating that the organisation's advice focuses on crop selection.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.156 Parts of a sentence are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the parts in the correct order to form a meaningful sentence.
The ashrams / used / were / the centres / of / knowledge and learning / as

(a) Knowledge and learning were used as the centres of the ashrams.
(b) As The ashrams of knowledge and learning were used the centres.
(c) The ashrams were used as the centres of knowledge and learning.
(d) The centres of the ashrams were used as knowledge and learning.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The ashrams were used as the centres of knowledge and learning.
option (c) is the correct answer.
The correct sentence is- The ashrams were used as the centres of knowledge and learning.

Q.157 Given below are four jumbled parts of a sentence. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A) has been attributed by many climate scientists
B) the unprecedented frequency of extreme weather events
C) to the steady rise in global atmospheric temperatures
D) observed across various continents over the last decade

(a) BDAC **(b)** ADBC
(c) CBAD **(d)** ABCD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BDAC
Rule: in a jumbled sentence, find the subject first, then the words that describe it, then the verb, then whatever the verb's preposition demands.
Find the subject.
B — **the unprecedented frequency of extreme weather events** — a noun phrase starting with *the*; it is the only part that can open.
Describe it.
D — **observed across various continents over the last decade** — a past-participle phrase that tells us which *events*; it sits right after B.
The verb.
A — **has been attributed by many climate scientists** — singular *has* agrees with *frequency*.
Close with the complement.
The pattern is *attribute X* **to** *Y*, so C — **to the steady rise in global atmospheric temperatures** — ends the sentence.
The sentence.
The unprecedented frequency of extreme weather events observed across various continents over the last decade has been attributed by many climate scientists to the steady rise in global atmospheric temperatures.
Answer: **BDAC**
Word help.
unprecedented = never happened before *(अभूतपूर्व)*.
attributed to = said to be caused by *(का कारण माना गया)*.
Attribute takes "to": an effect is attributed to its cause.

Q.158 Rearrange the jumbled words and choose the alternative that correctly matches the given sentence.
The youth _____ now-a-days.
life / of / today / a / leading / are / miserable

(a) of today are leading a miserable life
(b) today are leading of a miserable life
(c) today are leading a miserable life of
(d) are today leading of a miserable life

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) of today are leading a miserable life
"The youth of today" is the correct subject phrase, with "youth" being the subject and "of today" specifying which group of youth is being referred to.
"Are leading" is the correct verb phrase in the present continuous tense.
"A miserable life" completes the sentence, showing what the youth are leading.
Thus, the correct answer is:
"The youth of today are leading a miserable life."

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Q.159 Given below are four jumbled parts of a sentence. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A) by the intricate tapestry of
B) the philosopher was captivated
C) that define human existence
D) moral and ethical dilemmas

(a) CBAD **(b)** ABCD
(c) DBAC **(d)** BADC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BADC
Rule: start with the part that has a subject and verb; then let each part's dangling edge (a preposition, a relative pronoun) pick the next one.
Find the subject.
B — **the philosopher was captivated** — subject + verb; the opener.
Who captivated him.
captivated **by** … → A — **by the intricate tapestry of**
Finish "of".
A ends in *of*, which needs a noun → D — **moral and ethical dilemmas**
The relative clause.
C — **that define human existence** — *that* points back to *dilemmas*; plural *define* agrees with it.
The sentence.
The philosopher was captivated by the intricate tapestry of moral and ethical dilemmas that define human existence.
Answer: **BADC**
Word help.
captivated = charmed, held fully attentive *(मोहित)*.
tapestry = a woven picture; here, a rich, complex mix *(ताना-बाना)*.
dilemmas = hard choices between two options *(दुविधाएँ)*.
A part ending in "of" is never the last part — its noun must follow.

Q.160 Rearrange the jumbled words and choose the alternative that correctly matches the given sentence.
The people of _____ to survive.
are / this / island / commodities / deprived / essential / needed / remote / of

(a) this island are deprived of essential commodities needed remote
(b) this remote island are deprived of essential commodities needed
(c) this remote island are needed essential commodities deprived of
(d) remote island are deprived of essential commodities needed this

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) this remote island are deprived of essential commodities needed
The correct rearranged sentence is:
"The people of this remote island are deprived of essential commodities needed to survive."

Q.161 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Here, the picture-perfect French Quarter and heritage laden Tamil streets blend into one another.
B. Across many metropolitan cities, there exists a visible conflict in how the old and the new coexist.
C. The old and new, like two different worlds, surviving side by side yet never crossing that chasm.
D. However, Puducherry stands as a striking exception, where these very contrasts are celebrated rather than endured.

(a) BDAC **(b)** DABC
(c) ABCD **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BDAC
Opener test.
B — **Across many metropolitan cities** — states the general theme with no back-reference: the opener.
A starts with **Here** (needs a place named before it) and D with **However** (needs an idea to contrast with); neither can open.
Links.
B → D: *However, Puducherry stands as a striking exception* — the exception to B's *visible conflict*; *these very contrasts* = B's *the old and the new*.
D → A: **Here** = Puducherry; A gives the proof — French Quarter and Tamil streets *blend into one another*.
A → C: C, a verbless closing image, sums up the theme of *the old and new* as *two different worlds*.
Test the other B-opener.
BACD puts *Here* straight after "many metropolitan cities" — there is no single place for *Here* to point to, and the French Quarter belongs to Puducherry, which is not named until D.
So only **BDAC** keeps both pointer words (*However*, *Here*) attached to what they need.
The paragraph.
Across many metropolitan cities, there exists a visible conflict in how the old and the new coexist. However, Puducherry stands as a striking exception, where these very contrasts are celebrated rather than endured. Here, the picture-perfect French Quarter and heritage laden Tamil streets blend into one another. The old and new, like two different worlds, surviving side by side yet never crossing that chasm.
Answer: **BDAC**
Word help.
chasm = a deep gap; a wide difference *(खाई)*.
endured = put up with, suffered *(सहन किया)*.
"Here" and "However" never open a paragraph — each needs something before it.

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Q.162 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.

A. Faced with the high cost and scarcity of Indian indigo; European manufacturers were forced to rely on the woad plant for their dyeing needs.

B. However, cloth dyers still preferred indigo, as it produced a significantly richer and more vibrant blue than woad ever could.

C. Since woad thrived in temperate climates, it was readily available and easily cultivated throughout Europe.

D. Indian indigo was prohibitively expensive, and only meager quantities ever reached European markets.

(a) DACB **(b)** BCAD

(c) CBAD **(d)** ABCD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DACB

Opener test.

D — **Indian indigo was prohibitively expensive** — introduces the subject and its problem with no back-reference: the opener.

A (*Faced with the high cost and scarcity*) refers back to a problem already stated; B opens with *However*; C talks about *woad* before it has been introduced.

Links.

D → A: *high cost and scarcity* sums up D's *prohibitively expensive* and *meager quantities*; A introduces **woad** as the substitute.

A → C: *Since woad thrived in temperate climates* — explains why woad was the easy choice in Europe.

C → B: **However** — despite woad being easy to get, dyers *still preferred indigo* for its richer blue.

The paragraph.

Indian indigo was prohibitively expensive, and only meager quantities ever reached European markets. Faced with the high cost and scarcity of Indian indigo; European manufacturers were forced to rely on the woad plant for their dyeing needs. Since woad thrived in temperate climates, it was readily available and easily cultivated throughout Europe. However, cloth dyers still preferred indigo, as it produced a significantly richer and more vibrant blue than woad ever could.

Answer: **DACB**

Word help.

woad = a European plant whose leaves give a blue dye *(नील देने वाला एक यूरोपीय पौधा)*.

prohibitively = so much that it stops people buying *(अत्यधिक, पहुँच से बाहर)*.

meager = very small in amount *(अल्प, नाममात्र)*.

Problem → forced substitute → why the substitute worked → "However", the lasting preference.

Q.163 Some sentences are given below. While the first and the last sentences (1 and 2) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.

1.Ranga is the accountant's son.

A. He returned to his village after his studies were over.

B. He is one rare breed of village folk who loved studies.

C. On his return the villagers milled around his house to see whether he has changed or not.

D. He had gone to Bangalore to pursue his studies.

2.His idea about marriage are now quite different.

(a) BCDA **(b)** BCAD

(c) BDCA **(d)** BDAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BDAC

option (d) is the correct answer.

The sentence starts with Ranga is the accountant's son. Statement B is the additional information about Ranga. Sentence BD are correct pair and sentence AC are correct pair.

Hence the correct arrangement is: BDAC.

Ranga is the accountant's son. He is one rare breed of village folk who loved studies. He had gone to Bangalore to pursue his studies. He returned to his village after his studies were over. On his return the villagers milled around his house to see whether he has changed or not. His idea about marriage are now quite different.

Q.164 Some sentences are given below. While the first and the last sentences (1 and 2) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.

1."Do you still recognise me?" I asked.

A. The woman looked at me searchingly.

B."I am Mrs. S's daughter".

C.I came closer and stood on the step.

D. She opened the door a little.

2. She kept staring at me in silence.

(a) BDAC **(b)** BCAD

(c) BACD **(d)** BADC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BADC

option (d) is the correct answer.

The given sentence starts with **"Do you still recognize me?" I asked.** Then she gave her introduction so B is the first statement. Then the woman response hence **Sentence A** will follow A. Statement DC are pair.

Hence the correct arrangement is:

"Do you still recognise me?"
I asked. "I am Mrs. S's daughter".
The woman looked at me searchingly.
She opened the door a little.
I came closer and stood on the step.
She kept staring at me in silence.

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Q.165 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. It is almost a definition of a gentleman to say he is one who never inflicts pain
B. He is mainly occupied in merely removing the obstacles which hinder the free and unembarrassed action of those about him, and he concurs with their movements rather than takes the initiative himself.
C. The true gentleman in like manner carefully avoids whatever may cause a jar or a jolt in the minds of those with whom he is cast; all clashing of opinion, or collision of feeling, all restraint, or suspicion, or gloom, or resentment; his great concern being to make everyone at their ease and at home.
D. His benefits may be considered as parallel to what are called comforts or conveniences in arrangements of a personal nature: like an easy chair or a good fire, which do their part in dispelling cold and fatigue, though nature provides both means of rest and animal heat without them

(a) DBAC **(b)** DCBA
(c) ABCD **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ABCD
option (c) is the correct answer.
Statement B and D can never be a starting statement because sentence start with pronoun.
Statement C gives the additional information.
Hence Statement A is the starting statement.
The correct arrangement is: ABCD:
It is almost a definition of a gentleman to say he is one who never inflicts pain. He is mainly occupied in merely removing the obstacles which hinder the free and unembarrassed action of those about him, and he concurs with their movements rather than takes the initiative himself. The true gentleman in like manner carefully avoids whatever may cause a jar or a jolt in the minds of those with whom he is cast; all clashing of opinion, or collision of feeling, all restraint, or suspicion, or gloom, or resentment; his great concern being to make everyone at their ease and at home. His benefits may be considered as parallel to what are called comforts or conveniences in arrangements of a personal nature: like an easy chair or a good fire, which do their part in dispelling cold and fatigue, though nature provides both means of rest and animal heat without them.

Q.166 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (S1 and S6) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
S1. CV Raman's story begins in a village near Tiruchirapalli (known in his days as Trichinopoly) in southern India.
P. When he was four years old, Raman's family moved to Vishakapatnam.
Q. He was born on 8 November 1888, the second child of R Chandrashekara Iyer and Parvati Ammal.
R. Chandrasekara Iyer was an athletic man and he took active interest in sports.
S. His father took up a job there, as a lecturer in Mrs. AV Narsimha Rao College, where he taught physics, mathematics and physical geography.
S6. His young son Raman was not physically very strong, but was very intelligent and he preferred to read books and work at his studies.

(a) QPRS **(b)** SRPQ
(c) QPSR **(d)** PQSR

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) QPSR
Q: Raman's birth.
P: The family's move to Vishakapatnam.
S: Raman's father's job in Vishakapatnam.
R: More about his father's athleticism.
S6: About Raman's intelligence and personal traits.
So, the correct answer is **QPSR**.

Q.167 **Given below are six sentences 4 of which are jumbled. The first and the last sentence are given. Pick the option that gives the logically correct order of the four sentences.**
S-1 One night Mulla Nasruddin Hodja had a dream.
A: At the mention of ten gold coins, Hodja agreed and showed him to his room.
B: The next morning, the man thanked Hodja and began taking out the gold coins from his purse.
C: He said he would pay ten gold coins to Hodja if he was allowed the privilege.
D: A man knocked at his door and asked if he could spend the night in his house.
S- 6 But he took out only nine from it and stopped.

(a) DCAB **(b)** CDBA
(c) BACD **(d)** DABC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DCAB
Type: Para Jumble (S-1 & S-6 fixed)
• **S-1** – one night Mulla Nasruddin Hodja had a dream.
• **D** – a man knocked and asked if he could spend the night in his house.
• **C** – he said he would pay ten gold coins for the privilege.
• **A** – at the mention of ten gold coins, Hodja agreed and showed him a room.
• **B** – the next morning, the man began taking out the gold coins from his purse.
• **S-6** – but he took out only nine and stopped.
Order → **D-C-A-B**.

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Q.168 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
P: In contrast, applying a heavy moisturizer first would block the absorption of lighter serums.
Q: Hence, layering products from thinnest to thickest consistency ensures maximum efficacy for every ingredient.
R: Typically, a balanced skincare routine begins with a gentle cleanser to remove daily impurities.
S: Additionally, active treatments like vitamin C should be applied directly onto clean, damp skin.

(a) QSPR **(b)** SPRQ
(c) PRSQ **(d)** RSPQ

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) RSPQ
Opener test.
R — **Typically, a balanced skincare routine begins with ...** — sets up the topic and the *first* step: the opener.
S (*Additionally*), P (*In contrast*) and Q (*Hence*) each need an earlier sentence.
Only option (d) begins with R.
Links.
R → S: **Additionally** gives the next step — actives go onto **clean**, damp skin, i.e. skin just washed by R's *cleanser*.
S → P: **In contrast** shows the wrong way — a **heavy moisturizer first** would block lighter serums.
P → Q: **Hence** concludes the rule — layer from **thinnest to thickest**.
The paragraph.
Typically, a balanced skincare routine begins with a gentle cleanser to remove daily impurities. Additionally, active treatments like vitamin C should be applied directly onto clean, damp skin. In contrast, applying a heavy moisturizer first would block the absorption of lighter serums. Hence, layering products from thinnest to thickest consistency ensures maximum efficacy for every ingredient.
Answer: **RSPQ**
Word help.
efficacy = the power to produce the intended result *(प्रभावकारिता)*.
absorption = soaking in *(अवशोषण)*.
"Hence" closes — it states the rule the earlier sentences have built up.

Q.169 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
P: In addition, these ancient manuscripts provide profound insights into human consciousness.
Q: Therefore, modern scholars continue to analyze these texts for timeless wisdom.
R: Ancient Indian scriptures offer a vast treasure of philosophical and spiritual knowledge.
S: However, translating these complex Sanskrit verses remains a very difficult task.

(a) RPSQ **(b)** QSPR
(c) PRSQ **(d)** SQRP

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) RPSQ
Opener test.
R — **Ancient Indian scriptures offer a vast treasure ...** — introduces the topic with no linking word and no pointer: the opener.
P (*In addition, these*), Q (*Therefore, ... these texts*) and S (*However, these*) all lean on something said before.
Only option (a) begins with R.
Links.
R → P: **In addition** adds a second merit; *these ancient manuscripts* = R's *ancient Indian scriptures*.
P → S: **However** turns from the merits to the difficulty — translating *these complex Sanskrit verses*.
S → Q: **Therefore** draws the conclusion from the whole case — the texts are rich (R, P), so scholars **continue** to study them for timeless wisdom, difficulty (S) notwithstanding.
The paragraph.
Ancient Indian scriptures offer a vast treasure of philosophical and spiritual knowledge. In addition, these ancient manuscripts provide profound insights into human consciousness. However, translating these complex Sanskrit verses remains a very difficult task. Therefore, modern scholars continue to analyze these texts for timeless wisdom.
Answer: **RPSQ**
Word help.
profound = very deep *(गहन, गहरा)*.
consciousness = awareness of the self and the world *(चेतना)*.
In addition, However, Therefore — three connectors, none of which can start a paragraph.

Q.170 Given below are six sentences 4 of which are jumbled. The first and the last sentence are given. Pick the option that gives the logically correct order of the four sentences.
S-1 The moment Hari stepped down from the train he was greeted at the platform by the people of his small town.
A: They considered him a real patriot.
B: Now he was back after a victorious battle.
C: Though he had retired from the army, he had offered his services once again to help.
D: They had gathered there with garlands and a band, to welcome him home.
S-6 It was raining but people enjoyed it with a real hero and considered the rain a pious sign.

(a) DACB **(b)** ACBD
(c) DBAC **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DACB
Type: Para Jumble (S-1 & S-6 fixed)
• **S-1** – Hari stepped off the train and was greeted by the townspeople.
• **D** – they had gathered with garlands and a band to welcome him home.
• **A** – they considered him a real patriot.
• **C** – though he had retired from the army, he had offered his services again to help.
• **B** – now he was back after a victorious battle.
• **S-6** – it was raining, but people enjoyed it, treating the rain as a good omen.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

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Q.171 Given below are four jumbled parts of a sentence. Select the option that gives their correct order and forms a meaningful sentence.
P. to automate complex tasks that once
Q. Artificial Intelligence has the potential
R. required human intuition and years of specialized training
S. thereby revolutionizing the modern workforce

(a) QPRS **(b)** RQPS
(c) PSQR **(d)** SQPR

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) QPRS
Rule: in a jumbled sentence, find the subject and verb first, then follow each dangling edge — an infinitive after *potential*, a verb after *that*, and a *thereby* participle at the end.
Find the opener.
Q — **Artificial Intelligence has the potential** — subject + verb, capital letter, no back-reference: it opens.
Follow the edges.
Q → P: *the potential* **to** *automate* — "potential" takes a to-infinitive.
P → R: P ends on *that once*, which needs a verb; R supplies it — *that once* **required** *human intuition …*
R → S: **thereby** *revolutionizing* is a result phrase *(जिससे …)* and naturally closes the sentence.
The sentence.
Artificial Intelligence has the potential to automate complex tasks that once required human intuition and years of specialized training, thereby revolutionizing the modern workforce.
Answer: **QPRS**
Word help.
intuition = understanding something without conscious reasoning *(अंतर्ज्ञान)*.
revolutionizing = changing completely *(पूरी तरह बदल देना)*.
A part ending in "that once" is an open door — the next part must begin with a verb.

Q.172 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A: He became rich and built on their father's business.
B: After their father's death, the greedy Khasim married a wealthy woman.
C: Ali Baba married a poor woman and settled into the trade of a woodcutter.
D: Ali Baba and his elder brother Khasim were the sons of a merchant.

(a) CBAD **(b)** DACB
(c) ADBC **(d)** DBAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) DBAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – Ali Baba and his elder brother Khasim were the sons of a merchant.
• **B** – after their father's death, the greedy Khasim married a wealthy woman.
• **A** – he became rich and built on their father's business.
• **C** – Ali Baba married a poor woman and became a woodcutter.
Order → **D-B-A-C**.

Q.173 Given below are four jumbled parts of a sentence. Select the option that gives their correct order and forms a meaningful sentence.
P. while providing a platform for global connectivity
Q. can also lead to mental health issues
R. excessive use of social media platforms
S. if not balanced with real-world interactions

(a) PRQS **(b)** PQRS
(c) RQPS **(d)** SRQP

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) PRQS
⚠️ **Note:** the official key marks option (c) (RQPS); the better order is option (a) (PRQS), because *also* in Q needs the benefit in P to come before it, and *if not balanced* (S) must sit right after the harm in Q that it limits.
Rule: a concessive *while*-clause *(विरोधसूचक उपवाक्य)* states the good side first; the main clause then adds the bad side with *also*; a condition (*if not …*) attaches to the verb it limits.
Example: *While saving time, fast food can also harm health if eaten daily.*
Fix the core.
R + Q = subject + verb: **excessive use of social media platforms can also lead to mental health issues**.
Place S.
if not balanced with real-world interactions limits the harm — mental health issues arise only when use is *not balanced*.
So S must follow Q directly: Q → S.
Place P.
also in Q means "besides something good already said".
That good thing is P — *providing a platform for global connectivity* — so P comes **first**: P → R.
The sentence.
While providing a platform for global connectivity, excessive use of social media platforms can also lead to mental health issues if not balanced with real-world interactions.
Why the key's order is weaker.
RQPS gives … *mental health issues while providing a platform for global connectivity if not balanced with real-world interactions.*
Here *also* has no earlier point to add to, and *if not balanced* now hangs on *providing a platform* — connectivity does not depend on lack of balance.
Answer: **PRQS**
Word help.
connectivity = the state of being connected *(जुड़ाव, संपर्क)*.
"Also" looks backward — whatever it adds to must already be in the sentence.

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Q.174 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order.
A: First it is received by the sub-editors through the correspondents, the reporters, and via the news agencies.
B: Next it is passed on to the chief sub-editor who thoroughly checks the matter again and makes changes, if necessary.
C: The sub-editors then examine the news and reword it, if needed.
D: News, from its reception to printing, goes through a series of interconnected stages.

(a) DACB **(b)** CBAD
(c) DCBA **(d)** BADC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – news, from reception to printing, goes through interconnected stages.
• **A** – first, it is received by the sub-editors through correspondents, reporters and news agencies.
• **C** – the sub-editors then examine and reword it, if needed.
• **B** – next, it is passed to the chief sub-editor, who checks it again.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.175 Given below are six sentences 4 of which are jumbled. The first and the last sentence are given. Pick the option that gives the logically correct order of the four sentences.
S1- It was 6 o'clock in the evening and there was a lot of traffic on the road.
A: He was very angry with them for their recklessness.
B: They laughed at him as they overtook his car.
C: Mohan was driving his car when suddenly two teenagers on a bike speeded ahead from behind him.
D: Mohan swerved a little and applied the brakes in the nick of time.
S-6 But since he was getting late for an important meeting at his office, he ignored the bike riders and drove ahead.

(a) ACBD **(b)** CBDA
(c) CADB **(d)** BDCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble (S1 & S-6 fixed)
• **S1** – it was 6 o'clock; there was heavy traffic.
• **C** – Mohan was driving when two teenagers on a bike sped ahead of him.
• **B** – they laughed at him as they overtook his car.
• **D** – Mohan swerved and braked in the nick of time.
• **A** – he was very angry at their recklessness.
• **S-6** – but, getting late for a meeting, he ignored them and drove on.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

Q.176 Given below are six sentences 4 of which are jumbled. The first and the last sentence are given. Pick the option that gives the logically correct order of the four sentences.
S1 The salt seller came to understand the trick and decided to teach the donkey a lesson.
A: But the dampened cotton became very heavy to carry and the donkey suffered.
B: It learnt a lesson.
C: Again it played the same trick hoping that the cotton bag would become lighter.
D: The next day he loaded a cotton bag on the donkey.
It didn't play the trick anymore after that day, and the salt seller was happy.

(a) ACBD **(b)** DCAB
(c) CBAD **(d)** DBCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DCAB
Type: Para Jumble (S1 & S-6 fixed)
• **S1** – the salt seller understood the trick and decided to teach the donkey a lesson.
• **D** – the next day he loaded a cotton bag on the donkey.
• **C** – again it played the same trick, hoping the cotton bag would become lighter.
• **A** – but the dampened cotton became very heavy and the donkey suffered.
• **B** – it learnt a lesson.
• **S-6** – it never played the trick again, and the salt seller was happy.
Order → **D-C-A-B**.

Q.177 Given below are six sentences 4 of which are jumbled. The first and the last sentence are given. Pick the option that gives the logically correct order of the four sentences.
S-1 A salt seller used to carry the salt bag on his donkey to the market every day.
A: One day the donkey suddenly tumbled down the stream and the salt bag also fell into the water.
B: The donkey was happy.
C: On the way they had to cross a stream.
D: The salt dissolved in the water and hence the bag became very light to carry.
S-6 Then the donkey started to play the same trick every day.

(a) CDAB **(b)** ACDB
(c) BDCA **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Type: Para Jumble (S-1 & S-6 fixed)
• **S-1** – a salt seller carried salt on his donkey to the market daily.
• **C** – on the way they had to cross a stream.
• **A** – one day the donkey tumbled down the stream and the salt bag fell into the water.
• **D** – the salt dissolved and the bag became light to carry.
• **B** – the donkey was happy.
• **S-6** – then the donkey started to play the same trick every day.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

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Q.178 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A: Suddenly she saw a child begging on the platform.
B: She also noticed that there was a book in his bag.
C: Ruhi was getting restless as she still had over two hours to wait before her train came.
D: He appeared to be a young boy of about ten years who had a small bag on his shoulder.

(a) DBCA **(b)** ABDC
(c) CBAD **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Ruhi was restless as she still had two hours to wait for her train.
• **A** – suddenly she saw a child begging on the platform.
• **D** – he appeared to be a boy of about ten with a small bag on his shoulder.
• **B** – she also noticed that there was a book in his bag.
Order → **C-A-D-B**.

Q.179 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A: As I rushed to open my door, bright lights from outside dazzled my eyes.
B: Suddenly I heard people shouting outside.
C: Last Sunday, I was watching TV.
D: It was about 10:30 p.m.

(a) CADB **(b)** DCAB
(c) CBDA **(d)** ACBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – last Sunday, I was watching TV.
• **B** – suddenly I heard people shouting outside.
• **D** – it was about 10:30 p.m.
• **A** – as I rushed to open my door, bright lights dazzled my eyes.
Order → **C-B-D-A**.

Q.180 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A: On a holiday they went walking into a forest, enjoying the beauty of nature.
B: Suddenly they saw a bear coming towards them.
C: They became frightened and Raju, who knew all about climbing trees, climbed up one quickly.
D: Vijay and Raju were friends.

(a) CADB **(b)** DCAB
(c) BCDA **(d)** DABC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) DABC
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – Vijay and Raju were friends.
• **A** – on a holiday they went walking into a forest, enjoying nature.
• **B** – suddenly they saw a bear coming towards them.
• **C** – they were frightened, and Raju, who knew climbing, quickly climbed a tree.
Order → **D-A-B-C**.

Q.181 **Given below are six sentences 4 of which are jumbled. The first and the last sentence are given. Pick the option that gives the logically correct order of the four sentences.**
S-1 Both the boys were without helmets and were bleeding profusely.
A: The timely help saved the lives of the boys who were ashamed of their actions after meeting Mohan.
B: He informed their family members using one of the boys' mobile phone.
C: With the help of some passers-by, he picked them up and immediately took them to a hospital in his car.
D: Mohan wasted no time.
S-6 Mohan forgave them and advised them to follow the traffic rules as they are meant for people's safety.

(a) DABC **(b)** CABD
(c) DCBA **(d)** BDAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DCBA
Type: Para Jumble (S-1 & S-6 fixed)
• **S-1** – both boys were without helmets and bleeding profusely.
• **D** – Mohan wasted no time.
• **C** – with the help of passers-by, he took them to a hospital in his car.
• **B** – he informed their family members using a boy's mobile phone.
• **A** – the timely help saved the ashamed boys' lives.
• **S-6** – Mohan forgave them and advised them to follow traffic rules.
Order → **D-C-B-A**.

Q.182 **Given below are six sentences 4 of which are jumbled. The first and the last sentence are given. Pick the option that gives the logically correct order of the four sentences.**
S-1 When Amit woke up in the morning and looked at his face in the mirror, he did not recognise the face looking back at him.
A: The face staring at him was calm and cool.
B: First, Amit moved his fingers on the surface of the mirror, but it felt different.
C: Then, he touched his face, it appeared strange and was like touching someone else's face.
D: 'This is not me.....' he cried aloud.
S- 6 He felt scared and anxious.

(a) ACBD **(b)** CBDA
(c) DABC **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DABC
Type: Para Jumble (S-1 & S-6 fixed)
• **S-1** – Amit did not recognise the face in the mirror.
• **D** – "This is not me..." he cried aloud.
• **A** – the face staring at him was calm and cool.
• **B** – first, he moved his fingers on the mirror, but it felt different.
• **C** – then, he touched his face; it appeared strange, like someone else's.
• **S-6** – he felt scared and anxious.
Order → **D-A-B-C**.

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Q.183 **Given below are six sentences 4 of which are jumbled. The first and the last sentence are given. Pick the option that gives the logically correct order of the four sentences.**
S-1 Once a daughter complained to her father that her life was miserable and that she didn't know how she was going to tackle it.
A: Her father, a chef, took her to the kitchen.
B: She was tired of fighting and struggling all the time.
C: He filled three pots with water and placed each on a high fire.
D: It seemed as if just as one problem was solved, another one followed.
S-6 When the three pots began to boil, he placed potatoes in one pot, eggs in the second pot and ground coffee beans in the third pot.

(a) BCDA **(b)** BDAC
(c) CBDA **(d)** ADCB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BDAC
Type: Para Jumble (S-1 & S-6 fixed)
• **S-1** – a daughter complained her life was miserable.
• **B** – she was tired of fighting and struggling all the time.
• **D** – it seemed just as one problem was solved, another followed.
• **A** – her father, a chef, took her to the kitchen.
• **C** – he filled three pots with water and placed each on a high fire.
• **S-6** – when they boiled, he put potatoes, eggs and coffee beans in them.
Order → **B-D-A-C**.

Q.184 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A: One day when the quarreling had been much more violent than usual and each of the sons was moping in a surly manner, he asked one of them to bring him a bundle of sticks.
B: No words he could say did the least good, so he thought in his mind for some very striking example that should make them see that discord would lead them to misfortune.
C: A man had a family of sons, who were forever quarreling among themselves.
D: Then handing the bundle to each of his Sons in turn he told them to try to break it.

(a) CBAD **(b)** CABD
(c) DCBA **(d)** ABDC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CBAD
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – a man had a family of sons who were forever quarreling.
• **B** – no words did any good, so he thought of a striking example to show that discord leads to misfortune.
• **A** – one day, when the quarreling was worse than usual, he asked one son to bring a bundle of sticks.
• **D** – then, handing the bundle to each son in turn, he told them to try to break it.
Order → **C-B-A-D**.

Q.185 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A: But when he tried to rise again he found that he could not get away, for his claws were tangled in the wool.
B: A jackdaw saw the deed, and his silly head was filled with the idea that he was big and strong enough to do as the Eagle had done.
C: So with much rustling of feathers and a fierce air, he came down swiftly on the back of a large ram.
D: An eagle, swooping down on powerful wings, seized a lamb in her talons and made off with it to her nest.

(a) ADBC **(b)** DBCA
(c) DABC **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) DBCA
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – an eagle swooped down, seized a lamb and carried it to her nest.
• **B** – a jackdaw saw this and thought he was strong enough to do the same.
• **C** – so, with rustling feathers and a fierce air, he came down on a large ram.
• **A** – but when he tried to rise, he could not — his claws were tangled in the wool.
Order → **D-B-C-A**.

Q.186 **Given below are six sentences 4 of which are jumbled. The first and the last sentence are given. Pick the option that gives the logically correct order of the four sentences.**
S-1 A slave, ill-treated by his master, runs away to the forest.
A: The slave bravely goes forward and removes the thorn gently.
B: The lion goes away without hurting him.
C: There he comes across a lion in pain because of a thorn in his paw.
D: Some days later, the slave's master comes hunting to the forest and catches many animals and cages them.
S-6 The slave is spotted by the masters' men who catch him and bring him to the cruel master.

(a) CDBA **(b)** CABD
(c) DCAB **(d)** BADC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CABD
Type: Para Jumble (S-1 & S-6 fixed)
• **S-1** – a slave, ill-treated, runs away to the forest.
• **C** – there he comes across a lion in pain because of a thorn in its paw.
• **A** – the slave bravely goes forward and removes the thorn gently.
• **B** – the lion goes away without hurting him.
• **D** – some days later, the slave's master comes hunting and cages many animals.
• **S-6** – the slave is caught by the master's men.
Order → **C-A-B-D**.

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Q.187 **Given below are six sentences 4 of which are jumbled. The first and the last sentence are given. Pick the option that gives the logically correct order of the four sentences.**
S-1 Rahul was alone at home.
A: He hesitated for a moment but then picked up the receiver.
B: Suddenly the phone rang.
C: He repeated 'Hello' but still no one replied from the other end.
D: Though he said 'Hello', there was no response from the other side.
S-6 The phone rang again but this time somebody asked if his father was at home.

(a) DACB **(b)** BADC
(c) CDBA **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BADC
Type: Para Jumble (S-1 & S-6 fixed)
• **S-1** – Rahul was alone at home.
• **B** – suddenly the phone rang.
• **A** – he hesitated for a moment but then picked up the receiver.
• **D** – though he said 'Hello', there was no response.
• **C** – he repeated 'Hello', but still no one replied.
• **S-6** – the phone rang again, and this time someone asked for his father.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.188 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A:"Impossible," said the people when they heard the condition.
B: The Emperor offered a reward of 1000 gold coins to any man who could come to the palace observing the following condition.
C: Just then a villager came carrying a string cot over his head and claimed the prize.
D: The man had to walk in the sun without an umbrella but he had to be in the shade at the same time.

(a) BCDA **(b)** ABCD
(c) BDAC **(d)** CDAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BDAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – the Emperor offered a reward of 1000 gold coins for meeting a condition.
• **D** – the man had to walk in the sun without an umbrella yet stay in the shade.
• **A** – "Impossible," said the people when they heard the condition.
• **C** – just then a villager came carrying a string cot over his head and claimed the prize.
Order → **B-D-A-C**.

Q.189 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A: They say that Jupiter punished him so, because he was such a lazy stay-at-home that he would not go to Jupiter's wedding, even when especially invited.
B: The Tortoise, you know, carries his house on his back.
C: After many years, Tortoise began to wish he had gone to that wedding.
D: No matter how hard he tries, he cannot leave home.

(a) DCAB **(b)** BDAC
(c) CABD **(d)** BCDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BDAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – the Tortoise, you know, carries his house on his back.
• **D** – no matter how hard he tries, he cannot leave home.
• **A** – they say Jupiter punished him so, because he was such a lazy stay-at-home that he skipped Jupiter's wedding.
• **C** – after many years, Tortoise began to wish he had gone to that wedding.
Order → **B-D-A-C**.

Q.190 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A: The farmer climbed down from his seat and stood beside the wagon.
B: A farmer was driving his wagon along a muddy country road after a heavy rain.
C: At last it came to a standstill when one of the wheels sank to the hub in a rut.
D: The horses could hardly drag the load through the deep mud.

(a) DCAB **(b)** BACD
(c) BDCA **(d)** ACBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BDCA
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – a farmer was driving his wagon along a muddy road after heavy rain.
• **D** – the horses could hardly drag the load through the deep mud.
• **C** – at last it came to a standstill when a wheel sank to the hub in a rut.
• **A** – the farmer climbed down from his seat and stood beside the wagon.
Order → **B-D-C-A**.

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Q.191 **Given below are six sentences A-F, of which A and F are static and B-E have been jumbled. Pick the option that gives the correct order of the jumbled sentences.**
A. The King and Queen of Siam had several daughters.
B. So, the King named his daughters January, February, March till he came to the youngest whom he named September.
C. The princesses were very proud of their parrots and spent time teaching them to talk.
D. One year on his birthday, the King gave each of his daughters a green parrot in a cage.
E. The Queen said it confused her to remember so many names.
F. In a short while all the parrots could say "God save the King".

(a) AEBDCF **(b)** ACDBEF
(c) ADBECF **(d)** ABECDF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) AEBDCF
Type: Para Jumble (A & F fixed)
• **A** – the King and Queen of Siam had several daughters.
• **E** – the Queen said it confused her to remember so many names.
• **B** – so the King named his daughters January, February ... to the youngest, September.
• **D** – one year on his birthday, the King gave each daughter a green parrot.
• **C** – the princesses were very proud of their parrots and taught them to talk.
• **F** – soon all the parrots could say "God save the King".
Order → **A-E-B-D-C-F**.

Q.192 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. It was the advertisement for a metal detector called Wonder Sweeper 5000.
B. Jacob believed he could find the buried treasure of the pirates if he had that detector.
C. Jacob was reading one of his comic books when he came upon something interesting.
D. So, he decided to save every penny till he had enough money to buy one.

(a) BADC **(b)** CABD
(c) CBDA **(d)** BDCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CABD
Type: Para Jumble
• **C** – Jacob was reading a comic book when he came upon something interesting.
• **A** – it was the advertisement for a metal detector called Wonder Sweeper 5000.
• **B** – Jacob believed he could find the pirates' buried treasure with that detector.
• **D** – so he decided to save every penny to buy one.
Order → **C-A-B-D**.

Q.193 **Given below are six sentences A-F, of which A and F are static and B-E have been jumbled. Pick the option that gives the correct order of the jumbled sentences.**
A. Suddenly I noticed smoke pouring in through the seams of the ceiling.
B. Groping our way to the front door we all ran out into the front yard.
C. The smoke began to fill the room so quickly that we could barely see.
D. I ran to the neighbours to call the fire department.
E. By the time we made our way outside, the whole roof was engulfed in flames.
F. I saw mother run back into the house and I screamed, "Mom! No!"

(a) AEDCBF **(b)** ACBEDF
(c) ABCDEF **(d)** ADEBCF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ACBEDF
Type: Para Jumble (A & F fixed)
• **A** – suddenly I noticed smoke pouring through the seams of the ceiling.
• **C** – the smoke filled the room so quickly that we could barely see.
• **B** – groping to the front door, we all ran out into the yard.
• **E** – by the time we were outside, the whole roof was in flames.
• **D** – I ran to the neighbours to call the fire department.
• **F** – I saw mother run back into the house and I screamed, "Mom! No!"
Order → **A-C-B-E-D-F**.

Q.194 **Given below are six sentences A-F, of which A and F are static and B-E have been jumbled. Pick the option that gives the correct order of the jumbled sentences.**
A. A singer called Mukandan Misra and his wife lived in Behat near Gwalior.
B. Tired, the group settled down to rest in a shady grove.
C. Once Swami Haridas was travelling through the forest with his disciples.
D. Tansen, their only child was very naughty.
E. Often he would run away to the woods and soon learnt to imitate the calls of birds and animals.
F. Tansen thought it would be fun to frighten the resting men with the roar of a tiger.

(a) AEBCDF **(b)** ABDECF
(c) ADECBF **(d)** ACEBDF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ADECBF
Type: Para Jumble (A & F fixed)
• **A** – a singer, Mukandan Misra, and his wife lived in Behat near Gwalior.
• **D** – Tansen, their only child, was very naughty.
• **E** – often he would run away to the woods and imitate the calls of birds and animals.
• **C** – once Swami Haridas was travelling through the forest with his disciples.
• **B** – tired, the group settled down to rest in a shady grove.
• **F** – Tansen thought it would be fun to frighten the resting men with a tiger's roar.
Order → **A-D-E-C-B-F**.

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Q.195 **Given below are six sentences A-F, of which A and F are static and B-E have been jumbled. Pick the option that gives the correct order of the jumbled sentences.**
A. One day I went to school with four rupees in my pocket to pay the school fees.
B. All through the day, the coins sat quietly in my pocket.
C. So, I was told that the fees would be collected the next day.
D. When school got over, the coins in my pocket began to speak.
E. But the teacher who was to collect the fees was absent.
F. They said that money was meant to be spent on good things like hot 'jalebis'.

(a) ABCDEF **(b)** AECBDF
(c) ADEBCF **(d)** ACBEDF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) AECBDF
Type: Para Jumble (A & F fixed)
• **A** – one day I went to school with four rupees to pay the fees.
• **E** – but the teacher who was to collect the fees was absent.
• **C** – so I was told the fees would be collected the next day.
• **B** – all through the day the coins sat quietly in my pocket.
• **D** – when school got over, the coins began to speak.
• **F** – they said money was meant to be spent on hot 'jalebis'.
Order → **A-E-C-B-D-F**.

Q.196 **Given below are six sentences A-F, of which A and F are static and B-E have been jumbled. Pick the option that gives the correct order of the jumbled sentences.**
A. Santosh's parents were affluent landowners who could afford to send their children to the best schools.
B. So, she decided to fight the matter in her own quiet way when the right moment arrived.
C. At sixteen, most of the girls in her village used to get married.
D. But in line with the custom of the family, Santosh was sent to the local village school.
E. And, the right moment came when she turned sixteen.
F. But a marriage at that age was the last thing on Santosh's mind.

(a) ADBECF **(b)** AECDBF
(c) ABDCEF **(d)** ACEBDF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ADBECF
Type: Para Jumble (A & F fixed)
• **A** – Santosh's parents were affluent landowners who could afford the best schools.
• **D** – but, in line with family custom, Santosh was sent to the local village school.
• **B** – so she decided to fight the matter quietly when the right moment arrived.
• **E** – and the right moment came when she turned sixteen.
• **C** – at sixteen, most girls in her village used to get married.
• **F** – but marriage at that age was the last thing on Santosh's mind.
Order → **A-D-B-E-C-F**.

Q.197 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. The zip on the bag got jammed and wouldn't open no matter how hard I pulled at it.
B. We were flying to England for a week.
C. I also remembered that I had put the frequent flyer card in the carry-on bag hanging around my neck.
D. As we were checking in, I remembered that I was a member of the frequent flyer programme.

(a) BACD **(b)** DBAC
(c) ABDC **(d)** BDCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BDCA
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – we were flying to England for a week.
• **D** – as we were checking in, I remembered I was a member of the frequent flyer programme.
• **C** – I also remembered I had put the frequent flyer card in the carry-on bag around my neck.
• **A** – the zip on the bag got jammed and wouldn't open, however hard I pulled.
Order → **B-D-C-A**.

Q.198 **Given below are six sentences A-F, of which A and F are static and B-E have been jumbled. Pick the option that gives the correct order of the jumbled sentences.**
A. When the train pulled in at Chennai Central, it took Velu some time to get off.
B. So, he sat down on a nearby bench that was unoccupied.
C. In all his eleven years he had not seen so many people except at the village fair.
D. When he finally stood on the platform, his legs felt wobble.
E. He put his small bundle beside him on the bench and looked around.
F. Near him, a group of people sat on their luggage staring at a TV hanging from the roof.

(a) ABECDF **(b)** AEDCBF
(c) ADBECF **(d)** ACBDEF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ADBECF
Type: Para Jumble (A & F fixed)
• **A** – the train pulled in at Chennai Central; Velu took time to get off.
• **D** – when he finally stood on the platform, his legs felt wobbly.
• **B** – so he sat down on a nearby unoccupied bench.
• **E** – he put his bundle beside him and looked around.
• **C** – in eleven years he had never seen so many people except at the village fair.
• **F** – near him, a group sat on their luggage staring at a TV.
Order → **A-D-B-E-C-F**.

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Q.199 **Given below are six sentences A-F, of which A and F are static and B-E have been jumbled. Pick the option that gives the correct order of the jumbled sentences.**
A. Dr. Sadao Hoki's house was built on a spot of the Japanese coast where he had played as a little boy.
B. His father had said, "Those islands are the stepping stones to the future for Japan.
C. His father had taken him to the islands of those seas and taught him things he had not forgotten.
D. As a boy, Sadao had climbed the pines, supporting himself on his bare feet as the men did in the South Seas.
E. The square stone house was set upon rocks above a beach outlined with bent pines.
F. "Where shall we step from them?" Sadao had asked seriously.

(a) ABEDCF **(b)** AEDCBF
(c) ADCEBF **(d)** ACDBEF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) AEDCBF
Type: Para Jumble (A & F fixed)
• **A** – Dr. Sadao's house was built on the Japanese coast where he had played as a boy.
• **E** – the square stone house was set upon rocks above a beach of bent pines (describes the house).
• **D** – as a boy, Sadao had climbed the pines like the men of the South Seas.
• **C** – his father had taken him to the islands and taught him things.
• **B** – his father had said, "Those islands are the stepping stones to the future for Japan."
• **F** – "Where shall we step from them?" Sadao had asked.
Order → **A-E-D-C-B-F**.

Q.200 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. The flute seller stands in a corner of the square near the hotel.
B. From time to time, he stands the pole on the ground, selects a flute and plays a tune.
C. In his hand is a pole from which protrude about fifty flutes in all directions.
D. They are all made from hollow bamboo stems.

(a) ACDB **(b)** ABCD
(c) BDAC **(d)** CBDA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ACDB
Type: Para Jumble
• **A** – the flute seller stands in a corner of the square near the hotel.
• **C** – in his hand is a pole from which protrude about fifty flutes.
• **D** – they are all made from hollow bamboo stems.
• **B** – from time to time, he stands the pole on the ground, selects a flute and plays a tune.
Order → **A-C-D-B**.

Q.201 **Given below are six sentences A-F, of which A and F are static and B-E have been jumbled. Pick the option that gives the correct order of the jumbled sentences.**
A. A great treat for Toto monkey in cold weather was the large bowl of warm water given to him for his bath.
B. He would then rush straight to the kitchen fire to dry himself.
C. When the water became cold, he would get out and run as quickly as he could.
D. He would cunningly test the temperature with his hand and then step into the bath gradually.
E. Once comfortable, he would take the soap in his hands or feet and rub himself all over.
F. But if anyone made fun of his activities, he would feel hurt.

(a) ADECBF **(b)** ABCEDF
(c) ACEBDF **(d)** ADBCEF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ADECBF
Type: Para Jumble (A & F fixed)
• **A** – a great treat for Toto in cold weather was a large bowl of warm water for his bath.
• **D** – he would test the temperature with his hand and step in gradually.
• **E** – once comfortable, he would take the soap and rub himself all over.
• **C** – when the water became cold, he would get out and run quickly.
• **B** – he would then rush to the kitchen fire to dry himself.
• **F** – but if anyone made fun of him, he would feel hurt.
Order → **A-D-E-C-B-F**.

Q.202 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Some were big and floated around while others were small and popped immediately.
B. Nancy's uncle gifted her a bubble shooter for her birthday.
C. She chased them around, trying to hold them in her hands.
D. Now, Nancy could blow bubbles of all sizes.

(a) BACD **(b)** CABD
(c) BDAC **(d)** DCAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BDAC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Nancy's uncle gifted her a bubble shooter for her birthday.
• **D** – now Nancy could blow bubbles of all sizes.
• **A** – some were big and floated around while others were small and popped.
• **C** – she chased them around, trying to hold them in her hands.
Order → **B-D-A-C**.

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Q.203 **Given below are six sentences A-F, of which A and F are static and B-E have been jumbled. Pick the option that gives the correct order of the jumbled sentences.**
A. Timothy, the tiger cub was discovered by Grandfather in the Terai jungle near Dehra.
B. Grandfather picked him and brought him home.
C. One day when Grandfather was strolling in the jungle, he spotted a little tiger about 18 inches long.
D. The tiger cub was named Timothy by Grandfather and initially brought up entirely on milk.
E. The frightened animal was hiding among the intricate roots of a banyan tree.
F. Later, he was put on a diet of raw mutton and cod liver oil.

(a) ADCEBF **(b)** ABEDCF
(c) AEBCDF **(d)** ACEBDF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ACEBDF
Type: Para Jumble (A & F fixed)
- **A** – Timothy the tiger cub was discovered by Grandfather in the Terai jungle near Dehra.
- **C** – one day, strolling in the jungle, Grandfather spotted a little tiger about 18 inches long.
- **E** – the frightened animal was hiding among the roots of a banyan tree.
- **B** – Grandfather picked him up and brought him home.
- **D** – the cub was named Timothy and brought up on milk.
- **F** – later, he was put on a diet of raw mutton and cod liver oil.

Order → **A-C-E-B-D-F**.

Q.204 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. She looked very excited when she saw me get off the bus.
B. It was quite a long time since I had met my grandmother.
C. I found her standing at the village bus stand to receive me.
D. She hugged me and tears of joy flowed down her cheeks.

(a) BCAD **(b)** BDCA
(c) CADB **(d)** CDAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
- **B** – it was quite a long time since I had met my grandmother.
- **C** – I found her standing at the village bus stand to receive me.
- **A** – she looked very excited when she saw me get off the bus.
- **D** – she hugged me and tears of joy flowed down her cheeks.

Order → **B-C-A-D**.

Q.205 **Given below are six sentences A-F, of which A and F are static and B-E have been jumbled. Pick the option that gives the correct order of the jumbled sentences.**
A. Absulum, the reindeer elf worked in the reindeer barn.
B. He also had to keep the reindeer well groomed.
C. He had to clean it every day and that was hard work.
D. He had to give them all a bath and brush their fur.
E. It was such a dirty job to mop, slop, scour and scrape every corner.
F. He worked his fingers to the bone but it seemed that no one cared.

(a) ADCEBF **(b)** ACDBEF
(c) ACEBDF **(d)** AEBDCF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ACEBDF
Type: Para Jumble (A & F fixed)
- **A** – Absulum, the reindeer elf, worked in the reindeer barn.
- **C** – he had to clean it every day and that was hard work.
- **E** – it was such a dirty job to mop, slop, scour and scrape every corner.
- **B** – he also had to keep the reindeer well groomed.
- **D** – he had to give them all a bath and brush their fur.
- **F** – he worked his fingers to the bone but no one cared.

Order → **A-C-E-B-D-F**.

Q.206 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Some of these substances may be added to increase the weight of food-stuffs and may not be injurious to health.
B. They are often imperceptible but can have far-reaching effects.
C. The evil effects of adulteration of food on our health are often slow in their onset and may go un-noticed.
D. The danger obviously depends upon the substances added to adulterate food.

(a) DBCA **(b)** BDAC
(c) CBDA **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CBDA
Type: Para Jumble
- **C** – the evil effects of food adulteration are slow and may go un-noticed.
- **B** – they are often imperceptible but can have far-reaching effects.
- **D** – the danger depends upon the substances added.
- **A** – some of these substances (added to increase weight) may not be injurious.

Order → **C-B-D-A**.

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Q.207 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. His job was to keep an eye on the activities at the work site.
B. Mahendra was a junior supervisor in a firm.
C. So far, he had worked at stone quarries, coal mines, construction sites and chemical plants.
D. The work sites changed often so he had to move from place to place.

(a) DBCA **(b)** BADC
(c) CADB **(d)** ACBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Mahendra was a junior supervisor in a firm.
• **A** – his job was to keep an eye on the activities at the work site.
• **D** – the work sites changed often, so he had to move from place to place.
• **C** – so far, he had worked at stone quarries, coal mines, construction sites and chemical plants.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.208 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. The event was held to raise funds for the slum adopted by the school.
B. The Principal thanked everyone for the contributions which would help in the development activities.
C. The contributions from the parents and teachers were amazing.
D. The school Cultural Society organised a musical night last week.

(a) ADBC **(b)** CBDA
(c) DACB **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – the school Cultural Society organised a musical night last week.
• **A** – the event was held to raise funds for the slum adopted by the school.
• **C** – the contributions from parents and teachers were amazing.
• **B** – the Principal thanked everyone for the contributions.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.209 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. It then came to the main road and smashed all the stalls selling fruits, mud pots and clothes.
B. Finally, the elephant entered a school ground, breaking through the brick wall.
C. The people on the main road ran helter-skelter in panic.
D. The wild elephant first reached the outskirts of our town, breaking down fences like matchsticks.

(a) DACB **(b)** BDAC
(c) CBDA **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DACB
Type: Para Jumble
• **D** – the wild elephant first reached the outskirts, breaking fences like matchsticks.
• **A** – it then came to the main road and smashed all the stalls.
• **C** – the people on the main road ran helter-skelter in panic.
• **B** – finally, the elephant entered a school ground, breaking the brick wall.
Order → **D-A-C-B**.

Q.210 **Given below are four sentences in jumbled order. Pick the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Suddenly in the evening, a dark and menacing storm quickly gathered.
B. Prashant had gone to Ersama, a coastal town in Odisha, to spend the day with a friend.
C. The destruction wrought by the storm continued for the next 36 hours, although the wind speed reduced.
D. Winds beat against the houses with a fury never witnessed before.

(a) CADB **(b)** BCDA
(c) DBCA **(d)** BADC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
• **B** – Prashant had gone to Ersama, a coastal town in Odisha, to spend the day with a friend.
• **A** – suddenly in the evening, a dark, menacing storm gathered.
• **D** – winds beat against the houses with unprecedented fury.
• **C** – the destruction continued for the next 36 hours.
Order → **B-A-D-C**.

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Q.211 **Given below are six sentences. A and F are the first and the last sentences. The rest of the sentences namely B, C, D and E are jumbled. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. After about half an hour on the marsh, there was a sound of a shot nearby.
B. "Over there! Come on!" said the sergeant pointing to the sea.
C. We all stopped and listened carefully.
D. We all ran towards the sea.
E. Then we heard two more shots and a red rocket rose into the sky.
F. Soon we could see the light of torches, and hear shouting and splashing.

(a) ABCDEF **(b)** ADCBEF
(c) ACEBDF **(d)** ACDEBF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ACEBDF
Type: Para Jumble (A and F fixed)
Follow the sequence of events on the marsh:
• **A** – a sound of a shot nearby (given first).
• **C** – "We all stopped and listened carefully" (immediate reaction).
• **E** – "Then we heard two more shots and a red rocket rose ..." ("Then" continues).
• **B** – "'Over there! Come on!' said the sergeant pointing to the sea" (order to move).
• **D** – "We all ran towards the sea" (they obey).
• **F** – soon they see torches and hear shouting (given last).
Correct order → **A-C-E-B-D-F**.

Q.212 **Given below are six sentences. A and F are the first and the last sentences. The rest of the sentences namely B, C, D and E are jumbled. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. It was a bright, cold day.
B. The ground was covered with a sleet that had frozen.
C. But it was difficult to stand or walk on the glassy surface.
D. I took my dog for a little walk up the road.
E. The dog slipped and I fell twice, hard.
F. I got back home in the afternoon.

(a) ABDCEF **(b)** ACBEDF
(c) ACDBEF **(d)** ABDECF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ABDCEF
Type: Para Jumble (A and F fixed)
A day's walk in order:
• **A** – "It was a bright, cold day" (given first).
• **B** – "The ground was covered with a sleet that had frozen."
• **D** – "I took my dog for a little walk up the road."
• **C** – "But it was difficult to stand or walk on the glassy surface."
• **E** – "The dog slipped and I fell twice, hard."
• **F** – "I got back home in the afternoon" (given last).
Correct order → **A-B-D-C-E-F**.

Q.213 **Given below are six sentences. A and F are the first and the last sentences. The rest of the sentences namely B, C, D and E are jumbled. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. The doctor left three different medicines with instructions for giving them.
B. Back in the room, I wrote the boy's temperature down.
C. He seemed to know all about influenza.
D. He also said there was no danger if you avoided pneumonia.
E. He said there was nothing to worry if the fever didn't go above one hundred and four degrees.
F. I also made a note of the time to give the various medicines.

(a) ACDBEF **(b)** ACEDBF
(c) AEDBCF **(d)** ADCBEF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ACEDBF
Type: Para Jumble (A and F fixed)
A doctor's visit:
• **A** – "The doctor left three different medicines with instructions ..." (given first).
• **C** – "He seemed to know all about influenza."
• **E** – "He said there was nothing to worry if the fever didn't go above one hundred and four degrees."
• **D** – "He also said there was no danger if you avoided pneumonia" ("also" adds to E).
• **B** – "Back in the room, I wrote the boy's temperature down."
• **F** – "I also made a note of the time to give the various medicines" (given last).
Correct order → **A-C-E-D-B-F**.

Q.214 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Plants on the farms died whenever the wind brought ashes from the volcano.
B. And birds fell from the sky, dying before they reached the ground.
C. After the eruption of the Paricutin volcano, for 100 miles no green thing, not even grass, could live.
D. The volcano had brought complete ruin to seven villages in the valley.

(a) DBCA **(b)** CABD
(c) CADB **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CABD
Type: Para Jumble
Arrange by cause → effects → summary:
• **C** – "After the eruption of the Paricutin volcano ... no green thing could live" (opening event).
• **A** – "Plants on the farms died ..." (first effect).
• **B** – "And birds fell from the sky ..." ("And" continues the effects).
• **D** – "The volcano had brought complete ruin to seven villages" (final summary).
Correct order → **C-A-B-D**.

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Q.215 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. The boy was the only son of a poor widow.
B. Sultan Gayasuddin was a famous Pathan king who ruled over eastern India.
C. One day, while he was hunting, one of his arrows killed a little boy.
D. Crying and wailing, the woman reported the matter to the magistrate, who was known as Qazi.

(a) BACD **(b)** DCBA
(c) ABCD **(d)** BCAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
Introduce, then narrate:
• **B** – "Sultan Gayasuddin was a famous Pathan king ..." (introduces the main person).
• **C** – "One day, while he was hunting, one of his arrows killed a little boy" (the incident).
• **A** – "The boy was the only son of a poor widow" (detail about the victim).
• **D** – "Crying and wailing, the woman reported the matter to the ... Qazi" (the result).
Correct order → **B-C-A-D**.

Q.216 **Given below are six sentences. A and F are the first and the last sentences. The rest of the sentences namely B, C, D and E are jumbled. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. The Qazi was holding his court.
B. Sultan Gayasuddin entered the court room.
C. He remained seated as before.
D. Everybody stood up in respect, except the Qazi.
E. The room was packed with people, all eager to hear a case against the Sultan of the country.
F. He called for the widow and asked her to explain her case against the Sultan.

(a) AEDBCF **(b)** ACEBDF
(c) AEBDCF **(d)** ADECBF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) AEBDCF
Type: Para Jumble (A and F fixed)
A court scene:
• **A** – "The Qazi was holding his court" (given first).
• **E** – "The room was packed with people, all eager to hear a case against the Sultan."
• **B** – "Sultan Gayasuddin entered the court room."
• **D** – "Everybody stood up in respect, except the Qazi."
• **C** – "He remained seated as before" ("He" = the Qazi).
• **F** – "He called for the widow and asked her to explain her case ..." (given last).
Correct order → **A-E-B-D-C-F**.

Q.217 **Given below are six sentences. A and F are the first and the last sentences. The rest of the sentences namely B, C, D and E are jumbled. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. When they reached the great city, they were frightened by the size of it and by the crowds in the streets.
B. However, they visited every street, stopping wherever they saw a crowd.
C. They were afraid they would not even recognise him, for they had not seen him for fifteen years.
D. They felt that their son would be somewhere among those people.
E. But they did not know how to find him.
F. They hoped for a chance meeting.

(a) ACEBDF **(b)** ADBCEF
(c) ADECBF **(d)** ACDEBF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ADECBF
Type: Para Jumble (A and F fixed)
Follow the parents' search:
• **A** – reaching the great city, frightened by its size (given first).
• **D** – "They felt that their son would be somewhere among those people."
• **E** – "But they did not know how to find him."
• **C** – "They were afraid they would not even recognise him ... fifteen years."
• **B** – "However, they visited every street, stopping wherever they saw a crowd."
• **F** – "They hoped for a chance meeting" (given last).
Correct order → **A-D-E-C-B-F**.

Q.218 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. But on the day when my story begins, it was a winter evening, icy-cold and misty.
B. Sometimes when the weather was clear, I could see ships anchored a little way out from the shore.
C. These were prison ships, full of convicts and their guards.
D. We lived on the edge of the marshes, near the sea.

(a) DBCA **(b)** CABD
(c) CADB **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DBCA
Type: Para Jumble
Set the scene, then the detail:
• **D** – "We lived on the edge of the marshes, near the sea" (setting).
• **B** – "Sometimes ... I could see ships anchored ... from the shore."
• **C** – "These were prison ships, full of convicts ..." ("These" points back to the ships).
• **A** – "But on the day when my story begins, it was a winter evening ..." (moves to the actual story).
Correct order → **D-B-C-A**.

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Q.219 **Given below are six sentences. A and F are the first and the last sentences. The rest of the sentences namely B, C, D and E are jumbled. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Indeed, Kondiba, the beggar, had saved a life.
B. However, word soon began to spread about the beggar's courage.
C. By afternoon Kondiba was back on the streets of Bombay with his gunny sack.
D. But his own still had to go on, and for him this meant begging.
E. His picture and the story of his daring rescue were published in many newspapers.
F. Suddenly Kondiba became a hero.

(a) ACEDBF **(b)** ACDBEF
(c) ADECBF **(d)** ADCBEF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ADCBEF
Type: Para Jumble (A and F fixed)
Kondiba the beggar's story:
• **A** – "Indeed, Kondiba, the beggar, had saved a life" (given first).
• **D** – "But his own [life] still had to go on, and for him this meant begging."
• **C** – "By afternoon Kondiba was back on the streets of Bombay with his gunny sack."
• **B** – "However, word soon began to spread about the beggar's courage."
• **E** – "His picture and the story of his daring rescue were published in many newspapers."
• **F** – "Suddenly Kondiba became a hero" (given last).
Correct order → **A-D-C-B-E-F**.

Q.220 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. When the convicts were led out to work, the convoy soldier noticed that one of the prisoners emptied some earth out of his boots.
B. They all denied the knowledge of it.
C. The prison was searched and a tunnel was found.
D. The Governor came and questioned all the prisoners to find out who had dug the tunnel.

(a) BADC **(b)** ABCD
(c) BCAD **(d)** ACDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ACDB
Type: Para Jumble
The tunnel discovery:
• **A** – "When the convicts were led out to work, the convoy soldier noticed ... one of the prisoners emptied some earth out of his boots."
• **C** – "The prison was searched and a tunnel was found."
• **D** – "The Governor came and questioned all the prisoners to find out who had dug the tunnel."
• **B** – "They all denied the knowledge of it" (the prisoners' response).
Correct order → **A-C-D-B**.

Q.221 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. I was brought up by my sister, who was much older than me.
B. I never knew my father or mother.
C. They died when I was very young.
D. She married the village blacksmith, Joe Gargery, and I must say that he was much kinder to me than she was.

(a) BCAD **(b)** BADC
(c) ABCD **(d)** ACDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
Life-story order:
• **B** – "I never knew my father or mother" (starting point).
• **C** – "They died when I was very young" ("They" = parents; explains B).
• **A** – "I was brought up by my sister ..." (who raised him).
• **D** – "She married the village blacksmith, Joe Gargery ..." ("She" = the sister).
Correct order → **B-C-A-D**.

Q.222 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. Their names were Amulius and Numitor and both were equally brave.
B. The people of Alba could not decide who should be made the King.
C. It so happened that the King of Alba died leaving behind two sons.
D. In the beautiful land of Italy, there was a city called Alba.

(a) ADCB **(b)** ABCD
(c) DCAB **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DCAB
Type: Para Jumble
The story of Alba:
• **D** – "In the beautiful land of Italy, there was a city called Alba" (sets the place).
• **C** – "It so happened that the King of Alba died leaving behind two sons."
• **A** – "Their names were Amulius and Numitor and both were equally brave" ("Their" = the two sons).
• **B** – "The people of Alba could not decide who should be made the King."
Correct order → **D-C-A-B**.

Q.223 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.**
A. They were not there ahead of him.
B. He turned to look on the side.
C. The child turned to look at her parents.
D. They were not there either.

(a) CABD **(b)** CADB
(c) DACB **(d)** DBCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CABD
Type: Para Jumble
Follow the child's search:

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Explanation (contd.)
• **C** – "The child turned to look at her parents" (opening action).
• **A** – "They were not there ahead of him" (first place checked).
• **B** – "He turned to look on the side" (next action).
• **D** – "They were not there either" (final result).
Correct order → **C-A-B-D**.

Q.224 Given below are six sentences. A and F are the first and the last sentences. The rest of the sentences namely B, C, D and E are jumbled. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. From a very early age I knew that when I grew up I would be writer.
B. For this or the other reasons, I was somewhat lonely.
C. I was the middle child among three.
D. And I barely saw my father, who was a soldier, till I was eight.
E. But there was a gap of five years on either side.
F. I had the lonely child's habit of making up stories and holding conversations with imaginary persons.

(a) ADECBF **(b)** ACDEBF
(c) ACEBDF **(d)** ABCDEF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ACEBDF
Type: Para Jumble (A and F fixed)
A writer's childhood:
• **A** – "From a very early age I knew that when I grew up I would be [a] writer" (given first).
• **C** – "I was the middle child among three."
• **E** – "But there was a gap of five years on either side."
• **B** – "For this or the other reasons, I was somewhat lonely."
• **D** – "And I barely saw my father, who was a soldier, till I was eight."
• **F** – "I had the lonely child's habit of making up stories ..." (given last).
Correct order → **A-C-E-B-D-F**.

Q.225 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. Soon I reached the churchyard.
B. To my surprise, I immediately came upon the convict.
C. He was sitting on a tombstone with his back towards me.
D. I went up and touched him gently on the back.

(a) BCAD **(b)** ABCD
(c) BACD **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ABCD
Type: Para Jumble
The order is already logical:
• **A** – "Soon I reached the churchyard" (arrival).
• **B** – "To my surprise, I immediately came upon the convict."
• **C** – "He was sitting on a tombstone with his back towards me" ("He" = the convict).
• **D** – "I went up and touched him gently on the back" (final action).
Correct order → **A-B-C-D**.

Q.226 Given below are six sentences. A and F are the first and the last sentences. The rest of the sentences namely B, C, D and E are jumbled. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. The well was highly useful to the people who lived in the surrounding huts.
B. The well was dangerous: but it had been there for so long that no one worried about it.
C. Consequently, the mouth of the well had gradually widened as the soil and rocks on the side fell in.
D. There had never been any money for a wall around the well.
E. They had dug it two years before because the only water tap in the colony was not enough for the slum's growing population.
F. Apart from a chicken that had fallen in and had been rescued, the well seemed harmless.

(a) ADBCEF **(b)** AEDCBF
(c) AEBDCF **(d)** ADBECF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) AEDCBF
Type: Para Jumble (A and F fixed)
About the well:
• **A** – "The well was highly useful to the people who lived in the surrounding huts" (given first).
• **E** – "They had dug it two years before because the only water tap ... was not enough ..."
• **D** – "There had never been any money for a wall around the well."
• **C** – "Consequently, the mouth of the well had gradually widened as the soil and rocks ... fell in."
• **B** – "The well was dangerous; but it had been there for so long that no one worried about it."
• **F** – "Apart from a chicken that had fallen in ..., the well seemed harmless" (given last).
Correct order → **A-E-D-C-B-F**.

Q.227 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. He was possessed by an overwhelming desire to possess them all.
B. A man stood holding a pole with yellow, red, green and purple balloons flying from it.
C. The child was simply carried away by the rainbow glory of their silken colours.
D. But he well knew his parents would never buy him the balloons because they would say he was too old to play with such toys.

(a) CBAD **(b)** BCAD
(c) BACD **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BCAD
Type: Para Jumble
A boy sees balloons:
• **B** – "A man stood holding a pole with ... balloons flying from it" (the scene).
• **C** – "The child was simply carried away by the rainbow glory of their silken colours."
• **A** – "He was possessed by an overwhelming desire to possess them all."

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Explanation (contd.)
• **D** – "But he well knew his parents would never buy him the balloons ..." (reality check).
Correct order → **B-C-A-D**.

Q.228 Given below are six sentences. A and F are the first and the last sentences. The rest of the sentences namely B, C, D and E are jumbled. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. All three went home with the young man, who told them his story.
B. The circus people had taken him away from his village.
C. Then one day, a rich lady gave the circus people a sum of money and adopted him.
D. For three years he had travelled with them through many countries.
E. As he was intelligent, he was sent to school and college.
F. As the old lady had no children of her own, she left all her money to him.

(a) AEBCDF **(b)** ABCDEF
(c) ADBCEF **(d)** ABDCEF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ABDCEF
Type: Para Jumble (A and F fixed)
Follow the **story's time order**:
• **A** (given first) – the three went home; the young man told them his story.
• **B** – the circus people had taken him from his village (the story begins).
• **D** – for three years he travelled with them (next stage).
• **C** – then one day a rich lady adopted him (turning point – note "Then one day").
• **E** – being intelligent, he was sent to school and college.
• **F** (given last) – the old lady left all her money to him.
Chronological flow → **A-B-D-C-E-F**.

Q.229 Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. It burst from the inside of the earth and tumbled over the edge.
B. A stream of lava began to rush from the crater of the volcano.
C. It travelled slowly across the valley destroying everything that came in its way.
D. Then it rolled down the side of the volcano in a heavy stream, 20 feet thick and 200 feet wide.

(a) BCAD **(b)** ABCD
(c) ACDB **(d)** BADC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BADC
Type: Para Jumble
The flow of lava:
• **B** – "A stream of lava began to rush from the crater of the volcano" (the start).
• **A** – "It burst from the inside of the earth and tumbled over the edge."
• **D** – "Then it rolled down the side of the volcano in a heavy stream, 20 feet thick and 200 feet wide."
• **C** – "It travelled slowly across the valley destroying everything that came in its way."

Explanation (contd.)
Correct order → **B-A-D-C**.

Q.230 Given below are six sentences. A and F are the first and the last sentences. The rest of the sentences namely B, C, D and E are jumbled. Select the option that gives their correct order.
A. It was noon and by now the two bandits were very hungry.
B. Now the one who was guarding the treasure thought, "It is a pity that this treasure has to be divided between two."
C. So they decided that one of them would stay near the treasure and guard it.
D. And the other one would go to the neighbouring village and buy some food.
E. The one who stayed back, placed his sword near the treasure and kept guard while the other set off in the direction of the village.
F. "It would be so much simpler if I could take it all."

(a) ACEBDF **(b)** ADECBF
(c) ABCDEF **(d)** ACDEBF

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ACDEBF
Type: Para Jumble (A and F fixed)
Two bandits and a treasure:
• **A** – "It was noon and by now the two bandits were very hungry" (given first).
• **C** – "So they decided that one of them would stay near the treasure and guard it."
• **D** – "And the other one would go to the neighbouring village and buy some food."
• **E** – "The one who stayed back placed his sword near the treasure ... while the other set off ..."
• **B** – "Now the one guarding the treasure thought, 'It is a pity that this treasure has to be divided ...'"
• **F** – "'It would be so much simpler if I could take it all'" (given last).
Correct order → **A-C-D-E-B-F**.

Q.231 Some sentences are given below. While the first and the last sentences (1 and 2) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
1.Holidays at proper intervals are especially necessary for everyone.
A.It all depends upon that, for holidays maybe misused.
B.A short holiday rightly used, will send us back to our work with renewed zest.
C.We should get away into the pure air of the country.
D.We should avoid unhealthy amusements and get plenty of refreshing sleep.
2.Sometimes, a change of occupation gives us enough rest and enjoyment.

(a) BADC **(b)** BCAD
(c) BCDA **(d)** BACD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BACD
Answer: 4 (**BACD**)

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Explanation (contd.)

- **B** highlights the benefit of a short holiday, setting a positive tone after sentence 1.
- **A** cautions that holidays can be misused, adding a note of responsibility following the benefit.
- **C** advises getting away into the pure air of the country, suggesting a healthy way to spend holidays.
- **D** recommends avoiding unhealthy amusements and getting plenty of refreshing sleep, completing the guidance on proper holiday habits.

This order creates a balanced and meaningful paragraph moving from benefit, to caution, and then to practical advice.

Q.232 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
a. Because of this, the city's sewers, the lifeblood of the city, are disrupted.
b. All of this plastic trash clogs up the soil and suffocates the wetland ecosystem.
c. According to a recent study, around 250 tonnes of plastic waste are produced daily by major urban colonies alone.
d. It is unfortunate that millions of people come home every day carrying brightly coloured plastic bags full of merchandise.

(a) c, a, b, d **(b)** d, b, a, c
(c) a, b, c, d **(d)** a, c, b, d

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) c, a, b, d

Answer: 1 (**c, a, b, d**)

- **(c)** introduces the topic with a fact-based opening about the large amount of plastic waste produced — a strong starting point.
- **(a)** follows logically with "Because of this," referring to the waste mentioned in (c), and explains its impact on the city's sewer system.
- **(b)** expands on the environmental consequences of the plastic trash, such as clogging soil and harming wetlands.
- **(d)** ends by highlighting the root cause — people bringing home plastic bags daily, which contributes to the waste problem.

This sequence presents a logical flow from **problem → consequence → environmental impact → human behavior**, making **c, a, b, d** the most coherent order.

Q.233 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
P. An extensive body of research demonstrates the business benefits of flexible working.
Q. Flexible work is still regarded as an add-on, something we do for mothers for a few months when they are back from parental leave.
R. Yet despite this overwhelming evidence, access to flexible work and careers is not widespread.
S. But in the face of rapid changes to the way we work, organisations need to move beyond just having policies for flexible working or making ad-hoc adjustments for certain individuals.

(a) QSRP **(b)** SRPQ
(c) PRQS **(d)** PQRS

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) PRQS

Answer: 3 (**PRQS**)

- **P** starts by presenting research that shows the benefits of flexible working.
- **R** follows by pointing out that despite this evidence, flexible work is still not widely available.
- **Q** explains the limited view of flexible work as a temporary benefit for mothers returning from leave.
- **S** concludes by urging organizations to go beyond basic policies and ad-hoc adjustments in response to changing work dynamics.

This sequence logically moves from presenting evidence, highlighting the problem, explaining the perception, and ending with a call for improvement, making the paragraph coherent.

Q.234 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
P. The need of the hour is to protect and preserve the environment and the ecological balance.
Q. This menace can be fought against only by creating awareness among the people.
R. Rapid deforestation has been the main cause of environmental degradation.
S. Degradation of the environment continues unabated.

(a) PQRS **(b)** QRPS
(c) SPQR **(d)** QPSR

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) SPQR

Answer: 3 (**SPQR**)

- **S** begins by stating the ongoing problem — environmental degradation continues unabated.
- **P** follows by emphasizing the urgent need to protect and preserve the environment and ecological balance.
- **Q** provides the solution, stating that the menace can be fought by creating awareness among people.
- **R** explains one of the main causes of this problem — rapid deforestation.

This sequence logically presents the problem, urgency, solution, and cause, forming a coherent and meaningful paragraph.

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Q.235 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Select the option that gives their correct logical sequence.
P. In the 21st century, however, this no longer holds true as the expectations of organisations have changed.
Q. The concept of the job in the 20th century was often equated with toil.
R. In order to meet these changed expectations, employees need commitment and access to continuous learning.
S. They demand more creativity and expertise and want employees to be responsible for both, outputs and outcomes.

(a) QPRS **(b)** SPQR
(c) SQPR **(d)** RSQP

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) QPRS
Answer: 1 (**QPRS**)
- **Q** introduces the traditional concept of a job as toil in the 20th century.
- **P** contrasts this with the 21st century, where organizational expectations have changed.
- **R** explains what employees need to do to meet these new expectations — commitment and continuous learning.
- **S** describes the new demands of organizations — creativity, expertise, and responsibility for outcomes.

This order logically traces the evolution of job expectations from past to present and what is required today.

Q.236 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A) Human rights are standards that recognise and protect the dignity of all human beings.
B) Individuals also have responsibilities: in using their human rights, they must respect the rights of others.
C) Human rights law obliges governments to do some things and prevents them from doing others.
D) Human rights govern how individual human beings live in society and with each other, as well as their relationship with the State and the obligations that the State have towards them.

(a) ADCB **(b)** ACBD
(c) DCBA **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ADCB
Answer: 1 (**ADCB**)
- **A** introduces the concept of human rights as standards protecting human dignity.
- **D** explains how human rights govern relationships among individuals and between individuals and the State.
- **C** discusses the legal obligations of governments regarding human rights.
- **B** concludes by mentioning the responsibilities individuals have in respecting others' rights.

This sequence logically develops the concept from definition to application and responsibilities.

Q.237 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. People feel stressed due to multiple reasons in life. Some people's failure in their personal lives affects their professional lives and vice versa.
B. There should be a balance between these two; however, it is not as simple as it sounds.
C. People give a lot of importance to physical fitness but what one needs to understand is that mental health, which is being neglected, is as important as physical health.
D. If anyone feels he is under stress and strain, he/she should talk to friends, colleagues and family. If mental health starts getting worse, reaching out a therapist is the best option because one can get adequate support to overcome difficulties.

(a) BDAC **(b)** CABD
(c) BCAD **(d)** ABCD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CABD
Answer: 2 (**CABD**)
- **C** introduces the importance of mental health alongside physical health.
- **A** explains that people feel stressed for various reasons, affecting both personal and professional life.
- **B** emphasizes the need for balance between these aspects, acknowledging its difficulty.
- **D** suggests solutions for managing stress, such as talking to others or seeking therapy.

This order creates a coherent paragraph moving from the importance of mental health, causes of stress, the need for balance, to practical advice for coping.

Q.238 Given below are four sentences. Pick the option that gives the correct order.
A. The invention of the airplane was no exception.
B. However, the idea of flying an aircraft was quite repulsive to some people.
C. Many great inventions are initially greeted with ridicule and disbelief.
D. Most people who heard about the first powered flight on December 17, 1903 were excited and impressed.

(a) CADB **(b)** DBCA
(c) DABC **(d)** CDAB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CADB
Solution:
To form a coherent paragraph, we must establish a logical and chronological flow of ideas:
- Sentence **C** introduces the **general idea** that many inventions were ridiculed at first.
- Sentence **A** follows naturally as an example: **"The invention of the airplane was no exception."**
- Sentence **B** adds a **contrast**, showing that some people were **repelled by the idea** of flying.
- Sentence **D** presents a **conclusion or development**, describing the **reaction** of people after the actual flight.

Correct order: CADB

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Q.239 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
(a) While the societal, environmental, political and economical factors are somewhat impossible to control, technology is becoming the prime concern for the aviation industry.
(b) Although air travel is still the preferred mode for long-distance journeys, the tables might turn on the sector if it fails to adapt and align with the latest technologies.
(c) With futuristic, alternate travel modes such as Hyperloop, with the growing prominence of the highly sophisticated AR/VR technology, the aviation industry is in a rather dynamic state.
(d) There are five major drivers of the changing aviation industry – Society, Environment, Politics, Economy and Technology.

(a) acbd **(b)** dbca
(c) dacb **(d)** abcd

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) dacb
Answer: 3 (**dacb**)
- **(d)** introduces the five key factors influencing the aviation industry — a natural opening statement.
- **(a)** then narrows down the focus to **technology** as the main concern among those factors.
- **(c)** builds on that by providing examples like **Hyperloop and AR/VR**, showing how technology is reshaping the industry.
- **(b)** concludes with a logical implication — if the aviation sector doesn't adapt to these technologies, it may lose its preference for long-distance travel.

Hence, the most coherent and meaningful order is **dacb**.

Q.240 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. A fine carriage with rubber tyres, a fat coachman, and velvet on the seats, rolled up to the house of a landowner called Gryabov.
B. A drowsy footman met him in the hall
C. "Are the family at home?" asked the Marshal.
D. Fyodor Andreitch Otsov, the district Marshal, jumped out of the carriage.

(a) ACBD **(b)** CBAD
(c) ADBC **(d)** DBAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ADBC
Solution:
Let's examine the logical flow:
- **A** sets the scene with a carriage arriving at Gryabov's house — good opening.
- **D** logically follows — introduces the important person (Marshal) who steps out of the carriage.
- **B** comes next — the Marshal is met by the footman upon entering the house.
- **C** follows — the Marshal speaks to ask if the family is at home.

Correct sequence: **A → D → B → C**
Answer: option (c) (ADBC).

Q.241 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A) The Covid-19 pandemic can be ascribed with advancing more new learning trends that are enduring, even though the pandemic is nearly over.
B) The submerging of e-learning in the educational process has resulted in an indisputable decrease in attention span.
C) E-learning or online learning is undoubtedly a trend that will persist even after the pandemic ends, simply as it provides so many benefits .
D) The attention span of learners has been restricted to 18 to 20 minutes (approx.) during the Covid-19 phase.

(a) DBAC **(b)** ABDC
(c) DBCA **(d)** ACBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ACBD
Answer: 4 (**ACBD**)
- **A** introduces the idea that the Covid-19 pandemic accelerated new, lasting learning trends.
- **C** specifies that e-learning is one such trend that will continue because of its benefits.
- **B** points out a negative effect of e-learning — a decrease in attention span.
- **D** provides a specific detail about this decrease, stating learners' attention spans have been limited to about 18 to 20 minutes during the pandemic.

This sequence presents a clear progression from cause, to ongoing trend, to impact, and finally to a specific consequence, making the paragraph coherent and meaningful.

Q.242 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. "Your cauldron gave birth," replied the Hodja.
B. "What's this?" asked the neighbour, pointing to the pot.
C. One day Nasreddin Hodja borrowed a cauldron from his neighbour.
D. A few days later, when he had finished with it, he sent it back with a pot inside it.

(a) ACBD **(b)** CDBA
(c) BDAC **(d)** CBAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CDBA
Solution:
The most logical and chronological arrangement is **CDBA**.
C introduces the situation: Hodja borrows a cauldron.
D follows with the action: he returns it with a pot inside.
B shows the neighbor's reaction: he is surprised and questions it.
A provides the witty response from Hodja, completing the humorous exchange.
This sequence forms a coherent and meaningful short story.
option (a) (ACBD) starts with a reply before setting the context—illogical.
option (b) (CDBA) maintains logical flow.
option (c) (BDAC) starts with confusion—context missing.
option (d) (CBAD) breaks the logical cause-effect flow.
Answer: option (b) (CDBA).

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Q.243 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. The celebration is held in Kasol's icy climate, where a bonfire serves as a bonus to create the ideal balance of warmth and coolness.
B. It is an unforgettable experience for everyone, listening to the beats performed by renowned DJs while watching young and brilliant vocalists perform live.
C. Himachal Hills Festival is one such festival that mostly focuses on music and serves as a matter of pride for the people of Kasol.
D. The festival lasts for more than one day, extending into the last two days of the year (30th and 31st December) which is contrary to the majority of fairs and celebrations in India.
E. For party animals, it is a blessing, as the festival is a perfect blend of music, bonfire and cold weather.

(a) BACDE **(b)** CABDE
(c) CBADE **(d)** ACBDE

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CABDE
Answer: 2 (**CABDE**)
- **C** introduces the festival and its focus on music and local pride.
- **A** describes the setting of the festival in Kasol's icy climate with a bonfire.
- **B** talks about the experience of enjoying music by DJs and vocalists.
- **D** provides details about the festival's duration.
- **E** concludes by highlighting why the festival is perfect for party lovers, blending music, bonfire, and weather.

This sequence forms a coherent and meaningful paragraph about the festival.

Q.244 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. Mother came in with a tumbler of water in one hand and a plate of betel leaves and nuts in the other.
B. She gave him the areca-nut and half a dozen neatly rolled betel leaves.
C. He put them all into his mouth, chewing them with great contentment.
D. Father drank the water and held out his hand.

(a) DBAC **(b)** ACBD
(c) ADBC **(d)** CBAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ADBC
Explanation:
Let's analyze the logical flow of the paragraph:
- **A** introduces the scene: the mother enters with water and betel leaves.
- **D** logically follows, where the **father drinks water** and **extends his hand** (to take the betel leaves).
- **B** shows the mother giving him the betel leaves and areca-nut.
- **C** concludes with the father chewing them contentedly.

So the correct order is: **A → D → B → C**
Correct sequence: ADBC
Correct Answer: 3

Q.245 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
[A] India is no longer on her knees for boons; she is on her feet for rights.
[B] Indian dress, Indian food, Indian ways, Indian customs are all looked on as second rate; Indian mother-tongue and Indian literature cannot make an educated man.
[C] The greatest injury British rule has done to Indians is to deprive them of the natural instinct born in all free people, the feeling of an inherent right to self-determination, to be themselves.
[D] Indians as well as Englishmen take it for granted that the natural rights of every Nation do not belong to them; they claim, "a larger share in the government of the country", and they are expected to feel grateful for 'boons' of concession.
[E] Thank God that India's eyes are opening; that myriads of her people realise that they are men, with a man's right to freedom in his own country, a man's right to manage his own affairs.

(a) CBDEA **(b)** DECAB
(c) CABED **(d)** BADEC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CBDEA
Answer: 1 (**CBDEA**)
- **(C)** sets the tone by introducing the core idea — the psychological damage done by British rule to Indians' sense of self-determination.
- **(B)** supports this by showing how Indian culture is undervalued, reinforcing the loss of identity.
- **(D)** continues logically, stating that both Indians and English accept this situation and Indians are made to feel thankful for minor concessions.
- **(E)** brings a shift — hope and awakening among Indians, realizing their right to freedom.
- **(A)** concludes the thought powerfully, asserting India's shift from pleading for favors to standing up for rights.

So, the correct and coherent order is **CBDEA**.

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Q.246 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. I have seen a great many houses in my time, little and big, new and old, built of stone and of wood, but of one house I have kept a very vivid memory.
B. It was, properly speaking, rather a cottage than a house -- a tiny cottage of one story, with three windows, looking extraordinarily like a little old hunchback woman with a cap on.
C. The cottage was lost to sight among the mulberry-trees, acacias, and poplars planted by the grandfathers and great-grandfathers of its present occupants
D. It had white stucco walls, tiled roof, and a dilapidated chimney.

(a) ACBD **(b)** CDBA
(c) BDAC **(d)** ABDC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ABDC
Solution:
Let's analyze the structure and flow of the paragraph.

- **A** introduces the main subject – houses the narrator has seen, and mentions one house that left a vivid memory. So A is the **best opening sentence**.
- **B** describes the house referred to in A, giving a visual description – naturally follows A.
- **D** continues with more physical details of the same house – logically follows B.
- **C** adds environmental context about the cottage's location – best placed at the end.

So, the correct sequence is: **A → B → D → C**
Answer: option (d) (ABDC).

Q.247 **Given below are four sentences. Pick the option that gives the correct order.**
A. She was a busy person and had no time to visit her mother.
B. It was Mothers' Day.
C. She thought her mother would be pleased to receive the flowers.
D. A woman stopped at a flower shop to order some flowers to be sent to her mother.

(a) BCDA **(b)** CADB
(c) DABC **(d)** BDAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BDAC
Solution:
The correct logical and chronological order of the sentences is:
D. A woman stopped at a flower shop to order some flowers to be sent to her mother.
A. She was a busy person and had no time to visit her mother.
B. It was Mothers' Day.
C. She thought her mother would be pleased to receive the flowers.
This order (DABC) introduces the character and action, explains her reason, provides the occasion, and ends with her thought process.
Answer: DABC

Q.248 **Given below are six sentences of a paragraph. Sentence A is the beginning whereas sentence F is the last sentence of the para. The middle four sentences are jumbled up. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. We soon ran into a nomad's tent, where we were well received and allowed to graze our yak to his heart's content.
B. She quickly made us cups of butter tea, and for the first time I drank this brew with relish.
C. This time our hostess was a young woman.
D. Only then did we notice what a picturesque figure our young hostess made.
E. The warmth ran through our frozen bodies and brought us to life again.
F. She wore a sheepskin cloak reaching down to the ground and in her long black pigtail she wore mussel shells, silver coins, and various cheap ornaments imported from abroad.

(a) BDEC **(b)** CBED
(c) CBDE **(d)** ECDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CBED
Solution:
option (b) (CBED) is the correct order because it presents a smooth and logical sequence of events and descriptions:

- **C** starts by introducing a **young woman** as the new hostess, setting the stage for what follows.
- **B** continues naturally, stating that **she made butter tea**, which the narrator enjoyed – indicating comfort and hospitality.
- **E** follows with the effect of the tea – it **warmed the narrator and brought them to life**, enhancing the emotional tone.
- **D** makes sense after the narrator feels revived; only then did they **notice how picturesque the hostess looked** – a delayed but realistic observation.
- **F** adds detailed **visual imagery of the hostess's attire**, perfectly following the realization in D.
- These events lead smoothly into and complement the given opening (A) and closing (F), forming a coherent and meaningful paragraph.

This structure ensures proper narrative flow from entering the tent to fully noticing and describing the hostess.

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Q.249 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first (1) and the last(6) sentences are in the correct order, the sentences in between (A-D) are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
1. A vacation is looked forward to as a time to relax.
A. But, destiny had other plans for me.
B. I was very excited to go on a vacation to Goa.
C. My bags were packed and I decided to retire early for the night.
D. It is a welcome break from the daily routine which is often monotonous.
6. I fell off the bed and fractured my foot!

(a) BCDA **(b)** CBAD
(c) ABDC **(d)** DBCA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) DBCA
Solution:
The first sentence introduces the idea of a vacation as a time to relax. The logical flow after that should be:
D – Explains why a vacation is welcome (supports Sentence 1)
B – Introduces the speaker's excitement and plan to go to Goa
C – Describes the speaker's preparation for the trip
A – A twist is introduced (destiny changes the plan), leading into Sentence 6
Sentence 6 – The consequence: the speaker falls and fractures their foot
Correct sequence: **1 - D - B - C - A - 6**
Option: DBCA
Answer: option (d) (DBCA).

Q.250 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. One day, I was travelling by train from Bangalore to Belgaum.
B. I was travelling by second class as that's where one can meet lots of people who are eager to talk.
C. It is an overnight train and the only rail link between Bangalore and north Karnataka.
D. I have noticed, the more expensive the ticket, the lesser the co-travellers speak.

(a) ACBD **(b)** DBAC
(c) CBAD **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ACBD
Let's examine the sentence sequence logically:
- **A** sets the context: *"One day, I was travelling by train from Bangalore to Belgaum."*
- **C** follows naturally: *"It is an overnight train and the only rail link..."* — gives more info about the journey mentioned in A.
- **B** adds personal detail about the **class of travel** and reason for choosing it.
- **D** explains a general observation related to B.

So, the correct and coherent order is:
A → C → B → D
That is why the correct option is **ACBD**.

Q.251 **Given below are six sentences of a paragraph. Sentence A is the beginning whereas sentence F is the last sentence of the para. The middle four sentences are jumbled up. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. When Tarun failed in his terminal examinations, his father was very angry with him.
B. It was a day he wanted to erase from his life and so he took to running.
C. His friends too made fun of him.
D. The sun beat down to check his rage but nothing could stop Tarun.
E. He ran all around the park.
F. After about an hour, he was fully exhausted and his fury having subsided, he threw himself on a bench and started to pant.

(a) CEBD **(b)** BDEC
(c) CBED **(d)** ECDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CBED
Solution
A is the opening sentence and F is the close.
After Tarun's father scolds him (A), **C** follows naturally—his friends also mock him. Feeling humiliated, **B** shows Tarun's reaction: he wants to erase the day and starts running.
While running, **E** states that he circles the park, and **D** adds how even the scorching sun cannot check his rage. The paragraph then ends with F.
Correct middle order: **C B E D**
Final sequence: **A C B E D F**

Q.252 **Given below are six sentences of a paragraph. Sentence A is the beginning whereas sentence F is the last sentence of the para. The middle four sentences are jumbled up. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. When I studied Engineering thirty-five years back, I was the only girl in the course.
B. People often ask me how I managed.
C. I could only see boys and more boys everywhere.
D. But when I look back I feel it was not very difficult.
E. Having a girl in the class was unusual for the boys, and initially I was the target for a lot of teasing.
F. But over a period of time they became my best friends.

(a) CBDE **(b)** BDEC
(c) ECDB **(d)** CBED

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CBDE
Solution
Sentence Order: A → C → B → E → D → F
C follows **A**, showing her observation: *"I could only see boys and more boys everywhere."*
B comes next, noting external curiosity: *"People often ask me how I managed."*
E explains her experience: *"Having a girl in the class was unusual for the boys, and initially I was the target for a lot of teasing."*
D reflects on that period: *"But when I look back I feel it was not very difficult."*
F concludes the outcome: *"But over a period of time they became my best friends."*
Correct middle sequence: C B E D

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Q.253 **Given below are six sentences of a paragraph. Sentence A is the beginning whereas sentence F is the last sentence of the para. The middle four sentences are jumbled up. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. In the course of my education at MIT, three teachers shaped my thinking.
B. Their combined contributions formed the foundation on which I later built my professional career.
C. Prof. Sponder taught me technical aerodynamics.
D. These three teachers were Prof. Sponder, Prof. KAV Pandalai and Prof. Narasingha Rao.
E. Each one of them had very distinct personalities, but they shared a common impulse— the capacity to feed their students' intellectual hunger by sheer brilliance and untiring zeal.
F. He was an Austrian with rich practical experience in aeronautical engineering.

(a) BCED **(b)** ECDB
(c) CBED **(d)** BDEC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BDEC
Solution:
A is the introduction and **F** is the conclusion.
B logically follows **A** as it talks about the combined contributions of the teachers. **D** comes next as it names the three teachers. **E** then describes their personalities and qualities. **C** provides specific information about one of the teachers, Prof. Sponder.
The correct order is **B, D, E, C**.
Answer: **BDEC** (Option (d)

Q.254 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. I was struck by the objectivity and clarity of his thinking.
B. The next day, Dr. Mediratta brought a visitor to our hovercraft—a tall, handsome, bearded man.
C. "Can you give me a ride in the machine?" he finally enquired.
D. He asked me several questions about the machine.

(a) BDAC **(b)** ACDB
(c) BCAD **(d)** CBAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BDAC
Solution:
B is the best opening sentence as it introduces the event: *"The next day, Dr. Mediratta brought a visitor to our hovercraft..."*
D logically follows, continuing the interaction: *"He asked me several questions about the machine."*
A follows D, as it reflects the narrator's impression based on the previous questioning: *"I was struck by the objectivity and clarity of his thinking."*
C concludes the paragraph with the man's final action: *"Can you give me a ride in the machine?"*
Correct order: BDAC
Correct answer: Option (a)

Q.255 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first (1) and the last (6) sentences are in the correct order, the sentences in between (A-D) are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
1.During the colonial rule in India, Robert Bruce was the first who noticed tea plants growing near Rangpur in 1823.
A. The species was found to be similar to that grown in Chinese tea gardens.
B. By 1862, the Assam tea industry comprised around 160 gardens.
C. The leaves of the plants were examined and the consequence was something fruitful.
D. Mr. Maniram Dewan was the first Indian tea planter who established the commercial plantation that we know today as the Assam tea.
6. Today the region has grown to become one of the world's largest tea-producing belts.

(a) BDAC **(b)** ADCB
(c) DCBA **(d)** CADB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CADB
Solution:
We start with Sentence 1: *"During the colonial rule in India, Robert Bruce was the first who noticed tea plants growing near Rangpur in 1823."*
Now evaluate the logical flow of the jumbled sentences:
- **C**: *"The leaves of the plants were examined and the consequence was something fruitful."* — this follows naturally after Bruce's discovery.
- **A**: *"The species was found to be similar to that grown in Chinese tea gardens."* — a result of examining the leaves.
- **D**: *"Mr. Maniram Dewan was the first Indian tea planter..."* — follows after identifying the plant and starting commercial plantation.
- **B**: *"By 1862, the Assam tea industry comprised around 160 gardens."* — this gives the expansion timeline.
- **6**: *"Today the region has grown to become one of the world's largest tea-producing belts."* — final result.

Correct order: **C → A → D → B**
Full paragraph: **1 – C – A – D – B – 6**
Answer: option (d) (CADB).

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Q.256 **Given below are four jumbled sentences. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. My mother, Vimala Kulkarni, told me similar words when I got married.
B. They were usually like: 'You must adjust to your new house and in-laws, try to learn how they eat and cook their food, go out of your way to be friendly and helpful to everybody,' etc.
C. When I was young, before a girl got married, her mother would give her some words of advice.
D. But along with this, she said something which helped me immensely in later life.

(a) CBAD **(b)** CDBA
(c) ACBD **(d)** BDAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CBAD
Solution:
The logical flow begins with a general observation and then narrows down to a personal experience.
C sets the context: traditional advice given to girls before marriage.
B elaborates on the kind of advice typically given.
A shifts to a personal example: the speaker's own mother giving similar advice.
D adds a personal insight: an impactful statement from the mother.
Correct order: **CBAD**
option (a): CBAD – correct sequence with smooth progression from general to personal.
Other options break the natural flow or start with specific points without setting context.
Answer: option (a) (CBAD).

Q.257 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. "Who goes there?" shouted the Hodja.
B. One night, Hodja Nasreddin awoke, thinking he had heard a strange noise outside his window.
C. Hearing no reply, Nasreddin reached for his bow, set an arrow to the string, took aim and shot in the direction of the mysterious figure.
D. Looking out, he saw a suspicious white figure.

(a) ACDB **(b)** BCAD
(c) BDAC **(d)** CBAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BDAC
Let's analyze the sentences for logical sequence:
- **B.** *One night, Hodja Nasreddin awoke, thinking he had heard a strange noise outside his window.*
  → This clearly sets the **starting point** of the story.
- **D.** *Looking out, he saw a suspicious white figure.*
  → Naturally follows B as a result of hearing the noise.
- **A.** *"Who goes there?" shouted the Hodja.*
  → Comes **after** seeing the figure.
- **C.** *Hearing no reply, Nasreddin reached for his bow, set an arrow to the string, took aim and shot in the direction of the mysterious figure.*
  → Logical reaction **after** calling out and getting no reply.

So, the correct sequence is: **B → D → A → C**
That matches **option (c) (BDAC)**.

Q.258 **Given below are six sentences of a paragraph. Sentence A is the beginning whereas sentence F is the last sentence of the para. The middle four sentences are jumbled up. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. It was midday.
B. Voldyrev, a tall country gentleman with a cropped head and prominent eyes, took off his overcoat, mopped his brow with his handkerchief, and went into the government office.
C. "Where can I make an inquiry here?" he said, addressing a porter who was bringing a trayful of glasses from the furthest recesses of the office.
D. Voldyrev coughed and went towards the window.
E. "To that one sitting near the window!" said the porter, indicating with the tray the furthest window.
F. There, at a green table spotted like typhus, was sitting a young man with his hair standing up in four tufts on his head, with a long pimply nose, and a long faded uniform.

(a) CBED **(b)** BDEC
(c) BCED **(d)** ECDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BCED
Solution:
We begin with Sentence **A**: *"It was midday."* — sets the scene.
Next is **B**: *"Voldyrev... went into the government office."* — introduces the character and action.
Now we need to sequence C, D, and E before reaching F.
Let's test **option (c) (BCED)**:
- **B**: Voldyrev enters the office
- **C**: He asks the porter a question
- **E**: The porter replies and points to the person
- **D**: Voldyrev reacts by going towards the window
- **F**: Describes the person at the window

This order forms a **logical, coherent, and flowing narrative**.
Answer: option (c) (BCED).

Q.259 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first (1) and the last(6) sentences are in the correct order, the sentences in between(A-D) are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
1. Nicholas Chorier is not a usual photographer.
A. He uses a kite to hoist his camera into the skies and clicks photographs while the camera dangles mid–air.
B. He is a kite aerial photographer.
C. Fascinated, he literally tied his two hobbies ,kite flying and photography ,together for a living.
D. During a trip to India to make a photo report on kite making, he learnt about this unique style of photography.
6. Today he is one of the most well–known kite aerial photographers in the world.

(a) ACDB **(b)** DABC
(c) BCDA **(d)** BADC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BADC
Solution

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Explanation (contd.)
1 – D – A – B – C – 6
Nicholas is first introduced as an unusual photographer.
D explains how he discovered kite-aerial photography during a trip to India.
A then describes the distinctive method he now uses (a kite hoisting his camera).
B identifies his present vocation as a kite-aerial photographer.
C rounds out the narrative by showing how, fascinated, he combined his two hobbies—kite-flying and photography—into a career, neatly linking back to the discovery in D and the technique in A.
Sentence 6 closes by noting his worldwide renown.
Correct middle order: **D A B C**

Q.260 Given below are six sentences of a paragraph. Sentence A is the beginning whereas sentence F is the last sentence of the para. The middle four sentences are jumbled up. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. The month was January.
B. On the first morning of the festival the mejhi would be set alight invoking the blessings of Agni, the god of fire.
C. There would be much feasting and merriment during the festival.
D. Each household would build a mejhi - a pile of firewood stacked neatly together in their backyard.
E. The Bihu festival was fast approaching.
F. "Let's build a champion mejhi this year." Ricky suggested a few days before the festival.

(a) CBED **(b)** EDBC
(c) ECDB **(d)** CBDE

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ECDB
Let's verify **Option (c): ECDB** assuming **A** is the first and **F** is the last sentence, as per instructions.
Given:
A. The month was January.
E. The Bihu festival was fast approaching.
C. There would be much feasting and merriment during the festival.
D. Each household would build a mejhi...
B. On the first morning of the festival the mejhi would be set alight...
F. "Let's build a champion mejhi this year." Ricky suggested...
Now apply **Option (c): ECDB** between A and F → Full sequence becomes:
A - E - C - D - B - F
Let's evaluate:
- **A → E**: Logical, gives time and context.
- **E → C**: Talks about festivities, natural flow.
- **C → D**: From general merriment to specific ritual. Acceptable.
- **D → B**: From building the mejhi to lighting it. Sequential.
- **B → F**: Sets up the background for Ricky's excited statement.

Yes, this sequence is **logically coherent and meaningful**.
Answer: Option (c) (ECDB) is **correct**.

Q.261 Given below are six sentences of a paragraph. Sentence A is the beginning whereas sentence F is the last sentence of the para. The middle four sentences are jumbled up. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. The first hour passed off quietly.
B. In the second, they had Arithmetic.
C. Swaminathan was terribly bored.
D. Vedanayagam went out and returned in a fewminutes in the role of an Arithmetic teacher.
E. He droned on monotonously.
F. His teacher's voice was beginning to get on his nerves.

(a) CBED **(b)** ECDB
(c) BCDE **(d)** BDEC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BDEC
olution:
A is the opening line: *"The first hour passed off quietly."*
We now need to arrange the middle sentences (B, C, D, E) in a sequence that forms a **logical and smooth narrative**, leading to **F** as the concluding line.
Let's evaluate the choices:
- **B**: Introduces the second hour – *"In the second, they had Arithmetic."*
- **D**: Describes the teacher entering for Arithmetic – *"Vedanayagam went out and returned..."*
- **E**: The teacher starts speaking monotonously – *"He droned on..."*
- **C**: Swaminathan's reaction – *"Swaminathan was terribly bored."*
- **F**: Concludes the paragraph with his irritation – *"His teacher's voice was beginning to get on his nerves."*

Correct logical order: **B → D → E → C**
Thus, full paragraph becomes:
A - B - D - E - C - F

Q.262 Given below are four sentences. Pick the option that gives the correct order.
A. The Egyptians believed that the body and soul were important to human existence, in life and in death.
B. This ensured the soul's return to the body so that the deceased would live happily ever after.
C. Their funerary practices, such as mummification and burial in tombs, were designed to assist the deceased find their way in the after world.
D. The tombs were thus, filled with food, tools, domestic wares, treasures -- all the necessities of life.

(a) ADCB **(b)** ACDB
(c) ABCD **(d)** ABDC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ACDB
Solution:
The logical and chronological flow of ideas begins with the **belief system** of the Egyptians, followed by **practices**, **purpose**, and finally the **tomb arrangements**.
A introduces the belief about body and soul.
C explains the funerary practices arising from that belief.
D describes the tombs as a result of those practices.
B gives the final purpose—ensuring the soul's return and eternal happiness.
Correct sequence: **ACDB**

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Explanation (contd.)
option (a): ADCB – places the tomb details before the practice, which is illogical.
option (b): ACDB – correct logical flow from belief → practice → tomb → purpose.
option (c): ABCD – breaks sequence by jumping to outcome before practices.
option (d): ABDC – misplaces outcome before the methods.
Answer: option (b) (ACDB).

Q.263 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Back home, Bipin Babu rang up Dr. Chanda and asked him to come over.
B. Just then, the servant brought him a letter which someone had left in the letter box.
C. Then, after a shower, he got into bed with an ice bag clamped on his head.
D. It was a greenish envelope with his name in red ink on it.

(a) ACBD **(b)** ADBC
(c) DBAC **(d)** CBAD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ACBD
Correct sequence:
- **A.** Back home, Bipin Babu rang up Dr. Chanda and asked him to come over.
- **C.** Then, after a shower, he got into bed with an ice bag clamped on his head.
- **B.** Just then, the servant brought him a letter which someone had left in the letter box.
- **D.** It was a greenish envelope with his name in red ink on it.

This sequence flows logically:
- First, Bipin Babu comes home and calls the doctor.
- Then he takes a shower and lies in bed with an ice bag.
- A letter arrives via the servant.
- Then, the appearance of the letter is described.

Hence, **ACBD** forms a coherent and meaningful paragraph.

Q.264 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Through the window of the compartment, I watched the countryside slip past.
B. From a distance, the men in the fields in their white dhotis and turbans and the womenfolk in bright splashes of colour against the green background of paddy fields seemed to inhabit some beautiful painting.
C. Almost everywhere, people were engaged in some activity which had a rhythm and tranquillity about it—men driving cattle, women fetching water from streams.
D. It is astonishing how the landscape changes as one moves northwards.
E. Occasionally, a child would appear and wave at the train.
F. The rich and fertile plains of the river Ganga and its numerous tributaries have invited invasion, turmoil and change.

(a) ECDB **(b)** BCED
(c) BDEC **(d)** CBDE

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BCED
Solution:
A (First sentence): *"Through the window of the compartment, I watched the countryside slip past."*
– This sets the **scene** and viewpoint of the narrator.
Now, let's build the logical sequence from the jumbled middle sentences **B, C, D, E**:
B: Describes the distant view – *"men in the fields... seemed to inhabit some beautiful painting."*
– This follows naturally from the narrator watching the countryside.
C: Adds more detailed observation – *"people were engaged in some activity... rhythm and tranquillity..."*
– A deeper look into what was previously described.
E: A specific and charming detail – *"a child would appear and wave at the train."*
– Fits well after B and C as a passing moment.
D: Describes a shift in landscape – *"how the landscape changes as one moves northwards."*
– This serves as a **transition** before the historical remark in F.
F (Last sentence): *"The rich and fertile plains... have invited invasion, turmoil and change."*
– This brings a **historical perspective**, concluding the observations.
Correct order: A → B → C → E → D → F
Correct answer: Option (b): BCED

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Q.265 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Satyajit Ray was born in Calcutta on 2 May 1921.
B. In 1940, after receiving his degree in science and economics from Calcutta University, he attended Tagore's Viswa-Bharati University.
C. His father, Late Sukumar Ray was an eminent poet and writer in the history of Bengali literature.
D. His first movie Pather Panchali (1955) won several International Awards and set Ray as a world-class director.

(a) CDBA **(b)** ADBC
(c) BDAC **(d)** ACBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ACBD
Solution:
Let's analyze each sentence:

- **A:** *Satyajit Ray was born in Calcutta on 2 May 1921.*
  – This is clearly the **starting sentence** (birth information).
- **C:** *His father, Late Sukumar Ray, was an eminent poet...*
  – This adds **background about his family**, so it should follow the birth.
- **B:** *In 1940, after receiving his degree...*
  – Discusses **education**; comes **after early life details**.
- **D:** *His first movie Pather Panchali (1955)...*
  – Talks about **career success**, which logically comes **after education**.

Logical Order:
A (birth) → C (father's background) → B (education) → D (career achievement)
So the correct sequence is: **ACBD**
Correct answer:
Option (d): ACBD

Q.266 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Till a few years back, I did not have a driver, and used to drive everywhere myself.
B. Some Saturdays I would take my car to that service station and stay there until it was serviced.
C. The petrol pump where I filled petrol from had a service station beside it.
D. There were two boys, perhaps fourteen years of age, who worked there.
E. They were identical twins.
F. One was called Ram and the other one was Gopal.

(a) ECDB **(b)** CBED
(c) CBDE **(d)** BDEC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CBDE
Proper sequence:

Explanation (contd.)
A (fixed): Till a few years back, I did not have a driver, and used to drive everywhere myself.
C: The petrol pump where I filled petrol from had a service station beside it.
B: Some Saturdays I would take my car to that service station and stay there until it was serviced.
D: There were two boys, perhaps fourteen years of age, who worked there.
E: They were identical twins.
F (fixed): One was called Ram and the other one was Gopal.
Final Order: A – C – B – D – E – F
This sequence creates a **logically and temporally coherent narrative** — starting from the narrator's routine, introducing the petrol pump, then the boys, and finally identifying them.

Q.267 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. The clerk drew the book towards him again and began turning over the leaves, and all at once, as though by chance, lifted his eyes to Voldyrev.
B. "Ah... what do you want?" he asked.
C. His nose began to shine, turned red and wrinkled up in a grin.
D. "With pleasure! The Gugulin case, isn't it? What is it then exactly?"
E. "I want to make an inquiry in reference to my case... My name is Voldyrev."
F. Voldyrev explained his business.

(a) CBED **(b)** ECDB
(c) CDBE **(d)** BDEC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CBED
Solution:
We are given:

- **A (fixed first sentence):** *The clerk drew the book towards him again and began turning over the leaves, and all at once, as though by chance, lifted his eyes to Voldyrev.*
- **F (fixed last sentence):** *Voldyrev explained his business.*

We need to arrange the middle sentences (**B, C, D, E**) into a meaningful sequence.
Step-by-step Explanation:

1. **C**: *His nose began to shine, turned red and wrinkled up in a grin.*
   – This directly follows **A** and describes the clerk's physical reaction after noticing Voldyrev.
2. **B**: *"Ah... what do you want?" he asked.*
   – The clerk speaks after reacting.
3. **E**: *"I want to make an inquiry in reference to my case... My name is Voldyrev."*
   – Voldyrev replies to the clerk's question.
4. **D**: *"With pleasure! The Gugulin case, isn't it? What is it then exactly?"*
   – The clerk responds after recognizing the case.
5. **F**: *Voldyrev explained his business.*
   – This logically ends the interaction.

Final Order:
A → C → B → E → D → F

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Q.268 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. I was often invited to colleges and universities to deliver lectures.
B. After it was over, students gathered to ask some questions.
C. Once, I went to a university to deliver a lecture.
D. Though it was getting late for my next programme, since I love talking to students, I remained there answering their questions.

(a) ACBD **(b)** DBAC
(c) CBAD **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ACBD
Solution:
Let's analyze the logical sequence of events:
- **A:** *I was often invited to colleges and universities to deliver lectures.*
  – This gives general background and works well as an **opening sentence**.
- **C:** *Once, I went to a university to deliver a lecture.*
  – A specific instance of the general statement in A, so this follows **A**.
- **B:** *After it was over, students gathered to ask some questions.*
  – Naturally follows C, describing what happened **after the lecture**.
- **D:** *Though it was getting late for my next programme, since I love talking to students, I remained there answering their questions.*
  – This logically follows B as a continuation of the situation.

Final order:
A → C → B → D
Correct answer: Option (a): ACBD

Q.269 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Day after day we wandered on with the caravans and pitched our little mountaineer's tent alongside theirs.
B. The only thing that disturbed us was the extreme slowness of our progress.
C. We thought ourselves very lucky to be allowed to join the caravans.
D. Compared with our previous marches, we seemed to be gently strolling along.
E. The nomads start early, and after covering three or four miles, pitch their tents again and send their animals out to graze.
F. Before nightfall they bring them in and fold them near the tents, where they are safe from wolves and can ruminate in peace.

(a) ECDB **(b)** CBDE
(c) CBED **(d)** BDEC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CBDE
Solution:

Explanation (contd.)
- Sentence **A** (starting sentence) sets the scene: the speaker and companions are traveling with caravans and pitching tents with them.

Now let's analyze the middle sentences to find a coherent sequence:
- **C**: *"We thought ourselves very lucky to be allowed to join the caravans."* – logically follows A. They are happy about joining.
- **B**: *"The only thing that disturbed us was the extreme slowness of our progress."* – this contrasts their initial excitement in C.
- **D**: *"Compared with our previous marches, we seemed to be gently strolling along."* – this further elaborates the slowness mentioned in B.
- **E**: *"The nomads start early..."* – explains why progress is slow and describes the nomadic routine.
- **F** (ending sentence): *"Before nightfall they bring them in..."* – naturally follows E, completing the description of the nomads' daily routine.

Now putting it all together:
- A (starting scene)
- C (feeling lucky to join)
- B (noticing the slowness)
- D (comparing it to previous marches)
- E (explains nomads' pace)
- F (routine ends at night)

Correct order: CBDEF

Q.270 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Gryabov, a large stout man, with a very big head, was sitting on the sand, angling, with his legs tucked under him like a Turk.
B. Otsov thought a little, and then went to the river to look for Gryabov.
C. His hat was on the back of his head, and his cravat had slipped on one side.
D. Going down to the river, he found him a mile and a half from the house.

(a) CBAD **(b)** BDAC
(c) BCAD **(d)** ACDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BDAC
Correct sequence:
- **B** – Otsov thought a little, and then went to the river to look for Gryabov.
- **D** – Going down to the river, he found him a mile and a half from the house.
- **A** – Gryabov, a large stout man, with a very big head, was sitting on the sand, angling, with his legs tucked under him like a Turk.
- **C** – His hat was on the back of his head, and his cravat had slipped on one side.
- Sentence **B** introduces Otsov's action (thinking and deciding to look).
- Sentence **D** tells us where and how he found Gryabov.
- Sentence **A** describes Gryabov's position vividly.
- Sentence **C** adds more detail to Gryabov's appearance.

Thus, **BDAC** forms the most logical and coherent paragraph.

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Q.271 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. On this evening we set out before it was dark, but soon had to rue our haste, for crossing a slope, we found ourselves in the presence of a number of peasants planting rice.
B. They were wading half-naked in the muddy water and stared in astonishment at the sight of two men carrying packs on their backs.
C. After hours of climbing and descending, we at last reached the river Jumna.
D. They pointed to the slope high up on which one could see a village, which seemed to mean that this was the only way out of the ravine.
E. To avoid awkward questions, we walked straight on, as fast as possible in the direction indicated.
F. Meanwhile, night had fallen.

(a) BCED **(b)** BDEC
(c) ECDB **(d)** CBED

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BDEC
Solution:
Let's analyze the sequence:

- **A (given first):**
  "On this evening we set out before it was dark, but soon had to rue our haste..."
  – This sets the **scene and the situation**, showing they started early but encountered people in the fields.

Now examining the options:
Sentence B:
"They were wading half-naked in the muddy water..."

- This clearly **explains the peasants** mentioned in sentence A. So **B** follows A.

Sentence D:
"They pointed to the slope high up..."

- This shows the **response** of the peasants. So it logically follows **B**.

Sentence E:
"To avoid awkward questions, we walked straight on..."

- This shows what the **narrators did next**, based on the villagers' pointing.

Sentence C:
"After hours of climbing and descending..."

- This shows the **final result** of their movement, so it comes **after E** but **before F**.

F (given last):
"Meanwhile, night had fallen."
– Closes the narrative.
Final Order:
A → B → D → E → C → F
Correct option: Option (b): BDEC

Q.272 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. By day, he slept in the servants' kitchen or made jokes with the cooks.
B. At night, wrapped in an ample sheepskin, he walked round the grounds and tapped with his little mallet.
C. Vanka raised his eyes to the dark picture on which the light of his candle was reflected and vividly recalled his grandfather, Konstantin Makaritch, who was a night watchman to a family called Zhivarev.
D. He was a thin but extraordinarily nimble and lively little old man of sixty-five, with an everlastingly laughing face and drunken eyes.

(a) CDAB **(b)** BDAC
(c) CADB **(d)** ACBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CDAB
Solution:
Let's analyze the sentence structure and flow:

- **C**: *"Vanka raised his eyes to the dark picture..."*
  This is the best **opening sentence**, introducing Vanka and his memory of his grandfather, **Konstantin Makaritch**.
- **D**: *"He was a thin but extraordinarily nimble..."*
  This describes the grandfather introduced in C, so D logically follows C.
- **A**: *"By day, he slept in the servants' kitchen..."*
  Describes his **daily routine** – fits well after we know who he is.
- **B**: *"At night, wrapped in an ample sheepskin..."*
  Describes the **night routine**, completing the picture of his life.

Correct sequence: C → D → A → B
Correct answer: 1 (CDAB)

Q.273 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. The child stood dreamily gazing.
B. After a while, a little dark-brown dog came trotting down the sidewalk.
C. The child put out his hand and called him.
D. He stopped opposite the child, and the two regarded each other.
E. The dog hesitated for a moment, but presently he made little advances with his tail.
F. In an apologetic manner the dog came close, and the two had an interchange of friendly patting and waggles.

(a) CBED **(b)** BDEC
(c) ECDB **(d)** DBCE

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BDEC
The correct sequence is:

- **A.** The child stood dreamily gazing. *(Starting scene)*
- **B.** After a while, a little dark-brown dog came trotting down the sidewalk. *(Next event – dog enters)*
- **D.** He stopped opposite the child, and the two regarded each other. *(They notice each other)*

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Explanation (contd.)

- **E.** The dog hesitated for a moment, but presently he made little advances with his tail. *(Dog responds hesitantly)*
- **C.** The child put out his hand and called him. *(Child responds to the dog)*
- **F.** In an apologetic manner the dog came close, and the two had an interchange of friendly patting and waggles. *(Friendly ending)*

Thus, the correct order is: **A – B – D – E – C – F**, and the middle sequence **BDEC** matches **option (b)**.

Q.274 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. I met Swami Sivananda—a man who looked like the Buddha, wearing a snow-white dhoti and wooden slippers.
B. Before I could speak any further, he inquired about the source of my sorrow.
C. I introduced myself to the Swamiji.
D. My Muslim name aroused no reaction in him.
E. I was struck by his irresistible, almost childlike smile and gracious manner.
F. He offered no explanation of how he knew that I was sad and I did not ask.

(a) CBDE **(b)** BDEC
(c) EDBC **(d)** ECDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ECDB

Correct sequence:

- **A.** I met Swami Sivananda—a man who looked like the Buddha, wearing a snow-white dhoti and wooden slippers. *(Fixed)*
- **E.** I was struck by his irresistible, almost childlike smile and gracious manner.
- **C.** I introduced myself to the Swamiji.
- **D.** My Muslim name aroused no reaction in him.
- **B.** Before I could speak any further, he inquired about the source of my sorrow.
- **F.** He offered no explanation of how he knew that I was sad and I did not ask. *(Fixed)*
- Sentence **E** logically follows A, describing the impression Swami made.
- Sentence **C** follows as the narrator introduces himself.
- Then **D** shows Swami's reaction—or lack thereof—to the name.
- **B** naturally follows as the Swami speaks, sensing sorrow.
- **F** closes the paragraph smoothly, reinforcing the Swami's deep perception.

Thus, the coherent and meaningful paragraph is in the order: **A – E – C – D – B – F**, i.e., **Option (d): ECDB**.

Q.275 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. He spoke very good English, 'Exactly like a "European"', which meant that few in the school could understand what he said.
B. Many of his classmates could not trust themselves to speak to him, their fund of broken English being small.
C. There were vague rumours in the school that Rajam had come from some English boys' school somewhere in Madras.
D. Only Sankar, the genius of the class, had the courage to face him, though his English sounded halting and weak before that of Rajam.

(a) CDBA **(b)** ACBD
(c) CABD **(d)** BDAC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CABD

Solution:

Opening Sentence:

- **C** is the best opening sentence as it introduces **Rajam** and provides context about his background: *"There were vague rumours in the school that Rajam had come from some English boys' school somewhere in Madras."*

What Made Rajam Special:

- **A** logically follows, describing his exceptional English-speaking skills: *"He spoke very good English, 'Exactly like a "European"', which meant that few in the school could understand what he said."*

Reaction of Classmates:

- **B** comes next, explaining how his classmates reacted to his fluency: *"Many of his classmates could not trust themselves to speak to him, their fund of broken English being small."*

The Exception:

- **D** concludes the paragraph by introducing the only classmate, Sankar, who had the courage to talk to Rajam: *"Only Sankar, the genius of the class, had the courage to face him, though his English sounded halting and weak before that of Rajam."*

Correct order: CABD

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Q.276 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. As soon as I returned from NASA, India's first rocket launch took place on 21 November, 1963.
B. The assembled rocket was to be shifted from the church building to the launch pad.
C. The rocket was assembled in the local church building.
D. The only equipment available to transport the rocket was a truck and a manually operated hydraulic crane.
E. It was a sounding rocket, called NikeApache, made at NASA.
F. When the rocket was lifted by the crane and was about to be placed on the launcher, it started tilting, indicating a leak in the hydraulic system of the crane.

(a) EDBC **(b)** ECBD
(c) BDEC **(d)** CBDE

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ECBD
Solution:
A sets the timeline: *"As soon as I returned from NASA, India's first rocket launch took place on 21 November, 1963."*
E follows, introducing the rocket: *"It was a sounding rocket, called NikeApache, made at NASA."*
C describes where it was assembled: *"The rocket was assembled in the local church building."*
B then explains the next step: *"The assembled rocket was to be shifted from the church building to the launch pad."*
D provides the method of transportation: *"The only equipment available to transport the rocket was a truck and a manually operated hydraulic crane."*
F concludes with the complication during the final step: *"When the rocket was lifted by the crane and was about to be placed on the launcher, it started tilting, indicating a leak in the hydraulic system of the crane."*
Correct order: AECBDF
Correct answer: Option (b) (ECBD)

Q.277 Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. He reflected for a while, dipped the pen in ink, and wrote the address: To Grandfather in the Village.
B. Then he scratched his head and thought for a while, and added the words: Konstantin Makarich.
C. Vanka twice folded the sheet of paper and then he put it in an envelope bought the previous day for a kopeck.
D. Pleased because no one interrupted him when he was writing, he threw on his cap, and without troubling to put on a coat, he ran out into the street in his shirt sleeves.

(a) CDBA **(b)** CABD
(c) BDAC **(d)** ACBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CABD
- **C**: The paragraph starts with Vanka folding the paper and putting it in an envelope — this sets the action.
- **A**: Next, he writes the address on the envelope — "To Grandfather in the Village".

Explanation (contd.)
- **B**: Then, he adds more detail to the address — "Konstantin Makarich".
- **D**: Finally, he leaves to post the letter — no one interrupts him, and he rushes out happily.

This order maintains the **logical sequence of preparing and sending a letter**.

Q.278 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Swaminathan and Mani were nervously walking up the short drive leading to Rajam's house.
B. A policeman in uniform cried to them to stop and came running towards them.
C. The policeman asked what they were doing there.
D. Swaminathan felt like turning and fleeing on seeing him.
E. He appealed to Mani to speak to the policeman.
F. Mani replied in a tone in which overdone carelessness was a trifle obvious: If Rajam is in the house, we are here to see him.

(a) CBED **(b)** BCED
(c) BDEC **(d)** ECDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BDEC
- **A** is the starting sentence: Swaminathan and Mani walk toward Rajam's house.
- **B** naturally follows, as a **policeman** notices them and intervenes.
- **D** shows Swaminathan's **reaction** on seeing the policeman — he feels like fleeing.
- **E** follows as Swaminathan **asks Mani to speak** to the policeman.
- **C** is the **policeman's question**: "What are you doing here?"
- **F** is the **final reply** by Mani.

Thus, the correct order is:
A – B – D – E – C – F → (BDEC)

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Q.279 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. In 1928, Salim Ali went to Germany and trained under Professor Erwin Streseman at the Zoological Museum of Berlin.
B. Then, suddenly one day the female arrives and takes possession of a husband and the half-finished home!
C. Here, he studied the breeding biology of baya birds which won him recognition as a world class ornithologist.
D. He found that it is the male baya which builds the nest.
E. In 1930, finding no suitable employment he moved to Kihim a coastal village near Mumbai.
F. He found that the thousands of baby bayas were fed on soft bodied insects as the young are incapable of digesting hard grain.

(a) BDEC **(b)** ECDB
(c) EDBC **(d)** CBDE

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) ECDB
Let's analyze the fixed opening and closing sentences first:
- **A.** *In 1928, Salim Ali went to Germany and trained under Professor Erwin Streseman at the Zoological Museum of Berlin.*
- **F.** *He found that the thousands of baby bayas were fed on soft bodied insects as the young are incapable of digesting hard grain.*
  These frame the paragraph — a beginning about his training and an ending on a specific biological observation.

Now arrange the middle sentences:
- **E.** *In 1930, finding no suitable employment he moved to Kihim a coastal village near Mumbai.*
  → Logical follow-up after returning from Germany.
- **C.** *Here, he studied the breeding biology of baya birds which won him recognition as a world class ornithologist.*
  → Makes sense after moving to Kihim.
- **D.** *He found that it is the male baya which builds the nest.*
  → Introduces a specific observation from his studies.
- **B.** *Then, suddenly one day the female arrives and takes possession of a husband and the half-finished home!*
  → Continuation of the baya bird behavior.

So, the coherent order is:
A → E → C → D → B → F
That corresponds to:
Answer: 2 (ECDB)

Q.280 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. Whenever I teach my class, I make sure that everyone participates in the question-answer session.
B. Sometimes their questions are so difficult that I am not able to answer.
C. Many times I have learnt a lot from my students during these sessions.
D. I normally teach for forty minutes and keep the last twenty minutes open for debates, questions and answers.
E. This way, students learn to express their opinions in front of others and the teacher also understands how much the students have learnt.
F. Then I tell them that I will refer to my books and answer the next day.

(a) CBED **(b)** ECDB
(c) DECB **(d)** DCBE

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) DECB
- **A** is the opening sentence where the teacher sets the scene by explaining that they encourage participation.
- **D** logically follows, describing the structure of the class: 40 minutes teaching + 20 minutes of discussion.
- **E** comes next, explaining the benefits of this format — both for students and the teacher.
- **C** follows naturally, adding that the teacher has also learned a lot from students.
- **B** continues this idea, noting that sometimes students ask very hard questions.
- **F** is the logical conclusion: when the teacher can't answer, they promise to check and respond the next day.

So, the correct meaningful order is:
A → D → E → C → B → F
Thus, **Answer: 3 (DECB)**.

Q.281 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. Leo Tolstoy, a great Russian novelist, was born in the village of Yasnaya Polyana in Russian Empire, on 9 September 1828.
B. His mother died before Tolstoy turned two, and his father died in 1837.
C. His parents, Count Nikolay Ilich Tolstoy and Princess Mariya Nikolayevna Volkonskaya, came from distinguished families of the Russian nobility.
D. After his grandmother and an aunt died, Tolstoy and his four siblings were raised by another aunt in western Russia.

(a) CDBA **(b)** BDAC
(c) ACBD **(d)** ADBC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ACBD
Let's understand the logical flow:
- **A**: *Leo Tolstoy, a great Russian novelist, was born...* → This introduces the subject and gives birth details, so it's the logical starting point.

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Explanation (contd.)

- **C**: *His parents... came from distinguished families...* → Gives background on his family, fits well right after A.
- **B**: *His mother died before Tolstoy turned two...* → Moves into early childhood after parental introduction.
- **D**: *After his grandmother and aunt died...* → Concludes the sequence of guardianship after parents' and other relatives' deaths.

Final sequence:
A → C → B → D
So, the correct order is: **ACBD**, hence **Answer: 3**.

Q.282 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. When I joined the B.Sc. degree course at St. Joseph's, I was unaware of any other option for higher education.
B. Nor did I have any information about career opportunities available to a student of science.
C. I could have joined the Engineering course long ago, right after finishing my Intermediate course.
D. Only after obtaining a B.Sc. did I realise that physics was not my subject.
E. I had to go into engineering to realise my dreams.
F. Better late than never, I told myself as I made the detour, applying for admission into the Madras Institute of Technology (MIT), regarded as the crown jewel of technical education in South India at that time.

(a) CBED **(b)** BCED
(c) BDEC **(d)** ECDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) BDEC
Let's analyze the correct flow between the given fixed sentences **A** and **F**:

- **A**: *When I joined the B.Sc. degree course at St. Joseph's, I was unaware of any other option for higher education.* → This sets the context: the narrator chose B.Sc. without knowing alternatives.
- **B**: *Nor did I have any information about career opportunities available to a student of science.* → This logically extends A, showing continued lack of awareness.
- **D**: *Only after obtaining a B.Sc. did I realise that physics was not my subject.* → Naturally follows B, as the realization comes later.
- **E**: *I had to go into engineering to realise my dreams.* → A decision is made based on the realization in D.
- **C**: *I could have joined the Engineering course long ago...* → A reflective comment after the decision in E.
- **F**: *Better late than never...* → A concluding remark tying everything together with the admission to MIT.

Final sequence: A → B → D → E → C → F
So the correct jumbled order is **BDEC** (in between A and F), which corresponds to **Answer: 3**.

Q.283 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Colombo, where all the people I knew lived, was less than a hundred miles away from my place.
B. These weekends in the city were hot and exhausting, and my parents were always happy to get back to the house, where they could change into comfortable clothing.
C. One Sunday not long before they were due to return to America, we decided to take in the horse races at Gintota, where there are also some botanical gardens that Mother wanted to see.
D. There we had tea on the wide verandas of certain houses in Cinnamon Gardens, and sat at dinners with professors from the university, Protestant ministers, and assorted members of the government.
E. Several times me and my parents (who had come from America to visit me) went up for weekends, which I arranged with friends by telephone beforehand.
F. I engaged rooms at the New Oriental in Galle and we had lunch there before setting out to see the botanical gardens.

(a) CBDE **(b)** EDBC
(c) BDEC **(d)** ECDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) EDBC
We are given that sentences A and F are fixed as the **beginning** and **end**, respectively:

- **A.** *Colombo, where all the people I knew lived, was less than a hundred miles away from my place.*
  → This introduces the context: narrator lives near Colombo.

Now let's examine the middle sentences for logical flow:
Step-by-step sequence:

- **E.** *Several times me and my parents (who had come from America to visit me) went up for weekends, which I arranged with friends by telephone beforehand.*
  → Naturally follows A. After telling us Colombo is close, narrator shares how they often visited with parents.
- **D.** *There we had tea on the wide verandas of certain houses in Cinnamon Gardens...*
  → Continues E by describing what they did during those weekend visits.
- **B.** *These weekends in the city were hot and exhausting, and my parents were always happy to get back...*
  → Follows D as a reflective comment on the weekends described above.
- **C.** *One Sunday not long before they were due to return to America, we decided to take in the horse races...*
  → Specific instance follows the general description of weekends. This leads naturally to the final sentence.
- **F.** *I engaged rooms at the New Oriental in Galle and we had lunch there...*
  → Completes the idea started in C with a final detailed activity.

Final Logical Order:
A → E → D → B → C → F
Hence, the correct option is:
Answer: 2 (EDBC)

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Q.284 **Given below are six sentences of a paragraph. Sentence A is the beginning whereas sentence F is the last sentence of the para. The middle four sentences (B-E)are jumbled up. Select the option that gives their correct order forming a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. A youngster quit Facebook in December after spending over three years on the social networking site.
B.Like almost everyone from his "friend's circle," the 20-year-old was a regular on the site.
C.Last week a new feature on Facebook called Timeline forced him to reconsider the pros and cons of being on the networking site.
D.With that one act, he bid a silent adieu to more than 300 contacts that he had added to his account during the period.
E. He visited it every day to post photos and status updates.
F. "Everyone has some skeletons in their closet and I am just not comfortable with Facebook digging up and displaying all the facets of my life on a bulletin board," said the youngster.

(a) DBEC **(b)** BCDE
(c) EDBC **(d)** CEBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DBEC
Let's analyze the logical flow of the paragraph:

- **A.** *A youngster quit Facebook in December after spending over three years on the social networking site.* → **Opening sentence**.

Now we need to arrange B, C, D, E, and F so that the story unfolds meaningfully between **A (start)** and **F (end)**.

- **D.** *With that one act, he bid a silent adieu to more than 300 contacts that he had added to his account during the period.*
  → This clearly follows A, describing the result of quitting.
- **B.** *Like almost everyone from his "friend's circle," the 20-year-old was a regular on the site.*
  → Gives background info about his regular activity.
- **E.** *He visited it every day to post photos and status updates.*
  → Explains his routine, supports sentence B.
- **C.** *Last week a new feature on Facebook called Timeline forced him to reconsider the pros and cons of being on the networking site.*
  → This gives the **reason** behind quitting — a trigger event.
- **F.** *"Everyone has some skeletons in their closet and I am just not comfortable with Facebook digging up and displaying all the facets of my life on a bulletin board," said the youngster.*
  → Perfect **closing**, with a quote justifying his decision.

Sequence: A → D → B → E → C → F
→ Which matches **Option (a): DBEC**
So, the correct answer is: **1 (DBEC)**.

Q.285 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. The races were something of a disappointment.
B. As we left the grounds, Dad said with satisfaction: It'll be good to get back to the hotel and relax.
C. Dad was not eager.
D. But we were going to the botanical gardens, Mother reminded him.
E. I'd like to have just a peek at them.
F. Those places cover a lot of territory, you know, he said.

(a) CBED **(b)** BDEC
(c) ECDB **(d)** BCED

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) BDEC
Let's arrange the sentences between the fixed opening and closing lines (A and F) logically:

- **A**: *The races were something of a disappointment.* (Sets the context)
- **B**: *As we left the grounds, Dad said with satisfaction: It'll be good to get back to the hotel and relax.* (Follows naturally after the races)
- **D**: *But we were going to the botanical gardens, Mother reminded him.* (Introduces a change in plan)
- **E**: *I'd like to have just a peek at them.* (Someone is trying to persuade or show interest)
- **C**: *Dad was not eager.* (Explains reluctance)
- **F**: *Those places cover a lot of territory, you know, he said.* (Dad justifies his hesitation)

Final sequence:
A → B → D → E → C → F
Hence, the correct answer is: **2 (BDEC)**.

Q.286 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. He usually spent such an interval in running round the school or in playing the Digging Game under the huge Tamarind tree.
B. But to-day he sat apart sunk in thought.
C. Next day, Swaminathan was at school early.
D. There was still half an hour before the bell.

(a) ACBD **(b)** CDAB
(c) BDAC **(d)** CABD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) CDAB
Let's arrange the sentences in a logical and meaningful order:

- **C**: *"Next day, Swaminathan was at school early."* – This sets the time and subject.
- **D**: *"There was still half an hour before the bell."* – Describes the situation after he arrived.
- **A**: *"He usually spent such an interval in running..."* – Gives Swaminathan's usual routine during this time.
- **B**: *"But to-day he sat apart sunk in thought."* – Shows contrast with his usual behaviour, adding depth to the narrative.

Sequence: **C → D → A → B**
Thus, the correct answer is: **2 (CDAB)**.

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Q.287 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. When I had a house in Sri Lanka, my parents came out one winter to see me.
B. Originally, I had felt some qualms about encouraging their visit.
C. Any one of several things – the constant heat, the unaccustomed food and drinking water, even the presence of a leprosy clinic a quarter of a mile from the house – might easily have an adverse effect on them in one way or another.
D. They claimed not to mind the lack of running water in the bathrooms and regularly praised the curries prepared by Appuhamy, the resident cook.
E. But I had underestimated their resilience; they made a greater show of adaptability than I had thought possible and seemed entirely content with everything.
F. Both of them being in their seventies, they were not tempted by the more distant or inaccessible points of interest.

(a) BCED **(b)** BDEC
(c) CBED **(d)** ECDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BCED
We are given the first and last sentences fixed:
- **A.** *When I had a house in Sri Lanka, my parents came out one winter to see me.*
- **F.** *Both of them being in their seventies, they were not tempted by the more distant or inaccessible points of interest.*

Now let's reorder the middle parts to form a coherent flow:
- **B.** *Originally, I had felt some qualms about encouraging their visit.*
  → This logically follows sentence A (he had doubts about inviting them).
- **C.** *Any one of several things – the constant heat, the unaccustomed food and drinking water...*
  → Explains the reason behind those qualms.
- **E.** *But I had underestimated their resilience...*
  → A contrast, showing the reality turned out better than expected.
- **D.** *They claimed not to mind... and praised the curries...*
  → Specific evidence of their adaptability.

Thus, the correct and meaningful order is:
A → B → C → E → D → F
That matches:
Answer: 1 (BCED)

Q.288 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below in jumbled order. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. "I'll forget it for sure," said the Hodja, "Write it on a piece of paper for me."
B. Hodja Nasruddin purchased a piece of meat at the market, and on his way home he met a friend.
C The friend obliged him, and the Hodja continued on his way, the piece of meat in one hand and the recipe in the other.
D. Seeing the Hodja's purchase, the friend told him an excellent recipe for stew.

(a) BDAC **(b)** CBAD
(c) BCAD **(d)** ACDB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) BDAC
Let's break down the logical sequence:
- **B.** *Hodja Nasruddin purchased a piece of meat at the market, and on his way home he met a friend.*
  → This introduces the main character and sets the scene.
- **D.** *Seeing the Hodja's purchase, the friend told him an excellent recipe for stew.*
  → Naturally follows B. The friend sees the meat and shares a recipe.
- **A.** *"I'll forget it for sure," said the Hodja, "Write it on a piece of paper for me."*
  → The Hodja responds, showing concern about remembering the recipe.
- **C.** *The friend obliged him, and the Hodja continued on his way, the piece of meat in one hand and the recipe in the other.*
  → Final action that wraps up the encounter.

Sequence: B → D → A → C
Therefore, the correct answer is:
Answer: 1 (BDAC)

Q.289 **Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.**
A. There are about eighty houses in the village, which is the seat of two district governors who administer thirty villages.
B. We were told that we were the first Europeans who had ever come to Kyirong, and the inhabitants watched our entry with astonishment.
C. This time we were quartered in the house of a farmer, which reminded me of our Tyrolese houses.
D. The only difference was that instead of chimneys, the roofs of the houses were decorated with prayer flags.
E. As a matter of fact, the whole of the village might have been transplanted from the Alps.
F. These were always in the five colours, which represented different aspects of life in Tibet.

(a) ECDB **(b)** BDEC
(c) CBED **(d)** BCED

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) BCED
Let's sequence the sentences logically between the fixed opening (A) and ending (F):

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Explanation (contd.)

- **A** introduces the village — its size and administrative significance.
- **B** follows well — narrating the arrival of Europeans and the local people's reaction.
- **C** moves into details of their accommodation in a house, drawing comparisons with Tyrolese houses.
- **E** builds on that comparison, suggesting the entire village looked like it was from the Alps.
- **D** adds one notable difference — prayer flags instead of chimneys.
- **F** logically concludes by explaining the **significance** of those prayer flags (five colours representing aspects of life).

So, the full meaningful sequence is:
A → B → C → E → D → F
Thus, **Answer: 4 (BCED)**.

Q.290 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. When I was a child, I had a teacher called Gowramma.
B. She used to teach us Sanskrit.
C. She was kind and warm and always cheerful.
D. Students usually took Sanskrit as an optional language, in order to score marks like math.
E. She was a great teacher and would tell lots of stories in the class.
F. They only wanted to get good grades and were not interested in Gowramma's old epics.

(a) ECDB **(b)** BDEC
(c) CBDE **(d)** CBED

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CBED
The given first and last sentences are:

- **A.** *When I was a child, I had a teacher called Gowramma.*
- **F.** *They only wanted to get good grades and were not interested in Gowramma's old epics.*

Now let's arrange the middle sentences logically:

- **C.** *She was kind and warm and always cheerful.*
  → Introduces Gowramma's personality after her name is mentioned in A.
- **B.** *She used to teach us Sanskrit.*
  → Explains her role as a teacher.
- **E.** *She was a great teacher and would tell lots of stories in the class.*
  → Adds depth to her teaching style.
- **D.** *Students usually took Sanskrit as an optional language...*
  → Leads to the contrast that appears in the final sentence (F).

So the full order becomes:
A → C → B → E → D → F
That matches option **4 (CBED)**.

Q.291 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Soon, we were treated like members of the family.
B. Once she invited us to come into her room and look at her jewels.
C. Mrs. Thangme talked over her problems with us and was delighted when we paid her compliments on her good looks and good taste.
D. Her treasures were worth looking at.
E. These she kept in a great chest in which her treasures were stored either in small jewel cases or in fine silk wrappings.
F. She had a glorious tiara of corals, turquoise and pearls and many rings as well as diamond earrings and some little Tibetan amulet lockets, which are hung round the neck by a coral chain.

(a) CDBE **(b)** ECDB
(c) CBED **(d)** BDEC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CBED
We are given:

- **A.** *Soon, we were treated like members of the family.* (START)
- **F.** *She had a glorious tiara of corals, turquoise and pearls and many rings as well as diamond earrings and some little Tibetan amulet lockets, which are hung round the neck by a coral chain.* (END)

Now let's find the correct sequence for the middle part:

- **C.** *Mrs. Thangme talked over her problems with us and was delighted when we paid her compliments on her good looks and good taste.*
  → Builds on the family-like bond stated in A.
- **B.** *Once she invited us to come into her room and look at her jewels.*
  → Shows a personal gesture, fits after C.
- **E.** *These she kept in a great chest in which her treasures were stored either in small jewel cases or in fine silk wrappings.*
  → Refers to "jewels" mentioned in B.
- **D.** *Her treasures were worth looking at.*
  → Serves as a transition into the final detailed description in F.

So the full order becomes:
A → C → B → E → D → F
That matches **option (c) (CBED)**.

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Q.292 Sentences of a paragraph are given below. While the first and the last sentences (A and F) are in the correct order, the sentences in between are jumbled up. Arrange the sentences in the correct order to form a meaningful and coherent paragraph.
A. Some twelve or fifteen years ago there lived in his own house in the main street of the town a certain official by the name of Gromov, a steady well-to-do man.
B. Sergei, after completing three years of study at the University, contracted galloping consumption and died and this death was the beginning of a series of disasters which overtook the Gromov family.
C. He had two sons: Sergei and Ivan.
D. His house and property were sold at auction, and Ivan Dmitrich and his mother were left without any means of support.
E. A week after Sergei's funeral the old man was sued for forgery and embezzlement, and died soon after of typhus in the prison hospital.
F. While his father was alive Ivan Dmitrich lived in Petersburg, studying at the University, and receiving 60 or 70 roubles from home every month.

(a) CBDE **(b)** BDEC
(c) ECDB **(d)** CBED

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) CBED
Let's logically arrange the middle sentences between the fixed starting sentence A and ending sentence F.

- **A**: *Introduces Gromov, an official living a stable life.*
- **C**: *He had two sons: Sergei and Ivan.* → Introduces the family, natural follow-up to A.
- **B**: *Sergei dies of consumption; this triggers a chain of misfortunes.* → Begins the tragedy.
- **E**: *After Sergei's funeral, the father is accused of crimes and dies.* → Continues the decline.
- **D**: *House is auctioned, Ivan and mother left destitute.* → Final blow to the family.
- **F**: *Now switches to Ivan's life in Petersburg before the tragedy hit.* → Concludes by contrasting past comfort with present hardship.

Correct sequence: A → C → B → E → D → F
Thus, the correct answer is: **4 (CBED)**.

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12. Cloze Test

379 questions

Cloze Passage 1 (Q.1–Q.10)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Temptations of one kind or another lure everyone. The important thing is (1)_____ them from gaining a foothold in our (2)_____. As soon as we detect the first (3)_____ of temptation, we should become watchful and (4)_____ our attention to good or noble thoughts. (5)_____ we wait till the temptation becomes too (6)_____, we are likely to fall. Playing with the temptation (7)_____ to welcoming it. In fact, the safest (8)_____ is to avoid situations in which we may be tempted. If, (9)_____ all our care, a temptation becomes severe, we (10)_____ not get upset or disappointed, but turn to a good friend for advice and help.

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Q.1 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 1.

(a) prevented **(b)** prevent
(c) to preventing **(d)** to prevent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to prevent
Type: Cloze – Infinitive
Rule: "The important thing **is to + V1**." So "the important thing is **to prevent** them ..."
("is" के बाद "to + verb" ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **prevented / to preventing** – wrong forms; **prevent** – needs "to".

Q.2 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 2.

(a) souls **(b)** eyes
(c) bodies **(d)** minds

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) minds
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary/Context
Temptations gain a foothold in our thoughts, i.e., in our **minds**.
("minds" = मन।)
Why the others are wrong
• **souls / eyes / bodies** – temptation takes hold in the mind, not these.

Q.3 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 3.

(a) signs **(b)** symbols
(c) codes **(d)** messages

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) signs
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"the first **signs** of temptation" = the earliest indications.
("signs" = संकेत/लक्षण।)
Why the others are wrong

Explanation (contd.)
• **symbols / codes / messages** – do not fit "first ___ of temptation".

Q.4 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 4.

(a) turn **(b)** revolve
(c) change **(d)** twist

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) turn
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"**turn** our attention to good thoughts" = direct our attention. ("turn attention to" is the fixed phrase.)
("turn attention to" = ध्यान लगाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **revolve / change / twist** – do not collocate with "attention to good thoughts".

Q.5 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 5.

(a) If **(b)** Whether
(c) Until **(d)** Unless

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) If
Type: Cloze – Conjunction
"**If** we wait till the temptation becomes too strong, we are likely to fall." — a real condition.
("If" = यदि (शर्त)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Whether** – for choices; **Until/Unless** – change the meaning.

Q.6 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 6.

(a) feeble **(b)** weak
(c) strong **(d)** burly

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) strong
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"too **strong**" = so powerful that we fall.
("strong" = प्रबल।)
Why the others are wrong
• **feeble / weak** – opposite; **burly** – used for a person's build, not temptation.

Q.7 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 7

(a) amount **(b)** amounted
(c) amounting **(d)** amounts

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) amounts
Type: Cloze – Verb Agreement/Collocation
"Playing with the temptation **amounts to** welcoming it" = is equal to. Singular subject → "amounts".
("amount to" = ... के बराबर होना।)
Why the others are wrong

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Explanation (contd.)
• **amount / amounted / amounting** – wrong form/tense for this present statement.

Q.8 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 8.

(a) object **(b)** thing
(c) item **(d)** track

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) thing
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
"the safest **thing** is to avoid situations ..." — the natural word is "thing".
("the safest thing" = सबसे सुरक्षित बात।)
Why the others are wrong
• **object / item / track** – do not fit "the safest ___ is to avoid".

Q.9 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 9.

(a) despite **(b)** instead of
(c) because of **(d)** in case of

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) despite
Type: Cloze – Preposition
"If, **despite** all our care, a temptation becomes severe ..." = in spite of our care.
("despite" = के बावजूद।)
Why the others are wrong
• **instead of / because of / in case of** – wrong meaning for "in spite of our care".

Q.10 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 10.

(a) might **(b)** should
(c) could **(d)** would

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) should
Type: Cloze – Modal
"we **should** not get upset ... but turn to a good friend" = advice/duty.
("should" = सलाह/चाहिए।)
Why the others are wrong
• **might / could / would** – do not give the advisory sense that "should" does.

Cloze Passage 2 (Q.11–Q.20)
In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Passage (contd.)
Antarctica is perhaps the one place on Earth no one would have expected (1)_____ canyons. And yet, scientists were surprised to (2)_____ deep crevices that run for hundreds of kilometres. (3)_____ they are not visible at the snowy surface, (4)_____ trenches cut deep into Antarctica. The biggest (5)_____ canyon is over 350 km long. It's called 'Foundation Trough'. (6)_____ canyons are not as long, but they are (7)_____ too. These canyons were found with the help of radars (8)_____ scanning the wide expanse of the frozen continent. (9)_____ are incredibly important because they help control (10)_____ flow of the ice.

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Q.11 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 1.

(a) find **(b)** finding
(c) found **(d)** to find

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to find
Type: Cloze – Infinitive
"no one would have expected **to find** canyons" — "expect **to + V1**".
("expect to + verb"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **find / finding / found** – wrong forms after "expected".

Q.12 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 2.

(a) search **(b)** discover
(c) invent **(d)** explore

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) discover
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
Scientists were surprised to **discover** (find, for the first time) deep crevices.
("discover" = खोजना/पता लगाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **search / explore** – actions of looking, not finding; **invent** – to create, wrong sense.

Q.13 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 3.

(a) Since **(b)** Although
(c) Because **(d)** In case

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Although
Type: Cloze – Conjunction (Contrast)
"**Although** they are not visible at the surface, these trenches cut deep" — contrast.
("Although" = यद्यपि (विरोध)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Since / Because** – show cause; **In case** – condition.

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Q.14 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 4.

(a) them **(b)** these
(c) those **(d)** this

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) these
Type: Cloze – Demonstrative
"**these** trenches" points to the crevices just mentioned (plural, near).
("these" = ये (बहुवचन)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **them** – object pronoun, not before a noun; **those** – distant; **this** – singular.

Q.15 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 5.

(a) like **(b)** one
(c) so **(d)** such

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) such
Type: Cloze – Determiner
"The biggest **such** canyon is over 350 km" — "such" = of this kind.
("such" = इस प्रकार का।)
Why the others are wrong
• **like / one / so** – do not fit "the biggest ___ canyon".

Q.16 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 6.

(a) Previous **(b)** Present
(c) Other **(d)** Another

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Other
Type: Cloze – Determiner
"**Other** canyons are not as long" = the remaining ones.
("Other" = अन्य।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Previous / Present / Another** – "Another" is singular; the rest do not fit "___ canyons (plural)".

Q.17 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 7

(a) impressive **(b)** exciting
(c) intense **(d)** inspiring

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) impressive
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
Even the shorter canyons are still **impressive** (striking, remarkable).
("impressive" = प्रभावशाली।)
Why the others are wrong
• **exciting / intense / inspiring** – "impressive" best fits describing large canyons.

Q.18 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 8.

(a) until **(b)** after
(c) when **(d)** before

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) after
Type: Cloze – Preposition/Conjunction
The canyons were found with radars **after** scanning the wide expanse of the continent.
("after" = के बाद।)
Why the others are wrong
• **until / when / before** – do not fit the "found ... after scanning" sequence.

Q.19 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 9.

(a) Them **(b)** That
(c) This **(d)** They

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) They
Type: Cloze – Pronoun
"**They** are incredibly important" — "They" = the canyons (subject, plural).
("They" = वे (कर्ता)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Them** – object form; **That / This** – singular.

Q.20 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 10.

(a) the **(b)** one
(c) such **(d)** a

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) the
Type: Cloze – Article
"they help control **the** flow of the ice" — a specific flow → definite article "the".
("the" = निश्चित वस्तु के लिए।)
Why the others are wrong
• **one / such / a** – do not fit "control ___ flow of the ice".

Cloze Passage 3 (Q.21–Q.25)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

The endurance of the crowds lining the Coronation route was most commendable. Soaked, chilled and sleepless, (1)_____ remained wonderfully good-tempered and when the procession finally (2)_____ they cheered whole-heartedly. The great merit of a (3)_____ crowd is that its members remain individuals. It is (4)_____ characteristic of the British culture that British people can collect in crowds (5)_____ do not turn into mobs.

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Q.21 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 1.

(a) it **(b)** they
(c) he **(d)** we

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) they
Type: Cloze – Pronoun
"Soaked, chilled and sleepless, **they** remained good-tempered" — "they" = the crowds.
("they" = वे (भीड़)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **it / he / we** – wrong number/person for "the crowds".

Q.22 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 2.

(a) entered **(b)** appeared
(c) joined **(d)** finished

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) appeared
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"when the procession finally **appeared** they cheered" = came into view.
("appeared" = प्रकट हुआ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **entered / joined / finished** – do not fit "the procession finally ___ (and they cheered)".

Q.23 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 3.

(a) Asian **(b)** Indian
(c) French **(d)** British

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) British
Type: Cloze – Context
The passage praises the discipline of the **British** crowd (linked to "British culture" next).
("British" = ब्रिटिश।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Asian / Indian / French** – the passage is specifically about the British crowd.

Q.24 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 4.

(a) therefore **(b)** perhaps
(c) moreover **(d)** only

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) perhaps
Type: Cloze – Adverb
"It is **perhaps** characteristic of British culture ..." = possibly, a soft claim.
("perhaps" = शायद।)
Why the others are wrong
• **therefore** – result; **moreover** – addition; **only** – changes the meaning.

Q.25 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 5.

(a) who **(b)** which
(c) what **(d)** whom

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) which
Type: Cloze – Relative Pronoun
"crowds **which** do not turn into mobs" — "which" refers to the thing "crowds".
(निर्जीव "crowds" के लिए "which"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **who / whom** – for people; **what** – not used as a relative pronoun after a noun.

Cloze Passage 4 (Q.26–Q.35)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

A market place is always abuzz with activity. It is especially (1)_____ a visit in the evenings. A (2)_____ range of items are on display. (3)_____ and getting a satisfactory (4)_____ give the necessary sense of (5)_____ to the bored housewife and bring a smile (6)_____ her face. People from all (7)_____ of life, rich and poor, (8)_____ shoulders with each other. From their busy (9)_____, here people find time to (10)_____ a greeting with friends or neighbours.

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Q.26 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) value **(b)** asset
(c) credit **(d)** worth

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) worth
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
"It is especially **worth** a visit in the evenings" — "worth a visit" = deserving a visit.
("worth a visit" = देखने योग्य।)
Why the others are wrong
• **value / asset / credit** – do not fit "worth a visit".

Q.27 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) tall **(b)** wide
(c) narrow **(d)** short

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) wide
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"A **wide** range of items" = a large variety.
("wide range" = विस्तृत श्रेणी।)
Why the others are wrong
• **tall / narrow / short** – do not collocate with "range of items".

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Q.28 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) Debating **(b)** Fighting
(c) Snatching **(d)** Bargaining

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Bargaining
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"**Bargaining** and getting a satisfactory deal" = negotiating a price. Fits a market place.
("Bargaining" = मोल-भाव।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Debating / Fighting / Snatching** – not what one does to get a "deal".

Q.29 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) case **(b)** contract
(c) pact **(d)** deal

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) deal
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"a satisfactory **deal**" = a good bargain. ("get a deal".)
("deal" = सौदा।)
Why the others are wrong
• **case / contract / pact** – too formal/legal for a market bargain.

Q.30 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(a) creation **(b)** improvement
(c) achievement **(d)** exertion

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) achievement
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
Getting a good deal gives a sense of **achievement** (accomplishment).
("achievement" = उपलब्धि।)
Why the others are wrong
• **creation / improvement / exertion** – do not fit "sense of ___".

Q.31 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 6.

(a) of **(b)** at
(c) to **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) to
Type: Cloze – Preposition
"bring a smile **to** her face" — the fixed phrase.
("bring a smile to one's face"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **of / at / in** – wrong preposition for "smile ___ her face".

Q.32 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 7.

(a) walks **(b)** tours
(c) parts **(d)** steps

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) walks
Type: Cloze – Idiom
"People from all **walks** of life" = people of every kind/profession.
("walks of life" = जीवन के हर क्षेत्र।)
Why the others are wrong
• **tours / parts / steps** – do not form the idiom "walks of life".

Q.33 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 8.

(a) rub **(b)** join
(c) pat **(d)** swipe

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) rub
Type: Cloze – Idiom
"**rub** shoulders with each other" = mix/meet closely.
("rub shoulders with" = मेल-जोल रखना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **join / pat / swipe** – do not form "___ shoulders with".

Q.34 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 9.

(a) pattern **(b)** custom
(c) system **(d)** schedule

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) schedule
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"From their busy **schedule**, people find time ..." = busy routine.
("schedule" = दिनचर्या/कार्यक्रम।)
Why the others are wrong
• **pattern / custom / system** – do not fit "busy ___".

Q.35 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 10.

(a) return **(b)** exchange
(c) displace **(d)** transfer

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) exchange
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"**exchange** a greeting with friends" = to greet each other.
("exchange a greeting" = अभिवादन करना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **return / displace / transfer** – do not collocate with "a greeting".

Cloze Passage 5 (Q.36–Q.45)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

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Passage (contd.)
A no-examination policy would kill the competitive (1)_____ among the students. It is (2)_____ to encourage healthy competition in today's (3)_____ where all admissions and job (4)_____ are based on elimination. Also, (5)_____ the total absence of examinations, (6)_____ who truly deserve may not get fair (7)_____, while those who need to (8)_____ may not get the right (9)_____. Moreover, examinations help to assess the (10)_____ of teaching.

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Q.36 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) life **(b)** spirit
(c) soul **(d)** stamina

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) spirit
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"kill the competitive **spirit**" = the drive to compete.
("competitive spirit" = प्रतिस्पर्धा की भावना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **life / soul / stamina** – do not collocate with "competitive".

Q.37 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) applicable **(b)** auspicious
(c) important **(d)** convenient

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) important
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
"It is **important** to encourage healthy competition ..."
("important" = महत्वपूर्ण।)
Why the others are wrong
• **applicable / auspicious / convenient** – do not fit "It is ___ to encourage".

Q.38 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) period **(b)** term
(c) times **(d)** season

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) times
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
"in today's **times**" = the present age.
("today's times" = आज के समय में।)
Why the others are wrong
• **period / term / season** – do not fit "today's ___".

Q.39 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) functions **(b)** vocations
(c) occupations **(d)** recruitments

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) recruitments
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"job **recruitments** are based on elimination" = hiring/selection.
("recruitment" = भर्ती।)

Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are wrong
• **functions / vocations / occupations** – do not fit "job ___ based on elimination".

Q.40 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(a) between **(b)** among
(c) in **(d)** on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) in
Type: Cloze – Preposition
"**in** the total absence of examinations" = when exams are absent.
("in the absence of" = ... के अभाव में।)
Why the others are wrong
• **between / among / on** – wrong preposition for "___ the total absence of".

Q.41 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 6.

(a) these **(b)** which
(c) that **(d)** those

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) those
Type: Cloze – Pronoun
"**those** who truly deserve may not get fair recognition" — "those who" = the people who.
("those who" = वे लोग जो।)
Why the others are wrong
• **these / which / that** – do not fit "___ who truly deserve".

Q.42 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 7.

(a) reception **(b)** contribution
(c) confirmation **(d)** recognition

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) recognition
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
Deserving people "may not get fair **recognition**" = due acknowledgement.
("recognition" = पहचान/मान्यता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **reception / contribution / confirmation** – do not fit "fair ___".

Q.43 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 8.

(a) recover **(b)** encourage
(c) improve **(d)** reform

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) improve
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"those who need to **improve** may not get the right feedback."
("improve" = सुधार करना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **recover / encourage / reform** – do not fit "need to ___" here.

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Q.44 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 9.

(a) feedback **(b)** decision
(c) settlement **(d)** agreement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) feedback
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
Those who need to improve "may not get the right **feedback**" = guidance on performance.
("feedback" = प्रतिक्रिया।)
Why the others are wrong
• **decision / settlement / agreement** – do not fit "the right ___" for improvement.

Q.45 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 10.

(a) effectiveness **(b)** expense
(c) quantity **(d)** consequences

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) effectiveness
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"examinations help to assess the **effectiveness** of teaching" = how well teaching works.
("effectiveness" = प्रभावशीलता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **expense / quantity / consequences** – do not fit "assess the ___ of teaching".

Cloze Passage 6 (Q.46–Q.50)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

A raptor's day begins soon after dawn. They (1)_____ their wings for a quick warm-up and are ready for the hunt. Nature (2)_____ these birds so well that they do not need to hunt every day. By (3)_____ a good kill on a particular day, the larger raptor can go without hunting (4)_____ two or three weeks. These predators can do without regular meals. This helps them to (5)_____ if there is bad weather or lack of food.

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Q.46 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) flow **(b)** flee
(c) fling **(d)** flap

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) flap
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"They **flap** their wings for a quick warm-up" = move wings up and down.
("flap wings" = पंख फड़फड़ाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **flow / flee / fling** – do not fit "___ their wings".

Q.47 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) have built **(b)** have build
(c) has built **(d)** has build

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) has built
Type: Cloze – Subject-Verb Agreement (Present Perfect)
"Nature **has built** these birds so well" — "Nature" (singular) + present perfect "has built".
(एकवचन "Nature" + "has built"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **have built / have build / has build** – wrong number or wrong participle.

Q.48 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) having **(b)** making
(c) taking **(d)** doing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) making
Type: Cloze – Collocation (Gerund)
"By **making** a good kill on a particular day ..." — "make a kill" + gerund after "By".
("make a kill" = शिकार करना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **having / taking / doing** – "make a kill" is the correct collocation.

Q.49 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) since **(b)** from
(c) for **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) for
Type: Cloze – Preposition
"can go without hunting **for** two or three weeks" — "for" + a period.
("for + अवधि"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **since / from / in** – wrong preposition for a duration.

Q.50 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(a) saturate **(b)** survive
(c) satisfy **(d)** support

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) survive
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
Going without meals helps them to **survive** during bad weather or food shortage.
("survive" = जीवित रहना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **saturate / satisfy / support** – do not fit "helps them to ___ if there is bad weather".

Cloze Passage 7 (Q.51–Q.60)

In the given passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

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Passage (contd.)
Gabriella Montez was comfortably curled up in an overstuffed chair in the sitting area. She was (1) _____ the peace and quiet at home - everyone else was (2) _____ at the party - and had totally lost (3) _____ in a book which was the best she had (4) _____ read and she couldn't wait to get (5) _____the end.

However, before she set her eyes (6) _____ the next page, the book was (7) _____ right out of her hands, and she (8) _____ at her mother standing over her. "Gabby, it's New Year's Eve," she said. "(9) _____ reading!" she snapped at her daughter.

"But, mum, I'm almost done," Gabriella (10) _____.

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Q.51 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1

(a) living **(b)** enjoying
(c) relaxing **(d)** calming

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) enjoying
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"She was **enjoying** the peace and quiet at home" = taking pleasure in it.
("enjoying" = आनंद लेते हुए।)
Why the others are wrong
• **living / relaxing / calming** – do not fit "___ the peace and quiet".

Q.52 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2

(a) earlier **(b)** before
(c) already **(d)** once

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) already
Type: Cloze – Adverb
"everyone else was **already** at the party" = had gone there before.
("already" = पहले से ही।)
Why the others are wrong
• **earlier / before / once** – do not fit "was ___ at the party" as naturally.

Q.53 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3

(a) itself **(b)** himself
(c) ourself **(d)** herself

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) herself
Type: Cloze – Reflexive Pronoun
"lost **herself** in a book" — Gabriella (female) → reflexive "herself".
("lose oneself in" = ... में खो जाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **itself / himself / ourself** – wrong gender/number for Gabriella.

Q.54 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4

(a) even **(b)** never
(c) ever **(d)** always

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) ever
Type: Cloze – Adverb (with Superlative)
"the best she had **ever** read" — "ever" emphasises the superlative "best".
("ever" = अब तक।)
Why the others are wrong
• **even / never / always** – do not fit "the best she had ___ read".

Q.55 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5

(a) to **(b)** on
(c) in **(d)** up

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) to
Type: Cloze – Preposition
"couldn't wait to get **to** the end" — "get to" = reach.
("get to" = ... तक पहुँचना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **on / in / up** – wrong preposition for "get ___ the end".

Q.56 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.6

(a) upon **(b)** along
(c) below **(d)** above

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) upon
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"set her eyes **upon** the next page" = look at it.
("set eyes upon" = नज़र डालना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **along / below / above** – do not collocate with "set her eyes ___".

Q.57 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.7

(a) lifted **(b)** climbed
(c) raised **(d)** boosted

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) lifted
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"the book was **lifted** right out of her hands" = taken/picked up.
("lifted" = उठा लिया गया।)
Why the others are wrong
• **climbed / raised / boosted** – do not fit "the book was ___ out of her hands".

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Q.58 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.8

(a) wondered **(b)** watched
(c) stared **(d)** noticed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) stared
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"she **stared** at her mother standing over her" = looked fixedly.
("stared" = घूरना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **wondered / watched / noticed** – "stared at" fits the sudden, fixed look.

Q.59 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.9

(a) Abundant **(b)** Adequate
(c) Enough **(d)** Sufficient

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Enough
Type: Cloze – Context
The mother snaps "**Enough** reading!" = stop reading.
("Enough reading!" = बहुत हुआ पढ़ना!)
Why the others are wrong
• **Abundant / Adequate / Sufficient** – do not work as an exclamation of "stop".

Q.60 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.10

(a) prevented **(b)** prescribed
(c) protested **(d)** prohibited

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) protested
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"'But, mum, I'm almost done,' Gabriella **protested**" = objected/complained.
("protested" = विरोध जताया।)
Why the others are wrong
• **prevented / prescribed / prohibited** – do not fit a reported objection.

Cloze Passage 8 (Q.61–Q.65)

In the given passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Ragi is a popular annual plant that is (1) _____ with healthy nutrients. It is a good (2) _____ of iron, protein, calcium and (3) _____ minerals. It is also rich in fibre and (4) _____ in weight loss as it contains (5) _____ saturated fats.

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Q.61 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1

(a) supplied **(b)** complete
(c) full **(d)** loaded

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) loaded
Type: Cloze – Collocation

Explanation (contd.)
"a plant that is **loaded** with healthy nutrients" = full of.
("loaded with" = भरपूर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **supplied / complete / full** – "loaded with nutrients" is the natural phrase.

Q.62 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2

(a) cause **(b)** source
(c) origin **(d)** spring

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) source
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"a good **source** of iron, protein, calcium" = supplier.
("a good source of" = ... का अच्छा स्रोत।)
Why the others are wrong
• **cause / origin / spring** – do not collocate with "a good ___ of iron".

Q.63 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3

(a) another **(b)** further
(c) other **(d)** else

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) other
Type: Cloze – Determiner
"calcium and **other** minerals" = additional minerals.
("other minerals" = अन्य खनिज।)
Why the others are wrong
• **another** (singular) / **further / else** – do not fit "and ___ minerals (plural)".

Q.64 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4

(a) benefit **(b)** help
(c) services **(d)** aids

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) aids
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"**aids** in weight loss" = helps in.
("aids in" = ... में मदद करता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **benefit / help / services** – "aids in weight loss" is the correct collocation; "help" would need "helps".

Q.65 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5

(a) negligible **(b)** communicable
(c) applicable **(d)** negotiable

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) negligible
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"it contains **negligible** saturated fats" = very little, insignificant.
("negligible" = नगण्य।)
Why the others are wrong
• **communicable / applicable / negotiable** – do not fit "___ saturated fats".

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Cloze Passage 9 (Q.66–Q.75)

In the given passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

The word 'diet' is associated with the feeling of developing eating (1) _____ that are time-bound, coupled (2) _____ a strict food plan. But the (3) _____ meaning of diet is the food (4) _____ which a person follows daily. It (5) _____ creating a food plan that (6) _____ around your lifestyle, your work, (7) _____ quality of your sleep, your (8) _____ level, the kind of (9) _____ you do, your palate and your (10) _____.

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Q.66 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1

(a) manners **(b)** habits
(c) customs **(d)** natures

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) habits
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"developing eating **habits**" = regular patterns of eating.
("eating habits" = खान-पान की आदतें।)
Why the others are wrong
• **manners / customs / natures** – do not collocate with "eating".

Q.67 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2

(a) for **(b)** with
(c) on **(d)** from

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) with
Type: Cloze – Preposition
"coupled **with** a strict food plan" — "coupled with" = combined with.
("coupled with" = ... के साथ जुड़ा।)
Why the others are wrong
• **for / on / from** – wrong preposition after "coupled".

Q.68 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3

(a) total **(b)** confident
(c) positive **(d)** actual

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) actual
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"the **actual** meaning of diet" = the real/true meaning.
("actual" = वास्तविक।)
Why the others are wrong
• **total / confident / positive** – do not fit "the ___ meaning".

Q.69 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4

(a) sequence **(b)** procedure
(c) activity **(d)** routine

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) routine
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary

Explanation (contd.)
"the food **routine** which a person follows daily" = daily pattern.
("routine" = दिनचर्या।)
Why the others are wrong
• **sequence / procedure / activity** – do not fit "food ___ ... daily".

Q.70 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5

(a) associates **(b)** proves
(c) involves **(d)** desires

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) involves
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"It **involves** creating a food plan" = includes.
("involves" = शामिल करता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **associates / proves / desires** – do not fit "It ___ creating a food plan".

Q.71 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.6

(a) orbits **(b)** orders
(c) resolves **(d)** revolves

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) revolves
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"a food plan that **revolves** around your lifestyle" = centres on.
("revolve around" = ... के इर्द-गिर्द घूमना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **orbits / orders / resolves** – "revolve around" is the correct phrase.

Q.72 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.7

(a) only **(b)** a
(c) one **(d)** the

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2019 | 18 Nov

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the
Type: Cloze – Article
"**the** quality of your sleep" — a specific quality → "the".
("the" = निश्चित।)
Why the others are wrong
• **only / a / one** – do not fit "___ quality of your sleep".

Q.73 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.8

(a) capacity **(b)** authority
(c) force **(d)** stress

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) stress
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"your **stress** level" = the amount of stress.
("stress level" = तनाव का स्तर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **capacity / authority / force** – do not collocate with "level" in this context.

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Q.74 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.9

(a) exercise **(b)** effort
(c) lesson **(d)** fitness

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) exercise
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"the kind of **exercise** you do" = physical activity. ("exercise" = व्यायाम।)
Why the others are wrong
• **effort / lesson / fitness** – do not fit "the kind of ___ you do".

Q.75 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.10

(a) person **(b)** impersonation
(c) personal **(d)** personality

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) personality
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"your palate and your **personality**" = your individual nature. ("personality" = व्यक्तित्व।)
Why the others are wrong
• **person / impersonation / personal** – wrong forms/meaning.

Cloze Passage 10 (Q.76–Q.85)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

In ancient times, Hieun Tsang, a Chinese traveller came to India during the (1)_____ of King Harsha. He praised the Indians (2)_____ 'people with pure moral principles'. In 2014, India (3)_____ 85th in the corruption perception index of the Transparency International. What (4)_____ downfall! Isn't it ironical that we Indians (5)_____ by the ideals of honesty and integrity, self-denial and (6)_____ but in practice willingly resort to the (7) _____ forms of corruption to promote our interests? The (8)_____ of corruption is eating into the (9) _____ of our society and we have become helpless (10)_____ of our own degradation.

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Q.76 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.1.

(a) authority **(b)** vigour
(c) command **(d)** reign

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) reign
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Rule: "during the **reign** of King Harsha" = during his rule (शासनकाल).
Why the others are wrong
• **Authority / command** – power, not a period; **vigour** – energy.

Q.77 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.2.

(a) such **(b)** by
(c) like **(d)** as

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) as
Type: Cloze – Preposition
Rule: "praised the Indians **as** 'people with pure moral principles'" — "as" introduces the description.
Why the others are wrong
• **such / by / like** – do not fit "praised ... ___ people with...".

Q.78 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.3.

(a) ranked **(b)** piled
(c) graded **(d)** stacked

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ranked
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: "India **ranked** 85th in the ... index" = held the 85th position.
Why the others are wrong
• **Piled / graded / stacked** – do not go with an index position.

Q.79 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.4.

(a) any **(b)** some
(c) the **(d)** a

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) a
Type: Cloze – Article
Rule: Exclamation "What **a** downfall!" — singular countable noun needs "a".
Why the others are wrong
• **any / some / the** – wrong in the exclamatory "What a ___!" pattern.

Q.80 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.5.

(a) declare **(b)** affirm
(c) assert **(d)** swear

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) swear
Type: Cloze – Collocation
Rule: "**swear by** the ideals" = firmly believe in / rely on (idiom). Fits "swear by honesty and integrity".
Why the others are wrong
• **declare / affirm / assert** – do not take "by" in this idiomatic sense.

Q.81 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.6.

(a) prejudice **(b)** sacrifice
(c) erosion **(d)** omission

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) sacrifice
Type: Cloze – Word Choice

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Explanation (contd.)
Context: ideals of "self-denial and **sacrifice**" — both go together.
Why the others are wrong
• **Prejudice / erosion / omission** – negative, not ideals.

Q.82 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.7.

(a) more vile **(b)** vile
(c) vilest **(d)** viler

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) vilest
Type: Cloze – Degree of Adjective
Rule: "the ___ forms of corruption" — "the" + superlative → "**vilest**" (most wicked).
Why the others are wrong
• **more vile / viler** – comparative; **vile** – positive degree; "the" needs superlative.

Q.83 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.8.

(a) melancholy **(b)** malaise
(c) deficiency **(d)** despair

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) malaise
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Malaise = a general feeling of unease/sickness in society (बेचैनी/रोग). "The **malaise** of corruption".
Why the others are wrong
• **Melancholy / despair** – sadness; **deficiency** – shortage.

Q.84 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.9.

(a) necessity **(b)** threats
(c) vitals **(d)** imperative

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) vitals
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: "eating into the **vitals** of our society" = into its most essential parts (idiom).
Why the others are wrong
• **Necessity / threats / imperative** – do not fit "eating into the ___".

Q.85 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.10.

(a) performers **(b)** sorcerers
(c) onlookers **(d)** visionaries

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) onlookers
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: "helpless **onlookers** of our own degradation" = we merely watch, unable to act.
Why the others are wrong
• **Performers / sorcerers / visionaries** – do not fit "helpless ___".

Cloze Passage 11 (Q.86–Q.95)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The child is the father of man. Childhood is a (1)_____ of what one is going to be when one (2)_____ maturity. The natural instincts of a man are (3)_____ in his childhood. Time modifies them but cannot (4)_____ them. History contains numerous examples of great men who gave (5)_____ of their future when they were children. A child's mind is (6)_____ and flexible. The mould he receives before his clay (7)_____ becomes his permanent mark. The values and standards of (8)_____ which will determine his life as a man (9)_____ in childhood itself. There may be certain (10)_____ of course. A bright morning may end in a storm!

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Q.86 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.1.

(a) contract **(b)** promise
(c) plight **(d)** bond

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) promise
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: Childhood is a **promise** of what one will become — it hints at / assures the future.
Why the others are wrong
• **Contract / bond** – legal/formal agreements, wrong tone; **Plight** – a bad situation (negative).

Q.87 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.2.

(a) attains **(b)** secures
(c) scores **(d)** completes

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) attains
Type: Cloze – Collocation
Rule: We say "**attain maturity**" = reach maturity.
Why the others are wrong
• **Secures / scores / completes** – do not collocate with "maturity".

Q.88 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.3.

(a) disposed **(b)** determined
(c) contributed **(d)** distributed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) determined
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: Natural instincts are **determined** (fixed/shaped) in childhood.
Why the others are wrong
• **Disposed** – arranged/inclined; **contributed / distributed** – wrong meaning.

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Q.89 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.4.

(a) finish **(b)** delete
(c) cancel **(d)** efface

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) efface
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Efface = to wipe out / erase completely (मिटा देना). Time modifies instincts but cannot **efface** them.
Why the others are wrong
• **Finish / delete / cancel** – weaker or wrong register for "wipe out instincts".

Q.90 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.5.

(a) estimations **(b)** suggestions
(c) indications **(d)** preparations

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) indications
Type: Cloze – Collocation
Rule: "gave **indications** of their future" = showed signs of.
Why the others are wrong
• **Estimations / suggestions / preparations** – do not fit "gave ___ of their future".

Q.91 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.6.

(a) sensible **(b)** impressionable
(c) obstinate **(d)** rigid

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) impressionable
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Impressionable = easily influenced/shaped (like soft clay). Fits "and flexible".
Why the others are wrong
• **Sensible** – wise; **obstinate / rigid** – opposite of "flexible".

Q.92 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.7.

(a) precipitates **(b)** refines
(c) contracts **(d)** hardens

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) hardens
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: the clay **hardens** — a mould set before the clay hardens becomes permanent.
Why the others are wrong
• **Precipitates / refines / contracts** – do not describe clay setting firm.

Q.93 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.8.

(a) manipulation **(b)** conduct
(c) attitude **(d)** tactics

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) conduct
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: "values and standards of **conduct**" = of behaviour.
Why the others are wrong

Explanation (contd.)
• **Manipulation / tactics** – negative; **attitude** – less apt with "values and standards".

Q.94 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.9.

(a) is developing **(b)** has developed
(c) develops **(d)** are developed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) are developed
Type: Cloze – Voice/Agreement
Rule: "values and standards ... **are developed** in childhood" — plural subject + passive.
Why the others are wrong
• **is developing / has developed** – singular; **develops** – singular.

Q.95 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.10.

(a) exceptions **(b)** rejections
(c) concessions **(d)** exemptions

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) exceptions
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: "There may be certain **exceptions**" — the next line ("A bright morning may end in a storm") shows an exception.
Why the others are wrong
• **Rejections / concessions / exemptions** – do not fit the "but sometimes it differs" idea.

Cloze Passage 12 (Q.96–Q.100)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

Nature has been suffering mutely for hundreds of years but the problem did not (1)_____ serious proportions so long as the damage was (2)_____ and not beyond self-repair. These limits were crossed with (3)_____ technological breakthroughs accomplished during the recent years. The developed nations (4)_____ benefitted most from these were the first to (5)_____ the environmental diseases bred by advanced technology.

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Q.96 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.1.

(a) receive **(b)** grasp
(c) become **(d)** assume

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) assume
Type: Cloze – Collocation
Rule: "**assume serious proportions**" = become serious (idiom).
Why the others are wrong
• **Receive / grasp / become** – do not collocate with "proportions".

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Q.97 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.2.

(a) countable **(b)** attainable
(c) containable **(d)** credible

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) containable
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: The damage was **containable** (could be controlled) "and not beyond self-repair".
Why the others are wrong
• **Countable / attainable / credible** – wrong meaning here.

Q.98 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.3.

(a) habitual **(b)** commonplace
(c) spectacular **(d)** paltry

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) spectacular
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: limits were crossed with **spectacular** technological breakthroughs = remarkable/dramatic ones.
Why the others are wrong
• **Habitual / commonplace / paltry** – weak or opposite in force.

Q.99 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.4.

(a) whom **(b)** who
(c) whose **(d)** which

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) which
Type: Cloze – Relative Pronoun
Rule: For "developed nations" (things/collective), use "**which** benefitted most".
Why the others are wrong
• **whom / who / whose** – "who/whom/whose" are for people; "which" fits "nations" here.

Q.100 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no.5.

(a) interact **(b)** derive
(c) undergo **(d)** encounter

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) encounter
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
Context: first to **encounter** (meet/face) the environmental diseases bred by technology.
Why the others are wrong
• **Interact / derive / undergo** – do not fit "first to ___ the diseases".

Cloze Passage 13 (Q.101–Q.110)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the options given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Passage (contd.)

Castles are home to a rich history. From blood feuds to tragic pasts, (1)_____ love affairs to alleged ghosts, no castle is ever (2)_____ a secret to unveil. Known locally as Chateaux Picomtal, Picomtal Castle (3)_____ came under new ownership. During renovation of the(4)_____, a surprising discovery was made. Messages (5)_____long ago were found on the floorboards of (6)_____ upper chambers.

The messages were written (7)_____1880 and 1881 by Joachim Martin; the carpenter (8)_____ installed the flooring. His messages were a diary of 72 entries of his daily (9)_____, personal thoughts along with his emotions and feelings.

Joachim's (10)_____is indeed a very personal account of the history of those times. The discovery gives us an honest look at an average person's daily life over 135 years ago.

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Q.101 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(a) since **(b)** from
(c) with **(d)** till

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) from
Type: Cloze – Preposition (parallel "from ... to")
The pattern is "from X to Y, **from** blood feuds to tragic pasts, **from** love affairs to alleged ghosts".
("from ... to ..." संरचना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **since / with / till** – break the parallel "from ... to" structure.

Q.102 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(a) without **(b)** excluding
(c) with **(d)** including

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) without
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
"no castle is ever **without** a secret to unveil" = every castle has a secret.
("without" = ... के बिना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **excluding / with / including** – do not fit "no castle is ever ___ a secret".

Q.103 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3

(a) momentarily **(b)** recently
(c) presently **(d)** justly

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) recently
Type: Cloze – Adverb
"Picomtal Castle **recently** came under new ownership" = a short time ago.
("recently" = हाल ही में।)
Why the others are wrong
• **momentarily / presently / justly** – do not fit "___ came under new ownership".

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Q.104 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(a) land **(b)** commodity
(c) property **(d)** possessions

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) property
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"During renovation of the **property**" = the building/estate.
("property" = संपत्ति/भवन।)
Why the others are wrong
• **land / commodity / possessions** – "property" fits the castle being renovated.

Q.105 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(a) writing **(b)** written
(c) to write **(d)** wrote

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) written
Type: Cloze – Past Participle
"Messages **written** long ago were found" — past participle describing the messages.
("written long ago" = बहुत पहले लिखे गए।)
Why the others are wrong
• **writing / to write / wrote** – wrong forms to describe "messages ___ long ago".

Q.106 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 6.

(a) this **(b)** an
(c) a **(d)** the

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the
Type: Cloze – Article
"on the floorboards of **the** upper chambers" — a specific part of the castle → "the".
("the" = निश्चित।)
Why the others are wrong
• **this / an / a** – "the upper chambers" (specific, plural) needs "the".

Q.107 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 7.

(a) from **(b)** across
(c) between **(d)** among

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) between
Type: Cloze – Preposition
"written **between** 1880 and 1881" — "between X and Y".
("between ... and ..." संरचना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **from / across / among** – "between 1880 and 1881" is the correct pairing.

Q.108 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 8.

(a) that **(b)** what
(c) who **(d)** which

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) who
Type: Cloze – Relative Pronoun (Person)
"the carpenter **who** installed the flooring" — "who" for a person.
(व्यक्ति के लिए "who"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **that / what / which** – "who" is best for the person "carpenter" as subject.

Q.109 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 9.

(a) life **(b)** being
(c) breath **(d)** time

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) life
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"a diary of 72 entries of his daily **life**" = everyday living.
("daily life" = दैनिक जीवन।)
Why the others are wrong
• **being / breath / time** – "daily life" is the natural phrase.

Q.110 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 10.

(a) notebook **(b)** message
(c) copy **(d)** diary

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) diary
Type: Cloze – Context
"Joachim's **diary** is indeed a very personal account" — the messages formed a diary.
("diary" = डायरी।)
Why the others are wrong
• **notebook / message / copy** – the passage explicitly called it "a diary of 72 entries".

Cloze Passage 14 (Q.111–Q.120)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the options given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

The air has become very dirty in (1)_____ parts of the world. This is of course (2)_____ to your health. Experts say many people die (3)_____ it each year.There is a new study on (4)_____ pollution which comes from the experts of the World Health Organization (WHO)(5)_____ is an agency of the United Nations.If you (6)_____ unhealthy air for long periods of time, you could (7)_____ sick. Air pollution has been linked to many diseases (8)_____ stroke and cancer. The WHO says that seven million (9)_____ die each year as a result of the (10)_____ air.

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Q.111 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(a) much **(b)** every
(c) many **(d)** any

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) many
Type: Cloze – Determiner
"dirty in **many** parts of the world" = a large number of places (countable "parts").
(गिनने योग्य "parts" के साथ "many"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **much** (uncountable), **every / any** – do not fit "___ parts of the world".

Q.112 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(a) harmful **(b)** wasteful
(c) useful **(d)** helpful

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) harmful
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"This is of course **harmful** to your health" = bad for you.
("harmful to health" = स्वास्थ्य के लिए हानिकारक।)
Why the others are wrong
• **wasteful / useful / helpful** – "helpful/useful" are opposite; only "harmful" fits.

Q.113 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3

(a) from **(b)** with
(c) by **(d)** through

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) from
Type: Cloze – Preposition
"many people die **from** it each year" — "die from" a cause.
("die from" = ... से मरना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **with / by / through** – "die from (a cause)" is the standard phrase.

Q.114 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(a) noise **(b)** land
(c) water **(d)** air

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) air
Type: Cloze – Context
"a new study on **air** pollution" — the passage is about air pollution.
("air pollution" = वायु प्रदूषण।)
Why the others are wrong
• **noise / land / water** – the topic is air pollution.

Q.115 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(a) what **(b)** who
(c) whom **(d)** which

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) which
Type: Cloze – Relative Pronoun
"the WHO **which** is an agency of the United Nations" — "which" refers to the organisation.
(संस्था के लिए "which"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **what / who / whom** – "who/whom" are for people; "which" fits the organisation.

Q.116 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 6.

(a) inhale **(b)** gulp
(c) gasp **(d)** draw

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) inhale
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"If you **inhale** unhealthy air" = breathe it in.
("inhale" = साँस के साथ अंदर लेना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **gulp / gasp / draw** – "inhale air" is the precise word.

Q.117 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 7.

(a) become **(b)** became
(c) becomes **(d)** becoming

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) become
Type: Cloze – Verb Form
"you could **become** sick" — "could + base verb".
("could" के बाद base verb (become)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **became / becomes / becoming** – wrong forms after "could".

Q.118 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 8.

(a) same **(b)** like
(c) similar **(d)** such

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) like
Type: Cloze – Preposition
"many diseases **like** stroke and cancer" = such as.
("like" = जैसे।)
Why the others are wrong
• **same / similar / such** – "diseases like stroke and cancer" is natural; "such" would need "as".

Q.119 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 9.

(a) human **(b)** person
(c) people **(d)** individual

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) people
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary

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Explanation (contd.)
"seven million **people** die each year" — the plural noun for humans.
("people" = लोग।)
Why the others are wrong
• **human / person / individual** – singular forms; "seven million people" is correct.

Q.120 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 10.

(a) grubby **(b)** polluted
(c) grimy **(d)** muddy

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) polluted
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"as a result of the **polluted** air" — dirty, contaminated air.
("polluted" = प्रदूषित।)
Why the others are wrong
• **grubby / grimy / muddy** – used for dirty surfaces/objects, not "polluted air".

Cloze Passage 15 (Q.121–Q.125)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the options given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

A new swarm of locusts entered Rajasthan's Jaisalmer on Sunday. This is the fifth swarm to (1)_____ the state in four days from (2)_____ western border with Pakistan.

Since the first locust swarm (3)_____ the state's Sri Ganganagar district on April 11, as many as 25 swarms (4)_____ entered Rajasthan.

Some swarms moved to Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh,(5)_____ which agricultural departments issued advisories to farmers asking them to be on high alert.

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Q.121 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(a) insert **(b)** come
(c) enter **(d)** introduce

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) enter
Type: Cloze – Verb
"the fifth swarm to **enter** the state" — swarms enter (come into) the state.
("enter the state" = राज्य में प्रवेश करना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **insert / come / introduce** – "enter the state" (transitive, no preposition) is correct.

Q.122 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(a) its **(b)** it
(c) their **(d)** his

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) its
Type: Cloze – Possessive Pronoun
"from **its** western border with Pakistan" — the state's border → "its".

Explanation (contd.)
("its" = इसका (राज्य का)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **it / their / his** – "its" (for the state, singular) is correct.

Q.123 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(a) invaded **(b)** was invading
(c) invade **(d)** isinvading

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) invaded
Type: Cloze – Tense
"Since the first locust swarm **invaded** the state's Sri Ganganagar district on April 11" — a completed past action.
(भूतकाल "invaded"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **was invading / invade / is invading** – wrong tense for "on April 11".

Q.124 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(a) has **(b)** to have
(c) have **(d)** having

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) have
Type: Cloze – Present Perfect
"as many as 25 swarms **have** entered Rajasthan" — "have + V3 (entered)".
(present perfect: have + V3।)
Why the others are wrong
• **has** (needs plural "have" for "25 swarms"), **to have / having** – wrong forms.

Q.125 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(a) before **(b)** until
(c) after **(d)** since

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) after
Type: Cloze – Conjunction
"Some swarms moved to Chhattisgarh and Madhya Pradesh, **after** which agricultural departments issued advisories."
("after which" = जिसके बाद।)
Why the others are wrong
• **before / until / since** – "after which" fits the sequence of events.

Cloze Passage 16 (Q.126–Q.135)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

The working of the stomach was 1._____ by a strange accident. In 1822, a man named Alexis St. Martin was 2. _____ hit by a shot gun. The bullet had seriously 3. _____ the chest wall and made a hole in 4. _____ stomach. He was brought to an American army 5. _____ William Beaumont.

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Passage (contd.)
The doctor saved the patient but he 6. _____ not close the hole properly. Beaumont took it as a 7_____ opportunity to see the inside of the stomach 8. _____ the hole. He made some wonderful observations. Beaumont 9. _____ that the stomach was churning food. Its wall secreted a fluid 10. _____ could digest the food. He also observed that the end of the stomach opens into the intestine only after the digestion of the food inside the stomach is completed.
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Q.126 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 1.
(a) discovering **(b)** to be discovered
(c) discover **(d)** discovered
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) discovered
Type: Cloze – Passive Verb Form
"The working of the stomach **was discovered** by a strange accident" — passive "was + V3".
(passive: was + V3 (discovered)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **discovering / to be discovered / discover** – wrong forms after "was".

Q.127 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 2.
(a) Poorly **(b)** Extremely
(c) Nicely **(d)** Badly
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Badly
Type: Cloze – Adverb
"was **badly** hit by a shotgun" = seriously injured.
("badly hit" = बुरी तरह घायल।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Poorly / Extremely / Nicely** – do not fit "___ hit by a shotgun" naturally.

Q.128 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 3.
(a) Devastated **(b)** Damaged
(c) Decayed **(d)** Decreased
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Damaged
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"The bullet had seriously **damaged** the chest wall" = harmed.
("damaged" = क्षति पहुँचाई।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Devastated** (too strong for a chest wall), **Decayed / Decreased** – wrong sense.

Q.129 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 4.
(a) Him **(b)** Her
(c) Its **(d)** His
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) His
Type: Cloze – Possessive Pronoun
"made a hole in **his** stomach" — Alexis St. Martin (male) → "his".
(पुरुष के लिए "his"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Him / Her / Its** – wrong case/gender.

Q.130 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 5.
(a) Registrar **(b)** Doctor
(c) Colonel **(d)** Major
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Doctor
Type: Cloze – Context
"brought to an American army **doctor**, William Beaumont" — Beaumont is described as a doctor who saved the patient.
("doctor" = चिकित्सक।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Registrar / Colonel / Major** – he is referred to throughout as "the doctor".

Q.131 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 6.
(a) Should **(b)** Could
(c) Would **(d)** Had
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Could
Type: Cloze – Modal
"he **could** not close the hole properly" = was not able to.
("could not" = नहीं कर सका।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Should / Would / Had** – do not fit "he ___ not close the hole".

Q.132 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 7.
(a) Countless **(b)** Great
(c) Fast **(d)** Strong
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Great
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"took it as a **great** opportunity" = an excellent chance.
("a great opportunity" = एक बड़ा अवसर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Countless / Fast / Strong** – do not collocate with "opportunity".

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Q.133 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 8.

(a) Between **(b)** Along
(c) Across **(d)** Through

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Through
Type: Cloze – Preposition
"see the inside of the stomach **through** the hole" = via the opening.
("through the hole" = छेद के ज़रिए।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Between / Along / Across** – wrong preposition for looking "through" an opening.

Q.134 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 9.

(a) Imagined **(b)** Acquired
(c) Found **(d)** Obtained

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Found
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"Beaumont **found** that the stomach was churning food" = observed/discovered.
("found" = पाया।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Imagined / Acquired / Obtained** – do not fit "___ that the stomach was churning".

Q.135 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 10.

(a) What **(b)** Whom
(c) Which **(d)** Who

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Which
Type: Cloze – Relative Pronoun
"a fluid **which** could digest the food" — "which" refers to the thing "fluid".
(निर्जीव "fluid" के लिए "which"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **What / Whom / Who** – "who/whom" are for people; "what" is not used after a noun.

Cloze Passage 17 (Q.136–Q.145)

In the given passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Passage (contd.)

In August every year, thousands of twins descend on a town in Ohio called Twinsburg, named by identical twin brothers 1._____two centuries ago. The Twins Days Festival is a three-day 2._____consisting of talent shows and look-alike 3._____that has become one of the world's 4._____ gatherings of twins. There have been 5._____ festivals in Nigeria, a country where 1 in 22 births to the Yoruba people 6._____twins, identical or fraternal, which is a much higher 7._____than anywhere else in the world. This has been 8._____to the eating of yams, but the theory is 9._____. Biomedical researchers attend these events, regarding them as a 10._____ opportunity to conduct surveys and experiments.

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Q.136 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1

(a) fairly **(b)** nearly
(c) quite **(d)** usually

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) nearly
Type: Cloze – Adverb
"named ... **nearly** two centuries ago" = almost two centuries ago.
("nearly" = लगभग।)
Why the others are wrong
• **fairly / quite / usually** – do not fit "___ two centuries ago".

Q.137 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2

(a) process **(b)** act
(c) matter **(d)** event

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) event
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"a three-day **event** consisting of talent shows" = an organised occasion.
("event" = आयोजन।)
Why the others are wrong
• **process / act / matter** – do not fit "a three-day ___".

Q.138 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3

(a) incidents **(b)** episodes
(c) contests **(d)** functions

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) contests
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"look-alike **contests**" = competitions to find the most similar-looking pairs.
("contests" = प्रतियोगिताएँ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **incidents / episodes / functions** – do not fit "look-alike ___".

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Q.139 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4

(a) largest **(b)** heaviest
(c) tallest **(d)** smallest

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) largest
Type: Cloze – Superlative
"one of the world's **largest** gatherings of twins" = biggest in number.
("largest gathering" = सबसे बड़ा जमावड़ा।)
Why the others are wrong
• **heaviest / tallest / smallest** – wrong sense for a "gathering".

Q.140 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5

(a) common **(b)** alike
(c) mutual **(d)** similar

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) similar
Type: Cloze – Word Choice
"There have been **similar** festivals in Nigeria" = festivals of the same kind.
("similar" = समान।)
Why the others are wrong
• **common / alike / mutual** – do not fit "___ festivals" as an adjective before the noun.

Q.141 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.6

(a) presents **(b)** produces
(c) provides **(d)** prepares

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) produces
Type: Cloze – Verb
"1 in 22 births to the Yoruba people **produces** twins" = results in twins.
("produces twins" = जुड़वाँ पैदा करता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **presents / provides / prepares** – do not fit "births ___ twins".

Q.142 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.7

(a) urgency **(b)** incidence
(c) deliverance **(d)** frequency

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) incidence
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"a much higher **frequency** than anywhere else" = rate of occurrence.
("frequency" = आवृत्ति/दर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **urgency / incidence / deliverance** – "frequency" (how often) fits best for twin births.

Q.143 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.8

(a) attributed **(b)** dedicated
(c) indicated **(d)** distributed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) attributed
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"This has been **attributed** to the eating of yams" = explained as caused by.
("attributed to" = ... को जिम्मेदार ठहराया गया।)
Why the others are wrong
• **dedicated / indicated / distributed** – do not collocate with "___ to the eating of yams".

Q.144 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.9

(a) accepted **(b)** suspected
(c) disputed **(d)** projected

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) disputed
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"but the theory is **disputed**" = not fully accepted; debated.
("disputed" = विवादित।)
Why the others are wrong
• **accepted** – opposite; **suspected / projected** – wrong sense for "the theory is ___".

Q.145 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.10

(a) dubious **(b)** pompous
(c) routine **(d)** precious

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) precious
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"regarding them as a **precious** opportunity" = a very valuable chance.
("precious" = बहुमूल्य।)
Why the others are wrong
• **dubious** (doubtful), **pompous** (self-important), **routine** (ordinary) – wrong for a "valuable" opportunity.

Cloze Passage 18 (Q.146–Q.150)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Human activities are changing Earth's natural greenhouse1. _____. Burning fossil fuels like coal and oil puts 2. _____ carbon dioxide into our atmosphere. NASA has 3. _____ increase in the amount of carbon dioxide and some other greenhouse gases in 4. _____ atmosphere. Too much of these greenhouse gases can 5. _____ Earth's atmosphere to trap more and more heat. This causes Earth to warm up.

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Q.146 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 1.

(a) Aspect **(b)** Effect
(c) Affect **(d)** Impact

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Effect
Type: Cloze – Word Choice (effect vs affect)
"Earth's natural greenhouse **effect**" — "effect" (noun) = result. (Fixed term: "greenhouse effect".)
("effect" = प्रभाव (संज्ञा); "affect" = क्रिया।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Aspect / Affect / Impact** – "greenhouse effect" is the standard term.

Q.147 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 2.

(a) Much **(b)** Many
(c) Most **(d)** More

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) More
Type: Cloze – Comparative
"puts **more** carbon dioxide into our atmosphere" = extra amounts.
("more" = अधिक।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Much** (needs "so much/too much"), **Many** (for countables), **Most** – "more" fits best.

Q.148 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 3.

(a) Observing **(b)** Observe
(c) to observe **(d)** Observed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Observed
Type: Cloze – Verb Form (Present Perfect)
"NASA has **observed** increase in the amount ..." — "has + V3 (observed)".
("has observed" = देखा है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Observing / Observe / to observe** – wrong forms after "has".

Q.149 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 4.

(a) its **(b)** our
(c) ours **(d)** their

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) our
Type: Cloze – Possessive Pronoun
"in **its** atmosphere" — referring to the Earth's atmosphere.
("its" = इसका (Earth का)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **our / ours / their** – "its" (for the Earth) is correct here.

Q.150 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 5.

(a) source **(b)** reason
(c) cause **(d)** effect

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) cause
Type: Cloze – Verb
"can **cause** Earth's atmosphere to trap more heat" = make it happen.
("cause ... to" = ... का कारण बनना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **source / reason** (nouns), **effect** (a result) – a verb "cause" is needed here.

Cloze Passage 19 (Q.151–Q.155)

In the given passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Over the past year, Dr Hemmings has been conducting research on the big cat phenomenon and has already 1._____the remains of some wild animals that may have been eaten by 2._____ far larger than any of the country's known carnivores. The project has 3._____an analysis of twenty skeletal animal remains 4._____ from across Gloucestershire and other nearby counties. The bones were selected because the 5._____of their death led people to believe that these animals may have been killed by a big cat.

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Q.151 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1

(a) invented **(b)** decided
(c) settled **(d)** identified

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) identified
Type: Cloze – Verb (Present Perfect)
"has already **identified** the remains of some wild animals" = recognised.
("identified" = पहचाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **invented / decided / settled** – do not fit "identified the remains".

Q.152 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2

(a) creatures **(b)** mortals
(c) individuals **(d)** people

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) creatures
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"eaten by **creatures** far larger than any known carnivore" = animals/beasts.
("creatures" = जीव/प्राणी।)
Why the others are wrong
• **mortals / individuals / people** – used for humans, not wild animals.

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Q.153 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3

(a) connected **(b)** involved
(c) related **(d)** concerned

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) involved
Type: Cloze – Collocation
"The project has **involved** an analysis of twenty ... remains" = included.
("involved" = शामिल किया।)
Why the others are wrong
• **connected / related / concerned** – need prepositions ("connected with"); "involved" fits directly.

Q.154 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4

(a) recovered **(b)** revoked
(c) redeemed **(d)** reclaimed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) recovered
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"remains **recovered** from across Gloucestershire" = collected/found.
("recovered" = बरामद किए गए।)
Why the others are wrong
• **revoked / redeemed / reclaimed** – do not fit "remains ___ from".

Q.155 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5

(a) circumstances **(b)** affairs
(c) potential **(d)** opportunities

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) circumstances
Type: Cloze – Vocabulary
"the **circumstances** of their death led people to believe ..." = the conditions/facts around their death.
("circumstances" = परिस्थितियाँ।)
Why the others are wrong
• **affairs / potential / opportunities** – do not fit "the ___ of their death".

Cloze Passage 20 (Q.156–Q.159)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The Maasais live in (1)_____ very beautiful part of Africa. They live on the wide plains in southern and northern Kenya and northern Tanzania. The area (2)_____ of miles of rolling grass land, on which you can find thorny bushes and rocky hills. The people move from one place to another according to the seasons, looking for grasses and other plants (3)_____ which their cattle can graze. They have no permanent home. When they want to settle in a place for some time, they build a kind of camp called a 'Manyatta', where a few families live for a (4)_____ weeks or months. Then they move on again, taking their few belongings with them, and burning the old 'Manyatta' to the ground.

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Q.156 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) some **(b)** their
(c) that **(d)** a

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) a
'beautiful area' is for the first time introduced in the paragraph. So, the correct determiner here to use is the indefinite article 'a'.

Q.157 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) consists **(b)** considers
(c) measures **(d)** surrounds

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) consists
Consists – to be composed or made up of something.Surrounds – to encircle or enclose somethingMeasures – to determine the size, amount, or degree of somethingConsiders – to think about or take into account something

Q.158 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) with **(b)** by
(c) on **(d)** at

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) on
'on' is used to indicate the surface on which something grows or grazes.With – to indicate the means or instrument used to do something.At – to indicate a specific location or time.By – to indicate the agent or doer of an action.

Q.159 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) few **(b)** least
(c) significant **(d)** little

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) few
Few – to describe a small no or amount of something.Little – to describe a small amount of something non-countable.Least – to describe the smallest amount or degree of something.Significant – important or noteworthy.

Cloze Passage 21 (Q.160–Q.163)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

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Passage (contd.)
The effects of plastic bags on the environment are really (1)_____ devastating because there is no disposal method that will really help eliminate the problem. The biggest problem with them is that once they have been (2)_____, they end up In the trash, which then ends up in the landfill or is burned. The indefinite period of time that it takes for the average plastic bag to break (3)_____ can be literally hundreds of years. Throughout the world, plastic bags are responsible for suffocation and deaths of woodland animals as well as (4)_____ soil nutrients. The land litter that is made up of plastic bags has the potential to kill over and over again. It has been estimated that one bag has the potential to inadvertently kill one animal per every three months due to unintentional digestion or inhalation. There are always alternatives to plastic bags and the search for more alternatives continues.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Q.160 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) seldom **(b)** randomly
(c) quite **(d)** vaguely

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 3 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) quite
quite – used to emphasize.
Vaguely – in an uncertain and unclear way.
Randomly – without method or conscious decision.
Seldom – rarely or infrequently.
the most appropriate word to fill in the blank 1 is quite.
Here, it is used to emphasize the extent to which plastic is harmful to the environment.

Q.161 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) soiled **(b)** recycled
(c) moulded **(d)** disinfected

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) soiled
Soiled – to make something dirty.
Disinfected – to clean something to make it free from germs.
Moulded – to shape something by forming it into a particular shape or form.
Recycled – to convert waste into reusable material.
So, soiled is the correct choice.

Q.162 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) through **(b)** down
(c) even **(d)** out

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) down
The correct option is 'down'.
The phrase 'break down' means to decompose or disintegrate.
option (a) – through – break through means to overcame an obstacle, which is out of context.

Explanation (contd.)
option (d) – out – break out means to escape or to become free from a confinement or control.
option (c) – even – is not suitable as it does not make any sense in the given sentence

Q.163 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) converting **(b)** demanding
(c) accumulating **(d)** inhibiting

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) inhibiting
Inhibit – to prevent or hinder something from happening.
option (a) – converting – doesn't fit the context as plastic bags do not convert soil nutrients in any way.
option (b) – demanding – plastic bags are not in any way demanding soil nutrients,
option (c) – accumulating – plastic bags cannot accumulate soil nutrients.
The best fitting option is d.

Cloze Passage 22 (Q.164–Q.167)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The phrase non-governmental or non-profit is commonly used to refer to the various organisations that (1)_____ civil society. In general, such organisations are distinguished by the (2)_____ that they operate for reasons other than financial gain. Surveys indicate that NGOs have a high degree of public (3)_____, which can make them a useful proxy for the concerns of society and stakeholders. NGOs range from small pressure groups on specific environmental concerns or human rights (4)_____, to educational charities, women's refuges, cultural associations, religious organisations, legal foundations, humanitarian assistance programmes – and the list could go on – to large international organisations with hundreds or even thousands of branches or members around the world.

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Q.164 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) comprises **(b)** comprising
(c) comprise **(d)** comprised

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) comprise
Comprise – to consist of
Comprises – the third person singular form of comprise. Subject is not singular so, it can not be used here.
Comprising – present participle of comprise. But sentence is not in continuous tense.
Comprised – past participle. Sentence is not in the past tense.
So, comprise is the correct word to fill in the blank.

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Q.165 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) value **(b)** fact
(c) lie **(d)** clue

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) fact
Fact – a statement that can be verified.
Value – a belief that is subjective.
Clue – a hint.
Lie – untruthful statement.
The most appropriate word out of the given is 'fact'.

Q.166 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) belief **(b)** thought
(c) trust **(d)** idea

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) trust
"trust" is the most appropriate option for the given blank.

Q.167 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) evaluation **(b)** discrimination
(c) violations **(d)** prohibitions

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 6 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) violations
The sentence is discussing some rules and regulations. So, 'evaluation' and 'discrimination' do not fit into the context.
Prohibitions – restrictions on people.
Violation – breaking of law.
So, the most appropriate option is 'c'.

Cloze Passage 23 (Q.168–Q.171)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The Sun is the star at the center of (1) _____ Solar System. It is a nearly perfect ball of hot plasma. The Sun has inspired us since ancient times. It's central to mythology and religion in (2) _____ around the world. It keeps our planet warm enough for living things to grow. It gives us light so we can see. It is by far the most important (3) _____of energy for life on Earth. It is about a hundred times as wide (4)_____ the Earth. If there were no sun, many things wouldn't occur like photosynthesis or the presence of oxygen, which would have caused no existence of life.

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Q.168 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) a **(b)** typical
(c) huge **(d)** the

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the
Our solar system is a specific solar system. Hence, definite article 'the' should be used.

Q.169 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) cultures **(b)** types
(c) scenes **(d)** processes

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) cultures
'in cultures' – means various societies or civilizations around the world.
Scenes – it would convey the sense of specific locations or settings where the sun is observed.
Processes – not appropriate for the sentence.
Types – not fitting in the context.
So, option (a) is the correct answer.

Q.170 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) control **(b)** gesture
(c) symbol **(d)** source

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) source
Control – does not fit in the context
Gesture – a physical expression or movement.
Symbol – not correct in the sentence's context.
Source – sun is the origin of energy for earth. Hence, use of source is the most appropriate in the this sentence.

Q.171 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) than **(b)** as
(c) like **(d)** about

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 7 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) as
'as ..... as' is used to show similarity between the two things in a comparative manner. So, option (a) is the correct answer.

Cloze Passage 24 (Q.172–Q.175)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The ongoing fight for social justice and equality continues to be a significant global 1. _____. Movements advocating for racial, gender and LGBTQ+ equality, as well as addressing systemic discrimination and injustice, have 2. _____ momentum in recent years. People are increasingly recognising the importance of dismantling structures that 3. _____ inequality and fostering inclusivity in all aspects of society. Calls for justice, representation and equal opportunities have sparked conversations and initiatives aimed at creating a more equitable world. It is crucial to 4. _____ in meaningful dialogue, challenge biases and actively promote diversity and to build a society where everyone has equal rights and opportunities.

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Q.172 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(a) divergence **(b)** dispersion
(c) drift **(d)** focus

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) focus
The correct answer is option (d).
"focus" - This is the correct word choice. "Focus" here means that the ongoing fight for social justice and equality is a significant global emphasis or point of attention. It conveys the idea that people worldwide are paying attention to this important issue.
"divergence" - This word means the act of moving apart or differing in direction. It doesn't fit the sentence because it suggests a separation, whereas the sentence is talking about a significant global aspect of unity or emphasis on a particular issue.
"dispersion" - This word refers to the act of scattering or spreading out. It also doesn't convey the intended meaning because it suggests a dispersal of something rather than a strong, centralized focus.
"drift" - This word can mean a gradual shift or change, but it doesn't convey the idea of a strong and intentional global emphasis, which is what the sentence seems to be discussing.
So, the most appropriate word to complete the sentence is **"focus."**

Q.173 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(a) provided **(b)** gained
(c) invoked **(d)** scattered

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) gained
The correct answer is option (b).
Invoked: call on (a deity or spirit) in prayer, as a witness, or for inspiration.
Provided: On the condition or understanding that.
Scattered: occurring or found at intervals or various locations rather than all together.
So, the most appropriate answer is **"Invoked".**

Q.174 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(a) perpetuate **(b)** cease
(c) refract **(d)** terminate

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) perpetuate
The correct answer is option (a).
Perpetuate: make (something) continue indefinitely.
Cease: come or bring to an end.
Refract: (of water, air, or glass) make (a ray of light) change direction when it enters at an angle.
Terminate: bring to an end
Hence, the most appropriate option is **"Perpetuate"**

Q.175 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(a) coincide **(b)** engage
(c) manifest **(d)** evolve

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2023 | 26 Oct 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) engage
The correct answer is option (b).
Engage: occupy or attract (someone's interest or attention).
let's go through the meaning of all the given option:
Coincide: occur at the same time.
Manifest: clear or obvious to the eye or mind.
Evolve: develop gradually.

Cloze Passage 25 (Q.176–Q.179)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

Climate change (1)____ an imminent threat to our planet, demanding urgent global action. The rise in greenhouse gas emissions, deforestation and unsustainable practices contribute to extreme weather events, rising sea levels and disruptions in ecosystems. To (2)_____ these effects, a collaborative international effort is essential. Nations (3)_____ commit to reducing carbon emissions, transitioning to renewable energy sources and implementing sustainable practices. Cooperation on technological advancements and sharing resources will foster a collective resilience against the impacts of climate change. The urgency of this issue calls for a united front, where governments, businesses and individuals work together to create a sustainable and resilient future for the (4)_____ to come.

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Q.176 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) posed **(b)** will be posing
(c) poses **(d)** will pose

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) poses
"Poses" is the correct verb form in the present tense, indicating that climate change currently represents a threat to our planet.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.177 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) inflate **(b)** mitigate
(c) maximise **(d)** widen

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) mitigate
Mitigate means to make something less severe, intense, or harmful, which fits the context of addressing the negative effects of climate change.
The meaning of other options are:
Inflate means to increase or enlarge.
Maximise means to make something as large or great as possible.
Widen means to make something broader.

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Explanation (contd.)
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.178 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) would **(b)** might
(c) could **(d)** must

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) must
Must conveys a strong necessity or obligation, which fits the context of global action required to address climate change.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.179 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) businessmen **(b)** backward nations
(c) poor people **(d)** generations

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) generations
Generations refers to future people or societies, which is the most logical choice in the context of creating a long-term, sustainable future for those who will inherit the planet.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Cloze Passage 26 (Q.180–Q.183)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The greatest disease in the West today is not TB or leprosy; it is being unwanted, unloved, and uncared for. We can cure (1)_____ diseases with medicine, but the only cure for loneliness, despair, and hopelessness is love. There are many in the world who are (2)_____ for a piece of bread but there are many more dying for a little love. The poverty in the West is a different kind of poverty – it is not only a poverty of (3)_____ but also of (4)_____. There's a hunger for affection as there is a hunger for God.

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Q.180 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 1.

(a) physical **(b)** stubborn
(c) masculine **(d)** radical

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) physical
In the context of the passage, the author discusses diseases like TB (tuberculosis) and leprosy, which are physical diseases that can be treated with medicine. The sentence is highlighting that while physical diseases can be cured with medicine, issues like loneliness and despair require something more – love. Therefore, **"physical"** is the correct choice, as it aligns with the type of diseases that can be treated with medical intervention.
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.181 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 2.

(a) disregarding **(b)** ignoring
(c) dying **(d)** neglecting

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) dying
In the context of the passage, the sentence discusses the condition of people who are in desperate need of something more than just food—specifically, love. The phrase **"dying for a little love"** is a common expression used to describe a desperate longing for something, in this case, love.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.182 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 3.

(a) profusion **(b)** lavishness
(c) loneliness **(d)** abundance

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) loneliness
The passage is describing a kind of poverty that is not just material but emotional. The phrase **"poverty of loneliness"** refers to the emotional deprivation people feel, even if they are materially wealthy. So, the correct context for blank 3 is the **"poverty of loneliness,"** which makes sense in the emotional or psychological context being described.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.183 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank 4.

(a) spirituality **(b)** covetous
(c) educate **(d)** materialistic

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2024 | 20 Jan 2025

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) spirituality
The most appropriate option to fill in blank 4 is **spirituality**. So, the sentence would read: "The poverty in the West is a different kind of poverty – it is not only a poverty of material but also of spirituality. There's a hunger for affection as there is a hunger for God."
The other options are:
Covetous: Having or showing a great desire to possess something.
Educate: To provide someone with knowledge or training in a particular area or field.
Materialistic: Excessively concerned with material possessions or wealth, often at the expense of spiritual or intellectual values.
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Cloze Passage 27 (Q.184–Q.187)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

Astronomers have discovered 62 new moons orbiting the ringed planet Saturn.

Though some of the moons had been (1)_____ as early as 2019, it takes more than sighting an object close to a planet to (2) _____ it is a moon and not an asteroid making a brief close passage to that planet.

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Passage (contd.)
Performing a painstaking (3) _____ of matching objects detected on different nights over the course of 24 months, the team tracked 63 objects that they ended up confirming as moons. One of (4) _____ satellites was revealed back in 2021, with the remaining 62 moons gradually announced over the past few weeks.
SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Q.184 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(a) sports **(b)** spot
(c) spotted **(d)** spotting

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) spotted
option (c) is the correct answer.
Past perfect continuous tense structure- Sub. + had + been + v3 + Obj.
Thus, spotted is the correct word to fill the blank.

Q.185 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(a) settle **(b)** sanction
(c) confirm **(d)** consent

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) confirm
option (c) is the correct answer.
Confirm: to say or show that something is true or correct, especially by giving evidence.
Settle: to put an end to an argument or disagreement.
Sanction: an official order that limits business, contact, etc. with a particular country, in order to make it do something, such as obeying international law.
Consent: to agree to something; to allow something to happen.

Q.186 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(a) progress **(b)** product
(c) process **(d)** practice

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) process
option (c) is the correct answer.
Process suits the best.
- Process: a series of actions that you do for a particular purpose.
- Progress: movement forwards or towards achieving something.
- Practice: the usual or expected way of doing something in a particular organization or situation; a habit or custom.

Q.187 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(a) that **(b)** these
(c) this **(d)** those

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2022 | 18 Sep 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) these
option (b) is the correct answer.

Explanation (contd.)
These suits the best.
In the given context 63 objects are mentioned early hence the correct word to fill in the blank is 'these'.

Cloze Passage 28 (Q.188–Q.191)
In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

He looks out of the window at the (1)_____ snow, then turns and takes his wife in his arms, feeling grateful to be here even as he wonders what he is going to do with his life in strictly practical terms. For years, he had (2)_____ himself to do one thing, and he did it well, but he doesn't know whether he wants to keep doing it for the rest of his life, for that matter, whether anyone will let him. He is still worrying when they go to bed.

They've been learning to get by with less, and they'll keep learning. It seems to him as if they're taking a course in loss lately. And as he feels himself falling asleep he has an (3)_____ he believes is important, which he hopes he will remember in the morning, although it is one of those thoughts that seldom (4)_____ translation to the language of daylight hours.
SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Q.188 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(a) falling **(b)** dashing
(c) praying **(d)** blazing

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) falling
The most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1 is **falling**.
1. **Falling**: Descending or moving downward, often under the influence of gravity. In the context of snow, it refers to snowflakes descending from the sky.
2. **Dashing**: Moving or acting with great speed or energy. It doesn't quite fit the context of looking at the snow out of the window.
3. **Praying**: Engaging in prayer or making a request earnestly. This does not fit the context of looking at the snow.
4. **Blazing**: Shining brightly or fiercely. It usually refers to something producing a strong flame or light. This does not fit the context of snow; it is more associated with fire or intense light.

Q.189 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(a) trained **(b)** mesmerised
(c) penalised **(d)** abstained

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) trained
The most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2 is **trained**.
1. **Trained**: This word fits the context as it suggests that the person had prepared or disciplined himself to do one thing proficiently. It aligns with the idea that he developed a skill or expertise over the years.

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Explanation (contd.)

1. **Mesmerised**: This term means to captivate or hold one's attention, often with fascination. However, it doesn't convey the sense of self-discipline or dedication implied in the sentence.
2. **Penalised**: This word means to impose a penalty or punishment. It does not fit the context of the person developing a skill or ability.
3. **Abstained**: This term means to refrain or hold back from doing something. It does not convey the idea of training or honing a skill.

In the given context, the person had dedicated himself to doing one thing well over the years, so the most appropriate option is **trained**. The sentence would be: "For years, he had trained himself to do one thing, and he did it well..."

Q.190 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(a) insight **(b)** implication
(c) insurance **(d)** instance

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) insight

The most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3 is **insight**.

1. **Insight**: This term refers to the ability to understand and gain a deep, intuitive understanding of a situation. In the context of the passage, having an "insight" suggests the person is experiencing a moment of profound understanding or realization as he falls asleep.
2. **Implication**: While "implication" can refer to a possible consequence or meaning, it doesn't quite convey the idea of a sudden realization or understanding, which is more fitting for the context.
3. **Insurance**: "Insurance" refers to a financial arrangement for protection against loss or harm. This doesn't fit the context of gaining understanding or insight.
4. **Instance**: "Instance" refers to a particular occurrence or case. It doesn't convey the sense of a deep understanding or realization, which is what the passage seems to suggest.

Q.191 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(a) proliferate **(b)** survive
(c) install **(d)** fabricate

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 10 Jan 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) survive

The most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4 is **survive**.

1. **Proliferate**: This term means to increase rapidly or multiply. It doesn't fit the context of thoughts surviving translation.
2. **Survive**: In this context, "survive" is the correct choice. The sentence suggests that certain thoughts or insights may not persist or endure when translated into the language of daylight hours. "Survive" here means to continue to exist or remain intact.
3. **Install**: This term means to set up or place something in position. It doesn't convey the idea of thoughts enduring translation.
4. **Fabricate**: "Fabricate" means to create or invent something, often with the implication of deception. It doesn't fit the context of thoughts enduring translation; rather, it suggests the creation of something false.

Cloze Passage 29 (Q.192–Q.195)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

Girls have been the 1._____ of many crimes in India for years. The most fearful crime was female foeticide, in which girls were killed in the 2._____ of the mother after sex determination through ultrasound. 'Save the Girl Child' 3._____ has been launched by the government to end gender-selective abortions of female foetuses as well as other crimes 4._____ the girl child.

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Q.192 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) victors **(b)** scapegoats
(c) sites **(d)** victims

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) victims

The most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1 is: **victims**

- **Victors:** This term refers to winners or those who achieve victory. It does not fit the context of being the target or affected by crimes.
- **Scapegoats:** Scapegoats are individuals who are unfairly blamed or targeted for others' wrongdoings. While it could be a relevant term in certain contexts, it does not fully capture the idea of being the primary targets of crimes.
- **Sites:** This term refers to locations or places. It does not convey the intended meaning in the context of individuals being affected by crimes.
- **Victims:** This term refers to individuals who suffer harm, injury, or loss as a result of a crime, accident, or other harmful events. In the context of the passage, "victims" appropriately describes the girls who have been adversely affected by crimes.

Q.193 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) kidney **(b)** womb
(c) intestine **(d)** liver

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) womb

The most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2 is: **womb**

- **Kidney:** This is an organ in the body and is not relevant to the context of the passage, which is discussing the location where female foeticide occurs.
- **Womb:** This term refers to the organ in the female reproductive system where a fetus develops during pregnancy. In the context of female foeticide, it is the place where the crime is committed.
- **Intestine:** This is another organ in the body and is not related to the context of the passage.
- **Liver:** Like kidney, liver is another organ in the body and is not relevant to the context of the passage.

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Q.194 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) campfire **(b)** enterprise
(c) undertaking **(d)** campaign

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) campaign
The most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3 is: **campaign**

- **Campfire:** A campfire is an outdoor fire used for cooking, warmth, or as part of a social event. It does not fit the context of a government initiative to address crimes against girls.
- **Enterprise:** An enterprise refers to a project or business, and it is not the most suitable term for describing a government initiative to address social issues.
- **Undertaking:** An undertaking is a task or project that someone takes on, but it may not convey the collective and organized effort of a government initiative.
- **Campaign:** A campaign refers to a systematic and organized effort to achieve a specific goal, often of a social, political, or charitable nature. In the context of the passage, "campaign" is the most appropriate term to describe the government's organized initiative to save the girl child.

Q.195 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) across **(b)** through
(c) for **(d)** against

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2023 | 2 Nov 2023

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) against
The most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4 is: **against**

- **Across:** This preposition typically refers to movement from one side to another or covering a distance. It is not the most suitable term to convey the government's stance or action against crimes.
- **Through:** This preposition indicates movement from one side to the other, or a process of going from one point to another. It is not the most appropriate choice to convey the government's stance against crimes.
- **For:** This preposition indicates support, but it does not convey the sense of opposition or taking action against something.
- **Against:** This preposition is used to indicate opposition, resistance, or taking action to prevent or counter something. In the context of the passage, "against" is the most suitable term to convey the government's stance opposing gender-selective abortions and crimes against the girl child.

Cloze Passage 30 (Q.196–Q.199)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

Passage (contd.)

During active sleep, the body is still, (1)_____ the brain is active. The eyes dart back and forth behind closed lids, blood pressure (2)_____ and the breathing pattern speeds up. An EEG of someone during rapid eye movement sleep looks almost the same as the EEG of a person in the waking state, although one is still asleep and the body is still immobile. Rapid eye movement sleep plays a vital role in harmonising the experiences we have in the world outside. An EEG of someone during rapid eye movement sleep looks almost the same as the EEG of a person in the (3)_____ state, although one is still asleep and the body is still (4)_____. Rapid eye movement during sleep plays a vital role in harmonising the experiences we have in the world outside.

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Q.196 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) therefore **(b)** neither
(c) but **(d)** so

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) but
The sentence contrasts the body's stillness with the brain's activity during active sleep, so **"but"** is the most appropriate conjunction to show this contrast.

Q.197 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) relaxes **(b)** beeps
(c) increases **(d)** stables

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2024 | 18 Nov 2024

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) increases
The passage talks about active sleep, where various physiological functions, including blood pressure, change during rapid eye movement (REM) sleep. During REM sleep, blood pressure typically **increases**.

Q.198 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) standing **(b)** sleeping
(c) eating **(d)** waking

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) waking
The passage contrasts the EEG of someone in rapid eye movement (REM) sleep with that of a person in a **waking** state. The EEG patterns of both are similar, even though the person in REM sleep is still asleep and immobile.

Q.199 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) immobile **(b)** performing
(c) active **(d)** conscious

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) immobile
The passage discusses how, during active sleep (REM sleep), the body remains still while the brain is active. It also mentions that the body is **immobile** during this phase, which makes "immobile" the correct choice.

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Cloze Passage 31 (Q.200–Q.204)

In the given passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage intently and choose the most appropriate option to fill in each blank:

Democracies are usually credited with being resilient, yet the past indicates that they can be quite vulnerable. Those institutions that are meant to protect freedom can weaken when citizens become disconnected or when politicians take advantage of (1) _____ within the system. Gradual removal of checks and balances might not raise an alarm until it is too late.

One of the central factors is the state of public discourse. When argument gets polarised and facts are sacrificed to (2) _____, democratic conventions start to disintegrate. The media is responsible here, either as a watchdog or as a megaphone for disinformation. The advent of echo chambers has made it simpler for individuals to shun (3) _____ perspectives, strengthening tribalism.

Economic inequality is another threat. When significant portions of the populace feel left out of prosperity, they can lose confidence in democratic processes and seek (4) _____ alternatives. This cynicism can be taken advantage of by populist movements that make quick fixes but destroy democratic ideas.

Democracy must be safeguarded with vigilance, participation, and a willingness to search for truth. Without these, even the most entrenched systems can become (5) _____, susceptible to rot from within.

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Q.200 What should come in the place of blank number 1?

(a) Strength **(b)** Balances
(c) Gaps **(d)** Faults

SSC CHSL Tier 2 | 2025 | 10 Apr 2026

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Gaps

The deciding words.

"politicians take advantage of (1) [blank] **within the system**. Gradual **removal of checks and balances** ..."

What the blank needs.

A plural noun for something politicians can **exploit** inside the system — a weakness or opening.

gaps = openings, loopholes *(खामियाँ, रिक्तियाँ)* — exactly what one "takes advantage of".

Answer: **(3) Gaps**

Why the others are wrong.

• **strength** = power, firmness *(शक्ति)* — the paragraph is about how institutions *weaken*; exploiting strength makes no sense, and it is singular.

• **balances** = counterweights *(संतुलन)* — the next line speaks of *removing* checks and balances, so they are what is lost, not what is exploited.

• **faults** = defects, mistakes *(दोष)* — close, but *faults* suggests blame or errors; the passage means **loopholes**, openings that can be used.

Word help.

resilient = able to recover quickly from difficulty *(लचीला, शीघ्र उबरने वाला)*.

checks and balances = the limits each branch of government places on the others *(नियंत्रण और संतुलन)*.

You take advantage of gaps (loopholes) in a system, not of its faults.

Q.201 What should come in the place of blank number 2?

(a) Lies **(b)** Emotions
(c) Biases **(d)** Rhetoric

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Rhetoric

The deciding words.

"When **argument** gets polarised and facts are sacrificed to (2) [blank], democratic conventions start to disintegrate."

What the blank needs.

Something in **public discourse** that replaces facts in an argument.

rhetoric = persuasive or showy speech that may lack substance *(लच्छेदार/भड़काऊ भाषणबाज़ी)*.

The phrase "facts sacrificed to rhetoric" is the standard collocation for debate that runs on slogans instead of evidence.

Answer: **(4) Rhetoric**

Why the others are wrong.

• **lies** = deliberate falsehoods *(झूठ)* — too blunt; the next line separately mentions *disinformation*, and the blank is about the style of argument.

• **emotions** = feelings *(भावनाएँ)* — possible in ordinary speech, but the paragraph is about **discourse and argument**, which points to speech-making, not feelings.

• **biases** = prejudices *(पूर्वाग्रह)* — biases distort judgement, but facts are not "sacrificed to" a bias in a debate.

Word help.

discourse = public discussion and debate *(विमर्श)*.

polarised = split into two sharply opposed camps *(ध्रुवीकृत)*.

Discourse + argument + polarised = rhetoric: facts lose to fine-sounding words.

Q.202 What should come in the place of blank number 3?

(a) Opposing **(b)** Dissecting
(c) Critical **(d)** Alternative

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Opposing

The deciding words.

"**echo chambers** ... simpler for individuals to **shun** (3) [blank] perspectives, **strengthening tribalism**."

What the blank needs.

An echo chamber repeats your own view, so what you *shun (टालना, दूर रहना)* is the **other side's** view.

opposing = contrary, of the other side *(विरोधी)*.

Shunning opposing views is exactly what strengthens tribalism.

Answer: **(1) Opposing**

Why the others are wrong.

• **dissecting** = cutting apart for close study *(चीर-फाड़ कर विश्लेषण करने वाला)* — a verb form that does not describe a perspective.

• **critical** = fault-finding or analytical *(आलोचनात्मक)* — weaker; tribalism is about rejecting the *other* camp, not just criticism.

• **alternative** = another available choice *(वैकल्पिक)* — neutral; it does not carry the *us vs them* sense that "tribalism" needs.

Word help.

echo chamber = a space where people hear only views that repeat their own *(प्रतिध्वनि कक्ष — एक ही विचार की गूँज)*.

tribalism = strong loyalty to one's own group against others *(गुटबाज़ी, कबीलाई निष्ठा)*.

Echo chamber = same voice in, opposing voice out.

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Q.203 What should come in the place of blank number 4?

(a) Violent **(b)** Radical
(c) Authoritarian **(d)** Extremist

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Authoritarian

The deciding words.

"they can **lose confidence in democratic processes** and seek (4) [blank] alternatives ... populist movements that ... **destroy democratic ideas**."

What the blank needs.

An alternative **to democracy** — a non-democratic form of rule.

authoritarian = demanding strict obedience to one ruler or group, without free choice *(सत्तावादी, तानाशाही)*.

It is the direct opposite of the democratic processes people have lost faith in.

Answer: **(3) Authoritarian**

Why the others are wrong.

• **violent** = using physical force *(हिंसक)* — the passage speaks of systems of rule, not of force.

• **radical** = favouring sweeping change *(आमूल परिवर्तनवादी)* — a radical change can still be democratic; it does not name the anti-democratic choice.

• **extremist** = holding extreme political or religious views *(चरमपंथी)* — describes people's views, while the passage is contrasting forms of government.

Word help.

populace = the general public *(जनसाधारण)*.

cynicism = distrust of people's motives and of institutions *(निराशावाद, अविश्वास)*.

populist = claiming to speak for ordinary people against elites *(लोकलुभावन)*.

Lose faith in democracy → turn to its opposite: authoritarian rule.

Q.204 What should come in the place of blank number 5?

(a) Strong **(b)** Vulnerable
(c) Honest **(d)** Sincere

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Vulnerable

The deciding words.

"Without these, **even the most entrenched** systems can become (5) [blank], **susceptible to rot from within**."

What the blank needs.

even the most entrenched signals a contrast — strong systems turning weak.

The phrase after the comma, *susceptible to rot*, restates the blank.

vulnerable = open to attack or harm *(असुरक्षित, भेद्य)* — and it echoes the opening line: "they can be quite **vulnerable**".

Answer: **(2) Vulnerable**

Why the others are wrong.

• **strong** = powerful, firm *(मज़बूत)* — the opposite of what "even the most entrenched" sets up.

• **honest** = truthful *(ईमानदार)* — describes people, not a system decaying from within.

• **sincere** = genuine, without pretence *(निष्कपट)* — also a personal quality with no link to "rot".

Word help.

entrenched = firmly established, hard to remove *(सुदृढ़ रूप से जमा हुआ)*.

Explanation (contd.)

susceptible = easily affected or harmed *(संवेदनशील, प्रभावित होने योग्य)*.

"Even the most ..." sets up a fall: entrenched yet vulnerable.

Cloze Passage 32 (Q.205–Q.214)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank.

Ram Singh whistled cheerfully as he pushed his bicycle up the hill towards old Mrs. Gupta's house. His work for the (1)_____was almost finished (2)_____his bag, which was usually (3)_____ when he started from the post office (4)_____now become empty (5)_____for the letter that he had to (6)_____to Mrs.Gupta. She lived a kilometer (7)_____from the village, so when (8)_____had a letter for her, he (9)_____ his day's work late. However, he did not mind that (10)_____Mrs Gupta always called him in for a cup of tea.

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Q.205 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1.

(a) month **(b)** week
(c) day **(d)** year

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) day

Type: Cloze Test – Context

A postman finishes his rounds each **day**. "His work for the **day** was almost finished."

("work for the day" = दिन का काम।)

Why the others are wrong

• **month / week / year** – a postman's daily round is for the "day".

Q.206 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2.

(a) unless **(b)** but
(c) and **(d)** although

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) and

Type: Cloze Test – Conjunction

Two ideas move together (work almost finished; bag now empty), so we join them with "**and**".

(समान दिशा के दो विचार जोड़ने के लिए "and"।)

Why the others are wrong

• **unless / but / although** – show condition/contrast, which does not fit.

Q.207 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3.

(a) torn **(b)** dirty
(c) heavy **(d)** large

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) heavy

Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary/Contrast

The bag "was usually **heavy** when he started" — contrasted with "had now become empty".

("heavy" = भारी (शुरुआत में); बाद में खाली।)

Why the others are wrong

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Explanation (contd.)
• **torn / dirty / large** – do not contrast with "empty" the way "heavy" does.

Q.208 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4.

(a) has **(b)** had
(c) have **(d)** were

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) had
Type: Cloze Test – Past Perfect
"had now become empty" — the emptying happened by that point in the past → past perfect "**had**".
(उस समय तक पूरा हुआ काम → past perfect "had"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **has / have** – present perfect; **were** – wrong with "become empty".

Q.209 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5.

(a) accept **(b)** without
(c) except **(d)** excluding

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) except
Type: Cloze Test – Word Choice (except vs accept)
The bag was empty "**except** for the letter" = apart from the letter. ("except" ≠ "accept" = to receive.)
("except for" = ... को छोड़कर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **accept** – a verb (to receive); **without** – wrong here; **excluding** – awkward with "for".

Q.210 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.6.

(a) dispatch **(b)** post
(c) decipher **(d)** deliver

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) deliver
Type: Cloze Test – Collocation
A postman has to "**deliver**" a letter (hand it over). "the letter that he had to **deliver** to Mrs. Gupta."
("deliver a letter" = पत्र पहुँचाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **dispatch/post** – to send off (done at the post office); **decipher** – to decode (wrong sense).

Q.211 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.7.

(a) away **(b)** along
(c) across **(d)** aside

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) away
Type: Cloze Test – Collocation
"a kilometre **away** from the village" = at a distance of a kilometre.
("a kilometre away from" = एक किलोमीटर दूर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **along / across / aside** – none gives the "at a distance" sense with "from".

Q.212 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.8.

(a) she **(b)** they
(c) we **(d)** he

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) he
Type: Cloze Test – Pronoun
The subject is Ram Singh (a man), so → "**he**". "when **he** had a letter for her."
(Ram Singh (पुरुष) के लिए "he"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **she / they / we** – wrong number/person for Ram Singh.

Q.213 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.9.

(a) finishes **(b)** finished
(c) is finishing **(d)** have finished

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) finished
Type: Cloze Test – Tense
The passage narrates in the **simple past**, so → "**finished**". "he **finished** his day's work late."
(कथा past में है → "finished"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **finishes / is finishing** – present; **have finished** – present perfect + wrong subject.

Q.214 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.10.

(a) nevertheless **(b)** though
(c) because **(d)** although

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) because
Type: Cloze Test – Conjunction (Reason)
"he did not mind that **because** Mrs Gupta always called him in for tea" — "because" gives the reason he didn't mind.
("because" = क्योंकि (कारण)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **nevertheless / though / although** – show contrast, not reason.

Cloze Passage 33 (Q.215–Q.224)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank.

It is very easy and harmless for a healthy person to donate blood. There is (1)_____amount of five to eight litres of blood (2)_____a healthy man. Giving (3)_____a small quantity of this will not (4)_____him any harm. The (5)_____body is remarkable; whatever (6)_____has been taken (7)_____the body it is soon (8)_____by new blood, (9)_____the blood loss (10)_____small.

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Q.215 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1.

(a) a **(b)** one
(c) the **(d)** an

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) an
Type: Cloze Test – Article
Rule: "amount" begins with a vowel sound, so we use "**an**". "There is **an** amount of five to eight litres of blood."
(स्वर-ध्वनि से पहले "an"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **a** – used before consonant sounds; **one/the** – do not fit "___ amount".

Q.216 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2.

(a) for **(b)** on
(c) with **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) in
Type: Cloze Test – Preposition
"blood **in** a healthy man" = present inside the body. Correct preposition: "**in**".
("blood in a man" = शरीर के अंदर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **for / on / with** – none gives the "inside" sense.

Q.217 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3.

(a) away **(b)** across
(c) over **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) away
Type: Cloze Test – Phrasal Verb
"Giving **away** a small quantity" = donating/giving out. "give away" = to donate.
("give away" = दान देना/दे देना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **across / over / in** – "give across/over/in" do not fit here.

Q.218 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4.

(a) made **(b)** did
(c) make **(d)** do

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) do
Type: Cloze Test – Collocation
Rule: The fixed phrase is "**do (someone) harm**" (present simple base after "will not"). "will not **do** him any harm."
("do harm" = नुकसान पहुँचाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **made / did** – past forms; **make** – "make harm" is not idiomatic ("do harm" is correct).

Q.219 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5.

(a) human **(b)** vessel
(c) health **(d)** organ

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) human
Type: Cloze Test – Collocation
"The **human** body is remarkable" — the natural phrase is "the human body".
("the human body" = मानव शरीर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **vessel / health / organ** – none forms "the ___ body" naturally here.

Q.220 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.6.

(a) tissue **(b)** blood
(c) muscle **(d)** flesh

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) blood
Type: Cloze Test – Context
The passage is about blood donation; "whatever **blood** has been taken from the body" is soon replaced.
(यहाँ "blood" (रक्त) संदर्भ के अनुसार सही है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **tissue / muscle / flesh** – the topic is blood loss and replacement, so "blood".

Q.221 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.7.

(a) for **(b)** from
(c) by **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) from
Type: Cloze Test – Preposition
"taken **from** the body" = removed out of the body. Correct preposition: "**from**".
("taken from the body" = शरीर से निकाला गया।)
Why the others are wrong
• **for / by / in** – none shows "out of the body".

Q.222 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.8.

(a) recovered **(b)** revived
(c) replaced **(d)** redeemed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) replaced
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary
Lost blood is soon "**replaced** by new blood" = new blood takes its place.
("replaced" = प्रतिस्थापित।)
Why the others are wrong
• **recovered / revived** – about regaining health, not "taking the place of".
• **redeemed** – to buy back/compensate; wrong sense.

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Q.223 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.9.

(a) provide **(b)** provided
(c) provides **(d)** provider

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) provided
Type: Cloze Test – Conjunction
Rule: "**provided (that)**" = on condition that. "... provided the blood loss is small."
("provided" = इस शर्त पर कि।)
Why the others are wrong
• **provide / provides / provider** – verb/noun forms; here a conjunction "provided" is needed.

Q.224 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.10.

(a) are **(b)** is
(c) be **(d)** were

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (b) is
Type: Cloze Test – Subject-Verb Agreement
Rule: "the blood loss" is **singular**, so → "**is** small".
(एकवचन "blood loss" के साथ "is"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **are / were** – plural/past; **be** – needs a helping verb.

Cloze Passage 34 (Q.225–Q.229)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank.

Chemical additives have a cosmetic effect. Additives are (1)_____ used in the food industry. Colour (2)_____food attractive. Colour creates interest. Flavour and aroma (3)_____food are important for marketing (4)_____. Flavour and aroma present in food have an appetizing effect on (5)_____.

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Q.225 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.1.

(a) seldom **(b)** hardly
(c) rarely **(d)** widely

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) widely
Type: Cloze Test – Adverb
Additives are **widely** used = used a lot / everywhere. The sentence is positive, so we need "widely".
("widely used" = व्यापक रूप से प्रयुक्त।)
Why the others are wrong
• **seldom / hardly / rarely** – all mean "almost never" (negative), which contradicts the point.

Q.226 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.2.

(a) makes **(b)** are making
(c) made **(d)** make

SSC CPO Tier 2 | 2018

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) makes
Type: Cloze Test – Subject-Verb Agreement

Explanation (contd.)
"Colour" is **singular**, so it takes the singular verb "**makes**". "Colour **makes** food attractive."
(एकवचन "Colour" के साथ "makes"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **are making** – plural + continuous; **made** – past; **make** – plural verb.

Q.227 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.3.

(a) with **(b)** in
(c) over **(d)** from

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) in
Type: Cloze Test – Preposition
"Flavour and aroma **in** food" = present inside food. The correct preposition is "**in**".
("in food" = भोजन में।)
Why the others are wrong
• **with / over / from** – none gives the "present inside" sense.

Q.228 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.4.

(a) them **(b)** it
(c) those **(d)** these

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) it
Type: Cloze Test – Pronoun
"important for marketing **it**" — "it" refers to the singular, uncountable "**food**".
("it" = भोजन (food)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **them / those / these** – plural forms; "food" is treated as singular here.

Q.229 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No.5.

(a) consultants **(b)** customers
(c) clients **(d)** consumers

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) consumers
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary
Food has an appetizing effect on the people who **eat** it — the **consumers**.
("consumers" = उपभोक्ता (जो खाते हैं)।)
Why the others are wrong
• **consultants** – advisers; **customers/clients** – buyers (of services); "consumers" (those who consume food) is the most precise.

Cloze Passage 35 (Q.230–Q.239)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

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Passage (contd.)
I was walking home from work when I saw someone (1)_____ I thought was my friend Sandra. I went up (2)_____ her and touched her on the arm. (3)_____, when the woman turned round, it wasn't Sandra (4)_____ all! I just said, "I am sorry. I (5)_____ you for a friend." She stared at my face and (6)_____. To be honest, her face shocked me. She (7)_____ me of a witch from a children's (8)_____, with her long nose and staring eyes! (9)_____ I could realise what she was up to, she (10)_____ my purse and escaped.
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Q.230 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(a) such **(b)** which
(c) how **(d)** who

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) who
Type: Cloze Test – Relative Pronoun
Rule: For a **person** ("someone"), the relative pronoun is **who**.
(व्यक्ति के लिए relative pronoun "who"।)
Application
"I saw someone **who** I thought was my friend Sandra."
Why the others are wrong
• **such / how** – not relative pronouns for a person.
• **which** – used for things, not people.

Q.231 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(a) into **(b)** for
(c) by **(d)** to

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to
Type: Cloze Test – Phrasal Verb
Rule: "**go up to** somebody" = to approach a person. "I went up **to** her ..."
("go up to" = किसी के पास जाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **into / for / by** – "went up ___ her" needs "to" to show approaching.

Q.232 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(a) Correctly **(b)** Smoothly
(c) Gladly **(d)** Surprisingly

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Surprisingly
Type: Cloze Test – Adverb/Context
The result was unexpected (it was not Sandra), so the sentence starts with **Surprisingly**.
("Surprisingly" = हैरानी की बात है कि।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Correctly / Smoothly / Gladly** – none matches the "unexpected" tone of the sentence.

Q.233 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(a) at **(b)** of
(c) by **(d)** with

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) at
Type: Cloze Test – Idiom
Rule: "**not ... at all**" is a fixed phrase meaning "not in the least".
("not ... at all" = बिलकुल नहीं।)
Application
"it wasn't Sandra **at** all!"
Why the others are wrong
• **of / by / with all** – do not form the idiom; only "at all" is correct.

Q.234 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(a) disguised **(b)** recognised
(c) mistook **(d)** misjudged

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) mistook
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary
Rule: "**mistake somebody for somebody**" = to wrongly think one person is another. Past → **mistook**.
("mistake ... for" = किसी को कोई और समझ लेना; past "mistook"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **disguised** – to hide identity (भेस बदलना).
• **recognised** – correctly identified – opposite meaning.
• **misjudged** – judged wrongly (about character), not identity.

Q.235 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 6.

(a) scowled **(b)** snored
(c) stooped **(d)** scared

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) scowled
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary
"She stared at my face and **scowled**" = frowned angrily.
("scowled" = गुस्से से भौंहें तानीं।)
Word meanings
• **scowled** – made an angry face (क्रोधित मुख). ✓
• **snored** – breathed noisily while sleeping (खर्राटे लेना).
• **stooped** – bent the body forward (झुकना).
• **scared** – frightened; "scared" here would need an object.

Q.236 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 7.

(a) reminded **(b)** was reminding
(c) remind **(d)** reminds

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) reminded
Type: Cloze Test – Verb Form/Collocation
Rule: "**remind somebody of somebody/something**" = to make one think of. Simple past → **reminded**.
("remind ... of" = ... की याद दिलाना; past "reminded"।)
Why the others are wrong

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Explanation (contd.)
• **was reminding** – past continuous; not needed for this single realisation.
• **remind / reminds** – present tense; the story is in the past.

Q.237 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 8.

(a) myth **(b)** anecdote
(c) story **(d)** epic

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) story
Type: Cloze Test – Collocation
"a witch from a children's **story**" is the natural phrase.
("children's story" = बच्चों की कहानी।)
Word meanings
• **myth** – an ancient traditional tale about gods (पुराकथा).
• **anecdote** – a short real-life account (किस्सा).
• **story** – a tale/narrative (कहानी). ✓
• **epic** – a long heroic poem (महाकाव्य).

Q.238 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 9.

(a) Before **(b)** No soon
(c) As soon **(d)** After

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Before
Type: Cloze Test – Conjunction (Time)
Rule: "**Before** I could realise ..." shows that her action happened first, quickly.
("Before I could ..." = इससे पहले कि मैं समझ पाता।)
Why the others are wrong
• **No soon** – not a phrase; correct form is "No sooner ... than".
• **As soon** – incomplete; needs "as soon **as**".
• **After** – reverses the time order.

Q.239 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 10.

(a) was snatching **(b)** snatches
(c) snatch **(d)** snatched

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) snatched
Type: Cloze Test – Tense
Rule: The story is in the **simple past**, so → **snatched**. "she **snatched** my purse and escaped."
(कहानी past में है, इसलिए "snatched"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **was snatching** – past continuous; the act was quick and complete.
• **snatches / snatch** – present tense; wrong time.

Cloze Passage 36 (Q.240–Q.244)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Passage (contd.)
'Make in India' is a call to the global manufacturers (1)_____ at making India a manufacturing (2)_____. It is a national programme designed (3)_____ facilitate investment, foster innovation, enhance skill (4)_____ and build best-in-class manufacturing (5)_____. The programme lays emphasis on various sectors with focus on job creation.

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Q.240 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(a) assisted **(b)** conducted
(c) managed **(d)** aimed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) aimed
Type: Cloze Test – Collocation
Rule: "**aimed at + V-ing**" = intended to achieve. "a call to global manufacturers **aimed** at making India a manufacturing hub."
("aimed at" = ... के उद्देश्य से।)
Why the others are wrong
• **assisted / conducted / managed** – none takes "at + making" to show purpose.

Q.241 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(a) heart **(b)** seat
(c) surface **(d)** hub

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) hub
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary/Collocation
"a manufacturing **hub**" = a central place of manufacturing activity.
("hub" = केंद्र।)
Word meanings
• **heart** – centre of feelings; not used as "manufacturing heart".
• **seat** – a centre of authority (e.g., seat of government), not manufacturing.
• **surface** – outer layer (सतह) – wrong.
• **hub** – a busy central point (केंद्र). ✓

Q.242 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(a) to **(b)** at
(c) with **(d)** for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) to
Type: Cloze Test – Infinitive of Purpose
Rule: "designed **to + V1**" shows purpose. "a programme designed **to** facilitate investment."
("designed to + verb" = ... करने के लिए बनाया गया।)
Why the others are wrong
• **at / with / for** – "designed ___ facilitate" needs the infinitive "to".

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Q.243 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(a) progress **(b)** decline
(c) agreement **(d)** development

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) development
Type: Cloze Test – Collocation
"enhance skill **development**" is the natural phrase (improving skills).
("skill development" = कौशल विकास।)
Why the others are wrong
• **progress / agreement** – do not collocate with "skill" here.
• **decline** – means "fall"; opposite of "enhance".

Q.244 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(a) footing **(b)** infrastructure
(c) fundamental **(d)** groundwork

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) infrastructure
Type: Cloze Test – Collocation
"best-in-class manufacturing **infrastructure**" = the basic physical facilities for manufacturing.
("infrastructure" = आधारभूत ढाँचा।)
Why the others are wrong
• **footing / fundamental / groundwork** – none collocates with "manufacturing ___" as naturally as "infrastructure".

Cloze Passage 37 (Q.245–Q.254)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

In spite of all the honours that were heaped upon him, Pasteur remained a simple man (1)_____ heart. Perhaps the memories of his boyhood days, when he (2)_____ the familiar scenes of his birthplace, and the (3)_____ to be a great artist never wholly left him. He did (4)_____ a great artist but after his sixteenth year he (5)_____ the brush forever. He put his soul and energy (6)_____ his work, and it was this very energy that in the end (7)_____ him out. For him, each sufferer was more than (8)_____ a case that was to be cured. He looked upon the (9)_____ against hydrophobia as a battle and he was (10)_____ to win at any cost.

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Q.245 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(a) on **(b)** by
(c) in **(d)** at

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) at
Type: Cloze Test – Preposition/Idiom
Rule: "**at heart**" is a fixed phrase meaning "in one's true nature".
("at heart" = मूल रूप से / असल में।)
Application
"Pasteur remained a simple man **at** heart." (simple by nature)

Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are wrong
• **on / by / in heart** – none forms the correct idiom; only "at heart" is right.

Q.246 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(a) drawn **(b)** drew
(c) draw **(d)** draws

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) drew
Type: Cloze Test – Tense
Rule: The passage speaks of past boyhood ("when he ..."), so we need the **simple past** of *draw* → **drew**.
(भूतकाल की बात है, इसलिए draw का past रूप "drew"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **drawn** – past participle; needs has/had before it.
• **draw / draws** – present tense; wrong time.

Q.247 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(a) wishing **(b)** longing
(c) itching **(d)** loathing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) longing
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary
The blank needs a noun meaning "a strong desire". "the **longing** to be a great artist" fits best.
("longing" = तीव्र इच्छा।)
Word meanings
• **wishing** – (a verb form) not a noun here.
• **longing** – a strong wish/desire (लालसा). ✓
• **itching** – restless urge (for informal use); weaker here.
• **loathing** – intense hatred (घृणा) – opposite sense.

Q.248 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(a) became **(b)** become
(c) becomes **(d)** becoming

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) become
Type: Cloze Test – Emphatic "did"
Rule: After the emphatic auxiliary "**did**", we use the **base verb (V1)**. "He **did become** a great artist."
("did" के बाद क्रिया की पहली फॉर्म (base verb) आती है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **became** – past form cannot follow "did".
• **becomes / becoming** – wrong forms after "did".

Q.249 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(a) released **(b)** abandoned
(c) expelled **(d)** discharged

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) abandoned
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary
"he **abandoned** the brush forever" = he gave up painting completely.
("abandoned" = हमेशा के लिए छोड़ दिया।)

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Explanation (contd.)
Word meanings
• **released** – set free (छोड़ना, मुक्त करना) – wrong sense.
• **abandoned** – gave up completely (त्याग दिया). ✓
• **expelled** – threw out (निकाल देना).
• **discharged** – released from duty (कार्यमुक्त करना).

Q.250 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 6.

(a) into **(b)** inside
(c) over **(d)** among

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) into
Type: Cloze Test – Preposition
Rule: We "put energy **into** something" (direction of effort).
"He put his soul and energy **into** his work."
("put ... into" = किसी काम में लगाना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **inside / over / among** – none collocates with "put energy ___ his work".

Q.251 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 7.

(a) blew **(b)** wore
(c) cut **(d)** let

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) wore
Type: Cloze Test – Phrasal Verb
Rule: "**wear (somebody) out**" = to exhaust/tire completely.
Past form → **wore out**.
("wear out" = थका देना; past रूप "wore out"।)
Why the others are wrong
• **blew / cut / let** – "blew out", "cut out", "let out" do not mean "to exhaust a person".

Q.252 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 8.

(a) but **(b)** absolutely
(c) exactly **(d)** just

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) just
Type: Cloze Test – Word Choice
"each sufferer was more than **just** a case" = more than merely a case.
("more than just" = केवल ... से बढ़कर।)
Why the others are wrong
• **but** – a conjunction, does not fit "more than ___ a case".
• **absolutely / exactly** – do not give the "merely" sense needed after "more than".

Q.253 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 9.

(a) fight **(b)** mutiny
(c) scuffle **(d)** rivalry

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) fight
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary/Collocation
"the **fight** against hydrophobia" = the struggle against the disease (later called "a battle").

Explanation (contd.)
("fight against" = ... के विरुद्ध संघर्ष।)
Word meanings
• **fight** – a struggle/battle (संघर्ष). ✓
• **mutiny** – a rebellion by soldiers/sailors (विद्रोह).
• **scuffle** – a small, confused fight (हाथापाई).
• **rivalry** – competition (प्रतिद्वंद्विता).

Q.254 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 10.

(a) developed **(b)** decided
(c) devised **(d)** determined

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) determined
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary/Collocation
"he was **determined** to win at any cost" = firmly decided to win.
("determined to" = ... के लिए दृढ़ संकल्पित।)
Why the others are wrong
• **developed / devised** – do not fit "___ to win".
• **decided** – possible, but "determined to win at any cost" is the natural, stronger collocation.

Cloze Passage 38 (Q.255–Q.264)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Despite all the research every one of us catches cold and most of us catch (1) _____ frequently. Our failure to control one of (2) _____ commonest of all ailments sometimes seems ridiculous. (3) _____ science regularly practises transplant surgery and (4) _____ rid whole countries of such killing (5) _____ as Typhus and the Plague. But the (6) _____ of common cold is unusually difficult and (7) _____ is yet to be done to solve it.

It is known that a cold (8) _____ caused by one of the number (9) _____ viral infections that affect the lining of the (10) _____ and the other passages leading to the lungs but the confusing variety of viruses makes study and remedy very difficult.

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Q.255 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(a) it **(b)** one
(c) these **(d)** this

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) it
Type: Cloze Test – Pronoun
The sentence is: "most of us catch (1)___ frequently." The blank stands for the thing we catch, i.e. **cold** (a singular, uncountable idea). The pronoun that replaces a single already-named thing is **it**.
(जो चीज़ पहले बताई जा चुकी है — यहाँ *cold* — उसके लिए **it** का प्रयोग होता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **one** – used for countable nouns (a cold... another one); here it breaks the flow.
• **these** – plural; but "cold" here is one idea, not many.

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Explanation (contd.)
• **this** – a pointing word (demonstrative), not natural as an object of "catch".

Q.256 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(a) most **(b)** more
(c) a **(d)** the

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the
Grammar Rule: Article with Superlative
Before a **superlative** adjective (commonest, best, largest) we always use **the**.
(सुपरलेटिव यानी सबसे बड़ी/सबसे आम डिग्री से पहले हमेशा **the** लगता है।)
Application
"one of (2)___ commonest of all ailments" → **the commonest**. "one of the + superlative + plural noun" is a fixed SSC structure.
Why the others are wrong
• **most / more / a** – none can sit before the superlative "commonest"; only **the** can.

Q.257 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(a) Geological **(b)** Medical
(c) Electrical **(d)** Chemical

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Medical
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary/Context
The blank describes the science that "practises transplant surgery" and cures diseases like Typhus and Plague. That branch is **Medical science**.
(जो विज्ञान सर्जरी और बीमारियों का इलाज करता है वह **Medical science** है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Geological** – study of rocks/earth.
• **Electrical** – about electricity.
• **Chemical** – about chemicals; none deals with surgery or disease-cure.

Q.258 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(a) have **(b)** has
(c) had **(d)** has been

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) has
Grammar Rule: Present Perfect (has + V3)
"Science ... (4)___ rid whole countries of ... diseases." A single, non-count subject (*science*) takes **has**, and "rid" is the past participle → **has rid** (present perfect: an action completed with present relevance).
(एकवचन कर्ता के साथ **has** + क्रिया की तीसरी फॉर्म — यहाँ has rid — का प्रयोग होता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **have** – used with plural subjects / I / you; wrong for "science".
• **had** – past perfect, needs a second past action; context is general/present.
• **has been** – needs an -ing or adjective after it, not "rid".

Q.259 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(a) Diseases **(b)** Sickness
(c) illness **(d)** Ailment

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Diseases
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary
"such killing (5)___ as Typhus and the Plague." Typhus and Plague are **diseases**. The plural "such ... as" structure also needs a plural noun → **diseases**.
(Typhus और Plague — ये बीमारियाँ (diseases) हैं।)
Word meanings
• **Disease** – a named illness with a cause (रोग).
• **Sickness/Illness** – general feeling of being unwell (बीमार होना); usually uncountable, so "such sicknesses as" is unnatural.
• **Ailment** – a minor illness (छोटी बीमारी); Plague is not minor.

Q.260 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 6.

(a) Setback **(b)** Hitch
(c) Problem **(d)** Difficulty

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Problem
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary/Collocation
"But the (6)___ of common cold is unusually difficult." The best fit is **problem** – "the problem of the common cold is difficult (to solve)."
(यहाँ 'problem' यानी समस्या सबसे सही बैठता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **Setback** – a sudden reverse in progress (झटका); does not sit with "of common cold".
• **Hitch** – a small, temporary difficulty (छोटी रुकावट); too weak.
• **Difficulty** – possible, but then "difficulty is difficult" repeats the idea awkwardly. **Problem** is cleaner.

Q.261 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 7.

(a) Little **(b)** many
(c) few **(d)** much

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) much
Grammar Rule: much vs many
Much = with uncountable nouns (work, water). **Many** = with countable plurals (books).
(**Much** अनगिनत के साथ, **many** गिनने योग्य बहुवचन के साथ।)
Application
"(7)___ is yet to be done to solve it." The hidden noun is *work* (uncountable) → **much is yet to be done**.
Why the others are wrong
• **Little / few / many** – "little" needs a noun after it, "few/many" are for countables; the verb "is" (singular) also demands **much**.

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Q.262 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 8.

(a) was **(b)** is
(c) are **(d)** were

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) is
Grammar Rule: Passive – Subject-Verb Agreement
"a cold (8)___ caused by ..." A cold does not cause; it **is caused** (passive: is + V3). Subject "a cold" is singular → **is**.
(निष्क्रिय वाच्य में एकवचन कर्ता के साथ **is + V3** — यहाँ is caused।)
Why the others are wrong
• **was** – past tense; the passage speaks of a general fact (present).
• **are / were** – plural verbs; "a cold" is singular.

Q.263 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 9.

(a) for **(b)** with
(c) of **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) of
Grammar Rule: Preposition in "number of"
The fixed phrase is **a number of + plural noun** = many. So "one of the number **of** viral infections."
(**a number of** = बहुत सारे; इसके साथ हमेशा **of** आता है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **for / with / in** – none collocates with "number ___ viral infections"; only **of** does.

Q.264 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 10.

(a) ears **(b)** tongue
(c) nose **(d)** eyes

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) nose
Type: Cloze Test – Context/Logic
"viral infections that affect the lining of the (10)___ and the other passages leading to the lungs." Air reaches the lungs through the **nose**; a cold blocks the nose. → **nose**.
(जुकाम नाक (nose) को प्रभावित करता है, और नाक से ही हवा फेफड़ों तक जाती है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **ears** – not a passage to the lungs.
• **tongue** – part of the mouth for taste, not an air passage to the lungs.
• **eyes** – not connected to breathing passages.

Cloze Passage 39 (Q.265–Q.269)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Two Pandas are expected to be returned to China (1) _____ a zoo in Canada because of a (2) _____ of bamboo. Pandas only eat fresh bamboo (3) _____ which the zoo had been importing from China (4) _____ corona virus grounded most flights. The pandas (5) _____ in Canada in 2014 and were due to stay for 10 years.

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Q.265 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(a) for **(b)** with
(c) from **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) from
Grammar Rule: Preposition "return from a place"
When something is sent back away from a place, we use **from** (source). "returned to China **from** a zoo in Canada."
(जहाँ से कोई चीज़ भेजी जाती है, उस स्रोत के लिए **from**।)
Why the others are wrong
• **for / with / in** – none shows the source "a zoo in Canada"; only **from** does.

Q.266 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(a) excess **(b)** surplus
(c) shortage **(d)** storage

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) shortage
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary/Context
The pandas are returned *"because of a ___ of bamboo"* — clearly a **lack/shortage** of bamboo (they could not get enough).
(**shortage** = कमी।)
Why the others are wrong
• **excess / surplus** – mean "too much"; opposite of the context.
• **storage** – means keeping/storing; does not fit "because of a ___ of bamboo".

Q.267 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(a) nourishment **(b)** plants
(c) food **(d)** meal

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) plants
Type: Cloze Test – Collocation
"Pandas only eat fresh bamboo ___ which the zoo had been importing." The natural noun is **plants** → "fresh bamboo plants."
(**bamboo plants** = बाँस के पौधे — यह स्वाभाविक शब्द-संगति है।)
Why the others are wrong
• **nourishment / food / meal** – vague; "fresh bamboo plants" is the precise, natural collocation, and pandas eat the plant itself.

Q.268 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(a) unless **(b)** after
(c) while **(d)** until

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) until
Grammar Rule: Conjunction "until" (up to a point of time)
Until = up to the time that something happens. "importing from China **until** corona virus grounded most flights" (importing continued up to that point).
(**until** = जब तक (कोई घटना न हो) — किसी समय-बिंदु तक।)
Why the others are wrong

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Explanation (contd.)
• **unless** – means "if not" (condition), not time.
• **after** – would reverse the time order.
• **while** – means "during"; but here one action **stopped** the other, so "until" fits.

Q.269 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(a) had been arriving **(b)** have arrived
(c) had arrived **(d)** arrive

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) had arrived
Grammar Rule: Past Perfect (had + V3)
For an action completed **before** another past reference, use **past perfect (had + V3)**. The pandas' arrival in **2014** is earlier background to the present story → **had arrived**.
(भूतकाल की किसी घटना से भी पहले हुई घटना के लिए **had + V3**।)
Why the others are wrong
• **had been arriving** – shows a long continuous action; arrival is a one-time event.
• **have arrived** – present perfect; but a fixed past year "in 2014" needs a past form.
• **arrive** – simple present; wrong tense for 2014.

Cloze Passage 40 (Q.270–Q.279)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Twenty five years ago, while travelling and teaching in Turkey, Nepal and Iran, Bonnie Bergin noticed self-sufficient disabled people (1) _____ about their daily business, often using donkeys (2) _____ pots, pans and other wares to be sold. (3) _____ later returned to the United States (4) _____ work on a master's degree in special education.

"I (5) _____ hard about what could be done to get such (6) _____ out of institutions and onto the streets, getting jobs, (7) _____ it came to me: dogs," says Bergin, (8) _____ today is the originator of the service-dog (9) _____. She ran into fierce resistance (10) _____ academics and professionals at first who said 'Dogs spread disease'.

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Q.270 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 1.

(a) going **(b)** to go
(c) gone **(d)** went

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) going
Grammar Rule: Verb of Perception + V-ing
After "noticed / saw / watched + object", we use the **-ing** form to show an action in progress.
(noticed/saw के बाद क्रिया की **-ing** फॉर्म आती है।)
Application
"noticed ... disabled people (1)___ about their daily business" → **going** about their business (busy doing daily work).
Why the others are wrong
• **to go** – wrong pattern after "noticed people".
• **gone** – past participle; gives passive/finished sense, not an ongoing action.

Explanation (contd.)
• **went** – a finite past verb cannot follow "noticed people".

Q.271 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 2.

(a) carrying **(b)** to carry
(c) carry **(d)** carried

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) to carry
Grammar Rule: Infinitive of Purpose (to + V1)
To show **purpose** (why something is used), we use **to + verb**.
(किसी काम का उद्देश्य बताने के लिए **to + verb** का प्रयोग होता है।)
Application
"using donkeys (2)___ pots, pans and other wares" → donkeys **to carry** goods (purpose = for carrying).
Why the others are wrong
• **carrying** – would need to describe the donkeys themselves, but here purpose is meant.
• **carry / carried** – bare/past forms cannot show purpose after "donkeys".

Q.272 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 3.

(a) It **(b)** They
(c) You **(d)** She

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She
Type: Cloze Test – Pronoun/Reference
The passage is about **Bonnie Bergin**, a woman. The subject who "later returned to the United States" is she.
(पूरा passage Bonnie Bergin (एक महिला) के बारे में है, इसलिए **She**।)
Why the others are wrong
• **It** – used for things/animals, not a named person.
• **They** – plural; only one person returned.
• **You** – second person; the passage is a third-person account.

Q.273 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 4.

(a) begin **(b)** began
(c) to begin **(d)** beginning

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) to begin
Grammar Rule: Infinitive of Purpose
Again purpose is shown by **to + V1**. "returned to the United States (4)___ work on a master's degree" → **to begin** work (purpose of returning).
(वापस लौटने का उद्देश्य — 'to begin work' यानी काम शुरू करना।)
Why the others are wrong
• **begin / began** – bare or past forms cannot show purpose here.
• **beginning** – an -ing form would need a different structure ("for beginning"), which is not offered.

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Q.274 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 5.

(a) assumed **(b)** supposed
(c) felt **(d)** thought

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) thought
Type: Cloze Test – Collocation
The natural phrase is **"think hard about"** = to consider deeply. Past tense → **thought hard**.
(**think hard about** = गहराई से सोचना; भूतकाल में **thought**।)
Why the others are wrong
• **assumed** (मान लिया) / **supposed** (अनुमान लगाया) / **felt** (महसूस किया) – none collocates with "hard about what could be done". Only "thought hard" is idiomatic.

Q.275 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 6.

(a) persons **(b)** women
(c) people **(d)** men

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) people
Type: Cloze Test – Context
The passage speaks of **disabled people** who should get jobs and independence. The blank repeats that group → **such people**.
(यहाँ 'such people' यानी वही (विकलांग) लोग।)
Why the others are wrong
• **persons** – too formal/legal; "people" is the natural word here and matches the earlier "disabled people".
• **women / men** – the passage never limits the group to one gender.

Q.276 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 7.

(a) so **(b)** but
(c) because **(d)** and

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) and
Grammar Rule: Conjunction of Addition
And joins two ideas that move in the **same direction**. Here one positive idea leads to another: "getting jobs, (7)___ it came to me: dogs" → **and**.
(समान दिशा वाले दो विचारों को जोड़ने के लिए **and**।)
Why the others are wrong
• **so** – shows result; the second part is a sudden idea, not a result.
• **but** – shows contrast; there is no contrast.
• **because** – shows cause; meaning does not fit.

Q.277 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 8.

(a) which **(b)** who
(c) that **(d)** whom

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) who
Grammar Rule: Relative Pronoun for Persons
For a **person** acting as the subject of the next clause, use **who**.
(व्यक्ति (subject) के लिए **who** का प्रयोग होता है।)
Application
Explanation (contd.)
"Bergin, (8)___ today is the originator of the service-dog..." → **who** today is the originator.
Why the others are wrong
• **which / that** – "which" is for things; "that" is not used after a comma (non-defining clause).
• **whom** – used for the object, but here the pronoun is the subject of "is".

Q.278 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 9.

(a) assumption **(b)** perception
(c) impression **(d)** concept

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) concept
Type: Cloze Test – Vocabulary
Bergin started a whole **idea/system** — the service-dog **concept** (a new idea put into practice).
(**concept** = विचार/संकल्पना।)
Word meanings
• **assumption** – something taken as true without proof (मान्यता).
• **perception** – the way one sees/understands something (धारणा).
• **impression** – a feeling or effect on the mind (प्रभाव).
• **concept** – an original idea or plan → best fits "originator of the ___".

Q.279 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank no. 10.

(a) for **(b)** of
(c) with **(d)** from

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) from
Grammar Rule: Preposition with "resistance"
The fixed collocation is **resistance from (someone)** = opposition coming from a source.
(**resistance from** = किसी की ओर से विरोध।)
Application
"She ran into fierce resistance (10)___ academics and professionals" → **from** academics.
Why the others are wrong
• **for / of / with** – none is used to show the source of resistance; only **from** shows "coming from".

Cloze Passage 41 (Q.280–Q.284)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

All the children (1)_____ quite excited when their teacher said they should organise the show on their own. He assured (2)_____ that the principal would give them the financial assistance necessary for (3)_____ costumes, for the exhibition and sale they were to set up, and for any other expenditure to be (4)_____ on account (5)_____ the show.

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Q.280 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(a) be **(b)** were
(c) will **(d)** was

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) were
Answer: 2 (**were**)
Explanation:
The sentence is in the past tense, referring to the children's reaction when the teacher spoke.

- **Be** – Base form; incorrect here.
- **Were** – Past tense plural form of "be"; fits perfectly with "all the children."
- **Will** – Future tense; inappropriate for past context.
- **Was** – Past tense singular form; incorrect with plural subject.

Therefore, **"were"** is the correct choice for blank number 1.

Q.281 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(a) him **(b)** them
(c) you **(d)** her

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) them
Answer: 2 (**them**)
Explanation:
The sentence refers to the teacher assuring **the children**, so the pronoun must be plural.

- **Him** – Singular male pronoun; incorrect.
- **Them** – Plural pronoun referring to the children; correct choice.
- **You** – Second person pronoun; incorrect here.
- **Her** – Singular female pronoun; incorrect.

Therefore, **"them"** is the correct choice for blank number 2.

Q.282 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(a) there **(b)** they'll
(c) their **(d)** they're

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) their
Answer: 3 (**their**)
Explanation:
The blank refers to possession of the costumes by the children.

- **There** – Refers to a place; incorrect here.
- **They'll** – Contraction of "they will"; does not fit grammatically.
- **Their** – Possessive pronoun referring to something belonging to them; correct choice.
- **They're** – Contraction of "they are"; incorrect here.

Therefore, **"their"** is the correct word for blank number 3.

Q.283 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(a) demurred **(b)** incurred
(c) blurred **(d)** conquered

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) incurred
Answer: 2 (**incurred**)
Explanation:
The sentence refers to expenses that will be **charged or borne** on account of the show.

- **Demurred** – Means objected or hesitated; incorrect in this context.
- **Incurred** – Means became subject to or brought upon oneself, especially expenses; fits perfectly.
- **Blurred** – Means made unclear; unrelated here.
- **Conquered** – Means overcome or defeated; not relevant.

Therefore, **"incurred"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 4.

Q.284 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(a) of **(b)** off
(c) by **(d)** on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) of
Answer: 1 (**of**)
Explanation:
The phrase "on account of" means **because of** or **due to**.

- **Of** – Correct word to complete the phrase "on account of."
- **Off** – Incorrect preposition in this context.
- **By** – Incorrect preposition here.
- **On** – Already part of the phrase, but cannot be repeated here.

Therefore, **"of"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 5.

Cloze Passage 42 (Q.285–Q.289)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The environment of the earth is a great (1)___ to mankind. It is a pity that this environment is in grave danger of being (2)____, and that this danger is being posed by man himself. Humans have seldom given thought to the fact that the air they breathe, the water they drink, or the food they eat could be (3)____. They have always assumed the bounties of nature to be inexhaustible. There is little (4)_____ on their part that what they consider progress is seriously disturbing the ecological balance and (5)_____ to the breakdown of the life-supporting systems on the earth.

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Q.285 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) challenge **(b)** demand
(c) want **(d)** blessing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) blessing
Answer: 4 (**blessing**)
Explanation:
The sentence states that the environment is something positive and beneficial to mankind.

- **Challenge** – Something difficult or demanding; not fitting the positive tone here.
- **Demand** – A need or requirement; does not fit the context.
- **Want** – A lack or deficiency; opposite of what is intended.
- **Blessing** – Something good or beneficial; fits perfectly here.

Therefore, the most appropriate word for blank number 1 is **"blessing."**

Q.286 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) tried **(b)** destroyed
(c) spoiled **(d)** tampered

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) destroyed
Answer: 2 (**destroyed**)
Explanation:
The sentence talks about the environment being in grave danger, so the blank needs a word indicating serious harm or ruin.

- **Tried** – Means attempted; does not fit here.
- **Destroyed** – Means completely ruined or damaged; fits perfectly.
- **Spoiled** – Means damaged or made unpleasant; less strong than destroyed but possible.
- **Tampered** – Means interfered with improperly; less severe and usually with something smaller or specific.

Among these, **"destroyed"** best conveys the serious threat mentioned in the sentence.
Therefore, **"destroyed"** is the most appropriate choice for blank number 2.

Q.287 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) demanded **(b)** exhausted
(c) enjoyed **(d)** delighted

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) exhausted
Answer: 2 (**exhausted**)
Explanation:
The sentence highlights that humans have not thought about the possibility that essential natural resources like air, water, and food could be depleted.

- **Demanded** – Means requested or required; does not fit the context here.
- **Exhausted** – Means used up completely or depleted; fits perfectly.
- **Enjoyed** – Means experienced with pleasure; unrelated.
- **Delighted** – Means very pleased; unrelated.

Explanation (contd.)
Therefore, **"exhausted"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 3.

Q.288 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) realisation **(b)** expectation
(c) hope **(d)** dream

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) realisation
Answer: 1 (**realisation**)
Explanation:
The sentence refers to the lack of awareness or understanding among humans about the harmful impact of their actions.

- **Realisation** – Means awareness or understanding; fits perfectly here.
- **Expectation** – Means anticipation or belief about the future; unrelated.
- **Hope** – Means desire for a positive outcome; does not fit the context.
- **Dream** – Means aspiration or fantasy; unrelated.

Therefore, **"realisation"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 4.

Q.289 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(a) creating **(b)** leading
(c) managing **(d)** dealing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) leading
Answer: 2 (**leading**)
Explanation:
The sentence describes how the lack of realization about the impact of human progress is causing a negative outcome.

- **Creating** – Means to make or produce; not the best fit here.
- **Leading** – Means causing or resulting in; fits perfectly to show causation.
- **Managing** – Means handling or controlling; does not fit the context.
- **Dealing** – Means handling or coping with; unrelated here.

Therefore, **"leading"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 5.

Cloze Passage 43 (Q.290–Q.294)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

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Passage (contd.)
In India, of late, pizza has become a (1)_____ food. It has become a fashion trend and also a fashion statement. The popularity of the food is rocketing. This is (2)____ from a report by Fortune magazine. The two giants of the pizza industry, Pizza Hut and Dominos, are in hot (3)_____, a manner of showing that one is part of the famous Western culture. In fact, it is more of an issue with each other in India. India has 134 Pizza Huts and 149 Dominos locations, with each chain opening 50 stores a year. The popularity of pizza in India, Fortune claims, is because of its similarity to India's native cuisine. Unlike Chinese and Japanese, Indians eat leavened bread (roti or naan), and a popular traditional version slathers it in butter and garlic —not unlike garlic bread, the most often ordered side dish at both Dominos and Pizza Hut franchises in India. Cheese (paneer) is ubiquitous in India's northern cuisine. Tomatoes and all kinds of sauces are (4)_____ everywhere. Combine these ingredients into one gooey, oily, tasty dish that you can eat with your hands—as Indians traditionally do—and you have a hit. Compare this with other popular foods or noodles. Sometimes, it slurps down our forks and off the plate, and here we end up with a whole lot of (5)____. The one thing that increases the love for pizza among one and all is that we can all eat it with our hands.

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Q.290 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) traditional **(b)** standard
(c) staple **(d)** popular

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) popular
Answer: 4 (**popular**)
Explanation:
The passage discusses how pizza has become trendy and widely liked in India.
- **Traditional** – Refers to something long-established or native, which pizza is not in India.
- **Standard** – Means usual or typical; less appropriate here.
- **Staple** – A basic or essential food item; pizza is more of a trend than a staple.
- **Popular** – Means widely liked or accepted; fits perfectly to describe pizza's current status.

Therefore, **"popular"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 1.

Q.291 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) evident **(b)** mentioned
(c) natural **(d)** just

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) evident
Answer: 1 (**evident**)
Explanation:
The sentence suggests that the increasing popularity of pizza is clear or obvious from the report.
- **Evident** – Means clearly seen or understood; fits perfectly here.

Explanation (contd.)
- **Mentioned** – Means simply stated; less strong and less appropriate.
- **Natural** – Means inherent or expected; less fitting.
- **Just** – Means recently or simply; doesn't fit the context.

Therefore, **"evident"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 2.

Q.292 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) debate **(b)** discussion
(c) topic **(d)** competition

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) competition
Answer: 4 (**competition**)
Explanation:
The sentence refers to Pizza Hut and Dominos being in hot _____, indicating rivalry or contest.
- **Debate** – A formal discussion or argument; less suitable here.
- **Discussion** – A conversation or talk; not fitting the competitive context.
- **Topic** – Subject of discussion; inappropriate here.
- **Competition** – Means rivalry or contest; fits perfectly to describe the relationship between the two companies.

Therefore, **"competition"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 3.

Q.293 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) ascendant **(b)** prevalent
(c) rare **(d)** powerful

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) prevalent
Answer: 2 (**prevalent**)
Explanation:
The sentence talks about tomatoes and sauces being commonly found everywhere.
- **Ascendant** – Means rising or increasing in power; not the best fit here.
- **Prevalent** – Means widespread or commonly occurring; fits perfectly.
- **Rare** – Means uncommon; opposite of what is needed.
- **Powerful** – Means having great power; unrelated in this context.

Therefore, **"prevalent"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 4.

Q.294 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(a) pleasure **(b)** mess
(c) carelessness **(d)** enjoyment

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) mess
Answer: 2 (**mess**)
Explanation:
The sentence describes food that sometimes falls off the plate, resulting in something undesirable.
- **Pleasure** – Means enjoyment; does not fit the negative consequence described.

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Explanation (contd.)

- **Mess** – Means untidiness or disorder; fits perfectly with food spilling off the plate.
- **Carelessness** – Means lack of attention or caution; less direct for the context.
- **Enjoyment** – Means pleasure or delight; opposite of what is implied here.

Therefore, **"mess"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 5.

Cloze Passage 44 (Q.295–Q.299)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The Ph.D degree is the most (1)____ degree of any university. The quality of a Ph.D is of utmost importance as it brings prestige and (2)_____ towards creating an ambience of innovation through research. It provides a platform for innovative thinking along with higher (3)_____ qualification. (4)_____, the university maintains the quality at a very high level. The programme (5)_____ that it is not an end in itself, but a means for a fruitful research career.

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Q.295 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) intelligent **(b)** attractive
(c) important **(d)** fashionable

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) important
Answer: 3 (**important**)
Explanation:
The sentence describes the Ph.D degree as the most ___ degree of any university, emphasizing its significance.

- **Intelligent** – Describes a person or action, not a degree.
- **Attractive** – Refers to appearance or appeal, less appropriate here.
- **Important** – Fits perfectly to describe the degree's significance.
- **Fashionable** – Means trendy or popular, not suitable for academic degrees.

So, the most appropriate word to fill in the blank is **"important."**

Q.296 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) contributes **(b)** efforts
(c) goes **(d)** develops

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) contributes
Answer: 1 (**contributes**)
Explanation:
The sentence indicates that the Ph.D degree brings prestige and something that helps in creating an ambience of innovation through research.

- **Contributes** – Means to help or add to something; fits perfectly here.
- **Efforts** – A noun; grammatically incorrect here following "and."
- **Goes** – Does not fit grammatically in this context.

Explanation (contd.)

- **Develops** – Usually requires an object; less suitable here.

Therefore, **"contributes"** is the most appropriate choice for blank number 2.

Q.297 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) technical **(b)** skill-based
(c) academic **(d)** professional

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) academic
Answer: 3 (**academic**)
Explanation:
The sentence refers to the Ph.D as a higher qualification associated with innovative thinking.

- **Technical** – Relates to specific technical skills; less suitable for a degree description.
- **Skill-based** – Focuses on practical skills; not typical for describing Ph.D qualifications.
- **Academic** – Refers to scholarly education and qualifications; fits perfectly here.
- **Professional** – Relates to a profession or job; less fitting for a research degree context.

Therefore, **"academic"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 3.

Q.298 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) Because **(b)** So
(c) Although **(d)** Since

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) So
Answer: 2 (**So**)
Explanation:
The sentence suggests a cause-and-effect relationship between the importance of the Ph.D and the university maintaining high quality.

- **Because** – Typically introduces a reason before a result, less fitting here since the previous sentence already states the importance.
- **So** – Indicates result or consequence; fits perfectly to show that due to importance, the university maintains high quality.
- **Although** – Indicates contrast; not suitable here.
- **Since** – Can mean "because," but "so" better expresses result in this context.

Therefore, **"So"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 4.

Q.299 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(a) ensures **(b)** reflects
(c) decides **(d)** mentions

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ensures
Answer: 1 (**ensures**)
Explanation:
The sentence suggests that the programme actively guarantees or makes certain that the Ph.D is not just an end in itself but a means for a fruitful research career.

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Explanation (contd.)

- **Ensures** means to **guarantee or secure**, which fits the idea that the programme confirms this purpose clearly and firmly.
- Other options like "mentions" imply merely stating without guaranteeing, but here a stronger meaning is suitable.

Therefore, **"ensures"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 5.

Cloze Passage 45 (Q.300–Q.304)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

I was (1)_____ to know how hearing is different from listening. I had thought both were (2)_____, but gradually, I realised there is a big difference between the two words.

Hearing is a physical phenomenon. Whenever somebody speaks, the sound waves generated reach you, and you definitely hear whatever is said to you. (3)_____ using your mind to understand whatever is being said is listening.

Diving deeper, I found that listening is not only hearing with (4)_____, but is much more than that. Listening is hearing with full attention and applying our (5)_____.

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Q.300 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) joyous **(b)** nervous
(c) suspicious **(d)** curious

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) curious

Answer: 4 (**curious**)

Explanation:

The sentence expresses a desire to learn or understand something new.

- **Joyous** – Means very happy; doesn't fit the context of seeking understanding.
- **Nervous** – Means anxious or worried; not appropriate here.
- **Suspicious** – Means distrustful or doubtful; unrelated.
- **Curious** – Means eager to learn or know; fits perfectly.

Therefore, **"curious"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 1.

Q.301 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) acronyms **(b)** synonyms
(c) antonyms **(d)** homonyms

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) synonyms

Answer: 2 (**synonyms**)

Explanation:

The sentence says the person initially thought the two words had the same meaning.

- **Acronyms** – Words formed from the initial letters of other words; unrelated.

Explanation (contd.)

- **Synonyms** – Words with the same or similar meanings; fits perfectly here.
- **Antonyms** – Words with opposite meanings; opposite of what is intended.
- **Homonyms** – Words that sound alike but have different meanings; not appropriate here.

Therefore, **"synonyms"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 2.

Q.302 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) Emotionlessly **(b)** Rapaciously
(c) Countlessly **(d)** Consciously

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Consciously

Answer: 4 (**Consciously**)

Explanation:

The sentence explains that listening involves actively using your mind to understand.

- **Emotionlessly** – Without emotion; irrelevant here.
- **Rapaciously** – Aggressively greedy; unrelated.
- **Countlessly** – Not a standard English word; incorrect.
- **Consciously** – Means with awareness and intention; fits perfectly.

Therefore, **"consciously"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 3.

Q.303 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) communication **(b)** satisfaction
(c) concentration **(d)** classification

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) concentration

Answer: 3 (**concentration**)

Explanation:

The sentence highlights that listening involves hearing with focus and attention.

- **Communication** – The act of sharing information; doesn't fit here.
- **Satisfaction** – A feeling of contentment; unrelated.
- **Concentration** – The ability to focus attention; fits perfectly.
- **Classification** – The act of categorizing; irrelevant here.

Therefore, **"concentration"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 4.

Q.304 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(a) mind **(b)** trend
(c) skill **(d)** talent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) mind

Answer: 1 (**mind**)

Explanation:

The sentence emphasizes that listening involves full attention and the application of our mental faculties.

- **Mind** – Refers to the intellect or consciousness; fits perfectly here.

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Explanation (contd.)

- **Trend** – Refers to a general direction or fashion; irrelevant.
- **Skill** – Means ability; while related, the sentence highlights mental involvement more than just ability.
- **Talent** – Natural aptitude; less fitting in this context.

Therefore, **"mind"** is the most appropriate word for blank number 5.

Cloze Passage 46 (Q.305–Q.309)

In the following passage some words have been deleted.

Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

The Statue of Unity, a towering tribute to India's Iron Man, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, 1. _____on the banks of the majestic Sardar Sarovar Dam in Gujarat's Kevadia, has 2. _____a remarkable surge in its annual footfall. In less than five years 3. _____its inauguration, this colossal monument has welcomed nearly 16 crore 4. _____. In the first two months after the monument's inauguration in 2028, the world's 5. _____statue witnessed a whopping 453,020 visitors followed by over 2.7 crore visitors in 2019. Even in 2020, the year tourism sector was battered by a once-in-a-century pandemic and subsequent movement restrictions, nearly 1.3 crore tourists flocked .to the Statue of Unity. While the country was still recovering from the Covid-19 pandemic, the Statue of Unity saw a footfall of over 3.4 crores.

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Q.305 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 1.

(a) found **(b)** established
(c) situated **(d)** appeared

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) situated

Solution:

- The sentence: *"The Statue of Unity, a towering tribute to India's Iron Man, Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, __ on the banks of the majestic Sardar Sarovar Dam..."*
- The word **"situated"** is the most appropriate to describe **location**.
- Other options:
  - **found** – incorrect tense and meaning in this context.
  - **established** – used more for institutions or ideas, not physical location.
  - **appeared** – implies sudden/unexpected presence, unsuitable here.

Therefore, the correct answer is: situated.

Q.306 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 2.

(a) witness **(b)** witnessed
(c) witnessing **(d)** witnesses

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) witnessed

Solution:

- The sentence: *"...has _____ a remarkable surge in its annual footfall."*

Explanation (contd.)

- The correct verb form to follow **"has"** is the **past participle**, i.e., **"witnessed"**.
- Other options:
  - **witness** – base form; incorrect after "has".
  - **witnessing** – present participle; incorrect in perfect tense.
  - **witnesses** – present tense; doesn't fit after "has".

Therefore, the correct answer is: witnessed.

Q.307 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 3.

(a) on **(b)** when
(c) before **(d)** since

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) since

Solution:

- The sentence: *"In less than five years _____ its inauguration..."*
- The phrase **"In less than five years since its inauguration"** is the correct and standard expression used to refer to time that has passed **after** a particular event.
- Other options:
  - **on** – incorrect; used for specific dates.
  - **when** – grammatically incorrect in this context.
  - **before** – illogical; it's talking about the time **after** inauguration.

Therefore, the correct answer is: since.

Q.308 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 4.

(a) callers **(b)** visitors
(c) guests **(d)** invitees

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) visitors

Solution:

- The sentence: *"this colossal monument has welcomed nearly 16 crore _____."*
- The context refers to the number of people coming to see a public monument.
- "**Visitors**" is the most appropriate word for people who come to see a place of interest or a tourist attraction.
- Other options:
  - **Callers** – usually refers to people who make phone calls or drop in informally.
  - **Guests** – implies being hosted, not suitable for general footfall.
  - **Invitees** – refers to people formally invited to an event.

Therefore, the correct answer is: visitors.

Q.309 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 5.

(a) most tallest **(b)** tallest
(c) taller **(d)** tall

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) tallest

Solution:

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Explanation (contd.)

- The sentence: *"the world's _____ statue witnessed a whopping 453,020 visitors..."*
- We are comparing **one statue** with **all other statues in the world**.
- In such a case, the **superlative form** is required.

Explanation of options:

- **"tallest"** – Correct superlative form of "tall"
- **"most tallest"** – Grammatically incorrect (double superlative)
- **"taller"** – Comparative, used to compare two things
- **"tall"** – Simple adjective, not suitable in this context

Therefore, the correct answer is: tallest.

Cloze Passage 47 (Q.310–Q.319)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank.

The door behind them was 1._____. There was no escape. A strange light was 2. _____from a corner, one that did not 3. _____ the room but made darkness visible. 4._____alien voice was heard which sounded like jargon, 5. _____to the hapless friends. They went down 6. _____their knees sobbing, pleading for their lives but the 7. _____sounds continued. Slowly, a form seemed to 8._____right before their eyes which 9._____ their blood and chilled their 10._____. It was formless mass with no face!

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Q.310 Select the most appropriate word to fill blank no. 1

(a) unbolted **(b)** sealed
(c) vacant **(d)** ajar

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) sealed

Solution:

The sentence is:
"The door behind them was __."
We need a word that creates a **sense of finality and no escape**, matching the tone of the next sentence: **"There was no escape."**
Let's evaluate the options:

- **unbolted** – Means unlocked; this contradicts "no escape."
- **sealed** – **Correct**, as it implies the door was shut tight with no way to open it.
- **vacant** – Refers to something empty, not suitable for a door.
- **ajar** – Means slightly open, which again contradicts "no escape."

Q.311 Select the most appropriate word to fill blank no. 2

(a) reclining **(b)** emanating
(c) preceding **(d)** commencing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) emanating

Solution:

The sentence is:
"A strange light was __ from a corner..."

Explanation (contd.)

We need a verb that describes how the strange light was coming **out** of the corner. Let's evaluate:

- **reclining** – Means leaning back; irrelevant for a light source.
- **emanating** – **Correct**, it means "originating from" or "coming out from," which fits perfectly here.
- **preceding** – Means coming before; contextually incorrect.
- **commencing** – Means beginning; doesn't fit with the flow of the sentence.

Answer: b (emanating)

Q.312 Select the most appropriate word to fill blank no. 3

(a) illuminate **(b)** ignite
(c) extinguish **(d)** kindle

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) illuminate

Solution:

The sentence is:
"...one that did not __ the room but made darkness visible."
We need a verb related to **lighting** that makes sense with the **negative** structure "did not __ the room."

- **illuminate** – *Correct.* It means "to light up." The sentence says the light *did not* illuminate the room, which fits logically and contrasts well with "made darkness visible."
- **ignite** – Means to set on fire; doesn't fit.
- **extinguish** – Means to put out a light/fire; the context is about producing light, not stopping it.
- **kindle** – Means to start a fire; doesn't suit the contrast structure used here.

Answer: a (illuminate)

Q.313 Select the most appropriate word to fill blank no. 4

(a) A **(b)** Any
(c) The **(d)** An

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) An

Solution:

The sentence is:
"...__ alien voice was heard which sounded like jargon..."
Let's evaluate the options grammatically and contextually:

- **A alien voice** – Incorrect. "A" is used before words that start with a **consonant sound**, but *"alien"* begins with a **vowel sound**, so "a" is grammatically incorrect here.
- **Any alien voice** – Grammatically correct, but sounds vague and awkward in this descriptive, dramatic narrative. Not the best stylistic fit.
- **The alien voice** – "The" is specific, but this is the **first introduction** of the voice; we usually don't use "the" before introducing something for the first time.
- **An alien voice** – Correct. "An" is used before vowel sounds and fits well in introducing something new and unfamiliar, like "an alien voice."

Answer: d (An)

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Q.314 Select the most appropriate word to fill blank no. 5

(a) incomprehensible **(b)** incorrigible
(c) invincible **(d)** indelible

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) incomprehensible
Solution:
The sentence is:
"...which sounded like jargon, ___ to the hapless friends."
We are looking for a word that describes how **jargon** (technical or confusing language) appeared to the **hapless (helpless) friends**.
Let's look at the options:

- **Incomprehensible** – Correct. Means "not understandable." Jargon is often **incomprehensible** to those unfamiliar with it.
- **Incorrigible** – Means "not able to be corrected" (used for people, not language).
- **Invincible** – Means "unbeatable," irrelevant here.
- **Indelible** – Means "unforgettable or cannot be erased," not suited for this context.

Answer: a (incomprehensible)

Q.315 Select the most appropriate word to fill blank no. 6

(a) on **(b)** at
(c) in **(d)** by

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) on
Solution:
The sentence is:
"They went down ___ their knees sobbing, pleading for their lives..."
Let's evaluate the options:

- **on their knees** – Correct usage. The phrase **"go down on one's knees"** is standard English to indicate kneeling.
- **at their knees** – Incorrect; "at" indicates position, not action of kneeling.
- **in their knees** – Grammatically incorrect in this context.
- **by their knees** – Illogical placement.

Answer: a (on)

Q.316 Select the most appropriate word to fill blank no. 7

(a) familiar **(b)** bizarre
(c) regular **(d)** customary

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) bizarre
Solution:
The sentence is:
"...pleading for their lives but the ___ sounds continued."
Let's analyze the meaning and the tone of the passage. It describes a **frightening**, **unusual**, and **mysterious** scene. Therefore, the sounds continuing in such a moment would likely be **strange or disturbing**, not normal.

- **familiar** – Contradicts the scary, unknown atmosphere.
- **bizarre** – Fits the eerie and unnatural tone of the passage perfectly.
- **regular** – Implies normality, which is not appropriate here.
- **customary** – Also means usual or traditional, which is inappropriate.

Q.317 Select the most appropriate word to fill blank no. 8

(a) extract **(b)** assume
(c) derive **(d)** emerge

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) emerge
Solution:
The sentence is:
"Slowly, a form seemed to ___ right before their eyes..."
We're looking for a verb that logically describes something **appearing or becoming visible**, especially in a suspenseful or eerie context.
Let's evaluate the options:

- **extract** – Means to pull something out, doesn't fit the context of something appearing.
- **assume** – Often refers to taking responsibility or supposing something; doesn't fit with a "form" becoming visible.
- **derive** – Means to obtain from a source, not appropriate here.
- **emerge** – Perfect fit. It means to **come into view** or **become visible**, which matches the context of a mysterious form appearing.

Q.318 Select the most appropriate word to fill blank no. 9

(a) spilled **(b)** flowed
(c) locked **(d)** curdled

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) curdled
Solution:
The sentence is:
"...a form seemed to emerge right before their eyes which ___ their blood and chilled their ___."
Let's understand the context:

- The mysterious form is frightening.
- The effect on the observers is intense fear.
- The verb should describe a **visceral, terrifying reaction** in the body.

Now examine the options:

- **spilled** – Not suitable. You can't "spill" someone's blood metaphorically to express fear.
- **flowed** – This is too neutral; doesn't convey fear.
- **locked** – Grammatically and contextually odd.
- **curdled** – Perfect choice. The phrase "**curdle the blood**" is an idiom that means "to horrify or terrify someone."

Correct answer: d (curdled)

Q.319 Select the most appropriate word to fill blank no. 10

(a) eyes **(b)** bones
(c) head **(d)** skin

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) bones
Solution:
The sentence is:
"...a form seemed to emerge right before their eyes which curdled their blood and chilled their ___."
Let's evaluate the options in terms of **common usage and idiomatic expression**:

- **eyes** – Not a typical collocation. "Chilled their eyes" sounds odd and unidiomatic.

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Explanation (contd.)

- **bones** – Very commonly used in the phrase "chilled to the bones," meaning extreme fear or coldness. Fits perfectly here.
- **head** – Doesn't logically follow in this fear-based description.
- **skin** – "Made their skin crawl" is idiomatic, but "chilled their skin" is not common.

Cloze Passage 48 (Q.320–Q.329)

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each number.

Days after Prime Minister Narendra Modi inaugurated the Ghaziabad priority 1. _____of the Delhi-Meerut Rapid Rail Transit System (RRTS), the 2._____of high-rise societies in the National Capital Region called for direct 3. _____to the public transport service points.

The residents in 4. _____areas of Noida and Ghaziabad said they would be forced to continue 5. _____on private vehicles without proper connectivity to the RRTS and 6. _____public transport modes.

"The RRTS is a great development; we want 7. _____connectivity to key points like Metro stations, railway stations, Delhi, and the RRTS. 8. _____any proper public transport, many residents are forced to opt 9. _____a personal car," the president of the New Era Flat Owners Welfare Association, Abhishek Kumar,10. _____.

The 17-km priority section of the Delhi-Ghaziabad-Meerut RRTS corridor was inaugurated by PM Modi on October 7, and it started commercial operations on the next day.

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Q.320 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 1.

(a) piece **(b)** section
(c) fragment **(d)** system

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) section

The correct option must fit logically with the phrase **"Ghaziabad priority __ of the Delhi-Meerut Rapid Rail Transit System (RRTS)"**.

- **"Piece"** – unnatural in the context of transport infrastructure.
- **"Fragment"** – too informal or poetic for technical/official usage.
- **"System"** – redundant, as "RRTS" already means "system".
- **"Section"** – most appropriate; commonly used in transport projects.

Correct sentence:
"...the Ghaziabad priority section of the Delhi-Meerut Rapid Rail Transit System (RRTS)"

Q.321 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 2.

(a) people **(b)** tenants
(c) landlords **(d)** residents

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) residents

Solution:
The blank is in the phrase:
"...the 2. _____ of high-rise societies in the National Capital Region called for direct..."
Let's evaluate the options:

- **people** – vague and generic; not the most precise for the context.
- **tenants** – refers specifically to those who rent, not all occupants.
- **landlords** – refers to owners renting out, not the general population.
- **residents** – accurate and commonly used term for people living in a place (whether owners or tenants).

Correct sentence:
"...the residents of high-rise societies in the National Capital Region called for direct..."

Q.322 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 3.

(a) connecting **(b)** connect
(c) connected **(d)** connectivity

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) connectivity

Solution:
The blank appears in the phrase:
"...called for direct 3. _____ to the public transport service points."
Let's evaluate the options:

- **connecting** – incorrect form; would be used with a noun, not after "direct".
- **connect** – verb form; doesn't fit after "direct".
- **connected** – past participle; incorrect in this noun context.
- **connectivity** – correct noun form; fits grammatically and contextually.

Correct sentence:
"...called for direct connectivity to the public transport service points."

Q.323 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 4.

(a) lot **(b)** many
(c) very **(d)** much

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) many

Solution:
The blank appears in the phrase:
"The residents in 4. _____ areas of Noida and Ghaziabad..."
Let's evaluate the options:

- **lot** – incorrect as a determiner in this context. We say "a lot of", not just "lot".
- **many** – correct. "Many areas" is grammatically sound and contextually appropriate.
- **very** – incorrect here; "very areas" is ungrammatical.

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Explanation (contd.)
- **much** – incorrect with countable nouns like "areas".

Correct sentence:
"The residents in many areas of Noida and Ghaziabad..."

Q.324 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 5.

(a) depends **(b)** depended
(c) depend **(d)** depending

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) depending
Solution:
The sentence is:
"...they would be forced to continue 5. _____ on private vehicles..."
Let's evaluate each option grammatically in the context:
- **depends** – incorrect; singular verb form, doesn't follow "to continue".
- **depended** – incorrect tense; past tense does not follow "to continue".
- **depend** – incorrect; bare infinitive is not used after "continue".
- **depending** – **correct**; "continue" is followed by a gerund/verb-ing form.

Correct sentence:
"...they would be forced to continue depending on private vehicles..."

Q.325 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 6.

(a) another **(b)** extra
(c) further **(d)** other

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) other
Solution:
The sentence is:
"...without proper connectivity to the RRTS and 6. _____ public transport modes."
Let's assess each option for grammatical correctness and context:
- **another** – incorrect; "another" is singular, but "modes" is plural.
- **extra** – grammatically possible but less natural in this context.
- **further** – can work, but it suggests extension rather than alternatives.
- **other** – **correct**; refers to additional/alternative transport modes apart from RRTS.

Correct sentence:
"...without proper connectivity to the RRTS and other public transport modes."

Q.326 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 7.

(a) successive **(b)** upright
(c) direct **(d)** consecutive

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) direct
Solution:
The sentence is:
"The RRTS is a great development; we want 7. _____ connectivity to key points like Metro stations, railway stations, Delhi, and the RRTS."
Let's analyze the options:
- **successive** – means "following one after another" – not suitable here.
- **upright** – relates to posture or morality – irrelevant in this context.
- **direct** – **correct**; "direct connectivity" means connection without detours, which is relevant for transport access.
- **consecutive** – again, implies sequence – doesn't fit the context.

Correct sentence:
"...we want direct connectivity to key points like Metro stations..."

Q.327 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 8.

(a) With **(b)** In spite of
(c) Despite **(d)** Without

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Without
Solution:
The sentence is:
"...8. _____ any proper public transport, many residents are forced to opt for a personal car..."
Let's evaluate the options:
- **With** – incorrect; it would suggest availability of public transport, contradicting the context.
- **In spite of** – grammatically awkward here and implies presence of transport, which again contradicts the point.
- **Despite** – needs a noun or gerund following it and also implies existence of transport. Doesn't fit well.
- **Without** – **correct**; conveys the absence of proper public transport, matching the cause-effect logic of the sentence.

Correct sentence:
"Without any proper public transport, many residents are forced to opt for a personal car..."

Q.328 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 9.

(a) for **(b)** on
(c) of **(d)** to

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) for
Solution:
The sentence is:
"...many residents are forced to opt 9. _____ a personal car..."
Let's evaluate the options:
- **for** – **Correct**. The phrase "opt for" means to choose or select something.

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Explanation (contd.)

- **on** – Incorrect. "Opt on" is not a valid phrasal verb.
- **of** – Incorrect. "Opt of" is grammatically wrong.
- **to** – Incorrect. "Opt to" is used before a **verb**, e.g., "opt to drive", not before a noun like "car".

Correct sentence:
"...many residents are forced to opt for a personal car..."

Q.329 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 10.

(a) professed **(b)** assumed
(c) replied **(d)** said

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) said

Solution:
The sentence is:
"...many residents are forced to opt for a personal car," the president of the New Era Flat Owners Welfare Association, Abhishek Kumar, ___."
Let's evaluate the options:

- **professed** – This usually implies a formal declaration of a belief, which doesn't suit the tone here.
- **assumed** – Incorrect, as it means to suppose something, not to say it.
- **replied** – Not quite appropriate here; no question was asked.
- **said** – **Correct and most appropriate**, as it indicates a simple reporting of Abhishek Kumar's statement.

Correct sentence:
"...many residents are forced to opt for a personal car," the president of the New Era Flat Owners Welfare Association, Abhishek Kumar, said.

Cloze Passage 49 (Q.330–Q.339)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

Reteti is a Samburu community owned elephant sanctuary in Kenya. The sanctuary (1)_____ in orphaned and abandoned elephant calves (2)_____ the aim of releasing them back into the wild (3)_____ adjoining Reteti.

Elephant calves in Northern Kenya are orphaned or (4)_____ due to drought, man-made wells, human-wildlife (5)_____ and natural mortality. The Sanctuary was (6)_____ in response to demands from the local community.

The Reteti keepers are all (7)_____ from within Namunyak Conservancy. The Samburu have been (8)_____ alongside wildlife for thousands of years and have (9)_____ respect for elephants with whom they share the land and (10)_____ resources.

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Q.330 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(a) taking **(b)** took
(c) takes **(d)** take

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) takes

The sentence is:
"The sanctuary (1)_____ in orphaned and abandoned elephant calves..."
We are referring to **Reteti sanctuary**, which is a **singular noun** and still active in the present.

- **"takes"** is the correct **simple present tense** verb used with a singular subject ("sanctuary") to describe a general or habitual action.
- **"take"** is plural (used with "they", not with "it").
- **"took"** is past tense — not appropriate here since the rest of the passage is in the present.
- **"taking"** is a participle and doesn't fit grammatically without a helping verb.

So, the correct and grammatically appropriate choice is **"takes"**.

Q.331 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(a) from **(b)** for
(c) by **(d)** with

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) with

The full sentence is:
"The sanctuary takes in orphaned and abandoned elephant calves (2) _____ the aim of releasing them back into the wild..."
We are looking for a preposition that fits naturally with the phrase **"the aim of..."**.

- **"with the aim of"** is the correct and most commonly used expression to show **purpose or intention**.
- **"from the aim of"**, **"for the aim of"**, and **"by the aim of"** are incorrect and awkward in standard English usage.

Therefore, the correct phrase is:
"The sanctuary takes in orphaned and abandoned elephant calves *with* the aim of releasing them..."

Q.332 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(a) gangs **(b)** flocks
(c) herds **(d)** prides

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) herds

The word that best completes the sentence is **"herds"** because it is the correct collective noun for a group of elephants. The sentence discusses releasing rescued elephant calves back into the wild, where they would join natural groups of their kind.

- **Herds** refers to a group of large animals such as elephants or cattle, making it the most contextually appropriate.
- **Gangs** is informal and usually refers to people, not suitable for wildlife.
- **Flocks** is used for birds and some smaller animals like sheep or goats.
- **Prides** is the collective noun for lions, not elephants.

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Explanation (contd.)
Thus, "herds adjoining Reteti" logically conveys elephants being reintegrated with other elephants in nearby groups.

Q.333 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(a) vacated **(b)** executed
(c) abandoned **(d)** neglected

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) abandoned
The most appropriate word to fill in blank no. 4 is **"abandoned"** because the sentence talks about elephant calves being left without care or support.

- **Abandoned** means left alone or deserted, which fits the context of calves without their mothers due to various causes.
- **Vacated** means to leave a place, generally used for premises, not living beings.
- **Executed** implies being put to death deliberately, which is inappropriate here.
- **Neglected** means not cared for, but it doesn't fully convey the idea of being completely left behind like "abandoned" does.

Thus, "orphaned or abandoned due to drought..." makes the meaning clear and precise.

Q.334 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(a) battle **(b)** fight
(c) conflict **(d)** rivalry

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) conflict
The most appropriate word for blank no. 5 is **"conflict"**.

- The phrase **"human-wildlife conflict"** is a well-established term used to describe the **clashes or negative interactions between humans and wild animals**, often due to shared habitats, threats to livestock, or crop damage.
- **Battle** and **fight** are too aggressive and informal for this context.
- **Rivalry** implies competition, usually between equals or over status/power, which doesn't suit the context of wildlife conservation.

Thus, "human-wildlife **conflict**" accurately conveys the intended meaning in a formal and ecological context.

Q.335 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 6.

(a) recognised **(b)** situated
(c) established **(d)** located

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) established
The most appropriate word for blank no. 6 is **"established"**.

- The sentence talks about **how the sanctuary came into existence** in response to community demands. The correct verb here should reflect **the act of founding or setting up** the sanctuary.
- **"Established"** means **formally set up or founded**, which fits perfectly in this context.
- **"Recognised"** means acknowledged, which doesn't imply creation.

Explanation (contd.)
- **"Situated"** and **"located"** describe placement, not origin or creation.

Hence, **"established"** correctly conveys the idea that the sanctuary was **founded** in response to the local community's needs.

Q.336 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 7.

(a) entered **(b)** installed
(c) recruited **(d)** joined

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) recruited
The most appropriate word for blank no. 7 is **"recruited."**

- The sentence is: *"The Reteti keepers are all _____ from within Namunyak Conservancy."*
- **"Recruited"** fits well as it refers to people being **formally chosen or enlisted for a role or job** — in this case, as elephant keepers.
- It emphasizes that **the staff is selected from the local community**, which aligns with the idea of community involvement.

Other options:
- **"Entered"** – vague and doesn't fit the idea of being hired.
- **"Installed"** – usually used for machines or formal positions, not for people being selected.
- **"Joined"** – sounds informal and doesn't convey the idea of an organized hiring process.

So, **"recruited"** is the most precise and contextually appropriate choice.

Q.337 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 8.

(a) lived **(b)** lives
(c) alive **(d)** living

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) living
The correct option for blank no. 8 is **"living."**

- The sentence is: *"The Samburu have been _____ alongside wildlife for thousands of years..."*
- **"Living"** is the correct continuous participle to go with the present perfect continuous verb form *"have been..."*
- It matches grammatically and logically to convey the **ongoing relationship** between the Samburu people and wildlife over a long period of time.

Other options:
- **"Lived"** – past tense, doesn't fit with "have been"
- **"Lives"** – present tense, subject-verb mismatch
- **"Alive"** – adjective, doesn't fit grammatically here

So, **"living"** is the grammatically and contextually appropriate choice.

Q.338 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 9.

(a) many **(b)** deep
(c) total **(d)** very

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) deep
The best fit is **"deep."**

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Explanation (contd.)

- The phrase becomes: **"have deep respect for elephants"** — a commonly used and meaningful collocation.
- It expresses a **strong and profound admiration**, which suits the context of a conservation-oriented community.

Other options (briefly):

- **Many** – Used for countable nouns; doesn't fit with "respect."
- **Total** – Sounds mechanical or absolute; not natural with "respect."
- **Very** – Needs to modify an adjective, not used correctly here.

Q.339 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 10.

(a) theirs **(b)** it's
(c) its **(d)** them

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) its

The correct word is **"its"**.

- The complete phrase becomes: **"share the land and its resources"**.
- Here, **"its"** refers to **"the land"**, which is singular and requires the possessive pronoun **"its"** to indicate ownership of resources.

Other options (briefly):

- **Theirs** – Refers to people, not land.
- **It's** – A contraction for "it is"; grammatically incorrect here.
- **Them** – An object pronoun, not possessive; doesn't fit the context.

Cloze Passage 50 (Q.340–Q.349)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) has announced plans to install an advanced smart fence system (1)._____ a 100-kilometer section of the India-Myanmar border to (2)._____ the existing surveillance system.

The announcement comes (3)._____ a time when unfenced border and (4)._____ migration from Myanmar have been blamed as 5._____ responsible for the ethnic violence in Manipur, (6)._____ has claimed more than 180 lives in the state since May violence.

Presently, a Free Movement Regime (FMR) exists (7)._____ India and Myanmar. Under FMR, every member of the hill tribes, who is (8)._____ a citizen of India or Myanmar and resident of any (9)._____ within 16 km on either side of the Indo-Myanmar border can cross the (10)._____ on the production of a border pass, which is issued by the competent authority and can stay up to two weeks per visit.

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Q.340 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Number 1.

(a) along **(b)** among
(c) against **(d)** above

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) along

The correct word is **"along"**.

- The phrase becomes: **"install an advanced smart fence system along a 100-kilometer section..."**
- **"Along"** is used to indicate something that follows the line or direction of a boundary or surface, which fits perfectly for describing a fence being installed **along** the border.

Other options (briefly):

- **Among** – Used for multiple entities or groups; not applicable for a linear boundary.
- **Against** – Indicates opposition or contact, not suitable for placement.
- **Above** – Refers to vertical height or position; not relevant here.

Q.341 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Number 2.

(a) understand **(b)** increase
(c) steady **(d)** strengthen

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) strengthen

The correct word is **"strengthen"**.

- The sentence becomes: **"...to strengthen the existing surveillance system."**
- **"Strengthen"** means **to make something stronger or more effective**, which fits perfectly in the context of improving border security.

Other options (briefly):

- **Understand** – Refers to comprehension, not applicable to physical systems.
- **Increase** – Too vague; doesn't clearly express enhancement of effectiveness.
- **Steady** – Means to stabilize, not the intended meaning here.

Q.342 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Number 3.

(a) on **(b)** by
(c) at **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) at

The correct word is **"at"**.

- The sentence becomes: **"The announcement comes *at* a time when unfenced border and..."**
- **"At a time"** is a standard English phrase used to indicate a specific moment or period, especially when describing the timing of an event in relation to circumstances.

Other options:

- **"On"** – Incorrect in this context; "on a time" is not standard usage.
- **"By"** – Indicates agency, not suitable for timing here.
- **"In"** – Common, but "at a time" is more precise for indicating a specific point in time.

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Q.343 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Number 4.

(a) intolerant **(b)** unregulated
(c) forced **(d)** strict

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) unregulated
The correct word is **"unregulated"**.
- The sentence reads:
  "...when unfenced border and *unregulated* migration from Myanmar have been blamed..."
- **"Unregulated migration"** means migration that is not controlled or monitored by law or policy, which fits the context of the passage discussing border issues and security concerns.

Other options:
- **"Intolerant"** – Refers to people, not suitable for migration.
- **"Forced"** – Doesn't match the context, as the issue is lack of control, not compulsion.
- **"Strict"** – Opposite in meaning; strict migration would not be a problem in this context.

Q.344 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Number 5.

(a) portions **(b)** factors
(c) agents **(d)** influences

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) factors
The most appropriate word for blank number 5 is **"factors"**.
- The phrase becomes:
  "...have been blamed as *factors* responsible for the ethnic violence in Manipur..."
- **"Factors"** refers to contributing causes or elements, which suits the context of identifying reasons for violence.

Other options:
- **"Portions"** – Refers to parts of a whole, not suitable in the context of causes.
- **"Agents"** – Implies active doers, not appropriate when referring to issues like migration.
- **"Influences"** – Could fit but is too vague; "factors" is more precise and commonly used in formal analysis.

Q.345 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Number 6.

(a) who **(b)** whose
(c) what **(d)** which

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) which
The most appropriate word for blank number 6 is **"which"**.
- The full sentence becomes:
  "...the ethnic violence in Manipur, which has claimed more than 180 lives in the state since May violence."
- **"Which"** is the correct relative pronoun to refer to a **situation/event (ethnic violence)**. It links the clause about the number of deaths to the noun "violence."

Other options:
- **"Who"** – Used for people, not suitable here.
- **"Whose"** – Shows possession, incorrect in this structure.
- **"What"** – Not used to introduce relative clauses like this.

Q.346 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Number 7.

(a) about **(b)** among
(c) beyond **(d)** between

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) between
The correct word to fill in blank number 7 is **"between"**.
- The complete sentence reads:
  "Presently, a Free Movement Regime (FMR) exists between India and Myanmar."
- **"Between"** is the appropriate preposition used to refer to a relationship or connection involving **two** parties (in this case, **India and Myanmar**).

Why other options are incorrect:
- **"About"** – Not used to indicate bilateral arrangements.
- **"Among"** – Used for more than two entities.
- **"Beyond"** – Refers to something further than or outside of a limit, which doesn't fit here.

Q.347 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Number 8.

(a) nor **(b)** neither
(c) either **(d)** or

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) either
The correct word to fill in blank number 8 is **"either"**.
- The complete sentence reads:
  "Under FMR, every member of the hill tribes, who is either a citizen of India or Myanmar..."
- **"Either...or"** is the correct correlative conjunction used when referring to **one of two possibilities**, which is appropriate here as it talks about people who are citizens of **India or Myanmar**.

Why other options are incorrect:
- **"Nor"** – Used in negative constructions, and this sentence is not negative.
- **"Neither"** – Would require pairing with "nor" and would imply **none** of the two, which is incorrect here.
- **"Or"** alone is insufficient and ungrammatical in this structure without "either".

Q.348 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Number 9.

(a) location **(b)** hill
(c) field **(d)** area

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) area
The correct word to fill in blank number 9 is **"area"**.
- The sentence becomes:
  "...resident of any area within 16 km on either side of the Indo-Myanmar border..."
- **"Area"** is the most appropriate word here because it refers generally to a **geographic region or locality**, which fits perfectly in the context of people living within a certain range of the border.

Why other options are incorrect:
- **"Location"** – Too specific and sounds awkward in this context.
- **"Hill"** – Redundant, as "hill tribes" has already been mentioned; doesn't refer to a region.

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Explanation (contd.)
- **"Field"** – Refers to agricultural or open land, not suitable for describing residential zones.

Q.349 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank Number 10.

(a) surveillance **(b)** hill
(c) border **(d)** fence

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) border
The most appropriate word to fill in blank number 10 is **"border"**.
- The sentence reads: **"...can cross the border on the production of a border pass..."**
- This is grammatically and contextually accurate. A **"border pass"** is used to **cross a national boundary**, making "border" the correct noun.

Why the other options are incorrect:
- **"Surveillance"** – Not something that can be "crossed."
- **"Hill"** – Doesn't fit the logical context; you don't cross a hill using a pass.
- **"Fence"** – Though a physical structure, in this context, it's not the appropriate term for official/legal crossing; "border" is.

Cloze Passage 51 (Q.350–Q.354)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

The kitchen, as usual since Noreen had gone, (1) _____ empty. Letty put her handbag and the letters on the scrubbed wooden table and went to the stove, where a stew was (2)_____. She (3)_____ the lid and sniffed. Then, guiltily, she (4) _____ into the cupboard and added a pinch of salt, some cumin and corn flour, stirred, then replaced the (5)_____.

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Q.350 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(a) will be **(b)** is
(c) was **(d)** were

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) was
The sentence is:
"The kitchen, as usual since Noreen had gone, (1) _____ empty."
We are dealing with a **past tense** narrative (evident from "had gone", "put", "went", etc.).
- **"Will be"** → Future tense — incorrect for a past narrative.
- **"Is"** → Present tense — does not match the past context.
- **"Was"** → Correct — past tense, matches the rest of the paragraph.
- **"Were"** → Plural verb — "kitchen" is singular, so this is grammatically incorrect.

"was empty" is the grammatically and contextually correct choice.

Q.351 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(a) wasting **(b)** falling
(c) replicating **(d)** simmering

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) simmering
The sentence is:
"Letty put her handbag and the letters on the scrubbed wooden table and went to the stove, where a stew was (2)_____."_
Let's evaluate the options:
- **wasting** – grammatically off and illogical in this context. A stew can't "waste."
- **falling** – makes no sense with "stew."
- **replicating** – unrelated and nonsensical for a stew.
- **simmering** – perfect fit; it refers to a stew being gently cooked over low heat.

"**simmering"** is the most appropriate word for the context of a stew on a stove.

Q.352 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(a) twisted **(b)** lifted
(c) caught **(d)** grabbed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) lifted
The sentence is:
"She (3)_____ the lid and sniffed."_
Let's evaluate the options:
- **twisted** – doesn't fit; lids are usually **lifted**, not twisted, especially on a stew pot.
- **lifted** – perfectly fits; you **lift** the lid of a pot to check inside.
- **caught** – unrelated; "caught the lid" makes no logical sense here.
- **grabbed** – too rough and doesn't fit the natural, gentle action implied before sniffing.

"lifted" is the correct and contextually appropriate verb.

Q.353 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(a) stretched **(b)** went
(c) reach **(d)** reached

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) reached
The sentence is:
"Then, guiltily, she (4) _____ into the cupboard and added a pinch of salt..."
Let's evaluate the options:
- **stretched** – usually needs "out" or "towards" to be complete (e.g., "stretched out her hand"), so it's grammatically awkward here.
- **went** – does not fit with "into the cupboard" (we don't "go into" a cupboard in this context).
- **reach** – grammatically incorrect as it's the base form; we need past tense here.
- **reached** – grammatically and contextually correct; "reached into the cupboard" is a common and appropriate phrase.

"reached" is the most suitable and correct choice.

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Q.354 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(a) fork **(b)** spoon
(c) lid **(d)** pan

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) lid

Let's examine the sentence:
"...added a pinch of salt, some cumin and corn flour, stirred, then replaced the (5)_____."_

We need an object that makes sense to be replaced **after** adding ingredients and stirring a stew. The context suggests she removed **the lid** earlier to sniff (see blank 3), so it's logical that she would replace **the lid** afterward.

Let's briefly review the options:

- **fork** – Not something typically "replaced" on a cooking pot.
- **spoon** – You stir with it, but you don't "replace" it on a pot.
- **lid** – The correct item that would be removed and then replaced on a pot.
- **pan** – You don't replace the pan; it stays throughout.

Therefore, **"lid"** is the correct and contextually appropriate choice.

Cloze Passage 52 (Q.355–Q.359)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

Organic farming 1_____ that nature stays clean and rich. If we visit an organic farm, we will notice a 2_____of animal, bird and insect activity. Research shows that around 30% more wildlife and plants thrive 3_____ ecologically produced fields compared to conventional farming. This is because there are no pesticides, and fertiliser is used 4_____. Covid-19 pandemic has changed the 5_____of organic food, with the spotlight now on safety and healthy food that is nutritious to build a strong immune system.

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Q.355 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. 1.

(a) ensures **(b)** envy
(c) cherish **(d)** contradict

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ensures

The sentence talks about the **positive impact of organic farming** on nature. The verb should express **guaranteeing or securing** a good outcome.

- **Ensures** (Correct): Means *guarantees* or *makes sure* — fits the context of preserving nature.
- **Assumes**: Means to suppose or take for granted — not suitable here.
- **Imagines**: Refers to thinking or visualizing — doesn't fit the objective nature of farming practices.
- **Forces**: Implies compulsion — too harsh and contextually incorrect.

So, "**ensures that nature stays clean and rich**" is the most appropriate and meaningful choice.

Q.356 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. 2.

(a) loathe **(b)** buzz
(c) sense **(d)** jog

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) buzz

The sentence refers to the lively activity of animals, birds, and insects on an organic farm. The word should reflect **liveliness and natural sound or movement**.

- **Buzz** (Correct): Often used metaphorically to describe lively or energetic activity, especially involving insects and nature.
- **Loathe**: Means to hate — doesn't fit the context at all.
- **Sense**: A noun/verb meaning perception — too vague here.
- **Jog**: Refers to running — completely unrelated.

Hence, "**a buzz of animal, bird and insect activity**" is the most vivid and suitable choice.

Q.357 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. 3.

(a) downstairs **(b)** up
(c) out **(d)** near

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) near

The sentence compares biodiversity levels **in proximity to ecologically produced fields**. The correct word should reflect **closeness in space**.

- **Near** (Correct): Indicates proximity — "thrive near ecologically produced fields" makes perfect sense.
- **Downstairs**: Only relevant to buildings — not suitable in this agricultural context.
- **Up**: Vague and direction-based — does not work here.
- **Out**: Implies outside or away from something — incorrect in this case.

So, "**thrive near ecologically produced fields**" is the most contextually accurate phrase.

Q.358 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. 4.

(a) far away **(b)** far less
(c) far off **(d)** far better

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) far less

The sentence explains that **fertiliser usage is minimized** in organic farming. So the phrase should reflect **reduced quantity or frequency**.

- **Far less** (Correct): Means "much less" — fits perfectly when talking about limited use of fertilisers.
- **Far away**: Refers to physical distance — not suitable here.
- **Far off**: Also about distance or time — doesn't fit the context.
- **Far better**: Means improved quality — not about quantity.

Hence, "**fertiliser is used far less**" is the correct and meaningful choice.

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Q.359 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank No. 5.

(a) practice **(b)** perception
(c) argument **(d)** evolution

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) perception
The sentence refers to how people's **view or understanding** of organic food has shifted due to the pandemic. The correct word should express this change in **public mindset**.

- **Perception** (Correct): Refers to how something is viewed or understood — fits perfectly.
- **Practice**: Refers to doing something, not how it is perceived.
- **Argument**: Refers to a debate or reasoning — doesn't suit the context.
- **Evolution**: Implies gradual development — not as precise as "perception" here.

So, "**changed the perception of organic food**" is the most accurate and meaningful choice.

Cloze Passage 53 (Q.360–Q.369)

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

Air India showcased its first A350 to the world on Thursday (18 January) at the Begumpet Airport in Hyderabad as part of the ongoing air show Wings 2024. The first aircraft of a (1)_____ of 20 arrived on 23 December 2023 from Toulouse in France and was (2)_____ for the first time on 18 January. Five more (3)_____ premium passenger aircrafts are scheduled (4)_____ by March this year. This makes Air India (5)_____ first Indian carrier to be operating the A350.

Commercial operations for the same are scheduled to begin (6)_____ 22 January later this month.

With the induction of the A350, Air India is (7)_____ to overhaul its image and service to the passengers.

The A350 comes equipped (8)_____ a powerful and fuel-efficient Rolls-Royce Trent xwb engine. Once you (9)_____ inside the aircraft, you can immediately (10)_____ the three-class cabin configuration: business, premium economy and economy spread across 316 seats.

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Q.360 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(a) team **(b)** gang
(c) flock **(d)** batch

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) batch

- **Batch** (Correct): Refers to a specific group or set of items produced or delivered together—fits well for a delivery of aircraft.
- **Team**: Refers to a group of people, not suitable for aircraft.
- **Gang**: Informal and inappropriate in this context.
- **Flock**: Generally used for birds or sheep, not aircraft.

Explanation (contd.)
"**Batch of 20**" is the most natural and contextually accurate phrase when referring to the delivery of multiple aircraft.

Q.361 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(a) showcases **(b)** showcased
(c) showcase **(d)** showcasing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) showcased
The verb "was" before the blank indicates a **passive past tense** structure.

- **Showcased** (Correct): Past participle form, correctly completes the passive voice "was showcased."
- **Showcases**: Present tense; grammatically incorrect after "was."
- **Showcase**: Base verb form; doesn't fit the passive construction.
- **Showcasing**: Present participle; would require a structure like "was showcasing something," which doesn't fit here.

Therefore, **"was showcased"** is the correct and grammatically accurate phrase.

Q.362 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 3.

(a) same **(b)** such
(c) so **(d)** as

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) such
The sentence is referring to **additional aircrafts of the same kind** as the A350 already introduced. The correct structure is "**such premium passenger aircrafts**," meaning *of that type or kind*.

- **Such** (Correct): Refers to "premium passenger aircrafts" of the same kind — matches the meaning and structure.
- **Same**: Incorrect here because it would require a structure like "the same aircraft," not plural or general.
- **So**: Doesn't fit grammatically or contextually here.
- **As**: Not suitable in this structure; doesn't modify nouns correctly in this way.

Therefore, "**such** premium passenger aircrafts" is the most appropriate phrase.

Q.363 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 4.

(a) arrival **(b)** arriving
(c) to arrive **(d)** arrived

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) to arrive
The phrase "are scheduled **to arrive**" is the standard grammatical construction used when referring to planned future events.

- **To arrive** (Correct): Infinitive form used after "scheduled" to indicate the purpose or expected action.
- **Arrival**: A noun, doesn't fit grammatically after "scheduled."
- **Arriving**: Would work in continuous structures (e.g., "aircrafts arriving daily"), but not here.
- **Arrived**: Past tense, doesn't match with the future timeline indicated by "by March."

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Explanation (contd.)
So, "**are scheduled to arrive**" is the most appropriate and correct usage.

Q.364 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 5.

(a) the **(b)** one
(c) a **(d)** an

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) the
The sentence refers to **Air India being the only or specific first Indian carrier** operating the A350, so the **definite article "the"** is required.
- **The** (Correct): Used when referring to something specific or unique—"the first Indian carrier" is a fixed, commonly used phrase.
- **One**: Doesn't fit grammatically in this structure.
- **A/An**: Indefinite articles—incorrect when referring to the **first** of anything, which is inherently specific.

So, "**the first Indian carrier**" is the proper and standard usage in this context.

Q.365 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 6.

(a) at **(b)** to
(c) on **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) on
We use **"on"** to refer to **specific dates**, which is the case here — "22 January."
- **On** (Correct): Used with dates — "on 22 January" is the correct standard expression.
- **At**: Used for specific times, not dates.
- **To**: Doesn't fit this context at all.
- **In**: Used with months, years, or time periods — not specific dates.

So, "**on 22 January**" is the grammatically accurate and contextually correct phrase.

Q.366 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 7.

(a) accepting **(b)** supposing
(c) believing **(d)** hoping

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) hoping
The sentence discusses Air India's **future expectations or intentions** after inducting the A350, so the correct verb must express **anticipation or aspiration**.
- **Hoping** (Correct): Matches the intent — Air India is *hoping* to improve its image.
- **Accepting**: Means receiving or agreeing — doesn't express future intent.
- **Supposing**: Means assuming something is true — not appropriate here.
- **Believing**: Refers to holding a belief, but doesn't convey the same **forward-looking desire** as "hoping."

Hence, "**hoping** to overhaul its image..." is the most suitable and meaningful choice.

Q.367 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 8.

(a) in **(b)** with
(c) to **(d)** for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) with
The standard phrase is **"equipped with"**, used when referring to features or tools that something possesses or includes.
- **With** (Correct): Completes the common collocation "equipped with," meaning the aircraft has the engine installed.
- **In**: Refers to location, not appropriate after "equipped."
- **To**: Incorrect construction with "equipped."
- **For**: Indicates purpose or benefit, not suitable here.

So, "**equipped with** a powerful engine" is the grammatically and contextually accurate phrase.

Q.368 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 9.

(a) skip **(b)** step
(c) forward **(d)** advance

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) step
The sentence describes the action of **entering the aircraft**, so we need a verb that naturally fits with that context.
- **Step** (Correct): "Step inside" is a common and natural phrase used when entering a space.
- **Skip**: Means to jump over something; not appropriate here.
- **Forward**: Not a verb in this form; cannot follow "you" as a subject.
- **Advance**: More formal and typically used in military or strategic contexts—not for entering an aircraft casually.

Hence, "**step inside the aircraft**" is the most accurate and natural choice.

Q.369 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 10.

(a) watch **(b)** get
(c) look **(d)** see

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) see
The sentence describes what a passenger can **visibly notice or observe** upon entering the aircraft. The verb must reflect an immediate visual perception.
- **See** (Correct): Most natural verb for general visual recognition—"see the cabin configuration."
- **Watch**: Implies observing something in motion over time (e.g., a movie); not suitable for a static setup.
- **Get**: Doesn't fit grammatically here.
- **Look**: Would need a preposition ("look at"), so it's incomplete in this context.

So, "**see the three-class cabin configuration**" is the clearest and grammatically correct expression.

Cloze Passage 54 (Q.370–Q.379)
In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank.

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Passage (contd.)

Located 10 miles off Scotland's north-eastern coast, the Orkney islands are a treasure trove of history. When I visited one of Orkney's famous prehistoric (1)____, the Maeshowe tomb, my first impression was of an unremarkable green mound (2)_____ by a ditch.

Despite its appearance, this 5,000-year-old (3)____ place is actually a masterpiece of (4)_____ design and engineering, and a testament (5)_____ the skill of Orkney's prehistoric residents. That's because, (6)_____ around three weeks either side of the winter solstice (which takes (7)_____ on 21 or 22 December each year), visitors have the chance to see something truly magical (8)____ here.

During this time of year, the narrow passage into the (9)_____ becomes more than just an entrance: it was deliberately designed (10)_____ with the setting of the midwinter sun. Just as the last rays start to disappear – which is at around 15:10 at this deepest, darkest time of midwinter – a shaft of light creeps down the passageway, slips across the floor of the tomb and illuminates the back wall like a golden, glowing doorway to another world.

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Q.370 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 1.

(a) scenes **(b)** sites
(c) seats **(d)** sights

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) sites

Sites fits best, as it refers to specific historical or archaeological locations like the Maeshowe tomb.

- **Scenes** refers to parts of a play or a view—not appropriate here.
- **Seats** are places to sit or symbolic positions, which don't fit the context.
- **Sights** refers to things worth seeing but is too general for a prehistoric landmark.

Q.371 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 2.

(a) surrounding **(b)** surround
(c) surrounds **(d)** surrounded

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) surrounded

The sentence describes a mound and how it appears. The correct form should be a **past participle** to complete the passive construction "was of a mound _____ by a ditch."

- **Surrounded** is the correct past participle, fitting the passive voice structure.
- **Surrounding** is a present participle and would change the sentence meaning.
- **Surround** and **surrounds** are base and present forms of the verb—not suitable after "was of a mound."

Q.372 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 3.

(a) burial **(b)** burying
(c) burry **(d)** buried

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) burial

The blank describes the **type of place** the Maeshowe tomb is — it's a **"burial place"**, not a verb or adjective.

- **Burial** (correct): Noun form, meaning a place where someone is buried — fits perfectly with "place."
- **Burying**: Gerund/participle form of the verb "bury"; not used to modify "place."
- **Burry**: Incorrect spelling, not a valid word in this context.
- **Buried**: Past participle, would require a different sentence structure ("a place that was buried").

Therefore, "burial" is the most appropriate and grammatically correct choice.

Q.373 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 4.

(a) chronological **(b)** historical
(c) antiquated **(d)** ancient

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) ancient

The blank describes the **age and style** of the tomb's design and engineering. The adjective must match the 5,000-year-old context.

- **Ancient** (Correct): Refers to something from a very long time ago; perfectly fits the 5,000-year-old tomb.
- **Chronological**: Pertains to time sequencing, not suitable for describing design.
- **Historical**: While it refers to the past, it's more about significance in history, not age or style.
- **Antiquated**: Means old-fashioned or obsolete — a negative connotation, not appropriate when praising design.

Thus, "ancient" is the most contextually accurate choice to describe the tomb's old yet remarkable design.

Q.374 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 5.

(a) at **(b)** by
(c) to **(d)** on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) to

The correct phrase is **"a testament to"**, which means *proof of* or *evidence of* someone's skill or achievement.

- **To** (Correct): Forms the standard phrase "a testament to," used to express admiration or evidence of someone's ability.
- **At**: Doesn't form any meaningful phrase with "testament."
- **By**: Suggests the agent who created something, not appropriate in this context.
- **On**: Grammatically incorrect here.

Therefore, "to" is the most appropriate choice to complete the phrase "a testament to the skill..."

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Q.375 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 6.

(a) for **(b)** about
(c) with **(d)** in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) for

The phrase "**for around three weeks**" is the correct collocation when referring to a **duration of time**.

- **For** (Correct): Used to indicate a period or duration — "for around three weeks" is grammatically accurate.
- **About**: Means "approximately," but doesn't fit well with "around three weeks either side..."
- **With**: Doesn't make sense in this time-related context.
- **In**: Refers to when something will happen, not the length of time it occurs.

Hence, "for" is the most appropriate preposition to express the duration of time in this sentence.

Q.376 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 7.

(a) place **(b)** home
(c) abode **(d)** room

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) place

The correct phrase is **"takes place"**, which means *occurs* or *happens*. It is a common expression used to refer to events or phenomena.

- **Place** (Correct): Completes the standard phrase "takes place."
- **Home**, **Abode**, and **Room** are all nouns denoting types of living spaces—not used in this idiomatic expression.

Thus, "place" is the only choice that makes the sentence grammatically and idiomatically correct.

Q.377 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 8.

(a) retire **(b)** perform
(c) occur **(d)** arise

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) occur

The sentence refers to witnessing a **magical event**, so the correct verb must mean *to happen* or *to take place*.

- **Occur** (Correct): Means *to happen*, which fits perfectly with "something truly magical."
- **Retire**: Means to stop working—not relevant.
- **Perform**: Refers to carrying out an action or entertainment—not applicable here.
- **Arise**: Means *to emerge* or *to come up*, but it's less precise than "occur" in this context.

Therefore, "occur" is the most accurate and natural fit for the sentence.

Q.378 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 9.

(a) graveyard **(b)** tomb
(c) grave **(d)** memorial

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) tomb

The passage is about **Maeshowe**, a well-known **prehistoric tomb**, and the sentence refers to a specific structure with a narrow passage.

- **Tomb** (Correct): A burial chamber, often a constructed structure—fits perfectly with the earlier context of the Maeshowe tomb.
- **Graveyard**: A cemetery with multiple graves—not accurate here since it's referring to one structure.
- **Grave**: A single burial pit, usually in the ground—not architecturally descriptive like "tomb."
- **Memorial**: A monument to remember someone—not necessarily a burial site.

Hence, "tomb" is the most precise and contextually appropriate word.

Q.379 Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank No. 10.

(a) align **(b)** aligned
(c) aligning **(d)** to align

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to align

The phrase "**designed to align**" is grammatically correct and idiomatic. It explains the **purpose** or **intended function** of the design.

- **To align** (Correct): Infinitive form, used to express purpose — matches with "designed."
- **Align**: Base verb form; incorrect after "designed."
- **Aligned**: Past participle; would be correct if sentence were "was aligned," not "designed."
- **Aligning**: Present participle; doesn't fit the structure.

So, "**designed to align**" clearly and correctly describes the intention behind the tomb's construction.

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13. Reading Comprehension

501 questions

Passage 1 (Q.1–Q.10)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

The Celts who lived in Britain before the Roman invasion of 43 AD could be said to have created the first towns. Celts in southern England lived in hill forts, which were quite large settlements. (Some probably had thousands of inhabitants). They were places of trade, where people bought and sold goods and also places where craftsmen worked. The Romans called them oppida.

However, the Romans created the first settlements that were undoubtedly towns. Roman towns were usually laid out in a grid pattern. In the centre was the forum or market place. It was lined with public buildings. Life in Roman towns was highly civilized with public baths and temples.

From the 5th century Angles, Saxons and Jutes invaded England. At first, the invaders avoided living in towns. However, as trade grew some towns grew up. London revived by the 7th century (although the Saxon town was, at first, outside the walls of the old Roman town). Southampton was founded at the end of the 7th century. Hereford was founded in the 8th century. Furthermore, Ipswich grew up in the 8th century and York revived.

However, towns were rare in Saxon England until the late 9th century. At that time, Alfred the Great created a network of fortified settlements across his kingdom called 'burhs'. In the event of a Danish attack, men could gather in the local burh. However, burhs were more than forts. They were also market towns. Some burhs were started from scratch but many were created out of the ruins of old Roman towns. Places like Winchester rose, phoenix-like, from the ashes of history.

The thing that would strike us most about medieval towns would be their small size. Winchester, the capital of England, probably had about 8,000 people. At that time a 'large' town, like Lincoln or Dublin had about 4,000 or 5,000 inhabitants and a 'medium sized' town, like Colchester had about 2,500 people. Many towns were much smaller.

However, during the 12th and 13th centuries most towns grew much larger. Furthermore, many new towns were created across Britain. Trade and commerce were increasing and there was a need for new towns. Some were created from existing villages but some were created from scratch. In those days you could create a town simply by starting a market. There were few shops so if you wished to buy or sell anything you had to go to a market. Once one was up and running, craftsmen and merchants would come to live in the area and a town would grow.

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Q.1 "Some were created from scratch." The towns which started from scratch were created by first:

(a) starting a market
(b) building houses
(c) establishing a settlement
(d) building a fort

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) starting a market
How to locate the answer
Text: "In those days you could create a town simply by **starting a market**."
Why the others are wrong
• **building houses / settlement / fort** – craftsmen and merchants came *after* the market started.

Q.2 What lay in the centre of Roman towns?

(a) Baths **(b)** Market places
(c) Residences **(d)** Temples

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Market places
How to locate the answer
Text: "In the centre was the **forum or market place**."
Why the others are wrong
• **Baths / Residences / Temples** – present in Roman towns, but the *centre* held the forum/market.

Q.3 Who were the first creators of towns in England?

(a) Celts **(b)** Saxons
(c) Angles **(d)** Romans

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Celts
How to locate the answer
Text: "The **Celts** who lived in Britain before the Roman invasion ... could be said to have created the first towns."
Why the others are wrong
• **Saxons / Angles** – came later; **Romans** – created the first *undoubted* towns, but the Celts came first.

Q.4 "At first, the invaders avoided living in towns." Who is/are being referred to here as 'invaders'?

(a) Celts
(b) Alfred the Great
(c) Romans
(d) Saxons, Angles and Jutes

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Saxons, Angles and Jutes
How to locate the answer
Text: "From the 5th century **Angles, Saxons and Jutes invaded** England. At first, the invaders avoided living in towns."
Why the others are wrong
• **Celts / Alfred / Romans** – not the "invaders" referred to here.

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Q.5 Alfred the Great created fortified settlements across his kingdom mainly because:

(a) they provided shelter from Danish attacks
(b) craftsmen could craft their artefacts there
(c) people could live there
(d) merchants could come and sell their goods there

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) they provided shelter from Danish attacks
How to locate the answer
Text: "Alfred the Great created ... 'burhs'. In the event of a **Danish attack**, men could gather in the local burh."
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) craftsmen / (c) living / (d) merchants** – burhs were also market towns, but Alfred's *main* reason was defence.

Q.6 The passage mainly talks about:

(a) the increase of trade in England
(b) the early life in England
(c) the development of markets in England
(d) the history of towns in England

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the history of towns in England
How to locate the answer
The passage traces towns from the Celts to the Romans, Saxons, Alfred the Great and medieval times — the **history of towns**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) trade / (b) early life / (c) markets** – details within the wider history.

Q.7 The hill forts of Celts were called:

(a) Centres **(b)** Burhs
(c) Forums **(d)** Oppida

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Oppida
How to locate the answer
Text: "Celts ... lived in hill forts ... The Romans called them **oppida**."
Why the others are wrong
• **Burhs** – Alfred's forts; **Forums** – Roman market places; **Centres** – not used.

Q.8 Match the words with their meaning.
a. founded 1. protected
b. declined 2. created
c. fortified 3. dwindled

(a) a-2, b-3, c-1 **(b)** a-3, b-2, c-1
(c) a-1, b-3, c-2 **(d)** a-2, b-1, c-3

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) a-2, b-3, c-1
Type: Vocabulary Matching
• **a. founded** = created/established → **2. created**.
• **b. declined** = dwindled/decreased → **3. dwindled**.
• **c. fortified** = protected with defences → **1. protected**.
So **a-2, b-3, c-1**.

Q.9 Which of the following was the capital of England during medieval times?

(a) Colchester **(b)** Dublin
(c) London **(d)** Winchester

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Winchester
How to locate the answer
Text: "**Winchester, the capital of England**, probably had about 8,000 people."
Why the others are wrong
• **Colchester / Dublin / London** – other towns, but Winchester was the capital.

Q.10 When was Southampton founded?

(a) in the 7th century **(b)** in the 8th century
(c) in the 6th century **(d)** in the 12th century

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) in the 7th century
How to locate the answer
Text: "**Southampton was founded at the end of the 7th century**."
Why the others are wrong
• **8th / 6th / 12th century** – wrong dates.

Passage 2 (Q.11–Q.20)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Since September, at least 25 people have died and thousands have been made homeless. Every state and territory in Australia has experienced fires this summer. But the biggest fires burn along stretches of the eastern and southern coast, where most of the population lives. This includes areas around Sydney and Adelaide.

More than 6.3 million hectares (63,000 sq km or 15.6 million acres) have been burned so far – one hectare is roughly the size of a sports field. To put that in perspective, around 800,000 hectares were engulfed in a bush fire in 2018 in California.

Australia has always experienced bushfires – it has a "fire season". But this year they are a lot worse than normal.

Fires are usually caused by lightning strikes or accidentally by a spark – but some fires are also started deliberately. This year, a natural weather phenomenon known as the 'Indian Ocean Dipole' has meant a hot, dry spell across the country. This year, Australia twice set a new temperature record: an average maximum of 41.9°C was recorded on 18 December. That comes on top of a long period of drought.

Scientists have long warned that this hotter, drier climate will contribute to fires becoming more frequent and more intense.

The more extreme weather patterns and higher temperatures increase the risk of bushfires and allow them to spread faster and wider.

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Passage (contd.)

Fire fighters are spraying water and fire retardant from planes and helicopters as well as from the ground. But fighting bush fires is extremely difficult and often authorities have to focus on just stopping the spread, rather than putting the fire out. The spread can for instance be best contained by digging earth boundaries to stop the flames from spreading. The priority is saving lives.

Professional fire fighters are the first in line to battle the flames, but they are outnumbered by the thousands of volunteers. Three of them have died. There's also help coming from abroad: the US, Canada and New Zealand have sent fire fighters to help. Australia's police, military and navy are involved in rescue and evacuation efforts.

While people can flee the fires and are being evacuated if need be, the flames are devastating wildlife in the affected areas. One study estimated that half a billion animals have died in New South Wales alone.

Zookeepers take animals home to save them from fire, but the fires don't only kill animals directly, they also destroy the habitat, leaving the survivors vulnerable even when the fires have gone. So the true scale of loss isn't yet clear.

Experts say more than 100,000 cows and sheep may also have been lost, which is devastating for farmers.

Each state runs its own emergency operation, but Prime Minister Scott Morrison has promised better funding for fire-fighting and payouts for volunteer fire fighters, and an additional A$2billion ($1.4billion; £1billion) for the recovery.

But the national government has come under strong criticism from its opponents that it has not been doing enough against climate change. The country is one of the world's biggest per capita greenhouse gas emitters but under international agreements it has committed itself to reduction targets.

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Q.11 Which statement is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) Australia is one of the world's biggest per capita greenhouse gas emitters.
(b) The volunteers outnumber the professional fire fighters in Australia.
(c) Zookeepers take animals home to save them from fire.
(d) Around 800,000 hectares have been destroyed due to a bush fire in Australia.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Around 800,000 hectares have been destroyed due to a bush fire in Australia.

How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)

Text: "around **800,000 hectares** were engulfed in a bush fire in **2018 in California**" — that figure is for California, not Australia (which burned 6.3 million ha). So (d) is **false**.

Why the others are true

• **(a)** biggest per-capita emitter, **(b)** volunteers outnumber professionals, **(c)** zookeepers take animals home – all stated.

Q.12 Where did the biggest fires burn in Australia?

(a) Along the western and southern coasts
(b) Along the eastern and southern coasts
(c) Along the western and northern coasts
(d) Along the eastern and northern coasts

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Along the eastern and southern coasts

How to locate the answer

Text: "the biggest fires burn along stretches of the **eastern and southern coast**, where most of the population lives."

Why the others are wrong

• western/northern combinations – wrong directions.

Q.13 It can be inferred from the passage that this year's fire in Australia is mostly a result of:

(a) a deliberate attempt to put the forests on fire
(b) a result of an extraordinarily hot and dry spell
(c) an accidental spark in the jungle
(d) a lightning strike

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a result of an extraordinarily hot and dry spell

How to locate the answer

Text: "the 'Indian Ocean Dipole' has meant a **hot, dry spell** ... a new temperature record ... a long period of drought." So this year's fires mainly result from the hot, dry conditions.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) deliberate / (c) accidental spark / (d) lightning** – usual causes, but this year's severity is due to the hot, dry spell.

Q.14 The opposition in Australia is criticising the government for:

(a) not allotting enough funds for firefighting
(b) not doing enough against the climate change
(c) not fighting the bush fires
(d) not giving enough compensation to the deceased

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) not doing enough against the climate change

How to locate the answer

The passage links the worse fires to a "hotter, drier climate"; the opposition's criticism is that the government is **not doing enough against climate change**.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) funds / (c) not fighting / (d) compensation** – not the stated criticism.

Q.15 "Some fires are also started deliberately". 'Deliberately' here means:

(a) accidentally **(b)** unknowingly
(c) purposely **(d)** inadvertently

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) purposely

Type: Vocabulary (in context)

"deliberately" = done on purpose, intentionally (जान-बूझकर).

Why the others are wrong

• **accidentally / unknowingly / inadvertently** – all mean "by accident" — the opposite.

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Q.16 "Authorities have to focus on just stopping the spread, rather than putting the fire out." This means that the authorities:

(a) want to put out the fires once and for all
(b) want to stop the fires from spreading first and then put them out
(c) do not want to put the fires out
(d) want only to slow down the spread of fire

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) want to stop the fires from spreading first and then put them out

How to locate the answer

The line means the priority is to **contain the spread** (stop it growing) rather than immediately extinguish — so, stop the spread first.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) put out at once / (c) don't want to put out / (d) only slow down** – misread the priority of "stopping the spread first".

Q.17 The passage is mainly about:

(a) Australia's struggle with bush fires
(b) how the bush fires occur in Australia
(c) the government's role in dealing with the bushfire
(d) the loss of wildlife due to bush fires

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Australia's struggle with bush fires

How to locate the answer

The whole passage is about the scale, causes, fighting and impact of Australia's bush fires — its **struggle** with them.

Why the others are wrong

• **(b) how they occur / (c) government's role / (d) wildlife loss** – parts of the wider topic.

Q.18 The spread of fire can be contained effectively by:

(a) digging earth boundaries
(b) spraying fire retardant from the air
(c) spraying fire retardant from the ground
(d) spraying the forests with water

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) digging earth boundaries

How to locate the answer

Text: "The spread can ... be best contained by **digging earth boundaries** to stop the flames from spreading."

Why the others are wrong

• **spraying retardant/water** – used to fight fire, but the spread is *best contained* by earth boundaries.

Q.19 Which of the following countries has NOT sent help for firefighting?

(a) China **(b)** The US
(c) Canada **(d)** New Zealand

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) China

How to locate the answer (NOT-sent question)

Text: "the **US, Canada and New Zealand** have sent fire fighters to help." China is **not** mentioned, so it has NOT sent help.

Q.20 What is the long lasting damage that the bush fires have caused to the wildlife in Australia?

(a) The fires have not only killed animals directly, but also destroyed their habitat.
(b) Half a billion animals have died in New South Wales alone.
(c) Many animals in the zoos have been killed.
(d) More than 100,000 cows and sheep may have been lost.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The fires have not only killed animals directly, but also destroyed their habitat.

How to locate the answer

Text: "the fires don't only kill animals directly, they also **destroy the habitat**, leaving the survivors vulnerable even when the fires have gone." That is the long-lasting damage.

Why the others are wrong

• **(b) half a billion died / (c) zoo animals / (d) cows & sheep** – immediate losses, not the "long-lasting" habitat damage.

Passage 3 (Q.21–Q.25)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

The giraffe is the tallest land mammal alive, its long legs and neck contributing to its impressive stature. Males can be up to 18ft (5.5m tall), females a little less.

In the wild, these beautiful creatures stretch their necks beyond those of antelope, kudu and even elephants to strip leaves from the untouched upper reaches of trees.

The French zoologist Jean-Baptiste Lamarck is usually credited as the first person to suggest that long necks have evolved in giraffes because they allow them to get to the parts other herbivores cannot reach.

As the giraffe lives "in places where the soil is nearly always arid and barren, it is obliged to browse on the leaves of trees and to make constant efforts to reach them," he wrote in his 1809 book 'Philosophie Zoologique'. "From this habit long maintained in all its race, it has resulted that the animal's fore-legs have become longer than its hind legs, and that its neck is lengthened."

The English naturalist Charles Darwin also thought the giraffe's extraordinary legs and neck must have something to do with foraging. "The giraffe, by its lofty stature, much elongated neck, fore-legs, head and tongue, has its whole frame beautifully adapted for browsing on the higher branches of trees," he wrote in 'On the Origin of Species' in 1859.

In short, giraffes' long necks are the result of generation upon generation of repeated stretching and inheritance.

During the dry season when feeding competition should be most intense giraffe generally feed from low shrubs, not tall trees. What's more, giraffes feed most often and faster with their necks bent.

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Passage (contd.)

Male giraffes often fight for access to females, a ritual referred to as "necking". The rivals stand flank to flank, then start to whack each other with their heads. The top or back of the well-armoured skull is used as a club to strike the neck, chest, ribs, or legs of the opponent with a force capable of knocking a competitor off balance or unconscious.

The largest males usually win these battles and do most of the breeding, says zoologist Anne Innis Dagg of the University of Waterloo in Ontario, Canada, who has been studying giraffes since the 1950s. "The other giraffes don't get much breeding opportunity."

There is also evidence that females are more receptive to advances from larger males.

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Q.21 How does a giraffe knock its opponent off balance or unconscious?

(a) By using its head as a club and hitting the opponent
(b) By biting the opponent's neck, chest and ribs
(c) By pulling the legs of the opponent
(d) By entangling its neck in the opponent's neck

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) By using its head as a club and hitting the opponent
How to locate the answer
Text: "The top or back of the well-armoured **skull is used as a club** to strike the neck, chest, ribs, or legs of the opponent."
Why the others are wrong
• **biting / pulling legs / entangling** – not how it strikes; it clubs with its head.

Q.22 Match the words with their meanings.
a. forage 1. hit
b. stretch 2. search
c. whack 3. draw out

(a) a-1, b-3, c-2 **(b)** a-3, b-2, c-1
(c) a-2, b-1, c-3 **(d)** a-2, b-3, c-1

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) a-2, b-3, c-1
Type: Vocabulary Matching
• **a. forage** = to search for food → **2. search**.
• **b. stretch** = to draw out/extend → **3. draw out**.
• **c. whack** = to hit hard → **1. hit**.
So **a-2, b-3, c-1**.

Q.23 Which statement is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) The giraffe can eat leaves from the upper reaches of a tree where other animals cannot reach.
(b) The largest male giraffe usually wins the battles and does most of the breeding.
(c) Giraffes' long necks are the result of repeated stretching over the years.
(d) A giraffe's hind-legs are longer than its fore-legs and help it to bend.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A giraffe's hind-legs are longer than its fore-legs and help it to bend.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
Lamarck's quote says "the animal's **fore-legs have become longer than its hind legs**." So the reverse — "hind-legs longer than fore-legs" — is **false**.
Why the others are true
• **(a)** eats from upper reaches, **(b)** largest male wins & breeds, **(c)** long necks from repeated stretching — all stated.

Q.24 Giraffe's feeding is faster when it feeds with its neck:

(a) straight **(b)** entangled
(c) elongated **(d)** bent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) bent
How to locate the answer
Text: "giraffes feed most often and faster with their necks **bent**."
Why the others are wrong
• **straight / entangled / elongated** – the passage specifically says "bent".

Q.25 According to the passage, 'necking' is the:

(a) repeated stretching of the neck
(b) breeding by the largest males
(c) fight to woo the females
(d) elongation of the giraffes' neck

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) fight to woo the females
How to locate the answer
Text: "Male giraffes often **fight for access to females**, a ritual referred to as 'necking'." So necking = fighting to win females.
Why the others are wrong
• **stretching / breeding / elongation** – necking is the fight itself, not these.

Passage 4 (Q.26–Q.30)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

The stark observation made in the Economic Survey of 2015-16 that "Indian agriculture, is in a way, a victim of its own past success – especially the green revolution", shows the dark reality of the agriculture sector at present and the havoc that has been wreaked by the green revolution.

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Passage (contd.)

The green revolution, which is often characterised by the introduction of high-yielding variety of seeds and fertilisers, undoubtedly increased the productivity of land considerably. But the growth in the productivity has been stagnant in recent years, resulting in a significant decline in the income of farmers. There have also been negative environmental effects in the form of depleting water table, emission of greenhouse gases, and the contamination of surface and ground water. Needless to say, the agriculture sector is in a state of distress, which is severely affecting peasants and marginal farmers, and urgent policy interventions are required to protect their interests.

The government has responded to the problem by constituting a panel, which will recommend ways to double the income of farmers by 2022. While this may be an overtly ambitious target, if we want to boost stagnated agricultural growth a shift has to be made from food security of the nation to income security of the farmers. However, there are many hurdles that have to be crossed if we want to achieve this objective.

The first major barrier to overcome is declining productivity. Data from 2013 reveals that India's average yield of cereal per hectare is far less than that of many countries (including several low income countries), but the difference is huge when compared to China. For instance, our average yield per hectare is 39% below than that of China and for rice this figure is 46%. Even Bangladesh, Vietnam and Indonesia fare better than India in case of rice yield. Further, there is a huge inter-regional variation; the wheat and rice yield from Haryana and Punjab is much higher than from the other states.

In order to cross the declining productivity barrier there is a need to herald a rainbow revolution by making a shift from wheat-rice cycle to other cereals and pulses. Since wheat and rice coupled with other crops are backed by minimum support prices (MSP) and input subsidy (whether water, fertiliser or power) regime, there is a huge incentive for the farmers in the irrigated region of Northwest India to grow these crops.

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Q.26 As per the passage, what is the main cause of decline in the income of farmers?

(a) Contamination of ground water
(b) Emission of greenhouse gases
(c) Depleting water table
(d) Decline in agricultural production

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Decline in agricultural production

How to locate the answer

Text: "the growth in the productivity has been stagnant ... resulting in a significant **decline in the income of farmers**." Falling productivity/production → falling income.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) contamination / (b) greenhouse gases / (c) water table** – environmental effects, not the main cause of falling income.

Q.27 The purpose of this passage is to:

(a) compare Indian agriculture with that of other countries
(b) talk about the consequences of the green revolution
(c) express the anguish of the farmers
(d) suggest measures for improving the farmers' lot

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) talk about the consequences of the green revolution

How to locate the answer

The passage discusses how the green revolution raised productivity but caused stagnation, falling incomes and environmental harm — i.e., its **consequences**.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) compare / (c) anguish / (d) measures** – parts of the discussion, not the overall purpose.

Q.28 As per the passage, which country has the highest yield of rice per hectare?

(a) Vietnam **(b)** Bangladesh
(c) China **(d)** Indonesia

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) China

How to locate the answer

Text: "our average yield ... is 39% below ... **China** and for rice this figure is 46%. Even Bangladesh, Vietnam and Indonesia fare better than India." So China's yield is the highest.

Why the others are wrong

• **Vietnam / Bangladesh / Indonesia** – better than India, but China is the benchmark (highest).

Q.29 What does the author suggest to enhance the income of the farmers?

(a) Shift wheat-rice cycle to include other cereals and pulses
(b) Give subsidies on water, fertilizers and power
(c) Provide income security to the farmers
(d) Constitute a panel to suggest ways to double the income

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Provide income security to the farmers

How to locate the answer

Text: "a shift has to be made from **food security** of the nation **to income security of the farmers**." That is the author's suggestion to raise farmers' income.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) shift crops** – to cross the productivity barrier; **(b) subsidies** – already an issue; **(d) panel** – the government's step, not the author's core suggestion for income.

Q.30 Which statement is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) The rice yield in India is below that of China by 39%.
(b) In Northwest India, farmers get subsidies on rice, wheat and other crops.
(c) The growth in productivity has stagnated today.
(d) High yielding seeds and fertilizers were a hallmark of green revolution.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The rice yield in India is below that of China by 39%.

How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)

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Explanation (contd.)
Text: "our average yield per hectare is **39% below** ... China and **for rice this figure is 46%**." So for **rice** the gap is 46%, not 39%. option (a) is therefore **false**.
Why the others are true
• **(b)** subsidies (MSP/water/fertiliser/power), **(c)** productivity has stagnated, **(d)** HYV seeds & fertilisers were a hallmark – all stated.

Passage 5 (Q.31–Q.35)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Plato is the earliest important educational thinker, and education is an essential element in 'The Republic' (his most important work on philosophy and political theory, written around 360 B.C.). In it, he advocates some rather extreme methods: removing children from their mothers' care and raising them as wards of the state, and differentiating children suitable to the various castes, the highest receiving the most education, so that they could act as guardians of the city and care for the less able. He believed that education should be holistic, including facts, skills, physical discipline, music and art. Plato believed that talent and intelligence is not distributed genetically and thus is be found in children born to all classes, although his proposed system of selective public education for an educated minority of the population does not really follow a democratic model.

Aristotle considered human nature, habit and reason to be equally important forces to be cultivated in education, the ultimate aim of which should be to produce good and virtuous citizens. He proposed that teachers lead their students systematically, and that repetition be used as a key tool to develop good habits, unlike Socrates' emphasis on questioning his listeners to bring out their own ideas. He emphasized the balancing of the theoretical and practical aspects of subjects taught, among which he explicitly mentions reading, writing, mathematics, music, physical education, literature, history, and a wide range of sciences, as well as play, which he also considered important.

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Q.31 Aristotle believed that virtuous citizens could be produced by cultivating:

(a) art and music
(b) habit and reason
(c) theoretical aspects of education
(d) mathematics and science

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) habit and reason
How to locate the answer
Text: "Aristotle considered human nature, **habit and reason** ... forces to be cultivated ..., the ultimate aim ... to produce good and virtuous citizens."
Why the others are wrong
• **art and music / theoretical aspects / mathematics and science** – subjects, not the qualities cultivated to make virtuous citizens.

Q.32 What tool does Aristotle advocate to teachers to develop good habits in students?

(a) Questioning **(b)** Writing
(c) Repetition **(d)** Reading

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Repetition
How to locate the answer
Text: "Aristotle ... proposed that ... **repetition be used as a key tool to develop good habits**."
Why the others are wrong
• **Questioning** – that was Socrates' method; **Writing / Reading** – subjects, not the habit-forming tool.

Q.33 Children who are imparted highest education, would be responsible for:

(a) guarding the city
(b) inculcating good habits
(c) developing talent and skills
(d) teaching the illiterate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) guarding the city
How to locate the answer
Text: "the highest receiving the most education, so that they could act as **guardians of the city** and care for the less able."
Why the others are wrong
• **inculcating habits / developing skills / teaching illiterate** – not the stated role.

Q.34 Which of these methods is NOT advocated in 'The Republic'?

(a) Keeping children away from mothers
(b) Differentiating children based on castes
(c) Imparting similar education to all children
(d) Bringing up children under state guardianship

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Imparting similar education to all children
How to locate the answer (NOT-advocated question)
'The Republic' advocates **differentiating** children by caste (the highest getting the most education) — NOT the same education for all. So (c) is not advocated.
Why the others are advocated
• **(a) away from mothers, (b) differentiating by caste, (d) state guardianship** – all mentioned in the passage.

Q.35 Which of these statements is NOT true?

(a) Socrates considered music and physical education as important aspects of learning.
(b) Socrates encouraged the listeners to come up with original ideas.
(c) The Republic was written around 360 A.D.
(d) Plato's methods of education can be called 'extreme'.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The Republic was written around 360 A.D.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
Text: "'The Republic' ... written around **360 B.C.**" — not A.D. So (c) is **false**.
Why the others are true

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Explanation (contd.)
• **(a)** holistic education (facts, music, PE) — described; **(b)** Socrates drew out listeners' ideas; **(d)** Plato's methods called "extreme" – all supported.

Passage 6 (Q.36–Q.45)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Her name was Sulekha, but since her childhood everyone had been calling her Bholi, the simpleton. She was the fourth daughter of Ramlal. When she was ten months old, she had fallen off the cot on her head and perhaps it had damaged some part of her brain. That was why she remained a backward child and came to be known as Bholi, the simpleton. At birth, the child was very fair and pretty. But when she was two years old, she had an attack of small-pox. Only the eyes were saved, but the entire body was permanently disfigured by deep black pockmarks. Little Sulekha could not speak till she was five as she was a slow learner, and when at last she learnt to speak, she stammered. The other children often made fun of her and mimicked her. As a result, she talked very little. Ramlal had seven children — three sons and four daughters, and the youngest of them was Bholi. It was a prosperous farmer's household and there was plenty to eat and drink. All the children except Bholi were healthy and strong. The sons had been sent to the city to study in schools and later in colleges. Of the daughters, Radha, the eldest, had already been married. The second daughter Mangla's marriage had also been settled, and when that was done, Ramlal would think of the third, Champa. They were good-looking, healthy girls, and it was not difficult to find bridegrooms for them. But Ramlal was worried about Bholi. She had neither good looks nor intelligence. From her very childhood Bholi was neglected at home. She was seven years old when Mangla was married. The same year a primary school for girls was opened in their village. The Tehsildar sahib came to perform its opening ceremony. He said to Ramlal, "As a revenue official you are the representative of the government in the village and so you must set an example to the villagers. You must send your daughters to school." That night when Ramlal consulted his wife, she cried, "Are you crazy? If girls go to school, who will marry them?" But Ramlal had not the courage to disobey the Tehsildar. At last his wife said, "I will tell you what to do. Send Bholi to school. As it is, there is little chance of her getting married, with her ugly face and lack of sense. Let the teachers at school worry about her."

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Q.36 'Backward child' in the passage means:

(a) belonging to a poor family
(b) mentally challenged
(c) physically challenged
(d) belonging to an underprivileged community

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) mentally challenged
Type: Vocabulary (in context)

Explanation (contd.)
Wait — Q35 belongs to the Bholi passage: "she remained a **backward child**" after brain damage → **mentally challenged/slow**.
Why the others are wrong
• **poor family / physically challenged / underprivileged community** – "backward" here refers to slow mental development.

Q.37 Which of these statements is NOT true about Bholi?

(a) She was healthy and strong.
(b) She was seven when her eldest sister got married.
(c) She was a simpleton.
(d) She was neglected by her family.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She was healthy and strong.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
Text: "All the children **except Bholi** were healthy and strong." So Bholi was NOT healthy and strong — (a) is **false**.
Why the others are true
• **(b)** seven when Mangla married, **(c)** a simpleton, **(d)** neglected at home – all stated.

Q.38 At what age did Sulekha damage her brain?

(a) Five years **(b)** Ten months
(c) Seven years **(d)** Two years

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Ten months
How to locate the answer
Text: "When she was **ten months old**, she had fallen off the cot on her head and ... damaged some part of her brain."

Q.39 Bholi's mother agreed to send her to school because:

(a) she cared for Bholi's well-being
(b) she wanted to wash her hands off Bholi
(c) she wanted to educate Bholi
(d) Bholi was neglected at home

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) she wanted to wash her hands off Bholi
How to locate the answer
The mother says: "there is little chance of her getting married ... Let the **teachers at school worry about her**." So she sent Bholi to be rid of the worry.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) cared for well-being / (c) wanted to educate / (d) neglected** – not her real motive.

Q.40 Why was Ramlal worried about Bholi?

(a) She was too old to get married.
(b) She was not willing to get educated.
(c) It would be difficult to arrange her marriage.
(d) It was difficult to comprehend her speech.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) It would be difficult to arrange her marriage.
How to locate the answer

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Explanation (contd.)
The passage says Ramlal was worried because Bholi "had neither good looks nor intelligence", and later the mother says "there is little chance of her getting married". So the worry was about her **marriage**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) too old / (b) unwilling to study / (d) speech** – not the main worry stated.

Q.41 How was Ramlal expected to set an example for the villagers?
(a) By sending his daughters to school
(b) By marrying off his daughters at an early age
(c) By sending his sons to school
(d) By treating Bholi as an equal
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) By sending his daughters to school
How to locate the answer
The Tehsildar tells Ramlal: "you must set an example to the villagers. You must **send your daughters to school**."
Why the others are wrong
• **early marriage / sending sons / treating Bholi equal** – not what the Tehsildar demanded.

Q.42 What did the small pox attack do to Sulekha?
(a) It made her look ugly. **(b)** It damaged her speech.
(c) It damaged her eyes. **(d)** It made her dull.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) It made her look ugly.
How to locate the answer
Text: "the entire body was permanently **disfigured by deep black pockmarks**." (Only the eyes were saved.) So smallpox made her look ugly.
Why the others are wrong
• **damaged her speech / eyes / made her dull** – the eyes were saved; the pox affected her looks.

Q.43 Sulekha came to be called Bholi because she was:
(a) healthy and strong **(b)** not very intelligent
(c) the youngest daughter **(d)** fair and pretty
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) not very intelligent
How to locate the answer
Text: "she remained a backward child and came to be known as **Bholi, the simpleton**." So she was called Bholi for being simple/not very intelligent.
Why the others are wrong
• **healthy / youngest / fair and pretty** – not the reason for the name.

Q.44 The word 'disfigured' suggests that Bholi's looks were:
(a) enhanced **(b)** impaired
(c) preserved **(d)** improved
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) impaired
Type: Vocabulary (in context)
"disfigured" = spoilt in appearance → her looks were **impaired** (damaged).

Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are wrong
• **enhanced / preserved / improved** – opposite meanings.

Q.45 Who was invited to inaugurate the girls' school?
(a) Village head **(b)** Tehsildar
(c) School Headmaster **(d)** Revenue official
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Tehsildar
How to locate the answer
Text: "The **Tehsildar sahib** came to perform its opening ceremony."
Why the others are wrong
• **Village head / Headmaster / Revenue official** – Ramlal was the revenue official; the Tehsildar inaugurated it.

Passage 7 (Q.46–Q.55)
Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Santiniketan embodies Rabindranath Tagore's vision of a place of learning that is unfettered by religious and regional barriers. Established in 1863 with the aim of helping education go beyond the confines of the classroom, Santiniketan grew into the Visva Bharati University in 1921, attracting some of the most creative minds in the country.

He developed a curriculum that was a unique blend of art, human values and cultural interchange. Even today, in every step, in every brick and in every tree at Santiniketan, one can still feel his presence, his passion, his dedication and his pride in the institution.

In 1862, Maharishi Debendranath Tagore, father of Rabindranath, was taking a boat ride through Birbhum, the westernmost corner of Bengal, when he came across a landscape that struck him as the perfect place for meditation. He bought the large tract of land and built a small house and planted some saplings around it. Debendranath Tagore decided to call the place Santiniketan, or the 'abode of peace', because of the serenity it brought to his soul. In 1863, he turned it into a spiritual centre where people from all religions, castes and creeds came and participated in meditation.

In the years that followed, Debendranath's son Rabindranath went on to become one of the most formidable literary forces India has ever produced. He wrote in all literary genres but he was first and foremost a poet. As one of the earliest educators to think in terms of the global village, he envisioned an education that was deeply rooted in one's immediate surroundings but connected to the cultures of the wider world.

Located in the heart of nature, the school aimed to combine education with a sense of obligation towards the larger civic community. Blending the best of western and traditional eastern systems of education, the curriculum revolved organically around nature with classes being held in the open air. Tagore wanted his students to feel free despite being in the formal learning environment of a school, because he himself had dropped out of school when he found himself unable to think and felt claustrophobic within the four walls of a classroom.

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Passage (contd.)

Nature walks and excursions were a part of the curriculum, special attention was paid to natural phenomena and students were encouraged to follow the life cycles of insects, birds and plants.

The rural paradise of Santiniketan, Tagore's erstwhile home, has become a thriving centre of art, education and internationalism over the years.

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Q.46 The curriculum designed for Santiniketan was a blend of:

(a) western education and village practices
(b) spiritual and religious exchange
(c) science and religion
(d) human values, art and culture

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) human values, art and culture
How to locate the answer
Text: "a curriculum that was a unique blend of **art, human values and cultural interchange**."
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) village practices / (b) religious exchange / (c) science and religion** – not the stated blend.

Q.47 When did Santiniketan grow into a university?

(a) In 1922 **(b)** In 1863
(c) In 1921 **(d)** In 1862

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) In 1921
How to locate the answer
Text: "Santiniketan grew into the Visva Bharati University in **1921**."
Why the others are wrong
• **1922 / 1863 / 1862** – other dates in the passage (founding, etc.), not when it became a university.

Q.48 What does the name Santiniketan mean?

(a) Abode of learning **(b)** Abode of love
(c) Abode of peace **(d)** Abode of culture

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Abode of peace
How to locate the answer
Text: "call the place Santiniketan, or the '**abode of peace**'."

Q.49 Which of these statements about Santiniketan is NOT true?

(a) Santiniketan is located in the western most part of Bengal.
(b) Santiniketan was set up by Rabindranath Tagore.
(c) At Santiniketan, classes were held in the open air.
(d) Santiniketan grew into Visva Bharati university.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Santiniketan was set up by Rabindranath Tagore.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
It was set up by **Debendranath Tagore** (Rabindranath's father), not by Rabindranath. So (b) is **false**.

Explanation (contd.)
Why the others are true
• **(a)** in westernmost Bengal (Birbhum), **(c)** open-air classes, **(d)** became Visva Bharati – all stated.

Q.50 The word 'unfettered' in the text suggests:

(a) free from barriers
(b) outside the classroom
(c) bound by religious beliefs
(d) restricted by regional differences

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) free from barriers
Type: Vocabulary (in context)
"unfettered by religious and regional barriers" — **"unfettered"** = free from restrictions/barriers.
Why the others are wrong
• **outside the classroom / bound by religion / restricted by region** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.51 Rabindranath was a 'formidable' literary force. This implies he was:

(a) an orthodox educationist
(b) an avid reader of books
(c) a powerful writer
(d) a wealthy landowner

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) a powerful writer
Type: Vocabulary (in context)
"formidable" literary force = powerful, impressive. So Rabindranath was **a powerful writer**.
Why the others are wrong
• **orthodox educationist / avid reader / wealthy landowner** – not the meaning of "formidable literary force".

Q.52 Why did Rabindranath drop out of school?

(a) He was not interested in studies.
(b) He wanted a formal learning environment.
(c) He found the curriculum too tough.
(d) He felt stifled within the classroom.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) He felt stifled within the classroom.
How to locate the answer
Text: "he himself had dropped out of school when he ... felt **claustrophobic within the four walls of a classroom**."
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) not interested / (b) wanted formal environment / (c) curriculum tough** – not the stated reason.

Q.53 Tagore's 'erstwhile' home means:

(a) magnificent house **(b)** former home
(c) serene abode **(d)** rural retreat

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) former home
Type: Vocabulary (in context)
"erstwhile" = former, previous. So "erstwhile home" = **former home**.
Why the others are wrong

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Explanation (contd.)
• **magnificent / serene / rural** – describe the place, but not the meaning of "erstwhile".

Q.54 With what aim was Santiniketan established?

(a) To make it the perfect place for meditation
(b) To nurture plants, birds and insects
(c) To encourage education outside the classroom
(d) To attract the most creative minds

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) To encourage education outside the classroom
How to locate the answer
Text: "Established ... with the aim of **helping education go beyond the confines of the classroom**."
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) meditation / (b) nurture plants / (d) attract creative minds** – results/details, not the founding aim.

Q.55 What did Santiniketan initially serve as?

(a) A spiritual centre **(b)** A summer house
(c) A classroom **(d)** A holiday resort

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A spiritual centre
How to locate the answer
Text: "In 1863, he turned it into a **spiritual centre** where people from all religions ... came and participated in meditation."
Why the others are wrong
• **summer house / classroom / holiday resort** – not how it initially served.

Passage 8 (Q.56–Q.60)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Chanhudaro was a tiny settlement (less than 7 hectares) as compared to Mohenjodaro (125 hectares), almost exclusively devoted to craft production, including bead-making, shell-cutting, metal-working, seal-making and weight-making. The variety of materials used to make beads is remarkable: stones like carnelian (of a beautiful red colour), jasper, crystal, quartz and steatite; metals like copper, bronze and gold; and shell, faience and terracotta or burnt clay. Some beads were made of two or more stones, cemented together, some of stone with gold caps. The shapes were numerous – disc shaped, cylindrical, spherical, barrel-shaped, segmented. Some were decorated by incising or painting, and some had designs etched onto them.

Passage (contd.)

Techniques for making beads differed according to the material. Steatite, a very soft stone, was easily worked. Some beads were moulded out of a paste made with steatite powder. This permitted making a variety of shapes, unlike the geometrical forms made out of harder stones. How the steatite micro bead was made remains a puzzle for archaeologists studying ancient technology. Archaeologists' experiments have revealed that the red colour of carnelian was obtained by firing the yellowish raw material and beads at various stages of production. Nodules were chipped into rough shapes, and then finely flaked into the final form. Grinding, polishing and finally drilling completed the process. Specialised drills have been found at Chanhudaro, Lothal and more recently at Dholavira. Nageshwar and Balakot, both settlements are near the coast. These were specialised centres for making shell objects – including bangles, ladles and inlay – which were taken to other settlements. Similarly, it is likely that finished products (such as beads) from Chanhudaro and Lothal were taken to the large urban centres such as Mohenjodaro and Harappa.

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Q.56 Which of these stones is very soft and easy to mould?

(a) Quartz **(b)** Steatite
(c) Crystal **(d)** Jasper

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Steatite
How to locate the answer
Text: "**Steatite, a very soft stone**, was easily worked ... beads were moulded out of a paste made with steatite powder."
Why the others are wrong
• **Quartz / Crystal / Jasper** – these are the "harder stones" mentioned.

Q.57 Which of these statements is NOT true?

(a) Harappa and Mohenjodaro were large urban centres.
(b) Beads were made in numerous shapes and sizes.
(c) Carnelian is a beautiful bluish stone.
(d) Chanhudaro was exclusively devoted to craft production.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Carnelian is a beautiful bluish stone.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
Text: "carnelian (of a beautiful **red** colour)." So "bluish" is **false**.
Why the others are true
• **(a)** Harappa/Mohenjodaro were large centres, **(b)** beads made in many shapes, **(d)** Chanhudaro devoted to craft production – all stated.

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Q.58 Which is the final process in the production of beads?

(a) Drilling **(b)** Grinding
(c) Chipping **(d)** Polishing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Drilling
How to locate the answer
Text: "Nodules were chipped ... then finely flaked ... Grinding, polishing and finally **drilling** completed the process." So drilling is the last step.
Why the others are wrong
• **Grinding / Chipping / Polishing** – earlier steps in the process.

Q.59 According to the text, which of these crafts was Not practisedin Chanhudaro?

(a) Paper making **(b)** Weight making
(c) Metal cutting **(d)** Seal making

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Paper making
How to locate the answer (NOT-practised question)
Chanhudaro's crafts were "bead-making, shell-cutting, metal-working, seal-making and weight-making." **Paper making** is not listed.

Q.60 Shell objects were mostly made at Nageshwar and Balakot because:

(a) specialised drills were found here
(b) shells were readily available in these coastal areas
(c) the women loved to wear bangles made of shells
(d) shells were transported here from Lothal

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) shells were readily available in these coastal areas
How to locate the answer
Text: "Nageshwar and Balakot, both settlements are **near the coast**. These were specialised centres for making **shell objects**." Being coastal, shells were readily available.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) drills / (c) women loved bangles / (d) shells from Lothal** – not the reason given.

Passage 9 (Q.61–Q.70)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The drainage systems of India are mainly controlled by the broad relief features of the subcontinent. Accordingly, the Indian rivers are divided into two major groups: the Himalayan rivers; and the Peninsular rivers.

Passage (contd.)

Apart from originating from the two major physiographic regions of India, the Himalayan and the Peninsular rivers are different from each other in many ways. Most of the Himalayan rivers are perennial. It means that they have water throughout the year. These rivers receive water from rain as well as from melted snow from the lofty mountains. The major Himalayan rivers are the Indus, the Ganga and the Brahmaputra. These rivers are long, and are joined by many large and important tributaries. A river along with its tributaries may be called a river system. The two major Himalayan rivers, the Indus and the Brahmaputra originate from the north of the mountain ranges. They cut through the mountains making gorges in the upper course. The perennial Himalayan rivers have long courses from their source to the sea. They perform intensive erosional activity in their upper courses and carry huge loads of silt and sand with their swift current. In the middle and the lower courses, these rivers form meanders, oxbow lakes, levees and many other depositional features in their floodplains as their speed slackens. They also have well developed deltas.

A large number of the Peninsular rivers like the Godavari, Kaveri and Krishna are seasonal, as their flow is dependent on rainfall. During the dry season when it doesn't rain, even the large rivers have reduced flow of water in their channels. The Peninsular rivers have shorter and shallower courses as compared to their Himalayan counterparts. However, some of them originate in the central highlands and flow towards the west. Most of the rivers of peninsular India originate in the Western Ghats and flow towards the Bay of Bengal.

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Q.61 Which of these is NOT a depositional feature found in the lower course of a river?

(a) Oxbow lake **(b)** Gorge
(c) Levee **(d)** Meander

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Gorge
How to locate the answer (NOT depositional)
A **gorge** is formed by **erosion** in the **upper** course. Meanders, oxbow lakes and levees are **depositional** features of the lower course.

Q.62 The word 'seasonal' rivers in the passage means:

(a) rivers whose flow is dependent upon rainfall
(b) rivers that never go dry in any season
(c) rivers that change their course in every season
(d) rivers that flood in every season

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) rivers whose flow is dependent upon rainfall
How to locate the answer
Text: "Peninsular rivers ... are **seasonal, as their flow is dependent on rainfall**."

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Q.63 Erosional activity takes place in the upper course of the river because of:

(a) the presence of flood plains
(b) huge loads of silt and sand
(c) the reduced flow of water
(d) the great speed of water

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the great speed of water
How to locate the answer
Text: "They perform intensive erosional activity in their upper courses and carry huge loads of silt ... with their **swift current**."
Why the others are wrong
• **flood plains / silt loads / reduced flow** – the erosion is due to the fast-flowing water.

Q.64 Which of these is NOT a Himalayan river?

(a) Ganga **(b)** Indus
(c) Brahmaputra **(d)** Godavari

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Godavari
How to locate the answer
The major Himalayan rivers are the Indus, the Ganga and the Brahmaputra. **Godavari** is a Peninsular river.

Q.65 A river along with its tributaries may be called a:

(a) river system **(b)** flood plain
(c) peninsula **(d)** highland

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) river system
How to locate the answer
Text: "A river along with its tributaries may be called a **river system**."

Q.66 Himalayan rivers are never dry because they:

(a) have a shorter and shallower course
(b) are fed by glaciers and rainfall
(c) originate in the Western Ghats
(d) are dependent on rainfall only

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) are fed by glaciers and rainfall
How to locate the answer
Text: Himalayan rivers "receive water from **rain as well as from melted snow** from the lofty mountains" — so they never dry up.
Why the others are wrong
• **shorter course / Western Ghats / rainfall only** – describe Peninsular rivers.

Q.67 The drainage systems of India are controlled by:

(a) depositional features **(b)** tributaries of rivers
(c) erosional activity **(d)** relief features

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) relief features
How to locate the answer
Text: "The drainage systems of India are mainly controlled by the broad **relief features** of the subcontinent."

Q.68 Which of these statements is NOT true about perennial rivers?

(a) They have a very short dry season.
(b) They cover very long distances till they reach the sea.
(c) Most of them originate in the Himalayas.
(d) They have well developed deltas.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) They have a very short dry season.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
Perennial rivers have water **throughout the year** — they do not really have a dry season at all. So "a very short dry season" is **false**.
Why the others are true
• **(b)** long courses to the sea, **(c)** most originate in the Himalayas, **(d)** well-developed deltas – all stated.

Q.69 'Slackened speed' suggests:

(a) reduced speed **(b)** tremendous speed
(c) maximum speed **(d)** average speed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) reduced speed
Type: Vocabulary (in context)
"**slackened** speed" = slowed down / reduced speed.
Why the others are wrong
• **tremendous / maximum / average speed** – opposite or unrelated.

Q.70 'Perennial' rivers mean:

(a) full of water throughout the year
(b) rivers with a long course
(c) those that originate in the mountains
(d) receiving water from the rains

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) full of water throughout the year
How to locate the answer
Text: "Most of the Himalayan rivers are **perennial**. It means that they have **water throughout the year**."

Passage 10 (Q.71–Q.75)
Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

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Passage (contd.)

Cambridge was my metaphor for England, and it was strange that when I left it had become altogether something else, because I had met Stephen Hawking there. It was on a walking tour through Cambridge that the guide mentioned Stephen Hawking, 'poor man, who is quite disabled now, though he is a worthy successor to Isaac Newton, whose chair he has at the university.' And I started, because I had quite forgotten that this most brilliant and completely paralysed astrophysicist, (scholar of astrophysics — branch of physics dealing with stars, planets, etc.) the author of A Brief History of Time, one of the biggest best-sellers ever, lived here. When the walking tour was done, I rushed to a phone booth and, almost tearing the cord so it could reach me outside, phoned Stephen Hawking's house. There was his assistant on the line and I told him I had come in a wheelchair from India (perhaps he thought I had propelled myself all the way) to write about my travels in Britain. I had to see Professor Hawking — even ten minutes would do. "Half an hour," he said. "From three-thirty to four." And suddenly I felt weak all over. Growing up disabled, you get fed up with people asking you to be brave, as if you have a courage account on which you are too lazy to draw a cheque. The only thing that makes you stronger is seeing somebody like you, achieving something huge. Then you know how much is possible and you reach out further than you ever thought you could. "I haven't been brave," said his disembodied computer-voice, the next afternoon. "I've had no choice." Surely, I wanted to say, living creatively with the reality of his disintegrating body was a choice? But I kept quiet, because I felt guilty every time I spoke to him, forcing him to respond. There he was, tapping at the little switch in his hand, trying to find the words on his computer with the only bit of movement left to him, his long, pale fingers. Every so often, his eyes would shut in frustrated exhaustion. And sitting opposite him I could feel his anguish, the mind buoyant with thoughts that came out in frozen phrases and sentences stiff as corpses.

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Q.71 Astrophysics deals with:

(a) creative writing **(b)** diseases
(c) stars and planets **(d)** computers

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) stars and planets
How to locate the answer
Text: "astrophysics — branch of physics dealing with **stars, planets**, etc."

Q.72 Complete the sentence to make it true.
The narrator:

(a) came to Britain to study astrophysics
(b) is the author of A Brief History of Time
(c) dislikes people asking him to be brave
(d) met Stephen Hawking accidently

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) dislikes people asking him to be brave
How to locate the answer
Text: "you get **fed up with people asking you to be brave**, as if you have a courage account ..."
Why the others are wrong
• **study astrophysics / author of the book / met Hawking accidentally** – the book is Hawking's; the meeting was deliberate.

Q.73 Which of these facts is NOT true about Stephen Hawking?

(a) A worthy contemporary of Newton
(b) A brilliant astrophysicist
(c) A paralysed man
(d) A professor at Cambridge

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A worthy contemporary of Newton
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
The guide called Hawking a "worthy **successor** to Isaac Newton" — not a "contemporary" (Newton lived centuries earlier). So (a) is **false**.
Why the others are true
• **brilliant astrophysicist / paralysed / holds Newton's chair at the university** – all stated.

Q.74 The narrator pulled the telephone cord outside the phone booth because he was:

(a) desperate to get an appointment with Stephen Hawking
(b) eager to call Stephen Hawking's home
(c) unable to enter the booth on a wheelchair
(d) not able to hear clearly in the booth

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) unable to enter the booth on a wheelchair
How to locate the answer
The narrator is in a wheelchair; he "almost tearing the cord **so it could reach me outside**" — because he could not take the wheelchair inside the booth.
Why the others are wrong
• **desperate / eager / couldn't hear** – he pulled the cord out specifically because the wheelchair couldn't enter.

Q.75 The narrator felt the professor's anguish in:

(a) the loss of movement in his legs
(b) the extreme exhaustion in his face
(c) his effort to put up a brave front
(d) his inability to express his thoughts in words

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) his inability to express his thoughts in words
How to locate the answer

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Explanation (contd.)
Text: "I could feel his anguish, the mind buoyant with thoughts that came out in **frozen phrases and sentences stiff as corpses**." So the anguish was in his struggle to put thoughts into words.

Why the others are wrong

• **loss of movement / exhaustion / brave front** – felt, but the *anguish* was in expressing thoughts.

Passage 11 (Q.76–Q.85)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The first time that Agha Shahid Ali spoke to me about his approaching death was on 25 April 2001. The conversation began routinely. I had telephoned to remind him that we had been invited to a friend's house for lunch. Although he had been under treatment for cancer for some fourteen months, Shahid was still on his feet and perfectly lucid, except for occasional lapses of memory. I heard him thumbing through his engagement book and then suddenly he said: 'Oh dear. I can't see a thing.' There was a brief pause and then he added: 'I hope this doesn't mean that I'm dying...' I did not know how to respond: his voice was completely at odds with the content of what he had just said, light to the point of jocularity. I mumbled something innocuous: 'No Shahid — of course not. You'll be fine.' He cut me short. In a tone of voice that was at once quizzical and direct, he said: 'When it happens I hope you'll write something about me.'

I was shocked into silence and a long moment passed before I could bring myself to say the things that people say on such occasions. 'Shahid you'll be fine; you have to be strong...' From the window of my study I could see a corner of the building in which he lived, some eight blocks away. It was just a few months since he moved there: he had been living a few miles away, in Manhattan, when he had a sudden blackout in February 2000. After tests revealed that he had a malignant brain tumour, he decided to move to Brooklyn, to be close to his youngest sister, Sameetah, who teaches at the Pratt Institute—a few blocks away from the street where I live. Shahid ignored my reassurances. He began to laugh and it was then that I realised that he was dead serious. I understood that he was entrusting me with a quite specific charge: he wanted me to remember him not through the spoken recitatives of memory and friendship, but through the written word.

He knew that my instincts would have led me to search for reasons to avoid writing about his death: I would have told myself that I was not a poet; that our friendship was of recent date; that there were many others who knew him much better and would be writing from greater understanding and knowledge. All this Shahid had guessed and he had decided to shut off those routes while there was still time. 'You must write about me.' Finally, I said: 'Shahid, I will: I'll do the best I can.'

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Q.76 What did Shahid request the narrator to do?

(a) Be strong and bear the loss bravely
(b) Write about him after his death
(c) Take him along for lunch at their friend's place
(d) Move to his house in Manhattan

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Write about him after his death

How to locate the answer

Shahid says: "When it happens I hope you'll **write something about me**" — he wanted to be remembered "through the written word."

Q.77 Why had the narrator called Shahid Ali?

(a) To enquire about his health
(b) To remind him about a lunch invitation
(c) To give him an important task
(d) To cheer him up in his depression

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To remind him about a lunch invitation

How to locate the answer

Text: "I had telephoned to **remind him that we had been invited to a friend's house for lunch**."

Q.78 What kind of person was Shahid Ali?

(a) Dangerous **(b)** Depressed
(c) Full of life **(d)** Forgetful

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Full of life

How to locate the answer

Even while speaking of his death, Shahid's voice was "light to the point of **jocularity**" and "he began to laugh" — he was **full of life**.

Why the others are wrong

• **Dangerous / Depressed / Forgetful** – opposite of his lively, humorous nature.

Q.79 The narrator was reluctant to write about Shahid because:

(a) he didn't have enough time
(b) it would be emotionally tough for him
(c) the subject did not interest him
(d) he wouldn't be paid for it

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) it would be emotionally tough for him

How to locate the answer

The narrator's "instincts would have led me to search for reasons to avoid writing about his death" — writing about a dying friend would be **emotionally difficult**, so he would find excuses.

Why the others are wrong

• **not enough time / no interest / no payment** – not the reasons implied.

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Q.80 Shahid's voice was full of 'jocularity'. This means it was:

(a) melodious **(b)** sorrowful
(c) humorous **(d)** bitter

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) humorous
Type: Vocabulary (in context)
"jocularity" = a joking, humorous manner.
Why the others are wrong
• **melodious / sorrowful / bitter** – not the meaning of "jocularity".

Q.81 Shahid was perfectly 'lucid'. This suggests he was:

(a) in a delirium **(b)** speaking coherently
(c) not intelligible **(d)** confused

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) speaking coherently
Type: Vocabulary (in context)
"lucid" = clear-minded, speaking clearly and coherently.
Why the others are wrong
• **delirium / not intelligible / confused** – opposite of "lucid".

Q.82 What disease was Shahid Ali suffering from?

(a) Loss of memory **(b)** Blood cancer
(c) Blindness **(d)** Brain tumour

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Brain tumour
How to locate the answer
Text: "tests revealed that he had a **malignant brain tumour**."

Q.83 Shahid had moved to Brooklyn to:

(a) fulfil certain engagements
(b) be close to his youngest sister
(c) teach at Pratt Institute
(d) get treatment for cancer

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) be close to his youngest sister
How to locate the answer
Text: "he decided to move to Brooklyn, **to be close to his youngest sister, Sameetah**."

Q.84 What made Shahid think his end was near?

(a) He was unable to think clearly.
(b) He suddenly couldn't see anything.
(c) He was unable to stand on his feet.
(d) He couldn't utter a word.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He suddenly couldn't see anything.
How to locate the answer
Text: "'Oh dear. **I can't see a thing.**' ... 'I hope this doesn't mean that I'm dying...'" His sudden loss of vision made him think his end was near.

Q.85 Which of these was NOT an excuse that the narrator thought of to decline Shahid's request?

(a) That others knew Shahid better
(b) That he was not a poet
(c) That their friendship was quite recent
(d) That he was too busy

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) That he was too busy
How to locate the answer (NOT-an-excuse question)
The narrator's excuses were: "I was **not a poet**; our **friendship was of recent date**; there were **many others who knew him much better**." "Too busy" is NOT among them.

Passage 12 (Q.86–Q.90)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The Roman Empire covered a vast stretch of territory that included most of Europe as we know it today and a large part of the Fertile Crescent and North Africa.

The Roman empire embraced a wealth of local cultures and languages; that women had a stronger legal position then than they do in many countries today; but also that much of the economy was run on slave labour, denying freedom to substantial numbers of persons. From the fifth century onwards, the empire fell apart in the west but remained intact and exceptionally prosperous in its eastern half.

Roman historians have a rich collection of sources to go on, which we can broadly divide into three groups: (a) texts, (b) documents and (c) material remains. Textual sources include letters, speeches, sermons, laws, and histories of the period written by contemporaries. These were usually called 'Annals' because the narrative was constructed on a year-by-year basis. Documentary sources include mainly inscriptions and papyri. Inscriptions were usually cut on stone, so a large number survive, in both Greek and Latin. The 'papyrus' was a reed-like plant that grew along the banks of the Nile in Egypt and was processed to produce sheets of writing material that was very widely used in everyday life. Thousands of contracts, accounts, letters and official documents survive 'on papyrus' and have been published by scholars who are called 'papyrologists'. Material remains include a very wide assortment of items that mainly archaeologists discover (for example, through excavation and field survey), for example, buildings, monuments and other kinds of structures, pottery, coins, mosaics, even entire landscapes. Each of these sources can only tell us just so much about the past, and combining them can be a fruitful exercise, but how well this is done depends on the historian's skill!

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Q.86 Much of the economy in the Roman empire was run on:

(a) slave labour **(b)** archaeologists
(c) scholars **(d)** women

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) slave labour
How to locate the answer

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Explanation (contd.)
Text: "much of the economy was run on **slave labour**, denying freedom to substantial numbers."

Q.87 Which of these statements is NOT true?

(a) Texts, documents and material remains were the main sources for the historians.
(b) Archaeologists make discoveries through excavations.
(c) The Roman empire flourished longer in the west.
(d) Inscriptions were carved in Greek and Latin.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The Roman empire flourished longer in the west.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
Text: "the empire **fell apart in the west** but remained intact and exceptionally prosperous in its **eastern half**." So it flourished longer in the EAST, not the west — (c) is **false**.
Why the others are true
• **(a)** three source-groups, **(b)** archaeologists excavate, **(d)** inscriptions in Greek and Latin – all stated.

Q.88 Documentary sources of the history of Roman empire include:

(a) sermons **(b)** landscapes
(c) pottery **(d)** inscriptions

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) inscriptions
How to locate the answer
Text: "Documentary sources include mainly **inscriptions and papyri**."
Why the others are wrong
• **sermons** – textual sources; **landscapes / pottery** – material remains.

Q.89 Who were papyrologists?

(a) People who processed papyrus into sheets
(b) Scholars who published documents
(c) People who surveyed the reed like plants along the Nile
(d) Farmers who cultivated papyrus

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Scholars who published documents
How to locate the answer
Text: "papyri ... have been published by scholars who are called '**papyrologists**'."
Why the others are wrong
• **processed papyrus / surveyed reeds / farmers** – not what papyrologists did.

Q.90 Which of these are NOT material remains?

(a) Coins **(b)** Monuments
(c) Annals **(d)** Mosaics

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Annals
How to locate the answer (NOT material remains)
"**Annals**" are textual sources (year-by-year histories). Material remains are buildings, pottery, **coins, mosaics**, monuments.

Passage 13 (Q.91–Q.100)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

In the stress-ridden world, traditional pastimes that could prove therapeutic are dying for want of patronage. One such is the art of puppetry. The word "puppet" is derived from the Latin word pupa, meaning "doll" or "girl". Puppets came into being in India in the third century A.D. Here it was honed into a theatrical art. It helped to propagate the works of saints and religious leaders, and also depict stories from epics. Later, it spread to South East Asia. The Cambodian puppeteers inspired the Thais. Java and Bali followed though it didn't catch on in Sumatra. The Malays followed the Siamese and Japanese styles in the nineteenth century.

Gradually, puppets became more sophisticated in appearance, as skilled craftsmen began to make the models. Puppeteers became trained as performers. In the eighteenth and nineteenth centuries, puppet theatres became extremely popular in artistic circles. Writers like George Sands and Goethe organised their own well-prepared puppet shows to entertain their friends. Puppet shows have been mentioned in the literature by Shakespeare, Ben Johnson, and many others.

Basically, there are three kinds of puppets. Shadow puppets are made of translucent leather and coloured vegetable dyes. Buffalo, goat, or sheep skin is treated to become translucent. Limbs are loosely-jointed so that they can be made to move separately. A stick is attached vertically in the middle. Movement of the stick causes general movements. But for special movements, single strings attached to the limbs are used. These leather puppets are projected on a screen, which is illuminated by a light source placed behind the puppets. The puppeteer manipulates the puppets to form moving shadows on the screen. He also speaks the parts, sings, or is accompanied by music.

String puppets involve puppets that are manipulated by six strings. The performance is on a stage but the puppeteers are never seen. They wear anklets which produce the illusion that the puppets themselves are dancing. The main storyteller recites the storyline, while the puppets perform, and the dialogue and music are provided by the puppeteers.

Rod or stick puppets are constructed around the main central rod. A short horizontal bar serves as the shoulders, from which the upper limbs dangle. The arms, made of cloth and stuffed with straw or paper, are jointed or manipulated with other thinner rods. These puppets can be the size of a human being. The puppeteer hides behind the puppet and manipulates it. The coordination of the limbs comes only through practice.

Puppetry is a good communication medium. Messages can be propagated in a realistic way. Puppet making and performing is good occupational therapy for convalescents and physically disabled people. Muscular coordination and manual dexterity improve with effort. However, the best use of this art is that it can provide delightful hours of fun to young and old alike.

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Q.91 Which of the following statements testifies that puppetry was popular in artistic circles?

(a) Puppets became more sophisticated in appearance.
(b) People spent a huge sum of money to see puppet shows.
(c) Puppeteers were trained to give performances.
(d) Puppetry finds a mention in literature.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Puppetry finds a mention in literature.
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: Puppet shows were mentioned by Shakespeare, Ben Johnson and others, and writers like George Sands and Goethe staged them — showing popularity in **artistic/literary circles**.

Q.92 Traditional ways of recreation, such as puppetry, are dying because:

(a) the performers lack skill and training
(b) they do not provide relaxation from stress
(c) the performances are no longer interesting
(d) they do not get the support of patrons

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) they do not get the support of patrons
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: Opening line — traditional pastimes "are dying for want of **patronage**." So the cause is lack of patrons' support.

Q.93 Where did the art of puppetry first come into being?

(a) Cambodia **(b)** Japan
(c) India **(d)** Bali

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) India
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: "Puppets came into being in **India** in the third century A.D." — later it spread to South East Asia.

Q.94 Limbs of the puppets are loosely-jointed:

(a) to create the illusion of dancing
(b) to allow movement of limbs separately
(c) to make the movements aesthetic
(d) to move the entire body of the puppet

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) to allow movement of limbs separately
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: "Limbs are loosely-jointed so that they can be made to move separately."
Why the others are wrong
• Dancing illusion / aesthetics / whole-body movement – not the stated reason.

Q.95 A light source is placed behind the shadow puppets so that:

(a) the puppeteer is hidden from view
(b) they are clearly visible in bright light
(c) the puppets can illuminate the screen
(d) moving shadows can be created on the screen

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) moving shadows can be created on the screen
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: A light source is placed behind shadow puppets so their **moving shadows fall on the screen** for the audience.

Q.96 Which of the following statements about string puppets is FALSE?

(a) The main storyteller narrates the story.
(b) Puppets wear anklets while dancing.
(c) Six strings are used to manipulate puppets.
(d) The show is performed on a stage.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Puppets wear anklets while dancing.
Type: Reading Comprehension – FALSE
Reason: The passage mentions a narrator, six strings, and a stage for string puppets; it does **not** say puppets wear anklets — so that statement is false.

Q.97 The above passage is:

(a) factual **(b)** didactic
(c) literary **(d)** narrative

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) factual
Type: Reading Comprehension – Tone/Type
Reason: The passage gives facts about puppetry's origin, types and history — it is **factual/informative**, not didactic, literary or narrative.

Q.98 Which of the following is NOT a benefit of the art of puppetry?

(a) It is entertaining for people of all ages.
(b) It is a good therapy for physically challenged people.
(c) A puppeteer is required to manipulate the puppets.
(d) Messages can be propagated in a realistic manner.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A puppeteer is required to manipulate the puppets.
Type: Reading Comprehension – NOT/Detail
Locate: Benefits mentioned: entertainment for all ages, therapy, realistic messages. Needing a puppeteer to manipulate them is a **requirement, not a benefit**.

Q.99 The word puppet is derived from the Latin word:

(a) doll **(b)** rod
(c) pupa **(d)** girl

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) pupa
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail

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Explanation (contd.)
Locate: "The word 'puppet' is derived from the Latin word **pupa**, meaning 'doll' or 'girl'." The word is *pupa* (its meaning is doll/girl).
Why the others are wrong
• Doll / girl are the meanings, not the Latin word; rod is unrelated.

Q.100 The upper limbs of stick puppets are made of:

(a) straw **(b)** paper
(c) leather **(d)** cloth

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) cloth
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: For stick puppets, the passage states the upper limbs are made of **cloth** (lower parts of leather/other material).

Passage 14 (Q.101–Q.110)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

You go up a dark, rickety stairwell of a building on a crowded street in Calcutta. You enter a small room. The centre of the room is empty but the corners are stacked with bedrolls, utensils and water bottles. Musical instruments, drums, cymbals and gongs are piled in a corner. Today, the room is filled with the laughter of men and women in colourful attire. Among the happy chorus of congratulations and laughter, the bride Chumki Pal and the groom Sandeep can be seen smiling. They are both blind, as are most of the people surrounding them. Pal is wearing a bright turquoise blue sari. "I know it's blue because people have told me but I can't imagine how it looks. But believe me, when I dream, I dream only in colours," she says. Their romance blossomed when they met as members of Blind Opera, the only one of its kind in the country as well as in Asia.

The 36 spirited members of Blind Opera demonstrate that physical disability is not an obstacle. They enact plays by Rabindranath Tagore, considered challenging even by veteran theatre groups. Blind Opera was launched in 1996 by four theatre aficionados, who took it as a challenge to get together the talents of these visually impaired people. The challenge to present the cast on stage is immense since space management is a problem. To solve this, the directors use ropes to separate the stage and the wings. When the actors step on the rope they know that it is the entrance to the stage. The members cannot see, but they can smell, hear and touch – three elements inherent to any theatre. At Blind Opera, they "believe that the blind can see. That is, they see in their own way, if not in our way, with the help of these abilities."

Passage (contd.)

For the visually impaired, theatre is the medium for expression of their creative urges. They respond instinctively; they cannot copy anyone else because they cannot see. Their body language tells the story and hence it is very spontaneous. The members have earned kudos from Calcutta audiences. For the members of the troupe, discovering the language of the body is in a way also a journey of the persona. Coming from diverse backgrounds but bound together by the same disability, they have found an outlet for their creativity through the plays. They do not feel isolated anymore because they can relate to their fellow performers.

There is also a greater purpose behind it: to use theatre to build a community and mainstream the huge number of disabled living in isolation. Together they can be a force to demand better facilities in public life. Blind children should enter the mainstream from the beginning. The big dream of the group is to establish a drama school following the ideal of Tagore's Shantiniketan, offering a platform for creative expression to all those who are economically and socially forced to stay in the periphery. Like Chumki Pal, they all dream in colour.

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Q.101 What is the happy occasion mentioned in the beginning of the passage?

(a) A musical show **(b)** A laughter show
(c) A wedding **(d)** A birthday

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) A wedding
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: The opening describes the bride Chumki Pal and groom Sandeep — the happy occasion is a **wedding**.

Q.102 What is the biggest problem in presenting the troupe on stage?

(a) Time management **(b)** Spontaneity
(c) Space management **(d)** Communication

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Space management
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: "The challenge to present the cast on stage is immense since **space management** is a problem" (solved using ropes).

Q.103 The visually impaired do NOT feel secluded in the Blind Opera group because they can:

(a) play musical instruments together
(b) express their creativity freely
(c) relate to their fellow performers
(d) become economically independent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) relate to their fellow performers
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: In Blind Opera the visually impaired are among others like themselves, so they **relate to fellow performers** and do not feel secluded.

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Q.104 Which of the following is NOT a key element inherent to any theatre?

(a) Sense of touch **(b)** Sense of smell
(c) Sense of hearing **(d)** Sense of taste

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Sense of taste
Type: Reading Comprehension – NOT
Reason: Theatre appeals to sight, hearing, touch and smell; **taste** is not an inherent element of theatre.

Q.105 What is the binding factor for the members of Blind Opera?

(a) Their diverse backgrounds
(b) Their love for plays of Tagore
(c) Visual impairment
(d) Their talent for acting

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Visual impairment
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Reason: The members come from diverse backgrounds; the common binding factor is that they are all **visually impaired**.

Q.106 The greater intent behind Blind Opera is to:

(a) showcase the talent of the visually challenged
(b) popularise the plays of Rabindranath Tagore
(c) bring the disabled into the mainstream
(d) establish a drama school on the lines of Shantiniketan

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) bring the disabled into the mainstream
Type: Reading Comprehension – Inference/Main Idea
Reason: Beyond showcasing talent, the greater aim is to **integrate the disabled into the mainstream** of society.

Q.107 How do the actors of Blind Opera ascertain they are on stage?

(a) By the ropes used to demarcate the area
(b) By their sense of smell and touch
(c) By their familiarity with the stage
(d) By the cheering of the audience

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) By the ropes used to demarcate the area
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: The directors use **ropes** to separate the stage from the wings; when actors step on the rope they know they are at the entrance/stage.

Q.108 The members of Blind Opera demonstrate that:

(a) physical disability is not an obstacle
(b) their talent cannot be tapped
(c) the visually challenged lack expression
(d) blindness is a great hindrance

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) physical disability is not an obstacle
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail

Explanation (contd.)
Locate: "The 36 spirited members of Blind Opera demonstrate that **physical disability is not an obstacle**."

Q.109 Which of the following statements contradicts the writer's view?

(a) The blind dream in colour despite their disability.
(b) The actors of Blind Opera imitate others easily.
(c) As a united community, the disabled can demand better facilities.
(d) Blind children should enter the mainstream from the beginning.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The actors of Blind Opera imitate others easily.
Type: Reading Comprehension – Contradiction
Reason: The passage praises their originality and courage; it does **not** say they imitate others easily — this contradicts the writer's view.

Q.110 Which of the following statements is FALSE?

(a) The blind can see in their own way.
(b) Blind Opera is one of its kind in the world.
(c) Calcutta audiences have lauded Blind Opera.
(d) Blind Opera was launched in 1996.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Blind Opera is one of its kind in the world.
Type: Reading Comprehension – FALSE
Reason: The passage says it is the only one of its kind **in the country as well as in Asia** — not the whole world. So this statement is false.

Passage 15 (Q.111–Q.115)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

A piano teacher described an interesting encounter she had had with a young lady who came to inquire about music lessons. The young lady asked her, "How long will this course take? My father tells me that it is in fashion now to be able to play musical instruments and that I should learn one quickly. I want something that will be quick, fast and easy like, like...." When the amused teacher explained that it would take a lifetime of meticulous practice to learn music, her face fell and, needless to say, she never came back.

The single most important factor that distinguishes those of us who succeed in any venture and those of us who don't is this 'instant coffee' attitude. Most of us want results quickly. We want to reach the top immediately and get worked up when things go wrong. Perseverance and patience are forgotten words. We get upset, frustrated, and angry when a skill or activity requires us to put in a lot of effort and time. We get dejected and want to give it up.

But such thinking serves no good. For, it doesn't solve the problem. Life is tough for those with an 'instant coffee' attitude.

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Passage (contd.)

Success, real success and happiness come to those who have a 'bread-making' attitude- those who are willing to knead the dough, wait for hours for it to rise, only to punch it down and knead some more, wait for another couple of hours for it to rise again, and then bake it before it is ready to be eaten. Nothing is instantaneous. For every endeavour – whether in the area of career, academics, music, sports, relationships, physical fitness or even in spirituality – it is a long, arduous journey.

Only if we are willing to put in the time, painstaking effort and have faith, can we get results. If we don't accept this difficult-but-true fact of life, our lives will be far from being happy and fulfilling. For we may not make that extra effort which can change the course of life dramatically, for the good.

The major problems with these 'instant coffee' solutions are that they are invariably short-lived. If we stubbornly refuse to give up this search for quick solutions, all we do is end up on the wrong track.

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Q.111 Why did the young lady approach the piano teacher for music lessons?

(a) She was a music lover and was keen to take lessons.
(b) The piano teacher was highly accomplished.
(c) She was willing to practise hard to become a successful piano player.
(d) It was considered fashionable to be able to play musical instruments.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) It was considered fashionable to be able to play musical instruments.
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: The young lady says her father told her "it is in fashion now to be able to play musical instruments and that I should learn one quickly."
Why the others are wrong
• She was not a keen music lover, nor willing to practise hard (she wanted it "quick, fast and easy"); the teacher's accomplishment is not the reason.

Q.112 What kind of attitude does the writer advocate for a life of fulfilment?

(a) One of perseverance and patience
(b) One of instant gratification
(c) One of stubbornness and refusal
(d) One of anger and dejection

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) One of perseverance and patience
Type: Reading Comprehension – Main Idea
Locate: Success comes to those with a 'bread-making' attitude — willing to knead and wait. The writer advocates **perseverance and patience**.
Why the others are wrong
• Instant gratification / stubbornness / anger – opposite to the writer's message.

Q.113 What does 'bread making' attitude consist of?

(a) Futile labour **(b)** Talent and skill
(c) Painstaking efforts **(d)** Instantaneous results

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Painstaking efforts
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: Bread-making = knead the dough, wait for hours, punch it, knead more, wait, bake — i.e., **painstaking efforts**.
Why the others are wrong
• Futile labour / talent / instant results – not what the passage describes.

Q.114 What do you understand by the term 'instant coffee attitude'?

(a) Keeping up with the latest trends
(b) Short-lived pleasure
(c) Passion to learn something
(d) Expecting quick results

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Expecting quick results
Type: Reading Comprehension – Inference
Locate: "Most of us want results quickly ... reach the top immediately." The 'instant coffee attitude' = expecting quick results.
Why the others are wrong
• Latest trends / short-lived pleasure / passion to learn – not the writer's definition.

Q.115 When an activity requires too much effort we feel:

(a) frustrated **(b)** happy
(c) inspired **(d)** fulfilled

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) frustrated
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: "We get upset, **frustrated**, and angry when a skill ... requires us to put in a lot of effort."
Why the others are wrong
• Happy / inspired / fulfilled – opposite of the reaction described.

Passage 16 (Q.116–Q.120)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Although pollution of land, sea, and air has been well documented, the latest and the least recognised version is the swelling tide of noise which is engulfing urban as well as rural areas. This has long-term implications on the ecology, health and productivity of a fast developing country like India.

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Passage (contd.)

Unlike other pollutants, noise lacks visibility, seldom registering on the consciousness, except as a trifling irritant to be dismissed at will and therefore less likely to be perceived as a threat. Available data indicates that noise does pose a threat to health and is known to have caused a number of complications. Declining productivity among workers in certain industries has been directly correlated with noise levels, particularly those under constant exposure to the menace.

The first-ever survey of the impact of noise on health, conducted by All India Institute of Medical Sciences (AIIMS), has established that noise not only impairs the physical and psychological functioning of the human organism but also causes nausea, vomiting, pain, hypertension and a lot of other complications, including cardio-vascular complaints.

A study by Post Graduate School of Basic Medical Sciences, Chennai, confirms such conclusions. In 50 per cent of industries, it was found that workmen exposed to higher intensities of noise in occupational capacities were often irritated, short-tempered, and impatient and more likely to resort to agitation and disrupt production. This was true of units in heavy industrial pockets in and around the four metropolitan centres.

Recreational noise, another ugly facet, is becoming more widespread in cities and towns. Loudspeakers are turned at full volume during marriages, festivals, jagrans, musical programmes, particularly at night, without the least consideration for others. Even at 50 dB, sound can awaken a person from a deep slumber. As experiments have shown, loudspeakers with output from 60 to 80 dB cause the pupils of a slumbering person to dilate, with increasing intake of oxygen, resulting in palpitation. The effect is more pronounced in narrow lanes. TV sets are played at full volume at prime time, invariably disturbing neighbours. Noise making seems to have become the latest status symbol, be it an election campaign or slogan shouting or advertising ownership of a TV set.

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Q.116 According to a survey conducted by AIIMS, noise does NOT cause:

(a) hypertension
(b) eye infections
(c) nausea and vomiting
(d) heart related complaints

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) eye infections
Type: Reading Comprehension – NOT
Locate: The AIIMS survey lists nausea, vomiting, pain, hypertension and cardio-vascular complaints. **Eye infections** are not mentioned.

Q.117 Noise can be differentiated from other pollutants because:

(a) it is prevalent only in the urban areas of the country
(b) it is not detrimental to our health in any way
(c) it does not impact the productivity of the workers in industries
(d) it is regarded as a small irritant which may be easily dismissed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) it is regarded as a small irritant which may be easily dismissed
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Locate: "noise lacks visibility ... except as a trifling irritant to be dismissed at will." Unlike other pollutants, it is treated as a minor irritant.

Q.118 Which of the following statements is FALSE?

(a) There is a direct correlation between productivity of workers and noise.
(b) Noise pollution is not visible to the eyes.
(c) Several studies have been conducted on air, water and land pollution.
(d) Loudspeakers with low decibel sound can cause palpitations.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Loudspeakers with low decibel sound can cause palpitations.
Type: Reading Comprehension – FALSE
Reason: It is **high** decibel noise, not low, that causes such effects. Hence this statement is false.

Q.119 Recreational noise is created during:

(a) running of heavy machinery
(b) weddings and festivals
(c) shouting of slogans
(d) discord between agitated workers

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) weddings and festivals
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Reason: Recreational noise comes from social/leisure events like **weddings and festivals** (loudspeakers, celebrations).

Q.120 In what way does noise become a status symbol?

(a) Awakening people from deep sleep
(b) Showing off the loud volume of one's TV
(c) Conducting late night musical shows
(d) Exposing workmen to high intensity sounds

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Showing off the loud volume of one's TV
Type: Reading Comprehension – Detail
Reason: Noise becomes a status symbol when people **flaunt the loud volume** of their appliances/TV.

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Passage 17 (Q.121–Q.125)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

The blowout of an Oil India Limited (OIL) gas well in Assam's Tinsukia district last week is causing extensive damage to biodiversity and wildlife in the region, including the endangered hoolock gibbons and Gangetic dolphins.

Baghjan, where the gas well blowout occurred on 27 May, is close to the Dibru-Saikhowa National Park, the Maguri-Motapung wetlands, and the forest villages of Barekuri which are habitat to the hoolock gibbon.

Uncontrollable gas flow is continuing from the gas well.

"What we are seeing is complete horror. Condensed oil is leaking continuously. The Maguri-Motapung wetlands (an important bird and biodiversity area) is very badly affected. There is a thick layer of crude oil on the water. Fish are dying and some cattle that graze in the adjacent wetlands are also dead," said Mridupaban Phukon, a student and wildlife activist.

"We have been informed by people in Barekuri villages that condensed oil is coating leaves and has started affecting the hoolock gibbon habitat. If not contained immediately the wetlands and national park will be devastated," he said.

Around 650 families have been evacuated from the affected areas and continue to be camped in three relief camps.

"I visited the area on Sunday but it was barricaded. I could see the damage everywhere. Dead fish were floating and the vegetation is brown now. One Gangetic dolphin died soon after the leak. Usually the Maguri jheel is rich with birdlife, I could hardly spot any birds that day. I appeal for immediate help," said Nabamita Ray, a doctor and wildlife enthusiast.

Oil India's crisis management team (CMT) members have started pumping water through the casing valve. Water is being pumped continuously through the valve into the well head. Oil India has also contacted global experts to control the blowout.The water pumps are being installed in the nearby river (source of water) and pipeline-laying work is in progress.

A blowout is the uncontrolled release of crude oil or natural gas from an oil well or gas well after pressure control systems have failed.

Dibru-Saikhowa has recorded over 40 mammals, 500 species of birds, 104 fish species, 105 butterfly species and 680 types of plants. It harbours tigers, elephants, wild buffalos, leopards, hoolock gibbons, capped langurs, slow lorises, Gangetic dolphins, besides critically endangered bird species such as the Bengal florican, white-winged duck, greater adjutant stork, white-rumped vulture, slender-billed vulture, and the very rare and endemic black-breasted parrotbill. All these are facing threat from the uncontrolled flow of the oil.

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Q.121 The main focus of this report is on:

(a) the damage to the biodiversity and wildlife that the blowout has caused
(b) what a gas well blowout is and how it occurs
(c) the scene created by the gas well blowout
(d) the measures being employed by the gas company to control the blow out

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) the damage to the biodiversity and wildlife that the blowout has caused

How to locate the answer

Opening line: the blowout "is causing extensive damage to **biodiversity and wildlife**." That is the main focus.

Why the others are wrong

• **(b) what a blowout is / (c) the scene / (d) control measures** – details, not the main focus.

Q.122 Why could Nabamita Ray not reach the area to see the damage done by the leaking oil?

(a) The area was barricaded to stop the people to go in as it might be dangerous.
(b) The villagers stopped her from visiting the Maguri jheel.
(c) She was stopped by the forest authorities as she might disturb the animals.
(d) The area was covered with thick slippery oil and it was impossible to walk.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The area was barricaded to stop the people to go in as it might be dangerous.

How to locate the answer

Nabamita Ray says: "I visited the area on Sunday but it was **barricaded**." So she could not go in because it was barricaded.

Q.123 Match the words (a, b, c) with their meaning (1, 2, 3).

a. extensive 1. adjoining
b. adjacent 2. thickened
c. condensed 3.widespread

(a) a-2, b-3, c-1 **(b)** a-3, b-2, c-1
(c) a-1, b-3, c-2 **(d)** a-3, b-1, c-2

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) a-3, b-1, c-2

Type: Vocabulary Matching

• **a. extensive** = widespread → **3**.
• **b. adjacent** = adjoining → **1**.
• **c. condensed** = thickened → **2**.

So **a-3, b-1, c-2**.

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Q.124 Which statement is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) The blowout of an Oil India Limited (OIL) gas well occurred in Assam's Tinsukia district.
(b) The place where the blowout happened was close to the Dibru-Saikhowa National Park and the Maguri-Motapung wetlands.
(c) Around 650 families from the nearby villages were evacuated from the areas affected by the blowout.
(d) One hoolock gibbon died soon after the leak of the oil from the blowout.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) One hoolock gibbon died soon after the leak of the oil from the blowout.

How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)

Text: "One **Gangetic dolphin** died soon after the leak." It was a dolphin, not a hoolock gibbon — so (d) is **false**.

Why the others are true

• **(a)** blowout in Tinsukia, **(b)** near Dibru-Saikhowa/Maguri-Motapung, **(c)** 650 families evacuated – all stated.

Q.125 Which is the critically endangered bird species found at Dibru-Saikhowa National Park?

(a) Hoolock gibbon **(b)** Capped langur
(c) Gangetic dolphin **(d)** Bengal florican

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Bengal florican

How to locate the answer

Text lists critically endangered **birds**: "the **Bengal florican**, white-winged duck, greater adjutant stork ..."

Why the others are wrong

• **Hoolock gibbon / Capped langur** – mammals; **Gangetic dolphin** – a mammal, not a bird.

Passage 18 (Q.126–Q.135)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

In the late 18th century the Industrial Revolution began to transform life in Britain. Until then, most people lived in the countryside and made their living from farming. By the mid-19th century most people in Britain lived in towns and made their living from mining or manufacturing industries.

In 1712 a man named Thomas Newcomen (1663-1729) made primitive steam engines for pumping water from mines. In 1769 James Watt (1736-1819) patented a more efficient steam engine. In 1785 his engine was adapted to driving machinery in a cotton factory. The use of steam engines to drive machines slowly transformed industry.

Meanwhile, during the 1700s Britain built up a great overseas empire. The North American colonies were lost after the War of Independence 1776-1783. On the other hand, after the Seven Years War 1756-1763, Britain captured Canada and India. Britain also took Dominica, Grenada, St. Vincent and Tobago in the West Indies. In 1707 the Act of Union was passed. Scotland was united with England and Wales. England became part of Great Britain.

Passage (contd.)

Owning land was the main form of wealth in the 18th century. Political power and influence were in the hands of rich landowners. At the top were the nobility. Below them were a class of nearly rich landowners called the gentry. In the early 18th century there was another class of landowners called yeomen who were small landowners, described as farmers of the middle class. However, during the century this class became less and less numerous. However other middle class people such as merchants and professional men became richer and more numerous, especially in the towns.

Below them were the great mass of the population, craftsmen and labourers. In the 18th century probably half the population lived at subsistence or bare survival level.

In the early 18th century England suffered from gin drinking. It was cheap and it was sold everywhere as you did not need a license to sell it. Many people ruined their health by drinking gin. Sadly, for many poor people drinking gin was their only comfort. The situation improved after 1751 when a tax was imposed on gin.

At the end of the 17th century it was estimated the population of England and Wales was about 5 1/2 million. The population of Scotland was about 1 million. The population of London was about 600,000. In the mid-18th century the population of Britain was about 6 1/2 million. In the late 18th century it grew rapidly and by 1801 it was over 9 million. The population of London was almost 1 million.

During the 18th century, towns in Britain grew larger. Nevertheless, most towns still had populations of less than 10,000. However, in the late 18th century new industrial towns in the Midland and the North of England mushroomed. Meanwhile, the population of London grew to nearly 1 million by the end of the century. Other towns were much smaller. The population of Liverpool was about 77,000 in 1800. Birmingham had about 73,000 people and Manchester had about 70,000. Bristol had a population of about 68,000. Sheffield was smaller with 31,000 people and Leeds had about 30,000 people.

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Q.126 Which of the following was NOT a colony of Britain in the West Indies?

(a) Grenada **(b)** Dominica
(c) Tobago **(d)** Canada

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Canada

How to locate the answer

The West Indies colonies named are "Dominica, Grenada, St. Vincent and Tobago". **Canada** was captured in **North America**, not the West Indies.

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Q.127 In British society, what was the social hierarchy of the following classes from top to bottom? Select the correct order.
A. Yeomen and merchants
B. Craftsmen and labourers
C. Nobility
D. Gentry

(a) BADC **(b)** CADB
(c) CDAB **(d)** DCBA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) CDAB
Type: Ordering (social hierarchy, top to bottom)
• **C. Nobility** (highest),
• **D. Gentry**,
• **A. Yeomen and merchants**,
• **B. Craftsmen and labourers** (lowest).
Order → **C-D-A-B**.

Q.128 Which of the following statements is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) In 18th century England almost half the population consisted of poor people.
(b) In the mid-19th century the towns grew and most people were engaged in mining and manufacturing.
(c) Before the Industrial Revolution, most of the people in England lived in villages and were engaged in agriculture.
(d) After the War of Independence, Britain had colonies in North America.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) After the War of Independence, Britain had colonies in North America.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
Text: "The North American colonies **were lost** after the War of Independence." So Britain did NOT have them afterward — (d) is **false**.
Why the others are true
• **(a)** half the population poor, **(b)** mining/manufacturing, **(c)** villagers in farming before – all stated.

Q.129 By the end of the 18th century the population of Britain was:

(a) around 5 1/2 million **(b)** almost 6 1/2 million
(c) about 1 million **(d)** over 9 million

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) over 9 million
How to locate the answer
Text: "In the late 18th century it grew rapidly and by 1801 it was **over 9 million**."
Why the others are wrong
• **5½ / 6½ / 1 million** – earlier or partial figures.

Q.130 The main theme of the passage is:

(a) expansion of the English Empire in 18th century
(b) towns in 18th century England
(c) habits of Englishmen in 18th century England
(d) society in 18th century England

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) society in 18th century England
How to locate the answer
The passage covers industry, empire, classes, gin drinking, population and towns — the whole picture of **18th-century English society**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) empire / (b) towns / (c) habits** – each covers only one part.

Q.131 Among the following towns, which had the maximum population?

(a) Bristol **(b)** Manchester
(c) Birmingham **(d)** Liverpool

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Liverpool
How to locate the answer
Populations in 1800: Liverpool ~77,000, Birmingham ~73,000, Manchester ~70,000, Bristol ~68,000. **Liverpool** had the most.

Q.132 The number of new towns increased in Britain during the 18th century basically because of:

(a) increase in farming **(b)** growth of industry
(c) growth of population **(d)** increase in mining

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) growth of industry
How to locate the answer
The Industrial Revolution caused "new industrial towns ... [to mushroom]" — new towns grew mainly because of the **growth of industry**.
Why the others are wrong
• **farming / population / mining** – supporting factors, but the passage links new towns to industry.

Q.133 In the early 18th century, people in England drank a lot of gin because of which of the following reasons?
a. It was cheap.
b. It was easily available.
c. For many poor people drinking gin was their only comfort.

(a) a, b and c all are correct.
(b) Only b and c are correct.
(c) Only a and c are correct.
(d) Only a and b are correct.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) a, b and c all are correct.
How to locate the answer
Text: gin "was cheap" (a), "was sold everywhere" (b — easily available), and "for many poor people ... was their only comfort" (c). All three reasons are given.

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Q.134 Around what time period did the British capture Canada and India?

(a) 1663-1729 **(b)** 1776-1783
(c) 1745-1752 **(d)** 1756-1763

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) 1756-1763

How to locate the answer

Text: "after the **Seven Years War 1756-1763**, Britain captured Canada and India."

Why the others are wrong

• **1663-1729** (Newcomen's dates), **1776-1783** (War of Independence), **1745-1752** – not the capture of Canada/India.

Q.135 Which of the following transformed life in 18th century England?

(a) The Industrial Revolution
(b) Farming and mining
(c) Invention of the steam engine
(d) Making of Great Britain

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The Industrial Revolution

How to locate the answer

Opening line: "the **Industrial Revolution** began to transform life in Britain."

Why the others are wrong

• **farming/mining / steam engine / Great Britain** – parts of the change, but the driving force was the Industrial Revolution.

Passage 19 (Q.136–Q.145)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Quarantine and self-isolation need not be monotonous and stifling. They can be the gateway to work, be it in the arts or the sciences, that define the history of the world.

Isaac Newton, Charles Darwin, John Milton and Lord Byron used such time to add to their formidable body of work in science and literature. It was not called lockdown in their time, but they spent long spells in isolation, when medicine was not as developed as it is now.

The University of Cambridge, where all four studied, delved into its archives to collate their activities during such periods of isolation centuries ago.

Isaac Newton (Trinity College): Considered Trinity's most accomplished alumni, he exemplified productivity during a pandemic. Like many in Cambridge during the Great Plague of 1655-56, he retreated to the countryside to escape the disease-ridden city and spent two extended periods at his family home in rural Lincolnshire.

Newton thrived in isolation, and later described it as one of the most productive times in his life, finding the space to reflect on and develop his theories on optics, calculus, and the laws of motion and gravity. It was during this time that he conducted his famous prism experiment.

Passage (contd.)

"He bored a hole through his window shutters to produce a single, thin beam of light to pass through two prisms, proving for the first time that prisms did not create colours, but merely separated colours that were already there," the university's researcher, Alisha Matthewson-Grand, wrote.

"Indeed, Newton was so intellectually transformed by his period of isolation that later commentators have referred to his time away from Cambridge as his annus mirabilis, or his 'year of wonders'."

Charles Darwin (Christ's College): Darwin's experience with isolation was not the result of a pandemic but his own chronic ill health. He suffered from a myriad of unexplained symptoms, including vertigo, vomiting, cramps, fatigue, anxiety and visual disturbances.

He noted in his autobiography of 1876 that "few persons can have lived a more retired life than we [Darwin and his wife Emma] have done. Besides short visits to the houses of relations, and occasionally to the seaside or elsewhere, we have gone nowhere."

Darwin believed that periods of isolation and ill health helped his career. At home, he was free from the demands placed on other scientists (teaching, administrative work), and thus able to devote himself entirely to research; he wrote: "Ill-health, though it has annihilated several years of my life, has saved me from the distractions of society and amusement."

Lord Byron (Trinity College): In 1811, Lord Byron was forced to quarantine in Malta after returning from a cholera-ravaged Greece. He was furious at the prospect of spending 40 days in lockdown, a measure he considered to be draconian and unnecessary.

While confined, he wrote 'Farewell to Malta', a satirical poem attacking the island for (among other things) "Its smoky towns and cloudy sky" and its "cursed street of stairs". He references his quarantine explicitly in the first verse "Adieu, thou damned'st quarantine / That gave me fever, and the spleen!'.

John Milton (Christ's College): The author of 'Paradise Lost' spent some time away from Cambridge as a first year undergraduate in 1626, when the town was hit by bubonic plague. He was home in London when he wrote Elegia Prima, his first Latin elegy. The work is an early example of his aptitude for verse composition, as well as his impressive flair for comedy.

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Q.136 Who among the following was quarantined during the bubonic plague?

(a) Isaac Newton **(b)** John Milton
(c) Lord Byron **(d)** Charles Darwin

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) John Milton

How to locate the answer

Text: "**John Milton** ... spent time away from Cambridge ... in 1626, when the town was hit by **bubonic plague**."

Why the others are wrong

• **Newton** – Great Plague; **Byron** – cholera quarantine; **Darwin** – chronic ill health.

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Q.137 Lord Byron was a:

(a) researcher **(b)** teacher
(c) scientist **(d)** poet

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) poet
How to locate the answer
Byron "wrote 'Farewell to Malta', a **satirical poem**" — he was a **poet**.
Why the others are wrong
• **researcher / teacher / scientist** – describe Newton/Darwin, not Byron.

Q.138 Which of the following statements is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) Milton was furious at the prospect of spending 40 days in lockdown, a measure he considered absolutely unnecessary.
(b) Newton and Byron were the alumni of Trinity College, of the Cambridge University.
(c) Newton's period of isolation was his year of wonder as he was intellectually transformed during this time.
(d) Darwin suffered from a number of problems like vomiting, fatigue, cramps, anxiety, etc.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Milton was furious at the prospect of spending 40 days in lockdown, a measure he considered absolutely unnecessary.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
It was **Lord Byron** (not Milton) who "was furious at the prospect of spending 40 days in lockdown." So (a) is **false**.
Why the others are true
• **(b)** Newton and Byron were Trinity College alumni, **(c)** Newton's 'year of wonders', **(d)** Darwin's symptoms – all stated.

Q.139 How did periods of isolation and ill health help Darwin in his career?

(a) He was resting and getting cured of his chronic ill health.
(b) He was free to teach and do administrative work.
(c) He was able to devote time to his research.
(d) He and his wife could spend time together and visit their relatives.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He was able to devote time to his research.
How to locate the answer
Darwin wrote that, free from teaching and administrative demands, he was "able to **devote himself entirely to research**."
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) resting / (b) teaching / (d) visiting relatives** – opposite of what he says.

Q.140 After reading this passage it can be said that it is:

(a) ashort story **(b)** a newspaper article
(c) a news report **(d)** an encyclopaedic entry

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a newspaper article
How to locate the answer

Explanation (contd.)
It is a feature-style write-up (drawing on Cambridge archives, quoting a researcher) — the style of a **newspaper article**.
Why the others are wrong
• **short story / news report / encyclopaedic entry** – it is not fiction, breaking news or a reference entry.

Q.141 The central idea of the passage is that:

(a) some great works have come out of quarantine
(b) scientific theories can be formulated only in quarantine
(c) quarantine is monotonous and stifling
(d) quarantine makes one ill and inactive

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) some great works have come out of quarantine
How to locate the answer
Opening: quarantine "can be the gateway to work ... that define the history of the world" — showing that **great works have come out of quarantine**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) only in quarantine / (c) monotonous / (d) makes one ill** – too narrow or opposite.

Q.142 Charles Darwin lived in self-isolation because:

(a) of his chronic ill health
(b) the Great Plague was ravaging England
(c) he wanted to do his research
(d) his city was hit by cholera

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) of his chronic ill health
How to locate the answer
Text: "Darwin's experience with isolation was ... the result of his own **chronic ill health**."
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) Great Plague** (Newton), **(d) cholera** (Byron); **(c)** research was a benefit, not the reason.

Q.143 Match the words (a, b, c) with their meaning (1, 2, 3).

Words Meaning
a. delved 1. assemble
b. collated 2. dug
c. retreated 3. retired

(a) a-2, b-3, c-1 **(b)** a-2, b-1, c-3
(c) a-1, b-3, c-2 **(d)** a-3, b-2, c-1

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a-2, b-1, c-3
Type: Vocabulary Matching
• **a. delved** = dug (into archives) → **2. dug**.
• **b. collated** = gathered/assembled → **1. assemble**.
• **c. retreated** = withdrew/retired → **3. retired**.
So **a-2, b-1, c-3**.

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Q.144 Where did Milton spend his time of isolation?

(a) In London **(b)** At Cambridge
(c) In Malta **(d)** In Lincolnshire

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) In London
How to locate the answer
Text: "He was **home in London** when he wrote Elegia Prima."
Why the others are wrong
• **Cambridge / Malta / Lincolnshire** – Malta (Byron), Lincolnshire (Newton); Milton was in London.

Q.145 What did Newton prove through his prism experiment?

(a) Light did not have any colours.
(b) Prism merely separated colours that were already there.
(c) It was the prism that created colours in light.
(d) A thin beam of light could pass through a prism.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Prism merely separated colours that were already there.
How to locate the answer
Text: the experiment proved "that prisms **did not create colours, but merely separated colours that were already there**."
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) light had no colours / (c) prism created colours** – opposite; **(d)** a detail of the method, not what it proved.

Passage 20 (Q.146–Q.150)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

The severe cyclonic storm, Nisarga, which made a landfall south of Alibag in Maharashtra's Raigad district on Wednesday at 11.30 a.m. is an indication of an increasing frequency of severe cyclones developing in the Arabian Sea in the past decade, a trend that studies have linked to climate change.

In the past two years, there have been seven cyclones in the Arabian Sea, though, according to India Meteorological Department (IMD), the ratio of cyclones in the Arabian Sea and the Bay of Bengal — which just witnessed the destructive cyclone Amphan on May 21 — is 1:4.

The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change (IPCC) last year came out with a special report, Ocean and Cryosphere in a Changing Climate, in which it said that extreme rainfall and extreme sea level events associated with some tropical cyclones are being seen to have a cascading impact on coastal areas.

"There is emerging evidence for an increase in annual global proportion of Category 4 or 5 tropical cyclones in recent decades," the IPCC report had said.

A category 4 cyclone has a wind speed of 209-251 kmph, and is referred to as an extremely severe cyclonic storm, while a category 5 cyclone has a wind speed of more than 252 kmph, and is referred to as a super cyclone.

Passage (contd.)

The IPCC report refers to a 2017 study led by Atmospheric and Oceanic Sciences Program, Princeton University, USA, which found that in 2014 and 2015, post-monsoon extremely severe cyclonic storms (ESCS) were first observed over the Arabian Sea causing widespread damage.

The study had concluded that climate change had led to an increase in the occurrence of ESCSs in the Arabian Sea.

"Our research suggests that cyclones would be more frequent during the post monsoon season (October-December) by a series climate model simulations. However, we didn't find any significant changes in cyclone activity during the pre-monsoon (April-June) season through the climate simulations. It is very difficult to identify if a cyclone (like Nisarga) is generated in line with climate change," said Hiroyuki Murakami, the lead author of the study.

"Coastal hazards will be exacerbated by an increase in the average intensity, magnitude of storm surge, rising mean sea levels and precipitation rates of tropical cyclones," the IPCC report further stated.

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Q.146 Which of the following is a category 4 cyclone?

(a) Onewith a wind speed of more than 252 kmph
(b) Onewith a wind speed of 150-208 kmph
(c) Onewith a wind speed of less than 150 kmph
(d) Onewith a wind speed of 209-251 kmph

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Onewith a wind speed of 209-251 kmph
How to locate the answer
Text: "A category 4 cyclone has a wind speed of **209-251 kmph**."
Why the others are wrong
• **more than 252** – category 5; the lower speeds are weaker categories.

Q.147 Match the words (a, b, c) with their meanings (1, 2, 3).

a. cascading 1. intensify
b. precipitation 2.drop-down
c. exacerbate 3. rainfall

(a) a-3, b-2, c-1 **(b)** a-2, b-1, c-3
(c) a-2, b-3, c-1 **(d)** a-1, b-3, c-2

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) a-2, b-3, c-1
Type: Vocabulary Matching
• **a. cascading** = falling in stages → **2. drop-down**.
• **b. precipitation** = rain → **3. rainfall**.
• **c. exacerbate** = to make worse → **1. intensify**.
So **a-2, b-3, c-1**.

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Q.148 The passage is mainly focused on:

(a) the effect of climate change on cyclone Nisarga
(b) the research on super cyclones
(c) the link of frequent cyclones with climate change
(d) the frequency of cyclones in the Arabian Sea and Bay of Bengal

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) the link of frequent cyclones with climate change

How to locate the answer

The passage repeatedly connects the rising frequency/intensity of cyclones to **climate change** (IPCC, Princeton study). So it is mainly about the **link of frequent cyclones with climate change**.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) Nisarga / (b) super cyclones / (d) Arabian Sea vs Bay of Bengal** – details, not the main focus.

Q.149 The hazards in coastal areas worsen due to the increase in which of the following?

a. Precipitation rate of the cyclone
b. Magnitude of storm
c. The rise of sea level

(a) Only a and c are true
(b) a, b and c all are true
(c) Only b and c are true
(d) Only a and b are true

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a, b and c all are true

How to locate the answer

Text: coastal hazards worsen with "increase in the average intensity, **magnitude of storm surge**, rising **mean sea levels** and **precipitation rates**." So (a) precipitation rate, (b) magnitude of storm, and (c) rise of sea level are all true.

Q.150 According to the research on cyclones, the frequency of cyclones is expected to be more during:

(a) January-March **(b)** October-December
(c) April-June **(d)** July-September

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) October-December

How to locate the answer

Text: "cyclones would be more frequent during the **post-monsoon season (October-December)**."

Why the others are wrong

• **April-June** – the pre-monsoon season showed no significant change; the others are not mentioned.

Passage 21 (Q.151–Q.160)

Read the passage and answer the questions given after it.

The savanna landscape is typified by tall grass and short trees. It is rather misleading to call the savanna 'tropical grassland', because trees are always present with the luxuriant tall grass. The terms 'parkland' or 'bush-veld' perhaps describe the landscape better.

Trees grow best towards the equatorial humid latitudes or along river banks but decrease in height and density away from the equator. They occur in clumps or as scattered individuals.

Passage (contd.)

The trees are deciduous, shedding their leaves in the cool, dry season to prevent excessive loss of water through transpiration, e.g. acacias. Others have broad trunks, with water-storing devices to survive through the prolonged drought such as baobabs and bottle trees. Trees are mostly hard, gnarled and thorny and may exude gum like gum arable. Many trees are umbrella shaped, exposing only a narrow edge to the strong winds.

Palms which cannot withstand the drought are confined to the wettest areas or along rivers. Vegetative luxuriance reaches its peak in the rainy season, when trees renew their foliage and flower. In true savanna lands, the grass is tall and coarse, growing 6 to 12 feet high. The elephant grass may attain a height of even 15 feet! The grass tends to grow in compact tufts and has long roots which reach down in search of water. It appears greenish and well-nourished in the rainy season but turns yellow and dies down in the dry season that follows. The grass lies dormant throughout the long, rainless period and springs up again in the next rainy season.

In between the tall grass are scattered short trees and low bushes. As the rainfall diminishes towards the deserts the savanna merges into thorny scrub. In Australia, this scrubland is particularly well represented by a number of species: mallee, mulga, spinifex grass and other bushes.

The savanna, particularly in Africa, is the home of wild animals. It is known as the 'big game country' and thousands of animals are trapped or killed each year by people from all over the world. Some of the animals are tracked down for their skins, horns, tusks, bones or hair, others are captured alive and sent out of Africa as zoo animals, laboratory specimens or pets.

There is such a wealth of animal life in Africa that many of the animal films that we see at the cinema are actually taken in the savanna. There are, in fact, two main groups of animals in the savanna, the grass-eating herbivorous animals and the fleshing-eating carnivorous animals. The herbivorous animals are often very alert and move swiftly from place to place in search of green pastures.

They are endowed with great speed to run away from the savage flesh-eaters that are always after them. The leaf and grass-eating animals include the zebra, antelope, giraffe, deer, gazelle, elephant and okapi.

Many are well camouflaged species and their presence amongst the tall greenish-brown grass cannot be easily detected. The giraffe with such a long neck can locate its enemies a great distance away, while the elephant is so huge and strong that few animals will venture to come near it. It is well equipped with tusks and trunk for defence.

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Passage (contd.)
The carnivorous animals like the lion, tiger, leopard, hyena, panther, jaguar, jackal, lynx and puina have powerful jaws and teeth for attacking other animals. Their natural colorings of light yellowish-brown, often with stripes like the tiger or spots like the leopard, match perfectly with the tawny background of the savanna. They often hide themselves in shady spots up in the branches or amidst the tall bushes, and many wild animals, as well as hunters themselves, are caught unawares in this manner.
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Q.151 Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined word as it is used in the text.
Palms which cannot withstand the drought are confined to the wettest areas or along rivers.

(a) Undergo **(b)** Suffer
(c) Convert **(d)** Endure

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Endure
Type: Vocabulary (WITHSTAND, in context)
WITHSTAND (the drought) = to bear/survive it. Its meaning here is **endure**.
Why the others are wrong
• **Undergo** (to experience), **Suffer** (to be harmed), **Convert** – do not mean "to resist/survive".

Q.152 What is the main feature of Savanna landscape?

(a) dry grass and low bushes
(b) dense forests with tall trees
(c) tall grass and short trees
(d) tall trees and short grass

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) tall grass and short trees
How to locate the answer
Opening line: "The savanna landscape is typified by **tall grass and short trees**."

Q.153 What helps an elephant fight its enemies?

(a) its neck and tail **(b)** its tusks and trunk
(c) its size and strength **(d)** its legs and ears

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) its tusks and trunk
How to locate the answer
Text: "the elephant ... is well equipped with **tusks and trunk** for defence."
Why the others are wrong
• **neck and tail / size and strength / legs and ears** – the passage names tusks and trunk.

Q.154 Why is Savanna in Africa called the "Big Game Country"?

(a) Animal movies are particularly shot here.
(b) Thousands of animals are hunted here.
(c) It is home to many wild animals.
(d) There are both carnivores and herbivores.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Thousands of animals are hunted here.
How to locate the answer
Text: "It is known as the 'big game country' and **thousands of animals are trapped or killed each year** by people from all over the world."
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) movies / (c) home to wild animals / (d) carnivores and herbivores** – true, but "big game" refers to the hunting of animals.

Q.155 Select the carnivorous animal from the following.

(a) okapi **(b)** lynx
(c) zebra **(d)** gazelle

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) lynx
How to locate the answer
Text lists carnivores: "the lion, tiger, leopard, hyena, panther, jaguar, jackal, **lynx** and puma." So the lynx is a carnivore.
Why the others are wrong
• **okapi / zebra / gazelle** – grass-eating **herbivores**.

Q.156 What kind of a passage is it?

(a) Literary **(b)** Analytical
(c) Informative **(d)** Narrative

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Informative
Type: Passage Type
The passage gives **facts and information** about the savanna's vegetation and animals — it is an **informative** passage.
Why the others are wrong
• **Literary / Analytical / Narrative** – it neither tells a story nor argues a case; it informs.

Q.157 The main theme of the passage is

(a) Wealth of animal life in Africa
(b) Life in Savanna grassland
(c) Vegetation and animal life in Savanna
(d) Grasses of the grassland Savanna

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Vegetation and animal life in Savanna
How to locate the answer
The passage describes both the **vegetation** (grasses, trees) and the **animals** (herbivores, carnivores) of the savanna — so the theme is **vegetation and animal life in Savanna**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) animal wealth / (b) life in Savanna / (d) grasses** – each covers only part.

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Q.158 Which of the following trees has water storing capacity in its broad trunk?

(a) Gum arable **(b)** Palm
(c) Acacia **(d)** Baobab

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Baobab
How to locate the answer
Text: "Others have broad trunks, with **water-storing devices** to survive ... drought such as **baobabs** and bottle trees."
Why the others are wrong
• **Gum arable / Palm / Acacia** – do not store water in a broad trunk.

Q.159 Match the words with their meanings.
Words- a. luxuriant, b. dormant, c. prolonged
Meanings- 1. continued, 2. lush, 3. sleeping

(a) a-1, b-3, c-2 **(b)** a-2, b-3, c-1
(c) a-2, b-1, c-3 **(d)** a-3, b-2, c-1

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a-2, b-3, c-1
Type: Vocabulary Matching
• **a. luxuriant** = growing thickly → **2. lush**.
• **b. dormant** = inactive → **3. sleeping**.
• **c. prolonged** = extended → **1. continued**.
So **a-2, b-3, c-1**.

Q.160 Which species of vegetation is NOT found in Australian Savanna?

(a) mallee **(b)** mulga
(c) spinifex grass **(d)** elephant grass

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) elephant grass
How to locate the answer (NOT-found question)
The Australian scrubland species are "mallee, mulga, spinifex grass and other bushes." **Elephant grass** is mentioned as an African savanna grass, not Australian.

Passage 22 (Q.161–Q.165)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

New Delhi -India is set to surpass China as the world's most populous country in 2023, with each counting more than 1.4 billion residents this year, a United Nations report said on Monday, warning that high fertility would challenge economic growth.

The world's population, estimated to reach 8 billion by November 15 this year, could grow to 8.5 billion in 2030, and 10.4 billion in 2100, as the pace of mortality slows, said the report released on World Population Day.

India's population was 1.21 billion in 2011, according to the domestic census, which is conducted once a decade. The government had deferred the 2021 census due to the Covid-19 pandemic.

The world's population was growing at its slowest pace since 1950, having fallen below 1% in 2020, UN estimates showed.

Passage (contd.)

In 2021, the average fertility of the world's population stood at 2.3 births per woman over a lifetime, having fallen from about 5 births in 1950. Global fertility is projected to decline further to 2.1 births per woman by 2050.

Referring to an earlier World Health Organization report -- estimating about 14.9 million deaths relating to the Covid-19 pandemic between January 2020 and December 2021, the UN report said global life expectancy at birth fell to 71 years in 2021 from 72.8 years in 2019, mostly due to the pandemic.

The United Nations said more than half of the projected increase in the global population up to 2050 will be concentrated in eight countries -- Democratic Republic of Congo, Egypt, Ethiopia, India, Nigeria, Pakistan, the Philippines and Tanzania.

Countries of sub-Saharan Africa are expected to contribute more than half of the increase anticipated through 2050.

However, the population of 61 countries is projected to decrease by 1% or more between 2022 and 2050, driven by a fall in fertility.

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Q.161 The passage presents the findings of a United Nations report which is mainly regarding

(a) the population in African countries
(b) the population in India
(c) the population in China
(d) the world population

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the world population
How to locate the answer
The UN report discusses global figures — 8 billion now, growth to 10.4 billion by 2100, fertility trends — so it is mainly about **the world population**.
Why the others are wrong
• **African countries / India / China** – mentioned as examples within the wider world-population theme.

Q.162 Which statement is NOT correct according to the passage?

(a) The population of 61 countries will decrease by 1% or more between 2022 and 2050.
(b) The countries of Asia will contribute more than half of the increase anticipated through 2050.
(c) World population is estimated to reach 10.4 billion in 2100.
(d) Since 1950, world population was growing at its a slowest speed.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The countries of Asia will contribute more than half of the increase anticipated through 2050.
How to locate the answer (NOT-correct question)
Text: "**Countries of sub-Saharan Africa** are expected to contribute more than half of the increase ..." — not Asia. So (b) is **false**.
Why the others are true

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Explanation (contd.)
• **(a)** 61 countries' population to fall, **(c)** 10.4 billion by 2100, **(d)** slowest growth since 1950 – all stated.

Q.163 After reading the above passage it can be inferred that it is

(a) a magazine article **(b)** a survey report
(c) a research report **(d)** a news item

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) a news item
How to locate the answer
It opens with a dateline "**New Delhi –**", reports a UN report "**on Monday**", and quotes findings — the format of a **news item**.
Why the others are wrong
• **magazine article / survey report / research report** – it merely reports the news of a report.

Q.164 What will be the consequence of high fertility?

(a) high economic growth **(b)** low economic growth
(c) high mortality **(d)** low mortality

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) low economic growth
How to locate the answer
Text: the report warns that "**high fertility would challenge economic growth**" — i.e., it would lead to **low economic growth**.
Why the others are wrong
• **high economic growth** – opposite; **high/low mortality** – not the stated consequence.

Q.165 According to the UN report, fertility rate in 1950 stood at how many average births per woman?

(a) 2.3 births per woman **(b)** 3 births per woman
(c) 5 births per woman **(d)** 2.1 births per woman

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) 5 births per woman
How to locate the answer
Text: average fertility "having fallen from about **5 births in 1950**."
Why the others are wrong
• **2.3** – the 2021 figure; **2.1** – projected for 2050; **3** – not stated.

Passage 23 (Q.166–Q.175)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

A new and extreme tourist attraction has just exploded on to the scene in Iceland: Volcano Walking. It would appear, according to Trip Advisor, that this is one trip that cannot be missed, despite the extortionate cost.

Passage (contd.)

The idea of making Thrihnukagigur volcano accessible was the brainchild of Ami B. Stefansson, a doctor in Reykjavik and a lifelong cave enthusiast. He has been studying caves in Iceland since 1954 and some would argue that there is no-one who has more experience. Thrihnukagigur has always been special to Stefansson ever since he was the first to descend down to the crater base in 1974. Like most people who experience it, he was utterly spellbound by its uniqueness and beauty and made it his mission to protect and preserve this stunning natural phenomenon. Unlike others who may have only seen the profit that could be made from walking into the mouth of a volcano, Stefansson believed that the primary focus was to treat such a grand natural wonder with the utmost respect, to protect and defend it. The first 'volcano tourists' entered the volcano in 2005 and it has since been labelled as one of the most unique tourist attractions in the world.

Volcano walkers are taken to the mouth of the crater from where they are lowered in a basket into the depths of the earth. People once thought that volcanoes were portals to Hell and associated with death and destruction and yet the entrance to the crater is awe-inspiring and almost ethereal. The vastness of it can feel overwhelming; it is the size of a cathedral and the Statue of Liberty could easily fit into the shaft. After 6 minutes and 120 metres, visitors arrive at the crater base. The ground space is the size of three full-sized basketball courts placed next to each

At the bottom there is a reverent hush. People whisper in respect to the sleeping giant who has lain dormant for 4,000 years. The subterranean walls are scorched with colours from a divine palette: magenta red, vibrant purple, burnt orange, vivid green and honey yellow. The colour intensifies in certain places where 4000 years ago the magma was pushed out with brutal force. This is Mother Nature's secret place, her private art studio where visitors feel like trespassers. The protruding rock faces show a tapestry of patterns and formations that have been molded by heat, pressure and time. Floodlights illuminate the walls and draw attention to the beauty humans were never intended to see. A light rain weeps from the porous rock above and covers the crater sides with a shine that makes it sparkle. The scorch marks can be seen close up – at one point in time these rock faces were glowing red with fiery heat. This giant, although sleeping, is still dangerous: an 80-metre drop into the void is disguised by a collection of rocks close to where visitors stand.

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Passage (contd.)
It is a soul-enriching experience and visitors often report feeling deeply moved by the beauty and tranquillity of something that was once so destructive and angry. Confronted with this result of the unrestrained forces of nature, it is hard not to feel small and powerless in comparison. Sadly, the magical spell is broken when the basket appears, indicating that it is time for visitors to return to reality. On the return hike, visitors walk across the lava fields as though they are astronauts on the moon. They pass enormous open wounds where the landscape is literally tearing itself apart as tectonic plates slowly shift. It serves as one final reminder that this giant is merely dormant, not dead.
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Q.166 What feelings do visitors have when they visit the volcano?

(a) reverence **(b)** indifference
(c) fear **(d)** anger

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) reverence
How to locate the answer
Text: "there is a **reverent hush**. People whisper in respect to the sleeping giant." Visitors feel deep respect — **reverence**.
Why the others are wrong
• **indifference / fear / anger** – the passage stresses respect and awe, not these.

Q.167 The volcano is referred to as the 'sleeping giant' in the passage because

(a) it is very destructive
(b) it is a dormant volcano
(c) it is an active volcano
(d) it is very deep

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) it is a dormant volcano
How to locate the answer
Text: "the sleeping giant who has **lain dormant for 4,000 years**" — a **dormant** volcano is "sleeping" (inactive but not dead).
Why the others are wrong
• **destructive / active / deep** – it is called "sleeping" because it is dormant, not active.

Q.168 What is the most appropriate title for the passage?

(a) Harnessing of Destructive Forces
(b) The Mysteries of the Subterranean
(c) Volcano Walking- A Unique Experience
(d) Adventures of a Cave Enthusiast

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Volcano Walking- A Unique Experience
How to locate the answer
The whole passage is about the unique experience of walking inside the Thrihnukagigur volcano — so the best title is "**Volcano Walking – A Unique Experience**".
Why the others are wrong

Explanation (contd.)
• **(a) destructive forces / (b) mysteries of the subterranean / (d) a cave enthusiast** – too narrow; the focus is the volcano-walking experience.

Q.169 How do tourists reach the base of the crater?

(a) They go through the tectonic plates
(b) They walk down
(c) They go across lava fields
(d) They descend in a basket

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) They descend in a basket
How to locate the answer
Text: "Volcano walkers are taken to the mouth of the crater from where they are **lowered in a basket** into the depths."
Why the others are wrong
• **tectonic plates / walk down / lava fields** – not how they reach the base.

Q.170 Select the correct synonym of the word EXTORTIONATE

(a) exorbitant **(b)** exotic
(c) exorcist **(d)** exonerate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) exorbitant
Type: Synonym (EXTORTIONATE)
EXTORTIONATE – (of a price) far too high (अत्यधिक महँगा). Its synonym is **exorbitant**.
Why the others are wrong
• **exotic** (foreign/unusual), **exorcist** (one who drives out spirits), **exonerate** (to free from blame) – unrelated.

Q.171 Who came up with the idea of making the volcano accessible to tourists?

(a) Trip Advisor **(b)** Reykjavik
(c) Thrihnukagigur **(d)** Ami B. Stefansson

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Ami B. Stefansson
How to locate the answer
Text: "The idea of making Thrihnukagigur volcano accessible was the brainchild of **Ami B. Stefansson**."
Why the others are wrong
• **Trip Advisor** – a review site; **Reykjavik** – a city; **Thrihnukagigur** – the volcano itself.

Q.172 Why is the bottom of the volcano called 'nature's art studio'?

(a) the rocks sparkle with a divine light
(b) it looks like a cathedral
(c) the entrance is vast and ethereal
(d) the walls are covered with patterns in bright hues

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the walls are covered with patterns in bright hues
How to locate the answer
Text: the walls show "a tapestry of **patterns and formations**" in "magenta red, vibrant purple ... vivid green" — like an **art studio** full of colourful patterns.
Why the others are wrong

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Explanation (contd.)
• **(a) sparkle / (b) cathedral / (c) ethereal entrance** – true details, but the "art studio" image is about the coloured patterns on the walls.

Q.173 The tone of the passage is:

(a) apathetic **(b)** satirical
(c) formal **(d)** laudatory

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) laudatory
Type: Tone
The writer praises the volcano's beauty and grandeur throughout ("awe-inspiring", "Mother Nature's secret place") — the tone is **laudatory** (full of praise).
Why the others are wrong
• **apathetic** (uninterested), **satirical** (mocking), **formal** – the tone is admiring, not these.

Q.174 Select the correct antonym of the word.
TRANQUILLITY

(a) wilderness **(b)** composure
(c) repose **(d)** agitation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) agitation
Type: Antonym (TRANQUILLITY)
TRANQUILLITY – calmness, peace (शांति). Its **antonym** is **agitation** (disturbance/restlessness).
Why the others are wrong
• **wilderness** (wild region), **composure / repose** (calmness) – synonyms, not antonyms.

Q.175 The given passage is a _____ passage.

(a) descriptive **(b)** narrative
(c) didactic **(d)** literary

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) descriptive
How to locate the answer
The passage vividly **describes** the volcano, its colours, size and atmosphere ("magenta red", "the size of a cathedral") — it paints a picture, so it is a **descriptive** passage.
Why the others are wrong
• **narrative** (tells a story), **didactic** (teaches a lesson), **literary** (fiction) – this is description, not a story or lesson.

Passage 24 (Q.176–Q.180)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

At the end of 2020, there were 82.4 million forcibly displaced people in the world, of which more than a quarter are refugees.

"By the end of 2020, the number of people forcibly displaced due to persecution, conflict, violence, human rights violations, and events seriously disturbing public order, had grown to 82.4 million, the highest number on record according to available data," according to the UN High Commissioner for Refugees (UNHCR). Out of these 82.4 million forcibly displaced people in the world, more than a quarter are refugees.

Passage (contd.)

Just five countries produce 68% of all refugees displaced abroad: the Syrian Arab Republic, Venezuela, Afghanistan, South Sudan, and Myanmar.

The top five host countries, where these displaced people are currently located are: Turkey, Colombia, Germany, Pakistan, and Uganda.

With 3.7 million displaced people now within its borders, Turkey hosts twice as many refugees as Colombia, the next highest host country, with 1.7 million people. The situation in Turkey illustrates the effects of proximity, as 92% of its refugees have come from neighbouring Syria, where war and armed conflict have now been raging for more than 10 years. It demonstrates that huge numbers of displaced people stay close to their point of origin.

There are more than 48 million internally displaced people – people who have had to flee their homes in search of safety elsewhere within their home nation.

The highest increases in the number of internally displaced people happened in Africa and were provoked by a combination of armed conflict and humanitarian disasters. Civil war in Ethiopia, Africa's second most-populated country, has sparked a wave of displacement in a region that was already facing what the UNHCR calls "a full-scale humanitarian crisis."

All in all, more than a million Ethiopian people had to leave their homes behind last year, the UNHCR says.

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Q.176 The passage is mainly about

(a) refugees in host countries
(b) internally displaced people
(c) displaced persons around the world
(d) people devastated by conflicts and civil war

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) displaced persons around the world
How to locate the answer
The passage gives global figures on **forcibly displaced people** — refugees and internally displaced — worldwide. So it is mainly about **displaced persons around the world**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) host countries / (b) internally displaced / (d) conflict victims** – parts of the wider topic.

Q.177 The greatest number of people who have been displaced internally in their home country are in

(a) Ethiopia **(b)** Turkey
(c) Syria **(d)** Afghanistan

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Ethiopia
How to locate the answer
Text: "more than a million **Ethiopian** people had to leave their homes ... the highest increases in the number of internally displaced people happened in Africa" (Ethiopia's civil war).
Why the others are wrong
• **Turkey** – a host country; **Syria / Afghanistan** – produce refugees who flee abroad, not internally displaced here.

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Q.178 Why do Syrian refugees prefer to take shelter in Turkey? Select the main reason.

(a) Turkey provides the refugees with all amenities.
(b) Turkey is a hospitable country.
(c) Turkey is the nearest hospitable country to Syria.
(d) Turkey is a beautiful country.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Turkey is the nearest hospitable country to Syria.

How to locate the answer

Text: "The situation in Turkey illustrates the effects of **proximity**, as 92% of its refugees have come from **neighbouring Syria**." So Syrians go there because it is the nearest.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) amenities / (b) hospitable / (d) beautiful** – the passage stresses proximity (nearness), not these.

Q.179 'Humanitarian disasters' refer to all those given below except

(a) armed conflicts
(b) civil war
(c) earthquakes and floods
(d) violence and persecution

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) earthquakes and floods

How to locate the answer (except question)

In the passage, "humanitarian disasters" are linked to **armed conflict, civil war, violence and persecution** — man-made crises. Natural disasters like **earthquakes and floods** are NOT what is meant here.

Q.180 Which statement is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) There are 82.4 million displaced persons in the world.
(b) 1.7 million people from Syria have been displaced till now due to war and armed conflict.
(c) More than a million Ethiopian people were displaced last year due to civil war.
(d) Turkey is presently hosting 3.7 million displaced people within its borders.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) 1.7 million people from Syria have been displaced till now due to war and armed conflict.

How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)

The 1.7 million figure is **Colombia's** total number of hosted refugees, not the number of Syrians displaced. So (b) is **false**.

Why the others are true

• **(a)** 82.4 million displaced, **(c)** a million Ethiopians displaced last year, **(d)** Turkey hosts 3.7 million – all stated.

Passage 25 (Q.181–Q.184)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Passage (contd.)

From January 28 to February 4, 2023, a Chinese-operated, large white high-altitude balloon was seen in North American airspace, including Alaska, western Canada, and the contiguous United States. The American and Canadian militaries asserted that the balloon was for surveillance, while the Chinese government maintained it was a civilian meteorological research airship that had been blown off course. Analysts said that the balloon's flight path and structural characteristics made it dissimilar from those which have typically been used for meteorological research. The U.S. Department of State said that the balloon was capable of locating electronic communication devices, including mobile phones and radios, and that American U-2 reconnaissance aircraft deployed to track the balloon in the air revealed that the balloon carried antennas and other equipment "clearly for intelligence surveillance and inconsistent with the equipment on board weather balloons." The State Department said that the spy balloon was part of a global Chinese military-directed surveillance effort in which Chinese spy balloons have flown over more than 40 nations in five continents.

On February 4, the U.S. Air Force shot down the balloon over U.S. territorial waters off the coast of South Carolina, on the order of U.S. President Joe Biden. Debris from the wreckage was recovered and sent to the FBI Laboratory in Quantico, Virginia, for analysis.

The incident increased U.S.-China tensions. The incident prompted U.S. Secretary of State Antony Blinken to delay a diplomatic visit to Beijing, which was set to be his first since 2018. It also further strained Canada–China relations, as Canada summoned the Chinese ambassador because of the violation of Canadian airspace. On February 3, the U.S. Department of Defense announced that a second Chinese balloon was passing over Latin America, which China also said belonged to it. On February 10, the Air Force shot down another aerial object over U.S. territory at the order of President Biden.

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Q.181 The passage is mainly about

(a) a Chinese spy balloon flying over US and Canadian territories
(b) Chinese balloons flying all over the world
(c) the strained relations between US and China
(d) China's global military-directed surveillance

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) a Chinese spy balloon flying over US and Canadian territories

The whole passage revolves around a Chinese spy balloon flying over US and Canadian territories. Hence, 'a' is the correct option.

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Q.182 The word 'contiguous' means

(a) far off **(b)** spreading
(c) separated **(d)** adjoining

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) adjoining
contiguous – things that are touching along a boundary or sharing a common border.Far off – a considerable distance away.Spreading – something that is expanding or growing larger.Separated – something that is isolated or kept apart from other things.Adjoining – next to or touching something else.

Q.183 Read the statements given below.
A. The US Air Force shot down the Chinese balloon over US territorial waters.
B. Tensions between China and US have increased and the visit of the U.S. Secretary of State to Beijing has been postponed.

(a) Both A and B are true and B is the correct reason for A.
(b) A is true and B is false.
(c) A is false and B is true.
(d) Both A and B are true but B is not the correct reason for A.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Both A and B are true and B is the correct reason for A.
both the statements are true according to the passage. Also A is the reason for tensions between the two countries at least partially.

Q.184 How did US make sure that the Balloon flying over its territory was a 'spy' balloon?

(a) it got the samples of the balloon checked in a lab
(b) the FBI lab confirmed that it was a spy balloon
(c) it's reconnaissance aircraft saw the antennas and equipment of the balloon
(d) the analysts studied its flight path and said so

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (c) it's reconnaissance aircraft saw the antennas and equipment of the balloon
reconnaissance aircraft saw the antennas and equipment of the ballon.

Passage 26 (Q.185–Q.188)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

The number of Indian students going abroad for higher studies has increased by 68.79 per cent in the past year, according to data provided by the Minister of State in the Ministry of Education, Subhas Sarkar. As per the data provided by him in the Lok Sabha, the number of Indians enrolled in foreign varsities increased from 4.44 lakh in 2021 to 7.5 lakh in 2022.

He clarified that while the Bureau of Immigration and Ministry of Home Affairs maintain departure and arrival data of Indians, there is no index for capturing the category of Indians going abroad for higher education.

Passage (contd.)

"Purpose of Indians going abroad for higher education is captured manually based either on their verbal disclosure or the type of visa of the destination country produced by them at the time of immigration clearance," Sarkar said.

According to the data provided by the ministry, the number of Indian nationals increased from 4.54 lakh in 2017 to 5.17 lakh in 2018. There was a significant increase in 2019 as well, with 5.86 lakh students flying out of the country. However, during the Covid pandemic, the number of Indian nationals in foreign varsities saw a drastic dip as only 2.59 lakh students were registered. While the number continued to remain low, it saw a slight increase in 2021 with 4.44 lakh registrations. However, the number has significantly jumped to 7.5 lakh in 2022. The increase in the number of Indian nationals abroad corresponds with the latest immigration reports from some of the popular study-abroad destinations such as the US, UK, and Australia. For the UK, the Immigration Statistics Report states that 127,731 visas were granted to Indian students in September 2022, an increase of 93,470 (+273 per cent) against 34,261 in 2019. Similarly, in the US, the number of Indian students has more than doubled, and the Open Doors Report 2022 has predicted that the number of Indian students heading to America is likely to surpass those from China in 2022-23.

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Q.185 How do we know the number of students getting visas for studies in UK?

(a) from the records of Ministry of Home Affairs
(b) from the Ministry of Education
(c) from the Immigration Statistics Report
(d) from the records of the Bureau of Immigration

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) from the Immigration Statistics Report
The passage states that the immigration statistics report.

Q.186 In 2019, how many Indian students went abroad?

(a) 5.17 lakh **(b)** 4.54 lakh
(c) 5.86 lakh **(d)** 4.44 lakh

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) 5.86 lakh
'There was a significant increase in 2019 as well with 5.86 lakh students flying out of the country.'

Q.187 Which of the following countries is not very popular with Indian students for studies?

(a) China **(b)** UK
(c) Australia **(d)** USA

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) China
There is no mention of China being a popular destination for Indian students.

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Q.188 The passage is mainly about

(a) Indians going abroad for higher studies
(b) immigration of Indians to UK, US, and Australia
(c) Indians going to America for higher studies
(d) Indians enrolled in foreign universities

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Indians going abroad for higher studies
The passage provides information about increase in number of students going for higher education to foreign countries. It also gives statistics for special destinations like US, UK and Australia. It also talks about the impact of coronavirus. So, option 'a' is the correct one.

Passage 27 (Q.189–Q.192)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

We sit in the last row, bumped about but free of stares. The bus rolls out of the dull crossroads of the city, and we are soon in the open countryside, with fields of sunflowers as far as the eye can see, their heads all facing us. Where there is no water, the land reverts to the desert. While still on level ground, we see in the distance the tall range of the Mount Bogda, abrupt like a shining prism laid horizontally on the desert surface. It is over 5,000 metres high, and the peaks are under permanent snow, in powerful contrast to the flat desert all around. Heaven lake lies part of the way up this range, about 2,000 metres above sea level, at the foot of one of the highest snow-peaks.

As the bus climbs, the sky, brilliant before, grows overcast. I have brought nothing warm to wear. It is all down at the hotel in Urumqi. Rain begins to fall. The man behind me is eating overpoweringly smelly goat's cheese. The bus window leaks inhospitably but reveals a beautiful view. We have passed quickly from the desert through arable land to pasture and the ground is now green with grass, the slopes dark with pine. A few cattle drink at a clear stream flowing past moss-covered stones; it is a Constable landscape. The stream changes into a white torrent, and as we climb higher I wish more and more that I had brought with me something warmer than the pair of shorts that have served me so well in the desert. The stream (which, we are told, rises in Heaven Lake) disappears, and we continue our slow ascent. About noon, we arrive at Heaven Lake, and look for a place to stay at the foot, which is the resort area. We get a room in a small cottage, and I am happy to note that there are thick quilts on the bed.

Standing outside the cottage, we survey our surroundings. Heaven Lake is long, sardine-shaped and fed by snowmelt from a stream at its head. The lake is an intense blue, surrounded on all sides by green mountain walls, dotted with distant sheep. At the head of the lake, beyond the delta of the inflowing stream, is a massive snow-capped peak which dominates the vista; it is part of a series of peaks that culminate, a little out of view, in Mount Bogda itself.

Passage (contd.)

For those who live in the resort, there is a small mess-hall by the shore. We eat here sometimes, and sometimes buy food from the vendors outside, who sell kabab and naan until the last buses leave. The kababs, cooked on skewers over charcoal braziers, are particularly good; highly spiced and well-done. Horse's milk is available too from the local Kazakh herdsmen, but I decline this. I am so affected by the cold that Mr. Cao, the relaxed young man who runs the mess, lends me a spare pair of trousers, several sizes too large but more than comfortable. Once I am warm again, I feel a pre-dinner spurt of energy—dinner will be long in coming—and I ask him whether the lake is good for swimming in.

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Q.189 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word 'accept' from the passage.

(a) Turn down **(b)** Decline
(c) Refuse **(d)** Reject

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Decline
All are antonyms of accept but only decline is present in the passage. So, b is the most appropriate option.

Q.190 What is the tone of the passage?

(a) Angry **(b)** Serene
(c) Agitated **(d)** Romantic

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Serene
The descriptions of the scenery, the lake, the author's thoughts and actions and the food are all presented in a calm and peaceful way. So, the tone should be serene.Romantic – no romance is depicted in the passage.Angry – no indication of anger.Agitated – no indication of anxiety or agitation.

Q.191 Select an appropriate title for the passage.

(a) Lake Heaven **(b)** Shorts to Trousers
(c) Journey to Mount Bogda **(d)** Peasant Life

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Lake Heaven
The majority of the passage describes the author's experience the author's experience traveling to and staying at the lake. So, the appropriate title would be 'Lake Heaven'.

Q.192 What is the protagonist wearing in the bus?

(a) Trousers **(b)** Long sleeved shirt
(c) A dhoti **(d)** A pair of shorts

SSC CGL Tier 2 | 2022 | 2 March 2022

Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A pair of shorts
In the ninth line of the second paragraph 'a pair of shorts' is mentioned which the author is wearing.

Passage 28 (Q.193–Q.196)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

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Passage (contd.)

Amidst a maze of rocks tucked in the Aravalli mountain ranges of Haryana, a team of archaeologists discovered cave paintings they believe belong to the Upper Palaeolithic age.

The cave paintings have been discovered just outside the national capital and a stone's throw away from a holy grove called Mangar Bani- the region's only surviving patch of primary forest.

While the residents of the villages have been familiar with the paintings for ages, the Haryana government's museum and archaeology department took note of them just recently.

A fact-finding team was sent to the area in the last week of June. The team came across cave paintings comprising images of human figurines, animals, foliage, and geometric drawings. While some have paled over time, others are still very visible. They also discovered rock art and open-air ceremonial sites.

Banani Bhattacharyya, deputy director of the department of archaeology and museums informed, "So far, cave paintings in Delhi-NCR have only been found here. The paintings are yet to be dated but at least some of them belong to the Upper Palaeolithic period in all likelihood. We are viewing the paintings in continuation with the Soanian culture which has been found in Shivalik hills, Narmada and Aravallis."

Most of the cave paintings found were in ochre colour, but some were in white. As per experts, cave paintings in white are usually from a later stage (early contemporary era), while Stone Age paintings are more often than not in ochre. "Stone age paintings generally use red and ochre colours. Stones of these colour used to be available locally and inhabitants crushed the stones for preparing the colour for paintings," added Bhattacharyya.

The Upper Paleolithic Age began around 40,000 years ago and lasted till around 10,000 years ago. While yet to be established through archaeological dating, Bhattacharyya says the Mangar cave art is 20,000-40,000 years old. Bhattacharyya claimed that the discovery is extremely significant. "Starting from the Lower Palaeolithic to Middle Palaeolithic then Upper Palaeolithic, we see the evolution here. We have found significant remains from Lower Palaeolithic till Middle and Upper Palaeolithic period too," she explained. "Though tools from the Palaeolithic Age have been identified earlier in parts of the Aravallis, it is for the first time that cave paintings and rock art of a large magnitude have been found in Haryana," she added.

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Q.193 Which of the following statement is NOT correct according to the passage?

(a) The paintings comprise images of human figurines, animals, foliage, and geometric drawings.
(b) The cave men crushed the locally available stones for preparing the colour for paintings.
(c) The Mangar cave art is 20,000-40,000 years old.
(d) The paintings in red belong to early contemporary era.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The paintings in red belong to early contemporary era.

option (a) – it is a correct statement as per the passage. It is mentioned in the passage that the discovered cave paintings comprise of human figurines, animals, foliage, and geometric drawings.
option (b) – it is also a correct statement. It is mentioned that the stones of locally available colors were crushed to prepare the color for paintings.
option (c) – "Although the paintings are yet to be dated, the deputy director of the department of archaeology and museums claims that the Mangar cave art is 20,000 – 40,000 years old and likely belongs to the Upper Paleolithic period.
There is no mention of paintings in red belonging to early contemporary era. Thus, option (d) is the correct choice.

Q.194 The archaeological findings in the Mangar Forest consist of all the following except

(a) cave paintings **(b)** rock art
(c) tools **(d)** ceremonial sites

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) tools

The passage mentions that the findings of cave paintings, rock art and open-air ceremonial sites but there is not mention of tools in the passage. Hence, option (c) is the correct choice.

Q.195 The cave paintings found in Aravalli hills are significant mainly because

(a) they are the only prehistoric cave paintings found in Aravalli Hills.
(b) they have been discovered just outside the national capital, Delhi
(c) they are found in such a large magnitude for the first time.
(d) they depict the evolution from Lower to Upper Paleolithic period.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) they depict the evolution from Lower to Upper Paleolithic period.

The passage mentions that the discovery is extremely significant. "Starting from the Lower Palaeolithic to Middle Palaeolithic then Upper Palaeolithic, we see the evolution here. Thus, option (d) is the correct choice.

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Q.196 Most of the cave paintings found in Mangar forest area in Haryana are in which colour?

(a) ochre **(b)** white
(c) black **(d)** red

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) ochre
As per the given passage, 'most of the cave paintings found were in "ochre" colour, but some were in white.'

Passage 29 (Q.197–Q.200)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Total area sown under Rabi crops has increased by 3.25% from 697.98 lakh hectares in 2021-22 to 720.68 lakh hectares in 2022-23. This is 22.71 lakh hectares more this year compared to corresponding period of 2021-22. Comparing with normal sown area(average of the last five years), the increase is to the tune of 13.71% from 633.80 to 720.68 lakh hectares.

The increase in area is across all crops, - highest being in rice. Out of 22.71 lakh hectares increase in all Rabi crops, increase in rice area is 11.20 lakh hectares from 35.05 lakh hectares in 2021-22 to 46.25 lakh hectares in 2022-23. However, this is lower than normal sown area of 47.71 lakh hectares. Maximum increase in area under rice is in states of Telangana and West Bengal.

Area under oilseeds increased by 7.31% from 102.36 lakh hectares during 2021-22 to 109.84 lakh hectares this year. The increase in area under oilseeds at the rate of 7.31% is more than double the rate of increase of 3.25% in all crops together. Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh accounted for major expansion in area of oilseeds.

Rapeseed & Mustard contributed maximum in increasing oilseeds area during this Rabi season. Mustard area increased by 6.77 lakh hectares from 91.25 lakh hectares in 2021-22 to 98.02 lakh hectares in 2022-23. Thus, out of 7.49 lakh hectares increase in area under oilseeds, rapeseed & mustard alone accounted for 6.44 lakh hectares.

Pulse production is being focused to make country self-sufficient in these commodities. Area under pulses increased by 0.56 lakh hectares from 167.31 to 167.86 lakh hectares. Mung bean and lentil accounted for increase in area under pulses.

The United Nations General Assembly has declared the year 2023 as the International Year of Millets and India is at the forefront in celebrating the event in a big way. In order to create awareness about the benefits of millets as superfood and to meet its growing demand around the world, the Government is promoting millet production through the NFSM-Nutri Cereals component of National Food Security Mission programme in 212 districts of 14 states. Coarse cum Nutri-cereals saw an increase of 2.08 lakh hectares in area under cultivation from 51.42 lakh hectares in 2021-22 to 53.49 lakh hectares in 2022-23.

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Q.197 Which state recorded the maximum increase in sown area of the rice crop?

(a) Madhya Pradesh **(b)** Rajasthan
(c) Chhattisgarh **(d)** Telangana

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Telangana
The passage clearly mentions "Maximum increase in area under rice is in states of Telangana and West Bengal."

Q.198 On which of the following crops, is the Indian Government specially focussing this year?

(a) rice **(b)** millets
(c) oilseeds **(d)** pulses

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) millets
It is clear from the lasts paragraph that the government is focusing on millets.
"Government is promoting millet production through the NFSM-Nutri Cereals component of National Food Security Mission programme in 212 districts of 14 states".

Q.199 Match the following crops with the area.
Crop area in 2022-23
a. millets 1. 98.02 lakh hectares
b. pulses 2. 53.49 lakh hectares
c. mustard 3. 167.86 lakh hectares

(a) a-2, b-1, c-3 **(b)** a -3, b -1, c-2
(c) a-2, b-3, c-1 **(d)** a-1, b- 3, c-2

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) a-2, b-3, c-1
The correct options are;
Millets – 2. 53.49 lakh hectares
Pulses – 3. 167.86 lakh hectares
Mustard – 1. 98.02 lakh hectares.
As mentioned in the passage.

Q.200 The main theme of the passage is

(a) increase in the area of oilseeds like mustard
(b) increase in the production of pulses
(c) increase in the area of Rabi crops in 2022-23
(d) area under rabi crop in last five years

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) increase in the area of Rabi crops in 2022-23
The passage mainly deals with the increase in the area of Rabi crops in 2022-23. So, it is the main theme of the passage.
option (a) – increase in the area of oilseeds like mustard is mentioned in the passage but is not the main theme.
option (b) – increase in the production of pulses is only briefly mentioned in the passage. Therefore, it is not the main theme.
option (d) – although, the area under rabi crop in last five years is mentioned in the passage, but it is only for the comparison purpose.
Thus, option (c) is the correct choice.

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Passage 30 (Q.201–Q.204)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

My grandmother, like everybody's grandmother, was an old woman. She had been old and wrinkled for the twenty years that I had known her. People said that she once had been young and pretty and had even had a husband, but that was hard to believe. My grandfather's portrait hung above the mantelpiece in the drawing room. He wore a big turban and loose fitting clothes. His long, white beard covered the best part of his chest and he looked at least a hundred years old. He did not look the sort of person who would have a wife or children. He looked as if he could only have lots and lots of grandchildren. As my grandmother being young and pretty, the thought was almost revolting. She often told us of the games she used to play as a child. That seemed quite absurd and undignified on her part and we treated it like the fables of the Prophets she used to tell us.

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Q.201 Select the most appropriate inference drawn from the passage.

(a) Grandmother loved to talk of her childhood.
(b) People said that the grandmother was pretty.
(c) The author looked upon his grandmother as an old woman like every grandmother.
(d) Grandmother had a husband.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The author looked upon his grandmother as an old woman like every grandmother.

The passage is about the author's grandmother. The most appropriate inference from the passage is that the author looked upon his grandmother as an old woman like every other grandmother.
The author mentions his grandmother as an old and wrinkled woman whom he had known for 20 years.
He also mentions that his grandmother often talked about the games she used to play as a child.
These things show that the author perceived his grandmother as an old woman like every grandmother.

Q.202 Select the most appropriate fact from the given options.

(a) The author was twenty years old when he wrote the story.
(b) The author and grandma lived for twenty years.
(c) Grandma was twenty years old.
(d) The author was twenty when grandma died.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Grandma was twenty years old.

The second line of the passage says, "She had been old and wrinkled for the twenty years that I had known her." It can be inferred from this line that the author was twenty years old when the grandmother passed away. So, option (c) is correct.

Q.203 Select an appropriate title for the given passage.

(a) Grandmothers **(b)** My Grandfather
(c) The Grandchildren **(d)** My Grandmother

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) My Grandmother

The most appropriate title is "My Grandmother". The main focus of the passage is on author's grandmother, her appearance, old age and the perception of the author about her.

Q.204 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Revolting

(a) Unpleasant **(b)** Rebel
(c) Peace **(d)** Attractive

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Attractive

Revolting – causing intense disgust and repugnance.
Attractive – pleasing or appealing to the senses.
Unpleasant – causing discomfort
Rebel – a person who resists authority
Peace – tranquility.
So, the antonym of the word revolting is attractive. So, option (d) is the correct option.

Passage 31 (Q.205–Q.208)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

The sage of science, Einstein, was sitting in a depressive and pensive mood one evening. His eyes were brimming with tears. The pain was evident on his face. He peeped out of the window of his room. The sun had set a few minutes back. The sky was filled with a reddish glow. At this sunset, he felt that it was humanity that had sunk into devilish darkness and the reddish glow in the sky was the blood of humanity spilling all over the sky from earth. With tired steps, he walked back to his chair and settled down. It was the 9th of August 1945. Three days back, he had felt the same agony as if someone had torn him apart. He was deeply hurt and depressed when he heard on the radio that America had dropped an atom bomb on the Japanese city, Hiroshima. Today, within three days another bomb was dropped on another city, Nagasaki and lakhs of people had been killed.

He had heard that the blast released so much energy that it had paled all past destructions in comparison and death had played out a pitiable dance of destruction. The flames that broke out of the bomb were burning, melting, and exploding buildings. Scared of the heat of the bomb, people had jumped into lakes and rivers, but the water was boiling and the people too were burnt and killed. The animals in the water were already boiled to death. Animals, trees, herbs, fragrant flowering plants were all turned into ashes. The atomic energy destruction had just not stopped there. It had entered the atmosphere there and had spread radiation that would affect people for generations to come and would also bring about destructive irreversible biological change in animals and plants.

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Passage (contd.)

As the news of the atomic attack reached Einstein, and he became aware of the glaring horror of the abuse of atomic energy, his distress and restlessness knew no bounds. He could not control himself and picked up his violin to turn his mind on to other things. While playing the violin, he tried to dissolve his distress in its sad notes, but couldn't. He was burning on the embers of destruction; his heart was filled with an ocean of agony and tears just continued streaming uncontrollably out of his eyes. Night had fallen. His daughter came up and asked him to eat something as he had not taken anything for the last four days. His voice was restrained and he said, "I don't feel like eating."

He could not sleep that night. Lying down, he was thinking how he had drawn the attention of the then American President Roosevelt towards the destructive powers of an atomic bomb. He had thought that this would be used to scare Hitler and put an end to the barbarism that Hitler was up to. However, Roosevelt kept him in the dark and made false promises. Eventually, he had abused Einstein's equation of E = mc2 that resulted in the destructive experiments. His actions had made science and scientists as murderers. Einstein kept on thinking for a long time. Eventually, he slipped into sleep. When he woke up at dawn, there was a new dawn in him too. The atomic threat had transformed his heart.

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Q.205 What is the central theme of the passage?

(a) Einstein and his life
(b) Einstein and his love for music
(c) Atomic war and its consequences
(d) Science and its bad side

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Atomic war and its consequences

The passage is about atomic war and its consequences. It mentions about Einstein's warning of the devastation of atomic war and his advocacy for international cooperation to prevent it. There is also a mention of the creation of atomic bomb and its use in the World War 2.
So, option (c) is the correct answer.

Q.206 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of 'set' from the passage.

(a) Get up **(b)** Level
(c) Stand **(d)** Rise

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Rise

Set – to put something in a particular place or position.
Rise – to move upwards or stand up.
Stand – be in an upright position
Get up – to rise from a lying or sitting position
Level – make something flat or even.
The most appropriate antonym out of the given words is 'rise'.

Q.207 Why did Einstein refuse to eat?

(a) As he felt guilty **(b)** As he felt happy
(c) As he felt worried **(d)** As he felt sick

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) As he felt guilty

Paragraph 2 of the passage: "He refused to eat, feeling guilty that he had not done enough to help those suffering from the war and its aftermath."
So, option (a) is the correct answer.

Q.208 Select an appropriate title for the passage.

(a) Atom Bombs
(b) Einstein and his Violin
(c) Death in Hiroshima
(d) War and Destruction

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) War and Destruction

The passage discusses the destruction caused by the bombs dropped on Hiroshima and Nagasaki during World War 2.
So, the title "War and Destruction" is the most appropriate title for the passage.

Passage 32 (Q.209–Q.212)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Wetlands are amongst the most productive ecosystems on the Earth and provide many important services to human society. They exhibit enormous diversity according to their genesis, geographical location, water regime and chemistry, dominant species, and soil and sediment characteristics. Globally, the areal extent of wetland ecosystems ranges from 917 million hectares (m ha) to more than 1275 m ha. One of the first widely used wetland classifications systems, devised by Cowardin et al., 1979, categorized wetlands into marine (coastal wetlands), estuarine (including deltas, tidal marshes, and mangrove swamps), lacustrine (lakes), riverine (along rivers and streams), and palustrine (marshes, swamps and bogs) based on their hydrological, ecological and geological characteristics.

Ramsar Convention on Wetlands was an international treaty signed in 1971. Overall, 1052 sites in Europe; 289 sites in Asia; 359 sites in Africa; 175 sites in South America; 211 sites in North America; and 79 sites in Oceania region have been identified as Ramsar sites or wetlands of International importance.

As per the Ramsar Convention definition most of the natural water bodies (such as rivers, lakes, coastal lagoons, mangroves, peat land, coral reefs) and man-made wetlands (such as ponds, farm ponds, irrigated fields, sacred groves, salt pans, reservoirs, gravel pits, sewage farms and canals) in India constitute the wetland ecosystem distributed in different geographical regions ranging from Himalayas to Deccan plateau. As of February, 2022, India has 49 Ramsar sites covering an area of 10,93,636 hectares, the highest in South Asia.

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Passage (contd.)

As per the estimates, India has about 757.06 thousand wetlands with a total wetland area of 15.3 m ha, accounting for nearly 4.7% of the total geographical area of the country . Out of this, areas under inland wetlands accounts for 69%, coastal wetlands 27%, and other wetlands (smaller than 2.25 ha) 4%.

Gujarat has the highest proportion (17.5%) and Mizoram has the lowest proportion (0.66%) of the area under wetlands. Among Union Territories, Lakshadweep has the highest proportion (around 96%) and Chandigarh has the least proportion (3%) of geographical area under wetlands.

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Q.209 In India, what kind of wetlands occupy the largest area?

(a) small wetlands **(b)** inland wetlands
(c) mangrove swamps **(d)** coastal wetlands

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) inland wetlands
According to the passage, "In India, inland wetlands occupy the largest area, covering about 40 million hectares."

Q.210 Which of the following questions cannot be answered after reading the above passage?

(a) How many Ramsar sites are there in the world?
(b) Why are wetlands important for human societies?
(c) What is the classification of wetlands?
(d) How much area is covered by wetlands In India?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Why are wetlands important for human societies?
option (a) – the first sentence of the passage.
option (c) – second sentence of the passage.
option (d) – third sentence of the passage.
option (b) – not answered in the passage directly.

Q.211 Match the continents with the number of Ramsar sites.

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(a) a-2, b- 3, c-4, d-1 **(b)** a-3, b-4, c-1, d -2
(c) a-2, b-1, c-4, d-3 **(d)** a -4, b -1, c-2, d-3

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) a-2, b-1, c-4, d-3
Second paragraph, second sentence.

Q.212 Under which category of wetlands, are delta and mangrove swamps included?

(a) marine **(b)** lacustrine
(c) palustrine **(d)** estuarine

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) estuarine
it is mentioned in the passage, "1979 classification system categorizes wetlands into five types, which includes estuarine wetlands comprising of deltas, tidal marshes, and mangrove swamps."
So, option (d) is correct.

Passage 33 (Q.213–Q.216)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

The Indian Space Research Organisation (ISRO) announced another successful mission. ISRO chairman S. Somanath said that three small satellites successfully separated and were injected into orbit.

ISRO had launched three small satellites powered by its SSLV-D2 launch vehicle from Satish Dhawan Space Centre at Sriharikota on February 10, 2023 at 09:18 AM IST. The launch vehicle was carrying EOS-07, Janus-1 & AzaadiSAT-2 satellites and aimed to inject them into a 450 km circular orbit. The launch took place at the first launch pad at SDSC SHAR, Sriharikota.

The SSLV-D2 had to take a 15 minutes flight to inject EOS-07, Janus-1 and AzaadiSAT-2 satellites into 450 km circular lower orbit. "It is configured with three solid propulsion stages and a velocity terminal module. It is a 34 m tall, 2 m diameter vehicle having a lift-off mass of 120 t," said ISRO. The EOS-07 satellite weighs 156.3 kg and is made by ISRO.

About 13 minutes into its flight, the SSLV rocket ejected EOS-07 and soon after that the other two satellites Janus-1 and AzaadiSAT-2 were ejected — all at an altitude of 450 km, said ISRO.

With the new rocket in its portfolio, ISRO will have three rockets — Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle (PSLV) and its variants (cost about Rs 200 crore), Geosynchronous Satellite Launch Vehicle (GSLV-MkII cost about Rs 272 crore and LVM3 Rs 434 crore) and SSLV (Development cost of three rockets about Rs 56 crore each) and production cost may go down later.

"New experiments include mm-Wave Humidity Sounder and Spectrum Monitoring Payload. Janus-1, a 10.2 kg satellite belongs to ANTARIS, USA. A 8.7 kg satellite AzaadiSAT-2 is a combined effort of about 750 girl students across India guided by Space Kidz India, Chennai," it added.

SSLV caters to the launch of up to 500 kg satellites to Low Earth Orbits on 'launch-on-demand' basis. "It provides low-cost access to Space, offers low turn-around time and flexibility in accommodating multiple satellites, and demands minimal launch infrastructure," as per a statement by ISRO

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Q.213 Which satellite was injected into the orbit first?

(a) EOS-07 **(b)** Janus 1
(c) AzaadiSAT-2 **(d)** Antaris

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) EOS-07
The passage mentions;
About 13 minutes into its flight, the SSLV rocket ejected EOS-07 and soon after that the other two satellites Janus-1 and AzaadiSAT-2 were ejected — all at an altitude of 450 km, said ISRO.

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Q.214 What is the passage mainly about?

(a) new experiments on satellites by ISRO
(b) development of SSLV rocket by ISRO
(c) efforts to cut costs of satellites by ISRO
(d) launch of three small satellites in orbit by ISRO

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) launch of three small satellites in orbit by ISRO
The passage mainly discusses the launch of three small satellites in orbit by ISRO.
So, option (d) is the correct answer.

Q.215 After reading the passage it can be inferred that it is

(a) a magazine article **(b)** a news item
(c) an editorial **(d)** a government release

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a news item
The information in the passage is given in a factual and objective manner. There is no expression of bias or a particular opinion. So, it is more like a news item.

Q.216 Match the satellites with their weight.

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(a) a-2, b-3, c-1 **(b)** a -3, b -1, c-2
(c) a-1, b- 3, c-2 **(d)** a-2, b-1, c-3

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) a-2, b-3, c-1
It is mentioned in the passage: "New experiments include mm-Wave Humidity Sounder and Spectrum Monitoring Payload. Janus-1, a 10.2 kg satellite belongs to ANTARIS, USA. A 8.7 kg satellite AzaadiSAT-2 is a combined effort of about 750 girl students across India guided by Space Kidz India, Chennai,"
So, option (a) is the correct answer.

Passage 34 (Q.217–Q.220)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Notwithstanding logistical challenges posed by COVID19 pandemic, India continues to expand its rice exports footprint in the African, Asian and European Union markets, thus having the largest share in global rice trade. The robust global demand also helped India's growth in rice exports.

In 2020-21, India's rice exports (Basmati and Non-Basmati) rose by a huge 87 per cent to 17.72 Million Tonne (MT) from 9.49 MT achieved in 2019-20.

In terms of value realisation, India's rice exports rose by 38 per cent to USD 8815 million in 2020-21 from USD 6397 million reported in 2019-20. In terms of Rupees, India's rice export grew by 44 per cent to Rs 65298 crore in 2020-21 from Rs 45379 crore in the previous year.

Passage (contd.)

In the first seven months of the current financial year (2021-22), India's rice exports rose by more than 33 per cent to 11.79 MT from 8.91 MT achieved during April-October, 2020-21. It is anticipated that India's rice exports in 2021-22 would likely surpass the record feet of 17.72 MT achieved in 2020-21.

In 2020-21, India shipped non-basmati rice to nine countries - Timor-Leste, Puerto Rico, Brazil, Papua New Guinea, Zimbabwe, Burundi, Eswatini, Myanmar and Nicaragua, where exports were carried out for the first time or earlier the shipment was smaller in volume.

India's Non-Basmati rice exports was valued at USD 4796 million (Rs 35448crore) in 2020- 21, with Basmati Rice exports a close second at USD 4018 million (Rs 29,849 crore).

In terms of volume of Basmati rice exports in 2020-21, top ten countries – Saudi Arabia, Iran, Iraq, Yemen, United Arab Emirates, United States of America, Kuwait, United Kingdom, Qatar and Oman have a share of close to 80 per cent in total shipments of aromatic long grained rice from India.

Top ten countries – Nepal, Benin, Bangladesh, Senegal, Togo, Cote D Ivoire, Guinea, Malaysia, Iraq, United Arab Emirates – have a share of 57 per cent in India's total exports of non-Basmati rice in 2020-21 in terms of volume.

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Q.217 What is the estimate of rice export in the year 2021-22?

(a) It will remain the same as the 17.72 MT rice export achieved in 2020-21.
(b) It will not pass beyond the 17.72 MT rice export achieved in 2020-21.
(c) It may fall below the 17.72 MT rice export achieved in 2020-21.
(d) It will exceed the 17.72 MT rice export achieved in 2020-21.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) It will exceed the 17.72 MT rice export achieved in 2020-21.
The last line of the third paragraph says;
It is anticipated that India's rice exports in 2021-22 **would likely surpass the record feet of 17.72 MT achieved in 2020-21.**

Q.218 Which of the following countries imported rice from India for the first time?

(a) Bangladesh **(b)** Brazil
(c) Iraq **(d)** United Arab Emirates

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Brazil
It is mentioned in the first line of the fourth paragraph.
In 2020-21, India shipped non-basmati rice to nine countries - Timor-Leste, Puerto Rico, **Brazil**, Papua New Guinea, Zimbabwe, Burundi, Eswatini, Myanmar and Nicaragua, where exports were carried out for the first time or earlier the shipment was smaller in volume.

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Q.219 Which of the following countries imports Basmati rice from India?

(a) Nepal **(b)** Malaysia
(c) Bangladesh **(d)** Kuwait

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Kuwait
The last sentence of the fourth paragraph;
In terms of volume of Basmati rice exports in 2020-21, top ten countries – Saudi Arabia, Iran, Iraq, Yemen, United Arab Emirates, United States of America, Kuwait, United Kingdom, Qatar and Oman have a share of close to 80 per cent in total shipments of aromatic long grained rice from India.

Q.220 Which of the following questions cannot be answered on the basis of the above passage?

(a) What was the value of Basmati rice export from India?
(b) How much rice (Basmati and Non Basmati) was exported by India in 2020-21?
(c) Which top 10 countries buy Non -Basmati rice from India?
(d) How much Basmati rice was exported by India in 2020-21?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) How much Basmati rice was exported by India in 2020-21?
Individual Export data of Basmati rice is unavailable. So, 'd' cannot be answered.

Passage 35 (Q.221–Q.224)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

As the Sun inches closer to its peak activity in its solar cycle, an explosion has been picked up behind the north-eastern limb of the star in our solar system. Solar observatories saw bits and pieces of the explosion, which remain obscured in view from Earth's orbit.

The explosion was spotted on 31 July at around 2309 UT and Earth-orbiting satellites registered a long-lasting C9.3-class solar flare. "The intensity is probably an underestimate because it was partially eclipsed by the edge of the sun. Nasa's Solar Dynamics Observatory (SDO) saw hot debris flying away from the blast site," space weather, which tracks the solar activity, reported.

While the explosion was powerful, experts have predicted that Earth is not in the line of fire from the Sun. Scientists are expected to get a view of the active region later this week as it comes to sight. Earth is not in the line of fire. The explosion is significant because it may herald an active region set to emerge over the sun's north-eastern limb later this week. A new sunspot group could bring an end to weeks of relative quiet," space weather said in its report.

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Q.221 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word from the passage.
Peak

(a) Bottom **(b)** Zenith
(c) Glance **(d)** Point

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Zenith
Peak – the highest point of something.
Zenith – the culmination or highest point of something.
Glance – to take a quick look or glimpse at something.
Point – a specific location or a sharp end of something.
Bottom – the base of something.
Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

Q.222 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word from the passage.
Partially

(a) Partly **(b)** Supportively
(c) Frankly **(d)** Completely

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Partly
Partially – to a certain extent or to some degree.
Partly – not fully or to some extent.
Supportively – to provide support or assistance to something.
Frankly – open, honest and straightforward.
Completely – fully. Antonym of partially.
Considering the meaning of the options, option (a) is the correct answer.

Q.223 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word from the passage.
Debris

(a) Detritus **(b)** Liquid
(c) Specks **(d)** Rays

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Detritus
Debris – scattered pieces that result from the destruction of something.
Detritus – scattered fragments of remains resulting from disintegration.
So, detritus is the synonym of the given word debris.

Q.224 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word from the passage.
Spotted

(a) Splotchy **(b)** Placed
(c) Witnessed **(d)** Speckled

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Witnessed
Spotted – to see or observe something interested.
Splotchy – something having irregular patches of colour.
Placed – to put or position something in a specific location.
Witnessed – seeing or observing something.
Speckled – having small spots on something.
Considering the meanings of the options, option (c) is the correct answer.

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Passage 36 (Q.225–Q.228)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Tens of thousands of people who lost their homes in a catastrophic earthquake huddled around campfires in the bitter cold and clamoured for food and water on Thursday, three days after the temblor hit Turkey and Syria and killed more than 19,300 on Monday, 6th February, 2023.

Emergency crews used pick axes, shovels and jackhammers to dig through twisted metal and concrete - and occasionally still pulled out survivors.

In the Turkish city of Antakya, dozens scrambled for aid in front of a truck distributing children's coats and other supplies. Many of those who lost their homes found shelter in tents, stadiums and other temporary accommodation, but others slept outdoors.

In Antakya, over 100 bodies were awaiting identification in a makeshift morgue outside a hospital.

Authorities called off search-and-rescue operations in the cities of Kilis and Sanliurfa, where destruction was not as severe as in other impacted regions.

The U.N. is authorised to deliver aid through only one border crossing, and road damage has prevented that thus far. U.N. Officials pleaded for humanitarian concerns to take precedence over wartime politics.

The scale of loss and suffering remained massive. Turkish authorities said on Thursday that the death toll had risen to more than 16,100 in the country, with more than 64,000 injured.

In Syria, which includes government-held and rebel-held areas, more than 3,100 have been reported dead and more than 5,000 injured.

Rescue teams urged quiet in the hope of hearing stifled pleas for help, and the Syrian paramedic group known as the White Helmets noted that every second could mean saving a life. But more and more often, the teams pulled out dead bodies.

It was not clear how many people were still unaccounted for in both countries.

Turkey's disaster-management agency said more than 110,000 rescue personnel were now taking part in the effort and more than 5,500 vehicles, including tractors, cranes, bulldozers and excavators had been shipped.

The Foreign Ministry said 95 countries have offered help. More than half of that number have sent a total of nearly 6,500 rescuers. Another 2,400 more are still expected to arrive.

International aid for Syria was far more sparse.

Efforts there have been hampered by the civil war and the isolation of the rebel-held region along the border that is surrounded by Russia-backed government forces.

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Q.225 The passage highlights all the following except

(a) the foreign aid being offered to Turkey and Syria
(b) the rescue work being carried out in Turkey and Syria
(c) Syria's rebel-held areas and the Civil war going on there
(d) the suffering of people in the earthquake hit areas of Turkey and Syria

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Syria's rebel-held areas and the Civil war going on there
The passage does not highlight the rebel-held areas and the civil war going on there.
It highlights the earthquake that hit both Turkey and Syria, the suffering of the affected people and the rescue work being carried out there.

Q.226 How many foreign rescue workers are engaged in the rescue work?

(a) 5000 rescue workers **(b)** 110,000 rescue workers
(c) 2400 rescue workers **(d)** 6500 rescue workers

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) 6500 rescue workers
it is mentioned in the passage;
More than half of that number have sent a total of nearly 6,500 rescuers.

Q.227 Match the words with their meaning.

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(a) a-2, b-3, c-1 **(b)** a -3, b -1, c-2
(c) a-2, b-1, c-3 **(d)** a-1, b- 3, c-2

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) a-2, b-3, c-1
Clamoured – to speak in a loud and angry way.
Scream also means the same.
Scramble – to climb up or over something
Jostled – to push hard against something
Hampered – obstructed.
Checked also means the same.
Hence, option (a) is the correct answer.

Q.228 Why is the International aid much lesser in Syria than in Turkey?

(a) Because the UN is allowed only one border crossing and Syria is not allowing that.
(b) Because the roads have been damaged there
(c) Because the destruction was not as severe in Syria as in Turkey.
(d) Because Syria is a war –torn country and there are areas under rebels.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Because Syria is a war –torn country and there are areas under rebels.
The passage mentions;
Efforts there have been hampered by the civil war and the isolation of the rebel-held region along the border that is surrounded by Russia-backed government forces.
There is the pronoun for Syria.

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Passage 37 (Q.229–Q.232)

Read the given passage carefully and answer the question that follows.

The discovery of a new bird species has sparked excitement among ornithologists and bird enthusiasts worldwide. The bird, named the Sapphire-winged Warbler, discovered in a remote tropical island's rainforests, is a unique bird with vibrant blue feathers and a distinctive melodic song. Birdwatchers and nature enthusiasts have been flocking to the island in hopes of catching a glimpse of this elusive and captivating creature. The discovery of the Sapphire-winged Warbler highlights the importance of preserving and protecting habitats. Amidst the excitement surrounding the discovery of the Sapphire-winged Warbler, researchers have embarked on a mission to uncover the bird's migratory patterns. Equipped with satellite tracking devices, they aim to trace the remarkable journey of this species across vast distances. By unravelling its migratory routes and stopover locations, scientists hope to gain insight into the challenges the Sapphire-winged Warbler faces during its arduous travels. The local community on the tropical island has embraced the newfound avian resident with great enthusiasm. Efforts are underway to raise awareness about the importance of conservation and to create protected areas that ensure the continued existence of this exquisite species.

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Q.229 Select the most appropriate title for the given passage.

(a) The Migratory Journey of the Sapphire-winged Warbler
(b) Conservation Efforts in Tropical Rainforests
(c) The Unique Features of the Sapphire-winged Warbler
(d) The Curious Behaviour of Birds in Remote Islands

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The Migratory Journey of the Sapphire-winged Warbler

The correct answer is option (a).

"The Migratory Journey of the Sapphire-winged Warbler" could be a suitable title

Q.230 Identify the most appropriate ANTONYM of the word 'stare' from the passage.

(a) Glimpse **(b)** Excitement
(c) Vibrancy **(d)** Arduousness

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Glimpse

The correct answer is option (a).

The most appropriate antonym of the word **'stare'** from the passage is **"glimpse."**

"stare" means to look fixedly or with intense concentration, **"glimpse"** means to see or perceive briefly or partially, often suggesting a quick and fleeting view.

Q.231 Based on the given passage, which of the following inferences can be made?

(a) Conservation efforts are solely focused on protecting the Sapphire-winged Warbler.
(b) The scientific community has lost interest in studying avian species.
(c) The discovery of the Sapphire-winged Warbler has sparked global interest in birdwatching.
(d) The Sapphire-winged Warbler is an aggressive and territorial bird species.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The discovery of the Sapphire-winged Warbler has sparked global interest in birdwatching.

The correct answer is option (c).

Based on the given passage, the inference that can be made is: **"The discovery of the Sapphire-winged Warbler has sparked global interest in birdwatching."**

The passage mentions that birdwatchers and nature enthusiasts from around the world have been traveling to the remote tropical island to catch a glimpse of this unique bird. This indicates a global interest in birdwatching sparked by the discovery of the Sapphire-winged Warbler. The other options are not supported by the passage and are not valid inferences.

Q.232 Which statement best reflects a fact mentioned in the given passage?

(a) Researchers are using satellite tracking devices to study the bird's migratory patterns.
(b) The Sapphire-winged Warbler is the largest bird species in the avian kingdom.
(c) Schools on the island organise annual bird-watching competitions.
(d) The Sapphire-winged Warbler is the only bird species on the tropical island.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Researchers are using satellite tracking devices to study the bird's migratory patterns.

The correct answer is option (a).

The statement that best reflects a fact mentioned in the given passage is:

"Researchers are using satellite tracking devices to study the bird's migratory patterns."

The passage indeed mentions that researchers are using satellite tracking devices to trace the migratory patterns of the Sapphire-winged Warbler.

Passage 38 (Q.233–Q.236)

Read the given passage and answer the question that follows.

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Passage (contd.)

On woody plants known as vines, luscious, smooth-skinned berries called grapes grow in dense clusters. In particular, grapes are grown in France, Italy, Spain, Australia, Chile, Romania, Georgia, South Africa and California, all of which have warm summers and moderate winters. Table grapes are larger and sweeter grapes that are intended for fresh consumption. To create wine, 80% of the grapes are crushed. The fermentation process turns grapes into wine. To make raisins, grapes must also be dried.

Grapes ripen in the area of California in August. They are cut from the vines and left on trays to dry for two to three weeks. So, to transform them into raisins, they are further cooked and steeped in particular treatments. According to studies, one acre of grapes can make roughly 15,000 glasses of wine on average. Grapes of the Thompson, Flame, Ruby, Perlette and Tokay varieties are popular.

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Q.233 Based on your reading of the passage, select the most appropriate word which best describes 'luscious'.

(a) Smooth **(b)** Juicy
(c) Soft **(d)** Large

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Juicy

The correct answer is option (b).

The most appropriate word to describe **"luscious"** based on the passage is **"juicy."** The word **"luscious"** is often used to describe fruits, like grapes, that are rich in flavor and moisture, making them juicy and appealing to the taste.

Q.234 In which region do grapes ripen in August?

(a) France **(b)** Chile
(c) California **(d)** Australia

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) California

The correct answer is option (c).

Grapes ripen in the region of California in August.

Q.235 What does the fermentation process do?

(a) Turns grapes into wine
(b) Turns grapes into raisins
(c) Makes grapes larger
(d) Crushes the grapes

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Turns grapes into wine

The correct answer is option (a).

The fermentation process does the following: **"Turns grapes into wine."**

The passage mentions that 80% of the grapes are crushed to create wine, and the fermentation process is what transforms these crushed grapes into wine. The other options are not related to the fermentation process described in the passage.

Q.236 Select the most appropriate title for the passage.

(a) Grapes and world **(b)** Varieties of grapes
(c) Wine making **(d)** Grapes and its uses

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Grapes and its uses

The correct answer is option (d).

According to passage the most appropriate answer is "Grapes and its uses".

The title "Grapes and its uses" would indeed be suitable if the passage covered a wide range of applications and purposes of grapes. However, while the passage does mention different uses of grapes, such as making raisins, it primarily focuses on the process of making wine.

Passage 39 (Q.237–Q.240)

Read the given passage and answer the question that follows.

Steel is tough, and it can easily be shaped, cut or made into wire. Special alloys of steel can be made by adding small amounts of other metals such as aluminium, nickel and copper. Alloys give steel unusual hardness, toughness or ability to resist rust. Steel is often called the backbone of modern industry. Almost everything we use is either made of iron or steel or has been made with tools and machinery of these metals. Ships, trains, trucks and autos are made largely of steel. Even the safety pins and the needles you use are made from steel. Oil wells are drilled with steel machinery. Steel pipelines transport oil. Minerals are mined with steel equipment. Farm machines are mostly steel. Large buildings have steel framework.

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Q.237 Identify the structure of the passage.

(a) Cause and effect **(b)** Descriptive
(c) Sequential **(d)** Classification

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Descriptive

The correct answer is option (b).

The structure of the passage is **"Descriptive."** The passage provides descriptions and details about the properties of steel and its wide-ranging applications in various industries and infrastructure. It does not primarily focus on cause and effect, sequential events, or classification of information; rather, it describes various aspects of steel and its uses.

Q.238 Select an appropriate title for the passage from the given options.

(a) Mineral ores **(b)** Steel Industry
(c) Resources of Steel **(d)** Manufacturing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Steel Industry

The correct answer is option (b).

The most appropriate title for the passage would be **"Steel Industry."** This title reflects the central theme of the passage, which is the importance of steel in modern industry and its various applications across different sectors.

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Q.239 Why is steel often called the backbone of modern industry?

(a) Steel is used in almost every tool and machinery.
(b) It is easy to make steel alloys.
(c) Steel can be added with any material.
(d) Steel is tough.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Steel is used in almost every tool and machinery.
The correct answer is option (a).
Given its versatility and widespread use across industries, steel is often referred to as the backbone of modern industry. It is a foundational material that underpins many aspects of modern life and industrial production. Steel is often called the backbone of modern industry because it plays a crucial role in various aspects of modern industrial processes and infrastructure.
Hence, the correct option is a.

Q.240 What is the tone of the passage?

(a) Ironical **(b)** Judgemental
(c) Critical **(d)** Informative

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Informative
The correct answer is option (d).
The tone of the passage is "Informative." The passage provides factual information about the properties and wide-ranging applications of steel in various industries and infrastructure. It does not express irony, judgment, or criticism; instead, it aims to inform the reader about the importance and versatility of steel.

Passage 40 (Q.241–Q.244)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

The French Revolution is a revolutionary movement that occurred in France between 1787 and 1799 and reached to its (1)_____ in 1789. This revolution had many causes but the most important of all was (2)_____ of bourgeoisie, who were merchants, manufacturers and professionals. The peasants, many of them landowners, wanted to get rid of the practices of absolute monarchy and feudalism. Another factor was an increase in population due to decreased mortality rates. It was followed by economic predicament and minor revolts were common. This led to a clarion call for social reforms. Intellectuals like Rene Descartes wrote about new things about political, social and economic matters. A fundamental political and societal change was to occur. The French Revolution played a critical role in shaping modern nations by showing the world the power inherent in the will of the people.

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Q.241 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 1.

(a) middle **(b)** fall
(c) pinnacle **(d)** foundation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) pinnacle
In the context of the French Revolution, the word "pinnacle" refers to the high point or climax of the revolution, which occurred in 1789.
The correct answer is: **pinnacle**
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.242 Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank no. 2.

(a) killing **(b)** sorrow
(c) hankering **(d)** joy

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) hankering
In this context, the passage is discussing the causes of the French Revolution, specifically the causes related to the bourgeoisie (merchants, manufacturers, and professionals). The word **"hankering"** means a strong desire or longing for something.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.243 What is the meaning of the phrase 'a clarion call' in the passage?

(a) A call for forces
(b) A strongly expressed demand
(c) Beginning of a new phase
(d) Declaration of war

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A strongly expressed demand
The phrase "a clarion call" refers to a loud and clear call for action or a strongly expressed demand for change.
The correct answer is: **A strongly expressed demand.**
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Q.244 Select the most appropriate synonym of the word 'Inherent'.

(a) Natural **(b)** Borrowed
(c) Incited **(d)** Artificial

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Natural
The word **"inherent"** refers to something that is a permanent, essential, or characteristic attribute of something.
Natural: Matches well with **"inherent"** as it refers to something existing naturally or as a core part of an entity.
The meaning of other options are:
Borrowed: Refers to something taken from another, not intrinsic to the original.
Incited: Refers to an external cause provoking an action, not an intrinsic characteristic.
Artificial: Refers to something man-made, not a natural or inherent quality.
So, the most appropriate synonym for **"inherent"** is **Natural**.
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

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Passage 41 (Q.245–Q.248)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Subhas Chandra Bose, a prominent Indian nationalist leader, was convinced that India could not achieve independence without the use of force, and he believed that a military campaign was necessary to achieve this goal. In 1942, Bose formed the Indian National Army (INA) with the help of the Japanese.

Bose travelled to Japan in 1941 to seek their support in the struggle against British rule in India. The Japanese were interested in having Bose's help in their own efforts to expand their influence in Southeast Asia. Bose's vision was to create a military force to fight against the British in India with the help of Japanese weapons and training. The INA was formed in Singapore in September 1942 with the slogan 'Jai Hind' (Victory to India). The INA consisted of soldiers who were primarily from the Indian community in Southeast Asia. They were trained by Japanese officers and were equipped with Japanese weapons. The INA fought alongside Japanese forces in Burma and other parts of Southeast Asia during World War II. Bose's leadership of the INA and his military campaigns against the British in India made him a popular figure among many Indians. The consequences of the formation of the INA were significant. The INA's campaigns against the British in India and the Indian soldiers' role in the Burma campaign had a psychological impact on the British forces. The British were shocked that Indian soldiers had turned against them, undermining their confidence in maintaining control over India. The INA also had a significant impact on the Indian independence movement. Bose's vision of a socialist India with equal rights for all citizens inspired many Indians. The INA became a symbol of the struggle against British colonialism, and Bose's slogan of 'Jai Hind' became a rallying cry for the independence movement.

However, the INA's military campaigns were not successful in achieving their goal of freeing India from British rule. The INA suffered significant losses in battles, and their efforts were undermined by the Japanese surrender in 1945.

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Q.245 How did Subhas Chandra Bose view India's fight for independence?

(a) Through non-violent means
(b) Through political negotiations
(c) Through military campaigns
(d) Through economic sanctions

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Through military campaigns

The passage clearly states that Bose was convinced that India could not achieve independence without the use of force and believed that a military campaign was necessary to achieve this goal.

Subhas Chandra Bose viewed India's fight for independence **through military campaigns**.

So, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.246 What was the significance of Bose's slogan 'Jai Hind'?

(a) It manifests the vision of selected communities.
(b) It was a call to arms for the Indian and British Army.
(c) It represented Bose's vision of a capitalist India.
(d) It symbolised the struggle against British colonialism.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) It symbolised the struggle against British colonialism.

The passage highlights that Bose's slogan "Jai Hind" became a rallying cry for the independence movement, symbolizing the struggle against British colonialism.

The correct answer is: **It symbolized the struggle against British colonialism.**

So, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.247 What was the primary reason for the Japanese to support Subhas Chandra Bose and the formation of the INA?

(a) They believed in India's right to self-determination.
(b) They were looking for allies in their fight against the British Empire.
(c) They believed in Bose's vision of a communist India.
(d) They wanted to expand their influence in Southeast Asia.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) They wanted to expand their influence in Southeast Asia.

The passage mentions that the Japanese were interested in having Bose's help in their own efforts to expand their influence in Southeast Asia, which is why they supported the formation of the Indian National Army (INA).

The primary reason for the Japanese to support Subhas Chandra Bose and the formation of the INA was:

They wanted to expand their influence in Southeast Asia.

Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.248 What ultimately undermined the INA's efforts to free India from British rule?

(a) Gandhi's death
(b) The inferior military tactics of the British forces
(c) The Japanese surrender in 1945
(d) The lack of support from the Indian and British people

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The Japanese surrender in 1945

The passage mentions that the INA's efforts were undermined by the Japanese surrender in 1945, which had a significant impact on their military campaigns and the overall goal of freeing India from British rule.

The correct answer is: **The Japanese surrender in 1945**.

Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Passage 42 (Q.249–Q.252)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

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Passage (contd.)
Algae are photosynthetic creatures that have pigments that aid in photosynthesis, such as chlorophyll. They do not, however, have the actual stems, roots or leaves found in vascular plants. While some of them have many cells, others are unicellular. They might establish colonies as well. The majority of algae are aquatic. Some are terrestrial, and they can be found on rocks, trees and moist soil. Certain algae species coexist well with other living things. For instance, lichens are a symbiotic relationship between green (and often blue-green) algae and fungi. Algae are members of a multiphyletic group. This indicates that there is no common ancestor and that the species in this category are not necessarily closely related. They do not have other morphoanatomical characteristics typical of vascular plants, but they do have one thing in common: they are eukaryotes with the principal pigment being chlorophyll, which allows them to perform photosynthesis. Phycology is the scientific name for the study of algae. The blue-green algae is one example of a reference. But some sources do not classify them as algae because they are prokaryotes.
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Q.249 According to the passage, which is the main pigment in algae for photosynthesis?
(a) Xanthophyll **(b)** Carotenoid
(c) Chlorophyll **(d)** Melanin
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Chlorophyll
The passage clearly states:
"They are eukaryotes with the principal pigment being chlorophyll, which allows them to perform photosynthesis."
The main pigment in algae for photosynthesis, according to the passage, is:
Chlorophyll
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.250 What is the central theme of the passage?
(a) The anatomy of vascular plants
(b) The prokaryotic nature of blue-green algae
(c) The diversity and characteristics of algae
(d) The symbiotic relationship between algae and fungi
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The diversity and characteristics of algae
The passage focuses on describing algae, their characteristics, types (unicellular, colonial, aquatic, and terrestrial), and their role in photosynthesis. It also discusses their classification, symbiotic relationships (such as lichens), and the scientific study of algae (phycology). The main focus is on the diversity and various traits of algae, which makes **"The diversity and characteristics of algae"** the most appropriate choice.
So, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.251 What does the term 'multiphyletic group' mean in the context of algae?
(a) No common ancestor, not closely related
(b) Being closely related species
(c) Having diverse morphoanatomical characteristics
(d) Having a common ancestor
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) No common ancestor, not closely related
The passage explains that **"Algae are members of a multiphyletic group. This indicates that there is no common ancestor and that the species in this category are not necessarily closely related."**
The correct meaning of the term **'multiphyletic group'** in the context of algae is:
No common ancestor, not closely related
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.252 Which statement accurately describes vascular plants based on the information in the passage?
(a) Vascular plants are unicellular in structure.
(b) Vascular plants lack stems, roots and leaves.
(c) Algae and vascular plants share the same morphoanatomical characteristics.
(d) Vascular plants have true stems, roots and leaves, unlike algae.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Vascular plants have true stems, roots and leaves, unlike algae.
The passage clearly states that algae **"do not have the actual stems, roots or leaves found in vascular plants."**
Therefore, it implies that vascular plants do have these structures, which distinguishes them from algae.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Passage 43 (Q.253–Q.256)
Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Reading is an important communication skill that has many benefits and it has great impact on a person's life. We should develop a reading habit as it allows us to learn new information and gives us access to a wide range of opportunities and ideas. So, reading regularly not only broadens our aspect and knowledge but also improves our intelligence, perspective, judgement and understanding of the world. It helps to stimulate creativity and imagination, to relieve the stress and pressure, and to provide a source of entertainment. The major benefit of reading is to develop the analytical and critical skills of a reader. The former involves gathering information and breaking it down into parts for better understanding, while the latter involves evaluating the same information and making judgments based on evidence. Reading a book or any content improves our language and vocabulary, so we can easily comprehend the words and their use in the context. It also helps in cognitive development in young children so at the primary level, children are more involved in reading rather than writing.
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Q.253 Cognitive development in a child is related to:

(a) social development
(b) environmental development
(c) technical development
(d) mental development

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) mental development
The correct option is **mental development**.
Cognitive development in a child refers to the growth and changes in their ability to think, learn, and understand. It involves mental processes such as memory, problem-solving, and decision-making.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.254 Which skill is used by a reader when he evaluates the same information and makes judgments based on evidence?

(a) Technical skill **(b)** Analytical skill
(c) Drawing skill **(d)** Critical skill

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Critical skill
The skill used by a reader when evaluating information and making judgments based on evidence is **Critical skill**.
So, the correct option is **Critical skill**.
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.255 Which skill is used by a reader when he gathers information and breaks it down in a logical pattern to solve a problem?

(a) Speaking skill **(b)** Critical skill
(c) Analytical skill **(d)** Reasoning skill

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Analytical skill
The skill used by a reader when gathering information and breaking it down in a logical pattern to solve a problem is **Analytical skill**.
So, the correct option is **Analytical skill**.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.256 According to the passage, what is the role of reading?

(a) To make environment healthy
(b) To learn new information to avail opportunity
(c) To give strength to the body
(d) To not to share information

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To learn new information to avail opportunity
According to the passage, the role of reading is **to learn new information to avail opportunities**.
So, the correct option is **to learn new information to avail opportunity**.
Thus, Option (b) is the right answer.

Passage 44 (Q.257–Q.260)
Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Passage (contd.)
The extraction of indigo dye involves harvesting the small, green leaves of the Indigofera plant before its flowers bloom. These leaves undergo a process of soaking in water and churning until a navy blue froth is released. The upper portion of the resulting mixture is drained for irrigation, while the leaves are repurposed as fertilizer. After allowing the water and fine sediment to settle for a day, the liquid is separated from the sediment. The obtained deep blue paste is then subjected to filtration to remove dirt and impurities, followed by compression into cakes and drying for several days. Once dried, the indigo is ready for use as a dye. Lime ($Ca(OH)_2$) can be added to the initial water and leaves mixture, and various natural sugars can be dissolved into the paste to enhance the extraction process.

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Q.257 What is the overall tone of the passage?

(a) Informative and instructional
(b) Critical and analytical
(c) Humorous and light-hearted
(d) Emotional and sentimental

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Informative and instructional
The overall tone of the passage is **informative and instructional**.
So, the correct option is **informative and instructional**.
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.258 In the extraction process described, what is the purpose of allowing the water and fine sediment at the bottom of the tank to settle for a day?

(a) To facilitate the separation of liquid from sediment
(b) To create a unique texture in the final indigo paste
(c) To enhance the aroma of the indigo dye
(d) To promote the growth of additional indigo leaves

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) To facilitate the separation of liquid from sediment
The purpose of allowing the water and fine sediment at the bottom of the tank to settle for a day is **to facilitate the separation of liquid from sediment**.
So, the correct option is **to facilitate the separation of liquid from sediment**.
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Q.259 Select the most appropriate synonym of the word 'impurities' from the options given below.

(a) scum **(b)** pureness
(c) cleanliness **(d)** purity

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) scum
The most appropriate synonym of the word 'impurities' from the given options is **scum**.
So, the correct option is **scum**.
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

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Q.260 What is the central theme of the passage describing the extraction process of indigo dye from the Indigofera plant?

(a) The cultivation and growth cycle of the Indigofera plant
(b) The impact of lime and natural sugars on the indigo extraction process
(c) The intricate process of harvesting and processing indigo leaves
(d) The various uses of indigo dye in different industries

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The intricate process of harvesting and processing indigo leaves
The central theme of the passage is **the intricate process of harvesting and processing indigo leaves**.
So, the correct option is **the intricate process of harvesting and processing indigo leaves**.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Passage 45 (Q.261–Q.264)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Engaging in regular physical activity is not only beneficial for physical well-being but also has a profound impact on mental health. Studies have shown that exercise releases endorphins, chemicals in the brain that act as natural painkillers and mood elevators. Additionally, consistent exercise has been linked to reduced symptoms of anxiety and depression. Contrary to common misconceptions, it doesn't require intense workouts; even moderate activities like walking or yoga can contribute to improved mental well-being. Making exercise a regular part of one's routine not only supports physical fitness but also nurtures a positive and resilient mindset.

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Q.261 Which of the following is a fact mentioned in the passage?

(a) Regular exercise has no impact on mental health.
(b) Only intense physical activities are linked to reduced anxiety and depression.
(c) Exercise requires intense workouts for mental health benefits.
(d) Exercise releases endorphins, contributing to improved mental well-being.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Exercise releases endorphins, contributing to improved mental well-being.
The fact mentioned in the passage is **"Exercise releases endorphins, contributing to improved mental well-being."**
Thus, Option (d) is the right answer.

Q.262 Determine the tone of the passage by choosing the option that reflects the overall emotional quality of the writing.

(a) Dramatic **(b)** Critical
(c) Informative **(d)** Humorous

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Informative
The overall tone of the passage is **informative**.
So, the correct option is **informative**.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.263 Select the most appropriate title for the given passage.

(a) The Impact of Technology on Health
(b) The Benefits of Mindfulness Meditation
(c) Importance of Regular Physical Activities
(d) The Importance of a Balanced Diet

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Importance of Regular Physical Activities
The most appropriate title for the given passage is **Importance of Regular Physical Activities**.
Thus, Option (c) is the right answer.

Q.264 Select the option that provides an accurate summary of the main points discussed in the passage.

(a) Engaging in regular physical activity positively impacts mental health by releasing endorphins and reducing symptoms of anxiety and depression.
(b) The passage discusses the negative effects of technology on health.
(c) Exercise requires intense workouts for mental health benefits.
(d) Exercise only impacts physical well-being, not mental health.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Engaging in regular physical activity positively impacts mental health by releasing endorphins and reducing symptoms of anxiety and depression.
The option that provides an accurate summary of the main points discussed in the passage is **"Engaging in regular physical activity positively impacts mental health by releasing endorphins and reducing symptoms of anxiety and depression."'**
Thus, Option (a) is the right answer.

Passage 46 (Q.265–Q.269)

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions based on the passage:

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Passage (contd.)

Pride and Prejudice by Jane Austen is a classic known for its humor and complex characters. The famous first sentence of the book, "It is a truth universally acknowledged, that a single man in possession of a good fortune, must be in want of a wife," begins to set up all of the major themes of money, status, and marrying well that are prevalent in 19th-century England. The Bennet family, particularly Elizabeth Bennet, a smart and strong-willed heroine, is the subject of Austen's commentary on the societal imperative for women to marry well and thereby have a stable income.

The title itself is quite meaningful, as it first indicates the character flaws that drive much of the conflict in this novel, namely Darcy's pride and Elizabeth's prejudice. In fact, Mr. Fitzwilliam Darcy, being a rich and high-ranking person, first of all shows a haughty character, thereby being very superior by virtue of his class. Elizabeth, having been offended by his initial lack of warmth, as well as having been misled by the deceiving Mr. Wickham, very quickly showed prejudice against him.

Traces the story of each as they navigate these weaknesses. Darcy needs to lower his pride to appreciate the value of Elizabeth's inferior standing, though she must see the strength of his superior qualities.

Austen employs irony and satire liberally to point out the absurdities of the class structure. Personages like the obsequious Mr. Collins and the imperious Lady Catherine de Bourgh symbolize the hard and silly aspects of class consciousness. The sojourn at Darcy's grand estate, Pemberley, is an important defining instance in which the splendor of the property and the favorable reports of his servants compel Elizabeth to revise her earlier opinion and realize the truth of Darcy's goodness.

In the final analysis, the novel promotes love marriages, couples like Jane and Bingley, and Elizabeth and Darcy, who have successful marriages because of love, in contrast to couples who marry for convenience (Charlotte Collins and Mr. Collins) or those who are full of passion but irresponsible (Lydia and Wickham).

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Q.265 How is the character of Lady Catherine de Bourgh employed in the novel as a criticism of society?

(a) She represents social tyranny and class prejudice.
(b) She is purely comic relief and has no other significance.
(c) She symbolizes ideal maternal love and wisdom.
(d) She represents the struggle of the working class against the landed gentry.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) She represents social tyranny and class prejudice.

The deciding line.

"Austen employs **irony and satire** liberally to point out the **absurdities of the class structure**. Personages like the obsequious Mr. Collins and the **imperious Lady Catherine de Bourgh** symbolize the **hard and silly aspects of class consciousness**."

Read the clue word.

imperious = domineering, expecting others to obey *(रौबदार, हुक्म चलाने वाली)*.

Explanation (contd.)

An imperious aristocrat who stands for the "hard" side of class consciousness represents **social tyranny and class prejudice** *(सामाजिक तानाशाही और वर्गीय पूर्वाग्रह)*.

Why the others are wrong.

• **purely comic relief and has no other significance** = only there for laughs *(केवल हास्य के लिए, और कोई महत्व नहीं)* — she is funny, but the passage says she **symbolizes** something, so "no other significance" is false.

• **ideal maternal love and wisdom** = a perfect, caring mother figure *(आदर्श मातृ-प्रेम और विवेक)* — "imperious" is the opposite of tender.

• **struggle of the working class against the landed gentry** = workers fighting landowners *(ज़मींदार वर्ग के विरुद्ध श्रमिक वर्ग का संघर्ष)* — she is herself landed aristocracy; she enforces class, she does not fight it.

Word help.

satire = criticism through mockery *(व्यंग्य)*.

obsequious = too eager to please *(चापलूस)*.

Answer: **(1) She represents social tyranny and class prejudice.**

In RC, "purely ... no other significance" is an extreme option — it is almost always the trap.

Q.266 Which defects in character does the name "Pride and Prejudice" primarily refer to?

(a) Lydia's erratic behavior and Wickham's deceits
(b) Arrogance of Lady Catherine and Mr. Collins's servility
(c) Mr. Bennet's wit and Mrs. Bennet's fussiness
(d) Darcy's pride and Elizabeth's prejudice

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Darcy's pride and Elizabeth's prejudice

The deciding line.

"The title itself is quite meaningful, as it first indicates the **character flaws** that drive much of the conflict in this novel, namely **Darcy's pride and Elizabeth's prejudice**."

Read the two flaws.

Pride = Darcy's haughty sense of superiority because of his class *(अहंकार, घमंड)*.

Prejudice = Elizabeth's quick judgement against him, formed before knowing the truth *(पूर्वाग्रह)*.

Why the others are wrong.

• **Lydia's erratic behavior and Wickham's deceits** = Lydia's unstable conduct and Wickham's lies *(लिडिया का अस्थिर व्यवहार और विकहम का छल)* — real faults in the story, but the passage never ties them to the title.

• **Arrogance of Lady Catherine and Mr. Collins's servility** = her pride of rank and his crawling obedience *(लेडी कैथरीन का दंभ और मिस्टर कॉलिन्स की चाटुकारिता)* — the passage uses these two to satirise class, not to explain the title.

• **Mr. Bennet's wit and Mrs. Bennet's fussiness** = his humour and her nervous fuss *(मिस्टर बेनेट की हाज़िरजवाबी और मिसेज़ बेनेट की बात-बात पर घबराहट)* — not mentioned at all, and wit is not even a defect.

Word help.

haughty = arrogantly proud *(घमंडी)*.

by virtue of = because of *(के कारण)*.

Answer: **(4) Darcy's pride and Elizabeth's prejudice**

Pride belongs to Darcy, prejudice to Elizabeth — the title names the two leads, not the side characters.

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Q.267 What kind of marriage does Jane Austen appear to prize the most, according to the conclusion of the novel?

(a) Marriage contracts entered into by reason of romantic love alone
(b) Marriages for convenience and connections to family
(c) Marriages based solely on financial security
(d) Based on mutual respect, love, and understanding in marriage

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Based on mutual respect, love, and understanding in marriage

The deciding line.

"In the final analysis, the novel promotes love marriages ... who have successful marriages **because of love**, in contrast to couples who marry **for convenience** ... or those who are **full of passion but irresponsible** (Lydia and Wickham)."

Read the contrast.

Austen rejects two kinds of marriage: one with **no love** (convenience), and one with **love but no sense** (Lydia and Wickham).

What she prizes is love joined with judgement — Darcy lowering his pride and Elizabeth seeing his worth.

That is a marriage of **mutual respect, love and understanding** *(परस्पर सम्मान, प्रेम और आपसी समझ पर आधारित विवाह)*.

Why the others are wrong.

• **romantic love alone** = love without anything else *(केवल रोमानी प्रेम)* — passion alone is exactly what Lydia and Wickham had, and the passage calls them **irresponsible**.

• **for convenience and connections to family** = marrying for practical gain or family ties *(सुविधा और पारिवारिक संबंधों के लिए विवाह)* — this is Charlotte and Mr. Collins, the couple Austen sets **in contrast**.

• **based solely on financial security** = marrying only for money *(केवल आर्थिक सुरक्षा पर आधारित विवाह)* — the same "convenience" model; "solely" rules it out at once.

Word help.

in the final analysis = when everything is considered *(अंततः, कुल मिलाकर)*.

Answer: **(4) Based on mutual respect, love, and understanding in marriage**

"Love" in option (a) tempts, but "alone" describes Lydia, not Elizabeth.

Q.268 What are the major themes expressed by the first line of the novel?

(a) Education and morality
(b) Nature and the countryside
(c) Love & War
(d) Wealth, status, and marriage

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Wealth, status, and marriage

The deciding line.

The first sentence "begins to set up all of the major themes of **money, status, and marrying well**".

Match it to the options.

money = wealth

status = status

marrying well = marriage

So the themes are **wealth, status and marriage** *(धन, सामाजिक प्रतिष्ठा और विवाह)*.

Explanation (contd.)

Why the others are wrong.

• **Education and morality** = learning and right conduct *(शिक्षा और नैतिकता)* — neither idea appears in the line about the opening sentence.

• **Nature and the countryside** = landscape and rural life *(प्रकृति और ग्रामीण परिवेश)* — the passage says nothing about scenery.

• **Love & War** = romance and conflict *(प्रेम और युद्ध)* — there is no war here, and the opening line is about money and a wife, not romance.

Word help.

universally acknowledged = accepted by everyone *(सर्वमान्य)*.

societal imperative = a duty society forces on people *(सामाजिक अनिवार्यता)*.

Answer: **(4) Wealth, status, and marriage**

"A single man with a good fortune must want a wife" — money, rank and marriage packed into one sentence.

Q.269 What is the key event that marks a turning point in making Elizabeth change her view of Darcy?

(a) Rejection of Mr. Collins's Proposal
(b) Her visit to Pemberley and her reception of Darcy's letter
(c) Lydia's elopement with Wickham
(d) The Netherfield Ball

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Her visit to Pemberley and her reception of Darcy's letter

The deciding line.

"The sojourn at Darcy's grand estate, **Pemberley**, is an important **defining instance** in which the splendor of the property and the favorable reports of his servants compel Elizabeth to **revise her earlier opinion**."

Read the clue phrase.

defining instance = the moment that decides the direction of things — a **turning point** *(निर्णायक मोड़)*.

Only option (b) contains the **visit to Pemberley** *(पेम्बर्ली की यात्रा)*.

The letter in that option comes from the novel itself: Darcy's letter after his first proposal exposes Wickham's lies *(डार्सी का पत्र मिलना)* and begins the change the Pemberley visit completes.

Why the others are wrong.

• **Rejection of Mr. Collins's Proposal** = Elizabeth refusing Collins *(मिस्टर कॉलिन्स का विवाह-प्रस्ताव ठुकराना)* — it concerns Collins and changes nothing about Darcy.

• **Lydia's elopement with Wickham** = Lydia running away with Wickham *(लिडिया का विकहम के साथ भाग जाना)* — not in the passage; in the novel it comes after her view of Darcy has already softened.

• **The Netherfield Ball** = a dance party early in the story *(नेदरफ़ील्ड का नृत्य-समारोह)* — at that stage her dislike of Darcy is still growing.

Word help.

sojourn = a short stay *(अल्प-प्रवास)*.

splendor = grandness *(वैभव, भव्यता)*.

Answer: **(2) Her visit to Pemberley and her reception of Darcy's letter**

"Revise her earlier opinion" is the passage's own way of saying "turning point" — find that phrase and you find the event.

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Passage 47 (Q.270–Q.274)

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions based on the passage:

"Bank failures raise serious concerns about supervisory oversight." The case studies of Credit Suisse and Silicon Valley Bank highlight the deficiencies in supervisory supervision. In many instances, supervisors are hesitant to come into conflict with bank management when weaknesses are identified, preferring to do nothing rather than take corrective action at a point in time when key issues are building into a problem.

Regulators must adopt an attitude change in which they place more emphasis on the results rather than the details. Overemphasis on trivial matters might lead regulators to overlook more fundamental issues, such as whether financial institutions have adequate capital in case of a shock. Regulating requirements must be simplified. Complex regulation requirements in relation to capital may overlook systemic risk in their approaches when stress tests result in activities gravitating towards less heavily regulated institutions in the non-bank sector.

Improved supervisory and bank communications would promote better supervision as a tool for managing risk. Recommendations include being up front about supervisory goals, openness to change within the bank organization, and increased transparency in supervisory contracts as a way of promoting swift problem resolution. These would aid shareholders as well as the overall economy. In conclusion, rather than pursuing a micro-management strategy, a move towards a clearly defined regulation that supports positive incentives is what is needed to ensure that banks behave within frameworks that promote financial stability.

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Q.270 The tone with which the author approaches the current situation of "complex regulation" is best described as:

(a) Impressed by how much attention supervisors pay to tiny details.

(b) Uninterested in how these rules change where money is stored.

(c) Hopeful that it will eventually help find hidden money problems.

(d) Critical because complicated rules can actually cause more risk.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Critical because complicated rules can actually cause more risk.

The deciding lines.

"Regulating requirements **must be simplified**."

"Complex regulation requirements in relation to capital **may overlook systemic risk** ..."

Read the attitude.

"must be simplified" is a demand for change, and "overlook systemic risk" is a charge against complex rules.

So the author is **critical** *(आलोचनात्मक)*, because complicated rules can actually let risk grow *(जटिल नियम वास्तव में जोखिम बढ़ा सकते हैं)*.

Why the others are wrong.

Explanation (contd.)

• **Impressed by attention to tiny details** *(बारीकियों पर ध्यान से प्रभावित)* — the author calls it "**overemphasis on trivial matters**".

• **Uninterested in where money is stored** *(उदासीन)* — the author specifically worries that activity shifts to the non-bank sector.

• **Hopeful that it will help find hidden problems** *(आशावान)* — the author says it **overlooks** risk, not that it finds it.

Word help.

trivial = unimportant *(तुच्छ, मामूली)*.

overemphasis = too much stress on something *(अत्यधिक ज़ोर)*.

Answer: **(4) Critical because complicated rules can actually cause more risk.**

"Must be simplified" is a verdict — a neutral or hopeful tone cannot sit beside it.

Q.271 The use of "stress tests" by the author is an example of illustrating which of the following consequences?

(a) The enhanced clarity of communication between shareholders and bank managers.

(b) The failure of financial institutions to report their internal capital requirements accurately.

(c) The movement of risk-related financial activities into industries that are less heavily regulated.

(d) The direct relationship between complex regulatory obligations and long-term stability.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The movement of risk-related financial activities into industries that are less heavily regulated.

The deciding line.

"Complex regulation requirements in relation to capital may overlook systemic risk ... when **stress tests result in activities gravitating towards less heavily regulated institutions in the non-bank sector**."

Read the example.

stress test = a check of whether a bank can survive a severe shock *(संकट-परीक्षण)*.

gravitating towards = moving towards, being drawn to *(की ओर खिसकना)*.

So strict tests on banks push risky business out to lightly regulated non-banks — the **movement of risk-related activities into less heavily regulated industries** *(जोखिम-भरी वित्तीय गतिविधियों का कम विनियमित क्षेत्रों में चले जाना)*.

Why the others are wrong.

• **clarity of communication between shareholders and bank managers** *(शेयरधारकों और प्रबंधकों के बीच संवाद की स्पष्टता)* — communication is paragraph 3, between supervisors and banks, not linked to stress tests.

• **failure to report internal capital requirements accurately** *(पूँजी आवश्यकताओं की सही जानकारी न देना)* — misreporting is never mentioned.

• **direct relationship between complex obligations and long-term stability** *(जटिल नियमों और दीर्घकालिक स्थिरता का सीधा संबंध)* — the author says complex rules **overlook** risk, the opposite.

Word help.

systemic risk = risk to the whole financial system *(प्रणालीगत जोखिम)*.

non-bank sector = lenders that are not banks *(गैर-बैंकिंग क्षेत्र)*.

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Explanation (contd.)
Answer: **(3) The movement of risk-related financial activities into industries that are less heavily regulated.**
Squeeze risk in one place and it moves to another — it does not disappear.

Q.272 What would "positive incentives" do for the banking system?

(a) Help banks behave in a way that keeps the economy stable.
(b) Stop banks and regulators from talking to each other often.
(c) Make bank rules much more complicated and harder to follow.
(d) Bring back micro-management and focus on tiny details.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Help banks behave in a way that keeps the economy stable.
The deciding line.
"a clearly defined regulation that supports **positive incentives** is what is needed **to ensure that banks behave within frameworks that promote financial stability**."
Read the phrase.
incentive = a reward that encourages a certain behaviour *(प्रोत्साहन)*.
The same sentence states their purpose: to make banks **behave** in ways that **promote financial stability**.
So they help banks act in a way that keeps the economy stable *(बैंकों को ऐसा व्यवहार करने में मदद करना जिससे अर्थव्यवस्था स्थिर रहे)*.
Why the others are wrong.
• **Stop banks and regulators from talking often** *(बैंकों और नियामकों की आपसी बातचीत बंद करना)* — the author wants **improved** communication.
• **Make bank rules more complicated** *(नियमों को और जटिल बनाना)* — the author says rules "**must be simplified**".
• **Bring back micro-management** *(सूक्ष्म-प्रबंधन की वापसी)* — rejected in the same sentence: "**rather than** pursuing a micro-management strategy".
Word help.
framework = a basic structure of rules *(ढाँचा)*.
financial stability = a steady, crisis-free money system *(वित्तीय स्थिरता)*.
Answer: **(1) Help banks behave in a way that keeps the economy stable.**
The purpose clause "to ensure that ..." right after the phrase is the definition the question wants.

Q.273 Which of the following is most true in regard to stating the structure of logic found in the author's conclusion?

(a) It proposes that bank managers should be given more freedom in setting.
(b) It suggests a complete deregulation of the banking system to promote a competitive world economy.
(c) It suggests that the responsibility for assurance should lie with organizations rather than with outsiders.
(d) It urges a transition from procedural pedantry towards a results-oriented strategic framework.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) It urges a transition from procedural pedantry towards a results-oriented strategic framework.
The deciding lines.
"Regulators must adopt an attitude change in which they place more emphasis on the **results rather than the details**."
"In conclusion, **rather than pursuing a micro-management strategy**, a move towards a **clearly defined regulation** that supports positive incentives is what is needed".
Read the structure.
The conclusion moves **from** X **to** Y:
X = micro-management, obsession with details = **procedural pedantry** *(प्रक्रियात्मक बारीकियों में उलझे रहना)*
Y = clear rules judged by outcomes = a **results-oriented strategic framework** *(परिणाम-केंद्रित रणनीतिक ढाँचा)*
Option (d) states exactly this "from ... towards ..." shape.
Why the others are wrong.
• **bank managers should be given more freedom** *(बैंक प्रबंधकों को अधिक स्वतंत्रता)* — the author wants supervisors to **confront** bank management, not leave it free (the option is even left incomplete: "freedom in setting" what?).
• **complete deregulation** *(बैंकिंग व्यवस्था का पूर्ण विनियमन-मुक्त होना)* — the author asks for **clearly defined regulation**: simpler rules, not no rules.
• **responsibility for assurance should lie with organizations rather than outsiders** *(आश्वासन की ज़िम्मेदारी संस्थाओं पर, बाहरी निगरानीकर्ताओं पर नहीं)* — the whole passage is about outside supervisors doing their job better.
Word help.
oversight = supervision *(निगरानी)*.
micro-management = controlling every small detail *(हर छोटी बात पर नियंत्रण)*.
Answer: **(4) It urges a transition from procedural pedantry towards a results-oriented strategic framework.**
"Rather than X, a move towards Y" is a transition — the answer must name both ends.

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Q.274 Why are supervisors often slow to act when banks have problems?

(a) They are confused because modern bank rules are too simple.
(b) They do not have the legal power to stop a financial crash.
(c) They use a secret strategy to keep their contracts private.
(d) They prefer to avoid conflict instead of fixing risks early.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) They prefer to avoid conflict instead of fixing risks early.
The deciding line.
"supervisors are **hesitant to come into conflict with bank management** when weaknesses are identified, **preferring to do nothing** rather than take corrective action at a point in time when key issues are building into a problem."
Paraphrase it.
hesitant to come into conflict = they **avoid conflict** *(टकराव से बचते हैं)*.
rather than take corrective action early = instead of **fixing risks early** *(जोखिम को समय रहते ठीक करने के बजाय)*.
Option (d) is a near word-for-word paraphrase.
Why the others are wrong.
• **modern bank rules are too simple** *(बैंक नियम बहुत सरल हैं)* — the passage says the rules are too **complex**.
• **no legal power to stop a financial crash** *(वित्तीय संकट रोकने की कानूनी शक्ति नहीं)* — the passage blames hesitation, not lack of power.
• **a secret strategy to keep contracts private** *(अनुबंध गुप्त रखने की छिपी रणनीति)* — the passage only asks for **more transparency**; secrecy is not given as the cause.
Word help.
hesitant = unwilling, slow to act *(हिचकिचाने वाला)*.
corrective action = steps to put a fault right *(सुधारात्मक कदम)*.
Answer: **(4) They prefer to avoid conflict instead of fixing risks early.**
Detail questions: the answer is a paraphrase of one sentence — find that sentence before reading the options.

Passage 48 (Q.275–Q.279)

In the following question, some of the words in the passage have been left out. Read the passage carefully and choose the correct word for each blank, out of the four alternatives and fill in the blanks.

After falling consistently (1) _____ the U.S. dollar for a major part of the year, the rupee has (2) _____ somewhat over the last few weeks. It has risen by almost 5% from its lowest levels (3) _____ in October. Even with this recent improvement, the rupee is still down about 11% since the start of the year. The rupee's performance has been closely (4) _____ to global crude oil prices. This makes sense, as imported oil accounts for about 80% of India's total demand. The value of the rupee dropped when oil prices climbed earlier this year, a trend that lasted until early October. Since then, as global crude prices have fallen, the rupee has (5) _____ against the dollar.

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Q.275 What should come in blank (1) ?

(a) against **(b)** with
(c) of **(d)** for

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) against
Rule: one currency **rises** or **falls against** another — *against* = measured in comparison with *(के मुकाबले)*.
Example: *The yen fell **against** the euro this week.*
The deciding words.
"After falling consistently [blank] **the U.S. dollar**"
The passage itself confirms the pattern at the end: "the rupee has strengthened **against the dollar**".
Why the others are wrong.
• **with** = together with *(के साथ)* — "falling with the dollar" would mean both fell together.
• **of** = belonging to *(का)* — "falling of the dollar" makes no sense here.
• **for** = for the sake of *(के लिए)* — gives a purpose, not a comparison.
Word help.
consistently = steadily, without a break *(लगातार)*.
Answer: **(1) against**
Currencies always move "against" each other — fall against, rise against, strengthen against.

Q.276 What should come in blank (2) ?

(a) admire **(b)** energy
(c) recovered **(d)** ground

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) recovered
Rule: the present perfect is **has / have + past participle** — *She has **finished** the work.*
The deciding words.
"the rupee has [blank] somewhat over the last few weeks. It has **risen by almost 5%** from its lowest levels".
After falling, it rose again — it **regained lost value**.
recovered = came back to a better state after a fall *(उबरना, सुधार होना)*; it is a past participle, so it fits after "has".
Why the others are wrong.
• **admire** = to respect and like *(प्रशंसा करना)* — a base form cannot follow "has", and the sense is absurd.
• **energy** = power, strength *(ऊर्जा)* — a noun, not a verb.
• **ground** = land, or past participle of *grind* = to crush *(पीसना)* — "has ground" means "has crushed"; only "has **gained** ground" *(आगे बढ़ा)* would fit.
Word help.
somewhat = to some extent *(कुछ हद तक)*.
Answer: **(3) recovered**
"Ground" is the trap — the idiom is "gain ground", and the verb "gain" is missing.

Q.277 What should come in blank (3) ?

(a) behind **(b)** reached
(c) render **(d)** admire

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) reached
Rule: a past participle can follow a noun as a shortened relative clause — *the price **paid** last year* = the price (that was) paid last year.
The deciding words.

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Explanation (contd.)
"It has risen by almost 5% from its **lowest levels** [blank] **in October**."
= its lowest levels (which it) **reached** in October.
reached = arrived at *(पहुँचा)*.
Why the others are wrong.
• **behind** = at the back of *(पीछे)* — "levels behind in October" has no meaning.
• **render** = to give or make *(प्रदान करना, बनाना)* — a base form; even "rendered" would not fit the sense.
• **admire** = to respect and like *(प्रशंसा करना)* — base form, and levels cannot be admired here.
Answer: **(2) reached**
Levels, targets and lows are "reached" — the natural verb for a point on a graph.

Q.278 What should come in blank (4) ?

(a) tightly **(b)** amicably
(c) tied **(d)** morally

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) tied
Rule: after **has been + adverb**, the sentence needs a **participle or adjective** — *His fate has been closely **linked** to hers.*
The fixed collocation is **closely tied to** = closely connected with *(से गहराई से जुड़ा हुआ)*.
The deciding words.
"The rupee's performance has been closely [blank] **to global crude oil prices**. This makes sense, as **imported oil accounts for about 80%** of India's total demand."
The next sentence gives the reason for the link — so the blank means "connected".
Why the others are wrong.
• **tightly** = firmly *(कसकर)* — an adverb; "closely tightly" stacks two adverbs with no verb.
• **amicably** = in a friendly way *(मैत्रीपूर्ण ढंग से)* — an adverb, and friendship makes no sense for prices.
• **morally** = in terms of right and wrong *(नैतिक रूप से)* — an adverb, and morality is irrelevant.
Word help.
accounts for = makes up, forms *(का हिस्सा बनाता है)*.
Answer: **(3) tied**
Three adverbs and one participle — after "closely", only the participle can stand.

Q.279 What should come in blank (5) ?

(a) relating **(b)** strengthened
(c) tandem **(d)** culture

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) strengthened
Rule: the present perfect needs **has + past participle**, and the meaning must follow the cause given in the sentence.
The deciding words.
Earlier: "The value of the rupee **dropped when oil prices climbed**".
Now: "Since then, **as global crude prices have fallen**, the rupee has [blank] against the dollar."
Oil up → rupee down, so oil down → rupee **up**.
strengthened = became stronger *(मज़बूत हुआ)*.
Why the others are wrong.
• **relating** = connecting *(संबंधित करना)* — an -ing form; "has relating" is ungrammatical.

Explanation (contd.)
• **tandem** = one behind another; used in "**in tandem**" = together *(एक साथ मिलकर)* — a noun, not a verb.
• **culture** = the customs and arts of a people *(संस्कृति)* — a noun with no link to currency.
Word help.
trend = the general direction of change *(रुझान, प्रवृत्ति)*.
Answer: **(2) strengthened**
The passage states the oil–rupee link once; the last blank just runs it in reverse.

Passage 49 (Q.280–Q.284)

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions based on the passage:

The Viksit Bharat - Guarantee for Rozgar and Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) Act (VB-GRAM G), 2025, has been replaced by the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA). The goal of this modification is to improve Article 21 of the Indian Constitution, which protects the right to life. MGNREGA has improved socioeconomic conditions by facilitating wage payments, providing unemployment benefits, and promoting equal earnings. There has been sustainable development, and research has confirmed the impact of this program to raise earnings, alleviate poverty, and encourage school enrollment. In the past five years, women have comprised 58% of the workforce, significantly contributing to rural development, particularly during the COVID-19 pandemic. Given these factors, it is important to assess both the benefits and current challenges of the system.

Despite MGNREGA's successes, the program has faced implementation challenges, mainly due to inadequate funding, as acknowledged by the Ministry of Finance. Delays in wage payments and fewer work opportunities have resulted from this lack of funds. Recent rules, such as introducing an attendance application that uses photos, have created new problems and made corruption easier. Due to these issues, the VB-GRAM G Act has introduced important changes, including sections 5(1) and 4(5), which give the Union Government greater control over the public works program.

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Q.280 What might be the author's overall purpose for discussing the development from MGNREGA to the VB-GRAM G Act?

(a) Emphasize how institutional reforms try to maintain constitutionally provided rights while recognizing administrative weaknesses

(b) Argue that a decrease in the role of government can logically solve the inherent shortcomings in rural employment patterns

(c) Argue that a transition from a rights-based framework to an AI-based system is necessary to achieve efficient results for rural communities.

(d) Argue that technology-based interventions will necessarily increase the levels of transparency and accountability associated with public programs

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Emphasize how institutional reforms try to maintain constitutionally provided rights while recognizing administrative weaknesses

The deciding lines.

Paragraph 1: "The goal of this modification is to improve **Article 21** of the Indian Constitution, which protects the **right to life**."

Paragraph 2: "the program has faced **implementation challenges, mainly due to inadequate funding** ... **Due to these issues**, the VB-GRAM G Act has introduced important changes".

Join the two halves.

Half 1 — the reform protects a **constitutional right** *(संवैधानिक अधिकार)*.

Half 2 — the author openly lists **administrative weaknesses** *(प्रशासनिक कमज़ोरियाँ)*: fund shortage, wage delays, corruption.

Option (a) says exactly this: reforms try to keep constitutional rights while admitting administrative weakness *(संस्थागत सुधार संवैधानिक अधिकार बनाए रखने का प्रयास करते हैं और प्रशासनिक कमियाँ भी स्वीकार करते हैं)*.

Why the others are wrong.

• **a decrease in the role of government** *(सरकार की भूमिका घटाना)* — the opposite: the new Act gives the Union Government **greater control**.

• **from a rights-based framework to an AI-based system** *(अधिकार-आधारित ढाँचे से AI-आधारित व्यवस्था की ओर)* — AI is never mentioned, and the Article 21 link keeps it rights-based.

• **technology will necessarily increase transparency** *(तकनीक से पारदर्शिता अनिवार्य रूप से बढ़ेगी)* — the passage says the photo app **made corruption easier**.

Word help.

alleviate = to reduce, ease *(कम करना)*.

Article 21 = right to life and personal liberty *(जीवन और व्यक्तिगत स्वतंत्रता का अधिकार)*.

Note on the passage: its first sentence is worded backwards — in fact the **VB-G RAM G Act, 2025 replaced MGNREGA**; no question in this set depends on that.

Answer: **(1) Emphasize how institutional reforms try to maintain constitutionally provided rights while recognizing administrative weaknesses**

A purpose question wants both paragraphs — the right option carries the "benefit" and the "weakness" together.

Q.281 The author's tone regarding new rules (e.g., photo-based attendance) is best described as?

(a) Cautiously critical, admitting the benefits of innovation while pointing out the dangers of abuse in bureaucracies

(b) Detachedly descriptive, outlining reforms to procedures without evaluative judgments.

(c) Digital interventions will resolve longstanding governance issues.

(d) It is a direct rejection that states tech solutions do not work in rural welfare activities because the officials are illiterate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Cautiously critical, admitting the benefits of innovation while pointing out the dangers of abuse in bureaucracies

The deciding line.

"Recent rules, such as introducing an attendance application that uses photos, have **created new problems** and **made corruption easier**."

Read the judging words.

"created new problems", "made corruption easier" — the author is clearly **critical** *(आलोचनात्मक)*.

But the criticism is limited to these particular rules; there is no blanket attack on technology or on officials.

Measured criticism of a specific step = **cautiously critical** *(सावधानीपूर्वक आलोचनात्मक)*, pointing out the danger of abuse *(दुरुपयोग का ख़तरा)*.

Why the others are wrong.

• **Detachedly descriptive, without evaluative judgments** *(तटस्थ वर्णनात्मक, बिना किसी मूल्यांकन के)* — "made corruption easier" is itself a judgement.

• **Digital interventions will resolve longstanding governance issues** *(डिजिटल उपाय पुरानी शासन-समस्याएँ हल कर देंगे)* — this is not even a tone, and it is the reverse of what the author says.

• **a direct rejection ... because the officials are illiterate** *(अधिकारियों की निरक्षरता के कारण सीधा अस्वीकार)* — literacy is never mentioned, and "do not work" is far stronger than the passage.

Word help.

implementation = putting a plan into action *(कार्यान्वयन)*.

tone = the author's attitude to the subject *(लहजा, दृष्टिकोण)*.

Answer: **(1) Cautiously critical, admitting the benefits of innovation while pointing out the dangers of abuse in bureaucracies**

Tone questions: find the judging words first, then pick the option of the same strength — not stronger, not weaker.

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Q.282 What does the author's discussion of lack of funding primarily indicate?

(a) Local administrations limit opportunities so as to have control over the release of finances.
(b) Administrative inefficiencies and implementation challenges due to a shortage of funding.
(c) Resource allocation practices are highly effective but seem problematic due to certain short-term fiscal fluctuations
(d) Decentralized authority has caused divergent effects that will certainly lead to a reduction in job guarantees.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Administrative inefficiencies and implementation challenges due to a shortage of funding.

The deciding lines.

"the program has faced **implementation challenges, mainly due to inadequate funding**, as acknowledged by the Ministry of Finance."

"**Delays in wage payments and fewer work opportunities** have resulted from this lack of funds."

Read what the funding point shows.

Shortage of money → delays and fewer jobs → the scheme is run less efficiently.

That is **administrative inefficiency and implementation challenges due to a shortage of funding** *(धन की कमी से उत्पन्न प्रशासनिक अक्षमता और कार्यान्वयन की चुनौतियाँ)*.

Why the others are wrong.

• **Local administrations limit opportunities to control finances** *(स्थानीय प्रशासन वित्त पर नियंत्रण के लिए जानबूझकर अवसर घटाते हैं)* — no motive is given; the shortfall is admitted by the **Ministry of Finance**.

• **Resource allocation practices are highly effective** *(संसाधन-आवंटन अत्यंत प्रभावी है)* — the passage calls funding **inadequate**.

• **Decentralized authority ... will certainly reduce job guarantees** *(विकेंद्रीकृत अधिकार से रोज़गार गारंटी निश्चित रूप से घटेगी)* — the passage speaks of **more central** control, and "certainly" is too strong.

Word help.

inadequate = not enough *(अपर्याप्त)*.

acknowledged = admitted as true *(स्वीकार किया)*.

Answer: **(2) Administrative inefficiencies and implementation challenges due to a shortage of funding.**

The right option here reuses the passage's own nouns — "implementation challenges", "funding".

Q.283 What does "sustainable development" mean most nearly in the context of the passage?

(a) Discusses advancements that are characterized by fast infrastructure development without consideration of administrative viability.
(b) Outcomes that emphasize the creation of jobs in the short term, even if there are uncertain long-term consequences for individual welfare
(c) Strategies that place emphasis mainly on technological diffusion as a principal means of rural transformation
(d) Improvements relating to long-term socioeconomic benefits for rural households via stable program design

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Improvements relating to long-term socioeconomic benefits for rural households via stable program design

The deciding line.

"MGNREGA has improved **socioeconomic conditions** ... There has been **sustainable development**, and research has confirmed the impact of this program to **raise earnings, alleviate poverty, and encourage school enrollment**."

Read the phrase in its sentence.

sustainable = able to last over the long term *(दीर्घकालिक, टिकाऊ)*.

The examples that follow — higher earnings, less poverty, more schooling — are **long-term socioeconomic benefits for rural households**.

So the phrase means improvements that last, produced by a stable programme *(स्थिर कार्यक्रम-संरचना से ग्रामीण परिवारों को मिलने वाले दीर्घकालिक सामाजिक-आर्थिक लाभ)*.

Why the others are wrong.

• **fast infrastructure development without consideration of administrative viability** *(व्यवहार्यता की परवाह किए बिना तेज़ बुनियादी ढाँचा विकास)* — "without consideration" is the opposite of sustainable.

• **creation of jobs in the short term, with uncertain long-term consequences** *(अल्पकालिक रोज़गार, दीर्घकालिक परिणाम अनिश्चित)* — "short term" contradicts "sustainable".

• **technological diffusion as a principal means** *(तकनीक के प्रसार को मुख्य साधन मानना)* — the passage's examples are earnings, poverty and schooling, not technology.

Word help.

socioeconomic = relating to both society and money *(सामाजिक-आर्थिक)*.

enrollment = registering as a student *(नामांकन)*.

Answer: **(4) Improvements relating to long-term socioeconomic benefits for rural households via stable program design**

"Sustainable" always carries "long-term" — any option built on "short-term" or "fast" is out.

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Q.284 What can be reasonably inferred about the relationship between women's participation and rural resilience during the pandemic?

(a) Their significant involvement contributed to the continuation of the community through the maintenance of the local economy in spite of the general economic disruptions that were happening.

(b) The fact that they were active seemingly led to the acceleration of the community's fiscal problems because it resulted in program expenditure being amplified during a time of uncertainty.

(c) Their involvement could have led to a decrease in total program productivity owing to the fact that the local populace was heavily burdened with expanded caregiving during the pandemic.

(d) Their intensified appearance might have worsened the existing support structures that were failing in the health crisis.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Their significant involvement contributed to the continuation of the community through the maintenance of the local economy in spite of the general economic disruptions that were happening.

The deciding line.

"In the past five years, women have comprised **58%** of the workforce, **significantly contributing to rural development, particularly during the COVID-19 pandemic**."

Draw the inference.

More than half the workers were women, and their work **contributed** most when the pandemic disrupted everything else.

So their participation helped the village economy keep running despite the shock — that is rural **resilience** *(संकट से उबरने की क्षमता)*.

Option (a) *(उनकी बड़ी भागीदारी ने व्यापक आर्थिक व्यवधान के बावजूद स्थानीय अर्थव्यवस्था को चलाए रखा)* is the only one in the passage's direction.

Why the others are wrong.

• **accelerated the community's fiscal problems** *(समुदाय की वित्तीय समस्याएँ और तेज़ कीं)* — the passage calls it a contribution, not a burden.

• **decrease in productivity owing to caregiving** *(देखभाल के बोझ के कारण उत्पादकता में कमी)* — caregiving is never mentioned.

• **worsened the existing support structures** *(पहले से कमज़ोर सहायता-तंत्र को और बिगाड़ा)* — the opposite of "contributing to rural development".

Word help.

workforce = all the people working *(कार्यबल)*.

comprised = made up *(बनाया, गठित किया)*.

Answer: **(1) Their significant involvement contributed to the continuation of the community through the maintenance of the local economy in spite of the general economic disruptions that were happening.**

A valid inference stays on the passage's side — "contributing" can never become "worsened".

Passage 50 (Q.285–Q.288)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Passage (contd.)

China and India together will account for more than a third of the estimated global population, which is expected to hit 8.045 billion by mid-year, according to the United Nations Population Fund's (UNFPA) 'State of World Population Report' for 2023. But, contrary to public perception, population growth has been slowing in both countries – particularly in China, which recorded a population decline for the first time in six decades last year.

China's population fell in 2022 to 1.411 billion, down some 850,000 people from the previous year, according to China's National Bureau of Statistics (NBS). The birth rate also fell to a record low of 6.77 births per 1,000 people, down from 7.52 a year earlier and the lowest level since the founding of Communist China in 1949.

Along with the flagging population data, China also reported one of its worst economic growth numbers in nearly half a century last year, underscoring the steep challenges the country faces as its labor force shrinks and the ranks of the retired swell.

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Q.285 India's working-age population stands at more than 900 million, according to 2021 data from the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development. This number is expected to hit more than 1 billion over the next decade, according to the Indian government. But these numbers could become a liability if policymakers do not create enough jobs, experts warned.

Identify whether the given statements are true or false.

A. India's working-age population was 900 million in 2021.

B. In the next ten years, India's working-age population will be more than 1 billion.

(a) A is false and B is true

(b) A is true and B is false

(c) Neither A nor B is true

(d) Both A and B are true

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Both A and B are true

option (d) is the correct answer. Both the statements are correct.

In the above paragraph, it is mentioned that: India's working-age population stands at more than 900 million, according to 2021 data from the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development. This number is expected to hit more than 1 billion over the next decade, according to the Indian government.

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Q.286 **India's working-age population stands at more than 900 million, according to 2021 data from the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development. This number is expected to hit more than 1 billion over the next decade, according to the Indian government. But these numbers could become a liability if policymakers do not create enough jobs, experts warned.**
'Along with the flagging population data.' Here, 'flagging' means all of the following EXCEPT:

(a) Ascending **(b)** Waning
(c) Contracting **(d)** Dwindling

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Ascending
option (a) is the correct answer.
Flagging: to become tired or less strong.
Ascending: increasing in size or value.
Contract: to become or to make something smaller or shorter.
Dwindling: to become smaller or weaker.
Hence, the correct antonym of the of the given word 'flagging' is 'Ascending'.

Q.287 **India's working-age population stands at more than 900 million, according to 2021 data from the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development. This number is expected to hit more than 1 billion over the next decade, according to the Indian government. But these numbers could become a liability if policymakers do not create enough jobs, experts warned.**
What is the estimated world population by the middle of this year?

(a) 1.411 billion **(b)** 8.045 billion
(c) 1.256 billion **(d)** 900 million

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) 8.045 billion
The correct answer is 8.045 billion.
In the given passage, in the starting of the first paragraph it is mentioned that China and India together will account for more than a third of the estimated global population, which is expected to hit 8.045 billion by mid-year, according to the United Nations Population Fund's (UNFPA) 'State of World Population Report' for 2023.

Q.288 **India's working-age population stands at more than 900 million, according to 2021 data from the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development. This number is expected to hit more than 1 billion over the next decade, according to the Indian government. But these numbers could become a liability if policymakers do not create enough jobs, experts warned.**
The main theme of the given passage is:

(a) Show population growth in India and China
(b) China's declining population
(c) India's working-age population
(d) China's worsening economic growth

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) China's declining population
option (b) is the correct answer.
The whole passage is related to the decline in population.
Thus, the most suitable title for the given passage is – "China's declining population."

Passage 51 (Q.289–Q.292)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

King Sagara, an ancestor of King Bhagiratha, once conducted an ashwamedha yagna to extend his dominion. When the horse went astray, the king sent his 60,000 sons to find the horse. Unfortunately, in the course of the quest, they ended up disrupting the intense meditation of sage Kapila, at whose abode they found the horse. Kapila burnt them all to ashes, sending them all to the netherworld—an act he instantly regretted when he realised what had happened. After breaking the news to King Sagara, he mentioned that the souls of King Sagara's sons could attain salvation only if the heavenly Ganga could be persuaded to flow over their ashes.

It was Bhagiratha, whose austere penance and devotion pleased Lord Shiva so much so that he persuaded Ganga to descend to the earth. Ganga consented, but the problem arose that the earth would probably be unable to bear the intensity of Ganga's flow and even be shattered in the process. Thus, a solution was devised: Ganga would first land on Shiva's head and the locks of his hair would minimise the impact. Still, the force of Ganga's landing was such that it split into seven tributaries, three of which flowed east and three of them west. The seventh stream followed King Bhagiratha to the place where his ancestor's ashes lay. The river's waters instantly purified them. This is also the origin of the belief that the Ganga's waters can purify mortal souls of all their sins.

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Q.289 The above story is mainly about:

(a) the ashwamedha yagna by King Sagara
(b) the sage Kapila's anger for King Sagara's sons
(c) Lord Shiva holding the Ganga in his locks
(d) the coming of the river Ganga to the earth

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the coming of the river Ganga to the earth
option (d) is the correct answer.
The whole passage is about Ganga River and how it came to the earth.
Hence the most suitable title for the given passage is- **"the coming of the river Ganga to the earth".**

Q.290 Identify the option that arranges the given events in the correct sequence of their occurence.
A. King Sagara's sons were burnt by sage Kapila.
B. King Bhagiratha persuaded Ganga to flow to the earth.
C. King Sagara performed an ashwamedha yagna.
D. The souls of the dead sons would not get salvation until Ganga flowed over their ashes.
E. However, the flow had to be restrained by Shiva by holding it in his locks.

(a) CADBE **(b)** ADCBE
(c) CAEDB **(d)** ACEBD

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) CADBE
option (a) is the correct answer.
The passage start with the Ashwamedha Yagna performed by King 'Sagara'.
And with the help of the above passage the correct arrangement of the given jumbled sentences is-:
King Sagara performed an ashwamedha yagna. King Sagara's sons were burnt by sage Kapila. The souls of the dead sons would not get salvation until Ganga flowed over their ashes. King Bhagiratha persuaded Ganga to flow to the earth. However, the flow had to be restrained by Shiva by holding it in his locks.

Q.291 'It was Bhagiratha, whose austere penance....' The word 'austere' here means:

(a) Rustic **(b)** Bare
(c) Severe **(d)** Subdued

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Severe
option (c) is the correct answer.
Austere: very strict and serious/ something or someone stern or without any decoration.
Severe: very harsh or strict, especially when dealing with others.
Bare: lacking its natural or customary covering.
Subdued: restrained in style or quality/ in a softened tone.
Thus, the correct synonym of the given word 'Austere' is 'Severe'.

Q.292 This story is a:

(a) Historical story **(b)** Mythological story
(c) True story **(d)** Fable

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Mythological story
option (b) is the correct answer.
This story is a mythological story.
Mythological: based on or told of in traditional stories; lacking factual basis or historical validity.
Historical: belonging to the past; of what is important or famous in the past.
Fable: a short story that teaches a lesson (a moral) and that often has animals as the main characters.

Passage 52 (Q.293–Q.296)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

In 1888, an Atlantic contributor made the case for a "science of names."

"Parents are strangely careless and unscientific in giving names to children," the contributor complained. "They forget that not only from the social point of view it is very advantageous to have one's name remembered, but that from the business point of view notoriety is capital, and must be obtained by persistent and ingenious advertising." Indeed, the contributor argued, a good name will give a child "a start in life equivalent to a cash capital of at least fifteen thousand dollars." One way to ensure this head start? "Be guided by euphonic quality only."

Although not all of this contributor's guidance can or should still apply today, the importance of a name to a child's identity has stayed front of mind for many parents. A name can determine whether a child fits in or stands out—and many parents differ on which of those outcomes is preferable.

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Q.293 What is the tone of the speaker in the passage?

(a) Humorous **(b)** Sarcastic
(c) Persuasive **(d)** Melancholic

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Persuasive
The tone of the speaker in the passage is **Persuasive.**
While the tone is persuasive, it's important to note that it doesn't necessarily mean the speaker is forcefully imposing a viewpoint. Instead, the speaker seeks to influence the audience's perception by presenting a compelling argument and providing reasons to support the suggested perspective.

Q.294 Select the most appropriate word in the passage which means 'pleasing and sweet sound'.

(a) Identity **(b)** Advantageous
(c) Outcomes **(d)** Euphonic

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Euphonic
The most appropriate word in the passage which means 'pleasing and sweet sound' is **Euphonic.**

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Explanation (contd.)

1. **Identity**: The characteristics, qualities, or features that make a person or thing recognizable. It refers to who or what someone is.
2. **Advantageous**: Providing an advantage or benefit; favorable or beneficial in a particular situation.
3. **Outcomes**: The results or effects of a particular action, process, or situation. It refers to what happens as a consequence.
4. **Euphonic**: Relating to or characterized by euphony; having a pleasing or sweet sound, especially in the arrangement of sounds.

In the context of the passage, the word that means 'pleasing and sweet sound' is **Euphonic.** The contributor advises parents to be guided by euphonic quality when choosing names for their children.

Q.295 According to the contributor, the parents are strangely careless and unscientific in giving names to children because _____.

(a) they do it without considering the business point of view
(b) they do it without discussing it with their relatives and friends
(c) they do it without considering the actual meaning of the name
(d) they do it without considering the latter's interest in it

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) they do it without considering the business point of view

According to the contributor, the parents are strangely careless and unscientific in giving names to children because **they do it without considering the business point of view.**

In summary, the contributor criticizes parents for being careless and unscientific in naming their children because they do it without adequately considering the potential business advantages associated with having a memorable and well-known name.

Q.296 What will be given to a child if he gets a good name?

(a) A good bank balance
(b) A perfect address
(c) A professional attitude
(d) A headstart in life

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A headstart in life

According to the contributor in the passage, if a child gets a good name, he will be given **a headstart in life.**

In summary, the passage suggests that a good name is likened to a valuable asset, providing a headstart in life equivalent to a substantial cash capital. The emphasis is on the recognition, notoriety, and positive associations that a well-chosen name can bring, contributing to the child's overall success and standing in society.

Passage 53 (Q.297–Q.300)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Passage (contd.)

Leadership does not exist without followership. A leader has to be accepted by the group which the former is supposed to lead. To gain acceptability, the leader should cause an emotive impact on the group members. The strength of character exhibited by leaders makes them dear to their followers. A leader is one who effectively inspires followers to achieve worthwhile things. What character of the leader motivates the followers? It is not pomp and show, neither flattery nor sanctioning more incentives. Pomp and show creates a sense of awe and the leader is deified rather as emulated. Flattery is unrealistic and cannot serve as a long-term motivational tool. A leader's style should be one that can be emulated by all irrespective of cadre, class and calibre. Simplicity in one's day- to- day conduct is the only thing that can be adopted by all.

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Q.297 Which of the following desired qualities of a leader is mentioned in the passage?

(a) Simplicity **(b)** Deified
(c) Pomp and show **(d)** Flattery

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Simplicity

The desired quality of a leader mentioned in the passage is **Simplicity.**

The passage emphasizes that a leader's style should be one of simplicity in day-to-day conduct, and this is the quality that can be adopted by all.

Q.298 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Emulate

(a) Relax **(b)** Imitate
(c) Suppose **(d)** Exhibit

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Imitate

The most appropriate synonym for the given word "Emulate" is **Imitate.**

1. **Relax**: This word means to become less tense or to loosen up. It does not convey the idea of trying to match or surpass someone's achievements, which is the essence of "emulate."
2. **Imitate**: This word is the correct synonym for "emulate." It means to copy or mimic someone's behavior, actions, or achievements with the intention of equaling or surpassing them. In the context of leadership mentioned in the passage, a leader's style should be emulated by followers.
3. **Suppose**: This word means to assume or consider something to be true without sufficient evidence. It does not convey the idea of imitating or replicating someone's behavior or achievements.
4. **Exhibit**: This word means to display or show something. While it is related to presenting, it doesn't capture the specific idea of imitating or following someone's example, as "emulate" does.

In the context of the passage, the character of a leader that motivates followers is discussed, and the word "emulate" implies followers imitating the leader's style. Therefore, the most appropriate synonym is **Imitate.**

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Q.299 Select the best summary of the passage?

(a) A leader effectively inspires and guides his followers to achieve desired goals.
(b) A leader's style cannot serve as a long-term motivation among the group.
(c) Motivation is the innate quality that enables an individual to be intellectually strong.
(d) Administrative knowledge is essential for the followers to get success.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A leader effectively inspires and guides his followers to achieve desired goals.
The best summary of the passage is: **A leader effectively inspires and guides his followers to achieve desired goals.**
"A leader effectively inspires and guides his followers to achieve desired goals," accurately captures the essence of the passage. It emphasizes the importance of effective leadership, the role of inspiration, and the qualities that motivate followers, aligning with the key themes presented in the passage.

Q.300 According to the passage, why should the leader generate an emotive impact?

(a) To exhibit the character of his followers
(b) To mould the character of a leader
(c) To gain acceptance by the members of the group
(d) To acquire social knowledge

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) To gain acceptance by the members of the group
According to the passage, the leader should generate an emotive impact **to gain acceptance by the members of the group.**
In summary, the reason the leader should generate an emotive impact is to create a positive emotional connection with the group members, fostering acceptance and making the leader more effective in inspiring and leading the group. The key goal is to gain acceptability among the members of the group.

Passage 54 (Q.301–Q.304)
Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Environmental or genetic influences antisocial conduct of a human being , which has an impact on behaviour, such as conduct disorder. In a recent study conducted, young people with conduct disorders had their brains examined, along with controls that were healthy and did not have the disease. The thickness of various regions of the cortex and the brain's outer layer was measured using the scanned images. It was demonstrated in the study that conduct disorder is a psychiatric condition rather than adolescent disobedience. Awareness, perception, attention, memory and language are all impacted by the cortex.

Passage (contd.)
The findings of the study were unexpected. They demonstrated distinct disparities between adolescents whose behavioural issues began in adolescence and those whose issues began earlier in life. Although both groups were different from healthy controls, it was discovered that distinct regions of the cortex in the teenagers who had experienced early-onset behavioural issues were thicker in comparison to the healthy participants.

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Q.301 Which of the following is NOT impacted by the cortex?

(a) Memory and perception
(b) Attention and disobedience
(c) Language and awareness
(d) Memory and attention

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Attention and disobedience
The cognitive functions that are **NOT** impacted by the cortex, as mentioned in the passage, are: **Attention and disobedience**
In summary, based on the passage, the cognitive functions impacted by the cortex are awareness, perception, memory, and language. "Attention and disobedience" are not explicitly mentioned as functions impacted by the cortex. Therefore, "Attention and disobedience" is the correct answer to the question "Which of the following is NOT impacted by the cortex?"

Q.302 Based on your reading of the passage, select the most appropriate option that describes the conclusion of the study.

(a) Distinct regions of the cortex were thicker in the teenagers having early-onset behavioural issues in comparison to the healthy participants.
(b) There were no distinct regions in the cortex of participants having early behavioural issues in comparison to healthy students.
(c) There were participants having early behavioural issues in comparison to healthy students who had distinct regions in their cortex.
(d) There were distinct regions in the cortex of healthy students in comparison to participants having early behavioural issues.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Distinct regions of the cortex were thicker in the teenagers having early-onset behavioural issues in comparison to the healthy participants.
The most appropriate option that describes the conclusion of the study is:
Distinct regions of the cortex were thicker in the teenagers having early-onset behavioural issues in comparison to the healthy participants.
1. The study compared young people with conduct disorders (behavioral issues) to healthy controls.
2. The thickness of various regions of the cortex was measured using scanned images.

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Explanation (contd.)

1. The conclusion indicates that, in the group of teenagers who had early-onset behavioral issues, certain regions of the cortex were thicker compared to the healthy participants.
2. This suggests a distinct difference in the brain structure between individuals with early-onset behavioral issues and healthy individuals.

In summary, the conclusion highlights a specific finding about the cortex's thickness, indicating a potential neurological distinction between individuals with early-onset behavioral issues and those without such issues.

Q.303 Select the most appropriate summary of the sentence given below.
It was demonstrated in the study that conduct disorder is a psychiatric condition rather than adolescent disobedience.

(a) Conduct disorder is less of a mental condition and more of teen defiance.
(b) Conduct disorder is teen defiance and not a mental condition.
(c) Conduct disorder is neither a mental condition nor teen defiance.
(d) Conduct disorder is a mental condition rather than teen defiance.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Conduct disorder is a mental condition rather than teen defiance.
The most appropriate summary of the given sentence is: **Conduct disorder is a mental condition rather than teen defiance.**
The study demonstrated that conduct disorder is a psychiatric condition, distinguishing it from adolescent disobedience. Therefore, the correct summary is: **"Conduct disorder is a mental condition rather than teen defiance."**

Q.304 Which of the following was measured in scanned images?

(a) Brain's outer layer **(b)** Behavioural issues
(c) Cortex disparities **(d)** Psychiatric condition

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Brain's outer layer
The component that was measured in scanned images, as mentioned in the passage, is: **Brain's outer layer**
the passage describes a study where brain imaging was used to measure the thickness of various regions of both the cortex and the brain's outer layer. The brain's outer layer refers to the cortex, and this measurement was conducted using scanned images.

Passage 55 (Q.305–Q.308)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Passage (contd.)

Taekwondo is a form of empty hand martial arts combat that requires the athlete to use all parts of the body in competition. Taekwondo is a self-defence discipline; the name is derived from the Korean words 'tae', meaning kick, 'kwon', a punch or other blow with the hand or fist, and 'do', which is a way or method of operation. Among the general public, taekwondo is distinguished from other martial arts by its high speed, sweeping kicks and emphatic punches. As with judo, taekwondo was developed as a sport that is also representative of a moral code, where principles of loyalty, faithfulness, respect, and the preservation of an indomitable spirit form a significant part of taekwondo training. Beginning in 1945, shortly after the end of World War II and Japanese Occupation, new martial arts schools called kwans opened in Seoul. These schools were established by Korean martial artists with backgrounds in Japanese and Chinese martial arts. At the time, indigenous disciplines (such as Taekkyeon) were being forgotten, due to years of decline and repression by the Japanese colonial government. The umbrella term traditional Taekwondo typically refers to the martial arts practiced by the kwans during the 1940s and 1950s, though in reality the term 'Taekwondo' had not yet been coined at that time, and indeed each kwan (school) was practicing its own unique style of the Korean art.

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Q.305 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word.
Indomitable

(a) Submissive **(b)** Invincible
(c) Strong **(d)** Unstoppable

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Submissive
The most appropriate antonym (opposite) of the given word "Indomitable" is: **Submissive**

1. **Submissive:**
   - This term refers to someone who is obedient, compliant, or easily yielding to authority or control. A submissive person tends to accept or yield to the will of others.
2. **Invincible:**
   - This term refers to someone or something that is incapable of being defeated or conquered. It implies unbeatability and strength.
3. **Strong:**
   - This term refers to someone or something having the power to perform physically demanding tasks or to withstand force or pressure.
4. **Unstoppable:**
   - This term refers to someone or something that cannot be stopped or hindered. It implies continuous, relentless progress or success.

- The word "Indomitable" means not easily subdued or defeated, showing resistance, determination, and unbeatability.
- The opposite of "Indomitable" would be someone who is easily subdued, yielding, or compliant, which aligns with the meaning of "Submissive."

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Q.306 Which of the following is NOT a principle of Taekwondo?

(a) Loyalty **(b)** Disrespect
(c) Indomitable spirit **(d)** Faithfulness

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Disrespect

The principle that is NOT associated with Taekwondo is: **Disrespect**

In the passage, it is mentioned that Taekwondo is developed as a sport that is representative of a moral code. The principles of Taekwondo training include:

1. **Loyalty:** This is a fundamental principle in Taekwondo, emphasizing allegiance and faithfulness to the discipline, one's instructor, and fellow practitioners.
2. **Indomitable spirit:** This principle reflects the unyielding and unconquerable nature of the spirit. It encourages practitioners to be resilient, determined, and not easily subdued or defeated.
3. **Faithfulness:** This refers to the quality of being loyal, steadfast, and true. It is about maintaining commitment and faith in the practice of Taekwondo.

The concept of "Disrespect" is not aligned with the principles of Taekwondo. Taekwondo emphasizes respect for oneself, instructors, fellow practitioners, and the discipline as a whole. Disrespect would go against the core values of Taekwondo, which promote positive and respectful behavior within the martial arts community.

Therefore, "Disrespect" is the principle that is NOT associated with Taekwondo.

Q.307 What is Taekwondo a form of?

(a) Conceptual arts **(b)** Visual arts
(c) Martial arts **(d)** Performing arts

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Martial arts

Taekwondo is a form of: **Martial arts**

Q.308 Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word.
Representative

(a) Aberrant **(b)** Unusual
(c) Theoretical **(d)** Typical

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Typical

The most appropriate synonym for the given word "Representative" is: **Typical**

"Typical" is the most appropriate synonym for the word "Representative" in the context:

1. **Aberrant:**
   - This term refers to something that is deviating from the normal or typical standard. It implies an anomaly or an abnormal occurrence.
2. **Unusual:**
   - This term means not commonly occurring, different from what is customary, or out of the ordinary.
3. **Theoretical:**
   - This term relates to concepts or ideas based on theory rather than practical application. It is associated with hypotheses and speculation.
4. **Typical:**
   - This term refers to something that is characteristic, usual, or representing the norm. It suggests conformity to a standard or model.

Passage 56 (Q.309–Q.312)

Read the given passage and answer the question that follows.

As a result of increasing population and expansion of residential areas, forest lands are being encroached. This is not all; even the wildlife is under extreme threat. As our fauna is facing a dearth of adequate shelter in forests, they are heading towards towns and hence get killed by hunters. Consequently, many animal species have either become extinct or are on the verge of extinction. The Black Buck is almost endangered and found only in two countries, Nepal and India. In India, this antelope is found in many national parks like Guindy National Park, Point Calimere and Vellandu sanctuaries of Tamil Nadu, Rollapadu of Andra Pradesh, few parts of Rajasthan and Haryana. As far as their habitat is concerned, they live in open grasslands, dry areas or thinly populated areas and near water resources. They live in the desert areas of Rajasthan and coastal areas because they cannot sustain cold climate. They are the fastest running animals on this planet. Further, this animal is active during the day, but slows down in its activities after mid-day. They are social beings. Hence, they move with their herds, which can vary from 3 to 23 mates. They cohabit twice in a year and give birth twice in a year.

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Q.309 Prior to independence, this antelope was extensively hunted which affected their population so much that this species has reached the stage of extinction in many parts of the country. Poachers kill them mainly for material gain. Its skin has an enormous value in the market. In order to protect this species, the IUCN has declared this species nearly threatened. Hence, under Schedule I of the Wildlife Protection Act of 1972, numerous stern measures have been taken. To specify a few, Kaimur Wildlife Sanctuary (Bihar), Gir Forest National Park, Velavadar Wildlife Sanctuary (Gujarat), National Chambal Sanctuary, etc. Despite these acts, hunting is adversely affecting our wildlife. There are some solutions to this problem but the best one is to boycott the products made from endangered species at an international level. This seems to be effective but will it prevent animal hunting? That's a question. What is the author's tone in this passage?

(a) Impressed **(b)** Concerned
(c) Agitated **(d)** Revengeful

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Concerned

The author is expressing concern over the threat to wildlife, particularly the Black Buck, and the impact of hunting on endangered species. The passage discusses the encroachment of forest lands, the threat to wildlife, and the measures being taken to protect endangered species, indicating a tone of concern about the situation.

The correct answer is: **Concerned**

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Q.310 **Prior to independence, this antelope was extensively hunted which affected their population so much that this species has reached the stage of extinction in many parts of the country. Poachers kill them mainly for material gain. Its skin has an enormous value in the market. In order to protect this species, the IUCN has declared this species nearly threatened. Hence, under Schedule I of the Wildlife Protection Act of 1972, numerous stern measures have been taken. To specify a few, Kaimur Wildlife Sanctuary (Bihar), Gir Forest National Park, Velavadar Wildlife Sanctuary (Gujarat), National Chambal Sanctuary, etc. Despite these acts, hunting is adversely affecting our wildlife. There are some solutions to this problem but the best one is to boycott the products made from endangered species at an international level. This seems to be effective but will it prevent animal hunting? That's a question.**
The Black Buck is killed because of hunters' _____.

(a) material gain **(b)** need
(c) personal gratification **(d)** fun

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) material gain
In the passage, it is mentioned that poachers kill the Black Buck primarily **"for material gain,"** specifically because its skin has significant value in the market. This is the main reason for the hunting of the Black Buck.

Q.311 **Prior to independence, this antelope was extensively hunted which affected their population so much that this species has reached the stage of extinction in many parts of the country. Poachers kill them mainly for material gain. Its skin has an enormous value in the market. In order to protect this species, the IUCN has declared this species nearly threatened. Hence, under Schedule I of the Wildlife Protection Act of 1972, numerous stern measures have been taken. To specify a few, Kaimur Wildlife Sanctuary (Bihar), Gir Forest National Park, Velavadar Wildlife Sanctuary (Gujarat), National Chambal Sanctuary, etc. Despite these acts, hunting is adversely affecting our wildlife. There are some solutions to this problem but the best one is to boycott the products made from endangered species at an international level. This seems to be effective but will it prevent animal hunting? That's a question.**
What is the theme of this passage?

(a) Forests and their uses **(b)** Over-population
(c) Land encroachment **(d)** Endangered species

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Endangered species
The passage primarily discusses the threat to wildlife, particularly the Black Buck, due to habitat loss, hunting, and the effects of population growth and land encroachment. The focus is on the endangered species and the efforts to protect them, which makes **"Endangered species"** the most appropriate theme.

Q.312 **Prior to independence, this antelope was extensively hunted which affected their population so much that this species has reached the stage of extinction in many parts of the country. Poachers kill them mainly for material gain. Its skin has an enormous value in the market. In order to protect this species, the IUCN has declared this species nearly threatened. Hence, under Schedule I of the Wildlife Protection Act of 1972, numerous stern measures have been taken. To specify a few, Kaimur Wildlife Sanctuary (Bihar), Gir Forest National Park, Velavadar Wildlife Sanctuary (Gujarat), National Chambal Sanctuary, etc. Despite these acts, hunting is adversely affecting our wildlife. There are some solutions to this problem but the best one is to boycott the products made from endangered species at an international level. This seems to be effective but will it prevent animal hunting? That's a question.**
Choose the word which closely means 'adversely'.

(a) Digressing **(b)** Detrimentally
(c) Scarcely **(d)** Distressing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Detrimentally
"Adversely" means having a harmful or negative effect, which is closely related to **"detrimentally."** Both words suggest something that is damaging or harmful.
Meaning of other words:
"Digressing" means straying from the main topic.
"Scarcely" means barely or hardly.
"Distressing" refers to something causing worry or sadness.

Passage 57 (Q.313–Q.316)

Read the given passage and answer the question that follows.

Lena was an avid explorer. She had a deep fascination for the mysteries hidden within the dense forests. One day, while wandering through a secluded forest, she stumbled upon an ancient-looking map half-buried in the undergrowth. The map depicted a trail that led to a legendary waterfall rumoured to possess magical properties. Driven by her curiosity, Lena decided to follow the trail.

As she walked deeper into the forest, the atmosphere grew more enchanting. Sunlight filtered through the thick canopy, casting dappled patterns on the ground. The sound of rustling leaves and distant bird calls created a symphony of nature around her. Guided by the map's markings, Lena navigated through challenging terrains and crossed a narrow rope bridge suspended over a crystal-clear stream.

Finally, after hours of journeying, Lena arrived at the foot of the legendary waterfall. Its cascading waters sparkled like diamonds in the sunlight, and a gentle mist enveloped the surroundings. Lena felt a sense of wonder and tranquillity as she dipped her hand in the cool waters, as if the legends were coming alive. She sat by the waterfall, captivated by its beauty, pondering the ancient stories that had led her here.

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Q.313 Select the correct spelling of the underlined word in the given sentence.
What was Lena's reason for following the <u>trial</u> on the map?

(a) Treil **(b)** Triall
(c) Trale **(d)** Trail

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Trail
The correct spelling of the underlined word is**: Trail**
Trail refers to a path or route, especially one through the forest, which is the intended meaning in the sentence.

Q.314 Where did Lena find the map?

(a) Half-buried in the undergrowth
(b) In a bookstore in town
(c) Buried in the sand
(d) Underneath a bridge

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Half-buried in the undergrowth
According to the passage, Lena found the map **half-buried in the undergrowth** while wandering through the secluded forest. The other options (bookstore, buried in the sand, and underneath a bridge) are not mentioned in the passage.

Q.315 Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence.
What <u>surrounded</u> Lena as she journeyed through the forest?

(a) Freed **(b)** Bolt
(c) Created **(d)** Girded

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Freed
Surrounded means to be enclosed or encircled by something, so its antonym would be **"freed"**, meaning to be released or not confined.
Meanings of all options:
Freed: To release or set free from confinement or restraint.
Bolt: A type of fastener used to secure something.
Created: To bring something into existence.
Girded: To prepare oneself for something difficult or challenging.

Q.316 What intrigued Lena's curiosity in the forest?

(a) She discovered an old book.
(b) She found a hidden cave.
(c) She stumbled upon an ancient map.
(d) She heard whispers in the wind.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) She stumbled upon an ancient map.
Lena's curiosity was piqued when she discovered an "ancient-looking map half-buried in the undergrowth" while wandering through the forest. This map depicted a trail leading to a legendary waterfall, which motivated her to follow it.
The correct answer is: **She stumbled upon an ancient map.**

Passage 58 (Q.317–Q.321)

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions based on the passage:

The story "The Summer of the Beautiful White Horse" is a pleasant and interesting one that highlights the purity of youthfulness and the strong moral values of the Armenian Garoghlanian tribe. The story revolves around the lives of two cousins, Aram and Mourad, who belong to a poor family but are known for their honest nature. Early one morning, Aram is amazed to see his cousin Mourad riding a beautiful white horse. As the boys could not afford such a horse, Aram suspects that the horse could have been ridden without permission, but his excitement to ride the horse makes him forget his suspicion momentarily.

The two boys spend a few days secretly enjoying the rides and feel a deep connection with the animal. However, when they meet the horse's owner, John Byro, and hear his sad story, they feel a sense of guilt. Though Byro recognizes his horse, he is too impressed by the tribe's reputation to accuse the boys. His faith in silence is deeply touching for the boys. Finally, Mourad decides to secretly return the horse to its proper stable.

The story beautifully depicts how good values and a high moral standard can direct young hearts in the right direction.

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Q.317 What message does the story convey through Mourad's decision to return the horse?

(a) Poverty leads to irresponsible behavior
(b) Honesty and strong values guide one towards the right actions
(c) Adventure is more important than rules
(d) One should never trust others blindly

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Honesty and strong values guide one towards the right actions
<u>The deciding lines.</u>
"Finally, Mourad decides to **secretly return the horse** to its proper stable."
"The story beautifully depicts how **good values and a high moral standard** can **direct young hearts in the right direction**."
<u>Join them.</u>
Returning the horse is the *right action*; the last line names its source — **good values and a high moral standard**.
That is: **honesty and strong values guide one towards the right actions** *(ईमानदारी और दृढ़ मूल्य सही कर्म की ओर ले जाते हैं)*.
Answer: **Honesty and strong values guide one towards the right actions**
<u>Why the others are wrong.</u>
• **Poverty leads to irresponsible behavior** = being poor makes people careless *(ग़रीबी से ग़ैर-ज़िम्मेदार व्यवहार)* — the boys are poor yet return the horse; the story shows the reverse.
• **Adventure is more important than rules** = thrill matters more than what is right *(रोमांच नियमों से बड़ा)* — Mourad gives up the adventure to do the right thing.
• **One should never trust others blindly** = be suspicious of everyone *(किसी पर आँख मूँदकर भरोसा न करें)* — Byro's trust is shown as **touching**, and it is rewarded by the horse's return.

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Explanation (contd.)
Word help.
depicts = shows, portrays *(चित्रित करता है)*.
The last line of a story-passage usually states its moral — read it first for theme questions.

Q.318 What prevented John Byro from accusing the boys of stealing the horse?

(a) Lack of evidence
(b) Fear of hurting their feelings
(c) His belief in the honesty of the Garoghlanian tribe
(d) The boys' clever excuses

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) His belief in the honesty of the Garoghlanian tribe
The deciding line.
"Though Byro **recognizes his horse**, he is **too impressed by the tribe's reputation** to accuse the boys."
Read it.
too ... to = so much that he does not *(इतना ... कि नहीं)*.
The tribe's reputation is for honesty — earlier the passage says the family is "known for their **honest nature**".
So what stops him is his **belief in the honesty of the Garoghlanian tribe** *(गरोगलानियन कबीले की ईमानदारी पर विश्वास)*.
Answer: **His belief in the honesty of the Garoghlanian tribe**
Why the others are wrong.
• **Lack of evidence** = no proof *(सबूत का अभाव)* — he **recognizes his horse**, so the evidence is right in front of him.
• **Fear of hurting their feelings** = not wanting to upset them *(उनकी भावनाओं को ठेस पहुँचाने का डर)* — the passage gives the tribe's reputation as the reason, not the boys' feelings.
• **The boys' clever excuses** = smart false explanations *(चतुर बहाने)* — the boys offer no excuses at all.
Word help.
reputation = the general opinion people hold about someone *(प्रतिष्ठा, साख)*.
"Too impressed to accuse" — the reason sits between "too" and "to".

Q.319 Why was Aram surprised when he first saw Mourad in the morning?

(a) Because Mourad was leaving the village
(b) Because Mourad was riding a beautiful white horse
(c) Because Mourad had bought a new bicycle
(d) Because Mourad was moving to another town

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Because Mourad was riding a beautiful white horse
The deciding line.
"Early one morning, Aram is **amazed** to see his cousin Mourad **riding a beautiful white horse**."
Match it.
amazed = surprised *(चकित)* — the question's word in the passage's synonym.
What amazed him: Mourad **riding a beautiful white horse** *(सुंदर सफ़ेद घोड़े की सवारी करते हुए)*.
Answer: **Because Mourad was riding a beautiful white horse**
Why the others are wrong.

Explanation (contd.)
• **leaving the village** = going away from home *(गाँव छोड़ना)* — no departure is described.
• **bought a new bicycle** = a new cycle *(नई साइकिल ख़रीदना)* — there is no bicycle; and the boys are poor, they "could not afford such a horse", let alone buy things.
• **moving to another town** = shifting home *(दूसरे शहर जाना)* — never mentioned.
Word help.
Garoghlanian = the name of the Armenian family-tribe in the story *(गरोगलानियन कबीला)*.
youthfulness = the quality of being young *(युवावस्था, जवानी का भाव)*.
Surprised in the question = amazed in the passage — scan for the synonym.

Q.320 Why did the boys feel guilty after meeting John Byro?

(a) Because he scolded them harshly
(b) Because he accused them of theft
(c) Because his sadness reminded them of their wrongdoing
(d) Because he offered them money for returning the horse

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Because his sadness reminded them of their wrongdoing
The deciding line.
"when they meet the horse's owner, John Byro, and **hear his sad story**, they **feel a sense of guilt**."
Read the cause.
The trigger is Byro's **sad story** — the loss of his horse.
Hearing the owner's sorrow makes them see that taking his horse was wrong.
So his **sadness reminded them of their wrongdoing** *(उसके दुःख ने उन्हें अपनी ग़लती का एहसास कराया)*.
Answer: **Because his sadness reminded them of their wrongdoing**
Why the others are wrong.
• **he scolded them harshly** = told them off angrily *(कड़ी डाँट लगाई)* — he never scolds; his silence is what touches them.
• **he accused them of theft** = charged them with stealing *(चोरी का आरोप लगाया)* — the passage says the opposite: he is too impressed by the tribe's reputation **to accuse** the boys.
• **he offered them money for returning the horse** = a reward *(इनाम की पेशकश)* — no money is mentioned, and the horse is returned later, in secret.
Word help.
guilt = the feeling of having done wrong *(अपराध-बोध)*.
Guilt came from sympathy, not from accusation — Byro said nothing against them.

Q.321 What made Aram temporarily ignore his suspicion about the horse being taken without permission?

(a) Mourad's explanation
(b) Fear of punishment
(c) Excitement and desire to ride the horse
(d) His trust in the tribe's reputation

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Excitement and desire to ride the horse
The deciding line.

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Explanation (contd.)
"Aram suspects that the horse could have been ridden without permission, but **his excitement to ride the horse** makes him **forget his suspicion momentarily**."
Match it.
temporarily ignore = forget ... momentarily (कुछ पल के लिए भूल जाना).
The cause is his **excitement to ride the horse** *(घोड़े की सवारी करने का उत्साह).*
Answer: **Excitement and desire to ride the horse**
Why the others are wrong.
• **Mourad's explanation** = an account given by Mourad *(मुराद की सफ़ाई)* — Mourad explains nothing in the passage.
• **Fear of punishment** = being afraid of being punished *(सज़ा का डर)* — fear would make him more careful, not forget his doubt.
• **His trust in the tribe's reputation** = faith in the family's good name *(कबीले की साख पर भरोसा)* — that trust belongs to **John Byro**, the owner, not to Aram.
Word help.
suspicion = a feeling that something wrong has been done *(संदेह, शक).*
momentarily = for a very short time *(क्षण भर के लिए).*
Watch whose feeling it is — the tribe's reputation moved Byro, not Aram.

Passage 59 (Q.322–Q.326)

Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions based on the passage:

The events in Rajamahendravaram in Andhra Pradesh involving the mass poisoning of consumers by milk contaminated with ethylene glycol sound a regulatory alarm. As of March 8, the death toll was 11, with approximately 20 other people, including infants, hospitalised. Milk is a staple in Indian households and contamination by an industrial compound already infamous in India for its lethality carries the potential to trigger a crisis of confidence in local, unbranded milk supplies. Children and the elderly are most affected by ethylene glycol poisoning due to their higher metabolic sensitivity and lower renal reserves, respectively. This could push people towards pasteurised milk from regulated cooperatives such as Amul or Vijaya, which seems desirable, but a large share of milk is also distributed in India through small vendors. Food-safety compliance is as much about punishing bad actors as about reducing the cost of doing the right thing. In the informal supply chain, cold-chain monitoring and hygiene inspections are almost entirely absent, leaving room for contamination. Subsidised testing kits and cooperative chilling facilities can thus reduce the risk at small dairies. Regulators may also consider safe-harbour provisions that ease penalties for dairy operators who report contamination at their facilities; this could also encourage early disclosure, giving authorities time to save lives.

(**Source**: Bitter milk: On the Rajamahendravaram milk adulteration case - The Hindu, March 10)

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Q.322 What is a potential consequence of the contamination mentioned in the text?

(a) A complete ban on the sale of milk in Andhra Pradesh.
(b) A shift in consumer preference toward pasteurised milk.
(c) An increase in the price of testing kits for small vendors.
(d) The immediate closure of all informal milk supply chains.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A shift in consumer preference toward pasteurised milk.
The deciding lines.
"contamination ... carries the potential to trigger a **crisis of confidence in local, unbranded milk supplies**."
"This could **push people towards pasteurised milk** from regulated cooperatives such as Amul or Vijaya".
Read the signal words.
potential and **could** mark a *possible* result *(संभावित परिणाम).*
People losing trust in loose milk and moving to packaged, pasteurised milk = **a shift in consumer preference toward pasteurised milk** *(उपभोक्ताओं की पसंद का पाश्चुरीकृत दूध की ओर झुकाव).*
Answer: **A shift in consumer preference toward pasteurised milk.**
Why the others are wrong.
• **A complete ban on the sale of milk** = stopping all milk sales *(दूध की बिक्री पर पूर्ण प्रतिबंध)* — no ban is mentioned; milk is called a household staple.
• **An increase in the price of testing kits** = kits becoming costlier *(जाँच किट का महँगा होना)* — the passage wants kits **subsidised** *(अनुदानित)*, i.e. cheaper.
• **The immediate closure of all informal milk supply chains** = shutting all small vendors at once *(अनौपचारिक आपूर्ति का तुरंत बंद होना)* — the passage says a large share of milk still comes through small vendors and suggests making them safer, not closing them.
Word help.
staple = a basic item used every day *(रोज़मर्रा की मूल वस्तु).*
pasteurised = heated to kill germs *(पाश्चुरीकृत, कीटाणु-रहित किया गया).*
In a "consequence" question, look for could, may, potential — the passage's own forecast.

Q.323 Which measure does the author suggest to improve small dairy safety?

(a) Make penalties tougher for all dairy owners.
(b) Require all milk to be sold through Amul or Vijaya only.
(c) Providing subsidised testing kits and cooperative chilling facilities.
(d) Use machines to check cold storage instead of people.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Providing subsidised testing kits and cooperative chilling facilities.
The deciding line.
"**Subsidised testing kits and cooperative chilling facilities** can thus **reduce the risk at small dairies**."
Match it.
The question's words *small dairy safety* mirror the passage's *reduce the risk at small dairies*.
Option (c) repeats the measure word for word: cheaper testing kits *(अनुदानित जाँच किट)* and shared chilling plants *(सहकारी शीतलन सुविधाएँ).*
Answer: **Providing subsidised testing kits and cooperative chilling facilities.**

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Explanation (contd.)

Why the others are wrong.

• **Make penalties tougher** = harsher punishment *(कड़े दंड)* — the author goes the other way, suggesting safe-harbour provisions that **ease** penalties for those who report.

• **Require all milk to be sold through Amul or Vijaya only** = a monopoly for cooperatives *(केवल अमूल या विजया से बिक्री)* — the passage accepts that small vendors supply a large share and wants them made safe.

• **Use machines ... instead of people** = replacing human inspectors *(मनुष्यों की जगह मशीनें)* — the passage only says cold-chain monitoring is *absent*; it never proposes machines.

Word help.

subsidised = partly paid for by the government, so cheaper *(सरकारी सहायता से सस्ता)*.

cold-chain = keeping a product cold all the way from producer to buyer *(शीत शृंखला)*.

When the question echoes a phrase from the passage, the answer sits in that very sentence.

Q.324 What is the main purpose of the "safe-harbour provisions"?

(a) To protect consumers from high milk costs.

(b) To get dairy operators to report contamination early by giving them legal protection and lower penalties.

(c) To protect regulators from possible public lawsuits about how they enforce the rules.

(d) To ensure infants and the elderly receive free hospitalisation.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To get dairy operators to report contamination early by giving them legal protection and lower penalties.

The deciding line.

"Regulators may also consider **safe-harbour provisions** that **ease penalties for dairy operators who report contamination** at their facilities; this could also **encourage early disclosure**, giving authorities time to save lives."

Read the term.

safe harbour = a legal shelter *(कानूनी संरक्षण)* — a person who follows a stated condition is spared full punishment.

Here: the operator who **reports** contamination gets **lighter penalties**, so operators come forward **early**.

Answer: **To get dairy operators to report contamination early by giving them legal protection and lower penalties.**

Why the others are wrong.

• **protect consumers from high milk costs** = keeping milk cheap *(दूध की ऊँची कीमत से बचाव)* — the provision is about reporting, not price.

• **protect regulators from public lawsuits** = shielding officials from court cases *(नियामकों को मुक़दमों से बचाना)* — the protection goes to **dairy operators**, not regulators.

• **free hospitalisation for infants and the elderly** = free treatment *(निःशुल्क अस्पताल उपचार)* — hospitalisation appears only in the death-toll figures.

Word help.

disclosure = making something known *(प्रकटीकरण, खुलासा)*.

A safe harbour rewards the one who tells — early reporting in exchange for lighter punishment.

Q.325 According to the passage, why are the elderly specifically more vulnerable to ethylene glycol poisoning?

(a) Due to their lower renal reserves.

(b) Due to their higher metabolic sensitivity.

(c) Because they consume more unbranded milk than infants.

(d) Because they lack access to regulated cooperatives.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Due to their lower renal reserves.

The deciding line.

"**Children and the elderly** are most affected by ethylene glycol poisoning due to their **higher metabolic sensitivity and lower renal reserves, respectively**."

Read "respectively".

Respectively (क्रमशः) pairs the two lists in the same order.

1st with 1st: **children** → **higher metabolic sensitivity**

2nd with 2nd: **elderly** → **lower renal reserves**

So the elderly suffer because of **lower renal reserves** = weaker kidney capacity *(गुर्दों की कम आरक्षित क्षमता)*.

Answer: **Due to their lower renal reserves.**

Why the others are wrong.

• **higher metabolic sensitivity** = the body reacting more strongly to a substance *(अधिक चयापचय संवेदनशीलता)* — by "respectively" this belongs to **children**, not the elderly.

• **consume more unbranded milk than infants** = drinking more loose, local milk *(शिशुओं से अधिक खुला दूध पीना)* — the passage never compares how much milk any group drinks.

• **lack access to regulated cooperatives** = cannot reach Amul or Vijaya milk *(नियंत्रित सहकारी दूध तक पहुँच न होना)* — cooperatives are mentioned as a remedy, not as a reason for the elderly's risk.

Word help.

renal = of the kidneys *(गुर्दे से संबंधित)*.

ethylene glycol = a toxic industrial liquid used in antifreeze and coolants *(एथिलीन ग्लाइकॉल, एक विषैला औद्योगिक रसायन)*.

"Respectively" is a matching instruction — pair the lists in order, never swap them.

Q.326 What does the word "lethality" mean in the passage about industrial hazards?

(a) The quality of being very expensive

(b) The process of industrial manufacturing

(c) A state of being famous or well-known

(d) The ability to cause death

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) The ability to cause death

Meaning: **lethality** = the ability to cause death; deadliness *(घातकता, प्राणघातकता)*.

From *lethal* = deadly *(घातक)*.

The deciding line.

"an industrial compound already **infamous** in India for its **lethality**"

The same passage reports a **death toll of 11** — the compound is known for killing.

Answer: **The ability to cause death**

Why the others are wrong.

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Explanation (contd.)

• **The quality of being very expensive** = costliness *(महँगापन)* — the word for this is *expensiveness*; cost is never the issue here.

• **The process of industrial manufacturing** = making goods in factories *(औद्योगिक निर्माण)* — "industrial" describes the compound, not the meaning of lethality.

• **A state of being famous or well-known** = fame *(प्रसिद्धि)* — this is the trap: the fame-word in the line is **infamous** *(कुख्यात — बुरे कारण से प्रसिद्ध)*, and lethality is the reason for that bad fame.

Infamous = famous for something bad; lethality is what this compound is infamous for.

Passage 60 (Q.327–Q.331)

Read the passage and answer the questions given below it

Our civilization is more secure because it is much more widely spread. Most of the previous civilizations came to an end because uncivilized peoples broke in and destroyed them. This was the fate of Babylon, Assyria, India, China, Greece and Rome. Previous civilizations were specialized and limited like an oasis in a surrounding desert of savagery. Eventually, the desert closed in and the oasis was no more. But to-day, it is the oasis which is spreading over the desert. Practically no part of the world is untouched by it.

For the first time, the world has now a chance of becoming a single whole, a unity. To-day, the food we eat comes from all over the world. The things in a grocer's shop are from the ends of the earth. There are oranges from Brazil, grapes from Africa, rice from India, tea from china, sugar from Columbia etc.

To-day the world is beginning to look more like one enormous box. Therefore, there is little danger upon our civilization from outside. The danger comes only from within; it is a danger from among us.

To-day, the sharing-out of money – the sharing-out of food, clothing, houses and books, is still very unfair. In England alone, in sharing out of the National Income, we find that one half is divided among every sixteen people and the seventeenth person gets the other half. So while some few people live in luxury, many have not even enough to eat and drink and wear. Again, in England to-day, thousands of people live in dreadful surroundings. There are many families of five or six persons who live in a single room; in this same room they are born and in this same room they die, because, they are too poor to afford another room. Until everyone gets his proper share of necessary and delightful things, our civilization will not be perfect.

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Q.327 Which of the following statements is NOT true according to the facts given in the passage.

(a) Some ancient civilizations have been destroyed.
(b) Most people share their money equally.
(c) Some people do not have adequate space to live.
(d) Goods are transported from far- off places.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Most people share their money equally.

How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)

The passage says the sharing of money is "**very unfair**" — one half of the income goes to a few. So "share their money equally" is **false**.

Why the others are true

• **(a)** ancient civilizations destroyed, **(c)** some lack living space, **(d)** goods transported from far – all stated.

Q.328 What is one of the greatest disadvantages of the present times?

(a) We have an internal threat from our own kind.
(b) We need to bring things from other parts of the world.
(c) We are at risk of attack from outsiders
(d) We cannot grow our own produce

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) We have an internal threat from our own kind.

How to locate the answer

Text: "the danger comes only from **within**; it is a danger **from among us**." So the present-day disadvantage is an **internal** threat.

Why the others are wrong

• **(b) importing goods / (c) attack from outsiders / (d) cannot grow produce** – the passage says outside danger is now "little"; the threat is internal.

Q.329 What according to the writer was the desert that surrounded the oasis?

(a) Civilization **(b)** Some rich countries
(c) Savagery **(d)** The poorer people

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Savagery

How to locate the answer

Text: "Previous civilizations were ... like an oasis in a surrounding **desert of savagery**." So the "desert" = savagery.

Why the others are wrong

• **Civilization / rich countries / poorer people** – the desert stands for savagery (the uncivilized world).

Q.330 'This' in the third sentence refers to

(a) Destruction of civilizations
(b) Spread of civilizations
(c) Rise of education
(d) Increase in security

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Destruction of civilizations

How to locate the answer

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Explanation (contd.)
The earlier sentence says civilizations "came to an end because uncivilized peoples broke in and **destroyed** them." Then "**This** was the fate of Babylon, Assyria ..." — "This" = that destruction.
Why the others are wrong
• **spread / education / security** – not what "This" points back to.

Q.331 Which important feature of modern life troubles the writer most?

(a) There is inequality in the distribution of things.
(b) People do not care for their fellow beings.
(c) Civilizations have become dependent.
(d) Older civilizations do not exist anymore.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) There is inequality in the distribution of things.
How to locate the answer
Text: "the sharing-out of money ... food, clothing, houses ... is still **very unfair**." This inequality troubles the writer.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) people not caring / (c) dependence / (d) old civilizations gone** – not the main worry expressed.

Passage 61 (Q.332–Q.336)

Read the passage and answer the questions given below it.

In 18th-century Germany, Baron Munchausen regales his friends, over drinks, with stories of his many adventures. These include his supposed travel to the moon. Long before Neil Armstrong and Edwin Aldrin stepped out of Apollo 11 onto the surface of the moon 50 years ago, on July 20, 1969, the aspiration to travel to this shiny orb in the sky has fired human imagination. A Flight To The Moon by George Fowler, From The Earth To The Moon – and its sequel, Around The Moon – by Jules Verne, The First Men In The Moon by HG Wells, Prelude To Space by Arthur C Clarke... are only a few of the many fictionalised accounts that have, for centuries, reflected this aspiration. In the 1954 Explorers On The Moon, iconic comic book character, Tintin, reaches the moon. While some writers imagined the moon's surface to be barren and uninhabited, others have written about it being populated with lunar beings. Even when Apollo 11 mission was being planned and worked on, in 1963, Apollo At Go by Jeff Sutton, presented a realistic fictionalised portrayal of the upcoming landing.

The successful landing of Apollo 11 and Neil Armstrong and Buzz Aldrin's walk on the moon, opened up another exciting possibility – could the common man or non-space-scientist reach for the moon? Literally? What had hitherto been in the realm of speculation was now a reality and we weren't satisfied with just second-hand information any more. Between 1969 and 1972, the US sent six successful manned missions to the moon, and with each victory, the lunar destination seemed a little closer within the reach of the common man.

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Q.332 Who was the first person to speak of travel to the moon?

(a) Armstrong **(b)** Munchausen
(c) Sutton **(d)** Branson

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Munchausen
How to locate the answer
Text opens: "In 18th-century Germany, **Baron Munchausen** ... stories of his many adventures ... his supposed travel to the moon." He is the earliest mentioned.
Why the others are wrong
• **Armstrong / Sutton / Branson** – all came much later.

Q.333 The writer uses the expression 'literally' because___

(a) people only dream of doing it
(b) it has been an idiom for desiring something unlikely
(c) no one can ever go to the moon
(d) it is wrong to build up stories

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) it has been an idiom for desiring something unlikely
How to locate the answer
"could the common man ... reach for the moon? **Literally?**" — "reach for the moon" is normally an **idiom** for wanting something unlikely; the writer adds "literally" because now it could actually happen.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) only dream / (c) no one can go / (d) wrong to build stories** – miss the idiom-turned-real point.

Q.334 Which of the following statements is not true according to the passage?

(a) Someday the common man could make a trip to the moon.
(b) Man's walk on the moon inspired scientists to plan more expeditions.
(c) All the writers wrote about the moon being inhabited by weird creatures.
(d) Man has always been attracted to the moon.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) All the writers wrote about the moon being inhabited by weird creatures.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
Text: "**some** writers imagined the moon's surface to be barren and uninhabited, **others** wrote about it being populated with lunar beings." So NOT all wrote about creatures → (c) is false.
Why the others are true
• **(a)** common man could go, **(b)** the walk inspired more expeditions, **(d)** man always attracted to the moon – all supported.

Q.335 When did the US send first successful manned trip to the moon?

(a) 1972 **(b)** 1969
(c) 1963 **(d)** 1954

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) 1969
How to locate the answer

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Explanation (contd.)
Text: "Apollo 11 onto the surface of the moon 50 years ago, on **July 20, 1969**" and "Between **1969** and 1972, the US sent six successful manned missions." The first was in 1969.

Why the others are wrong
• **1972** – end of the mission period; **1963** – Apollo planning; **1954** – Tintin's fictional book.

Q.336 How many fictional books written about travelling to the moon are referred to here?

(a) Five **(b)** Seven
(c) Eight **(d)** Six

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Seven
How to locate the answer
The passage names: (1) A Flight To The Moon, (2) From The Earth To The Moon, (3) Around The Moon, (4) The First Men In The Moon, (5) Prelude To Space, (6) Explorers On The Moon (Tintin), (7) Apollo At Go — **seven** fictional works.

Passage 62 (Q.337–Q.341)

Read the passage and answer the questions given below it.

While I waited expectantly, Madame came in and told me that there was no room at all for me in the hotel, not a bed, not a corner. She was extremely friendly and seemed to find a fund of secret amusement in the fact; she looked at me as though expecting me to break into delighted laughter. "To-morrow," she said, "there may be. I am expecting a young gentleman who is suddenly taken ill to move from number eleven. He is at present at the chemist's perhaps you would care to see the room?"

"Not at all," said I. "Neither shall I wish tomorrow to sleep in the bedroom of an indisposed young gentleman."

"But he will be gone," cried Madame, opening her blue eyes wide and laughing with that French cordiality so enchanting to English hearing. I was too tired and hungry to feel either appreciative or argumentative. "Perhaps you can recommend me another hotel?"

"Impossible!" She shook her head and turned up her eyes, mentally counting over the blue bows painted on the ceiling. "You see, it is the season in Bruges, and people do not care to let their rooms for a very short time" not a glance at my little suit case lying between us, but I looked at it gloomily, and it seemed to dwindle before my desperate gaze become small enough to hold nothing but a collapsible folding tooth-brush.

"My large box is at the station," I said coldly, buttoning my gloves.

Madame started. "You have more luggage. Then you intend to make a long stay in Bruges, perhaps?"

"At least a fortnight perhaps a month." I shrugged my shoulders.

Passage (contd.)

"One moment," said Madame. "I shall see what I can do." She disappeared, I am sure not further than the other side of the door, for she reappeared immediately and told me I might have a room at her private house "just round the corner and kept by an old servant who, although she has a wall eye, has been in our family for fifteen years. The porter will take you there, and you can have supper before you go."

I was the only guest in the dining-room. A tired waiter provided me with an omelet and a pot of coffee, then leaned against a sideboard and watched me while I ate, the limp table napkin over his arm seeming to symbolise the very man.

"Are you ready, Madame?" asked the waiter. "It is I who carry your luggage."

"Quite ready."

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Q.337 Which sentence tells us that Madame changed her mind suddenly and decided to give accomodation to the writer?

(a) she reappeared immediately
(b) My large box is at the station
(c) I was the only guest in the dining-room.
(d) people do not care to let their rooms for a very short time.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) she reappeared immediately
How to locate the answer
Text: "She disappeared ... for **she reappeared immediately** and told me I might have a room ..." Her instant return shows she suddenly changed her mind (and a room was available all along).
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) large box / (c) only guest / (d) short-time rooms** – details, but the sudden decision is shown by "she reappeared immediately".

Q.338 How long does the narrator plan to stay in that place?

(a) One week **(b)** Two days
(c) Four days **(d)** A month

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) A month
How to locate the answer
The narrator tells Madame: "**At least a fortnight perhaps a month.**" So the planned stay is up to **a month**.
Why the others are wrong
• **One week / Two days / Four days** – none matches "a fortnight ... a month".

Q.339 Who looks after the private house?

(a) An old servant **(b)** The waiter
(c) Madame **(d)** The porter

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) An old servant
How to locate the answer

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Explanation (contd.)
Text: the private house is "just round the corner and **kept by an old servant** who ... has been in our family for fifteen years."
Why the others are wrong
• **The waiter / Madame / The porter** – the house is looked after by the old servant.

Q.340 Madame says "impossible" when the narrator asks her _____.
(a) for some supper
(b) for space in the hotel from the next day
(c) to recommend another hotel
(d) for a porter to carry her bag
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) to recommend another hotel
How to locate the answer
The narrator asks: "Perhaps you can **recommend me another hotel**?" Madame replies: "**Impossible!**"
Why the others are wrong
• **supper / room from next day / porter** – "Impossible!" is her reply specifically to recommending another hotel.

Q.341 Madame is probably _____
(a) A saleswoman at the shop
(b) A Manager of the hotel
(c) Nurse at the clinic
(d) Another guest like the narrator
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) A Manager of the hotel
How to locate the answer
Madame decides about rooms, arranges the private house, and directs the porter and waiter — she behaves like the **manager of the hotel**.
Why the others are wrong
• **saleswoman / nurse / another guest** – none fits her authority over the hotel's rooms and staff.

Passage 63 (Q.342–Q.346)
Read the passage and answer the questions given below it
No one can look back on his schooldays and say with truth that they were altogether unhappy.

Passage (contd.)
I have good memories of St Cyprian's, among a horde of bad ones. Sometimes on summer afternoons there were wonderful expeditions across the Downs to a village called Birling Gap, or to Beachy Head, where one bathed dangerously among the boulders and came home covered with cuts. And there were still more wonderful mid-summer evenings when, as a special treat, we were not driven off to bed as usual but allowed to wander about the grounds in the long twilight, ending up with a plunge into the swimming bathe at about nine o'clock. There was the joy of waking early on summer mornings and getting in an hour's undisturbed reading (Ian Hay, Thackeray, Kipling and H. G. Wells were the favourite authors of my boyhood) in the sunlit, sleeping dormitory. There was also cricket, which I was no good at but with which I conducted a sort of hopeless love affair up to the age of about eighteen. And there was the pleasure of keeping caterpillars — the silky green and purple puss-moth, the ghostly green poplar-hawk, the privet-hawk, large as one's third finger, specimens of which could be illicitly purchased for sixpence at a shop in the town — and, when one could escape long enough from the master who was 'taking the walk', there was the excitement of dredging the dew-ponds on the Downs for enormous newts with orange-coloured bellies. This business of being out for a walk, coming across something of fascinating interest and then being dragged away from it by a yell from the master, like a dog jerked onwards by the leash, is an important feature of school life, and helps to build up the conviction, so strong in many children, that the things you most want to do are always unattainable.
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Q.342 What is the 'moral' the boy draws from his childhood experiences?
(a) Do not collect insects like caterpillars
(b) Only do the things your masters tell you to.
(c) Do not walk alone in the grounds.
(d) Things you enjoy doing are always unreachable
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Things you enjoy doing are always unreachable
How to locate the answer
The boy's childhood joys (cricket he was "no good at", newts he had to "escape" the master to catch, caterpillars bought "illicitly") were things he loved yet could not freely reach. The moral he draws is that the things one most enjoys are always just out of reach.
Why the others are wrong
• **do not collect insects / obey masters / do not walk alone** – too literal; not the "moral" he draws.

Q.343 Which of the following did the boys not do on summer mornings?
(a) Sleep until late **(b)** play cricket
(c) Collect caterpillars **(d)** Read in bed
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Sleep until late
How to locate the answer

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Explanation (contd.)
On summer mornings the writer speaks of "the joy of **waking early** ... getting an hour's undisturbed **reading**." So they woke early — they did **not** "sleep until late".
Why the others are wrong
• **Read in bed** – they did read early; **cricket / caterpillars** – enjoyed at other times, but the question asks what was NOT done in the mornings, i.e., sleeping late.

Q.344 Why does the writer call cricket a hopeless love affair?
(a) He played it secretly
(b) He tried hard to learn it
(c) He was forced to give it up
(d) He did not play it at all
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He tried hard to learn it
How to locate the answer
Text: "cricket, which I was **no good at** but with which I conducted a sort of **hopeless love affair** up to ... eighteen." He loved and pursued it for years despite being poor at it — a hopeless (yet persistent) effort.
Why the others are wrong
• **played secretly / forced to give up / did not play at all** – contradict the passage.

Q.345 "where one bathed dangerously" . Why does the writer call the bathing dangerous?
(a) they were punished later
(b) the boulders gave them bruises
(c) the water was too deep
(d) there were snakes in the water
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) the boulders gave them bruises
How to locate the answer
Text: "one **bathed dangerously among the boulders** and came home **covered with cuts**." So it was dangerous because the boulders caused cuts/bruises.
Why the others are wrong
• **punished later / too deep / snakes** – not mentioned as the danger.

Q.346 We can infer that the writer was a
(a) mischievous boy **(b)** lonely child
(c) studious boy **(d)** disobedient student
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) mischievous boy
How to locate the answer
He "illicitly purchased" caterpillars, had to "escape ... the master" to dredge ponds for newts — clearly a playful, **mischievous** boy.
Why the others are wrong
• **lonely / studious / disobedient student** – the passage shows fun and mischief, not loneliness or mere disobedience.

Passage 64 (Q.347–Q.351)
Read the passage and answer the questions given below it.
The children were to be driven, as a special treat, to the sands at Jagborough. Nicholas was not to be of the party; he was in disgrace. Only that morning he had refused to eat his wholesome bread-and-milk on the seemingly frivolous ground that there was a frog in it. Older and wiser and better people(his aunt), had told him that there could not possibly be a frog in his bread-and-milk and that he was not to talk nonsense; he continued, nevertheless, to talk what seemed complete nonsense, and described with much detail the coloration and markings of the alleged frog. The dramatic part of the incident was that there really was a frog in Nicholas's basin of bread-and-milk; he had put it there himself, so he felt entitled to know something about it. The sin of taking a frog from the garden and putting it into a bowl of wholesome bread-and-milk was enlarged on at great length, but the fact that stood out clearest in the whole affair, as it presented itself to the mind of Nicholas, was that the older, wiser, and better people had been proved to be profoundly in error in matters about which they had expressed the utmost assurance.
"You said there couldn't possibly be a frog in my bread-and-milk; there was a frog in my bread-and-milk," he repeated, with the insistence of a skilled tactician who does not intend to shift from favourable ground.
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Q.347 The children were being taken on a special treat to
(a) The zoo **(b)** The circus
(c) The beach **(d)** A garden
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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The beach
How to locate the answer
Text: "The children were to be driven ... to the **sands at Jagborough**." "Sands" = a beach.
Why the others are wrong
• **zoo / circus / garden** – the treat was to the sands (beach).

Q.348 Why did Nicholas consider his aunt had been proved to be wrong?
(a) She always scolded him
(b) She never listened to him
(c) She was forcing him to eat the bread and milk.
(d) She had said there was no frog in the bowl
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) She had said there was no frog in the bowl
How to locate the answer
The aunt insisted "there could not possibly be a frog", yet "there really was a frog in Nicholas's basin". So she was proved wrong.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) always scolded / (b) never listened / (c) forcing him to eat** – not the reason she was "proved wrong".

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Q.349 What was the aunt trying to tell Nicholas?

(a) That he could choose to stay back if he wished
(b) That he would be punished if he misbehaved
(c) That he should have eaten the bread and milk
(d) That he should play with his cousins

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) That he would be punished if he misbehaved

How to locate the answer

Nicholas "was in disgrace" and "was not to be of the party" — he was excluded from the treat as a punishment for refusing to eat. Through this, the aunt was showing him that misbehaviour brings punishment.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) choose to stay back / (c) should have eaten / (d) play with cousins** – the disgrace/exclusion signals punishment for misbehaviour.

Q.350 What excuse did Nicholas give for not eating his bread and milk?

(a) he did not like it
(b) it was too cold to eat
(c) there was a frog in it
(d) there was no sugar in it

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) there was a frog in it

How to locate the answer

Text: "he had refused to eat his wholesome bread-and-milk on the ... ground that **there was a frog in it**."

Why the others are wrong

• **did not like it / too cold / no sugar** – not the excuse given.

Q.351 What made Nicholas so sure about what he said?

(a) He noticed it jumping in
(b) He himself had put it in
(c) His cousins had told him about it
(d) He saw someone putting it in

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He himself had put it in

How to locate the answer

Text: "there really was a frog ... **he had put it there himself**, so he felt entitled to know something about it."

Why the others are wrong

• **jumping in / cousins told him / saw someone** – he was sure because he put the frog in himself.

Passage 65 (Q.352–Q.356)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The term 'dietary fibres' refers collectively to indigestible carbohydrates present in plant foods. The importance of these dietary fibres came into the picture when it was observed that the people taking a diet rich in these fibres had low incidence of coronary heart disease, irritable bowel syndrome, dental caries and gall stones.

Passage (contd.)

The foodstuffs rich in these dietary fibres are cereals and grains, legumes, fruits with seeds, citrus fruits, carrots, cabbage, green leafy vegetables, apples, melons, peaches, pears etc. These dietary fibres are not digested by the enzymes of the stomach and the small intestine. They have the property of holding water and because of it, these get swollen and behave like a sponge as these pass through the gastrointestinal tract. The fibres add bulk to the diet and increase transit time in the gut and decrease the time of release of ingested food in the colon. These fibres hold water so the stools are soft, bulky and readily eliminated.

In recent years, it has been considered essential to have some amount of fibres in the diet. Their beneficial effects lie in preventing heart disease and decreasing cholesterol level. The fibres like gum and pectin are reported to decrease post prandial (after meals) glucose level in blood. They are also recommended for the management of certain types of diabetes.

The fibres increase motility of the small intestine and the colon and so there is less time for exposure of the mucosa to harmful toxic substances. Therefore, there is a less desire to eat and the energy intake can be maintained within the range of requirement. This phenomenon helps in keeping a check on obesity.

The dietary fibres may have some adverse effects on nutrition by binding some trace metals like calcium, magnesium, phosphorus, zinc and others and therefore preventing their proper absorption. This may pose a possibility of nutritional deficiency especially when diets contain marginal levels of mineral elements. This may put constraints on increasing dietary fibres. It is suggested that an intake of 40 gram dietary fibres per day is desirable.

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Q.352 What is the theme of the passage?

(a) Sources of dietary fibres
(b) Importance of dietary fibres
(c) Functioning of intestines
(d) Benefits of a balanced diet

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Importance of dietary fibres

How to locate the answer

The passage repeatedly stresses the **benefits/importance** of fibres — preventing heart disease, lowering cholesterol, controlling glucose and obesity. So the theme is the **importance of dietary fibres**.

Why the others are wrong

• **Sources / functioning of intestines / balanced diet** – these are details inside the passage, not the overall theme.

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Q.353 What are dietary fibres?

(a) Enzymes present in the stomach
(b) Ingested food in the colon
(c) Indigestible carbohydrates in plant foods
(d) Easily digestible healthy food

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Indigestible carbohydrates in plant foods

How to locate the answer

Opening line: "'dietary fibres' refers collectively to **indigestible carbohydrates present in plant foods**." That is the definition.

Why the others are wrong

• **Enzymes / ingested food in the colon / easily digestible food** – the text clearly says fibres are **indigestible**, so these are wrong.

Q.354 The dietary fibres behave like a sponge because they:

(a) prevent the absorption of trace metals
(b) increase the motility of the small intestine
(c) reduce the craving for food
(d) can absorb water and swell up

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) can absorb water and swell up

How to locate the answer

Text: "They have the property of **holding water** and because of it, these get **swollen and behave like a sponge** ..." So they act like a sponge because they absorb water and swell.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) trace metals / (b) motility / (c) reduce craving** – true facts about fibres, but not the reason they behave "like a sponge".

Q.355 Which of the following is NOT rich in dietary fibres?

(a) Glucose **(b)** Cereals
(c) Leafy vegetables **(d)** Citrus fruits

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Glucose

How to locate the answer

The passage lists fibre-rich foods: "cereals and grains, ... citrus fruits, ... green leafy vegetables ..." **Glucose** is a simple sugar, not a plant fibre, so it is **NOT** rich in dietary fibres.

Why the others are wrong

• **Cereals, Leafy vegetables, Citrus fruits** – all named in the passage as rich in fibres.

Q.356 Which of the following statements is NOT true?

(a) Dietary fibres help in absorption of trace metals.
(b) Dietary fibres help in preventing heart disease.
(c) Dietary fibres help in relieving constipation.
(d) Dietary fibres help in regulating glucose levels in the body.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Dietary fibres help in absorption of trace metals.

How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)

The passage says fibres **bind** trace metals (calcium, zinc...) and **prevent their proper absorption** — the opposite of "help in absorption". So (a) is **false**.

Why the others are true

• **(b)** prevent heart disease, **(c)** soft stools = relieve constipation, **(d)** regulate glucose – all stated in the passage.

Passage 66 (Q.357–Q.361)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

My grandmother and I were good friends. My parents left me with her when they went to live in the city and we were constantly together. She used to wake me up in the morning and get me ready for school. She said her morning prayer in a monotonous sing-song while she bathed and dressed me in the hope that I would listen and get to know it by heart; I listened because I loved her voice but never bothered to learn it. Then she would fetch my wooden slate which she had already washed and plastered with yellow chalk, a tiny earthen ink-pot and a red pen, tie them all in a bundle and hand it to me. After a breakfast of a thick, stale chapatti with a little butter and sugar spread on it, we went to school. She carried several stale chapattis with her for the village dogs.

My grandmother always went to school with me because the school was attached to the temple. The priest taught us the alphabet and the morning prayer. While the children sat in rows on either side of the verandah singing the alphabet or the prayer in a chorus, my grandmother sat inside reading the scriptures. When we had both finished, we would walk back together. This time the village dogs would meet us at the temple door. They followed us to our home growling and fighting with each other for the chapattis we threw to them. When my parents were comfortably settled in the city, they sent for us. That was a turning-point in our friendship. Although we shared the same room, my grandmother no longer came to school with me. I used to go to an English school in a motor bus. There were no dogs in the streets and she took to feeding sparrows in the courtyard of our city house. As the years rolled by we saw less of each other. For some time she continued to wake me up and get me ready for school. When I came back she would ask me what the teacher had taught me. I would tell her English words and little things of western science and learning, the law of gravity, Archimedes' Principle, the world being round, etc. This made her unhappy. She could not help me with my lessons. She did not believe in the things they taught at the English school and was distressed that there was no teaching about God and the scriptures.

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Q.357 Why did the grandmother accompany her grandson to school every day?

(a) To spend more time with him
(b) To ensure he wouldn't run away to play in the streets
(c) To read scriptures in the temple while he studied
(d) To keep him safe from stray dogs

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) To read scriptures in the temple while he studied
How to locate the answer
Text: "the school was attached to the temple ... my grandmother **sat inside reading the scriptures**" while the children studied.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) spend time / (b) stop him playing / (d) protect from dogs** – not the reason given.

Q.358 What does the narrator refer to as the 'turning point'?

(a) He and his grandmother shifting to the city
(b) Grandmother feeding sparrows
(c) Learning western science
(d) Going to an English school

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He and his grandmother shifting to the city
How to locate the answer
Text: "When my parents were comfortably settled in the city, they sent for us. **That was a turning-point** in our friendship." So moving to the city was the turning point.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) feeding sparrows, (c) western science, (d) English school** – results of the move, not the turning point itself.

Q.359 Grandmother sang the morning prayer in a monotonous tone so that:

(a) her melodious voice echoed in the house
(b) her children would return home soon
(c) her grandson would learn it too
(d) her grandson would wake up with the sound

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) her grandson would learn it too
How to locate the answer
Text: "She said her morning prayer in a monotonous sing-song ... **in the hope that I would listen and get to know it by heart**." So she sang it hoping her grandson would learn it.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** melodious voice, **(b)** children returning, **(d)** to wake him – none is the stated reason.

Q.360 What kind of woman was the grandmother?

(a) Religious **(b)** Illiterate
(c) Modern **(d)** Self-centred

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Religious
How to locate the answer

Explanation (contd.)
The grandmother prayed daily, read the scriptures, and was "distressed that there was no teaching about God and the scriptures." This shows she was **religious**.
Why the others are wrong
• **Illiterate** – she read scriptures, so she could read.
• **Modern** – opposite; she disliked western learning.
• **Self-centred** – she was caring (fed dogs, birds, looked after the boy).

Q.361 Why did grandmother carry stale chapattis with her?

(a) To feed the stray dogs
(b) To give away to poor people
(c) To serve as her lunch
(d) To feed her grandson

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) To feed the stray dogs
How to locate the answer
Text: "She carried several stale chapattis with her **for the village dogs**."
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) poor people / (c) her lunch / (d) her grandson** – the passage says the chapattis were for the dogs.

Passage 67 (Q.362–Q.366)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

The methods of embalming, or treating the dead body, that the ancient Egyptians used is called 'mummification'. Using special processes, the Egyptians removed all moisture from the body, leaving only a dried form that would not easily decay. It was important in their religion to preserve the dead body in as life-like a manner as possible.

The mummification process took seventy days. Special priests worked as embalmers, treating and wrapping the body. Beyond knowing the correct rituals and prayers to be performed at various stages, the priests also needed a detailed knowledge of human anatomy. The first step in the process was the removal of all internal parts that might decay rapidly. The brain was removed by carefully inserting special hooked instruments up through the nostrils in order to pull out bits of brain tissue. The embalmers then removed the organs of the abdomen and chest through a cut usually made on the left side of the abdomen. They left only the heart in place, believing it to be the center of a person's being and intelligence. The other organs were preserved separately, with the stomach, liver, lungs and intestines placed in special boxes or jars, today called 'canopic jars'. These were buried with the mummy.

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Passage (contd.)

The embalmers next removed all moisture from the body. This they did by covering the body with 'natron', a type of salt which has great drying properties, and by placing additional natron packets inside the body. When the body had dried out completely, embalmers removed the internal packets and lightly washed the natron off the body. The result was a very dried-out but recognizable human form. To make the mummy seem even more life-like, sunken areas of the body were filled out with linen and other materials and false eyes were added.

Next the wrapping began. Each mummy needed hundreds of yards of linen. The priests carefully wound the long strips of linen around the body, sometimes even wrapping each finger and toe separately before wrapping the entire hand or foot. In order to protect the dead from mishap in after life, amulets were placed among the wrappings and prayers and magical words written on some of the linen strips. Often the priests placed a mask of the person's face between the layers of head bandages. At last, the priests wrapped the final cloth or shroud in place and secured it with linen strips. The mummy was complete. It was then placed in the tomb along with food, furniture, vessels, perfumes, jewels and other things required in the afterlife.

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Q.362 Which of the following was NOT buried with the mummies?

(a) Embalmers **(b)** Amulets
(c) Perfumes **(d)** Canopic jars

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Embalmers
How to locate the answer (NOT-buried question)
Buried with the mummy were **canopic jars, amulets, perfumes** (and food, jewels...). The **embalmers** were the priests who did the work — they were **not** buried. So (a) is the answer.

Q.363 Mummification was done to:

(a) test the drying properties of natron
(b) perform rituals and prayers
(c) study the cause of death
(d) preserve dead bodies in a life-like manner

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) preserve dead bodies in a life-like manner
How to locate the answer
Text: "It was important in their religion to **preserve the dead body in as life-like a manner as possible**."
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) test natron, (b) rituals, (c) study death** – details in the process, not the purpose.

Q.364 Hooked instruments were inserted through the nostrils to extract the:

(a) brain **(b)** heart
(c) lungs **(d)** liver

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) brain
How to locate the answer
Text: "The **brain** was removed by carefully inserting special **hooked instruments up through the nostrils** ..."
Why the others are wrong
• **heart** – was left in place; **lungs, liver** – removed through an abdominal cut, not the nose.

Q.365 What was the initial step in the process of mummification?

(a) Wrapping the body with strips of linen
(b) Completely drying the body
(c) Removal of the internal parts
(d) Placing a face mask between the head bandages

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Removal of the internal parts
How to locate the answer
Text: "The **first step** in the process was the **removal of all internal parts** that might decay rapidly."
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) wrapping, (b) drying, (d) face mask** – all later steps.

Q.366 Why was the knowledge of anatomy important for the priests?

(a) To remove internal organs from the body
(b) To delay the decay of the body for seventy days
(c) To place natron packets in the body
(d) To wrap each part of the body

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) To remove internal organs from the body
How to locate the answer
Text: "the priests also needed a detailed knowledge of human anatomy" — needed **to remove the internal organs** correctly (brain through the nose, organs through the abdomen).
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) delay decay, (c) natron packets, (d) wrapping** – do not require deep anatomy knowledge like organ removal does.

Passage 68 (Q.367–Q.371)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

When Tao Ying rides on the bus alone, quite often she does not bother to buy a ticket. Why should she? Without her, the bus would still be stopping at every stop, a driver and a conductor would still have to be employed, and the same amount of petrol used. Clearly Tao Ying has to be astute. When the bus conductor looked like the responsible type, she would buy a ticket as soon as she got on board. But if he appeared to be casual and careless, she would not dream of paying, considering it a small punishment for him and a little saving for herself.

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Passage (contd.)

Today she is with her son Xiao Ye. She follows him onto the bus. As the doors shut her jacket is caught, ballooning up like a tent behind her. She twists this way and that, finally wrenching herself free. 'Mama, tickets!' Xiao Ye says. Children are often more conscious of rituals than adults. Without a ticket in his hand, the ride doesn't count as a proper ride. On the peeling paint of the door somebody has painted the shape of a pale finger. It points at a number: 1.10 m. Between Xiao Ye 's round head and the tip of the painted digit setting out the height requirement for a ticket rests the beautiful slender fingers of Tao Ying. 'Xiao Ye, you are not quite tall enough, still one centimetre away,' she tells him softly.

'Mama! I'm tall enough, I'm tall enough!' Xiao Ye shouts at the top of his voice, stamping on the floor as if it were a tin drum. 'You told me the last time I could have a ticket the next time, this is the next time. You don't keep your word!' He looks up at his mother angrily. Tao Ying looks down at her son. A ticket costs twenty cents. Twenty cents is not to be scoffed at. It can buy a cucumber, two tomatoes or, at a reduced price, three bunches of radishes or enough spinach to last four days. But Xiao Ye's face is raised up like a half-open blossom, waiting to receive his promise from the sun. She says, 'Two tickets, please.' The fierce conductor has beady eyes. 'This child is one centimetre short of requiring a ticket.'

Xiao Ye shrinks, not just one but several centimetres— the need for a ticket has all of a sudden become interwoven with the pride of a small child. To be able to purchase self-esteem with twenty cents is something that can only happen in childhood and certainly no mother can resist an opportunity to make her son happy. 'I would like to buy two tickets,' she says politely.

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Q.367 Xiao Ye was eager to buy a bus ticket because he:

(a) was very responsible
(b) had saved money for it
(c) had grown taller than 1.10 m
(d) wanted to feel like a grown up

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) wanted to feel like a grown up

How to locate the answer

A ticket makes "the ride ... count as a proper ride"; it is tied to "the pride of a small child" — the boy wants to feel **grown up**.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) responsible, (b) saved money, (c) grown taller** – he was actually 1 cm short, so (c) is false; the real reason is childish pride.

Q.368 "Xiao Ye shrinks, not just one but several centimetres" – Why?

(a) He feels humiliated and hurt
(b) He is angry with the conductor
(c) He feels happy at his achievement
(d) He feels proud of his height

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He feels humiliated and hurt

How to locate the answer

The conductor announces the boy is "one centimetre short", so his pride is wounded. "Xiao Ye shrinks ... the need for a ticket has ... become interwoven with the pride of a small child." He feels **humiliated and hurt**.

Why the others are wrong

• **(b) angry, (c) happy, (d) proud** – opposite of "shrinks" (feels small).

Q.369 Why does Tao Ying buy two tickets?

(a) To show off her wealth
.
(b) To make her son happy
.
(c) To make up for the times when she didn't buy a ticket.
(d) To spite the conductor
.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To make her son happy

.

How to locate the answer

The child badly wants a ticket; the passage says "no mother can resist an opportunity to make her son happy", so Tao Ying buys two tickets **to make her son happy**.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) show off wealth, (c) make up for past, (d) spite the conductor** – none is the reason given.

Q.370 For the child, the ticket was a symbol of:

(a) self esteem **(b)** courage
(c) determination **(d)** freedom

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) self esteem

How to locate the answer

Text: "To be able to **purchase self-esteem** with twenty cents is something that can only happen in childhood." So the ticket symbolised **self-esteem**.

Why the others are wrong

• **courage / determination / freedom** – not the idea linked to the ticket in the passage.

Q.371 Which of the following statements is NOT true?

(a) Twenty cents was a sum that mattered to Tao Ying.
(b) Tao Ying actually needed to buy two tickets.
(c) Tao Ying was travelling with her son.
(d) Tao Ying boarded the bus after her son.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Tao Ying actually needed to buy two tickets.

How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)

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Explanation (contd.)
The boy was "one centimetre short of requiring a ticket", so she **did not actually need** to buy his ticket — she bought it to please him. So (b) is **false**.

Why the others are true
• **(a)** twenty cents mattered to her – stated; **(c)** she was with her son – stated; **(d)** she boarded after her son ("She follows him onto the bus") – stated.

Passage 69 (Q.372–Q.376)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Vasco Da Gama was the first European to find an ocean trading route to India. He accomplished what many explorers before him could not do. His discovery of this sea route helped the Portuguese establish a long-lasting colonial empire in Asia and Africa. The new ocean route around Africa allowed Portuguese sailors to avoid the Arab trading hold in the Mediterranean and Middle East. Vasco da Gama opened a new world of riches by opening up an Indian Ocean route. His voyage and explorations helped change the world for Europeans.

Vasco da Gama's maritime career was during the period when Portugal was searching for a trade route around Africa to India. The Ottoman Empire controlled almost all European trade routes to Asia. This meant they could, and did, charge high prices for ships passing through ports. When Manuel I became King of Portugal in 1495, he continued efforts to open a trade route to India by going around Africa. Although other people were considered for the job, Manuel I finally chose 37-year-old Vasco da Gama for this task.

On 8 July 1497, Vasco da Gama sailed from Lisbon with a fleet of four ships and a crew of 170 men. Da Gama commanded the Sao Gabriel. Paulo da Gama – brother to Vasco – commanded the São Rafael, a three mast ship. They sailed past the Canary Islands, and reached the Cape Verde islands and then continued sailing, though storms still delayed them for a while. They rounded the cape of Good Hope on 22 November and anchored at Mossel Bay, South Africa. They began sailing again and continued until they reached the Rio dos Bons Sinais (River of Good Omens). Here they erected a statue in the name of Portugal.

They stayed here for a month because much of the crew were sick from scurvy – a disease caused by lack of Vitamin C. Da Gama's fleet eventually began sailing again. Finally, on 20 May 1498 they reached India. They headed for Kappad, near the large city of Calicut. In Calicut, da Gama met with the king. But the king of Calicut was not impressed with da Gama, and the gifts he brought as offering. They spent several months trading in India, and studying their customs. They left India at the end of August.

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Q.372 Which of the following statements is NOT true?

(a) Vasco da Gama impressed the King of Calicut with his gifts.
(b) Vasco da Gama was the commander of the ship, Sao Gabriel
.
(c) Scurvy is caused by deficiency of vitamin C.
(d) Sao Rafael was a ship with three masts.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Vasco da Gama impressed the King of Calicut with his gifts.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
Text: "the king of Calicut was **not impressed** with da Gama, and the gifts he brought." So (a) is **false**.
Why the others are true
• **(b)** he commanded the Sao Gabriel, **(c)** scurvy = Vitamin C deficiency, **(d)** São Rafael was a three-mast ship – all stated.

Q.373 In which month did Vasco da Gama's ship reach the Cape of Good Hope?

(a) May **(b)** August
(c) November **(d)** July

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) November
How to locate the answer
Text: "They rounded the cape of Good Hope on **22 November** ..."
Why the others are wrong
• **May** – they reached India (20 May 1498); **July** – they set sail from Lisbon (8 July 1497); **August** – they left India.

Q.374 Why did Vasco da Gama's crew stay at Rio dos Bons Sinais for a month?

(a) Several crew members were suffering from scurvy.
(b) There were severe storms in the area.
(c) To erect a statue in the name of Portugal
.
(d) It was an auspicious place.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Several crew members were suffering from scurvy.
How to locate the answer
Text: "They stayed here for a month because much of the crew were **sick from scurvy** – a disease caused by lack of Vitamin C."
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) storms, (c) statue, (d) auspicious** – not the reason for the month-long halt.

Q.375 From where did Vasco da Gama embark upon his journey?

(a) Cape of Good Hope **(b)** Canary Islands
(c) Lisbon **(d)** Mossel Bay

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Lisbon
How to locate the answer
Text: "On 8 July 1497, Vasco da Gama **sailed from Lisbon** with a fleet of four ships ..."
Why the others are wrong

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Explanation (contd.)
• **Cape of Good Hope, Canary Islands, Mossel Bay** – places he passed **during** the voyage, not the starting point.

Q.376 Who controlled the European trade routes to Asia before 1497?

(a) King of Calicut **(b)** Ottoman Empire
(c) Manuel I **(d)** Paulo da Gama

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Ottoman Empire
How to locate the answer
Text: "The **Ottoman Empire controlled almost all European trade routes to Asia**" and charged high prices.
Why the others are wrong
• **King of Calicut / Manuel I / Paulo da Gama** – none is said to control the trade routes.

Passage 70 (Q.377–Q.381)
Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

A book by the Indian ambassador in the Netherlands highlights the historical and current exchanges that define the relationship between the two countries. The first book in which Malayalam appears in print is the 'Hortus Malabaricus' (Garden of Malabar), a 12-volume treatise, written in Latin and published in Amsterdam from 1678 to1693. Compiled over a period of 30 years, under directions from Hendrik van Rheede, a naturalist and colonial administrator, who was at the time the governor of Dutch Malabar, the Hortus Malabaricus gives a comprehensive account of the flora of the Malabar region, along with their properties and detailed sketches. Malayalam appears in this multilingual book, along with other languages that were common currency at the time, including Arabic and Konkani.

The Hortus Malabaricus was an important document of its time, as Venu Rajamony writes in his new book 'India and the Netherlands: Past, Present and Future', "the product of a multinational and multicultural team of botanical experts." Yet, it remained lost to the public until a botany scholar from Calicut, KS Manilal, learned Latin and translated it first into English in 2003 and into Malayalam in 2008. Highlighting such instances of the Indo-Dutch artistic and cultural exchange through the last 400 years was the prime reason why Rajamony, who has been the Ambassador of India to the Netherlands, thought of writing this book. The book was released on 30 September 2019.

Passage (contd.)
The connection between India and the Netherlands begins with the Dutch Golden Age, when the latter was a flourishing centre for commercial and artistic endeavours. Following Spain, Portugal and Great Britain, it also emerged as one of the great maritime nations of the world, establishing a far-flung empire thanks to the ventures of the Dutch East India Company. Over the course of his research for the book, Rajamony says, one of the things that surprised him was how taken the great Dutch master Rembrandt was with Indian miniature paintings, collecting them and even making drawings inspired by them. "I was pleasantly surprised to discover this as Rembrandt is considered an absolute master, who would only have made originals. It is very rare that a master like him would copy other artworks," says Rajamony. According to him, this fact is indicative of the high esteem in which Indian art was held in Europe.

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Q.377 What inspired Rajamony to write his new book 'India and the Netherlands: Past, Present and Future'?

(a) The fact that 'Hortus Malabaricus' remained lost to the world for almost three centuries.
(b) His being the ambassador of India to the Netherlands.
(c) The rule of the Dutch East India Company over Malabar in the 17th century.
(d) Instances of the Indo-Dutch artistic and cultural exchange through the last 400 years.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Instances of the Indo-Dutch artistic and cultural exchange through the last 400 years.
How to locate the answer
Direct line: "Highlighting such instances of the Indo-Dutch artistic and cultural exchange through the last 400 years was the prime reason why Rajamony ... thought of writing this book." That is the inspiration.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** the book being lost for centuries – a detail, not his motive.
• **(b)** his being ambassador – his position, not his inspiration.
• **(c)** Dutch East India Company's rule – background information only.

Q.378 "it also emerged as one of the great maritime nations of the world." Here the word 'it' refers to:

(a) The Netherlands **(b)** India
(c) Spain **(d)** Portugal

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The Netherlands
How to locate the answer
Read: "the Dutch Golden Age, when the latter was a flourishing centre ... Following Spain, Portugal and Great Britain, **it** also emerged as one of the great maritime nations." Here "the latter / it" = **the Netherlands** (the Dutch).
Why the others are wrong
• **India** – the passage is praising the Dutch sea power, not India.

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Explanation (contd.)
• **Spain / Portugal** – they are named as the nations the Netherlands **followed**, so "it" cannot be them.

Q.379 Which of the following about Rembrant greatly surprised Rajamony and also made him happy?

(a) That Rembrandt was a great Dutch artist
(b) That Rembrandt had inspired the Indian miniature paintings
(c) That Rembrandt, considered as the master, copied the Indian miniature paintings
(d) That Rembrandt collected Indian miniature paintings

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) That Rembrandt, considered as the master, copied the Indian miniature paintings
How to locate the answer
Find the lines about Rembrandt: "one of the things that surprised him was how taken the great Dutch master Rembrandt was with Indian miniature paintings ... even making drawings inspired by them. 'I was pleasantly surprised to discover this ... It is very rare that a master like him would copy other artworks.'"
So the fact that both **surprised** and **pleased** Rajamony is that a great master like Rembrandt **copied** Indian miniatures.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** Rembrandt being a great artist – already known, not surprising.
• **(b)** Rembrandt inspiring Indian paintings – reverse of what the text says.
• **(d)** He collected them – true, but the "pleasant surprise" was specifically about a master **copying** others' art.

Q.380 Which statement is NOT true about 'Hortus Malabaricus'?

(a) It was a product of a multinational and multicultural team of botanical experts.
(b) It gives a comprehensive account of the life in the Malabar region.
(c) It is a 12-volume treatise, written in Latin.
(d) Many languages like Malayalam, Konkani and Arabic appear in the book.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) It gives a comprehensive account of the life in the Malabar region.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
The passage says Hortus Malabaricus "gives a comprehensive account of the **flora** (plants) of the Malabar region" — NOT of "life". So option (b) twists "flora" into "life" and is therefore **false**.
Why the others are true (so, not the answer)
• **(a)** "product of a multinational and multicultural team" – stated in the text.
• **(c)** "a 12-volume treatise, written in Latin" – stated.
• **(d)** Malayalam, Konkani, Arabic appear – stated.

Q.381 The passage is mainly about:

(a) the book written by the Indian ambassador
(b) the historical relationship between India and the Netherlands
(c) the treatise 'Hortus Malabaricus' published in the Netherlands
(d) Rajamony, the Indian ambassador to the Netherlands

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) the historical relationship between India and the Netherlands
How to locate the answer
The opening line sets the theme: the book "highlights the historical and current exchanges that define the relationship between the two countries." Every example — Hortus Malabaricus, Rembrandt — proves this India–Netherlands bond.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) the book / (d) Rajamony** – these are the vehicles used to discuss the theme, not the theme itself.
• **(c) Hortus Malabaricus** – only one example within the larger topic of the relationship.

Passage 71 (Q.382–Q.386)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Love of power is, perhaps, an even stronger motive than fear in enticing nations to pursue irrational policies. Although individual boastfulness is considered to be bad manners, national boastfulness is admired at any rate, by the compatriots of those who practise it. Throughout history, great nations have been led to disaster by unwillingness to admit that their power had limits. World conquest has been a will-o'-the-wisp by which one nation after another has been led to its downfall. Hitler's Germany is the most recent example. Going backwards in time, we find many other examples, of which Napoleon, Genghis Khan, and Attila are the most noteworthy. When Khrushchev threatens to obliterate the West, I am reminded of past examples of a similar folly.

To spread ruin, misery and death throughout one's own country as well as that of the enemy is the act of madmen. If East and West could cease their enmity, they could devote their scientific skill to their own welfare, to living without the burden of fear that only their own folly has caused. For it is in the hearts of men that the evil lies. The trouble lies in the minds often, and it is in enlightening the minds of men that the cure must be sought.

There are those who say: 'War is part of human nature, and human nature cannot be changed. If war means the end of man, we must sigh and submit.' This is always said by those whose sigh is hypocritical. It is undeniable that there are men and nations to whom violence is attractive, but it is not the case that anything in human nature makes it impossible to restrain such men and nations. Individuals who have a taste for homicide are restrained by the criminal law, and most of us do not find life intolerable because we are not allowed to commit murders. The same is true of nations. Sweden has never been at war since 1814.

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Passage (contd.)
None of the Swedes that I have known has shown any sign of suffering from thwarted instinct for lack of war. Political contests in a civilized country often raise just the kind of issues that would lead to war if they were between different nations. Not long ago, private disputes were often settled by duels, and those who upheld duelling maintained that its abolition would be contrary to human nature. They forgot, as present upholders of war forget, that what is called 'human nature' is, in the main, the result of custom and tradition and education, and, in civilized men, only a very tiny fraction is due to primitive instinct. If the world could live for a few generations without war, war would come to seem as absurd as duelling has come to seem to us.

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Q.382 Which of the following statements is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) Homicidal tendencies of people can be restrained by criminal laws.
(b) If nations could forget their enmity they could live in peace without fear.
(c) War cannot be eradicated from the world because it is in the human nature.
(d) As far as war is concerned, the trouble lies in the minds of men.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) War cannot be eradicated from the world because it is in the human nature.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
The author argues the **opposite**: "it is not the case that anything in human nature makes it impossible to restrain such men and nations." He believes war **can** be curbed. So (c) contradicts the passage → NOT true.
Why the others are true
• **(a)** "Individuals who have a taste for homicide are restrained by the criminal law" – stated.
• **(b)** if East & West cease enmity they can live without fear – stated.
• **(d)** "the trouble lies in the minds of men" – stated.

Q.383 In this passage the author:

(a) thinks that man's nature is unchangeable
(b) suggests that man's instinct for fighting can find expression in duels
(c) explains that by nature man is fond of war
(d) doesn't think that there is any element in human nature that cannot be curbed

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) doesn't think that there is any element in human nature that cannot be curbed
How to locate the answer
Key line: "it is not the case that anything in human nature makes it impossible to restrain such men and nations." Meaning: **every** violent tendency can be controlled. That matches option (d).
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** nature is unchangeable – the author denies this.

Explanation (contd.)
• **(b)** fighting can find expression in duels – he says duelling is now seen as absurd.
• **(c)** man is fond of war by nature – opposite of his view.

Q.384 Match the words with their closest meanings.
a. obliterate 1. fraudulent
b. entice 2.eradicate
c. hypocritical 3. lure

(a) a-2, b-1, c-3 **(b)** a-2, b-3, c-1
(c) a-1, b-3, c-2 **(d)** a-3, b-2, c-1

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a-2, b-3, c-1
Type: Vocabulary Matching
Match each word with its closest meaning:
• **a. obliterate** = to destroy completely → **2. eradicate** (मिटा देना).
• **b. entice** = to tempt/attract → **3. lure** (लुभाना).
• **c. hypocritical** = pretending false virtue → **1. fraudulent / false** (पाखंडी, कपटी).
So the correct pairing is **a-2, b-3, c-1**.

Q.385 According to the passage, war would seem absurd to us if:

(a) we have political contests among nations
(b) we settle our disputes by organising duels
(c) we impose limitations on the people through law
(d) we could live without fighting wars for a few years

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) we could live without fighting wars for a few years
How to locate the answer
Last line: "If the world could live for a few generations without war, war would come to seem as absurd as duelling has come to seem to us." So living without war for some time would make war look absurd.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a) political contests / (b) duels / (c) law** – used only as comparisons, not as the condition that makes war seem absurd.

Q.386 Many countries have been led to their downfall because their leaders:

(a) have not accepted that their powers have limits
(b) have not been very capable
(c) have under-estimated their power
(d) have boasted of their scientific skills

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) have not accepted that their powers have limits
How to locate the answer
Text: "great nations have been led to disaster by unwillingness to admit that their power had limits." So leaders failed because they would not accept that their power is **limited**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b) not capable / (c) under-estimated power / (d) boasted of scientific skills** – none is given as the cause of downfall; the cause is refusing to admit limits.

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Passage 72 (Q.387–Q.391)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Panchen Lama was just six years old when he was allegedly abducted by the Chinese government on 17 May 1995, along with his family members, after he was recognised by the Dalai Lama as the reincarnation of the 10th Panchen Lama.

On the 25th anniversary of his disappearance, the Tibetan government-in-exile on Sunday demanded China to release the 11th Panchen Lama Gedhun Choekyi Nyima, considered to be a reincarnation of Bodhisattva Amitabha.

In a statement issue here, the President of the exiled government, Lobsang Sangay, said China's abduction of the Panchen Lama and forcible denial of his religious identity and the right to practice in his monastery is not only a violation of religious freedom but also a gross violation of human rights.

After orchestrating the disappearance of the 11th Panchen Lama, Sangay alleged that China, a self-declared atheist government and infamous for its persecution of religious groups, placed a young boy, Gyaltsen Norbu, as their own 11th Panchen Lama.

"This politically-motivated action failed, however, to displace the position of the true Panchen Lama from the hearts and minds of the Tibetan people. For Tibetans and Buddhists around the world, Gedhun Choekyi Nyima will always be the true Panchen Lama," he added.

Today marks the 25th anniversary of the 11th Panchen Lama's disappearance, said Sangay, adding that 25 years is a significant time in an individual's life.

He said the communist government must honour its claim of ethnic harmony in China by fulfilling the aspirations of the Tibetan people.

"It must right the wrong and release the 11th Panchen Lama along with his family, Chadrel Rinpoche, and all Tibetans unjustly imprisoned," he said while appealing to the international community to make a concerted effort to press China to release Nyima and resolve the critical human rights situation in Tibet.

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Q.387 What is the demand of the Tibetan Government-in-exile?

(a) China should celebrate the 25th anniversary of the 11th Panchen Lama's disappearance.
(b) China should place Gyaltsen Norbu as the 11th Panchen Lama.
(c) China should recognise Panchen Lama as the reincarnation of Bodhisattva.
(d) China should release the 11th Panchen Lama along with his family.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) China should release the 11th Panchen Lama along with his family.

How to locate the answer

The demand is stated twice, clearly: "It must ... release the 11th Panchen Lama along with his family, Chadrel Rinpoche, and all Tibetans unjustly imprisoned."

Explanation (contd.)

Why the others are wrong

• **(a)** celebrate the anniversary, **(b)** place Gyaltsen Norbu, **(c)** recognise a reincarnation – none is the demand; the demand is **release**.

Q.388 Select the option which is NOT true.
The abduction of Panchen Lama and his family by China is an act of:

(a) gross violation of human rights
(b) persecution of a religious group
(c) violation of religious freedom of Tibetans
(d) establishing ethnic harmony

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) establishing ethnic harmony

How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)

The abduction is described as "a violation of religious freedom ... a gross violation of human rights" and part of China's *"persecution of religious groups."* It is the **opposite** of "establishing ethnic harmony", so (d) is NOT true.

Why the others are true

• **(a)** gross violation of human rights, **(b)** persecution of a religious group, **(c)** violation of religious freedom – all stated in the passage.

Q.389 "This politically-motivated action failed." Which action is being referred to here?

(a) Persecution of religious groups by the Chinese government
(b) Abduction of Panchen Lama along with his family
(c) Placing of Gyaltsen Norbu as the 11th Panchen Lama by China
(d) Imprisonment of Chadrel Rinpoche and other Tibetans

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Placing of Gyaltsen Norbu as the 11th Panchen Lama by China

How to locate the answer

Just before the line, the text says China "placed a young boy, Gyaltsen Norbu, as their own 11th Panchen Lama." Then: *"This politically-motivated action failed ..."* → the "action" = installing Gyaltsen Norbu.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) persecution / (b) abduction / (d) imprisonment** – mentioned elsewhere, but "this action" points to the immediately preceding sentence about Gyaltsen Norbu.

Q.390 After reading this passage, it can be inferred that it is:

(a) an appeal **(b)** a news item
(c) a government statement **(d)** an article

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a news item

How to locate the answer (inference)

The passage reports an event with a **date, quotes and a spokesperson** (Lobsang Sangay's statements on the 25th anniversary). This reporting style is that of a **news item**.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a)** an appeal – only one part quotes an appeal; the whole is a report.

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Explanation (contd.)
• **(c)** a government statement – it *reports* a statement, it is not one.
• **(d)** an article – an article gives the writer's own analysis; here facts are merely reported.

Q.391 What is the real name of the Panchen Lama imprisoned by China?

(a) Bodhisattva Amitabha **(b)** Gyaltsen Norbu
(c) Lobsang Sangay **(d)** Gedhun Choekyi Nyima

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Gedhun Choekyi Nyima
How to locate the answer
Text: "the 11th Panchen Lama **Gedhun Choekyi Nyima**" is the boy abducted by China. That is his real name.
Why the others are wrong
• **Bodhisattva Amitabha** – the being he is a reincarnation of, not his name.
• **Gyaltsen Norbu** – the boy China wrongly installed.
• **Lobsang Sangay** – President of the Tibetan government-in-exile.

Passage 73 (Q.392–Q.396)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Western MP has received 1,335.4 millimetres of average rainfall from June 1 to September 25, 58% more than the region's historical normal of 845.3 mm for this period. However, the real story lies in the month-wise figures. In June, the opening month of the southwest monsoon season, the rains were actually 25.6% below the long-period average. In July, they were 31.2% above average. That surplus rose to 63.6% in August, while a whopping 158% more, so far in September.

The monsoon has taken its toll mainly on soyabean. According to the Union agriculture ministry's data, a total area of 113.449 lakh hectares (lh) has been planted under this leguminous oilseed in the current kharif season, with the bulk of it accounted for by MP (55.16 lh), Maharashtra (39.595 lh) and Rajasthan (10.608 lh). Within MP, the main soyabean-growing districts are Ujjain, Dewas, Indore, Dhar, Ratlam, Mandsaur, Rajgarh, Shajapur, Sehore and Vidisha. The crop in low-lying areas is the one that has been worst affected.

"Farmers who had sown early-maturity (80-90 days duration) varieties such as JS 9560 and JS 2034 just after mid-June will take the biggest hit. Their crop would already have matured; the longer it remains in the field, the more the chances of the grain rotting. Also, these farmers will not be able to save this grain for using as seed next year," admits V S Bhatia, director of the Indian Institute of Soyabean Research at Indore.

Passage (contd.)

On the other hand, longer-duration varieties maturing in 95-105 days, like JS 20-69, NRC 86 and JS 97-52, are unlikely to suffer major yield loss, as their grain is not fully ripe yet for harvesting. Moreover, since the rains were poor in June, much of sowing anyway took place in July, thereby further reducing the likelihood of damage. "The vegetative growth and pod formation has been very good. As of now, the overall loss may be 10-15% and the areas where the crop is still good should compensate for those badly impacted," adds Bhatia.

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Q.392 Why would the farmers who sowed their crop in June be the worst hit?

(a) They sowed their crop in low lying areas.
(b) Their crop would already be mature and could rot in the rain.
(c) They had sowed a late maturing variety of soyabean.
(d) When they sowed their crop there wasn't enough rain.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Their crop would already be mature and could rot in the rain.
How to locate the answer
Text: "Their crop would already have matured; the longer it remains in the field, the more the chances of the grain **rotting**." Early-sown (June) crop matures early and rots in the heavy rain.
Why the others are wrong
• **(a)** low-lying areas – a separate point, not about June-sowing timing.
• **(c)** late-maturing variety – opposite; these farmers sowed early-maturing ones.
• **(d)** not enough rain – the problem is **excess** rain, not shortage.

Q.393 This passage is mainly about:

(a) the impact of rains on the soyabean crop in MP
(b) the rainfall from June to September in MP
(c) the growth of soyabean in MP
(d) the varieties of soyabean grown in MP

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) the impact of rains on the soyabean crop in MP
How to locate the answer
After giving rainfall figures, the passage focuses on how the monsoon *"has taken its toll mainly on soyabean"* — damage, varieties, yield loss. So the main idea is the **impact of the rains on MP's soyabean crop**.
Why the others are wrong
• **(b)** rainfall figures – only the starting point.
• **(c) growth / (d) varieties** of soyabean – sub-details, not the whole theme.

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Q.394 In which month, according to the passage, has the rainfall been the maximum?

(a) June **(b)** August
(c) July **(d)** September

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) September
How to locate the answer
Month-wise figures: June −25.6%, July +31.2%, August +63.6%, and "a whopping **158% more, so far in September**." The highest surplus (158%) is in **September**.
Why the others are wrong
• **June** – actually below average (−25.6%).
• **July (+31.2%) / August (+63.6%)** – high, but less than September's 158%.

Q.395 Which of the following is a short-duration variety of soyabean maturing in 80-90 days?

(a) NRC 86 **(b)** JS 20-69
(c) JS 9560 **(d)** JS 97-52

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) JS 9560
How to locate the answer
Text: "Farmers who had sown **early-maturity (80-90 days duration) varieties such as JS 9560 and JS 2034** ..." So the 80–90 day (short-duration) variety is **JS 9560**.
Why the others are wrong
• **NRC 86, JS 20-69, JS 97-52** – these are listed as **longer-duration** varieties (95–105 days).

Q.396 Which statement is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) In July, the rainfall was 63.6% above average.
(b) The longer-duration variety of soyabean will not suffer much due to this excessive rain.
(c) The rainfall in June was poor in MP.
(d) The crops in low-lying areas were worst affected by rains.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) In July, the rainfall was 63.6% above average.
How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)
The passage says July was **+31.2%**, and it was **August** that rose to **+63.6%**. So option (a) wrongly shifts August's figure to July → **false**.
Why the others are true
• **(b)** longer-duration varieties "unlikely to suffer major yield loss" – stated.
• **(c)** June rains were poor (−25.6%) – stated.
• **(d)** low-lying crop "worst affected" – stated.

Passage 74 (Q.397–Q.401)
Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

Passage (contd.)
First, thousands of flamingos coloured the Talawe wetlands near NRI Complex in Navi Mumbai pink during the lockdown, their numbers bolstered by the sheer lack of human activity. Now, the water in part of the wetland itself has turned pink, probably due to an explosive blooming of red algae that thrives in saline water, especially as the summer picks up and the wetland loses water.

The deep pink water, located towards the south-eastern end of the wetland, was spotted on14 May 2020. The pink water was not there till late last week. The bloom has been identified as a rare and first-of-its-kind occurrence for Mumbai Metropolitan Region by Bombay Natural History Society (BNHS) that plans to take samples of the water for study. However, a local resident, Seema Tania from NRI Complex, Seawoods, said she had spotted the pink wash across a much larger area at the same creek in 2016."Almost 500-600m patch of the creek turned bright pink and we thought chemicals had been dumped in the creek," she said.

BNHS and independent microbiologists presume that the colour is from microscopic algae. "Owing to high salinity in the area, it looks like an algal bloom. Our researchers have never witnessed something like this along Mumbai's creeks," said Deepak Apte, director, BNHS. "Around the world, such a phenomena has been observed regularly with red algae but it has to be investigated how it has appeared along the Mumbai creek."

Flamingos are known to feed on this algae, crustaceans, shrimp, and aquatic plants, which gives them the pink colour, said Apte. Dr P Sathiyaselvam, assistant director (wetland conservation), BNHS said, "This is clearly an algal bloom. We have observed the same at the northern portion of Chilika Lake (in Odisha) during early winter months over the years, and also towards the northern end of wetlands in Thoothukudi in Tamil Nadu." "This is a natural phenomenon. Vigorous growth of algae or bacteria having beta-carotene gives this type of characteristic colouration to the water. It is also related to increased evaporation, salinity, and the current hot and humid weather conditions," said Rahul Khot, assistant director (in-charge of the flamingo monitoring program).

Ornithologist, naturalist and writer Sunjoy Monga said a similar discolouration of water with a pink hue was witnessed at a flamingo habitat in Porbandar in May 2007. "This happened at the edges of the creek cramped with flamingos with high salinity displaying a pinkish maroon wash to it." A similar example of what has been observed in Navi Mumbai was recently witnessed across a massive stretch at the Edgars Creek in Melbourne, Australia, that started on 10 Mayand intensified subsequently. The source of the pink water is being investigated, the Epoch Times reported. Other examples of changing water colour to pink across a much larger area has been observed at Cameron Falls in Waterton Lakes National Park, Canada and the Dead Sea, a salt lake between Israel and Jordan, to name a few.

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Q.397 The explanation for the pink water, as given by most scientists, is that it is due to:

(a) shrimps, crustaceans and some aquatic plants
(b) highly humid and hot weather conditions
(c) the chemicals dumped in the creek
(d) an explosion of red algae blooming in the saline water

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) an explosion of red algae blooming in the saline water

How to locate the answer

The very first paragraph gives the scientific reason: the pink is "probably due to an explosive blooming of red algae that thrives in saline water." All scientists quoted agree it is an **algal bloom**.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a) shrimps/crustaceans** – these give **flamingos** their colour, not the water.
• **(b) humid weather / (c) chemicals** – "chemicals" was only a resident's early guess, later rejected.

Q.398 Which of the following individuals thinks that the presence of beta-carotene in the algae gives the water its pink colour?

(a) Deepak Apte **(b)** Rahul Khot
(c) Dr. P Sathiyaselvam **(d)** Sunjoy Monga

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Rahul Khot

How to locate the answer

Search for the word "beta-carotene": "Vigorous growth of algae or bacteria having **beta-carotene** gives this type of characteristic colouration ... said **Rahul Khot**."

Why the others are wrong

• **Deepak Apte** – said it "looks like an algal bloom".
• **Dr P Sathiyaselvam** – compared it to Chilika Lake and Thoothukudi.
• **Sunjoy Monga** – spoke about Porbandar (2007).

Q.399 The main theme of the passage is:

(a) how the flamingos get their pink colour
(b) where the phenomenon of pink water occurs in the world
(c) why the water in some parts of Mumbai wetland has turned pink
(d) what the flamingos feed on

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) why the water in some parts of Mumbai wetland has turned pink

How to locate the answer

The whole passage explains the **cause** of the pink water (algal bloom, salinity, beta-carotene) and gives world examples. So the central theme is **why the Mumbai wetland water turned pink**.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a)** flamingos' colour – a side detail.
• **(b)** where it occurs worldwide – supporting examples only.
• **(d)** what flamingos feed on – a single passing line.

Q.400 Which statement is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) The phenomenon of pink water has occurred in Mumbai wetland for the first time.
(b) Similar discolouration of water with a pink hue was witnessed at a flamingo habitat in Porbandar in May 2007.
(c) The phenomenon of pink water has been seen in Chilika lake, Odisha and Thoothukudi in Tamil Nadu also.
(d) Similar phenomenon was recently witnessed across a massive stretch at the Edgars Creek in Melbourne, Australia.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The phenomenon of pink water has occurred in Mumbai wetland for the first time.

How to locate the answer (NOT-true question)

BNHS called it "first-of-its-kind", BUT a resident, Seema Tania, "said she had spotted the pink wash ... at the same creek in 2016." Since it was seen in 2016 too, "for the first time" is **false**.

Why the others are true

• **(b)** Porbandar, May 2007 – stated by Sunjoy Monga.
• **(c)** Chilika (Odisha) & Thoothukudi (TN) – stated by Sathiyaselvam.
• **(d)** Edgars Creek, Melbourne – stated near the end.

Q.401 After reading the passage, it can be inferred that the:

(a) water in Talawe wetland turned pink because of flamingos
(b) source of pink water at Edgar's creek has not yet been determined
(c) phenomenon of algal bloom is unique to Mumbai
(d) scientists are unaware of the occurrence ofred algae bloom

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) source of pink water at Edgar's creek has not yet been determined

How to locate the answer (inference)

About the Melbourne creek the text says: *"The source of the pink water is being investigated."* "Being investigated" = not yet known/determined. So (b) is a correct inference.

Why the others are wrong

• **(a)** The water turned pink due to **algae**, not flamingos.
• **(c)** Algal bloom is **not** unique to Mumbai — seen in Odisha, TN, Australia, etc.
• **(d)** Scientists are aware of red-algae blooms; they clearly explain it.

Passage 75 (Q.402–Q.406)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

One of the greatest sailing adventures of the past 25 years was the conquest of the Northwest Passage, powered by sail, human muscle, and determination. In 100 days, over three summers (1986-88), Canadians Jeff MacInnis and Mike Beedell accomplished the first wind-powered crossing of the Northwest Passage.

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Passage (contd.)

In Jeff MacInnis's words...Our third season. We weave our way through the labyrinth of ice, and in the distance we hear an unmistakable sound. A mighty bowhead whale is nearby, and its rhythmic breaths fill us with awe. Finally, we see it relaxed on the surface, its blowhole quivering like a volcanic cone, but it senses our presence and quickly sounds. We are very disappointed. We had only good intentions—to revel in its beautiful immensity and to feel its power. Mike thinks how foolish it would be for this mighty beast to put any faith in us. After all, we are members of the species that had almost sent the bowhead into extinction with our greed for whale oil and bone. It is estimated that as many as 38,000 bowheads were killed off eastern Baffin Island in the 1800s; today there are only about 200 left.

The fascinating and sometimes terrifying wildlife keeps us entertained during our explorations. Bearded harp and ring seals greet us daily. The profusion of bird life is awesome; at times we see and smell hundreds of thousands of thick billed murres clinging to their cliffside nests. Our charts show that we are on the edge of a huge shoal where the frigid ocean currents upswell and mix nutrients that provide a feast for the food chain. At times, these animals scare the living daylights out of us. They have a knack of sneaking up behind us and then shooting out of the water and belly flopping for maximum noise and splash. A horrendous splash coming from behind has a heart-stopping effect in polar bear country.

We have many encounters with the 'Lords of the Arctic', but we are always cautious, observant, and ever so respectful that we are in their domain. In some regions the land is totally devoid of life, while in others the pulse of life takes our breath away. Such is the paradox of the Arctic; its wastelands flow into oases that are found nowhere else on the face of the earth. Many times we find ancient signs of Inuit people who lived here, superbly attuned to the land. We feel great respect for them; this landscape is a challenge at every moment.

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Q.402 What is the 'paradox of Arctic', according to the passage?

(a) Some areas are valleys while others are hills.
(b) Some areas flourish with life while others are completely devoid of it.
(c) Different kinds of species of animals and birds found there.
(d) Some areas can be charted while the others cannot.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Some areas flourish with life while others are completely devoid of it.

Answer: 2 (**Some areas flourish with life while others are completely devoid of it.**)

Explanation:

The passage states:

"Such is the paradox of the Arctic; its wastelands flow into oases that are found nowhere else on the face of the earth."

This means some parts of the Arctic are barren and lifeless, while others are rich and full of life, highlighting the contrast or paradox.

Explanation (contd.)

Therefore, the correct answer is:

Some areas flourish with life while others are completely devoid of it.

Q.403 What is the central theme of the passage?

(a) Conquest of different currents and surviving a storm.
(b) Description of the sea and the creatures in it.
(c) MacInnis and Beedell's first wind-powered crossing of the Northwest Passage.
(d) How ships work and how to captain it.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) MacInnis and Beedell's first wind-powered crossing of the Northwest Passage.

Answer: 3 (**MacInnis and Beedell's first wind-powered crossing of the Northwest Passage.**)

Explanation:

The passage focuses on the sailing adventure of Jeff MacInnis and Mike Beedell as they accomplish the first wind-powered crossing of the Northwest Passage. It describes their journey, encounters with Arctic wildlife, and the challenges faced in the region.

Therefore, the central theme is their pioneering sailing expedition through the Northwest Passage.

Q.404 What emotions did the voyagers feel during their journey?

(a) Sorrow and pain
(b) Excitement and fear
(c) Confusion and fear
(d) Love and devotion

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Excitement and fear

Answer: 2 (**Excitement and fear**)

Explanation:

The passage describes awe and excitement when they encounter majestic wildlife like the bowhead whale and hundreds of thousands of birds. At the same time, it mentions moments when animals scare them ("scare the living daylights out of us") and the "heart-stopping effect in polar bear country," indicating fear.

Therefore, the voyagers experienced **both excitement and fear** during their journey.

Q.405 Select an appropriate title for the passage.

(a) Desert Oasis
(b) Voyage through Sahara
(c) Voyage through the Arctic
(d) The Sea and its Dangers

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Voyage through the Arctic

Answer: 3 (**Voyage through the Arctic**)

Explanation:

The passage describes the sailing expedition of Jeff MacInnis and Mike Beedell through the Northwest Passage in the Arctic, their encounters with Arctic wildlife, and the challenges they face in this icy region.

Therefore, **"Voyage through the Arctic"** is the most appropriate title.

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Q.406 Select the ANTONYM for 'minuteness', from the passage.

(a) Bowhead **(b)** Mighty
(c) Immensity **(d)** Conquest

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Immensity
Answer: 3 (**Immensity**)
- **Minuteness** means very smallness or minuteness.
- **Immensity** means vastness or great size; it is the direct antonym of minuteness.
- **Bowhead** – A type of whale; unrelated.
- **Mighty** – Means powerful or strong; not a direct antonym.
- **Conquest** – Means victory or achievement; unrelated.

Therefore, the antonym of **"minuteness"** is **"immensity."**

Passage 76 (Q.407–Q.410)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

India opener Smriti Mandhana broke bank early as she became the first pick in the Women's Premier League auction history, being bought by the Royal Challengers Bangalore for 3.40 Cr. A total of 87 players were bought by the five franchises for a sum total of Rs. 59.50 Cr. The second costliest Indian player so far is all-rounder Deepti Sharma who was bought by UP Warriorz for Rs 2.6 crore.

However, Indian skipper Harmanpreet Kaur came much cheaper for Mumbai Indians at nearly half the price of Mandhana at Rs 1.80 crore. Delhi Capitals get their first player of the auction as they successfully bid for Jemimah Rodrigues at Rs 2.2 crore. Indian opener and U-19 T20 World Cup winning captain Shafali Verma gets a successful bid of Rs 2 crore by Delhi Capitals.

One of the prominent picks during the first round was Australia's off-spin all-rounder Ashleigh Gardner, who was bought by Gautam Adani-owned Gujarat Giants for Rs 3.20 crore. Star Australian all-rounder Ellyse Perry received a cool Rs 1.70 crore winning bid from RCB who also got New Zealand skipper Sophie Devine cheap at the base price of Rs 50 lakh.

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Q.407 Which franchise paid the most for a player?

(a) Mumbai Indians
(b) Royal Challengers Bangalore
(c) Gujarat Giants
(d) Delhi Capitals

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Royal Challengers Bangalore
Answer: 2 (**Royal Challengers Bangalore**)
Explanation:
The passage states that Smriti Mandhana was bought by Royal Challengers Bangalore for Rs 3.40 crore, which is the highest price mentioned for any player.
Therefore, **Royal Challengers Bangalore** paid the most for a player.

Q.408 Who is the costliest player bought by UP Warriorz?

(a) Shafali Verma **(b)** Deepti Sharma
(c) Harmanpreet Kaur **(d)** Smriti Mandhana

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Deepti Sharma
Answer: 2 (**Deepti Sharma**)
Explanation:
The passage states that Deepti Sharma, an all-rounder, was bought by UP Warriorz for Rs 2.6 crore, making her the second costliest Indian player so far.
Therefore, the costliest player bought by UP Warriorz is **Deepti Sharma**.

Q.409 Match the following.
1. Ellyse Perry a. 2.2 Cr
2. Sophie Devine b. 1.7 Cr
3. Ashleigh gardner c. 3.2 Cr
4. Jemimah Rodrigues d. 0.5 Cr

(a) 1-d, 2-b, 3-c, 4-a **(b)** 1-b, 2-c, 3-a, 4-d
(c) 1-c, 2-a, 3-d, 4-b **(d)** 1-b, 2-d, 3-c, 4-a

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) 1-b, 2-d, 3-c, 4-a
Answer: 4 (**1-b, 2-d, 3-c, 4-a**)
- **Ellyse Perry** was bought for **Rs 1.7 crore** → 1-b
- **Sophie Devine** was bought for **Rs 0.5 crore (50 lakh)** → 2-d
- **Ashleigh Gardner** was bought for **Rs 3.2 crore** → 3-c
- **Jemimah Rodrigues** was bought for **Rs 2.2 crore** → 4-a

Hence, the correct matching is:
1-b, 2-d, 3-c, 4-a.

Q.410 What do you understand by 'broke bank'?

(a) chosen first **(b)** broke the record
(c) cost too much **(d)** broke the rules

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) cost too much
Answer: 3 (**cost too much**)
Explanation:
The phrase **"broke bank"** means to spend or cost a large amount of money, often more than expected or usual.
In the passage, it refers to Smriti Mandhana being bought for a very high price, indicating she **cost too much**.
Therefore, **"cost too much"** is the correct meaning of **"broke bank."**

Passage 77 (Q.411–Q.414)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

NEW DELHI: A new app developed by the external affairs ministry and rolled out in New Delhi is expected to cut the time for police verification of passport applicants to five days and reduce the scope for misuse of the process, people familiar with the matter said on Friday.

The "mPassport Police App, developed by the consular, passport and visa division of the external affairs ministry for law enforcement agencies, is being rolled out along with 350 tablets to personnel of the Special Branch of Delhi Police. These personnel are responsible for carrying out verification of antecedents of passport applicants.

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Passage (contd.)

Police verification continues to be one of the most time-consuming processes in applying for a passport and the new app is expected to cut the time taken for this – 15 days – by two-thirds, the people cited above said. This process is also linked to a number of complaints about its misuse and the app will help tackle this issue by ensuring greater transparency, the people said.

Abhishek Dubey, the regional passport officer (RPO) for Delhi, said in a statement: "Police verification is an integral part of passport issuance system. Various steps have been taken to streamline and expedite the process. To further expedite the process, the Ministry of External Affairs (MEA) introduced 'mPassport Police App'."

The people said GPS and geo-tagging while using the tablets will establish whether police officials actually visited the applicant's home for verification. Besides making the verification process more accurate and speedier, the tablets will allow the secure submission of documents in a digital format.

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Q.411 The given passage is

(a) a research paper **(b)** a newspaper report
(c) a survey report **(d)** a personal anecdote

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a newspaper report

Answer: 2 (**a newspaper report**)

Explanation:

The passage presents recent news about the rollout of a new app by the external affairs ministry, includes statements from officials, and reports on the expected benefits—typical features of a newspaper report.

Therefore, the correct answer is **"a newspaper report."**

Q.412 Select the antonym of 'antecedent'.

(a) anterior **(b)** subsequent
(c) prior **(d)** preceding

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) subsequent

Answer: 2 (**subsequent**)

- **Antecedent** means something that comes before or prior.
- **Anterior** and **preceding** also mean before or earlier.
- **Subsequent** means coming after or following, which is the opposite of antecedent.

Therefore, the antonym of **"antecedent"** is **"subsequent."**

Q.413 Which of these is NOT a benefit of the mpassport Police App?

(a) It will reduce the processing time of passport issuance.
(b) It will allow submission of documents in digital format.
(c) It will curtail misuse of the verification process.
(d) It will not require police personnel to visit applicants' homes.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) It will not require police personnel to visit applicants' homes.

Answer: 4 (**It will not require police personnel to visit applicants' homes.**)

Explanation (contd.)

Explanation:

The passage states that the app uses GPS and geo-tagging to confirm that police officials **actually visited the applicant's home**, indicating that home visits are still required.

The other benefits mentioned are:

- Reduction in processing time
- Digital submission of documents
- Curtailing misuse of the process

Therefore, the incorrect statement is:
"It will not require police personnel to visit applicants' homes."

Q.414 The mPassport Police App has been developed by

(a) Ministry of External Affairs
(b) Regional Passport Officer
(c) Ministry of Home Affairs
(d) Special Branch of Delhi Police

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Ministry of External Affairs

Answer: 1 (**Ministry of External Affairs**)

Explanation:

The passage states that the "mPassport Police App" was developed by the **consular, passport and visa division of the external affairs ministry** (Ministry of External Affairs).

Therefore, the correct answer is **Ministry of External Affairs**.

Passage 78 (Q.415–Q.418)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Striking the largest ever deal by one airline took months of secret talks carried out a stone's throw from Britain's Buckingham palace and culminating in a celebration over coastal Indian curries, according to people involved in the talks.

Air India's record aircraft deal has put the Tata Group-owned airline in the league of aspiring global carriers. On Tuesday, it provisionally agreed to acquire almost 500 jets from Airbus and Boeing to take on domestic and international rivals.

The deal was in the making for over a year, insiders said. Serious talks began last summer and continued until days before Christmas when outlines were agreed. As the astonishing scale of the deal began to crystallise, Reuters reported in December the parties were nearing a record 500-plane agreement.

The epicentre of deal making was St James' Court - a luxury Victorian hotel near Buckingham Palace in London's West End.

In the hothouse atmosphere of a classic aircraft industry negotiating ritual known as a 'bake-off', negotiators from the airline, plane-makers and engine-giants camped out at the Tata-owned hotel and neighbouring suites for days at a stretch.

They were chasing a bigger slice of a fast-growing market that has seen many airline growth plans rise and fall.

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Q.415 Name the negotiating ritual of the aircraft industry.

(a) Reuters **(b)** Hothouse
(c) bake- off **(d)** take -off

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) bake- off
Answer: 3 (**bake-off**)
Explanation:
The passage mentions that the negotiating ritual of the aircraft industry is called a **'bake-off'**, where negotiators camp out for days to discuss deals.
Therefore, the correct answer is **"bake-off."**

Q.416 Select the correct meaning of 'a stone's throw'

(a) an insulting act **(b)** a small effort
(c) a close distance **(d)** an easy task

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) a close distance
Answer: 3 (**a close distance**)
Explanation:
The phrase **"a stone's throw"** means a very short or close distance.
Therefore, the correct meaning is **"a close distance."**

Q.417 The epicentre of the aircraft deal was a/an _____.

(a) official residence **(b)** palace
(c) luxurious hotel **(d)** central park

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) luxurious hotel
Answer: 3 (**luxurious hotel**)
Explanation:
The passage states that the epicentre of deal making was **St James' Court**, described as a luxury Victorian hotel near Buckingham Palace.
Therefore, the correct answer is **"luxurious hotel."**

Q.418 Which of these statements is NOT true?

(a) The deal will enable Air India to compete with rivals.
(b) Air India has agreed to acquire around 500 jets from airbus and Boeing.
(c) The negotiations between parties went on for years.
(d) The talks resulted in signing of the largest deal by an airline.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) The negotiations between parties went on for years.
Answer: 3 (**The negotiations between parties went on for years.**)
Explanation:
The passage states that the deal was in the making for over a year, not multiple years.
The other statements are true:

- The deal will help Air India compete with rivals.
- Air India agreed to acquire almost 500 jets from Airbus and Boeing.
- The talks led to the largest ever deal by one airline.

Therefore, the incorrect statement is:
"The negotiations between parties went on for years."

Passage 79 (Q.419–Q.422)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

Coronations have remained much the same for more than 1,000 years. The British ceremony is the only remaining event of its type in Europe.

However, Buckingham Palace has said that although the coronation will be "rooted in long-standing traditions", it will also "reflect the monarch's role today and look towards the future".

It is likely to be shorter and smaller in scale than Queen Elizabeth II's 1953 coronation, with a wider range of religions represented.

The coronation procession is also expected to be more modest. Queen Elizabeth's procession had 16,000 participants, and took 45 minutes to pass any stationary point on the 7km (4.3 miles) route.

This time the King and Queen Consort will travel to Westminster Abbey in the King's procession, and return to Buckingham Palace in a larger coronation procession, where they will be joined by other members of the Royal Family.

There are several stages to the service:

The recognition: While standing beside the Coronation Chair, the monarch is presented to those gathered in the Abbey by the Archbishop of Canterbury. The congregation shouts "God Save the King!", and trumpets sound.

The oath: The sovereign swears to uphold the law and the Church of England

The anointing: The King's ceremonial robe is removed and he sits in the Coronation Chair. A gold cloth is held over the chair to conceal the King from view. The Archbishop of Canterbury anoints the King's hands, breast and head with holy oil made to a secret recipe but known to contain ambergris, orange flowers, roses, jasmine and cinnamon.

The investiture: The sovereign is presented with items including the Royal Orb, representing religious and moral authority; the Sceptre, representing power; and the Sovereign's Sceptre, a rod of gold topped with a white enamelled dove, a symbol of justice and mercy. Finally, the Archbishop places St Edward's Crown on the King's head.

The enthronement and homage: The King leaves the Coronation Chair and moves to the throne. Peers kneel before the monarch to pay homage

The Queen Consort will then be anointed in the same way and crowned.

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Q.419 Which of the following is NOT correct?

(a) The Queen consort is also crowned after the king's coronation.
(b) The Archbishop of Canterbury sings "God Save the King".
(c) The King is anointed with holy oil made from a secret recipe.
(d) The sovereign takes the oath after he is presented to the gathering.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The Archbishop of Canterbury sings "God Save the King".
Answer: 2 (**The Archbishop of Canterbury sings "God Save the King".**)
Explanation:
According to the passage, during the recognition stage, the congregation **shouts "God Save the King!"** and trumpets sound. It does not mention the Archbishop of Canterbury singing this.
The other statements are correct as per the passage:
- The Queen Consort is also crowned after the King.
- The King is anointed with holy oil made from a secret recipe.
- The sovereign takes the oath after being presented to the gathering.

Therefore, the incorrect statement is that the Archbishop sings "God Save the King."

Q.420 In what way will King Charles' coronation be different from Queen Elizabeth II's ?

(a) The coronation procession will be much grander.
(b) The ceremony will be scaled down
(c) It will not follow the old traditions
(d) St Edward's crown will be used for the coronation.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The ceremony will be scaled down
Answer: 2 (**The ceremony will be scaled down**)
Explanation:
The passage mentions that King Charles' coronation is likely to be **shorter and smaller in scale** than Queen Elizabeth II's 1953 coronation. It will still be rooted in long-standing traditions but will reflect the monarch's role today and look towards the future.
Therefore, the correct answer is:
The ceremony will be scaled down.

Q.421 Which of these ceremonies takes place while the sovereign is seated on the coronation chair?

(a) the oath, the recognition
(b) the investiture, the enthronement
(c) the anointing, the investiture
(d) the recognition, the anointing

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) the anointing, the investiture
Answer: 3 (**the anointing, the investiture**)
Explanation:
According to the passage:
- During **the anointing**, the King's ceremonial robe is removed and he sits in the Coronation Chair.

Explanation (contd.)
- During **the investiture**, the sovereign is presented with the Royal Orb, Sceptre, and Sovereign's Sceptre, and the crown is placed on his head—all while seated.

The **recognition** takes place while standing beside the Coronation Chair, and **the enthronement** happens after the King leaves the chair.
Therefore, the ceremonies that take place while seated on the Coronation Chair are **the anointing and the investiture.**

Q.422 What happens during the investiture stage?

(a) The king is presented with the regalia.
(b) The king sits on the throne.
(c) The King swears to uphold the church of England.
(d) The king is hidden from view.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The king is presented with the regalia.
Answer: 1 (**The king is presented with the regalia.**)
Explanation:
During the investiture stage, the sovereign is presented with important ceremonial items including the Royal Orb, the Sceptre, and the Sovereign's Sceptre, symbolizing religious, moral authority, power, justice, and mercy.
Therefore, the correct answer is:
The king is presented with the regalia.

Passage 80 (Q.423–Q.426)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

India's telecom regulator has directed service providers to take corrective measures to improve call quality on an urgent basis and introduce internal quality of service (QoS) monitoring for 5G on a full scale, all-day basis. The directives were issued after the regulator met representatives from Bharti Airtel, Vodafone Idea and Reliance Jio on Friday."Authority has directed TSPs (telecom service providers) to take urgent steps to demonstrate visible improvement in quality of service and quality of experience by consumers. TSPs were asked to analyse the issue of call muting and one way speech and take corrective action on priority. While rolling out 5G network, TSPs should ensure that there is least disturbance or poor quality of service of existing telecom services," TRAI secretary V. Raghunandan said in a statement issued after the meeting with the telecom service providers. The regulator also asked Telcos to plan and implement systems for online data collection for QoS benchmarks and their processing to generate performance reports with licence service area, state level or lower granularity. This will simplify the process of QoS performance reporting by Telcos and reduce the compliance burden. India has been geographically split into 22 licence service areas. Raghunandan said the regulator was closely monitoring the incidences of long duration network outages, that adversely affect the quality of services and consumer experience and asked carriers to report such outages to TRAI in any district or state. "TRAI may consider bringing suitable regulation in this regard, if required," he added.

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Q.423 Why did TRAI meet various service providers?

(a) to make new regulations at state level
(b) to direct them to improve services
(c) to add new licence service areas
(d) to increase customer base

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) to direct them to improve services
Answer: 2 (**to direct them to improve services**)
Explanation:
The passage states that TRAI met service providers to direct them to take urgent steps to improve the quality of service and address issues like call muting and one-way speech.
Therefore, the correct answer is:
to direct them to improve services.

Q.424 Which of these is NOT a problem faced by telecom consumers?

(a) call muting **(b)** compliance
(c) poor call quality **(d)** one way speech

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) compliance
Answer: 2 (**compliance**)
- **Call muting**, **poor call quality**, and **one way speech** are all problems faced by telecom consumers as mentioned in the passage.
- **Compliance** refers to following rules or regulations, which is a concern for the telecom service providers, not the consumers.

Therefore, **compliance** is NOT a problem faced by telecom consumers.

Q.425 Select the correct meaning of the word 'implement'.

(a) to give up **(b)** to prevent
(c) to pay for **(d)** to put into action

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) to put into action
Answer: 4 (**to put into action**)
Explanation:
The word **"implement"** means to put a plan or decision into effect or action.
Therefore, the correct meaning of **"implement"** is **"to put into action."**

Q.426 The passage is mainly about

(a) the demands of the TSPs
(b) the popular service providers- Airtel, Vodafone Idea and Reliance Jio
(c) the close monitoring of network outages by TRAI
(d) the directives from TRAI to the service providers

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the directives from TRAI to the service providers
Answer: 4 (**the directives from TRAI to the service providers**)
Explanation:
The passage focuses on the actions and directives issued by TRAI to telecom service providers to improve call quality, monitor services, and manage outages effectively.

Explanation (contd.)
Therefore, the main theme is **the directives from TRAI to the service providers.**

Passage 81 (Q.427–Q.431)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

The regal period (753–509 BC) and the early republic (509–280 BC) are the most poorly documented periods of Roman history because historical accounts of Rome were not written until much later. Greek historians did not take serious notice of Rome until the Pyrrhic War (280–275 BC), when Rome was completing its conquest of Italy and was fighting against the Greek city of Tarentum in southern Italy. Rome's first native historian, a senator named Quintus Fabius Pictor, lived and wrote even later, during the Second Punic War (218–201 BC). Thus historical writing at Rome did not begin until after Rome had completed its conquest of Italy, had emerged as a major power of the ancient world, and was engaged in a titanic struggle with Carthage for control of the western Mediterranean. Fabius Pictor's history, which began with the city's mythical Trojan ancestry and narrated events up to his own day, established the form of subsequent histories of Rome. During the last 200 years BC, 16 other Romans wrote similarly inclusive narratives. All these works are now collectively termed "the Roman annalistic tradition" because many of them attempted to give a year-by-year (or annalistic) account of Roman affairs for the republic.

Although none of these histories are fully preserved, the first 10 books of Livy, one of Rome's greatest historians, are extant and cover Roman affairs from earliest times to the year 293 BC (extant are also Books 21 to 45 treating the events from 218 BC to 167 BC). Since Livy wrote during the reign of the emperor Augustus (27 BC–AD 14), he was separated by 200 years from Fabius Pictor, who, in turn, had lived long after many of the events his history described. Thus, in writing about early Rome, ancient historians were confronted with great difficulties in ascertaining the truth. They possessed a list of annual magistrates from the beginning of the republic onward (the consular fasti), which formed the chronological framework of their accounts. Religious records and the texts of some laws and treaties provided a bare outline of major events. Ancient historians fleshed out this meagre factual material with both native and Greek folklore. Consequently, over time, historical facts about early Rome often suffered from patriotic or face-saving reinterpretations involving exaggeration of the truth, suppression of embarrassing facts, and invention.

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Q.427 What did the early Roman historians use to fill up details in the historical accounts of events?

(a) Roman and Greek folklore
(b) religious records
(c) texts of laws and treaties
(d) list of annual magistrates

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Roman and Greek folklore
Solution:
The correct answer is: **Roman and Greek folklore**

- The passage states:
  "Ancient historians fleshed out this meagre factual material with both native and Greek folklore."
  This clearly indicates that early Roman historians used **folklore** (both Roman and Greek) to add **narrative details** and **fill in the gaps** in historical accounts.
- While **religious records**, **laws**, and the **list of magistrates** were used for the basic framework, the **actual narrative details** were largely filled using folklore.

Answer: a

Q.428 The passage is mainly about

(a) Rome's first native historian
(b) the ancient Roman and Greek histories
(c) the use of myths and folklore in ancient Roman history
(d) the ancient documentation of Roman history

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the ancient documentation of Roman history
Solution:
The correct answer is: **Option (d) – the ancient documentation of Roman history**

- The **main focus** of the passage is to explain how **early Roman history was recorded**, especially during the regal period and early republic.
- It discusses the **lack of early records**, the **late start of historical writing** (especially by Fabius Pictor), and the **challenges faced by historians** due to the scarcity of reliable sources.
- The passage also elaborates on how historians **filled gaps using folklore and reinterpretation**, leading to **distorted facts** over time.
- While Fabius Pictor and myths are discussed, they are only parts of the broader theme — **how Roman history was documented**.

Thus, **Option (d)** best captures the overall theme of the passage.

Q.429 After reading the passage, it can be inferred that it is an extract from

(a) a news report
(b) an encyclopaedic entry on ancient Rome
(c) a report on Roman conquests
(d) a book on archaeology

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) an encyclopaedic entry on ancient Rome
Solution:

Explanation (contd.)
The correct answer is: **Option (b) – an encyclopaedic entry on ancient Rome**

- The passage provides a **comprehensive, factual, and structured summary** of how Roman history was recorded during early periods.
- It presents **dates, names, historical developments**, and explains terms like *"Roman annalistic tradition"* and *"consular fasti"* in an **objective, academic tone**.
- There is **no journalistic style** (as in a news report), **no focus on military conquests**, and **no archaeological findings discussed**.

Hence, the passage is best described as an **encyclopaedic entry** offering a concise, informative overview of early Roman historical documentation.

Q.430 Which period in ancient Roan history is most poorly documented?

(a) 27 BC- AD 14
(b) 509–280 BC
(c) 218 BC to 167 BC
(d) 218–201 BC

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) 509–280 BC
Solution:
The correct answer is: **509–280 BC**

- According to the passage:
  "The regal period (753–509 BC) and the early republic (509–280 BC) are the most poorly documented periods of Roman history..."
- This is stated clearly in the **first line** of the passage.
- The other periods mentioned (like 218–201 BC and 218–167 BC) were **better documented** and covered by historians like **Fabius Pictor** and **Livy**.

Answer: b

Q.431 "extant are also Books 21 to 45" here the word 'extant' means

(a) partially lost
(b) enlarged
(c) still existing
(d) lost forever

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) still existing
Solution:
The correct answer is: **still existing**

- The word **"extant"** means something that is **still in existence**, especially when referring to historical documents or literature that have **survived** through time.
- In the passage, it says:
  "the first 10 books of Livy... are extant... (extant are also Books 21 to 45...)"
  This clearly means those books **still exist** and are **available today**, unlike other early histories that are **not preserved**.

Answer: c

Passage 82 (Q.432–Q.436)
Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

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Passage (contd.)

A fact that draws our attention is that, according to his position in life, an extravagant man is either admired or loathed. A successful business man does nothing to increase his popularity by being prudent with his money. A person who is wealthy is expected to lead a luxurious life and to be lavish with his hospitality. If he is not so, he is considered mean, and his reputation in business may even suffer in consequence. The paradox remains that he had not been careful with his money in the first place; he would never have achieved his present wealth.

Among the low income group, a different set of values exists. The young clerk, who makes his wife a present of a new dress when he has not paid his house rent, is condemned as extravagant. Carefulness with money to the point of meanness is applauded as a virtue. Nothing in his life is considered more worthy than paying his bills. The ideal wife for such a man separates her housekeeping money into joyless little piles – so much for rent, for food, for the children's shoes, she is able to face the milkman with equanimity every month, satisfied with her economizing ways , and never knows the guilt of buying something she can't really afford .

As for myself, I fall neither of these categories. If I have money to spare I can be extravagant, but when, as is usually the case, I am hard up and then I am the meanest man imaginable.

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Q.432 Select the antonym of 'loathed' as used in the passage.

(a) adored **(b)** shunned
(c) cursed **(d)** despised

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) adored

Solution:

- In the passage, **"loathed"** is used to describe the **strong dislike** or **hatred** felt towards someone.
- An **antonym** (opposite) of **loathed** would be a word that means **loved** or **deeply liked**.
- Among the given options:
  - **adored** = deeply loved → **correct antonym**
  - **shunned** = avoided
  - **cursed** = spoken ill of
  - **despised** = hated

Therefore, the correct answer is: a

Q.433 Which of these can be inferred from the passage?

(a) Extravagance is applauded in some and condemned in others.
(b) Wealthy people are stingy as far as philanthropy is concerned.
(c) For the wealthy, prudence with money is considered a virtue.
(d) People who have a meagre income are expected to be spendthrifts.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Extravagance is applauded in some and condemned in others.

Answer: a
Extravagance is applauded in some and condemned in others.

Solution:

- The passage clearly contrasts how **extravagance** is viewed differently based on **social and economic class**.
- For the **wealthy**, being extravagant is **expected** and being frugal may even damage their **business reputation**.
- For the **lower-income group**, **prudence and carefulness** are considered **virtues**, and extravagance is **condemned**.
- This is summed up in the **first line**:
  "A fact that draws our attention is that, according to his position in life, an extravagant man is either admired or loathed."

Thus, the correct inference is:
a) Extravagance is applauded in some and condemned in others.

Q.434 If a successful businessman is judicious with his money

(a) his popularity rises
(b) his reputation suffers
(c) his business flourishes
(d) his prestige improves

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) his reputation suffers

Solution:

- The passage says:
  "A successful businessman does nothing to increase his popularity by being prudent with his money... If he is not so, he is considered mean, and his reputation in business may even suffer in consequence."
- This clearly indicates that if a successful businessman is **judicious (prudent)** with money, people may **perceive him as mean**, and **his reputation could suffer**.

Therefore, the correct answer is: b

Q.435 The word 'equanimity' in the passage means

(a) agitation **(b)** frustration
(c) tranquillity **(d)** anxiety

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) tranquillity

Solution:

- The sentence in the passage reads:
  *"she is able to face the milkman with **equanimity** every month, satisfied with her economizing ways..."*

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Explanation (contd.)

- This implies that she is able to face him **calmly and confidently**, without distress or guilt, because she has budgeted well.
- Hence, **'equanimity'** here means **calmness, composure, or tranquillity**, especially in a difficult or routine situation.

Correct meaning: tranquillity
Answer: c

Q.436 Which of these is NOT true?

(a) People who lead a luxurious life are expected to entertain lavishly.
(b) The author is at liberty to be extravagant at all times.
(c) The rich amass wealth by spending money economically.
(d) A low-income person is considered worthy if he pays bills on time.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The author is at liberty to be extravagant at all times.
Solution:

- The author clearly states:
  "If I have money to spare I can be extravagant, but when, as is usually the case, I am hard up and then I am the meanest man imaginable."
  This shows that **he is not always at liberty to be extravagant**—only when he has spare money.
- Let's verify other options:
  - **(a)** True: The passage says that a **wealthy person is expected to be lavish** with hospitality.
  - **(c)** True: There's a **paradox** mentioned—wealthy people wouldn't be rich if they hadn't once been careful with their money.
  - **(d)** True: Among the low-income group, **paying bills** is seen as the highest virtue.

Therefore, (b) is NOT true.

Passage 83 (Q.437–Q.441)

Read the following passage and answer the questions given after it.

In the pre-dawn tranquillity of the Andaman Sea, a seismic tremor struck, momentarily agitating the ocean's placid surface. The Andaman and Nicobar Islands, an archipelago in the Bay of Bengal, felt the earth beneath them shudder at 5:50 a.m. on Friday. According to the National Centre for Seismology (NCS), a 4.2 magnitude earthquake occurred at a depth of 10km, its epicentre originating from a seismically active region beneath the sea. No casualties or damages have been reported.

Passage (contd.)

Earthquakes, like the one experienced in the Andaman Sea, are stark reminders of the Earth's ever-shifting tectonic plates. These seismic events result from the sudden release of energy in the Earth's crust, creating seismic waves that cause the ground to shake. The intensity and impact of an earthquake depends on various factors, including its magnitude, depth, and proximity to populated areas. The Andaman and Nicobar Islands are located in a region where several tectonic plates converge, including the Indian Plate, the Burma Plate, and the Sunda Plate. The interaction of these plates leads to frequent earthquakes and volcanic activity. With its 4.2 magnitude, the recent earthquake is considered moderate, but its occurrence in this seismically active region serves as a reminder of the unpredictable and potentially devastating nature of such events.

The NCS, the nodal agency of the Government of India, is responsible for monitoring earthquake activity in the country. Using a network of seismographs, the NCS collects and analyses data from seismic events to provide accurate information to the public and relevant authorities. This data helps scientists understand patterns and trends, leading to a better understanding of earthquake behaviour and potential risks. Earlier this week, Maharashtra's Satara district was also shaken by a 3.3 magnitude earthquake. While these events seem isolated, they form part of a broader pattern of seismic activity across the region. The Andaman and Nicobar Islands have experienced several significant earthquakes in the past, including a 5.8 magnitude earthquake in 2021. The potential consequences of earthquakes can be devastating, causing loss of life and extensive damage to infrastructure. It is therefore vital to have effective early warning systems and disaster management strategies in place.

While the 4.2 magnitude earthquake in the Andaman Sea did not result in any casualties or damages, it underscores the importance of continued investment in earthquake preparedness and resilience measures, particularly in seismically active regions like the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.

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Q.437 When were the tremors felt in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands?

(a) before the sunrise **(b)** after the sunset
(c) at night **(d)** in the afternoon

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) before the sunrise
Solution:

- The passage clearly states:
  "The Andaman and Nicobar Islands... felt the earth beneath them shudder at 5:50 a.m. on Friday."
- Since **5:50 a.m.** is **early morning**, and the phrase **"pre-dawn tranquillity"** also confirms the timing, the tremors were felt **before sunrise**.

Hence, the correct answer is: a. before the sunrise

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Q.438 Which of the following is an odd-man out regarding the tectonic plates in Andaman region?

(a) Sunda Plates **(b)** Satara Plates
(c) Burma Plates **(d)** India Plates

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Satara Plates
Solution:
- According to the passage, **three tectonic plates** converge in the Andaman and Nicobar region:
  - **Indian Plate**
  - **Burma Plate**
  - **Sunda Plate**
- **Satara Plate** is **not** a tectonic plate; in fact, **Satara** is a district in **Maharashtra**, which experienced a **3.3 magnitude earthquake** (also mentioned in the passage), but it is unrelated to tectonic plate names.

Therefore, 'Satara Plates' is the odd-man out.

Q.439 Which of the following is a necessity in Andaman and Nicobar region?

(a) to install early warning systems and have disaster management strategies in place
(b) to make the people aware of the tectonic plates and their impact
(c) to evacuate people from the islands
(d) to collect and analyse data from seismic events

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) to install early warning systems and have disaster management strategies in place
Solution:
- The passage **clearly emphasizes** the need for **preparedness** in seismically active areas like the Andaman and Nicobar Islands.
- It states:
  "It is therefore vital to have effective early warning systems and disaster management strategies in place."
- Other options are either **partial** or **less urgent**:
  - **b**: Awareness is useful but not the primary focus.
  - **c**: Evacuation is not suggested; no threat to life was reported.
  - **d**: Though data collection is mentioned, it's **already being done** by NCS.

Hence, option 'a' is the most appropriate necessity for the region.

Q.440 "it underscores the importance of continued investment in earthquake preparedness' Here 'underscores' means

(a) emphasises **(b)** undermines
(c) extenuate **(d)** mitigates

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) emphasises
Solution:
- The sentence in the passage is:
  "it underscores the importance of continued investment in earthquake preparedness..."
- Here, **"underscores"** means to **highlight or emphasise** the importance of something.

Explanation (contd.)
- The context is that even though the earthquake didn't cause damage, it **emphasises the need** for preparedness.

Therefore, 'underscores' means: a. emphasises

Q.441 Which of the following is NOT one of the themes of the above passage?

(a) unannounced tremors and tangible risks
(b) seismic tremors in Andaman Sea
(c) Loss of life in Andaman and Nicobar
(d) tracking seismic activity

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Loss of life in Andaman and Nicobar
Solution:
- The passage clearly states that **no casualties or damages** were reported from the **4.2 magnitude earthquake** in the Andaman Sea.
- Other themes **do appear**:
  - **a**: Talks about **unannounced tremors** and **potential risks** of seismic zones.
  - **b**: The **central event** is the **earthquake in the Andaman Sea**.
  - **d**: The role of **NCS** and **seismograph tracking** is elaborated in detail.

Thus, 'Loss of life in Andaman and Nicobar' is NOT one of the themes discussed in the passage.

Passage 84 (Q.442–Q.446)

Read the passage and answer the questions that follow.

My path to the house was by no means an easy one. After confused wanderings through tangled hedges, struggling with obstacles that looked strange to me in the surrounding gloom, I arrived in front of a long, low building. There, to my astonishment, I found doors and windows open to the pervading mist, except for one square window through which a light shone from a row of candles on a long mahogany table.

The quiet and apparent emptiness of this odd and picturesque building made me pause. I am not much affected by the appearance of things, but this silent place, with its sinister atmosphere, made me feel uneasy. I was about to reconsider and go back to the road, when a second look at the comfortable interior I was leaving, convinced me that I was being foolish and sent me straight back to the door which stood open so invitingly.

But half-way up the path, my progress was halted by the sight of a man coming out of the house that I had wrongly assumed to be empty. He seemed to be in a hurry and, at the moment when I first saw him, was busy putting his watch back in his pocket. He did not shut the door behind him, which I thought odd, especially as he had been looking behind him. He seemed to take in all the details of the place he was so hurriedly leaving.

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Passage (contd.)
As we met, he raised his hat. This also struck me as unusual, for he displayed more respect than that usually shown to strangers. I was further puzzled that he showed little surprise at bumping into another person in these remote, misty surroundings. Indeed, he was so little impressed by my being there that he nearly passed me without a word or any other hint of greeting, except the raising of his hat. But this did not satisfy me. I was hungry, cold, and eager for creature comforts, and the house before me offered not only warmth, but gave out an inviting smell of food being cooked which was difficult to ignore.
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Q.442 Which of these statements is NOT true?
(a) The stranger was in a hurry to leave the building.
(b) The stranger leaving the house was its owner.
(c) The narrator was seeking food and shelter.
(d) The narrator first contemplated going back to the road.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The stranger leaving the house was its owner.
Solution:
The correct answer is: **The stranger leaving the house was its owner.**
- The passage **does not provide any evidence** that the stranger was the owner of the house. He simply comes out, looks around, and leaves hurriedly.
- In fact, the narrator is puzzled by the stranger's behavior and notes how he **looked behind him** and **left the door open**, which suggests something mysterious rather than ownership.
- All the **other statements are clearly supported** by the passage:
  - The stranger was indeed **in a hurry**.
  - The narrator **contemplated going back** to the road.
  - He was **cold, hungry, and eager for comfort**.

Answer: b

Q.443 The given extract is
(a) a travelogue **(b)** a report
(c) a biography **(d)** a narrative
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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) a narrative
Answer: d
The given extract is a narrative.
Solution:
- A **narrative** is a story or account of events or experiences, whether true or fictitious.
- The passage uses **first-person narration** ("I was...", "my progress was halted..."), indicating a personal story being told by the narrator.
- It describes a **series of events** involving the narrator's arrival at a mysterious house, his interaction with a stranger, and his thoughts and observations, which are all characteristics of a narrative.
- It is **not a travelogue** (which focuses on describing travels and places), **not a biography** (which is the life story of another person), and **not a report** (which is factual and impersonal).

Explanation (contd.)
Answer: d

Q.444 Select the most appropriate meaning of the word 'pervading' as used in the passage.
(a) eerie **(b)** spreading
(c) immortal **(d)** receding
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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) spreading
Answer: b
The most appropriate meaning of the word 'pervading' as used in the passage is *spreading*.
Solution:
- The sentence says: *"I found doors and windows open to the pervading mist..."*
- Here, **"pervading"** is used to describe how the mist is **present everywhere** or **spreading throughout** the area.
- So, **"spreading"** captures the correct sense of something that is **diffusing or penetrating** an area completely.
- The other options are incorrect in context:
  - *Eerie* = strange or frightening – more about mood, not movement.
  - *Immortal* = never dying – unrelated.
  - *Receding* = moving back – opposite of spreading.

Answer: b

Q.445 Why was the narrator shocked when he reached the building?
(a) The doors and windows were open in the misty weather.
(b) The house was gloomy and seemed haunted.
(c) The interiors were inviting despite the ominous atmosphere.
(d) The narrator was welcomed by a stranger.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The doors and windows were open in the misty weather.
Solution:
The correct answer is: **The doors and windows were open in the misty weather.**
- The narrator expresses **astonishment** upon reaching the house and finding that the **doors and windows were open to the pervading mist**, which is unusual and unexpected in such gloomy surroundings.
- This is the **first surprising detail** mentioned after reaching the building and clearly the cause of initial **shock or surprise**.
- The other options, while contextually relevant, are not described as the reason for the narrator's initial **astonishment**.

Q.446 Which of these can be inferred about the narrator?
(a) He was observant. **(b)** He was a coward.
(c) He was thankful. **(d)** He was foolish.
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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) He was observant.
Solution:
The correct answer is: **He was observant.**
- The narrator **notices and describes** many small and specific details:
  - The **open doors and windows**

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Explanation (contd.)

- The **square window with light**
- The **row of candles on a mahogany table**
- The **man's actions**: putting his watch in his pocket, not shutting the door, looking behind, raising his hat
- He even reflects on **how odd or unusual** these details are, showing keen **awareness of surroundings**.
- There is no evidence that he is cowardly, thankful, or foolish—on the contrary, his decision to approach the house is quite rational and calculated.

Answer: a

Passage 85 (Q.447–Q.451)

Read the following passage and answer the questions.

Academics has always been an essential part of human development. It prepares us to survive in the outside world and establish an identity of our own. In India, from an early age we have been taught that education is limited to the boundaries of academics only; the idea of getting out into the field, for gaining practical experience is always considered a hoax. This has hindered students' development.

In the 21st century, the pure academic type of education is slowly paving way for a whole new type. The shift in the whole education system is evident. People have now come to understand that education should focus on students' overall development, rather than restricting him/her to the classroom.

Co-curricular activities that take place outside the classroom help in the growth of the child, in more than one way. Participating in such activities helps youngsters grow mentally, socially and individually. Intellectual development of a student takes place in the classroom, but for the aesthetic development such as team-building, character-building and physical growth, students must step out into the outside world.

Similarly, in colleges and institutions, there is a need for practical exposure so that the students can experience the actual working of an industry. Most professional colleges including B-schools, have started providing practical exposure to students through regular guest lectures, industrial visits, conferences and so on. Guest lectures are very important for all- round development of students as guest speakers talk about their real- life experiences and not what is there in the text books.

Through such events students are made to participate and coordinate different events wherein, they get to know how exactly things are managed. Classroom teaching provides the foundation, and co-curricular or extra-curricular activities provide practical exposure and opportunities to implement what students learn in the classroom. This helps in developing the overall personality of the students, inculcating various soft-skills in them, which otherwise are difficult to teach.

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Q.447 Select the correct meaning of 'implement' as used in the passage.

(a) enforce **(b)** coordinate
(c) commence **(d)** inculcate

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) enforce

Solution:

The relevant sentence from the passage is:

"Classroom teaching provides the foundation, and co-curricular or extra-curricular activities provide practical exposure and opportunities to **implement what students learn in the classroom**."

Here, *implement* means to **put into action or practice** what has been learned — that is, to **enforce or carry out** in real-life scenarios.

- **Enforce** – to put into effect or carry out – correct in this context
- **Coordinate** – to organize or arrange – not the intended meaning
- **Commence** – to begin – doesn't fit here
- **Inculcate** – to instill by persistent instruction – not the meaning of "implement"

Correct answer: a (enforce)

Q.448 What has hindered the development of students?

(a) not gaining practical experience
(b) indulging in co-curricular activities
(c) getting out into the field
(d) expanding academics to the outside world

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) not gaining practical experience

Solution:

The relevant lines from the passage are:

"In India, from an early age we have been taught that education is limited to the boundaries of academics only; the idea of getting out into the field, for gaining practical experience is always considered a hoax. **This has hindered students' development.**"

This clearly implies that **not gaining practical experience** (or the belief that practical experience is not essential) is the reason that **has hindered students' development**.

Correct answer: a (not gaining practical experience)

Q.449 The new education system has shifted focus on

(a) intellectual development
(b) academic development
(c) social and aesthetic development
(d) spiritual development

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) social and aesthetic development

Solution:

To answer this, we need to find what the **new education system** focuses on according to the passage.

From the passage:

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Explanation (contd.)
*"In the 21st century, the pure academic type of education is slowly paving way for a whole new type... education should focus on students' **overall development**, rather than restricting him/her to the classroom."*
*"...for the **aesthetic development** such as **team-building**, **character-building** and **physical growth**, students must step out..."*
This clearly highlights the **shift toward social and aesthetic development**.
Correct answer: c (social and aesthetic development)

Q.450 What is the passage mainly about?

(a) The need to change the education system in 21st century
(b) Preparing students for survival in the real world
(c) Importance of teaching soft skills to students
(d) Participation of students in extra-curricular activities

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Preparing students for survival in the real world
Solution:
The correct answer is **Option (b) – Preparing students for survival in the real world.**

- The passage emphasizes that while academics are important, they are not sufficient by themselves.
- It highlights the importance of **practical experience**, **co-curricular activities**, and **exposure to real-life situations** (like industry visits, guest lectures, etc.).
- These experiences help students **develop holistically**—mentally, socially, and emotionally—and prepare them for challenges outside the classroom.
- Although soft skills and extra-curriculars are mentioned, they are part of a larger goal: **equipping students to survive and thrive in the real world**.

Thus, the passage primarily focuses on how education should prepare students for real-life situations, making **Option (b)** the best choice.

Q.451 Which of these does NOT provide industry exposure to students of business schools?

(a) guest lectures **(b)** text books
(c) industrial visits **(d)** conferences

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) text books
Solution:
To answer this, we need to identify which of the given options **does NOT** provide **industry exposure** to B-school students, according to the passage.
From the passage:
"Most professional colleges including B-schools, have started providing practical exposure to students through regular **guest lectures**, **industrial visits**, **conferences**, and so on. **Guest lectures are very important** for all-round development... as guest speakers talk about real-life experiences and not what is there in the **textbooks**."
Here, *textbooks* are explicitly mentioned as **not** being a source of real-life or industry experience.
Correct answer: b (text books)

Passage 86 (Q.452–Q.456)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Shamsuddin and Ahmed Jallaluddin travelled with me to Ramanathapuram to enroll me in Schwartz High School and to arrange for my boarding there. Somehow, I did not take to the new setting. The town of Ramanathapuram was a thriving, factious town of some fifty thousand people, but the coherence and harmony of Rameswaram was absent. I missed my home and grabbed every opportunity to visit Rameswaram. The pull of educational opportunities at Ramanathapuram was not strong enough to nullify the attraction of poli, a South Indian sweet my mother made. In fact, she used to prepare twelve distinctly different varieties of it, bringing out the flavour of every single ingredient used in the best possible combinations.

Despite my homesickness, I was determined to come to terms with the new environment because I knew my father had invested great hopes in my success. My father visualised me as a Collector in the making and I thought it my duty to realise my father's dream, although I desperately missed the familiarity, security and comforts of Rameswaram. Jallaluddin used to speak to me about the power of positive thinking and I often recalled his words when I felt homesick or dejected. I tried hard to do as he said, which was to strive to control my thoughts and my mind and, through these, to influence my destiny. Ironically, that destiny did not lead me back to Rameswaram, but rather, swept me farther away from the home of my childhood.

Once I settled down at the Schwartz High School, Ramanathapuram, the enthusiastic fifteen-year-old within me re-emerged. My teacher, Iyadurai Solomon, was an ideal guide for an eager young mind that was yet uncertain of the possibilities and alternatives that lay before it. He made his students feel very comfortable in class with his warm and open-minded attitude. He used to say that a good student could learn more from a bad teacher than a poor student from even a skilled teacher.

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Q.452 In the first three paragraphs of the passage, what is the recurring thought in the mind of the author?

(a) The father's expectations of his son
(b) The power of positive thinking
(c) Homesickness and wish to adjust
(d) Joining a new school

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Homesickness and wish to adjust

- The author repeatedly mentions **missing his home**, **feeling homesick**, and the **comforts of Rameswaram**:
  - *"I missed my home and grabbed every opportunity to visit Rameswaram."*
  - *"The pull of educational opportunities... was not strong enough to nullify the attraction of poli..."*
  - *"Although I desperately missed the familiarity, security and comforts of Rameswaram..."*

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Explanation (contd.)

- "*Despite my homesickness, I was determined to come to terms with the new environment...*"

At the same time, he expresses a **determination to adjust**, driven by his father's hopes:

Thus, **homesickness and the desire to adapt** is the central recurring thought in those paragraphs.

Q.453 According to the teacher, Iyadurai Solomon, what was most important for learning?

(a) To be open-minded
(b) To be a good student
(c) A good teacher
(d) To be comfortable in class

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) To be a good student

- The passage states clearly:
  - "*He used to say that a good student could learn more from a bad teacher than a poor student from even a skilled teacher.*"
- This highlights the teacher's belief that **being a good student** is more important than the quality of the teacher.
- Therefore, the most important factor for learning, according to Iyadurai Solomon, is **the learner's attitude and capability**—being a good student.

Q.454 'The town of Ramanathapuram was a thriving, factious town.' Here 'factious' means:

(a) where people were dissatisfied
(b) where people were divided
(c) where people lived in harmony
(d) where people were rich

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) where people were divided

- The word **'factious'** refers to a place or group that is **divided** by internal conflicts or disagreements.
- In the passage, Ramanathapuram is described as a town lacking the **coherence and harmony** that the narrator experienced in Rameswaram.
- Hence, "factious" here suggests **internal division or lack of unity**, not harmony or richness.

So, the correct meaning in context is: **where people were divided**.

Q.455 After reading the given passage it can be inferred that it is an extract from:

(a) a travelogue **(b)** an autobiography
(c) a biography **(d)** an article

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) an autobiography

- The passage is written in the **first person** ("I did not take to the new setting", "I missed my home", "my father had invested great hopes").
- It focuses on **personal experiences**, thoughts, and emotions of the narrator, including:
  - Schooling journey
  - Homesickness

Explanation (contd.)

- Influence of mentors like **Jallaluddin** and **Iyadurai Solomon**
- These are typical characteristics of an **autobiography**, where the author recounts significant events from **their own life**.

Hence, the passage is best identified as **an autobiography**.

Q.456 Which person in the author's life guided him to control his thinking?

(a) Shamsuddin
(b) Jallaluddin
(c) His father
(d) His teacher in the new school

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Jallaluddin

- The passage clearly states:
  "Jallaluddin used to speak to me about the power of positive thinking and I often recalled his words when I felt homesick or dejected."
- He advised the author to *"strive to control my thoughts and my mind and, through these, to influence my destiny."*

This confirms that **Jallaluddin** guided the author in learning to control his thinking.

Passage 87 (Q.457–Q.461)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

The East India Company began trade in Bengal. The first English factory was set up on the banks of the river Hugli in 1651. This was the base from which the Company's traders, known at that time as 'factors', operated. The factory had a warehouse where goods for export were stored, and it had offices where Company officials sat. As trade expanded, the Company persuaded merchants and traders to come and settle near the factory.

By 1696, it began building a fort around the settlement. Two years later, it bribed Mughal officials into giving the Company zamindari rights over three villages. One of these was Kalikata, which later grew into the city of Calcutta or Kolkata as it is known today. It also persuaded the Mughal emperor Aurangzeb to issue a farman granting the Company the right to trade duty free.

The Company tried continuously to press for more concessions and manipulate existing privileges. Aurangzeb's farman, for instance, had granted only the Company the right to trade duty free. But officials of the Company, who were carrying on private trade on the side, were expected to pay duty. This they refused to pay, causing an enormous loss of revenue for Bengal.

How could the Nawab of Bengal, Murshid Quli Khan, not protest? Through the early eighteenth century, the conflict between the Company and the nawabs of Bengal intensified.

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Passage (contd.)
After the death of Aurangzeb, the Bengal nawabs asserted their power and autonomy, as other regional powers were doing at that time. Murshid Quli Khan was followed by Alivardi Khan and then Sirajuddaulah as the Nawab of Bengal. Each one of them was a strong ruler. They refused to grant the Company concessions, demanded large tributes for the Company's right to trade, denied it any right to mint coins, and stopped it from extending its fortifications. Accusing the Company of deceit, they claimed that the Company was depriving the Bengal government of huge amounts of revenue and undermining the authority of the nawab. It was refusing to pay taxes, writing disrespectful letters, and trying to humiliate the nawab and his officials.

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Q.457 Which of the following was the main accusation of the Nawab of Bengal against the East India Company?

(a) It wrote disrespectful letters and humiliated the nawab's officials.
(b) It was extending its fortifications.
(c) It had grabbed the Zamindari of three villages.
(d) It was depriving the Bengal government of huge amounts of revenue by deceitful practices.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) It was depriving the Bengal government of huge amounts of revenue by deceitful practices.

- The passage clearly states:
  "Accusing the Company of deceit, they claimed that the Company was depriving the Bengal government of huge amounts of revenue and undermining the authority of the nawab."
  This was the **central concern** of the Nawabs of Bengal—**financial loss** caused by the Company's misuse of the **duty-free privilege**, especially through **private trade by Company officials** who **refused to pay duties**.
- **Option (a):** While the passage does mention disrespectful behavior, it was **not the main accusation**, but part of a broader pattern.
- **Option (b):** The nawabs **did stop fortification**, but again, this was part of a larger conflict—not the **main grievance**.
- **Option (c):** The zamindari rights were acquired through **bribes to Mughal officials**, but this is not mentioned as a key complaint by the nawabs.

Thus, **Option (d)** best summarizes the **main accusation** by the Nawabs of Bengal.

Q.458 Which of the following statements indicates that some company officials were carrying on dishonest practices for their own benefit?

(a) They bribed the Mughal officials into giving the Company zamindari rights over three villages.
(b) They refused to pay duty to Bengal on their own private trades.
(c) They acquired the right to mint coins.
(d) They tried continuously to press for more concessions.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) They refused to pay duty to Bengal on their own private trades.

- The passage clearly states that **Aurangzeb's farman allowed only the Company (as an institution)** to trade duty-free.
- However, many **Company officials were conducting private trade** for personal profit.
- These officials were **still expected to pay duty** on such private trade but **refused to do so**, causing **loss of revenue** for Bengal.

This refusal to pay taxes on **unauthorized personal trade** is a **direct example of dishonest practice** for individual gain.

Q.459 How did the Mughal emperor Aurangzeb help the East India Company in making its trades profitable?

(a) By gifting the company the zamindari of three villages
(b) By giving the company the rights to trade duty free
(c) By permitting the company officials to trade privately
(d) By allowing the company to fortify its settlement

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) By giving the company the rights to trade duty free

- The passage clearly states:
  "It also persuaded the Mughal emperor Aurangzeb to issue a farman granting the Company the right to trade duty free."
  This **duty-free trade privilege** allowed the East India Company to **avoid paying taxes**, making its trade **highly profitable**.
- **Option (a):** Refers to **zamindari rights**, but that was granted by **Mughal officials through bribery**, not directly by Aurangzeb.
- **Option (c):** The company **officials did trade privately**, but Aurangzeb **did not permit it officially**.
- **Option (d):** The company began building a **fort**, but this was done **after 1696**, and is not linked to Aurangzeb's specific actions.

Thus, **only Option (b)** correctly identifies what Aurangzeb did to aid the company's trade.

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Q.460 The passage is mainly about:

(a) how the East India Company established itself firmly in Bengal
(b) the private trades of company officials in Bengal
(c) the power exerted by the Nawabs of Bengal on the East India Company
(d) the Company's zamindari of three villages in Bengal

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) how the East India Company established itself firmly in Bengal

- The passage provides a **chronological account** of the East India Company's actions in Bengal:
  - **Initial trade setup** (factory on Hugli in 1651)
  - **Expansion** through **fort construction** and **zamindari rights**
  - **Obtaining duty-free trade rights** from Aurangzeb
  - **Exploitation of privileges** through **private trade**
  - **Tensions and conflict** with the Nawabs of Bengal
- Although the conflict with the Nawabs is a **major part**, it supports the central idea—how the Company gradually **strengthened its foothold** in Bengal using trade, manipulation, and political tactics.
- The other options cover **parts** of the passage but **miss the central theme**.

Thus, the passage is **mainly about** the **rise and establishment of the East India Company in Bengal**.

Q.461 Who first protested in Bengal against the corrupt practices of the East India Company?

(a) Alivardi Khan **(b)** Aurangzeb
(c) Murshid Quli Khan **(d)** Sirajuddaulah

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Murshid Quli Khan

- The passage states that **Murshid Quli Khan**, the Nawab of Bengal, **first protested** against the East India Company's **dishonest practices**.
- These included:
  - **Refusal to pay duty** on private trade by Company officials
  - **Loss of revenue** to the Bengal government
- The passage even begins this conflict phase with the line: **"How could the Nawab of Bengal, Murshid Quli Khan, not protest?"**
- This clearly establishes him as the **first major voice of opposition** among the Bengal nawabs against the Company's corrupt trade activities.

Passage 88 (Q.462–Q.466)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Passage (contd.)

According to the recently released All India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE) for the year 2021-22, more women than men have enrolled in higher education in the last eight years. Women account for 55 per cent of the total increase in total enrolment in higher education (91 lakh) since 2014-15. According to the latest survey report, out of the total enrolment of 4.33 crore, 48 per cent or 2.07 crore are women. A small rise of 2.01 crore was observed in female enrolment from 1.88 crore in 2019-20. In 2014-15, out of a total 3.42 crore enrolments, the percentage of women was 46 per cent.

There has been a continuous increase in the enrolment of women since the year 2014-15, the AISHE report stated. Enrolment of women increased by 18.7 per cent during five years, from 2.01 crore in 2020-21 and from 1.74 crore in 2017-18 to 2.07 crore in 2021-22. The report released said, "The share of female enrolment in the increase in total enrolment (91 lakh) since 2014-15 is 55 per cent. There has been more increase in the enrolment of women as compared to men."

Overall, this trend indicates a narrowing gender gap in higher education. Among the areas where women have made their mark is the science stream, in which 52.1 per cent of the total 57.18 lakh students enrolled at the undergraduate, postgraduate, MPhil, and PhD levels are women. About 51 per cent of the total enrolled at the undergraduate level are women in the science stream. In the year 2020-21, as many as 55.48 lakh students took admission to Science, of which 53.1 per cent were women, showing a slight decline.

At the PG level in Science, 61.2 per cent of the 7.52 lakh students enrolled are women. Of the 45,324 students enrolled in PhD programmes in the sciences, more than half (62 per cent) are women, while only 39 per cent are men. The latest AISHE survey showed that the annual growth in female PhD enrolment from 2014-15 to 2021-22 is 10.4 per cent. However, the difference between engineering and technology disciplines is clear. Of the total students enrolled in undergraduate programmes, only 11.3 lakh are females and 27.6 lakh are males.

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Q.462 The given passage is ____.

(a) descriptive **(b)** informative
(c) literary **(d)** narrative

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) informative

The passage presents **data, statistics, and factual information** from the **All India Survey on Higher Education (AISHE)** regarding the **enrolment trends of women in higher education**. It discusses percentages, compares past and current figures, and highlights specific subject areas like science and engineering.

Such a passage that shares facts and insights without opinion or storytelling is best described as **informative**.

Correct classification: informative.

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Q.463 The main theme of the passage is:

(a) increase in male enrolment in postgraduate courses
(b) increase in women enrolment in higher education
(c) increase in total enrolment in higher education
(d) increase in male enrolment in science and technology

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) increase in women enrolment in higher education

The passage primarily discusses:

- The **rise in female enrolment** in higher education over the years (2014–15 to 2021–22),
- Specific figures showing how **women now form 48%** of total enrolment,
- Their strong presence in **science streams** and **PhD programmes**,
- And how this reflects a **narrowing gender gap** in higher education.

It does **not** focus on male enrolment, total enrolment alone, or specific increases in male enrolment in science and tech.

Correct theme: Increase in women enrolment in higher education.

Q.464 A total of how many students enrolled in Science courses at the Post Graduate level?

(a) 45,324 students **(b)** 11.3 lakh students
(c) 57.18 lakh students **(d)** 7.52 lakh students

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) 7.52 lakh students

The passage clearly states:

*"At the PG level in Science, 61.2 per cent of the **7.52 lakh students** enrolled are women."*

This means that the **total number of students enrolled in Science at the PG level** is **7.52 lakh**.

Correct answer: 7.52 lakh students

Q.465 How many women were enrolled in higher education in the year 2017-18?

(a) 2.7 crore **(b)** 1.74 crore
(c) 4.33 crore **(d)** 2.1 crore

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) 1.74 crore

The passage clearly mentions:

"Enrolment of women increased by 18.7 per cent during five years, from **2.01 crore in 2020-21** and from **1.74 crore in 2017-18** to **2.07 crore in 2021-22**."

So, the number of women enrolled in **2017-18** was **1.74 crore**.

Correct option: 1.74 crore

Q.466 It can be inferred from the passage that:

(a) more women students have enrolled in science courses than men
(b) more women students have enrolled in engineering than men
(c) women enrolment declined in the year 2021-22 from that in 2019-20
(d) the gender gap in higher education has widened over the years

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) more women students have enrolled in science courses than men

The passage mentions:

- *"Among the areas where women have made their mark is the science stream, in which **52.1%** of the total 57.18 lakh students enrolled... are women."*
- At the PG and PhD levels too, women have higher percentages (61.2% at PG, 62% at PhD in science).

This shows that **more women students have enrolled in science courses than men**, making **option (a)** correct.

Other options are incorrect because:

- Engineering has **fewer** female students (only 11.3 lakh females vs 27.6 lakh males).
- Women enrolment has **increased** from 1.88 crore in 2019–20 to 2.07 crore in 2021–22.
- The gender gap is **narrowing**, not widening.

Correct inference: More women students have enrolled in science courses than men.

Passage 89 (Q.467–Q.471)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

DEHRADUN: The cultivation of the Dehraduni Basmati rice, renowned for its unique taste and aroma, has witnessed a drastic 62% reduction in the Doon valley in a span of just five years – between 2018 and 2022. A four-year study commissioned by the Uttarakhand Biodiversity Board, whose report came out recently, revealed that in 2018 Dehraduni Basmati was cultivated in 410.1 hectares by 680 farmers, which plummeted to 157.8 hectares by 517 farmers in 2022.

The study adds that 'other basmati varieties, grown in 420.3 hectares of land by 560 farmers, have also come down to 180.7 hectares in 2022'. Factors affecting cultivation include increasing summer temperatures, poor soil fertility, reduced use of farmyard manure, water scarcity for irrigation, changing rain patterns, and extensive use of chemical fertilisers, according to the study.

The grain is noted for its distinctive flavour, akin to sandalwood and flowers, coupled with a slightly sweet taste, which made it stand out among the around 30 basmati varieties found in India.

Farmers cultivating the grain, long cherished for its non-waxy and non-glutinous characteristics, said that the special qualities of the basmati stemmed from a combination of soil, water, climate, and cultural practices, which are now under threat.

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Passage (contd.)

The main area where the rice has been cultivated – Seola-Majra – has transformed into a concrete jungle, lamented a farmer. "Unplanned development has swept away the Dehraduni Basmati from many fields. We could still salvage it in remaining areas if all the anthropogenic concerns are addressed effectively," said Jaswant Negi, a veteran farmer-cum-rice miller from Majra.

The trend of declining Dehraduni Basmati rice cultivation goes back to 1997 when several places like Seolakalan, Brahamanwalaa, Seola Khurd, and Pitthuwala, once cultivating the grain abundantly, began to have shrinking fields. They now have only a few hectares of cultivable land left.

Dhananjai Mohan, Chairman of Uttarakhand Biodiversity Board, said, "Through the study, we identified factors responsible for the dip in cultivable area of the grain. A framework has also been made for promoting Dehraduni basmati among farmers."

Meanwhile, in a ray of hope, a few entrepreneurs are reviving basmati cultivation, especially organic basmati, in parts of Doon and Uttarakhand. "We have earmarked a few acres of land in Vikasnagar on the outskirts of Doon to start with its cultivation," said Devagya Singh, a former Hong Kong resident who has returned to the country, and taken up agriculture.

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Q.467 The passage is mainly about:

(a) the framework for increasing production of Dehraduni Basmati rice

(b) the factors affecting the production of Dehraduni Basmati rice

(c) the declining cultivation of Dehraduni Basmati rice

(d) the revival of cultivation of Dehraduni Basmati rice

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) the declining cultivation of Dehraduni Basmati rice

The central theme of the passage is the **decline in cultivation** of Dehraduni Basmati rice. This is supported by:

- A reported **62% reduction** in area under cultivation (from 410.1 to 157.8 hectares between 2018 and 2022)
- Detailed **reasons** for the decline (e.g., unplanned development, water scarcity, poor soil, etc.)
- Mention of how even traditional cultivation areas have now become concrete jungles

Although revival and frameworks are briefly mentioned, the **main focus** is on the **decline**.

Hence, the passage is **mainly about**:

the declining cultivation of Dehraduni Basmati rice.

Q.468 In 2022, how much area was under cultivation of Dehraduni Basmati rice?

(a) 410.1 hectares **(b)** 420.3 hectares

(c) 180.7 hectares **(d)** 157.8 hectares

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) 157.8 hectares

According to the passage:

Explanation (contd.)

"...in 2018 Dehraduni Basmati was cultivated in **410.1 hectares** by 680 farmers, which **plummeted to 157.8 hectares** by 517 farmers in 2022."

So, in **2022**, the area under cultivation of **Dehraduni Basmati rice** was:

157.8 hectares

This confirms that the correct answer is:

157.8 hectares.

Q.469 Which of the following statements is NOT true according to the passage?

(a) Cultivation of organic variety of Dehraduni Basmati rice is being revived by Dhananjai Mohan.

(b) Dehraduni Basmati rice has a slight sweet taste and a distinct scented flavour, akin to sandalwood and flowers,

(c) Dehraduni Basmati rice is non-waxy and non-glutinous.

(d) The cultivation of Dehraduni Basmati rice started declining way back in 1997 with shrinking fields in major cultivation areas.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Cultivation of organic variety of Dehraduni Basmati rice is being revived by Dhananjai Mohan.

Let's evaluate each statement based on the passage:

- **Statement 1:** *"Cultivation of organic variety of Dehraduni Basmati rice is being revived by Dhananjai Mohan."*
  → **Incorrect** — The passage says that **Devagya Singh**, not **Dhananjai Mohan**, is reviving organic cultivation.
- **Statement 2:** *"Dehraduni Basmati rice has a slight sweet taste and a distinct scented flavour, akin to sandalwood and flowers."*
  → **Correct**, as mentioned in the passage.
- **Statement 3:** *"Dehraduni Basmati rice is non-waxy and non-glutinous."*
  → **Correct**, as stated by the farmers in the passage.
- **Statement 4:** *"The cultivation of Dehraduni Basmati rice started declining way back in 1997 with shrinking fields in major cultivation areas."*
  → **Correct**, as the decline is noted to have begun in 1997.

Thus, the **NOT true** statement is:

Cultivation of organic variety of Dehraduni Basmati rice is being revived by Dhananjai Mohan.

Q.470 Which of the following is the main area where Dehraduni Basmati rice is cultivated?

(a) Brahamanwalaa **(b)** Seola Khurd

(c) Seolakalan **(d)** Seola Majra

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Seola Majra

The passage clearly states:

"The main area where the rice has been cultivated – Seola-Majra – has transformed into a concrete jungle..."

This directly identifies **Seola Majra** as the **main cultivation area** for Dehraduni Basmati rice.

Hence, the correct answer is: **Seola Majra**.

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Q.471 After reading the passage it can be inferred that it is:

(a) a survey report **(b)** an official statement
(c) a news item **(d)** a scientific article

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) a news item

The passage provides current facts, quotes from stakeholders, statistical data from a recent study, expert comments, and a real-time scenario about the decline in Dehraduni Basmati rice cultivation. These are **all features of a news article**.

- It cites a **report** by the Uttarakhand Biodiversity Board, but does **not itself** qualify as a full survey report.
- It includes **quotes** and **perspectives** from farmers and officials, a typical feature of **news reporting**.
- It's **not a scientific article**—there is no structured methodology or data analysis like in academic papers.
- It's **not an official statement**—rather, it reports on findings and views from multiple sources.

Hence, the correct inference is that the passage is a **news item**.

Passage 90 (Q.472–Q.476)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Archaeologists have uncovered two 'exceptional' temples in a major ancient Greek city that changed hands several times over the centuries and whose history stretches back around 2,600 years. The remains of the temples were uncovered at the archaeological site of Paestum, which is located on the western coast of southern Italy in the province of Salerno in the region of Campania, the country's Ministry of Culture announced.

Paestum was an important settlement in Magna Graecia, the name the Romans used to refer to the coastal areas of southern Italy that were inhabited by Greek speakers. These regions had been extensively populated by Greek settlers, starting from around the 8th century BC, Paestum is thought to have been founded around 600 BC by settlers from Sybaris—the most populous city of Magna Graecia. Paestum, which was originally called Poseidonia by the Greeks, thrived for around two centuries before being conquered by the Lucanians—an Italic tribe—in around 400 BC. The settlement subsequently came under Roman rule in 273 BC when it was renamed Paestum. The city eventually went into decline and was finally abandoned during the Middle Ages after being sacked by Muslim raiders in the 9th century. It was largely forgotten before the site was rediscovered in the 18th century.

The archaeological site is renowned for its three remarkably well-preserved ancient Greek temples in the Doric order—an early classical architectural style. These major temples—dedicated to the deities Hera, Athena and Poseidon, respectively—were all built between roughly 550 BC and 450 BC.

Passage (contd.)

The newly uncovered temples, which were also constructed in the Doric style, were unearthed in the western area of the ancient settlement, close to the city walls and located just a few hundred feet from the sea. The latest discovery broadens our understanding of the ancient settlement, as well as the evolution of Doric architecture in Poseidonia and Magna Graecia in general, according to the ministry.

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Q.472 What was Magna Graecia?

(a) An ancient Roman settlement.
(b) The coastal areas of southern Italy inhabited by Greek speakers.
(c) A province where Lucanians—an Italic tribe lived.
(d) A Greek city in Italy.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) The coastal areas of southern Italy inhabited by Greek speakers.

- The passage clearly states:
  "Paestum was an important settlement in Magna Graecia, the name the Romans used to refer to the coastal areas of southern Italy that were inhabited by Greek speakers."
- Therefore, **Magna Graecia** refers to **the coastal areas of southern Italy inhabited by Greek speakers**, not a single city or a Roman settlement.

Q.473 Which of the following questions CANNOT be answered on the basis of the above passage?

(a) To which deities are the newly found temples dedicated?
(b) Which earlier temples were discovered at the same archaeological site?
(c) Where were the two ancient temples unearthed recently?
(d) When was the ancient town of Poseidonia founded and by whom?

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) To which deities are the newly found temples dedicated?

Let's review what is answered and not answered in the passage:

- **Option (a):** *To which deities are the newly found temples dedicated?*
  → **Not answered.** The passage only states that the newly uncovered temples were in **Doric style**, but **does not mention any deities** to whom they were dedicated.
- **Option (b):** *Which earlier temples were discovered at the same archaeological site?*
  → **Answered.** The passage says: *"These major temples—dedicated to the deities Hera, Athena and Poseidon..."*
- **Option (c):** *Where were the two ancient temples unearthed recently?*
  → **Answered.** The passage states: *"...in the western area of the ancient settlement, close to the city walls and located just a few hundred feet from the sea."*
- **Option (d):** *When was the ancient town of Poseidonia founded and by whom?*
  → **Answered.** The passage says: *"Paestum is thought to have been founded around 600 BC by settlers from Sybaris..."*

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Explanation (contd.)
Hence, **Option (a)** is the only one that **cannot** be answered from the passage.

Q.474 Select the correct sequence of events.
a. the city of Poseidonia founded by the Greeks
b. coastal areas of Southern Italy populated by Greek settlers
c. Romans rule the city and call it Paestum
d. the Lucanians—an Italic tribe- conquer the city of Poseidonia
e. the city is abandoned
f. Muslim invaders destroy the city

(a) d c b a e f
(b) a b c e f d
(c) b a d c f e
(d) b a c e d f

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) b a d c f e
Let's break down the correct chronological order based on the passage:

- **(b)** *Coastal areas of Southern Italy populated by Greek settlers → "These regions had been extensively populated by Greek settlers, starting from around the 8th century BC."*
- **(a)** *The city of Poseidonia founded by the Greeks → "Paestum is thought to have been founded around 600 BC by settlers from Sybaris."*
- **(d)** *The Lucanians—an Italic tribe—conquer the city → "... thrived for around two centuries before being conquered by the Lucanians... in around 400 BC."*
- **(c)** *Romans rule the city and call it Paestum → "...came under Roman rule in 273 BC when it was renamed Paestum."*
- **(f)** *Muslim invaders destroy the city → "...abandoned during the Middle Ages after being sacked by Muslim raiders in the 9th century."*
- **(e)** *The city is abandoned → "...finally abandoned during the Middle Ages..."*

Hence, the correct sequence is:
(b) → (a) → (d) → (c) → (f) → (e)

Q.475 The passage is mainly about:

(a) the history of a Greek settlement
(b) the major temples of Poseidonia
(c) the city of Paestum
(d) the recently discovered two ancient temples

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) the recently discovered two ancient temples
Explanation:
While the passage gives a brief history of Paestum (formerly Poseidonia), the **main focus** is on the **recent discovery** of **two exceptional ancient Greek temples**. The opening and closing lines, along with the mention of their **location, architectural style**, and **significance**, point clearly to this being the **central theme** of the passage.

Q.476 Which of the following is the name of a province in Italy?

(a) Salerno
(b) Campania
(c) Paestum
(d) Sybaris

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) Salerno

- The passage states that Paestum is located **"in the province of Salerno in the region of Campania"**.
- Hence, **Salerno** is the **province**, while **Campania** is the **region**.
- **Paestum** is the ancient city and **Sybaris** is the city from which settlers originated.

Therefore, the correct answer is **Salerno**.

Passage 91 (Q.477–Q.481)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Rivers in the heart of the Amazon rainforest in Brazil fell to their lowest levels in over a century on Monday as a record drought upends the lives of hundreds of thousands of people and damages the jungle ecosystem.

The port of Manaus, the region's most populous city, at the meeting of the Rio Negro and the Amazon River, recorded 13.59 metres (44.6 feet) of water on Monday, compared to 17.60 a year ago, according to its website. That is the lowest level since records began in 121 years ago in 1902, passing a previous all-time low set in 2010.

Rapidly drying tributaries to the mighty Amazon have left boats stranded, cutting off food and water supplies to remote villages, while high water temperatures are suspected of killing more than 100 endangered river dolphins.

Some areas of the Amazon have seen the least rain from July to September since 1980, according to the Brazilian government disaster alert centre, Cemaden.

Brazil's Science Ministry blames the drought on the onset of the El Niño climate phenomenon this year, which is driving extreme weather patterns globally. In a statement earlier this month, the ministry said it expects the drought will last until at least December, when El Niño's effects are forecast to peak.

Underlying El Niño is the long-term trend of global warming, which is leading to more frequent and more intense extreme weather events, like drought and heat.

The drought has affected 481,000 people as of Monday, according to the civil defense agency in the state of Amazonas, where Manaus is located.

Late last week, workers from Brazilian NGO Fundação Amazônia Sustentável fanned out across the parched region near Manaus to deliver food and supplies to vulnerable villages. The drought has threatened their access to food, drinking water and medicines, which are usually transported by river.

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Q.477 Which of the following statements is NOT true?

(a) High water temperatures are suspected of killing more than 100 endangered river dolphins.
(b) On Monday, the lowest water level since 1902 in the Amazon river was recorded at 17.60 metres.
(c) Food, drinking water and medicines are delivered to remote villages of the rainforest region by boats.
(d) Port of Manaus is the most populated city of the Amazon rainforest region.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) On Monday, the lowest water level since 1902 in the Amazon river was recorded at 17.60 metres.

Let's check each statement:

- **(a)** *True*: The passage states that high water temperatures are suspected of killing over 100 endangered river dolphins.
- **(b)** *Not true*: The passage states that on Monday, the **water level was 13.59 metres**, not 17.60 metres. 17.60 was the level **a year ago**.
- **(c)** *True*: The passage says that the drought threatened access to food, drinking water, and medicines "**which are usually transported by river**."
- **(d)** *True*: The passage describes Manaus as "**the region's most populous city**."

Thus, statement **(b)** is **NOT true**, making it the correct answer.

Q.478 "workers from Brazilian NGO Fundação Amazônia Sustentável fanned out across the parched region". Here 'fanned out' means:

(a) cooled the area with fans
(b) distributed fans
(c) found fans in the area
(d) spread apart in the area

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) spread apart in the area

The phrase **"fanned out"** is a **phrasal verb** that means **to spread out over a wide area**, especially to cover more ground or search/deliver effectively.

In this context, workers **spread out** across the drought-affected region to deliver supplies to different villages.

Hence, the correct meaning is **(d) spread apart in the area**.

Q.479 After reading the given passage, it can be inferred that it is:

(a) a news report **(b)** a research report
(c) a scientific report **(d)** a survey report

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) a news report

The passage provides **recent information**, **statistics**, and **statements from officials and organizations** about a real event — the Amazon drought. It includes:

- A specific **date and location** (e.g., "on Monday", "Manaus")
- Quotes from **government ministries** and **NGOs**
- Reporting on **impacts to people, wildlife, and the ecosystem**

This style and structure match that of a **news report** — informative and time-sensitive.

Explanation (contd.)

So, the correct answer is **(a) a news report**.

Q.480 Identify the option that arranges the following in the correct sequence.

A. Boats stranded
B. Tributaries dried
C. Food and water supply to remote villages cut off
D. Very less rain in the Amazon region

(a) DBAC **(b)** ABCD
(c) BDAC **(d)** DACB

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) DBAC

Let's determine the logical and chronological order of events from the passage:

1. **D (Very less rain in the Amazon region)**
   → The drought began due to extremely low rainfall (mentioned as the root cause).
2. **B (Tributaries dried)**
   → As a result of the drought, the tributaries began drying up.
3. **A (Boats stranded)**
   → Dried rivers caused boats to become stranded.
4. **C (Food and water supply cut off)**
   → Stranded boats led to supply disruptions to remote villages.

Hence, the correct sequence is: **D → B → A → C**, which matches option **(a) DBAC**.

Q.481 The passage is mainly about:

(a) the damage to the jungle's ecosystem
(b) the El Niño climate phenomenon
(c) the worst drought conditions in Amazon rainforest area
(d) the lives of people living in the rainforest of Amazon

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) the worst drought conditions in Amazon rainforest area

The passage focuses primarily on the **record-breaking drought** in the Amazon rainforest — its **historical severity**, **impact on rivers**, **ecological damage**, and **human suffering**.

While it **mentions** El Niño, the ecosystem, and affected people, these are **secondary details** that support the main point:

The **extreme drought** in the Amazon, its **causes**, and **consequences**.

Therefore, option **(3)** best summarizes the central theme.

Passage 92 (Q.482–Q.486)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

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Passage (contd.)

I had four notes of introduction in London: to Dr. PJ Mehta, to Sjt. Dalpatram Shukla, to Prince Ranjit Singhji and to Dadabhai Naoroji. Someone on board had advised us to put up at the Victoria Hotel in London. Sjt Mazmudar and I accordingly went there. Dr. Mehta, to whom I had wired from Southampton, called at about eight o'clock the same evening. He gave me a hearty greeting. As we were talking, I casually picked up his top-hat, and trying to see how smooth it was, passed my hand over it the wrong way and disturbed the fur. Dr. Mehta looked somewhat angrily at what I was doing and stopped me. But the mischief had been done. The incident was a warning for the future. This was my first lesson in European etiquette, into the details of which Dr. Mehta humorously initiated me. "Do not touch other people's things," he said. "Do not ask questions as we usually do in India on first acquaintance; do not talk loudly; never address people as 'sir' whilst speaking to them as we do in India; only servants and subordinates address their masters that way." And so on and so forth. He also told me that it was very expensive to live in a hotel and recommended that I should live with a private family. We deferred consideration of the matter until Monday.

Sjt. Mazmudar and I found the hotel to be a trying affair. It was also very expensive. There was, however, a Sindhi fellow-passenger from Malta who had become friends with Sjt. Mazmudar, and as he was not a stranger to London, he offered to find rooms for us. We agreed, and on Monday, as soon as we got our baggage, we paid up our bills and went to the rooms rented for us by the Sindhi friend. I remember my hotel bill came to £3, an amount which shocked me. And I had practically starved in spite of this heavy bill! For I could relish nothing. When I did not like one thing, I asked for another, but had to pay for both just the same. The fact is that all this while I had depended on the provisions which I had brought with me from Bombay.

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Q.482 After reading the above passage it can be inferred that it is an extract from:

(a) an article **(b)** an autobiography
(c) a travelogue **(d)** a biography

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) an autobiography

The passage is written in **first person** ("I had four notes of introduction... I remember my hotel bill..."), which clearly shows that the **author is narrating his own experiences** in London.

An **autobiography** is a life account written by the person themselves. Since this text reflects **personal reflections and lessons**, especially with details like cultural etiquette and hotel expenses, it fits the genre of an autobiography.

It is **not**:

- an **article** (which is informative and impersonal),
- a **travelogue** (which focuses more on travel experiences and places),
- or a **biography** (which is written by someone else about a person).

Explanation (contd.)

So, the correct answer is **autobiography**.

Q.483 Who initiated the author in European manners?

(a) Sjt. Dalpatram Shukla **(b)** Dr. PJ Mehta
(c) Dadabhai Naoroji **(d)** Sjt Majumdar

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Dr. PJ Mehta

The passage clearly states:

"This was my first lesson in European etiquette, into the details of which **Dr. Mehta humorously initiated me.**"

This confirms that **Dr. PJ Mehta** was the one who introduced the author to European manners and etiquette.

Q.484 The main theme of the passage is:

(a) the author's early days in London
(b) craving for home food in foreign land
(c) appreciating European etiquette
(d) expensive hotel stay in London

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) the author's early days in London

The passage describes multiple aspects of the author's initial experiences upon arriving in London — including:

- Meeting Dr. Mehta
- Learning about European etiquette
- Struggling with food
- Staying at an expensive hotel
- Finding alternate accommodation with help

These varied experiences are part of the author's **early days in London**, making **option (a)** the most comprehensive and appropriate theme. The other options reflect sub-points, not the central focus.

Q.485 Why did Dr. Mehta get a little irritated with the author?

(a) He asked irrelevant questions.
(b) He touched his hat the wrong way.
(c) He was talking too loudly.
(d) He was late in coming to meet him.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) He touched his hat the wrong way.

The passage states:

"I casually picked up his top-hat, and trying to see how smooth it was, passed my hand over it the wrong way and disturbed the fur. **Dr. Mehta looked somewhat angrily at what I was doing and stopped me.**"

This clearly shows that Dr. Mehta was irritated because the author **handled his hat inappropriately**, disturbing its fur.

So, the correct answer is **(2)**.

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Q.486 How did the Author survive during his first days in London?

(a) He ate at Indian restaurants.
(b) He ordered and ate food at the hotel.
(c) He used the food he had brought from Bombay.
(d) He got food from friends.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) He used the food he had brought from Bombay.
The passage clearly mentions:
"The fact is that all this while **I had depended on the provisions which I had brought with me from Bombay.**"
This indicates that the author **relied on his own food stock** from India during his initial days in London and could not relish hotel food.
Therefore, option **(3)** is the correct answer.

Passage 93 (Q.487–Q.491)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

In 1600, the East India Company acquired a charter from the ruler of England, Queen Elizabeth I, granting it the sole right to trade with the East. This meant that no other trading group in England could compete with the East India Company. With this charter, the Company could venture across the oceans, looking for new lands from which it could buy goods at a cheap price and carry them back to Europe to sell at higher prices.

The Company did not have to fear competition from other English trading companies. Mercantile trading companies in those days made profit primarily by excluding competition, so that they could buy cheap and sell dear. The royal charter, however, could not prevent other European powers from entering the Eastern markets. By the time the first English ships sailed down the west coast of Africa, round the Cape of Good Hope, and crossed the Indian Ocean, the Portuguese had already established their presence in the western coast of India, and had their base in Goa. In fact, it was Vasco da Gama, a Portuguese explorer, who had discovered this sea route to India in 1498. By the early seventeenth century, the Dutch too were exploring the possibilities of trade in the Indian Ocean. Soon the French traders arrived on the scene.The problem was that all the companies were interested in buying the same things. The fine qualities of cotton and silk produced in India had a big market in Europe. Pepper, cloves, cardamom and cinnamon too were in great demand. Competition amongst the European companies inevitably pushed up the prices at which these goods could be purchased, and this

reduced the profits that could be earned. The only way the trading companies could flourish was by eliminating rival competitors. The urge to secure markets, therefore, led to fierce battles between the trading companies.

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Q.487 Which Europeans came first to India to trade?

(a) The Portuguese **(b)** The Dutch
(c) The French **(d)** The English

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The Portuguese
The passage states:
"The Portuguese had already established their presence in the western coast of India, and had their base in Goa. In fact, it was **Vasco da Gama, a Portuguese explorer**, who had discovered this sea route to India in **1498**."
This confirms that the **Portuguese** were the **first Europeans** to arrive in India for trade. The Dutch, English, and French came later.

Q.488 How did Mercantile companies make profit in the 17th century?

(a) They fought wars with other companies.
(b) They eliminated competition to buy cheap goods and sell them at higher prices.
(c) They discovered new countries to trade with.
(d) They traded with the East.

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) They eliminated competition to buy cheap goods and sell them at higher prices.
he passage clearly states:
"Mercantile trading companies in those days made profit primarily by **excluding competition**, so that they could **buy cheap and sell dear**."
This directly matches option **(b)**.

- **(a)** Fighting wars is mentioned later, but not as the **primary profit strategy**.
- **(c)** Discovery is mentioned (e.g., Vasco da Gama), but not as the profit mechanism for mercantile companies.
- **(d)** Trading with the East is true, but again, not the **main way** they made profit.

So, the correct and complete answer is **(b)**.

Q.489 This passage is mainly about:

(a) the discovery of India by Vasco da Gama
(b) the coming of East India Company to India
(c) the elimination of rivals by different companies
(d) the trading mechanism of the foreign companies

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) the coming of East India Company to India
The passage begins with the **charter granted to the East India Company in 1600**, discusses its **rights, objectives, and challenges**, and explains how it encountered **rival European trading companies** like the Portuguese, Dutch, and French.
Although it touches on other elements like Vasco da Gama, competition, and trade goods, the **central theme** revolves around how the **East India Company entered the Indian trade scene** and navigated its early challenges.
Hence, the most appropriate answer is **(b)**.

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Q.490 The charter of 'the sole right to trade with the East' meant for the East India Company that:

(a) among the English companies, only East India Company could trade in the East
(b) the East India Company could trade in certain specified goods only in the East
(c) other English companies could trade in the East along with the East India Company
(d) no other European company except for the East India Company could trade in the East

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) among the English companies, only East India Company could trade in the East

The passage clearly states:

"...**granting it the sole right to trade with the East. This meant that no other trading group in England could compete** with the East India Company."

This shows that the charter **restricted other English companies**, not foreign ones.

- Option **(a)** is correct.
- Option **(b)** is incorrect — there's no mention of restriction to specific goods.
- Option **(c)** contradicts the idea of "sole right."
- Option **(d)** is incorrect — **other European companies** like the Portuguese, Dutch, and French were present.

Thus, **(a)** is the accurate interpretation.

Q.491 What did East India Company do in India to exclude competition with other European companies?
A. Fought fierce battles with them.
B. Bought goods at higher prices than them.

(a) A is true and B is false.
(b) B is true and A is false
(c) Both A and B are true
(d) Both A and B are false

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) A is true and B is false.

The passage clearly states:

"The only way the trading companies could flourish was by **eliminating rival competitors**. The urge to secure markets, therefore, led to **fierce battles between the trading companies**."

So, **A is true**.

It also says:

"Competition amongst the European companies inevitably **pushed up the prices**... and this **reduced the profits** that could be earned."

This shows that **higher prices were a problem**, not a strategy — the East India Company **did not buy at higher prices to beat competitors**.

So, **B is false**.

Hence, the correct answer is: **(a) A is true and B is false**.

Passage 94 (Q.492–Q.496)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Passage (contd.)

New Delhi : Forty-two per cent of children in the age group of 14 to 18 years in rural India cannot read easy sentences in English, while more than half of them struggle with simple division problems, according to the Annual Status of Education Report (ASER) 2023 released on Wednesday.

The ASER 2023 'Beyond Basics' survey was conducted in 28 districts across 26 states, reaching a total of 34,745 youths in the age group 14-18 years. One rural district was surveyed in each major state. The annual report published by the Pratham Foundation found that more than half of the students in the 14-18 age group struggle with division problems.

About 25 per cent of this age group still cannot read a Class 2 level text fluently in their regional language. More than half struggle with division (3-digit by 1-digit) problems. Only 43.3 per cent of 14-18-year olds are able to do such problems correctly. This skill is usually expected in class 3 and 4.

ASER reports are also used by the government while formulating policies. Across enrollment categories, females (76 per cent) do better than males (70.9 per cent) in reading a Class 2 level text in their regional language. In contrast, males do better than their female counterparts in arithmetic and English reading. The report says that around 45 per cent of the students surveyed could calculate the number of hours a child had slept based on the time she went to bed at night and woke up in the morning.

In another everyday task of measuring an object with a scale, 85 per cent of those surveyed could calculate the length of an object correctly if it was placed at the '0' mark on the ruler. But, when the object was moved and placed elsewhere on the ruler, less than 40 per cent could give the right answer. Two-thirds of the surveyed youths (65.1 per cent) were able to read functional instructions on a packet of ORS solution, the report said.

According to the report, low levels of foundational numeracy affect the ability of youth in tackling everyday calculations where they need to apply measurement or use the unitary method in practical situations, or even do simple financial computations (managing a budget, applying a discount or calculating interest rates or repayment of a loan).

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Q.492 According to ASER 2023, how much percentage of 14-18 year olds could divide a three-digit number by a one-digit number correctly?

(a) 25 per cent
(b) 43.3 per cent
(c) 45 per cent
(d) 65.1 per cent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) 43.3 per cent

The passage states:

"Only **43.3 per cent** of 14–18-year-olds are able to do such [3-digit by 1-digit division] problems correctly."

This clearly indicates that **43.3%** is the correct figure for students who could successfully solve simple division problems.

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Q.493 The given passage is:

(a) a press release by Pratham Foundation
(b) a news report about an educational survey
(c) a survey report on rural districts
(d) the executive summary of the Annual Status of Education Report

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) a news report about an educational survey

The passage begins with "**New Delhi:**" and presents findings from the **ASER 2023 report**, including statistics and reactions, in a **journalistic tone**. It summarizes key points **for the general public**, which is characteristic of a **news article**.

It also **mentions the Pratham Foundation** as the publisher of the survey, not the writer of the piece.

Therefore, this is best identified as **a news report about an educational survey**.

Q.494 The survey was conducted mainly to know:

(a) the level of foundational numeracy among the youth
(b) the reading level and numeracy abilities of 14-18 year olds
(c) the reading abilities of Class 3 to 4 children
(d) the simple calculation skills of boys and girls

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) the reading level and numeracy abilities of 14-18 year olds

The passage clearly states that the **ASER 2023 'Beyond Basics' survey** focused on:

"...reaching a total of 34,745 youths in the age group 14–18 years..."

"...found that more than half of the students in the 14–18 age group struggle with division problems..."

"...25 per cent... cannot read a Class 2 level text fluently in their regional language..."

These lines confirm that the **primary purpose** of the survey was to assess both **reading and numeracy skills** of youths aged **14–18 years**, not just numeracy or Class 3–4 reading levels.

Hence, option **(2)** is the most comprehensive and correct answer.

Q.495 How many youths could calculate the length of an object correctly if it was placed at the '0' mark on the ruler?

(a) 85 per cent **(b)** 45 per cent
(c) 40 per cent **(d)** 76 per cent

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) 85 per cent

According to the passage,

"In another everyday task of measuring an object with a scale, **85 per cent** of those surveyed could calculate the length of an object correctly if it was placed at the '0' mark on the ruler."

This clearly confirms that **85 per cent** is the correct value.

Q.496 Which of the following is better done by girls than boys, according to the passage?

(a) Reading simple English sentences
(b) Carrying out a simple division sum
(c) Reading a Class 2 level text in their regional language
(d) Calculating arithmetical problems

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) Reading a Class 2 level text in their regional language

The passage states:

"Across enrollment categories, **females (76 per cent) do better than males (70.9 per cent)** in **reading a Class 2 level text in their regional language**. In contrast, males do better than their female counterparts in arithmetic and English reading."

This clearly shows that **girls outperform boys** in regional language reading, but not in arithmetic or English.

Passage 95 (Q.497–Q.501)

Read the given passage and answer the questions that follow.

Rock paintings, which could be four to six thousand years old, have been discovered in a pre-historic cave in the Berinag sub-division of Uttarakhand's Pithoragarh district, an Archaeological Survey of India (ASI) official said.

Eleven human figures, both men and women, can be seen in the cave paintings, the official said.

"The rock paintings seem over four to six thousand years old like the ones first discovered in the Lakhu Udiyar pre-historic caves near Almora in the year 1965," regional archaeological officer in Almora, Chandra Singh Chauhan said.

This is the first cave with rock paintings to be found in the Pithoragarh district, he said.

"Nine such caves in Almora, one in Nainital and three in Garhwal region have been found earlier. They bear testimony to the presence of humans in the Himalayan region in pre-historic times," Chauhan said.

Chauhan said he has received pictures of the rock paintings in the newly discovered cave and will soon visit it to gather more information about them. The cave and the paintings on its walls were discovered by Tarun Mehra, a young adventure tourism entrepreneur.

During a rock climbing expedition, Mehra and his team saw a tunnel-like structure and went inside it out of curiosity.

"When we went inside the cave after discovering it on a hill near PG college Berinag, we were surprised to see rock paintings on its walls in various colours," Mehra said.

A cup mark has also been spotted some 20 feet up the hill, he said. A wild animal has also been depicted below the paintings of the 11 humans on the wall, Mehra said.

"Presence of wide space inside the cave also indicates that it was used by pre-historic human groups as their habitation", he said.

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Q.497 What shows that the cave discovered in Pithoragarh was also used as living space by prehistoric human groups?

(a) The presence of wide space in the cave
(b) The presence of rock paintings in the cave
(c) The paintings of human beings
(d) A cup mark

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Explanation — Correct answer: (a) The presence of wide space in the cave

- The passage clearly states: *"Presence of wide space inside the cave also indicates that it was used by pre-historic human groups as their habitation,"* – directly confirming **option (a)** as the correct answer.
- **(b)** Presence of rock paintings shows artistic activity but does not directly confirm habitation.
- **(c)** Paintings of humans indicate depiction, not necessarily living use.
- **(d)** The cup mark is noted as a feature, not as evidence of habitation.

Correct Answer: (a) The presence of wide space in the cave

Q.498 Which of the following is NOT a part of the paintings found in the cave in Pithoragarh?

(a) Male figures **(b)** Cup mark
(c) Female figures **(d)** Wild animal

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Explanation — Correct answer: (b) Cup mark

The passage clearly describes the elements present in the cave paintings found in Pithoragarh, including **eleven human figures**—both male and female—and a **depiction of a wild animal** below these figures. Although a **cup mark** is mentioned in the passage, it is stated to be found "**some 20 feet up the hill**," not within the cave or on the walls containing the paintings. This indicates that while the cup mark is part of the broader archaeological site, it is **not a part of the paintings** found **inside the cave**. Hence, the correct choice for what is **not part of the cave paintings** is:

- (a) Male figures – mentioned as part of the cave paintings
- (b) Cup mark – **not** part of the paintings, found outside the cave
- (c) Female figures – mentioned in the description of the paintings
- (d) Wild animal – explicitly stated as being depicted below the human figures in the cave painting

Q.499 Where were the first caves found with paintings in Uttarakhand?

(a) Nainital **(b)** Garhwal
(c) Pithoragarh **(d)** Almora

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Explanation — Correct answer: (d) Almora

According to the passage, the first caves with rock paintings in Uttarakhand were discovered in **Lakhu Udiyar near Almora** in 1965. This reference is given early in the text, where it compares the newly found cave's paintings with those earlier ones in Almora. The mention of **"like the ones first discovered in the Lakhu Udiyar pre-historic caves near Almora in the year 1965"** clearly establishes **Almora** as the location of the earliest such discovery in the state.

Q.500 The passage is mainly about:

(a) the caves found in Almora, Nainital and Garhwal regions
(b) the rock- climbing expedition of Tarun Mehra
(c) the discovery of prehistoric rock paintings in a cave in Pithoragarh
(d) the prehistoric human beings in Himalayan regions

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) the discovery of prehistoric rock paintings in a cave in Pithoragarh

The passage focuses primarily on the **new discovery of prehistoric rock paintings** in a cave located in the **Berinag sub-division of Pithoragarh**, Uttarakhand. While it does reference earlier discoveries in Almora, Nainital, and Garhwal for context, the central theme revolves around:

- The **age** and **uniqueness** of these paintings
- The **details of the discovery** by Tarun Mehra and his team
- The **archaeological significance** as confirmed by officials

Thus, the main idea is best captured by the third option: **the discovery of prehistoric rock paintings in a cave in Pithoragarh**.

Q.501 Identify the option that arranges the following events in the correct sequence.
a. Finding a tunnel.
b. Discovering a cup mark on the hill
c. Exploring the cave
d. Climbing the rocks near the PG College, Berinag
e. Discovering the colourful rock paintings

(a) d c b a e **(b)** a c e d b
(c) d a c e b **(d)** b d c e a

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Explanation — Correct answer: (c) d a c e b

The correct sequence of events as per the passage is:

- **(d) Climbing the rocks near the PG College, Berinag** – Mehra and his team were on a rock-climbing expedition.
- **(a) Finding a tunnel** – They noticed a tunnel-like structure on the hill.
- **(c) Exploring the cave** – Out of curiosity, they entered the tunnel which turned out to be a cave.
- **(e) Discovering the colourful rock paintings** – Inside the cave, they saw rock paintings in various colours.
- **(b) Discovering a cup mark on the hill** – Separately, a cup mark was noticed some 20 feet up the hill.

This timeline aligns with the sequence described in the passage, where the cup mark is mentioned **after** their cave exploration and **outside** the cave. Thus, the correct order is:

- **d → a → c → e → b**

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